

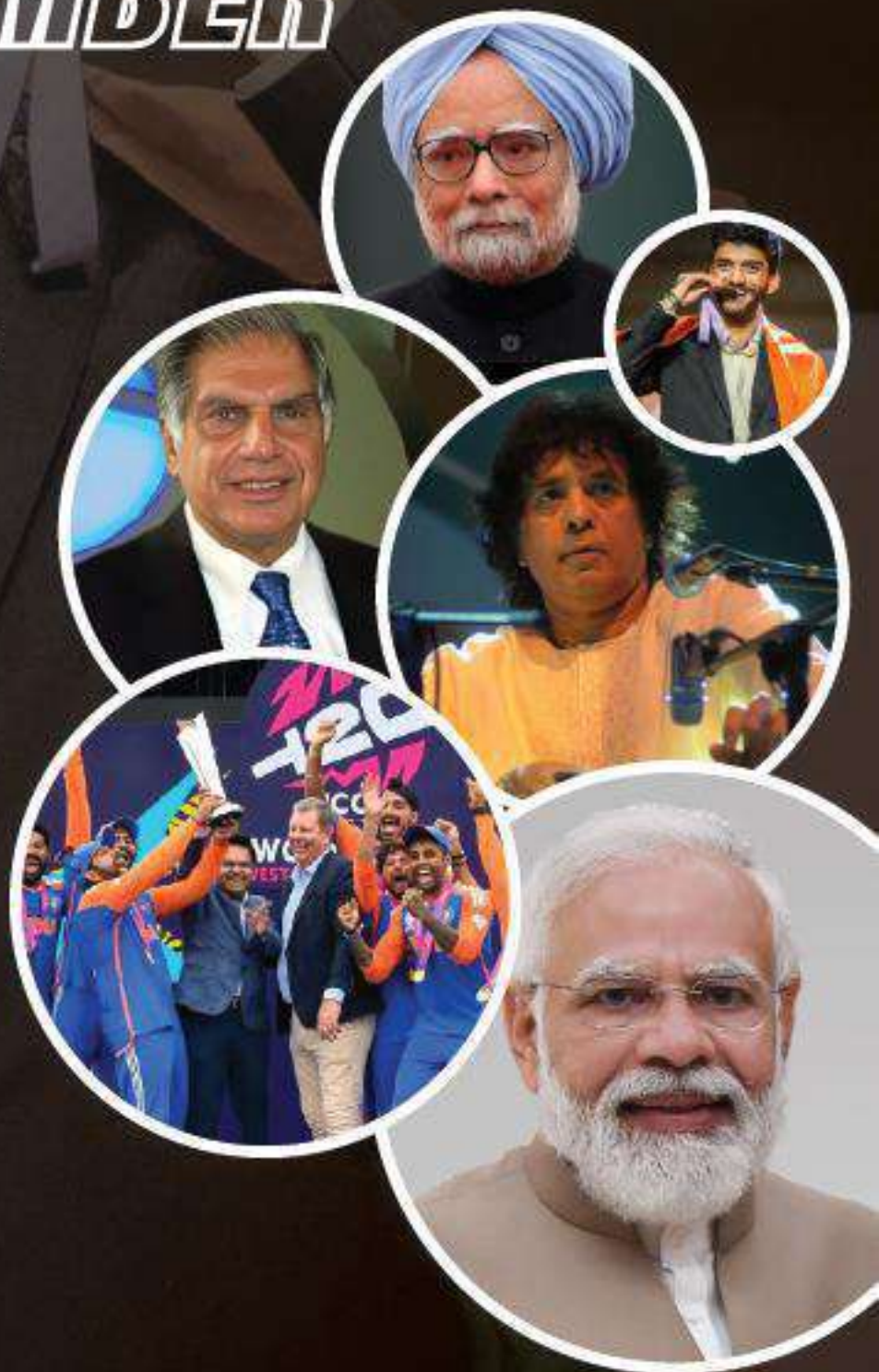
YEARBOOK 2025

JANUARY TO DECEMBER 2024

USEFUL FOR
ALL COMPETITIVE
EXAM

TOPIC COVERED

- **G7 Summit 2024**
- **Budget 2024-25**
- **Economic Survey 2023-24**
- **Paris 2024 Olympics**
- **Nobel Prize 2024**
- **BRICS Summit 2024**
- **G20 Summit 2024**
- **Monetary Policy 2024**
- **Padma Awards 2024**
- **Oscars 2024**
- **T20 World Cup 2024**



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Most Important Current Affairs

January to December 2024

Most Important Current Affairs of January 2024

Golden Globes Awards 2024: Here is the full list of winners

The **81st Golden Globe Awards** are set to be presented in a lavish event at **The Beverly Hilton in Beverly Hills, California, USA**. This year's ceremony is anticipated to be highlighted by **Greta Gerwig's widely popular film Barbie** and **Christopher Nolan's hit movie Oppenheimer**. Barbie is at the forefront with nine nominations, including Best Picture Musical or Comedy, and acting nods for Margot Robbie and Ryan Gosling, along with three nominations for its original songs.

Here's the complete list of Golden Globes Awards 2024

Category	Winner
Best Film – Drama	Oppenheimer
Best Actress – Drama	Lily Gladstone, Killers of the Flower Moon
Best Film – Musical or Comedy	Poor Things
Best Actor – Musical or Comedy	Paul Giamatti, The Holdovers
Best TV Series – Drama	Succession
Best Actress in a TV Series – Drama	Sarah Snook, Succession
Best TV Series – Musical or Comedy	The Bear
Best Limited Series, Anthology Series or TV Movie	Beef
Cinematic and Box Office Achievement	Barbie
Best Original Song	What Was I Made For? by Billie Eilish and Finneas (Barbie)
Best Original Score	Ludwig Göransson, Oppenheimer
Best Actor – Drama	Cillian Murphy, Oppenheimer
Best Actress – Musical or Comedy	Emma Stone, Poor Things
Best Director	Christopher Nolan, Oppenheimer
Best Animated Film	The Boy and the Heron
Best Actor in a TV Series – Drama	Kieran Culkin, Succession
Best Actress in a TV Series – Musical or Comedy	Ayo Edebiri, The Bear
Best Non-English Language Film	Anatomy of a Fall
Best Performance in Stand-Up Comedy on TV	Ricky Gervais, Ricky Gervais Armageddon

Category	Winner
Best Actor in a TV Series – Musical or Comedy	Jeremy Allen White, The Bear
Best Screenplay	Justine Triet and Arthur Harari, Anatomy of a Fall
Best Supporting Actor in a TV Series	Matthew Macfadyen, Succession
Best Supporting Actress in a TV Series	Elizabeth Debicki, The Crown
Best Actor in a Limited Series, Anthology Series or TV Movie	Steven Yeun, Beef
Best Actress in a Limited Series, Anthology Series or TV Movie	Ali Wong, Beef
Best Supporting Actor	Robert Downey Jr, Oppenheimer
Best Supporting Actress	Da'Vine Joy Randolph, The Holdovers

Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports Announced the National Sports Awards 2023

The **Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports** announced the **National Sports Awards 2023**, honouring individuals and institutions that have excelled in their respective fields. The awards ceremony, held at Rashtrapati Bhavan, witnessed the presentation of various awards to sportspersons, coaches, and entities for their outstanding contributions to sports in the country.

Full list of National Sports Awards 2023

Here is the complete list of winners who got National Sports Awards, for his/her remarkable contribution to their respective sports:

Name	Sport
Mohammed Shami	Cricket
Pawan Sehrawat	Kabaddi
Ritu Negi	Kabaddi
Vaishali Rameshbabu	Chess
Murali Sreeshankar	Athletics
Parul Chaudhary	Athletics
Krishan Bahadur Pathak	Hockey
Sushila Chanu	Hockey
Sunil Kumar	Wrestling
Antim Panghal	Wrestling
Aditi Gopichand Swami	Archery
Ojas Pravin Deotale	Archery
Ayhika Mukherjee	Table Tennis
Mohammad Hussamuddin	Boxing

Name	Sport
Esha Singh	Shooting
Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar	Shooting
Naorem Roshibina Devi	Wushu
Diksha Dagar	Golf
Harinder Pal Sandhu	Squash
Sheetal Devi	Para-Archery
Anush Agarwalla	Equestrian
Divyakriti Singh	Equestrian Dressage
Nasreen Shaikh	Kho-Kho
Pinki Singh	Lawn bowls
Illuri Ajay Kumar Reddy	Blind cricket
Prachi Yadav	Para Canoeing

Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award:

- Satwik Sairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty (badminton)

Dronacharya Award for Outstanding Coaches in Sports and Games 2023:

- Ganesh Prabhakaran (mallakhamb), Mahavir Saini (para athletics), Lalit Kumar (wrestling), RB Ramesh (chess), Shivendra Singh (hockey).

Dhyan Chand Lifetime Award

- Kavita (kabaddi), Manjusha Kanwar (badminton), Vineet Kumar Sharma (hockey).

Maulana Abul Kalam Azad (MAKA) Trophy 2023:

- Guru Nanak Dev University, Amritsar (winner),
- Lovely Professional University, Punjab (1st runners-up),
- Kurukshetra University, Kurukshetra (2nd runners-up).

Emmys Awards 2024, Complete List Of Winners

Here's the complete List of Emmys Awards 2024

Category	Winner(s)
Drama Series	Succession
Comedy Series	The Bear
Lead Actress in a Drama Series	Sarah Snook (Succession)
Lead Actor in a Drama Series	Kieran Culkin (Succession)
Limited or Anthology Series	Beef
Lead Actress in a Limited or Anthology Series or Movie	Ali Wong (Beef)
Lead Actor in a Limited or Anthology Series or Movie	Steven Yeun (Beef)
Variety Special (Live)	Elton John Live: Farewell from Dodger Stadium
Directing for a Drama Series	Mark Mylod (Succession)
Writing for a Limited or Anthology Series or Movie	Lee Sung Jin (Beef)

Category	Winner(s)
Writing for a Drama Series	Jesse Armstrong (Succession)
Supporting Actor in a Limited or Anthology Series or Movie	Paul Walter Hauser (Black Bird)
Directing for a Limited or Anthology Series or Movie	Lee Sung Jin (Beef)
Talk Series	The Daily Show With Trevor Noah
Writing for a Variety Series	Last Week Tonight With John Oliver
Outstanding Competition Program	RuPaul's Drag Race
Writing for a Comedy Series	Christopher Storer (The Bear)
Directing for a Comedy Series	Christopher Storer (The Bear)
Supporting Actress in a Limited or Anthology Series or Movie	Niecy Nash-Betts (Monster: The Jeffrey Dahmer Story)
Scripted Variety Series	Last Week Tonight With John Oliver
Lead Actor in a Comedy Series	Jeremy Allen White (The Bear)
Supporting Actor in a Comedy Series	Ebon Moss-Bachrach (The Bear)
Supporting Actor in a Drama Series	Matthew Macfadyen (Succession)
Supporting Actress in a Drama Series	Jennifer Coolidge (The White Lotus)
Lead Actress in a Comedy Series	Quinta Brunson (Abbott Elementary)
Supporting Actress in a Comedy Series	Ayo Edebiri (The Bear)

EAM S. Jaishankar Boosts India-Nepal Relations in Two-Day Visit

In a diplomatic triumph, India's External Affairs Minister (EAM) S. Jaishankar concluded his two-day visit to Nepal, solidifying ties through various initiatives and agreements. The pivotal event of the visit was the **7th India-Nepal Joint Commission meeting**, culminating in a landmark accord for India to import **10,000 MW of hydroelectricity** from Nepal over the next decade.

1. Key Agreements

- The 7th India-Nepal Joint Commission meeting resulted in a significant pact: India will import 10,000 MW of hydroelectricity from Nepal over the next decade.

2. Reconstruction Aid

- India announced a financial package of **Nepali Rs 1,000 crore (USD 75 million)** for rebuilding infrastructure in areas affected by the 2015 earthquake.

- Inaugurated jointly by Jaishankar and Nepal's N P Saud, post-quake reconstruction projects include schools, health facilities, and cultural heritage sites.

3. Transformative Ties

- Jaishankar highlighted the transformation in India-Nepal relations, emphasizing connectivity in physical, digital, and energy realms as a foundation for collaboration.
- Tribhuvan University Central Library in Kathmandu was inaugurated, symbolizing strengthened people-to-people linkages.

4. Shared Responsibilities

- EAM Jaishankar emphasized the shared responsibilities in building ties and commended India's post-2015 earthquake efforts, including funding for 50,000 houses.

5. Treaty Review

- Both sides reviewed various aspects of bilateral relations, including the **1950 Treaty of Peace and Friendship**, security matters, and boundary-related issues.

6. The 'HIT' Formula

- Referring to PM Modi's 2014 visit, Jaishankar recalled the 'HIT' formula for India-Nepal relations: **Highways, Iways (Information ways), and Transways (Connectivity)**.

7. Power Trade Agreement

- A long-term power trade agreement was signed, aiming to increase Nepal's power export to India to 10,000 MW within the next 10 years. Currently, Nepal's electricity capacity is around 2,600 MW.

Abu Dhabi's First Temple Inaugurated by PM Modi on 14 Feb

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurates another significant temple on February 14 in **Abu Dhabi**. The **BAPS Hindu Mandir**, located in the capital's Abu Mureikha area, marks the first Hindu temple in the UAE and is anticipated to be one of the largest and most exquisite Hindu temples outside of India, as well as the largest in West Asia.

Background and Diplomatic Significance

During PM Modi's first visit to the **UAE in 2015**, the country allocated land in **Abu Dhabi for the construction of a Hindu temple**. This visit held diplomatic importance, making Modi the first Indian Prime Minister in 34 years to visit the strategic Gulf nation. The temple project was inaugurated by the PM in February 2018, and construction commenced in December 2019.

BAPS Hindu Mandir Details

- Location: Abu Dhabi's Abu Mureikha area.
- Size and Cost: Built on over 5.4 hectares at a cost of Rs 700 crore.

- Architecture: Incorporates intricately designed pink sandstone and marble façade with seven spires representing each of the Emirates of the UAE.
- Materials Used: 40,000 cubic meters of marble, 1,80,000 cubic meters of sandstone, and over 1.8 million bricks.
- Facilities: The complex includes a large amphitheatre, a gallery, a library, a food court, a majlis, two community halls accommodating 5,000 people, gardens, and children's play areas.

BAPS Hindu Mandir Design and Inspiration

- The temple's design draws inspiration from Vedic architecture and sculptures.
- Artisans in India crafted many statues and carvings, shipped to Abu Dhabi.

BAPS Organization:

- Full Form: **Bochasanwasi Shri Akshar Purushottam Swaminarayan Sanstha (BAPS)**.
- Roots: A socio-spiritual Hindu faith rooted in the Vedas, pioneered by Bhagwan Swaminarayan in the late 1700s.
- Establishment: Formally established in **1907 by Shastriji Maharaj (1865-1951)**.
- Global Presence: BAPS claims to operate over 3,850 centers worldwide, including 1,100 temples.
- Notable Project: BAPS was behind the construction of Akshardham in Robbinsville, New Jersey, the world's largest Hindu temple outside of India.

Akshardham Mahamandir (Robbinsville, New Jersey)

- Size: Spans 185 acres and stands at 191 feet high.
- Construction: Used 1.9 million cubic feet of stone from 29 different sites worldwide, including Bulgaria, Italy, Greece, Turkey, and India.
- Affiliation: Akshardham temples in Delhi and Gujarat are also run by BAPS.

PM Modi Inaugurates ₹1,156 Crore Projects in Lakshadweep

In a significant development, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** inaugurated projects worth ₹1,156 crore during his visit to the Lakshadweep islands. Among these projects is the **Kochi-Lakshadweep Islands Submarine Optical Fibre Cable**, a ₹1,072-crore initiative providing 100 Gbps internet connectivity to the islands.

Enhancing Connectivity and Internet Speeds

The undersea cable link, executed by Japanese firm NEC and laid by BSNL, promises 100 times faster internet for the residents of Lakshadweep. Covering 1,868 kilometers, it connects **Kavaratti, Agatti, Amini, Kadmat, Chetlet, Kalpeni, Minicoy, Androth, Kiltan, Bangaram, and Bitra**. This initiative allows telecom companies to offer 4G, 5G, and high-speed broadband for the first time in the archipelago.

Multi-Faceted Development Initiatives

Apart from the internet cable, other projects include a thermal desalination plant, tap connections under Jan Jeevan Mission, a solar power plant, and the headquarters of Indian Reserve Battalion. The PM also laid the foundation for healthcare facility renovation and Nand Ghar model Anganwadis on different islands.

Empowering Youth through Education and Infrastructure

Highlighting the absence of higher education institutions in the past, PM Modi emphasized recent steps to address this issue. Initiatives include launching educational institutions for arts and science on Andrott and Kadmat islands and a Polytechnic College in Minicoy. The PM also distributed laptops to college students, bicycles to girl school students, Kisan Credit Cards, and PMJAY Cards, showcasing a holistic approach towards the socio-economic development of Lakshadweep.

PM Modi Launched PRITHVI VIGYAN Scheme worth nearly 4,800 crore rupees

The Indian government, under the leadership of Prime Minister **Shri Narendra Modi**, has launched an ambitious initiative named **PRITHVI (PRITHVi Vigyan)**, a comprehensive scheme by the **Ministry of Earth Sciences**. With a significant budget of **Rs. 4,797 crore**, the program spans from 2021-26, marking a new era in the study and understanding of Earth sciences in India.

Objectives of PRITHVI Scheme

The PRITHVI scheme aims to revolutionize our understanding and interaction with various Earth systems. Its objectives include:

- **Long-Term Observations:** Strengthening the continuous monitoring of the Earth's atmosphere, oceans, geosphere, cryosphere, and solid earth to track and record essential changes.
- **Model Development:** Creating advanced models for better forecasting of weather, oceanic, and climatic hazards, and deepening the understanding of climate change.
- **Polar and Oceanic Exploration:** Venturing into the unexplored polar regions and high seas to discover new phenomena and resources.
- **Technology Advancement:** Innovating technologies for the sustainable exploitation of oceanic resources, benefiting society.
- **Knowledge Translation:** Converting scientific insights into practical services for societal, environmental, and economic advantages.

The Role of the Ministry of Earth Sciences

The Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) plays a pivotal role in this initiative, translating scientific knowledge into valuable services for society. These services encompass:

- Weather forecasts and warnings.
- Alerts for natural disasters like cyclones, floods, and tsunamis.
- Earthquake monitoring and more.

The MoES's work in this regard has been instrumental in saving lives and reducing property damage during natural disasters.

Prithiv Scheme: Operational and Research Framework

The MoES conducts its research and operational activities through ten esteemed institutes, including:

- India Meteorological Department (IMD)
- National Centre for Medium Range Weather Forecasting (NCMRWF)
- Centre for Marine Living Resources and Ecology (CMLRE)

And others

These institutes work in tandem, supported by a fleet of research vessels, to conduct ground-breaking research and provide essential services.

Earth System Sciences: A Multidisciplinary Approach

Earth System Sciences encompass the comprehensive study of the Earth's atmosphere, hydrosphere, geosphere, cryosphere, and biosphere. MoES's PRITHVI scheme takes a holistic approach to these disciplines, integrating their complex interactions for a deeper understanding of Earth sciences.

The Impact of PRITHVI

PRITHVI promises to unify various disciplines under Earth sciences, fostering integrated, multidisciplinary research. This collaborative effort aims to address significant challenges in weather, climate, oceanography, cryospheric studies, seismology, and sustainable resource utilization.

In conclusion, the PRITHVI scheme represents a significant leap forward in the realm of Earth sciences in India. It not only enhances our understanding of Earth's complex systems but also ensures that this knowledge is transformed into practical applications for societal benefit. With its comprehensive approach and robust framework, PRITHVI is set to make a lasting impact on how we interact with and understand our planet.

Six Nations Top Global Passport Ranking, With Access To 194 Destinations

In a significant development, **France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Singapore, and Spain** share the **top spot** in the quarterly ranking of the world's most powerful passports. Enjoying visa-free or visa-on-arrival access to an impressive **194 destinations**, this marks a **historic high since the inception of the Henley Passport Index 19 years ago**.

Triumphant Rise of Europe: Second and Third Positions

Japan and Singapore, holding the top position for the past five years, now see a triumphant rise for Europe. **Finland and Sweden**, tied with South Korea, secure the second spot with easy access to 193 destinations. Following closely, Austria, Denmark, Ireland, and the Netherlands claim the third position, providing access to 192 destinations.

Global Passport Rankings: Fourth and Fifth Positions

The fourth position is collectively held by **Belgium, Luxembourg, Norway, Portugal, and the United Kingdom**, with access to 193 destinations. **Greece, Malta, and Switzerland** secure the fifth spot.

Noteworthy Improvements: Australia, New Zealand, Czechia, and Poland

Australia and New Zealand have advanced their standings, now sharing the sixth position with **Czechia and Poland**. The **United States and Canada**, along with **Hungary**, are tied in seventh place, boasting visa-free access to 188 destinations.

India's Passport Ranking in 2024: Position 80 with Access to 62 Countries

India secures the 80th position, with visa-free access to 62 countries. The global passport landscape showcases varying degrees of accessibility, highlighting the significance of diplomatic relations and international cooperation.

World's Most Powerful Passports for 2024: A Snapshot

The ranking underscores the evolving dynamics of global travel and the importance of diplomatic ties in facilitating international mobility.

Rank	Countries	Destinations
1	France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Singapore, Spain	194
2	Finland, South Korea, Sweden	193
3	Austria, Denmark, Ireland, Netherlands	192
4	Belgium, Luxembourg, Norway, Portugal, United Kingdom	193
5	Greece, Malta, Switzerland	190
6	Czech Republic, New Zealand, Poland	189
7	Canada, Hungary, United States	188
8	Estonia, Lithuania	187
9	Latvia, Slovakia, Slovenia	186
10	Iceland	185

The ranking underscores the evolving dynamics of global travel and the importance of diplomatic ties in facilitating international mobility.

Swachh Survekshan Awards 2023: Indore and Surat Share Cleanest City Title

In a prestigious ceremony hosted by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA), the **Swachh Survekshan Awards 2023** witnessed President Droupadi Murmu conferring accolades to 13 distinguished awardees across various cleanliness categories.

Cleanest City Title: Indore and Surat Joint Winners

Indore, for the remarkable seventh consecutive time, secured the cleanest city title. However, this year, it shared the honors with Surat, marking a unique joint victory. The President, Smt. Droupadi Murmu, presented the awards at the Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.

Top Performers in Other Categories

- **Cities with Population under 1 Lakh:** Sasvad, Patan, and Lonavala claimed the top three spots.
- **Cleanest Cantonment Board:** Mhow Cantonment Board in Madhya Pradesh emerged as the top performer.
- **Cleanest Ganga Towns:** Varanasi and Prayagraj received recognition as the best and cleanest Ganga towns.
- **Best Performing States:** Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, and Chhattisgarh secured the top three awards for their outstanding performance.
- **Safaimitra Surakshit Sheher:** Chandigarh received the award for the Best Safaimitra Surakshit Sheher.

Swachh Survekshan 2023 Highlights

- The President launched the **Swachh Survekshan 2023 dashboard** during the ceremony.
- A total of 110 awards were bestowed, celebrating excellence in cleanliness initiatives.
- The theme for the Cleanliness Survey 2024 is **"Reduce, Reuse, and Recycle."**
- The ceremony was attended by Union Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Hardeep Singh Puri and other dignitaries.



Key Statistics and Achievements

- Data revealed that 4,447 urban local bodies participated in Swachh Survekshan 2023, making it the world's largest cleanliness survey.
- The survey received an impressive 12 core citizen responses, reflecting widespread public engagement.

US Leads 2024 Military Rankings, India Fourth, Bhutan Ranks Lowest

The **Global Firepower's Military Strength Rankings for 2024** offer a comprehensive assessment of military capabilities worldwide. The rankings, encompassing 145 countries, take into account more than 60 factors, including troop numbers, military equipment, financial stability, geographic location, and available resources. The culmination of these factors results in a PowerIndex score, providing a nuanced perspective on global military strength.

Top 10 Most Powerful Militaries

The top 10 countries with the most powerful militaries in the world, according to Global Firepower's rankings for 2024, are as follows:

Sno.	Country	Power Index
1	United States	0.0699
2	Russia	0.0702
3	China	0.0706
4	India	0.1023
5	South Korea	0.1416
6	United Kingdom	0.1443
7	Japan	0.1601
8	Turkey	0.1697
9	Pakistan	0.1711
10	Italy	0.1863

These rankings reflect the culmination of various factors, showcasing the strengths and capabilities of each nation's military.

10 Countries with the Least Powerful Militaries

In contrast, the report also highlights the countries with the least powerful militaries, emphasizing the diversity of global military capabilities. The bottom 10 countries in the rankings for 2024 are:

Sno.	Country
145	Bhutan
144	Moldova
143	Suriname
142	Somalia
141	Benin
140	Liberia

Sno.	Country
139	Belize
138	Sierra Leone
137	Central African Republic
136	Iceland

Understanding the challenges these nations face and the factors contributing to their lower military rankings provides insight into the complex dynamics of global security.

The Best FIFA Football Awards 2024

The **Best FIFA Football Awards 2024** recognized the most exceptional talents in football. Lionel Messi and Aitana Bonmati emerged as the best players, with several others receiving prestigious honours. The ceremony, held in London, celebrated players, coaches, and teams for their achievements in the 2023 season.

The Best FIFA Football Awards 2024: Key Winners and Highlights

1. Men's Player of the Year: Lionel Messi

- Lionel Messi, playing for Argentina and Inter Miami, won the Best FIFA Men's Player award, edging out Erling Haaland in a tiebreaker.
- Messi and Haaland both scored 48 points, but Messi received more points from national captains.
- Messi is the first footballer to win this award three times.

2. Women's Player of the Year: Aitana Bonmati

- Aitana Bonmati, from Barcelona and the Spanish national team, claimed the Best FIFA Women's Player award.
- Bonmati had an extraordinary year, winning the World Cup, Spanish League, Spanish Super Cup, and the Champions League with Barcelona.
- She made history by winning all the titles she contested in a season and being voted the best player in all of them.

3. Men's Coach of the Year: Pep Guardiola

- Pep Guardiola, the coach of Manchester City, was named the Best Men's Coach.
- Under his leadership, Manchester City achieved a historic treble, including their first Champions League.

4. Women's Coach of the Year: Sarina Wiegman

- England coach Sarina Wiegman received the women's best coach award, tying the record for most wins in this category.

5. Men's and Women's Goalkeeper of the Year: Ederson and Mary Earps

- Ederson, from Manchester City and Brazil, was awarded the Best Men's Goalkeeper.
- Mary Earps, representing Manchester United and England, won the Best Women's Goalkeeper award.

6. FIFA Puskas Award: Guilherme Madrugá

- Guilherme Madrugá, from Botafogo-SP, won the FIFA Puskas Award 2023 for his spectacular overhead kick.

7. FIFA Special and Fair Play Awards

- Brazilian football legend Marta received The FIFA Special Award.
- The Brazil men's national team earned the FIFA Fair Play award for their stand against racism.

8. FIFA Fan Award

- The FIFA Fan Award 2023 went to Argentinian fan Hugo Daniel "Toto" Iniguez.

FIFA FIFPro World 11s

Men's World XI:

- Goalkeeper: Thibaut Courtois (Real Madrid/Belgium)
- Defenders: Kyle Walker, Ruben Dias, John Stones (all Manchester City)
- Midfielders and Forwards: Bernardo Silva, Kevin De Bruyne (Manchester City), Jude Bellingham (Real Madrid), Lionel Messi (Inter Miami), Erling Haaland (Manchester City), Kylian Mbappe (Paris Saint-Germain), Vinicius Jr (Real Madrid).

Women's World XI:

- Goalkeeper: Mary Earps (Manchester United/England)
- Defenders: Olga Carmona (Real Madrid), Lucy Bronze (Barcelona), Alex Greenwood (Manchester City)
- Midfielders: Kiera Walsh (Barcelona), Alessia Russo (Arsenal), Lauren James (Chelsea).

PM Modi Unveils Ram Mandir Stamps: A Historic Moment in Indian Culture

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** recently launched a series of **commemorative postage stamps** dedicated to **Ayodhya's Ram Temple**, marking a significant cultural event in India. This gesture not only honours the Ram Temple but also emphasizes the international appeal of Lord Ram across various societies.

Overview of the Commemorative Stamps

Design and Elements

- The collection comprises six distinct stamps, each featuring key figures and symbols associated with Lord Ram's narrative, including the **Ram Temple, Lord Ganesh, Lord Hanuman, Jatayu, Kevatray, and Ma Shabri**.
- The designs incorporate essential elements related to Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Mandir, showcasing the temple, the revered **Choupai 'Mangal Bhavan Amangal Hari,' the sun, the Saryu River**, and the sculptures in and around the temple.

- Each stamp is adorned with gold leaf detailing for the sun rays and the Choupai, adding a majestic touch.

Global Appeal

- The launch includes a 48-page book featuring stamps issued by over 20 countries, such as the **US, New Zealand, Singapore, Canada, Cambodia, and organizations like the United Nations**.
- This collection is intended to showcase Lord Ram's global popularity and influence across different societies.

Cultural Significance

- The stamps reflect the five physical elements of nature — **sky, air, fire, earth, and water, known as 'Panchabhutas.'**
- These designs establish harmony and are symbolic of the universal principles that Lord Ram represents.

Ram Mandir: A Symbol of Faith and Unity

- The Ram Mandir, located in Ayodhya, holds immense religious and cultural significance in India. The temple is dedicated to Lord Ram, a major deity in Hinduism and a central figure in the Indian epic Ramayana. The construction and consecration of the Ram Mandir have been long-awaited events, celebrated by millions across the nation and the world.

Pran Pratishtha Ceremony

- The Pran Pratishtha (consecration) ceremony of the Ram Mandir is a monumental event, with **Prime Minister Narendra Modi as the chief guest**.
- Over 7,000 attendees, including politicians, celebrities, industrialists, and saints, are expected to participate in this historic ceremony.

Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2024, Full List Of Winners

Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2024

The **Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2024** was declared, with the awards set to be presented by President Droupadi Murmu at a formal event at Vigyan Bhawan in New Delhi on January 22.

This year, 19 children from various parts of the country have been recognized for their outstanding accomplishments. The Ministry of Women and Child Development revealed that Prime Minister Narendra Modi will engage with the recipients on January 23. Additionally, these children will be featured in the Republic Day parade on January 26, 2024.

Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2024, Full List Of Winners

The Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar awardees include one child each in the fields of Bravery, Science & Technology, and Innovation; four in Social Service; five in Sports; and seven in Art and Culture. The group, as per the Ministry's press release, consists of 9 boys and 10 girls from 18 different States and Union Territories.

Sr. No.	Name	State	Category
1	Aaditya Vijay Bramhane (posthumous)	Maharashtra	Bravery
2	Anushka Pathak	Uttar Pradesh	Art & Culture
3	Arijeet Banerjee	West Bengal	Art & Culture
4	Armaan Ubhrani	Chattisgarh	Art & Culture
5	Hetvi Kantibhai Khimsuriya	Gujarat	Art & Culture
6	Ishfaq Hamid	Jammu & Kashmir	Art & Culture
7	Md Hussain	Bihar	Art & Culture
8	Pendyala Laxmi Priya	Telangana	Art & Culture
9	Suhani Chauhan	Delhi	Innovation
10	Aryan Singh	Rajasthan	Science & Technology
11	Avnish Tiwari	Madhya Pradesh	Social Service
12	Garima	Haryana	Social Service
13	Jyotsna Aktar	Tripura	Social Service
14	Saiyam Mazumder	Assam	Social Service
15	Aaditya Yadav	Uttar Pradesh	Sports
16	Charvi A	Karnataka	Sports
17	Jesicca Neyi Saring	Arunachal Pradesh	Sports
18	Linthoi Chanambam	Manipur	Sports
19	R Surya Prasad	Andhra Pradesh	Sports

Ayodhya Ram Mandir Inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi

On January 22, 2024, Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **Ram Mandir in Ayodhya**, marking a momentous occasion in India's history. The inauguration involved the 'Pran Pratishtha' (consecration) ceremony of the Ram Lalla idol, a pivotal event that symbolizes the infusion of life into the idol. The event, attended by over 7,000 dignitaries, was not just a religious ceremony but also a cultural milestone for India.

Prime Minister's Participation

Prime Minister Modi's involvement was central to the ceremony. He participated in the 'Pran Pratishtha' of the Ram Lalla idol from 12:29:03 pm to 12:30:35 pm, a brief but highly auspicious 84-second window during the '**Abhijit muhurta**'. His visit to Ayodhya spanned nearly four hours, filled with various activities and rituals associated with the inauguration.

The Ram Lalla Idol and Temple Complex

The Ram Lalla idol, crafted by renowned sculptor Arun Yogiraj from Karnataka, is a 51-inch black-coloured depiction of Lord

Ram as a five-year-old child. It was installed inside the temple's sanctum sanctorum on January 18 as part of the preparatory rituals. The temple itself, an architectural marvel, stands at a length of **380 feet**, a **width of 250 feet**, and a **height of 161 feet**, embodying the traditional Nagara style of architecture.

Comprehensive Security and Celebrations

Ayodhya was transformed into a secure and festive zone. An extensive security network, including AI-powered drones and 13,000 security personnel, was deployed. The city was adorned with flowers and lights, echoing with slogans and verses from the Ramayana. The celebrations extended beyond Ayodhya, with people from different states contributing various gifts and offerings.

ICC Awards 2023, Check the Awardee's Name

The **ICC Awards 2023**, organized by the **International Cricket Council**, represents the pinnacle of recognition for international cricket players. These prestigious awards celebrate the extraordinary talents and achievements of cricketers from around the world. This year's ceremony saw a range of players being honoured for their exceptional performances across various formats of the game.

The ICC Awards 2023 witnessed a diverse group of cricketers being acknowledged for their outstanding contributions to the sport.

Here are all the winners of ICC Awards 2023:

ICC Men's Cricketer of the Year

- Australia skipper **Pat Cummins** was announced as the winner of the **Sir Garfield Sobers Trophy for the ICC Men's Cricketer of the Year 2023**. The inspirational captain had a stellar run with the bat and ball, and garnered remarkable team accolades, including a victory in the ICC World Test Championship Final, retention of the Ashes, and a record sixth triumph in the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2023.

ICC Men's ODI Cricketer of the Year 2023

- Veteran Indian batter **Virat Kohli** was crowned the **ICC Men's ODI Cricketer of the Year 2023** for his exceptional year in the 50-over format. Player of the tournament at the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2023, Virat Kohli was announced as the ICC Men's ODI Cricketer of the Year 2023. The Indian batter had a superb year with the bat, culminating in a record tally of runs at the home World Cup, where his contributions played a major part in India's run to the final.

ICC Men's Test Cricketer of the Year 2023

- Usman Khawaja** was named as the ICC Men's Test Cricketer of the Year 2023. Khawaja edged out tough competition from teammate Travis Head, India spinner Ravichandran Ashwin, and England's Joe Root for the award following a successful year that culminated in Australia claiming their first ICC World Test Championship title. He scored 1210 runs in 13 Tests in the year.

Rachael Heyhoe Flint Award for ICC Women's Cricketer of the Year 2023

- England's all-rounder **Nat Sciver-Brunt** took home the Award for the second year in a row. 2023 was yet another remarkable year for Sciver-Brunt, with some of her exceptional knocks coming during the home Ashes against Australia.

ICC Women's ODI Cricketer of the Year 2023

- Chamari Athapaththu**, already leading the Women's T20I and ODI sides of the year, added another feather to her cap by winning this feat. Athapaththu was rewarded for her exceptional year with the bat in ODIs. The Sri Lanka top-order batter made significant contributions with the bat and as captain, notably leading the side to a first bilateral series win over New Zealand.

ICC Men's Associate Cricketer of the Year 2023

- Bas de Leede** was named as the **ICC Men's Associate Cricketer of the Year 2023** for his remarkable all-round run in the year. He was the standout player for the Netherlands at the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2023 Qualifier and the World Cup in India.

ICC Women's Associate Cricketer of the Year 2023

- Queentor Abel** made Kenya proud by winning the ICC Women's Associate Cricketer of the Year for 2023. She picked 30 T20I wickets at an unreal average of 7.36, and scored 476 T20I runs at 34.

ICC Men's T20I Cricketer of the Year 2023

- For the second successive year, **India's T20I beast Suryakumar Yadav** has been awarded the ICC Men's T20I Cricketer of the Year award. With his eclectic mix of shots, Suryakumar dominated 2023 with an average that closed in on 50 and a strike rate exceeding 150. The backbone of India's middle order got starts throughout the year, delivering several match-winning contributions.

ICC Women's T20I Cricketer of the Year 2023

- Hayley Matthews** became just the second player from the West Indies to win the honour. Former skipper Stafanie Taylor was the previous cricketer to have won this award in 2015. Matthews added to her reputation with some sensational knocks with the bat and her sharp work with the ball. Her very best came against Australia in Australia.

ICC Men's Emerging Cricketer of the Year 2023

- Rachin Ravindra** beat South Africa quick Gerald Coetzee, Sri Lanka pacer Dilshan Madushanka, and India batter Yashasvi Jaiswal for the prized award. He had an amazing ICC Men's Cricket World Cup in India where he amassed a whopping 578 runs.

ICC Women's Emerging Cricketer of the Year 2023

- Litchfield edged out Bangladesh teenager **Marufa Akter**, England quick Lauren Bell and Scotland all-rounder

Darcey Carter for the coveted award on the back of a remarkable 12 months at the top of Australia's strong batting order.

Republic Day 2024, Date, Theme, History and Significance

Republic Day in India is celebrated every year on **January 26th** to commemorate the day when the Constitution of India came into effect in **1950**, replacing the **Government of India Act (1935)**. This day marks India's emergence as a sovereign, democratic republic. The **75th Republic Day** in 2024 holds a special place in the hearts of Indians as it symbolizes the journey of the nation from colonial rule to an independent, vibrant democracy.

Republic Day 2024 Theme

The themes for Republic Day 2024, "**Viksit Bharat**" (**Developed India**) and "**Bharat – Loktantra ki Matruka**" (**India – Mother of Democracy**), encapsulate the aspirations and democratic ethos of the nation.

Republic Day 2024 Chief Guest

For the Republic Day 2024 celebrations, the guest of honour is **Emmanuel Macron**, the President of France. This significant day will be marked with various patriotic events, including an impressive parade and a vivid showcase of India's cultural richness. The occasion is set to honour India's unity, diversity, and development remarkably and memorably.

History of Republic Day

The origins of Republic Day go back to India's fight for independence from British colonialism. After gaining independence on **August 15, 1947**, India was governed by the **Government of India Act, of 1935**, and did not have its constitution. Under the leadership of **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar**, a committed committee was formed to draft the constitution. This effort culminated in the adoption of the Constitution of India on **January 26, 1950**, marking a **pivotal shift as India emerged as a sovereign, socialist, secular, and democratic republic**.



Significance of Republic Day

Republic Day is significant as it represents the true spirit of independent India. It is a day to remember the sacrifices of freedom fighters and the struggles of the Indian independence movement. It also serves as a reminder of the commitment to uphold the values enshrined in the Constitution, including unity, integrity, and diversity. Republic Day stands as a source of pride for Indians worldwide, symbolizing the end of the struggle for independence and the establishment of a self-governing nation. It serves as a tribute to the democratic principles enshrined in the Constitution, guiding the nation forward. Moreover, Republic Day showcases India's cultural richness and unity in diversity through grand celebrations in New Delhi.

Republic Day Celebrations

The main event of Republic Day is the grand parade held in the capital, **New Delhi, at Rajpath**, showcasing India's military

might and cultural diversity. The parade includes a display of advanced military equipment, vibrant cultural tableaux from various states, and performances by school children. The celebration also features prestigious bravery and civilian awards like the **Ashok Chakra and Padma Awards**.

Padma Awards 2024 Winners List, Padma Awardees

Padma Awards 2024: The Padma Awards, among India's highest civilian honours, are given in three categories: **Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, and Padma Shri**. These awards recognize outstanding service in various areas like arts, social work, public affairs, science, trade, medicine, education, sports, and civil service. The Padma Vibhushan is for exceptional service, the Padma Bhushan is for high-order service, and the Padma Shri is for distinguished service in any area. These awards are announced on Republic Day each year.

Padma Awards 2024: Padma Vibhushan Awards 2024 Winners List

S.No.	Awardee Name	Field	State
1.	Ms. Vyjayantimala Bali	Art	Tamil Nadu
2.	Shri Konidela Chiranjeevi	Art	Andhra Pradesh
3.	Shri M Venkaiah Naidu	Public Affairs	Andhra Pradesh
4.	Shri Bindeshwar Pathak	Social Work	Bihar
5.	Ms. Padma Subrahmanyam	Art	Tamil Nadu

Padma Awards 2024- Detailed List of Padma Bhushan Awardees 2024

S.No.	Awardee Name	Field	State/Country
1.	Ms. M Fathima Beevi	Public Affairs	Kerala
2.	Shri Hormusji N Cama	Literature & Education	Maharashtra
3.	Shri Mithun Chakraborty	Art	West Bengal
4.	Shri Sitaram Jindal	Trade & Industry	Karnataka
5.	Shri Young Liu	Trade & Industry	Taiwan
6.	Shri Ashwin Balachand Mehta	Medicine	Maharashtra
7.	Shri Satyabrata Mookherjee	Public Affairs	West Bengal
8.	Shri Ram Naik	Public Affairs	Maharashtra
9.	Shri Tejas Madhusudan Patel	Medicine	Gujarat
10.	Shri Olanchery Rajagopal	Public Affairs	Kerala
11.	Shri Dattatray Ambadas Mayaloo alias Rajdutt	Art	Maharashtra
12.	Shri Togdan Rinpoche	Others – Spiritualism	Ladakh
13.	Shri Pyarelal Sharma	Art	Maharashtra
14.	Shri Chandreshwar Prasad Thakur	Medicine	Bihar
15.	Ms. Usha Uthup	Art	West Bengal
16.	Shri Vijaykanth	Art	Tamil Nadu
17.	Shri Kundan Vyas	Literature & Education – Journalism	Maharashtra

Padma Awards 2024- Padma Shri Awardees 2024 Name List

SN	Name	Field	State/Region/Country
1	Shri Khalil Ahamad	Art	Uttar Pradesh
2	Shri Badrappan M	Art	Tamil Nadu
3	Shri Kaluram Bamaniya	Art	Madhya Pradesh
4	Ms. Rezwana Choudhury Bannya	Art	Bangladesh
5	Ms. Naseem Bano	Art	Uttar Pradesh
6	Shri Ramlal Bareth	Art	Chhattisgarh
7	Ms. Gita Roy Barman	Art	West Bengal
8	Ms. Parbati Baruah	Social Work	Assam
9	Shri Sarbeswar Basumatary	Others – Agriculture	Assam
10	Shri Som Datt Battu	Art	Himachal Pradesh
11	Ms. Takdira Begum	Art	West Bengal
12	Shri Sathyanarayana Beleri	Others – Agriculture	Kerala
13	Shri Drona Bhuyan	Art	Assam
14	Shri Ashok Kumar Biswas	Art	Bihar
15	Shri Rohan Machanda Bopanna	Sports	Karnataka
16	Ms. Smriti Rekha Chakma	Art	Tripura
17	Shri Narayan Chakraborty	Science & Engineering	West Bengal
18	Shri A Velu Ananda Chari	Art	Telangana
19	Shri Ram Chet Chaudhary	Science & Engineering	Uttar Pradesh
20	Ms. K Chellammal	Others – Agriculture	Andaman & Nicobar Islands
21	Ms. Joshna Chinappa	Sports	Tamil Nadu
22	Ms. Charlotte Chopin	Others – Yoga	France
23	Shri Raghuveer Choudhary	Literature & Education	Gujarat
24	Shri Joe D Cruz	Literature & Education	Tamil Nadu
25	Shri Ghulam Nabi Dar	Art	Jammu & Kashmir
26	Shri Chitta Ranjan Debbarma	Others – Spiritualism	Tripura
27	Shri Uday Vishwanath Deshpande	Sports	Maharashtra
28	Ms. Prema Dhanraj	Medicine	Karnataka
29	Shri Radha Krishan Dhiman	Medicine	Uttar Pradesh
30	Shri Manohar Krishana Dole	Medicine	Maharashtra
31	Shri Pierre Sylvain Filliozat	Literature & Education	France
32	Shri Mahabir Singh Guddu	Art	Haryana
33	Ms. Anupama Hoskere	Art	Karnataka
34	Shri Yazdi Maneksha Italia	Medicine	Gujarat
35	Shri Rajaram Jain	Literature & Education	Uttar Pradesh
36	Shri Jankilal	Art	Rajasthan

SN	Name	Field	State/Region/Country
37	Shri Ratan Kahar	Art	West Bengal
38	Shri Yashwant Singh Kathoch	Literature & Education	Uttarakhand
39	Shri Zahir I Kazi	Literature & Education	Maharashtra
40	Shri Gaurav Khanna	Sports	Uttar Pradesh
41	Shri Surendra Kishore	Literature & Education – Journalism	Bihar
42	Shri Dasari Kondappa	Art	Telangana
43	Shri Sridhar Makam Krishnamurthy	Literature & Education	Karnataka
44	Ms. Yanung Jamoh Lego	Others – Agriculture	Arunachal Pradesh
45	Shri Jordan Lepcha	Art	Sikkim
46	Shri Satendra Singh Lohia	Sports	Madhya Pradesh
47	Shri Binod Maharana	Art	Odisha
48	Ms. Purnima Mahato	Sports	Jharkhand
49	Ms. Uma Maheshwari D	Art	Andhra Pradesh
50	Shri Dukhu Majhi	Social Work	West Bengal
51	Shri Ram Kumar Mallick	Art	Bihar
52	Shri Hemchand Manjhi	Medicine	Chhattisgarh
53	Shri Chandrashekhar Mahadeorao Meshram	Medicine	Maharashtra
54	Shri Surendra Mohan Mishra (Posthumous)	Art	Uttar Pradesh
55	Shri Ali Mohammed & Shri Ghani Mohammed* (Duo)	Art	Rajasthan
56	Ms. Kalpana Morparia	Trade & Industry	Maharashtra
57	Ms. Chami Murmu	Social Work	Jharkhand
58	Shri Sasindran Muthuvel	Public Affairs	Papua New Guinea
59	Ms. G Nachiyar	Medicine	Tamil Nadu
60	Ms. Kiran Nadar	Art	Delhi
61	Shri Pakaravur Chithran Namboodiripad (Posthumous)	Literature & Education	Kerala
62	Shri Narayanan E P	Art	Kerala
63	Shri Shailesh Nayak	Science & Engineering	Delhi
64	Shri Harish Nayak (Posthumous)	Literature & Education	Gujarat
65	Shri Fred Negrit	Literature & Education	France
66	Shri Hari Om	Science & Engineering	Haryana
67	Shri Bhagabat Padhan	Art	Odisha
68	Shri Sanatan Rudra Pal	Art	West Bengal
69	Shri Shankar Baba Pundlikrao Papalkar	Social Work	Maharashtra
70	Shri Radhe Shyam Pareek	Medicine	Uttar Pradesh
71	Shri Dayal Mavjibhai Parmar	Medicine	Gujarat
72	Shri Binod Kumar Pasayat	Art	Odisha
73	Ms. Silbi Passah	Art	Meghalaya

SN	Name	Field	State/Region/Country
74	Ms. Shanti Devi Paswan & Shri Shivan Paswan* (Duo)	Art	Bihar
75	Shri Sanjay Anant Patil	Others – Agriculture	Goa
76	Shri Muni Narayana Prasad	Literature & Education	Kerala
77	Shri K S Rajanna	Social Work	Karnataka
78	Shri Chandrashekar Channapatna Rajannachar	Medicine	Karnataka
79	Shri Bhagwatilal Rajpurohit	Literature & Education	Madhya Pradesh
80	Shri Romalo Ram	Art	Jammu & Kashmir
81	Shri Navjivan Rastogi	Literature & Education	Uttar Pradesh
82	Ms. Nirmal Rishi	Art	Punjab
83	Shri Pran Sabharwal	Art	Punjab
84	Shri Gaddam Sammaiah	Art	Telangana
85	Shri Sangthankima	Social Work	Mizoram
86	Shri Machihan Sasa	Art	Manipur
87	Shri Omprakash Sharma	Art	Madhya Pradesh
88	Shri Eklabya Sharma	Science & Engineering	West Bengal
89	Shri Ram Chander Sihag	Science & Engineering	Haryana
90	Shri Harbinder Singh	Sports	Delhi
91	Shri Gurvinder Singh	Social Work	Haryana
92	Shri Godawari Singh	Art	Uttar Pradesh
93	Shri Ravi Prakash Singh	Science & Engineering	Mexico
94	Shri Seshampatti T Sivalingam	Art	Tamil Nadu
95	Shri Somanna	Social Work	Karnataka
96	Shri Kethavath Somlal	Literature & Education	Telangana
97	Ms. Shashi Soni	Trade & Industry	Karnataka
98	Ms. Urmila Srivastava	Art	Uttar Pradesh
99	Shri Nepal Chandra Sutradhar (Posthumous)	Art	West Bengal
100	Shri Gopinath Swain	Art	Odisha
101	Shri Laxman Bhatt Tailang	Art	Rajasthan
102	Ms. Maya Tandon	Social Work	Rajasthan
103	Ms. Aswathi Thirunal Gouri Lakshmi Bayi Thampuratty	Literature & Education	Kerala
104	Shri Jagdish Labhshanker Trivedi	Art	Gujarat
105	Ms. Sano Vamuzo	Social Work	Nagaland
106	Shri Balakrishnan Sadanam Puthiya Veetil	Art	Kerala
107	Shri Kurella Vittalacharya	Literature & Education	Telangana
108	Shri Kiran Vyas	Others – Yoga	France
109	Shri Jageshwar Yadav	Social Work	Chhattisgarh
110	Shri Babu Ram Yadav	Art	Uttar Pradesh

Republic Day 2024: Tableaux List

The **Republic Day Parade at Kartavya Path in 2024** promises to be a vibrant and eclectic celebration of India's unity in diversity. With **25 captivating tableaux from 16 states and Union Territories**, the parade showcases a kaleidoscope of themes ranging from education and empowerment to traditional arts and sports achievements. Each tableau represents the unique cultural, social, and technological facets of the participating regions, contributing to the rich tapestry of India's national identity.

Here is the **list of tableaux or Jhakiyaan displayed on 75th Republic Day of India**:

25 States' Tableaux or 'Jhakiyaan' on Republic Day 2024		
State/ Ministry	Theme	Highlights
Andhra Pradesh	Revolutionizing School Education	Focus on global competitiveness in education.
Rajasthan	Women's Handicraft Industries	Showcasing Ghoomar dance, Meera Bai's statue, and traditional handicrafts.
Odisha	Women in Handicrafts and Handlooms	Emphasizing women's role in preserving and promoting traditional arts.
Haryana	Empowerment of Women	Illustrating empowerment through the 'Mera Parivar – Meri Pehchan' program.
Madhya Pradesh	Women's Integration in Development	Featuring Avani Chaturvedi, the first woman fighter pilot, and women in various sectors.
Chhattisgarh	Muria Darbar Tradition in Bastar	Highlighting tribal community decision-making and equal involvement of men and women.
Ladakh	Indian Women's Ice Hockey Team	Showcasing achievements and contributions of Ladakhi women in sports.
Manipur	Women in Socio-Economic Activities	Featuring women working with lotus stems, Ima Keithel market, and lotus silk making.
Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology	AI in various sectors	Illustrating the role of artificial intelligence in diverse industries.
CRPF	Women Empowerment	Central Armed Police Forces' tableaux focusing on empowering women.
IAF	Power Beyond Boundaries	Showcasing major assets of the Indian Air Force, including recent inductions

Filmfare Awards 2024 Winners List

Filmfare Awards 2024 Winners

The **69th edition** of the **Filmfare Awards 2024** took place in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**. The event featured hosting by **Karan Johar**, and performances by **Kareena Kapoor, Karisma Kapoor, Varun Dhawan, and Kartik Aaryan among others**. This year, the two-day celebration in Gujarat opened with a Curtain Raiser, leading up to the Filmfare Awards ceremony. The 69th Hyundai Filmfare Awards 2024 with Gujarat Tourism was held in **GIFT City, Gujarat**.

Filmfare Awards 2024 Winners

Category	Winner
Best Film	12th Fail
Best Director	Vidhu Vinod Chopra (12th Fail)
Best Actor in a Leading Role (Male)	Ranbir Kapoor (Animal)
Best Actor in a Leading Role (Female)	Alia Bhatt (Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani)
Best Film (Critics')	Joram (Devashish Makhija)
Best Actor (Critics')	Vikrant Massey (12th Fail)
Best Actress (Critics')	Rani Mukerji (Mrs Chatterjee vs. Norway), Shefali Shah (Three of Us)
Best Actor in a Supporting Role (Male)	Vicky Kaushal (Dunki)

Category	Winner
Best Actor in a Supporting Role (Female)	Shabana Azmi (Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani)
Best Lyrics	Amitabh Bhattacharya ("Tere Vaaste" – Zara Hatke Zara Bachke)
Best Music Album	Animal (Pritam, Vishal Mishra, Manan Bhardwaj, Shreyas Puranik, Jaani, Bhupinder Babbal, et al.)
Best Playback Singer (Male)	Bhupinder Babbal (Arjan Vailly – Animal)
Best Playback Singer (Female)	Shilpa Rao (Besharam Rang – Pathaan)
Best Story	Amit Rai (OMG 2), Devashish Makhija (Joram)
Best Screenplay	Vidhu Vinod Chopra (12th Fail)
Best Dialogue	Ishita Moitra (Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani)
Best Background Score	Harshavardhan Rameshwar (Animal)
Best Cinematography	Avinash Arun Dhaware (Three of Us)
Best Production Design	Subrata Chakraborty, Amit Ray (Sam Bahadur)
Best Costume Design	Sachin Lovelekar, Divvyaa Gambhir, Nidhhi Gambhir (Sam Bahadur)
Best Sound Design	Kunal Sharma (Mpse) (Sam Bahadur) Sync Cinema (Animal)
Best Editing	Jaskunwar Singh Kohli- Vidhu Vinod Chopra (12th Fail)
Best Action	Spiro Razatos, Anl Arasu, Craig Macrae, Yannick Ben, Kecha Khamphakdee, Sunil Rodrigues (Jawan)
Best VFX	Red Chillies VFX (Jawan)
Best Choreography	Ganesh Acharya ("What Jhumka?" – Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani)
Best Debut Director	Tarun Dudeja (Dhak Dhak)
Best Debut Male	Aditya Rawal (Faraaz)
Best Debut Female	Alizeh Agnihotri (Farrey)
Lifetime Achievement Award	David Dhawan

Australian Open 2024 Winners

Jannik Sinner secured his first Grand Slam in men's singles, while Aryna Sabalenka claimed her second in women's singles. Rohan Bopanna, at 43, became the oldest man to win men's doubles. Hsieh Su-Wei and Elise Mertens won women's doubles, and Hsieh, with Jan Zielinski, clinched mixed doubles.

Category	Winner	Runner-Up
Men's Singles	Jannik Sinner (Italy)	Daniil Medvedev (Russia)
Women's Singles	Aryna Sabalenka (Belarus)	Zheng Qinwen (China)
Men's Doubles	Rohan Bopanna (India) & Matthew Ebden (Australia)	Simone Bolelli and Andrea Vavassori (Italy)
Women's Doubles	Hsieh Su-Wei (Taiwan) & Elise Mertens (Belgium)	Jelena Ostapenko and Lyudmyla Kichenok (Latvia-Ukraine)
Mixed Doubles	Hsieh Su-wei (Taiwan) & Jan Zielinski (Poland)	Desirae Krawczyk (USA) & Neal Skupski (Britain)

Finance Ministry Issues 'Indian Economy – A Review' Report Instead of Economic Survey

In 2024, India will not have the usual **Economic Survey** traditionally presented before the **Union Budget**. Instead, Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** will present an interim

budget, known as a vote-on-account, on February 1. The reason for not presenting the Economic Survey this year is the election context. 2024 is an election year in India, and presenting the Economic Survey could lead to politicization due to the potential change in government after the elections. This could disrupt the regular Budget process.

However, the **Ministry of Finance** has released an alternative report titled **“Indian Economy – A Review,”** prepared by the office of **Chief Economic Advisor (CEA) V Anantha Nageswaran**. This report does not replace the official Economic Survey but provides valuable insights into the Indian economy’s trajectory and prospects over the past decade and its future outlook. It’s important to note that the official Economic Survey is expected to be presented after the general elections and the formation of the new government. The Review consists of two chapters and takes stock of the state of the Indian economy and its journey in the **last 10 years and offers a brief sketch of the outlook for the economy in the coming years.**

Key points from “Indian Economy – A Review” include

1. India’s projected growth to a \$5 trillion economy in the next 3 years and a potential to reach \$7 trillion by 2030.
2. The review focuses on structural reforms undertaken in the past decade and their positive impact.
3. It offers a cautious outlook on future growth and inflation, acknowledging global uncertainties and challenges.
4. India is expected to surpass a GDP growth rate of 7.2% in FY24, outpacing the global economy.
5. For the third consecutive year, the Indian economy is set to achieve a growth rate exceeding 7%.
6. There has been a rise in public sector investment, a robust financial sector, and substantial non-food credit growth over the past decade.
7. India is now the third-largest fintech economy globally, after the USA and the UK.
8. India has become the fourth-largest stock market worldwide, surpassing Hong Kong.
9. The PM Jan Dhan Yojana has significantly increased the percentage of women holding bank accounts.
10. There has been a surge in the female labour force participation rate and initiatives like the Skill India Mission, Start-Up India, and Stand-Up India are contributing to this increase.
11. A significant increase in the Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) for females in higher education.
12. The report highlights the dynamism in the MSME sector due to government support.
13. The implementation of GST and the integration of domestic markets have improved economic efficiency and lowered logistics costs.

Government Appoints Four key Members of the Sixteenth Finance Commission

The government has taken a significant step in shaping the **Sixteenth Finance Commission (SFC)** by appointing **4-key members**, three of whom are designated as full-time members. The Commission, headed by Shri Arvind Panagariya, former Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog, was constituted on December 31, 2023.

Appointed Members

1.	Shri. Ajay Narayan Jha, former member, 15th Finance Commission and former Secretary, Expenditure	Full time Member
2.	Smt. Annie George Mathew, former Special Secretary, Expenditure	Full time Member
3.	Dr. Niranjan Rajadhyaksha, Executive Director, Artha Global	Full time Member
4.	Dr. Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Advisor, State Bank of India	Part time Member

Sixteenth Finance Commission: Dr. Arvind Panagariya Appointed Chairman

Context

In adherence to **Article 280(1)** of the Constitution, the Government of India, with the President’s approval, has established the Sixteenth Finance Commission. **Dr. Arvind Panagariya**, former Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog and Professor at Columbia University, assumes the role of Chairman. Shri Ritvik Ranjanam Pandey has been appointed as the Commission’s Secretary, and detailed terms of reference have been outlined in the official notification.

Key Appointments

- **Chairman:** Dr. Arvind Panagariya
- **Secretary:** Shri Ritvik Ranjanam Pandey

Terms of Reference

The Sixteenth Finance Commission is tasked with making recommendations on three crucial matters:

1. **Distribution of Net Proceeds:**
 - Allocation of taxes between the Union and the States under Chapter I, Part XII of the Constitution.
 - Division of respective shares among the States.
2. **Grants-in-Aid:**
 - Principles governing grants-in-aid to States’ revenues from the Consolidated Fund of India.
 - Sums to be granted under Article 275 for purposes other than specified in the provisos to clause (1) of that article.
3. **Resource Augmentation:**
 - Measures to enhance a State’s Consolidated Fund for supporting Panchayats and Municipalities, based on State Finance Commission recommendations.

Additional Mandate

The Commission will also review financing arrangements for Disaster Management initiatives, aligning with the Disaster Management Act, 2005, and provide relevant recommendations.

Timeline

The Sixteenth Finance Commission is expected to submit its comprehensive report by **October 31, 2025**, covering a five-year period starting from April 1, 2026.

Most Important Current Affairs of February 2024

Government Appoints Four key Members of the Sixteenth Finance Commission

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Appointed Members

1.	Shri. Ajay Narayan Jha , former member, 15th Finance Commission and former Secretary, Expenditure	Full time Member
2.	Smt. Annie George Mathew , former Special Secretary, Expenditure	Full time Member
3.	Dr. Niranjana Rajadhyaksha , Executive Director, Artha Global	Full time Member
4.	Dr. Soumya Kanti Ghosh , Group Chief Economic Advisor, State Bank of India	Part time Member

Sixteenth Finance Commission: Dr. Arvind Panagariya Appointed Chairman

Context

In adherence to **Article 280(1)** of the Constitution, the Government of India, with the President's approval, has established the Sixteenth Finance Commission. **Dr. Arvind Panagariya**, former Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog and Professor at Columbia University, assumes the role of Chairman. Shri Ritvik Ranjanam Pandey has been appointed as the Commission's Secretary, and detailed terms of reference have been outlined in the official notification.

Key Appointments

- **Chairman:** Dr. Arvind Panagariya
- **Secretary:** Shri Ritvik Ranjanam Pandey

Terms of Reference

The Sixteenth Finance Commission is tasked with making recommendations on three crucial matters:

1. Distribution of Net Proceeds

- Allocation of taxes between the Union and the States under Chapter I, Part XII of the Constitution.
- Division of respective shares among the States.

2. Grants-in-Aid:

- Principles governing grants-in-aid to States' revenues from the Consolidated Fund of India.
- Sums to be granted under Article 275 for purposes other than specified in the provisos to clause (1) of that article.

3. Resource Augmentation:

- Measures to enhance a State's Consolidated Fund for supporting Panchayats and Municipalities, based on State Finance Commission recommendations.

Additional Mandate

The Commission will also review financing arrangements for Disaster Management initiatives, aligning with the Disaster Management Act, 2005, and provide relevant recommendations.

Timeline

The Sixteenth Finance Commission is expected to submit its comprehensive report by **October 31, 2025**, covering a five-year period starting from April 1, 2026.

LK Advani awarded Bharat Ratna, Announced by PM Modi

The Indian government has announced that **LK Advani**, one of the most prominent figures in Indian politics, will be conferred with the **Bharat Ratna**, the nation's highest civilian award. This prestigious honour is a testament to Advani's indelible contribution to Indian politics and society over several decades.

The Bharat Ratna is a fitting recognition of LK Advani's legacy as a statesman who has dedicated his life to the nation. His leadership has not only shaped the BJP but also left a lasting impact on Indian politics and governance. The award celebrates his immense contributions and his role as a catalyst for political and social change in India.

Born on **November 8, 1927, in Karachi**, LK Advani's political journey is a saga of resilience, leadership, and profound influence on the Indian political landscape. Advani, a key architect of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), has been instrumental in shaping the party's ideology and steering it to national prominence.

LK Advani, Architect of Political Change

Advani's political career is marked by his visionary leadership and strategic acumen. His **Rath Yatra in 1990** was a turning point in Indian politics, significantly impacting the national discourse and contributing to the BJP's rise as a major political force. As a seasoned parliamentarian and a government official, Advani has held several key positions, including that of the Deputy Prime Minister of India.

LK Advani, Contributions and Controversies

Advani's tenure in politics has not been without controversies. However, his contributions to national security, governance, and public welfare have been significant. His role in promoting infrastructure development and his tough stance on national security are particularly noteworthy. Advani's political journey is a reflection of his commitment to his principles and his unwavering dedication to India's development.

Grammy Awards 2024, Check The Complete List Of Winners

Grammy Awards 2024

The **66th Annual Grammy Awards**, marking a significant milestone in the music industry, celebrated the most remarkable recordings, compositions, and artists of the year, from **October 1, 2022, to September 30, 2023**. Chosen

meticulously by the esteemed members of The Recording Academy, this prestigious ceremony took place on February 4, 2024. Returning to the iconic **Crypto.com Arena in Los Angeles for its 21st year**, the event was broadcast live on CBS, with streaming options available on Paramount, ensuring a global audience could partake in the festivities.

Grammy Awards 2024, Check The Complete List Of Winners

Category	Winner
Song of the Year	Billie Eilish – What Was I Made For? from Barbie
Best Pop Vocal Album	Taylor Swift – Midnights
Best R&B Song	SZA – Snooze
Best Country Album	Lainey Wilson – Bell Bottom Country
Best Música Urbana Album	Karol G – Mañana Será Bonito
Best Pop Solo Performance	Miley Cyrus – Flowers
Best Progressive R&B Album	SZA – SOS
Best R&B Performance	Coco Jones – ICU
Best Folk Album	Joni Mitchell – Joni Mitchell at Newport (Live)
Producer of the Year, Non-Classical	Jack Antonoff
Songwriter of the Year, Non-Classical	Theron Thomas
Best Pop Duo/Group Performance	SZA featuring Phoebe Bridgers – Ghost in the Machine
Best Dance/Electronic Recording	Skrillex, Fred again.. and Flowdan – Rumble
Best Pop Dance Recording	Kylie Minogue – Padam Padam
Best Dance/Electronic Music Album	Fred again.. – Actual Life 3 (January 1 – September 9 2022)
Best Traditional R&B Performance	PJ Morton featuring Susan Carol – Good Morning
Best R&B Album	Victoria Monét – Jaguar II
Best Rap Performance	Killer Mike featuring André 3000, Future and Eryn Allen Kane – Scientists & Engineers
Best Melodic Rap Performance	Lil Durk featuring J Cole – All My Life
Best Rap Song	Killer Mike featuring André 3000, Future and Eryn Allen Kane – Scientists & Engineers
Best Rap Album	Killer Mike – Michael
Best Country Solo Performance	Chris Stapleton – White Horse
Best Country Song	Chris Stapleton – White Horse
Best Song Written for Visual Media	Billie Eilish – What Was I Made For? from Barbie
Best Comedy Album	Dave Chappelle – What’s in a Name?
Best Global Music Album	Indian musicians Shankar Mahadevan and Zakir Hussain’s fusion band ‘Shakti’
Best African Music Performance	Tyla – Water
Best Musical Theater Album	Some Like It Hot
Best Alternative Music Album	boygenius – The Record
Best Alternative Music Performance	Paramore – This Is Why
Best Rock Album	Paramore – This Is Why
Best Rock Song	boygenius – Not Strong Enough
Best Metal Performance	Metallica – 72 Seasons
Best Rock Performance	boygenius – Not Strong Enough
Best Country Duo/Group Performance	Zach Bryan featuring Kacey Musgraves – I Remember Everything

RBI's Analysis Report on Trend and Progress of Banking in India 2022-23

The annual performance report of the Indian banking sector, compliant with **Section 36(2) of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949**, presents a comprehensive analysis of the sector's achievements and challenges. It encompasses cooperative banks and **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)**, providing insights into their contributions to the country's economic framework.

Stability and Strength of the Banking System

The report highlights the robustness of India's banking system and NBFCs, underpinned by high capital ratios, improved asset quality, and substantial earnings growth. This solid foundation has enabled credit expansion in double digits, thereby supporting domestic economic activities. However, the report emphasizes the necessity for enhanced governance, risk management, and the creation of additional financial buffers to sustain progress.

Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs)

SCBs have experienced significant growth, with their combined balance sheets expanding by 12.2% in the fiscal year 2022-23, marking a nine-year high. This growth is attributed mainly to credit expansion in the retail and services sectors. Additionally, SCBs have strengthened their capital buffers and asset quality, with the **Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) ratio reaching a ten-year low of 3.9% by March 2023 and further dropping to 3.2% by September 2023**. Remarkably, no bank was under the prompt corrective action (PCA) framework by March 2023, indicating improved health of the banking sector.

Capital Adequacy Ratios

The Capital to Risk (Weighted) Assets Ratio (CRAR) has seen varying trends across different bank types:

- Public Sector Banks (PSBs) reported an increase in **CRAR from 14.6% in 2022 to 15.5% in 2023**.
- Private Sector Banks (PVBs) experienced a slight decrease in **CRAR from 18.8% to 18.6%**.
- Foreign Banks (FBs) maintained a stable **CRAR at 19.8%**.
- These figures reflect the banking sector's efforts to maintain or improve capital adequacy, essential for absorbing potential losses.
- Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)
- The report provides a detailed analysis of NPAs, showing an overall improvement in asset quality. The Gross NPA percentage of Gross Advances decreased for most bank groups, indicating effective management of bad loans. Public Sector Banks (PSBs), for instance, saw a decrease in **Gross NPA percentage from 7.3% to 5.0%**.

Non-banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)

NBFCs have shown remarkable growth and improvement in asset quality, with their combined balance sheets growing by **14.8%** in 2022-23. The sector has witnessed a significant credit expansion, particularly in unsecured loans, micro-finance, and MSME loans. The **Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) ratio for NBFCs declined to 4.1%**, showcasing an improvement in asset quality.

Co-operative Banks

Co-operative banks continue to play a vital role in India's financial landscape, especially in rural areas. The government and the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** have taken steps to enhance the regulatory framework and provide these banks with more autonomy in capital acquisition, ensuring their continued contribution to financial inclusion.

Contagion Risk and Regulatory Measures

The interconnectedness between NBFCs and banks poses a potential contagion risk, necessitating careful monitoring. The RBI has introduced macroprudential measures to maintain financial stability, including increased risk weights for certain types of consumer credit loans and bank lending to NBFCs.

Customer Service and Financial Inclusion

Despite advancements in banking technology, the RBI has noted that customer service quality needs to catch up. Efforts are being made to ensure banking solutions are accessible to all, including seniors and those with special needs. Additionally, the RBI is focused on mitigating systemic risks by evaluating the over-reliance on specific IT service providers.

Sportstar Aces Awards 2024, Check Complete List of Winners

Category	Winner
Sportsman of the Year (Track and Field)	Men's Relay Team
Sportswoman of the Year (Track and Field)	Parul Chaudhary
Sportsman of the Year (Team Sports)	Hardik Singh, Mohammed Shami
Sportswoman of the Year (Team Sports)	Vandana Katariya
Sportsman of the Year (Individual)	Satwiksairaj Rankireddy, Chirag Shetty
Sportswoman of the Year (Individual)	Rameshbabu Vaishali, Sift Kaur Samra
Sportsman of the Year (Parasports)	Sumit Antil
Sportswoman of the Year (Parasports)	Thulasimathi Murugesan
Coach of the Year	Rahul Dravid
Young Achiever of the Year (Male)	Prathamesh Samadhan Jawkar
Young Achiever of the Year (Female)	Tilottama Sen

Category	Winner
Lifetime Achievement Award	Chandu Borde, Karnam Malleswari
Sportstar of the Year (Male)	Neeraj Chopra
Sportstar of the Year (Female)	Sheetal Devi
National Team of the Year	India Men's Cricket Team
Club/State Team of the Year	Saurashtra Cricket Team
Moment of the Year	Sheetal Devi Hits the Bullseye
International Icon	Muttiah Muralitharan
Best State for the Promotion of Sport	Tamil Nadu
Best PSU for the Promotion of Sport	NTPC Ltd
Best Corporate for the Promotion of Sport	Tata Steel Ltd
Best University for the Promotion of Sport	SRM Institute of Science and Technology
Sport for Social Good	Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Board
Ace of Aces Award	Rohan Bopanna

AIIMS Launches iOncology.ai for Early Cancer Detection

In a landmark collaboration between AIIMS, New Delhi, and the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (CDAC), Pune, the groundbreaking **AI platform iOncology.ai** has been unveiled. This cutting-edge technology focuses on the early detection of cancer, particularly targeting breast and ovarian cancers, which are prevalent among women in India.

Global Cancer Scenario

- Cancer surpasses cardiovascular diseases in high-income and middle-income countries in terms of fatality rates.
- GLOBOCAN estimates for 2020 show 19.3 million incident cancer cases worldwide, with India ranking third after China and the United States.

Cancer Statistics in India

- A Lancet study predicts a 57.5% increase in cancer cases in India by 2040, reaching 2.08 million.
- In 2022, over 8 lakh deaths in India were attributed to cancer, mainly due to late detection, resulting in a mere 20% survival rate.

About iOncology.ai

- Developed in collaboration with CDAC and the Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology, iOncology.ai utilizes AI to reduce false negatives in manual cancer diagnosis.
- The platform employs deep learning models and self-learning capabilities to analyze complex medical data with unparalleled accuracy and efficiency.

- Initial focus lies on early detection of breast and ovarian cancers, leveraging a dataset of approximately half a million radiological and histopathological images from AIIMS.

Positive Reception and Future Collaborations

- iOncology.ai has been successfully implemented in five district hospitals, demonstrating its potential for widespread impact.
- It received positive feedback at a Med-Hackathon event during AIIMS Research Day celebrations and is poised for further partnerships with cancer hospitals and research centers across India.

MoU between AIIMS and DGE for Rheumatological Disorders

- The Department of Rheumatology at AIIMS New Delhi has signed an MoU with the Directorate General of Employment, Ministry of Labour & Employment, Government of India.
- This initiative aims to address challenges faced by patients with disabilities due to rheumatological disorders by providing certifications for employable skills and promoting economic upliftment and vocational rehabilitation.

Bharat Ratna to Honour PV Narasimha Rao, Chaudhary Charan Singh, and MS Swaminathan

India's highest civilian award, the **Bharat Ratna**, is set to honour the indelible contributions of three distinguished individuals whose efforts have significantly shaped the nation's trajectory. **Former Prime Ministers PV Narasimha Rao and Chaudhary Charan Singh, alongside renowned agricultural scientist MS Swaminathan**, are the esteemed recipients of this prestigious accolade, acknowledging their unparalleled dedication to the progress of India.

Bharat Ratna, PV Narasimha Rao

PV Narasimha Rao, often hailed as the **Architect of Modern India**, played a pivotal role in ushering in economic liberalization in the early 1990s. His visionary leadership not only averted a financial crisis but also laid the groundwork for India's rapid growth and integration into the global economy. Rao's tenure as Prime Minister was marked by bold reforms that transformed the economic landscape, fostering investment, expansion of the private sector, and enhancing India's competitiveness worldwide.

Beyond economics, Rao's impact was profoundly felt in India's foreign policy, where he redefined relationships, steering the country through the post-Cold War era with strategic finesse. His initiatives towards strengthening ties with the East, including the Look East policy, paved the way for a new era in diplomatic relations and economic partnerships.

Rao's contributions extended into the realms of language and education, where he championed the cause of cultural diversity and literacy. His policies aimed at preserving India's rich linguistic heritage while promoting education as a means of empowerment.

Bharat Ratna, Chaudhary Charan Singh, Champion of the Farmers

Chaudhary Charan Singh revered as a true champion of India's agrarian community dedicated his life to the welfare of the farmers. His tenure as Prime Minister, though brief, was impactful, particularly his advocacy for policies that supported the agricultural sector and upheld the rights of the farmers. Singh's legacy is a testament to his commitment to rural development and his belief in the vital role of agriculture in India's economy.

Singh's initiatives aimed at alleviating farmer distress, improving agricultural productivity, and ensuring fair prices for crops have left an enduring mark on India's agricultural policies. His efforts to reform the agrarian landscape resonate with millions of farmers across the nation, making him a beloved figure among the rural populace.

Bharat Ratna, MS Swaminathan, Father of the Green Revolution

Dr. MS Swaminathan's contributions to India's agricultural revolution are monumental. As the architect of the **Green Revolution**, Swaminathan's scientific acumen and innovative approaches to crop improvement significantly increased food production, thereby mitigating the threat of famine and ensuring food security for millions. His work not only transformed India from a food-importing country to one of self-sufficiency but also inspired agricultural reforms worldwide.

Swaminathan's dedication to sustainable agriculture and his advocacy for the conservation of biodiversity have shaped the discourse on ecological balance and responsible farming practices. His vision extends beyond immediate agricultural gains, focusing on the long-term well-being of the planet and its inhabitants.

PM Modi's UAE Visit

Prime Minister Narendra Modi embarked on a two-day visit to the United Arab Emirates (UAE), where he was warmly received by President Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan. Their cordial meeting included discussions on various fronts, signifying the strengthening of bilateral relations.

Here are the key highlights of PM Modi's visit

Warm Reception and Strategic Talks

- President Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan warmly welcomed Prime Minister Modi at the airport, showcasing the strong personal rapport between the leaders.
- The two leaders engaged in wide-ranging discussions, focusing on reviewing the strategic partnership and identifying areas for further collaboration.
- Several agreements were signed during the visit, including a **Bilateral Investment Treaty** and an Intergovernmental Framework Agreement on the India-Middle East Economic Corridor, signifying a deepening of economic cooperation.

Inauguration of BAPS Mandir and Gratitude for Support

- Prime Minister Modi expressed gratitude to President Al Nahyan for his support in facilitating the construction of the first Hindu stone temple in the UAE, located in Abu Dhabi.
- The inauguration of the **Bochasanwasi Shri Akshar Purushottam Swaminarayan Sanstha (BAPS)** Mandir underscores the cultural and religious ties between India and the UAE.

Digital Initiatives and Financial Collaboration

- Modi congratulated the UAE President on the launch of the domestic card JAYWAN, which is based on India's digital RuPay credit and debit card stack.
- A transaction using the JAYWAN card was witnessed by both leaders, highlighting the advancement of financial technology and collaboration between the two countries.

Participation in World Government Summit 2024

- Prime Minister Modi's participation as a guest of honor in the World Government Summit 2024 in Dubai underscores India's global significance and commitment to multilateral cooperation.
- His keynote address at the summit reaffirms India's role in shaping discussions on global governance and development.

Frequent Engagements Highlight Strong Ties

- Modi's visit marks his seventh to the UAE since 2015, demonstrating the continuity and depth of engagement between the leadership of India and the UAE.
- With his third visit in the past eight months alone, the frequency underscores the importance both nations attach to strengthening bilateral relations.

Supreme Court Collegium Recommends Transfer Of 3 High Court Judges

The **Supreme Court collegium**, led by Chief Justice D Y Chandrachud, has recommended the transfer of **three high court judges** upon their respective requests. The decisions were made in accordance with the interests of better administration of justice and personal reasons cited by the judges.

Recommendation 1: Justice Moushumi Bhattacharya

- Request:** Justice Moushumi Bhattacharya of the Calcutta High Court has sought a transfer to another high court due to personal reasons, as conveyed in a communication dated February 12, 2024.
- Resolution:** The collegium has acceded to Justice Moushumi Bhattacharya's request and recommended her transfer to the High Court for the State of Telangana.

Recommendation 2: Justice Anu Sivaraman

- Request:** Justice Anu Sivaraman has requested a transfer out of the State of Kerala.
- Resolution:** The collegium has accepted Justice Anu Sivaraman's request and recommended her transfer to the Karnataka High Court.

Recommendation 3: Justice Sujoy Paul

- **Request:** Justice Sujoy Paul has sought a transfer because his son practices in the High Court of Madhya Pradesh.
- **Resolution:** The collegium has resolved to recommend Justice Sujoy Paul's transfer to the High Court for the State of Telangana, considering the better administration of justice.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi Inaugurates Abu Dhabi's First Hindu Stone Temple

In a historic event on February 14, Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated **Abu Dhabi's first Hindu stone temple**, marking a significant milestone in the **UAE's** cultural and religious inclusivity. The inauguration ceremony was imbued with devotional chants and witnessed the presence of spiritual leaders from the Swaminarayan sect, highlighting the temple's importance to the global Hindu community.

Global Aarti: A Spiritual Unison

A highlight of the event was the "Global Aarti," performed simultaneously at over **1,200 temples of the Swaminarayan** sect worldwide. This act of global spiritual unity was orchestrated by the **Bochasanwasi Shri Akshar Purushottam Swaminarayan Sanstha (BAPS)**, illustrating the widespread reverence and support for the newly inaugurated temple.

A Meeting of Faiths

Prior to the inauguration, Prime Minister Modi engaged with individuals from various faiths who played a crucial role in the temple's construction, emphasizing the collaborative spirit that underpinned the project. This interaction underscored the temple's ethos of unity and the bridging of cultural divides.

Temple Architecture: A Blend of Tradition and Technology

Located on a **27-acre site near Al Rahba off the Dubai-Abu Dhabi Sheikh Zayed Highway**, the temple was constructed at a cost of approximately **Rs 700 crore**. It stands as a testament to ancient architectural principles derived from Hindu scriptures, the Shilpa and Sthapathya Shastras, which guide mandir design and construction. The temple's architecture harmonizes traditional methods with modern scientific techniques, incorporating over 300 high-tech sensors to monitor temperature, pressure, and seismic activity. This innovative approach allows for ongoing research and ensures the temple's safety and sustainability.

Eco-Friendly Construction

Remarkably, the temple's construction involved no metal use, with fly ash replacing a significant portion of cement in the concrete mix, thereby reducing the carbon footprint. The use of heat-resistant nano tiles and heavy glass panels merges traditional aesthetics with modern functionality, catering to the UAE's extreme temperatures and ensuring visitor comfort.

Craftsmanship and Global Collaboration

Constructed in the Nagara style of architecture, similar to the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, the temple required 18 lakh bricks, seven lakh man-hours, and 1.8 lakh cubic metres of Rajasthan-sourced sandstone. The intricate carvings and the marble used in the interiors, mined from Italy and carved in India, showcase the global effort and craftsmanship invested in the temple's creation.

A Landmark of Hindu Faith in the Gulf

The temple's establishment, supported by the land donated by the UAE government, marks a new era for the Hindu community in the Gulf region. It joins three other Hindu temples in Dubai but stands out for its size and traditional stone architecture, symbolizing a significant cultural and religious landmark.

Prime Minister Modi's UAE Visit

This visit, Prime Minister Modi's seventh to the UAE since 2015 and his third in the last eight months underscores the deepening ties between India and the UAE. The inauguration of the temple during this visit highlights the mutual respect and acknowledgement of cultural and religious diversity between the two nations.

The Abu Dhabi Hindu temple not only serves as a place of worship but also as a beacon of cultural harmony, architectural innovation, and environmental consciousness. It signifies the growing inclusivity within the UAE and strengthens the bond between India and the Emirates, promising a future of shared values and mutual respect.

Gulzar and Jagadguru Rambhadracharya Awarded Prestigious Jnanpith Award 2023

The Jnanpith Award, India's most prestigious literary accolade, has announced its recipients for the year 2023, marking a momentous occasion in the annals of Indian literature. This year, the honour is bestowed upon two luminaries from the world of letters: celebrated Urdu poet and Bollywood personality **Gulzar**, and the distinguished Sanskrit scholar and spiritual leader **Jagadguru Rambhadracharya**. Their selection for the **58th edition of the award** underscores the rich diversity and depth of Indian literary traditions, spanning the classical to the contemporary.

Gulzar: A Versatile Literary Genius

Gulzar, born Sampooran Singh Kalra, has etched his name in the realms of Urdu poetry and Hindi cinema with an indelible ink. As one of the finest Urdu poets of his generation, Gulzar's contributions extend beyond the poetic to include significant works as a writer and director in Bollywood. His achievements have been recognized with numerous accolades, including the Sahitya Akademi Award for Urdu, the Dadasaheb Phalke Award, the Padma Bhushan, and several National Film Awards. Notably, his song "Jai Ho" from the film "Slumdog Millionaire" has won both an Oscar and a Grammy, showcasing his international acclaim.

Gulzar's directorial ventures such as "Koshish," "Parichay," and "Mausam," among others, are considered classics. His creation of the 'Triveni,' a unique genre of non-rhyming three-line poetry, and his focus on children's poetry in recent years, highlight his innovative spirit and versatility.

Jagadguru Rambhadracharya: A Scholar of Sanskrit and Spirituality

Jagadguru Rambhadracharya stands as a towering figure in the world of Sanskrit scholarship and Hindu spirituality. As the founder and head of **Tulsi Peeth in Madhya Pradesh**, his contributions to education, literature, and spiritual discourse are unparalleled. Authoring over 240 books and texts, including four epics, Rambhadracharya's prolific output spans a variety of themes and forms. His receipt of the Padma Vibhushan in 2015 attests to his significant impact on Indian culture and scholarship.

A polyglot fluent in 22 languages, Rambhadracharya's influence extends across linguistic and sectarian boundaries, embodying the universal appeal of Indian spiritual and literary traditions.

Jnanpith Award 2023 Committee

The awardees were selected by a committee headed by Odia writer Pratibha Rai. Other members of the selection committee included Madhav Kaushik, Damodar Mauzo, Suranjan Das, Purushottam Bilmale, Praful Shiledar, Harish Trivedi, Prabha Verma, Janaki Prasad Sharma, A. Krishna Rao and Jnanpith director Madhusudan Anand.

The Jnanpith Award, A Legacy of Literary Excellence

Established in **1965** by the **Bharatiya Jnanpith**, the **Jnanpith Award** recognizes outstanding contributions to Indian literature. With a legacy spanning over five decades, the award has celebrated the works of authors across various Indian languages, reflecting the country's rich linguistic and cultural tapestry. The award includes a cash prize of **₹11 lakh**, a statue of Vagdevi, and a citation, symbolizing the highest honour in Indian literature.

This year's selection of Gulzar and Jagadguru Rambhadracharya for their contributions to Urdu and Sanskrit literature, respectively, marks the second time Sanskrit and the fifth time Urdu has been recognized, highlighting the inclusive nature of the award.

BAFTA Awards 2024, Check the Complete List of Winners

Check out the **FULL List of BAFTA Awards 2024 Winners Here**

S.No	Category	Winner
1	Best Film	Oppenheimer
2	Outstanding British Film	The Zone of Interest
3	Outstanding Debut by a British Writer, Director, or Producer	Earth Mama – Savanah Leaf (Writer, Director, Producer), Shirley O'Connor (Producer), Medb Riordan (Producer)
4	Film Not in the English Language	The Zone of Interest

S.No	Category	Winner
5	Documentary	20 Days in Mariupol
6	Animated Film	The Boy And The Heron
7	Director	Christopher Nolan, Oppenheimer
8	Original Screenplay	Anatomy of a Fall
9	Adapted Screenplay	American Fiction
10	Leading Actress	Emma Stone, Poor Things
11	Leading Actor	Cillian Murphy, Oppenheimer
12	Supporting Actress	Da'Vine Joy Randolph, The Holdovers
13	Supporting Actor	Robert Downey Jr., Oppenheimer
14	Original Score	Oppenheimer
15	Cinematography	Oppenheimer
16	Editing	Oppenheimer
17	Casting	The Holdovers
18	Production Design	Poor Things
19	Costumer Design	Poor Things
20	Makeup & Hair	Poor Things
21	Sound	The Zone of Interest
22	Special Visual Effects	Poor Things
23	British Short Animation	Crab Day
24	EE Rising Star Award	Mia McKenna-Bruce
25	British Short Film	Jellyfish and Lobster

MS Dhoni Named Captain of IPL's Greatest All-Time Team

The **Indian Premier League (IPL)**, since its inception in 2008, has been a powerhouse of talent and excitement in the cricketing world. To commemorate its success, a selection panel comprising esteemed former cricketers and journalists convened to assemble the IPL's all-time greatest team.

Selection Panel:

WasimAkram
MatthewHayden
TomMoody
DaleSteyn
Approximately 70 Journalists

Captaincy:

The iconic Mahendra Singh Dhoni was unanimously chosen to lead this star-studded ensemble, bringing his unparalleled leadership and cricketing acumen to the fore.

Batting Order:

Position	Player
Opener	David Warner
Opener	Virat Kohli
3	Chris Gayle
4	Suresh Raina
5	AB de Villiers
6	Suryakumar Yadav

All-Rounders:

- Hardik Pandya
- Ravindra Jadeja
- Kieron Pollard

Bowling Attack:

Type	Player
Spinner	Rashid Khan
Spinner	Sunil Narine
Spinner	Yuzvendra Chahal
Pacer	Lasith Malinga
Pacer	Jasprit Bumrah

Prime Minister Modi's Ambitious Inaugurations and Initiatives in Jammu

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's upcoming visit to **Jammu** is set to mark a significant milestone in the region's developmental journey. With a suite of projects worth over **Rs 45,375 crore (\$5.5 billion approximately)** set to be inaugurated or initiated, this visit underscores the Central Government's commitment to enhancing infrastructure and healthcare in Jammu and Kashmir.

World's Highest Railway Bridge

A highlight of the Prime Minister's visit is the inauguration of the world's highest railway bridge over the **Chenab River**. Towering at **359 metres** above the riverbed, this engineering marvel surpasses the height of the Eiffel Tower by 35 metres. Spanning **1.3 km**, the bridge is a critical component of the **111-km Katra-Banihal stretch of the Udhampur-Srinagar-Baramulla Railway Line (USBRL) Project**. This bridge is not just an infrastructural achievement but a significant step towards connecting the Kashmir valley with Katra in Jammu, promising to reduce travel time between Katra and Srinagar by five hours.

Additionally, PM Modi will flag off the valley's first electric train and a train service linking Sangaldan station to Baramulla station, further enhancing the region's connectivity.

AIIMS Jammu Inauguration

Another significant initiative is the inauguration of the **All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) in Vijaypur (Samba), Jammu**. This state-of-the-art facility, established under the **Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana** at a cost of over **Rs 1,660 crore, sprawls over 227 acres**. It boasts 720 beds, a medical college with 125 seats, a nursing college with 60 seats, and an AYUSH Block, among other amenities. The hospital is set to offer 18 specialities and 17 super-specialities, including cardiology, neurology, and surgical oncology, equipped with an ICU, emergency services, modular operation theatres, and digital health infrastructure to extend its reach to remote areas.

New Terminal at Jammu Airport

The foundation stone for a new terminal at **Jammu Airport** will also be laid by the Prime Minister. Envisioned on a **40,000 sqm area**, the terminal aims to cater to 2,000 passengers during peak hours, embodying modern facilities while reflecting the local culture. This development is expected to bolster air connectivity, tourism, trade, and economic growth in the region.

Additional Projects

Moreover, PM Modi will initiate the development of a state-of-the-art, fully automated Common User Facility (CUF) Petroleum depot in Jammu. With a storage capacity of about **100,000 KL**, the **Rs 677 crore** facility will store various fuels and is aimed at enhancing the region's energy security.

Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024 Announced

The **Dadasaheb Phalke International Film Festival Awards 2024** took place in Mumbai, where 40 individuals received accolades for their significant contributions to the advancement of Indian cinema. Selected by a panel comprising esteemed figures from the Indian film industry, these awardees were recognized at the **70th edition of DPIFF**.

Dadasaheb Phalke International Film Festival Awards list

Category	Winner	Work
Best Actor	Shah Rukh Khan	Jawan
Best Actress	Rani Mukerji	Mrs Chatterjee vs Norway
Best Film	Jawan	
Best Director	Sandeep Reddy Vanga	Animal
Best Actor (Critics)	Vicky Kaushal	Sam Bahadur
Best Actress (Critics)	Kareena Kapoor	Jaane Jaan
Best Film (Critics)	12th Fail	
Best Director (Critics)	Atlee	Jawan
Best Actor in a Negative Role	Bobby Deol	Animal

Category	Winner	Work
Best Actress in a Comic Role	Sanya Malhotra	Kathal
Best Actor in a Comic Role	Ayushmann Khurrana	Dream Girl 2
Best Actor in a Supporting Role	Anil Kapoor	Animal
Best Actress in a Supporting Role	Dimple Kapadia	Pathaan
Most Versatile Actress	Nayanthara	
Most Promising Actor	Vikrant Massey	12th Fail
Most Promising Actress	Adah Sharma	The Kerala Story
Best Music Director	Anirudh Ravichander	Jawan
Best Playback Singer (Male)	Varun Jain and Sachin Jigar	"Tere Vaste"
Best Playback Singer (Female)	Shilpa Rao	"Besharam Rang"
Best Lyricist	Javed Akhtar	"Nikle The Kabhi Hum Ghar Se"
Best Short Film	Good Morning	
Best International Feature Film	Oppenheimer	
Best Cinematographer	Gnweana Shekar VS	IB71

Dadasaheb Phalke International Film Festival Awards in Television

Category	Winner	Work
Best Actor in a Television Series	Neil Bhatt	Ghum Hai Kisikey Pyaar Meiin
Best Actress in a Television Series	Rupali Ganguly	Anupamaa
Television Series of the Year	Ghum Hai Kisikey Pyaar Meiin	

Dadasaheb Phalke International Film Festival Awards for OTT

Category	Winner	Work
Best Actor in a Web Series	Shahid Kapoor	Farzi
Best Actress in a Web Series	Sushmita Sen	Aarya 3
Best Actor in a Web Series (Critics)	Aditya Roy Kapur	Night Manager
Best Actress in a Web Series (Critics)	Karishma Tanna	Scoop
Best Web Series	Farzi	
Best Web Series (Critics)	The Railway Men	

Special Awards:

- Outstanding Contribution to the Film Industry: Moushumi Chatterjee
- Outstanding Contribution to the Music Industry: KJ Yesudas

Army Clinches Khelo India Winter Games 2024 Title on Final Day

The **Khelo India Winter Games 2024** concluded in Gulmarg, with the **Army emerging victorious** after a thrilling final day of competition.

Army Tops the Medal Tally

Alpine skier **Bobby Pandey's gold medal** in the parallel slalom event proved decisive, propelling Army to the top of the medal table with **10 gold medals**. This narrow margin placed them one gold ahead of **Karnataka (9 gold)** and three ahead of **Maharashtra (7 gold)**, who had led after the first round in Ladakh.

Individual Performances Shine

- **Mehak from Uttarakhand** secured gold in the women's parallel slalom.
- **Uttarakhand** finished fifth overall with three gold medals, all in skiing events.
- **Himachal Pradesh** secured fourth place with four gold medals, led by **Aanchal Thakur's double gold** performance.
- **Army** dominated the games, particularly in Gulmarg, with **nine gold medals** added to their ice hockey gold from Ladakh. Notably, **snowboarder Kulvinder Sharma** and **Nordic skier Padma Namgial** each bagged two individual gold medals for the team.
- **Karnataka's Thekkada Bhavani Nanjunda** emerged as the individual star, clinching a remarkable **hat-trick of gold medals** in Gulmarg, despite their reliance on ice skating success in Ladakh.

Technical Expertise and Olympian Involvement

The **Sports Authority of India (SAI)** successfully managed the technical aspects of the games. Additionally, **six Olympians, including Shiva Keshavan and Arif Mohammed Khan**, actively contributed to the conduct of the event, lending their expertise and experience.

The **Khelo India Winter Games 2024** witnessed exceptional performances and a captivating battle for the top spot. The Army's triumph, individual brilliance, and the involvement of Olympians mark a successful edition of the winter sporting event.

Gaganyaan Mission and ISRO Projects Inauguration by PM Modi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi disclosed the identities of the four pilots currently undergoing training for India's first human space flight mission, Gaganyaan, during his visit to the Vikram Sarabhai Space Center (VSSC) in Kerala's Thiruvananthapuram. The astronauts, **Group Captain P Balakrishnan Nair, Group Captain Ajit Krishnan, Group Captain Angad Pratap, and Wing Commander S Shukla**, were also awarded 'astronaut wings' by the Prime Minister. Accompanying PM Modi were Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, Union Minister Muraleedharan, and ISRO Chairman S Somanath.

Astronaut Designates

- Group Captain P Balakrishnan Nair
- Group Captain Ajit Krishnan
- Group Captain Angad Pratap
- Wing Commander S Shukla

About the Gaganyaan Mission

The Gaganyaan mission marks India's pioneering venture into manned space exploration, slated for launch between 2024-2025. Its objective is to deploy a crew of three individuals into a 400 km orbit for a three-day mission, culminating in a safe return to Earth via landing in Indian sea waters.

ISRO's Milestones and Progress

ISRO achieved a significant milestone in the human rating of its **CE20 cryogenic engine**, a pivotal component powering the cryogenic stage of the human-rated LVM3 launch vehicle for Gaganyaan missions. The completion of the final round of ground qualification tests on February 13, 2024, at the High Altitude Test Facility in ISRO Propulsion Complex, Mahendragiri, signifies a crucial advancement in India's preparations for the mission.

Inauguration of Space Infrastructure Projects

- PM Modi inaugurated three key space infrastructure projects during his visit to Kerala, including the **PSLV Integration Facility (PIF)** at Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota.
- Additionally, he inaugurated the new '**Semi-cryogenics Integrated Engine and stage Test facility**' at ISRO Propulsion Complex, Mahendragiri, and the '**Trisonic Wind Tunnel**' at VSSC, Thiruvananthapuram.
- These projects, developed at a cost of approximately ₹1,800 crore, signify India's commitment to enhancing its space capabilities and infrastructure.

India's Position at 42 in the Global Intellectual Property Index 2024

The **US Chamber of Commerce** recently unveiled the **12th edition** of its **International Intellectual Property (IP) Index**, offering a comprehensive evaluation of the IP landscape across the globe. This year's index ranked 55 economies, assessing their IP frameworks' effectiveness in fostering innovation and creative industries. The United States retained its position at the pinnacle, followed closely by the United Kingdom and France, highlighting the critical role of robust IP systems in economic development.

India's Position in the Global Ranking

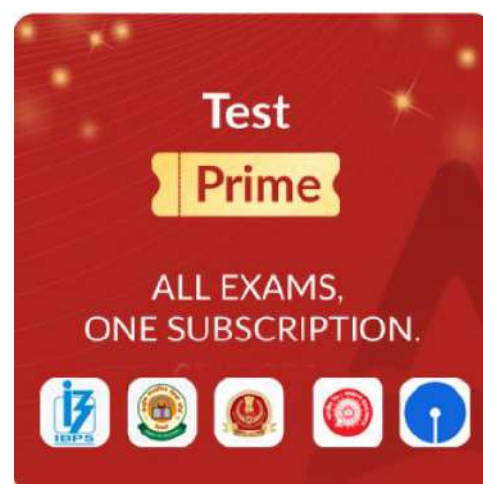
India secured the **42nd position out of the 55 countries evaluated**, with an overall score of 38.64 percent. This placement underscores the ongoing challenges and opportunities for India in strengthening its IP framework to bolster innovation and economic growth. Despite the static position, the inclusion of India in the analysis signifies its importance in the global IP discourse.

Global Leaders in IP Rights

The index identified the top 10 economies with the most effective IP frameworks, led by the United States with a score of 95.48 percent. The United Kingdom and France followed, demonstrating the preeminence of Western economies in the IP domain. This hierarchy of nations reflects the direct correlation between strong IP protections and economic prosperity.

Top 10 Economies for IP Rights

1. United States (95.48%)
2. United Kingdom (94.12%)
3. France (93.12%)
4. Germany (92.46%)
5. Sweden (92.12%)
6. Japan (91.26%)
7. Netherlands (91.24%)
8. Ireland (89.38%)
9. Spain (86.44%)
10. Switzerland (85.98%)



Most Important Current Affairs of March 2024

PM Narendra Modi Presents National Creators Award

Prime Minister Narendra Modi presented the **first-ever National Creators Award** at the Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi. The event marked a significant milestone in recognizing and celebrating creators who have made impactful contributions across various domains.

Awards span 20 categories including storytelling, and social change

The National Creators Award encompasses **20 categories**, highlighting the diversity and depth of creativity across different fields. From storytelling to social change advocacy, environmental sustainability to education, and gaming among others, the awards aim to acknowledge excellence and innovation that drives positive change in society.

Winner	Award
Jaya Kishori	Best Creator for Social Change
Kabita Singh (Kabita's Kitchen)	Best Creator in Food Category
Drew Hicks	Best International Creator
Kamiya Jani	Favourite Travel Creator
Ranveer Allahbadia (BeerBiceps)	Disruptor of the Year
RJ Raunac (Bauaa)	Most Creative Creator-Male
Shraddha Jain	Most Creative Creator (Female)
Aridaman	Best Micro Creator
Nishchay	Best Creator in Gaming Category
Ankit Baiyanpuria	Best Health and Fitness Creator
Naman Deshmukh	Best Creator in Education Category
Jahnvi Singh	Heritage Fashion Icon
Malhar Kalambe	Swachhta Ambassador
Gaurav Chaudhary	Best Creator in Tech Category
Maithili Thakur	Cultural Ambassador of The Year
Pankhti Pandey	Favourite Green Champion
Keerthika Govindasamy	Best Storyteller
Aman Gupta	Celebrity Creator

Triumph of Creativity at the National Creators Award

The winners, including three international creators, were selected from over 1.5 lakh nominations, highlighting the extensive reach and impact of their work. The National Creators Award serves as a testament to the power of creativity in driving positive change and inspiring millions around the world.

Oscars 2024 Announced, Check Full List of Winners

The **Oscars 2024 ceremony** took place at the **Dolby Theater in Los Angeles**, with **Jimmy Kimmel** hosting for the fourth time. The film **"Oppenheimer"** emerged as the big winner, earning 13 nominations and taking home prestigious awards, including Best Director, Best Actor, and Best Picture.

Cillian Murphy's performance in the title role of "Oppenheimer" earned him the Best Actor award, continuing his successful run after winning similar honors at other major award shows like the Golden Globes, BAFTAs, and Screen Actors Guild Awards. The film "Poor Things" also had a notable presence, winning awards in the categories of Hair and Makeup, Production Design, and Costume Design.

The Malayalam film "Everyone is a Hero" (2023), which was chosen as India's official entry for the International Feature Film category at the 2024 Academy Awards, has been eliminated from the Oscars race. Despite being the country's representative, the film did not make it to the final shortlist of nominations in that category.

Oscars 2024 Announced, Check Full List of Winners

The film "Oppenheimer" had a triumphant night at the **96th Academy Awards**, securing a remarkable seven Oscars, including some of the most prestigious categories.

Category	Winner
Best Supporting Actress	Da'Vine Joy Randolph, "The Holdovers"
Best Animated Short	"War Is Over!"
Best Animated Feature	"The Boy and the Heron"
Best Original Screenplay	"Anatomy of a Fall"
Best Adapted Screenplay	"American Fiction"
Best Makeup and Hairstyling	"Poor Things"
Best Production Design	"Poor Things"
Best Costume Design	"Poor Things"
Best International Feature	"The Zone of Interest"
Best Supporting Actor	Robert Downey Jr., "Oppenheimer"
Best Visual Effects	"Godzilla Minus One"
Best Film Editing	"Oppenheimer"
Best Documentary (Short Subject)	"The Last Repair Shop"
Best Documentary Feature	"20 Days in Mariupol"
Best Cinematography	"Oppenheimer"
Best Short Film (Live Action)	"The Wonderful Story of Henry Sugar"
Best Sound	"The Zone of Interest"
Best Score	"Oppenheimer"
Best Song	"What Was I Made For?" from "Barbie"
Best Actor	Cillian Murphy,

Category	Winner
	"Oppenheimer"
Best Director	Christopher Nolan, "Oppenheimer"
Best Actress	Emma Stone, "Poor Things"
Best Picture	"Oppenheimer"

India Jumps 14 Ranks on UNDP Gender Inequality Index

According to the **Human Development Report 2023-2024** released by the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)**, India has made significant progress in bridging the gender divide. The country has improved its ranking by **14 positions** on the Gender Inequality Index (GII) 2022 compared to the previous year.

In the **GII 2022**, India ranked **108 out of 193 countries**, with a **score of 0.437**. This marks a significant improvement from the 2021 ranking of 122 out of 191 countries, with a score of 0.490. Over the past decade, India's rank in the **GII** has consistently improved, indicating steady progress towards achieving gender equality.

The Gender Inequality Index

The Gender Inequality Index (GII) is a composite measure that evaluates gender inequality across three dimensions:

1. Reproductive health
2. Empowerment
3. Labor market participation

It takes into account indicators such as maternal mortality ratio, adolescent birth rate, percentage of parliamentary seats held by women, population with secondary education by gender, and labour force participation by gender. A lower **GII** value indicates lower inequality between women and men.

The 2023-2024 HDR builds on the 2021-2022 Human Development Report findings, which saw the global HDI value fall for the first time—two years in a row. This report reveals that human development recovery is uneven in nature. While wealthy countries are showing signs of robust recovery, the poorest are struggling. All the member countries in the Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) have surpassed their 2019 HDI level. But among least developed countries, only one in two have recovered their already low pre-crisis HDI levels.

Top-Ranked Countries

The top-ranked countries in the **GII 2022** are:

1. Denmark
2. Norway
3. Switzerland
4. Sweden
5. Netherlands

India's Progress on Gender Inequality Index

Year	Rank	Score
2022	108	0.437
2021	122	0.490
2020	123	0.493
2019	122	0.501
2018	127	0.501

India's commitment to accelerating economic growth and improving the quality of life for its citizens is reflected in its steady progress on the Gender Inequality Index and other human development indicators.

Human Development Index (HDI)

India's Human Development Index (HDI) value has also increased to 0.644 in 2022, placing the country at the **134th spot out of 193 countries and territories**. This improvement comes after a drop in HDI value in 2021 and a flat trend over the past few years.

Since 1990, India has made remarkable progress in human development, with increases in life expectancy, expected years of schooling, mean years of schooling, and per-capita gross national income (GNI).

GOI Approves Electric Vehicle Policy to Boost Local Manufacturing

The **Indian government** made a landmark announcement on **March 15**, approving a comprehensive scheme aimed at positioning India as a global hub for **electric vehicle (EV) manufacturing**. This policy, designed by the Ministry of Commerce & Industry, seeks to entice significant investments from renowned global EV manufacturers into the Indian market. The essence of the policy is to foster innovation, attract investments, and make advanced technology accessible within the country.

Key Policy Highlights

- **Minimum Investment:** Companies are required to invest at least Rs 4,150 crore, with the policy not capping the maximum possible investment. This move is to ensure substantial financial influx into the EV sector.
- **Manufacturing Timeline:** The policy allows a three-year window for companies to establish their manufacturing facilities in India, commencing commercial production of EVs.
- **Local Sourcing:** A notable feature of this initiative is the mandate for companies to achieve a 25% localisation level by the end of the third year and 50% by the fifth year, promoting domestic industries and components.
- **Import Benefits:** To kickstart the transition, the government has permitted companies to import up to 8,000 EVs annually at a reduced customs duty of 15% on cars valued over \$35,000. This is a significant reduction from the current tariffs of 70% to 100%.

- **Incentive Caps and Conditions:** The duty waiver on imported EVs is directly linked to the company's investment or an equivalent incentive under the PLI scheme (capped at Rs 6,484 crore), whichever is lower. Furthermore, the policy outlines a limit of 40,000 EVs over five years, provided the investment hits the \$800 million mark.

Ensuring Compliance and Promoting Domestic Growth

To ensure that companies adhere to their commitments, a bank guarantee equivalent to the customs duty savings is required. This guarantee stands as a compliance measure, safeguarding the policy's objectives and ensuring that the benefits are accurately aligned with investments and local sourcing milestones.

A Leap Towards Sustainable Mobility

This policy is a strategic step towards enhancing the EV ecosystem in India, promoting the Make in India initiative, and ensuring access to cutting-edge technology. It aligns with the global shift towards sustainable transportation solutions, positioning India as a significant player in the EV manufacturing sector. Through this policy, the government aims not only to attract foreign investments but also to stimulate domestic production capabilities, fostering an environment conducive to the growth of the electric vehicle industry in India.

India's Human Development Index ranking 134 out of 193 countries

India's position in the United Nations Human Development Index (HDI) for 2022 improved slightly, ranking **134 out of 193 countries with an HDI value of 0.644**. This signifies progress in various dimensions of human development, albeit with a continued need to focus on women-led development, as highlighted by the UNDP.

India's HDI Trends

Between 1990 and 2022, India experienced a significant increase in its HDI value by **48.4%, from 0.434 to 0.644**, placing it in the medium human development category. The country's HDI improvement reflects advancements in life expectancy, education, and Gross National Income (GNI) per capita.

India's Gender Inequality Progress

India has shown progress in reducing gender inequality, ranking **108 out of 166 countries** in the Gender Inequality Index (GII) 2022. Despite improvements, there remains a significant gender gap in the labor force participation rate, with a difference of 47.8 percentage points between women and men.

Performance of India's Neighbors

Comparatively, India's neighbors vary in their human development achievements. Sri Lanka and China are ranked higher, categorized under the High Human Development category. Nepal and Pakistan have been ranked even lower in the HDI index.

Global Inequality Trends

The global HDI is projected to reach record highs in 2023, yet inequality persists. Rich countries have achieved record levels of human development, while half of the world's poorest countries remain below their pre-crisis levels, exacerbating global inequality and stoking political polarization.

Key Country Rankings in HDI 2022

Rank	Country	HDI Value	Change from 2021
75	China	0.788	+0.003
78	Iran	0.780	+0.004
78	Sri Lanka	0.780	-0.003
87	Maldives	0.762	+0.009
125	Bhutan	0.681	+0.004
129	Bangladesh	0.670	+0.008
134	India	0.644	+0.011
146	Nepal	0.601	+0.010
164	Pakistan	0.540	+0.003
182	Afghanistan	0.462	-0.011

These rankings highlight the varying degrees of human development across countries and underscore the need for concerted efforts to address inequalities and foster inclusive development globally.

Finland Tops Happiness Rankings For 7th Year, Afghanistan Ranks Last

The **World Happiness Report** is an annual survey conducted by the United Nations. It ranks countries based on factors like **life satisfaction, GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity, and corruption**.

For the seventh year in a row, **Finland** has been named the **happiest country** in the world. Other **Nordic countries** like **Denmark, Iceland, and Sweden** also ranked among the top 10 happiest nations.

World's 10 Happiest Countries in 2024

Rank	Country
1	Finland
2	Denmark
3	Iceland
4	Sweden
5	Israel
6	Netherlands
7	Norway
8	Luxembourg
9	Switzerland
10	Australia

Afghanistan Remains the Unhappiest Country

At the bottom of the list is **Afghanistan**, which has been plagued by a **humanitarian crisis** since the **Taliban** regained control in 2020.

Notable Changes in Rankings

- The **United States** and **Germany** dropped out of the top 20 happiest countries for the first time, ranking 23rd and 24th, respectively.
- **Costa Rica** and **Kuwait** entered the top 20 at positions 12 and 13.
- The report noted that the happiest countries no longer include any of the world's **largest countries**.

India's Ranking and Factors Affecting Life Satisfaction

- **India** ranked **126** in the happiness index, the same as the previous year.
- Factors like **marital status**, **social engagement**, and **physical health** also influence life satisfaction among older Indians.
- **Satisfaction with living arrangements** emerges as a critical factor, reflecting the strong desire among older Indians to age in place and maintain autonomy and social bonds.

India has the second-largest older population globally, with 140 million individuals aged 60 and above, trailing only China. The report said that older Indian men, particularly those in higher age brackets, presently married, and those with an education, tend to report greater life satisfaction compared to their counterparts.

Among older Indians, factors such as dissatisfaction with living arrangements, perceived discrimination, and poor self-rated health are linked to lower life satisfaction. Education level, social caste, and contentment with living arrangements also play a significant role in life satisfaction.

Happiness Trends

- The sharpest decline in happiness since 2006-10 was observed in **Afghanistan**, **Lebanon**, and **Jordan**.
- The biggest increases in happiness were reported in the Eastern European countries of **Serbia**, **Bulgaria**, and **Latvia**.
- **Happiness inequality** increased in every region except Europe, which the report described as a "worrying trend".

Factors Contributing to Finland's Happiness

According to a happiness researcher from the University of Helsinki, some key factors contributing to Finland's happiness include:

- **Close connection to nature**
- **Healthy work-life balance**
- **Attainable understanding of success** (not solely focused on financial gain)
- **Strong welfare society**
- **Trust in state authorities**
- **Low levels of corruption**
- **Free healthcare and education**

Generational Differences in Happiness

The report found that younger generations were happier than their older peers in most regions of the world, except for:

- **North America**
- **Australia**
- **New Zealand**

In these regions, happiness among groups under 30 has dropped dramatically since 2006-10, with older generations now happier than the young.

Most Important Current Affairs of April 2024

Hockey India Awards 2023

Hardik Singh and **Salima Tete** were named the **Players of the Year** for 2023 in the men's and women's categories, respectively, at the sixth annual **Hockey India Awards**.

During the event, Hockey India announced the **revival of the Hockey India League (HIL)**, which will return in **January 2025** after a hiatus since 2017. The revived league will feature **eight men's teams** and **six women's teams**, with auctions likely to be held after the **Paris Olympics**.

Notable Awards and Winners

- **Hardik Singh**, who was also the **FIH Player of the Year**, received the **Balbir Singh Sr. Trophy** and a cash prize of **₹25 lakhs**.
- The Indian teams that won the **Junior Asia Cups** and the **Asian Champions Trophy** (both men's and women's) were rewarded.
- The **men's Asian Games winning side** was also felicitated.

Other Award Winners:

- **P.R. Sreejesh** (Goalkeeper of the Year) – ₹5 lakhs
- **Harmanpreet Singh** (Defender of the Year) – ₹5 lakhs
- **Hardik Singh** (Midfielder of the Year) – ₹5 lakhs
- **Abhishek** (Forward of the Year) – ₹5 lakhs
- **Deepika Soreng** (Women's U-21 Player of the Year) – ₹10 lakhs
- **Araijeet Singh Hundal** (Men's U-21 Player of the Year) – ₹10 lakhs
- **Salima Tete** (Player of the Year, Women) – ₹25 lakhs
- **Ashok Kumar** (Major Dhyan Chand Lifetime Achievement Award) – ₹30 lakhs

The Hockey India Awards celebrated the outstanding performances of Indian hockey players and teams, while also recognizing the sport's rich history and legacy.

Forbes World's Billionaires List 2024: Indian Billionaires Make Their Mark

According to the Forbes 38th Annual World's Billionaires List 2024, **Mukesh Ambani**, Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Reliance Industries Limited (RIL), is the only Indian to make it to the list of the top 10 billionaires in the world. Ambani was ranked 9th on the list, which was topped by Bernard Arnault & family, owner of the French luxury giant LVMH.

Youngest Indian Billionaire:

Nikhil Kamath At the age of **37 years**, **Nikhil Kamath**, co-founder of **Zerodha**, is the **youngest Indian billionaire** in the Forbes list.

Global Wealth and Billionaire Count

According to the Forbes report, there are **2,781 billionaires** in the world from **77 countries**. The **combined wealth** of the billionaires was **\$14.2 trillion**, an increase of **\$2 trillion** from 2023.

Countries with the Highest Number of Billionaires

- **First:** The United States of America, with **813 billionaires** and a combined wealth of **\$5.7 trillion**.
- **Second:** China, with **406 billionaires** and a combined wealth of **\$1.3 trillion**.
- **Third:** India, with **200 billionaires** and a combined wealth of **\$954 billion**.
- **Fourth:** Germany, with **132 billionaires**.
- **Fifth:** Russia, with **120 billionaires**.

Top 10 Billionaires in the World

1. **Bernard Arnault & family** (France): \$233 billion
2. **Elon Musk** (USA): \$195 billion
3. **Jeff Bezos** (USA): \$194 billion
4. **Mark Zuckerberg** (USA): \$177 billion
5. **Larry Ellison** (USA): \$114 billion
6. **Warren Buffett** (USA): \$133 billion
7. **Bill Gates** (USA): \$128 billion
8. **Steve Ballmer** (USA): \$121 billion
9. **Mukesh Ambani** (India): \$116 billion
10. **Larry Page** (USA): \$114 billion

Top 10 Indian Billionaires

1. **Mukesh Ambani**: \$116 billion (9th globally)
2. **Gautam Adani**: \$84 billion (17th globally)
3. **Shiv Nadar**: \$36.9 billion (39th globally)
4. **Savitri Jindal & Family**: \$33.5 billion (46th globally)
5. **Dilip Shanghvi**: \$26.7 billion (69th globally)
6. **Cyrus Poonawala**: \$21.3 billion (90th globally)
7. **Kushal Pal Singh**: \$20.9 billion (92nd globally)
8. **Kumarmangalam Birla**: \$19.7 billion (98th globally)
9. **Radhakrishna Damani**: \$17.6 billion (107th globally)
10. **Lakshmi Mittal**: \$16.4 billion (113th globally)

World Economic Forum Announces 2024 Young Global Leaders Community

The **World Economic Forum (WEF)** has announced the **20th edition of its Young Global Leaders Community**: The Class of 2024. The list includes nearly 90 individuals under the age of 40 from diverse fields, including politics, business, civil society, the arts, and academia.

Indians Included in the 2024 List

This year, five Indians have been selected for the Young Global Leaders program. They are:

1. **Bhumi Pednekar** (Art and Culture) – Bollywood actress known for films like “Dum Laga Ke Haisha”, “Toilet: Ek Prem Katha”, and “Badhaai Do”

2. **Adwaita Nayar** (Business) – Chief Executive Officer, Nyka Fashion
3. **Arjun Bhartia** (Business) – Director, Jubilant Group
4. **Priya Aggarwal Hebbar** (Business) – Non-Executive Director, Vedanta Limited
5. **Sharad Vivek Sagar** (Social Entrepreneurs) – Founder and Chief Executive Officer, Dexterity Global

Hurun Global Unicorn Index 2024: Unveiling the State of Global Startup Ecosystem

In 2024, the global unicorn landscape witnessed significant developments and challenges, as outlined in the **Hurun Global Unicorn Index**. While the **United States maintained its lead with 703 unicorns** and **China followed with 340**, **India ranked third with 67 unicorns**. However, India experienced a notable decline in unicorn creation for the first time since 2017, attributed primarily to a lack of investment despite robust stock market performance.

India's Declining Unicorn Creation: A Concerning Trend

India, once a burgeoning hub for startups, witnessed a notable decline in unicorn creation for the first time since 2017, according to the **Hurun Global Unicorn Index 2024**. Despite ranking third globally with 67 unicorns, India experienced a slowdown attributed mainly to a lack of investment, despite robust stock market performance.

Offshore Unicorn Creation: A Surprising Revelation

Contrary to the domestic slowdown, Indian founders showcased remarkable entrepreneurial prowess abroad. The report highlighted India's role as a significant contributor to offshore unicorns, with 109 unicorns founded outside the country, surpassing the count within India.

Global Unicorn Landscape: Insights and Trends

The Hurun Global Unicorn Index cataloged 1,453 unicorns across 53 countries and 291 cities, reflecting the diverse and expansive nature of the startup ecosystem. While the US and China led in unicorn count, the index underscored the emergence of unicorns from diverse locations, including Australia and Malta.

Year of AI: Transformative Innovations and Valuation Surges

The year **2024** was hailed as “the year of AI,” marked by notable advancements and valuation surges in **AI-driven startups**. OpenAI's valuation soared to \$100 billion, symbolizing the growing influence of AI technologies globally, with notable contributions from startups in China and elsewhere.

Entrepreneurship Evolution: Global Expansion and Spinoffs

Entrepreneurship witnessed a golden era, with the number of unicorns tripling since 2019. While the US led in unicorn creation, China emerged as a significant player, driven by sectors like AI, semiconductors, and new energy. Moreover, spinoffs from larger companies, particularly in China, added to the diversity and innovation within the unicorn landscape.

Top 10 Unicorns: Key Players and Value Contribution

The top 10 unicorns represented a substantial portion of the world's unicorn valuation, contributing \$198 billion in value addition. Notable newcomers like **OpenAI**, **Canva**, and **Binance** reshaped the unicorn hierarchy, highlighting the evolving dynamics of the global startup ecosystem.

105 Years of Jallianwala Bagh Massacre

The **Amritsar Massacre**, also known as the **Jallianwala Bagh Massacre**, remains one of the darkest episodes in India's struggle for independence. On **April 13, 1919**, **General Dyer** ordered his soldiers to open fire on an unarmed gathering in Jallianwala Bagh, Amritsar, leading to hundreds of deaths and injuries. In **2024**, **India observes 105th anniversary of the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre** which serves as a poignant reminder of the sacrifices made in the pursuit of freedom. The repercussions of this atrocity continue to reverberate through history, influencing political discourse and public memory.

Background of Jallianwala Bagh Massacre

The **aftermath of World War I** saw heightened expectations among Indians for greater political autonomy from British colonial rule. However, instead of easing repressive emergency powers, the **British government passed the Rowlatt Acts in 1919**, further inflaming tensions. Widespread discontent, particularly in the Punjab region, set the stage for a confrontation between Indian nationalists and British authorities.

The Buildup to Tragedy

The **arrest and banishment** of prominent **Indian leaders in Amritsar** sparked violent protests on **April 10, 1919**. Amidst the chaos, **Brig. Gen. Reginald Edward Harry Dyer** was tasked with restoring order, imposing a ban on public gatherings and escalating tensions in the city.

Jallianwala Bagh Massacre Unfolds

On **April 13**, a peaceful gathering of thousands at **Jallianwala Bagh**, enclosed by walls with only one exit, became the site of unspeakable horror. Without warning, British troops under Dyer's command opened fire on the unarmed crowd, trapping them within the confines of the space. The indiscriminate shooting continued until the soldiers ran out of ammunition, leaving hundreds dead and many more wounded.

Jallianwala Bagh Massacre – Consequences

News of the massacre spread rapidly, sparking outrage across India and beyond. **Rabindranath Tagore** renounced his **knighthood in protest**, while **Mohandas Gandhi**, initially hesitant to act, launched the **noncooperation movement** in response to the atrocity. The British government ordered an investigation, resulting in Dyer's censure and resignation from the military. However, reactions in Britain were mixed, with some praising Dyer as a hero.

Legacy of Jallianwala Bagh Massacre

The Jallianwala Bagh site, now a national monument, serves as a poignant reminder of the sacrifices made in the struggle for Indian independence. The massacre left a permanent scar on Indo-British relations and galvanized the Indian nationalist movement, paving the way for future resistance against colonial rule.

World Cybercrime Index Unveiled: Russia and Ukraine Top List

A newly developed **World Cybercrime Index** sheds light on the origins and prevalence of cybercrime across the globe. Compiled by a team of researchers including Miranda Bruce, Jonathan Lusthaus, Ridhi Kashyap, Nigel Phair, and Federico Varese, the index draws insights from surveys conducted among leading cybercrime experts worldwide. Despite challenges in pinpointing cybercriminal locations due to sophisticated masking techniques, the index identifies key countries where cybercrime thrives, emphasizing the urgent need for targeted preventive measures.

Research Methodology and Findings

The index is based on a comprehensive survey completed by 92 top cybercrime experts. Through expert focus groups and pilots, the survey refined insights into five categories of cybercrime: technical products/services, attacks/extortion, data/identity theft, scams, and cashing out/money laundering. Results highlight a concentration of cybercriminal activity in select countries, with **China, Russia, Ukraine, the United States, Romania, and Nigeria** consistently ranking among the top 10 across all categories.

Key Rankings and Insights

- Russia and Ukraine emerge as the top two hubs of cybercrime, according to the index.
- India secures the 10th position, scoring notably in impact, professionalism, and technical skills.
- China and the United States closely follow, showcasing their prominence in cybercriminal activities.
- Certain cybercrimes are associated with specific countries, such as data/identity theft with the United States and technical products/services with China.

Implications and Limitations

While the index offers valuable insights for cybercrime research and preventive efforts, it faces limitations. The pool of experts surveyed may not represent global diversity adequately, potentially skewing results. Moreover, interpretations of survey questions could introduce inaccuracies. Additionally, the index does not fully address the complex landscape of state-sponsored cybercrime and profit-driven illicit activities, signaling the need for further research and nuanced approaches to combatting cyber threats.

Indian Girls Shine at 13th European Girls' Mathematical Olympiad 2024

The 13th edition of the prestigious **European Girls' Mathematical Olympiad (EGMO)** took place in the picturesque city of **Tskaltubo, Georgia**, from April 11 to 17, 2024. Amidst fierce competition, the Indian contingent emerged victorious, showcasing their remarkable mathematical prowess and securing a coveted haul of medals.

Medal Tally: A Resounding Success

The 4-member Indian team clinched a total of four medals, including two **silver** and two **bronze**, in the 13th EGMO 2024. The illustrious medal winners are:

Student's Name	Location (State)	Award/Medal
Gunjan Agarwal	Gurgaon, Haryana	Silver Medal
Sanjana Philo Chacko	Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala	Silver Medal
Larissa	Hisar, Haryana	Bronze Medal
Saeer Vitthal Patil	Pune, Maharashtra	Bronze Medal

Guiding Force: A Dedicated Mentorship

The Indian team's success can be attributed to the unwavering guidance and support provided by the esteemed mentors, **Sahil Mhaskar** (Head), **Ms. Aditi Muthkhole** (Deputy Head), and **Ms. Ananya Ranade** (Supervisor) from the **Chennai Mathematical Institute**. Their mentorship has been instrumental in shaping the team's exceptional performance.

A Remarkable Milestone

This achievement marks the second time in India's EGMO journey, which began in 2015, that all four participants have secured medals at the prestigious competition. This feat not only celebrates the individual brilliance of the participants but also highlights India's growing stature in the global mathematical arena.

Nurturing Excellence: TIFR-HBCSE's Pivotal Role

The **Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR) – Homi Bhabha Center for Science Education (HBCSE)** serves as India's nodal center for Olympiad programs in various disciplines, including Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Astronomy, and Junior Science. With structured training through the **EGMO Training Camp (EGMOTC)** and continuous support from the **National Board of Higher Mathematics** (Department of Atomic Energy), HBCSE plays a pivotal role in nurturing and preparing talented students for prestigious international competitions.

Felicitation Ceremony: Celebrating Excellence

To honor the achievements of the Indian delegation, a felicitation ceremony was organized at the Main Building of HBCSE on the morning of April 18, 2024. The ceremony served as a platform to celebrate the remarkable success of these young mathematical prodigies and acknowledge their dedication and hard work.

As India continues to foster an environment that nurtures and encourages excellence in the field of mathematics, the achievements of the Indian team at the 13th EGMO 2024 serve as a testament to the nation's commitment to promoting and recognizing exceptional talent on the global stage.

The Laureus World Sports Awards 2024 Announced

The prestigious **2024 Laureus Sports Awards** ceremony, held in Madrid, was a grand celebration of the world's best athletes and their remarkable achievements. The event honored several sporting icons who have left an indelible mark on their respective disciplines.

Laureus World Sportsman of the Year: Novak Djokovic

Novak Djokovic, the world's top-ranked tennis player, etched his name in the annals of Laureus history by becoming the **Laureus World Sportsman of the Year for the fifth time**. This achievement matched Roger Federer's record for the most decorated male athlete in this category. Djokovic had previously won this coveted award in 2012, 2015, 2016, and 2019.

Laureus World Sportswoman of the Year: Aitana Bonmatí

In a historic moment, **Aitana Bonmatí**, a football star from Barcelona and the Spanish national team, became the first footballer to be named the **Laureus World Sportswoman of the Year**. Her exceptional skills and sportsmanship on the pitch were celebrated, marking a significant milestone for the sport.

Comeback of the Year: Simone Biles

Simone Biles, the American artistic gymnast, added another accolade to her impressive collection. With 37 World and Olympic medals, she is now the most decorated gymnast in history. Her remarkable comeback and outstanding contributions to the sport were duly recognized at the awards ceremony.

Breakthrough of the Year: Jude Bellingham

Jude Bellingham, an English professional footballer who plays as a midfielder for Real Madrid and the England national team, was honored for his breakthrough performances. Carlos Alcaraz, a tennis ace and a Real Madrid fan, presented the award to Bellingham, acknowledging his contributions to the sport.

Sporting Legends Gracing the Ceremony

The event was graced by sporting legends who presented awards to the winners. **Tom Brady**, a seven-time Super Bowl champion, and **Usain Bolt**, the sprinting GOAT, presented the awards to Djokovic and Bonmatí, respectively, adding to the event's grandeur and significance.

Other Notable Awards

- **Team of the Year Award:** Spain Women's Football Team
- **Action Sportsperson of the Year Award:** Arisa Trew
- **Laureus Sport for Good Award:** Fundación Rafa Nadal
- **Sportsperson of the Year with a Disability Award:** Diede de Groot

About the Laureus Sports Awards

The Laureus World Sports Awards is an annual event that celebrates remarkable sporting achievements and showcases the initiatives of Laureus Sport for Good. Shortlists for various categories are created through votes from over 1,000 sports media professionals from more than 70 countries, while the International Paralympic Committee shortlists the World Athlete of the Year with a Disability.

The winners in each category are determined by votes from the Laureus World Sports Academy, a unique group of sporting legends. The event provides a platform for supporting Laureus Sport for Good by showcasing the incredible work done to transform young lives worldwide.

The 2024 Laureus Sports Awards ceremony was a fitting tribute to the world's greatest athletes and their achievements, highlighting the values of sportsmanship, perseverance, and excellence that inspire generations.

Alok Shukla Wins Prestigious Goldman Environmental Prize 2024

Alok Shukla, a renowned environmental activist and convenor of Chhattisgarh Bachao Andolan, has been selected for the **prestigious 2024 Goldman Environmental Prize**. Also known as the **"Green Nobel Prize,"** this annual award honours grassroots environmental champions worldwide for their outstanding contributions to environmental protection.

Winners of the 2024 Goldman Environmental Prize

This year, seven people from six inhabited regions of the globe have been selected for the annual Goldman Environmental Prize. They are :

Serial no.	Winner	Country	Region
1	Marcel Gomes	Brazil	South and Central America
2	Murrawah Maroochy Johnson	Australia	Islands & Island Nations
3	Alok Shukla	India	Asia
4	Teresa Vicente	Spain	Europe
5	Andrea Vidaurre	United States of America	North America
6	Nonhle Mbuthuma and Sinegugu Zukulu	South Africa	Africa

Eminent Personalities Honoured with Prestigious Pandit Lacchu Maharaj Award

Noted Hindi film superstars **Hema Malini** and **Saira Banu**, along with other prominent personalities from the fields of art and culture, will be honoured with the prestigious Pandit Lacchu Maharaj Award. The award ceremony will take place on **31 August 2024** in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.

10 eminent personalities to be awarded the Lacchu Maharaj award

The Lacchu Maharaj Award, Instituted in memory of the famous kathak exponent Lacchu Maharaj, was not given after 2014. Thus, the Pandit Lacchu Maharaj Ballet Foundation has decided to honour 10 personalities this year. No award has been announced for the year 2020 due to COVID-19. The awardees are:

Serial Number	Awardee	Award for Year	Belongs to Place	Exponent of Dance form
1	Uma Sharma	2015	New Delhi	Kathak
2	Rama Vaidyanathan	2016	New Delhi	Kathak
3	Uma Dogra	2017	Jaipur	Kathak
4	Hema Malini	2018	Mumbai	Kathak, Film actress
5	Saira Banu	2019	Mumbai	Kathak, Film actress
6	Sandhya Puricha, Chairman of Sangeet Natak Akademi	2018	Mumbai	Bharatanatyam Exponent
7	Dr. Malabika Mitra	2021	Kolkata	Kathak
8	Prachi Shah	2022	Mumbai	Kathak, Film actress
9	Ashim Bandhu Bhattacharya	2023	Mumbai	Kathak
10	Pandit Rajendra Gangani	2024	Jaipur	Kathak

Most Important Current Affairs of May 2024

IPL 2024 Award Winners, Check the Complete list

Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) won the IPL 2024 title, defeating **Sunrisers Hyderabad (SRH)** in the final. **KKR's Sunil Narine** was named the Most Valuable Player and Ultimate Fantasy Player of the Season. **SRH's Nitish Kumar Reddy** was the Emerging Player of the Season. **Virat Kohli (RCB)** won the Orange Cap for most runs, while **Harshal Patel (PBKS)** took the Purple Cap for most wickets. Other award winners included **Abhishek Sharma (SRH)** for Most Sixes, **Travis Head (SRH)** for Most Fours, and **Jake Fraser-McGurk (DC)** for Best Strike Rate. **SRH** received the Fair Play Award, while the **Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium in Hyderabad** won the Pitch and Ground Award.

Here is the full list of awards for the Indian Premier League 2024 season

Kolkata Knight Riders emerged as champions of IPL 2024, defeating **Sunrisers Hyderabad** in the final. **Sunil Narine (KKR)** won the Most Valuable Player and Ultimate Fantasy Player awards, while **Virat Kohli (RCB)** and **Harshal Patel (PBKS)** claimed the Orange and Purple Caps respectively.

Award	Recipient
Winner (Rs. 20 crore)	Kolkata Knight Riders
Runner Up (Rs. 12.5 crore)	Sunrisers Hyderabad
Emerging Player of the Season (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Nitish Kumar Reddy (SRH)
Ultimate Fantasy Player of the Season (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Sunil Narine (KKR)
Most Valuable Player (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Sunil Narine (KKR)
Orange Cap (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Virat Kohli (RCB)
Purple Cap (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Harshal Patel (PBKS)
Most Sixes Award (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Abhishek Sharma (SRH)
Most Fours Award (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Travis Head (SRH)
Best Strike Rate Award (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Jake Fraser-McGurk (DC)
Catch of the Season (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Ramandeep Singh (KKR)
Fair Play Award (Rs. 10 Lakh)	Sunrisers Hyderabad
Pitch and Ground Award (Rs. 50 Lakh)	Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium, Hyderabad
Player of the match (IPL Final)	Mitchell Starc
Fantasy player of the match (IPL Final)	Mitchell Starc
Most sixes in the match (IPL Final)	Venkatesh Iyer
Most fours in the match (IPL Final)	Rahmanullah Gurbaz
Most dot balls in the match (IPL Final)	Harshit Rana

World Press Freedom Index 2024 Announced, India Ranked 159th Out of 180 Countries

In the latest edition of the **World Press Freedom Index** published annually by **Reporters Without Borders (RSF)**, India finds itself at a concerning position, **ranking 159th out of 180 countries**. This marks a slight improvement from its **previous rank of 161**, yet it still underscores significant challenges faced by journalists in the country. Surprisingly, India trails behind its neighboring nation **Pakistan**, which holds the **152nd position**, while Sri Lanka stands at 150th place. **Norway** topped the ranking, while **Denmark** was on the second rank in World Press Freedom Index. **Sweden** ranked third on the list.

Press Freedom Index Overview

The **World Press Freedom Index** evaluates **180 countries** based on the freedom and independence journalists have to work and report. The rankings shed light on the varying degrees of press freedom across the globe. In the **Asia-Pacific region**, which ranks as the **world's second most challenging area for journalism**, several countries, including Myanmar,

China, North Korea, Vietnam, and Afghanistan, are among the most dangerous for media personnel. Notably, no Asian country made it to the **Index's top 15 this year**, indicating a pervasive challenge to press freedom in the region.

Press Freedom in South Asia

The **recently released 2024 World Press Freedom Index** by **Reporters Without Borders (RSF)** has once again shed light on the state of press freedom across the globe. In **South Asia**, India finds itself ranked at **159th**, while its neighbor **Pakistan stands marginally higher at 152**. **Sri Lanka**, another regional player, is **positioned at 150**. These rankings underscore the challenges journalists face in the region, where the ability to work and report independently is often compromised.

Changing Dynamic in Asia-Pacific Region

The **Asia-Pacific region**, known for its complexities, presents a challenging landscape for journalists. **Myanmar, China, North Korea, Vietnam, and Afghanistan** are among the **top ten most dangerous countries for media personnel**, reflecting the precarious environment journalists operate in. Notably, this year sees none of the region's countries in the top 15 of the index, signaling a concerning trend for press freedom advocates.

Middle East and North Africa

In the **Middle East and North Africa**, press freedom concerns persist, with **nearly half of the countries facing "very serious" situations**. Countries like **Yemen, Saudi Arabia, Iran, and Syria** continue to grapple with challenges to journalistic freedom. The United Arab Emirates joins the list of countries in the red zone, highlighting widespread issues across the region.

Europe's Role and Challenges

Contrastingly, Europe, particularly within the **European Union**, boasts countries where press freedom is **considered "good."** However, challenges persist, with countries like **Hungary, Malta, and Greece** facing scrutiny for their treatment of the media. The adoption of the **European Media Freedom Act (EMFA)** reflects efforts to safeguard press freedom within the EU.

Global Trends and Concerns

The **2024 World Press Freedom Index** reveals a worrying decline in the political indicator, one of five detailed indicators in the report. States and political forces are increasingly failing to protect press freedom, leading to hostile actions against journalists. The use of artificial intelligence, particularly in disinformation campaigns, poses a significant threat, with deepfakes being utilized to influence elections.

War Against Nature and Journalist Peril

Journalists covering environmental stories also face significant risks, **with 44 journalists killed in the past 15 years** while reporting on environmental issues. This underscores the dangers associated with reporting on critical global issues and the need to protect journalists working in these areas.

2024 Pulitzer Prize Winners Announced

The prestigious **Pulitzer Prizes** for 2024 were announced on **May 7, 2024**, by **Columbia University** in the United States of America. The awards, considered the most prestigious in the fields of journalism and arts, were conferred by Columbia University on the recommendation of the **Pulitzer Prize Board**. The winners will be formally recognized at a ceremony later, presided over by the president of Columbia University.

Journalism Category

Category	Winner
Public Service	Pro Publica (Joshua Kaplan, Justin Elliott, Brett Murphy, Alex Mierjeski, and Kirsten Berg)
Investigative Reporting	Hannah Dreier (The New York Times)
International Reporting	Staff of The New York Times
Editorial Writing	David E. Hoffman (The Washington Post)
Breaking News Photography	Photography Staff of Reuters
Feature Photography	Photography Staff of Associated Press
Audio Reporting	Staff of the Invisible Institute and USG Audio

Book, Drama, and Music Category

Category	Winner
Fiction	Night Watch by Jayne Anne Phillips
Drama	Primary Trust by Eboni Booth
History	No Right to an Honest Living: The Struggles of Boston's Black Workers in the Civil War Era by Jacqueline Jones
Biography	King: A Life by Jonathan Eig Master Slave Husband Wife: An Epic Journey from Slavery to Freedom by Ilyon Woo
Memoir and Autobiography	Liliana's Invincible Summer: A Sister's Search for Justice by Cristina Rivera Garza
Poetry	Tripas: Poems by Brandon Som
Music	Adagio (For Wadada Leo Smith) by Tyshawn Sorey
General Nonfiction	A Day in the Life of Abed Salama: Anatomy of a Jerusalem Tragedy by Nathan Thrall

Special Awards and Citations

- A special citation was issued to the late writer and critic **Gregory Stephen Tate (Greg Tate)**, an American writer, musician, and producer.

- A special citation was also given to journalists and media workers covering the war in Gaza.

Indian Literary Masterpieces Inscribed on UNESCO's Memory of the World Register

In a **proud moment** for India, three of its literary treasures – the **Ramcharitmanas**, **Panchatantra**, and **Sahṛdayāloka-Locana** – have been inscribed on **UNESCO's Memory of the World Asia-Pacific Regional Register**. This prestigious recognition celebrates India's **rich literary heritage** and **cultural legacy**, affirming the timeless wisdom and artistic expressions that have shaped the nation's identity.

Preserving Timeless Wisdom for Future Generations

The **inclusion** of these masterpieces in the Register signifies a crucial step in **global cultural preservation efforts**. It ensures that the profound teachings and narratives embodied within these works continue to **inspire and enlighten** generations to come, transcending boundaries of time and place.

Honoring the Creative Genius of Literary Legends

The **Ramcharitmanas**, authored by the renowned **Goswami Tulsidas**, the **Panchatantra** by **Pt. Vishnu Sharma**, and the **Sahṛdayāloka-Locana** by **Acharya Anandvardhan**, have profoundly influenced Indian literature and culture. These literary gems have left an **indelible mark** on readers and artists alike, shaping the nation's **moral fabric** and **artistic expressions**.

IGNCA's Pivotal Role in Securing Global Recognition

The **Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA)** played a pivotal role in securing this historic achievement during the **10th meeting of the Memory of the World Committee for Asia and the Pacific (MOWCAP)**. Professor **Ramesh Chandra Gaur**, representing IGNCA, successfully presented and defended the nominations, highlighting their cultural significance and garnering support from representatives and observers.

A Milestone in Cultural Preservation and Promotion

This milestone not only celebrates India's literary gems but also underscores IGNCA's unwavering dedication to **preserving and promoting** the nation's cultural heritage on a global stage. It reaffirms the organization's commitment to advancing India's literary legacy and contributing to the collective efforts of cultural preservation worldwide.

With the **Ramcharitmanas**, **Panchatantra**, and **Sahṛdayāloka-Locana** now inscribed on the prestigious Register, India's literary treasures have secured their rightful place among the world's most significant cultural assets, ensuring their enduring impact for generations to come.

2024 MOWCAP Regional Register for Asia-Pacific

Serial Number	Inscribed Item	Country
1	Funafuti: The Edgeworth David 1897 Expedition Documents	Australia and Tuvalu
2	Sultana's Dream- by Rokeya S. Hossain	Bangladesh
3	Archives Relating to the Chengdu Traditional Teahouses	China
4	Huizhou Genealogy Archives	China
5	Printing Blocks Housed at the Derge Printing House	China
6	The Illustrated Manuscripts of Rāmacaritamānasa of Tulasīdāsa	India
7	The Manuscript of the Sahṛdayāloka-Locana: Seminal Text of Indian Poetics	India
8	The 15th Century Manuscript of the Pañcatantra Fables	India
9	Indarung I, The First Cement Plant in Southeast Asia (1910-1972)	Indonesia
10	Indonesian Sugar Research Institute's Archives 1887-1986: The Role of ISRI's Research Activities to the World Sugar Industry	Indonesia
11	The Tambo Tuanku Imam Bonjol Manuscript	Indonesia
12	Al-Tarikh Salasilah Negeri Kedah: Genealogical History of Kedah State	Malaysia
13	The Royal Correspondence of Baginda Omar (Surat Persendirian Baginda Omar)	Malaysia
14	Family Chart of Hereditary Lords of the Khalkha Mongols, the House of Genghis Khan	Mongolia
15	Mongolia's First Postage Stamps 'Eldev Ochir'	Mongolia
16	Doctrina Christiana en Lengua Española y Tagala (Christian Doctrine in Spanish and Tagalog), Manila, 1593	Philippines
17	Hinilawod Epic Chant Recordings	Philippines
18	Images of Khorezm Oasis by Khudaibergan Devanov (1879-1937)	Uzbekistan
19	Turkestan Album" 1871-1872	Uzbekistan
20	Bas-reliefs on the Nine Bronze Urns in Huế Imperial Palace	Vietnam

World's super-rich list of the Bloomberg Billionaires Index

Mukesh Ambani and Gautam Adani have made it to the **top 15 world's super-rich list of the Bloomberg Billionaires Index**. This marks a significant achievement, especially for Gautam Adani, who reclaimed his position after losing it in 2023 due to short selling in his company's stock. Notably, for the first time, all individuals in the top 15 have a net worth of \$100 billion or more.

Mukesh Ambani's Ranking and Wealth

Mukesh Ambani, Chairman and Managing Director of Reliance Industries Limited (RIL), is **ranked 12th with a wealth of \$110 billion**. RIL operates across various sectors including petrochemicals, oil and gas, telecom, retail, and financial services, making Ambani one of the wealthiest individuals globally.

Gautam Adani's Comeback

Gautam Adani, with a **wealth of \$100 billion**, is **ranked 14th**. Adani Group's business interests span ports, airports, power generation and transmission, green energy, edible oils, cement, and real estate. After a challenging year in 2023 due to accusations from Hindenburg Research and a subsequent sharp decline in his company's stock prices, Adani's fortunes

rebounded. The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) and the Supreme Court cleared his name, leading to a resurgence in share prices driven by foreign investment.

First Woman to Reach \$100 Billion

Bettencourt Meyers, owner of the famous **L'Oreal company**, has become the **first woman to achieve a net worth of \$100 billion**. Her wealth reached \$101 billion, placing her **14th on the list**, due to L'Oreal's share price recording its best year since 1998. This milestone marks a significant achievement in gender representation among the world's wealthiest.

Richest Person in South America

Carlos Slim of Mexico, with a **net worth of \$106 billion**, has been included in the list for the first time, **ranking 13th**. Slim's wealth comes from his diverse business interests, including construction, telecommunications, and retail. He is the richest person in South America, highlighting the region's economic potential.

World's Richest Man

Bernard Arnault, the founder and CEO of LVMH, continues to lead the **world's richest list with a net worth of \$222 billion**. LVMH's luxury brands have maintained robust performance, securing Arnault's top position.

Other notable rankings on the list of billionaires in the world:

- **Jeff Bezos:** The founder of Amazon.com Inc. is the second richest person with a net worth of \$208 billion.
- **Elon Musk:** CEO of Tesla, ranks third with a net worth of \$187 billion. Despite a significant drop of over \$40 billion this year, Musk remains one of the wealthiest individuals globally.

ICC Players of the Month for April 2024 Announced

The International Cricket Council (ICC) has revealed the winners of the **ICC Player of the Month** awards for **April 2024**.

Hayley Matthews: ICC Women's Player of the Month

Hayley Matthews, the West Indies captain, has been named the **ICC Women's Player of the Month** for her exceptional all-round performances that spearheaded the West Indies' success in Pakistan across both ODI and T20I series.

Dominant Displays Across Formats

Matthews' third ICC Women's Player of the Month award comes after an array of eye-catching all-round displays in April, resulting in **451 runs** and **12 wickets** across both ODIs and T20Is.

The West Indies skipper set the tone early with an unbeaten 140 and three wickets in the opening ODI, followed by a 141-run knock and two wickets in the third ODI, sealing the series sweep.

In the subsequent T20I series, Matthews reinforced her position as the top-ranked Women's T20I all-rounder, scoring back-to-back half-centuries and taking six wickets, inspiring the tourists to a 4-1 series triumph.

Muhammad Waseem: ICC Men's Player of the Month

Muhammad Waseem, the UAE captain and opener, has been named the **ICC Men's Player of the Month** for his notable run-scoring feats as the UAE triumphed in the ACC Premier Cup.

Explosive Batting Displays

Waseem becomes the first UAE player to win the accolade, thanks to a string of powerful knocks that saw his side claim the ACC Premier Cup in Oman.

The opener struck **269 runs** during the month at an average of 44.83, including a sparkling 56-ball century in the final showdown against the hosts.

With an eye-catching strike rate of 182.99, Waseem's explosive strokeplay was evident throughout the UAE's campaign, with brisk knocks against Bahrain, Oman, and Cambodia.

Most Important Current Affairs of June 2024

T20 World Cup 2024, India Lifts the Trophy

India beats South Africa by 7 runs and lifts the India lifts ICC T20 World Cup 2024 for 2nd time after 2007. India has ended an 11-year trophy drought by defeating South Africa in the T20 World Cup final by a margin of 7 runs. This victory marks India's second T20 World Cup title. At the end of their 20 overs, South Africa managed to reach 169/8, chasing India's 176/7.

T20 World Cup 2024, India Lifts the Trophy

Earlier, **Virat Kohli (76)** and **Axar Patel (47)** weathered the early storm to push India to a competitive score in the ICC Men's T20 World Cup final against South Africa in Bridgetown on June 29.

Here is the list of all winners of the T20 World Cup 2024:

- Player of the match – Virat Kohli (India)
 - Player of the tournament – Jasprit Bumrah (India)
- Meanwhile, Afghanistan's Rahmanullah Gurbaz finished the tournament with most runs – 281 in eight innings at a strike rate of over 124. Rohit Sharma was second in the list with 257 runs at a strike rate of 156.70. Afghanistan's Fazalhaq Farooqi was the joint highest wicket-taker with along with India's Arshdeep Singh – 17 wickets.

Virat Kohli dropped a bombshell that sent shockwaves through the cricketing world. The **33-year-old batting maestro** announced his retirement from T20 international cricket, bringing an end to a glittering career in the shortest format of the game.

Kohli's decision came moments after he was awarded the **Man of the Match** trophy for his stellar performance in the final. The timing of his announcement added a bittersweet flavor to India's victory celebrations, as fans grappled with mixed emotions of joy and sadness. Following Virat Kohli's decision to step away from T20 internationals, Indian captain **Rohit Sharma** revealed that he too had played his final match in the format. Star India all-rounder **Ravindra Jadeja** has announced his decision to **retire from T20 internationals** following **India's T20 World Cup 2024 triumph**. Ravindra Jadeja has called it quits from **T20 internationals**, bowing out on a high with the **T20 World Cup 2024 trophy**.



PM Narendra Modi Takes Oath for the 3rd term as PM

On a historic day, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** took the oath of office for an unprecedented **third straight term** as the head of a **coalition government**. The swearing-in ceremony witnessed the induction of several leaders from the **National Democratic Alliance (NDA)** partners, reflecting the BJP's commitment to rewarding its allies.

Modi's Remarkable Achievement

At the age of 73, Modi equalled the feat of India's first Prime Minister, **Jawaharlal Nehru**, who won three consecutive general elections in **1952, 1957, and 1962**. This achievement underscores Modi's enduring popularity and his party's dominance in the country's political landscape.

Cabinet Composition: Balancing Experience and Allies

Following Modi's oath-taking, several senior leaders, including **Rajnath Singh**, **Amit Shah**, and **Nitin Gadkari**, were sworn in as **Cabinet Ministers**. Seasoned leaders like **Nirmala Sitharaman** also retained their positions, ensuring continuity and experience in key portfolios.

In a strategic move, Modi inducted several MPs from NDA partners, acknowledging their contributions to the alliance's success. The **Telugu Desam Party (TDP)** and the BJP in Andhra Pradesh, where the NDA won an impressive **21 out of 25 Lok Sabha seats**, secured two ministerial berths each.

Other notable inclusions were **Ram Mohan Naidu** and **Pemmasani Chandrashekhar** from the TDP, **H.D. Kumaraswamy** from the JD(S), and **Sarbananda Sonowal** from the BJP.

NDA's Electoral Performance

The NDA secured a comfortable **286 seats** in the recently concluded general elections. However, the BJP's individual tally of **240 seats** fell short of the **272-majority mark**, indicating a decline from its previous performances of **303 seats in 2019** and **282 seats in 2014**.

International Presence at the Swearing-in Ceremony

Reflecting India's growing global stature, leaders from seven countries in the **South Asia** and **Indian Ocean** regions graced the swearing-in ceremony with their presence. Their attendance underscores the importance of strengthening regional ties and fostering cooperation in the region.

As Modi embarks on his third term, the nation eagerly anticipates the unveiling of his cabinet's complete composition and the allocation of crucial portfolios. With a blend of experienced leaders and fresh faces from coalition partners, the new government is poised to tackle the challenges ahead and chart a course towards a prosperous and inclusive India.

QS World University Rankings 2025 Announced

The much-awaited **QS World University Rankings 2025** have been announced, featuring an impressive **1,500 universities** across **105 higher education systems**. This year's ranking stands as the largest ever, underscoring the global commitment to academic excellence and innovation.

Top-Ranked Universities

The rankings are led by prestigious institutions that have consistently maintained their positions at the forefront of higher education. Here are the top 10 universities according to the QS World University Rankings 2025:

Rank	University	Location	Overall Score
1	Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)	Cambridge, United States	100
2	Imperial College London	London, United Kingdom	98.5
3	University of Oxford	Oxford, United Kingdom	96.9
4	Harvard University	Cambridge, United States	96.8
5	University of Cambridge	Cambridge, United Kingdom	96.7
6	Stanford University	Stanford, United States	96.1
7	ETH Zurich	Zürich, Switzerland	93.9
8	National University of Singapore (NUS)	Singapore	93.7
9	UCL	London, United Kingdom	91.6
10	California Institute of Technology (Caltech)	Pasadena, United States	90.9

Top-Ranked Universities-India

Rank	University	Location	Overall Score
118	Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IITB)	Mumbai, India	56.3
=150	Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IITD)	New Delhi, India	52.1
211	Indian Institute of Science	Bangalore, India	45.0
=222	Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur (IIT-KGP)	Kharagpur, India	43.7
=227	Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IITM)	Chennai, India	43.5
263	Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IITK)	Kanpur, India	39.3
=328	University of Delhi	New Delhi, India	33.8
335	Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee (IITR)	Roorkee, India	33.4
=344	Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati (IITG)	Guwahati, India	32.9
383	Anna University	Chennai, India	30.6

77th World Health Assembly

The **International Health Regulations of 2005** are amended by the **77th World Health Assembly**, taking into account **300 recommendations from member states**. The purpose of amendments is to strengthen nations' capacity to anticipate and address pandemic and public health emergencies of global concern. They contain measures to support developing nations in creating, bolstering, and preserving the fundamental capacities mandated by the **IHR**, as well as measures to enable **fair access to pertinent health items during medical emergencies**.

Aim of the Amendment

Amendments aim at **improving countries' ability to prepare for and respond to Public Health Emergencies of International Concern and Pandemic Emergencies**. They include provisions for facilitating equitable access to relevant health products during health emergencies, as well as mobilizing financial resources to support developing countries in building, strengthening, and maintaining the core capacities required under the **IHR**.

Importance of 77th World Health Assembly

- In its **77th session**, the theme for this year's event is **"Health For All: All for Health"**.
- To have a **deeper comprehension of the risks to and effects of global healthcare**.
- Key threats to global health are identified in the paper **Shaping the Future of Health and Healthcare**, along with possible solutions.

Why there is a need for World Health Assembly

Over the past few years, **society** has experienced a **wave of adverse events, including the COVID-19 pandemic, geopolitical conflicts and the impacts of the climate and energy crises**, which have engulfed **global health and healthcare**.

Every year, the World Health Assembly is tasked with tackling global healthcare challenges like these and deciding how best to overcome them.

What is the World Health Assembly

The **World Health Assembly** is the **governing body of the World Health Organization (WHO)**, an organization under the **United Nations (UN)** that is tasked with advancing **global health and ensuring that everyone has access to the best possible medical treatment**. Every year, representatives from WHO member states convene at the **UN headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland**, to discuss a particular healthcare agenda defined by the organization's Executive Board. There are **34 technically qualified members of the Executive Board** who are elected to **three-year terms**. Each year in January, they convene to decide on the agenda and any resolutions to be presented to the World Health Assembly for approval.

What does the Assembly do

The World Health Assembly's **delegates deliberate over the Executive Board's policy agenda** for the upcoming year and determine the health objectives and tactics that will direct the **WHO's efforts in the field of public health**. Voting to select the organization's **Director-General for a five-year term** is one of the organization's other duties. Head of the world's premier public health agency, **Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus**, was re-elected in 2022 to a second term in office. Along with overseeing financial policies, the Assembly also approves the proposed budget program to finance WHO activities in the future, tracks the implementation of work programs, and develops strategies to close gaps.

French Open 2024, Check Complete list of Winners

The **French Open 2024** witnessed a thrilling conclusion as the young Spanish sensation, **Carlos Alcaraz**, emerged victorious in the men's singles final. In a gruelling five-set battle against the formidable **Alexander Zverev**, Alcaraz showcased his resilience and skill, conquering the German with a scoreline of 6-3, 2-6, 5-7, 6-1, 6-2.

List of Winners French Open 2024:

Title	Winner	Runner up
Men's Singles	Carlos Alcaraz	Alexander Zverev
Women's Singles	Iga Swiatek	Jasmine Paolini
Men's doubles	Marcelo Arevalo & Mate Pavic	Simone Bolelli and Andrea Vavassori
Women's doubles	Coco Gauff & Katerina Siniakova	Sara Errani & Jasmine Paolini
Mixed doubles	Laura Siegemund and Edouard Roger-Vasselin	Desirae Krawczyk and Neal Skupski

Global Peace Index 2024: An Overview

The **Global Peace Index (GPI) 2024**, published by the **Institute for Economics & Peace (IEP)**, provides a comprehensive measure of global peacefulness, evaluating **163 independent states and territories**. This report highlights the trends, results, and economic impacts of violence across the world, offering valuable insights into the current state of peace and the factors influencing it.

Key Findings

Overall Peacefulness

- **Global Peace Deterioration:** The average level of global peacefulness deteriorated by 0.56% in 2024. This marks the fifth consecutive year of declining peacefulness.
- **Country Improvements and Deteriorations:** In the past year, 65 countries recorded improvements in peacefulness, while 97 countries saw deteriorations. This is the highest number of countries to experience a decline in a single year since the index's inception.

Regional Highlights

- **Most Peaceful Countries:** Iceland remains the most peaceful country, a position it has held since 2008, followed by Ireland, Austria, New Zealand, and Singapore.
- **Least Peaceful Countries:** Yemen is now the least peaceful country, followed by Sudan, South Sudan, Afghanistan, and Ukraine.

Regional Performance

- **Europe:** Europe continues to be the most peaceful region, despite a slight deterioration in peacefulness over the past year.
- **Middle East and North Africa (MENA):** MENA remains the least peaceful region, with significant conflicts in countries like Yemen and Sudan contributing to its low ranking.
- **North America:** North America recorded the largest regional deterioration, driven by increased violent crime and perceptions of criminality in both Canada and the US.

Trends in Peacefulness

- **Militarisation:** The Militarisation domain saw the largest year-on-year deterioration. Military expenditure (% of GDP) increased in 86 countries, reflecting broader trends of rising militarisation.
- **Ongoing Conflict:** The Ongoing Conflict domain also deteriorated significantly, influenced by ongoing wars in Gaza and Ukraine. The number of conflicts involving at least one state has reached a new high.
- **Safety and Security:** This domain recorded a slight improvement, driven by reductions in violent demonstrations, terrorism impact, and the homicide rate in several regions.

Economic Impact of Violence

- **Global Cost:** The economic impact of violence on the global economy in 2023 was \$19.1 trillion, equivalent to 13.5% of global GDP or \$2,380 per person.
- **Conflict Costs:** The conflict in Ukraine had a significant economic impact, shrinking Ukraine's economy by an estimated 30% in 2022. The Syrian civil war has led to an 85% drop in GDP since its onset.
- **Military and Security Expenditure:** Over 74% of the total economic impact of violence is attributed to military and internal security expenditure, with military spending alone accounting for \$8.4 trillion.

War in the 21st Century

- **Changing Nature of Conflict:** Modern warfare is increasingly characterised by technological advancements and geopolitical competition. Non-state actors are now more capable of engaging larger states using technologies like drones.
- **Internationalisation of Conflict:** Conflicts are becoming more internationalised, with 92 countries now engaged in conflicts beyond their borders. This complicates negotiation processes and prolongs conflicts.

- **Asymmetric Warfare:** The rise of asymmetric warfare, including drone attacks by non-state groups, has made conflicts more complex and harder to resolve.

Positive Peace and the Halo Approach

- **Positive Peace:** Defined as the attitudes, institutions, and structures that create and sustain peaceful societies, Positive Peace is crucial for forecasting and mitigating future conflicts.
- **Halo Approach:** IEP's Halo approach provides a framework for analyzing societal systems and designing resilience-building programs. This adaptive approach helps in creating effective policies for building Positive Peace.

Table of Rankings

Rank	Country	Score	Change in Rank
1	Iceland	1.112	↔
2	Ireland	1.303	↔
3	Austria	1.313	↑1
4	New Zealand	1.323	↓1
5	Singapore	1.339	↑3
6	Switzerland	1.35	↑3
7	Portugal	1.372	↓1
8	Denmark	1.382	↓3
9	Slovenia	1.395	↓2
10	Malaysia	1.427	↑2
116	India	2.319	↑5
163	Yemen	3.397	↓2

Highlights of G7 Summit 2024

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on June 14, held a series of bilateral meetings with world leaders. The countries including UK counterpart **Rishi Sunak**, French President **Emmanuel Macron**, Ukrainian President **Volodymyr Zelensky**, and others, on the sidelines of the G7 Summit, in southern Italy's Apulia. Later, the Prime Minister also met Pope Francis of the Vatican.

About G7 Summit

The **G7 Summit** is an international forum held annually for the leaders of the **G7 member states** of France, the **United States**, the **United Kingdom**, **Germany**, **Japan**, **Italy**, and **Canada** (in order of rotating presidency), and the **European Union** (EU).

Features of the G7 Summit

At the G7 Summit, the leaders of the G7, which shares fundamental values such as **freedom**, **democracy** and **human rights**, exchange candid views on important challenges the international community is facing at that time, such as the global economy, regional affairs and various global issues, and issue a document as an outcome of such discussions. With the leadership of the leaders of the G7, which shares fundamental values, the G7 has effectively responded to important challenges that the international community faces.

The Beginning of the G7 Summit

In the **1970s**, developed countries that faced various challenges such as the Nixon shock (1971) and the first oil crisis (1973) began recognizing the need to create a forum to comprehensively discuss policy coordination of macro economy, currency, trade, and energy, among others, at a leader's level. Against this backdrop, proposed by then-French President Giscard d'Estaing, the **first Summit** was held in **November 1975** at the Chateau de Rambouillet (located in the outskirts of Paris), with participation from six countries- **France, the United States, the United Kingdom, Germany, Japan, and Italy**. Since then, Summits have been held **annually** with revolving Presidency. **Russia's membership** was suspended in **March 2014** in response to its annexation of Crimea.

About 2024 G7 Summit

The **50th G7** includes **Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, the United Kingdom**, and the **United States**. **Italy**, hosting the summit, has invited African leaders-Algerian President **Abdelmadjid Tebboune**, Kenyan President **William Ruto**, and Tunisian President **Kais Saied**-to discuss Meloni's plans for development and migration in **Africa**. Other guests include Ukrainian President **Zelenskyy**, Brazilian President **Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva**, Indian Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**, and Turkish President **Recep Tayyip Erdogan**. Many G7 countries are also experiencing political changes. With Biden, UK Prime Minister **Rishi Sunak**, and French President **Emmanuel Macron** facing elections soon, there is pressure on the G7 to achieve as much as possible while the current leadership remains.

Theme of this year summit

The theme of this year's summit, which will be attended by President **Recep Tayyip Erdoğan** of the Republic of Türkiye, as a special guest, has been set as **"rules-based international system."**

Italy's agenda for the 2024 summit?

The **2024, 50th G7** summit will be held from **13 to 15 June in Apulia**, in Italy. It will be the first major international forum hosted by the Italian prime minister, **Giorgia Meloni**, since she took office in October 2022. As well as the wars in **Ukraine and Gaza**, Italy says it wants the summit to **focus on Africa and migration, economic security, and international co-operation** on artificial intelligence (AI).

Focus of this year summit

- **Supporting Ukraine's Fight for Freedom:** G7 leaders announced a plan to provide Ukraine with \$50 billion in new financing by bringing forward the interest earned on immobilized Russian sovereign assets held in the European Union and other jurisdictions. The Biden Administration this week issued a sweeping set of new sanctions and export control measures, guided by G7 commitments to intensify the pressure on Russia for its war against Ukraine. In Puglia, President Biden and President Zelensky signed the U.S.-Ukraine Bilateral Security Agreement as a demonstration of enduring U.S.

support for Ukraine, including through binding commitments to deepen our security and defense cooperation and to consult in the event of a future armed attack.

- **Advancing International Peace, Security, and Prosperity:** The G7's work is grounded in a shared commitment to respect the UN Charter, promote international peace and security, and uphold the free and open rules-based international order.
- **Promoting Economic Resilience and Economic Security:** President Biden rallied the G7 to take further steps to protect our workers, industries, and the investments.
- **Partnering with Developing Countries to Invest in their Future:** The G7 is taking ambitious steps to scale up support to developing countries and accelerate progress toward the Sustainable Development Goals.
- **Accelerating the Clean Energy Transition to Address Climate Change:** The G7 is accelerating its work to address the challenges of climate change, pollution, and biodiversity loss.
- **Promoting Health and Food Security:** The G7 continues to lead global efforts to address the food security crisis and support strong, resilient and responsive health systems around the world.
- **Investing in Childcare to Support Women's Economic Participation:** The G7 is tackling the unequal gender distribution of care work, which contributes to gender inequality.
- **Enhancing Our Partnership on Migration:** Drawn from the principles of the Los Angeles Declaration on Migration and Protection that President Biden launched at the Summit of the Americas in 2022, the G7 affirmed a collective commitment to addressing migration in ways that reflect both the challenges and opportunities it presents.
- **Deepening Cooperation on Artificial Intelligence:** In line with the Biden Administration's vision laid out in the October 2023 Executive Order on the Safe, Secure, and Trustworthy Development and Use of Artificial Intelligence, the G7 is building partnerships around the world to ensure the benefits of artificial intelligence and other technologies are widely shared while mitigating risks.
- **Increasing Coordination to Promote AI Safety:** G7 leaders committed to step up efforts to enhance interoperability between our respective approaches to AI governance and risk management.

India's Environment Performance in 2024

India's latest ranking in the **Environmental Performance Index (EPI) for 2024** places it at **176th out of 180 countries**, reflecting slight improvement from previous years but still positioning it among the **world's lowest performers**. The index, prepared by **Yale and Columbia universities**, highlights India's struggles in crucial areas like air quality, biodiversity, and greenhouse gas emissions.

Top 10 Countries in the Environmental Performance Index 2024

1. **Estonia** – Score: 75.3
2. **Luxembourg** – Score: 75.0
3. **Germany** – Score: 74.6
4. **Finland** – Score: 73.7
5. **United Kingdom** – Score: 72.7
6. **Sweden** – Score: 70.5
7. **Norway** – Score: 70.0
8. **Austria** – Score: 69.0
9. **Switzerland** – Score: 68.0
10. **Denmark** – Score: 67.9

Environmental Challenges

India faces severe challenges in several key environmental metrics:

Air Quality

Continues to be a major concern, with India ranking poorly in air quality compared to global standards, surpassing even its South Asian neighbors.

Biodiversity and Habitat

Scores poorly in measures related to ecosystem vitality, species protection, and terrestrial biome preservation.

Greenhouse Gas Emissions

Despite efforts in renewable energy, India remains one of the largest emitters globally, impacting climate change efforts.

Progress Amid Challenges

While India ranks low overall, there are areas showing improvement:

Climate Change

Notwithstanding its overall low ranking, India's efforts in climate change mitigation have been recognized, particularly with initiatives in renewable energy and a commitment to achieving net-zero emissions by 2070.

Sector-Specific Gains

India's scores are bolstered by advancements in waste management, forest conservation, and agricultural practices.

Policy and International Comparisons

Coal Dependence

Heavy reliance on coal continues to hamper India's environmental performance, contributing significantly to air pollution and greenhouse gas emissions.

Global Context

The index highlights disparities among nations, with India's ranking affected by the relative progress of other countries in environmental stewardship.

Future Challenges and Financial Needs

Sustainability Goals

India faces substantial challenges in achieving sustainability across multiple fronts, necessitating significant financial investments estimated at \$160 billion annually to meet climate goals and environmental targets.

India's Environmental Performance: Key Points

Ranking

India ranks 176th out of 180 countries in the 2024 Environmental Performance Index.

Challenges

- **Air Quality:** India faces severe challenges with air quality, often exceeding safe limits.
- **Biodiversity:** Concerns over ecosystem vitality, species protection, and habitat preservation.
- **Greenhouse Gas Emissions:** One of the largest global emitters, impacting climate change efforts.

Progress

- **Climate Change Initiatives:** Pursuing renewable energy projects and aiming for net-zero emissions by 2070.
- **Sector-Specific Improvements:** Advancements in waste management, forest conservation, and agriculture.

Policy and International Comparisons

- **Coal Dependence:** Heavy reliance on coal remains a significant environmental challenge.
- **Global Context:** India's ranking affected by the environmental progress of other nations.

Future Needs

- **Financial Investments:** Estimated \$160 billion annually needed for climate mitigation efforts and environmental sustainability.

PM Modi Inaugurates New Campus of Nalanda University in Bihar

On **June 19**, Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **new campus** of **Nalanda University**, an international institution of learning near the ancient ruins of Nalanda in Rajgir, Bihar. The PM asserted that Nalanda is a **symbol of India's academic heritage** and a proclamation of the enduring nature of knowledge.

Establishment and Functioning

- The **Parliament of India** established Nalanda University through the **Nalanda University Act, 2010**, based on decisions taken at the East Asia Summits in 2007 and 2009.
- The university started functioning in 2014 from a temporary location with 14 students, and construction of the new campus began in 2017.
- Representatives from **17 participating countries**, including ambassadors and ministers, attended the inauguration event.

Reviving a Global Centre of Learning

PM Modi emphasized that the **renaissance of Nalanda University** will introduce India's potential to the world and once again become a **major centre for cultural exchange**. He highlighted that the heritage of many countries and Asia is linked to Nalanda, which flourished for 800 years before its destruction in the 12th century.

Promoting Sustainability and Knowledge

The Prime Minister stressed that India has lived as a model of sustainability for centuries and should become a **centre of education and knowledge for the world**. He expressed his vision for India to have the world's most comprehensive skill system and an advanced research-oriented higher education system.

International Participation and Offerings

- Nalanda University has participation from **17 nations**, including Australia, Bangladesh, Bhutan, China, and others, who have signed MoUs in support of the university.
- The university offers **137 scholarships** to international students, sponsored by various organizations and countries.
- It provides **Post Graduate and Doctoral research courses**, as well as short-term certificate courses.

PM's Commitment and Vision

PM Modi emphasized the Central government's commitment to providing all possible support to Nalanda University. He encouraged students to be curious, courageous, and kind, expressing confidence that the youth will provide leadership to the world, and Nalanda will become an important centre for global causes.

The article is written in simple language, with headings and subheadings. Important keywords are highlighted, and the word limit of 600 words is maintained. The tone of the article is in the style of "Important Days" types, focusing on the inauguration of the new campus of Nalanda University, its historical significance, and PM Modi's vision for reviving India's academic heritage and promoting sustainability and knowledge.

Sweden Tops, India at 63rd Rank on Global Energy Transition Index: WEF

According to the Global Energy Transition Index released by the **World Economic Forum (WEF) on 19 June 2024**, India has **been ranked 63rd out of 120 countries**, improving three ranks from **last year's 67th position**. Sweden has again topped the Index, reflecting its continued leadership in energy transition. The WEF highlighted India's significant advancements in energy equity, security, and sustainability.

Global Energy Transition Index Overview

The Global Energy Transition Index, published annually by the WEF in association with Accenture, evaluates nations' progress and preparedness in building an equitable, secure, and sustainable energy future. It tracks government policies and their effectiveness in reducing carbon dioxide emissions, promoting non-fossil-based power sources, and enhancing energy efficiency.

2024 Rankings

European nations dominate the 2024 Index's top ranks:

1. Sweden
2. Denmark

3. Finland
4. Switzerland
5. France

China is ranked 20th, while India stands at 63rd. The report indicates that 107 out of 120 countries have shown progress in their energy transition over the past decade, despite challenges such as economic volatility and geopolitical tensions.

India's Progress and Global Role

The WEF commended India's initiatives in encouraging non-fossil-based energy sources, particularly solar energy. India's improvements in energy security, equity, and sustainability are noteworthy, positioning the country as a critical player in the global energy transition alongside China. India is now the fourth largest in the renewable energy market globally, with renewable energy and biomass comprising 42% of its power generation capacity. Significant investments are also being made in electric vehicles and green hydrogen.

World Economic Forum

Founded in 1971 by German economist Klaus Schwab, the WEF is a non-profit international organization **headquartered in Cologny, Switzerland**. It aims to foster collaboration between global stakeholders to address common challenges. The WEF publishes several influential reports, including the Global Gender Gap Report, Global Competitiveness Report, Global Travel and Tourism Report, and Global IT Report.

Implications and Recommendations

The WEF suggests that other nations can replicate India's policies and innovative initiatives for a green energy transition. Despite progress, the report urges further efforts to reduce coal usage and emissions, emphasizing the potential of green technology in shaping the future of energy systems globally.

World Economic Forum: Key Points

Purpose

- **Collaboration Platform:** Facilitates cooperation among business, political, academic, and other leaders to address global challenges.
- **Global Issues:** Focuses on shaping global, regional, and industry agendas to improve the state of the world.

Foundation

- **Founded:** 1971
- **Founder:** Klaus Schwab, a German economist

Headquarters

- **Location:** Cologny, Switzerland

Key Activities

- **Annual Meetings:** Hosts annual meetings in Davos, Switzerland, bringing together global leaders from various sectors.
- **Reports and Research:** Publishes influential reports like the Global Gender Gap Report, Global Competitiveness Report, Energy Transition Index, and Global IT Report.

- **Initiatives:** Launches initiatives and partnerships to address issues such as climate change, economic development, and social inclusion.

Notable Reports

- **Global Gender Gap Report**
- **Global Competitiveness Report**
- **Energy Transition Index**
- **Global Travel and Tourism Report**
- **Global IT Report** (in collaboration with INSEAD and Cornell University)

Overall Mission

- **Improving the State of the World:** Aims to drive impactful actions through public-private cooperation and innovative solutions for global progress.

53rd GST Council Meeting Overview

The **53rd GST Council** met under the Chairpersonship of Union Minister for Finance & Corporate Affairs **Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman** in New Delhi. The meeting was attended by key officials, including Union Minister of State for Finance **Shri Pankaj Chaudhary**, Chief Ministers of Goa and Meghalaya, Deputy Chief Ministers of Bihar, Haryana, Madhya Pradesh, and Odisha, Finance Ministers of States & UTs (with legislature), and senior officers of the Ministry of Finance & States/ UTs.

Key Recommendations and Decisions

The GST Council made several recommendations concerning changes in GST tax rates, trade facilitation measures, and compliance streamlining in GST.

Changes in GST Tax Rates

GST Rates on Goods

- **Uniform IGST Rate on Aircraft Parts:** A uniform rate of 5% IGST will apply to imports of parts, components, testing equipment, tools, and tool-kits of aircrafts to boost MRO activities.
- **Milk Cans GST Rate:** All milk cans (steel, iron, aluminum) will attract a 12% GST rate.
- **Paper Products GST Rate Reduction:** The GST rate on carton, boxes, and cases of both corrugated and non-corrugated paper or paper-board has been reduced from 18% to 12%.
- **Solar Cookers GST Rate:** All solar cookers, whether single or dual energy source, will attract 12% GST.
- **Poultry Keeping Machinery:** The GST entry covering poultry keeping machinery attracting 12% GST has been amended to specifically incorporate "parts of poultry keeping machinery" and regularize past practice.
- **Sprinklers GST Rate:** All types of sprinklers, including fire water sprinklers, will attract 12% GST.
- **Defence Forces IGST Exemption:** The IGST exemption on imports of specified items for defence forces has been extended for five years till 30th June 2029.

- **RAMA Programme IGST Exemption:** IGST exemption on imports of research equipment/buoys under the RAMA programme has been extended subject to conditions.
- **Compensation Cess on SEZ Imports:** Compensation Cess on imports in SEZ by SEZ Unit/developers for authorized operations is exempted w.e.f. 01.07.2017.
- **Miscellaneous Exemptions:** Compensation Cess on supply of aerated beverages and energy drinks to authorized customers by Unit Run Canteens under Ministry of Defence and Adhoc IGST exemption on imports of technical documentation for AK-203 rifle kits for Indian Defence forces are also recommended.

GST Rates on Services

- **Indian Railways Services Exemption:** Services provided by Indian Railways to the general public, such as platform tickets, retiring rooms/waiting rooms, cloakroom services, and battery-operated car services, are exempt from GST.
- **SPV Services Exemption:** Services provided by Special Purpose Vehicles (SPV) to Indian Railways for infrastructure use during the concession period and maintenance services by Indian Railways to SPV are exempt.
- **Accommodation Services Exemption:** Accommodation services valued up to Rs. 20,000 per month per person supplied for a minimum continuous period of 90 days are exempt from GST.
- **Co-insurance and Re-insurance Services:** Co-insurance premium apportioned by lead insurer to the co-insurer and transactions of ceding commission/re-insurance commission between insurer and re-insurer are declared as no supply under Schedule III of the CGST Act.
- **GST Liability on Reinsurance Services:** GST liability on reinsurance services of specified insurance schemes will be regularized retrospectively.
- **Retrocession Clarification:** Retrocession, re-insurance of re-insurance, is eligible for exemption under Sl. No. 36A of notification No. 12/2017-CTR.
- **RERA Statutory Collections:** Statutory collections by Real Estate Regulatory Authority (RERA) are exempt from GST.
- **Incentive Sharing under RuPay and BHIM-UPI:** Further sharing of incentive under NPCI's promotion scheme for RuPay Debit Cards and BHIM-UPI transactions is not taxable.

Measures for Facilitation of Trade

- **Section 128A Insertion for Conditional Waiver:** Section 128A will be inserted in CGST Act to provide conditional waiver of interest or penalty for demands raised under Section 73 for FY 2017-18 to FY 2019-20.
- **Reduction of Government Litigation:** Monetary limits for filing appeals in GST by the department before GST Appellate Tribunal, High Court, and Supreme Court are prescribed to reduce litigation.
- **Pre-deposit Amount for Appeals:** Pre-deposit amount for filing appeals under GST is reduced to ease cash flow for taxpayers.

- **GST on Extra Neutral Alcohol (ENA):** ENA used for manufacturing alcoholic liquor for human consumption is excluded from GST.
- **TCS Rate Reduction for ECOs:** TCS rate for supplies through Electronic Commerce Operators (ECOs) is reduced from 1% to 0.5%.
- **Appeal Filing Time in GST Appellate Tribunal:** The time for filing appeals in GST Appellate Tribunal is extended.
- **Relaxation in Section 16(4):** Section 16(4) of CGST Act is amended retrospectively for initial years to allow relaxation in availing input tax credit.
- **GSTR-4 Due Date Extension:** The due date for filing GSTR-4 for composition taxpayers is extended from 30th April to 30th June.
- **Interest Calculation in Rule 88B:** Amendment in rule 88B to exclude amounts in the Electronic Cash Ledger on due date from interest calculation for delayed return filing.
- **Section 11A Insertion:** Section 11A is inserted in CGST Act to regularize non-levy or short levy of GST due to common trade practices.
- **Refund of Additional IGST on Export:** A mechanism for claiming refund of additional IGST paid on upward revision in price of exported goods is prescribed.

Clarifications and Compliance Measures

- **Valuation of Import of Services:** Value of import of services by a related person, where the recipient is eligible for full input tax credit, is clarified.
- **Input Tax Credit on Optical Fiber Cables:** ITC is not restricted for ducts and manholes used in Optical Fiber Cable networks.
- **Place of Supply for Custodial Services:** Place of supply for custodial services provided by Indian Banks to Foreign Portfolio Investors is determined under Section 13(2) of the IGST Act.
- **Valuation of Corporate Guarantees:** Valuation of corporate guarantees between related persons is clarified, with amendments to rule 28(2) of CGST Rules.
- **Reverse Charge Mechanism Invoices:** The relevant financial year for availing ITC under RCM is the year the invoice is issued by the recipient.
- **Miscellaneous Clarifications:** Clarifications on various issues, including taxability of re-imbursement of securities, input tax credit reversals, and taxability of loans between related persons, are provided.

Additional Recommendations

- **Transitional Credit for ISD:** Amendment in section 140(7) of CGST Act to provide transitional credit for invoices before the appointed date.
- **GSTR-1A Facility:** A new optional facility in FORM GSTR-1A is provided for amending details before filing GSTR-3B.
- **Annual Return Exemption:** Filing of annual return in FORM GSTR-9/9A for FY 2023-24 is exempted for taxpayers with annual turnover up to two crore rupees.

- **Section 122(1B) Amendment:** Section 122(1B) of CGST Act is amended to clarify penal provisions for e-commerce operators.
- **Rule 142 Amendment:** Rule 142 of CGST Rules is amended for adjusting amounts paid against pre-deposit for appeals.

Biometric Aadhaar Authentication

- **Pan-India Rollout:** Biometric-based Aadhaar authentication for GST registration applicants is recommended on an All-India basis in a phased manner.

Common Time Limit for Demand Notices

- **Amendments in Sections 73 and 74:** Amendments to provide a common time limit for issuance of demand notices and orders for FY 2024-25 onwards.

Sunset Clause for Anti-Profitteering

- **Amendments in Sections 171 and 109:** Amendments to provide a sunset clause for anti-profitteering under GST and handling by GSTAT.

Export Duty and IGST Refunds

- **Amendments in Section 16 of IGST Act and Section 54 of CGST Act:** Refunds for goods subjected to export duty are restricted.

B2C Inter-State Supplies Reporting

- **Threshold Reduction:** The threshold for reporting B2C inter-State supplies in FORM GSTR-1 is reduced from Rs. 2.5 Lakh to Rs. 1 Lakh.

GSTR-7 Filing Requirements

- **Monthly Filing:** Registered persons required to deduct tax at source must file GSTR-7 monthly, even if no tax is deducted.

These comprehensive recommendations and clarifications from the 53rd GST Council meeting aim to streamline GST compliance, facilitate trade, and address various industry concerns.

Centre Notifies Anti-Paper Leak Law Amid NEET, NET Row

The Centre has introduced a stringent anti-paper leak law amid controversies surrounding the **NEET and UGC-NET exams**. The law, which came into force on June 21, 2024, imposes severe penalties, including up to 10 years of imprisonment and a fine of Rs 1 crore, to curb malpractices in competitive examinations.

Details of the Law

The new law, named the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, aims to prevent cheating in public exams conducted by entities such as the UPSC, SSC, and NTA. It includes provisions for a minimum of three to five years of imprisonment for cheating, and five to ten years of imprisonment for organized cheating crimes, along with hefty fines.

Context and Immediate Reactions

The law's enactment comes amidst allegations of paper leaks and subsequent cancellation of the UGC-NET 2024, affecting over 9 lakh candidates. The Opposition Congress has criticized the timing, calling it "damage control." Congress leader **Jairam Ramesh** emphasized the need for proactive measures to prevent such leaks.

Exams Impacted by Paper Leaks

The NEET and UGC-NET exams have been at the center of the controversy, with the **CSIR-UGC NET** also facing similar allegations. The education ministry has postponed the CSIR-UGC NET scheduled for June 25-27, 2024, due to claims of a leak on the dark web. This scandal could delay the CUET-UG results, affecting undergraduate admissions in central universities.

Government and NTA Response

Following the allegations, the CBI has registered an FIR against unknown suspects for cheating and criminal conspiracy. The education ministry has instructed the NTA to take preventive measures to ensure the integrity of upcoming exams.

Implications

The implementation of this law marks the first major step towards addressing paper leaks in centrally-conducted public examinations. It highlights the government's commitment to maintaining the integrity of the examination process, although it has sparked significant political debate and criticism.

Most Important Current Affairs of July 2024

Budget 2024-25

The Union Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman presented the Union Budget 2024-25 in Parliament. The highlights of the budget are as follows:

Part-A

Budget Estimates 2024-25:

- Total receipts other than borrowings: Rs. 32.07 lakh crore.
- Total expenditure: Rs. 48.21 lakh crore.
- Net tax receipt: Rs. 25.83 lakh crore.
- Fiscal deficit: 4.9 per cent of GDP.
- The government aims to reach a deficit below 4.5 per cent next year.
- Inflation continues to be low, stable and moving towards the 4% target; Core inflation (non-food, non-fuel) at 3.1%.
- The budget focuses on **EMPLOYMENT, SKILLING, MSMEs, and the MIDDLE CLASS.**

Package of PM's five schemes for Employment and Skilling

Prime Minister's Package of 5 Schemes and Initiatives for employment, skilling and other opportunities for 4.1 crore youth over a 5-year period.

1. **Scheme A - First Timers:** One-month salary of up to Rs. 15,000 to be provided in 3 installments to first-time employees, as registered in the EPFO.
2. **Scheme B - Job Creation in manufacturing:** Incentive to be provided at specified scale directly, both employee and employer, with respect to their EPFO contribution in the first 4 years of employment.
3. **Scheme C - Support to employers:** Government to reimburse up to Rs. 3,000 per month for 2 years towards EPFO contribution of employers, for each additional employee.
4. **New centrally sponsored scheme for Skilling-** 20 lakh youth to be skilled over a 5-year period and 1,000 Industrial Training Institutes to be upgraded in hub and spoke arrangements.
5. **New Scheme for Internship in 500 Top Companies** to 1 crore youth in 5 years

Nine Budget Priorities in Pursuit of 'Viksit Bharat':

1. Productivity and Resilience in Agriculture
2. Employment & Skilling
3. Inclusive Human Resource Development and Social Justice
4. Manufacturing & Services
5. Urban Development
6. Energy Security
7. Infrastructure
8. Innovation, Research & Development and
9. Next Generation Reforms

Priority 1: Productivity and resilience in Agriculture

- Allocation of Rs. 1.52 lakh crore for agriculture and allied sectors.
- New 109 high-yielding and climate-resilient varieties of 32 field and horticulture crops to be released for cultivation by farmers.
- 1 crore farmers across the country to be initiated into natural farming, with certification and branding in next 2 years.
- 10,000 need-based bio-input resource centres to be established for natural farming.
- Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for Agriculture to be implemented for coverage of farmers and their lands in 3 years.

Priority 2: Employment & Skilling

- As part of the Prime Minister's package, 3 schemes for 'Employment Linked Incentive' to be implemented - Scheme A - First Timers; Scheme B - Job Creation in manufacturing; Scheme C - Support to employers.
- To facilitate higher participation of women in the workforce,
 1. working women hostels and crèches to be established with industrial collaboration
 2. women-specific skilling programmes to be organized
 3. market access for women SHG enterprises to be promoted

Skill Development

- New centrally sponsored scheme for Skilling under Prime Minister's Package for 20 lakh youth over a 5-year period.
- Model Skill Loan Scheme to be revised to facilitate loans up to Rs. 7.5 lakh.
- Financial support for loans upto Rs. 10 lakh for higher education in domestic institutions to be provided to youth who have not been eligible for any benefit under government schemes and policies.

Priority 3: Inclusive Human Resource Development and Social Justice

Purvodaya

- Industrial node at Gaya to be developed along the Amritsar-Kolkata Industrial Corridor.
- Power projects, including new 2400 MW power plant at Pirpainti, to be taken up at a cost of Rs. 21,400 crore.

Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act

- Special financial support through multilateral development agencies of Rs. 15,000 crore in the current financial year.
- Industrial node at Kopparthy along Vishakhapatnam-Chennai Industrial Corridor and at Orvakal along Hyderabad-Bengaluru Industrial Corridor.

Women-led development

- Total allocation of more than Rs. 3 lakh crore for schemes benefitting women and girls.

Pradhan Mantri Janatiya Unnat Gram Abhiyan

- Socio-economic development of tribal families in tribal-majority villages and aspirational districts, covering 63,000 villages benefitting 5 crore tribal people.

Bank branches in North-Eastern Region

- 100 branches of India Post Payment Bank to be set up in the North East region.

Priority 4: Manufacturing & Services

Credit Guarantee Scheme for MSMEs in the Manufacturing Sector

- A credit guarantee scheme without collateral or third-party guarantee in term loans to MSMEs for purchase of machinery and equipment.

Credit Support to MSMEs during Stress Period

- New mechanism to facilitate continuation of bank credit to MSMEs during their stress period.

Mudra Loans

- The limit of Mudra loans under 'Tarun' category to be enhanced to Rs. 20 lakh from Rs. 10 lakh for those who have successfully repaid previous loans.

Enhanced scope for mandatory onboarding in TReDS

- Turnover threshold of buyers for mandatory onboarding on the TReDS platform to be reduced from Rs. 500 crore to Rs. 250 crore..

MSME Units for Food Irradiation, Quality & Safety Testing

- Financial support to set up 50 multi-product food irradiation units in the MSME sector .

E-Commerce Export Hubs

- E-Commerce Export Hubs to be set up under public-private-partnership (PPP) mode for MSMEs and traditional artisans to sell their products in international markets.

Critical Mineral Mission

- Critical Mineral Mission to be set up for domestic production, recycling of critical minerals, and overseas acquisition of critical mineral assets.

Offshore mining of minerals

- Auction of the first tranche of offshore blocks for mining, building on the exploration already carried out.

Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) Applications

- Development of DPI applications in the areas of credit, e-commerce, education, health, law and justice, logistics, MSME, services delivery, and urban governance.

Priority 5: Urban Development

Transit Oriented Development

- Formulation of Transit Oriented Development plans and strategies to implement and finance 14 large cities above 30 lakh population.

Urban Housing

- Investment of Rs. 10 lakh crore, including the central assistance of Rs. 2.2 lakh crore in next 5 years, under PM Awas Yojana Urban 2.0 proposed to address the , housing needs of 1 crore urban poor and middle-class families.

Street Markets

- New scheme to support the development of 100 weekly 'haats' or street food hubs every year for the next 5 years in select cities.

Priority 6: Energy Security

Energy Transition

- Policy document on 'Energy Transition Pathways' to balance the imperatives of employment, growth and environmental sustainability to be brought out.

Pumped Storage Policy

- Policy for promoting pumped storage projects for electricity storage to be brought out.

Research and development of small and modular nuclear reactors

- Government to partner with private sector for R&D of Bharat Small Modular Reactor and newer technologies for nuclear energy, and to set up Bharat Small Reactors.

Advanced Ultra Super Critical Thermal Power Plants

- Joint venture proposed between NTPC and BHEL to set up a full scale 800 MW commercial plant using Advanced Ultra Super Critical (AUSC) technology.

Roadmap for 'hard to abate' industries

- Appropriate regulations for transition of 'hard to abate' industries from the current 'Perform, Achieve and Trade' mode to 'Indian Carbon Market' mode to be put in place.

Priority 7: Infrastructure

Infrastructure investment by Central Government

- Rs. 11,11,111 crore (3.4 % of GDP) to be provided for capital expenditure.

Infrastructure investment by state governments

- Provision of Rs. 1.5 lakh crore for long-term interest free loans to support states in infrastructure investment.

Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY)

- Launch of phase IV of PMGSY to provide all-weather connectivity to 25,000 rural habitations.

Irrigation and Flood Mitigation

- Financial support of Rs. 11,500 crore to projects such as the Kosi-Mechi intra-state link and other schemes in Bihar.
- Government to provide assistance to Assam, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Sikkim for floods, landslides and other related projects.

Tourism

- Comprehensive development of Vishnupad Temple Corridor, Mahabodhi Temple Corridor and Rajgir.
- Assistance for development of temples, monuments, craftsmanship, wildlife sanctuaries, natural landscapes and pristine beaches of Odisha.

Priority 8: Innovation, Research & Development

- Anusandhan National Research Fund for basic research and prototype development to be operationalised.
- Financing pool of Rs. 1 lakh crore for spurring private sector-driven research and innovation at commercial scale.

Space Economy

- Venture capital fund of Rs. 1,000 crore to be set up for expanding the space economy by 5 times in the next 10 years.

Priority 9: Next Generation Reforms

Rural Land-Related Actions

- Unique Land Parcel Identification Number (ULPIN) or Bhu-Aadhaar for all lands
- Digitization of cadastral maps
- Survey of map sub-divisions as per current ownership
- Establishment of land registry
- Linking to the farmers registry

Urban Land-Related Actions

- Land records in urban areas to be digitized with GIS mapping.

Services to Labour

- Integration of e-shram portal with other portals to facilitate such one-stop solution.
- Open architecture databases for the rapidly changing labour market, skill requirements and available job roles.
- Mechanism to connect job-aspirants with potential employers and skill providers.

NPS Vatsalya

- NPS-Vatsalya as a plan for contribution by parents and guardians for minors.

PART B

Indirect Taxes

GST

- Buoyed by GST's success, tax structure to be simplified and rationalised to expand GST to remaining sectors.

Sector specific customs duty proposals

Medicines and Medical Equipment

- Three cancer drugs namely Trastuzumab, Deruxtecan, Osimertinib and Durvalumab fully exempted from custom duty.
- Changes in Basic Customs Duty (BCD) on x-ray tubes & flat panel detectors for use in medical x-ray machines under the Phased Manufacturing Programme.

Mobile Phone and Related Parts

- BCD on mobile phone, mobile Printed Circuit Board Assembly (PCBA) and mobile charger reduced to 15 per cent.

Precious Metals

- Customs duties on gold and silver reduced to 6 per cent and that on platinum to 6.4 per cent.

Other Metals

- BCD removed on ferro nickel and blister copper.
- BCD removed on ferrous scrap and nickel cathode.
- Concessional BCD of 2.5 per cent on copper scrap.

Electronics

- BCD removed, subject to conditions, on oxygen free copper for manufacture of resistors.

Chemicals and Petrochemicals

- BCD on ammonium nitrate increased from 7.5 to 10 per cent.

Plastics

- BCD on PVC flex banners increased from 10 to 25 per cent.

Telecommunication Equipment

- BCD increased from 10 to 15 per cent on PCBA of specified telecom equipment.

Trade facilitation

- For promotion of domestic aviation and boat & ship MRO, time period for export of goods imported for repairs extended from six months to one year.
- Time-limit for re-import of goods for repairs under warranty extended from three to five years.

Critical Minerals

- 25 critical minerals fully exempted from customs duties.
- BCD on two critical minerals reduced.

Solar Energy

- Capital goods for use in manufacture of solar cells and panels exempted from customs duty.

Marine products

- BCD on certain broodstock, polychaete worms, shrimp and fish feed reduced to 5 per cent.
- Various inputs for manufacture of shrimp and fish feed exempted from customs duty.

Leather and Textile

- BCD reduced on real down filling material from duck or goose.
- BCD reduced, subject to conditions, on methylene diphenyl diisocyanate (MDI) for manufacture of spandex yarn from 7.5 to 5 per cent.

Direct Taxes

- Efforts to simplify taxes, improve tax payer services, provide tax certainty and reduce litigation to be continued.
- Enhance revenues for funding development and welfare schemes of government.
- 58 per cent of corporate tax from simplified tax regime in FY23, more than two-thirds taxpayers availed simplified tax regime for personal income tax in FY 24.

Simplification for Charities and of TDS

- Two tax exemption regimes for charities to be merged into one.
- 5 per cent TDS rate on many payments merged into 2 per cent TDS rate.
- 20 per cent TDS rate on repurchase of units by mutual funds or UTI withdrawn.
- TDS rate on e-commerce operators reduced from one to 0.1 per cent.
- Delay for payment of TDS up to due date of filing statement decriminalized.

Simplification of Reassessment

- Assessment can be reopened beyond three years upto five years from the end of Assessment Year only if the escaped income is ₹ 50 lakh or more.
- In search cases, time limit reduced from ten to six years before the year of search.

Simplification and Rationalisation of Capital Gains

- Short term gains on certain financial assets to attract a tax rate of 20 per cent.
- Long term gains on all financial and non-financial assets to attract a tax rate of 12.5 per cent.
- Exemption limit of capital gains on certain financial assets increased to ₹ 1.25 lakh per year.

Tax Payer Services

- All remaining services of Customs and Income Tax including rectification and order giving effect to appellate orders to be digitalized over the next two years.

Litigation and Appeals

- 'Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme, 2024' for resolution of income tax disputes pending in appeal.
- Monetary limits for filing direct taxes, excise and service tax related appeals in Tax Tribunals, High Courts and Supreme Court increased to ₹60 lakh, ₹2 crore and ₹5 crore respectively.
- Safe harbour rules expanded to reduce litigation and provide certainty in international taxation.

Employment and Investment

- Angel tax for all classes of investors abolished to bolster start-up eco-system.
- Simpler tax regime for foreign shipping companies operating domestic cruises to promote cruise tourism in India.
- Safe harbour rates for foreign mining companies selling raw diamonds in the country.
- Corporate tax rate on foreign companies reduced from 40 to 35 per cent.

Deepening tax base

- Security Transactions Tax on futures and options of securities increased to 0.02 per cent and 0.1 per cent respectively.
- Income received on buy back of shares in the hands of recipient to be taxed.

Social Security Benefits.

- Deduction of expenditure by employers towards NPS to be increased from 10 to 14 per cent of the employee's salary.
- Non-reporting of small movable foreign assets up to ₹20 lakh de-penalised.

Other major proposal in Finance Bill

- Equalization levy of 2 per cent withdrawn.

Changes in Personal Income Tax under new tax regime

- Standard deduction for salaried employees increased from ₹50,000 to ₹75,000.
- Deduction on family pension for pensioners enhanced from ₹15,000/- to ₹25,000/-

Revised tax rate structure:

0-3 lakh rupees	Nil
3-7 lakh rupees	5 per cent
7-10 lakh rupees	10 per cent
10-12 lakh rupees	15 per cent
12-15 lakh rupees	20 per cent
Above 15 lakh rupees	30 per cent

- Salaried employee in the new tax regime stands to save up to ₹ 17,500/- in income tax.

Economic Survey 2023-24: Key Highlights and Analysis

The **Economic Survey 2023-24**, presented by Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman, provides a detailed overview of India's economic performance and future outlook. Here are the key highlights and analysis, organized by thematic chapters:

Chapter 1: State of the Economy – Steady as She Goes

- **GDP Growth Projection:** The Economic Survey conservatively projects a **real GDP growth of 6.5–7%**, with balanced risks, despite higher market expectations.
- **Momentum Maintenance:** India's economy continued its momentum from FY23 into FY24, facing minimal impact from external challenges due to macroeconomic stability.
- **Real GDP Growth:** Real GDP grew by **8.2% in FY24**, exceeding 8% in three out of four quarters.
- **Gross Value Added (GVA):** GVA grew by **7.2% in FY24** (at 2011-12 prices) and net taxes at constant prices grew by **19.1%**.
- **Inflation Management:** Retail inflation reduced from **6.7% in FY23 to 5.4% in FY24** due to effective administrative and monetary policies.
- **Current Account Deficit (CAD):** CAD improved to **0.7% of GDP in FY24** from 2.0% in FY23.
- **Post-Pandemic Recovery:** Real GDP in FY24 was **20% higher than FY20**, a notable recovery achieved by few major economies.
- **Tax Collection:** **55%** of tax collected from direct taxes, and **45%** from indirect taxes.
- **Welfare Programs:** Government ensured free food grains to **81.4 crore people** and progressively increased capital expenditure.

Chapter 2: Monetary Management and Financial Intermediation - Stability is the Watchword

- **Banking Sector Performance:** India's banking and financial sectors performed exceptionally well in FY24.
- **Policy Rate:** RBI maintained a steady policy rate, keeping the **policy repo rate at 6.5%**.
- **Credit Growth:** Credit disbursement by Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) reached **₹164.3 lakh crore**, growing by **20.2%** by March 2024.
- **Broad Money (M3) Growth:** Excluding HDFC merger, M3 grew by **11.2% YoY** as of 22 March 2024.
- **Non-Performing Assets (NPA):** Gross and net NPAs at multi-year lows, indicating improved bank asset quality.
- **Agriculture Credit:** Agriculture and allied activities saw double-digit credit growth in FY24.
- **Industrial Credit:** Industrial credit growth was **8.5%**, up from 5.2% the previous year.
- **Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC):** **31,394 corporate debtors** involving **₹13.9 lakh crore** disposed off by March 2024.
- **Capital Markets:** Primary capital markets facilitated capital formation of **₹10.9 lakh crore** in FY24.

- **Market Capitalisation:** Indian stock market's market capitalisation to GDP ratio is the fifth largest in the world.
- **Financial Inclusion:** Digital Financial Inclusion (DFI) is the next big challenge for sustainable economic growth.

Chapter 3: Prices and Inflation - Under Control

- **Retail Inflation:** Maintained at **5.4%** in FY24, the lowest since the pandemic, due to timely policy interventions.
- **Fuel Prices:** Central Government announced price cuts for LPG, petrol, and diesel, keeping retail fuel inflation low.
- **LPG and Fuel Inflation:** LPG cylinder prices reduced by **₹200** in August 2023; petrol and diesel prices lowered by **₹2 per litre**.
- **Core Inflation:** Core services inflation eased to a nine-year low; core goods inflation declined to a four-year low.
- **Food Inflation:** Increased from **6.6% in FY23 to 7.5% in FY24** due to extreme weather events impacting farm output.
- **Inflation Management:** Dynamic stock management, open market operations, and subsidised food items helped mitigate food inflation.
- **State Inflation:** **29 States and UTs** recorded inflation below 6% in FY24.

Chapter 4: External Sector - Stability Amid Plenty

- **Geopolitical Challenges:** Despite geopolitical headwinds, India's external sector remained strong.
- **Logistics Performance Index:** Improved rank from **44th in 2018 to 38th in 2023** out of 139 countries.
- **Current Account Deficit:** Improved to **0.7% of GDP in FY24** due to moderation in imports and rising services exports.
- **Global Export Share:** India's share in global goods exports was **1.8% in FY24**.
- **Services Exports:** Grew by **4.9% to USD 341.1 billion**, driven by IT/software services and other business services.
- **Remittances:** India is the top remittance recipient globally with **USD 120 billion** in 2023.
- **External Debt:** External debt to GDP ratio was **18.7%** at the end of March 2024.

Chapter 5: Medium-Term Outlook – A Growth Strategy for New India

- **Policy Focus Areas:** Job and skill creation, agricultural potential, MSME bottlenecks, green transition, managing relations with China, deepening the corporate bond market, tackling inequality, and improving youth health.
- **Amrit Kaal Strategy:** Based on six key areas: boosting private investment, expanding MSMEs, agriculture as a growth engine, financing green transition, bridging education-employment gap, and building state capacity.
- **Growth Compact:** For 7%+ growth, a tripartite compact between the Union Government, State Governments, and the private sector is essential.

Chapter 6: Climate Change and Energy Transition: Dealing with Trade-Offs

- **Climate Action Recognition:** India is the only G20 nation aligned with a 2-degree centigrade warming target.
- **Renewable Energy:** Non-fossil sources reached **45.4%** of installed electricity generation capacity by 31 May 2024.
- **Emission Reduction:** Reduced emission intensity of GDP by **33% from 2005 levels** by 2019.
- **Energy Savings:** Total annual energy savings of **51 million tonnes of oil equivalent**, translating to annual cost savings of **₹1,94,320 Crore**.
- **Green Bonds:** Issued **₹16,000 Crore** in January-February 2023 and **₹20,000 Crore** in October-December 2023.

Chapter 7: Social Sector - Benefits that Empower

- **Welfare Impact:** Digitisation of healthcare, education, and governance has increased the impact per rupee spent.
- **Welfare Expenditure Growth:** Nominal GDP grew at **9.5% CAGR** while welfare expenditure grew at **12.8% CAGR** between FY18 and FY24.
- **Inequality Reduction:** Gini coefficient declined in both rural (from **0.283 to 0.266**) and urban (from **0.363 to 0.314**) sectors.
- **Ayushman Bharat:** **34.7 crore cards** generated, covering **7.37 crore hospital admissions**.
- **Mental Health Coverage:** **22 mental disorders** covered under Ayushman Bharat – PMJAY.
- **Early Childhood Education:** 'Poshan Bhi Padhai Bhi' programme aims to develop the world's largest, universal, high-quality preschool network at Anganwadi Centres.
- **Vidyanjali Initiative:** Enhanced educational experiences for **1.44 crore students** through community engagement.
- **Higher Education Enrolment:** Faster growth in enrolment from underprivileged sections (SC, ST, OBC) with a **31.6% increase** since FY15.
- **R&D Progress:** Nearly **one lakh patents** granted in FY24, up from less than 25,000 in FY20.
- **Housing and Roads:** Under PM-AWAS-Gramin, **2.63 crore houses** constructed; **15.14 lakh km** roads completed under Gram Sadak Yojana since 2014-15.

Chapter 8: Employment and Skill Development: Towards Quality

- **Labour Market Improvement:** Unemployment rate declined to **3.2% in 2022-23**.
- **Urban Unemployment:** Declined to **6.7%** in the quarter ending March 2024.
- **Workforce Distribution:** **45%** in agriculture, **11.4%** in manufacturing, **28.9%** in services, and **13%** in construction.
- **Youth Unemployment:** Declined from **17.8% in 2017-18 to 10% in 2022-23**.
- **EPFO Payroll:** Significant growth in new subscribers, especially in the **18-28 years band**.

- **Female Labour Force Participation:** Rising steadily for six years.
- **Manufacturing Sector Recovery:** Employment in organised manufacturing sector above pre-pandemic levels.
- **Wages Growth:** Rural wages grew at **6.9% CAGR**, urban at **6.1% CAGR**.
- **Factories Growth:** Number of factories employing over 100 workers grew by **11.8%** over FY18 to FY22.
- **EPFO Membership:** Grew at **8.4% CAGR** between FY15 and FY24.
- **Job Generation Requirement:** **78.5 lakh jobs annually** needed in the non-farm sector until 2030.

Chapter 9: Agriculture and Food Management – Plenty of Upside Left If We Get It Right

- **Agriculture Growth:** Registered an average annual growth rate of **4.18%** over the last five years.
- **Agricultural Credit:** Total credit disbursed to agriculture amounted to **₹22.84 lakh crore** as of January 31, 2024.
- **Kisan Credit Cards:** **7.5 crore KCCs** issued with a limit of **₹9.4 lakh crore**.
- **Micro Irrigation:** **90.0 lakh hectares** covered under 'Per drop more crop' from 2015-16 to 2023-24.

Chapter 10: Industry - Small and Medium Matters

- **Industrial Growth:** **9.5%** growth rate supporting overall economic growth of **8.2%** in FY24.
- **Manufacturing Sector:** Achieved an average annual growth rate of **5.2%** over the last decade.
- **Coal Production:** Accelerated coal production reduced import dependence.
- **Pharmaceutical Market:** India is the world's third largest by volume with a valuation of **USD 50 billion**.
- **Clothing Manufacturing:** India is the second-largest globally and among the top five exporters.
- **Electronics Manufacturing:** Accounts for **3.7%** of the global market share in FY22.
- **PLI Schemes:** Attracted over **₹1.28 lakh crore** of investment until May 2024, leading to production/sales of **₹10.8 lakh crore** and employment generation of **over 8.5 lakh**.

Chapter 11: Services - Fuelling Growth Opportunities

- **Services Sector Contribution:** **55%** of overall GVA, back to pre-pandemic levels.
- **Active Companies:** **65%** of the highest number of active companies are in the services sector.
- **Global Services Exports:** Constituted **4.4%** of the world's commercial services exports in 2022.
- **Computer and Business Services Exports:** Accounted for **73%** of India's services exports, with a **9.6% YoY** growth.
- **Aviation Sector Growth:** **15% YoY** increase in total air passengers handled.
- **Services Sector Credit:** **₹45.9 lakh crore** in March 2024, with a **22.9% YoY** growth.

Chapter 12: Infrastructure – Lifting Potential Growth

- **Public Sector Investment:** Significant role in funding large-scale infrastructure projects.
- **National Highway Construction:** Pace increased to around **34 km per day** by FY24.
- **Railway Capital Expenditure:** Increased by **77%** in the past five years.
- **Airport Infrastructure:** New terminal buildings operationalised at **21 airports**, increasing passenger handling capacity by **62 million** per annum.
- **Clean Energy Investment:** ₹8.5 lakh crore (USD 102.4 billion) between 2014 and 2023.

Chapter 13: Climate Change and India

- **Global Climate Strategies:** Flawed and not universally applicable, overconsumption not addressed.
- **India's Ethos:** Emphasizes a harmonious relationship with nature, contrasting with overconsumption cultures.
- **Sustainable Housing:** Shift towards 'traditional multi-generational households'.
- **Mission LIFE:** Focuses on human-nature harmony, promoting mindful consumption to address global climate change.

The Economic Survey 2023-24 provides a detailed analysis of India's economic landscape, highlighting its resilience and strategic initiatives aimed at sustainable and inclusive growth. With focused efforts on macroeconomic stability, financial inclusion, climate action, and social welfare, India is well-positioned to navigate future challenges and capitalize on growth opportunities.

Wimbledon 2024 Final, Check Complete Winners List

Carlos Alcaraz defended his Wimbledon title as he defeated **Novak Djokovic** 6-2, 6-2, 7-6 in the **Wimbledon 2024 final**. At 21, Alcaraz is the youngest player in open era to win men's singles at Wimbledon and Roland Garros in the same year. On Women's Category, **Barbora Krejčíková** defeated **Jasmine Paolini** in their Wimbledon 2024 singles showdown, at the All England Lawn Tennis and Croquet Club in London.

Here is the winner's list of Wimbledon 2024

Category	Winner(s)	Runner(s)-up	Score
Men's Singles	Carlos Alcaraz	Novak Djokovic	6-2, 6-2, 7-6 (7-4)
Women's Singles	Barbora Krejčíková	Jasmine Paolini	6-2, 2-6, 6-4
Mixed Doubles	Hsieh Su-Wei & Jan Zielinski	Santiago Gonzalez & Giuliana Olmos	6-4, 6-2
Women's Doubles	Taylor Townsend & Katerina Siniakova	Gabriela Dabrowski & Erin Routliffe	Not provided
Men's Doubles	Patten & Heliovaara	Max Purcell & Jordan Thompson	6-7 (7-9), 7-6 (10-8), 7-6 (11-9)

Centre Reconstitutes NITI Aayog

The Centre has reconstituted the NITI Aayog, the **Apex public policy think tank of the Union government**, following changes in the council of ministers. Prime Minister Narendra Modi remains the chairperson, with **economist Suman K Bery** continuing as the vice-chairperson. The reconstituted NITI Aayog includes **four full-time members** and **15 Union Ministers**, including those from BJP allies, serving as either ex-officio members or special invitees.

Leadership and Full-Time Members

- **Chairperson:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi
- **Vice-Chairperson:** Economist Suman K Bery
- **Full-Time Members**
 - VK Saraswat (Former ISRO DG and Scientist)
 - Ramesh Chand (Agricultural Economist)
 - Dr. VK Paul (Paediatrician)
 - Arvind Virmani (Noted Economist)

Ex-Officio Members from the Cabinet

- **Rajnath Singh** (Defence)
- **Amit Shah** (Home)
- **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** (Agriculture)
- **Nirmala Sitharaman** (Finance)

Special Invitees

- **Nitin Gadkari** (Road Transport and Highways)
- **JP Nadda** (Health)
- **HD Kumaraswamy** (Heavy Industries and Steel, from JD(S))
- **Jitan Ram Manjhi** (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises, from HAM)
- **Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh** (Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying, from JD(U))
- **Virendra Kumar** (Social Justice and Empowerment)
- **Rammohan Naidu** (Civil Aviation, from TDP)
- **Jual Oram** (Tribal Affairs)
- **Annpurna Devi** (Women and Child Development)
- **Chirag Paswan** (Food Processing Industries, from LJP(RV))
- **Rao Inderjit Singh** (Statistics and Programme Implementation)

Background

NITI Aayog, established in 2015, replaced the 65-year-old Planning Commission. This restructuring aims to incorporate a broader range of expertise and representation, including significant input from NDA allies.

AIFF awards 2024 Announced

The **All India Football Federation (AIFF)** recently held its annual awards ceremony, recognizing outstanding achievements in Indian football for the 2023-24 season. The top honours went to **Lallianzuala Chhangte** and **Indumathi Kathiresan**, who were named the male and female Players of the Year respectively.

Men's Player of the Year: Lallianzuala Chhangte

Lallianzuala Chhangte, the 27-year-old winger from **Mumbai City FC**, secured the AIFF Men's Player of the Year award for the second consecutive time. This achievement makes him only the fifth player to win the award multiple times. Chhangte's exceptional performance included:

- Scoring 11 goals and providing 7 assists in all competitions for Mumbai City FC
- Being the highest-scoring Indian in the Indian Super League (ISL)
- Scoring against Qatar in Doha during the FIFA World Cup Qualifiers in June 2024

Women's Player of the Year: Indumathi Kathiresan

Indumathi Kathiresan, the 30-year-old midfielder, became the first player from Tamil Nadu to win the AIFF Women's Player of the Year award. Her accomplishments include:

- Winning the 2023-24 Indian Women's League (IWL) title with Odisha FC
- Scoring 5 goals in the IWL and winning the Best Midfielder award
- Scoring against Estonia in the Turkish Women's Cup in February 2024

Promising Players of the Year

Men's Category: David Lalhlansanga

David Lalhlansanga, the 22-year-old striker from Mohammedan Sporting, was named the AIFF Promising Men's Player of the Year. His impressive record includes:

- Scoring 34 goals across various competitions (I-League, Calcutta Football League, and Durand Cup)
- Helping Mohammedan Sporting win the I-League and Calcutta Football League titles
- Earning his first national team call-up in May 2024 for the FIFA World Cup Qualifiers

Women's Category: Neha

18-year-old winger **Neha** received the AIFF Promising Women's Player of the Year award for her outstanding performances, including:

- Scoring 2 goals in India's SAFF U19 Women's Championship triumph
- Contributing 3 goals in Haryana's run to the Senior Women's National Football Championship final
- Scoring for HOPS FC in the IWL and being part of the senior India squad for international friendlies

Coaching Excellence

- **Men's Coach of the Year:** Khalid Jamil (Jamshedpur FC)
- **Women's Coach of the Year:** Sukla Dutta (India U-19 team and Sreebhumi FC)

Other Notable Awards

- **Referee of the Year:** Ramachandran Venkatesh
- **Assistant Referee of the Year:** Ujjal Halder

Table of AIFF Award Winners for 2023-24

Category	Winner
Men's Player of the Year	Lallianzuala Chhangte
Women's Player of the Year	Indumathi Kathiresan
Promising Men's Player of the Year	David Lalhlansanga
Promising Women's Player of the Year	Neha
Men's Coach of the Year	Khalid Jamil
Women's Coach of the Year	Sukla Dutta
Referee of the Year	Ramachandran Venkatesh
Assistant Referee of the Year	Ujjal Halder

State Association Awards

The AIFF also recognized various state football associations for their contributions to the sport:

- **Most Successful MA (Club Competitions):** Indian Football Association (West Bengal)
- **Most Successful MA (NFC Competitions):** All Manipur Football Association
- **Best MA – Supporting Women's Football:** Punjab Football Association
- **MA with most player registrations (men's):** Kerala Football Association
- **MA with most player registrations (women's):** Western India Football Association (Maharashtra)

Special Recognition

Special awards were given to state governments and associations for their support in hosting various AIFF events:

- Government of Arunachal Pradesh and Arunachal Pradesh Football Association
- Government of Odisha and Football Association of Odisha
- Jammu and Kashmir Sports Council

Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Three new criminal laws –**Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita**, **Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** and the **Bharatiya Sakshya Adhinyam** -came into effect across the country on **July 1, 2024**. These laws will replace the **colonial-era Indian Penal Code, Code of Criminal Procedure** and the **Indian Evidence Act**, respectively.

What is Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita?

- The **Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023** (BNSS) was introduced on **August 11, 2023** to replace the **CrPC**. It amends provisions on bail, expands the scope of property seizure, and alters powers of police and Magistrates. The Bill has been examined by the Standing Committee on Home Affairs.

- **Bharatiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita** has **531** sections (in place of 484 sections of CrPC). A total of **177 provisions** have been changed in the Sanhita and nine new sections as well as **39** new sub-sections have been added to it. The act has added 44 new provisions and clarifications.

Highlights of the Bill

- The **Bharatiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 (BNSS)** seeks to replace the **Criminal Procedure Code, 1973 (CrPC)**. The **CrPC** provides for the procedure for arrest, prosecution, and bail.
- **BNSS** mandates forensic investigation for offences punishable with **seven years** of imprisonment or more. Forensic experts will visit crime scenes to collect forensic evidence and record the process.
- All trials, inquiries, and proceedings may be held in electronic mode. Production of electronic communication devices, likely to contain digital evidence, will be allowed for investigation, inquiry, or trial.
- If a proclaimed offender has absconded to evade trial and there is no immediate prospect of arresting him, the trial can be conducted and judgement pronounced in his absence.
- Along with specimen signatures or handwriting, finger impressions and voice samples may be collected for investigation or proceedings. Samples may be taken from a person who has not been arrested.

Key Issues and Analysis

- The **BNSS** allows up to **15 days of police custody**, which can be authorised in parts during the initial 40 or 60 days of the **60 or 90 days period** of judicial custody. This may lead to denial of bail for the entire period if the police has not exhausted the 15 days custody.
- The powers to attach **property** from proceeds of crime does not have safeguards provided in the **Prevention of Money Laundering Act**.
- The **CrPC** provides for bail for an accused who has been detained for half the maximum imprisonment for the offence. The **BNSS** denies this facility for anyone facing multiple charges. As many cases involve charges under multiple sections, this may limit such bail.
- The use of handcuffs is permitted in a range of cases including economic offences, contradicting Supreme Court directions.
- The **BNSS** allows evidence collected by retired or transferred investigating officers to be presented by their successors. This violates normal rules of evidence when the author of the document can be cross examined.
- Recommendations of **high level committees** on changes to the **CrPC** such as reforms in sentencing guidelines and codifying rights of the accused have not been incorporated in the **BNSS**.

Difference between New Law (Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita 2023) and Old Law

Aspect	Old Law (Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973)	New Law (Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023)
Introduction Date	1973	2023
Colonial Influence	Retained elements from British colonial rule	Drafted to reflect post-independence and modern Indian values
Language and Terminology	Archaic legal language	Simplified and modernized language
Structure	Detailed procedural code with 484 sections	Revised structure, updated sections
Arrests	Procedures for arrests detailed in Sections 41-60	New provisions for digital warrants, use of technology in arrests
Investigation	Traditional methods of investigation	Emphasis on forensic evidence, cyber investigations
Bail and Bonds	Detailed provisions in Sections 436-450	Streamlined process, emphasis on bail reform
Trial Procedures	Detailed trial procedures	Simplified and expedited trial processes
Witness Protection	Limited provisions	Comprehensive witness protection programs
Victim Rights	Basic recognition of victim rights	Enhanced victim compensation and support mechanisms
Speedy Trial	Emphasis on speedy trial, often delayed	Stronger provisions for ensuring speedy trial
Digital Evidence	Limited recognition	Comprehensive recognition and procedures for digital evidence
Police Reforms	Basic guidelines	Detailed guidelines on police reforms, accountability mechanisms
Appeals and Revisions	Detailed in Sections 372-394	Updated to include digital submission of appeals, faster processes
Juvenile Procedures	Governed by Juvenile Justice Act, 2015	Integrated approach with special provisions for juveniles
Technology Use	Limited use	Extensive use of technology in legal processes
Alternative Dispute Resolution	Basic provisions	Expanded focus on ADR mechanisms

Aspect	Old Law (Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973)	New Law (Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023)
Preventive Measures	Sections on preventive actions like Section 107, 144	Strengthened preventive measures, modern context considerations
Community Policing	Limited provisions	Emphasis on community policing and involvement
Special Courts	Provisions for special courts	Expansion and more specific guidelines for special courts
Inter-State Coordination	Basic guidelines	Enhanced inter-state coordination mechanisms
Legal Aid	Basic provisions for free legal aid	Strengthened and expanded legal aid provisions
Electronic Monitoring	Not covered	Provisions for electronic monitoring of offenders
Public Participation	Limited mechanisms	Increased focus on public participation in criminal justice

Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023, Check Complete Details

The **three New Criminal Laws**– **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023**, **Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023** and **Bharatiya Sakshya Adhinyam, 2023**, will come into force **July 1, 2024**. The government of India has held regular meetings with **States and Union Territories** and they are fully geared up in terms of **technology, capacity building** and **awareness generation** to implement the **new Criminal Laws**.

What is Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023?

- The **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS)** is the official criminal code in the **Republic of India**. It came into **effect on 1 July, 2024** after being passed by the parliament in December 2023 to replace the **Indian Penal Code (IPC)**, which dated back to the period of **British India**.
- Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita** has 358 sections (instead of 511 sections of IPC). A total of 20 new crimes have been added to the Sanhita, and the imprisonment sentence has been increased for 33 crimes. The amount of fine has been increased in 83 crimes and mandatory minimum punishment has been introduced in 23 crimes.

Offences included in Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023

In the **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita**, **20 new offences** have been added to and **19 provisions** in the repealed IPC have been dropped. The punishment of imprisonment has been increased for **33 offences**, and fines have been increased for 83 offences. A mandatory minimum punishment has been introduced for **23 offences**. A sentence of community service has been introduced for six offences.

- Offences against the body:** The BNS retains the provisions of the IPC on murder, abetment of suicide, assault and causing grievous hurt. It adds new offences such as organised crime, terrorism, and murder or grievous hurt by a group on certain grounds.
- Sexual offences against women:** The BNS retains the provisions of the IPC on rape, voyeurism, stalking and insulting the modesty of a woman. It increases the threshold for the victim to be classified as a major, in the case of gang rape, from 16 to 18 years of age.
- Offences against property:** The BNS retains the provisions of the IPC on theft, robbery, burglary and cheating. It adds new offences such as cybercrime and financial fraud.
- Offences against the state:** The BNS removes sedition as an offence. Instead, there is a new offence for acts endangering India's sovereignty, unity and integrity.
- Offences against the public:** The BNS adds new offences such as environmental pollution and human trafficking.

Highlight of The New Criminal Law

- Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023** will replace the IPC. It will have **358 sections** instead of the earlier 511 sections, 175 sections have been changed, 8 new sections have been added and 22 sections have been repealed.
- State-of-the-art technologies** have been incorporated into this law. The definition of documents has been expanded to include **electronic or digital records**, e-mails, server logs, computers, smartphones, **laptops, SMS, websites, locational evidence, mail and messages** available on devices, which can be used in courts, which will give freedom from the pile of papers.
- A provision has been made in this law to digitise the entire process from **FIR to case diary**, case diary to charge sheet and from charge sheet to judgment. At present, only the appearance of the accused in court can be done through video conferencing.
- The new laws make **videography compulsory** at the time of search and seizure, which will be part of the case and this will save the innocent citizens from being implicated. No charge sheet will be valid without such recording by the police.
- The Government will set up the **National Forensic Science University** which after three years will produce **33,000 forensic science experts and scientists** every year. The government aims to take the conviction ratio **above 90%** with these laws. For this, an important provision has been provided which will make the visit of the forensic team to the crime scene compulsory for offences **punishable for 7 years or more**.
- The new laws also allow '**Zero FIR (e-FIR)**' to ensure the convenience of the citizens. Wherever the crime may have happened, the citizens will be able to **tolodge complaints** even outside of their police station area. Within **15 days** of the registration of the crime, it will have to be forwarded to the concerned police station.

7. The **statement of the victim** has been made compulsory in the case of **sexual violence and video recording** of the statement has also been made compulsory in the case of sexual harassment. It will be compulsory for the police to give the status of the complaint to the complainant in **90 days** and thereafter **every 15 days**. No government will be able to withdraw a case of imprisonment of 7 years or more without hearing the victim, which will protect the rights of the citizens.
8. For the first time, the government is bringing community service as a punishment. The scope of summary trials in small cases has also been increased. Now offenses punishable up to **3 years** will be included in summary trial. A time limit of 90 days has been fixed for filing the charge sheet and depending on the situation, the court will be able to give permission for a further 90 days.
9. The government will have to decide on the **permission for trial against a civil servant or police officer in 120 days**, otherwise, it will be treated as deemed.
10. For the first time, a provision has been made to **criminalise sexual intercourse** on the basis of false promises of marriage, employment and promotion and on the basis of false identity. In all cases of gang rape, a provision of **20 years of punishment or life imprisonment** has been made, which is not being implemented today. In the case of **girls below 18 years of age**, a provision of the death penalty has also been kept. For mob lynching, all three provisions of **7 years**, life imprisonment and the death penalty have been kept. There was **no provision for mobile phones or chain snatching from women**, but now provision has been kept for the same.

Difference between The New Criminal Law and Old Law

Aspect	Old Law (Indian Penal Code, 1860)	New Law (Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023)
Introduction Date	1860	2023
Colonial Influence	Drafted during British colonial rule	Drafted in post-independence India, reflecting modern values
Language and Terminology	Archaic English	Simplified and modernized language
Structure	511 sections	Revised structure, includes new sections
Offenses against the State	Sections on sedition, less emphasis on national security	Stronger focus on national security, cybercrimes, terrorism
Sexual Offenses	Outdated definitions, limited recognition of modern crimes	Expanded definitions, includes cyberstalking, digital harassment

Aspect	Old Law (Indian Penal Code, 1860)	New Law (Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023)
Gender Neutrality	Certain sections gender-specific	More gender-neutral provisions
Cybercrimes	Minimal references	Comprehensive sections on cybercrimes
Punishments	Traditional forms of punishment	Updated punishments, includes alternative sentencing
Restorative Justice	Limited provisions	Emphasis on restorative justice and victim compensation
Corruption and Bribery	General provisions	Detailed provisions to address modern forms of corruption
Economic Offenses	Basic definitions	Expanded to include financial frauds, money laundering
Defamation	Criminal defamation included	Modified to align with freedom of speech considerations
Adultery	Criminal offense	Decriminalized
Homosexuality	Criminalized under Section 377	Decriminalized following the Supreme Court judgment
Blasphemy	Strict provisions	More balanced approach respecting freedom of religion
Marital Rape	Not recognized	Recognized and criminalized
Implementation Mechanism	Traditional methods	Modernized with emphasis on technology and forensic science
Juvenile Justice	Separate act (Juvenile Justice Act, 2015)	Integrated approach with special provisions
Reform Focus	Punitive	Emphasis on rehabilitation and reform

Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA), 2023, Check Details

The new criminal laws, the **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS)**, the **Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS)** and the **Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA)** are taking effect from **July 1, 2024**. These laws repeal and replace the **Indian Penal Code**, the **Code of Criminal Procedure** and the **Indian Evidence Act** respectively.

New law passed

The new law was passed by **Parliament** last **December**, with Home Minister Amit Shah, who had piloted the change, saying that the legislations would give priority to providing justice, unlike the British-era laws that gave primacy to penal action. "These laws are made by Indians, for Indians and by an Indian Parliament and marks the end of colonial criminal justice laws," he said.

All about Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam

The **Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA)** replaces the **Indian Evidence Act** and introduces changes in the way evidence is processed. The BSA allows for "**electronic and digital records**". This covers a wide range of electronic records, which includes emails, server logs, files stored on computers,

laptops, or smartphones, website content, location data, and text messages, among others. The BSA also allows for **oral evidence** to be taken electronically. Additionally, to provide more protection to the victim and enforce transparency in investigation related to an **offence of rape**, the statement of the victim shall be recorded through audio-video means.

Expanded secondary evidence

The BSA has also expanded "**secondary evidence**" to include oral and written admissions. It states that secondary evidence will include "evidence of a person who has examined a document, the original of which consists of numerous accounts or other documents which cannot conveniently be examined in Court, and who is skilled in the examination of such documents".

Difference between Old Law and New Law

Aspect	Old Law (Indian Evidence Act, 1872)	New Law (Bhartiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023)
Introduction Date	1872	2023
Colonial Influence	Drafted during British colonial rule	Drafted to reflect post-independence and modern Indian values
Language and Terminology	Archaic English	Simplified and modernized language
Structure	Structured with 167 sections	Revised structure, includes new sections
Admissibility of Evidence	Detailed rules on admissibility	Updated rules considering technological advancements
Electronic Evidence	Basic recognition in amendments	Comprehensive provisions for electronic and digital evidence
Hearsay Rule	Strict adherence to hearsay rule	Modified to accommodate modern communication methods
Witness Testimony	Traditional procedures	Enhanced procedures including video conferencing for testimony
Relevance of Evidence	Defined under Sections 5-55	Expanded to include modern types of evidence
Documentary Evidence	Sections 61-90	Updated to include electronic documents
Presumption	Various presumptions detailed	New presumptions reflecting modern societal norms
Confessions	Sections 24-30 cover confessions	Revised provisions on confessions, especially digital confessions
Privileged Communication	Detailed in Sections 122-132	Expanded to cover modern professional communications
Expert Testimony	Sections 45-51	Broadened scope to include digital forensic experts
Burden of Proof	Sections 101-114 cover burden of proof	Updated rules considering new types of evidence
Character Evidence	Sections 52-55	Revised to reflect current societal values
Presumption of Innocence	Strongly upheld	Continued emphasis with additional safeguards
Alibi	Specific provisions	More detailed provisions on proving alibi
Sexual Offenses Evidence	Limited recognition of victims' rights	Enhanced protections and considerations for victims
Corroboration	Requirement for corroboration in certain cases	Updated requirements, especially in cases of digital evidence
Chain of Custody	Basic principles	Detailed procedures for maintaining chain of custody for digital evidence

Aspect	Old Law (Indian Evidence Act, 1872)	New Law (Bhartiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023)
In-camera Proceedings	Limited provisions	Expanded scope for in-camera proceedings, especially in sensitive cases
Forensic Evidence	Basic inclusion	Extensive provisions for forensic evidence, including DNA
Hostile Witnesses	Provisions for dealing with hostile witnesses	Updated rules considering the impact of digital threats
Adverse Inference	Sections on adverse inference from silence or non-production of evidence	Updated to reflect modern legal standards
Reforms Focus	Admissibility and relevance primarily	Emphasis on efficiency, technology, and victim rights

RBI's 29th Financial Stability Report (FSR) July 2024: An Overview

The **Financial Stability Report (FSR)** is a comprehensive, half-yearly publication that involves contributions from all financial sector regulators in India. It reflects the collective assessment of the Sub-Committee of the Financial Stability and Development Council on current and emerging risks to the stability of the Indian financial system. The July 2024 edition of the FSR highlights various aspects of global and domestic macro financial risks, the soundness and resilience of financial institutions, regulatory initiatives, and an assessment of systemic risk.

Global Macrofinancial Risks

The global economy and financial system demonstrate resilience amidst significant risks and uncertainties. Despite the improvement in near-term prospects, several factors pose downside risks:

- **Disinflation Pitstops:** Challenges in achieving the last mile of disinflation.
- **High Public Debt:** The rising levels of public debt across nations.
- **Stretched Asset Valuations:** Overvaluation of assets in financial markets.
- **Economic Fragmentation:** Growing economic divisions among countries.
- **Geopolitical Tensions:** Persistent geopolitical conflicts and their economic impacts.
- **Climate Disasters:** Increasing frequency and severity of climate-related disasters.
- **Cyber Threats:** Rising threats from cyber-attacks and security breaches.

Emerging market economies (EMEs) remain particularly vulnerable to these external shocks and spillovers.

Domestic Macrofinancial Risks

India's strong macroeconomic fundamentals and a stable financial system have underpinned the sustained expansion of its economy. Key factors supporting this growth include:

- **Moderating Inflation:** A trend of decreasing inflation rates.
- **Strong External Position:** Robust foreign exchange reserves and favorable trade balances.
- **Fiscal Consolidation:** Ongoing efforts to reduce fiscal deficits and manage public debt.

These factors have bolstered business and consumer confidence, with domestic financial conditions further strengthened by the healthy balance sheets of financial institutions.

Financial Institutions: Soundness and Resilience

Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs)

SCBs have shown remarkable improvement in profitability and asset quality:

- **Profitability:** Return on assets (RoA) and return on equity (RoE) are at 1.3% and 13.8%, respectively.
- **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs):** Gross NPAs and net NPAs are at multi-year lows of 2.8% and 0.6%, respectively.
- **Capital Buffers:** The capital to risk-weighted assets ratio (CRAR) and the common equity tier 1 (CET1) ratio stand at 16.8% and 13.9%, respectively, well above the regulatory minimum.

Macro stress tests for credit risk indicate that SCBs have adequate capital buffers to withstand adverse stress scenarios.

Urban Co-operative Banks (UCBs) and Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)

- **UCBs:** The CRAR for UCBs increased to 17.5% in March 2024.
- **NBFCs:** The CRAR for NBFCs slightly declined to 26.6%, still significantly above the regulatory minimum.

The insurance sector's consolidated solvency ratio remains above the minimum threshold limit of 150%, and stress tests on mutual funds and clearing corporations indicate robust resilience.

Regulatory Initiatives and Other Developments in the Financial Sector

Global Initiatives

Regulatory efforts globally continue to focus on:

- Promoting financial stability.
- Consistent implementation and refinement of global standards.
- Safeguarding the banking system from interconnectedness with non-banking financial institutions.
- Addressing risks from the digitalization of finance.
- Improving climate-related risk assessments.
- Strengthening resilience to cyber risks.

Domestic Initiatives

In India, regulatory initiatives aim to enhance the safety and resilience of the financial system by:

- Implementing proportionate regulations.
- Leveraging technology to improve customer service, governance, and risk management.
- Limiting procyclical activities while fostering efficiency.

Assessment of Systemic Risk

The most recent systemic risk survey (SRS) conducted in May 2024 categorized all major risk groups to domestic financial stability as 'medium.' Key findings include:

- **Optimism in Domestic Financial System:** Respondents showed optimism regarding the soundness of India's financial system.
- **Global Spillover Risks:** Risks from global spillovers have diminished, with increased confidence in the Indian financial system.
- **Near-term Risks:** The main near-term risks identified were geopolitical risks, tightening of global financial conditions, and capital outflows.

Highlights of the Reports

- The global economy is facing heightened risks from prolonged geopolitical tensions, elevated public debt, and the slow progress in the last mile of disinflation. Despite these challenges, the global financial system has remained resilient, and financial conditions stable.
- The Indian economy and the financial system remain robust and resilient, anchored by macroeconomic and financial stability. With improved balance sheets, banks and financial institutions are supporting economic activity through sustained credit expansion.
- The capital to risk-weighted assets ratio (CRAR) and the common equity tier 1 (CET1) ratio of scheduled commercial banks (SCBs) stood at 16.8 per cent and 13.9 per cent, respectively, at end-March 2024.
- SCBs' gross non-performing assets (GNPA) ratio fell to a multi-year low of 2.8 per cent and the net non-performing assets (NNPA) ratio to 0.6 per cent at end-March 2024.
- Macro stress tests for credit risk reveal that SCBs would be able to comply with minimum capital requirements, with the system-level CRAR in March 2025 projected at 16.1 per cent, 14.4 per cent and 13.0 per cent, respectively, under baseline, medium and severe stress scenarios. These scenarios are stringent conservative assessments under hypothetical shocks and the results should not be interpreted as forecasts.
- Non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) remain healthy, with CRAR at 26.6 per cent, GNPA ratio at 4.0 per cent and return on assets (RoA) at 3.3 per cent, respectively, at end-March 2024.

Indian Government Reshuffles Cabinet Committees in July 2024

On July 3, 2024, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's National Democratic Alliance (NDA)** government reorganized eight important groups within the Union Cabinet. This happened after Modi was sworn in as Prime Minister for the third time in a row, which is a record.

What are Cabinet Committees?

Cabinet Committees are small groups of ministers who work on specific areas of government. They help make decisions and manage different parts of the government's work.

Key Points About the New Cabinet Committees

- There are 72 members in the Union Council of Ministers, including Prime Minister Modi.
- 31 of these members are Cabinet-rank ministers.
- These Cabinet ministers are part of the newly formed committees.
- Prime Minister Modi leads most of the committees, but not all.

The Eight Cabinet Committees

1. Appointments Committee of the Cabinet

- Members: Prime Minister Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah
- Purpose: Makes decisions about important government appointments

2. Cabinet Committee on Security

- Key members: Prime Minister Modi, Defence Minister, Home Minister, Finance Minister, and External Affairs Minister
- Purpose: Deals with matters related to national security

3. Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs

- Led by: Prime Minister Modi
- Includes: Ministers of Defence, Home Affairs, Finance, Agriculture, and others
- Purpose: Handles important economic matters

4. Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs

- Headed by: Prime Minister Modi
- Members: Several key ministers including Defence, Home Affairs, and Finance
- Purpose: Manages political issues and strategies

5. Cabinet Committee on Investment and Growth

- Led by: Prime Minister Modi
- Includes: Ministers of Finance, Road Transport, Railways, and others
- Purpose: Focuses on boosting investment and economic growth

6. Cabinet Committee on Skill, Employment and Livelihood

- Notable absence: Prime Minister Modi is not a member
- Key members: Ministers of Defence, Home Affairs, Education, and Labour
- Purpose: Works on improving skills, creating jobs, and enhancing livelihoods

7. Cabinet Committee on Parliamentary Affairs

- Notable absence: Prime Minister Modi is not a member
- Led by: Defence Minister Rajnath Singh
- Purpose: Manages government business in Parliament

8. Cabinet Committee on Accommodation

- Headed by: Home Minister Amit Shah
- Includes: Ministers of Finance, Housing, and Urban Affairs
- Purpose: Deals with housing and accommodation for government officials

24th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit: Key Highlights

The **24th Meeting of the Council of Heads of State of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)** took place on July 4, 2024, in Astana, Kazakhstan. This important gathering brought together leaders from various countries to discuss regional cooperation and security issues.

Host and Venue

- **Host:** Kazakhstan President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev
- **Location:** Astana, the capital of Kazakhstan

Notable Attendees

Several world leaders participated in the summit, including:

- Russian President Vladimir Putin
- Chinese President Xi Jinping
- Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif
- UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres

India's Representation

- Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi did not attend the summit
- India was represented by External Affairs Minister Dr. S Jaishankar

Key Developments

1. Belarus Joins SCO

- Belarus was admitted as the 10th full member of the SCO
- Previously, Belarus held observer status in the organization

2. Focus on Combating Terrorism

- Dr. Jaishankar read Prime Minister Modi's address at the summit
- Modi emphasized that terrorism in any form cannot be justified
- He called for decisive action against cross-border terrorism

- The Prime Minister stressed the need to counter terrorism financing and recruitment

3. SCO Expansion

- The SCO was originally established in 2001 with five members
- India and Pakistan joined in 2017
- Iran became the 9th member in 2023
- Belarus is now the 10th member as of 2024

Looking Ahead: 25th SCO Summit

- The next SCO Council of Heads of State Meeting will be held in China
- China has taken over the rotating presidency of the SCO from Kazakhstan
- The Chinese city of Qingdao has been named the SCO's tourism and cultural capital for 2024-2025

About the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation

Purpose

- The SCO is an intergovernmental organization focused on regional security and cooperation

Concerns

- Some analysts worry that the SCO is becoming an anti-Western alliance led by China and Russia
- This may be one reason why Prime Minister Modi chose not to attend the summit

Structure

- The Council of Heads of States is the SCO's highest decision-making body
- It meets once a year

Key Facts

- Headquarters: Beijing, China
- Permanent Members: 10 countries (including the latest addition, Belarus)
- Observer Members: Afghanistan and Mongolia

Sixteenth Finance Commission Constitutes Five-Member Advisory Council

The **Sixteenth Finance Commission** has constituted an advisory council with **five members to advise** the Commission on any of the **Terms of Reference (ToR)** or related subjects. The Finance Commission, as per the ToR, will also suggest measures to augment the Consolidated Fund of a State to supplement the resources of panchayats and municipalities.

Advisory Council Members

Poonam Gupta, Director General of the National Council of Applied Economic Research, has been appointed as the convenor of the Advisory Council. The other members are:

- D.K. Srivastava, Chief Policy Advisor at EY
- Neelkanth Mishra, Chief Economist at Axis Bank
- Pranjul Bhandari, Chief India Economist at HSBC Securities & Capital Markets
- Rahul Bajoria, MD & Head of EM Asia (ex-China) Economics at Barclays

Role and Functions of the Advisory Council

The advisory council will assist the Commission in

- Preparing papers or research studies
- Monitoring or assessing studies commissioned by the Finance Commission
- Enhancing the Commission's understanding of issues in its ToR
- Broadening the Commission's ambit and understanding by seeking the best national and international practices on fiscal devolution

Terms of Reference (ToR)

The ToR approved by the Cabinet include

- Distribution of net proceeds of taxes between the Union and states under Chapter I, Part XII of the Constitution
- Allocation of respective shares of such proceeds between states
- Principles governing the grants-in-aid of the revenues of states out of the Consolidated Fund of India
- Sums to be paid to states by way of grants-in-aid of their revenues

Constitutional Mandate

The Finance Commission is a constitutionally mandated body established every five years to devise a formula for distributing net tax proceeds between the Centre and the states as well as among states and local bodies. Currently, India shares 41% of federal taxes with states as recommended by the 15th panel.

UNESCO Expands World Network of Biosphere Reserves

The United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) has recently made a significant announcement, approving the designation of **11 new Biosphere Reserves** across 11 countries. This expansion brings the total number of sites in the **World Network of Biosphere Reserves** to an impressive **759**, spanning **136 countries** worldwide. This development marks a crucial step forward in global efforts to protect biodiversity and promote sustainable development.

Newly Designated Biosphere Reserves

The latest additions to the UNESCO Biosphere Reserve list showcase a diverse range of ecosystems and cultural landscapes across the globe. These new sites include:

1. **Kempen-Broek Transboundary Biosphere Reserve** (Belgium, Kingdom of the Netherlands)
2. **Darién Norte Chocoano Biosphere Reserve** (Colombia)
3. **Madre de las Aguas Biosphere Reserve** (Dominican Republic)
4. **Niumi Biosphere Reserve** (Gambia)
5. **Colli Euganei Biosphere Reserve** (Italy)
6. **Julian Alps Transboundary Biosphere Reserve** (Italy, Slovenia)

7. **Khar Us Lake Biosphere Reserve** (Mongolia)
8. **Apayaos Biosphere Reserve** (Philippines)
9. **Changnyeong Biosphere Reserve** (Republic of Korea)
10. **Val d'Aran Biosphere Reserve** (Spain)
11. **Irati Biosphere Reserve** (Spain)

Understanding Biosphere Reserves: Balancing Nature and Human Activity

Definition and Purpose

A **Biosphere Reserve** is an international designation granted by UNESCO for areas that represent significant natural and cultural landscapes. These reserves can encompass large terrestrial, coastal, or marine ecosystems, or a combination thereof. The fundamental goal of Biosphere Reserves is to achieve a delicate balance between **economic and social development**, the **preservation of cultural values**, and the **conservation of nature**.

Criteria for Designation

To be designated as a Biosphere Reserve, a site must meet several key criteria:

1. Contain a **protected core area** of high nature conservation value
2. Be a **biogeographically significant unit** large enough to sustain viable populations across all trophic levels
3. Involve **local communities** and utilize their knowledge in biodiversity preservation
4. Demonstrate potential for preserving **traditional tribal or rural modes of living** that harmonize with the environment

The Three-Zone Approach

Biosphere Reserves are typically divided into three interconnected zones:

1. **Core Zone**: The most protected area, often a national park or sanctuary, kept free from human interference
2. **Buffer Zone**: Surrounds the core zone, allowing activities that protect and support the core zone's integrity
3. **Transition Zone**: The outermost part, where human activities and conservation efforts coexist harmoniously

India's Commitment to Biosphere Reserves

The Biosphere Reserve Project

In 1986, the Government of India launched the **Biosphere Reserve scheme**, aligning with UNESCO's Man and Biosphere (MAB) programme. This initiative provides financial assistance to states for the maintenance and development of biosphere reserves, with varying ratios of central to state funding depending on the region.

India's Biosphere Reserve Network

As of 2024, India boasts **18 notified biosphere reserves**, of which **12 are recognized** by UNESCO's MAB programme. These reserves span diverse ecosystems across the country, from the Nilgiri mountains to the Sundarbans delta, showcasing India's rich biodiversity and commitment to conservation.

Global Impact and Future Prospects

The expansion of the World Network of Biosphere Reserves represents a significant stride in global conservation efforts. With **759 sites** covering a total area of **7,442,000 square kilometers** and impacting the lives of approximately **275 million people**, these reserves play a crucial role in:

- Conserving biodiversity
- Promoting sustainable development
- Preserving cultural heritage
- Facilitating scientific research and environmental education

As the network continues to grow, it strengthens the global community's capacity to address pressing environmental challenges while fostering sustainable economic growth and cultural preservation.

India to Observe 'Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas' on June 25

The Government of India, under the leadership of Prime Minister **Shri Narendra Modi**, has made a significant decision to observe **June 25** annually as '**Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas**' (Constitution Murder Day). This observance is intended to commemorate the immense sacrifices and contributions of those who endured the harsh realities of the **1975 Emergency**.

Purpose and Significance

The Union Home Minister emphasized that this decision serves a dual purpose:

1. To honor the spirit of millions who struggled to revive democracy
2. To acknowledge the inexplicable persecution faced by citizens at the hands of an oppressive government during the Emergency period

The observance of Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas is expected to play a crucial role in keeping the eternal flame of **individual freedom** and the defense of **democracy** alive in every Indian citizen. By doing so, it aims to prevent any dictatorial force from repeating the horrors of the past.

The Emergency: A Dark Chapter in Indian Democracy

Historical Context

The Emergency refers to a 21-month period from **June 25, 1975, to March 21, 1977**. During this time, the government led by Prime Minister **Indira Gandhi** invoked special provisions in the Constitution to impose sweeping executive and legislative measures on the country.

Key Events and Consequences

1. **Suspension of Civil Liberties:** The government curtailed fundamental rights, including the freedom of speech and expression guaranteed under **Article 19(1)(a)** of the Indian Constitution.
2. **Press Censorship:** The Emergency saw the implementation of pre-censorship of the press, severely limiting the free flow of information.
3. **Mass Arrests:** Almost all opposition leaders were imprisoned, effectively silencing dissent.

4. **Electoral Disruption:** The government cancelled scheduled elections, undermining the democratic process.

5. **Rule by Decree:** The normal functioning of democracy was replaced by authoritarian rule through executive orders.

Impact on Fundamental Rights

The Emergency period witnessed a severe curtailment of fundamental rights. The freedom of speech and expression, a cornerstone of any democratic society, was particularly targeted. This led to:

- Pre-censorship of the press
- Restrictions on public gatherings and protests
- Limitations on personal freedoms

Significance of June 25, 2024

This year marks a significant milestone as India enters the **fiftieth year** since the imposition of the Emergency. The decision to observe Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas annually from this year onwards carries special weight in light of this anniversary.

Looking Forward: Preserving Democratic Values

Educational Importance

By instituting this annual observance, the government aims to educate younger generations about this critical period in Indian history. It serves as a reminder of the fragility of democratic institutions and the importance of safeguarding constitutional rights.

Strengthening Democratic Foundations

The observance of Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas is expected to:

1. Reinforce the importance of constitutional values
2. Encourage civic engagement and political awareness
3. Foster a deeper appreciation for democratic freedoms

National Reflection

This annual event provides an opportunity for national reflection on the importance of:

- Upholding the rule of law
- Protecting individual freedoms
- Maintaining a vibrant and free press
- Ensuring the independence of democratic institutions

NITI Aayog Releases SDG India Index 2023-24

The SDG India Index 2023-24 reveals significant **national and subnational progress on Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**. India's composite score improved to 71, reflecting advancements across key sectors like **poverty eradication, economic growth, climate action, and biodiversity conservation**.

State-wise Progress

- **Front Runner States:** 32 States and UTs achieved scores between 65 and 99, with notable improvements seen in Uttar Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, and West Bengal.

- **New Entrants:** Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Chhattisgarh, and others join the Front Runner category due to substantial score increases.

Goal-wise Achievements

- **Goal 13 (Climate Action):** Score increased from 54 to 67, showcasing enhanced disaster preparedness and renewable energy adoption.
- **Goal 1 (No Poverty):** Improved from 60 to 72, driven by social welfare schemes like PMAY and Ayushman Bharat.

Key Interventions

- Initiatives such as PM Awas Yojana and Ujjwala Yojana contributed significantly to housing, sanitation, and clean energy goals.
- Increased financial inclusion and digital infrastructure development further supported economic growth and societal welfare.

Institutional Framework

NITI Aayog's role in localizing SDGs and fostering competitive federalism has been pivotal, promoting sustainable development as integral to national and subnational policies.

Future Directions

The SDG India Index serves as a crucial tool for evaluating progress and guiding policy decisions towards achieving the 2030 Agenda. The focus remains on inclusive growth and environmental sustainability.

(Sustainable Development Goals) SDG's Goal : Key points

Number of Goals

There are 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) established by the United Nations.

Members Involved

All 193 member states of the United Nations have committed to achieving these goals by 2030.

Purpose

The SDGs aim to address global challenges such as poverty, inequality, climate change, environmental degradation, peace, and justice.

Targets

Each goal has specific targets, totaling 169 targets across all SDGs, to guide national and global efforts towards sustainable development.

Adoption

The SDGs were adopted by all UN member states in 2015 as part of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

Implementation

Countries are encouraged to localize and integrate the SDGs into national policies and programs, with regular monitoring and reporting on progress.

Global Impact

The SDGs provide a framework for global cooperation, encouraging collaboration among governments, businesses, civil society, and citizens to achieve a more sustainable and equitable world by 2030.

Most Important Current Affairs of August 2024

Neeraj Chopra Clinches Silver in Javelin at Paris 2024 Olympics

Neeraj Chopra, the reigning Olympic champion, put on an impressive display at the Paris Olympics, winning the silver medal in the men's javelin throw event. Chopra's season-best throw of **89.45m** earned him the runner-up position, but he was unable to defend his title, as Pakistan's Arshad Nadeem broke the **Olympic record** with a stunning throw of **92.97m**.

Chopra, who was the defending champion coming into the competition, was unable to replicate his gold-medal-winning performance from the 2020 Tokyo Olympics. However, his silver-medal finish is still a remarkable achievement, as he continues to establish himself as one of the world's premier javelin throwers.

Arshad Nadeem's Historic Gold Medal

The true star of the event was Pakistan's Arshad Nadeem, who produced a remarkable performance to claim the gold medal. Nadeem's record-breaking throw of **92.97m** not only secured him the top spot on the podium but also etched his name in the Olympic history books.

Nadeem's triumph is a significant accomplishment for Pakistan, as it marks the country's first-ever gold medal in the javelin throw event. The 25-year-old athlete's victory is a testament to his dedication, hard work, and the growing strength of Pakistan's sports program.

Anderson Peters Wins Bronze

Grenada's Anderson Peters rounded out the podium with a bronze-medal-winning throw of **88.54m**. Peters, a former world champion, demonstrated his consistency and skill, delivering a strong performance to secure the third spot.

The men's javelin throw event at the Paris Olympics was a true showcase of the sport's global talent and the fierce competition at the highest level. Neeraj Chopra's silver medal, Arshad Nadeem's record-breaking gold, and Anderson Peters' bronze have all contributed to the excitement and drama of the Games.

Significance of the Performances

Neeraj Chopra's silver medal is a significant achievement, as he continues to cement his status as one of the world's best javelin throwers. His consistent performances at the highest level have earned him widespread acclaim and respect in the sporting community.

Arshad Nadeem's historic gold medal triumph is a remarkable accomplishment that will inspire and motivate aspiring athletes in Pakistan and around the world. His record-breaking throw has set a new benchmark for the event and will undoubtedly spur on the next generation of javelin throwers to pursue their dreams.

The men's javelin throw event at the Paris Olympics has once again showcased the global reach and appeal of the sport. The podium finishers hailing from different countries – India, Pakistan, and Grenada – is a testament to the diversity and inclusivity of the Olympic Games.

Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2024

In a significant move to recognize and honor outstanding contributions to science, technology, and innovation, the Indian government has announced the inaugural **Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskars**. This new award system, replacing over 300 previous awards from various science departments, aims to celebrate the achievements of academics, technologists, and inventors across the country.

The Vigyan Ratna Puraskar: Honoring a Lifetime of Achievement

Dr. Govindarajan Padmanabhan: The First Recipient

The highest honor, the **Vigyan Ratna Puraskar**, has been awarded to **Dr. Govindarajan Padmanabhan**, a celebrated biochemist and former director of the Indian Institute of Science-Bengaluru. Dr. Padmanabhan, also a Padma Bhushan laureate, receives this lifetime achievement award in recognition of his significant contributions to the field of biochemistry.

Table of Recipients

Award Category	Recipient(s)	Field
Vigyan Ratna Puraskar	Dr. Govindarajan Padmanabhan	Biochemistry
Vigyan Shri	Dr. Annapurini Subramanian	Astrophysics
	Dr. Anandharamakrishnan C	Agriculture Science
	Dr. Avesh Kumar Tyagi	Atomic Energy
	Prof. Umesh Varshney, Prof. Jayant Bhalchandra Udgaonkar	Biological Sciences
	Prof. Syed Wajih Ahmad Naqvi	Earth Sciences
	Prof. Bhim Singh	Engineering Sciences
	Prof. Adimurthi Adi, Prof. Rahul Mukherjee	Mathematics and Computer Science
	Prof. Dr. Sanjay Behari	Medicine
	Prof. Lakshmanan Muthusamy, Prof. Naba Kumar Mondal	Physics
	Prof. Rohit Srivastava	Technology and Innovation
Vigyan Yuva	Krishna Murthy SL, Swarup Kumar Parida	Agricultural Science
	Radhakrishnan Mahalakshmi, Prof. Aravind Penmatsa	Biological Sciences

Award Category	Recipient(s)	Field
	Vivek Polshettiwar, Vishal Rai	Chemistry
	Roxy Mathew Koll	Earth Sciences
	Abhilash, Radha Krishna Ganti	Engineering Sciences
	Purabi Saikia, Bappi Paul	Environmental Science
	Mahesh Ramesh Kakde	Mathematics and Computer Science
	Jitendra Kumar Sahu, Pragya Dhruv Yadav	Medicine
	Urbasi Sinha	Physics
	Digendranath Swain, Prashant Kumar	Space Science and Technology
	Prabhu Rajagopal	Technology and Innovation
Vigyan Team	Team Chandrayaan-3	Space Science

Top 10 Richest Global Central Banks in 2024

Central banks are the backbone of a nation's financial system, playing a pivotal role in maintaining **economic stability** and fostering **growth**. Their primary responsibilities include implementing **stable monetary policies** and ensuring **financial stability**. As we delve into the rankings of the world's wealthiest central banks in 2024, we gain valuable insights into the global economic landscape and the financial prowess of various nations.

The Significance of Central Bank Wealth

Economic Indicators

The total wealth of a central bank serves as a crucial indicator of a country's **economic health**. This wealth is primarily assessed through the central bank's **assets**, with the balance sheet acting as a key metric. A robust central bank balance sheet often correlates with a strong and stable economy.



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Regulatory Role

Central banks globally maintain specialized departments dedicated to **regulation and supervision**. These departments are staffed with experts who diligently monitor compliance with established financial laws and regulations, ensuring the integrity of the financial system.

Regional Dominance and Disparities

European Dominance

A striking observation in the 2024 rankings is the dominance of European central banks. Seven out of the top ten central banks are based in Europe, with a combined worth of an astounding **\$11.09 trillion**. This underscores the economic strength and financial stability of the European region.

African Absence

Notably absent from the top 10 list are African central banks. This absence can be attributed to several challenges facing the region, including:

1. Rising inflation
2. Fragile financial markets
3. Weak monetary policy transmission systems

These factors highlight the economic disparities and developmental challenges that persist in certain regions.

India's Position

While not in the top 10, India's **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** holds a respectable 12th position globally. As of March 31, 2024, the RBI's balance sheet grew by **11.08%** year-on-year, reaching **Rs 70.47 trillion**. This growth is primarily attributed to the bank's liquidity management and foreign currency (forex) activities, reflecting India's growing economic influence on the global stage.

Top 10 Richest Central Banks in the World

Based on data compiled by the Sovereign Wealth Fund Institute (SWFI), here are the top 10 wealthiest central banks in the world by total assets:

Rank	Name of the Central Bank	Total Assets (USD)	Country	Region
1	Federal Reserve System	\$7,835,559,000,000	USA	North America
2	People's Bank of China	\$6,004,919,369,845	China	Asia
3	Bank of Japan	\$5,543,058,448,125	Japan	Asia
4	Deutsche Bundesbank	\$2,776,759,343,640	Germany	Europe
5	Bank of France	\$2,011,001,711,400	France	Europe
6	Norges Bank	\$1,632,986,563,336	Norway	Europe
7	Bank of Italy	\$1,383,293,987,542	Italy	Europe
8	Bank of England	\$1,288,250,668,160	United Kingdom	Europe

Rank	Name of the Central Bank	Total Assets (USD)	Country	Region
9	Bank of Spain	\$1,049,435,626,385	Spain	Europe
10	Swiss National Bank	\$944,013,351,477	Switzerland	Europe

Analysis of the Top 10

Global Distribution

The list showcases a diverse geographical representation:

- 1 North American central bank
- 2 Asian central banks
- 7 European central banks

Economic Powerhouses

The central banks featured in this list represent some of the world's largest and most significant economies. Their substantial asset bases reflect their crucial role in the global financial system.

Regional Observations

1. **North America:** The Federal Reserve System of the USA tops the list, highlighting the country's economic dominance.
2. **Asia:** China and Japan's central banks occupy the 2nd and 3rd positions, underscoring Asia's growing economic influence.
3. **Europe:** The strong presence of European central banks demonstrates the region's collective economic strength and financial stability.

Implications and Insights

Economic Influence

The vast assets held by these central banks signify their substantial influence on global economic policies and financial markets. Their decisions can have far-reaching consequences on international trade, currency valuations, and economic stability.

Financial Stability

The robust asset bases of these central banks provide a strong foundation for managing economic crises and implementing effective monetary policies. This financial strength is crucial for maintaining stability during economic turbulence.

Global Economic Balance

The distribution of wealth among these central banks reflects the current balance of economic power globally. It highlights the continued economic strength of traditional powerhouses while also showcasing the rising influence of emerging economies, particularly in Asia.

70th National Film Awards

The winners of the **70th National Film Awards** are announced at the **National Media Center in New Delhi** on August 16, with the **Malayalam film Aattam** emerging as the Best Feature Film.

70th National Film Awards 2024 winners

- **Rishab Shetty** won the **Best Actor** award for **Kantara**, the Best Actress honour was shared by **Nithya Menen** for **Thiruchitrabalam** and **Manasi Parekh** for **The Kutch Express**, respectively.
- The **Best Director** honour went to **Sooraj Barjatya** for his film, **Uunchai**. **Ponniyin Selvan I**, **KGF 2**, **Brahmastra** and **Aparajito** were among the other films which won awards at the ceremony.
- The awards were announced by the **chairperson of the Feature Film Jury**, **Rahul Rawail**; **Nila Madhab Panda**, chairperson of the Non-Feature Film Jury; and **Gangadhar Mudalair**, chairperson of the Best Writing on Cinema Jury.

2023 National Film Awards

In 2023, the Best Actor honour was won by **Allu Arjun** for **Pushpa: The Rise** and the Best Actress award was won by **Alia Bhatt** and **Kriti Sanon** for **Gangubai Kathiawadi** and **Mimi**, respectively. **Rocketry: The Nambi Effect** won the award for Best Feature Film.

History of this award

First handed out in 1954, these awards were known as the **State Awards**. In those years, only best films in different regional languages were recognised and awarded. The awards for actors and technicians working on the films were first given in 1967. **Nargis** was the first actor to win **Best Actress** for her performance in **Raat Aur Din**. **Uttam Kumar** won the Best Actor award for **Antony Firingee** and **Chiriyakhana** in the same year.

List of 70th National Film Awards 2024 winners

Feature Film Categories

Category	Winner	Film
Best Feature Film	Aattam	Aattam
Best Actor	Rishab Shetty	Kantara
Best Actress	Nithya Menen, Manasi Parekh	Tiruchitrabalam, Kutch Express
Best Director	Sooraj Barjatya	Uunchai
Best Supporting Actress	Neena Gupta	Uunchai
Best Supporting Actor	Pawan Malhotra	Fouja
Best Feature Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment	Kantara	Kantara
Best Debut Film of a Director	Pramod Kumar	Fouja
Best Telugu Film	Karthikeya 2	Karthikeya 2

Category	Winner	Film
Best Tamil Film	Ponniyin Selvan – Part 1	Ponniyin Selvan – Part 1
Best Punjabi Film	Baaghi Di Dhee	Baaghi Di Dhee
Best Odia Film	Daman	Daman
Best Malayalam Film	Saudi Velakka CC.225/2009	Saudi Velakka CC.225/2009
Best Marathi Film	Vaalvi	Vaalvi
Best Kannada Film	KGF: Chapter 2	KGF: Chapter 2
Best Hindi Film	Gulmohar	Gulmohar
Best Tiwa Film	Sikaisal	Sikaisal
Best Bengali Film	Kaberi Antardhan	Kaberi Antardhan
Best Assamese Film	Emuthi Puthi	Emuthi Puthi
Special Mention	Manoj Bajpayee, Sanjoy Salil Chowdhury	Gulmohar, Kadhikan
Best Action Direction	KGF: Chapter 2	KGF: Chapter 2
Best Choreography	Tiruchitrabalam	Tiruchitrabalam
Best Lyrics	Fouja	Fouja
Best Music Director	Pritam (Songs), AR Rahman (Background Score)	Various
Best Makeup	Aparajito	Aparajito
Best Costumes	Kutch Express	Kutch Express
Best Production Design	Aparajito	Aparajito
Best Editing	Aattam	Aattam
Best Sound Design	Ponniyin Selvan – Part 1	Ponniyin Selvan – Part 1
Best Screenplay	Aattam	Aattam
Best Dialogues	Gulmohar	Gulmohar
Best Cinematography	Ponniyin Selvan – Part 1	Ponniyin Selvan – Part 1
Best Female Playback Singer	Bombay Jayashri	Saudi Velakka CC.225/2009
Best Male Playback Singer	Arijit Singh	Brahmastra
Best Child Artist	Sreepath	Mallikappuram
Best Film in AVGC	Brahmastra	Brahmastra
Best Non-Feature Film Promoting Social and Environmental Values	Kutch Express	Kutch Express

Film Writing

Category	Winner	Work
Best Critic	Deepak Dua	–
Best Book on Cinema	Kishore Kumar: The Ultimate Biography	–

Non-Feature Film Categories

Category	Winner	Film
Best Non-Feature Film	Ayena	Ayena
Best Debut Film	Madhyantara	Madhyantara
Best Biographical /Historical/ Compilation Film	Aanakhi Ek Mohenjo Daro	Aanakhi Ek Mohenjo Daro
Best Arts/Culture Film	Ranga Vibhoga/Varsa	Ranga Vibhoga/Varsa
Best Script	Mono No Aware	Mono No Aware
Best Narrator	Murmurs of the Jungle	Murmurs of the Jungle
Best Music Direction	Fursat	Fursat
Best Editing	Madhyantara	Madhyantara
Best Sound Design	Yaan	Yaan
Best Cinematography	Mono No Aware	Mono No Aware
Best Direction	From the Shadow	From the Shadow
Best Short Film	Xunyota	Xunyota
Best Animated Film	The Coconut Tree	The Coconut Tree
Best Non-Feature Film Promoting Social and Environmental Values	On the Brink Season 2 – Gharial	On the Brink Season 2 – Gharial
Best Documentary	Murmurs of the Jungle	Murmurs of the Jungle

Paris Olympics 2024

The Paris Olympics 2024 marks a significant milestone in the history of the modern Olympic Games. This edition of the Summer Olympics is expected to bring together athletes from around the world in a celebration of sports, unity, and international cooperation. Here's a comprehensive look at the details of the Paris Olympics 2024:

Theme and Mascot of Paris Olympics 2024

- **The Phryges:** official mascots of the Paris 2024 Games
- The theme of this year's Olympic Day is '**Let's Move and Celebrate**' to inspire and encourage people to embrace the joy of movement this summer.

Olympic Games in a few figures

- **Billions** of television viewers worldwide
- **350,000** hours of TV broadcast
- **Millions** of spectators

- **35** venues
- **10,500** athletes
- **20,000** accredited journalists
- **45,000** volunteers
- **+600,000** meals served at the Athletes' Village every day

Paris 2024 Olympic Games key figures

- **The XXXIII (33rd) Olympiad**
- **26 July to 11 August 2024**
- **19 days of competition** (handball, football and rugby take place from 24 July)
- **329 events**
- **Athletes from over 200 NOCs and the IOC Refugee Olympic Team**
- **32 sports (including the 4 additional sports)**
- **754 sessions (competitions and ceremonies)**
- **10,500 athletes**

Paris Olympics Edition

- **Paris Olympics 2024:** This edition marks the 33rd Summer Olympic Games and the third time Paris will host the Olympics, with previous editions in 1900 and 1924. The Paris 2024 Olympics is particularly significant as it commemorates the centenary of the last Paris Olympics.

Top 10 Country in Medal Tally

Rank	NOCs	Gold Medals (G)	Silver Medals (S)	Bronze Medals (B)	Total Medals
1	United States of America	40	44	42	126
2	People's Republic of China	40	27	24	91
3	Japan	20	12	13	45
4	Australia	18	19	16	53
5	France	16	26	22	64
6	Netherlands	15	7	12	34
7	Great Britain	14	22	29	65
8	Republic of Korea	13	9	10	32
9	Italy	12	13	15	40
10	Germany	12	13	8	33
62	Pakistan	01	0	0	1
71	India	0	1	5	6

Indian Medal Tally

- Opening Ceremony: Badminton superstar PV Sindhu and table tennis ace Sharath Kamal;
- Closing Ceremony: Double bronze medal winning shooter Manu Bhaker and bronze winning Indian men's hockey player PR Sreejesh;

- Abhinav Bindra selected as torchbearer for the 2024 Paris Olympics;
- Gagan Narang Appointed as India's Chef-De-Mission for Paris Olympics 2024;
- A contingent of **117** Indian athletes has been competing for medals and sporting glory at the ongoing Paris Olympics 2024.

Athlete	Medal	Event
Manu Bhaker	Bronze	Women's 10m air pistol shooting
Manu Bhaker-Sarabjot Singh	Bronze	Mixed team 10m air pistol shooting
Swapnil Kusale	Bronze	Men's 50m rifle 3 positions shooting
Indian hockey team	Bronze	Men's hockey
Neeraj Chopra	Silver	Men's javelin throw
Aman Sehrawat	Bronze	Men's 57kg wrestling

CEAT Cricket Awards 2024

The **CEAT Cricket Awards**, one of the most prestigious accolades in the cricketing world, held its 26th edition on August 21, 2024, in Mumbai. These awards, initiated in **1995-96** and sponsored by the RP Goenka Group company CEAT Tyres, honor exceptional performances of cricketers globally. The 2024 ceremony recognized outstanding achievements during the 2023-24 cricketing season, showcasing the best talents across various formats of the game.

Major Awards and Recipients

International Cricketer of the Year

Rohit Sharma, the captain of the Indian men's cricket team, was bestowed with the coveted **CEAT International Cricketer of the Year Award**. This recognition came on the back of his exemplary performance in the 2023-24 season, during which:

- Sharma amassed approximately 1800 runs in international cricket.
- He scored 597 runs in the 13th ICC Men's ODI Cricket World Cup.
- Under his leadership, India reached the World Cup final, ultimately finishing as runners-up to Australia.
- Sharma's consistent performance and leadership skills were key factors in his selection for this prestigious award.

ODI Batter of the Year

Virat Kohli received the award for the **Best ODI Batter of the Year**, following a phenomenal season in One Day Internationals. His achievements include:

- Scoring 1377 runs in the 2023-24 season.
- Accumulating six centuries and eight fifties.
- Leading the run charts in the 2023 ODI World Cup with 765 runs at an astounding average of 95.62.
- Surpassing Sachin Tendulkar's record by scoring his 50th ODI century.

- Kohli's exceptional form and milestone achievements made him the clear choice for this award.

Lifetime Achievement Award

The **Lifetime Achievement Award** was presented to **Rahul Dravid**, former Indian cricket captain and current coach of the Indian men's cricket team. Known as "The Wall" for his impeccable defensive technique, Dravid's recent coaching success includes:

- Leading India to victory in the 9th ICC Men's T20 World Cup in Barbados.
- Guiding the team to a triumph over South Africa in the final.
- This award recognizes Dravid's immense contribution to Indian cricket, both as a player and a coach.

Other Notable Awards

Test Cricket

- **Test Batter of the Year:** Yashashvi Jaiswal
- **Test Bowler of the Year:** Ravichandran Ashwin

ODI Cricket

- **ODI Bowler of the Year:** Mohammad Shami

T20 Cricket

- **T20 Batter of the Year:** Phil Salt (England)
- **T20 Bowler of the Year:** Tim Southee (New Zealand)

Domestic Cricket

- **Domestic Cricketer of the Year:** Sai Kishore (Left-arm spinner from Tamil Nadu)

Women's Cricket

- **Women's Batter of the Year:** Smriti Mandhana
- **Women's Bowler of the Year:** Deepti Sharma

Special Recognitions

Several players and administrators received special mementos for their unique achievements:

- **Harmanpreet Kaur:** For captaining the most matches in Women's T20I history.
- **Shreyas Iyer:** For outstanding leadership in the TATA IPL.
- **Shafali Verma:** For scoring the fastest double century in Women's Test Match cricket.
- **Jay Shah:** Awarded for excellence in sports administration as the BCCI Secretary.

Key Takeaways From PM Modi Ukraine Visit

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has wrapped up his **trip to Ukraine**. Modi became the first Indian prime minister to make a state visit to Ukraine since the two countries established relations over three decades ago.

P.M Modi's Ukraine visit

In his Ukraine visit some key outcomes to be noted, such as:

Homage to Mahatma Gandhi's statue

Modi and Volodymyr Zelenskyy held wide-ranging talks at **Mariinskyi Palace**, the official residence of the Ukrainian President, paid homage to Mahatma Gandhi's statue at 'Oasis of Peace' park in Kyiv.

Honored the memory of the children

P.M Modi honoured the memory of the children that have been killed by the Russia-Ukraine war at the Martyrologist Exposition on children at the **National Museum of History of Ukraine**.

Focusing on the development of a strategic partnership

“Following the visit, we also agreed on a **joint statement** focusing on the development of a strategic partnership, bilateral trade, and continued military-technical cooperation,” said the Ukrainian President, whose country is at **war with Russia**.

Joint India-Ukraine statement

PM Modi’s office in the joint **India-Ukraine statement** said both leaders reiterated their readiness for further cooperation in upholding principles of international law, including the UN Charter, such as respect for territorial integrity and sovereignty of states. “They agreed on the desirability of closer bilateral dialogue in this regard,” the joint statement said.

India is not neutral

“We (India) are not neutral. From the very beginning, we have taken sides. And we have chosen the side of peace. We have come from the land of Buddha where there is no place for war,” PM Modi said in his opening remarks during the talks. “We have come from the land of Mahatma Gandhi who had given a message of peace to the entire world,” he said.

Expansion and deepen bilateral trade

Both sides agreed to ask the Indian-Ukrainian Intergovernmental Commission (IGC) to explore all possible ways to not only restore bilateral trade and economic relations to pre-conflict levels, but expand and deepen them further. There has been a significant reduction in the annual bilateral trade in goods since 2022 due to the challenges related to the ongoing conflict.

Diplomatic balancing act

PM Modi’s visit to Kyiv is seen in many quarters as a diplomatic balancing act as his trip to Russia triggered anguish among some Western countries. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said PM Modi reiterated the need for “practical engagement” between all stakeholders to develop an innovative solution that will help build broad acceptability and contribute towards peace and stability.

Comprehensive reform of the UN Security Council

Both sides called for a comprehensive reform of the UN Security Council to reflect **contemporary global realities** and to make it more representative, effective and efficient in dealing with issues of **international peace and security**. Ukraine reiterated its support for **India’s permanent membership** of a reformed and expanded **UN Security Council**.

Gol Approves Unified Pension Scheme for Government Employees

In a significant move to enhance retirement benefits for government employees, the Union Cabinet on Saturday approved the **Unified Pension Scheme (UPS)**. This new scheme is set to benefit approximately **23 lakh government employees** and will serve as an alternative to the existing National Pension System (NPS).

Background

The decision comes after a thorough review of the current pension system. In 2023, the finance ministry established a committee led by finance secretary TV Somanathan to evaluate the National Pension System for government employees. The NPS, which has been in effect since April 1, 2004, will now coexist with the newly introduced UPS.

Key Features of the Unified Pension Scheme

Assured Pension

One of the most notable features of the UPS is the **assured pension**. Employees who have completed a minimum qualifying service of 25 years will be entitled to a pension that is **50% of the average basic pay** drawn over the last 12 months prior to superannuation. This provision ensures a stable and substantial income for retirees.

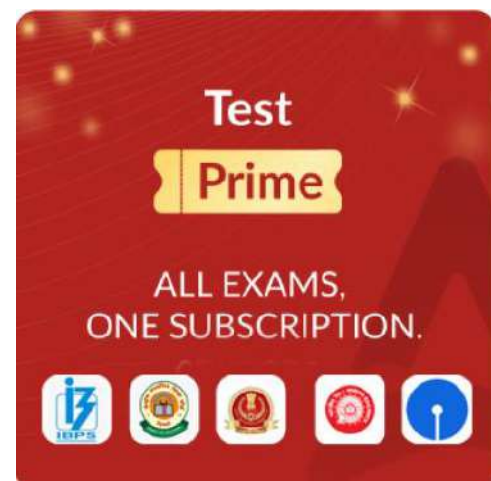
For those with shorter service periods, a proportionate plan has been put in place. Employees with a minimum of 10 years of service will also be eligible for pension benefits, albeit at a reduced rate commensurate with their years of service.

Family Pension

The UPS also introduces an **assured family pension**. In the unfortunate event of an employee’s death, their family will receive a pension at the rate of **60% of the employee’s pension**. This provision offers crucial financial support to the families of deceased government employees.

Minimum Pension Guarantee

To ensure a basic standard of living for all retirees, the UPS establishes a **minimum pension of Rs. 10,000 per month**. This benefit is available to employees who have completed a minimum of 10 years of service and have reached superannuation.



Inflation Protection

Recognizing the impact of rising costs on retirees, the UPS includes provisions for **inflation indexation**. This feature applies to the assured pension, assured family pension, and the minimum pension. Additionally, **Dearness Relief** will be provided based on the All India Consumer Price Index for Industrial Workers (AICPI-IW), similar to the benefit extended to current service employees.

Lump Sum Payment

Upon superannuation, employees will receive a **lump sum payment** in addition to their gratuity. This payment will be calculated as **1/10th of the monthly emoluments** (pay plus Dearness Allowance) as on the date of superannuation for every completed six months of service. Importantly, this lump sum payment will not reduce the quantum of the assured pension.

Eligibility and Implementation

The Unified Pension Scheme is set to take effect from **April 1, 2025**. However, its benefits will extend retroactively to those who have already retired or will retire up until March 31, 2025, with arrears being provided.

Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw highlighted that the scheme will positively impact approximately **23 lakh government employees**.

Transition from NPS to UPS

Current subscribers to the National Pension System will have the option to **switch to the UPS** from the next financial year. This flexibility allows employees to choose the scheme that best suits their retirement planning needs.

Most Important Current Affairs of September 2024

Hayao Miyazaki Receives Prestigious Ramon Magsaysay Award

In a momentous recognition of his contributions to the world of animation and storytelling, **Hayao Miyazaki**, the renowned Japanese film director and co-founder of Studio Ghibli, has been awarded the esteemed **Ramon Magsaysay Award** for 2024. This honor, often referred to as "Asia's Nobel Prize," underscores Miyazaki's profound impact on both the art of animation and global cultural discourse.

List of Ramon Magsaysay Award Winners for 2024

Honoree	Country	Profession/Role	Contribution
Hayao Miyazaki	Japan	Animator	Beloved Japanese animator known for his iconic work in animation.
Phuntsho Karma	Bhutan	Scholar and Social Worker	Bhutanese scholar and social worker, recognized for contributions to education and social causes.
Nguyen Thi Ngoc Phuong	Vietnam	Doctor	Works for victims of Agent Orange used during the Vietnam War.
Farhan Farwiza	Indonesia	Conservationist	Founder of Yayasan Hutan Alam dan Lingkungan Aceh (HAKA), dedicated to preserving the Leuser ecosystem.
Rural Doctors Movement	Thailand	Medical Organization	A movement of doctors committed to providing healthcare in rural areas of Thailand.

National Teachers' Awards 2024

On September 5, 2024, India celebrated Teachers' Day with a prestigious ceremony in New Delhi, where **President Droupadi Murmu** conferred the **National Teachers' Award 2024** to 82 exceptional educators from across the country. This annual event, commemorating the birth anniversary of Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, recognizes the pivotal role of teachers in shaping the nation's future.

Table of Awardees

Dept. of School Education & Literacy Awardees:

Sl. No.	Name of the Awardee	Designation	School Name & Address	State / UT of Org
1	Avinasha Sharma	Lecturer	GMSSSS NIT 3 Faridabad	Haryana
2	Sunil Kumar	Lecturer	GSSS Khargat	Himachal Pradesh
3	Pankaj Kumar Goyal	Teacher	GSSS Girls Barnala	Punjab
4	Rajinder Singh	Teacher	Govt. Primary School, Kothe Inder Singh Wale	Punjab
5	Baljinder Singh Brar	Vice Principal	Government Senior Secondary School 4JJ	Rajasthan

Sl. No.	Name of the Awardee	Designation	School Name & Address	State / UT of Org
6	Hukam Chand Chaudhary	Teacher	Government Senior Secondary School BSF Bikaner	Rajasthan
7	Kusum Lata Gariya	Acting Head Teacher	Government Upper Primary School Veena	Uttarakhand
8	Chandralekha Damodar Mestri	Teacher	Satyawati Soiru Angle Higher Secondary School, Mashem Loliem	Goa
9	Chandreshkumar Bholashankar Borisagar	Acting Head Teacher	Navi Badhada Primary School, Badhada	Gujarat
10	Vinay Shashikant Patel	Principal	R.F. Patel High School, Vadadla	Gujarat
11	Madhav Prasad Patel	Teacher	Govt. Middle School Lidhora	Madhya Pradesh
12	Sunita Godha	Teacher	Govt. High School, Khajuria Sarang	Madhya Pradesh
13	K Sharda	Teacher	Govt. Upper Primary School Khedamara	Chhattisgarh
14	Narasimha Murthy H K	Teacher	Daffodils English School, Sanjaynagar-19	Karnataka
15	Dwiti Chandra Sahu	Teacher	Govt. High School Billesu	Odisha
16	Santosh Kumar Kar	Teacher	Jaya Durga High School, Narla Road	Odisha
17	Ashis Kumar Roy	Teacher	Sri Nara Singha Vidyapith, Atharakhai	West Bengal
18	Prasanta Kumar Marik	Head Teacher	Shalbagan G S F P School, 1 No. Gurdaha	West Bengal
19	Dr Urfana Amin	Master	BHSS Soura	Jammu and Kashmir
20	Ravi Kant Dwivedi	Head Teacher	Primary School Bhagesar	Uttar Pradesh
21	Shyam Prakash Maurya	Teacher	Upper Primary School Malhupur	Uttar Pradesh
22	Dr. Minakshi Kumari	Teacher	Shiv Ganga Girls Plus 2 High School Madhubani	Bihar
23	Sikendra Kumar Suman	Acting Head Teacher	New Primary School Tarahani	Bihar
24	K Suma	Teacher	GMS Dugnadab	A & N Islands
25	Sunita Gupta	Lecturer	Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya, Dhamangawn	Madhya Pradesh
26	Charu Sharma	Principal	Dr Rajendra Prasad Kendriya Vidyalaya, New Delhi	Delhi
27	Ashok Sengupta	Teacher	PM SHRI Kendriya Vidyalaya No.1 Jalahalli West, Kamagondannahalli	Karnataka
28	H N Girish	Lecturer	Government PU College for Girls NN0045 Hunsur, Mysuru	Karnataka
29	Narayanaswamy R	Head Teacher	Government High School Bashettihalli	Karnataka
30	Jyoti Panka	Teacher	PM SHRI Government Higher Secondary School Longding	Arunachal Pradesh
31	Lephizo Apon	Teacher	GHSS Dimapur, United Colony Ward-20	Nagaland
32	Nandita Chongtham	Teacher	Sagolband Rishikul Upper Primary School, Sagolband	Manipur
33	Yankila Lama	Teacher	Modern Senior Secondary School, Arithang	Sikkim
34	Joseph Vanlalhruaia Sailo	Lecturer	Synod Higher Secondary School, Tuithiang Veng Aizawl	Mizoram
35	Everlasting Pyngrope	Principal	Myngken Christian Higher Secondary School, Bhoirymbong	Meghalaya
36	Dr Nani Gopal Debnath	Teacher	Netaji Subhas Vidyaniketan, Netaji Choumuhani	Tripura

Sl. No.	Name of the Awardee	Designation	School Name & Address	State / UT of Org
37	Dipen Khanikar	Teacher	Chi Chia Bokuloni Girls High School, No3	Assam
38	Dr Asha Rani	Post Graduate Teacher	Plus 2 High School Chandankiyari, Bokaro	Jharkhand
39	Jinu George	Teacher	S.D.V.B.H.S.S, Alappuzha	Kerala
40	K Sivaprasad	Teacher	VPAUPS Kundur kunnu, Thachanattukara	Kerala
41	Midde Srinivasa Rao	Teacher	S.P.S Municipal High School Plus, Gudivada	Andhra Pradesh
42	Suresh Kunati	Teacher	ZP High School Urandur	Andhra Pradesh
43	Prabhakar Reddy Pesara	Teacher	ZPSS Thirumalayapalem	Telangana
44	Thaduri Sampath Kumar	Teacher	ZPHS Dammannapet	Telangana
45	Pallavi Sharma	Principal	Mamta Modern Sr. Sec. School, Vikaspuri	Delhi
46	Charu Maini	Principal	DAV Public School Sector 48-49, Gurugram	Haryana
47	Gopinath R	Teacher	Panchayat Union Middle School – Rajakuppam	Tamil Nadu
48	Muralidharan Ramiya Sethuraman	Vocational Teacher	TVS Higher Secondary School, Madurai	Tamil Nadu
49	Mantaiah Chinni Bedke	Teacher	Z.P. Upper Primary Digital School Jajavandi	Maharashtra
50	Sagar Chittaranjan Bagade	Teacher	Sou S.M. Lohia High School & Junior College, Kolhapur	Maharashtra

Dept. of Higher Education Awardees:

Sl. No.	Name of the Awardee	Designation	Name & Address of the Institute	State / UT of Org
1	Prof. Anitha Suseelan	Head	School of Architecture at Christ University, Bangalore	Karnataka
2	Prof. Birinchi Kumar Sarma	Professor	Institute of Agricultural Sciences, Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi	Uttar Pradesh
3	Dr. C. Jaya Sankar Babu	Associate Professor	Department of Hindi, Puducherry University	Puducherry
4	Dr. A. Gandhimathi	Lecturer	Department of English, Polytechnic College, Salem	Tamil Nadu
5	Prof. Kapil Ahuja	Professor	Department of Computer Science and Engineering, IIT Indore	Madhya Pradesh
6	Prof. S.R. Keshava	Professor	Department of Economics, Bangalore University	Karnataka
7	Dr. Nandavaram Mrudula Babu	Associate Professor & Head	Department of Telugu, Govt. Degree College for Women, Hyderabad	Telangana
8	Prof. Nidhi Jain	Professor	Department of Chemistry, Indian Institute of Technology Delhi	New Delhi
9	Prof. Nilabh Tiwari	Head	Department of Education, Central Sanskrit University	New Delhi
10	Prof. Parmar Ranjitkumar Khimjibhai	Head	Department of Electrical Engineering, Government Polytechnic, Junagadh	Gujarat
11	Prof. Shahanaz Ayub	Associate Professor	Department of Electronics & Communication Engineering, Bundelkhand Institute of Engineering, Jhansi	Uttar Pradesh
12	Prof. Shilpagauri Prasad	Associate Professor	Department of English, PDEA's Prof. Ramkrishna More Arts, Commerce and Science College, Pune	Maharashtra

Sl. No.	Name of the Awardee	Designation	Name & Address of the Institute	State / UT of Org
13	Dr. Shimi S.L.	Associate Professor	Electrical Engineering Department, Punjab Engineering College	Chandigarh
14	Prof. A.S. Smiline Girija	Head	Department of Microbiology, Saveetha Dental College and Hospitals, SIMATS, Saveetha University, Chennai	Tamil Nadu
15	Prof. Srinivas Hotha	Professor	Department of Chemistry, Indian Institute of Science Education and Research Pune	Maharashtra
16	Prof. Vinay Sharma	Professor	Department of Management Studies & Joint Professor with the Department of Design, IIT Roorkee	Uttarakhand

Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship Awardees:

Sl. No.	Name of the Awardee	Name & Address of the Institute	State / UT of Org
1	Smt. Kadia Darshanaben Jishneshkumar	ITI, Dashrath	Gujarat
2	Shri Radhakrishnan PK	Govt. ITI, Kozhikode	Kerala
3	Shri Muhammad Akbar M	Govt. ITI, Koyilandy	Kerala
4	Shri Prashant Dixit	Govt. Divisional ITI, Bhopal	Madhya Pradesh
5	Shri Tinku	Govt. ITI, Pusa	New Delhi
6	Shri Vivek Chandaliya	Govt. ITI, Kolhapur	Maharashtra
7	Ms. Natasha Oreste Carvalho	Govt. ITI, Mapusa	Goa
8	Smt. Premlata Rahangdale	Govt. Divisional ITI, Bhopal	Madhya Pradesh
9	Shri Shivalingaiah K.J.	Govt. ITI, Mysuru	Karnataka
10	Shri Utpal Saikia	North East Skill Centre, Guwahati	Assam
11	Shri Vijay Ganapati Chari	Govt. ITI, Cacora	Goa
12	Ms. Sarita Devi	Govt. ITI, Shamshi	Himachal Pradesh
13	Shri Jitendra Jangir	NSTI, Patna	Bihar
14	Smt. B Pauvlin Priya	NSTI, Chennai	Tamil Nadu
15	Dr. Jyoti Jain	MSME, Firozabad	Uttar Pradesh
16	Smt. Vanamala Swapna	National Institute for MSME, Hyderabad	Telangana

Paris Paralympics 2024: Full List of Winners

India concluded its most successful Paralympic campaign ever at the **2024 Paris Paralympics**, securing an unprecedented **29 medals**.

2024 Paralympic Games Mascot: "Phryge"

The 2024 **Paris Paralympic Games** introduced a vibrant and meaningful **mascot named "Phryge."** The mascot represents the spirit of revolution and freedom, embodying the values of the Paralympic movement—determination, inclusivity, and the triumph of the human spirit.

Phryge: The Symbol of the 2024 Games

- **Inspiration:** The mascot is inspired by the Phrygian cap, a symbol of liberty and freedom that has deep historical roots in France. This symbol has been reimagined in a modern, dynamic form, reflecting the innovative and inclusive spirit of the Paris 2024 Paralympics.

- **Design:** Phryge is characterized by its bold colors, predominantly red, with an approachable and energetic appearance. Its design is intended to resonate with both children and adults, promoting the message that sports can unite people and break down barriers.
- **Message:** The mascot's mission is to encourage everyone to get involved in sports, regardless of their abilities, and to celebrate diversity and the strength of the human spirit. Phryge stands as a reminder that the Paralympic Games are not just about competition but about inclusion, resilience, and the power of sport to change lives.

This impressive tally included:

- **7 gold** medals
- **9 silver** medals
- **13 bronze** medals

Indian medal winners at Paris 2024 Paralympics

No.	Athlete	Sport	Event	Medal
1	Avani Lekhara	Shooting	Women's 10m Air Rifle Standing SH1	Gold
2	Mona Agarwal	Shooting	Women's 10m Air Rifle Standing SH1	Bronze
3	Preethi Pal	Athletics	Women's 100m T35	Bronze
4	Manish Narwal	Shooting	Men's 10m Air Pistol SH1	Silver
5	Rubina Francis	Shooting	Women's 10m Air Pistol SH1	Bronze
6	Preethi Pal	Athletics	Women's 200m T35	Bronze
7	Nishad Kumar	Athletics	Men's High Jump T47	Silver
8	Yogesh Kathuniya	Athletics	Men's Discus Throw F56	Silver
9	Nitesh Kumar	Badminton	Men's Singles SL3	Gold
10	Thulasimathi Murugesan	Badminton	Women's Singles SU5	Silver
11	Manisha Ramadass	Badminton	Women's Singles SU5	Bronze
12	Suhas Yathiraj	Badminton	Men's Singles SL4	Silver
13	Rakesh Kumar / Sheetal Devi	Archery	Mixed Team Compound Open	Bronze
14	Sumit Antil	Athletics	Javelin Throw F64	Gold
15	Nithya Sre Sivan	Badminton	Women's Singles SH6	Bronze
16	Deepthi Jeevanji	Athletics	Women's 400m T20	Bronze
17	Mariyappan Thangavelu	Athletics	Men's High Jump T63	Bronze
18	Sharad Kumar	Athletics	Men's High Jump T63	Silver
19	Ajeet Singh	Athletics	Men's Javelin Throw F46	Silver
20	Sundar Singh Gurjar	Athletics	Men's Javelin Throw F46	Bronze
21	Sachin Khilari	Athletics	Men's Shot Put F46	Silver
22	Harvinder Singh	Archery	Men's Individual Recurve Open	Gold
23	Dharambir	Athletics	Men's Club Throw F51	Gold
24	Parnav Soorma	Athletics	Men's Club Throw F51	Silver
25	Kapil Parmar	Judo	Men's -60kg J1	Bronze
26	Praveen Kumar	Athletics	Men's High Jump T64	Gold
27	Hokato Hotozhe Sema	Athletics	Men's Shot Put F57	Bronze
28	Simran	Athletics	Women's 200m T12	Bronze
29	Navdeep Singh	Athletics	Men's Javelin Throw F41	Gold

India's medals at Paris 2024 Paralympics sport-by-sport

Sport	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
Archery	1	0	1	2
Athletics	4	6	7	17
Badminton	1	2	2	5
Judo	0	0	1	1
Shooting	1	1	2	4
TOTAL	7	9	13	29

Paris 2024 Paralympics medals tally

Rank	Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	People's Republic of China	94	76	50	220
2	Great Britain	49	44	31	124
3	United States of America	36	42	27	105
4	Netherlands	27	17	12	56
5	Brazil	25	26	38	89
18	India	7	9	13	29

Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2024

In a significant recognition of efforts to combat air pollution, the **Union Environment Ministry** has presented the **"National Clean Air City" Awards** during the **Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2024**. This event, held as part of a national workshop celebrating the **"International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies"** in Jaipur on Saturday, showcased the remarkable strides made by various Indian cities in improving their air quality.

Top Performers: A City-wise Breakdown

The awards were categorized based on population size, acknowledging the unique challenges and achievements of cities across different scales.

Major Cities (Population over 10 lakh)

1. **Surat, Gujarat:** Emerged as the top major city in India for air quality improvements
2. **Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh:** Secured the second position
3. **Agra, Uttar Pradesh:** Ranked third among large cities

Medium-sized Cities (Population between 3 lakh and 10 lakh)

1. **Firozabad, Uttar Pradesh**
2. **Amravati, Maharashtra**
3. **Jhansi, Uttar Pradesh**

These cities were recognized for their significant efforts in implementing air quality improvement measures.

Smaller Cities (Population under 3 lakh)

1. **Raebareli, Uttar Pradesh**
2. **Nalgonda, Telangana**
3. **Nalagarh, Himachal Pradesh**

The inclusion of smaller cities in the awards highlights the importance of air quality management across all urban scales in India.

US Open 2024, Complete list of Winners

The 2024 US Open, held from August 19 to September 8 at **Flushing Meadows**, Queens, New York City, concluded with groundbreaking victories in both the men's and women's singles categories. **Jannik Sinner** of Italy and **Aryna Sabalenka** of Belarus emerged as champions, each claiming their first US Open title and adding to their growing list of Grand Slam achievements.

Winners List of the 2024 US Open

Event	Winner (Nationalities)	Runners-UP (Nationalities)
Men's Single	Jannik Sinner (Italy)	Taylor Fritz (USA)
Women's Single	Aryna Sabalenka (Belarus)	Jessica Pegula (USA)
Men's Double	Max Purcell and Jordan Thompson (Both Australian)	Kevin Krawietz and Tim Puetz (Both from Germany)
Women's Double	Lyudmyla Kichenok (Ukraine)and Jelena Ostapenko (Latvia)	Kristina Mladenovic (France) and Zhang Shuai (China)
Mixed Doubles	Sara Errani and Andrea Vavassori (Both from Italy)	Donald Young and Taylor Townsend (Both American)

National Florence Nightingale Awards 2024

On September 11, 2024, the **President of India, Smt Droupadi Murmu**, presided over a distinguished ceremony at **Rashtrapati Bhavan** to present the **National Florence Nightingale Awards** for the year 2024. This prestigious event recognized outstanding contributions in the field of nursing, highlighting the crucial role that nursing professionals play in the healthcare system.

Background of the Awards

Origin and Purpose

The **National Florence Nightingale Awards** were established by the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India**. These awards serve a dual purpose:

1. To recognize the exceptional services provided by nursing personnel across the country.
2. To honor the legacy of **Florence Nightingale**, the pioneering British nurse who set the standards for modern nursing practices.

Significance in the Indian Healthcare System

These awards hold immense importance in India's healthcare landscape:

- They motivate nursing professionals to strive for excellence in their field.
- The awards raise awareness about the critical role of nurses in healthcare delivery.

- They help in setting benchmarks for quality nursing care across different regions of India.

The 2024 Award Ceremony

Venue and Presiding Dignitary

The ceremony took place at the prestigious **Rashtrapati Bhavan**, the official residence of the President of India. The event was graced by the presence of **President Droupadi Murmu**, underscoring the national importance of these awards.

Categories of Awards

The 2024 National Florence Nightingale Awards were presented in three main categories:

1. **ANM (Auxiliary Nurse Midwife)**: Recognizing grassroots-level healthcare workers.
2. **LHV (Lady Health Visitor)**: Honoring supervisory nursing personnel.
3. **Nurse**: Acknowledging registered nurses across various specializations.

The Awardees

This year's awards celebrated the diverse contributions of nursing professionals from across India. The recipients represented various states and union territories, reflecting the nationwide impact of nursing excellence.

Table of Awardees

S.No.	Category	Name	State/UT
1	ANM	Smt. Sheela Mondal	Andaman & Nicobar
2	ANM	Ms. Iken Lollen	Arunachal Pradesh
3	ANM	Ms. Vidjeyacoumary V	Puducherry
4	ANM	Ms. Januka Pandey	Sikkim
5	ANM	Smt. Anindita Pramanik	West Bengal
6	LHV	Ms. Brahmacharimayum Amusana Devi	Manipur
7	Nurse	Maj Gen Ignatius Delos Flora	Delhi
8	Nurse	Ms. Prem Rose Suri	Delhi
9	Nurse	Dr. Tabasum Irshad Handoo	Jammu & Kashmir
10	Nurse	Dr. Nagarajaiah	Karnataka
11	Nurse	Ms. Shamshad Beegum Attalada	Lakshadweep
12	Nurse	Ms. Asha Wamanrao Bawane	Maharashtra
13	Nurse	Ms. H Mankimi	Mizoram
14	Nurse	Ms. Sanjukta Sethi	Odisha
15	Nurse	Mr. Radhey Lal Sharma	Rajasthan

TIME's World's Best Companies 2024

TIME magazine's **World's Best Companies of 2024** list has brought significant recognition to Indian businesses, highlighting their growing influence on the global stage. This prestigious ranking, which includes 1000 companies worldwide, features **22 Indian-born enterprises** this year, showcasing the country's expanding corporate footprint and economic prowess.

TIME World's Best Companies of 2024

Rank	Company Name	Headquarters	Overall Score	Industry
1	Apple	United States	97.75	IT, Electronics, Hardware & Equipment
2	Accenture	Ireland	97.70	Professional Services
3	Microsoft	United States	97.65	IT, Electronics, Hardware & Equipment
4	BMW Group	Germany	97.41	Automotive Industry & Suppliers
5	Amazon	United States	96.47	Technology, Media & Services
6	Electricite de France	France	96.22	Utilities
7	American Express	United States	96.08	Banking & Financial Services
8	Meta Platforms	United States	96.04	Technology, Media & Services
9	Siemens	Germany	95.96	Conglomerate
10	JPMorgan Chase	United States	95.93	Banking & Financial Services



Below is a tabular representation of all Indian companies featured in TIME's World's Best Companies 2024 list:

Company Name	Global Rank	Score
HCLTech	112	91.75
Infosys	119	91.55
Wipro	134	91.29
Mahindra Group	187	90.57
Axis Bank	504	86.72
State Bank of India	518	86.56
ICICI Bank	525	86.43
Larsen & Toubro	549	86.12
Kotak Mahindra Bank	551	86.10
ITC Limited	586	85.60
Hero MotoCorp	597	85.50
Reliance Industries	646	84.87
Motherson Group	697	84.19
Adani Group	736	83.72
NTPC Limited	752	83.45
Yes Bank	783	82.64
Bank of Baroda	850	80.96
Godrej & Boyce	921	78.30
Bajaj Group	952	76.39
Cipla	957	76.04
Bharat Electronics Limited	987	73.69
MRF	993	72.98

Emmy Awards 2024, Complete List of Winners

The **76th Primetime Emmy Awards ceremony**, held at the **Peacock Theater** in Los Angeles on September 16, 2024, marked a significant event in the television industry. This prestigious award show, honouring excellence in primetime television programming, rolled out the red carpet for the second time in just one year, creating a buzz of excitement among TV enthusiasts and industry professionals alike.

Major Winners and Highlights

Outstanding Drama Series: Shōgun Dominates

The night's biggest winner was FX's sensational **Japan-set historical drama series Shōgun**, which claimed the coveted title of **Outstanding Drama Series**. This triumph was just the beginning of Shōgun's impressive run, as the show went on to secure a total of four major awards:

- Outstanding Drama Series**
- Best Lead Actor in a Drama Series:** Hiroyuki Sanada
- Best Lead Actress in a Drama Series:** Anna Sawai
- Best Directing for a Drama Series:** Frederick E. O. Toye

The sweeping success of Shōgun underscores the growing appreciation for international storytelling and period dramas in mainstream American television.

Here is the full list of Emmy Awards 2024 Winners

Category	Winner
Outstanding Drama Series	Shogun
Outstanding Comedy Series	Hacks
Outstanding Limited or Anthology Series	Baby Reindeer
Lead Actor, Drama	Hiroyuki Sanada, Shogun
Lead Actress, Drama	Anna Sawai, Shogun
Lead Actor, Comedy	Jeremy Allen White, The Bear
Lead Actress, Comedy	Jean Smart, Hacks
Lead Actor, Limited Series or Movie	Richard Gadd, Baby Reindeer
Lead Actress, Limited Series or Movie	Jodie Foster, True Detective: Night Country
Supporting Actor, Drama	Billy Crudup, The Morning Show
Supporting Actress, Drama	Elizabeth Debicki, The Crown
Supporting Actor, Comedy	Ebon Moss-Bachrach, The Bear
Supporting Actress, Comedy	Liza Colon-Zayas, The Bear
Supporting Actor, Limited Series or Movie	Lamorne Morris, Fargo
Supporting Actress, Limited Series or Movie	Jessica Gunning, Baby Reindeer
Outstanding Reality or Competition Program	Traitors
Best Scripted Variety Series	Last Week Tonight With John Oliver
Outstanding Writing for a Variety Special	Alex Edelman, Just for Us
Outstanding Directing for Limited Series or Movie	Steven Zaillian, Ripley
Outstanding Writing, Comedy	Hacks
Outstanding Talk Show	The Daily Show
Outstanding Writing for a Drama Series	Will Smith, Slow Horses
Best Writing, Limited Series	Richard Gadd, Baby Reindeer
Outstanding Directing for Comedy Series	Christopher Storer, The Bear
Best Directing for Drama Series	Frederick E. O. Toye, Shogun

Centre Notifies Appointment Of Chief Justices Of 8 High Courts

The Central Government, through the Ministry of Law and Justice, notified the **appointment of Chief Justices to eight High Courts** to fill key judicial positions and ensure the smooth functioning of the judicial system in various states. Union Law Minister (Independent Charge) **Arjun Ram Meghwal** announced the **appointment of Chief Justices to eight High Courts**.

Background

The **Supreme Court Collegium**, in its recommendations regarding the appointment of Chief Justices, originally made proposals on July 11, 2023. However, on September 17, 2023, the **Collegium altered some of its earlier recommendations** concerning the appointment of Chief Justices to four High Courts.

New Appointments

1. **Justice Manmohan** (presently Acting CJ of Delhi High Court) – Chief Justice of Delhi High Court.
2. **Justice Rajiv Shakdher** (presently Judge of Delhi HC) – Chief Justice of Himachal Pradesh High Court.
3. **Justice Suresh Kumar Kait** (Judge of Delhi HC) – Chief Justice of Madhya Pradesh High Court.
4. **Justice Indra Prasanna Mukerji** (Judge of Calcutta HC) – Chief Justice of Meghalaya High Court.
5. **Justice Nitin Madhukar Jamdar** (Judge of Bombay HC) – Chief Justice of Kerala High Court.
6. **Justice Tashi Rabstan** (Judge of J&K&L HC) – Chief Justice of Jammu & Kashmir & Ladakh High Court.
7. **Justice KR Shriram** (Judge of Bombay HC) – Chief Justice of Madras High Court.
8. **Justice MS Ramachandra Rao** (presently CJ of HP HC) – Chief Justice of Jharkhand High Court.

Global Innovation Index 2024

India has climbed to the **39th position among 133 global economies** in the Global Innovation Index (GII) 2024, as announced by **Union Minister Piyush Goyal**. **India also ranked 1st among 10 economies** in the Central and Southern Asian region and led the lower-middle-income economies group. The country was **81st in 2015 and rose to 39th** due to its thriving innovation ecosystem, powered by entrepreneurs, startups, and public-private partnerships.

Key Achievements

India ranked 1st in Central & Southern Asia and among lower-middle-income economies, **4th in WIPO's Science & Technology Cluster Rankings**, with cities like Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, and Chennai in the global top 100 S&T clusters. India also ranked **7th globally in intangible asset intensity**.

Global Performance Overview

"In Central and Southern Asia, India (39th) continues to lead, advancing by one spot. The Islamic Republic of Iran (64th, down by two places) follows, with Kazakhstan (78th) in third place. Uzbekistan (83rd) retains its 4th position within the region."

India's continued rise is part of a broader innovation trend, with China, Turkey, Vietnam, and the Philippines among the fastest climbers in the last decade. Switzerland, Sweden, the US, Singapore, and the UK remain the world's top innovators.

Global rankings:

1. Switzerland (Number 1 in 2023)
2. Sweden (2)
3. United States of America (3)
4. Singapore (5)
5. United Kingdom (4)
6. Republic of Korea (10)
7. Finland (6)
8. Netherlands (Kingdom of the) (7)
9. Germany (8)
10. Denmark (9)
11. China (12)
12. France (11)
13. Japan (13)
14. Canada (15)
15. Israel (14)
16. Estonia (16)
17. Austria (18)
18. Hong Kong, China (17)
19. Ireland (22)
20. Luxembourg (21)

Central and Southern Asia region in the Global Innovation Index (GII) 2024:

GII Rank	Economy	Income Group Rank	Region Rank
39	India	1	1
64	Iran (Islamic Republic of)	6	2
78	Kazakhstan	25	3
83	Uzbekistan	10	4
88	Pakistan	12	5
90	Sri Lanka	13	6
105	Bangladesh	22	7
106	Kyrgyzstan	23	8
108	Nepal	24	9
111	Tajikistan	27	10

Hurun India Under-35 List 2024

The **Hurun India Under-35 list for 2024** has emerged as a prestigious recognition of India's young entrepreneurial talent, highlighting the achievements of 150 entrepreneurs aged 35 or younger. This comprehensive list spans various industries, from retail giants to innovative tech startups, showcasing the diverse and dynamic nature of India's business landscape.

Prominent Figures: The Faces of Young Indian Entrepreneurship

Ambani Siblings: Continuing a Legacy of Innovation

Among the most notable names on the list are **Isha Ambani** and **Akash Ambani**, scions of the Reliance Industries empire. Their inclusion highlights the growing influence of next-generation leadership in established business houses.

Isha Ambani: Retail Powerhouse

- **Age:** 32 years old
- **Position:** Non-executive director at **Reliance Retail**
- **Significance:** One of the youngest women on the list, representing the future of India's retail sector

Akash Ambani: Telecom Titan

- **Position:** Chairman of **Reliance Jio Infocomm**
- **Ranking:** 32nd position on the list
- **Impact:** Leading Reliance's charge in the telecom and digital services sector

Alakh Pandey: Revolutionizing Education

Alakh Pandey, founder of Physics Wallah, stands out as a prime example of how technology is transforming education in India. His inclusion in the list underscores the growing importance of edtech in the country's entrepreneurial ecosystem.

Women Entrepreneurs: Breaking Barriers and Setting Trends

Youngest Women on the List

1. **Isha Ambani** (32 years old) – Reliance Retail
2. **Parita Parekh** (32 years old) – Toddle (Education technology platform)

Other Notable Women Entrepreneurs

- **Aneri Patel, Aneesha Tiwari, and Anjali Merchant** (33-34 years old): Continuing family businesses
- **Saloni Anand** (34 years old): Traya Health (Hair care sector)
- **Ghazal Alagh** (35 years old): CEO of Mama Earth (Recently went public)

India's Historic Triumph at the 2024 Chess Olympiad

The 2024 Chess Olympiad in **Budapest, Hungary** has etched itself into the annals of Indian sports history. In an unprecedented achievement, India secured **gold medals** in both the men's and women's team categories, marking a watershed moment for chess in the country.

Dominant Performances in the Final Round

Both Indian teams showcased their prowess in the decisive final round:

- **Men's Team:** Achieved a commanding 3.5-0.5 victory over Slovenia
- **Women's Team:** Mirrored the men's success with a 3.5-0.5 win against Azerbaijan

This dual triumph places India in an elite group, joining only **China** and the former **Soviet Union** as nations to have won gold in both categories in a single Olympiad edition.

Men's Team: A Golden First

Breaking New Ground

The men's team's gold medal represents a significant leap forward from their previous achievements:

- **Bronze medals** in 2014 and 2022
- First-ever **gold medal** in 2024

Young Talents Shine

India's victory was spearheaded by a group of prodigious young players:

- **D Gukesh** (18 years old): World Championship challenger
- **Arjun Erigaisi** (21 years old): Delivered crucial wins
- **R Praggnanandhaa** (19 years old): Regained form in the final round
- **Vidit Gujrathi** (29 years old): Secured a draw on the fourth board

The performance of these young stars underscores India's bright future in chess.

Women's Team: Making History

First-Ever Gold Medal

The women's team's triumph is particularly significant:

- **First gold medal** in the Chess Olympiad
- Improvement from **bronze medal** in 2022 (Chennai)

Key Players in the Final Round

- **D Harika** (33 years old): Displayed technical mastery on the top board
- **Divya Deshmukh** (18 years old): Outclassed opponent Givhar Beydullayeva, securing individual gold on the third board
- **Vantika Agrawal:** Emerged victorious
- **R Vaishali:** Held her ground with a draw

Best Tourism Villages Competition-2024

The **Ministry of Tourism** in Government of India announced the winners of the Best Tourism Villages Competition 2024 on the occasion of World Tourism Day 2024. This award competition was the 2nd edition since its launching.

Best Tourism Villages Competition-2024 Winner

S.No	Name	State	Categories
1.	Dhudmars	Chhattisgarh	Adventure Tourism
2.	Aru	J & K	
3.	Kuthlur	Karnataka	
4.	Jakhol	Uttarakhand	
5.	Baranagar	West Bengal	Agri Tourism
6.	Kumarakom	Kerala	
7.	Karde	Maharashtra	
8.	Hansali	Punjab	
9.	Supi	Uttra khand	Community Based Tourism
10.	Chitrakote	Chhattisgarh	
11.	Minicoy Island	Lakshadweep	
12.	Sialsuk	Mizoram	
13.	Deomali	Rajasthan	
14.	Alpana Gram	Tripura	

S.No	Name	State	Categories
15.	Sualkuchi	Assam	Craft
16.	Maniabandha	Odisha	
17.	Pranpur	Madhya Pradesh	
18.	Umden	Meghalaya	
19.	Nirmal	Telangana	
20.	Hafeshwar	Gujarat	Heritage
21.	Andro	Manipur	
22.	Mawphlang	Meghalaya	
23.	Keeladi	Tamil Nadu	
24.	Pura Mahadev	Uttar Pradesh	
25.	Dudhani	Dadra Nagar Haveli	Responsible Tourism
26.	Kadalundi	Kerala	
27.	Tar Village	Ladakh	
28.	Sabarvani	Madhya Pradesh	
29.	Ladpura Khas	Madhya Pradesh	
30.	Bandora	Goa	Spiritual And Wellness
31.	Rikhiapeeth	Jharkhand	
32.	Melkalingam	Tamil Nadu	
33.	Patti	Telangana	
34.	Somasila Ahobilam	Andhra Pradesh	
35.	Harshil	Uttarakhand	Vibrant Village
36.	Gunji	Uttarakhand	

IIFA Awards 2024: Check the Full List Of Winners

IIFA 2024 Awards: Celebrating Excellence in Indian Cinema
The pinnacle of the evening was the announcement of the winners, recognizing outstanding contributions across various categories in the Indian film industry.

Major Award Winners

- **Best Film:** "Animal" (Directed by Sandeep Reddy Vanga)
- **Best Actor:** Shah Rukh Khan for "Jawan"
- **Best Actress:** Rani Mukerji for "Mrs Chatterjee vs Norway"
- **Best Director:** Vidhu Vinod Chopra for "12th Fail"
- **Best Supporting Actor:** Anil Kapoor for "Animal"
- **Best Supporting Actress:** Shabana Azmi for "Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani"
- **Best Actor in Negative Role:** Bobby Deol for "Animal"

Screenplay and Music Awards

- **Best Story:** "Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani"
- **Best Story (Adapted):** "12th Fail"
- **Best Music:** "Animal"
- **Best Lyrics:** Siddharth-Garima for "Satranga" from "Animal"
- **Best Singer Male:** Bhupinder Babbal for "Arjan Valley" from "Animal"
- **Best Singer Female:** Shilpa Rao for "Chaleya"

Special Recognition Awards

- **Outstanding Contribution to Indian Cinema:** Jayantimal Gada and Hema Malini
- **Achievement on completing 25 years in cinema:** Karan Johar

Most Important Current Affairs of October 2024

Nobel Prize 2024 Winners List

The 2024 Nobel Prize announcement started from October 7, recognizing outstanding scientific, economic, literature, and peace contributions. The Nobel prize announcement began with the award for **medicine or physiology on October 7**. The Awards will be giving into 6 categories. Nobel Prize 2024 is to be announced from **October 7th to 14th, 2024**.

The Nobel Prize winner list 2024

Winner's Name	Category	Topic
John J. Hopfield (US) and Geoffrey E. Hinton (Canada)	Physics	"for foundational discoveries and inventions that enable machine learning with artificial neural networks"
David Baker (US) and Demis Hassabis and John M. Jumper (London)	Chemistry	"for computational protein design" and "for protein structure prediction"
Victor Ambros (US) and Gary Ruvkun (US)	Medicine	"for the discovery of microRNA and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation"
Han Kang (South Korea)	Literature	"for her intense poetic prose that confronts historical traumas and exposes the fragility of human life"
Nihon Hidankyo (Japan)	Peace	"for its efforts to achieve a world free of nuclear weapons and for demonstrating through witness testimony that nuclear weapons must never be used again"
Daron Acemoglu (Turkish-American), Simon Johnson (British-American) and James A. Robinson (American-British)	Economics	"for studies of how institutions are formed and affect prosperity"

PM E-DRIVE Scheme Overview

- **Objective:** Accelerate EV adoption and build infrastructure under Swachh Vahan initiative, aligning with PM Modi's vision for net-zero emissions by 2070.
- **Financial Outlay:** ₹10,900 crore for two years.

Transition: Shift from FAME and Electric Vehicle Promotion Scheme (EMPS) to PM E-DRIVE.

Key Components:

- **Subsidies & Demand Incentives:** ₹3,679 crore for 24.79 lakh e-2Ws, 3.16 lakh e-3Ws, 14,028 e-buses.
- **E-Voucher System:** Aadhaar-authenticated e-vouchers for EV buyers.
- **E-Ambulances & E-Trucks:** ₹500 crore each.
- **E-Buses:** ₹4,391 crore for 14,028 e-buses across nine cities.
- **Public Charging Infrastructure:** ₹2,000 crore for 72,300 fast chargers.
- **Test Agency Modernization:** ₹780 crore for upgrading testing agencies.

Fund Allocation (in ₹ crore):

- **e-2 Wheelers:** ₹1,772 crore (24.79 lakh vehicles).
- **e-3 Wheelers (L5):** ₹715 crore (2.05 lakh vehicles).
- **e-Ambulances:** ₹500 crore.
- **e-Trucks:** ₹500 crore.
- **e-Buses:** ₹4,391 crore.
- **Charging Stations:** ₹2,000 crore.
- **Testing Agencies Upgradation:** ₹780 crore.

Key Features:

- **E-Voucher:** Aadhaar-authenticated digital vouchers for EV incentives.
- **Testing Agencies:** Modernization to meet new EV tech standards.

Focus: Affordable, environment-friendly transportation, primarily for commercial EVs, with incentives for advanced battery-fitted EVs.

Small Savings Scheme Interest Rates Unchanged for Q3 FY25

The government has announced that interest rates for small savings schemes, including the Public Provident Fund (PPF) and National Savings Certificate (NSC), will remain unchanged for the third consecutive quarter from October 1, 2024, to December 31, 2024. Key rates include 8.2% for the Sukanya Samriddhi Scheme, 7.5% for Kisan Vikas Patra (maturing in 115 months), 7.1% for PPF, and 4% for Post Office Savings Deposits. The NSC maintains a rate of 7.7%, and the Monthly Income Scheme continues to offer 7.4%. The last revisions occurred in the fourth quarter of the previous fiscal year, marking a trend of stability in the economic environment.

Key Rates Overview:

- **Sukanya Samriddhi Scheme:** 8.2%
- **Kisan Vikas Patra:** 7.5% (matures in 115 months)

- **Public Provident Fund (PPF):** 7.1%
- **National Savings Certificate (NSC):** 7.7%
- **Post Office Savings Deposit:** 4%
- **Monthly Income Scheme:** 7.4%

The interest rates are reviewed quarterly and primarily apply to accounts opened during the specified periods, reflecting consistency in the government's approach to small savings schemes.

Interest rates for various small savings schemes for the specified periods

Scheme	Rate of Interest (01.04.24 to 30.06.24)	Rate of Interest (01.07.24 to 30.09.24)	Compounding Frequency
Senior Citizens Savings Scheme (SCSS)	8.20%	8.20%	Paid Quarterly
Public Provident Fund (PPF)	7.10%	7.10%	Annually
Sukanya Samriddhi Account Scheme (SSA)	8.20%	8.20%	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra (KVP)	7.50% (matures in 115 months)	7.50% (matures in 115 months)	Annually
National Savings Certificate (NSC)	7.70%	7.70%	Annually

The rates for SCSS, KVP, and NSC are applicable only for newly opened accounts during the period from 01.07.2024 to 30.09.2024.

GI Tags for Bodo Traditional Products

The Geographical Indications Registry in Chennai has granted GI tags to eight traditional products from Assam, celebrating the Bodo community's cultural heritage. These include three rice beer variants, four food items, and the Bodo Aronai textile.

Traditional Rice Beer Variants

1. **Bodo Jou Gwran:** Highest alcohol content (~16.11%).
2. **Maibra Jou Bidwi:** Ceremonial welcome drink, made from half-cooked rice and natural yeast.
3. **Bodo Jou Gishi:** Traditional rice-based beverage.

Traditional Food Items

1. **Bodo Napham:** Fermented fish delicacy.
2. **Bodo Ondla:** Rice powder curry with garlic, ginger, and salt.
3. **Bodo Gwkha:** Festive dish for Bwisagu celebration.
4. **Bodo Narzi:** Semi-fermented jute leaf dish, rich in Omega 3 and vitamins.

Traditional Textile

Bodo Aronai: Traditional shawl reflecting Bodo designs inspired by nature.

Cultural and Economic Impact

These GI tags help **preserve traditional knowledge**, protect **Bodo heritage**, and support **local industries**, creating potential economic opportunities for the community.

70th National Film Awards (2022) Ceremony

The winners of the **70th National Film Awards for the year 2022** were announced by the jury on 16th August 2024. The 70th National Film Awards ceremony was held on October 8, 2024, at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi, where President Droupadi Murmu presented the awards. The event was attended by Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw and other distinguished guests.

Key Sections of the Awards

- **Feature Film Awards:** Recognizing outstanding feature films across various languages and genres.
- **Non-Feature Film Awards:** Celebrating excellence in short films, documentaries, and animation.
- **Best Writing on Cinema:** Honoring books and critics that explore and contribute to the discourse on Indian cinema.
- **Dadasaheb Phalke Award:** Awarded for lifetime contributions to Indian cinema.

Notable Award Winner

- Best Feature Film: Aattam (The Play)
- Best Popular Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment: Kantara
- Best Feature Film Promoting National, Social, and Environmental Values: Kutch Express
- Best Film in AVGC: Brahmastra Part 1: Shiva
- Best Debut Film of a Director: Fouja
- Best Direction: Sooraj Barjatya for Unchai
- Best Actor in a Leading Role: Rishab Shetty for Kantara
- Best Actress in a Leading Role:
 1. Nithya Menen for Thiruchitrabalam (Tamil)
 2. Manasi Parekh for Kutch Express (Gujarati)
- Best Actor in a Supporting Role: Pavan Raj Malhotra for Fouja (Haryanvi)
- Best Actress in a Supporting Role: Neena Gupta for Uunchai (Hindi)
- Best Child Artist: Sreepathy for Malikappuram (Malayalam)
- Best Male Playback Singer: Arijit Singh for "Kesariya" from Brahmastra Part 1: Shiva (Hindi)
- Best Female Playback Singer: Bombay Jayashri for Saudi Vell
- Mithun Chakraborty, who received the prestigious Dadasaheb Phalke Award, while
- AR Rahman won his seventh national award for Ponniyin Selvan I, which also took home the Best Film award.

Global Hunger Index 2024

The Global Hunger Index (GHI) is a comprehensive tool that tracks and measures hunger at the global, regional, and national levels. The 2024 GHI report sheds light on hunger levels across 127 countries, with specific emphasis on India's ranking and challenges.

India's Performance in GHI 2024

- India ranks **105th out of 127 countries in the Global Hunger Index 2024**, placing it in the "serious" hunger category.
- India's GHI score is 27.3, indicating a severe level of hunger.

Top 10 Performers in 2024

Country	Ranking
Belarus	1-22
Bosnia and Herzegovina	1-22
Chile	1-22
China	1-22
Costa Rica	1-22
Croatia	1-22
Estonia	1-22
Georgia	1-22
Hungary	1-22
Kuwait	1-22

The 22 countries with 2024 GHI scores of less than 5 are not assigned individual ranks, but rather are collectively ranked 1-22. Differences between their scores are minimal.

Worst Performers in the List

Rank	Country
121	Niger
122	Haiti
123	Dem. Rep. of the Congo
124	Madagascar
125	Chad
126	Yemen
127	Somalia

For the 2024 GHI report, data were assessed for 136 countries. Out of these, there were sufficient data to calculate 2024 GHI scores for and rank 127 countries (by way of comparison, 125 countries were ranked in the 2023 report).

India's Neighboring Countries

- 4. China
- 52. Thailand
- 56. Sri-Lanka

- 68. Nepal
- 74. Myanmar
- 77. Indonesia
- 84. Bangladesh
- 109. Pakistan
- 116. Afghanistan

5th National Water Awards 2023

The **Department of Water Resources, River Development, and Ganga Rejuvenation (DoWR, RD & GR)**, under the **Ministry of Jal Shakti**, proudly announces the winners of the **5th National Water Awards (NWA), 2023**. These prestigious awards recognize the efforts of individuals, organizations, and institutions across India in **water conservation and management**. With **38 winners** across **9 categories**, the awards aim to raise awareness and encourage best practices in water usage and sustainability.

Categories and Winners of 5th National Water Awards 2023

The awards were given in **9 categories**, recognizing contributions from **states, districts, village panchayats, schools, colleges, industries, water user associations, institutions, and civil society organizations**. Below is a detailed list of winners for each category.

Best State

Rank	State
1st	Odisha
2nd	Uttar Pradesh
3rd	Gujarat (Joint Winner)
3rd	Puducherry (Joint Winner)

Best District (Zone-Wise)

Zone	District	State
South	Visakhapatnam	Andhra Pradesh
North-East	Dhalai	Tripura
North	Banda (Joint Winner)	Uttar Pradesh
North	Ganderbal (Joint Winner)	Jammu & Kashmir
West	Indore	Madhya Pradesh
East	Balangir	Odisha

Best Village Panchayat

Rank	Village Name	State
1st	Pullampara, Thiruvananthapuram	Kerala
2nd	Masulpani, Kanker	Chhattisgarh
3rd	Hampapuram, Anantapur (Joint Winner)	Andhra Pradesh
3rd	Khliehrangnah, West Jaintia Hills (Joint Winner)	Meghalaya

Best Urban Local Body

Rank	Urban Local Body	State
1st	Surat	Gujarat
2nd	Puri	Odisha
3rd	Pune	Maharashtra

Best School or College

Rank	School/College Name	State
1st	Govt. Upper Primary School, Jethwanka Bas	Rajasthan
2nd	Govt. Sarvodya Kanya Vidyalaya, Paschim Vihar	New Delhi
3rd	Khairbani Ashram School, Baisinga	Odisha
–	BHSS, Zainakote (Special Mention)	Jammu & Kashmir

Best Industry

Rank	Industry Name	State
1st	Aravali Power Company Private Limited	Haryana
2nd	Apollo Tyres Limited	Tamil Nadu
3rd	Raymond Uco Denim Pvt Ltd	Maharashtra

Best Water User Association

Rank	Water User Association	State
1st	Pentakli Project Union of Water User Association	Maharashtra
2nd	Water User Cooperative Society	Karnataka
3rd	Parambur Big Tank Water User Association	Tamil Nadu

Best Institution (Other than School/College)

Rank	Institution Name	State
1st	Tamil Nadu Agricultural University	Tamil Nadu
2nd	Koner Lakshmaiah Education Foundation	Andhra Pradesh
3rd	Indian Institute of Technology, Madras (Joint Winner)	Tamil Nadu
3rd	Sri Tirumala Nagar Resident Welfare Association	Andhra Pradesh
–	IIT Tirupati (Special Mention)	Andhra Pradesh
–	Birla Institute of Science and Technology (Special Mention)	Rajasthan

Best Civil Society

Rank	Civil Society Name	State
1st	BAIF Development Research Foundation	Maharashtra
2nd	Yuva Mitra, Mitrangan Campus	Maharashtra
3rd	Gramin Vikas Trust	Gujarat
–	Art of Living, Vyakti Vikas Kendra India (Special Mention)	Karnataka
–	S. M. Sehgal Foundation (Special Mention)	Haryana

PM Internship Scheme

The **Prime Minister's Internship Scheme** was launched on October 3, 2024. This ambitious initiative, implemented through an online portal, **aims to provide one crore young individuals with valuable internship opportunities over the next five years**, allowing them to immerse themselves in diverse business environments and explore various professions.

Background

- **Announced In:** Union Budget 2024-25.
- **Aim :** To provide one crore internship opportunities over five years.
- **Platform :** Implemented through an online portal.
- **Objective :** Equip youth with skills and real-world exposure across diverse sectors.
- **Pilot Project (2024-25)**
- **Target:** 1.25 lakh internships.
- **Sectors Covered:** 24 sectors, including oil, gas, energy, travel, hospitality, automotive, banking, and financial services.
- **Company Selection:** Based on Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) expenditure over the past three years.

Key Highlights of the PM Internship Scheme

Eligibility Criteria

- **Age Range :** 21-24 years.
- **Candidates :** Indian nationals not employed full-time or engaged in full-time education.
- **Educational Qualifications :** High School, ITI certificates, diplomas, or bachelor's degrees (BA, B.Sc, B.Com, BCA, BBA, B.Pharm, etc.).
- **Program Duration :** 12 months.

Financial Assistance

- **Monthly Stipend:** ₹5,000 (₹500 from partner companies and ₹4,500 from the government via DBT).
- **One-time Grant:** ₹6,000 upon joining the internship.
- **Insurance Coverage:** All interns will be covered under Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana and Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana, with premiums paid by the government.

PM Internship Portal

- A **centralized online platform to manage** the internship lifecycle.
- Companies can post internship opportunities and shortlist candidates.
- Candidates can apply for up to five internships based on location, sector, and qualifications.
- Shortlisting prioritizes diversity and inclusivity, **focusing on Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, OBCs, and Persons with Disabilities.**

Global Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI)

The **2024 Global Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI)** report highlights the alarming interconnections between violent conflict and multidimensional poverty across various nations. According to the report, approximately **1.1 billion people** live in acute multidimensional poverty, with **455 million** residing in conflict-affected regions.

Key Findings

Child Poverty: Over **half** (584 million) of the impoverished population are children under 18, indicating a severe impact on the youth, with **27.9%** of children living in poverty compared to **13.5%** of adults.

Basic Needs: Many poor individuals lack essential resources, including adequate sanitation (828 million), housing (886 million), and cooking fuel (998 million).

Nutrition: Over **637 million** people live in households with at least one undernourished individual, with South Asia and Sub-Saharan Africa being significantly affected.

Global Trends

Since the inception of the MPI in **2010**, it has served as an essential tool for identifying vulnerable populations. The report reflects on the achievements and ongoing challenges in poverty reduction, emphasizing the urgent need for investment in peace to effectively address poverty.

Indicators and cutoffs

Dimension	Indicators	Deprivation Cutoffs
Health	Child mortality	Deprived if a child under the age of 18 years has died in the family in the five years preceding the survey.
Nutrition	Undernourishment	Deprived if any adult or child, for whom there is nutritional information, is undernourished.
Education	Years of schooling	Deprived if no household member has completed six years of schooling.
	School attendance	Deprived if no household member aged 'school entrance age + six' years or older has completed six years of schooling.

Dimension	Indicators	Deprivation Cutoffs
Standard of Living	Cooking fuel	Deprived if the household cooks with dung, wood, or charcoal.
	Sanitation	Deprived if the household's sanitation facility is either not improved (according to MDG guidelines), is shared with other households, or both.
	Drinking water	Deprived if the household does not have access to improved drinking water (according to MDG guidelines) or improved drinking water is more than a 30-minute walk from home.
	Electricity	Deprived if the household has no electricity.
	Housing	Deprived if at least one of the three housing materials for roof, walls, and floor are inadequate: the floor is of natural materials and/or the roof and/or walls are of natural or rudimentary materials.
	Assets	Deprived if the household does not own more than one of these assets: radio, TV, telephone, computer, animal cart, bicycle, motorbike, or refrigerator and does not own a car or truck.

UDAN Scheme

In a landmark announcement on October 21, 2024, Civil Aviation Minister K. Rammohan Naidu declared that the government will extend the **UDAN (Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik) scheme** for an additional **10 years**. The decision, made during a special event celebrating eight years of the scheme, reinforces the government's commitment to enhancing regional air connectivity and making air travel accessible to every citizen of India.

The UDAN scheme, launched on October 21, 2016, has been instrumental in not only boosting regional airlines but also creating thousands of jobs and significantly contributing to the growth of tourism across India. With 601 air routes and 71 operationalized airports under the scheme, UDAN has drastically improved air travel infrastructure in underserved and remote regions.

The UDAN Scheme's Journey: 2016–2024

The UDAN scheme was initially launched for a period of 10 years in 2016. Its core objectives include:

- **Enhancing regional air connectivity** by offering subsidies to airlines that operate flights on unserved or underserved routes.
- **Boosting tourism and trade** by connecting smaller cities and remote regions with major hubs.
- **Making flying affordable** for the common citizen by capping airfares on specific routes.

Over the past eight years, UDAN has seen remarkable growth, operationalizing more than 601 air routes and making 71 airports fully functional. This has not only bridged the accessibility gap between India's metropolitan and non-metro areas but also revolutionized the nation's aviation sector by reducing airfares on regional routes.

Extension for Another 10 Years

- In his address, Civil Aviation Minister K. Rammohan Naidu highlighted the success of the UDAN scheme and the reasons for extending it for another decade. He noted that UDAN has made substantial contributions to connecting the hinterlands of India to urban centers, thus boosting regional development and contributing to the overall economy. With the scheme set to expire in 2026, this extension signals a continued commitment to sustainable regional aviation growth.
- Additionally, Civil Aviation Secretary Vumlungmang Vualnam emphasized that while the extension is welcome, the ministry is also looking into the financial viability of the scheme, with an aim to streamline the subsidy and operational procedures. Ensuring that the scheme remains fiscally sustainable is critical to maintaining the affordability and frequency of flights across the country's remote regions.

India's Aviation Infrastructure: From 74 to 157 Airports

- One of the most notable successes of the UDAN scheme has been the exponential increase in the number of operational airports across India. When the scheme was launched in 2016, India had only 74 airports in service. By 2024, this number has more than doubled to 157, a clear testament to UDAN's success in boosting India's aviation infrastructure.
- This growth is a part of the broader vision to ensure that aviation infrastructure in India continues to expand, with a goal of 350-400 operational airports by 2047. This ambitious target aligns with India's 100th year of independence, positioning the nation as a global leader in aviation connectivity and infrastructure.

Milestones in RCS-UDAN Development

UDAN Versions

- **UDAN 1.0** : Awarded 128 flight routes to five airline companies across 70 airports, including 36 newly operational airports.
- **UDAN 2.0** : Announced connections to 73 underserved and unserved airports; included helipads for the first time.

- **UDAN 3.0** : Introduced tourism routes and connected water aerodromes with seaplanes, focusing on the Northeast Region.
- **UDAN 4.0** : Emphasized operations in the Northeastern regions, hilly states, and islands, incorporating helicopters and seaplanes.

UDAN 5.0

- Launched with improvements based on stakeholder feedback, focusing on Category-2 (20-80 seats) and Category-3 (>80 seats) aircraft.
- Removed the 600 km distance cap, allowing airlines to operate without distance restrictions.
- Airlines must commence operations within 4 months of route award.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi marked the 8th anniversary of the **UDAN (Ude Desh ke Aam Nagrik) scheme**, celebrating its transformative impact on India's aviation sector. **Launched in October 2016**, UDAN aimed to make air travel affordable for the common man and boost regional connectivity.

BRICS Summit 2024

The **2024 BRICS Summit**, held in **Kazan, Russia**, from October 22-24, marks a significant turning point for the group as Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the UAE join its ranks following their inclusion at the 2023 summit. The event centers around the theme, **"Strengthening Multilateralism for Fair Global Development and Security,"** with key discussions on alternative global payment systems, dedollarization, and enhanced cooperation. The summit witnessed the adoption of the BRICS Kazan Declaration, endorsing UN reforms and investigating cross-border financial solutions to reduce reliance on the US dollar.

16th BRICS Summit: Key Outcomes

- **BRICS Pay**: A new payment system introduced to facilitate financial transactions among member nations, providing an alternative to SWIFT for international settlements.
- **Kazan Declaration**: Adoption of reforms to the UN, support for Palestine's full UN membership under the two-state solution, and deliberations on using national currencies for trade.

Key Bilateral Meetings

- **China-Russia**: Presidents Xi and Putin reaffirmed their strategic partnership, advancing the Belt and Road Initiative and Eurasian Economic Union integration.
- **India-China**: PM Modi and President Xi resolved a four-year military standoff, aiming to bolster relations between the two ancient civilizations.
- **India-Iran**: Discussions focused on Chabahar Port, Afghanistan, Central Asia, and the Israel-Palestine conflict.
- **Russia-South Africa**: President Ramaphosa acknowledged Russia's support during apartheid, reinforcing their ties.

Global Participation

- Leaders from several nations, including South Africa, China, India, and UAE, attended, with Brazilian President Lula da Silva participating online due to health reasons. Other countries such as Armenia, Belarus, and Uzbekistan also sent delegates, contributing to the growing influence of BRICS on global geopolitics.

15th BRICS Summit

- The **15th BRICS Summit**, held in **Johannesburg**, marked a significant milestone with the group's expansion by inviting **six new members: Argentina, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia, and the UAE**. The expansion highlights BRICS' aim to strengthen its global influence and increase representation from the Global South, effective from January 2024. Leaders reaffirmed their commitment to multilateralism, international law, and sustainable development, pushing for reforms in global governance bodies like the UN.

Key Developments

- BRICS Expansion and Influence
- The summit saw invitations extended to nations across Africa, Latin America, and West Asia, enhancing the group's geopolitical weight. Over 40 nations have expressed interest in joining BRICS, reflecting the bloc's growing relevance. The inclusion of energy-rich countries like Saudi Arabia and Iran also bolsters BRICS' strategic resources.

Common Currency and Space Cooperation

- The BRICS leaders agreed to explore the possibility of creating a common currency for trade and investment, aiming to reduce reliance on the US dollar. India proposed the formation of a BRICS space consortium, with particular significance following its successful lunar mission.

India's Role and Challenges

- While India stands to benefit from a more diverse BRICS, it faces challenges, including managing its relationships with China, navigating trade imbalances, and ensuring a balanced approach within the group. India advocates for global governance reforms in the UN and other multilateral organizations, warning that without reforms, these institutions may become obsolete.



A Platform for Global Reform

- India, along with other BRICS members, seeks to use the bloc's expansion to push for broader reforms in global institutions. The expansion sets the stage for BRICS to play a pivotal role in reshaping 21st-century global governance, ensuring that developing nations have a stronger voice on the world stage.

Pravasi Bharatiya Divas

Odisha is set to host the **18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas** from **January 8th to 10th next year** in its capital city, **Bhubaneswar**. The event, which celebrates the contributions of the Indian diaspora, will take place at Janata Maidan.

Key Event Details

- Event** : 18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD)
- Dates** : January 8 to 10, 2025
- Location** : Janata Maidan, Bhubaneswar, Odisha
- Approval** : Proposal approved by Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi after submission from the Union Ministry of External Affairs (MEA).

Event Organization

Jointly Organized by

- Odisha Government
- Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)

Preparations

- A five-member delegation from the MEA has visited Bhubaneswar to coordinate with state officials.
- Various committees have been established to ensure smooth execution of the event.

Pravasi Bharatiya Divas

Significance and History

Overview

- Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD) is celebrated annually on January 9th to honor the contributions of the overseas Indian community towards the development of India.
- The date was chosen to commemorate Mahatma Gandhi's return to India from South Africa in 1915, marking the start of his role in India's freedom movement.

Key Historical Milestones

First Celebration

- PBD was **first celebrated in 2003** to recognize the contributions of the Indian diaspora.

Biennial Event

- Since 2015, Pravasi Bharatiya Divas has been held every two years to engage the Indian diaspora in developmental initiatives.

Last Edition

- The previous PBD was held in Indore, Madhya Pradesh.

Significance of January 9th

- Mahatma Gandhi's Return to India (1915)**
- January 9 was chosen for the PBD celebration to honor Mahatma Gandhi's return to Mumbai from South Africa in 1915.**
- Gandhi's return marked a significant turning point in India's freedom struggle, symbolizing the potential of the Indian diaspora in shaping the nation's future.

Importance of Pravasi Bharatiya Divas

- PBD recognizes the **invaluable contributions of the Indian diaspora to the nation's socio-economic, cultural, and political progress.**
- The event serves as a **platform for overseas Indians to reconnect with their roots and contribute to India's development through investment, knowledge sharing, and policy collaboration.**
- The celebration offers an opportunity for the Government of India to engage with the global Indian community, understand their needs, and foster relationships that support India's global outreach.

COP on United Nations Biodiversity Conference

The two-week United Nations Biodiversity Conference (**COP16**) commenced today in **Colombia**, bringing together environmental leaders from nearly 200 countries to evaluate historic commitments **aimed at halting and reversing the loss of biodiversity.**

Conference Objectives

- Delegates in Cali will discuss strategies **to combat the rapid rate of destruction of natural habitats and ensure compliance** with the 2022 biodiversity accord.
- Countries are expected to commit to setting aside 30% of their territories for conservation purposes and to reduce subsidies for businesses that negatively impact the environment.
- The conference aims to establish mandatory reporting for companies on their environmental impact, promoting transparency and accountability.
- Countries were **expected to submit their biodiversity plans** by the start of the summit, but as of Friday, only 31 out of 195 countries had filed plans with the UN biodiversity secretariat.

About United Nations Biodiversity Conference

- The UN Biodiversity Conference is the **regular meeting of the countries who have signed (and are therefore 'parties to') the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD).**
- CBD is an international agreement for conserving biodiversity with the vision of "living in harmony with nature by 2050".
- The **convention was adopted at the Rio Earth Summit in 1992.**
- The first Conference of the Parties to the convention (**COP 1**) took place in Nassau, Bahamas in 1994.

- The COP is the arena for international governments to meet and review progress on the convention and establish new measures needed to support its goals.

Objectives

- The conservation of biological diversity,
- The sustainable use of its components,
- The fair and equitable sharing of the benefits of biological diversity.

How many countries are part of the Convention on Biological Diversity?

- **A total of 196 countries** (including India) are party to the Convention on Biological Diversity – although the United States is notably absent.
- Each country is required to **set National Biodiversity Strategies and Action Plans (NBSAPs)** detailing how the principles of the conservation and sustainable use of biological resources will be integrated into their country's national policies.

Secretariat

- The CBD Secretariat is based in Montreal, Canada.

INDIA-CHINA LAC Agreement

India recently announced a pivotal agreement regarding patrolling along the **Line of Actual Control (LAC)** with China. This development is seen as a potential stepping stone toward normalizing relations between the two nations following tensions that escalated in 2020. The pact entails a structured approach to disengagement and resolution of the long-standing border disputes, specifically in areas like the **Depsang Plains and Demchok**.

Key Highlights of the Agreement

Restoration of Patrolling Rights

The agreement allows both nations to restore mutual patrolling rights in the Depsang Plains and the Demchok region, areas where disputes existed even before the 2020 border incursions. Indian troops will now be permitted to patrol up to **Patrolling Points (PP) 10 to 13 in the Depsang Plains and the Charding Nullah in Demchok**. Notably, areas where previous disengagements occurred—such as **Galwan Valley, Pangong Tso, and Gogra-Hot Springs**—are explicitly excluded from renegotiation.

India-China LAC Agreement: What this means, Implications and Cautions

Three-Step Process: Disengagement, De-escalation, and Demilitarization

The agreement outlines a phased process focusing on:

1. **Disengagement:** Immediate withdrawal of troops from frontline positions.
2. **De-escalation:** Gradual reduction of military presence along the LAC, currently estimated at 50,000 to 60,000 troops from each side.
3. **Demilitarization:** Long-term objective of reducing military hardware and personnel in sensitive border areas.

This structured approach aims to prevent future incidents, particularly those akin to the deadly clashes in Galwan Valley, which claimed the lives of 20 Indian soldiers and at least four Chinese soldiers.

Background: The Road to Agreement

Modi's Call for Improved Relations

In April 2024, Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi emphasized the importance of addressing the prolonged border situation to normalize India-China relations. His call for constructive dialogue was met with a positive response from Beijing.

Positive Chinese Response

Chinese officials acknowledged that the relationship between India and China transcends the border dispute, indicating a willingness to engage in constructive dialogue.

Focus on Patrolling Rights

In May 2024, Indian External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar articulated optimism regarding the resolution of remaining border disputes, particularly highlighting the significance of patrolling rights in the Ladakh region.

Significance of the Patrolling Pact

The patrolling arrangement is a cornerstone of the agreement and is critical for maintaining order and stability along the LAC. In the absence of a clear physical demarcation, regular patrols are essential for asserting territorial claims. The Indian troops typically patrol to their perceived borders and leave behind markers, such as Indian-made items, to indicate their presence.

Guidelines for Troop Conduct

The agreement also reaffirms commitments made in the 2005 Border Pact, specifically Article 4, which outlines guidelines for troop conduct during face-offs. This includes self-restraint in encounters, prohibition of force, and mutual courtesy, aiming to prevent escalation during incidents along the border.

Diverging Interpretations Post-Agreement

Following the announcement, there were noticeable differences in how India and China interpreted the agreement:

Indian Perspective

India's official statement emphasized a **"complete disengagement and resolution of issues"** arising from the 2020 confrontations. Indian leaders reiterated that a comprehensive resolution of border standoffs is a prerequisite for normalizing bilateral relations.

Chinese Perspective

In contrast, China described the agreement as **"important progress"** but maintained that broader relations should not be held hostage to the border dispute. This reflects a preference for a compartmentalized approach to diplomatic relations.

Planned Steps for Future Resolution

Both countries have indicated plans for future dialogue to seek a fair and mutually acceptable solution to the boundary question. **India's Special Representatives** are set to meet soon, while China aims for diplomatic discussions at various levels to restore relations.

Conclusion: Cautious Optimism in India's Strategic Circles

While there is cautious optimism regarding the path forward, strategic circles in India are mindful of the complexities involved. The phased process of **disengagement, de-escalation, and eventual troop reduction** is anticipated to take several years, contingent on both nations' adherence to the agreement. The future remains uncertain as to whether these steps will unfold in parallel or sequentially, but the initial steps have initiated a trust-building process between two historically adversarial neighbors.

Future Implications of the LAC Agreement

The LAC agreement holds significant implications for both countries. While it serves as a catalyst for trust-building and aims to prevent future clashes, India's cautious approach, in contrast to China's broader focus on ties, hints at the complexities ahead. The path to lasting resolution may require extensive negotiations, underscoring the delicate balance that both nations must navigate as they seek to redefine their bilateral relationship.

Centre Appoints 29 Joint Secretaries

In a significant move aimed at strengthening various departments, the Government of India has appointed 29 officers as Joint Secretaries across different ministries and sectors. The reshuffle, orchestrated by the Centre, involves officers from a range of central services, including the **Indian Defence Accounts Service (IDAS)**, **Indian Railway Service of Electrical Engineers (IRSEE)**, **Indian Audit and Accounts Service (IA&AS)**, and **Indian Revenue Service (IRS)**, among others. This reshuffle reflects the government's commitment to optimizing governance by assigning experienced and specialized personnel to pivotal roles.

Key Appointments in the Ministry of Home Affairs

Three officers have been designated as Joint Secretaries in the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA):

- **Praveen Kumar Rai** and **Rakesh Kumar Pandey**, both officers from the **Indian Defence Accounts Service (IDAS)**, have been entrusted with Joint Secretary roles in the Home Ministry.
- **Rajesh Gupta**, from the **Indian Railway Service of Electrical Engineers (IRSEE)**, has also been appointed as Joint Secretary in the MHA, bringing his engineering expertise to the table.

Additionally, **Raj Kumar**, a 1999-batch officer from the **Indian Audit and Accounts Service (IA&AS)**, has been appointed as **Director (Finance)** in the **Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)**, where he will serve a five-year tenure under the Ministry of Home Affairs.

Strategic Roles in Economic and Cooperative Sectors

Several senior officers have been assigned to roles critical to India's economic growth and cooperative development:

- **Deepak Agarwal**, a 2000-batch **Indian Administrative Service (IAS)** officer from the Uttar Pradesh cadre, has been appointed as **Managing Director (Joint Secretary level)** at the **National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED)**. NAFED plays a crucial role in promoting cooperative marketing, and Agarwal's leadership is expected to enhance its efficiency.
- **Premjit Lal** has taken the role of **Executive Director** at the **India Trade Promotion Organisation (ITPO)**, where his leadership will focus on promoting Indian trade and organizing events to enhance global trade engagement.

Appointments in Administrative and Personnel Management

To improve administrative efficiency and streamline personnel management, two experienced IAS officers have been appointed to significant positions:

- **Chauhan Sarita Chand** has been appointed as **Joint Secretary** in the **Department of Administrative Reforms & Public Grievances**, an essential department focused on improving governance mechanisms and addressing public grievances.
- **P Bala Kiran**, another IAS officer, has been appointed as **Joint Secretary** in the **Department of Personnel & Training**, where he will play a role in overseeing personnel policies, training, and human resource management across government departments.

Key Roles in Social Welfare and Women Empowerment

In a move that underscores the government's commitment to social welfare and women's empowerment, the Centre has appointed **Bhavna Saxena**, a 1996-batch **Indian Police Service (IPS)** officer of the Andhra Pradesh cadre, as the **CEO of the Central Adoption Resource Authority (CARA)**. CARA, under the **Ministry of Women & Child Development**, is responsible for the adoption process in India, and Saxena's experience in the police service is expected to bring operational discipline to this sensitive area.

Appointments in Petroleum, Commerce, and Corporate Affairs

Key appointments were made in departments critical to India's industrial and economic landscape:

- **Anjan Kumar Mishra**, a 1998-batch officer from the **Indian Ordnance Factories Service (IOFS)**, has been designated as **Secretary** of the **Petroleum & Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB)** under the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas. This role is crucial in regulating India's oil and gas sector, which has strategic importance for the country's energy security.

- **Kesang Yangzom Sherpa**, a 1995-batch IRS (Income Tax cadre) officer, has taken on the role of **Joint Secretary in the Department of Commerce**. Her experience in tax-related fields will bring valuable insights to the department responsible for regulating and promoting India's international trade.
- **Balamurugan D** has been appointed as **Joint Secretary in the Ministry of Corporate Affairs**, where he will be tasked with overseeing corporate governance, regulatory frameworks, and the facilitation of business in India.

Environmental and Agricultural Roles

Recognizing the importance of environmental conservation and sustainable agriculture, the Centre has appointed senior bureaucrats in relevant roles:

- **Rajat Agarwal** and **Ved Prakash Mishra** have been appointed as **Joint Secretaries in the Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change**. Their roles will involve tackling issues related to environmental policy, climate change initiatives, and forest conservation, which are critical to India's ecological future.
- **Rama Shankar Sinha** has been appointed as **Joint Secretary in the Department of Animal Husbandry & Dairying**. His role is pivotal in supporting the livestock sector, ensuring food security, and providing livelihood to millions in rural areas.

Enhancing Development in the North Eastern Region

As part of the government's ongoing efforts to foster development in India's North Eastern states, **Niraj Kumar**, an officer from the **Central Secretariat Service (CSS)**, has been appointed as **Joint Secretary in the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (DoNER)**. This role will involve promoting developmental initiatives and addressing socio-economic challenges in the North East.

68th Ballon d'Or Paris, France

The 2024 Ballon d'Or ceremony in Paris was a night dominated by Manchester City and Spain midfielder Rodri, who triumphed over competitors from Real Madrid to claim **football's most prestigious individual award**. The event was also notable for numerous other recognitions, including those for promising young talents, coaching excellence, and outstanding club achievements.

Awarding Body

- Ballon d'Or is an annual award given by **France Football** to the best male and female footballers over the previous year.
- This Year UEFA also partnered with France Football award.

Rodri (Spain, Manchester City)

- The **28-year-old** secured the **men's Ballon d'Or** award, celebrating his instrumental contributions to Manchester City's success, including their Premier League win and his exceptional performance for Spain in the Euro 2024 tournament.

- Rodri edged out Real Madrid's Vinicius Junior, Jude Bellingham, and Dani Carvajal, each known for their incredible form over the season.
- Aside from his club success, Rodri was named the Player of the Tournament at Euro 2024, showcasing his vital role in Spain's victorious campaign.

Aitana Bonmatí (Spain, Barcelona)

- For the second consecutive year, Bonmatí earned the title of the world's best female footballer.
- Achievements: Bonmatí helped FC Barcelona win the Spanish league, the Spanish cup, and the Her outstanding season led to a 1-2-3 finish for Barcelona, with her teammates Caroline Graham Hansen and Salma Paralluelo following in the rankings.
- She received the award from actress Natalie Portman, who acknowledged her contributions to women's football.

Lamine Yamal Wins Kopa Trophy

- The 17-year-old prodigy claimed the Kopa Trophy, awarded to the best player under 21.
- Yamal played a key role in Spain's Euro 2024 campaign, notably scoring a stunning goal in the semifinal against France. He also scored 16 goals at club level in the 2023/24 season.
- Yamal is now the sixth player to receive this award, joining previous winners like Kylian Mbappé and Jude Bellingham.

Men's Club of the Year

- **Real Madrid** took home the Men's Club of the Year award for the winning UEFA Champions League, La Liga and Spanish super cup.

Coach of the Year

- **Carlo Ancelotti, Real Madrid's manager**, was named Men's Coach of the Year. His leadership led the club to success in both La Liga and the UEFA Champions League.
- Ancelotti accepted the award, reflecting on his team's successes despite the club's absence from the ceremony.

Additional Honors

Yashin Trophy (Best Goalkeeper)

Emiliano Martínez (Argentina, Aston Villa)

- Recognized for his exceptional season, including performances for Argentina's national team.

Gerd Müller Trophy

- Shared by Kylian Mbappé (France, PSG/Real Madrid) and Harry Kane (England, Bayern Munich) for their 52-goal achievements across all competitions.

Women's Coach of the Year

Emma Hayes (Chelsea, USA)

- Hayes was celebrated for her success with Chelsea and her impact on the women's game internationally.

Socrates Award

- Jenni Hermoso (Spain, Tigres UANL) – Recognized for her humanitarian efforts off the field.

Complete List of 2024 Ballon d'Or Award Winners

- Men's Ballon d'Or: Rodri (Manchester City, Spain)
- Women's Ballon d'Or: Aitana Bonmatí (Barcelona, Spain)
- Kopa Trophy: Lamine Yamal (Barcelona, Spain)
- Yashin Trophy: Emiliano Martínez (Aston Villa, Argentina)
- Men's Coach of the Year: Carlo Ancelotti (Real Madrid, Italy)
- Women's Coach of the Year: Emma Hayes (Chelsea/USA)
- Men's Club of the Year: Real Madrid
- Women's Club of the Year: FC Barcelona
- Gerd Müller Trophy: Kylian Mbappé (PSG/Real Madrid) & Harry Kane (Bayern Munich)
- Socrates Award: Jenni Hermoso (Spain, Tigres UANL) – Recognized for her humanitarian efforts off the field.

PM Man Ki Baat October

In the recent episode of Mann Ki Baat, the Prime Minister of India touched on several pivotal themes: the country's unity, cultural heritage, the significance of self-reliance, and growing technological advancements. This comprehensive session highlighted India's journey of resilience and progress while celebrating its diverse cultural tapestry and strides in innovation.

A Special Visit to Ulihatu: A Tribute to Bhagwan Birsa Munda

The Prime Minister recalled his memorable visit to **Ulihatu Village**, the birthplace of **Bhagwan Birsa Munda**, on his birth anniversary, emphasizing the deep connection with India's freedom struggle felt during this visit. He noted how touching the sacred soil of Ulihatu reminded him of the immense **strength and courage** ingrained in the nation's heritage, a legacy shaping the destiny of millions of Indians.

Honoring the Legacy of Sardar Patel and Bhagwan Birsa Munda

Reflecting on India's history of remarkable figures, the Prime Minister highlighted **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** and **Bhagwan Birsa Munda** as towering icons whose legacies have contributed to the idea of a unified India. With celebrations of their **150th birth anniversaries** on the horizon, he urged the nation to commemorate their contributions, inspiring unity and resilience.

Key Focus: Sardar Patel and Bhagwan Birsa Munda symbolize unity in diversity, making their life stories vital sources of inspiration for contemporary India.

A Global Celebration of Indian Heritage

The **150th birth anniversary** of **Mahatma Gandhi** was a remarkable global event, resonating from **Times Square, New York**, to remote villages in Africa. The Prime Minister acknowledged that Gandhiji's ideals of **truth** and **non-violence** transcended borders, finding relevance among young people worldwide. This global reverence was similar when celebrating **Swami Vivekananda's** birth anniversary,

which helped today's youth appreciate India's **spiritual and cultural strengths**.

India's Growing Animation and Gaming Industry

India's Animation Industry is evolving into a global powerhouse. Animated series like **Chhota Bheem** and **Motu-Patlu** have captured audiences in India and beyond. The Prime Minister lauded Indian talent in the animation field, mentioning that Indian artists are also contributing to international productions, like the **Spider-Man** and **Transformers** franchises.

The **gaming sector** is also thriving, with Indian games now attracting worldwide attention. With significant opportunities in **VR, AR, and game development**, India is poised to lead in innovative digital content. The Prime Minister's message to the youth was clear: seize the moment, harness creativity, and establish India's name in global gaming and animation.

Atmanirbhar Bharat: India's Path to Self-Reliance

The Prime Minister emphasized the **Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan**, or **Self-Reliant India Mission**, as a campaign powered by the collective spirit of the people. Through initiatives like local mobile manufacturing, defense exports, and **space achievements**—including the recent **South Pole lunar landing**—India is swiftly progressing toward self-reliance across multiple sectors.

The recent installation of Asia's largest **Imaging Telescope MACE** in Ladakh is another feather in India's cap, showcasing indigenous capabilities even in extreme conditions.

Key Highlight: India, once heavily dependent on imports, is now a leading producer and exporter in numerous fields, exemplifying the transformative impact of self-reliance.

Combating Cyber Frauds and Ensuring Digital Security

Raising awareness about **Digital Arrest** frauds, the Prime Minister discussed how these scams work and shared steps for citizens to protect themselves. He advised everyone to follow three key steps: **Stop, Think, and Take Action**. For any suspicious calls, the **national cyber helpline (1930)** and **cybercrime.gov.in** are resources to report scams. The Prime Minister also urged schools and colleges to educate students on digital safety, further strengthening India's stance on **cybersecurity**.

Preserving India's Cultural Heritage

The Prime Minister highlighted the tireless work of individuals preserving India's rich cultural heritage. He noted the **Cheriyal Folk Art** of Telangana, the **Abujhmadia tribal art** in Chhattisgarh, and **Sarangi performances** preserving **Dogra culture**. Through the efforts of dedicated artists, Indian traditions are being kept alive and are even spreading internationally, creating "Cultural Bridges" that connect India to the world.

Global Reach: Indian cultural influences have reached places as diverse as **Yakutsk** in Russia, where Kalidasa's **Abhijnana Shakuntalam** is performed, and **Peru**, where Indian classical dance is gaining popularity.

Fit India Movement and National Unity Day

The **Fit India Movement** has become a way of life across the country, with fitness activities incorporated into school curriculums. Highlighting the upcoming **National Unity Day** on **October 31**, which coincides with Deepawali, the Prime Minister encouraged maximum participation in the **Run for Unity** on **October 29**. The event celebrates both **physical fitness** and **national unity**, reflecting the spirit of a healthier, stronger India.

Focus on Fitness: From school initiatives like the **Fit India School Hours** to family fitness activities, the movement is influencing people of all ages and promoting holistic wellness.

Concluding Thoughts

This episode of Mann Ki Baat resonated with a message of unity, self-reliance, and cultural pride. The Prime Minister's words emphasized the need to celebrate India's rich legacy while advancing with modern innovations, urging every citizen to play their part in building a resilient and globally recognized India.

Keywords and Themes

- **Unity in Diversity**
- **Bhagwan Birsa Munda**
- **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**
- **Mahatma Gandhi**
- **Self-Reliant India (Atmanirbhar Bharat)**
- **Digital Security**
- **Cyber Awareness**
- **Indian Cultural Heritage**
- **Fit India Movement**
- **VR Tourism**

Most Important Current Affairs of November 2024

Rise in Glacial Lake Himalaya Report Tells

A recent government report indicates that glacial lakes and water bodies in the Himalayan region **have experienced a 10.81% increase in area from 2011 to 2024**, primarily driven by climate change. This expansion raises concerns about the heightened risk of glacial lake outburst floods (GLOFs). The report, accessed by PTI from the Central Water Commission (CWC), highlights that lakes in India have seen an even more significant growth, with a surface area increase of 33.7%.

Key Findings from the CWC Report

Expansion of Indian Lakes

- The total area of glacial lakes in **India grew from 1,962 hectares in 2011 to 2,623 hectares in 2024**, marking a 33.7% increase.
- A total of 67 lakes in India experienced over 40% increase in surface area, categorizing them as high-risk for GLOFs.

Regional Variations

- The most notable **expansions were recorded in Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, and Arunachal Pradesh**.

- Overall, glacial lakes across the Himalayan region increased from 533,401 hectares in 2011 to 591,108 hectares in 2024.

Impacts of Climate Change

Melting Glaciers

- The rapid expansion of glacial lakes is attributed to the accelerated melting of glaciers due to rising temperatures, posing significant threats to downstream communities, infrastructure, and biodiversity.

Physical Changes

- The shrinking of mountain glaciers and expansion of glacial lakes are primary indicators of climate change in the Himalayan environment.

Risks Associated with GLOFs

- GLOFs (Glacial Lake Outburst Floods) occur when glacial lakes breach their natural moraine dams, leading to sudden and often catastrophic floods.
- The report emphasizes the urgent need for rigorous monitoring and risk management strategies to mitigate the impacts of GLOFs.

Technological Advancements in Monitoring

Satellite Technology

The CWC has adopted advanced satellite technologies, such as,

- Sentinel-1 Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)
- Sentinel-2 Multispectral Imagery

Monitoring Capabilities

- These technologies enable **precise monitoring of lake sizes with 10-meter accuracy, even under challenging conditions like cloud cover.**

Transboundary Risks

- The report identifies the **transboundary risks posed by glacial lake expansions in neighboring countries, including Bhutan, Nepal, and China.**
- Emphasizes the importance of collaboration for effective management of GLOFs, including data sharing and joint risk assessment strategies.

Recommendations for Risk Mitigation

- Development of robust early warning systems is essential for disaster preparedness.
- Promoting awareness among local populations is crucial to safeguard vulnerable communities.
- Improvement of disaster management plans through international and regional cooperation is vital for effective responses to potential GLOFs.

Implications for Water Availability

Impact on River Systems

- The expansion of glacial lakes may affect water availability in major river systems such as the Ganga, Brahmaputra, and Indus.

Monitoring Patterns

- The CWC report utilized data comparisons from 2011 and five to ten-year averages to identify patterns of glacial lake expansion, allowing for targeted risk assessments.

About Glacial lakes/GLOF

- Glacial lakes are **large bodies of water** that sit in front of, on top of, or beneath a melting glacier.
- As a glacier withdraws, it leaves behind a depression that gets filled with meltwater, thereby forming a lake.
- The more the glacier recedes, the bigger and more dangerous the lake becomes. Such lakes are mostly dammed by unstable ice or sediment composed of loose rock and debris.
- In case the boundary around them breaks, huge amounts of water rush down the side of the mountains, which could cause flooding in the downstream areas. This is called the Glacial Lake Outburst Flood.

Reasons for GLOFs

- It can be triggered by various reasons, including glacial calving, where sizable ice chunks detach from the glacier into the lake, inducing sudden water displacement.
- Incidents such as avalanches or landslides can also impact the stability of the boundary around a glacial lake, leading to its failure, and the rapid discharge of water.

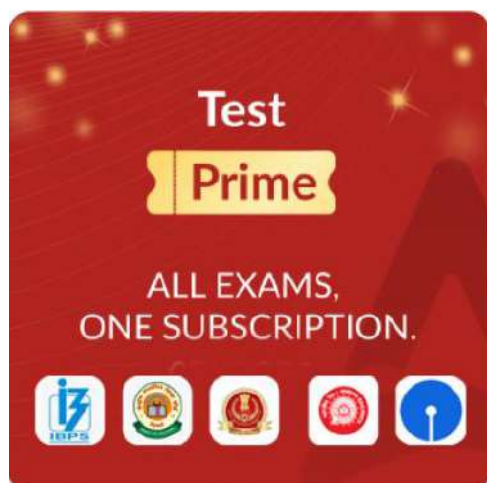
ILO's 352nd Session

The 352nd Governing Body meeting of the **International Labour Organisation (ILO)** is currently taking place in **Geneva**. This important gathering began on October 28 and will run until November 7, bringing together representatives from member countries to discuss key labor issues and strategies for improving working conditions globally.

India's Progress at ILO Governing Body Meeting

Event Overview

- The 352nd Governing Body meeting of the International Labour Organisation (ILO) is currently underway in Geneva, running from October 28 to November 7.



Key Speaker

- Sumita Dawra, Labour and Employment Secretary of India**, presented India's initiatives and progress in improving living standards and employment.

Multidimensional Poverty Reduction

- India has successfully lifted 248 million individuals out of multidimensional poverty over the past nine years, according to the Multidimensional Poverty Index.
- This reflects the government's commitment to addressing all dimensions of poverty.

Employment Growth

- The country has seen the addition of **approximately 170 million persons to economic activities between 2016-17 and 2022-23**, based on provisional estimates.
- This growth highlights the positive trends in employment and economic participation.

Government Initiatives

- PM Jan Dhan Yojana:** A financial inclusion program aimed at providing banking access to the unbanked population.
- PM Jeevan Jyoti Yojana:** Offers affordable life insurance to vulnerable populations.
- PM Suraksha Bima Yojana:** Provides affordable accident insurance.
- These initiatives demonstrate India's focus on enhancing financial inclusion and protecting vulnerable groups.

Transformation in Financial Inclusion

- Ms. Dawra emphasized India's remarkable transformation over the last decade regarding financial inclusion, ensuring that access to financial services is prioritized for all, especially vulnerable populations.

Convergent Approach Advocacy

- India advocated for a convergent approach among UN bodies, aiming for a synergistic operation to promote social justice and sustainable inclusive development globally.

Overview of the 352nd Session of the ILO

Agenda Highlights

- Strategic Plan for 2026–2029
- Global Coalition for Social Justice
- Democratization of Governance
- World Summit for Social Development 2025

Country-Specific Situations

Follow-Up on Ukraine

- Continued discussions on the resolution addressing the Russian Federation's aggression against Ukraine, focusing on its implications for labor rights and conditions.

Palestine's Participation

- Deliberations regarding Palestine's status within the ILO and its rights to participate in ILO meetings will take place.

Examination of Country Cases

The Governing Body **will assess labor situations** in several countries, including,

- Belarus
- Nicaragua
- Venezuela
- Bangladesh
- Guatemala
- Myanmar

Governing Body Function

- The Governing Body serves as the Executive Body of the ILO, **meeting three times a year (in March, June, and November) to make decisions on**,
 1. ILO policy
 2. Agenda for the International Labour Conference
 3. ILO Programme and Budget

About International Labour Organization (ILO)

- It is a specialized **agency of the United Nations (UN)** dedicated to improving labor conditions and living standards throughout the world.

History

- It was created in 1919, as part of the Treaty of Versailles that ended World War I, to reflect the belief that universal and lasting peace can be accomplished only if it is based on social justice.
- In 1946, the ILO became a specialized agency of the newly formed UN.

ISA's Key Decisions In 7th Assembly Session

India and France have been elected as **President and Co-President** of the International Solar Alliance (ISA) for a **two-year term from 2024 to 2026**. India was the sole candidate for the presidency, while France won the co-presidency in a contest with Grenada.

Election Results

- **India was the sole candidate** for the position of **ISA President**.
- The Co-Presidency was contested between France and Grenada, with France emerging as the winner.

ISA Assembly Event

- **The Seventh Session of the ISA Assembly** is underway at the **Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi** from 3 to 6th November, 2024.
- Ministers and representatives from **29 countries are in attendance** to discuss solar energy goals and initiatives.

India's Role and Impact

- **Union Minister Pralhad Joshi, who is also the ISA President**, emphasized that India's election reflects its substantial contributions to global solar energy efforts.
- Under the leadership of Prime Minister Modi, India has been advancing solar adoption and boosting investments in essential solar projects worldwide.

Future Ambitions

- India and France, together with ISA member countries, **aim to elevate ambitions in promoting solar energy and making a transformative impact globally**.
- The ISA leadership promises a decade of accelerated solar energy progress to benefit countries around the world.

Regional Vice Presidents and Vice Chairs

ISA has appointed eight Vice Presidents, two from each of its four geographical regions,

- **Africa:** Ghana and Seychelles as Vice Presidents; South Sudan and Comoros as Vice Chairs.
- **Asia and the Pacific:** Australia and Sri Lanka as Vice Presidents; United Arab Emirates and Papua New Guinea as Vice Chairs.
- **Europe and Others:** Germany and Italy as Vice Presidents; Greece and Norway as Vice Chairs.
- **Latin America and the Caribbean:** Grenada and Suriname as Vice Presidents; Jamaica and Haiti as Vice Chairs.

New Director General-Designate

- **Ashish Khanna** has been named the **Director General-Designate**, set to assume office in March 2025 after Ajay Mathur's term concludes.

ISA's Mission and Investment Goals

- The ISA, established in 2015 by India's Prime Minister Narendra Modi and France's President François Hollande, **seeks to mobilize over USD 1,000 billion by 2030 to support large-scale solar energy deployment**.
- Its objectives include **scaling up solar energy, reducing the cost of solar power, and promoting innovation in solar technology** through demand aggregation and capacity building.

ISA's Role in Green Energy Transition

- The ISA **promotes renewable energy as a crucial solution for reducing dependence on fossil fuels**.
- Solar energy is increasingly seen as a key to global climate mitigation efforts, aligning with worldwide efforts to expand green energy sources.

ISA Demonstration Projects (Initiated in 2020)

- Targeted at Least Developed Countries (LDCs) and Small Island Developing States (SIDS).
- Aimed to showcase scalable solar technology applications and build member countries' capacity to implement solar solutions.
- Countries Benefiting from 11 Projects: Bhutan, Burkina Faso, Cambodia, Cuba, Djibouti, Ethiopia, Mauritius, Samoa, Senegal, The Gambia, and Tonga.

Viability Gap Funding (VGF) Scheme

- Proposed funding support between 10% and 35% of a solar project's cost for LDCs and SIDS.
- Countries self-identify solar projects eligible for grants, provided they secure 90% of the project's total cost.

Background of India's "Panchamrit" Pledge at COP26

Key Commitments for Climate Action

At the 2021 COP26 summit, India presented an ambitious "Panchamrit" pledge outlining its commitments to combat climate change. Here are the main goals,

500 GW Non-Fossil Fuel Capacity by 2030

- India aims to achieve a total of 500 gigawatts (GW) of electricity capacity from non-fossil fuel sources by 2030.
- This includes renewable energy sources such as solar, wind, and hydro.

50% of Energy from Renewables by 2030

- India plans to generate half of its total energy requirements from renewable sources by 2030.
- This shift to renewables will reduce reliance on fossil fuels and lower greenhouse gas emissions.

Reduction of 1 Billion Tonnes in Emissions by 2030

- India is committed to reducing its projected total emissions by 1 billion tonnes by 2030.
- This target underscores India's dedication to lowering its carbon footprint over the next decade.

45% Reduction in Emissions Intensity of GDP by 2030

- India aims to decrease the emissions intensity of its GDP by 45% compared to 2005 levels by 2030.
- This target reflects India's goal of achieving economic growth with fewer emissions.

Achieving Net-Zero Emissions by 2070

- India has set a target to reach net-zero emissions by 2070.
- This commitment aligns with global efforts to limit temperature rise and mitigate climate change impacts.

Henley Passport Index 2024 October

In the latest Henley Passport Index released in October 2024, **Singapore** has once again emerged as the world's most powerful passport. This accolade reflects the country's robust global standing and extensive diplomatic relations, granting its citizens **visa-free access** to an impressive **195 countries**. This article delves into the rankings, the methodology behind them, and a comparison with other nations, highlighting the implications for global travel.

Henley Passport Index 2024

Rank	Country	Visa-Free Access
1st	Singapore	195
2nd	France	192
2nd	Germany	192
2nd	Italy	192
2nd	Japan	192
2nd	Spain	192

Rank	Country	Visa-Free Access
3rd	Austria	191
3rd	Denmark	191
3rd	Finland	191
3rd	Ireland	191

Singapore: The Pinnacle of Passport Power

Singapore continues to lead the Henley Passport Index, reinforcing its status as a **global travel powerhouse**. With access to **195 countries** without the need for a visa, Singaporean passport holders enjoy unparalleled travel freedom. This is indicative of Singapore's strong diplomatic ties and its commitment to fostering international relationships.

Second Place Contenders

Following Singapore, **France, Germany, Italy, Japan, and Spain** are tied for the second position. Each of these nations offers their citizens **visa-free access** to **192 countries**. This shared rank illustrates the significance of European nations in the realm of international travel and their strong diplomatic networks.

The United States: A Global Player

In the latest rankings, the **United States** has secured the **8th position**, allowing its citizens **visa-free entry** to **186 countries**. Although still a strong contender, this position reflects a slight decline in its global passport power, highlighting the evolving nature of international relations and travel accessibility.

India's Position

In contrast, **India** ranks **83rd**, providing its citizens with **visa-free access** to **58 countries**. This ranking underscores the challenges that Indian passport holders face in terms of global mobility. However, the growing emphasis on international relations may pave the way for improved access in the future.

The Dominance of Asian Powers

Asian countries have consistently excelled in the Henley Passport Index, with nations like **Japan, Singapore, and South Korea** frequently occupying top positions. This trend reflects the **strong diplomatic relationships** that these nations have cultivated over the years. For example, Japan has maintained its passport strength, allowing citizens extensive travel opportunities, which enhances tourism and global engagement.

Methodology Behind the Rankings

The **Henley Passport Index** employs a meticulous methodology to determine passport rankings. This process involves evaluating several key factors, including:

- Visa-Free Access:** The primary criterion is the number of countries a passport holder can enter without a visa. A higher number indicates greater travel freedom.
- Diplomatic Relations:** The strength of a country's diplomatic ties significantly influences its passport power. Nations with robust international agreements tend to rank higher.

- **International Agreements:** The nature of treaties and agreements with other nations also plays a vital role in determining visa policies, further impacting passport rankings.

The World's Weakest Passports

While some passports grant their holders considerable travel freedom, others offer limited options. The **Henley Passport Index 2024** highlights the least powerful passports, which require holders to obtain visas for most international travel. The countries that rank at the bottom of the index include:

Here is the information presented in a tabular format:

Rank	Country	Visa-Free Access
102nd	Pakistan	33
102nd	Yemen	33
103rd	Iraq	31
104th	Syria	27
105th	Afghanistan	26

Shilp Samagam Mela 2024

The Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment inaugurated the '**Shilp Samagam Mela 2024**' with a grand opening at Dilli Haat, New Delhi. Organized by key Corporations under the Ministry, including the National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation (NSFDC), National Backward Classes Finance and Development Corporation (NBCDFC), and National Safai Karmachari Finance and Development Corporation (NSKFDC).

Objective

- The mela aims to **empower marginalized artisans** by providing a marketplace for their crafts and products, encouraging economic inclusion and cultural promotion.

Opening Ceremony

- Union Minister Dr. Virendra Kumar (Social Justice and Empowerment) declared the fair open.
- Union Minister of State (SJE) Shri B.L. Verma, along with other senior ministry officials, attended the inauguration.

Launch of 'TULIP'

- **Full Form:** Traditional Artisans' Upliftment Livelihood Programme.
- **Purpose:** To support artisans from marginalized communities, including Scheduled Castes (SC), Other Backward Classes (OBC), sanitation workers, and persons with disabilities.
- **Digital Platform:** TULIP provides an e-platform for these artisans to sell their products globally, leveraging e-marketing for broader exposure.

Digital Initiatives Mentioned

PM-SURAKSHA Portal

- A digital portal introduced by Prime Minister Modi, allowing target groups to access subsidized loan schemes.

PM-DAKSH Portal

- An online platform for skill development training aimed at empowering marginalized communities.

Financial Schemes

- **Vishwas Yojana:** Offers financial assistance to SC, BC, and sanitation worker communities.
- **Namaste Yojana:** Provides financial protection to sanitation workers and supports their welfare.

Rang Paridhan Program

- **Objective:** This initiative showcases uniforms crafted by artisans, reinforcing India's cultural heritage.
- **Implementation:** Premier corporations under the Ministry will adopt these artisan-made uniforms for their personnel.

Impact of Schemes

Loan Assistance

- Approximately 5.6 million beneficiaries and their families have accessed loan assistance.

Skill Training

- Over 614,000 young individuals have received skill development training through Ministry initiatives.

Economic Empowerment

- These initiatives aim to economically empower marginalized communities and integrate them into the mainstream economy.

Fair Details

Dates: The mela runs from 5th to 15th November.

Stalls and Participants

- 105 stalls showcase traditional crafts from 16 states.
- Featured crafts include metalwork, wooden artifacts, cane and bamboo items, pottery, handloom products, jewelry, leather goods, and textiles.

Cultural Programs

- Each evening, colorful cultural performances will be held to celebrate India's diverse traditions and artistic expressions.

PM Vidyalaxmi Scheme

The Union Cabinet, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved the **PM-Vidyalaxmi scheme on November 6, 2024**, aimed at providing financial support to meritorious students seeking higher education. The scheme ensures collateral-free, guarantor-free loans for students enrolling in **top 860 Quality Higher Education Institutions (QHEIs)** across India, covering tuition fees and other educational expenses. With an outlay of ₹3,600 crore, this scheme targets to benefit **22 lakh students annually**, empowering them to pursue their academic dreams without financial barriers.

PM-Vidyalaxmi Scheme: Key Features

Eligibility and Loan Coverage: Students admitted to the top 860 QHEIs, including government and private institutions based on NIRF rankings, will be eligible for full education loans covering tuition and course-related expenses.

Loan Amount and Credit Guarantee: Students can avail loans up to ₹7.5 lakh, with a 75% credit guarantee for defaults, providing banks with security in loan disbursement.

Interest Subvention: Students with a family income of up to ₹8 lakh, not availing other government scholarships, will receive a 3% interest subvention on loans up to ₹10 lakh during the moratorium period.

Targeted Beneficiaries: The scheme prioritizes government institution students pursuing technical and professional courses. It is expected to benefit over 7 lakh new students annually, with 1 lakh students receiving interest subvention.

PM-Vidyalaxmi Scheme: Digital Platform for Streamlined Application Process

A unified portal, 'PM-Vidyalaxmi', will facilitate applications for loans and interest subvention, integrating with all banks and offering payments through e-vouchers and CBDC wallets.

PM-Vidyalaxmi Scheme: Empowering India's Youth for a Brighter Future

The scheme aligns with the government's broader vision of making higher education accessible to talented youth, especially from poor and middle-class backgrounds. Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan emphasized that PM-Vidyalaxmi will remove financial obstacles, empowering India's "yuva shakti" to reach their full potential.

Hurun India Philanthropy List 2024

The EdelGive-Hurun India Philanthropy List 2024 reveals an inspiring rise in philanthropic contributions across India. With over 200 philanthropists donating nearly ₹8,783 crore, this year's report reflects an increasing dedication among the nation's wealthiest individuals to drive social change. Here, we examine the top philanthropists, key trends, and the regional impact that showcase the growing importance of individual giving in India's social and economic landscape.

Top 10 Philanthropists in 2024:

Rank	Name	Donation (INR Cr)	Growth (%)	Primary Cause	Company/Foundation
1	Shiv Nadar & Family	2,153	5%	Education	Shiv Nadar Foundation
2	Mukesh Ambani & Family	407	8%	Admission for Disadvantaged Communities	Reliance Foundation
3	Bajaj Family	352	33%	Education for Engineering	Bajaj Group Trust
4	Kumar Mangalam Birla & Family	334	17%	Education	Aditya Birla Capital Foundation
5	Gautam Adani & Family	330	16%	Education for Remote Villages	Adani Foundation
6	Nandan Nilekani	307	62%	Ecosystem Building	Nilekani Philanthropies
7	Krishna Chivukula	228	New	Education	ASHA Foundation
8	Anil Agarwal & Family	181	-25%	Education	Anil Agarwal Foundation
9	Susmita & Subroto Bagchi	179	63%	Public Healthcare	Mindtree
10	Rohini Nilekani	154	-10%	Ecosystem Building	Rohini Nilekani Philanthropies

ISA Launches World Solar Report Series

The **3rd edition of the World Solar Report series** was launched at the **7th Assembly of the International Solar Alliance**, spotlighting key areas in the global transition to sustainable energy. This year's release includes four reports: the World Solar Market Report, World Investment Report, World Technology Report, and Green Hydrogen Readiness Assessment for African Countries.

Release Details

- Launched at the 7th Assembly of the International Solar Alliance (ISA) by Pralhad Joshi, India's Minister for New and Renewable Energy and President of the ISA Assembly.
- First introduced in 2022, this report series provides comprehensive insights into the global solar industry's progress, challenges, and investment trends.

Focus Areas of the Report Series

- The report series covers global solar growth, investment trends, technological advancements, and green hydrogen potential in Africa.
- Comprises four reports, **World Solar Market Report, World Investment Report, World Technology Report, and Green Hydrogen Readiness Assessment for African Countries.**

Individual Reports Summary

World Solar Market Report

Solar Capacity Surge

- Global solar capacity skyrocketed from 1.22 GW in 2000 to 1,418.97 GW in 2023, showing a 40% annual growth rate.
- In 2023, solar power additions accounted for 345.83 GW—75% of all new renewable capacity.

- Solar generation has reached 1,628.27 TWh, a significant increase from 1.03 TWh in 2000.

Manufacturing Capacity

- By the end of 2024, solar manufacturing capacity is projected to exceed 1,100 GW, over twice the anticipated demand.
- Solar cell prices have dropped to \$0.037/watt, and advanced module prices (TOPCon and PERC) are below \$0.10/watt.

Job Creation

- Solar industry jobs reached 7.1 million in 2023, a 44% increase from 4.9 million in 2022. Notably, 86% of these jobs are concentrated in ten countries.

Future Projections

- Global solar capacity may rise to between 5,457 and 7,203 GW by 2030, driven by commitments under the Paris Agreement.

World Investment Report: Shift in Global Energy Investments

Investment Growth

- Global energy investments are projected to grow from \$2.4 trillion in 2018 to \$3.1 trillion by 2024, with a 5% annual growth rate.

Renewables Lead

- Clean energy investments, nearly doubling those in fossil fuels, are expected to rise from \$1.2 trillion in 2018 to \$2 trillion by 2024.

Solar's Investment Dominance

- Solar attracted around 59% (USD 393 billion) of total renewable energy investments (USD 673 billion).

Regional Insights

- APAC led solar investments in 2023, investing USD 223 billion.
- EMEA invested USD 91 billion, and AMER contributed USD 78 billion to solar projects.

World Technology Report: Solar Technology Breakthroughs

Efficiency Advancements

- Monocrystalline solar PV modules have reached a record 24.9% efficiency, enhancing solar power's potential.

Material Innovation

- The manufacturing process now requires 88% less silicon per watt than in 2004, reflecting both efficiency gains and cost reduction potential.

Cost Reductions

- The levelized cost of energy (LCOE) for utility-scale solar PV has dropped by 90% from 2010 to 2023, reaching \$0.044/kWh.
- Country-specific declines in utility-scale PV costs range from 76% to 93%.

Green Hydrogen Readiness Assessment for African Countries

Need for Green Hydrogen

- Direct electrification alone cannot decarbonize industries dependent on fossil fuels, such as steel, fertilizers, and refined fuel production.

Production Process

- Green hydrogen, generated via renewable-powered electrolysis, provides a clean substitute for coal, oil, and gas.

African Potential

- Countries like Egypt, Morocco, and Namibia have been identified for their renewable resource availability, supporting green hydrogen's role in industry decarbonization and job creation.

High-Level Conference on New Technologies for Clean Energy Transition

- Organized by ISA alongside the Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (India), Asian Development Bank (ADB), and the International Solar Energy Society (ISES).
- Aimed at driving real-world impact through dialogue on new-age solar technologies, storage solutions, and solar's role in equitable development.

QS Asia Rankings 2025

The **QS Asia Rankings 2025** recently unveiled by Quacquarelli Symonds (QS) reflect India's significant academic progress on a global scale. With **161 Indian universities** included among the **984 ranked institutions across Asia**, and six institutions making it to the **top 100**, this ranking affirms India's expanding influence in the academic landscape of Asia. Here, we'll explore India's top 10 universities in the QS Asia 2025 rankings, their positions, and the factors contributing to their success.

India's Top 10 Universities in QS Asia Rankings 2025

Here's a closer look at **India's top 10 universities** as per the QS Asia 2025 rankings:

1. **IIT Delhi** – Rank **44**
2. **IIT Bombay** – Rank **48**
3. **IIT Madras** – Rank **56**
4. **IIT Kharagpur** – Rank **60**
5. **Indian Institute of Science (IISc)** – Rank **62**
6. **IIT Kanpur** – Rank **67**
7. **University of Delhi** – Rank **81**
8. **IIT Guwahati** – Rank **104**
9. **IIT Roorkee** – Rank **108**
10. **Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU)** – Rank **110**

IIT Delhi, **IIT Bombay**, and **IIT Madras** stand as India's premier institutions, recognized for their academic standards, research outputs, and reputational impact. Each institute brings unique strengths that contribute to their high rankings, cementing their status as world-class universities.

India in South Asian Rankings: Leading the Region

Among **308 universities across India and Pakistan**, IIT Delhi has emerged as the top institution in the **South Asian category**. With **seven Indian universities** making it to South Asia's **top 10**, India dominates the regional rankings. Notably, **National University of Sciences & Technology (NUST), Islamabad**, shares the **6th position with IIT Kanpur**, indicating healthy regional competition and cooperation within South Asia.

Ranking Parameters: Criteria for QS Asia 2025

QS assesses universities based on a **comprehensive set of metrics** that underscore the strengths of Indian institutions. The key criteria include:

1. **Academic Reputation:** This measures a university's global standing and respect among academics.
2. **Faculty-Student Ratio:** A lower ratio signifies better academic support and mentoring.
3. **Citations per Paper:** Reflects research quality and impact.
4. **Papers per Faculty:** Measures research productivity of faculty members.
5. **International Research Network:** Evaluates the diversity and reach of international collaborations.
6. **Employer Reputation:** Gauges the opinion of employers about the employability of a university's graduates.
7. **Proportion of International Faculty and Students:** Reflects the global diversity at an institution.
8. **Inbound and Outbound Exchange:** Measures exchange programs that promote cross-cultural learning.
9. **Faculty with PhDs:** Evaluates the qualification of teaching staff, indicating their expertise.

Top 5 Rankings– 2025 Top Asian Universities include leading institutions from China, Singapore, and Japan.

- Peking University
- location Beijing, China (Mainland)
- The University of Hong Kong
- location Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR
- National University of Singapore (NUS)
- location Singapore, Singapore
- Nanyang Technological University, Singapore (NTU Singapore)
- location Singapore, Singapore
- Fudan University
- location Shanghai, China (Mainland)



FIH Hockey Stars Awards 2024

The FIH Hockey Star Awards 2024 ceremony, which took place on November 8, 2024, in Muscat, Oman, celebrated the top performers in international hockey. Indian hockey team captain Harmanpreet Singh was named the **Men's Player of the Year**, while legendary goalkeeper PR Sreejesh was awarded the **Men's Goalkeeper of the Year**. The awards are determined by a voting process that includes national team captains, coaches, experts, and fans, as well as media representation.

Harmanpreet Singh – A Historic Year for India

Harmanpreet Singh, regarded as one of the top drag-flickers in modern hockey, was pivotal to India's success at the Paris 2024 Olympics, where India clinched the bronze medal. He finished the tournament as the **top scorer** with 10 goals, a remarkable achievement. Additionally, Harmanpreet led the Indian team to a **gold medal** at the Asian Champions Trophy in September 2024, where he was named **Player of the Tournament**.

Harmanpreet received **63.84% of the votes**, including 15.27% from national associations, 40% from the expert panel, and 13.57% from fans. This is his **third consecutive FIH Player of the Year award**, having previously won the accolade in 2021 and 2022.

PR Sreejesh – The Great Wall of India

PR Sreejesh, widely known as the "Great Wall of India," won the **Goalkeeper of the Year** award for the **third time**, having previously won in 2021 and 2022. He was instrumental in India's dramatic quarter-final victory over Great Britain at the Paris 2024 Olympics, where he played a crucial role after India was reduced to 10 men. In recognition of his contributions to Indian hockey, he received **62.22% of the votes**.

Sreejesh, who announced his retirement after the Paris 2024 Olympics, expressed his gratitude, calling the award "a dream year" and one of the most special accolades in his career.

FIH Hockey Star Awards 2024 – Full List of Winners

Below is the complete list of winners at the FIH Hockey Star Awards 2024:

Award Category	Winner	Country
Men's Player of the Year	Harmanpreet Singh	India
Women's Player of the Year	Yibbi Jansen	Netherlands
Men's Goalkeeper of the Year	PR Sreejesh	India
Women's Goalkeeper of the Year	Ye Jiao	China
Men's Rising Star of the Year	Sufyan Khan	Pakistan
Women's Rising Star of the Year	Zoe Diaz	Argentina
Men's Coach of the Year	Jeroen Delmee	Netherlands
Women's Coach of the Year	Alyson Annan	China
Men's Umpire of the Year	Steve Rogers	Australia
Women's Umpire of the Year	Sarah Wilson	Scotland

COP 29 UNFCCC Baku, Azerbaijan

The **29th UN Climate Summit, COP29, kicked off in Baku, Azerbaijan**, on November 11, 2024, with discussions set to focus on vital climate finance mechanisms, particularly the new **“New Collective Quantified Goal” (NCQG)**. The summit, running until November 22, aims to address urgent global climate issues and secure financial commitments to assist developing nations in combating the devastating effects of climate change, caused largely by greenhouse gas emissions. COP29 has been dubbed the **“Finance COP”** due to its central focus on financial strategies, including a push for greater funding commitments and the role of the private sector in driving climate action.

Financial Commitments and Global Cooperation

COP29’s key agenda is to secure agreements on climate finance, addressing the historic failure to meet previous funding targets. In 2009, developed countries pledged **\$100 billion** annually for climate finance at **COP15 in Copenhagen**, but these commitments have not been fully realized. This year, the focus is on achieving a substantial increase in funding to support developing nations transitioning to clean energy and building resilience to climate impacts. However, critics question who should contribute and how wealthy countries can be held accountable for their promises. The summit also aims to expand adaptation finance to enhance climate resilience in vulnerable countries.

The Role of Carbon Markets and Emission Targets

A critical issue for COP29 is the progress on carbon markets, especially on whether nations can use carbon trading systems to meet their emission reduction targets under the Paris Agreement. Talks on this topic have stalled for years, but some analysts view advancements on carbon trading as essential for accelerating the global shift from fossil fuels. Another significant milestone will be the announcement of updated national emission reduction goals, with countries like Brazil, the UK, and the UAE set to announce new targets during the summit.

The Road Ahead: Urgency and Global Action

COP29 presents a final opportunity for nations to set their emission reduction targets before the February 2025 deadline. With climate impacts intensifying and the need for bold action greater than ever, the summit’s outcome could determine the future trajectory of global climate efforts. Despite the challenges, COP29 is an essential step toward securing the international cooperation necessary to mitigate the climate crisis.

COP summits along with their respective locations

COP Summit	Year	Location
COP1	1995	Berlin, Germany
COP2	1996	Geneva, Switzerland
COP3	1997	Kyoto, Japan
COP4	1998	Buenos Aires, Argentina

COP Summit	Year	Location
COP5	1999	Bonn, Germany
COP6	2000	The Hague, Netherlands
COP7	2001	Marrakech, Morocco
COP8	2002	New Delhi, India
COP9	2003	Milan, Italy
COP10	2004	Buenos Aires, Argentina
COP11	2005	Montreal, Canada
COP12	2006	Nairobi, Kenya
COP13	2007	Bali, Indonesia
COP14	2008	Poznań, Poland
COP15	2009	Copenhagen, Denmark
COP16	2010	Cancun, Mexico
COP17	2011	Durban, South Africa
COP18	2012	Doha, Qatar
COP19	2013	Warsaw, Poland
COP20	2014	Lima, Peru
COP21	2015	Paris, France
COP22	2016	Marrakech, Morocco
COP23	2017	Bonn, Germany
COP24	2018	Katowice, Poland
COP25	2019	Madrid, Spain
COP26	2021	Glasgow, United Kingdom
COP27	2022	Sharm El Sheikh, Egypt
COP28	2023	Dubai, United Arab Emirates
COP29	2024	Baku, Azerbaijan

55th International Film Festival of India

The 55th edition of the International Film Festival of India (IFFI) is set to begin in Panaji, Goa, transforming the city into a vibrant hub of global culture and cinema. Established in 1952, IFFI has become one of Asia's leading film festivals, showcasing diverse storytelling and creativity. The 2024 edition promises an exciting lineup of films, workshops, and a focus on accessibility and inclusivity, offering a platform for filmmakers and audiences alike to engage in cultural exchange.

IFFI 2024: Highlights and Key Themes

The theme of IFFI 2024, **“Young Filmmakers – The Future is Now,”** reflects the importance of youth in shaping the future of cinema. Union Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting, Dr. L. Murugan, praised the festival’s growing international stature, likening it to renowned global festivals such as Cannes. He highlighted the overwhelming response IFFI 2024 received for international film submissions, underscoring the festival’s expanding global impact.

A Diverse Film Lineup

IFFI 2024 boasts **16 curated segments** of films, ensuring that there's something for every film lover. The program features everything from **heartwarming dramas to intense documentaries**, covering every corner of cinema. This year's highlights include **national and international premieres**, giving audiences an exclusive first look at groundbreaking cinematic stories.

The International Cinema Segment

The **International Cinema** section brings together culturally and artistically exceptional films from across the globe. This section maintains IFFI's reputation for showcasing the best in **international cinema**, with films selected by **esteemed experts** from the film industry. The lineup includes some of the **year's top films**, offering a panoramic view of the world through a cinematic lens.

Indian Panorama

The **Indian Panorama** is a hallmark of IFFI, showcasing 25 **Feature Films** and 20 **Non-Feature Films** chosen from hundreds of entries. The feature category includes **five mainstream films**, with the opening film being Swatantrya Veer Savarkar (Hindi), directed by **Randeep Hooda**. The **Non-Feature Films** lineup, opening with Ghar Jaisa Kuch (Ladakhi) by **Harsh Sangani**, reflects contemporary **Indian values** and explores themes unique to India's cultural landscape.

Best Debut Director of Indian Feature Film

IFFI 2024 introduces a new award category, the **Best Debut Director of Indian Feature Film**, dedicated to emerging voices in Indian cinema. The festival will honor **five debut films** by directors from various Indian regions, including:

- Boong (Manipuri) by **Lakshmi Priya Devi**
- Gharat Ganpati (Marathi) by **Navjyot Bandiwadkar**
- Mikka Bannada Hakki (Kannada) by **Manohara K**
- Razakar (Telugu) by **Yata Satyanarayana**
- Thanupp (Malayalam) by **Ragesh Narayanan**

These films bring fresh perspectives and unique narratives from **regional India** to a global audience, reinforcing the importance of diverse voices in Indian cinema.

Celebrating Indian Cinema's Heritage

Centenary Tribute to Indian Cinema Legends

IFFI 2024 pays tribute to **four Indian cinema legends**: actor **Raj Kapoor**, director **Tapan Sinha**, Telugu icon **Akkineni Nageswara Rao (ANR)**, and singer **Mohammed Rafi**. As part of the centenary celebration, restored versions of their classic films will be screened, showcasing the **rich heritage of Indian cinema**. The **National Film Development Corporation (NFDC)** has spearheaded the restoration, preserving these cinematic treasures for future generations.

Special Audio-Visual Presentation

A unique **audio-visual presentation** during the festival's opening ceremony will honor these icons, offering a glimpse into their lives and legacies. This tribute provides newer audiences with an understanding of their impact on Indian cinema and the **cultural significance** of their contributions.

Cultural Exchange: Australia as the Country of Focus

Each year, IFFI shines a spotlight on one country to highlight its contributions to global cinema. In 2024, **Australia** takes center stage, showcasing **seven films** across various genres, from **dramas and thrillers to documentaries** and comedies. These films offer insights into **Australia's cultural diversity**, including stories from its **Indigenous communities** and modern society. This segment underscores the **India-Australia cultural partnership**, reinforced by the **Audio-Visual Co-Production Treaty** signed by the two nations.

Beyond Screenings: Workshops, Masterclasses, and Networking Events

Red Carpet and Glitz of Cinema

IFFI's **Red Carpet event** brings the glamour of the film industry to life, with appearances from **renowned actors, directors, and filmmakers**. This high-profile event celebrates cinema in all its glory, allowing **delegates and fans** to experience the allure of the festival firsthand.

Educational and Networking Opportunities

In addition to screenings, IFFI offers an array of **workshops, masterclasses**, and networking events aimed at cultivating appreciation for filmmaking. The **"Creative Minds of Tomorrow"** segment, **Film Bazaar**, and **Cine Mela** provide a platform for budding talents to engage with industry experts and gain valuable insights into the world of cinema.

Inclusivity and Accessibility at IFFI 2024

IFFI 2024 has taken significant steps toward ensuring **accessibility for all**. Venue modifications, such as **ramps, handrails, tactile pathways, and braille signage**, allow individuals with disabilities to participate fully. The festival's commitment to **inclusivity** is part of India's broader mission to create **barrier-free spaces** for national and international events, allowing everyone to enjoy the magic of cinema.

IFFI's Legacy: A Premier Platform for Global Cinema

Founded in **1952**, the International Film Festival of India is one of **Asia's most prestigious film festivals**. Since **2004**, Goa has served as its permanent home, attracting **filmmakers and cinephiles** from around the globe. Organized by the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting** in collaboration with the **Entertainment Society of Goa**, IFFI has gained accreditation from the **International Federation of Film Producers' Associations (FIAPF)**, cementing its status as one of the world's most respected competitive film festivals.

Following the recent merger of film media units, **NFDC** now manages the event, which continues to strengthen cultural ties and build an **international appreciation for Indian and global cinema**.

G20 Summit 2024 Rio Declaration

The Rio de Janeiro Declaration, released at the G20 Leaders' Summit in Rio de Janeiro on November 18, 2024, emphasizes several core commitments, including the taxation of billionaires, energy transition, and support for global climate initiatives like COP30 in Brazil. This historic declaration marks the culmination of Brazil's presidency, led by President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, who outlined the achievements and progressive themes championed during the summit.

Key Outcomes of the 2024 G20 Summit Highlighted by President Lula

At the closing of the G20 Brasil Leaders' Summit, President Lula emphasized the substantial achievements of Brazil's presidency. These include:

- **Creation of the G20 Social Summit:** A platform dedicated to social issues, aimed at fostering cooperation among member nations.
- **Roadmap for Enhancing Multilateral Development Banks (MDBs):** A strategic guide to reform MDBs for better global financial governance.
- **Focus on Africa and External Debt:** Initiatives to address challenges faced by African nations and reduce external debt burdens.
- **Women's Empowerment Working Group:** Establishment of a dedicated group to advance gender equality and women's rights.
- **Inclusion of SDG 18:** A newly introduced Sustainable Development Goal focusing on ethnic-racial equality.

Emphasis on Trade and Sustainable Development

The declaration outlines principles for **trade and sustainable development**, emphasizing the importance of fair and sustainable trade practices. It also commits to:

- **Increasing Renewable Energy Production:** Pledges to enhance renewable energy output by 2023.
- **Coalition for Local and Regional Production of Vaccines and Medicines:** A coalition to boost healthcare self-sufficiency in developing regions.
- **Investment in Public Policies for Water and Sanitation:** Promoting investments to ensure access to clean water and proper sanitation.

President Lula's Reflections

President Lula highlighted the exhaustive efforts of Brazil's presidency, noting, "We have worked hard, even though we know that we have only scratched the surface of the profound challenges facing the world." He underscored the significance of collaboration between the Sherpa and Finance Tracks, which led to more effective outcomes.

Transition to South Africa's Presidency

As the G20 presidency transitioned to South African President Cyril Ramaphosa, Lula acknowledged the shared cultural, political, and economic ties between Africa and Latin America. He remarked that by 2026, every G20 nation would have held the presidency at least once, stressing, "This is the right time to evaluate the role we have played so far and how we should act from now on."

Focus on Key Themes of the Declaration

Social Inclusion and Poverty Eradication

The **Global Alliance Against Hunger and Poverty** was a major highlight, aimed at eliminating world hunger by 2030. Key points include:

- **Support from Global Leaders and Institutions:** 81 countries, 26 international organizations, 9 financial institutions, and 31 philanthropic foundations have joined this effort.

- **Inauguration Ceremony:** Attended by global leaders, including President Joe Biden, Olaf Scholz, Xi Jinping, and Emmanuel Macron.
- **FAO Statistics:** Lula cited that 733 million people are undernourished in 2024, emphasizing that political decisions, rather than scarcity, perpetuate hunger and poverty.

Climate Action and Energy Transition

Reinforcement of Climate Commitments

The G20 leaders reiterated their commitments to the **Paris Agreement** and the pursuit of carbon neutrality. They emphasized:

- **Mobilization Against Climate Change:** Urgent actions needed to meet climate targets, with an emphasis on public and private green financing.
- **Support for COP30:** Endorsement of **COP30, set to be held in Belém, Brasil, in 2025**, and ongoing negotiations at COP29 in Baku, Azerbaijan.
- **New Quantified Collective Objective for Climate Financing (NCQG):** A goal to enhance climate financing mechanisms.

Energy Transition Measures

The declaration stressed:

- **Investment in Developing Countries:** Support for fair and sustainable energy transitions in the Global South.
- **Phasing Out Fossil Fuel Subsidies:** Commitment to eliminating inefficient subsidies while promoting renewable energy.
- **Clean and Sustainable Energy Initiatives:** Efforts to drive energy transitions in line with environmental sustainability.

Global Governance Reform

Strengthening International Institutions

The declaration calls for comprehensive reform in global governance, including:

- **Modernization of the United Nations:** Enhancing the UN's ability to address global crises.
- **International Financial System Reform:** Advocating for a more inclusive and resilient financial architecture.
- **Inclusive Multilateral Trading System:** Promoting fair trade policies to benefit all nations.
- **Ethical Development of Artificial Intelligence:** Guidelines to ensure that AI advancements align with global ethical standards.

Addressing Inequality and Promoting Racial Equality

New Initiatives to Combat Inequality

For the first time, the G20 committed to addressing racial inequality, through:

- **Progressive Taxation Policies:** Advocating for the taxation of billionaires to redistribute wealth and reduce inequality.
- **Mobilizing Resources for Basic Sanitation:** Investments aimed at ensuring access to clean water and proper sanitation.

- **Support for Ethnic-Racial Equality:** Introducing measures to combat racism and promote social cohesion.

Establishment of the Global Alliance Against Hunger and Poverty

Alliance Objectives and Framework

The **Global Alliance** aims to fast-track progress toward the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) by 2030. Key features include:

- **Country-Driven and Evidence-Based Programs:** Encouraging nations to tailor solutions to their unique challenges.
- **Knowledge Exchange and International Cooperation:** Facilitating collaboration among governments, NGOs, and financial entities.
- **Policy Tools and Instruments:** A set of rigorously evaluated strategies to guide nations in eradicating hunger.

Alliance Portal

The dedicated website provides comprehensive resources, including:

- **Event Agendas and News Updates:** Information on meetings and developments.
- **Participation Guidelines:** How countries and organizations can join the Alliance.
- **Policy Programs:** Tools available to adapt to local contexts for impactful results.

Global Initiative for Information Integrity on Climate Change

Addressing Climate Disinformation

This initiative, emerging from the G20 discussions, targets climate denialism and disinformation. It focuses on:

- **Collaboration Among Countries and Researchers:** Strengthening global efforts to counter false narratives on climate change.
- **Funding Research and Strategic Actions:** Collecting data to support informed decision-making and communication strategies.
- **Support for COP30:** Ensuring accurate information dissemination to bolster climate action ahead of the 2025 conference.

President Lula concluded, "Countries cannot tackle this problem individually. This initiative will bring together countries, international organizations, and networks of researchers to support joint efforts to combat disinformation."

Brazil, UN, and UNESCO Launch Global Initiative for Information Integrity on Climate Change

- Brazil, in collaboration with the United Nations (UN) and UNESCO, has launched the Global Initiative for Information Integrity on Climate Change.
- The initiative aims to tackle disinformation affecting climate change actions, financing research, and spreading accurate climate-related information.
- The initiative is supported by an initial fund target of \$10 to \$15 million, raised over 36 months and managed by UNESCO.

Fundraising and Use of Grants

- Funds will be raised with the participation of several countries, including confirmed partners like Chile, Denmark, France, Morocco, the United Kingdom, and Sweden.
- The fund will distribute grants to non-governmental organizations (NGOs) focusing on:
 - Conducting research on climate information integrity.
 - Developing effective communication strategies.
 - Running public awareness campaigns about climate change.

Global Support and Commitment

- UN Secretary-General António Guterres emphasized the need to combat disinformation, including denial, greenwashing, and harassment of climate scientists.
- UNESCO Director-General Audrey Azoulay highlighted the importance of reliable information, supporting journalists and researchers who face risks while investigating climate issues.
- The initiative aligns with the Global Digital Compact, promoting assessments of disinformation's impact on achieving Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Sustainability and Climate Change Action

- The Declaration demands firm commitments to reducing greenhouse gas emissions, preventing deforestation, and protecting oceans.
- It stresses that adaptation and mitigation strategies must respect scientific knowledge and indigenous wisdom.
- Efforts must be aligned with Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC) and the Paris Agreement to keep warming below 1.5°C.

Just Transition Principles

- The just transition framework emphasizes replacing fossil fuels with a low-carbon economy, addressing social and environmental disparities.
- The proposal calls for extensive environmental education and social participation to empower communities.
- Special focus is given to energy poverty, environmental racism, and providing equitable opportunities for workers.

Conservation Efforts and Financial Mechanisms

- The **Tropical Forest Forever Fund (TFFF)** is proposed to finance forest conservation and support local communities.
- A **New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG)** on climate finance is recommended to secure ongoing support for biodiversity and climate resilience.

Tax Justice and Funding Reforms

Progressive Taxation of the Super-Rich

- Social movements advocate for progressive taxes on the wealthiest individuals to fund social and environmental initiatives.
- Funds must be transparently managed and involve civil society in oversight to ensure effective use.

Commitment to Inclusive Global Solutions

- The Declaration concludes with a call for transformative leadership, urging G20 heads of state to address climate change, hunger, and governance reforms.
- Civil society representatives highlight the essential role of inclusive and participatory governance in shaping a sustainable and equitable world.

ALTT EFF 2024 Film Festival

The **All Living Things Environmental Film Festival (ALT EFF)** returns to Mumbai for its 2024 edition, running from **November 22 to December 8 at Liberty Cinema**. Since its inception in 2020, ALT EFF has become a significant platform for environmental storytelling, bringing global issues of sustainability and climate change to the forefront through cinema. The festival is expanding its reach, with screenings in over **70 cities across India**, including villages, fostering a wider conversation on environmental challenges.

A Growing Platform for Environmental Storytelling

ALT EFF was launched in Panchgani, Maharashtra, and quickly grew into India's leading environmental film festival, screening over **50 films annually**. It features a mix of international and Indian films across genres like documentaries, fiction, and animated films, all exploring themes such as climate change, biodiversity, and sustainability. The festival's hybrid format includes both in-person and virtual screenings to maximize its impact.

Notable Partnerships and Film Highlights

Prominent figures like Bollywood actor Jackie Shroff, serving as the brand ambassador, and acclaimed director Richie Mehta, who advocates for environmental consciousness, support the festival. Notable films this year include **Poacher (directed by Richie Mehta)**, focusing on illegal wildlife trade, and **The Last Forest**, a documentary on India's indigenous tribes fighting deforestation. These films highlight the intersection of human activity and environmental destruction, encouraging activism and reflection.

A Vision for Change Through Cinema

Kunal Khanna, co-founder and festival director, emphasizes the festival's mission to make environmental films accessible to people across India. With his experience in sustainability policies from his time in Australia, Khanna advocates for climate justice and highlights critical issues like marine life, indigenous cultures, and the cost of capitalism. The festival not only entertains but also sparks conversations, inspiring audiences to reflect on their own roles in addressing climate change.

ALT EFF (All Living Things Environmental Film Festival)

Inception & Growth: Launched in 2020 in Panchgani, Maharashtra, ALT EFF has grown into India's leading environmental film festival.

Dates & Location: The 2024 edition takes place from November 22 to December 8 at Liberty Cinema in Mumbai.

Film Selection: Screens approximately 50 films annually, blending Indian and international works focused on environmental and socio-ecological issues.

Festival Format: Hybrid approach with both in-person screenings and virtual events.

Themes: Covers climate change, biodiversity, conservation, sustainability, and the impact of human activity.

Prominent Figures: Actor Jackie Shroff is the brand ambassador; director Richie Mehta is an advocate for environmental consciousness.

Notable Films: Highlights include *Poacher* (on illegal wildlife trade) and *The Last Forest* (on indigenous tribes defending the environment).

Reach & Accessibility: Expands to over 70 cities across India, including 30+ villages, making the festival accessible to diverse communities.

Vision: Aims to inspire environmental activism and spark meaningful conversations on climate justice through cinema.

PM Modi Receives Highest Honors from Guyana and Dominica

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has been conferred prestigious awards by Guyana and Dominica in recognition of his significant contributions during the COVID-19 pandemic, as well as his efforts in strengthening international ties, especially between India and these Caribbean nations. These awards highlight the deepening diplomatic relations and the global recognition of Modi's leadership in global health, climate resilience, and development cooperation.

Guyana's 'The Order of Excellence' Award

- PM Modi was awarded 'The Order of Excellence,' Guyana's highest honor, by President Irfaan Ali.
- The award acknowledges his exceptional contributions during the COVID-19 pandemic and his global leadership.
- Modi dedicated the honor to the people of India, highlighting the long-standing ties between India and Guyana.
- The award emphasizes the strengthening of India-Guyana relations, with Modi's visit seen as a testament to India's commitment to these ties.

Dominica's 'Award of Honour'

- Modi was also conferred the 'Dominica Award of Honour' by President Sylvanie Burton of Dominica.
- The award recognizes Modi's leadership and India's support during the COVID-19 pandemic, including the provision of 70,000 AstraZeneca vaccines to Dominica.
- Modi dedicated the award to the people of India and emphasized the unbreakable bond between India and Dominica, especially in times of crisis.
- Dominica's Prime Minister Roosevelt Skerrit praised Modi for his global partnership and South-South collaboration, recognizing the enduring legacy of his leadership.

Recognition of Global Leadership

- Both awards highlight Modi's statesmanship, resilience in the face of global challenges, and commitment to human solidarity.
- Modi's actions during the pandemic, particularly the provision of vaccines and other forms of support, are central to the recognition by both nations.
- The awards reflect shared values between India, Guyana, and Dominica, such as democracy, resilience, and unity in addressing global issues like climate change and sustainable development.

Future Implications

- These awards **underscore the growing influence of India in global diplomacy, particularly in the Caribbean and South-South cooperation.**
- Modi's contributions to **healthcare, education, and climate resilience** have strengthened India's global standing and bilateral ties with these nations.

Upcoming Recognition

- Barbados is set to confer its top award on Modi, bringing his international awards tally to 19.

Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar For 2022 and 2023

The **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar (UBKUP)** is a prestigious award instituted by the **Sangeet Natak Akademi** in 2006 to honor outstanding young performing artists across India. Named after Bharat Ratna **Ustad Bismillah Khan**, the award aims to encourage and motivate young practitioners in music, dance, drama, folk and tribal arts, puppetry, and other performing arts.

On **22nd November 2024**, **Union Minister of Culture and Tourism, Shri Gajendra Singh Shekhawat**, will confer the awards for the years **2022 and 2023** in a special ceremony at the **Dr. Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi**. The ceremony will be presided over by **Dr. Sandhya Purecha**, Chairman of Sangeet Natak Akademi, and **Smt. Uma Nanduri**, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Culture.

About the Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar

- Instituted in:** 2006
- Eligibility:** Artists up to the age of 40 years.
- Purpose:** To recognize and motivate young talent in the performing arts and promote India's rich cultural heritage.

Award Components

- Cash Prize:** ₹25,000/-
- Plaque**
- Angavastram**

The award is conferred annually to celebrate the exceptional contribution of young artists in preserving and innovating traditional and modern performing arts.

Awards Ceremony and Post-Event Highlights

Award Ceremony Details

- Date and Time:** 22nd November 2024, 11 A.M.
- Venue:** Dr. Ambedkar International Centre, Janpath, New Delhi

Presided by

- Dr. Sandhya Purecha, Chairman, Sangeet Natak Akademi
- Smt. Uma Nanduri, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Culture

Performing Arts Festival

The award ceremony will be followed by a **festival of performing arts** featuring the awardees.

- Dates:** 22nd–26th November 2024
- Venues:**
 - Meghdoot Theatre Complex**, Rabindra Bhawan, Copernicus Marg, New Delhi
 - Abhimanch Theatre**, National School of Drama, Bhawalpur House, New Delhi
 - Vivekanand Auditorium**, Kathak Kendra, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi

Significance of the Award

The **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar** plays a pivotal role in preserving India's diverse artistic traditions and promoting innovation within traditional frameworks. The award ensures that young artists are recognized and supported for their efforts in showcasing India's cultural richness globally.

Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar recipients for 2022 and 2023:

Year	Field of Activity	Name	Specialization
2022	Music	Samit Mallick	Hindustani Vocal
		Samarth Janve	Hindustani Vocal
		Sangeet Mishra	Hindustani Instrumental – Sarangi
		Partho Roy Choudhury	Hindustani Instrumental – Santoor
		K. Gayatri	Carnatic Vocal
		I. Sweta Prasad	Carnatic Vocal
		B. Anantha Krishnan	Carnatic Instrumental – Violin
		Sahana S.V	Carnatic Instrumental – Veena
		Manoj Rai	Creative & Experimental Music
		Nandini Rao Gujar	Other Major Traditions of Music (Sugam Sangeet)

Year	Field of Activity	Name	Specialization
	Dance	Mandakranta Roy	Bharatanatyam
		Kadam Parikh	Kathak
		Urmika Maibam	Manipuri
		T. Reddi Lakshmi	Kuchipudi
		Arupa Gayatri Panda	Odissi
		Dimpee Baishya	Sattriya
		Akshara M Das	Mohiniattam
		Pradyumna Kumar Mohanta	Chhau
		Mingma D. Lepcha	Creative & Experimental Dance
		Aparna Nangiar	Nangiarkoothu
	Theatre	Beluru Raghunandan	Playwriting
		Ifra Mushtaq Kak	Direction
		Harishankar Ravi	Direction
		Harwinder Singh	Acting
		Kumar Ravikant	Acting
		Siddhi Upadhye	Acting
		Mukunda Nath	Mime
		Sangeet Shrivastava	Allied Theatre Arts – Lighting
	Traditional/Folk/Tribal and Puppetry	Lata Tiwari & Sanjay Datt Panday	Folk Music & Dance (Uttarakhand)
		Chow Saratham Namchoom	Folk Music (Arunachal Pradesh)
		Sampriya Pooja	Folk Music & Dance (Chhattisgarh)
		Suryawanshi Pramila Kautikrao	Folk Dance Lavani (Maharashtra)
		Kumar Uday Singh	Folk Dance (Bihar)
		Nasarullah EPI	Folk Dance (Lakshadweep)
		Binita Devi	Puppetry (Assam)
		Mahesh Aba Satarkar	Folk Dance (Goa)
		Vasava Mukeshbhai M.	Folk Dance (Gujarat)
		Gulzar Ahmad Bhat	Folk Dance (Jammu & Kashmir)
		Moirangthem Kendra Singh	Nata Sankirtan (Manipur)
	Overall Contribution	Anuthama Murali	Overall Contribution in Performing Arts
2023	Music	Anuja Zokarkar	Hindustani Vocal
		Monika Soni	Hindustani Vocal
		Rishi Shankar Upadhyay	Hindustani Instrumental – Pakhawaj
		Sarang Rajan Kulkarni	Hindustani Instrumental – Sarod
		S. R. Vinay Sharva	Carnatic Vocal
		Ramakrishnan Murthy	Carnatic Vocal
		Akshay Anantapadmanabhan	Carnatic Instrumental – Mridangam
		Saikhom Pinky Devi	Creative & Experimental Music
		Satyavathi Mudavath	Creative & Experimental Music
		Nagesh Shankarrao Adgaonkar	Other Major Traditions of Music (Abhang)
	Dance	Apoorva Jayaraman	Bharatanatyam
		Meghranjani Medhi	Kathak
		Kalamandalam Vipin Sankar	Kathakali

Year	Field of Activity	Name	Specialization
		Pukhrambam Reepa Devi	Manipuri
		Muramalla Surendra Nadh	Kuchipudi
		Debasis Pattnaik	Odissi
		Mukunda Saikia Barbayan	Sattriya
		Vidya Pradeep	Mohiniattam
		Sunita Mahato	Chhau
		Venkateshwaran Kuppuswamy	Music for Dance
	Theatre	Priyadarshini Mishra	Playwriting
		Bendang Walling	Direction
		Suvojit Bandyopadhyay	Direction
		Rutuja Rajan Bagwe	Acting
		Vipan Kumar	Acting
		Shruti Singh	Acting
		Mallikarjuna Rao Bachala	Allied Theatre Arts – Make-up
		Puneet Dimari & Amit Khanduri	Ramleela (Uttarakhand)
	Traditional/Folk/Tribal and Puppetry	Angadi Bhaskar	Dappalu (Telangana)
		Alok Bishoyi	Folk Dance & Music (Odisha)
		M. Prakash	Folk Dance (Puducherry)
		Padma Dolker	Folk Music & Dance (Ladakh)
		Sukhram Pahan	Folk Music (Jharkhand)
		Yusuf Khan Mewati Jogi	Folk Music (Rajasthan)
		Kalamandalam Ravisankar T S	Folk Instrument (Chenda, Kerala)
		Dixit Kushal Manvantray	Folk Dance (Gujarat)
		Priyanka Shakti Thakur	Traditional Music (Maharashtra)
		Anureet Pal Kaur	Folk Music (Punjab)
		Charu Sharma	Folk Music (Himachal Pradesh)
	Overall Contribution	Laxminarayan Jena	Overall Contribution in Performing Arts

116th PM Man Ki Baat

This comprehensive speech from Mann Ki Baat touches upon various inspiring themes, initiatives, and the spirit of collective efforts in India. Here's a summary of its key highlights:

1. Youth Empowerment and NCC (National Cadet Corps):

- Celebrating NCC Day, the PM emphasized the transformative impact of NCC on youth, instilling discipline, leadership, and service.
- NCC's reach has expanded to over 20 lakh cadets, with a significant increase in girl cadets (40%).
- A call for maximum youth participation in NCC for personality development and nation-building.

2. 'Vikasit Bharat Young Leaders Dialogue':

- Scheduled for 11-12 January 2024 at Bharat Mandapam, Delhi, coinciding with Swami Vivekananda's 162nd birth anniversary.

- An initiative to gather 2,000 youth leaders from across India to present ideas for India's development, inspiring new participation in politics and leadership.

3. Digital Inclusion:

- Examples of young changemakers like Virendra (Lucknow) and Mahesh (Bhopal) aiding elderly citizens with Digital Life Certificates and digital payments.
- Awareness campaigns against cyber fraud like "Digital Arrest" scams.

4. Libraries and Education:

- Creative libraries like Prakrith Arivagam (Chennai) and others in Bihar and Hyderabad are fostering a love for books among children and aiding competitive exam preparation.
- Libraries are becoming hubs for creativity and social transformation.

5. Indian Diaspora and History:

- The Indian diaspora's contributions in countries like Guyana and Oman are being documented through projects preserving their historical and cultural legacies.
- The PM invited citizens to share stories of Indian immigrants with #IndianDiasporaStories.

6. 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' Campaign:

- Over 100 crore trees planted in just five months under this campaign, now gaining international traction.
- Stories of remarkable contributions, such as 12 lakh trees planted in 24 hours in Indore and unique women-led efforts in Rajasthan.

7. Sparrow Conservation:

- Campaigns like Kudugal Trust in Chennai and Early Bird in Mysuru are promoting biodiversity and reviving the sparrow population, engaging children creatively.

8. Cleanliness and Sustainability:

- A special Swachhata Abhiyan has led to clutter-free government offices and waste-to-wealth innovations.
- Examples include Akshara and Prakriti from Mumbai creating fashion items from fabric scraps and Kanpur's Ploggers Group converting garbage into tree guards.

Key Messages:

- The PM underscored the importance of youth in shaping a developed India.
- Citizens were encouraged to take proactive roles in conservation, sustainability, digital inclusion, and cultural preservation.
- Collective efforts and creativity were celebrated as powerful tools for transformation.

This episode is a testament to how grassroots initiatives, guided by inspired leadership, are creating significant impact across India.

Times Higher Education (THE) Interdisciplinary Science Rankings 2024

India has made great progress in global university rankings, especially in **Interdisciplinary Science**, as shown in the **Times Higher Education (THE) Interdisciplinary Science Rankings 2025**. This ranking highlights universities that are leading the way in **research** and **collaboration** across different subjects to tackle global challenges like **climate change**, **health issues**, and **technology developments**.

Why This is Important for India

India has emerged as the **most represented country** in the rankings, with **65 Indian universities** making it to the list. This reflects India's growing role in **interdisciplinary research**, where universities bring together knowledge from different fields to solve complex issues.

Top Indian Universities in the Interdisciplinary Science Rankings 2025

The following table shows the top Indian universities ranked in the **Interdisciplinary Science Rankings 2025**. Indian universities are recognized for their research output, reputation, and focus on addressing global problems.

Rank	University
42	Anna University
65	VIT University
84	SRM Institute of Science and Technology
92	KIIT University
98	University of Delhi
99	Lovely Professional University
101	Amity University, Noida
102	Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences
103	Jamia Millia Islamia
105	Jawaharlal Nehru University

Top Global Universities in the Interdisciplinary Science Rankings 2025

The rankings also feature universities from across the world, including the **United States** and **Singapore**, which continue to lead the field of interdisciplinary research.

Rank	University	Country
1	Massachusetts Institute of Technology	United States
2	Stanford University	United States
3	National University of Singapore	Singapore
4	California Institute of Technology	United States
5	Duke University	United States
6	University of Minnesota	United States
7	Wageningen University & Research	Netherlands
8	University of California, Santa Barbara	United States
9	Nanyang Technological University	Singapore
10	University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	United States

India's Growing Role in Global Academia

India is becoming a key player in global academic research, with many universities focusing on **interdisciplinary studies**. This involves combining **engineering**, **life sciences**, **computer science**, and other fields to solve important challenges like **healthcare**, **environmental sustainability**, and **technology innovation**.

Cabinet Approves PAN 2.0 Project

The **Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)**, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the **PAN 2.0 Project**, an upgrade of the current **PAN/TAN system**, with a financial **outlay of ₹1,435 crore**. The project aims to streamline and digitize the PAN services, enhancing taxpayer registration and service delivery. PAN 2.0 is a part of the government's Digital India vision, which focuses on improving the digital infrastructure and making the PAN a common identifier across various government systems.

Key Features of PAN 2.0

Seamless Transition: There is no need for existing PAN holders to reapply, as the current PAN cards remain valid.

Digitization: Introduction of QR codes on PAN cards and significant upgrades to infrastructure for better security and user experience.

Improved Efficiency: The system promises faster service delivery, enhanced data consistency, and eco-friendly operations by minimizing paper use.

Centralized Ecosystem: Consolidation of core and non-core PAN/TAN activities for smoother operation and improved validation services.

Impact on Taxpayers

No Reapplication Needed: Current PAN cards will remain valid, and there is no need for taxpayers to reapply for a new card.

Enhanced User Experience: The digital transformation ensures quicker processing, increased security, and better integration across various government services, making the PAN a unified digital business identifier.

Free of Cost: The upgrades, including the addition of a QR code, will be provided free of charge to taxpayers.

55th International Film Festival of India 2024

The 55th International Film Festival of India (IFFI) came to a magnificent conclusion on **28th November 2024** at the **Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Indoor Stadium, Goa**, marking the end of a nine-day celebration of global and Indian cinema. The closing ceremony honored cinematic excellence, promoted creative dialogue, and celebrated young and seasoned filmmakers from across the globe.

Key Highlights from the Closing Ceremony

1. Golden Peacock Award: Best Film

The prestigious **Golden Peacock Award for Best Feature Film** was awarded to the Lithuanian film **"Toxic"**, directed by **Saulė Bliuvaitė**. The film, a coming-of-age narrative, received high praise for its sensitive portrayal of friendship and adolescence in a struggling socio-economic environment.

2. Silver Peacock Awards

- **Best Director:** **Bogdan Muresanu** for **The New Year That Never Came** (Romania).
- **Best Actor (Male):** **Clément Faveau** for **Holy Cow** (France).
- **Best Actor (Female):** Jointly awarded to **Vesta Matulytė** and **Ieva Rupeikaitė** for **Toxic** (Lithuania).

3. Special Jury Award

French filmmaker **Louise Courvoisier** received the **Special Jury Award** for her film **Holy Cow**.

4. ICFT-UNESCO Gandhi Medal

The Georgian film **"Crossing"** by **Levan Akin** was honored for promoting peace and non-violence.

5. Best Debut Film

The award for **Best Debut Feature Film** was won by **Sarah Friedland** for **Familiar Touch** (USA).

Honouring Indian Talent

1. Best Debut Director of an Indian Feature Film

The newly introduced award for Best Debut Director of Indian Feature Film went to **Navjyot Bandiwadkar** for the Marathi film **Gharat Ganpati**. This recognition highlights IFFI's commitment to encouraging emerging Indian filmmakers.

2. Best Web Series (OTT)

The Best Web Series (OTT) award was presented to the Marathi series **"Lampan"**, directed by **Nipun Dharmadhikari**.

3. Indian Film Personality of the Year

Actor **Vikrant Massey** was honored with the Indian Film Personality of the Year Award for his exceptional contributions to Indian cinema.

Lifetime Achievement and Special Felicitations

1. Satyajit Ray Lifetime Achievement Award

Australian filmmaker **Phillip Noyce** received the **Satyajit Ray Lifetime Achievement Award**, recognizing his outstanding contributions to global cinema.

2. Special Felicitations

Veteran Indian filmmaker **Ramesh Sippy** and celebrated actress **Jaya Prada** were felicitated for their remarkable contributions to Indian cinema.

Voices from the Ceremony

Chief Minister of Goa, Pramod Sawant

"The festival has placed Goa on the global map as a hub for cinema. Initiatives like Film Bazaar have attracted international filmmakers, and we assure seamless support for shooting in Goa."

Secretary, Ministry of I&B, Sanjay Jaju

"This IFFI has been the most vibrant, celebrating young filmmakers and creative talents. The future of Indian cinema is brighter than ever."

Complete Winners List

Award	Winner	Film/Project	Country
Golden Peacock (Best Film)	Saulė Bliuvaitė	Toxic	Lithuania
Silver Peacock (Best Director)	Bogdan Muresanu	The New Year That Never Came	Romania
Silver Peacock (Best Actor – Male)	Clément Faveau	Holy Cow	France
Silver Peacock (Best Actor – Female)	Vesta Matulytė, Ieva Rupeikaitė	Toxic	Lithuania
Special Jury Award	Louise Courvoisier	Holy Cow	France
Best Debut Feature Film	Sarah Friedland	Familiar Touch	USA
Best Debut Director of Indian Film	Navjyot Bandiwadkar	Gharat Ganpati	India
ICFT-UNESCO Gandhi Medal	Levan Akin	Crossing	Georgia
Best Web Series (OTT)	Nipun Dharmadhikari	Lampan	India
Indian Film Personality of the Year	Vikrant Massey	—	India

Most Important Current Affairs of December 2024

Women-Centric Welfare Schemes in FY25: Key Allocations and Initiatives

In FY25, women-centric welfare schemes collectively account for **0.5% of India's GDP**, reflecting their growing prominence in state policies and national budgets. Maharashtra leads with the largest allocation of **\$5.4 billion (1.1% of its GDP)**, while nine states collectively allocate \$18 billion for such initiatives. These schemes, including cash transfers and developmental programs, have emerged as pivotal political tools to attract women voters, as seen in Maharashtra's "**Ladki Bahin Yojana**," a significant factor in the BJP-led coalition's electoral success. Haryana proposes the highest monthly cash transfer at **₹2,100 for eligible women, impacting 1.7% of its GDP**, the highest among states.

Key State-Level Initiatives

Top Allocators: Haryana, Karnataka, and West Bengal allocate substantial budgets, with schemes ranging from ₹1,000 to ₹2,100 monthly cash transfers.

Economic Impact: Haryana's scheme is projected to cost 1.7% of its GDP, while Delhi and Tamil Nadu see minimal economic strain at 0.2% and 0.4%, respectively.

Precedents: Assam (2020) and West Bengal (2021) pioneered these initiatives, with West Bengal spending \$1.7 billion (0.8% of its GDP).

National Schemes for Women Empowerment

Safety and Support: One Stop Centres (Sakhi Centres) and Women Helplines provide integrated support for violence survivors.

Rehabilitation Initiatives: The Swadhar Greh and Ujjawala Schemes assist women in distress and victims of trafficking.

Accommodation and Childcare: The Working Women Hostel Scheme offers safe housing and day-care facilities for employed women.

Education and Equality: The Beti Bachao Beti Padhao program addresses declining child sex ratios and promotes education for girls.

Community Empowerment: The Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme fosters rural women's empowerment through inter-sectoral convergence.

Maternity Benefits and Umbrella Initiatives

PMMVY: This conditional cash transfer scheme provides ₹6,000 to eligible mothers for nutritional and health needs during pregnancy and lactation.

Mission Shakti: An integrated program for women's safety, security, and empowerment through convergence across governance levels and enhanced digital infrastructure.

Past and Present Context

The evolution of women-centric schemes underscores a shift from standalone welfare to integrated empowerment models. States have adopted diverse strategies with varying fiscal impacts, reflecting a balance between voter engagement and developmental goals. At the national level, initiatives aim to mainstream women's participation in governance and nation-building, marking a transition toward sustainable, inclusive growth.

Filmfare OTT Awards 2024 Celebrating Digital Excellence

The 5th edition of the Filmfare OTT Awards 2024 was a grand celebration of the best in digital entertainment. The event highlighted the outstanding contributions from **both films and series in the OTT space**, with notable achievements in various categories.



Key Highlights of Filmfare OTT Awards 2024

Category	Award	Winner
Series Category	Best Series	The Railway Men
	Best Director Series	Sameer Saxena and Amit Golani (Kaala Paani)
	Best Actor, Series (Male): Comedy	Rajkumar Rao (Guns & Gulaabs)
	Best Actor, Series (Male): Drama	Gagan Dev Riar (Scam 2003 – The Telgi Story)
	Best Actor, Series (Female): Comedy	Geetanjali Kulkarni (Gullak Season 4)
	Best Actor, Series (Female): Drama	Manisha Koirala (Heeramandi: The Diamond Bazaar)
	Best Supporting Actor, Series (Female): Comedy	Nidhi Bisht (Maamla Legal Hai)
	Best Supporting Actor, Series (Female): Drama	Mona Singh (Made In Heaven Season 2)
	Best Original Story, Series	Biswapati Sarkar (Kaala Paani)
	Best Comedy (Series/Specials)	Maamla Legal Hai
	Best (Non-Fiction) Original (Series/Special)	The Hunt For Veerappan
	Best Dialogue, Series	Sumita Arora (Guns & Gulaabs)
	Best Production Design, Series	Subrata Chakraborty and Amit Ray (Heeramandi: The Diamond Bazaar)
	Best Debut Director, Series	Shiv Rawail (The Railway Men)
Films Category	Best Film, Web Original	Amar Singh Chamkila
	Best Director, Web Original Film	Imtiaz Ali (Amar Singh Chamkila)
	Best Actor, Web Original Film (Male)	Diljit Dosanjh (Amar Singh Chamkila)
	Best Actor, Web Original Film (Female)	Kareena Kapoor (Jaane Jaan)
	Best Supporting Actor, Web Original Film (Male)	Jaideep Ahlawat (Maharaj)
	Best Supporting Actor, Web Original Film (Female)	Wamiqa Gabbi (Khufiya)
	Best Dialogue (Web Original Film)	Imtiaz Ali and Sajid Ali (Amar Singh Chamkila)

Category	Award	Winner
	Best Cinematographer (Web Original Film)	Sylvester Fonseca (Amar Singh Chamkila)
	Best Production Design (Web Original Film)	Suzanne Caplan Merwanji (The Archies)
	Best Editing (Web Original Film)	Aarti Bajaj (Amar Singh Chamkila)
	Best Background Music (Web Original Film)	A R RAHMAN (Amar Singh Chamkila)
	Best Story (Web Original Film)	Zoya Akhtar, Arjun Varain Singh, Reema Kagti (Kho Gaye Hum Kahan)
	Best Music Album, Film	A R RAHMAN (Amar Singh Chamkila)
	Best Debut Director, Film	Arjun Varain Singh (Kho Gaye Hum Kahan)
	Best Debut Male, Film	Vedang Raina
Critics Category	Best Series, Critics	Guns & Gulaabs
	Best Director, Critics	Mumbai Diaries Season 2
	Best Actor, Series (Male), Critics: Drama	Kay Kay Menon (Bambai Meri Jaan)
	Best Actor, Series (Female), Critics: Drama	Huma Qureshi (Maharani S03)
	Best Film, Critics	Jaane Jaan
	Best Actor (Male), Critics – Film	Jaideep Ahlawat
	Best Actor (Female), Critics – Film	Ananya Panday
	Special Recognition	Arjun Varain Singh (Kho Gaye Hum Kahan)

Banking Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024 Set To Introduce in the Lok Sabha

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman is set to introduce the **Banking Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024 in the Lok Sabha** on 2nd December, 2024. The bill aims to amend several key banking-related legislations, including the **Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, the **Banking Regulation Act, 1949**, the **State Bank of India Act, 1955**, and the **Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) Acts of 1970 and 1980**. The amendments are expected to enhance the functioning and regulation of the banking sector, and the bill will be considered for debate and passage in the lower house of Parliament.

Key Amendments in the Banking Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024

1. Definition of Fortnight for Cash Reserves

Current Definition

- The RBI Act defines a "fortnight" as the period from Saturday to the second following Friday (including both days) to calculate the average daily balance held by scheduled banks as cash reserves.

Proposed Amendment

The Bill changes the definition of a "fortnight" to:

- The period from the 1st day to the 15th day of each month, and
- The period from the 16th day to the last day of each month.

Impact

- This change also applies under the Banking Regulation Act, where non-scheduled banks are required to maintain cash reserves.

2. Tenure of Directors of Co-operative Banks

Current Rule

- Directors of co-operative banks (except the chairman or whole-time directors) **cannot hold office for more than eight consecutive years.**

Proposed Amendment

- The Bill seeks to increase the tenure for directors of co-operative **banks to 10 consecutive years.**

Impact

- This extension is expected to provide stability in the governance of co-operative banks.

3. Prohibition on Common Directors in Co-operative Banks

Current Rule

- The Banking Regulation Act prohibits a director from serving on the boards of more than one bank, with exceptions for directors appointed by the RBI.

Proposed Amendment

- The Bill extends this **exemption** to the directors of central co-operative banks, allowing them **to serve on the board of a state co-operative bank in which they are a member.**

Impact

- This aims to enhance coordination and strengthen the leadership within the co-operative banking system.

4. Substantial Interest in a Company

Current Rule

- The Banking Regulation Act defines "substantial interest" as holding shares worth more than ₹5 lakh or 10% of the paid-up capital, whichever is less.

Proposed Amendment

- The Bill increases this threshold to ₹2 crore**, allowing individuals and their families (spouse or minor children) to hold a larger stake before it is considered substantial.

Impact

- This change is expected to relax restrictions on shareholding, particularly benefiting larger investors and corporate entities.

5. Nomination for Deposits and Bank Products

Current Rule

- The Banking Regulation Act allows **depositors to appoint a single nominee** for their deposits, articles, or lockers.

Proposed Amendment

The Bill allows up to **four nominees** for,

- Deposits (either simultaneously or successively).
- Other items like articles and lockers (successively).

Impact

- The Bill outlines that in case of simultaneous nominations, the distribution will be according to a declared proportion. For successive nominations, the person listed first in the order of nomination will have priority.

Outcome

- This will facilitate the distribution of assets and clarify the rights of multiple nominees.

6. Settlement of Unclaimed Amounts

Current Rule

- Under the State Bank of India Act and the Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) Acts of 1970 and 1980, unpaid or unclaimed dividends are transferred to an unpaid dividend account, and after seven years, they are moved to the Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF).

Proposed Amendment

- The Bill widens the scope of funds that can be transferred to the IEPF, now including:
- Shares for which dividends have not been claimed for seven consecutive years.
- Interest or redemption amounts for bonds that remain unpaid/unclaimed for seven years.

Impact

- Individuals can claim unclaimed funds that have been transferred to the IEPF, helping to resolve outstanding claims and promote financial transparency.

7. Remuneration of Auditors

Current Rule

- The remuneration for auditors of banks is decided by the RBI in consultation with the central government.

Proposed Amendment

- The Bill empowers banks to **determine the remuneration for their auditors** independently.

Impact

- This amendment is expected to streamline the process and reduce bureaucratic involvement in the auditing procedures of banks.

India Highlights Green Initiatives at UNCCD COP16 in Riyadh

India joins 197 nations at the 16th Conference of the Parties (COP) of the **United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)**, which commenced on December 2, 2024, in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, marking the convention's first-ever session in West Asia. **Union Minister Bhupender Yadav** and **Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini** lead India's delegation, presenting the ambitious Aravalli Green Wall Project and showcasing India's commitment to combating desertification.

Key Highlights of UNCCD COP16

Theme and Focus: The 16th COP centers on the theme "Our Land. Our Future," emphasizing sustainable land management to reverse desertification and land degradation globally.

Historic Context: The UNCCD, one of the three agreements from the 1992 Rio Earth Summit, entered into force in 1996 and includes 197 parties. The conference occurs biennially, with COP15 held in May 2022 in Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire.

India's Role at COP16

"Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam" Initiative: Minister Yadav planted a sapling at the Indian Embassy in Riyadh under India's "Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam" campaign, advocating for eco-consciousness.

Mission LiFE Engagement: He encouraged Indian students to adopt sustainable practices through Mission LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment).

Aravalli Green Wall Project: India is presenting this flagship initiative aimed at restoring 1.15 million hectares of degraded land across four states, signaling its proactive stance on environmental restoration.

Significance of the UNCCD

Global Goals: The UNCCD aims to achieve land degradation neutrality (LDN) under the Changwon Initiative launched in 2011, with over 120 countries committing to LDN targets.

Scientific Approach: The convention promotes reclaiming degraded lands using innovative scientific methods.

Connections with Other Environmental Summits of 2024

UNFCCC COP29: Held in Baku, Azerbaijan (November 11-22), focusing on global warming and the Paris Agreement targets.

CBD COP16: The biodiversity summit started in Cali, Colombia, but was postponed due to quorum issues and will resume in Rome in February 2025.

Monetary Policy Meeting Dec 2024

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) conducted its latest bi-monthly **Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting** in December 2024. Governor Shaktikanta Das announced several crucial measures and projections to address current economic challenges while maintaining stability. Here's a detailed breakdown:

CRR Cut by 50 Basis Points to 4%

To tackle liquidity concerns, the **Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)** was reduced by **50 basis points to 4%**. This move aligns with the RBI's neutral policy stance, aimed at ensuring economic stability without disruptive interventions.

RBI Monetary

Policy Meeting Dec 2024: Key Highlights

Repo Rate Unchanged at 6.5%

The MPC decided by a 4-2 majority to maintain the **repo rate at 6.5%**. The Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) rate and the Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) rate were also retained at 6.25% and 6.75%, respectively. This cautious approach reflects the central bank's focus on balancing inflation and growth.

GDP Growth Forecast Lowered for FY25

The RBI revised the GDP growth forecast for **FY25 to 6.6%**, down from the earlier projection of 7.2%. Governor Das attributed the adjustment to weaker-than-expected Q2 growth and specific challenges in the manufacturing sector. Despite this, high-frequency indicators suggest potential stabilization ahead.

Inflation Projections for FY25

The RBI forecasted an inflation rate of **4.8%** for FY25. Food inflation is expected to persist during Q3 but may ease from Q4 onward. Quarterly projections are as follows:

- Q3 FY25: 5.7%
- Q4 FY25: 4.5%
- Q1 FY26: 4.6%
- Q2 FY26: 4.0%

Support for the Agricultural Sector

In a significant move, the RBI increased the collateral limit for agricultural loans from Rs 1.6 lakh crore per borrower to Rs 2 lakh crore. This aims to enhance financial support for farmers and boost credit availability in the sector.

Introduction of SORR Benchmark

The RBI proposed a new benchmark, the Secured Overnight Rupee Rate (SORR), to strengthen market-based pricing mechanisms and enhance transparency in monetary operations.

New Communication Initiative: RBI Podcasts

The RBI plans to launch podcasts as a communication tool to improve public engagement and transparency. This initiative reflects the central bank's commitment to leveraging technology for better outreach.

Measures to Attract Foreign Capital

To boost foreign investments, the RBI raised interest rate ceilings on FCNR-B deposits and increased FCNR deposit rates. These measures aim to attract higher foreign portfolio inflows, which have totaled \$9.3 billion so far in FY25.

Addressing Unclaimed Deposits

The RBI directed banks to segregate unclaimed deposit accounts using Direct Benefit Transfers (DBT). This step aims to ensure transparency and efficiency in beneficiary identification while facilitating the seamless flow of DBT funds.

Challenges in Domestic Consumption

Private consumption growth slowed to 6% in the September quarter from 7.5% earlier, reflecting a decline in urban demand. Fixed investment growth also dipped to 5.4%. However, government consumption rebounded by 4.4%, driven by election-related activities.

Key Members of the MPC

The Monetary Policy Committee comprises six members:

1. Shaktikanta Das (Governor, RBI)
2. Michael Debabrata Patra (Deputy Governor, RBI)
3. Rajiv Ranjan (Executive Director, RBI)
4. Ram Singh (Director, Delhi School of Economics)
5. Saugata Bhattacharya (Economist)
6. Nagesh Kumar (Director, ISID)

These measures and insights reflect the RBI's balanced approach to addressing economic challenges while fostering growth and stability. The central bank continues to monitor developments closely, ensuring proactive and effective policymaking.

QS World University Rankings: Sustainability 2025

In a groundbreaking update to the global higher education scene, **QS Quacquarelli Symonds**, renowned for its expertise in university rankings, has released the **third edition of the 'QS World University Rankings: Sustainability 2025'**. This prestigious ranking evaluates universities based on their **sustainability initiatives**, considering factors like **environmental impact**, **social responsibility**, and **governance**. The 2025 edition has brought notable improvements for **Indian institutions**, especially the **Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs)**, with IIT Delhi securing a top spot.

IIT Delhi Leads with Exceptional Growth

Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IITD) has emerged as the **top Indian university** in the **QS Sustainability Rankings 2025**, placing at **171st globally**. This represents an impressive improvement of **255 ranks** from last year's global position of **426th**. IIT Delhi's remarkable rise is attributed to its continued commitment to sustainability through **green campus initiatives**, **innovative research**, and **collaborative projects** focused on sustainable development.

The institution has long been a leader in **environmental research**, with numerous projects dedicated to reducing carbon footprints and promoting clean energy. IIT Delhi's improvement is a testament to its unwavering focus on integrating **sustainable practices** into its academic and operational frameworks.

QS World University Rankings: Sustainability 2025

Rank in India	2025 Ranking	2024 Ranking	Change	Institution
1	171	426	255	Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IITD)

Rank in India	2025 Ranking	2024 Ranking	Change	Institution
2	202	349	147	Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur (IIT-KGP)
3	234	303	69	Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IITB)
4	245	522	277	Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IITK)
5	277	344	67	Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IITM)
6	299	220	-79	University of Delhi
7	376	505	129	Indian Institute of Science
8	396	449	53	Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT)
9	401	576	175	Manipal Academy of Higher Education – Manipal University (MAHE)
10	412	496	84	Anna University

IIT Madras Completes 410-Meter Hyperloop Test Track

In a significant development for India's transportation future, the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras** has successfully completed a 410-meter-long Hyperloop test track. This groundbreaking achievement was officially announced by Union Railway Minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw** and marks a major milestone in the country's pursuit of high-speed transportation technology. The project, which represents the first of its kind in India, is being developed as part of a **collaboration** between the Indian Railways, IIT Madras' **Avishkar Hyperloop** team, and **TuTr**, an innovative startup incubated at IIT Madras.

What is Hyperloop Technology?

- Hyperloop is an advanced **transportation system** that was originally proposed by **Elon Musk** in 2012. The system is designed to provide high-speed travel through low-pressure tubes, enabling **vacuum-sealed environments** that significantly reduce air resistance and friction, which are typically encountered in traditional transport methods. The goal of the **Hyperloop** is to offer **faster, energy-efficient, and sustainable transportation** over long distances. With speeds potentially reaching over 1,000 kilometers per hour, Hyperloop could redefine travel, cutting down journey times significantly.
- The technology aims to combine **high speed** with **low energy consumption**, making it an environmentally friendly alternative to conventional transportation modes. The design allows for **low operating costs** and **faster travel times**, making it an ideal solution for the growing demand for efficient and quick travel in congested urban areas and along busy transportation corridors.

Project Phases

- The Hyperloop project at IIT Madras will be rolled out in **two phases**. The first phase involves the construction of an **11.5-kilometer test track**, which will be used primarily for testing and **certification of the technology**. This initial phase will showcase the core capabilities of the Hyperloop system, ensuring that it meets all technical, safety, and regulatory requirements before moving on to full-scale implementation.
- In the second phase, the test track will be expanded to around **100 kilometers**, bringing the project closer to its goal of becoming a commercially viable form of transport. The **Mumbai-Pune corridor** has been selected as the site for the first full-scale implementation of the Hyperloop, and it promises to revolutionize intercity travel. With speeds of up to **1,100 kilometers per hour**, the travel time between Mumbai and Pune could be reduced to just **25 minutes**, a dramatic decrease from the current travel time of approximately 3 to 4 hours by road or rail.

Speed and Efficiency of Hyperloop Trains

- One of the standout features of the Hyperloop system is its ability to achieve **exceptional speeds**. Hyperloop trains can reach speeds of up to **1,100 km/h**, making it one of the fastest modes of ground transport in the world. However, for regular operation, the expected **cruising speed** of the Hyperloop system is around **360 km/h**, which is still faster than conventional high-speed trains.
- The key to this extraordinary speed lies in the **vacuum-sealed environment** within the tubes. In conventional systems, friction and air resistance act as significant barriers to speed. The low-pressure environment in Hyperloop tubes effectively eliminates these barriers, enabling the vehicles to travel with minimal drag, resulting in significantly **faster travel times**. Additionally, the system's **energy efficiency** is a major advantage, as the reduced resistance leads to lower energy consumption compared to traditional high-speed transportation.

The Avishkar Hyperloop Team

- The **success of the Hyperloop project** at IIT Madras can largely be attributed to the dedicated efforts of the **Avishkar Hyperloop team**, consisting of **76 students** from IIT Madras. This talented group of engineers, designers, and innovators is focused on developing the core technology for the Hyperloop system. The team's work involves extensive research and development, particularly in areas such as **vacuum systems, propulsion systems, and aerodynamics**.
- The students' commitment to pushing the boundaries of innovation has played a vital role in advancing the project, with their collaborative efforts ensuring that the technological challenges of creating a viable Hyperloop system are addressed. Their work will not only contribute to the success of the Hyperloop project but will also bolster India's position as a global leader in **cutting-edge transportation technologies**.

TuTr: A Key Partner in the Hyperloop Initiative

- TuTr**, a startup incubated at IIT Madras, is another crucial partner in the **Hyperloop project**. As a startup focused on **advanced transportation technologies**, TuTr brings valuable expertise to the table, particularly in areas like **transportation system design** and **system integration**. This collaboration between academia and industry is essential for the Hyperloop project's success, combining IIT Madras' **research capabilities** with TuTr's **practical experience** in developing and scaling innovative technologies.
- The partnership with TuTr is expected to play a pivotal role in bringing the Hyperloop concept from the drawing board to reality, with the aim of enhancing India's transportation capabilities through **advanced technological solutions**.

Future Prospects: Mumbai-Pune Hyperloop

- Once the test track is successfully completed and the technology is validated, the next step will be the **implementation of the first full-scale Hyperloop system** in India. The **Mumbai-Pune corridor** has been identified as the pilot project, and it promises to drastically reduce travel times between these two major cities. The potential benefits of such a system are immense, as it could not only reduce **congestion** and **pollution** but also create a more **sustainable** and **efficient** transportation network for India.
- Despite the progress made so far, it is important to note that the Hyperloop project is still in its **development stage**. Several challenges, such as **regulatory approval, infrastructure development, and funding**, remain to be addressed. However, the successful completion of the 410-meter test track marks an important step toward realizing the vision of a high-speed, **energy-efficient transportation system** in India.

National Panchayat Awards 2024

The **National Panchayat Awards 2024** marked a significant moment in India's rural development landscape, honoring 45 exceptional **Panchayats** for their remarkable contributions to sustainable and inclusive growth. Held on December 11, 2024, at **Vigyan Bhawan** in New Delhi, the prestigious event was graced by the **Hon'ble President of India**, Smt. Droupadi Murmu, and the **Union Minister of Panchayati Raj**, Shri Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh.

Historical Context and Significance

Constitutional Foundations

The awards commemorate the **73rd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1992**, which granted constitutional status to Panchayats as institutions of local self-governance. Traditionally celebrated on April 24th, the 2024 ceremony was rescheduled due to the **General Elections to the Lok Sabha**.

Scale and Participation

In a testament to grassroots democratic participation, **1.94 lakh Gram Panchayats** competed in this year's awards. Notably, **42% of the 42 award-winning Panchayats** were led by women, highlighting the growing role of female leadership in rural governance.

Award Categories: Recognizing Comprehensive Rural Development

1. Deen Dayal Upadhyay Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (DDUPSVP)

This category recognized excellence across nine **Localization of Sustainable Development Goal (LSDG)** thematic areas. **27 Gram Panchayats** from diverse states including Andhra Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, and others were honored for their exceptional performance in:

- Poverty alleviation
- Health
- Education
- Water conservation
- Sanitation
- Infrastructure development
- Social justice
- Good governance

2. Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar

Nine Panchayats were conferred with this prestigious award for their holistic approach to implementing sustainable development goals across all themes.

3. Gram Urja Swaraj Vishesh Panchayat Puraskar

Recognizing innovation in renewable energy, Panchayats from **Maharashtra, Odisha, and Tripura** were awarded for their remarkable contributions to sustainable energy practices.

4. Carbon Neutral Vishesh Panchayat Puraskar

Highlighting environmental sustainability, Gram Panchayats from **Maharashtra, Odisha, and Uttar Pradesh** were honoured for their efforts in achieving net-zero carbon emissions.

5. Panchayat Kshamta Nirmaan Sarvottam Sansthan Puraskar

Institutions from **Kerala, Maharashtra, and Odisha** were recognized for providing exceptional support to Panchayats in implementing Localization of Sustainable Development Goals.

Selection Process: Ensuring Transparency and Excellence
The awards featured a **rigorous multi-level evaluation process** involving committees from Block to National levels. Panchayats were assessed through detailed questionnaires covering nine LSDG themes, ensuring a comprehensive and fair assessment of their performance.

Financial Recognition and Support

A total of **46 crore rupees** in prize money was distributed to 45 awardees, with funds directly transferred to their accounts. This financial recognition aims to motivate and support rural governance initiatives.

Key Publications and Documentation

A significant highlight was the unveiling of a booklet titled **'Best Practices on Works of Awardee Panchayats'**, documenting the innovative practices of award-winning Panchayats and serving as a knowledge repository for other rural governance institutions.

Broader Objectives and Impact

The **National Panchayat Awards** aim to:

- Promote best practices in rural development
- Foster healthy competition among Panchayati Raj Institutions
- Inspire transformative approaches to local governance
- Align local development with United Nations Sustainable Development Goals

Lok Sabha Passes Railways (Amendment) Bill 2024 Amid Disruptions

The Lok Sabha passed the **Railways (Amendment) Bill, 2024** during the Winter Session despite disruptions, with **Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw** addressing concerns over potential privatisation. The bill aims to subsume the **Railway Board Act, 1905**, into the **Railways Act, 1989**, simplifying the legal framework while empowering the Railway Board with statutory powers. Opposition leaders raised concerns over privatisation, centralisation of authority, and representation of marginalised communities, which the minister dismissed as unfounded.

Key Provisions of the Bill

Statutory Powers to Railway Board: Grants the central government authority to determine the board's composition, qualifications, and terms of service, ensuring operational flexibility.

Simplified Legal Framework: Merges provisions of the Indian Railway Board Act, 1905, into the Railways Act, 1989, eliminating the need for dual references.

Enhanced Connectivity: Facilitates superfast train operations and expansions, including rerouting through Thawe Junction in Bihar, to benefit local communities and pilgrims.

Ministerial Clarifications and Achievements

Privatisation Concerns Dismissed: Vaishnaw assured that railway assets remain government-owned, describing privatisation fears as a "fake narrative."

Decentralisation Emphasised: Highlighted 100% delegation of tendering powers to zone general managers, accelerating project approvals and decentralisation.

Improved Passenger Services: Cited plans for 13,000 additional trains and ongoing production of 10,000 general coaches to cater to low-income passengers.

Historical Context and Need for Amendments

Legislative Evolution: The Indian Railways Act, 1890, governed railway operations until replaced by the Railways Act, 1989, which lacked statutory provisions for the Railway Board.

Simplification Goal: By incorporating the Railway Board Act of 1905, the amendment aligns historical provisions into a single, comprehensive framework for efficiency.

Indian Heritage Conservation Projects Shine at UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards 2024

Two Indian heritage conservation projects—the **Abathsahayeswarar Temple Conservation Project** in Tamil Nadu and the **BJPCI Conservation Project** in Maharashtra—have garnered global recognition by winning the **UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards for Cultural Heritage Conservation 2024**. These projects, celebrated for their commitment to preserving India's cultural legacy, were among the eight winners selected from the Asia-Pacific region. The awards, announced by the **United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation (UNESCO)** on **6 December 2024** at its regional office in Bangkok, Thailand, spotlight the efforts of individuals and organisations dedicated to restoring and conserving heritage sites across the region.

Abathsahayeswarar Temple Conservation Project

- The **Abathsahayeswarar Temple Conservation Project** in **Thukkatchi, Tamil Nadu**, received the **Award of Distinction**, recognizing its exemplary efforts to safeguard a historic cultural treasure.
- **Temple Overview**
- The **Abathsahayeswarar Temple**, dedicated to **Lord Dakshinamurthy (a form of Lord Shiva)**, is a revered religious site located in **Thukkatchi village** in the **Thiruvaur District of Tamil Nadu**. The temple holds historical and spiritual significance, as it is mentioned in the **7th-century Tamil Saivite text 'Thevaram'** and is one of the **Paadal Petra Sthalams** (sacred places glorified in Tamil Shaivite literature).

Award-Winning Conservation Efforts

- The conservation project was lauded for its innovative use of **modern engineering expertise** alongside the **traditional knowledge of Hindu temple builders, known as sthapathis**, to ensure the **structural conservation** of the temple. This harmonious blend of traditional and modern techniques exemplifies a sustainable approach to heritage preservation, earning the temple the **UNESCO Award of Distinction**.

BJPCI Conservation Project

- The **BJPCI Conservation Project** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**, was honored with the **Award of Merit** for its restoration work on a historic educational institution.

Historical Significance

- The **BJPCI (Sir Byramjee Jeejeebhoy Parsee Charitable Institution)** school building, constructed in **1908** in **Gothic architectural style**, has been a cornerstone of education for economically disadvantaged communities in Mumbai. The school was originally established to promote learning among the **economically weaker sections of society**.

Restoration Work

- The restoration of the BJPCI school building was meticulously planned and executed during the school's **two-month summer break**. The project preserved the structure's architectural integrity while adapting it to meet modern safety and usability standards. The effort underscores the importance of maintaining **cultural heritage** while ensuring its relevance in contemporary contexts.
- UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards for Cultural Heritage Conservation

About the Awards

- Established in **2000**, the **UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards for Cultural Heritage Conservation** aim to recognize and promote efforts to **restore, conserve, and transform structures** and buildings of heritage value. The awards celebrate projects that demonstrate excellence in **sustainability, technical achievements**, and an understanding of the **cultural and historical significance** of heritage sites.

Selection Process

- A **seven-member jury** of conservation practitioners specializing in **architecture, archaeology, and community development** evaluated the submissions. The winners were selected based on three main criteria:
 1. **Understanding of Place:** How well the project reflects the cultural and historical context of the site.
 2. **Technical Achievements:** The use of innovative and effective restoration techniques.
 3. **Sustainability and Impact:** The long-term viability and community benefits of the project.

Award Categories and Winners

The **2024 UNESCO Awards for Cultural Heritage Conservation** include five categories:

1. **Award of Excellence** (highest honor)
2. **Award of Distinction**
3. **Award of Merit**
4. **Award for New Design in Heritage Contexts**
5. **Special Recognition for Sustainable Development**

List of 2024 Winners

Award of Excellence:

- **Inari-yu Bathhouse Restoration Project**, Tokyo, Japan

Award of Distinction:

- **Abathsahayeswarar Temple Conservation Project**, Thukkatchi, Tamil Nadu
- **Gunan Street Historic Block Conservation Project**, Yixing, Jiangsu Province, China

Award of Merit:

- **BJPCI Conservation Project**, Mumbai, India
- **Guanyin Hall Teahouse Conservation Project**, Chengdu, Sichuan Province, China
- **Helou Pavilion Conservation Project**, Shanghai, China
- **Observatory Tower Conservation Project**, Christchurch, New Zealand

Special Recognition for Sustainable Development:

- **Gunan Street Historic Block Conservation Project**, Jiangsu Province, China
- **Helou Pavilion Conservation Project**, Shanghai, China

Award for New Design in Heritage Contexts:

- **Rabindhorn Building**, Bangkok, Thailand

About UNESCO

Overview

The **United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation (UNESCO)**, founded on **16 November 1945**, is a specialized agency of the **United Nations**. Its mission is to **build a culture of peace, eradicate poverty**, and promote **sustainable development** and **intercultural dialogue** through education, science, culture, communication, and information.

Key Facts

- **Headquarters:** Paris, France
- **Members:** 195 Member States and 8 Associate Members

ITA Awards 2024

The **Indian Television Academy Awards (ITA) 2024** was a **grand celebration of the best in Indian television, showcasing exemplary talent and storytelling**. Held with much fanfare, the event honored iconic shows, remarkable performances, and innovative narratives that have shaped Indian television over the past year. The ceremony was a testament to the dynamic evolution of television content in India, highlighting its ability to captivate audiences while pushing creative boundaries.

Key Highlights of ITA Awards 2024

General Overview

- **Platform:** Prestigious awards recognizing excellence in Indian television.
- **Host:** Gaurav Khanna, renowned for his role in Anupamaa.
- **Broadcast Date:** December 31, 2024, on Star Plus.
- **Attendees:** Featured top television stars including Rupali Ganguly, Harshad Chopda, Pranali Rathod, and others.

Key Winners

- **Popular TV Actor:** Harshad Chopda (Yeh Rishta Kya Kehlata Hai).
- **Popular TV Actress:** Pranali Rathod (Yeh Rishta Kya Kehlata Hai).
- **Popular TV Actor (Jury):** Amar Upadhyay (Doree).
- **Popular TV Actress (Jury):** Neha Harsora (Udne Ki Aasha).
- **Iconic TV Personality of the Year:** Rupali Ganguly (Anupamaa).
- **Best Show (Drama Series – Popular):** Anupamaa.
- **Best Show (Drama Series – Jury):** Udne Ki Aasha.
- **Best Negative Actor:** Nikitin Dheer (Shrimad Ramayan).
- **Best Comedy Actors:** Subhangi Atre, Aashif Sheikh, Rohitash Gaur (Bhabhi Ji Ghar Par Hain).
- **Best Hindi Channel:** Aaj Tak

Star Performers and Highlights

- The event featured stunning performances by leading actors.
- Heartwarming speeches reflected the gratitude and passion of the winners.
- The awards recognized both established and emerging talent in Indian television.

The New Nyaya Sanhita Mechanisms for Quick Justice Delivery

The **Nyaya Sanhita**, a **comprehensive legislative reform**, aims to expedite the justice process in India, ensuring quicker and fairer resolution of cases. The law prioritizes the completion of crucial stages of investigation and trial within specific time frames. With a focus on expediting justice for women, children, and other marginalized sections of society, **the Nyaya Sanhita introduces mechanisms that tackle delays in the judicial system**. These reforms aim to restore public confidence in the legal system, reduce case backlogs, and deliver justice in a timely manner.

Key Mechanisms of the Nyaya Sanhita for Quick Justice Delivery

1. **Faster and Fair Resolution of Cases**
 - The new Nyaya Sanhita mandates strict time limits for various stages of investigation and trial.
 - **Preliminary Enquiry:** Must be completed within 14 days.
 - **Further Investigation:** To be completed within 90 days.
 - **Supply of Documents to Victim and Accused:** Within 14 days.
 - **Commitment of Case for Trial:** Within 90 days.
 - **Filing of Discharge Applications:** Within 60 days.
 - **Framing of Charges:** Within 60 days.
 - **Pronouncement of Judgment:** Within 45 days.
 - **Filing of Mercy Petitions:** 30 days before the Governor and 60 days before the President.
 - These timeframes aim to ensure that cases progress without unnecessary delays, promoting swift justice.
2. **Fast-Track Investigations**
 - The law prioritizes investigations, especially for sensitive cases such as those involving women and children.
 - **Investigation for Offenses Against Women and Children:** Must be completed within two months of recording the information.
 - This ensures that justice for vulnerable sections of society is not delayed, addressing pressing concerns about their safety and rights.
3. **Limited Adjournments in Courts**
 - To curb delays in the courtroom, the Nyaya Sanhita limits adjournments.
 - **A maximum of two adjournments will be allowed per case.**
 - This mechanism ensures that cases do not get prolonged unnecessarily and prevents the legal system from becoming a vehicle for delay tactics.

4. Establishment of Time-Bound Procedures

- Time limits are applied to various stages, including,
- **Preliminary Enquiry:** 14 days
- **Further Investigation:** 90 days
- **Supply of Documents:** 14 days
- **Trial Commitment:** 90 days
- **Discharge Applications:** 60 days
- **Charge Framing:** 60 days
- **Judgment Pronouncement:** 45 days
- **Mercy Petitions Filing:** 30 days (Governor), 60 days (President)

Jalvahak Scheme

India's inland waterways sector received a significant boost with the unveiling of the '**Jalvahak**' scheme by the Union Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways (MoPSW), Shri Sarbananda Sonowal. **Designed to promote long-haul cargo movement across National Waterways 1 (Ganga), 2 (Brahmaputra), and 16 (Barak)**, this initiative aims to transform waterways into a sustainable, efficient, and economical mode of transportation. Alongside the launch of this scheme, fixed scheduled cargo services were inaugurated, marking a step toward enhancing logistics and decongesting road and rail networks.

Launch of 'Jalvahak' Policy

- **Incentivizes long-haul cargo transportation** on National Waterways 1, 2, and 16.
- Provides a **reimbursement of up to 35%** of the operating expenditure incurred by cargo owners.
- **Targets distances exceeding 300 km**, focusing on bulk and containerized cargo.
- Encourages partnerships with private operators by allowing cargo owners to hire vessels outside government entities like IWAI or ICSL.
- **Validity:** Initially launched for a **three-year period**.

Inauguration of Fixed Scheduled Sailing Service

Cargo Ships Launched

- MV AAI
- MV Homi Bhaba
- MV Trishul with Dumb Barges Ajay & Dikhu.

Routes and Transit Times

- NW 1 (Ganga): Fixed timelines for Kolkata-Patna-Varanasi routes.
- Kolkata to Patna: 7 days.
- Patna to Varanasi: 5 days.
- Kolkata to Varanasi: 14 days.
- NW 2 (Brahmaputra) via IBPR:
- Kolkata to Pandu (Guwahati): 18 days.
- Pandu to Kolkata: 15 days.

Economic & Ecological Advantages

- Promotes a sustainable mode of transportation with lower carbon emissions compared to road and rail.
- Reduces logistics costs and boosts trade efficiency.
- Decongests overburdened railways and roadways.

Current Cargo Movements Under Jalvahak

- **MV Trishul** – Carried 1500 tonnes of cement from Kolkata to Guwahati via IBPR.
- **MV Aai** – Transported 1000 tonnes of gypsum to Patna.
- **MV Homi Bhaba** – Delivered 200 tonnes of coal to Varanasi.

Performance Goals

- **Target for 2030:** 200 million MT of cargo movement.
- **Long-term vision for 2047:** 500 million MT, contributing significantly to India's Blue Economy.
- **Modal shift objective:** 800 million tonne-kilometers with an investment of ₹95.4 crore by 2027.

India's Inland Waterways: Potential and Challenges

Current Infrastructure

- **Total navigable length:** 20,236 km.
- **Rivers:** 17,980 km.
- **Canals:** 2,256 km.
- India's cargo movement via waterways remains underutilized compared to nations like the United States, China, and the EU.

Recent Progress

- Growth in cargo volume: From 18.07 million MT (2013-14) to 132.89 million MT (2023-24), a 700% increase.

Challenges

- Limited mechanized craft suitable for inland navigation.
- Need for greater private sector involvement.
- Awareness among cargo owners regarding the cost-effectiveness and efficiency of waterways.

Significance of 'Jalvahak' and Fixed Services

- **Trade Enhancement:** Offers businesses a cost-effective and environmentally sustainable alternative.
- **Economic Growth:** Revives underutilized waterways in eastern India, including Bengal and the Northeast.
- **Community Impact:** Improves livelihoods and connectivity for communities along riverine routes.

Leadership Perspectives

- **Union Minister Shri Sarbananda Sonowal:** Emphasized the vision of transformation through transportation and revitalizing inland waterways under PM Modi's leadership.
- **Union Minister of State Shantanu Thakur:** Highlighted the historic turnaround in logistics movement for Bengal.
- **Minister of State for Transportation Daya Shankar Singh:** Celebrated the initiative as a pathway to economic prosperity for riverine communities.

Understanding La-Nina's Effect

La Niña, a phase of the El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO), has significant effects on global weather patterns. This climatic phenomenon is characterized by cooler-than-usual sea surface temperatures in the central and eastern Pacific Ocean. **While La Niña typically leads to increased rainfall in India during the monsoon season,** it can also cause disruptions in other parts of the world, such as droughts in Africa and intensified hurricanes in the Atlantic. The emergence of La Niña is a critical factor in determining India's seasonal weather, including its monsoons and winters. However, the delay in La Niña's expected onset in 2024 has raised questions about its eventual impact.

What is La Niña?

- La Niña is part of the El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO) and occurs when the **central and eastern Pacific Ocean experiences cooler-than-normal sea surface temperatures.**
- It often **brings opposite weather effects compared to El Niño,** which is marked by warmer sea surface temperatures.

Impact on India's Climate

- **Monsoons:** La Niña typically leads to normal or above-normal rainfall during the monsoon season in India.
- **Winter:** La Niña winters tend to be colder, but not always uniformly across the country.
- **Summer:** La Niña generally mitigates extreme heat during the summer, contrasting with the hotter, drier conditions associated with El Niño.

Delayed La Niña in 2024

- The La Niña phase **was expected to begin by July 2024, but it has not emerged as predicted.**
- Forecasts suggest that **La Niña may form by late 2024 or early 2025,** but its strength may be weaker than usual.
- Historically, La Niña has formed more commonly in the monsoon or pre-monsoon periods. It has formed only twice between October and December since 1950.

Current Oceanic Niño Index (ONI) Values

- The ONI compares three-month average sea surface temperatures in the tropical Pacific to a 30-year average.
- For La Niña, ONI values must be below -0.5°C , and the current ONI value is around -0.3°C , indicating a weak La Niña.

La Niña Winter

- **Southern India:** Cities like Bengaluru and Hyderabad have experienced colder winters, though this may not be directly linked to La Niña, given the weak ONI values.
- **Northern India:** There has been a delay in the onset of winter, with above-normal temperatures observed.
- **Air Quality:** La Niña winters tend to have higher wind speeds, which help in dispersing pollutants and improving air quality. However, lower planetary boundary layer heights can trap pollutants near the ground.

Effects of La Niña on Air Pollution

- Faster wind speeds during La Niña winters **help transport pollutants away,** improving air quality.
- A lower planetary boundary layer height could potentially trap pollutants, worsening air quality, especially if people burn biomass for heating.

La Niña and Monsoon Outlook for 2025

- If **La Niña persists into the summer of 2025,** it **could offer relief from extreme heat,** unlike the intense heatwaves observed in El Niño years.
- La Niña generally supports a robust monsoon, leading to normal or above-normal rainfall in India.
- **El Niño Impact:** El Niño years, on the other hand, typically result in below-average rainfall during the monsoon, as seen in 2023.

Historical La Niña and El Niño Trends

- **India has received less rainfall during intense El Niño events** (e.g., 1980s, 1990s), with more pronounced effects in north and south India.
- In contrast, **La Niña years (e.g., 2020, 2021, 2022) have generally provided normal or above-normal rainfall.**

Potential Impact of La Niña in 2024-2025

If La Niña forms as expected, it could lead to,

- A milder winter, with cooler temperatures in southern India.
- A more moderate summer with less intense heat.
- A stronger monsoon season, with higher rainfall across India, benefiting agriculture and water resources.

Gadhimai Festival

The Gadhimai Festival, held every **five years in southeastern Nepal,** is one of the **world's most controversial religious observances,** known for the **mass slaughter of animals.** This **quinquennial event,** rooted in centuries of tradition, draws hundreds of thousands of Hindus who believe the ritual **will appease the Hindu goddess Gadhimai,** bringing them prosperity. However, the festival's massive scale and the cruelty involved have sparked fierce debates between animal rights activists and devotees. Despite legal challenges and public outcry, the festival's bloodshed continues, raising important questions about the intersection of religion, tradition, and animal welfare.

Key Points on the Gadhimai Festival

Origins and Beliefs

- **Founder:** Bhagwan Chowdhary, founder of the Gadhimai temple in Bariyarpur, Bara District, Nepal.
- **Mythology:** According to the legend, Gadhimai, the goddess of power, promised prosperity to Chowdhary in exchange for a blood sacrifice.
- **Animal Sacrifice:** Initially, human blood was desired, but animal blood was substituted, which became the foundation of the tradition.

Rituals and Scale of the Sacrifice

- **Animal Sacrifice:** The festival includes the slaughter of a variety of animals, including rats, pigeons, goats, and water buffaloes.
- **Estimates:** In the 2019 festival, around 250,000 animals were sacrificed. In 2009, the figure was as high as 500,000 animals.
- **Involvement:** Animals are sometimes brought from India, and the Nepalese government has historically supported the event.

Efforts to End the Sacrifices

- **Petitions and Legal Challenges:** Animal welfare groups and individuals, including former actress Brigitte Bardot, have petitioned the courts in Nepal and India to stop the festival's animal sacrifices.

Supreme Court Rulings

- **India (2014):** The Supreme Court ordered that neighboring Indian states restrict the **transport of animals for the Gadhimai festival**.
- **Nepal (2016):** The Supreme Court ruled that the government should phase out and discourage animal sacrifices. However, this ruling has been largely ignored, and the sacrifices continue.

Government Responses

- The Nepalese government has stated that it would not use force to prevent the sacrifices, citing religious sentiments.
- In 2015, temple caretakers promised a blood-free festival in 2019, but the killings went ahead as planned.

Ongoing Debate

- **Supporters:** Devotees view the Gadhimai festival as an important, untouchable religious tradition essential for gaining blessings from the goddess.
- **Criticism:** Activists argue the festival exploits both animals and impoverished communities, calling the sacrifices cruel, violent, and inhumane.

Current Status

- **2024 Festival:** The animal sacrifices began on December 8, despite ongoing legal and ethical concerns.
- **Global Attention:** The Gadhimai Festival remains a flashpoint for discussions about animal rights, cultural practices, and the role of religion in modern society.

FIFA THE BEST AWARDS 2024

The Best FIFA Football Awards 2024 were held in Doha, Qatar, on December 17, where several individuals were honored for their exceptional performances throughout the year. The event recognized the best players, coaches, and goalkeepers in both men's and women's football, as well as other prestigious awards like the FIFA Puskás Award and FIFA Fan Award. The awards were determined by a voting system that included national team coaches, captains, media members, and fans, all of whom contributed to crowning the winners.

FIFA The Best Award 2024 Highlights

The Best FIFA Men's Player

- **Winner:** Vinicius Jr (48 points)
- **Second:** Rodri (43 points)
- **Third:** Jude Bellingham (37 points)
- Vinicius Jr claimed his first Best Men's Player award, topping the voting with strong support from fans, coaches, and players.

The Best FIFA Women's Player

- **Winner:** Aitana Bonmati (52 points)
- **Second:** Barbra Banda (39 points)
- **Third:** Caroline Graham Hansen (37 points)
- Bonmati retained her title, earning overwhelming support across all categories.

The Best FIFA Men's Goalkeeper

- **Winner:** Emiliano Martinez (26 points)
- **Second:** Ederson (16 points)
- **Third:** Unai Simon (13 points)
- Martinez regained the title with strong backing from Argentine figures.

The Best FIFA Women's Goalkeeper

- **Winner:** Alyssa Naeher (26 points)
- **Second:** Cata Coll (22 points)
- **Third:** Mary Earps (11 points)
- Naeher's excellent performances were recognized with the highest voting support.

The Best FIFA Men's Coach

- **Winner:** Carlo Ancelotti (26 points)
- **Second:** Xabi Alonso (22 points)
- **Third:** Luis de la Fuente (11 points)
- Ancelotti earned his first Best Men's Coach award for his successful career, including Real Madrid's triumphs.

The Best FIFA Women's Coach

- **Winner:** Emma Hayes (23 points)
- **Second:** Jonatan Giraldez (20 points)
- **Third:** Arthur Elias (13 points)
- Hayes was honored for her leadership and achievements with Chelsea FC.

The FIFA Puskás Award

- **Winner:** Alejandro Garnacho (26 points)
- **Second:** Yassine Benzia (22 points)
- **Third:** Denis Omedi (16 points)
- Garnacho's stunning goal won him the prestigious award for the best goal of the year.

The FIFA Marta Award

- **Winner:** Marta (22 points)
- **Second:** Asisat Oshoala (20 points)
- **Third:** Sakina Karchaoui (16 points)
- The award celebrated the iconic Brazilian player's remarkable contribution to football.

The FIFA Fan Award

- **Winner:** Guilherme Gandra Moura

The FIFA Fair Play Award

- **Winner:** Thiago Maia

The Best FIFA Men's 11

- **Goalkeeper:** Emiliano Martinez
- **Defenders:** Ruben Dias, Dani Carvajal, Antonio Rudiger, William Saliba
- **Midfielders:** Jude Bellingham, Rodri, Toni Kroos
- **Forwards:** Erling Haaland, Lamine Yamal, Vinicius Junior

The Best FIFA Women's 11

- **Goalkeeper:** Alyssa Naeher
- **Defenders:** Irene Paredes, Ona Batlle, Lucy Bronze, Naomi Girma
- **Midfielders:** Aitana Bonmati, Lindsey Horan, Gabi Portilho, Patri Guijarro
- **Forwards:** Caroline Graham Hansen, Salma Paralluelo

Sahitya Akademi Awards 2024

Sahitya Akademi announced its annual **Sahitya Akademi Awards in 21 languages**. Eight books of poetry, three novels, two short story collections, three essays, three literary criticism works, one play, and one research work won the Sahitya Akademi Awards 2024. Awards in Bengali, Dogri, and Urdu will be declared at a later stage.

Sahitya Akademi Awards 2024

Category	Awardees
Poetry	Sameer Tanti (Assamese), Dileep Jhaveri (Gujarati), Gagan Gill (Hindi), K. Jayakumar (Malayalam), Haobam Satyabati Devi (Manipuri), Paul Kaur (Punjabi), Mukut Maniraj (Rajasthani), Dipak Kumar Sharma (Sanskrit)
Novel	Aron Raja (Bodo), Easterine Kire (English), Sohan Koul (Kashmiri)
Short Stories	Yuva Baral (Nepali), Hundraj Balwani (Sindhi)
Essays	Mukesh Thali (Konkani), Mahendra Malangia (Maithili), Baishnab Charan Samal (Odia)
Literary Criticism	K.V. Narayana (Kannada), Sudhir Rasal (Marathi), Penugonda Lakshminarayana (Telugu)
Play	Maheswar Soren (Santali)
Research	A.R. Venkatachalapathy (Tamil)

Sahitya Akademi Award 2024- Full List

Language	Title and Genre	Name of the Author
Assamese	Pharingbore Bator Kathaa Jane (Poetry)	Sameer Tanti
Bodo	Swrni Thakhwi (Novel)	Aron Raja
English	Spirit Nights (Novel)	Easterine Kire
Gujarati	Bhagwan-ni Vato (Poetry)	Dileep Jhaveri

Language	Title and Genre	Name of the Author
Hindi	Main Jab Tak Aai Bahar (Poetry)	Gagan Gill
Kannada	Nudigala Alivu (Literary Criticism)	K.V. Narayana
Kashmiri	Psychiatric Ward (Novel)	Sohan Koul
Konkani	Rangtarang (Essays)	Mukesh Thali
Maithili	Prabandh Sangrah (Essays)	Mahendra Malangia
Malayalam	Pingalakeshini (Poetry)	K. Jayakumar
Manipuri	Mainu Bora Nungshi Sheiroi (Poetry)	Haobam Satyabati Devi
Marathi	Vindanche Gadyarop (Criticism)	Sudhir Rasal
Nepali	Chichimira (Short Stories)	Yuva Baral
Odia	Bhuti Bhakti Bibhruti (Essays)	Baishnab Charan Samal
Punjabi	Sun Gunvanta Sun Budhivanta: Itihaasnamaa Punjab (Poetry)	Paul Kaur
Rajasthani	Gaon Ar Amma (Poetry)	Mukut Maniraj
Sanskrit	Bhaskaracaritam (Poetry)	Dipak Kumar Sharma
Santali	Seched Sawnta Ren Andha Manm (Play)	Maheswar Soren
Sindhi	Purzo (Short Stories)	Hundraj Balwani
Tamil	Tirunelveli Ezucciyum Vaa. Vuu.ci. Yum 1908 (Research)	A.R. Venkatachalapathy
Telugu	Deepika (Criticism)	Penugonda Lakshminarayana

55th GST Council Meeting Key Highlights and Proposals

The 55th GST Council meeting, chaired by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, convened ministers from 28 states, two Union Territories, and key stakeholders. The discussions centered on vital tax reforms impacting consumers and businesses across sectors, focusing on luxury items, essential services, and rationalizing the tax structure.

Key Highlights

Luxury Items Under Spotlight

- **Proposal to increase GST rates on high-end products,**
- Wristwatches priced above ₹25,000 and shoes costing over ₹15,000 per pair may attract a 28% GST (up from 18%).
- **Premium garments above ₹10,000 might also face a steep 28% tax, while,**
- Garments below ₹1,500 remain at 5%.
- Garments between ₹1,500 and ₹10,000 may see a jump to 18%.
- **Aim:** Align taxation with pricing structures of luxury goods.

Reforms for Food Delivery Platforms

- **GST rate for platforms like Swiggy and Zomato** may be reduced.
- From 18% with Input Tax Credit (ITC) to a simplified 5% without ITC.

Impact

- **Lower delivery charges, benefiting consumers.**
- Address disparity between dining out and food delivery taxation.

GST on Insurance Products

- **Proposals to reform GST on insurance premiums** to make policies affordable:
- Health insurance plans with ₹5 lakh coverage and term life insurance may be exempted from GST.
- Current GST on health and life insurance premiums is 18%, while endowment and annuity plans have variable rates.
- **Recommendations:** Exemptions for senior citizen-focused policies.
- **Rationale:** Align with international practices where insurance products are largely tax-free.

Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) in GST

Proposal to bring ATF under the GST regime

- Airlines could claim input tax credit, reducing operational costs.
- Resistance likely from states due to revenue concerns.
- Rate Rationalization on 148 Items

Proposed increase in GST for certain goods

- Items like compact vehicles and pre-owned electric vehicles may move from the 12% to 18% bracket.

Sin Goods

- **Aerated beverages, cigarettes, and tobacco could see GST rates rise to 35% (from 28%), with additional cess.**

Current GST Structure

- **Four main GST slabs:** 5%, 12%, 18%, and 28%, alongside zero percent and special rates for precious metals.
- Law permits a maximum combined GST rate of 40% (20% CGST + 20% SGST).

Challenges with Proposed Changes

- High taxation on items like cigarettes may increase smuggling and tax evasion, causing greater revenue loss.
- Differentiated tax slabs based on price could lead to administrative complexity and evasion tactics.

Concerns with Revenue and Compliance

- Quality of revenue remains poor due to high social costs of raising additional tax revenue.
- Evasion persists despite increased GST collections, necessitating better analytics and enforcement.

Broader Recommendations

- Expanding the GST base by including petroleum products like ATF and natural gas.
- Reducing litigation and arrears to enhance efficiency.
- Ensuring minimal disruption to the current stability in GST compliance and collections.

PM Rashtriya Bal Puraskar Awards 2024

President Droupadi Murmu presented the **Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2024** on December 26, 2024, to **17 exceptional children** from across India. These awards honor remarkable achievements in **seven categories: art and culture, bravery, innovation, science and technology, social service, sports, and environment**. During the ceremony, the President lauded the awardees for their exceptional contributions and emphasized the importance of providing opportunities to nurture children's talents. She highlighted the courage and patriotism demonstrated by these young achievers, which inspire confidence in India's future.

Highlights of The Award Ceremony 2024

- **Number of Awardees:** 17 children (7 boys and 10 girls).
- **Categories:** Art and Culture, Bravery, Innovation, Science and Technology, Social Service, Sports, and Environment.
- **Award Distribution:** Winners hailed from 14 states and union territories.

Notable Awardees and Their Achievements

Art and Culture

- **Keya Hatkar (14 years):** An author and disability advocate excelling in art and culture.
- **Ayaan Sajad (12 years):** A Sufi singer from Kashmir contributing to Kashmiri music.
- **Vyas Om Jignesh (17 years):** A cerebral palsy-affected Sanskrit scholar who memorized over 5,000 slokas.

Bravery

- **Saurav Kumar (9 years):** Saved three girls from drowning.
- **Loanna Thapa (17 years):** Rescued 36 residents from a fire.

Innovation

- **Sindhoora Raja (15 years):** Developed self-stabilizing devices for Parkinson's patients.
- **Risheek Kumar (17 years):** Founded Kashmir's first cybersecurity firm.

Sports

- **Hembati Nag:** A judo player from a Naxal-affected area who won silver at the Khelo India National Games.
- **Anish Sarkar:** Youngest FIDE-ranked chess player at the age of three.

GST Collections 2024

Trends in GST Revenue Collection (January – December 2024)

Month	GST Collection (₹ Crore)
January 2024	₹1,72,129 crore
February 2024	₹1,68,337 crore
March 2024	₹1.78 lakh crore
April 2024	₹2.10 lakh crore
May 2024	₹1.73 lakh crore
June 2024	₹1.74 lakh crore
July 2024	₹1.82 lakh crore
August 2024	₹1.75 lakh crore
September 2024	₹1,73,240 crore
October 2024	Rs. 1,87,346 crore
November 2024	Rs. 1,82,269 crore
December 2024	Update soon



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Banking Current Affairs and Financial Current Affairs

January to December 2024

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of January 2024

S.no	Content Description	Date/Details
1	Approval for 30th Tranche of Electoral Bonds	The Indian government has granted approval for the release of the 30th tranche of electoral bonds, which will be on sale from January 2 to January 11, 2024. This coincides with the anticipated Supreme Court verdict on the validity of the electoral bonds scheme.
2	RBI Increases Bulk Deposit Limit for UCBs	The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has increased the bulk deposit limit for large urban co-operative banks (UCBs) to ₹1 crore and above, from the previous ₹15 lakh limit. This applies to UCBs in Tier 3 (deposits ₹1,000 crore to ₹10,000 crore) and Tier 4 (deposits over ₹10,000 crore) categories.
3	India's Corporate Sector Investment Lags in FY24	India's corporate sector investment in the first nine months (9M) of FY24 stood at ₹10.80 lakh crore, which is below expectations. Sectors like aviation, chemicals, machinery, and power showed caution in their investment approach.
4	Tata Pay Receives RBI's Payment Aggregator License	Tata Pay, the digital payments app by Tata Digital, has been granted a payment aggregator (PA) license by the RBI, positioning it among leaders like Razorpay, Cashfree, and Google Pay.
6	SBI Secures \$1 Billion for ESG Financing	SBI secured \$1 billion to address the growing demand in the domestic Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) financing market. This includes a syndicated social loan of \$750 million with an additional \$250 million green shoe option.
7	NPCI & IndusInd Bank Launch 'Samman RuPay Credit Card'	NPCI, in collaboration with IndusInd Bank, launched the UPI-enabled 'Samman RuPay Credit Card' exclusively for government sector employees. This aligns with the RBI's recent approval for integrating RuPay credit cards with UPI.
8	LIC to Acquire Stake in National Housing Bank's New Company	LIC's board has approved acquiring up to 10% stake in a new company promoted by the National Housing Bank (NHB), aimed at investing in residential mortgage-backed securities.
9	SBI & Rural Development Ministry Collaborate for Rural SHGs	SBI and the Rural Development Ministry have signed an MoU to streamline enterprise financing for rural self-help groups (SHGs), facilitating financial inclusion in rural India.
10	NPCI Launches UPI-PayNow Linkage for India-Singapore Transactions	NPCI has introduced the UPI-PayNow linkage, allowing direct remittances between India and Singapore, enhancing cross-border financial inclusion and convenience.
11	Extension of Michael Debabrata Patra's Tenure as RBI Deputy Governor	The Indian government extended Michael Debabrata Patra's tenure as RBI Deputy Governor for one more year, marking the second extension of his tenure.
12	RBI Imposes Penalties on Dhanlaxmi Bank, Punjab and Sind Bank, and ESAF Small Finance Bank	The RBI imposed monetary penalties on these banks in January 2024 for violations of banking norms.
13	SBI Launches Green Rupee Term Deposit (SGRTD) Scheme	SBI launched the SGRTD to raise funds for supporting environmentally-friendly projects, aligning with India's goal of net carbon neutrality by 2070.

S.no	Content Description	Date/Details
14	FCI Celebrates 60th Anniversary with Focus on Food Self-Sufficiency	FCI celebrated its 60th anniversary, with Union Minister Piyush Goyal emphasizing India's food self-sufficiency and FCI's role in combating hunger.
15	Yes Bank Launches SmartFin Digital SCF Platform for MSMEs	Yes Bank introduced SmartFin, a digital Supply Chain Finance platform for MSMEs, developed with Veefin Solutions, to improve working capital efficiency.
16	RBI Proposes Self-Regulatory Organizations (SROs) for Fintech	The RBI released a draft framework for establishing self-regulatory organizations in the fintech sector to balance innovation and regulatory needs for consumer protection.
17	WEF & Telangana Government Set Up 19th 4IR Centre in Hyderabad	The Telangana government and WEF will launch the world's first thematic 4IR Centre dedicated to health tech and life sciences in Hyderabad in February 2024.
18	Karnataka Bank & Clix Capital Form Digital Co-Lending Partnership	Karnataka Bank and Clix Capital formed a digital co-lending partnership targeting India's MSME sector via the Yubi Co.lend platform.
19	LIC Surpasses SBI in Market Capitalization	LIC has overtaken SBI in market capitalization, showcasing its remarkable revival and growth after its initial public offering (IPO).
20	HDFC Bank Plans First Branch in Singapore	HDFC Bank is planning to open its first branch in Singapore as part of its strategy to expand its global footprint following its merger with Housing Development Finance Corp.
21	ICICI Bank Canada Launches 'Money2India' App for Fund Transfers	ICICI Bank Canada introduced the 'Money2India (Canada)' app, offering Canadian customers seamless 24/7 fund transfers to any Indian bank.
22	CDSL Celebrates Silver Jubilee with Multi-lingual Initiatives	CDSL, Asia's first listed depository, launched two multi-lingual initiatives to enhance inclusivity and accessibility in the capital market.
23	LIC Launches Jeevan Dhara II Plan	LIC unveiled the Jeevan Dhara II plan, offering a non-participating, individual savings, deferred annuity option with life cover and higher annuity rates at advanced ages.
24	AIIB Invests in India's Largest Renewable Energy InvIT	AIIB invested INR 4.86 billion in Sustainable Energy Infra Trust (SEIT), India's largest Renewable Energy Infrastructure Investment Trust (InvIT).
25	YES BANK Executes First Export Finance Transaction on ITFS Platform	YES BANK became the first Indian bank to execute an export finance transaction on RXIL Global IFSC's International Trade Financing Services Platform (ITFS).
26	AU Small Finance Bank to Merge with Fincare Small Finance Bank	AU SFB announced its merger with Fincare SFB, effective from February 1, 2024, pending necessary approvals.
27	HDFC Bank Achieves 20 Million Active Credit Cards	HDFC Bank reached the milestone of 20 million active credit cards, dominating a quarter of India's credit card market.
28	RBI Revises Eligibility for UCBs in Second Schedule	The RBI revised the eligibility norms for urban co-operative banks (UCBs) to bring them under an updated regulatory framework based on the Revised Regulatory Framework of 2022.
29	ONGC Forms Subsidiary for Green Energy & Gas Sector	ONGC received approval for forming a subsidiary focused on green energy and gas sector initiatives as part of its diversification strategy.
30	LIC Granted Approval to Acquire 9.99% Stake in HDFC Bank	The RBI granted LIC approval to acquire up to 9.99% aggregate holding in HDFC Bank, subject to certain conditions.
31	BOB Financial Rebrands as BOBCARD with 'Credit Reimagined'	Bank of Baroda's subsidiary, BOB Financial Solutions, rebranded as BOBCARD Limited, with a focus on reshaping India's credit landscape.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of February 2024

Event	Details
Bank of Baroda Rebranding	BOBCARD Limited, the card subsidiary of Bank of Baroda, has rebranded with a new logo named 'Baroda Sun' and the tagline "Credit Reimagined." This initiative highlights a commitment to reshaping India's credit landscape with innovative and customer-centric solutions.
RBI Restrictions on Paytm Payments Bank	The RBI has imposed business restrictions on Paytm Payments Bank due to non-compliance and concerns raised during an external audit.
RBI Digital Payments Index (RBI-DPI)	The RBI-DPI surged to 418.77 in September 2023, showcasing a 10.94% annual increase in digital payments and reflecting growing adoption of online transactions.
Increase in Sovereign Gold Bonds (SGB)	The Indian government has more than doubled the issuance of Sovereign Gold Bonds (SGB) for FY 2024-25, from ₹1,500 crore in FY 2023 to ₹3,500 crore in FY 2024-25.
ESAF Small Finance Bank Bancassurance Partnership	ESAF Small Finance Bank has partnered with Edelweiss Tokio Life Insurance, focusing on customer needs, growth, and innovation in the financial sector.
RBI's ₹2,000 Currency Notes Reintegration	As of February 1, 2024, 97.50% of ₹2,000 notes have been successfully reintegrated into the banking system following the government's withdrawal initiative.
HDFC Bank's Stake Acquisition Approval	The RBI approved HDFC Bank's acquisition of stakes in six banks, including ICICI, Axis, and YES Bank, with an aggregate stake limit of 9.5%, valid until February 2025.
Fintech Authorization as Payment Aggregators	RBI has authorized Juspay, Decentro, and Zoho to operate as payment aggregators, positioning them alongside other major players in the fintech space.
Offline Functionality for e-Rupee Transactions	RBI has introduced offline functionality for e-rupee transactions to facilitate payments in areas with poor or limited internet connectivity.
Visa and Mastercard Directive	RBI has instructed Visa and Mastercard to cease card-based commercial payments by businesses due to non-compliance with KYC norms.
LIC's Increase in SBI Cards & Payments Stake	LIC has increased its stake in SBI Cards & Payments from 4.99% to 5.02% through open market purchases, strengthening its position in the company.
South Indian Bank's Technology Awards	South Indian Bank won the Best Technology Bank of the Year Award at the 19th IBA Annual Banking Technology Conference, receiving six awards, including three wins.
RBI & Nepal Rastra Bank UPI Integration	RBI has collaborated with Nepal Rastra Bank to integrate India's UPI with Nepal's NPI, streamlining cross-border remittances and facilitating cost-effective transfers.
PayU's Credit Lines on UPI	PayU, in collaboration with NPCI, introduced 'Credit Lines on UPI,' allowing merchants to make payments through pre-sanctioned credit lines.
City Union Bank's Award Achievements	City Union Bank won seven awards at the 19th Banking Technology Conference, including three wins and one runner-up position.
SIDBI's Fund of Funds for Startups (FFS) Report	SIDBI released a report on the FFS scheme, showcasing its positive impact on India's startup ecosystem, highlighting CRISIL's assessment of its transformative influence.
SBI's Digital Enrollment for Insurance Schemes	SBI introduced a self-subscribing digital enrollment for customers under PMJJBY and PMSBY schemes, eliminating the need for branch visits.
LIC's 'Amritbaal' Insurance Product	LIC launched a new insurance product, 'Amritbaal,' a savings life insurance plan aimed at the younger demographic, providing non-linked, non-participating benefits.
ICICI Bank Chairman Appointment	ICICI Bank appointed Mr. Pradeep Kumar Sinha as Non-Executive Part-time Chairman following the retirement of Mr. G. C. Chaturvedi.
India's Outward FDI Surge	India's outward FDI commitments surged 25.7% YoY to \$2.09 billion in January 2024, despite a sequential decline from December 2023 figures.
HDFC Bank's Profit	HDFC Bank emerged as the most profitable company for FY 2024, with a net profit of Rs 44,300 crore, followed by SBI and IOC.
ADB's Loan for Fintech Education	ADB sanctioned a \$23 million loan to promote fintech education and research in GIFT City, Gujarat, bolstering India's fintech ecosystem.
HDFC Bank's Credila Stake Divestment Approval	RBI approved HDFC Bank's plan to divest 90% of its stake in HDFC Credila, following the merger directive to reduce its holding to below 10%.
RBI Financial Literacy Week 2024	RBI is promoting financial literacy among young adults through the 2024 Financial Literacy Week (FLW) campaign, focusing on savings, banking essentials, and digital hygiene.
Dvara Money & Jana SFB Partnership	Dvara Money partnered with Jana SFB to enhance digital banking services and set new standards in fintech innovation.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of March 2024

News	Details
Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurates NUCFDC	The National Urban Cooperative Finance and Development Corporation Limited (NUCFDC) was inaugurated in New Delhi to modernize and strengthen the Urban Cooperative Banking Sector, benefiting banks and customers.
Policybazaar Insurance Brokers gets IRDAI approval	PB Fintech's subsidiary, Policybazaar Insurance Brokers, is now authorized to sell reinsurance products in addition to general and life insurance, enhancing insurance penetration in India.
Kotak Mahindra Bank launches Smart Choice Gold Loan	Kotak Mahindra Bank introduces a new gold loan targeting aspirational customers, leveraging gold reserves in Indian households.
RBI approves merger of Fincare Small Finance Bank and AU Small Finance Bank	The RBI approved the merger of Fincare Small Finance Bank with AU Small Finance Bank, effective from April 1.
RBI imposes ban on IIFL Finance gold loans	The Reserve Bank of India imposed a ban on IIFL Finance for gold loan approval and disbursement due to supervisory concerns.
UPI Transactions decline in February	UPI transactions saw a 0.7% drop in value and 0.8% drop in volume in February 2024 due to technical issues and the shorter month.
RBI to launch interoperable internet banking payment system	The Reserve Bank of India announced an interoperable payment system for internet banking to improve the efficiency of digital payments in India.
30 banks on UDGM portal for unclaimed deposits	The RBI's UDGM portal now allows individuals to search for unclaimed deposits across 30 participating banks.
Kotak Life Insurance launches Kotak G.A.I.N.	Kotak Life Insurance introduces Kotak G.A.I.N., a non-linked participating product offering long-term savings and income.
RBI and Bank Indonesia ink MoU for local currencies	A MoU was signed between RBI and Bank Indonesia to facilitate cross-border transactions using the Indian Rupee (INR) and Indonesian Rupiah (IDR).
NIPL partners with Fonepay for UPI transactions	NPCI International Payments Ltd partners with Nepal's Fonepay to enable cross-border UPI transactions between India and Nepal.
IndusInd Bank and Mastercard launch PayWear	IndusInd Bank collaborates with Mastercard to introduce 'Indus PayWear', tokenized wearables for contactless payments.
IREDA celebrates 38th Foundation Day	Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Ltd. (IREDA) celebrates its 38th Foundation Day, reflecting on its green finance journey.
CCI approves merger of GIPL and NESFB	The Competition Commission of India approves the merger of Garagepreneurs Internet Private Limited with North East Small Finance Bank.
SIDBI secures \$24.5 million for Avaana Sustainability Fund	SIDBI receives \$24.5 million from the Green Climate Fund for the Avaana Sustainability Fund, supporting climate finance initiatives.
Private Banks share of deposits increases	Private sector banks' share of total deposits rises to 34% as of December 2023, up from 25% in 2017-18.
Tata Motors to set up manufacturing unit in Tamil Nadu	Tata Motors announces an investment of Rs 9,000 crore to set up a new manufacturing unit in Tamil Nadu.
RBI issues halt order on co-branded credit cards	The RBI has ordered Federal Bank and South Indian Bank to stop issuing new co-branded credit cards.
India-ADB sign \$181 million loan for Ahmedabad's infrastructure	India and the Asian Development Bank (ADB) sign a loan agreement for \$181 million to improve infrastructure in Ahmedabad's peri-urban areas.
RBI imposes ₹1.40 crore penalty on Bank of India	RBI imposes a monetary penalty on Bank of India for non-compliance with certain banking regulations.
RBI releases guidelines for climate-related financial risks	RBI issues draft guidelines on climate-related financial risks for regulated entities to ensure transparency and risk management.

News	Details
India-ADB signs \$23 million loan for fintech landscape	India and ADB sign a \$23 million loan to enhance fintech education and innovation in Gujarat's GIFT-City.
SANY India partners with J&K Bank for machinery financing	SANY India partners with J&K Bank to offer accessible financial solutions for machinery acquisition in infrastructure projects.
Axis Bank pledges ₹100 crore to National Cancer Grid	Axis Bank contributes ₹100 crore to the National Cancer Grid for research and digital health adoption in oncology.
RBI purchases 8.7 tonnes of gold in January 2024	RBI purchases 8.7 tonnes of gold, increasing its reserves to 812.3 tonnes as of January 2024.
YES Bank partners with Indian Olympic Association	YES Bank becomes the official banking partner for Team India at the Paris Olympics 2024.
India's insurance sector receives ₹53,900 crore FDI	India's insurance sector receives Rs 53,900 crore in Foreign Direct Investment between 2014-2024.
RBI fines Tamilnad Mercantile Bank and DCB Bank	RBI imposes fines on Tamilnad Mercantile Bank (Rs 1.31 crore) and DCB Bank (Rs 63.6 lakh) for non-compliance with interest rate directives.
Airtel Payments Bank launches smart contactless watch	Airtel Payments Bank partners with Noise and Mastercard to launch a smart watch for contactless payments.
Axis Mutual Fund partners with Enparadigm for employee training	Axis Mutual Fund collaborates with Enparadigm to provide AI-driven training for enhanced employee performance.
DBS Bank commits \$250 million for new-age startups	DBS Bank commits USD 250 million to support new-age startups in India's growing entrepreneurial ecosystem.
SBI Cards launches Titan SBI Card for shopping	SBI Cards launches Titan SBI Card offering benefits like cashback, gift vouchers, and rewards for shoppers.
PolicyBazaar sets up PB Pay Private Limited for payment services	PolicyBazaar plans to diversify into payment aggregation with a new subsidiary, PB Pay Private Limited.
Federal Bank launches Flash Pay for contactless payments	Federal Bank introduces 'Flash Pay', a smart key chain enabling contactless NCMC payments.
Modi government allocates Rs 6212.03 crore for RRB recapitalization	The Union Government allocates Rs 6212.03 crore to recapitalize Regional Rural Banks (RRBs) in India.
RBI takes action against five co-operative banks	The RBI penalizes five co-operative banks for regulatory violations without questioning their customer transactions.
CCI approves Adani Power acquisition of Lanco Amarkantak Power	The Competition Commission of India approves Adani Power's full acquisition of Lanco Amarkantak Power Ltd.
IRDAI designates LIC, GIC Re, and New India Assurance as D-SIIs	IRDAI designates LIC, GIC Re, and New India Assurance as Domestic Systemically Important Insurers (D-SIIs) for 2023-24.
SEBI cancels Karvy Investor Services registration	SEBI cancels Karvy Investor Services Ltd's registration as a merchant banker due to eligibility breaches.
Kotak Mahindra Bank acquires Sonata Finance	Kotak Mahindra Bank acquires Sonata Finance Pvt Ltd for Rs. 537 crore, expanding its microfinance sector footprint.
Axis Bank introduces digital US dollar FDs for NRIs	Axis Bank introduces digital US dollar fixed deposits for NRIs at the GIFT City, Gujarat.
India's forex reserves rise to \$642.631 billion	India's foreign exchange reserves hit a new high of \$642.631 billion as of March 2024.
Bank of India receives ₹564.44 crore penalty from Income Tax Department	Bank of India faces a ₹564.44 crore penalty from the Income Tax Department for AY 2018-19.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of April 2024

Event	Details
HDFC Bank	Pursuing the sale of its entire stake in HDFC Education and Development Services through the Swiss challenge method to maintain transparency and regulatory compliance.
RBI 90th Anniversary	The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is entering its 90th year on April 1st, 2024. Prime Minister Modi will attend the event at Mumbai's National Centre for the Performing Arts.
GST Collection	In March 2024, GST collection reached Rs 1.78 lakh crore, an 11.5% increase compared to the previous year, marking the second-highest collection since the introduction of GST.
UPI Transactions FY24	UPI processed ₹19.78 lakh crore in March 2024, setting a new record for transaction volume and value, surpassing ₹18.41 lakh crore set in January 2024.
Credit Card Usage	As of December 2023, credit card usage in India surged to over 100 million cards, reflecting growing consumer spending and bank initiatives.
Karnataka Bank QIP	Karnataka Bank raised Rs 600 crore through a Qualified Institutional Placement (QIP) as part of a Rs 1,500 crore capital raise program.
RBI - DIGITA	The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is contemplating the creation of the Digital India Trust Agency (DIGITA) to combat illegal lending apps and enhance cybersecurity.
AU Small Finance Bank Merger	AU Small Finance Bank merged with Fincare Small Finance Bank, consolidating its presence in South India through an all-stock deal.
SEBI - SCORES 2.0	The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) launched SCORES 2.0, an upgraded complaint redress system to streamline investor complaint processes.
Axis Bank & Max Life Insurance	The Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved Axis Bank's acquisition of a stake in Max Life Insurance to strengthen Max Life's growth and solvency margins.
UPI Transaction Growth (2023)	UPI transactions surged by 56% YoY in the second half of 2023, with transaction value rising by 44%, totaling Rs 99.68 trillion.
RBI Forex Regulations Deferred	RBI postponed the implementation of new regulations for exchange-traded forex derivatives to May 3, 2024.
RBI Penalties on Banks	RBI imposed penalties on IDFC First Bank and LIC Housing Finance for non-compliance with regulations.
SIDBI - KarmaLife Collaboration	SIDBI partnered with KarmaLife to provide micro-loans to gig workers through KarmaLife's mobile app.
RBI Consumer Confidence Survey	RBI's March 2024 survey revealed a rise in consumer confidence, with the Future Expectations Index reaching 125.2, the highest since 2019.
RBI NBFC Registration	RBI canceled registrations of four NBFCs and received voluntary surrenders from 11 other entities due to business exit or non-requirement.
Canara Bank & SINE MoU	Canara Bank signed an MoU with SINE, IIT Bombay, to provide financial assistance to startups.
SBI & Standard Chartered CDS Trade	SBI and Standard Chartered conducted a ₹25 crore Credit Default Swap (CDS) trade as part of credit risk management initiatives.
HDFC Bank Lakshadweep Branch	HDFC Bank opened a branch in Lakshadweep, marking its first private sector bank presence in the Union Territory.
Direct Tax Collections (FY 2023-24)	Net direct tax collections for FY 2023-24 exceeded budget estimates by Rs 1.35 lakh crore, showing a growth of 17.7% compared to the previous year.
HDFC Life Insurance Leadership Change	Deepak S Parekh resigned as chairman of HDFC Life, and Keki Mistry was appointed as the new chairman.
PayU RBI Authorization	PayU received in-principle authorization from RBI to operate as a Payments Aggregator under the Payment Settlements Act, 2007.
Gems and Jewellery Exports	India's gems and jewellery exports fell by 14.94% to \$32.02 billion in FY 2023-24 compared to the previous year.
RBI Guidelines for ARCs	RBI issued new guidelines for Asset Reconstruction Companies (ARCs), requiring a minimum capital of Rs 300 crore to ensure financial stability.
Kotak Mahindra Bank RBI Action	Kotak Mahindra Bank's shares dropped by 10% after RBI restricted the bank from onboarding new customers online due to IT system deficiencies.

Event	Details
RBI FEMA Regulations for Direct Listings	RBI issued regulations to facilitate the direct listing of Indian companies on international stock exchanges.
NABARD & RBI Innovation Hub	NABARD partnered with the RBI Innovation Hub to digitalize agricultural lending and improve access for farmers.
SBI Card - Travel Credit Cards	SBI Card launched three travel-centric credit card variants, designed to cater to diverse travel needs with curated benefits.
Talkcharge Technologies RBI Directive	RBI instructed Talkcharge Technologies to stop issuing prepaid wallets and refund balances held in these wallets by May 17, 2024.
IndusInd Bank & CIH RBI Pilot Program	IndusInd Bank successfully executed RBI's pilot program on programmable CBDC, targeting farmers for carbon credit generation.
RBI Guidelines for SFBs Transition	RBI issued guidelines for Small Finance Banks (SFBs) seeking to transition to Universal Banks, ensuring financial stability.
The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has imposed penalties	RBI has imposed penalties totaling Rs 60.3 lakh on five co-operative banks for contravening various regulatory norms. These penalties primarily stem from non-compliance with specific directives issued by the RBI, encompassing bans on loans and advances to directors and their relatives, restrictions on opening savings accounts for certain entities, and maintenance of deposit accounts. Penalty Breakdown Rajkot Nagarik Sahakari Bank: Fined Rs 43.30 lakh for violations related to loans to directors and their relatives, prohibition on certain savings account openings, and deposit account maintenance. The Kangra Co-operative Bank (New Delhi): Penalized Rs 5 lakh. Rajdhani Nagar Sahkari Bank (Lucknow): Also fined Rs 5 lakh. Zila Sahakari Bank, Garhwal (Kotdwar, Uttarakhand): Subject to a Rs 5 lakh penalty. District Co-operative Bank (Dehradun): Imposed with a penalty of Rs 2.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of May 2024

News Item	Summary
RBI guidelines for SFBs to Universal Banks	RBI issues guidelines for Small Finance Banks (SFBs) to transition to Universal Banks, outlining eligibility and procedural requirements.
OTP Fraud Prevention by MHA and SBI Cards	MHA collaborates with SBI Cards and telecom operators to combat OTP fraud by developing a solution to alert users about OTP thefts.
RBI and CP Issuances by NBFCs	RBI's decision to raise risk weights on loans to high-rated NBFCs increases CP issuances by NBFCs to a 4.5-year high of ₹1.2 lakh crore in Q1 2024.
RBI revokes Acemoney's License	RBI revokes the license of Acemoney (India) Limited due to irregular lending practices and inadequate risk management in digital lending.
UPI Transactions Dip in April 2024	UPI transactions dip slightly in volume and value in April but show robust year-on-year growth.
India-Bangladesh MoU on Officer Training	India renews MoU with Bangladesh for training 1500 officers between 2025-2030, strengthening ties in governance.
RBI Penalizes Co-operative Banks	RBI imposes penalties on five co-operative banks for regulatory deficiencies in compliance.
RBI Introduces Floating Rate Bond (FRB) 2034	RBI introduces Floating Rate Savings Bond 2034, with 8% interest rate, resetting every 6 months based on market conditions.
ICICI Bank Market Capitalization Milestone	ICICI Bank's shares surge, crossing ₹8 trillion in market capitalization, placing it among India's top five companies.
Fi NBFC License from RBI	Neobanking startup Fi receives RBI's approval for an NBFC license, enabling it to offer loans from its own books.
YES Bank Introduces Pi and Phi Credit Cards	YES Bank launches Pi (digital-only) and Phi (physical) credit cards, blending fintech with traditional banking.
HDFC Life Campaign for Simplified Insurance	HDFC Life launches the "No Jhanjhat Life Insurance Fatafat" campaign to simplify and speed up life insurance purchases online.

News Item	Summary
RBI Updates on ₹2000 Banknotes Circulation	RBI reveals 97.76% of ₹2000 notes have been reabsorbed; only ₹7,961 crore remain in circulation.
GetVantage NBFC License from RBI	GetVantage becomes the first revenue-based finance startup to obtain an NBFC license from RBI.
RBI Updates for Custodian Banks	RBI updates guidelines for custodian banks amid T+1 settlement regime, lowering the maximum intraday risk cap to 30%.
ICICI Bank UPI for NRI Customers	ICICI Bank introduces UPI transactions for NRI customers using international mobile numbers.
Bank of Baroda's BoB World App Resumed	RBI lifts restrictions on Bank of Baroda's BoB World mobile app, allowing customer onboarding after corrective actions.
HDFC Bank's Parivartan Start-up Grants	HDFC Bank, with NITI Aayog's Atal Innovation Mission, grants Rs 19.6 crore to 170 social sector startups in FY24.
P-Note Investments in Indian Markets	P-note investments in Indian capital markets hit ₹1.5 lakh crore in February 2024, marking a six-year high.
RBI G-Sec Buyback Details	RBI conducts a buyback of ₹17,384 crore of G-Secs, accepting only ₹10,513 crore despite ₹40,000 crore being notified.
YES Bank Partners EBANX for Payment Solutions	YES Bank partners with EBANX to offer scalable cross-border payment solutions for Indian merchants.
SBI Financial Performance	SBI records a record net profit of ₹20,698 crore in Q1 2024, driven by strong non-interest income and cost management.
India's Fiscal Deficit Outlook	India's fiscal deficit for FY24 expected to be better than the government's projection, driven by increased tax receipts.
Quant Mutual Fund's Stake in RBL Bank	RBI approves Quant MF's stake increase in RBL Bank to 9.98% by 2025.
HDFC Bank's Virtual Credit Card – Pixel Play	HDFC Bank launches Pixel Play, a virtual credit card that allows personalized card designs via PayZapp.
LIC's Deadline Extension for Public Shareholding	SEBI extends LIC's deadline for achieving 10% public shareholding to May 2027.
India's Internet Economy Growth	India's internet economy poised to hit \$1 trillion by 2030, with e-commerce growing rapidly.
GST Portal Introduces Tax Compliance Measures	New forms and procedures introduced by GST portal to curb tax evasion in the tobacco sector.
RBI Repurchases Government Bonds	RBI repurchases ₹2,069 crore of G-Secs out of ₹60,000 crore, facing resistance due to higher bond prices.
SBI General Insurance Launches Surety Bond Bima	SBI General Insurance launches Surety Bond Bima for securing infrastructure development projects.
IRDAI Adjustments to Surety Bond Regulations	IRDAI amends regulations to make surety bonds more accessible for infrastructure projects.
SEBI's Amendments to LODR Regulations	SEBI revises LODR regulations, focusing on market capitalization calculations for listed companies.
Bank of Maharashtra's Strong Growth	Bank of Maharashtra outperforms peers with 15% growth in total business and deposits.
PSBs Expected to Deliver Higher Dividends	Public sector banks expected to deliver 30% higher dividends for FY24, totaling ₹18,013 crore.
YES Bank Launches YES Grandeur Premium Banking Service	YES Bank introduces YES Grandeur, a premium banking service for affluent customers.
Swiggy Partners with SHIELD for Fraud Prevention	Swiggy teams up with SHIELD to enhance fraud detection and prevention in its Delivery Partner ecosystem.
RBI's Dividend Transfer to Govt	RBI transfers ₹2.11 lakh crore as dividend to the Government of India for FY23-24.
HDFC Bank Divests Stake in Protean eGov Technologies	HDFC Bank sells 3.2% stake in Protean eGov Technologies for ₹150 crore, while Nippon India Mutual Fund acquires a similar stake.
RBI Imposes Penalty on Hero FinCorp	RBI imposes a ₹3.1 lakh penalty on Hero FinCorp for non-compliance with fair practices code.

News Item	Summary
RBI Unveils New Initiatives	RBI introduces Pravaah portal, Retail Direct Mobile App, and FinTech Repository for improved regulatory processes.
RBI Penalty on ICICI Bank and YES Bank	RBI penalizes ICICI Bank and YES Bank for regulatory violations in financial reporting.
RBI Penalizes HSBC for FEMA Breach	RBI fines HSBC ₹36.38 lakh for failing to comply with FEMA regulations under the Liberalised Remittance Scheme.
RBI Takes Action Against Edelweiss Group	RBI takes strict action against Edelweiss Group for loan manipulation and regulatory non-compliance.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of June 2024

News Headline	Key Details
RBI Cancels Green Bond Auction	Traders refused to pay the greenium, highlighting reluctance for sustainable investments.
SBI's Market Capitalization	SBI's market capitalization surpassed ₹8 lakh crore, driven by strong stock performance.
SEBI's Saathi 2.0 App	SEBI launched "Saathi 2.0" to simplify financial concepts and assist investors.
PNB Dilutes Stake in Canara HSBC Life	PNB plans to dilute 10% stake in Canara HSBC Life Insurance through an IPO.
Bank Clinic by AIBEA	AIBEA's Bank Clinic will provide guidance on addressing banking grievances, focusing on RBI's regulatory standards.
Axis Bank-Bajaj Allianz Partnership	Axis Bank and Bajaj Allianz General Insurance partnered to boost insurance penetration across Axis Bank's network.
SBI Mutual Fund's Historic Milestone	SBI Mutual Fund surpassed ₹10 trillion in assets under management (AUM), driven by the equity boom.
RBI Absorbs Surplus Liquidity	RBI conducted ₹44,430 crore in reverse repo auctions to absorb excess liquidity from the banking system.
Air India and Vistara Merger	NCLT approved the merger of Air India and Vistara, with Singapore Airlines holding 25.1% stake in Air India.
Zurich Insurance Acquires Kotak Mahindra General Insurance	RBI approved Zurich Insurance's acquisition of 70% stake in Kotak Mahindra General Insurance for ₹5,560 crore.
RBI's Hackathon on Financial Fraud Prevention	RBI launched HaRBInGer 2024 hackathon to develop tech solutions for preventing financial frauds.
RBI Raises Bulk FD Limit	RBI raised the bulk fixed deposit limit from ₹2 crore to ₹3 crore to refine liquidity management.
India Exim Bank Expands in East Africa	India Exim Bank opened a representative office in Nairobi, Kenya, to enhance trade with East Africa.
Tax Devolution for States	₹1.39 lakh crore in tax devolution approved for states, including an additional installment for development.
Bank of India Acquires Stake in Clearing Corporation	Bank of India acquired a 6.125% stake in Clearing Corporation of India Ltd. (IFSC) for ₹6.125 crore.
SBI's Expansion with NBFCs/HFCs	SBI sanctioned loans totaling ₹2,030 crore to 2.79 lakh borrowers through collaboration with 23 NBFCs/HFCs.
PNB to Open Dubai Representative Office	PNB received board approval to open a representative office in Dubai, expected in the current financial year.
GAIL's 1500 KTA Ethane Cracker Project	GAIL plans a ₹60,000 crore project in Madhya Pradesh to produce ethylene and bolster petrochemical infrastructure.
RBI's Action on Payment Frauds	RBI plans to launch a Digital Payments Intelligence Platform to combat rising payment frauds.
SBI's SME Digital Business Loans	SBI launched SME Digital Business Loans, offering quick loan approvals in 45 minutes.
Axis Bank Fined by FIU	FIU levied a ₹1.66 crore penalty on Axis Bank for neglecting suspicious transaction reporting.
RBI Imposes Penalties on Banks	RBI fined Central Bank of India ₹1.45 crore and Sonali Bank ₹96.4 lakh for breaches of customer protection and KYC norms.

News Headline	Key Details
Purvanchal Co-operative Bank's License Revoked	RBI revoked the license of Purvanchal Co-operative Bank due to inadequate capital and bleak earnings.
IFC Invests in Brookfield Solar Power Project	IFC committed \$105 million to Brookfield's Bikaner Solar Power project in Rajasthan to expand renewable energy infrastructure.
Axis Bank Increases Stake in Max Life Insurance	Axis Bank invested ₹336 crore to increase its shareholding in Max Life Insurance.
Indian Funds in Swiss Banks Drop	Indian funds in Swiss banks declined by 70% in 2023, dropping to a four-year low of 1.04 billion Swiss Francs.
SBI Distributes ₹6,959 Crore Dividend to Govt	SBI distributed a higher dividend of ₹6,959 crore for FY 2023-24, reflecting record profits.
RBI's High Demand in VRR Auction	RBI's VRR auction saw ₹1.6 trillion in bids, showing high demand for cash amid tight liquidity.
RBI's DBIE Portal Update	RBI updated its 'Database on Indian Economy' portal with a new domain for seamless access.
SBI to Open 400 New Branches	SBI announced plans to open 400 new branches in FY 2024-25 to improve customer service and enhance digital banking.
Kotak Mahindra Bank to Expand Branches	Kotak Mahindra Bank plans to add 175-200 new branches in FY25 despite regulatory restrictions.
ICICI Bank Crosses \$100 Billion Market Capitalization	ICICI Bank became the sixth company in India to surpass \$100 billion in market capitalization.
India's External Debt Increases	India's external debt rose by \$39.7 billion to \$663.8 billion, though the debt-to-GDP ratio decreased.
India's Short-Term Debt Declines	India's short-term external debt ratio fell, strengthening the external sector's resilience.
SBI Raises ₹10,000 Crore Through Infrastructure Bonds	SBI raised ₹10,000 crore through its fifth infrastructure bond issuance, attracting significant investor interest.
RBI's GNPA Ratio Projection	RBI projected a reduction in the gross non-performing assets (GNPA) ratio to 2.5% by March 2025.
RBI's Revised Currency Swap Arrangement	RBI revised the currency swap framework for SAARC countries for the 2024-2027 period.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of July 2024

News Headline	Key Details
Union Bank of India Launches "Union Premier" Branches	Tailored for high-value customers in rural and semi-urban markets, offering personalized banking services.
RBI Increases Ways and Means Advances Limit for States and UTs	Raised by 28%, from ₹47,010 crore to ₹60,118 crore, to help manage temporary cash flow mismatches.
World Bank Approves \$1.5 Billion Financing for Low-Carbon Energy	Financing to promote green hydrogen, electrolyzers, and renewable energy, aligned with India's energy transition targets.
RBI Collaborates on Project Nexus for Cross-Border Payments	Multilateral initiative for efficient retail cross-border payments, expected to go live by 2026.
SBI Launches "MSME Sahaj" for Online Business Loans	Web-based platform to offer credit against GST invoices to MSMEs.
ICICI Bank Launches 'Student Sapphire Forex Card'	Forex prepaid card designed for students going abroad for higher education, offering exclusive benefits.
RBI Imposes ₹1.32 Crore Penalty on PNB	Monetary penalty for violations related to loans, advances, and KYC norms.
NPS Records 40.1% Growth, Reaches ₹2.47-Lakh Crore	Growth fueled by equity markets and expanding private sector subscriptions, pushing total NPS assets to ₹12.5-lakh crore.
Bank of Baroda Plans to Raise ₹7,500 Crore Through Bonds	Plans to raise funds through Additional Tier-I and Tier-II bonds to support growth.
RBI Launches OBICUS Survey for Manufacturing Sector	Quarterly survey to inform monetary policy decisions, focusing on orders, inventories, and capacity utilization.

News Headline	Key Details
SEBI Introduces New Guidelines for Credit Rating Agencies	Guidelines for credit rating agencies to streamline operations and enhance ease of business.
PSBs Pay ₹6,481 Crore Dividend to Government	Four public sector banks (Canara Bank, Indian Bank, Bank of India, EXIM Bank) paid dividends for FY 2023-24.
ICICI Prudential Launches Nifty Oil & Gas ETF	New ETF launched in the Indian investment landscape focusing on the Nifty Oil & Gas sector.
Kotak Mahindra AMC Launches BSE PSU Index Fund	Passive equity fund tracking the BSE PSU Index, offering low-cost investment in PSU stocks.
PNB Introduces 'Safety Ring' Feature for Cyber Fraud Protection	Additional layer of security for internet and mobile banking users to prevent unauthorized access.
World Bank Approves \$1.5 Billion for Low-Carbon Energy Development	Funding for scaling up green hydrogen and renewable energy in India as part of the country's energy transition.
India's Wholesale Price Index (WPI) Shows 3.36% Inflation	Provisional inflation rate driven by increased prices in food, crude oil, and manufacturing sectors.
SBI Launches "Amrit Vrishti" Term Deposit Scheme	444-day term deposit with an interest rate of 7.25%, offering an additional 0.50% for senior citizens.
ADB Approves \$240.5 Million for Solar Rooftop Systems in India	Financing for the expansion of residential rooftop solar systems to enhance energy access.
RBI Sets Up Committee for White-Label ATMs Fee Review	Committee to review and recommend a sustainable fee model for white-label ATMs.
IndusInd Bank Launches 'Wrestle for Glory' CSR Program	CSR initiative in partnership with Inspire Institute of Sport to support athletes.
SIDBI Receives \$215.6 Million from Green Climate Fund	Funds to create a corpus of \$1 billion for financing projects for MSMEs in climate mitigation and adaptation.
AU Small Finance Bank Approves Transition to Universal Bank	AU Small Finance Bank plans to shift from a small finance bank to a universal bank.
CPI for Agricultural and Rural Labourers Increases by 11 Points	CPI-AL and CPI-RL rose to 1280 and 1292, respectively, in June 2024.
RBI Introduces Prompt Corrective Action Framework for UCBs	Framework for weaker urban co-operative banks to improve their financial health.
India's Digital Payments Increase by 12.6% YoY	Digital payments grew by 12.6% in FY2024, according to RBI's Digital Payments Index.
Karnataka Bank Partners with ICICI Lombard for Insurance Products	Strategic partnership to offer a range of insurance products to Karnataka Bank customers.
RBI Selects Five Entities for Fifth Cohort of Regulatory Sandbox	Entities selected for testing in RBI's theme-neutral regulatory sandbox.
SEBI Launches 'SEVA' AI-Powered Chatbot for Investors	AI chatbot designed to assist investors with a range of functions in the securities market.
11 PSBs Charge Rs 2,331 Crore for Non-Maintenance of Minimum Balance	Eleven public sector banks imposed fees for non-maintenance of minimum balance in FY2024.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of August 2024

News Headline	Key Details
RBI Tightens Public Deposit Norms for Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)	Aligns HFC regulations with NBFC norms for public deposits.
RBI Sets Up Expert Committee on Benchmarking Statistics	Led by Deputy Governor Michael Patra, the 10-member committee will submit its report by November 2024.
PNB Launches PNB ANTAH DRISHTI Braille Debit Card	Initiative aimed at improving financial accessibility for visually impaired individuals.
Axis Bank Unveils 'Primus' Credit Card for UHNWIs	An ultra-premium credit card launched in partnership with Visa for ultra-high-net-worth individuals.
RBL Bank Introduces Vijay Fixed Deposits	Special scheme launched to commemorate India's 78th Independence Day.

News Headline	Key Details
L&T Finance Ltd. Transitioned to NBFC-ICC	Transformed from NBFC-CIC to NBFC-ICC after merging subsidiaries like L&T Finance and L&T Infra Credit Ltd.
RBI Cancels Licenses of 78 Urban Cooperative Banks	Maharashtra tops the list with 36 license cancellations, followed by Uttar Pradesh (14) and Karnataka (8).
Pakistan Paid \$3.6 Billion Interest on IMF Loans in 40 Years	Disclosure made by Pakistan's finance ministry during a Senate Standing Committee meeting on Economic Affairs.
RBI Revises Bad and Doubtful Debt Reserve (BDDR) Norms for Cooperative Banks	Aims to standardize the accounting and prudential treatment of NPAs.
Capital Small Finance Bank Partners with Edelweiss Life Insurance	Collaboration for a bancassurance tie-up.
RBI Increases UPI Tax Payment Limit to Rs 5 Lakh	UPI limit for tax payments raised from Rs 1 lakh to Rs 5 lakh per transaction.
RBI Changes Credit Reporting Frequency to Every 15 Days	A significant shift from the earlier monthly credit reporting requirement.
Setu and Axis Bank Launch UPI Setu	A new API infrastructure provider initiative by Pine Labs' Setu in collaboration with Axis Bank.
RBI Revamps Cheque Truncation System (CTS)	Reduces cheque clearing cycles to enhance efficiency and reduce settlement risks.
China Approves Construction of 11 New Nuclear Reactors	Total investment of \$31 billion (220 billion yuan) across five sites.
RBI Governor Shaktikanta Das Ranked Top Central Banker Globally	Recognized for the second consecutive year by the US-based Global Finance magazine.
Airtel Payments Bank Introduces Face Match Feature	AI-based security feature to enhance account protection.
RBI Forecasts Private Capital Expenditure to Reach ₹2.45 Trillion in FY25	Up from ₹1.59 trillion in FY24, indicating substantial growth.
NPCI Launches 'UPI Circle'	Feature allows primary UPI account holders to delegate payment responsibilities securely to secondary users.
NCLT Approves Slice-North East Small Finance Bank Merger	Merger aims to combine fintech and small finance banking strengths.
RBI Updates e-Mandate Framework	Adds auto-replenishment for FASTag and NCMC balances.
Bandhan Bank Launches Avni Savings Account	A savings account specifically designed for women.
Jana Small Finance Bank Wins Four ICC Emerging Asia Banking Awards	Recognized for innovation and excellence in banking.
ESAF Small Finance Bank and NPCI Launch Inori RuPay Platinum Credit Card	A new credit card offering in collaboration with NPCI.
LIC Presents ₹3,662.17 Crore Dividend Cheque to Finance Minister	Dividend declared at ₹6 per share for 2023-24, doubling from ₹3 per share in the previous fiscal year.
RBI Fines UCO Bank and Cent Bank Home Finance Ltd. for Regulatory Violations	UCO Bank fined ₹2.68 crore for multiple violations; Cent Bank Home Finance fined ₹2.1 lakh for KYC non-compliance.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of September 2024

News Headline	Key Details
POP Launches India's First Multi-Brand Co-Branded Credit Card	The YEB BANK POP-CLUB RuPay credit card integrates brands like Zomato, Blinkit, and Cleartrip to address key spending areas in partnership with RuPay and Yes Bank.
HDFC Bank Introduces GIGA for Gig Workers	A suite of financial products and services for India's 30-50 million gig workers, including freelancers.
SBI Foundation Launches 3rd Edition of SBI Asha Scholarship Programme	Targets support for 10,000 underprivileged students with substantial financial assistance.
RBI Penalizes NBFCs for Non-Compliance	Godrej Housing Finance Ltd. and Aadhar Housing Finance Ltd. fined ₹5 lakh each; HUDCO fined ₹3.5 lakh.
CPI-IW for July 2024 Rises to 142.7	The Consumer Price Index for Industrial Workers increased by 1.3 points in July 2024, as per the Labour Bureau.

News Headline	Key Details
Union Bank of India Joins PCAF	First major Indian bank to sign the Partnership for Carbon Accounting Financials, aligning with RBI's climate risk disclosure guidelines.
India's Forex Reserves Reach All-Time High of \$689.235 Billion	Forex reserves increased by \$5.248 billion as of September 6, 2024.
HDFC CSR Initiative to Boost Marginal Farmers' Income	Aims to increase income for 5 lakh farmers earning less than ₹60,000 annually by 2025 under the Parivartan program.
India Becomes 6th Largest Market in MSCI ACWI IMI	India surpasses China with a 2.35% weight in the index, now the largest emerging market in MSCI ACWI IMI.
Windfall Tax on Domestically Produced Crude Oil Scrapped	Effective September 18, 2024, the windfall tax on crude oil reduced to zero.
YES BANK and Paisabazaar Launch PaisaSave Credit Card	A co-branded credit card offering by YES BANK and Paisabazaar for consumer credit needs.
Axis Bank Partners with Mastercard to Launch MyBiz Credit Card	A credit card designed for sole proprietors and SMEs, offering business and travel benefits.
Bank of Baroda and EaseMyTrip Introduce Co-Branded Travel Debit Card	Aimed at frequent travelers, it's the first co-branded travel debit card launched by a public sector bank in India.
SEBI Implements UPI for Public Issues	Retail investors must use UPI to block funds for debt securities worth up to ₹5 lakh.
SEBI Launches Foreign Portfolio Investor Outreach Cell	Part of the AFD, this cell aims to enhance engagement with foreign portfolio investors.
IndusInd Bank Reappoints Sumant Kathpalia as MD & CEO	His new term will run from March 24, 2025, to March 23, 2028, pending RBI and shareholder approval.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of October 2024

Bank Name	Purpose
IndusInd Bank	The board of IndusInd Bank has approved the reappointment of Sumant Kathpalia as Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (MD & CEO) for another three-year term from March 24, 2025, to March 23, 2028, pending approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and shareholders.
Federal Bank	- Federal Bank has signed an MoU with Bhashini, an AI-powered language translation platform, to integrate vernacular language support into its AI chatbot, Feddy. - This collaboration, inspired by the Reserve Bank Innovation Hub's (RBIH) initiative for local language banking, aims to make banking services more inclusive and accessible across India. - With Feddy now capable of responding in 14 languages, customers will have greater ease in accessing banking services, particularly in their native languages, marking a significant step in enhancing the accessibility of financial services.
HDFC Bank	- HDFC Bank has officially announced the divestment of its entire 100% stake in HDFC Education and Development Services Pvt. Ltd (HDFC Edu) to Vama Sundari Investments for ₹192 crore. - This all-cash transaction, valued at ₹9.60 per share, aligns with the bank's strategy to comply with regulatory requirements and streamline its operations following the merger with e-HDFC Ltd.
Bank of Baroda	- Announced its decision to sell its Oman operations to Bank Dhofar as part of a broader strategy to rationalize its foreign business footprint. This acquisition will take place on a going concern basis, pending approval from regulatory authorities. - The total business of BoB's Oman operations is valued at 113.35 million Omani Rials, with a net worth of 25.54 million Omani Rials.
Axis Bank	International Finance Corporation (IFC) has partnered with Axis Bank to provide a \$500 million loan aimed at scaling up blue finance and green projects in India. - This is IFC's first blue investment in the country and the largest climate finance initiative by IFC in India to date. Blue loans focus on funding water and wastewater management, reducing ocean plastic pollution, restoring marine ecosystems, and promoting offshore renewable energy, among others.
Bank of Baroda	Bank of Baroda (BoB) has introduced a new 400-day term deposit scheme known as the 'bob Utsav Deposit Scheme', aimed at offering higher interest rates to various categories of depositors during the festive season. - This scheme not only provides competitive interest rates for general depositors but also caters specifically to senior and super senior citizens, making it a beneficial investment option for a wide range of customers.

Bank Name	Purpose
	The interest rates offered under this scheme vary based on the category of the depositor: - General Citizens: The scheme provides an interest rate of 7.30%. - Senior Citizens (aged 60 and above): Eligible for a higher interest rate of 7.80%. - Super Senior Citizens (aged 80 and above): Benefiting from the highest interest rate in the category, 7.90%. - Non-Callable Deposits: Offering interest rates as high as 7.95%, making it an attractive option for customers who do not require premature withdrawal.
HDFC Bank	HDFC Bank has officially opened its first branch in Singapore as part of its strategy to expand its international operations. - Granted a wholesale banking license by the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS), effective from October 15, 2024, the bank aims to offer a variety of financial products and services to residents of Singapore.
Jio Payments Bank	Jio Payments Bank, a subsidiary of Jio Financial Services, has successfully obtained a mutual fund distribution license from the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI). - This Category 1 Execution-only Platform (EOP) license enables Jio Payments Bank to distribute the direct plans of various mutual fund schemes, marking a significant step in its expansion within the financial services sector.
State Bank of India (SBI)	State Bank of India (SBI) successfully raised ₹5,000 crore through the issuance of Additional Tier-I (AT-I) bonds, marking its first issuance for the current financial year. The bonds, which carry a coupon rate of 7.98%, are aimed at strengthening the bank's capital base and comply with Basel-III norms.
State Bank of India	State Bank of India (SBI) has been awarded the title of Best Bank in India for 2024 by Global Finance Magazine during its 31st Annual Best Bank Awards, held in Washington, coinciding with the Annual Meetings of the IMF and the World Bank. SBI Chairman CS Setty accepted the award, highlighting the bank's dedication to exceptional services and its role in promoting financial inclusion across the nation.
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	Ujjivan Small Finance Bank has secured approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for foreign exchange services, marking a significant milestone in its operational capabilities. The bank has been granted the 'Authorised Dealer Category 1 licence', allowing it to offer a comprehensive range of foreign exchange products and services.
State Bank of India	Solex Energy has partnered with the State Bank of India (SBI) to provide financing options for solar projects, targeting commercial, industrial, and institutional customers. Under this collaboration, SBI will offer loans up to ₹10 crore through its Surya Shakti Solar Finance Scheme, aiming to make solar energy more accessible and affordable in India.
North East Small Finance Bank	Fintech firm Slice has successfully merged with North East Small Finance Bank over a year after receiving approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). This merger consolidates their operations, assets, and brand identities into one institution, enhancing the bank's footprint in India's northeastern region.
State Bank of India (SBI) and India Exim Bank	The State Bank of India (SBI) and India Exim Bank are actively supporting businesses in African countries by addressing the trade finance gap, as highlighted by the South African heads of the two organizations during the India Entrepreneurs Forum (IEF).
IndusInd Bank	IndusInd Bank has partnered with Tata Power Renewable Energy Limited (TPREL) to provide collateral-free solar financing solutions for Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) in India. This strategic alliance aims to facilitate easy access to solar energy financing, promoting sustainability and reducing operational costs for MSEs.

Current Affairs related to Regulatory authorities		
S.No.	Name	Purpose
1.	Reserve Bank of India	RBI action: The Reserve Bank of India has barred four NBFCs from sanctioning and disbursing loans for charging exorbitant interest rates. Affected NBFCs: The four entities are Asirvad Microfinance, Arohan Financial Services (MFI), DMI Finance, and Navi Finserv (founded by Flipkart co-founder Sachin Bansal). Ban effective date: The ban will take effect on October 21, 2024, allowing time for pending transactions to close. Monetary policy warning: RBI Governor Shaktikanta Das had cautioned NBFCs and MFIs about prioritizing excessive returns and charging high fees and penalties in the October 8, 2024 monetary policy statement.

Current Affairs related to Regulatory authorities		
S.No.	Name	Purpose
		- Supervisory concerns: The action was based on supervisory concerns about excessive weighted average lending rates (WALR) and interest spread over cost of funds. - RBI inspections: Detailed inspections of NBFC-MFIs were conducted in the first quarter of the financial year, focusing on pricing policies and interest rates charged to customers.
2.	Reserve Bank of India	Rupee Resilience: The Indian rupee settled at 83.97 against the US dollar due to active RBI intervention, preventing it from breaching the critical 84 mark. RBI's Role: The Reserve Bank of India intervened in non-deliverable forwards (NDF) and local spot markets, helping stabilize the rupee amid pressure from foreign portfolio outflows, rising crude oil prices, and a strengthening dollar index. Key Factors Affecting the Rupee: - Foreign equity outflows from India. - Rising crude oil prices. - Strong US dollar index. Forward Premiums: Dollar-rupee forward premiums dropped by 11 basis points to 2.27%, influenced by higher US Treasury yields and better-than-expected US job data. US Economic Impact: The US added 254,000 jobs in September, exceeding the forecast of 140,000, narrowing the interest rate differential between the US and India. India's Forex Reserves: India's foreign exchange reserves surged past \$700 billion, supported by RBI interventions and foreign currency assets. Historical Trends: The rupee has hit new lows over the past two months due to fears of a slowing US economy and declining interest in emerging market currencies. Future Outlook: The rupee's future trajectory will depend on US economic indicators and Federal Open Market Committee decisions regarding interest rates. RBI's Market Activity: In FY24, RBI has net bought \$19.2 billion in the spot market, though net dollar sales have totaled \$2.4 billion, reflecting a tightening balance of payments and widening trade deficit.
3.	Reserve Bank of India	Revised Framework (2024-2027): The RBI, with the Government of India's concurrence, has introduced a revised Currency Swap Framework for SAARC countries for the period 2024-2027. INR Swap Window: A new INR Swap Window has been introduced with a corpus of ₹250 billion to offer swap support in Indian Rupees, providing various concessions. US Dollar/Euro Swap Window: The existing US Dollar/Euro Swap Window will continue, with a corpus of US\$ 2 billion for SAARC countries. Currency Swap Facility: Originally launched on November 15, 2012, the SAARC Currency Swap Facility provides financial backstop support for foreign exchange liquidity or balance of payment crises for SAARC countries. Bilateral Swap Agreements: The facility will be available to SAARC member countries, subject to them signing bilateral swap agreements with the RBI.
4.	Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has appointed Aviral Jain as Executive Director (ED) with effect from October 01, 2024. - Prior to being promoted to ED, Jain was serving as Regional Director for Maharashtra. As Executive Director, he will look after the several departments for the smooth functioning of RBI.
5.	Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India on Tuesday said 98 per cent of the ₹2,000 denomination notes have been returned since its May 2023 move to withdraw the currency notes. - The total value of notes of the denomination has reduced to ₹7,117 crore from the ₹3.56 lakh crore on May 19, 2023, the central bank said. - On May 19, 2023, the RBI announced a surprise decision to withdraw the ₹2,000 currency notes. The move was prompted on quality concerns and the denomination introduced after the demonetisation of November 2016 fulfilling its purpose. - The central bank said ₹2,000 notes continue to be legal tender and can be exchanged at 19 issue offices of the RBI either physically or sent by post for a credit into bank accounts.
6.	Reserve Bank of India (RBI)	Purpose of Alert List: Identifies entities unauthorized to operate under the Foreign Exchange Management Act, 1999 (FEMA) or electronic trading platforms (ETPs) for forex transactions. Recent Update: 13 new entities added to the list, bringing the total to 88. Notable Additions: TDFX, Inefex, Ranger Capital, and others now included for unauthorized forex activities.

Current Affairs related to Regulatory authorities

S.No.	Name	Purpose
		Consumer Warning: RBI advises consumers to avoid unauthorized platforms and verify any forex entity's authorization status. Promotion of Unauthorized Services: Entities may promote unauthorized forex platforms or claim to provide training and advisory services, potentially misleading users. Verification of Authorization: Presence on the list doesn't confirm authorization; consumers should check RBI's official list for verification.

Other Important Banking Related Current Affairs

- The Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) has significantly boosted its stake in **Bank of Maharashtra from 4.05% to 7.10%**, as disclosed in an exchange filing on October 5, 2024. This increase follows the allotment of **25.96 crore** equity shares priced at ₹57.36 each through a Qualified Institutional Placement (QIP). This strategic move reflects LIC's confidence in the bank's growth potential and is aimed at strengthening its balance sheet to support expansion plans.
- Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal has informed that the Indian and UAE governments are working on **interlinking the UPI of India and the AANI of UAE**. It will facilitate seamless cross-border transactions between two countries. This will benefit over 3 million Indians residing in the UAE enabling them to use the power of UPI and AANI.
- Pakistan is witnessing widespread protests after the government raised **taxes by 40%** as part of a **\$7 billion bailout deal** with the **International Monetary Fund (IMF)**.
- HDFC Life, a prominent player in India's insurance sector, has earned dual accolades for its commitment to **Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI)** by **Avtar and Seramount**. Recognised among the **Best Companies for Women in India (BCWI)** and as **'Exemplars of Inclusion'** in the Most Inclusive Companies Index (MICI), HDFC Life stands out for its supportive ecosystem not only for women but also for people with disabilities, the **LGBTQ+ community**, and diverse cultural backgrounds.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of November 2024

Bank Name	Details of the News
SEBI	SEBI has proposed changes to enhance flexibility, governance, and investor protection in Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs), Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs), and Small and Medium REITs (SM REITs). Key proposals include allowing interest rate derivatives for hedging, recognizing fixed deposits in leverage calculations, and enabling the transfer of locked-in units among sponsors.
Canara Bank	State-owned Canara Bank aims to recoup approximately ₹6,000 crore from bad loans in H2 FY25, reflecting efforts to improve asset quality and build on recent financial performance.
SBI Mutual Fund	SBI Mutual Fund has become the first fund house in India to exceed ₹10 lakh crore in assets under management (AUM), reaching ₹10.99 lakh crore in the September quarter, positioning it ahead of its competitors.
SEBI	SEBI has proposed significant changes to the securitisation framework to enhance investor protection and streamline regulations, including a minimum investment threshold, limits on investor participation, mandatory dematerialisation, and liquidity safeguards.
Punjab & Sind Bank	Punjab & Sind Bank has launched an e-Bank Guarantee (e-BG) facility in partnership with NeSL, replacing paper-based processes with a fully digital system using e-stamping and e-signatures, enhancing efficiency and reducing verification time.
IDFC FIRST Bank	IDFC FIRST Bank, in collaboration with Swift, has launched a real-time tracking service for international money transfers, making it the first Indian bank to offer end-to-end traceability for cross-border payments.
Deutsche Bank	Deutsche Bank has injected ₹5,113 crore into its Indian operations, marking its largest capital infusion in recent years to fund growth and expand services across corporate, investment, and private banking.
RBI	The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has added 10-year Sovereign Green Bonds (SGRBs) to the list of Government securities available for non-resident investment under the Fully Accessible Route (FAR), aligning with India's growing inclusion in global bond indices.
SBI	State Bank of India (SBI), in partnership with APIX, launched the 'SBI Innovation Hub' at the Singapore Fintech Festival from November 6-8, 2024, fostering innovation in financial technology.
RBI	The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has introduced six amendments to its KYC Master Directions to streamline the customer onboarding process and enhance the security and reliability of financial transactions.

Bank Name	Details of the News
ADB	The Asian Development Bank (ADB) has approved a \$200 million loan to improve urban infrastructure and climate resilience in Uttarakhand through the Uttarakhand Livability Improvement Project.
PSBs	Public Sector Banks (PSBs) reported strong performance in FY 2024-25, with an 11% year-on-year growth in aggregate business and net profit increasing by 25.6%.
World Bank & ADB	The World Bank and ADB have agreed to grant a loan of ₹13,500 crore for the development of Amaravati, the capital city of Andhra Pradesh.
RBI	RBI confirmed that SBI, HDFC Bank, and ICICI Bank will remain Domestic Systemically Important Banks (D-SIBs), with increased capital requirements starting April 2025.
RBI	RBI introduced a framework allowing Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) to convert investments into Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) if their holdings exceed 10% equity in Indian companies.
SBI	SBI aims to secure a \$1.25 billion five-year loan, which would be the largest dollar-denominated loan from India's financial sector in 2024, to be used for general corporate purposes.
Galaxy Health Insurance	Galaxy Health Insurance launched its first product, 'Galaxy Promise', offering comprehensive family health coverage with flexible sum insured options ranging from ₹3 lakh to ₹1 crore.
Karnataka Bank Ltd.	Karnataka Bank launched two student-focused financial products, 'KBL Peak' and 'KBL Genius', supporting students in managing finances and achieving academic goals.
SBI	SBI successfully raised \$500 million through five-year bonds from international investors, demonstrating strong global investor confidence in its creditworthiness.
India	India has emerged as the fastest-growing economy among G20 countries, with a projected 7% GDP growth for 2024, reflecting its resilience amid global challenges.
SBI	SBI marked the centenary of its Horniman Circle Branch with the unveiling of a ₹100 commemorative coin and the release of a book detailing the bank's evolution.
SEBI	SEBI has abolished the requirement for issuer companies to deposit 1% of the issue size with stock exchanges before launching public equity issues, streamlining market processes.
RBI	RBI increased the transaction limit for UPI 123Pay from ₹5,000 to ₹10,000, benefiting India's 400 million feature phone users, and also raised the UPI Lite wallet limit from ₹2,000 to ₹5,000.
RBI & MMA	RBI and the Maldives Monetary Authority (MMA) signed a MoU to promote the use of local currencies (INR and MVR) in cross-border transactions, enhancing bilateral trade and reducing transaction costs.
IndusInd Bank & UNICEF	IndusInd Bank, in partnership with UNICEF, launched an initiative to promote Disaster Resilient Communities and Climate Risk-Informed Administrative Systems in five districts across India.
Punjab National Bank (PNB)	PNB joined the Partnership for Carbon Accounting Financials (PCAF), reflecting its commitment to sustainability and aligning with global standards for greenhouse gas emissions accounting.
FSIB	The Financial Services Institutions Bureau (FSIB) recommended Binod Kumar as the next Managing Director and CEO of Indian Bank to succeed S L Jain.
Canara HSBC Life Insurance	Canara HSBC Life Insurance launched OmniGen AI, a generative AI solution designed to optimize risk evaluation in underwriting, powered by Amazon Web Services (AWS).
SBI	SBI raised ₹50,000 crore in FY25 through domestic bonds, reinforcing its strong financial position and supporting economic growth, financial inclusion, and rural entrepreneurship.
Union Minister Piyush Goyal	Union Minister Piyush Goyal launched the CII Ease of Doing Business and Regulatory Affairs Portal, which provides real-time updates on government initiatives for improving business efficiency.
India & ADB	India secured a \$98 million loan from the Asian Development Bank (ADB) to boost horticulture productivity through the Atmanirbhar Clean Plant Programme.
RBI	On Dhanteras, RBI announced the successful transportation of 102 tonnes of gold from the Bank of England to India, aimed at strengthening India's gold reserves.

Banking and Financial Current Affairs of December 2024

Bank Name	Details of the News
Navi Finserv	- On December 2, 2024, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) lifted the supervisory restrictions on Navi Finserv, a non-banking financial company (NBFC) led by Sachin Bansal. - The restrictions, imposed on October 17, 2024, were lifted after the company addressed regulatory concerns related to loan pricing practices and non-compliance with lending norms.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has increased the UPI Lite wallet limit to Rs 5,000 and the per-transaction limit to Rs 1,000, enhancing offline payment capabilities. - This change aims to encourage wider adoption of UPI Lite for seamless, higher-value transactions without internet. Replenishment of the wallet will be done online with Additional Factor Authentication (AFA) for added security.

Bank Name	Details of the News
Reliance Securities Ltd	- SEBI imposed a ₹9 lakh penalty on Reliance Securities Ltd (RSL) for violating stock broker norms during an inspection of its records from April 2022 to December 2023. - The violations included poor record-keeping, unauthorized terminal use, and lack of office segregation. Despite corrective actions, SEBI maintained the penalty due to non-compliance during the inspection period.
SEBI	- SEBI clarified that digital platforms are not required to register as Specified Digital Platforms (SDPs). - The framework simplifies compliance for regulated entities (REs) while offering flexibility for digital platforms. SEBI stated that preventive measures for SDP recognition are voluntary, with no regulatory framework governing SDPs.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has allowed Small Finance Banks (SFBs) to offer pre-sanctioned credit lines via Unified Payments Interface (UPI), aiming to improve financial inclusion. This decision targets underserved groups, such as micro-entrepreneurs, small businesses, and rural customers. - The credit products will focus on smaller loan amounts with shorter terms, particularly for new-to-credit individuals with limited access to formal credit.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI), led by Governor Shaktikanta Das, will launch a podcast series to enhance public communication and financial literacy. - This initiative aims to provide more accessible and transparent information, focusing on monetary policy and financial education.
BOBCARD	- BOBCARD has launched the TIARA Credit Card, a premium, women-centric offering designed to empower modern women. Key features include rewards on travel, dining, international purchases, and lifestyle; health perks like free health packages and personal accident cover; and lifestyle benefits with vouchers from brands like Myntra, Nykaa, and Lakme Salon. - Additional perks include OTT memberships, movie ticket discounts, unlimited lounge access, and reduced forex mark-up. The card is powered by the RuPay network and comes with a joining fee of ₹2,499 + GST.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is developing the Secured Overnight Rupee Rate (SORR) as a new benchmark for interest rate derivatives. Based on secured money market transactions like repo and TREPS, SORR aims to be robust, trade-based, and manipulation-resistant. - This initiative aligns with global best practices like SOFR, promoting transparency in India's benchmark-setting methodology.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has raised interest rate ceilings on FCNR(B) deposits to attract foreign capital. Banks can now offer ARR plus 400 bps for 1-3 year deposits and ARR plus 500 bps for 3-5 year deposits. - This move aims to support the rupee and increase dollar inflows, but its impact may be limited due to cheaper global funding options. The relaxation is valid until March 31, 2025.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI), through its Innovation Hub (RBIH), has launched MuleHunter.AI, an AI tool to detect mule bank accounts involved in illicit activities like money laundering. - This initiative targets the growing issue of online financial fraud, which accounts for 67.8% of cybercrime in India, using machine learning to improve detection over traditional systems.
Reserve Bank of India	- Sanjay Malhotra, a seasoned bureaucrat and Revenue Secretary, has been appointed as the 26th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). - A 1990-batch IAS officer from the Rajasthan cadre, he succeeds Shaktikanta Das after his tenure ends on December 10, 2024. Malhotra brings over 30 years of experience in sectors like finance, taxation, power, IT, and mining.
Asian Development Bank	- The Asian Development Bank (ADB) has approved a \$500 million loan to support India's renewable energy expansion and climate-resilient infrastructure. - This initiative aims to reduce carbon emissions and address India's vulnerability to natural disasters, aligning with the country's sustainable development goals.
Axis Bank	- Max Life Insurance has rebranded as Axis Max Life Insurance following Axis Bank's increased stake in the company. The rebranding features a new logo combining Axis's iconic 'A' and burgundy color, symbolizing trust and modernity. - This move aims to expand the company's reach, enhance customer service, and drive long-term growth, particularly beyond metro and tier 1 cities.
Reserve Bank of India	The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has raised the limit for collateral-free agricultural loans from ₹1.6 lakh to ₹2 lakh, effective January 1, 2025. This move aims to support small and marginal farmers amid rising input costs and inflation.

Bank Name	Details of the News
	Banks are required to implement the new guidelines and run awareness campaigns to inform farmers about the revised loan provisions.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has introduced measures to address the rising issue of unclaimed deposits, which include inactive savings/current accounts or term deposits for over 10 years. Contributing factors include account inactivity, unclaimed fixed deposits, and funds left after the death of account holders. - The Depositor Education and Awareness (DEA) Fund grew 26%, from ₹62,224.89 crore in 2022-23 to ₹78,212.53 crore in 2023-24, with savings accounts making up 73% of unclaimed deposits.
Indian Government	- The Indian government has raised ₹8,625 crore through minority stake sales in FY 2024-25. While no specific disinvestment target has been set for FY25, the government continues its focus on strategic disinvestment and privatization to enhance sectoral efficiency and economic potential. - Starting from 2023-24, separate disinvestment targets have been discontinued.
India Data Centre Market	- India's data centre market is expected to surpass \$100 billion by 2027, up from \$60 billion between 2019-2024. - Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu are key hubs, with Mumbai, Chennai, Delhi-NCR, and Bengaluru leading the sector. The surge in demand is driven by industries like BFSI, technology, fintech, and generative AI, positioning India as a global leader in digital infrastructure.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) lifted the supervisory restrictions on ECL Finance Ltd and Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd (Edelweiss ARC) after both entities took corrective actions. - In May 2024, ECL Finance was restricted from conducting structured transactions, while Edelweiss ARC faced limitations on acquiring assets and reorganizing receipts. Following their adherence to regulatory norms, RBI has allowed both companies to resume normal operations.
Asian Development Bank	- The Central government and Asian Development Bank (ADB) have signed a \$42 million loan to strengthen coastal and riverbank protection in Maharashtra. The project will address coastal erosion using hybrid approaches like offshore reefs and beach nourishment, while enhancing the resilience of tourism and fisheries sectors. - It also promotes community inclusion, focusing on disaster preparedness with the involvement of women, youth, and vulnerable groups.
IndusInd Bank	- The RBI imposed penalties on IndusInd Bank (₹27.3 lakh) and Manappuram Finance (₹20 lakh) for regulatory violations identified during inspections as of March 31, 2023. - IndusInd Bank was fined for opening savings deposit accounts for ineligible entities, while Manappuram Finance failed to verify customers' PAN and assigned multiple Identification Codes instead of a Unique Customer Identification Code (UCIC).
ICICI Bank	- ICICI Bank and Times Internet launched the Times Black ICICI Bank Credit Card, a super-premium card designed for high-net-worth individuals (HNIs) in India. - Powered by Visa, it offers exclusive luxury services and benefits, with a unique metallic design featuring historic printing plates from The Times of India, symbolizing tradition and innovation.
SEBI	- SEBI issued an interim order banning Sachin Bakul Dagli, an equity dealer at PNB MetLife, and eight other entities for involvement in a front-running scheme. - This fraud, active for over three years, resulted in illegal gains of ₹21.16 crore by misusing non-public trade information. The investigation, covering January 1, 2021, to July 19, 2024, revealed violations of SEBI's PFUTP regulations and the SEBI Act.
Reserve Bank of India	- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has formed an eight-member committee to create the Framework for Responsible and Ethical Enablement of Artificial Intelligence (FREE-AI) in the financial sector. - Led by Pushpak Bhattacharyya from IIT Bombay, the committee will assess global and Indian AI adoption, review regulatory approaches, and recommend ethical governance in areas like banks, NBFCs, FinTechs, and payment systems. - It will also identify AI risks and propose mitigation strategies, with the final report due in six months.
Reserve Bank of India (RBI)	- India's current account deficit (CAD) for Q2 FY2024-25 moderated to \$11.2 billion (1.2% of GDP) from \$11.3 billion (1.3% of GDP) due to strong services exports and improved net services receipts. - Despite a higher merchandise trade deficit of \$75.3 billion, driven by increased imports, services exports in categories like computer services, business services, travel, and transportation grew significantly. The CAD is expected to rise to 2.5-2.7% of GDP in Q3 due to a record-high trade deficit in November.

3

Economy Current Affairs

January to December 2024

Economy Current Affairs of January 2024

- The **HSBC India Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI)** for manufacturing dropped to an 18-month low of 54.9 in December, down from 56 in November, signaling a slowdown. Despite this, the sector remains in expansion mode, marking 30 consecutive months with the index above 50, indicative of growth. The decline was attributed to a weaker rise in new orders and output.
- India Ratings and Research (Ind-Ra) has upgraded **PNB Housing Finance Limited's non-convertible debentures (NCDs)** to 'IND AA+' from 'IND AA' with a stable outlook. The NCD limit has been split into bank loans and NCDs, with a corresponding 'IND AA+' rating assigned to the bank loans.
- **Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPI)** made historic monthly acquisitions of Indian equities, reaching 661.35 billion rupees (\$8 billion) in December, according to National Securities Depository data. This surge catapulted **India's Nifty 50 and Sensex** benchmarks to fresh record highs. The first half of December alone witnessed a record fortnightly purchase of shares worth 427.33 billion rupees, attributed to lower U.S. bond yields and expectations of Federal Reserve interest rate cuts.
- In the week concluding on December 29, India's foreign exchange reserves witnessed a substantial uptick, surging by \$2.759 billion, reaching a **total of \$623.2 billion**, as reported by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Friday. This follows a previous week's increase of \$4.471 billion, bringing the overall reserves to \$620.441 billion. Notably, in October 2021, India's forex kitty had achieved an unprecedented peak at \$645 billion.
- In response to the evolving dynamics of the global oil market, the Indian government has decided to slash the **windfall tax on domestically-produced crude oil**, effective January 16. The tax, levied as the Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED), has been reduced from Rs 2,300 per tonne to Rs 1,700 per tonne.
- India's equity market has outpaced **Hong Kong's Hang Seng**, securing the fourth position globally with a market capitalization of \$4.33 trillion. This milestone, marking India's ascendancy, underscores the nation's robust economic standing. The **US remains the largest stock market** with a staggering \$50.86 trillion market cap, followed by China at \$8.44 trillion and Japan at \$6.36 trillion.

- In a positive turn, ICRA has revised its **bank credit growth estimates** for FY24 upwards to 14.9-15.3%, surpassing the previous projection of 12.8-13.0%. The surge is attributed to robust performance in the retail segment and non-banking finance companies (NBFCs), according to Anil Gupta, Senior Vice President at ICRA.
- In a strategic move to bolster the **mobile phone manufacturing industry in India**, the Centre has announced a significant reduction in import duties on mobile phone components. The import duty on parts used for mobile phone manufacturing has been slashed to **10% from the earlier 15%**. This decision aligns with India's broader objectives to enhance its role in global supply chains and increase exports.

Economy Current Affairs of February 2024

- India's core sector output growth plummeted to a **14-month low of 3.8% YoY** in December, as reported by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. This sharp decline from the previous month's 7.9% was attributed to a high base and a slowdown in six constituent sectors. Notably, only fertilizers (5.8%) and cement (1.3%) sectors saw an output acceleration in December.
- The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) reports a remarkable milestone in Unified Payment Interface (UPI) transactions for January, reaching a **record ₹18.41 trillion**. This marks a 52% increase in volume and a substantial 42% rise in value compared to the same month in the previous financial year.
- The liquidity deficit in the banking system has significantly reduced to approximately **₹1.40 lakh crore** as of February 4, down from a **recent high of ₹3.46 lakh crore** on January 24. This decline is attributed to increased government spending, as per data from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Consequently, overnight money market rates have eased, with the weighted average rate dropping to 6.33 per cent from last month's range of 6.50 per cent to 6.75 per cent.
- During a meeting of the Central Board of Trustees (CBT), the apex decision-making body of the **Employees' Provident Fund Organization (EPFO)**, it was decided to increase the interest rate on employees' provident fund (EPF) deposits to **8.25%** for the fiscal year 2023-24. This marks a three-year high for the interest rate on EPF deposits.

- In January 2024, **India's retail inflation** reached a three-month low of 5.1%, while the **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)** exhibited a growth of 3.8% in December 2023, showcasing a favorable trend in both sectors.
- **India's services trade surplus** reached an unprecedented \$44.9 billion in the October-December quarter of FY24, marking a 16% year-on-year increase. This surge in surplus, amidst challenging global conditions, is anticipated to alleviate the current account deficit (CAD) for the period.
- The **National Coal Index** (Provisional) has shown a significant **decline of 4.75% in December 2023** at 155.44 points compared to December 2022, where it was at 163.19 points. This notable decrease indicates sufficient availability of coal in the market to meet the growing demands.
- India's mineral output witnessed a notable increase of **5.1%** compared to the same period in 2022, according to the **Ministry of Mines**. The mining and quarrying sector's index of mineral production for December reached 139.4, marking a significant rise from the previous year.
- The **Flash Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI)** for India, compiled by HSBC, reached a seven-month high of **61.5 in February**, indicating strong performance in both manufacturing and services sectors. However, stagnant job growth raises concerns despite robust economic activity.

Economy Current Affairs of March 2024

- In February, India's service sector sustained its growth trajectory, supported by positive demand trends. However, there was a slight moderation in growth compared to January, with the Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) dropping to **60.6 from 61.8**. Despite this decline, the sector remained well above the neutral mark of 50.0, indicating a sharp rate of expansion.
- In a notable increase, India's outward foreign direct investment (FDI) commitments soared to **\$3.47 billion in February 2024**, marking a significant rise from the \$2.82 billion recorded in February 2023, and an increase from \$2.18 billion in January 2024. This data, released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), highlights a growing trend in India's financial commitments abroad.
- In February 2024, the **All-India Consumer Price Index (CPI) for Agricultural Laborers and Rural Laborers** remained stable, with figures of 1258 and 1269, respectively, based on the 1986-87=100 index. However, there were notable fluctuations observed among constituent states. Eight states saw a decline in the CPI-AL, while seven experienced a similar trend in the CPI-RL, with two states showing no change.

- In **January 2024**, the index of mineral production in the mining and quarrying sector stood at **144.1**, indicating a **5.9% increase** compared to January 2023. The cumulative growth for **April-January 2023-24** over the corresponding period of the previous year is recorded at **8.3%**.
- S&P Global Ratings anticipates a repo rate reduction of up to **75 basis points by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** during the fiscal year 2024-25. This move aligns with projected adjustments in US policy rates, with the majority of the cuts expected in the latter **half of the financial year**. The agency also foresees similar rate adjustments in Indonesia, New Zealand, and the Philippines. Factors such as **declining inflation, a reduced fiscal deficit, and lower US policy rates** set the stage for the RBI to initiate rate cuts, possibly around June 2024 or later.
- The Indian government has outlined its borrowing strategy for the first half of the fiscal year 2024-25, aiming to raise **Rs 7.5 lakh crore** from the market through the issuance of various bonds, including sovereign green bonds.
- The Government e Marketplace (GeM) has witnessed a remarkable growth, doubling its Gross Merchandise Value (GMV) to **₹4-lakh crore in fiscal year 2023-24**. **CEO P K Singh** announced plans for potential expansion, including opening the portal for consumer use and enhancing its services.

Economy Current Affairs of April 2024

- **SEBI has granted approval to CRISIL ESG Ratings & Analytics** as a Category 1 provider of ESG ratings, marking a significant development in the realm of **environmental, social, and governance (ESG)** assessments in India. This accreditation underscores the growing importance of independent ESG ratings in financial markets, particularly in guiding decision-making for issuers and investors towards sustainable practices.

Economy Current Affairs of May 2024

- India has adjusted its **windfall tax on petroleum crude**, reducing it to 8,400 Indian rupees (**\$100.66 per metric ton from 9,600 rupees**, effective May 1. This decision comes after a recent increase in the tax from 6,800 rupees to 9,600 rupees per metric ton on April 16.
- Factory output in India saw a notable rise, **registering a growth of 4.9% in March**, a significant leap from the 1.9% recorded in the same period the previous year. However, this figure fell slightly short of **February 2024's 5.7%**. For the fiscal year 2023-24, the factory output grew by 5.8%, a marginal increase from the previous year. The uptick was particularly evident in manufacturing and construction goods output.

- In the **financial year ending March 2024**, the cumulative profit of public sector banks (PSBs) **surged, reaching over ₹1.4 lakh crore**, marking a significant 35% increase from the previous year's earnings of ₹1.04 lakh crore. State Bank of India (SBI) emerged as a major contributor, accounting for over 40% of the total earnings.
- In the fiscal year 2023-24, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) saw a significant increase in its gold reserves, adding **27.46 metric tonnes** and reaching a **total of 822.10 metric tonnes** by the end of **March 2024**. This brought the share of gold in the total foreign exchange reserves to about 8.15%, up from 7.81% in the previous year.
- India's foreign exchange reserves saw an increase of \$2.56 billion, reaching a total of \$644.15 billion for the week ended May 10, according to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). This follows a previous increase of \$3.668 billion after three consecutive weeks of decline.
- In response to rising credit demand and falling liquidity, State Bank of India (SBI) has increased short-term retail fixed deposit rates by **25-75 basis points (bps)**, marking its **first interest rate hike since December**. This move, likely to be emulated by other banks, reflects a strategic adjustment to offer better returns for depositors.
- Net **foreign direct investment (FDI)** into India experienced a notable **decrease of 62.17%** in the fiscal year 2023-24 (FY24), plummeting to **\$10.58 billion from the previous year's \$27.98 billion**. This decline is attributed primarily to increased repatriation of capital and Indian companies' investments abroad.
- In a strategic move to improve liquidity in the commodity derivatives market, the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** has **reduced the deliverable period for commodity derivatives** from the previous 5 days to **3 days**. This regulatory change is set to take effect from **July 1, 2024**, and will apply to contracts with staggered delivery scheduled after this date.

Economy Current Affairs of June 2024

- India's Index of Industrial Production (IIP) recorded a growth rate of **4.9% in March 2024**, showing a slight slowdown primarily attributed to a faltering mining sector. This decline follows a robust 5.6% growth in February 2024 and contrasts sharply with the 1.9% growth seen in March 2023.
- The rationalisation of GST rates is under **preliminary assessment** to address imbalances and avoid the inverted duty structure where the **final product's tax is lower than that on inputs**. Although the industry has called for **rationalisation**, involving reworking rates and merging the four slabs into three, the government plans to proceed cautiously with a detailed analysis.

Economy Current Affairs of July 2024

- In May 2024, growth in **India's core sector industries** decelerated to **6.3% from 6.7% in April**, driven by varied performance across sectors. Coal and electricity saw accelerated growth due to increased demand during a heat wave, while sectors like cement and fertilizers contracted. Factors such as reduced capex, adequate fertiliser stocks, and lower diesel demand influenced sectoral output. The overall impact of these dynamics reflects on the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), expected to print between **4-5% for May 2024**.
- India's employment growth provisionally rose to **6% in FY24 compared to 3.2% in FY23**, according to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). This increase brought the total employment to 643.3 million, up from 596.7 million the previous year, with 46.7 million jobs created.
- The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) **Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index)**, which measures the extent of financial inclusion across the country, rose to **64.2 in March 2024 from 60.1 in March 2023**. This improvement reflects growth across all sub-indices, indicating a deepening of financial inclusion.
- In June 2024, India's economic landscape witnessed significant growth driven by robust performance in both manufacturing and services sectors. The Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) for manufacturing soared, accompanied by strong hiring activity, marking a 19-year high. Concurrently, the **Eight Core Industries Index expanded by 6.5% year-on-year** in the initial months of **FY25**, led by sectors like coal and electricity.
- In June 2024, India's retail inflation reached a **four-month high of 5.08%**, driven by a sharp rise in food prices, particularly vegetables, amidst extended heatwave conditions. This surge marks the 57th consecutive month above the **RBI's 4% target range**, limiting immediate prospects for interest rate cuts.
- In June 2024, the All India Consumer Price Index (CPI) showed a **year-on-year inflation rate of 5.08%**. This rate varied across rural and urban areas, with rural inflation at 5.66% and urban inflation at 4.39%. Compared to May 2024, inflation for essential sub-groups like 'Eggs', 'Spices', 'Meat & fish', and 'Pulses & products' decreased. The CPI for General Indices and Consumer Food Price Index (CFPI) also showed increases, with rural CFPI notably rising by 9.15%. These figures reflect varied price dynamics impacting different segments of the population across India.

Economy Current Affairs of August 2024

- **India's retail inflation rate**, as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI), fell to **3.54% in July**, reaching a nearly 5-year low.
- India's industrial production, as measured by the **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)**, grew by **4.2% in June 2024**, marking the slowest growth in **five months**.
- India's urban unemployment rate slightly decreased to **6.6% in Q1 FY25** from **6.7% in Q4 FY24**, as per the **Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)** data released by the **National Statistical Office (NSO)**.
- The latest **"Men and Women"** report by the **National Statistical Office (NSO)** reveals a stark financial disparity between **men and women in India**. While women own a significant portion of bank accounts.
- **Foreign direct investment (FDI)** in India's food processing sector experienced a significant decline of **30% in the fiscal year 2023-24**, totaling **Rs 5,037.06 crore**, down from **Rs 7,194.13 crore in 2022-23**.
- The Ministry of Finance reported that India's fiscal deficit for the **first quarter of FY25** stood at **8.1% of the full-year estimate**, a significant improvement from 25.3% in the same period last year.

Economy Current Affairs of September 2024

- In August 2024, **India's GST collections reached ₹1.75 lakh crore**, marking a 10% year-on-year growth compared to **₹1.59 lakh crore in August 2023**. This increase reflects robust domestic consumption and higher imports. The central government collected **₹30,862 crore**, while states collected **₹38,411 crore** before adjustments. **IGST on imports and inter-state sales** amounted to **₹93,621 crore**.
- **Telangana, Tamil Nadu, and Rajasthan** have reported the highest growth in real **Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) for FY24** among the ten largest states based on their GSDP, according to recent data from the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI). The services sector, which contributes significantly to the **Gross Value Added (GVA)** of large states, has played a crucial role in this economic expansion.
- **India's Consumer Price Index (CPI)**-based retail inflation rose marginally to **3.65% in August from 3.6% in July**, remaining below the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) medium-term target of 4% for the second time in nearly five years. This slight increase is attributed to a high base effect from the previous year. The Index of Industrial Production (IIP) also saw a modest rise, reaching **4.83% in July compared to 4.72% in June**.
- **India's wholesale price index (WPI)**-based inflation fell to a four-month low of 1.31% in August, down from **2.04% in July**. This decline is primarily attributed to reduced prices of manufactured products and food items.

According to data from the Commerce Ministry, food price inflation **decreased to 3.11% in August from 3.45% in July**. Key factors include lower prices in cereals (8.44%), paddy (9.12%), and pulses (18.57%), although onion prices remained high at 65.75%. Conversely, potato prices surged by 77.96%, and fruit prices increased by 16.7% in August.

- India's foreign exchange reserves reached a record high of **\$692.3 billion as of September 20**, according to data released by the Reserve Bank of India on September 27. The reserves increased by **\$2.84 billion during the week, following a total rise of \$19.3 billion** over the previous five weeks. The rise in reserves was driven by the Reserve Bank of India's interventions in the forex market and inflows into local stocks and bonds.
- The **Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council** has formed a **10-member Group of Ministers (GoM)**, chaired by **Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary**, to address the future taxation of luxury, sin, and demerit goods as the compensation cess is set to expire in March 2026. The GoM's primary objective is to propose a new taxation structure to replace the compensation cess after its abolition. Currently, the compensation cess, levied at varying rates on specified goods in addition to the 28% GST, was originally intended to last five years following the rollout of GST.

Economy Current Affairs of October 2024

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- **BSE and NSE** have announced revisions to their **transaction fees, effective from October 1, 2024**. The changes, which impact various segments, align with SEBI's July directive mandating a uniform fee structure across market infrastructure institutions (MIIs). This move eliminates the previous slab-based structure and ensures transparency for end clients.

- In the April-June 2024 quarter, **India's current account deficit (CAD) increased to \$9.7 billion**, or 1.1% of GDP, up from \$8.9 billion (1% of GDP) in Q1 FY2024, according to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). This marginal widening is attributed to a rise in the merchandise trade deficit, which expanded to \$65.1 billion from \$56.7 billion in the previous year. The CAD had recorded a surplus of \$4.6 billion (0.5% of GDP) in the previous January-March quarter.
- The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) celebrates its Eighth Annual Day on **1st October 2024**. Senior officers of the Government and regulatory bodies will grace the occasion. Over the past eight years, the IBC has significantly accelerated the resolution of insolvency cases.
- The **Index of Eight Core Industries (ICI)** serves as a crucial indicator of the industrial health of the economy. In August 2024, the combined index declined by **1.8%** compared to August 2023. However, production in the **Steel and Fertilizers** sectors demonstrated positive growth during the same period.
- India's foreign exchange reserves have exceeded **\$700 billion for the first time**, reaching **\$704.89 billion in the week** ending September 27, 2024. This marks a record increase of **\$12.58 billion**, with foreign currency assets (FCAs) rising by \$10.4 billion to \$616 billion and gold reserves increasing by \$2 billion to \$65.7 billion. The surge is attributed to RBI's dollar purchases and favorable valuation adjustments, driven by declining U.S. Treasury yields, a weakening dollar, and rising gold prices.
- India's wholesale price inflation (WPI) increased to **1.84% in September 2024**, up from **1.31% in August**, driven by a sharp rise in food prices, according to data from the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. This surge was primarily due to a spike in vegetable prices, with onion, potato, and tomato costs rising by **78.8%, 78.1%, and 74.5%, respectively**. The food price inflation rose to 11.53% from 3.11% in August, marking a two-year high. Despite deceleration in other categories such as fuel and manufactured products, food price inflation led the overall increase.
- According to a report released by the **International Monetary Fund (IMF)**, the world's total **public debt is poised to surpass \$100 trillion this year for the first time**.
- India's outward foreign direct investment (FDI) reached \$3.7 billion in October 2024, a notable increase from \$2.55 billion in October 2023, according to the RBI. However, it showed a slight decline from \$3.77 billion in September 2024.
- **India's inflation rate for October 2024 stood at 6.21%**, with rural areas experiencing higher inflation at 6.68%, compared to 5.62% in urban areas. The Consumer Food Price Index (CFPI) rose by 10.87%, with rural inflation at 10.69% and urban inflation at 11.09%.
- **India's industrial production grew by 3.1% in September 2024**, recovering from a 0.1% contraction in August. This growth was driven by strong manufacturing performance and modest increases in electricity generation and mining. However, the growth rate slowed compared to 6.4% in September 2023, signaling a more tempered industrial recovery.
- In the **July-September 2024** quarter, India's **urban unemployment rate** fell to **6.4%**, the lowest in recent years, down from **6.6%** in the previous quarter. **Men's unemployment** decreased to **5.7%**, and **women's unemployment** dropped to **8.4%**. The **Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR)** increased to **50.4%**, with women's LFPR slightly rising to **25.5%**. The **Worker Population Rate (WPR)** in urban areas was **47.2%**, with **men at 70.7%** and **women at 23.4%**, indicating positive trends in **job creation and labor force participation**.
- India's **foreign exchange reserves** dropped by a record **\$17.76 billion to \$657.8 billion** for the week ending November 15, 2024, marking the largest weekly decline since 1998. This drop was driven by the **strengthening of the US dollar**, the **Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) intervention** to protect the **rupee**, and falling **gold prices**.
- The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved **Alphabet Inc.'s subsidiary, Shoreline International Holdings LLC**, to acquire a stake in **Walmart-owned Flipkart**. This follows **Flipkart's May 2024 funding round**, where **Google** invested **\$350 million** of the **\$1 billion** raised. Additionally, CCI approved **MUFG Bank Ltd.'s** acquisition of an additional stake in **DMI Finance**, raising MUFG's shareholding to **20%**.
- In **FY24**, the Union Government collected **₹16,398 crore** in **GST** from **health and life insurance services**, marking a **680% increase** from **FY20**. However, this was a slight decrease from **₹16,770 crore** in **FY23**. **Life insurance** contributed **₹8,135 crore**, while **health insurance** contributed **₹8,263 crore**. Additionally, **₹2,045 crore** was raised from **reinsurance services**, with **₹561 crore** from life reinsurance and **₹1,484 crore** from health reinsurance. **Rashtriya Swasthya Bima Yojana** and **Jan Arogya Bima Policy** remain exempt from **GST**.

Economy Current Affairs of November 2024

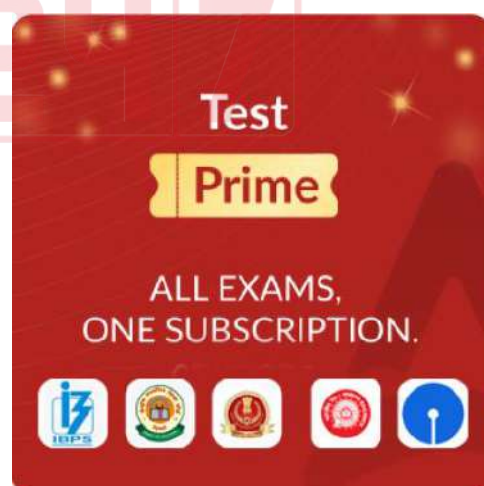
- On the occasion of **Diwali and to mark its 30th anniversary**, the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) has launched its **official mobile app, NSEIndia**, and expanded its corporate website to support a **total of 12 languages**. This initiative aims to create a more inclusive financial ecosystem for millions of investors across India, allowing them to access market information in their preferred regional languages.

- India's **milk production** reached **239.30 million tonnes** in 2023-24, a **3.78% increase**, maintaining its position as the world's largest producer. The growth, driven by better **milch cattle productivity** and higher **per capita milk availability**, was highlighted by **Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh** on **National Milk Day**. **Per capita milk availability** rose from **459 gm** to **471 gm** per day. Despite a slight slowdown, India continues to lead globally in milk production and aims to boost **milk exports**.
- India's **core sector growth** rose to **3.1% in October**, marking a recovery after a contraction in August. This growth, driven by coal, refinery products, and steel, follows a 2.4% increase in September. The core sector, which makes up 40% of the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), showed signs of improvement despite challenges in crude oil and natural gas.
- In October 2024, India set a **record** with **16.58 billion UPI transactions** worth **Rs 23.5 trillion**, marking the highest monthly volume and value since UPI's launch in 2016. This surge, driven by platforms like **UPI**, **IMPS**, **FASTag**, and **AePS**, reflects India's growing shift towards **digital payments**, fueled by the festive season and increasing adoption by both **merchants** and **consumers**.
- In October 2024, India's **GST collections** reached **Rs 1.87 lakh crore**, an **8.9% year-on-year increase**, marking the second-highest monthly GST collections since the regime began in July 2017. This rise was driven by stronger **domestic transactions**, though **import revenue** showed slower growth. Despite the rebound from a **low growth phase** in September, the growth rate remains below the **double-digit** levels seen in previous years, with the highest collection recorded in **April 2024** at **Rs 2.10 lakh crore**.
- The Indian government **abolished the windfall tax** on **crude petroleum, petrol, diesel, and Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF)**, effective November 2, 2024. Introduced in **July 2022** to curb excessive profits from oil companies during the **Russia-Ukraine war**, the tax aimed to stabilize **domestic supplies** and fund welfare programs. Its removal follows a **review** by the PMO, **Revenue Department**, and **Petroleum Ministry**, citing stabilizing **crude prices** and reduced revenue from the tax.
- **Morgan Stanley** revised India's **GDP growth** projection for FY25 to **6.3%** from **6.7%**, following a **5.4% GDP growth** in Q2 FY25, the lowest since March 2023. The slowdown is attributed to weaker **private consumption** and **capital expenditure**, though the **services sector** remained resilient. Despite this, **Morgan Stanley** expects a **recovery** in H2 FY25, driven by **government spending**, improved **rural demand**, and **easing financial conditions**.
- The **OECD** has upgraded India's **GDP growth forecast** for **FY25** to **6.8%**, citing strong **public infrastructure spending**, **private consumption**, and agricultural recovery. This growth momentum is expected to continue through **FY25** and **FY26**, driven by **investment** and **rural income growth**. Despite global uncertainties and geopolitical risks, India's **economic resilience** points to a promising future.
- India has surpassed **\$1 trillion** in **FDI inflows** from **April 2000 to September 2024**, reaching **\$1,033.4 billion**. This growth is driven by favorable government policies and strong economic performance, with key sectors like **services**, **software**, **telecommunications**, and **manufacturing** attracting investments. Major sources of FDI include **Mauritius** (25%), **Singapore** (24%), and the **US** (10%). Other investors include the **Netherlands**, **Japan**, **UK**, and **UAE**.

Economy Current Affairs of December 2024

- India's **FDI** rose by **45%** to **USD 29.79 billion** in H1 of FY 2024-25, driven by growth in **services**, **computer**, **telecom**, and **pharma** sectors. The **July-September quarter** saw a 43% increase, totaling **USD 13.6 billion**. **Maharashtra** was the top recipient. Key investors included **Mauritius**, **Singapore**, and the **US**, with **non-conventional energy** also attracting significant FDI.
- India's **GST revenue** grew by **8.5%** to **₹1.82 lakh crore** in November 2024, driven by a **9.4%** increase in **domestic transactions**. Key figures include **Central GST** at ₹34,141 crore, **State GST** at ₹43,047 crore, **Integrated IGST** at ₹91,828 crore, and **Cess** at ₹13,253 crore. This follows a record **₹2.10 lakh crore** collection in April 2024.
- In the **July-September 2024-25** quarter, **Singapore** became the largest source of **FDI** for India, contributing **50%** of the total **USD 13.6 billion** inflows, a **43% increase**. From **April 2000 to March 2024**, Singapore's cumulative FDI in India reached **USD 159.94 billion**, emphasizing its crucial role in India's **economic growth**.
- India's **retail inflation** is projected to have fallen to **5.53%** in **November**, down from **6.21%** in October, primarily due to moderating **vegetable prices**, especially **tomatoes**. The decline reflects a slowdown in **core inflation** and offers relief to households. **Edible oil price reductions** and seasonal drops in vegetable prices also helped stabilize inflation. The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** maintains steady interest rates, signaling a cautious approach amid economic slowdowns.
- **Retail inflation** for agricultural and rural workers declined in **October 2024**, easing to **5.96%** for farm workers and **6%** for rural laborers, down from **6.36%** and **6.39%** in September. This reflects an improvement compared to **October 2023** inflation rates. The **Consumer Price Index (CPI)** for both groups rose slightly, indicating a small increase in the cost of living. **CPI-AL** was 1,315 points and **CPI-RL** was 1,326 points, showing an uptick from September.

- The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** has downgraded India's **GDP growth forecast** for FY25 to **6.5%** and FY26 to **7%**, citing weak industrial output, low public spending, and tight monetary policies. **Q2FY25** saw a slowdown to **5.4%** growth. Despite these challenges, India's economy remains supported by strong **agriculture**, resilient **services**, and falling **crude oil prices**.
- India's **GDP growth projections** for **FY25** have been downgraded by multiple agencies due to global and domestic challenges. **CARE Ratings** lowered its estimate from **6.8%** to **6.5%**, citing **corporate profitability contraction**, reduced **public capex**, and sluggish **urban consumption**. **Fitch Ratings** revised its forecast to **6.4%**, while the **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** pegged it at **6.5%**.
- India's **wholesale inflation** moderated to **1.9%** in **November**, down from **2.4%** in October, with food price inflation easing from **11.6%** to **8.9%**. Despite this, prices for **manufactured products** like **food products**, **furniture**, **pharmaceuticals**, and **electrical equipment** continued to rise. **Food price inflation** saw a significant drop in vegetable prices but **potato prices** surged by **82.8%**, and **edible oils** rose by **28%**. Inflation in **pulses**, **fruits**, **wheat**, and **paddy** persisted at a slower pace.
- In the first half of **FY 2024-25**, **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**, including **State Bank of India (SBI)**, reported a **net profit of ₹85,520 crore**, marking a **26% growth** from the previous year. This success reflects improved **asset quality**, **credit monitoring**, and **operational efficiency**, supported by **strengthened governance** and a **bolstered capital base**.
- India's **net direct tax collections** for **FY 2023-24** have risen by **16.45%** to **Rs 15.82 lakh crore** by December 17, driven by a **21% increase** in **advance tax payments**. This growth reflects improved tax collection mechanisms and efforts to reduce the fiscal deficit, with contributions from **corporate tax**, **personal income tax**, **securities transaction tax (STT)**, and other levies.
- India's economy is projected to grow at **6.6%** in FY26, driven by **investments** (7.2% growth) and **consumption** (6.9% growth), despite fiscal and external challenges. **Inflation** is expected to ease to **4.3%**, with gradual **monetary easing**. The government's fiscal target of reducing the deficit to **4.5%** by FY26 remains achievable, supported by projected **nominal growth** of **10.2%** and **capex growth** of **10%**.
- India's **retail inflation** dropped to **5.48%** in November from **6.21%** in October, mainly due to falling **food prices**, particularly vegetables. This brought inflation within the **Reserve Bank of India's (RBI)** target range, fueling hopes of a potential **rate cut** in early 2025. **Industrial production** also showed growth, enhancing economic optimism. However, **core inflation** and volatile food prices remain concerns. **Food inflation** decreased to **9.04%**, driven by lower vegetable prices, though some items like **potatoes** and **garlic** continued with high inflation.
- India's **industrial output** growth slowed to **3.5%** in **October 2024**, a significant drop from **11.9%** in the same month last year. The **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)** stood at **149.9**, up from **144.9** in October 2023. The slowdown was attributed to weaker performance in the **mining**, **electricity**, and **manufacturing** sectors.
- India's economic growth is projected to reach **6.5%** in **FY25**, despite a sluggish first half, according to the **Finance Ministry's Monthly Economic Review**. The slowdown is mainly due to the **RBI's restrictive monetary policy** and **weaker demand**. However, **agricultural activity** and **industrial gains** are expected to boost growth in the second half, offsetting global uncertainties.
- India's **current account deficit (CAD)** for **Q2 FY2024-25** moderated to **\$11.2 billion** (1.2% of GDP) from **\$11.3 billion** (1.3% of GDP) due to strong **services exports** and improved **net services receipts**. Despite a **higher merchandise trade deficit** of **\$75.3 billion**, driven by increased imports, **services exports** in categories like **computer services**, **business services**, **travel**, and **transportation** grew significantly. The **CAD** is expected to rise to **2.5-2.7% of GDP** in **Q3** due to a record-high **trade deficit** in November.



Business Current Affairs of January 2024

- In December, UPI transactions soared by an impressive **42% year-on-year**, reaching an astounding value of **Rs 18 lakh crore**. The transaction volume witnessed a substantial **54% rise**, totaling **1,202 crore**. Remarkably, the month-on-month growth in UPI transaction volume was a substantial **7%**.
- In a noteworthy alliance, **ITC**, a prominent Indian conglomerate, has joined forces with **Microsoft and Skymet** to address the escalating challenges faced by tobacco farmers in India due to climate change. The adverse impacts of climate change on agriculture are well-known, and the tobacco sector is no exception, suffering an estimated **loss of ₹800-900 crore in export revenues**.
- **India's electric vehicle (EV)** landscape is witnessing a groundbreaking development as **Ola Electric**, the IPO-bound electric scooter company, **secures eligibility for the government's Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme**. This achievement positions Ola Electric as a key player in the push towards sustainable transportation.
- In a significant development, **Binny Bansal**, co-founder of **Flipkart**, has ventured into the e-commerce space once again with his latest startup, **OppDoor**.
- **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)**, the Mumbai-based conglomerate with a diverse portfolio in energy and petrochemical businesses, concluded the year 2023 on a remarkable note. The company achieved a significant milestone by becoming the **first in India to produce ISCC-Plus certified chemically recycled polymers**.
- **Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd (APSEZ)**, a prominent player in the ports and logistics sector, recently made significant announcements regarding its leadership structure. The company declared that **CEO Karan Adani would be stepping into the role of Managing Director**, succeeding Gautam Adani. In parallel, the company welcomed **Ashwani Gupta, former global Chief Operating Officer at Nissan Motors, as its new CEO**.
- **REC Limited**, a prominent Maharatna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) established in 1969 under the **Ministry of Power**, has recently entered into a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with **Rail Vikas Nigam Limited (RVNL)**. This collaboration aims to provide financial support of up to **Rs. 35,000 Crores** for a range of Infrastructure Projects over the next 5 years, showcasing the commitment of both entities to drive essential developments in the sector.
- **Adidas**, the renowned athletic footwear and apparel giant, is making strategic moves to enhance its global operations by establishing its first and only **Global Capacity Centre (GCC) in Asia outside of China**. This significant development underscores the growing trend of multinational corporations choosing India as a prime destination for setting up their GCCs, capitalizing on the country's abundant software skills.
- **Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC)**, one of India's leading energy exploration and production companies, achieved a significant milestone on January 7 by commencing the **first oil production from the deep-water KG-DWN 98/2 Block**. Located in the Krishna Godavari (KG) basin off the Bay of Bengal on the **Kakinada coast**, this development marks a crucial step forward in India's energy landscape.
- A recent report by **CBRE-CREDAI** sheds light on the landscape of micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) in India, revealing noteworthy trends and state-wise contributions. As of December 2023, the country boasts over 3 crore registered MSMEs, with **Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and Uttar Pradesh** jointly constituting nearly 40% of this vibrant sector.
- In a positive development, **Power Finance Corporation (PFC)** witnessed a nearly one percent surge in early trade on January 10, following the green light from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to establish a finance company within **Gujarat's GIFT City**, an International Financial Services Centre (IFSC).
- In a groundbreaking move, the **International Hockey Federation (FIH)** has sealed a significant media rights partnership with **Viacom18**, spanning the four-year period from 2023 to 2027. This exclusive agreement encompasses all FIH events, with the exception of the FIH Nations Cup.
- **The World Bank** reveals a surprising resilience in the global economy, though shadows loom over the future, anticipating a **third consecutive year of slowdown** in 2024. After a robust rebound to 6.2% in 2021, global growth waned to 3.0% in 2022 and further to 2.6% in 2023. Projections indicate a continued deceleration to 2.4% in 2024 before a modest recovery to 2.7% in 2025, notably below the 3.1% average of the 2010s.
- The semiconductor industry in India is witnessing a significant boost as **Simmtech**, a South Korean firm, announced its plans to set up a manufacturing plant in **Sanand, Gujarat**. With an investment of Rs 1,250 crore, Simmtech aims to contribute to the creation of a **robust semiconductor ecosystem in the state**. This development was disclosed by Union Minister for Electronics and Information Technology, **Ashwini Vaishnav**, during the ongoing Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit in Gandhinagar.
- **Tata Consumer Products Ltd (TCPL)**, on January 12, revealed its plans to acquire a 100% stake in Capital Foods, renowned for brands such as '**Ching's Secret**' and '**Smith & Jones**,' for a substantial ₹5,100 crore. The strategic acquisition is structured in phases, with an initial 75% equity shareholding secured upfront and the remaining 25% to be acquired over the next three years.

- Bengaluru-based **space tech startup Pixxel** marked a significant milestone on January 15 with the inauguration of its cutting-edge spacecraft manufacturing facility, named **"MegaPixxel."** The 30,000 sq ft facility is poised to revolutionize satellite production capabilities in India.
- The Ministry of Home Affairs in India has revoked the **Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Act, 2020**, registration of the **Centre for Policy Research (CPR)** in New Delhi, alleging violations. The leading public policy research institution, spearheaded by Congress leader Mani Shankar Aiyar's daughter, Yamini Aiyar, has faced government scrutiny for purportedly breaching FCRA regulations.
- The **Employees' Provident Fund Organization (EPFO)** has recently issued a circular stating the removal of **Aadhaar** from the list of acceptable documents for proof of **date of birth (DoB)** for correction and updation purposes. This decision, effective from January 16, 2024, follows a directive from the **Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)** and aligns with the Aadhaar Act, 2016, which does not recognize Aadhaar as proof of date of birth.
- Taiwanese tech giant **Foxconn**, a long-time Apple Inc. partner, is diversifying from China and joining forces with **HCL Group** to establish a chip packaging and testing facility in India. Foxconn's subsidiary, **Foxconn Hon Hai Technology India Mega Development**, will invest \$37.2 million for a 40% stake, with the remaining held by HCL. This strategic move comes amidst Foxconn's increased investments in India, motivated by geopolitical tensions with China.
- **L&T Construction's railways** strategic business group has clinched a significant contract valued between **₹10,000 to ₹15,000 crore** for a pivotal segment of the Mumbai-Ahmedabad bullet train project. The 'mega' order, received from a Japanese agency overseeing the **Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail Project (MAHSR)**, entails the construction of 508 route km of high-speed electrification works.
- **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)**, a prominent name in the global IT services sector, has achieved a significant milestone by being rated the second most valuable IT services brand in the world, according to the **2024 Global 500 IT Services Ranking by Brand Finance**. This achievement underscores TCS's commitment to innovation, sustainability, and global expansion, positioning it as a leader in the technology industry.
- **DLabs at the Indian School of Business (ISB)** has announced the initiation of **'Build for Billions'**, a startup accelerator program centered around financial inclusion for the informal economy. This innovative program has been launched in partnership with the **Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH) and Union Bank of India**.
- In a significant move towards fostering international digital transactions, **Google India Digital Services** and **NPCI International Payments Ltd (NIPL)** have joined hands to propel UPI payments beyond the borders of India. The recently signed Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between the two entities is poised to revolutionize the way Indian travellers engage in financial transactions abroad.
- In a major development at the World Economic Forum 2024, the Adani Group unveiled plans to invest Rs 50,000 crore over the next decade in establishing a **1 GW hyperscale data centre in Maharashtra**. The conglomerate's flagship company, Adani Enterprises Ltd, and the Maharashtra government formalized this commitment through a memorandum of understanding (MoU) signed in the presence of Maharashtra Chief Minister Eknath Shinde and Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani.
- In a strategic move, **Tata Sons Private Limited** has successfully utilized its Right to Match card, retaining the prestigious title sponsorship of the **Indian Premier League (IPL)** for the upcoming five seasons, spanning **2024 to 2028**. This development follows the Board of Control for Cricket in India's (BCCI) release of an Invitation to Tender (ITT) for Title Sponsor Rights in late December 2023.
- In a significant development, **four electricity distribution companies (DISCOMs)** from Delhi and Uttar Pradesh have achieved the prestigious **A+ rating** in the latest **Consumer Service Rating of Discoms (CSR) report**. The report, unveiled by Power Minister RK Singh, is a comprehensive evaluation of DISCOMs across the country, aimed at enhancing their accountability towards consumers.
- Sony issued a notice terminating the merger agreement with Zee Entertainment Enterprises Ltd. (ZEEL) and Culver Max Entertainment Private Limited (CME), formerly known as Sony Pictures Networks India Private Limited. The **\$10-billion deal**, signed on December 22, 2021, faced challenges in meeting closing conditions within the specified timeframe.
- The Competition Commission of India (CCI) has given the nod to significant business transactions, signaling a shifting landscape in the corporate sector. Among the approved deals is the **JSW Group's** strategic move to acquire a substantial **38% stake in MG Motor India**. Facilitated through JSW Ventures Singapore, a newly established subsidiary of JSW International Tradecorp Pte Ltd, the acquisition is poised to reshape the dynamics of the automotive industry.
- **Air India**, a subsidiary of the Tata Group, incurred a hefty fine of Rs **1.1 crore** from the **Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)**, the country's aviation regulator, for safety breaches. This penalty was imposed following a pilot's report concerning insufficient emergency oxygen supply on Air India's B777 aircraft, which are crucially utilized for long-range flights.
- In a significant development, **Zomato Payments Private Limited**, the subsidiary of popular food delivery platform Zomato, has obtained the much-coveted payment aggregator (PA) license from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). The approval, dated January 24, 2024, empowers Zomato Payments to facilitate ecommerce transactions through its platform.

- **Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency (IREDA)**, a Government of India enterprise under the administrative control of the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy, has taken a remarkable step towards fostering transparency and promoting renewable energy initiatives. On January 25, 2024, IREDA unveiled '**Pahal**,' the insightful house journal of its Vigilance Department, marking a significant milestone in its commitment to accountability and sustainability.
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- **THDC India Limited (THDCIL)**, a prominent Power Sector PSU, proudly unveiled **India's Largest Electrolyser End Fuel Cell-based Green Hydrogen Pilot Project** at its office complex in Rishikesh. The initiative aligns with the "National Green Hydrogen Mission," showcasing THDCIL's commitment to sustainable energy practices.
- **GAIL**, India's leading gas company, has made significant strides in enhancing its liquefied natural gas (LNG) portfolio through a recent partnership with the United Arab Emirates' (UAE) **ADNOC Gas**. Under this deal, GAIL is set to procure 0.5 million tonnes of LNG annually for a decade, marking a crucial step towards meeting India's growing demand for natural gas.
- **Toyota**, the renowned Japanese automaker, has once again secured its position as the **world's top-selling automaker in 2023**. This achievement underscores Toyota's continued dominance in the global automotive market and its commitment to innovation, quality, and customer satisfaction.
- **NTPC Green Energy Ltd (NGEL)**, a subsidiary of NTPC, recently inked a groundbreaking Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) worth **Rs 80,000 crore with the Maharashtra government**. This strategic collaboration aims to pioneer green hydrogen projects within the state, aligning closely with the government's vision outlined in its Green Investment Plan.
- In response to escalating rice prices, the Government of India has unveiled the '**Bharat**' brand rice, aiming to address market volatility and ensure affordability for consumers. The rice will be available in **5- and 10-kg packs at ₹29 per kg** through cooperatives such as Nafed, NCCF, and Kendriya Bhandar.
- India has officially introduced the **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** at the iconic **Eiffel Tower** in Paris, marking a significant step towards realizing Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of globalizing UPI. This initiative follows the digital payments sector agreement signed between India and France in July of the previous year, making France the first European country to adopt India's UPI for retail transactions.
- The Gautam Adani-led Adani Group is constructing the **world's largest single-location copper manufacturing plant** in Mundra, Gujarat. This \$1.2 billion facility, set to commence its first phase operations by March-end, aims to reach a full-scale production capacity of 1 million tonnes by 2029.
- Forty days after an ammonia gas leak from a fertilizer plant owned by **Coromandel International Limited** shook Ennore in Tamil Nadu, the Environment, Climate Change and Forest Department has taken decisive actions against the company. The department has slapped a significant penalty of **Rs 5.92 crore** on Coromandel International Limited for its role in the gas leak incident. This reflects the seriousness with which authorities are addressing environmental hazards.

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- **REC Limited**, a Maharatna Central Public Sector Enterprise under the Ministry of Power and a leading NBFC, has been honored with the prestigious **Best Green Bond – Corporate Award** at The Asset Triple A Awards for Sustainable Finance. This recognition underscores REC's commitment to Sustainable Finance and Environmental Sustainability.
- Tata Group has made history by becoming the first Indian conglomerate to surpass the **₹30 lakh crore mark** in combined market capitalization. This significant achievement is driven by strong performances from key subsidiaries, including **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Tata Motors, Tata Power, and Indian Hotels**.
- In a visionary collaboration with philanthropist Ratan Tata, **Tata Trusts** proudly announces the launch of the nation's foremost **Small Animal Hospital in Mahalaxmi, Mumbai**. This groundbreaking initiative is a testament to Mr. Tata's enduring commitment to pet healthcare and veterinary care. Spanning an impressive 98,000 square feet across five floors, this state-of-the-art facility epitomizes excellence in pet healthcare.
- Flywire Corporation, in collaboration with the State Bank of India (SBI), aims to modernize and **digitize international education payments** for Indian students. This partnership facilitates seamless transactions in Indian Rupees, ensuring compliance with the Liberalized Remittance Scheme (LRS) guidelines.
- The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** has approved a **\$200 million loan** to enhance flood and riverbank erosion risk management along the Brahmaputra River in Assam, India. This project aims to build on previous successful initiatives and address the persistent challenges of flooding and erosion in the region.
- India's flagship instant payment system, the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), along with RuPay card services, is set to be launched in **Sri Lanka and Mauritius** on February 12. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Sri Lankan President Ranil Wickremesinghe, and Mauritius Prime Minister Pravind Jugnauth will oversee the launch, marking a significant milestone in digital financial integration.
- Paytm E-commerce has undergone a significant transformation, renaming itself as **Pai Platforms**. Alongside this rebranding, it has acquired **Bitsila**, a prominent seller platform operating within the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC).
- Paytm's parent company, One97 Communications, is exploring transitioning its payments service into a **third-party payment app (TPAP)** to ensure uninterrupted access to the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) for its customers. Talks have begun with the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**, the governing body overseeing the UPI ecosystem in the country.
- **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)** achieved a significant milestone on Indian stock exchanges by surpassing a market capitalization of **₹20-lakh crore**. This marks the first instance of any company achieving this valuation on the Indian bourses. The surge in market value is attributed to various factors including robust performance across its business segments and favorable market conditions.
- **Tata Group and Uber** are in talks to form a strategic partnership aimed at enhancing traffic volumes and engagement on Tata's digital platform, **Tata Neu**. Despite Tata Neu's positioning as a 'super app,' it has encountered challenges such as stagnant user growth and low engagement.
- The **Serum Institute of India (SII)**, led by Adar Poonawalla, has recently secured the prestigious title of **India's most valuable unlisted company**, boasting a valuation of Rs 1.92 lakh crore, as per the esteemed **Burgundy Private Hurun India 500 list**. This achievement highlights SII's crucial role not only in driving innovation in healthcare but also in shaping the nation's economic trajectory.
- In a move aimed at fostering innovation and entrepreneurship, **Tata Steel** recently inked a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **IIT Bhubaneswar Research and Entrepreneurship Park (REP)**. This partnership signifies a strategic alignment between industry and academia to explore avenues for mutual growth and development.
- The government has increased the authorized capital of the **Food Corporation of India (FCI)** from **₹10,000 crore to ₹21,000 crore**, demonstrating a significant commitment to enhancing its operational capacities. This initiative, announced by the Food Ministry, underscores the government's dedication to strengthening FCI's role in ensuring food security and safeguarding farmers' interests.
- **REC Limited**, a Maharatna Central Public Sector Enterprise under the Ministry of Power and a prominent NBFC, has been honored with the '**Innovative Technology Development Award**' at the 'Building India 2047: Technology for Better Tomorrow' CSR Summit, hosted by IIT Madras.
- The Indian government is set to invite private investment worth **\$26 billion** into its **nuclear energy sector**. This initiative aims to bolster non-carbon-emitting energy sources, aligning with India's goal of increasing non-fossil fuel-based electricity generation to 50% by 2030.
- IT services and consulting firm **Tech Mahindra** finalized the acquisition of **Orchid Cybertech Services (OCSI)**, purchasing a 100% stake in the company through its wholly-owned subsidiary for a total of \$3.27 million (₹24.75 crores). This move marks a significant step for Tech Mahindra in expanding its service offerings and strengthening its partnership with TPG Telecom.

- **Paymart**, a fintech startup, announced its **partnership with five Indian banks** to introduce a groundbreaking virtual, cardless, and hardware-less cash withdrawal service. The partnered banks include IDBI Bank, Indian Bank, Jammu & Kashmir Bank, and Karur Vyasa Bank, with discussions underway with four additional banks for further collaboration.
- **Reliance Industries**, led by **Mukesh Ambani**, in collaboration with some of the country's premier engineering institutions, is poised to unveil its pioneering **ChatGPT-style service named 'Hanooman' next month**. This initiative marks a significant milestone in the advancement of AI capabilities within India, promising to bring a new era of digital innovation and accessibility.
- **Mswipe Technologies**, a prominent player in India's digital payments sector, has been awarded a **Payment Aggregator (PA) license** by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). This significant development follows the company's receipt of an in-principle approval earlier in 2022. Mswipe aims to leverage this license to bolster its range of offerings, providing comprehensive payment technology solutions across various channels.
- PhonePe has launched the **Indus Appstore**, a made-in-India Android app marketplace, aiming to rival Google Play Store and Apple App Store. The platform hosts over **2 Lakh apps** across 45 categories, offering a diverse range of applications to users.
- The legal battle between **PayPal and the FIU** commenced in March 2018 when the latter demanded registration as a reporting entity under the PMLA. Despite PayPal's resistance, the FIU imposed a penalty in December 2020, alleging non-cooperation and failure to comply with anti-money laundering obligations. This penalty was initially overturned in July 2023, but the court ruled that PayPal must adhere to reporting obligations under the PMLA as a payments system operator.
- **SJVN Limited**, a Mini Ratna, Category-I and Schedule 'A' Central public sector enterprise under the administrative control of **Ministry of Power, Government of India**, has marked a significant milestone in its journey towards sustainable energy solutions. On February 23, 2024, SJVN announced the commencement of successful commercial operations of its **50 MW Gujrai Solar Power Station** in Kanpur Dehat, Uttar Pradesh.
- **NTPC Renewable Energy Ltd.** inaugurates its inaugural solar project in **Chhattargarh, Rajasthan**, with a capacity of 70 MW, marking a significant milestone in India's renewable energy sector. This project contributes to NTPC Group's total installed capacity, which now stands at 73,958 MW, further solidifying its position as a key player in the country's energy landscape.
- The **National Sample Survey Office (NSSO)** has released findings from the **Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES)** conducted from August 2022 to July 2023. This survey aimed to assess the Household **Monthly Per Capita Consumption Expenditure (MPCE)** across various demographics, spanning rural and urban sectors, states, union territories, and socio-economic groups.
- In a significant development, **Vijay Shekhar Sharma**, the Founder and CEO of Paytm, has resigned from his role as part-time non-executive chairman and board member of **Paytm Payments Bank**. This move comes amidst a restructuring of the bank's board in response to regulatory concerns and a directive from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to wind down operations by March 15.
- Gautam Adani's conglomerate inaugurated two defense facilities in northern India, representing an investment of **30 billion rupees (\$362 million)**. These facilities, established by Adani Defence & Aerospace, signify India's drive towards self-reliance in defense manufacturing.
- **KPDCL (Kashmir Power Distribution Corporation Limited)** has extended its amnesty scheme for domestic consumers in Jammu & Kashmir. The scheme allows consumers to clear outstanding electricity dues in easy installments without late payment surcharges. Disconnected connections can be restored by paying only the principal amount.
- **Reliance Industries and Reliance Foundation** have launched a bold initiative, **Vantara (Star of the Forest)**, dedicated to the rescue, treatment, care, and rehabilitation of animals in need. This ambitious program, spearheaded by **Anant Ambani**, aims to create a national and international impact on animal welfare.
- **Amazon Pay**, the fintech arm of Amazon India, has secured a **payment aggregator license** from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), joining a select group of authorized organizations in the country.
- **Reliance Industries (RIL)** has unveiled a significant merger deal with **Viacom18 Media and The Walt Disney Company**, aimed at forming a joint venture (JV) that will integrate the operations of Viacom18 and Star India. This strategic move is poised to reshape the landscape of the Indian entertainment and sports industry. RIL commits to investing Rs 11,500 crore (approximately US\$ 1.4 billion) into the JV to support its growth strategy.

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- Ecommerce giant **Flipkart** has made a significant move in the digital payments space by introducing its own UPI services, **Flipkart UPI**, in partnership with **Axis Bank**. This initiative aims to provide customers with seamless payment options directly integrated into the Flipkart platform.

- **REC Limited**, a prominent Maharatna Central Public Sector Enterprise under the Ministry of Power and a leading Non-Banking Finance Company, has recently joined hands with the **Unit of Science and Educational Development (UNISED)** to bolster educational initiatives in **Siddharthnagar district, Uttar Pradesh**. Through its Corporate Social Responsibility arm, REC Foundation, REC has pledged a significant financial assistance of Rs. 9.91 crores for the education of approximately 75,500 children in the district.
- In a virtual ceremony, Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman received an interim dividend cheque of **₹2,441.44 crore** from LIC Chairman Siddhartha Mohanty, showcasing the insurance giant's financial strength. The event also marked the inauguration of **LIC's new international business centre at GIFT City, Gujarat**, emphasizing the company's dedication to offering top-notch insurance and financial services globally.
- **Tata Motors**, India's largest commercial vehicle manufacturer, has recently unveiled its **next-generation, green-fuel powered commercial vehicles to Tata Steel**. The fleet comprises Prima tractors, tippers, and the Ultra EV bus, which are powered by Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) and battery electric technologies. The flag-off ceremony took place during Tata Group's Founder's Day celebrations in Jamshedpur, officiated by Mr. N Chandrasekaran, Chairman of Tata Sons.
- The government of India has announced plans to sell up to **7% of its stake in NLC India**, formerly known as Neyveli Lignite Corp, through an Offer for Sale (OFS). This move aims to raise between **Rs 2,000 crore and Rs 2,100 crore**, contributing to the government's disinvestment goals.
- Accenture, a global leader in technology consulting and services, has unveiled a strategic initiative aimed at enhancing upskilling opportunities for its clients. This involves a significant **investment of \$1 billion over three years** and includes the acquisition of California-based edtech platform, Udacity.
- **Fly91**, a regional airline headquartered in **Goa**, has reached a significant milestone in its journey with the issuance of its **Air Operator Certificate (AOC)** by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) under the Ministry of Civil Aviation.
- State-owned **Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd (BHEL)** has clinched a significant order from power giant **NTPC** to establish a **1,600 MW Singrauli thermal power project (Stage-II)**. This underscores BHEL's continued prowess in the power generation equipment sector.
- **Indian Oil Corporation Ltd (IOC)**, the nation's premier oil firm, is set to revolutionize the motorsports industry by manufacturing fuel tailored for adrenaline-pumping **Formula One (F1) racing**. With its latest offering, 'Storm' petrol, IOC aims to expand its repertoire of niche fuels, catering to the high-performance demands of motor racing enthusiasts.
- **Infibeam Avenues**, India's pioneering AI-powered fintech company and the country's first listed entity in this domain, has achieved a significant milestone. On March 4, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) granted the final authorization for Infibeam Avenues to function as a **payment aggregator** under its renowned payment gateway brand, CCAvenue. This development follows the in-principle approval given in October 2022.
- The Union Cabinet has sanctioned a **4% increase in Dearness Allowance (DA)** and Dearness Relief (DR) for central government employees and pensioners, effective from January 1. This decision aims to benefit over 10 million employees and 6.79 million pensioners, with a combined impact on the exchequer of **Rs 12,869 crore** annually.
- **NLCIL** has emerged victorious in securing a **600 MW Solar Power Project** tender within the **GSECL Khavda Solar Park**, initiated by GUVNL through a competitive bidding process. Reflecting its commitment to renewable energy initiatives, NLCIL has entrusted the project development responsibilities to NIGEL, its green energy wholly owned subsidiary.
- The Department of Science and Technology (DST), in collaboration with T-Hub, has launched the **Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence Technology Hub (MATH)** in Hyderabad. This initiative aims to accelerate AI innovation, facilitate job creation, and foster a supportive ecosystem for AI and ML startups.
- **Big Bang Boom Solutions (BBBS)**, a homegrown IDEX (Innovations for Defence Excellence) startup, clinches a major order **exceeding Rs 200 Crores** for its state-of-the-art anti-drone technology. Signed by the Ministry of Defence (MoD) with BBBS, this **contract marks the largest under the IDEX initiative**, aimed at benefiting the Indian Army and the Indian Air Force.
- **Aditya Birla Capital's** decision to merge with its wholly-owned subsidiary, Aditya Birla Finance, is poised to reshape the **NBFC** landscape in India. This strategic move not only consolidates their financial services arm but also aligns with RBI's regulations, avoiding the need for Aditya Birla Finance to go public.
- **Tata Power Solar Systems Limited (TPSSL)**, a fully integrated solar company in India and a subsidiary of TPREL (Tata Power Renewable Energy Limited), has achieved a significant milestone by completing the **country's largest Solar and Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) project** in Rajnandgaon, **Chhattisgarh**.
- **National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (NIELIT)** of India and the **Information Technology Institute (ITI) of Egypt**. This significant event took place in Cairo, Egypt. This collaboration seeks to **bridge the gap in ICT skills**, enhancing industry engagement and fostering meaningful international cooperation between India and Egypt.

- **Aurionpro Solutions** has clinched a significant deal with the **State Bank of India (SBI)** for the license, implementation, and support of its cutting-edge cash management and transaction banking platform, **iCashpro+**. Valued at nearly **Rs 100 crore**, this prestigious contract entails phased delivery of license and implementation over **12 months**, followed by a **6-year** maintenance and support period.
- India's **Numaligarh Refinery Limited (NRL)** opens its first overseas office in **Dhaka, Bangladesh**, signaling its commitment to international expansion and stronger regional ties. High Commissioner of India to Bangladesh, Pranay Verma, inaugurates NRL's liaison office in the presence of NRL managing director Bhaskar Jyoti Phukan and other dignitaries.
- **Reliance Industries**, India's largest private company, has announced its acquisition of **Paramount Global's** entire **13.01%** stake in **Viacom 18 Media** for **Rs 4,286 crore (\$517 million)**. This significant transaction underscores Reliance's strategic positioning in the media industry, further solidifying its presence in the competitive market.
- The **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** releases the monthly Wholesale Price Index (WPI) for India. This report provides crucial information on price changes in various sectors of the economy, aiding in economic analysis and policy formulation. The WPI for February 2024, with a base year of 2011-12, reflects a 0.20% provisional annual inflation rate, driven primarily by increases in food articles, crude petroleum & natural gas, electricity, machinery & equipment, and motor vehicles, trailers & semi-trailers.
- **Adani Green Energy** announced the operationalisation of an additional **126 MW** capacity in its **300 MW** wind power project in **Gujarat**. This comes after the earlier operationalisation of **174 MW**, marking a significant milestone for the company.
- **Max India Ltd** announced a strategic partnership between its subsidiary, **Antara Assisted Care Services Limited**, and the **Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT Delhi)**. This collaboration aims to address the challenges faced by India's aging population by developing tailored solutions to improve their quality of life.
- **Startup Mahakumbh 2024**, a groundbreaking initiative led by industry giants such as ASSOCHAM, Nasscom, Bootstrap Incubation & Advisory Foundation, TiE, and Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association, is set to unite over 1,000 startups, 50 unicorns, 500 incubators, and 5,000 delegates from 23 countries. This three-day event, supported by the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**, aims to foster innovation and collaboration across various sectors, featuring prominent figures like Amitabh Kant, Sivasubramanian Ramann, and Falguni Nayar.
- **Tata Sons**, aiming to alleviate its debt, plans to sell **0.65% equity in Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)** for **₹9,362.3 crore**. This move precedes a potential IPO, with related stocks rallying. TCS dividends, contributing 95% of FY23 revenue, highlight its strategic importance within Tata's asset portfolio.
- **Reliance Consumer Products (RCPL)** has solidified a strategic partnership with **Elephant House**, a prominent Sri Lankan beverage manufacturer. This collaboration aims to introduce, market, distribute, and sell Elephant House brand beverages throughout India, thereby augmenting RCPL's beverage offerings.
- **Grid Controller of India Limited (GRID-INDIA)** has achieved a significant milestone by being conferred with the status of **Miniratna Category-I Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)**. This recognition was bestowed upon by the **Ministry of Power, Government of India**, highlighting GRID-INDIA's pivotal role in the nation's power landscape.
- **The National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI)** is gearing up to introduce the **BhashaNet** portal during the upcoming **Universal Acceptance (UA) Day**. This initiative aims to advance digital inclusion and linguistic diversity in India, showcasing collaborative efforts between NIXI and the Ministry of **Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**.
- In a significant move, the **Gujarat Cooperative Milk Marketing Federation (GCMMF)**, the organization behind the iconic **Amul** brand, is set to launch its fresh milk products in the United States for the first time. This expansion marks a major milestone for the brand, as it aims to cater to the **Indian diaspora and Asian population** in the US.
- **PepsiCo**, the U.S. food and beverage giant, has committed to investing an additional **\$400 million** in **Vietnam**. This decision was made public during a visit by delegations from over 60 U.S. enterprises, including Suntory PepsiCo Vietnam Beverage, to Vietnam last week.
- **Innoviti Payments and Concerto Software** have received **payment aggregator (PA) licences** from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), marking significant milestones in the digital payments landscape of India. Innoviti operates the PA '**Innoviti Link**', serving 2,500 online merchants, while Concerto Software's gateway '**Vegaah**' joins the league of authorized PA solutions.
- **Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ)**, a subsidiary of the Adani Group, has acquired a controlling **95% stake in Gopalpur Port** located in **Odisha**. The deal, valued at Rs 3,350 crore, solidifies APSEZ's position in the ports and logistics sector.

- **Wipro-GE Healthcare**, a prominent player in medical technology and digital solutions, is set to invest **Rs 8,000 crore** over the next five years in India. This investment aims to strengthen its manufacturing output and research and development capabilities. The company's focus is on expanding its **'Make in India for the World' initiative**, emphasizing increased localization and exports of medical equipment.
- In a remarkable move, two of India's richest businessmen, **Mukesh Ambani** and **Gautam Adani**, have joined forces for the first time. **Reliance Industries**, owned by Ambani, has acquired a **26% stake** in a power project owned by Adani's company in **Madhya Pradesh**.
- The Index of Eight Core Industries (ICI) witnessed a significant **6.7% increase** (provisional) in **February 2024** compared to the same month in 2023. This growth was driven by positive performances across various sectors, including **Coal, Natural Gas, Cement, Steel, Crude Oil, Electricity, and Refinery Products**.
- Tata Passenger Electric Mobility (TPEM), a unit of **Tata Motors**, has announced a strategic partnership with **Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL)** to establish a **nationwide network of 5,000 public charging stations** for electric vehicles (EVs) by the end of 2024.
- **The Adani Group** has announced the start of the first phase of the world's largest single-location **copper manufacturing plant** at **Mundra in Gujarat**. The facility, owned by Kutch Copper (a subsidiary of Adani Enterprises Ltd), will help reduce **India's dependence on copper imports** and support the **energy transition**.

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- On March 26, 2024, **Savita Oil Technologies** announced a significant equity transaction via a block deal, wherein the company's promoter, Mr. Gautam N. Mehra, sold a **3% stake to SBI Mutual Fund**. This resulted in a reduction of the promoter group's stake to 59.78%.
- Chhattisgarh-based **Bharat Aluminium Company Limited (BALCO)**, a unit of Vedanta Aluminium, has achieved the Aluminium Stewardship Initiative (ASI) Performance Standard V3 Certification. This accolade positions BALCO as the inaugural Indian company to attain this certification, reflecting its commitment to sustainable practices in the aluminium value chain.
- Paradip Port Authority, Odisha, surpasses Deendayal Port Authority, Kandla, to become India's leading cargo-handling major port in the fiscal year 2023-24, handling **145.38 Million Metric Tons (MMT)** of cargo, marking a **7.4% growth from the previous year**.
- Tata Technologies and BMW Group have inked a partnership to establish an automotive software and IT development center in Chennai, Pune, and Bengaluru. With Chennai's prominence in housing IT solution hubs

for auto giants like Visteon, Ford, and Renault Nissan, the focus here will be on business IT solutions.

- In a significant move, PepsiCo India announces a massive investment of **₹1,266 crore to establish a cutting-edge flavour manufacturing facility in Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh**. Scheduled to commence operations in the first quarter of 2026, this plant marks a pivotal moment for both PepsiCo and the local economy.
- **Adani Green Energy Ltd (AGEL)** has achieved a significant milestone by **surpassing 10,000 MW** of renewable energy capacity in its operational portfolio. This accomplishment solidifies AGEL's position as the foremost player in India's renewable energy sector.
- Star Health Insurance, a leading provider of **retail health insurance** in India, has collaborated with PhonePe, a prominent digital payments platform. This partnership aims to make quality health insurance accessible through PhonePe's app, offering the **Star Comprehensive Insurance Policy with monthly and annual payment options**.
- In a strategic move aimed at enhancing insurance distribution across India, **ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company** has forged a partnership with **Policybazaar**. This collaboration aims to leverage Policybazaar's digital platform to offer a wide range of insurance products to **approximately 10 million customers**.
- **Ashneer Grover** is the co-founder and former managing director of the fintech company **BharatPe**. After his high-profile exit from BharatPe in 2022, Grover has now ventured into the fintech space again with a new app called **ZeroPe**.
- In a significant move, **Japan's MUFG is set to purchase a 20% stake in HDB Financial Services**, a subsidiary of India's HDFC Bank. The deal is poised at a valuation of \$9-10 billion before the initial public offering (IPO), making it one of the largest transactions in India's shadow banking sector. HDB Financial, a non-deposit-taking lender, is expected to command a valuation ranging from \$9 billion to \$12 billion during its IPO, contingent on prevailing market conditions.
- In a significant development, Revolut India, backed by Tiger Global and Softbank, has secured in-principle approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to issue **Prepaid Payment Instruments (PPI)**. This approval marks a crucial step for Revolut in expanding its presence in the Indian market, enabling the provision of multi-currency forex cards and cross-border remittance services.
- **Adani Green Energy Limited, an Adani Group company**, is building the world's largest renewable energy park in **Khavda, Kutch district of Gujarat**. The park is spread over 538 square kilometers, which is about five times larger than the total size of the French capital, Paris.

- In a groundbreaking collaboration, **Razorpay and Airtel Payments Bank have unveiled the UPI Switch**, a cutting-edge cloud-based infrastructure designed to revolutionize the landscape of digital payments. This innovative product promises to enhance success rates by 4-5% and handle an impressive 10,000 **transactions per second (TPS)**, offering businesses unprecedented efficiency and scalability.
- In a significant move, **BharatPe has unveiled BharatPe One**, an innovative all-in-one payment device set to redefine digital transactions. This cutting-edge product integrates POS, QR, and speaker functionalities into a single device, promising unparalleled convenience for merchants and customers alike.
- **Adani Group's Vizhinjam Port in Kerala** has received approval from the government to operate as India's inaugural transshipment port. This designation is significant as it allows cargo to be transferred from large vessels to smaller ones, contributing to India's goal of becoming a manufacturing hub. Presently, a substantial portion of India's transshipment cargo is handled by ports abroad, such as those in Colombo and Singapore.
- The increasing reliance of **India on Chinese industrial goods presents significant economic and security concerns, with China's share in New Delhi's imports rising from 21% to 30% over the last 15 years**. This situation demands a strategic reassessment of import strategies to foster diversified and resilient supply chains.
- **Hitachi Payment Services** has unveiled **new upgradable ATMs in India**, allowing banks to adapt their machines into **Cash Recycling Machines (CRMs)** as per evolving needs. Manufactured under the 'Make in India' initiative, these ATMs offer flexibility and efficiency to banks, potentially revolutionizing the Indian ATM industry.
- The Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency (IREDA), a public sector enterprise, has been granted the coveted '**Navratna**' status by the government, according to a recent filing with the stock exchanges. This prestigious designation takes the total number of **Navratna PSEs (Public Sector Enterprises)** in India to 17.
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- Cred has launched an innovative UPI-based '**Scan and Pay**' service, marking its entry into the offline payments sphere, challenging incumbents like PhonePe, Google Pay, and Paytm. This service allows users to make payments directly from their bank accounts using any QR code, extending convenience to large format stores such as supermarkets, fast-food joints, beauty salons, and fashion boutiques.
- **Indian Oil Corporation (IOC)** has announced a significant investment of **Rs 5,215 crore to develop 1 gigawatt (GW)** of renewable energy capacity in India. This strategic move aligns with IOC's broader diversification strategy beyond traditional oil and gas ventures.
- **Worldline ePayments** India has announced its receipt of approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to operate as a payment aggregator. This approval underscores the company's dedication to the Indian market and emphasizes its commitment to compliance within a well-regulated payments landscape.
- India's manufacturing sector has continued its robust performance into the first quarter of the new fiscal year, maintaining its momentum from the previous year's stellar showing. In April, the **HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI)** revealed a buoyant picture, with manufacturing activity registering its second strongest expansion since early 2021.
- In the dynamic landscape of Indian startups, **former BharatPe COO Dhruv Dhanraj Bahl** steps into the world of venture capital with the launch of his **maiden fund, Eternal Capital**, with a substantial corpus of **Rs 240 crore**, including a greenshoe option.
- **Micron India's Sanand unit** gears up to unveil its inaugural batch of domestically manufactured **semiconductor chips in 2025**, with a focus on global exportation. Anand Ramamoorthy, the managing director, underscores the burgeoning global demand, strategic partnerships, and the diverse applications spanning various sectors, notably emphasizing agility and the scarcity of talent in niche domains such as cybersecurity.
- **Adani Green Energy Ltd (AGEL)** has successfully secured **USD 400 million** financing from a consortium of five leading international banks for its **750 MW solar projects in Rajasthan and Gujarat**. The financing will support the construction of these projects, expected to come online from November 2024 onwards.

Business Current Affairs of May 2024

- The increasing reliance of **India on Chinese industrial goods presents significant economic and security concerns, with China's share in New Delhi's imports rising from 21% to 30% over the last 15 years**. This situation demands a strategic reassessment of import strategies to foster diversified and resilient supply chains.
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- In a significant development, REC Ltd., under the Ministry of Power, has obtained approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to establish a subsidiary in **Gujarat International Finance Tech-City (GIFT), Gandhinagar**. This move reflects REC's strategic initiative to diversify its portfolio and tap into new avenues for growth within the burgeoning hub of financial services in India.
- India and Ghana are poised to integrate their payment systems, **UPI and GHIPSS**, to facilitate instant and cost-effective fund transfers between the two nations. Within **six months, NPCI's UPI is set to be operational on Ghana's GHIPSS platform**, marking a significant step in financial collaboration.
- **Bhavesht Gupta, the President and Chief Operating Officer** overseeing payments and lending businesses, will transition to an advisory role due to personal reasons. This move aims to ensure smooth continuity in Paytm's growth initiatives. Meanwhile, **Rakesht Singh** has been appointed as the new **CEO of Paytm Money Ltd**, signaling a renewed focus on scaling and innovation in wealth management products.
- The **National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT)** Mumbai has sanctioned Sapphire Media's acquisition plan for **Reliance Broadcast Network's Big 92.7 FM**. This approval follows a resolution process initiated in February 2023 under the **Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code**.
- IREDA, a state-owned entity under the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**, has formed a subsidiary named **IREDA Global Green Energy Finance IFSC Limited** at the **International Financial Services Centre (IFSC)** within GIFT City, Gujarat. This move aims to leverage global financial markets to support the growth of the renewable energy sector in India.
- **Bharti Enterprises, led by Sunil Bharti Mittal**, divested 38.50 lakh shares of ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company for **₹663 crore through open market transactions**. This sale reduced Bharti Enterprises' stake in ICICI Lombard from 2.43% to 1.63%. Concurrently, ICICI Bank, the promoter, increased its stake in ICICI Lombard to 51.7% by purchasing 21 lakh shares.
- Zeta, a global provider of cutting-edge banking technology, has unveiled its Digital Credit as a Service offering at Democratizing Credit 2024. Leveraging **NPCI's Credit Line on UPI scheme**, Zeta aims to tap into the burgeoning credit market in India, projecting transaction volumes to surpass \$1 trillion by 2030. With a goal to capture 50% of this market, Zeta's solution streamlines credit issuance processes for banks, facilitating the rapid deployment of diverse credit products.
- **Thomas Cook India** has revolutionized international money transfers with the **launch of TCPay**, a user-friendly digital service designed to simplify and enhance the remittance process. Traditionally, sending money abroad involved tedious paperwork and limited operating hours. With TCPay, customers can now enjoy 24x7 remittances with ease and efficiency.
- **Hinduja Group's IndusInd International Holdings (IIHL)** has obtained approval from the **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** for the acquisition of Reliance Capital. This acquisition encompasses Reliance Capital's insurance subsidiaries, including Reliance General Insurance and Reliance Nippon Life Insurance.
- Infosys, a global leader in digital services and consulting, has been awarded the **ISO 42001:2023 certification by TUV India**, for its **Artificial Intelligence Management System (AIMS)**. This certification highlights Infosys' commitment to implementing responsible AI practices and adhering to regulatory standards.
- In a significant stride towards sustainable energy practices, the **Bhilai Steel Plant (BSP)**, a key unit of the **Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)** situated in **Chhattisgarh**, is set to inaugurate the state's premier floating solar project. This venture marks a pivotal moment in Chhattisgarh's journey towards renewable energy and underscores BSP's commitment to reducing its carbon footprint while promoting eco-friendly initiatives.
- In a groundbreaking move, **Hero MotoCorp, India's leading two-wheeler manufacturer**, has become the first in its sector to integrate with the **Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)**. By leveraging ONDC's platform, Hero MotoCorp aims to enhance accessibility and convenience for its customers, offering a seamless digital experience for purchasing two-wheeler parts, accessories, and merchandise.
- In a significant move, **PhonePe has joined forces with LankaPay** to introduce **UPI payments in Sri Lanka**. This collaboration allows PhonePe users to seamlessly utilize UPI for transactions across LankaPay QR merchants, providing them with familiarity and security while traveling.
- The **Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO)** forecasts India's merchandise exports to reach **\$500-510 billion in FY25**, rebounding from a 3% contraction in the previous fiscal year. Services exports are estimated to contribute \$390-400 billion, culminating in total exports of approximately \$890-910 billion. Noteworthy sectors driving this growth include engineering, advertising services, and the expansion of global capability centers.
- In anticipation of increased demand in the automotive sector, **Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd** has unveiled an ambitious plan to **invest ₹26,000 crore** in its automotive business over the **next three years**. This significant investment will span **from FY25 to FY27** and is aimed at developing new vehicles and enhancing production capacity.
- The Indian government has announced plans for public sector companies like **Coal India, NMDC, and ONGC Videsh Ltd (OVL)** to actively seek critical mineral assets overseas. This strategic move aims to secure vital mineral resources essential for various industries, including clean energy technologies and electric vehicles.

- **Fusion Micro Finance** has obtained a **\$25 million loan** from the **United States International Development Finance Corporation (DFC)** to fuel its expansion plans, primarily focusing on empowering rural women entrepreneurs. The initial disbursement of \$20 million, part of an **eight-year loan**, aims to enhance business operations and advance financial inclusion efforts.
- Tata Motors' subsidiaries, **Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles (TMPV)** and **Tata Passenger Electric Mobility (TPEM)**, have teamed up with Bajaj Finance to offer an innovative financing programme for their authorised passenger and electric vehicle dealers. This partnership aims to streamline financing options and support the business operations of these dealers.
- Tech mogul **Elon Musk introduced SpaceX's Starlink satellite** internet service in **Indonesia**, aiming to enhance connectivity in remote regions of the archipelago nation. The inauguration took place in Bali, where Musk, alongside Indonesian officials, emphasized the transformative potential of improved internet access.
- In a strategic move to expand its foothold within the **Gujarat International Finance Tec City (GIFT City)**, the State Bank of India (SBI) has finalized the acquisition of a **6.125% stake in CCIL IFSC Limited**. The transaction, valued at ₹6.125 crore, marks SBI's commitment to enhancing its role in the International Financial Services Centre (IFSC) at GIFT City.
- AstraZeneca, a leading pharmaceutical company, announced plans to construct a state-of-the-art manufacturing facility in Singapore with a focus on producing **antibody-drug conjugates (ADCs)**, a promising class of **cancer-fighting medications**.
- Indian Oil Corporation Ltd. (IOCL) has marked a significant milestone by exporting its first-ever consignment of **100 octane premium fuel, XP100, to Sri Lanka**. The high-quality fuel, designed for premium high-end vehicles, was **shipped from the Jawaharlal Nehru Port Trust in Mumbai**. This event highlights IOCL's commitment to expanding its global reach and showcasing the quality of its products.
- **SIDBI**, in collaboration with **Airbus Helicopters**, has entered the realm of helicopter financing in India through a recent **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)**. This partnership aims to facilitate the financing of Airbus helicopters for potential civil operators in the country.
- Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Services, a prominent player in India's non-banking finance sector, has secured a corporate agency license from the **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)**. This license empowers Mahindra Finance to act as a 'corporate agent (composite)' under the Insurance Act, 1938, facilitating the distribution of insurance products.
- Tech giant **Google is investing \$350 million** in Walmart-owned e-commerce firm Flipkart as part of a \$1 billion funding round. This investment aims to support Flipkart's growth as it targets a \$60 billion valuation at the time of its initial public offering (IPO), planned for 2025-26.
- Walt Disney Co. has struck a deal to **sell its 30% minority stake in Tata Play Ltd. to Tata Group, valuing the company at approximately \$1 billion**. This move allows Disney to focus on merging its Indian unit with **Mukesh Ambani's Viacom 18 Media Pvt**, forming an \$8.5 billion entertainment giant.
- **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)** has signed a deal to modernize the core banking technology of Burgan Bank, a leading **commercial bank in Kuwait**. Burgan Bank will deploy TCS BaNCS to consolidate multiple legacy applications into a contemporary universal banking solution, enhancing innovation and customer relationships.
- The Prudential Authority of the South African Reserve Bank has imposed a **financial penalty of 10 million rand (₹4.5 crore)** on the State Bank of India's South Africa branch for non-compliance with certain provisions of the country's **Financial Intelligence Centre Act 38 of 2001 (FIC Act)**. The penalty comprises an immediately payable portion of 5.50 million rand, already paid, and a suspended amount of 4.50 million rand, contingent on compliance within 36 months.
- The Government of India, being the largest shareholder in **Life Insurance Corporation (LIC)**, **will receive a dividend of Rs 3,662 crore** following LIC's declaration of an interim dividend of Rs 6 per share. LIC reported a net profit of Rs 13,782 crore for the quarter ending March 31, 2024, marking a 4.5 percent increase compared to the same period last year.
- **GAIL (India) Ltd.**, the nation's leading **natural gas transmission and distribution company**, has achieved a significant milestone with the commissioning of its **first green hydrogen plant**. Located in **Vijaipur, Madhya Pradesh**, this plant marks GAIL's foray into the realm of **new and alternative energy sources**.
- Reliance Industries is set to begin construction on **India's first Multimodal Logistics Park at Mappedu near Chennai in June**, a project conceptualized 12 years ago. Despite initial setbacks, the project, valued at Rs 1,424 crore and spanning 184.27 acres in Tiruvallur district, is now ready to proceed, with potential to revolutionize the southern region's logistics landscape.
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- Reliance Industries, India's major refining company, has inked a significant agreement with **Russia's Rosneft**. Under this deal, Reliance will purchase at least 3 million barrels of oil per month from Rosneft, **paying in Russian roubles**. This move aligns with Russian President Vladimir Putin's call for alternative trading mechanisms amid Western sanctions. Additionally, the agreement enables Reliance to secure oil at discounted rates amidst expectations of extended OPEC+ supply cuts.
- European Union banks, including **Credit Agricole, Societe Generale, Deutsche Bank, and BNP Paribas**, are facing hurdles in trading Indian government bonds and derivatives due to a deadlock between their home authorities and Indian policymakers regarding audit oversight rights. The **European Securities and Markets Authority (ESMA)** de-recognized the **Clearing Corp of India (CCIL) in October 2022**, prompting the need for alternative clearing mechanisms.
- Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) and **Tata Group**, two of India's prominent business conglomerates, have been named among the **World's 100 'Most Influential Companies'** by the renowned TIME magazine. This recognition highlights their significant impact and influence on a global scale.

Business Current Affairs of June 2024

- Unified Payments Interface (UPI) achieved a **record-breaking 14.04 billion transactions in May**, marking a significant increase from the 13.30 billion transactions recorded in April. This reflects a **49% year-on-year growth**. The total transaction value reached Rs 20.45 lakh crore, with an average daily transaction count of 453 million and an average daily transaction value of Rs 65,966 crore.
- Ashok Leyland**, the Indian flagship of the **Hinduja Group** and one of the country's leading commercial manufacturers, launched '**Sarathi Suraksha Policy**' a **comprehensive insurance policy for safeguarding the driver community**.
- Adani One, the digital platform of the Adani Group, and ICICI Bank have introduced two variants of co-branded credit cards in partnership with Visa. This launch signifies Adani Group's entry into the retail financial sector, **offering cardholders up to 7% Adani reward points on spending within the Adani ecosystem**.
- Arka Fincap Limited, a subsidiary of **Kirloskar Oil Engines Limited**, has obtained a Corporate Agency License from the **IRDAI**, marking a significant milestone. This license allows Arka to venture into insurance distribution, enhancing its existing financial solutions portfolio to meet customer needs comprehensively.
- NPCI International and the Reserve Bank of Peru have joined forces to introduce a UPI-like real-time payments system in Peru, marking a pioneering move for South America. This collaboration aims to revolutionize **Peru's financial landscape**, fostering economic growth and financial inclusion by leveraging India's renowned Unified Payment Interface (UPI) technology.
- Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)** is set to develop a **global economic hub in Navi Mumbai**, having secured sub-leases on approximately **3,750 acres of land for Rs 13,400 crore**. The lease spans 43 years and stems from a **memorandum of understanding signed with the Maharashtra government in 2018**.

- Muthoot Microfin Limited has entered into a strategic **co-lending partnership** with the State Bank of India (SBI). This collaboration aims to extend financial services to women entrepreneurs in rural and semi-urban areas across India. Under this agreement, both entities will co-lend to **Joint Liability Groups (JLGs)** engaged in agricultural, allied activities, and other income-generating enterprises. The loan amounts, ranging from Rs 10,000 to Rs 3,00,000, are tailored to provide substantial support to women entrepreneurs in rural regions.
- The Indian digital payment company **PhonePe** has announced a partnership with **Sri Lankan ride-hailing platform PickMe**. This collaboration allows Indian travelers in Sri Lanka to use PhonePe's UPI payment option to pay for PickMe rides, enabling cashless transactions and enhancing travel convenience.
- **Aurionpro Payments**, a subsidiary of Aurionpro Solutions, has received approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to operate as an online payment aggregator under the **Payments Settlements Act, 2007**. This authorization allows the Mumbai-based company to offer digital payment services to merchants nationwide through its payment gateway brand, AuroPay.
- **Tiger Global-backed neobanking startup Jupiter Money** has received final authorization from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to offer digital wallet services. This new offering will enable customers to make UPI payments, money transfers, and other transactions through the Jupiter Prepaid Account, slated for launch in the coming months.
- Tata Communications has finalized a significant **five-year agreement with World Athletics** to provide broadcasting services, enhancing global coverage of premier events starting from the **Tokyo World Championships**. This partnership marks Tata Communications as a pivotal supplier, committed to innovation and audience engagement.
- In a bid to streamline dispute resolution involving government or public sector enterprises (PSEs), the **Finance Ministry** has set a cap of **₹10 crore for arbitration cases**. This move aims to mitigate the perceived challenges of lengthy proceedings and potential misconduct among arbitrators. The Ministry also advises against automatically including arbitration clauses in large government contracts, emphasizing mediation and judicial adjudication as viable alternatives.
- ATM operators in India are advocating for an increase in interchange fees by **Rs 2 per transaction**, citing financial sustainability challenges. The **Confederation of ATM Industry (CATMI)** has formally approached the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** to raise the current maximum fee from **Rs 21 to Rs 23 per transaction**, as reported by the Economic Times.
- India's equity market has **once again outpaced Hong Kong**, securing the position as the **world's fourth-largest by market capitalization**. With **India's market value soaring to \$5.2 trillion**, bolstered by a 10% surge following a post-election market rebound, it now leads Hong Kong, which stands at \$5.17 trillion after a 5.4% decline from its peak this year. This marks a significant shift in global market rankings, reflecting India's robust economic fundamentals and investor confidence.
- India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) has teamed up with **Ria Money Transfer**, a global leader in cross-border money transfers and a business segment of **Euronet Worldwide, Inc.**, to offer innovative remittance services in rural India. This collaboration aims to provide convenient and affordable financial services directly to the doorsteps of customers in remote areas.
- **SabPaisa (SRS Live Technologies Private Limited)**, a payment solutions provider, has announced that the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has granted final approval to operate as a **Payment Aggregator (PA)** under the **Payments and Settlement Systems Act of 2007**.
- At its Golden Jubilee celebration, Central Electronics Limited (CEL) was honored with **"Mini RATNA" status (Category-1)** by Union Minister **Dr. Jitendra Singh**. This recognition underscores CEL's transformation from a loss-making PSU to a profitable entity, achieving a net profit of approximately **Rs 58 crore** and consistently paying dividends to the Government of India for three consecutive years.
- The **Uttar Pradesh Cabinet** approved **Tata Sons' proposal** to build a **'museum of temples'** in Ayodhya, a project worth **Rs 650 crore** to be funded through **Tata's corporate social responsibility fund**. Additionally, the state cabinet has also sanctioned **Rs 100 crore** for further development works in **Ayodhya** and endorsed the initiation of **helicopter services in Lucknow, Prayagraj, and Kapilvastu**.
- **Mindspace Business Parks REIT**, the owner and developer of quality Grade A office portfolio, has announced its **₹650 crore Sustainability Linked Bond issuance** placed with the **International Finance Corporation (IFC)**. The coupon of the bond is linked to Mindspace's commitment to achieve certain ESG targets towards building a greener eco-system.

Business Current Affairs of July 2024

- Tata Group has maintained its position as **India's most valuable brand** with a value of **US\$ 28.6 billion**, marking a **9% increase from last year**. Infosys ranks second, and HDFC Group has surged to third place following its merger with HDFC Ltd.
- One 97 Communications Limited, the parent company of Paytm, has introduced **'Paytm Health Saathi'**, an affordable healthcare and income protection plan tailored for its merchant partners. Available through the **'Paytm for Business'** app, this initiative aims to support the well-being and business continuity of Paytm's extensive network of merchants.

- **Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd** has undergone a transformation, rebranding itself to **Sammaan Capital Ltd**. This change reflects its shift from a promoter-led entity to a board-run, diversified financial institution. The rebranding, effective upon receipt of regulatory approvals, marks a significant milestone in the company's 25-year journey since its inception as Indiabulls Financial Services Limited in 2000.
- Muthoot Finance has been exclusively selected as the only Indian NBFC for the **Financial Action Task Force's (FATF)** Mutual Evaluation report for 2023-24. This recognition highlights Muthoot Finance's global trustworthiness and compliance with stringent financial regulations.
- Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL), a **'Maharatna'** and **Fortune Global 500 Company**, has proudly announced its role as the official **Principal Partner of the Indian Olympic Association (IOA)** for four years, spanning from the **Paris Olympics in 2024** to the **Los Angeles Olympics in 2028**.
- **ICICI Lombard**, a leading private general insurer in India, has **launched 'Elevate'**, a pioneering health insurance product **integrating AI technology**. This innovative offering is designed to meet the diverse needs of modern lifestyles and unforeseen medical emergencies, emphasizing personalized solutions and comprehensive coverage.
- Tata Power Solar Systems Limited has launched the **'Ghar Ghar Solar'** initiative in **Uttar Pradesh**, starting from **Varanasi**, aimed at providing every home with clean energy through rooftop solar solutions. This initiative promises substantial financial savings and environmental benefits for residents.
- REC Limited, a leading lender in the power sector, has successfully secured a **5-year green loan** amounting to **31.96 billion Japanese yen** (approximately \$200 million). The transaction, facilitated by **Deutsche Bank's Gift City branch**, marks one of the initial yen-denominated green loan deals for the bank in India.
- In **May 2024**, **India's industrial output** expanded by **5.9% year-over-year**, marking the **highest growth in seven months**. This growth surpassed expectations, with notable contributions from electricity generation and consumer durables.
- Jio Financial Services has received approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to transition from a **Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** to a **Core Investment Company (CIC)**. Following this announcement, the company's shares saw an increase of over **2% on the NSE**.
- In June 2024, India's total exports (merchandise and services combined) reached an estimated **USD 65.47 billion**, marking a **5.40% increase from June 2023**. Meanwhile, total imports for the month were estimated at USD 73.47 billion, a 6.29% rise compared to the same

period last year. For the April-June 2024 quarter, total exports were estimated at USD 200.33 billion, reflecting an 8.60% growth, while total imports stood at USD 222.89 billion, up 8.47% from the previous year. The merchandise trade deficit for the quarter increased to USD 62.26 billion from USD 56.16 billion in April-June 2023.

- Continuing with its endeavor to increase the **contribution of bancassurance** and its pursuit to provide life insurance coverage to all **by 2047**, **Life Insurance Corporation (LIC)** of India has tied-up with one of the best technologically advanced and promising banks in the country, **IDFC First Bank Ltd**, under **Corporate Agency Arrangement**.
- **ONGC Videsh Limited (OVL)**, a subsidiary of ONGC, has acquired **Norwegian firm Equinor's stake in Azerbaijan's offshore Azeri Chirag Gunashli (ACG) oil field** and an associated **oil pipeline for \$60 million**. This increases OVL's stake in the oil field to 2.95% and in the **Baku-Tbilisi-Ceyhan (BTC) pipeline to 3.097%**.
- **Airbus and Tata** are joining forces to manufacture India's first H125 helicopter, which is set to roll out by 2026.
- **The Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA)** is set to develop India's first integrated agricultural export facility at Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Mumbai.
- **UltraTech Cement**, a flagship of the **Aditya Birla Group**, will acquire a **32.72% equity stake in India Cements for ₹3,945 crore**.
- **Aditya Birla Group Chairman**, Mr. Kumar Mangalam Birla on July 30, announced the launch of the **Group's jewellery retail business**, marking the Group's foray into the rapidly expanding **Rs.6.7 lakh crore** Indian jewellery market.
- Three prominent payment companies—**Amazon Pay, Adyen, and Mumbai-based BillDesk**—have secured the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) cross-border payment aggregator license.
- **Shriram Capital** has received in-principle approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to establish an **Asset Reconstruction Company (ARC)**.
- The Government of India is **implementing a ₹2,516 Crore project** for the computerization of functional **Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS)**.

Business Current Affairs of August 2024

- **NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)** has achieved a major milestone by surpassing 100,000 cross-border Unified Payments Interface (UPI) Person-to-Merchant (P2M) transactions in Nepal.
- Bharti Global, the international investment arm of Bharti Enterprises, is set to **acquire a 24.5% stake** in the **British telecom giant BT Group plc** for approximately **\$4 billion**.
- **Amazon India and Gentari Green Mobility India** have announced a strategic partnership aimed at significantly boosting **Amazon's electric vehicle (EV) fleet** for last-mile deliveries.

- **State-owned Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd (BHEL)** has been awarded a significant contract by **Damodar Valley Corporation (DVC)** to set up a **1,600 MW thermal power project**.
- India and Israel, two nations with rich cultural histories, have cultivated diplomatic ties that extend beyond politics to encompass trade, investments, and collaborations across diverse industries.
- From luxurious Persian rugs to high-quality saffron, Iran's offerings are treasured worldwide, including in India. Recently, interest in Iranian goods has surged in India, driven by their superior quality, distinctiveness, and cultural charm. Let's explore the **variety of Iranian products** that are increasingly making their presence felt in the Indian market.
- **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)** has achieved a milestone by advancing two positions in the 2024 **Fortune Global 500 list**, securing the 86th spot.
- **Boeing** announced **Robert "Kelly" Ortberg** as its new **CEO**, effective August 8, replacing **David Calhoun**. This leadership change comes as the company reports a substantial loss of over \$1.4 billion in the second quarter, with significant declines in revenue and ongoing issues with safety, production, and legal matters.
- **Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation**, in collaboration with the **Habitat Charitable Trust**, has proposed the construction of a state-of-the-art **faecal sludge treatment plant (FSTP)** at Sarovaram.
- Fintech company Slice has received approval from the **National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT)** for its merger with **North East Small Finance Bank**.
- **Amul** has been named the world's strongest food brand in **Brand Finance's Global Food & Drinks Report 2024**.
- **PhonePe** on August 22, announced the **launch of Credit Line on UPI** on its platform. Consumers who avail credit lines from their banks can now link these **credit lines to UPI** on **PhonePe** and seamlessly make merchant payments.
- **Flipkart's Supply Chain Operations Academy (SCOA)** exchanged a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** at the Samarth event with the mission to upskill thousands of employable youth across India.
- **Tata AIA Life Insurance** has recently unveiled its latest offering in the term insurance segment – **Sampoorna Raksha Promise**. This innovative product is designed to provide enhanced financial security to policyholders and their families, addressing various aspects of life insurance needs.
- **Piramal Finance**, a subsidiary of **Piramal Enterprises Limited**, has partnered with the Central Bank of India to expand co-lending operations aimed at supporting underserved markets.
- **Amazon**, the global e-commerce giant, has announced the beta launch of **Rufus**, a cutting-edge **generative AI-powered conversational shopping assistant**, in India.
- **Bharti Airtel** has unveiled a **new content partnership with Apple**, set to offer exclusive **Apple Music and Apple TV+** deals to customers in India later this year. As part of this collaboration, **Apple TV+** will be integrated into **Airtel's Xstream** video-streaming service available through premium Wi-Fi and postpaid plans.
- **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)** has unveiled its **fifth TCS Pace Studio in Manila, Philippines**, aiming to drive digital innovation across the **Asia-Pacific region**.
- During Reliance Industries' 47th Annual General Meeting (AGM), Chairman **Mukesh Ambani** announced a groundbreaking development in the field of artificial intelligence. The company's telecom arm, **Reliance Jio**, is set to launch a comprehensive suite of AI tools and applications called '**Jio Brain**'.
- **Infosys** has expanded its **partnership with NVIDIA** to develop generative AI solutions tailored for telecom operators. Utilizing **NVIDIA's NIM inference microservices**, NeMo Retriever models, NeMo Guardrails, and Riva. Infosys aims to enhance telecommunication operations and customer service. Early results show significant improvements in latency and accuracy.
- Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** granted '**Navratna**' status to **four Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs)**: **NHPC**, **Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI)**, **Railtel Corporation of India (RCIL)**, and **Satluj Jal Vidyut Nigam (SJVN)**. This brings the total number of **Navratna CPSEs in India to 25**.
- **Mastercard** has globally debuted its **Payment Passkey Service in India**, aiming to enhance online shopping security and convenience. Unveiled at the **Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai**, this service, initially piloted with Indian payment leaders like **Juspay, Razorpay, and PayU**, along with banks such as **Axis Bank**, leverages biometric authentication—replacing traditional passwords and OTPs with more secure fingerprint or facial recognition methods.
- In a recent development, **Zomato** has approved the acquisition of **Paytm's entertainment and ticketing business for ₹2,048 crore** in a cash deal.

Business Current Affairs of September 2024

- **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)** has made history as the first Indian company to exceed ₹10 lakh crore in annual revenue. This milestone was revealed during **RIL's Annual General Meeting (AGM)** by Chairman **Mukesh Ambani**. For the financial year 2023-24, Reliance achieved a record consolidated turnover of ₹10,00,122 crore (USD 119.9 billion), with a net profit of ₹79,020 crore (USD 9.5 billion).

- The Union Ministry of **Finance plans to divest a 6.78% stake** in General Insurance Corporation of India (GIC Re) through an offer-for-sale (OFS) to raise approximately Rs 4,700 crore. This will be the **first stake sale since GIC Re's listing in 2017**. The sale will commence on Wednesday for non-retail investors, with retail investors and GIC employees able to bid on Thursday.
- **Star Health and Allied Insurance**, a prominent health insurance provider in India, has taken a groundbreaking step towards inclusivity by introducing an insurance policy in **Braille**. This initiative marks a significant milestone in empowering visually impaired individuals, allowing them to access crucial health insurance information independently.
- **Kotak General Insurance** has undergone a transformative rebranding, emerging as **Zurich Kotak General Insurance**. This change comes on the heels of a major acquisition that sees the global insurance giant, Zurich Insurance Group, taking a commanding 70% stake in the company. This move not only reshapes the competitive landscape of India's general insurance market but also signals a new chapter in foreign investment in the country's financial services sector.
- **Paysharp**, an emerging startup from Tamil Nadu, has achieved a major milestone. On **August 30, 2024**, the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** granted Paysharp its final authorization, cementing the company's position in India's dynamic payment system ecosystem.
- Private sector lender RBL Bank has launched a new credit card in collaboration with Indian Oil Corporation, named **'Xtra Credit Card'**, as part of its strategy to moderately grow its credit card portfolio and enhance customer engagement. The move comes amid scrutiny from the RBI over the rapid growth of the riskier unsecured credit segment.
- **The Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has cleared the proposal of India's giant business group Tata Motors Finance Limited merger into the **Tata Capital Limited** marking a significant consolidation into Tata group financial services. The merger will be carried out through a scheme of arrangement to be submitted to the **National Company Law Tribunal**.
- **Adani Airports Holdings Limited (AAHL)** launched an application **'Aviio'** for the future Airport ecosystem, which generally provides real time information like waiting times, gate change, baggage updates etc, this will enhance airport operations.
- **The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** has increased the transaction limits for tax payments using **UPI (Unified Payment Interface)**, by allowing people to send **5 lakh in a single transaction**.
- The Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) has selected Infosys to develop its **next-generation digital platform** as

part of its **DIVE** (Digital Innovation and Value Enhancement) programme. This new platform will serve as an integrated end-to-end solution, enhancing customer services, business lifecycle management, and operational activities for sales intermediaries, while also offering a digital front-end for branch employees.

- **VisionNxt**, launched by the **National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT)**, is a fashion forecasting initiative aimed at fostering global competition and elevating Indian culture and design. Combining Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Emotional Intelligence (EI), it provides trend insights tailored to India's socio-economic and cultural diversity.
- **Tata Steel** has successfully commissioned **India's largest blast furnace** at its **Kalinganagar facility in Odisha**, marking a significant milestone for the steel sector. With a total investment of **Rs 27,000 crore**, this Phase II expansion will increase the plant's capacity from 3 million tonnes per annum (MTPA) to 8 MTPA.
- Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman represented India at the **9th Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) Board of Governors** meeting held in Samarkand, Uzbekistan, on September 25-26, 2024. During her visit, she also engaged in discussions with **Uzbekistan's President Shavkat Mirziyoyev** on the sidelines of the meeting.
- **Shankh Air**, **India's latest airline**, is poised to make its debut by the end of 2024 after receiving approval from the civil aviation ministry. This marks a significant development for **Uttar Pradesh as Shankh Air** aims to become the **state's first scheduled airline**, establishing hubs in Lucknow and the upcoming Noida International Airport. The airline plans to focus on both inter- and intra-state routes, targeting areas with high demand and limited direct flight options.

Business Current Affairs of October 2024

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- **Anil Ambani's Reliance Group** is making significant strides into **Bhutan's renewable energy sector** by planning the development of 1,270 megawatts of solar and hydroelectric power projects. In a strategic partnership with Druk Holding and Investments Ltd (**DHI**), the commercial arm of the Bhutanese government.

- In a new partnership aimed at enhancing sustainability, the Adani Group will supply renewable energy from its upcoming **solar-wind hybrid** project in **Khavda, Gujarat, to Google starting in 2025**. The Khavda project, located in the world's largest renewable energy facility, is set to begin commercial operations in Q3 2025. With a strong track record in large-scale renewable projects, Adani will provide tailored energy solutions to support Google's carbon-free energy goal and help reduce the carbon footprints of industrial clients.
- **PFC (Power Finance Corporation)**, a **Maharatna company** and leading NBFC in the Indian power and infrastructure sector, announced the successful closing of issuance of the largest-ever foreign currency term loan from an Indian PSU amounting to **USD 1.265 billion**. This landmark transaction was executed through a facility agreement with multiple banks based in **IFSC GIFT City, Gandhinagar**.
- **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved a **\$162 million loan** to enhance **tourism development in Himachal Pradesh**. This funding, aimed at reviving the tourism economy in the five districts severely affected by the pandemic—Hamirpur, Kangra, Kullu, Mandi, and Shimla—will support the Sustainable and Inclusive Tourism Development Project. The project targets the promotion of heritage and cultural sites while developing new infrastructure, ultimately unlocking the state's tourism potential.
- Reliance's beauty platform **Tira** announced the launch of globally luxury skincare and haircare brand **Augustinus Bader** for the Indian Market. Known for its scientifically advanced and award-winning formulas, Augustinus Bader products are now available exclusively on Tira.
- In line with its focus on enhancing the welfare of **Naval Civilians**, the **Indian Navy** has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with **Bajaj Allianz Life Insurance**. This initiative is a key highlight of 2024, declared as the **"Year of Naval Civilians."** It underscores the Navy's commitment to financial security and inclusivity for its civilian workforce, particularly by offering affordable life insurance options, including term insurance, to safeguard their families in the event of an untimely death.
- **Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)** has been upgraded to the status of Maharatna, making it the **14th Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** to receive this prestigious classification from the Government of India.
- **Navi**, a **fintech company co-founded by Sachin Bansal**, has made significant strides in the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) landscape, emerging as **India's fifth-largest ecosystem player**. In September, the company achieved remarkable transaction volumes, **processing 120.41 million transactions valued at Rs 6,549.1 crore**. This growth underscores Navi's expanding presence in the highly competitive UPI market, which is dominated by major players like PhonePe, Google Pay, and Paytm.
- **Global index provider FTSE Russell** has announced that India's sovereign bonds will be included in its Emerging Markets Government Bond Index (**EMGBI**) starting September 2025. This follows similar inclusions by JP Morgan and Bloomberg Index Services, which could potentially attract billions of dollars into India's local bond market. Additionally, **South Korean government bonds** are set to be added to the **FTSE World Government Bond Index (WGBI) in November 2025** after spending two years on the watch list.
- Paytm has received approval from the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** to onboard new UPI users, ending a nine-month embargo imposed by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). This decision is expected to increase Paytm's UPI transaction volumes and boost its market position.
- Deloitte **India's latest Economic Outlook** projects that India's economy will grow between **7.0% and 7.2%** in the fiscal year 2024-25, despite a recent slowdown where GDP expanded by only 6.7% year-on-year in Q1 of FY25.
- Freo, the digital finance application, has received a corporate agent license from the **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)**, allowing it to offer a range of customized insurance products to its 25 million users. This initiative comes amid India's low insurance penetration rate of **approximately 4.2%**, which is significantly below the **global average of 7%**.
- The **International Copper Association (ICA)** is a prominent global industry body that brings together major copper producers worldwide. Representing **50% of the world's copper production**, ICA is a **not-for-profit trade association** comprising 33 member organizations spanning six continents.
- **Mukesh Ambani's Reliance Industries** has teamed up with **US chipmaker Nvidia** to establish AI infrastructure in India, announced during the **Nvidia AI Summit 2024 in Mumbai**. This collaboration aims to position India as a leading intelligence market, with plans to deploy **Nvidia's GB 200** supercomputer technology for large-scale AI capabilities.
- **Nvidia has officially dethroned Apple** as the world's most valuable company, achieving this milestone on Friday after a remarkable surge in its stock price driven by soaring demand for its cutting-edge supercomputing AI chips. At one point, **Nvidia's market value soared to an impressive \$3.53 trillion**, just edging out **Apple, which was valued at \$3.52 trillion**, according to data from LSEG.
- **GAIL (India) Limited and VERBIO India** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to jointly develop agricultural residue-based **compressed biogas (CBG)** projects in India. This collaboration aims to turn agricultural waste into renewable energy, aligning with India's climate objectives and enhancing rural incomes.

- **Jio Financial Services Limited (JFSL)** has introduced **SmartGold**, a digital gold investment platform, allowing customers to invest in **24-karat physical gold** through the **JioFinance app**. This offering aligns with the company's broader strategy to enhance financial services accessibility during the **auspicious Dhanteras season**.
- Jio Financial Services Ltd (JFSL) and BlackRock Inc. officially announced the incorporation of two joint venture companies, Jio BlackRock Asset Management Private Limited and Jio BlackRock Trustee Private Limited, to enter the mutual fund sector in India.

Business Current Affairs of November 2024

- **NTPC Limited and Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC)** have launched a 50:50 Joint Venture Company (JVC) through their green energy subsidiaries, NTPC Green Energy Ltd. (NGEL) and ONGC Green Energy Ltd. (OGL). This collaboration, approved by DIPAM and NITI Aayog, aims to accelerate India's renewable and new energy objectives.
- **BEML Limited has received the "Self-Certification" status** for its defense equipment from the Department of Defence Production, Government of India. The certification was presented to BEML's Chairman and MD, Shantanu Roy, by RA Govardhana during an event at the company's headquarters.
- **Royal Enfield** has recently unveiled its highly anticipated **electric vehicle (EV) brand, "Flying Flea"**, an homage to one of the brand's most iconic models.
- **The International Finance Corporation (IFC)** has partnered with Bajaj Finance Ltd. (BFL), committing \$400 million as part of a \$1 billion initiative to boost access to climate finance in India. The investment will focus on financing electric vehicles (EVs), energy-efficient consumer goods (EECG), and women-owned micro-enterprises, supporting India's climate goals and promoting financial inclusion.
- In a move to enhance apprenticeship programs across India, the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** has restructured the **Central Apprenticeship Council (CAC)**, tasked with reforming existing rules and promoting industry adoption of on-the-job training.
- **India's smartphone market became the second largest globally by unit volume and third by value in Q3 2024**, accounting for 15.5% of global shipments, just behind China's 22%. By value, India's market share rose slightly to 12.3%, up from 12.1% the previous year, surpassing the US, which held a 12% share.
- **Tata Power has teamed up with Noida International Airport (NIA)** to invest Rs 550 crore in renewable energy, including a 13 MW solar facility and 10.8 MW of wind power. This partnership supports NIA's sustainability goals and Tata Power's commitment to sustainable infrastructure in India's aviation sector.
- **Union Home Minister Amit Shah has approved three major projects** totaling Rs. 725.62 crore under the "Expansion and Modernization of Fire Services in the States." The projects, aimed at enhancing fire safety infrastructure, will benefit Chhattisgarh (Rs. 147.76 crore), Odisha (Rs. 201.10 crore), and West Bengal (Rs. 376.76 crore).
- In the fortnight ending November 1, 2024, credit and deposit growth nearly aligned, with credit increasing by 11.9% and deposits growing by 11.83% year-on-year. This marks a shift from the previous period, where credit growth had consistently outpaced deposits, reflecting the impact of RBI's regulatory measures and a slowdown in sectors like unsecured loans and non-banking financial companies (NBFCs).
- **India's merchandise exports grew by 17.3% in October 2024, reaching \$39.2 billion, the fastest pace in 28 months.** This growth was driven by pre-Christmas inventory buildup in Western countries, boosting demand for products like engineering goods, electronics, chemicals, and garments.
- **Reliance Industries and Walt Disney** have finalized an \$8.5 billion merger of their Indian media assets, concluded on 14th November.
- **Nvidia and SoftBank Corp** have unveiled the world's first AI and 5G-integrated telecom network, 5G AI-RAN, which transforms base stations into AI-powered computing hubs. This innovation, launched through the AI-RAN Alliance at Mobile World Congress, marks a major leap in telecom technology by enabling simultaneous management of AI and 5G operations.
- **Tata Electronics** has acquired a **60% stake in Pegatron's iPhone plant in Tamil Nadu**, India, marking a significant step in strengthening Tata's role as a major **Apple supplier**. This deal signifies a shift in the **geopolitical supply chain**, with **India** emerging as a key hub for **iPhone manufacturing**. The **joint venture** will see Tata managing daily operations, while **Pegatron** will offer **technical support**.
- **Punit Goenka**, the **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **Zee Entertainment Enterprises**, resigned from his role as MD but will remain as CEO. This decision comes just days before a shareholders' meeting where Goenka was set to seek approval for a new five-year term as MD and CEO, starting January 1, 2025, and ending December 31, 2029.
- Meta plans to appeal a **₹213.14 crore** fine imposed by the **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** over its 2021 **WhatsApp privacy policy update**. CCI accuses Meta of **anti-competitive practices**, alleging the company forced users to accept new **data-sharing terms**, a claim Meta denies.

- To address **mis-selling** of insurance, the **IRDAI** launched the **Bima Sugam platform**. **IRDAI Chairman Debasish Panda** stressed that banks should focus on **core lending activities** and avoid pressuring customers into unsuitable insurance products. This aligns with **Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman's** call for more **responsible bancassurance** practices.
- On November 21, 2024, **Kenyan President William Ruto** announced the **cancellation** of multimillion-dollar deals with **Indian business tycoon Gautam Adani**, citing concerns over **bribery** and **fraud allegations**. This decision follows **U.S. indictments** against Adani, one of Asia's richest men, accusing him of **securities fraud** and a **bribery scheme** related to a **solar energy project** in India.
- **DPIIT** has approved the **₹10,000-crore acquisition** of Reliance Capital (RCAP) by IndusInd International Holdings (IIHL), backed by the Hinduja Group. This acquisition helps resolve RCAP's ₹40,000-crore liabilities and moves the troubled financial entity closer to finalizing the deal.
- The **Ministry of Labour & Employment** has directed the **EPFO** to ensure **UAN activation** using **Aadhaar-based OTP**, enhancing access to **digital services**, promoting **transparency**, and supporting the **Employment Linked Incentive (ELI) Scheme**. The initiative will expand to **biometric authentication** with **face-recognition technology** for greater efficiency.
- On November 22, 2024, **Asia Index Private Ltd**, a subsidiary of the **Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE)**, announced the latest reconstitution of the benchmark **BSE Sensex**. **Zomato**, the online food delivery giant, will replace **JSW Steel** in the 30-stock index, effective from **December 23, 2024**. The reshuffling also impacts other indices, including the **BSE 100**, **BSE Sensex 50**, and **BSE Sensex Next 50**.
- India has signed a **historic Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA)** with **Switzerland, Iceland, Norway, and Liechtenstein** (forming the **European Free Trade Association (EFTA)**). The agreement grants India access to **99.6% of EFTA's market**, with projections of **\$100 billion in FDI** and **1 million direct jobs** over the next 15 years. It aims to boost India's **global market position** and support initiatives like **"Make in India"** and **"Atmanirbhar Bharat."**
- The **Confederation of Indian Industry (CII)** established a **strategy cell** in **Coimbatore** to help **manufacturing SMEs** develop sustainable growth strategies and compete globally. The cell offers **expert mentorship**, strategic advice, and support for **6 to 12 months** to help businesses scale. The initiative aims to make local industries **global players** with tailored support from a team of **six experts**.

Business Current Affairs of December 2024

- In **October 2024**, India's **UPI** set a record with **16.58 billion transactions** worth **Rs 23.5 trillion**. This marked a **10% increase** in volume and **14% in value** from September, driven by a surge in **person-to-merchant transactions** during the festive season. The daily average surpassed **535 million transactions** valued at **Rs 75,801 crore**, with **45% year-on-year growth** in volume and **37% in value**.
- The **National Small Industries Corporation Limited (NSIC)** achieved a milestone by paying a record **Rs. 37.97 crore** dividend to the **Government of India** for FY 2023-24. **NSIC's revenue** increased by **18.16%** to **Rs. 3,273 crore**, and its **Profit After Tax (PAT)** rose by **14.55%** to **Rs. 126.56 crore**. The **dividend cheque** was presented by **Dr. Subhansu Sekhar Acharya** to **Jitan Ram Manjhi** and **Shobha Karandlaje**.
- The **World Bank** approved a **\$188.28 million loan** to **Maharashtra** to boost economic growth in its underdeveloped districts. Provided by the **IBRD**, the loan has a **15-year maturity** with a **five-year grace period**. The project aims to enhance **district-level governance**, improve **e-governance services**, and encourage **private sector involvement** to accelerate **economic development** and **job creation**.
- The **Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** has granted **FCRA licenses** to **USIN Foundation** and reinstated **CNI's license**, allowing the **Church of North India** to resume receiving foreign funds for **social and religious activities**. This decision reflects the MHA's ongoing scrutiny of **NGOs** and increasing **regulatory oversight**.
- India's **gold reserves** reached **882 tonnes** in October 2024, with the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** adding **27 tonnes**. This marks a five-fold increase in gold purchases, totaling **77 tonnes** in 2024. The RBI's acquisition in October accounted for **45%** of global central bank gold purchases. Of India's total gold reserves, **510 tonnes** are held domestically.
- The **Adani Group** plans to invest **\$2 billion** in acquiring **ports in Europe** to strengthen its global presence in sea trade. **Adani Ports & Special Economic Zones Ltd. (APSEZ)** aims to acquire two or three terminals in Europe, which handles **40% of global sea trade**. Domestically, APSEZ currently handles **27%** of India's cargo, with plans to increase it to **40%** by 2030. The group operates ports in **Sri Lanka, Israel, Australia, Tanzania, and Greece**.
- **Jayen Mehta**, Managing Director of **Amul**, has had his tenure extended until **2029-2030**. Having been with **GCMMF** since 1991, Mehta has significantly contributed to shaping the **Amul** brand. His leadership follows his interim MD role in January 2023, succeeding **R.S. Sodhi**, who led for over a decade.

- Coca-Cola has sold a 40% stake in **Hindustan Coca-Cola Holdings (HCCH)** to **Jubilant Bhartia Group** for ₹12,500 crore, aligning with its global refranchising strategy. The deal strengthens Coca-Cola's presence in India, while Jubilant Bhartia will leverage its expertise from businesses like **Domino's** and **Dunkin'** to drive growth in **Hindustan Coca-Cola Beverages (HCCB)**, Coca-Cola's largest bottler in India.
- India's **atomic power capacity** has nearly doubled from **4,780 MW** in 2014 to **8,081 MW** in 2024, achieving this in just **10 years**—a milestone that historically took over **60 years**. By **2031-32**, the capacity is projected to triple to **22,480 MW**, reinforcing India's leadership in **nuclear energy**.
- BMW Group and **UNICEF** have partnered to provide **quality STEM education** to 100,000 marginalized children, focusing on **girls** in **Assam, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, and West Bengal**. The initiative aims to bridge **educational gaps** and promote **gender equality**. This program is part of a global collaboration between BMW and UNICEF, targeting over **10 million children** worldwide.
- HSBC India has partnered with **Indian Hotels Company (IHCL)** to launch the **HSBC Taj Credit Card**, a luxury card offering exclusive benefits for affluent Indians. In collaboration with **Visa**, the card provides **welcome offers** for stays at **Taj Palaces**, **exclusive access** to **Taj InnerCircle Platinum** and lounges, along with **discounts** on room rates, meals, and spa treatments. It targets the growing demand for **premium travel** and **luxury experiences** among India's elite.
- **UltraTech Cement**, part of the **Aditya Birla Group**, received **CCI approval** for its **₹3,954-crore acquisition** of **India Cements Ltd (ICL)**. This strategic move strengthens UltraTech's presence in the **southern cement market**, particularly in **Tamil Nadu**, supporting its growth strategy to expand **installed capacity** and achieve **global leadership** in the cement industry.
- **Tata Power Renewable Energy** has partnered with **Canara Bank** to offer affordable financing for rooftop solar installations under the **PM Surya Ghar Scheme**. The initiative provides loans of up to **Rs 6 Lakh** for systems ranging from **3 kW to 10 kW** with low interest rates and no collateral. The aim is to promote clean energy adoption and support **India's renewable energy targets**.
- **NTPC** plans to set up a **nuclear power project** in **Bihar** as part of its strategy to diversify its energy portfolio and expand non-fossil energy capacity. The company has approached the state government for **land allocation** to move forward with the project, which aims to meet future energy demands.
- India has risen from **23rd** in global smartphone exports in 2019 to **3rd** in 2024, with **exports crossing ₹20,000 crore** in November 2024. This 92% growth compared to November 2023 underscores India's success in leveraging **government initiatives** and a strong **domestic production ecosystem**.
- The **Indian government** will inject **₹500 crore** into **Industrial Finance Corporation of India (IFCI)** to improve its financial health ahead of restructuring. This infusion is expected to raise the government's stake in IFCI, currently at **71.72%** (as of September 2024). The decision was approved in the **Supplementary Demand for Grants for 2024-25** in the **Lok Sabha**, with funds reallocated from savings, ensuring no extra cash outflow.
- **Adani Group** has acquired an **85.8% stake** in **Air Works**, India's largest private-sector **Maintenance, Repair, and Overhaul (MRO)** company, valued at **Rs 400 crore**. This acquisition strengthens Adani's position in the **defence** and **civil aviation MRO** sectors, expanding into an integrated aviation services ecosystem. **Air Works**, with operations in **35 cities**, over **1,300 personnel**, and approvals in **20+ countries**, specializes in both **civil and defence MRO services**.
- On **December 20, 2024**, India and the **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** signed a **\$500 million loan agreement** to support **sustainable infrastructure projects** aligned with India's **climate goals**. The loan, guaranteed by the government, will be channeled through **India Infrastructure Finance Company Limited (IIFCL)** for **green projects** in sectors like **energy transition, urban development, education, and healthcare**. The partnership emphasizes **environmentally sustainable infrastructure** and **long-term investment** to support India's **net-zero emissions** commitment.



National Current Affairs of January 2024

- The **Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities** (Divyangjan), under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India, organised a distinctive event aimed at showcasing the products and craftsmanship of Divyang entrepreneurs and artisans from across the nation. The event, titled **'Divya Kala Mela,'** took place in Surat, Gujarat, spanning from December 29, 2023, to January 7, 2024.
- The **10th phase of Sagar Parikrama**, a government initiative focused on the welfare of fishing communities and coastal development, took place from **January 1st to 6th, 2024**, traversing various locations in **Andhra Pradesh and Puducherry**. This event marks a significant step towards addressing the issues faced by fishermen and fish farmers and facilitating their economic upliftment.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** laid the foundation stone for a slew of development projects worth over **Rs 20,000 crore in Tiruchirappalli, Tamil Nadu**. The projects encompass various sectors, including rail connectivity, roads, oil and gas, and shipping, and are poised to contribute significantly to the state's progress.
- India's Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) has launched the **'National Single Window System (NSWS),'** a unified portal designed by **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)** to streamline the import of medical devices. The initiative aims to create a centralized platform for investors, enhancing the ease of doing business. The NSWS, developed by TCS through Invest India, becomes operational from January 1.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi marked a historic moment as he dedicated the **Rs 400 crore Demonstration Fast Reactor Fuel Reprocessing Plant (DFRP)** at the **Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR), Kalpakkam**, to the nation. This facility is a significant step towards advancing India's nuclear capabilities, designed to reprocess fuel from **Prototype Fast Breeder Reactors (PFBR)**.
- In a significant move towards agricultural reform, **Union Cooperation Minister Amit Shah** inaugurated a **tur dal procurement portal**, enabling farmers to register and sell their produce to the National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Ltd (NAFED) and the National Cooperative Consumers' Federation of India Limited (NCCF). The portal guarantees a minimum support price (MSP) or market price for the farmers. Minister Shah, during the launch, also highlighted plans to extend this facility for urad, masoor, and maize farmers in the future.
- The Indian government plans to establish **'Bharat Park,'** a dedicated trade zone in the UAE, featuring showrooms and warehouses to display and store Indian-made goods for a global audience. **Union Minister Piyush Goyal** emphasizes the zone's role in facilitating international purchases of Indian products, with secure transactions in the UAE.
- Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal announced a significant government investment of **Rs 60,000 crore by 2047** in the development of river cruise tourism and eco-friendly vessels. This initiative aims to boost tourism, enhance water transport, and create employment opportunities.
- The **Inland Waterways Authority of India**, operating under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways (MoPSW), created history by hosting the **inaugural meeting of the Inland Waterways Development Council (IWDC) in Kolkata**. This significant event, spearheaded by Union Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways, **Sarbananda Sonowal**, brought together representatives from waterway states, central government officials, and experts aboard the MV Ganga Queen.
- Union Health Minister **Dr Mansukh Mandaviya** recently inaugurated **'Prasadam,'** the **nation's first healthy and hygienic food street**, in a grand ceremony at Neelkanth Van, Mahakal Lok, **Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh**.
- **Hyderabad's Begumpet Airport** is set to host the aviation extravaganza, **Wings India 2024, from January 18 to 21**, marking the country's most significant civil aviation event. Jointly organized by the **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MOCA)** and the **Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Indian Industry (FICCI)**, this four-day biennial spectacle promises to be a showcase of cutting-edge aviation technology and machinery.
- This December, **India's 43rd Antarctic expedition**, led by the National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research, welcomed scientists from **Mauritius and Bangladesh** onboard, marking a significant step in international polar research collaboration. This initiative stems from the maiden **Colombo Security Conclave (CSC) Oceanographers and Hydrographers conference** held in 2022, which laid the groundwork for scientific partnerships among member nations. This conference facilitated joint endeavors in oceanographic and hydrographic studies, paving the way for further cooperation.
- **Nashik, Maharashtra**, recently hosted the prestigious **27th National Youth Festival from January 12 to 16, 2024**. This significant event was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The festival, coinciding with the birth anniversary of Swami Vivekananda, celebrated youthful talent and skills across the nation.

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** inaugurates the new campus of the **National Academy of Customs, Indirect Taxes & Narcotics (NACIN)** at Palasamudram in Andhra Pradesh's Sri Sathya Sai district. The event is scheduled for January 16, marking a significant development in the region's educational infrastructure. NACIN, spread over 500 acres, is dedicated to capacity building in indirect taxation and narcotics control administration. This national-level, world-class training institute will train officials from the Indian Revenue Service (Custom & Indirect Taxes), central allied services, state governments, and partner nations.
- In a significant development, India is poised to secure exploration and development rights for **five lithium blocks in Argentina**, marking its second international foray into critical minerals after a partnership with Australia in 2022. India has taken a crucial step towards reducing its ₹24,000 crore lithium import dependency, primarily sourced from China. The deal finalized between **Khanij Bidesh India Ltd. (KABIL)** and **Catamarca Minera Y Energética Sociedad Del Estado (CAMYEN)**, an Argentine state-owned mining and energy company.
- President of India, **Smt Droupadi Murmu**, inaugurated the **5th Edition of the Meghalaya Games** in Tura, Meghalaya. In her address, the President highlighted the tremendous potential for the development of sports and sportspersons in the North East region, citing its rich tradition of a strong sports culture.
- India is set to **launch a year-long festival**, seeking global connections through the celebration of Ramayan and its cultural significance. Coinciding with the Ayodhya Ram Temple inauguration, it marks the commencement of a cultural extravaganza **uniting the world through Ramayana**.
- The **Kashi Ropeway in Varanasi**, inspired by the theme of **Lord Shiva**, is set to be a landmark project combining spirituality and modern transportation. This article provides an overview of this unique initiative, intended to enhance the travel experience in one of India's most sacred cities.
- The **Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)** has recently unveiled a new clothing range called '**Sanatan Khadi Vastra**' at its flagship store in Connaught Place, New Delhi. This launch aligns with the broader vision of promoting Khadi as a symbol of national pride and sustainable fashion.
- In a remarkable development for **India's wildlife conservation**, the first-ever confirmed sighting of the rare **Tibetan Brown Bear (scientific name: Ursus arctos pruinosus)** was recorded in the high altitudes of **North Sikkim**. This discovery, made by the joint efforts of the Sikkim Forest Department and WWF-India, marks a significant addition to the country's mammal diversity and highlights the ecological richness of the region.
- Union Minister for Civil Aviation **Shri Jyotiraditya M Scindia** inaugurated **Wings India 2024**, Asia's largest aviation expo, at Begumpet Airport in Hyderabad. This event marks a significant milestone in the Indian aviation sector, highlighting its growth and future potential.
- In a noteworthy development aimed at strengthening cultural ties, the **Government of India**, under the **New Education Policy**, has decided to include **Farsi (Persian)** as one of the **nine classical languages of India**. This announcement was made by External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar during a two-day visit to Iran, highlighting the cultural, literary, and linguistic connections between Iran and India.
- In a significant move, the **Ministry of Education in India** has announced new guidelines for coaching centres. These guidelines come in response to growing concerns about student welfare, unregulated growth of private coaching, and rising cases of student suicides and other incidents linked to coaching centres. Students below **16 years old cannot be enrolled**, and admission is allowed only for post-secondary school examinations.
- The Prime Minister, **Shri Narendra Modi**, marked a historic day in Solapur, Maharashtra, by laying the foundation stone for **8 AMRUT projects and dedicating over 90,000 completed houses under PMAY-Urban**. The event also witnessed the distribution of PM-SVANIDHI benefits to 10,000 beneficiaries, showcasing the government's commitment to inclusive development.
- In a momentous occasion, the Union Minister of Ayush and Ports, Shipping & Waterways, **Shri Sarbananda Sonowal**, laid the foundation stone for '**Ayush Diksha**,' a pioneering center dedicated to the development of future Ayush professionals. The ceremony took place at the Central Ayurveda Research Institute campus in Bhubaneswar.
- In a historic first, the **2024 Republic Day Parade in India** will witness the participation of two all-women contingents from the defence forces, marking a significant milestone in the country's journey towards gender equality and empowerment in the military. These contingents will include members from the **Indian Army, Navy, and Air Force**, showcasing the seamless integration and valour of Indian armed forces.
- In a significant move towards promoting multilingualism in education, the central government has introduced the '**Anuvadini**' app, an Artificial Intelligence-based platform. The initiative aims to make study materials for all school and higher education courses available in digital form, specifically in Indian languages listed in the **8th Schedule of the Indian Constitution**.
- In a historic moment, President Droupadi Murmu inaugurated Kaushal Bhawan, symbolizing India's unwavering commitment to empowering its youth through skill development. Under the aegis of the **Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship (MSDE)**, the Bhawan is set to catalyze the realization of aspirations and nurture the nation's young talent, steering India toward a more skilled future.

- The **14th edition** of the Annual **All India Police Commando Competition** (AIPCC) began on January 22, 2024 at the Greyhounds Training Centre in Kapuluppada, Visakhapatnam. Elite commando forces from 16 states are participating in this week-long competition.
- In a significant development, Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated and laid the foundation stone for projects worth over **Rs 19,100 crores in Bulandshahr, Uttar Pradesh**. The diverse projects spanned crucial sectors such as rail, road, oil and gas, and urban development.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **Diamond Jubilee celebration of the Supreme Court** of India and unveiled key technology initiatives during the event held at the Supreme Court auditorium in Delhi. The occasion marked the beginning of the **Supreme Court's 75th year**, coinciding with the 75th year of the Indian Constitution.
- The **Republic Day Parade 2024** witnessed a remarkable tableau that captured the essence of India as the **'Mother of Democracy.'** This stunning representation not only enthralled the audience but also clinched the **first spot in the parade**, symbolizing India's rich democratic heritage. The tableau of the **Ministry of Culture** has secured the first prize at the Republic Day Parade 2024.
- In a significant move, the President of India nominated **Shri Satnam Singh Sandhu** as a member of the Rajya Sabha. This decision recognizes Sandhu's remarkable contributions to education, philanthropy, and community development.
- Union Health Minister **Mansukh Mandaviya** recently spearheaded the inauguration of cutting-edge healthcare facilities at **AIIMS Bhubaneswar**, marking a pivotal moment for healthcare in Odisha. Executive Director Ashutosh Biswas expressed gratitude towards Minister Mandaviya for his unwavering dedication to advancing healthcare in the region.
- Union Minister of Ayush and Ports, Shipping & Waterways, Sarbananda Sonowal, along with Chief Minister Assam, laid the foundation stone for the **Central Research Institute of Yoga & Naturopathy (CRIYN)** and a **100-bedded Naturopathy hospital at Dihing Khamtighat in Dibrugarh**.
- Building on the resounding success of the 2023 edition, **India Energy Week 2024** is set to take place in Goa from February 6 to 9, 2024. This premier event, inaugurated by the Hon'ble Prime Minister of India Shri Narendra Modi, is the country's largest and sole comprehensive energy exhibition and conference.
- Following the inauguration of the Ram temple in Ayodhya, the **Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC)** has introduced a meticulously crafted tour program, immersing travelers in the spiritual tapestry woven by the Ramayana.
- In a significant development for India's cultural heritage, Union Culture Minister **G. Kishan Reddy** recently laid the foundation stone for the country's **digital National Museum of Epigraphy at the Salar Jung Museum, Hyderabad**. Spearheaded by the **Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)**, this museum aims to house approximately one lakh ancient writings spanning various times and languages, preserving them for future generations.
- The **International Energy Agency (IEA)** forecasts India to become the primary driver of global oil demand growth by 2030, despite a projected decline in domestic production. This trend, highlighted at the **India Energy Week 2024**, underscores India's emergence as the second-largest crude importer worldwide.
- The Education Minister, **Dharmendra Pradhan**, recently started the EdCIL Vidyanjali Scholarship Programme. This new program is all about making it easier for students who don't have much money to get a good education. It follows the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020's** goals to make education available to everyone.
- President Smt. Droupadi Murmu inaugurated the **'Vividhita ka Amrit Mahotsav'** at Rashtrapati Bhavan, showcasing Northeast India's cultural richness. Organized by the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region and Ministry of Culture, the event ran from February 8th to 11th, 2024.
- NITI Aayog, under the leadership of CEO BVR Subrahmanyam, is spearheading an ambitious initiative to drive economic transformation in four key cities – **Mumbai, Surat, Varanasi, and Vizag**. This initiative aims to propel India towards becoming a developed economy by 2047.

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- The **Ministry of Culture** takes a momentous stride towards cultural enrichment with the inauguration of the **Regional Centre of Sangeet Natak Akademi** in Hyderabad, known as the **Dakshin Bharat Sanskritik Kendra**. This initiative aims to foster the diverse cultural heritage of South India.
- In a move towards growth, Prime Minister Narendra Modi dedicated development projects in **Jhabua, Madhya Pradesh**, focusing on uplifting the tribal population. These projects, with an estimated worth of about Rs 7300 crores, aim to bolster various sectors, including water supply, education, road infrastructure, and more.
- Union Minister for Tourism, Culture and Development of Northeast Region, G. Kishan Reddy, revealed that **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** is set to inaugurate the upcoming **fourth terminal at Cherlapally, Telangana** towards the end of the month or in the first week of March.
- Chief Secretary Atal Dulloo inaugurated the 2nd edition of the **SARAS Aajeevika Mela**, organized by the Jammu & Kashmir Rural Livelihoods Mission (JKRLM). Accompanied by dignitaries including Dr. Shahid Iqbal Choudhary and Indu Kanwal Chib, Dulloo emphasized the event's role in showcasing the resilience and creativity of rural women entrepreneurs.
- After 42 years of its existence, the **Palace on Wheels** luxury train is set to embark on a new route, delving into the sacred Indian cities of **Ayodhya, Kashi, and Varanasi** in Uttar Pradesh. This significant alteration in its itinerary marks a departure from its traditional destinations, promising passengers a unique spiritual experience.
- The Rail Coach Factory (RCF) aims to roll out the first prototype of the Vande Metro coach by April. The Vande Metro is designed on the concept of India's first indigenous semi-high-speed train, Vande Bharat, catering to intercity passengers covering distances of up to 250 km.
- **Five years ago**, on February day, India faced one of its darkest moments in recent history. **The Pulwama attack**, a horrific act of terrorism, shook the nation to its core, leaving an indelible scar on the heart of every Indian. A suicide bomber, driving an explosives-laden vehicle, targeted a convoy of **Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)** personnel in Pulwama, Jammu and Kashmir, claiming the lives of 40 brave soldiers. These soldiers were either returning from leave or heading to deployment areas, unaware of the tragedy that lay in wait.
- India is engaged in discussions with ministers from member countries of the **International Energy Agency (IEA)** regarding its application to attain full membership in the **Paris-based organization**, comprising **31 nations**.

These talks acknowledge India's strategic significance in addressing global energy and climate challenges, as highlighted during the IEA's 2024 ministerial meeting held in Paris.

- On February 14th, 2024, a vehicle dedicated to NMBA was launched at the **Department of Social Justice and Empowerment (DAIC)** in Delhi. The ceremony was graced by the presence of the Minister of Social Justice and Empowerment. This vehicle served as a platform for conducting NMBA awareness activities across Delhi-NCR, amplifying the reach and impact of the initiative.
- In a landmark decision, the **Supreme Court** ruled the **electoral bonds scheme unconstitutional**, citing it as arbitrary and violative of **Article 14** of the Constitution. This verdict came following a batch of pleas challenging the legality of the scheme, which allowed for anonymous funding to political parties.
- The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in collaboration with the **National Institute of Electronics and IT (NIELIT)**, is hosting the Future Skills Summit in Guwahati. The event, inaugurated by Union Minister of State for Electronics and IT, Rajeev Chandrasekhar, aims to convene young Indians, thought leaders, industry experts, policymakers, educators, and technology enthusiasts to strategize on catalyzing future-ready talent for India and the world.
- India's Permanent Representative to the United Nations, **Ruchira Kamboj**, recently chaired the **62nd Session of the Commission for Social Development**, marking a notable moment in international cooperation on social development issues.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** has virtually inaugurated the **Jyotisar Anubhav Kendra**, a museum and interpretation center inspired by the epic Mahabharata, from Rewari. While the project is still under completion, the opening of two out of its five planned galleries marks a promising start. This initiative, with an investment of approximately Rs 240 crore, is set to enhance the cultural and spiritual tourism landscape of Kurukshetra, Haryana.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** is set to unveil a colossal **125-foot statue of Bir Lachit Borphukan in Lahdoigarh, Hologapar, Jorhat**. This announcement was made by the Assam Chief Minister in a recent statement, highlighting a series of significant events planned for the first week of March this year, aimed at honoring the state's rich history and cultural heritage.
- **India** has cemented its position as the **third-largest digitalized nation in the world**, trailing only behind the technological powerhouses of the **United States of America (USA)** and **China**. This significant finding is part of the **"State of India's Digital Economy Report, 2024,"** unveiled by the **Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations (ICRIER)**, a renowned Delhi-based think tank.

- The **'Sagar Aankalan'** guidelines aim to enhance the **efficiency and competitiveness of Indian ports**. Enforced nationwide, these guidelines for National Benchmarking of Indian Ports Performance are set to revitalize the country's maritime infrastructure.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the foundation stone-laying ceremony of the **Shri Kalki Dham Temple in Sambhal, Uttar Pradesh**. The event was marked by speeches from key figures, including Chairman **Pramod Krishnam** and Chief Minister **Yogi Adityanath**, reflecting on the temple's significance and highlighting developmental initiatives in the region.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and UAE Vice President **Mohamed bin Rashid Al Maktoum** laid the foundation stone of **Bharat Mart**, integrating retail, warehousing, and logistics at Jebel Ali Free Trade Zone in Dubai, during a virtual ceremony. The Bharat Mart facility is set to emerge as a pivotal hub for commerce and logistics in Dubai.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** inaugurated a series of ambitious educational and infrastructure projects across India, totaling an investment of ₹13,375 crore. These projects are part of a larger initiative that saw the launch of projects worth ₹30,500 crore in various sectors. The educational sector benefited significantly, with the establishment of new **IIMs, IITs, Kendriya Vidyalayas, Navodaya Vidyalayas, and an AIIMS**, marking a significant boost to India's educational infrastructure.
- **Dr. Virendra Kumar**, the Union Minister of Social Justice and Empowerment, virtually launched several projects **valued at over Rs 100 crore**. These initiatives, focused on improving rehabilitation facilities and promoting inclusivity, highlight the government's dedication to citizen welfare. The inauguration ceremony featured the introduction of crucial facilities across various regions.
- In a historic moment, the **Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad (IITH)** witnessed the dedication of its transformative Campus Development Project to the nation by the Honorable Prime Minister, **Shri Narendra Modi** via Video Conference. The dedication ceremony of the **Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad's (IITH)** transformative Campus Development Project witnessed the presence of distinguished leaders, marking a significant milestone in the institution's journey.
- Union Minister of Education and Skill Development & Entrepreneurship, **Shri Dharmendra Pradhan**, spearheaded the inauguration of the **first Skill India Centre (SIC) in Sambalpur, Odisha**. The event witnessed the presence of esteemed dignitaries, including the Secretary, the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE), **Shri Atul Kumar Tiwari**, and CEO, NSDC and MD, NSDC International, **Shri Ved Mani Tiwari**.
- The **Ministry of AYUSH** and the **Ministry of Tribal Affairs** have unveiled a collaborative effort aimed at improving the **public health of tribal students**. This joint initiative focuses on implementing Ayurvedic interventions to address health issues among over 20,000 tribal students.
- The Chief Justice of India, **Justice DY Chandrachud**, inaugurated the **'Ayush Holistic Wellness Centre'** within the premises of the Supreme Court of India. The event took place today in the presence of Companion Judges of the Supreme Court of India, along with guests including Minister of Ayush and Ports, Shipping and Waterways, **Shri Sarbananda Sonowal**, and Minister of State for Ayush, **Dr. Munjpara Mahendrabhai**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **9th edition of Raisina Dialogue** in New Delhi, marking a significant moment for global discourse on geopolitics and geo-economics. Joining him in the inaugural session was the Prime Minister of Greece, **Kyriakos Mitsotakis**, who graced the event as the Chief Guest.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** is scheduled to inaugurate the foundation stone laying ceremony for **550 Amrit Bharat stations on February 26**. The initiative aims to improve railway station facilities by developing rooftop plazas and city centers, with an investment of Rs 40,000 crore. Additionally, the Prime Minister will lay foundation stones for about **1,500 road overbridges and underbridges across different states**.
- **Guru Ravidas Jayanti 2024**, marks the **647th anniversary of the birth of Guru Ravidas**, observed on **February 23rd**. **Guru Ravidas**, also known as **Raidas**, stands as one of the eminent saints of the **North Indian Bhakti movement**. Born into a marginalized untouchable leather-working caste in **Varanasi**, his life and works profoundly reflect the challenges and struggles of his social background.
- The **Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways (MoPSW)** has collaborated with the **Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Shillong** to establish the first **'Gati Shakti Research Chair'** in India. This initiative aims to enhance academic research in multimodal logistics, particularly focusing on the North-East region.
- After the success of the 'International Purple Fest, 2024' held in Goa from 8th to 13th January, 2024, the **Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPwD)** under the Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment is set to host a day-long celebration of inclusivity at **Amrit Udyaan** in the Rashtrapati Bhawan on 26th February, 2024.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** recently inaugurated **two institutes** of the Union Ministry of Ayush, marking a significant step forward in the promotion of healthcare across the nation. The inauguration ceremony, held virtually, saw the unveiling of the **'Central Research Institute of Yoga & Naturopathy' (CRIYN)** in Jhajjar, Haryana, and the National Institute of Naturopathy (NIN) titled **'NISARG GRAM'** in Pune, Maharashtra.

- The **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** introduced the **Surrogacy (Regulation) Amendment Rules, 2024** on 21-2-2024, altering the Surrogacy (Regulation) Rules, 2022. These amendments, effective immediately, address significant changes regarding the use of donor gametes and consent agreements in surrogacy arrangements.
- Union Minister of Information and Broadcasting, **Shri Anurag Singh Thakur**, revealed plans for a new office of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) in **Chandigarh**. This move aims to support filmmakers in the region by making the process of obtaining film certification more convenient.
- In the **110th episode** of '**Mann Ki Baat**', Prime Minister Narendra Modi celebrates the remarkable contributions of women across India. With Women's Day around the corner, he highlights the inspiring journey of women like **Sunita Devi**, affectionately known as "Drone Didi," who are breaking barriers and transforming lives. From mastering drone technology to revolutionizing agriculture in villages, women are scripting a new narrative of empowerment and progress.
- In a significant stride towards bolstering India's healthcare infrastructure and services, Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi dedicated **Five All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) to the nation**. The AIIMS facilities located in Rajkot (Gujarat), Bathinda (Punjab), Raebareli (Uttar Pradesh), Kalyani (West Bengal), and Mangalagiri (Andhra Pradesh) mark a pivotal moment in the country's journey towards enhancing tertiary healthcare access and quality.
- **Rajeev Chandrasekhar**, Union IT Minister, recently met with Shanker Trivedi, senior vice president at NVIDIA, at the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY). The discussion centered around India's evolving Digital Public Infrastructure and examined potential collaborative efforts in the field of Sovereign AI.
- The government has announced the initiation of the '**Mera Pehla Vote Desh Ke Liye**' campaign in higher educational institutions nationwide starting from February 27, 2024. This campaign aims to foster active participation among the youth in the electoral process, emphasizing the significance of voting for the betterment of the nation.
- The pilot project for the '**World's Largest Grain Storage Plan in Cooperative Sector**', expansion of PACS, and digital transformation aim to enhance food security, economic development, and governance, benefiting millions of farmers. The ceremony, held at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, marks a significant step towards enhancing food security, economic development, and governance within the cooperative domain.
- External Affairs Minister **S Jaishankar** is set to confer the esteemed title of '**Global Jain Peace Ambassador**' upon **Acharya Lokesh Muni**. The ceremony, scheduled to take place in Karnataka, will be organized by the Jain pilgrim center, Navagraha Tirtha Kshetra, in Hubli Varur.
- In alignment with the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**, the Union Education Minister **Dharmendra Pradhan** has announced the launch of the **SWAYAM Plus** platform, operated by **IIT-Madras**. This initiative aims to provide industry-relevant courses to enhance the employability of learners, including working professionals.
- The central government, under Section 3 of the **Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967**, has declared two factions of the **Muslim Conference in Jammu & Kashmir** as unlawful associations. This measure aims to combat terrorism and preserve national security. Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** made the announcement via a statement on social media platform **X**, highlighting the government's dedication to dismantling terror networks and safeguarding the nation's integrity.
- Union Home Minister Shri Amit Shah, along with Gujarat Chief Minister **Shri Bhupendra Patel** and other dignitaries, inaugurated the '**Swaminarayan Institute of Medical Science and Research**' at the Shri Swaminarayan Vishwamangal Gurukul in **Kalol, Gandhinagar, Gujarat**. This significant development marks a pivotal moment in the advancement of medical education and healthcare services in the region.

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- Observed every year on **March 3**, World Hearing Day 2024 fall on a Sunday. The theme for this year, as designated by the World Health Organization (WHO), is "**Changing mindsets: Let's make ear and hearing care a reality for all.**" This theme underscores the need to combat societal misconceptions and stigmatizing attitudes through heightened awareness and the dissemination of information, targeting both the general public and healthcare providers.
- Union Minister for Minority Affairs, **Smriti Zubin Irani**, introduced two significant initiatives aimed at enhancing the Haj pilgrimage experience for 2024. The **Haj Suvidha App** was launched to provide essential information and access to crucial services, while the **Haj Guide-2024** was released to educate pilgrims about various aspects of the journey, with a focus on utilizing the app effectively.
- Union Minister for Steel and Civil Aviation, **Sh. Jyotiraditya M. Scindia**, virtually inaugurated **India's 1st Green Hydrogen Plant in Stainless Steel Sector located at Jindal Stainless Limited, Hisar**, on 4th March, 2024. The inauguration also witnessed the presence of Secretary, Ministry of Steel Sh. Nagendra Nath Sinha, Managing Director (Jindal Stainless Limited), Sh. Abhyuday Jindal, Founder, Hygenco Sh. Amit Bansal, and other officials of the Ministry of Steel.

- Union Minister of Chemicals and Fertilisers and Health and Family Welfare, **Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya**, virtually inaugurated **three centers of the Central Institute of Petrochemicals Engineering & Technology (CIPET) from New Delhi**. These centers, located in Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Madhya Pradesh, are significant additions to CIPET's network.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** marked the beginning of a new era in India's nuclear energy sector by witnessing the "Core Loading" at the **Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor (PFBR) in Kalpakkam, Tamil Nadu**. This event signifies the near completion of India's first indigenous PFBR, a landmark project fully designed and constructed within the country by Bharatiya Nabhikiya Vidyut Nigam Limited (BHAVINI), in collaboration with over 200 Indian industries, including numerous MSMEs.
- In a significant stride towards bolstering cyber-security measures and enhancing citizen empowerment, the **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)** recently unveiled the **Digital Intelligence Platform (DIP)** alongside the '**Chakshu**' facility on the Sanchar Saathi portal. This initiative aims to foster collaboration among stakeholders to combat the misuse of telecom resources in cyber-crime and financial frauds.
- **Minister Hardeep Singh Puri**, overseeing Petroleum and Natural Gas as well as Housing and Urban Affairs, dedicated **201 CNG Stations and India's inaugural Small Scale LNG Unit of GAIL** to the nation via video conferencing. The event, graced by numerous dignitaries, underscored the government's pledge to elevate the share of natural gas in the primary energy basket to 15% by 2030.
- In a significant development, the Indian government, following consultations with the **Election Commission of India (ECI)**, has revised the minimum age criterion for senior citizens to avail the postal ballot voting facility. The decision, which comes into effect immediately, raises the eligibility age from **80 to 85 years**, marking a pivotal change in the electoral process aimed at ensuring greater convenience for the nation's elderly population.
- **India's first National Dolphin Research Center (NDRC)** was officially inaugurated by Bihar Chief Minister **Nitish Kumar**. This landmark facility, built at a cost of Rs 30 crore, is situated on the banks of the Ganges River within the Patna University campus.
- A new chapter in management education unfolds as the Union Minister for Education, Skill Development & Entrepreneurship, **Shri Dharmendra Pradhan**, inaugurated the **Centre of Management Education** jointly established by IIM Mumbai and IIM Sambalpur. The inauguration took place at the NALCO Training Institute in **Angul, Odisha**, amidst the presence of **Shri Sridhar Patra, CMD, NALCO**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated India's pioneering underwater metro train service in **Kolkata**, ushering in a landmark achievement in the nation's infrastructure and urban development. The service, which is a significant component of the **Kolkata Metro's East-West corridor**, is designed to enhance connectivity between **Howrah and Salt Lake**, the twin cities of West Bengal's capital.
- In a significant development, Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw will inaugurate the '**NITI For States**' platform by NITI Aayog in New Delhi. This platform, serving as a **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)**, is designed to bolster policy formulation and promote good governance across states.
- India, as a party to the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES), has recently implemented stringent measures to regulate the possession and trade of exotic pets. **The Living Animal Species (Reporting and Registration) Rules, 2024**, issued by the Union environment ministry on February 28, aim to enforce the provisions of the Convention and ensure the protection of endangered wildlife.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** has unveiled his ambitious plan to make **India a prime wedding destination**, aiming to boost tourism and retain revenue within the country. His recent address at a rally in Jammu and Kashmir highlighted this mission, emphasizing the potential of hosting weddings in diverse locales across India.
- Union Minister of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, **Arjun Munda**, unveiled the **Agriculture Integrated Command and Control Centre** at Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi. This initiative aims to empower farmers nationwide by providing them with essential information, services, and facilities.
- On the occasion of the **134th Foundation Day of the National Archives** of India, Minister of State for Parliamentary Affairs and Culture, **Arjun Ram Meghwal**, will inaugurate a digital exhibition titled "**Subhash Abhinandan**" in New Delhi on March 11th. Organized by the National Archives of India, the exhibition commemorates the life of Subhash Chandra Bose, featuring 16 sections covering key aspects from his birth to the present day.
- The Ministry of Women and Child Development will organize **Poshan Pakhwada** nationwide from **March 9 to March 23, 2024**. This 15-day celebration aims to spread awareness about **nutrition, dietary practices, and women's health**.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated projects worth **Rs 118 crore 72 lakh** in Madhya Pradesh through video conferencing. These projects are under the **Swadesh Darshan 2.0** scheme and the **Prasad** scheme.

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi, during the Viksit Bharat North East programme in Itanagar, Arunachal Pradesh on March 09, 2024, virtually dedicated the **Sela Tunnel** project to the nation. Constructed by the **Border Roads Organisation (BRO)** at an altitude of 13,000 feet, the tunnel is situated on the road from **Tezpur, Assam, to Tawang in Arunachal Pradesh's** West Kameng district. The project, valued at **Rs 825 crore**, aims to provide all-weather connectivity and bolster the Armed Forces' readiness in the region.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi unveiled a **125-foot bronze statue** of the legendary Ahom general, **Lachit Borphukan**, at his burial site in eastern Assam's Jorhat district. This event marks a significant tribute to Borphukan's valor and leadership in the history of Assam.
- At the end of the decade from **2014 to 2024**, India has emerged as the world's **second-largest producer of mobile phones**. This achievement marks a significant transition for the country's electronics manufacturing sector.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the Gurgaon stretch of the **Dwarka Expressway** alongside Haryana CM **Manohar Lal Khattar** and Union Minister **Nitin Gadkari**. The inspection of the expressway was conducted on foot, showcasing its significance for transportation infrastructure.
- Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated the commencement of **Piped Natural Gas (PNG)** facilities in 41 villages and various development projects in **178 villages** under the '**Dilli Gramodaya Abhiyan**'. The initiative aims to uplift the infrastructure and living standards in rural areas of Delhi.
- Union Minister for Communications, Electronics, and Information Technology and Railways, **Ashwini Vaishnaw**, unveiled **India's fastest and indigenously developed IP/MPLS (Multiprotocol Label Switching) router in Bengaluru**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** made headlines by inaugurating **15 significant airport projects**, marking an unprecedented infrastructural addition in Uttar Pradesh's Azamgarh. This extensive initiative, almost valued at **₹10,000 crore**, encompasses a blend of new airports, expanded terminals, foundation stones for future airports, and other ancillary facilities.
- **National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR)** celebrated its **19th Foundation Day** at the **Jacaranda Hall, Indian Habitat Centre, New Delhi**. To mark this special occasion, the Commission invited children from different parts of the country to acknowledge their efforts and participation in the Commission's Pariksha Parv campaign.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited Sabarmati Ashram to inaugurate **Kochrab Ashram** and launch the **Master Plan of the Gandhi Ashram Memorial**. This significant event commemorated Mahatma Gandhi's legacy and contributions to India's freedom struggle.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi unveiled the inaugural **automobile in-plant railway siding at Suzuki Motor Gujarat Private Limited**, a wholly-owned subsidiary of **Maruti Suzuki India Limited (MSIL)**. The ceremony, conducted via video conferencing, signifies a pivotal advancement in the execution of the Prime Minister's flagship Gati Shakti programme.
- Union Minister **Shri Rajeev Chandrasekhar**, responsible for Electronics and IT, Skill Development, Entrepreneurship, and Jal Shakti, inaugurated **India's first FutureLABS center at C-DAC Thiruvananthapuram**. Named the "**Centre for Semiconductor Chips & Systems for Strategic Electronics**," this pioneering initiative aims to catalyze an ecosystem for next-generation chip design, manufacturing, and research.
- Dr. Jitendra Singh, the Union Minister of Science & Technology, inaugurated the "**National Speed Breeding Crop Facility**" at **NABI (National Agri-Food Biotechnology Institute)**, Mohali. This initiative aligns with PM Modi's vision of increasing farmers' income and promoting Agri StartUps.
- **Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya**, Union Minister for **Chemicals and Fertilizers and Health and Family Welfare**, spearheaded the inauguration of a credit assistance program aimed at bolstering **Jan Aushadhi Kendras** across India. The program, initiated through a collaboration between **SIDBI and PMBI**, underscores the government's commitment to enhancing accessibility and affordability of medicines, echoing Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of '**Sanjeevani**' for the underprivileged.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated three semiconductor projects virtually, with a combined investment of approximately **Rs 1.25 Lakh Crore**. These projects signify a significant step towards bolstering India's semiconductor industry. The three facilities include a semiconductor fabrication unit in Dholera, Gujarat, an Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility in Morigaon, Assam, and another OSAT facility in Sanand, Gujarat.
- **Yoga Mahotsav-2024** marked the **100-day** countdown to the 10th edition of the **International Day of Yoga (IDY)** on **June 21st, 2024**, at **Vigyan Bhawan**. This year, the event focused on the theme "Yoga for Women Empowerment," reflecting the **Ministry of Ayush's** commitment to promote global health and peace through yoga, particularly emphasizing women's well-being.
- Union Minister of Information and Broadcasting, **Anurag Singh Thakur**, inaugurated **PB-SHABD**, a news sharing service, alongside the revamped websites of **DD News** and **Akashvani News**, and an updated News on Air mobile app at the **National Media Centre, New Delhi**.

- Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri unveiled '**Ethanol 100**', an automotive fuel aimed at reducing emissions and promoting sustainability. This initiative is part of a broader strategy to increase ethanol blending in petrol, with significant strides already made in enhancing availability and infrastructure across select states.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi virtually inaugurated India's first integrated oil palm processing unit, operated by **3F Oil Palm**, marking a significant stride in the nation's journey towards self-reliance in edible oils. Situated in **Arunachal Pradesh's Roing**, this project aligns with Mission Palm Oil under the National Mission on Edible Oils – Oil Palm (NMEO-OP).
- Ahead of announcing the dates for the upcoming **Lok Sabha elections**, Chief Election Commissioner **Rajiv Kumar** introduced a new mobile application called '**Know Your Candidate**' (KYC). This app will enable voters to find out if any electoral candidate in their constituency has any criminal records.
- The **Maharishi Ayurveda Hospital** in Shalimar Bagh, Delhi, is making headlines for its in-house restaurant, **Soma-The Ayurvedic Kitchen**. This restaurant is being hailed as the **first Ayurvedic Kitchen in India**.
- **Pashupati Kumar Paras**, former Union minister and president of the **Rashtriya Lok Janshakti Party (RLJP)**, resigned from the Union Cabinet following his party's exclusion from the **National Democratic Alliance (NDA)** seat-sharing arrangement in Bihar for the upcoming Lok Sabha elections. In response, President **Droupadi Murmu** accepted his resignation and appointed **Kiren Rijiju** with an additional charge as the **Minister of Food Processing Industries**.
- Dr. Neeraj Mittal, Secretary of India's Department of Telecommunications, led a significant delegation to Geneva for strategic meetings at the **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)** Headquarters from March 18-20. The aim was to enhance collaboration and explore innovative initiatives in telecommunications and information and communication technology (ICT) sectors.
- **GoodEnough Energy** has announced that it will start operations at **India's first battery energy storage gigafactory** in the northern region of **Jammu and Kashmir by October 2023**.
- Haiti is facing a severe **crisis** due to escalating **gang violence**. Armed **gangs** have launched **attacks** in the suburbs of Port-au-Prince, prompting India to launch **Operation Indravati** to **evacuate** its nationals to the Dominican Republic. Similarly, the **US** has airlifted more than 15 Americans to Santo Domingo.
- In a determined effort to ensure accessibility and inclusivity in the electoral process, the **Election Commission has introduced the Saksham App**. This initiative aims to address the needs of **voters above 85 years of age and Persons-with-Disabilities (PWDs) with a 40 percent benchmark disability**, allowing them to cast their votes from the comfort of their homes.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and his Bhutanese counterpart **Tshering Tobgay** jointly inaugurated a modern hospital in the Bhutanese capital, Thimphu. The **Gyalsuen Jetsun Pema Wangchuk Mother and Child Hospital** is a shining example of the strong **development cooperation** between India and Bhutan.
- India aims to replace its minimum wage system with a living wage framework by 2025, seeking assistance from the International Labour Organization (ILO) for technical support in creating and implementing this transition.
- The **Election Commission of India (ECI)** is keeping a close watch on the election process through the **cVIGIL app**. The app allows citizens to report violations of the **Model Code of Conduct** and **election expenditures** by capturing photos and videos. **Chief Election Commissioner Rajiv Kumar** said that cVIGIL empowers citizens to report violations, with assured action within **100 minutes**.

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- The **Indian government** has taken proactive steps to address carbon emissions in the steel industry by establishing a task force to investigate the potential use of biochar. With the steel sector contributing significantly to greenhouse gas emissions, this initiative aims to reduce carbon intensity and promote **sustainability in steel manufacturing processes**. Given its potential significance in reducing carbon emissions within the steel industry, the formation of the 14th Task Force on 'Use of Biochar and Other Relevant Products in Steel Making' was endorsed by the ministry.
- The Indian government aimed to raise funds through the sale of stakes in state-run companies in the **fiscal year 2023/24**. However, the achieved amount of **165 billion rupees** fell short of the internal target by about **9%**, reaching **\$1.98 billion**. This setback is attributed to the forthcoming general elections, causing a shift in focus away from Prime Minister Narendra Modi's privatization agenda.
- On March 29, 2024, Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** was honoured with the '**Merchant Navy Flag**', pinned on his lapel by Secretary **T.K. Ramachandran** of the **Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways**. This marked the beginning of the **National Maritime Week** celebrations, which span from **March 29 to April 5**.
- Amidst the growing buzz around **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, the trailer and song launch event for India's first Hindi film on this subject, "**IRAH**," took place in Mumbai. The movie boasts an impressive cast, including **Rohit Bose Roy, Rajesh Sharma, Karishma Kotak, and Rakshith Bhandarry** in prominent roles.
- India's engineering exports soared by **15.9% year over year in February 2024**, marking the third consecutive month of growth and reaching a **record high of \$9.94 billion for the fiscal year 2023–2024**. Notably, this growth surpassed December 2023 figures.

- The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has introduced the 'One Vehicle, One FASTag' norm, which aims to prevent the use of a single FASTag for multiple vehicles or linking multiple FASTags to a particular vehicle. This new norm has come into effect from **April 1, 2024**. NHAI had previously extended the compliance deadline to the end of March, considering the issues faced by Paytm FASTag users.
- The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare introduces the **myCGHS app for iOS**, delivering enhanced healthcare accessibility and digital experiences to **Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS)** beneficiaries. **Launched on April 3rd, 2024**, the app prioritizes user safety with robust security measures.
- India aims to bolster its strategic petroleum reserves (SPRs) by constructing its first privately managed storage facility in partnership with a private company by 2029-30.
- The President of India, **Smt Droupadi Murmu**, launched India's first **home-grown gene therapy** for cancer at **IIT Bombay** on April 4, 2024. This groundbreaking treatment, called '**CAR-T cell therapy**', is a major breakthrough in the battle against cancer.
- **Dr. Manmohan Singh**, former **Prime Minister of India**, **retire** from the **Rajya Sabha**, marking the end of his **three-decade-long tenure** in the **Upper House**.
- India is embarking on establishing its first privately managed strategic petroleum reserve (SPR) by 2029-30. This initiative aims to allow the operator the liberty to trade all stored oil, aligning with models seen in countries such as **Japan and South Korea**. India's current SPR strategy involves partial commercialization, with plans to expand this approach with new SPR projects.
- In line with its ambitions for a sustainable energy future, India aims to ramp up its nuclear power production significantly, targeting a capacity of **1 lakh MW by 2047**. This objective, outlined in a report titled '**Synchronising Energy Transitions Towards Possible Net Zero for India: Affordable and Clean Energy for All**,' highlights the nation's commitment to expanding its nuclear energy sector.
- In response to requests from friendly nations including **Bangladesh, the United Arab Emirates, Bahrain, Mauritius, and Bhutan**, the Indian government has granted approval for the export of onions. India, a significant **global exporter of onions**, had enforced a **ban on onion exports in December 2023**, leading to soaring prices in these nations.
- India aims to halt **urea imports by the end of 2025** by boosting domestic production and promoting alternative fertilizers. This is in response to the nation's significant reliance on imports, which currently satisfy around 30% of its annual urea demand.
- India has removed export restrictions on essential commodities for the Maldives, including items like **eggs, potatoes, onions, rice, wheat flour, sugar, and dal**, for the **fiscal year 2024-25**. This move comes despite strained diplomatic relations between the two countries since November last year.
- In a strategic move to bolster its maritime presence and enhance regional connectivity, India has gained operational control over the **Sittwe Port in Myanmar**, following approval from the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**. The agreement allows **India Ports Global (IPGL)**, a company fully owned by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, to manage the **entire port on the Kaladan River**, marking **India's second overseas port acquisition after Chabahar in Iran**.
- The President of India, **Smt Droupadi Murmu**, inaugurated a two-day **Homoeopathy Symposium organized by the Central Council for Research in Homoeopathy** in New Delhi on World Homoeopathy Day (April 10, 2024). The theme of the symposium, "Empowering Research, Enhancing Proficiency," is highly relevant in the 21st century.
- India has once again utilized the peace clause at the **World Trade Organization (WTO)** for the fifth consecutive time, citing rice subsidies exceeding the prescribed limit during the 2022-23 marketing year. Despite breaching the 10% domestic support ceiling, India faces no immediate repercussions due to the peace clause provision, agreed upon at the 2013 Bali ministerial.
- In a landmark achievement, **French automaker Citroën has become the first multinational car manufacturer** to export **electric vehicles (EVs)** produced in India to the international market. The company announced the commencement of exports of its locally manufactured ë-C3, sending an **initial shipment of 500 units to Indonesia from the Kamarajar Port**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** is poised to make history as the **first Indian Prime Minister since Indira Gandhi to grace the cover of Newsweek**. In a comprehensive interview, PM Modi discussed a spectrum of topics, including China, economic reforms, the upcoming Lok Sabha polls, the Quad alliance, and the role of democracy in India.
- In a gesture of solidarity and support, **India has donated 35 ambulances and 66 school buses to various organizations in Nepal**, bolstering infrastructure in the crucial sectors of health and education. **Indian Ambassador to Nepal, Naveen Srivastava**, officiated the handover ceremony alongside Finance Minister **Barshaman Pun**.
- In a significant stride towards advancing India's rail infrastructure, the country is gearing up to launch an indigenous **bullet train** capable of reaching speeds exceeding **250 kilometres per hour (km/h)**. This groundbreaking initiative is set to revolutionize high-speed rail travel in India, showcasing the nation's engineering prowess and commitment to cutting-edge technology.

- In a move to simplify and streamline the process of students' transition from one school to another, the School Education Department in the state has made the use of **Permanent Education Number (PEN)** mandatory from the academic year 2024-25. PEN is a unique identification number assigned to every student by the Union Ministry of Education, through the **UDISE+ (Unified District Information System for Education Plus)** portal, which covers more than 14.89 lakh schools, 95 lakh teachers, and 26.5 crore children.
- On the auspicious occasion of **Mahaveer Jayanti**, Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the 2550th Bhagwan Mahaveer Nirvan Mahotsav at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi. The event paid tribute to the 24th Tirthankar, **Bhagwan Mahaveer**, whose teachings of **Ahimsa (Non-Violence)**, **Satya (Truthfulness)**, **Asteya (Non-Stealing)**, **Brahmacharya (Chastity)**, and **Aparigraha (Non-attachment)** have illuminated the path of peaceful coexistence and universal brotherhood.
- In celebration of **Earth Day**, the **Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR)** recently unveiled **India's largest Climate Clock at its headquarters in New Delhi**. This initiative underscores CSIR's commitment to raising awareness about climate change and its adverse impacts.
- The **Indian Historical Records Commission (IHRC)** is an **apex advisory body** on archival matters in India. Established in **1919**, the IHRC serves as a national forum for creators, custodians, and users of records, advising the Government of India on the **management of records** and their use for **historical research**. The IHRC is headed by the **Union Minister of Culture**.
- India takes a significant step in renewable energy with the inauguration of its first multi-purpose green hydrogen pilot project at the **1,500 MW Nathpa Jhakri Hydro Power Station (NJHPS)** in Himachal Pradesh's **Jhakri**. Spearheaded by **Satluj Jal Vidyut Nigam (SJVN)**, the project aims to produce green hydrogen through renewable energy sources.
- **India's pharmaceutical exports** witnessed robust growth in the fiscal year 2023-24, reaching **\$28 billion**, marking a **10% increase compared to the previous fiscal year**. Despite a 3% dip in total exports, the pharmaceutical sector demonstrated resilience and significant expansion.
- The **Gem & Jewellery Export Promotion Council (GJEPC)** announces a significant milestone for **India's Gem and Jewellery (GJ)** industry as it receives **Authorized Economic Operator (AEO)** status from the Ministry of Finance. This status, previously denied, now facilitates smoother export-import processes, reduces cargo release times, and lowers bank guarantees by 50%, aiming to enhance ease of doing business.
- Invest India predicts that India's ecommerce sector will skyrocket to **\$325 billion by 2030**, with rural India driving much of the growth. This surge is fueled by factors such as increased internet penetration, affordable internet services, and a rising number of smartphone users.

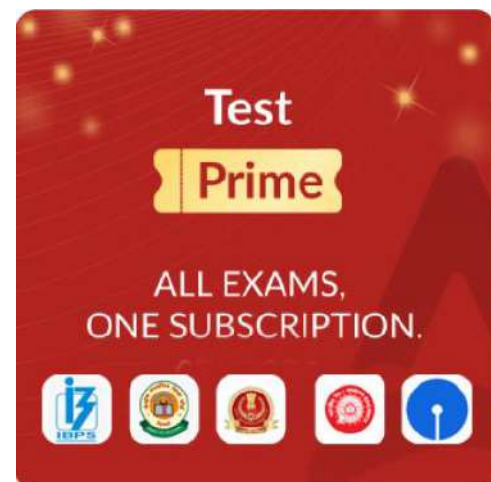
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- Invest India predicts that India's ecommerce sector will skyrocket to **\$325 billion by 2030**, with rural India driving much of the growth. This surge is fueled by factors such as increased internet penetration, affordable internet services, and a rising number of smartphone users.
- A report by the **Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI)** highlights India's escalating dependence on Chinese imports, with the import bill surging to over \$101 billion in 2023-24 from around \$70 billion in 2018-19. Over the past fifteen years, China's share of India's industrial goods imports has risen significantly, reaching 30%, while imports from China have outpaced **India's total imports by 2.3 times**.
- India emerged as the **global leader in remittances in 2022**, receiving over **\$111 billion**, surpassing the **\$100 billion mark for the first time**. The **International Organisation for Migration (IOM)** highlighted India, alongside Mexico, China, the Philippines, and France, as the top five remittance recipient countries.
- India's toy exports experienced a slight decline to **USD 152.34 million** in the **fiscal year 2023-24**, with limited benefits from quality control measures. Despite efforts to bolster the domestic industry and ensure product safety, exports did not see significant improvement.
- India's remarkable surge in solar energy deployment propelled it past Japan, securing its position as the **world's third-largest solar power generator in 2023**. Solar energy continued its unprecedented growth streak, outpacing coal in global electricity generation for the **19th consecutive year**.
- India has reaffirmed its dedication to the global fight against terrorism by contributing \$500,000 to the **UN Counter-Terrorism Trust Fund (CTTF)**. **Ambassador Ruchira Kamboj**, India's Permanent Representative to the UN, delivered the contribution to **Under Secretary General Vladimir Voronkov** on May 7. This financial support adds to India's ongoing commitment, totaling \$2.55 million, aimed at bolstering multilateral efforts against terrorism.
- According to data from the **Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI)**, an economic think tank, **China** has emerged as India's **largest trading partner** in the fiscal year 2023-24, surpassing the **United States**. The **two-way commerce** between India and China stood at a staggering **\$118.4 billion**, slightly edging out the **\$118.3 billion** traded with the US.
- The grand commencement of **IndiaSkills 2024** took place at **Yashobhoomi, Dwarka, New Delhi** on 15 May 2024. Over the span of four days, this esteemed competition will assess the proficiency of students across 61 diverse categories, providing a platform for showcasing talent at both national and international levels.

- Inauguration of the Bharat Pavilion, formerly known as the **India Pavilion**, marked a significant moment at the **77th Cannes Film Festival**. The renaming reflects India's commitment to traditional storytelling while seeking global collaborations.
- India has signed a 10-year agreement to develop and operate Iran's strategic Chabahar Port to strengthen trade ties with Central Asia and Afghanistan, bypassing Pakistan. However, this deal faces potential US sanctions, complicating New Delhi's strategic objectives.
- In April, India's merchandise exports saw a **modest 1% increase, reaching \$34.99 billion**, driven by robust growth in sectors like electronics, chemicals, petroleum products, and pharmaceuticals, despite global economic uncertainties. However, the trade deficit widened to a five-month high of \$19.1 billion, with imports rising by 10.25% to \$54.09 billion. Notably, imports of gold and crude oil surged, contributing to the deficit.
- The Cabinet has greenlit an ambitious financial allocation of over **Rs 10,300 crore for the IndiaAI Mission**, aimed at fortifying India's AI innovation ecosystem. Spearheaded by a public-private partnership model, this significant investment over the next five years is poised to catalyze various strategic initiatives, including compute infrastructure expansion, startup empowerment, and ethical AI deployment.
- The **Artara'24 Fine Arts Exhibition and Competition** has made its mark in Dubai as a prestigious platform for discovering and nurturing emerging artistic talents from India. The event aimed to uncover hidden artistic gems, with a particular focus on the Indian talent residing in Dubai.
- The **Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW)** recently marked **International Women in Maritime Day**, recognizing the significant contributions of 27 women seafarers to the maritime industry. The event aimed to honor these professionals and promote gender equality within the maritime sector.
- India is set to play a pivotal role in facilitating the first-ever focused discussions on regulating tourism in Antarctica at the **46th Antarctic Treaty Consultative Meeting (ATCM)** and the 26th Meeting of the **Committee for Environmental Protection (CEP)**.
- In a significant stride, India's market capitalization has surged to **\$5 trillion, marking a historic achievement**. This remarkable feat was accomplished in under six months since surpassing the \$4 trillion mark, showcasing the nation's robust economic resilience and investor confidence.
- As the **Doordarshan** channel **DD Kisan** marks its **9th anniversary on 26 May 2024**, it is set to embark on a remarkable journey by introducing **Krish and Bhoomi**, the first **AI anchors** in India's government broadcasting history. This groundbreaking move underscores the

channel's commitment to leveraging cutting-edge technology to better serve the nation's agricultural community.

- India is the only country among the world's top five crude steel producers to record positive growth in April 2024, according to the **World Steel Association**. India, the second-largest crude steel producer globally, achieved a **growth rate of 3.9% compared to April 2023**.
- Smartphones have become a major export success story for India, now ranking as the fourth-largest export item **with a 42% growth, reaching \$15.6 billion in FY24**. This marks an improvement by one notch in the ranking from the preceding year. Data collection for smartphones as a separate category began in April 2022, highlighting the sector's rapid growth.
- The **Food and Nutrition Board (FNB)**, a technical branch of the **Ministry of Women and Child Development (WCD)** responsible for providing logistical support to community nutrition programs, has been **officially dissolved** as part of the government's plan to rationalize various bodies.
- India faced a trade deficit with nine out of its **top ten trading partners in the fiscal year 2023-24**, according to official data. Notably, China emerged as India's largest trading partner, surpassing the United States, with bilateral commerce totaling \$118.4 billion.
- India has achieved a significant milestone with the successful flight test of the indigenously developed **anti-radiation missile Rudram-II**. Fired from a **Su-30 MKI fighter aircraft off the coast of Odisha**, this missile is poised to become a vital asset for the Indian Armed Forces, serving as a force multiplier in suppression of enemy air defenses (SEAD) missions.
- The Indian government has raised the maximum limit of retirement gratuity and death gratuity from Rs 20 lakh to Rs 25 lakh, effective from January 1, 2024. This revision, issued by the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, aims to enhance benefits for Central government employees.



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- The Centre has introduced a new numbering series, 160xxxxxx, for making service or transactional calls. This move aims to help citizens easily identify legitimate calls and curb unsolicited voice calls from telemarketers using 10-digit mobile numbers.
- India created a world record with **64.2 crore voters**, including **31.2 crore women**, participating in the **Lok Sabha Election 2024**. Chief Election commissioner **Rajiv Kumar** said that the number is 1.5 times of the voters of all **G7 countries – US, UK, France, Germany, Italy, Japan and Canada**.
- Om Birla**, the incumbent **Lok Sabha Speaker**, has achieved a remarkable feat by winning the **Kota parliamentary seat on June 4, 2024**. With a resounding margin of **41,139 votes**, Birla has become the first **presiding officer in 20 years** to be re-elected to the **Lower House of Parliament**.
- The **Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) Chairman, HRI Sanjay Kumar Agarwal**, officially launched the **GST Bhawan**, the official complex of the **Central Board of Indirect Tax (CGST) Rohtak Commissionerate, in Rohtak, Haryana**. At the inaugural ceremony were **Shri Shashank Priya, Member of CBIC (GST, Legal, CX & ST)**, together with officers and staff from the **CGST Rohtak Commissionerate, Panchkula Zone**, and senior CBIC officers.
- NOTA** created a **record with 2.18 lakh voters in Madhya Pradesh's Indore** opting for the **'none of the above'** option in the Lok Sabha elections, counting for which is underway on Tuesday. Of the total voters, **14.01 per cent opted for 'None of the Above', introduced in 2013** following a Supreme Court order.
- The United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (**UNESCO**) South Asia Regional Office, in collaboration with the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (**MeitY**), Government of India, organized the **National Stakeholder Workshop on Safe, Trusted, and Ethical AI at the Taj Palace Hotel, New Delhi**. This event, following the approval of the IndiaAI Mission by the Government of India, marks a significant step towards enhancing India's AI ecosystem, with a substantial allocation exceeding Rs 10,000 crore.
- Two environmentalists, **Jai Dhar Gupta and Vijay Dhasmana** created **India's first biosphere in a tiger reserve**, called the **Rajaji Raghathi Biosphere (RRB)** within the **Rajaji National Park in Uttarakhand**.
- The **National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)** has issued a notice to four states- **Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Gujarat**. This notice follows a **2020 case** in which a father sold his daughter for **2.5 lakhs** and later filed a complaint with the commission upon discovering her dead body.
- In a strategic move to counter China's growing influence in the region, India sets its sights on managing the **Mongla Port in Bangladesh**. Following the successes of **Chabahar in Iran and Sittwe in Myanmar**, India aims to further strengthen its commercial and security interests by expanding its overseas port operations.
- India** on June 10, wholeheartedly welcomed **Egypt, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia and Ethiopia** joining the **BRICS** as their representatives attended for the first time a key meeting of the grouping **hosted by Russia**. Senior diplomat **Dammu Ravi** led the Indian delegation at the BRICS Foreign Ministers' Meeting in **Nizhny Novgorod**, in western Russia.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi** on June 10, signed the release of the **17th instalment of the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN Nidhi) scheme**. The move will benefit more than 93 million farmers by disbursing **more than Rs 20,000 crore**. 16th Installment of **PM KISAN** scheme was released on **28th February 2024**.
- The **National Commission for Indian Medical Systems** organized a two-day National Conference, **'PRANA'** Protecting Rights and Novelties in ASUS (Mind to Market for Indian System of Medicines [ISM] Professionals) in Collaboration with **All India Council for Technical Education and Ministry of Education's Innovation Cell** to mark its fourth foundation.
- Indian universities and higher education institutions (HEIs)** will now be allowed to offer **admissions twice a year** on lines of foreign universities. The two admission cycles- followed globally also- will be **July-August** and **January-February** from the **2024-25 academic session**.
- National Crime Record Bureau (NCRB)** has launched a **Mobile App "NCRB Sankalan of Criminal Laws"** to serve as a comprehensive guide providing complete information about the new criminal laws at one place. The New criminal laws will come into force from the **1st of next month (July)**.
- Jammu & Kashmir** on June 12, broadened its existing **Memorandum of Cooperation (MoC) with New Zealand** into a full-fledged strategic agreement. The partnership taps into New Zealand's globally recognized strengths in breeding technology, sustainable farm management and advanced disease control measures within the **sheep sector**.
- India** is the **world's second largest source of nitrous oxide (N2O)**, a greenhouse gas that heats up the atmosphere far more than carbon dioxide. Nearly **11%** of such global man-made emissions in 2020 were from India, topped only by **China at 16%**. The major source of these emissions **comes from fertiliser usage**, according to a global assessment of N2O emissions published in the journal **Earth System Science Data** on June 12.

- Thousands of **Kashmiri Pandits** converged at the **Kheer Bhawani temple** in Kashmir Valley's Ganderbal district to attend the annual **festival of Zyestha Ashtami** on June 14. Many of them had migrated to different parts of the country in the **1990s** in the wake of raging militancy.
- Rajya Sabha Chairperson and Vice President **Jagdeep Dhankhar** inaugurated the '**Purna Sthal**' (**Inspiration Site**) within the Parliament House Complex. This newly constructed site houses statues of **national icons and freedom fighters** that were previously scattered across different locations on the premises.
- India** is set to join an elite group of nations with the launch of its ambitious **Deep Sea Mission**, making it the **sixth country** to embark on such a groundbreaking endeavor. Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, Earth Sciences, PMO, Atomic Energy, Space, Personnel, Public Grievances, and Pensions, expressed pride and happiness over the progress of this mission during a recent meeting in New Delhi.
- The Union Cabinet has approved economic measures totaling over **₹2.88-lakh crore**, including an MSP hike for 14 Kharif crops, the **expansion of Varanasi airport**, and the establishment of a new major port at Vadhavan. These decisions, announced in the first Cabinet meeting after the allocation of portfolios to Union Ministers in the Modi government's third term, aim to bolster various sectors and drive economic growth.
- As a precursor to the 3rd edition of **World Food India**, Union Minister of Food Processing Industries, Shri **Chirag Paswan** and Union Minister of State for Food Processing Industries and Railways, Shri **Ravneet Singh**, launched the **website and mobile application** for **World Food India 2024**.
- The **Union Cabinet**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, has approved the **Viability Gap Funding (VGF) scheme** for the implementation of **offshore wind energy projects** in India. This decision marks a significant step towards harnessing the vast offshore wind energy potential within the **country's exclusive economic zone**. The total financial outlay for this scheme is **₹7,453 crore**.
- The Union Cabinet, under the leadership of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has sanctioned the Central Sector Scheme titled "**National Forensic Infrastructure Enhancement Scheme (NFIES)**" with a comprehensive financial allocation of **Rs. 2254.43 crore spanning from 2024-25 to 2028-29**. This initiative, spearheaded by the Ministry of Home Affairs, aims to bolster India's forensic capabilities through strategic investments in infrastructure and manpower.
- In a significant boost to the **India's port development programme**, as many as **9 ports of India** made it to the **Global Top 100** in the latest edition of **Container Port Performance Index (CPPI)**, 2023. This report is prepared by the **World Bank** and **S&P Global Marketing Intelligence**). The Union Minister of **Ports, Shipping & Waterways**, **Sarbananda Sonowal** gave credit to the ambitious **Sagarmala programme**, envisioned by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, for modernisation of the ports and improving their efficiency.
- To realise the vision of saturating **National Highways with green cover**, **NHAI** will undertake a unique initiative to plant **Miyawaki plantation** on land parcels adjacent to National Highways at various locations. Total land area of over **53 acres** has been identified at different places in and around **Delhi-NCR** to establish the Miyawaki plantations.
- The Indian government has approved the construction of a new major port at **Vadhavan in the Dahanu taluka of Palghar district, Maharashtra**. This project, aligned with the PM Gatishakti programme, aims to boost India's foreign trade capabilities and local economy. The **Union Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, sanctioned this on June 19, 2024.
- The Union Cabinet chaired by **Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi** approved the proposal of **Airports Authority of India (AAI)** for development of **Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport, Varanasi with an outlay of Rs 2,870 crore**. It includes Construction of New Terminal Building, Apron Extension, Runway Extension, **Parallel Taxi Track & Allied works**.
- In a bid to enhance road safety, the **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)** has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Delhi**, a technical university established by the **Government of National Capital Territory (NCT)**. This collaboration aims to leverage Artificial Intelligence (AI) to improve the availability and condition of road signs on National Highways, covering approximately 25,000 kilometers.
- In a significant development, **Bhartruhari Mahtab**, a **seven-term Lok Sabha member**, has been appointed as the **pro tem Speaker** of the Lower House. The announcement was made by Parliamentary Affairs Minister **Kiren Rijju** on June 20.
- The government monetised assets worth **₹1.56 lakh crore under the National Monetisation Pipeline (NMP)** in the financial year **2023-24**, falling short of the target of **₹1.8 lakh crore**. This performance represents approximately **159% of the achievement in 2021-22**. The NMP aims to unlock the value of brownfield infrastructure assets, with a total monetisation potential estimated at **₹6 lakh crore** over a four-year period from FY22 to FY25.

- The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has issued an advisory circular titled '**Gender Equality in the Civil Aviation Sector**' aimed at increasing **women's representation in aviation to 25% by 2025**. This initiative aligns with the gender equality principles enshrined in the Indian Constitution and the **International Civil Aviation Organisation's (ICAO)** vision for equal opportunities in aviation.
- **Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Shri Amit Shah** inaugurated the '**Fast Track Immigration – Trusted Traveller Programme**' at **Terminal-3 of Indira Gandhi International Airport**, New Delhi June 22. Union Home Secretary and several other dignitaries were present on the occasion.
- In **Ladakh**, as a tribute to the **heroes of the Kargil War**, the Indian Army has opened the **Khalubar War Memorial** to tourists. This opening ceremony was part of the 'Forever in Operations' Division's Pre-Kargil Vijay Diwas celebrations as this year, the country will celebrate the **25th anniversary of Kargil Vijay Diwas** on 26 July. Located in the renowned **Aryan Valley** this memorial commemorates the bravery and sacrifices of soldiers who fought to reclaim the valley during the war.
- **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) president** and Union Minister **Jagat Prakash Nadda** has been named **Leader of the House in the Rajya Sabha**. Mr. Nadda replaces Union Minister **Piyush Goyal**, who recently won the Lok Sabha election and took oath on June 24, as a member of the Lower House of Parliament.
- On a momentous day for Indian democracy, **Om Birla** was re-elected as the **Speaker of the 18th Lok Sabha**. This event marks an important milestone in India's parliamentary history and reminds us of the strength of our democratic institutions.
- In a pioneering move, the Ministry of Coal has initiated India's inaugural pilot project for underground **coal gasification in Jharkhand**. Located at the **Kasta coal block in Jamtara District**, this innovative venture by Eastern Coalfields Limited aims to transform the coal industry.
- The **Bharat Centre of Olympic Research and Education (BCORE)** was inaugurated on June 23, at the **Rashtriya Raksha University in Gujarat's Gandhinagar district**. Speaking at the inauguration event, **Indian Olympic Association president** and legendary sprinter **PT Usha** said the centre will serve as a hub of **knowledge, innovation and performance** in the Indian sports ecosystem.
- **Central Civil Services (Leave) Rules, 1972**, commissioning mothers opting for surrogacy will now be entitled to **180 days of maternity leave**. This revision extends childcare leave to commissioning mothers with fewer than two surviving children, marking a departure from the **previous 50-year-old regulation**. Commissioning fathers

are also granted 15 days of paternity leave under the amended rules.

- The **Director General of Railway Protection Force (RPF) Manoj Yadava** today launched the **Sangyaan App**, **designed by the RPF Tech Team** to provide in-depth information on three new Criminal Acts: the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) 2023, the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) 2023, and the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhinyam (BSA) 2023.
- The **Government of India** has made a **whopping contribution of USD 1,169,746** for '**Hindi @ UN**' project to expand the use of Hindi in the **United Nations**. The Government of India has been making continuous efforts to expand the use of Hindi in the United Nations.
- The **Central Railway** has installed a **floating solar plant of 10 MWp** capacity in the **Igatpuri lake** located in the Western Ghats, a first-of-its-kind initiative by the Indian Railways. Central Railway has always played an active role in opting for clean & renewable energy for its traction requirements and has taken various bold and revolutionary steps to fulfil the same.

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- Air India is establishing **South Asia's largest flight training school** in **Maharashtra's Amravati** district with an investment of **over ₹200 crore**. Scheduled to open in the first quarter of the next financial year, this initiative aims to secure a steady pipeline of pilots for the airline, which will require 500-700 pilots annually to support its expansion plans following a mega order of 470 Airbus and Boeing aircraft in 2023.
- **Union Minister of Mines, G. Kishan Reddy**, along with Minister of State Satish Chandra Dubey, inaugurated the **District Mineral Foundation (DMF) Gallery at Shastri Bhawan in New Delhi** on Tuesday, 2nd July 2024. The gallery showcases products from Self-Help Groups (SHGs) formed under the Pradhan Mantri Khanij Kshetra Kalyan Yojana and those supported by mining companies under their Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives.
- The **Government of India** announced a significant extension to one of its flagship urban development initiatives. The **Smart Cities Mission**, originally set to conclude on June 30, 2024, will now continue until **March 31, 2025**. This extension marks a crucial phase in India's journey towards creating technologically advanced and livable urban spaces.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** hosted the **T20 World Cup-winning Indian cricket team** for breakfast on June 4. The team led by skipper **Rohit Sharma** arrived in Delhi in the early morning from **Bridgetown in Barbados**, where it was stranded for five days owing to a Category-4 hurricane.
- **President Droupadi Murmu** presided over the Defence Investiture Ceremony-2024 (Phase-I) at Rashtrapati Bhavan, presenting Gallantry Awards to distinguished servicemen and women.

- In a significant move to boost entrepreneurship, **Union Minister Piyush Goyal** has announced an **80% reduction** in licensing fees for **women entrepreneurs** and a **50% reduction for MSMEs** under the **Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO)**. This initiative aims to encourage greater participation from women and MSMEs in the petroleum and explosives sectors, balancing industry compliance with public safety.
- India is gearing up to host the prestigious **Malabar naval exercise** alongside the United States, Japan, and Australia in the **Bay of Bengal this October**. This comes amidst escalating regional tensions fueled by China's assertive actions in the South China Sea and its expanding footprint across the **Indian Ocean Region (IOR)**. The **28th edition of the exercise** will focus on advanced **anti-submarine warfare** and aims to enhance military interoperability among the four countries.
- The **Government of India** has mandated that all stainless steel and aluminium utensils conform to the **Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)**. According to a press release by the **Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution**, this directive, **effective from March 14, 2024**, under the Quality Control Order issued by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), **Ministry of Commerce and Industry**, makes the ISI mark compulsory for these utensils.
- India, represented by a high-level delegation led by **Shri T.K. Ramachandran, Secretary of the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways**, has taken a prominent role in shaping international maritime policies at the **132nd session of the Council of the International Maritime Organization (IMO) in London**. The session, which began on July 8, 2024, and continues until July 12, 2024, addresses critical issues and proposals for the future of global maritime operations.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **INS Towers** at the Indian Newspaper Society (INS) Secretariat in Mumbai's Bandra Kurla Complex. This new facility is set to serve as a modern hub for the newspaper industry in Mumbai, addressing the evolving needs of INS members.
- The Centre has strengthened the authority of the **Lieutenant Governor (LG) of Jammu and Kashmir** through amendments to the **Jammu and Kashmir Reorganization Act, 2019**. The amended rules, effective immediately upon publication in the Official Gazette, significantly enhance the LG's powers, particularly in matters related to transfers, postings of all-India service officers, police, and judicial appointments.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** has achieved a significant milestone on **social media platform X, surpassing 100 million followers**. This milestone solidifies his position as the **most followed global leader on X**, far ahead of other world figures such as **US President Joe Biden, Dubai ruler Sheikh Mohammed, and Pope Francis**.
- **Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation, Shri Amit Shah** on July 14, inaugurated the **Pradhan Mantri Colleges of Excellence** in all 55 districts of the state from **Indore, Madhya Pradesh**. Many dignitaries, including the **Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh, Dr. Mohan Yadav** and Union Minister **Smt. Savitri Thakur** were present on the occasion.
- India is set to launch its **first national toll-free anti-narcotics helpline, '1933'**, alongside an email service under the name **MANAS (Madak Padarth Nisedh Asuchna Kendra)**. Scheduled for launch by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** during the seventh Narco-Coordination Centre meeting on July 18, the helpline aims to provide a user-friendly platform for citizens to report **drug-related crimes and seek assistance 24x7**.
- The **Indian government** has released the first tranche of **USD 2.5 million** to the United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestinian Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA) as part of its **annual contribution of USD 5 million** for the year **2024-25**. The **UNRWA**, which has carried out direct relief and works **programmes for registered Palestinian refugees** since **1950**, is making efforts to keep up its functioning in the middle of the **Israel-Hamas war in Gaza**.
- India has announced a **fresh list of 346 military hardware** items that will only be procured from state-run domestic manufacturers after a ban on their import kicks in under a staggered timeline. This is part of a broader initiative to boost domestic defence industries and reduce import dependence.
- **Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh** recently inaugurated Asia's inaugural health research-related **"Pre-clinical Network Facility"** at Faridabad's **Translational Health Science & Technology Institute (THSTI)**. This facility, selected by the Coalition for Epidemic Preparedness Innovations (CEPI), is notable as **Asia's first and the 9th globally** to handle BSL3 pathogens.
- The **Ministry of Education** and the **University Grants Commission (UGC)** unveiled an ambitious project aimed at enriching the landscape of Indian language literature in higher education. This groundbreaking initiative, known as **ASMITA (Augmenting Study Materials in Indian Languages through Translation and Academic Writing)**, sets out to develop an impressive 22,000 books in Indian languages over the next five years.
- In a significant move to bolster India's international relations, **External Affairs Minister Dr. S Jaishankar** embarked on a two-day visit to Mauritius on July 16 and 17, 2024. This visit marked a crucial step in reinforcing the strong bonds between India and Mauritius, two nations with deep historical and cultural ties.
- India has successfully completed its **4th periodic review** by the **Human Rights Committee** under the **International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR)** in Geneva, showcasing its commitment to the protection and promotion of human rights.

- The **Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)**, launched in September 2023 by key G20 members including India, the United States, and Brazil, is poised to take a significant step forward in its institutional development. The Indian government is preparing to sign a headquarters agreement with the alliance, marking a crucial milestone in the organization's evolution and India's role in global sustainable energy initiatives.
- The theme of the **India Mobile Congress 2024**, 'The Future is Now', was unveiled on July 19 by **Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia**, Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region on July 18. The theme signifies how India stands at the heart of the technological evolution and **IMC 2024** bringing together global leaders, **visionaries**, **pioneers**, and innovators to collaborate and actively shape the technologies transforming our world today, where the future isn't just a concept, it's happening.
- The **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)** organised an event on **18th July 2024**, named "**Utkrishtata ki Ore Badhte Kadam**". Celebrating Achievements, Inspiring Excellence to felicitate best performers under **PM Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) Yojana** and **Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana – National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM)**.
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- The Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC), a **Mini-Ratna PSU** under the Ministry of Railways, has achieved a notable milestone by advancing to the **Scheduled 'A' category** of Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs). This upgrade from '**Schedule B**' was announced by the Ministry of Railways in an office memorandum dated July 19, 2024.
- **Three training institutes of DoT**– National Telecommunications Institute for Policy Research, Innovation and Training (**NTIPRIT**), the National Institute of Communication Finance (**NICF**) and Wireless Monitoring Training & Development Centre (**WMTDC**) have been merged into a single administrative entity, named '**National Communications Academy**' (**NCA**) with immediate effect. The Minister of Communications (MoC) approved the merger of these entities on the recommendation of the **Committee for Organisational Reforms**.
- **India's National Flag Day** commemorates the **adoption of the Indian national flag** on July 22, 1947, by the Constituent Assembly, just days before the country attained Independence from British rule on August 15, 1947.
- The **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)** at NITI Aayog and the **World Intellectual Property Organisation (WIPO)** on July 22, joined hands towards building **joint innovation programmes in the Global South**.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced India's contribution of **one million dollars** to the **UNESCO World Heritage Centre** to support heritage conservation globally, particularly in the Global South.
- The Department of School Education and Literacy is observing **Shiksha Saptah from July 22 to July 28, 2024**, to celebrate the fourth anniversary of the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**.
- The Indian Railways has been allocated a record **capital expenditure (Capex) of Rs 2,62,200 crore** for the fiscal year 2024-25, maintaining the same level as announced in the **Interim Budget 2024**.
- In the Regular Union Budget for FY 2024-25, the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** has received an allocation of **Rs 6,21,940.85 crore (approximately US \$75 billion)**, marking the highest allocation among all ministries.
- **Forest Survey of India (FSI)**, Dehradun, an organization under the Ministry carries out the assessment of forest cover biennially.
- **Shri H.D. Kumaraswamy**, Union Minister of Steel and Heavy Industries, launched **SIMS 2.0**, the upgraded Steel Import Monitoring System.
- **President Droupadi Murmu** has renamed two important halls in **Rashtrapati Bhavan**, formerly known as '**Durbar Hall**' and '**Ashok Hall**', to '**Ganatantra Mandap**' and '**Ashok Mandap**' respectively.
- **India's installed nuclear power capacity** is set to increase from 8,180 MW to 22,480 MW by 2031-32, according to Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh.
- **Mankind Pharma** has entered into a definitive agreement to acquire a 100 per cent stake in **Bharat Serums and Vaccines (BSV)** from Advent International.
- **India** has taken over the Chair of the Asian Disaster Preparedness Centre (ADPC) for the year 2024-25, succeeding China.
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi will chair the 9th Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog on July 27, 2024, at the **Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre, New Delhi**.
- The Government has approved setting up of 7 (Seven) PM Mega Integrated Textile Region. Apparel (**PM MITRA Parks**) in Greenfield/Brownfield sites (including a Greenfield project in Virudhanagar Tamil Nadu) with world class infrastructure including plug and play facility with an outlay of Rs. 4,445 cr for a period of seven years upto 2027-28.

- To fulfill Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi's vision of disaster resilient India, Ministry of Home Affairs under the guidance of Home Minister, Shri Amit Shah has taken several initiatives to ensure effective management of disasters in the country.
- The capital city of India is poised to unveil a groundbreaking addition to its rich tapestry of historical attractions. On July 29, 2024, the country's **first sunken museum** at the Humayun's Tomb complex, a **UNESCO World Heritage Site**, will be inaugurated in Delhi.
- External Affairs Minister **S. Jaishankar** unveiled a bust of Mahatma Gandhi in Tokyo's Edogawa ward, highlighting Gandhi's global legacy and timeless message of **peace and non-violence**.
- July 27, 2024, marks the 9th death anniversary of **Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam**, a visionary scientist, educator, and the 11th President of India. Renowned as the **"Missile Man of India,"** Dr. Kalam made monumental contributions to aerospace engineering and defense technology, particularly through the Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme.
- **Nita Ambani**, IOC member and founder of the Reliance Foundation, inaugurated the India House during the Paris 2024 Olympics on July 27.
- During his three days visit to Laos, the External Affairs Minister **S Jaishankar** unveiled a special commemorative stamp set showcasing **Ram Lalla's idol from Ayodhya**.
- **The Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)** celebrated its **18th Foundation Day** at its Prithvi Bhavan Headquarters today on July 27, marking nearly two decades of significant contributions to Earth system sciences.
- The Ministry of Education celebrated the 4th anniversary of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 at the **Akhil Bhartiya Shiksha Samagam (ABSS) 2024**, held at the Manekshaw Centre Auditorium in New Delhi.
- The inaugural ceremony of **'One DAE One Subscription' (ODOS)** took place on July 29, at Tata Memorial Hospital, in Mumbai.
- Union Minister for Environment, Forest, and Climate Change, Shri **Bhupender Yadav**, launched the **Ideas4LiFE** portal at the Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi.
- A total of **628 tigers** died in India during the past five years due to natural causes and other reasons, including poaching, according to government data.
- In 2023, India experienced a notable reduction in average tariffs while increasing the use of **non-tariff measures**. According to the **WTO report**, India's average tariffs **decreased to 17% from 18.1% in 2022**.
- As many as 3,49,633 farmers benefited to the tune of ₹563 crore for the financial year 2022-23 under the **Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)**.
- In a groundbreaking initiative, **Periyar Tiger Reserve (PTR) in Thekkady** has installed a wind turbine to power real-time monitoring cameras and Wi-Fi connectivity within its expansive forest.

- **The Ex-Servicemen Contributory Health Scheme (ECHS)** has introduced the Electronic Services e-Health Assistance and Tele-consultation (E-SeHAT) module as of July 30, 2024.
- 16-year-old **Jiya Rai** from Mumbai has set a new world record as the youngest and fastest para-swimmer to cross the English Channel.

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- **"VIRAASAT"**, a fortnight long exhibition dedicated to celebrating **10th National Handloom Day** began at **Handloom Haat in Janpath** on 3rd August, 2024.
- **President Droupadi Murmu** embarked on a **six-day visit** to Fiji, New Zealand, and Timor-Leste, marking significant diplomatic engagements.
- The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) has launched the **e-Sankhyiki portal on June 29**, marking a significant advancement in data management and dissemination in India.
- Indian President **Droupadi Murmu** embarked on a significant two-day state visit to Fiji, marking a milestone in the diplomatic relations between the two nations.
- On the fifth anniversary of the abrogation of **Articles 370 and 35(A)**, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** highlighted the decision as a pivotal moment in Indian history, marking the beginning of a new era of progress and prosperity for **Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) and Ladakh**.
- The Government of India has successfully completed and operationalized **four major projects** under the **Namami Gange Mission 2.0** in the first quarter of **fiscal year 2024-25**.
- The government has reversed its controversial decision to remove indexation benefits for long-term capital gains (**LTCG**) **tax on property sales**.
- **Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya (GSV)** has started its **first executive training program** for the aviation sector at the **Asian Institute of Transport Development (AITD)** at Dwaraka, **New Delhi**.
- The Government of **India and the World Bank** have joined forces to construct the **Green National Highway Corridor Project (GNHCP)**.
- The **National Commission for Women (NCW)** has inaugurated the **Digital Shakti Center in New Delhi** to address the rising cybercrimes against women.
- Prime Minister Narendra **Modi-led government** is all set to table the **Waqf (Amendment) Bill, 2024**, in the **Lok Sabha** on August 8. The new bill that proposes **to amend the Waqf Act, 1995** will be introduced in the Lok Sabha by **Minority Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju**.
- India's renewable energy capacity has surged by 165% over the past decade, increasing from **76.38 GW in 2014 to 203.1 GW in 2024**, according to **Union Minister Pralhad Joshi**.

- The **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting** has prepared the draft Broadcasting Services (Regulation) Bill, 2024 which will replace the **Television Network Act of 1995**.
- The nation prepares to celebrate its **78th Independence Day**. This day marks the **historic moment in 1947** when India achieved freedom from **British colonial rule** after a prolonged struggle.
- The **West Bengal government and UNICEF** have teamed up to encourage fathers to play an active role in **promoting breastfeeding among new mothers**.
- The third edition of the '**Har Ghar Tiranga**' campaign, aimed at fostering patriotism and national pride by encouraging citizens to display the national flag at their homes, will **run from August 9 to August 15**.
- The **Union Ministry of Railways** is set to fast-track the deployment of the latest version of its indigenous anti-collision system, **Kavach 4.0**, with plans to issue tenders for installation in **20,000 locomotives this year**.
- The **Indian Cost Accounts Service (ICoAS)** celebrated its **Foundation Day in New Delhi** with the theme '**ICoAS @ Viksit Bharat**'.
- The **Union Cabinet** on August 9, approved **eight new railway projects** at an **estimated cost of ₹24,657 crore** to provide connectivity, facilitate ease of travelling, minimise logistics cost, reduce oil imports and lower carbon dioxide emissions.
- In response to the volatile situation in Bangladesh, the Indian government has established a committee to monitor the **Indo-Bangladesh border** and ensure the safety of Indian nationals and minority communities in the neighboring country.
- **Kasturi Cotton Bharat** programme of Ministry of Textiles is a pioneering effort in traceability, certification and branding of Indian cotton. The details of **Kasturi Cotton Bharat program** and implementation of block chain technology for traceability.
- **BIMSTEC members** should re-examine the priorities of member nations with regards to trade negotiations so that the delayed Free Trade Agreement can be finalized.
- **Punjab, Telangana, Kerala, and West Bengal** have yet to implement the **Right to Education (RTE) Act, 2009**. Union Minister of State for Education, Jayant Chowdhary, disclosed this in the Rajya Sabha.
- The Society for Applied Microwave Electronics Engineering & Research (SAMEER), an R&D institute under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), has signed a **Transfer of Technology (ToT)** agreement with **Toshniwal Hyvac Pvt. Ltd.** and **Sir Automation Industries**.
- **Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal** has announced the restoration of the Diamond Imprest Licence, a move aimed at revitalizing **India's gems and jewellery sector**.
- Indian Railways and the National Capital Region Transport Corporation (**NCRTC**) have partnered to promote the '**One India-One Ticket**' initiative, aiming to streamline travel for passengers using both **mainline railway services and Namo Bharat trains**.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** on 15th August, stressed on the **need to bring a 'Secular Civil Code'** instead of using the term '**Universal Civil Code**', hinting at the government's intention to broad-base the policy and avoid friction on the contentious issue, both within the ruling NDA and outside.
- The government is set to launch '**Kisan Ki Baat**', a **monthly radio programme** aimed at bringing scientific knowledge to farmers, Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan announced on August 15.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** will serve as the **chief guest at the inaugural ET World Leaders Forum**, scheduled for August 31 in New Delhi.
- The **Union Government** on August 15, launched the **AI-based National Pest Surveillance System (NPSS)** that will help farmers to connect with agriculture scientists and experts on controlling pests using their phone.
- India has initiated an **anti-dumping investigation** into the **import of hot rolled flat products from Vietnam** following complaints that these products are being sold at significantly low prices, negatively impacting the domestic steel industry.
- The **Lok Sabha speaker** on August 17, named the constituents of the **six new Parliamentary Committees** including the Public Accounts Committee (PAC) which examines government expenditure.
- India has reduced the windfall tax on **petroleum crude oil to Rs 2,100 per metric tonne**, effective August 17, down from **Rs 4,600 per tonne**.
- The **Union Cabinet** has greenlit significant airport infrastructure projects in **West Bengal and Bihar**, with a total investment of **approximately ₹2,962 crore**.
- **Nepal** will export nearly **1,000 MW** of electricity to **India**, External Affairs Minister **S Jaishankar** said after meeting his Nepalese counterpart **Arzu Rana Deuba** in New Delhi on August 19.
- The World Health Organization (WHO) has designated **Mpox as a public health emergency of international concern**, primarily due to its increasing **prevalence in Africa**.
- Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** on August 18, released the centenary commemorative coin of **Dr. Kalaignar M. Karunanidhi** in Chennai.
- To provide end to end support for promotion of handloom sector and welfare of handloom workers, Ministry of Textiles is implementing the **National Handloom Development Programme** and **Raw Material Supply Scheme** across the country.

- India's first Constitution Museum, named **"The Constitution Academy and The Rights & Freedoms Museum,"** is set to be inaugurated by **OP Jindal Global University** on November 26, 2024.
- The **Union Minister of Power and Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs**, Shri Manohar Lal, on August 20, launched Portal for Online monitoring of Projects **Thermal (PROMPT) in New Delhi**.
- The Union Ministry of Power launched three new online platforms—**PROMPT, DRIPS, and JAL VIDYUT DPR**—to enhance efficiency, transparency, and effectiveness in the power sector.
- **India overtook China** as the **world's biggest importer of Russian oil** in July as Chinese refiners bought less because of lower profit margins from producing fuels, a comparison of import data showed.
- The Health Ministry has formed a **14-member National Task Force (NTF)** to address the safety and working conditions of medical professionals in India.
- Information and Broadcasting Minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw** launched **'Create in India Challenge-Season One'** in New Delhi on August 22 in the run-up to the **World Audio Visual and Entertainment Summit**.
- **India's** space efforts received a significant boost with the successful launch of **RHUMI-1**, the world's first mobile hybrid rocket.
- On India's inaugural **National Space Day**, the nation witnessed a significant educational milestone with the release of **'Sapno ki Udaan'**, an innovative e-magazine.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** distributed **certificates to 11 lakh new Lakhpati Didis** in a function organised at **Jalgaon in Maharashtra**.
- The **Ministry of Home Affairs** has decided to create **five new districts in the union territory of Ladakh**, said home minister **Amit Shah** on August 26.
- The **Union Government** has introduced **new 2024 guidelines** aimed at improving the handling of public grievances, focusing on citizen empowerment and streamlining the redressal process.
- Union **Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman** inaugurated the new **GST Bhawan in Udaipur**, located in the **Hiran Magri area**.
- The **National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)**, India has announced the results of its **online human rights photography competition – 2024** organized in collaboration with **MyGov**.
- **Teghbir Singh**, a five-year-old boy from Ropar, Punjab, has etched his name in the annals of mountaineering history. Teghbir has become the **youngest Asian** to successfully scale **Mount Kilimanjaro**, Africa's highest peak, standing at an impressive **5,895 meters** above sea level.
- **Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi** earlier on August 28, chaired the meeting of the **44th edition of PRAGATI**, the

ICT-based multi-modal platform for Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation, involving Centre and State governments.

- **Defence Minister Rajnath Singh** is set to commission **India's second nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN)**, INS Arighat (S-3), at a quiet event in Visakhapatnam, marking a significant boost to India's nuclear deterrence and second-strike capability. This submarine, armed with **750-km range K-15 nuclear ballistic missiles**, will patrol the Indo-Pacific under India's strategic command.
- **Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant** awarded **Indian citizenship to Joseph Francis Pereira**, a 78-year-old Pakistani Christian, under the **Citizenship (Amendment) Act (CAA)**. This marks the first instance of a Goan receiving citizenship through this amendment.
- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has given the green light to 12 new project proposals under the **National Industrial Corridor Development Programme (NICDP)**.
- **On National Sports Day in New Delhi**, Union Minister of Youth Affairs and Sports, **Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya**, launched the **"Retired Sportsperson Empowerment Training" (RESET) Programme**.
- August 30, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** will visit **Maharashtra to lay the foundation stone** of the **Vadhvan Port project** and address the **Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2024** in Mumbai.
- The **Indian Army** has launched the **first phase of Project NAMAN**, aimed at providing dedicated support and services to **Defence pensioners, veterans, and their families**.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** will flag off three new **Vande Bharat trains** around 12:30 pm on August 31. "These new Vande Bharat trains shall provide the people of the region the **world-class** means to travel with speed and comfort and will cater to **three states – Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, and Karnataka.**"

National Current Affairs of September 2024

- **India Post Payments Bank (IPPB)**, a key player in driving financial inclusion across India, proudly marked its **7th Foundation Day on September 2, 2024**. Since its nationwide launch in 2018 by Prime Minister **Shri Narendra Modi**, the IPPB has been instrumental in transforming India's financial landscape by providing accessible, affordable, and trusted digital banking services to underserved and unbanked families at their doorstep.
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi addressed the **Economic Times World Leaders Forum in New Delhi**, where he highlighted India's economic growth, governance, and global ambitions.

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi unveiled a commemorative postage stamp celebrating **75 years of the Supreme Court of India** during the inaugural session of the **District Judges Conference at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi**. The event was attended by **Supreme Court Chief Justice Dr. D.Y. Chandrachud, Minister of Law & Justice Arjun Ram Meghwal**, and other dignitaries.
- The **7th Rashtriya Poshan Maah** was launched today at **Mahatma Mandir, Gandhinagar, Gujarat**, marking a significant step towards enhancing nutrition awareness and well-being across the nation. The event featured prominent figures such as **Union Minister Smt. Annpurna Devi, Chief Minister of Gujarat Shri Bhupendrabhai Patel**, and **Gujarat's Minister of Women and Child Development Smt. Bhanuben Babariya**, alongside senior officials from both the Government of India and the State Government of Gujarat.
- In a significant event marking the evolution of India's judiciary, **President Droupadi Murmu** unveiled the **new flag and insignia of the Supreme Court of India during the two-day National Conference of District Judiciary held in New Delhi**. The ceremony, attended by members of the judiciary from across the nation, symbolized the rich cultural and legal heritage of India, encapsulated in the newly designed symbols of the highest court.
- In a historic move that underscores India's commitment to becoming a global hub for semiconductor manufacturing, the **Union Cabinet**, chaired by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**, approved the proposal of **Kaynes Semicon Pvt Ltd** to establish a semiconductor manufacturing unit in Sanand, Gujarat. The meeting, held in New Delhi on 2 September 2024, marks a significant milestone in India's Semiconductor Mission, which was launched in 2022 to boost the country's semiconductor capabilities.
- Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has given its approval to seven comprehensive schemes. These initiatives, with a total outlay of **Rs 14,235.30 Crore**, aim to revolutionize various aspects of agriculture in India.
- Under the **National One Health Mission (NOHM)**, a comprehensive mock drill named "**Vishanu Yuddh Abhyas**" (**Virus War Exercise**) was held in **Ajmer district, Rajasthan**, from August 27 to August 31, 2024. This exercise aimed to assess the pandemic preparedness of the **National Joint Outbreak Response Team (NJORT)**, which includes experts from human health, animal husbandry, and wildlife sectors. The drill simulated a zoonotic disease outbreak to evaluate the readiness and response of the teams involved.
- **President Droupadi Murmu** has approved the formation of the **23rd Law Commission of India for a three-year term**, effective from 1 September 2024 to 31 August 2027. This commission will consist of a full-time chairperson, four members, and additional ex-officio and part-time members. Its primary mandate is to review and recommend legal reforms to enhance the Indian legal system.
- The **Vishvasya-Blockchain Technology Stack** was launched by the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** to provide **Blockchain-as-a-Service (BaaS)** with a geographically distributed infrastructure. This initiative aims to support permissioned blockchain applications and promote transparent, secure, and trusted digital service delivery in India.
- On September 3, 2024, Prime Minister Narendra Modi embarked on a significant diplomatic journey by arriving in **Bandar Seri Begawan**, the capital of Brunei. This visit marks a historic milestone as it is the first time an Indian Prime Minister has visited Brunei since the establishment of diplomatic ties between the two nations on May 10, 1984. The visit is part of a broader two-nation tour that includes Singapore, spanning from September 3 to 5, 2024.
- The Ministry of **Women and Child Development** has been honored with the **National Award for e-Governance 2024 (Gold)** for its digital initiative, **Poshan Tracker**. This tool, **part of Mission Poshan 2.0**, enables real-time monitoring of children's growth, focusing on those **aged 0-6 years**.
- India is setting ambitious goals to significantly increase its presence in the global alcoholic beverage market, targeting exports worth **US\$ 952.9 million (Rs. 8,000 crore)** in the coming years. As part of the '**Make in India**' initiative, the government, supported by the **Agricultural & Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)**, seeks to elevate India from its current **40th position** in global alcoholic beverage exports. The aim is to achieve **US\$ 1 billion** in export revenue.
- Union Minister of Textiles, **Shri Giriraj Singh**, unveiled the '**VisionXt Fashion Forecasting Initiative**' developed by the **National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT)**. This launch event, which also saw the introduction of a bilingual web portal and the India-specific Fashion Trend Book '**Paridhi 24x25**', marks a pivotal moment in India's fashion and textile sector.
- In celebration of the birth anniversary of **Hockey Legend Major Dhyan Chand** and in alignment with the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports' **National Sports Day 2024**, the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting organized "**Khel Utsav 2024**" from **August 27 to August 30, 2024**. The event took place at **Major Dhyan Chand Stadium and Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, New Delhi**.
- **Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya**, India's Union Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports, announced India's bid for the 2030 Youth Olympics during his speech at the of the **Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) 44th General Assembly** on September 8, 2024. India will compete against Peru, Colombia, Mexico, Thailand, Mongolia, Russia, Ukraine, and Bosnia and Herzegovina for hosting rights. This bid is seen as a precursor to India's ambition to host the 2036 Olympics.

- The Ministry of Steel organized the event called “Greening steel : Pathway to Sustainability” on 10th September in New Delhi. In this event members from different ministries, academia, think tank, field specialists have participated to discuss the agenda of the meeting.
- In a momentous event at **Nirvachan Sadan**, the **Election Commission of India (ECI)** celebrated the achievements of two remarkable Paralympic archers while simultaneously enlisting their support to inspire voters across the nation. **Ms. Sheetal Devi** and **Shri Rakesh Kumar**, fresh from their bronze medal victory in Archery at the **Paris Summer Paralympics 2024**, were honored for their sporting prowess and appointed as **national icons for Persons with Disabilities (PwDs)**.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi commemorated the **132nd anniversary of Swami Vivekananda’s** landmark speech at the **World’s Parliament of Religions in Chicago**, delivered in **1893**. Modi highlighted that Vivekananda’s address introduced India’s timeless message of **unity, peace, and brotherhood** to the global audience. He praised the enduring impact of Vivekananda’s words, noting their continued inspiration across generations.
- In a significant development for India’s ornamental fisheries sector, Union Minister for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying, **Shri Rajiv Ranjan Singh Alias Lalan Singh**, unveiled the “**Rangeen Machhli**” mobile application. The launch event took place at the prestigious **ICAR-Central Institute of Freshwater Aquaculture (ICAR-CIFA)** in **Bhubaneswar**, marking a new era in the dissemination of knowledge and resources for ornamental fish enthusiasts and professionals alike.
- India has been announced as the exclusive partner for the **European Hydrogen Week**, set to take place in November 2024. This announcement was made on the second day of the **International Conference on Green Hydrogen (ICGH-2024)**, held at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**. The partnership underscores India’s commitment to aligning with EU green regulations to enhance its export potential in the green hydrogen sector.
- On September 11, 2024, Prime Minister Narendra Modi virtually inaugurated the **2nd International Conference on Green Hydrogen**, which is being held at **Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi from September 11-13, 2024**. The conference aims to position India as a leader in the global green hydrogen ecosystem by discussing recent technological advances and fostering strategic investments and partnerships to accelerate green hydrogen adoption.
- **Union Minister for Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal**, launched the ‘**Jan Sunwai portal**’, which is an **online platform of the Department of commerce**, designed to streamline communication between **stakeholders and authorities**.
- **Union Home Minister of India Shri. Amit Shah** inaugurated 2 days National Security Strategies Conference 2024 in the capital of India at **New Delhi**. This conference will hold talks on various aspects of security and its challenges.
- **Union Minister Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia**, Hon’ble Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region (DoNER), has officially launched the website for the **Ashtalakshmi Mahotsav**. The launch, held at **Sanchar Bhawan in New Delhi**, highlights the government’s dedication to showcasing Northeast India’s cultural and economic richness on both national and international platforms.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi introduced a newborn calf, ‘Deepjyoti’**, born at his official residence at **Lok Kalyan Marg, New Delhi**. Sharing a video on X, PM Modi revealed that the calf, with a unique light-like mark on its forehead, inspired the name ‘**Deepjyoti**’, which translates to ‘**light of the lamp**’.
- The Honorable Vice President of India Shri. Jagdeep Dhankhar has inaugurated the “**Constitutional Temple – Samvidhan Mandir**” at 433 Industrial Training Institutes across Maharashtra. This programme was organized by the **Maharashtra Skill, Employment, Entrepreneurship, and Innovation Department**.
- The **GST Council** has constituted a **13-member Group of Ministers (GoM)** to review and suggest GST rates on health and life insurance premiums. The report is due by **October 30, 2024**, and **Bihar Deputy CM Samrat Choudhary leads the group**. The decision was made during the **54th GST Council meeting on September 9, 2024**. A final decision will be made in November based on the GoM’s recommendations.
- **Typhoon Yagi** recently struck Southeast Asia, the government of India has launched **Operation Sadbhavana**, a humanitarian initiative aimed at providing crucial assistance to affected countries. This operation exemplifies India’s commitment to its **Act East Policy** and its role as a **first responder** in providing **Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)** to nations in need.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated **India’s first Namoo Bharat Rapid Rail on September 16, 2024**, which will operate between **Ahmedabad and Bhuj**. Known as the Vande Metro, this new train covers a **360-kilometre distance in 5 hours and 45 minutes**, making stops at nine stations along the route.
- **Cambodia’s Angkor Wat** has been recognized as the **most photogenic UNESCO World Heritage site in Asia** by Times Travel, as announced by **Cambodian Prime Minister Hun Manet on September 15**. This accolade was revealed through a post on his official Telegram channel, featuring Times of India’s list of Asia’s top ten most photogenic UNESCO sites.

- The **Union Cabinet** has approved several key proposals with a total outlay **exceeding ₹60,000 crore**, covering areas from agriculture to space exploration. The much-anticipated 'One Nation, One Poll' policy, enabling simultaneous elections across India, also received approval. Additionally, the **PM-AASHA scheme** was revamped with a **₹35,000 crore budget** to ensure Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for farmers. The Cabinet also sanctioned a ₹24,474.53 crore subsidy on phosphatic and potassic (P&K) fertilizers for the 2024-25 rabi season.
- The Union Cabinet has approved the **Biotechnology Research Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development (Bio-RIDE)** scheme to boost biotechnology research, innovation, and entrepreneurship with an outlay of **₹9,197 crore for the 15th Finance Commission period (2021-22 to 2025-26)**.
- The **Central government** has allocated **Rs 12,554 crore** to various states this year for relief and rehabilitation of those affected by natural disasters. This includes funding from multiple disaster relief and mitigation funds.
- The **union cabinet chaired by the Honorable Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi** has approved the **building of the first unit of the Bharatiya Anatriksh Station (BAS)** by extending the scope of Gaganyaan program.
- The **Indian government** has mandated that platform aggregators onboard themselves and their **gig workers onto the e-Shram portal**, an initiative aimed at providing unorganised labour with access to various social security schemes. This step is crucial to ensure workers' access to social welfare benefits and to maintain an accurate registry of beneficiaries.
- **President Droupadi Murmu** attended the Safai Mitra Sammelan in Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh. The Safai Mitra Sammelan was organized as part of the **fortnightly Swachhata Hi Seva—2024 campaign** launched by the government of India.
- **Union Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports and Labour & Employment, Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya** inaugurated the **Second Edition of the Inclusion Conclave** organized by **National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA)**, India in New Delhi. **Union Minister of State for Youth Affairs & Sports, Ms. Raksha Nikhil Khadse** was also present on the occasion.
- The Union Cabinet approved the establishment of the **National Centre of Excellence (NCoE)** for Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, Comics, and Extended Reality (AVGC-XR) on September 18, 2024. Designed to mirror the IITs and IIMs, this initiative aims to bolster India's position as a global content hub, enhancing the country's soft power and attracting foreign investments in the media and entertainment sector. The centre will be located in Mumbai as a Section 8 Company under the Companies Act, 2013.
- The **nuclear power reactor that achieved criticality** is the first of a new series of Pressurised Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs) to be built at **Rajasthan Atomic Power Project in Rawatbhata**.
- The **Union Ministry for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Bhupendra Yadav**, led the country in this year's **Clean the Beach Campaign** on the occasion of the **International Coastal Clean-up Day on 21 September 2024**. The minister participated in an event to clean the beach at Juhu in Mumbai.
- **Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal** inaugurated **Invest India's new office in Singapore**. The office will serve as a **dedicated point of contact for companies from the region looking to invest in India**, fostering collaboration across sectors.
- The foundation stone for India's first of its kind **CO₂-to-Methanol pilot plant** with an overall **capacity of 1.4 Tons Per Day (TPD)** was unveiled virtually by **Prof. Abhay Karandikar, Secretary, Department of Science and Technology (DST), Government of India**, at Thermax Limited premises in **Pune, Maharashtra**.
- Under a transformative collaboration with the **United States, India is set to launch its inaugural national security semiconductor fabrication plant**, designed to **produce chips for military applications and critical telecommunications**.
- In a **significant move to safeguard India's critical power infrastructure**, **Union minister Manohar Lal** inaugurated the **Computer Security Incident Response Team Power (CSIRT-Power) at Northern Regional Power Committee in New Delhi**.
- **President Droupadi Murmu** will inaugurate the **16th Assembly of the Asian Organization of Supreme Audit Institutions (ASOSAI)** on September 24, 2024, in New Delhi. This significant event marks the beginning of crucial discussions centered on the evolving role of Supreme Audit Institutions (SAIs) in promoting transparency and accountability.
- **Central Silk Board (CSB)** marked a significant milestone with the celebration of its **Platinum Jubilee** in Mysuru. The event, commemorating 75 years of dedicated service to India's silk industry, was graced by numerous dignitaries and witnessed several important launches and releases.
- **Union Minister of Textiles, Shri Giriraj Singh**, alongside Union Minister of State for External Affairs & Textiles, Pabitra Margherita, launched the India-specific fashion trend book **"Paridhi 24x25,"** a bilingual web portal of VisionXt, and an AI Taxonomy e-book.
- The **7th Rashtriya Poshan Maah**, celebrated across India in 2024, marks a significant milestone in the country's ongoing battle against malnutrition. This monthlong campaign, an integral part of India's mission to eradicate nutritional deficiencies, has brought renewed energy and focus to the national discourse on health and nutrition.

- **Vice-President Jagdeep Dhankhar** stressed the importance of producing substantial results in research and development (R&D), underscoring that **contributions must go beyond mere cosmetic efforts**. Addressing the **83rd CSIR Foundation Day** celebrations in New Delhi.
- **Minister of Communications, Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia** visited **Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT) Bengaluru Campus** and inaugurated the **5G O-RAN (Open Radio Access Network) Testing lab**.
- India has been elected to the fifteen-member steering committee of the Global Operational Network of **Anti-Corruption Law Enforcement Authorities (Globe Network)** during a plenary session in Beijing, as announced by the **Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)** on September 26, 2024. This election follows a multi-stage voting process and underscores India's commitment to addressing international corruption and financial crime.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi virtually launched **three PARAM Rudra supercomputers** on September 26, 2024, emphasizing the importance of technological advancements for empowering the underprivileged. Developed indigenously under the National Supercomputing Mission (NSM) at a **cost of ₹130 crore each**, these high-performance computing systems are strategically deployed in Pune, Delhi, and Kolkata. With a total investment of ₹850 crore in the project, these supercomputers aim to facilitate pioneering scientific research across various disciplines.
- As the Assembly election approaches, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi, on September 29, 2024**, virtually inaugurated and laid the foundation stone for various projects worth **₹11,200 crore** in Maharashtra. This event comes after his scheduled visit to Pune on September 26 was cancelled due to heavy rain in the city.
- India has officially signed the **Biodiversity Beyond National Jurisdiction (BBNJ)** Agreement, known as the **High Seas Treaty**, which aims to promote the conservation of marine genetic resources and ensure the fair and equitable sharing of benefits. **External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar** highlighted the significance of the treaty in a post on X, stating that it represents a crucial step towards maintaining the health and resilience of oceans.
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- **BharatGen was inaugurated in New Delhi**, marking a significant step in India's commitment to generative AI. The initiative aims to enhance public service delivery and citizen engagement by developing foundational models in language, speech, and computer vision. **Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State for various portfolios**, emphasized BharatGen's role in positioning India as a global leader in generative AI, similar to the transformative impact of UPI.
- Marking the completion of **10 years** of the launch of one of the most significant mass movements for cleanliness - the **Swachh Bharat Mission**, the Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi today participated in Swachh Bharat Diwas 2024 program on the occasion of **155th Gandhi Jayanti on 2nd October in Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi**. Shri Modi launched and laid the foundation stone for several sanitation and cleanliness projects worth over Rs 9600 crore including projects under AMRUT and AMRUT 2.0, National Mission for Clean Ganga and GOBARdhan Scheme. The theme for Swachhata Hi Seva 2024 is **'Swabhav Swachhata, Sanskaar Swachhata'**.
- In a significant diplomatic gesture, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** announced on Tuesday that the road in front of the **Jamaica High Commission** in New Delhi has been officially named **'Jamaica Marg'**. This announcement came during a joint press conference with **Jamaican Prime Minister Andrew Holness**, highlighting the deepening ties between the two nations.
- In a significant move, the **Union Cabinet approved** the conferral of classical language status to **Marathi, Bengali, Assamese, Pali, and Prakrit on October 3, 2024**. This decision, following long-pending demands, highlights India's rich linguistic heritage and aims to preserve and promote these ancient languages.
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved a **₹2,028.57 crore Productivity Linked Bonus (PLB)** for **11.72 lakh railway employees**, recognizing their exceptional performance in the 2023-24 financial year. Each eligible employee will receive a **maximum bonus of ₹17,951**, typically disbursed ahead of the Durga Puja and Dussehra holidays. This initiative aims to motivate staff across various categories, including track maintainers, loco pilots, and station masters, by incentivizing continuous improvements in operational efficiency and service delivery.

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- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated GAIL (India) Limited's Compressed Bio Gas (CBG) plant in Ranchi, Jharkhand, via virtual mode during a ceremony at **Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi**, marking **Swachh Bharat Diwas 2024**. This facility, with a feedstock processing capacity of 150 Tonnes Per Day (TPD) and a production capacity of 5 Tonnes Per Day (TPD), represents an investment of ₹26 crore and aims to convert the organic fraction of Municipal Solid Waste (MSW) into renewable energy.
- **Honorable Prime Minister Narendra Modi** virtually inaugurated the '**Lal Tipara Gaushala**' with **Bio-CNG plant** in Gwalior and launched various development projects of Rs 685 crore in Madhya Pradesh on the occasion of Swachhta Diwas. Swachhta Diwas is observed on the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti (October 2) every year.
- The government has established **13,822 Jan Aushadhi Kendras** across the country under the Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana (PMBJP) till 30th September of 2024. These Kendras have also **achieved record sales of 200 Crore rupees** in the last month, which is the highest monthly sales in the history of the PMBJP.
- In a major step towards sustainability, Union Minister of State for Coal and Mines, **Shri Satish Chandra Dubey** remotely inaugurated 51 rooftop solar power plants of **Bharat Coking Coal Limited (BCCL)** under **Special Campaign 4.0 from Ranchi**. These solar plants, with a cumulative capacity of 2.428 MW, highlight BCCL's focus on reducing carbon emissions while utilizing unused building spaces.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **Banjara Virasat Museum in Pohardevi, Washim, Maharashtra**, celebrating the rich cultural heritage of the Banjara community. The museum, a four-story structure, houses 13 galleries showcasing the legacy of the Banjara community and its leaders. Modi also paid floral tributes to Sant Sevalal Maharaj and Sant Ramrao Maharaj, spiritual icons of the community, and performed rituals at the Jagdamba Temple. He is set to launch agricultural and animal husbandry **initiatives worth ₹23,300 crore**.
- India has recently signed a **Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT)** with the **United Arab Emirates (UAE)** aimed at enhancing investor confidence and fostering stronger economic ties. One of the key changes in this agreement is the reduction of the arbitration period for foreign investors from five years to three years. This new provision allows investors to seek international arbitration if disputes are unresolved by the Indian judicial system within the stipulated timeframe. The BIT, effective from August 31, 2024, also extends protections to shares and bonds, broadening the scope of investments covered compared to the previous agreement.
- In a significant move to preserve and showcase India's rich maritime heritage, the Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the development of the **National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC)** at **Lothal, Gujarat**. The project will unfold in two phases, and it aligns with the government's broader vision to highlight the country's ancient maritime prowess, which dates back over 4,500 years.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **Indian Institute of Skills (IIS) in Mumbai**, aiming to enhance youth employability and create an industry-ready workforce for **Industry 4.0**. The **IIS, built on a 4-acre campus** at the **National Skill Training Institute**, focuses on cutting-edge technologies like factory automation, AI, data analytics, and additive manufacturing.
- The government, led by Labour and Employment Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, has announced the establishment of **10 new ESIC medical colleges** and the extension of the unemployment allowance scheme under the **Atal Beemit Vyakti Kalyan Yojna until June 2026**. These decisions align with the **Prime Minister's Independence Day (2024)** promise to add 75,000 medical seats in the next five years.
- **India's textiles sector** is set for significant expansion, with an **11% year-on-year** growth in Ready-Made Garments (RMG) of all Textiles exports, as per India's trade data of August 2024, signaling a bright future. The Textiles sector in the country is expected to grow to **USD 350 billion by 2030**, driven by India's inherent strengths and a strong policy framework that encourages investment and exports.
- India has officially launched its '**Study in India**' campaign at the **20th International Education Show in Sharjah**, aiming to attract international students to its universities. The initiative, organized by EdCIL under the Ministry of Education, is a significant step in positioning India as a global education hub. The India Pavilion was inaugurated by **Ahmed Mohamed Obaid Al Naboodah** from the Sharjah Chamber of Commerce and Industry and Yatin Patil, Deputy Consul General of India in Dubai.
- **The Central Government** has officially **revoked President's Rule** in Jammu and Kashmir, paving the way for the appointment of a new Chief Minister. In a notification issued by President Droupadi Murmu, the revocation was enacted under the powers granted by the **Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019**, and relevant constitutional provisions.
- India has surged to **become the second-biggest supplier of restricted critical technologies** to Russia, US and European officials said, highlighting the challenge in efforts to choke off exports fueling President Vladimir Putin's war machine.

- India has become the **second-largest supplier of restricted technologies, such as microchips, circuits, and machine tools, to Russia, following China.**
- The **Supreme Court of India's Lady Justice statue** has undergone a significant transformation under **Chief Justice DY Chandrachud's** guidance, symbolizing a shift in judicial philosophy. Unlike the traditional portrayal with a blindfold, the new statue has open eyes, representing an Indian judiciary that is aware, conscious, and empathetic, rather than blindly impartial. The sword, a longstanding symbol of authority and punishment, has been replaced by the Indian Constitution, underscoring that justice in India is rooted in constitutional values rather than retribution. However, the scales are retained, maintaining the emphasis on fairness and balanced judgment, reflecting the judiciary's commitment to weigh all perspectives in each decision.
- In a significant ruling, the **Supreme Court on October 17** upheld the constitutional validity of **Section 6A of the Citizenship Act, 1955**, with a 4-1 majority, affirming the Assam Accord. The bench, led by **Chief Justice DY Chandrachud**, deemed the provision constitutional, recognizing its role in addressing illegal immigration from Bangladesh into Assam.
- Assam Accord and Section 6A: **Section 6A, introduced in 1985** following the Assam Accord, grants citizenship to those who entered Assam before January 1, 1966, and allows others who arrived by March 24, 1971, to register after a 10-year waiting period. Those who entered after this cut-off are subject to detection and deportation.
- In a significant policy shift, the Indian Railways has announced a reduction in the **Advance Reservation Period (ARP)** for long-distance train bookings from **120 days to 60 days**, effective November 1, 2024. This decision aims to enhance passenger convenience by reducing the blocking of funds for ticket bookings made months in advance, especially during peak travel seasons like festivals.
- In a significant move to tackle the rising tide of online scams and cyber frauds, the Secretary of Information and Broadcasting, Sh. Sanjay Jaju, delivered the keynote address at the launch of the **"Scam se Bacho" campaign in New Delhi**. This initiative, **developed by Meta in collaboration with key government ministries.**
- On Saturday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the **'Karmayogi Saptah' National Learning Week (NLW)** aimed at enhancing the individual and organizational capacity of civil servants. This initiative, **part of the broader 'Mission Karmayogi' launched in September 2020**, seeks to foster a future-ready civil service that embodies Indian values while maintaining a global outlook.

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- **New Delhi is considering inviting Indonesia's newly elected President, Prabowo Subianto**, as the chief guest for Republic Day 2025, highlighting the strengthening ties between India and Indonesia. The potential invitation reflects plans for high-level discussions, enhanced defense cooperation, and the possible participation of the Indonesian military in the Republic Day parade.
- India has unveiled its **updated National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (NBSAP) at the 16th UN Biodiversity Conference in Colombia**, committing to protect 30% of its terrestrial, inland water, and coastal marine areas by 2030. This goal aligns with the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework, which aims for global protection of 30% of land and ocean areas.
- **India inaugurated its new consulate in Brisbane on November 4, 2024**, with External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar leading the ceremony. The opening marks a significant step in enhancing India-Australia relations, which have been strengthened by initiatives like a trade agreement that has opened new opportunities for both nations.
- **The Union Cabinet has approved a ₹10,700 crore equity infusion for the Food Corporation of India (FCI) to reduce its debt dependency and lower the government's subsidy burden.** FCI plays a crucial role in India's food security, handling 70% of food subsidies, procuring grains at Minimum Support Price (MSP), and distributing food to 800 million beneficiaries under the National Food Security Act (NFSA) of 2013.
- **Honorable President Droupadi Murmu** embarked on her first visit to Indian Navy ships at sea aboard the **indigenous aircraft carrier INS Vikrant** on 7th November.
- November 8, Bengaluru marked a milestone with the inauguration of its first digital **population clock** at the **Institute for Social and Economic Change (ISEC)**. This innovative installation will display real-time population estimates for both Karnataka and the entire country, providing citizens, researchers, and policymakers with up-to-date demographic data.
- In response to the Supreme Court's criticism of the "toothless" penalties under the **Environment Protection Act (EPA) of 1986**, the Union Ministry of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change has doubled the fines on stubble burning.
- The Government of India, through the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), has issued a call for proposals (CfP) for setting up **Centers of Excellence (CoE)** under the Research and Development (R&D) Scheme of the National Green Hydrogen Mission. Announced on 4th November 2024.

- **ATMOS 2024**, a three-day technical fest at BITS Pilani's Hyderabad campus, runs from November 8 to 10, featuring a range of innovative activities and competitions like Robot Wars, Drone Racing, and Hackathons. The event offers students an engaging platform to showcase their technical skills and creativity.
- Union Minister Shri JP Nadda launched the **"Scheme for Strengthening the Medical Device Industry"** with a budget of Rs. 500 crore, focusing on making India self-sufficient in medical devices. The scheme supports manufacturing, skill development, clinical studies, infrastructure, and industry promotion, aiming to boost the sector's growth and self-reliance.
- Nirmala Sitharaman, India's Finance Minister, launched the **National MSME Cluster Outreach Programme in Bengaluru**, in collaboration with the Department of Financial Services and SIDBI. The event, attended by key officials, connected around 150 MSME clusters virtually, focusing on improving access to financial services and fostering MSME growth across the country.
- The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) has announced the signing of an agreement to establish the **BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation) Energy Centre in Bengaluru**, Karnataka. The agreement, formalized by MEA Secretary Jaideep Mazumder and BIMSTEC Secretary General Indramani Pandey, aims to enhance energy cooperation among BIMSTEC member states.
- The **Kartarpur Sahib Corridor**, connecting India and Pakistan, marks its fifth anniversary on November 9, 2024. Inaugurated by Prime Minister Modi in 2019, it allows Indian pilgrims to visit the Gurdwara Sri Kartarpur Sahib, where **Guru Nanak Dev Ji** spent his final years. The corridor is a significant step in religious diplomacy, offering visa-free access to the sacred site.
- **Li Quanhai** was re-elected **president of World Sailing** for a new four-year term at the General Assembly in Singapore on November 9, 2024. He secured 55 votes, defeating Rodion Luka (UKR) and Philippe Rogge (BEL), marking a significant achievement as the only Chinese president of an Olympic International Federation.
- **Chief Justice D.Y. Chandrachud** concluded his tenure as the 50th Chief Justice of India on Sunday, after two years of landmark rulings and reforms. His leadership greatly influenced the Indian judiciary, emphasizing judicial independence, transparency, and accessibility, leaving a lasting legacy.
- **Hindalco Industries Ltd.**, the metals division of the Aditya Birla Group, has been ranked the world's most sustainable aluminium company for the fifth consecutive year in the 2024 S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment. With a score of 87 points, the company improved by 9 points from 2023 and led its closest competitor by 22 points.
- The **5th National EMRS Cultural & Literary Fest and Kala Utsav**, organized by NESTS (National Education Society for Tribal Students), is being held from November 12-15, 2024, in Bhubaneswar, Odisha. The event, hosted by OMTES, celebrates the 150th birth anniversary of Bhagwan Birsa Munda, with the theme "A Tribute to Bhagwan Birsa Munda & Tribal Freedom Fighters," highlighting the rich cultural and historical ties of India's tribal communities.
- The Ministry of Coal launched the **Mine Opening Permission module** on the Single Window Clearance System (SWCS) portal on November 7, 2024, to streamline the approval process for opening coal mines.
- In a historic 4-3 decision on November 8, 2024, the **Supreme Court overturned its 1967 ruling in the Azeez Basha case, which had denied Aligarh Muslim University (AMU) minority institution status.** This landmark judgment allows AMU's minority status to be reassessed in light of its historical, administrative, and founding context, under the protection of Article 30 of the Indian Constitution.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi is set to undertake a **crucial three-nation tour** from November 16-21, which will include attending the **G20 Summit in Brazil**, visiting Nigeria, and concluding with a state visit to Guyana.
- The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has approved the creation of the Central Industrial Security Force's (CISF) **first-ever all-women battalion**, announced on 12th November, 2024.
- The government approved 12 research projects worth ₹13.3 crore on 12th November, under the **National Technical Textiles Mission.**
- **President Droupadi Murmu** inaugurated the Swami Vivekananda Vidya Mandir school at Zanda Chowk in Silvassa on 13th November.
- The **43rd India International Trade Fair (IITF)** is back at **Pragati Maidan, Delhi, from November 14 to 27**, showcasing India's commitment to **"Vocal for Local, Local to Global"** with products from across the country and the world.
- On November 13, the **Supreme Court of India** issued guidelines **to prevent the demolition of people's homes and private properties by the government solely based on accusations of a crime.**
- The **18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD)** Convention will be held from January 8 to January 10, 2025, in Bhubaneswar, Odisha. The official website for the 18th PBD Convention was launched.
- PM Modi will inaugurate and lay the foundation stone for multiple development projects worth over Rs 6,640 crore in Jamui on the occasion of **Janjatiya Gaurav Divas (Tribal Pride Day).**

- **The National Mission for Clean Ganga (NMCG)** is leading efforts under the Clean Ganga Mission to preserve the river's biodiversity, including endangered species like the Ganga Dolphin. A key initiative is the launch of a Dolphin Ambulance to rescue injured dolphins, helping restore the ecological balance of the Ganga and protect its flora and fauna.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the **first-ever Bodoland Mohotsov** on **15th November at 6:30 PM** at the **SAI Indira Gandhi Sports Complex in New Delhi**.
- At the inauguration of **Symbiosis International University's first international campus in Dubai Knowledge Park**, External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar and UAE Minister Sheikh Nahyan bin Mubarak Al Nahyan emphasized the event's importance for strengthening education and bilateral ties between India and the UAE.
- The **United States** has returned over **1,400 looted artifacts** worth **\$10 million** to **India** as part of an ongoing effort to repatriate stolen cultural items from **South and Southeast Asia**. Among the returned items is a **celestial dancer sandstone sculpture**, which had been illegally smuggled from **central India** to **London** and later sold to a patron of the **New York Metropolitan Museum of Art**.
- On **October 29, 2024**, during **Dhanvantari Jayanti** and **Ayurveda Day**, Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated health projects worth **₹12,850 crore** at the **All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA) in New Delhi**. A key highlight was the launch of the **Ayushman Vay Vandana Card**, which offers **free hospital treatment** for **senior citizens aged 70 and above**. The initiative has already enrolled **10 lakh senior citizens**, marking a significant step in enhancing healthcare access for the elderly in India.
- The **Bharat National Cyber Security Exercise (Bharat NCX 2024)** is a major initiative aimed at enhancing India's **cyber defense capabilities**. Organized by the **National Security Council Secretariat (NSCS)** in collaboration with **Rashtriya Raksha University (RRU)**, the 12-day exercise focuses on equipping professionals with advanced skills in **cyber defense, incident response, and strategic decision-making** to address evolving cybersecurity challenges.
- The small village of **Dhudmaras** in **Chhattisgarh's Bastar district** has been selected by the **United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO)** for its **Best Tourism Village Upgrade programme**. This initiative aims to promote **sustainable tourism**, enhance **local tourism infrastructure**, preserve **cultural heritage**, and improve the **quality of life** for residents.
- During his visit to **Nigeria**, Prime Minister Narendra Modi presented **President Bola Ahmed Tinubu** with a **Silofar Pancharit Kalash**, showcasing **Kolhapur's traditional metal craftsmanship**. The **silver kalash** features intricate **engraving**, including **floral motifs, deities, and traditional patterns**, symbolizing India's rich **cultural heritage**. This diplomatic gesture strengthens **India-Nigeria ties** and highlights India's commitment to **cultural exchange with Africa**.
- **Prasar Bharati** launched its own **OTT platform 'Waves'** at the **55th International Film Festival of India (IFFI)**. Offering a mix of **classics and contemporary programming**, the platform provides **family-friendly entertainment** in **over 12 languages** across genres like **infotainment, gaming, education, shopping, and live events**. Available on **Android and iOS**, **Waves** aims to bridge the **digital divide** and advance the **Digital India** vision, particularly for **rural audiences**.
- India has launched its **first AI Data Bank**, aimed at fostering **innovation** and enhancing **national security**. Announced by **Union Minister Jitendra Singh** at the **7th ASSOCHAM AI Leadership Meet 2024**, the initiative provides **researchers, startups, and developers** with access to **high-quality datasets** to create scalable AI solutions. It supports sectors like **healthcare, space exploration, and national security**, positioning AI as a key driver for **economic growth and governance**.
- **Shri C.R. Paatil**, the **Minister of Jal Shakti**, launched the **"Bhu-Neer"** portal during the **India Water Week 2024**. Developed by the **Central Ground Water Authority (CGWA)** and **National Informatics Centre (NIC)**, the portal aims to streamline groundwater regulation in India. It seeks to enhance **transparency, efficiency, and sustainability** in groundwater management, simplifying processes for obtaining groundwater withdrawal permits.
- India's first **Constitution Museum**, inaugurated by **Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla** on **November 23, 2024**, at **O.P. Jindal Global University, Sonapat**, celebrates **75 years** of the Indian Constitution and honors its architects.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated **India's first modern self-sufficient gaushala** in **Laltipara, Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh**. Named **Adarsh Gaushala**, it features a cutting-edge **Compressed Bio-Gas (CBG) plant**, symbolizing a significant step toward **sustainable development** and **green energy**. This initiative aligns with Modi's vision of **"Waste to Wealth"**, showcasing how organic waste can be converted into valuable resources.
- **NITI Aayog** has recommended adding **coking coal** to India's **critical minerals list**, highlighting its significance in **steel production** and **infrastructure development**. This move aligns with global trends, such as the **European Union's** classification of coking coal as a critical material. India's heavy dependence on imports (85% of coking coal) calls for enhanced domestic production. The report, **"Enhancing Domestic Coking Coal Availability to Reduce the Import of Coking Coal,"** advocates for policy changes to utilize India's **16.5 billion tonnes of medium coking coal reserves** and achieve **self-reliance** while meeting **Net Zero** goals by **2070**.

- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** participated in the **Odisha Parba 2024** celebrations held at **Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, New Delhi** from **November 22-24**, organized by the **Odia Samaj**. The event highlighted **Odisha's vibrant cultural, social, and political heritage**. In his address, the Prime Minister celebrated Odisha's **legacy**, historical contributions, and promising future.
- **Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh** inaugurated the **VISION Portal** (Viksit Bharat Initiative for Student Innovation and Outreach Network) on **21 November 2024** in **New Delhi**. Developed by the **Utsav Foundation**, a non-profit organization based in **Gurugram**, the portal aims to uplift **underprivileged youth** through **education, skill development, and sustainable livelihoods**.
- The **Union Cabinet**, led by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved the **One Nation One Subscription (ONOS)** scheme, allocating **₹6,000 crore** for **2025-2027**. The initiative aims to provide **seamless access** to scholarly articles for **1.8 crore students, faculty, and researchers** across **6,300 government-managed institutions**. This aligns with **India's ViksitBharat@2047 vision, NEP 2020, and the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF)**. Access will be managed digitally via the **INFLIBNET platform** under the **UGC**.
- The **Government of India** launched the **National Mission on Natural Farming (NMNF)** with a **₹2,481 crore** allocation, approved by the **Union Cabinet** on **November 25, 2024**. The scheme aims to promote **natural farming** for **1 crore farmers** and cover **750,000 hectares** over two years. It integrates past initiatives like **Bhartiya Prakratik Krishi Paddhati** and **Gobardhan Mission** to promote **Zero Budget Natural Farming (ZBNF)** and locally adapted methods.
- **Union Minister for Education, Shri Dharmendra Pradhan**, launched **The TeacherApp**, a digital platform developed by **Bharti Airtel Foundation** to empower educators. The app offers **260+ hours** of digital content, including **courses, videos, podcasts, and live expert sessions**. It aligns with the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020** to enhance **pedagogical skills, foster creativity, and improve classroom engagement**. Key features include **teaching kits** with **900+ hours** of content and **interactive webinars**.
- **Union Minister Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan** launched the third edition of the **"Nayi Chetna – Pahal Badlaav Ki"** campaign on **November 25, 2024**, to combat gender-based violence in India. Organized by **DAY-NRLM**, the month-long initiative aims to raise awareness, promote community engagement, and strengthen victim support systems across all states and UTs, running until **December 23, 2024**.
- The **Ministry of Tourism** promotes **India's tourism potential** globally, with specific initiatives to boost tourism in **states like Himachal Pradesh**. It utilizes various **platforms and strategies** to enhance India's visibility as a top tourist destination.
- On **26th November 2024**, **President Droupadi Murmu** unveiled the **Sanskrit and Maithili translations** of the **Indian Constitution** in **New Delhi**, marking **Samvidhan Diwas** and the **75th anniversary** of its adoption. The event celebrated India's **linguistic diversity** and reaffirmed the Constitution's importance as the nation's guiding framework.
- The **Indian government** has extended the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)** until **31st March 2028** with a renewed focus under **Atal Innovation Mission 2.0**. Approved by the **Union Cabinet** on **25th November 2024**, the initiative aims to fill gaps in the **innovation ecosystem**, promote **inclusivity**, and improve **entrepreneurial outcomes**, building on its original mission launched in 2016 to foster **innovation and entrepreneurship**.
- **Union Minister Smt. Annapurna Devi** launched the **"Bal Vivah Mukht Bharat"** campaign in **New Delhi**, aiming to **eradicate child marriage** and empower girls. The campaign aligns with **Viksit Bharat** by 2047 and includes the launch of the **Child Marriage Free Bharat Portal**, an online platform for reporting child marriage incidents and enforcing the **Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006**. The initiative supports **education, health, and safety** for girls.
- The **13th National Seed Congress (NSC) 2024**, inaugurated virtually by **Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan** on **November 28**, is being held at the **International Rice Research Institute South Asia Regional Centre (ISARC)** in **Varanasi**. The three-day event brings together over **700 delegates** to discuss **innovation, collaboration, and strategies** to enhance the **Indian and global seed sectors**.
- The **Ministry of Tourism** has approved **40 projects** worth over **Rs 3,295 crore** to promote sustainable tourism and reduce overcrowding at popular sites. These projects, spanning **23 states**, aim to transform lesser-known destinations into iconic tourist spots. The projects were selected from **87 proposals** received under the **Special Assistance to States/Union Territories for Capital Investment (SASCI)** guidelines and will be funded through **long-term interest-free loans**. This initiative focuses on enhancing **tourism infrastructure** and stimulating local economies.
- The **India International Science Festival (IISF) 2024** will be held at **IIT Guwahati** from **November 30 to December 3, 2024**, marking the first time the event is hosted in **North East India**. Organized by the **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** and coordinated by **CSIR-NIIST**, the festival focuses on **science-society engagement and interdisciplinary collaboration**. The theme, **"Transforming India into an S&T driven Global Manufacturing Hub,"** aligns with India's vision to integrate **science, technology, and industrial growth** for global leadership.

- The **Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs** has received **28 proposals** from **23 states** for developing new cities, in line with the **central government's initiative** to address urban expansion. This follows a **commitment made in February 2021** to create eight new cities, with an allocated **Rs 8,000 crore** for their development. Each city will receive **Rs 1,000 crore**, and the proposals are under review by an expert committee to ensure quality and adherence to **15th Finance Commission** guidelines.
- The **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** revealed that **Telangana, Karnataka, and Maharashtra** have reported the highest number of **cybercrime cases** in the past three years, with Telangana leading. Between 2020-2022, Telangana recorded **30,596 cases**, Karnataka **31,433**, and Maharashtra **19,307**. To tackle this, the **Central Government** has introduced a **13-pronged strategy** to strengthen **cybercrime detection**, investigation, and prosecution.
- Indian Railways launched the '**Sanraksha**' mobile app to enhance passenger safety by training and building the capacity of railway staff. After a successful pilot in the **Nagpur division**, the app is being rolled out across 16 divisions and will eventually be implemented nationwide. Key features include **data analytics, AI integration, smart learning, and real-time feedback** to improve **frontline safety staff** performance. Developed by **Dilip Singh**, the app aims to create a more secure environment for travelers.
- India has been **re-elected** to the **United Nations Peacebuilding Commission (PBC)** for the **2025-2026 term**, emphasizing its continued commitment to **global peace and stability**. This re-election highlights India's role as a **founding member** and major **contributor** to UN **peacekeeping** efforts, reaffirming its ongoing engagement with the PBC since its establishment in 2005.
- The **Supreme Court Collegium**, led by **Chief Justice of India (CJI) Sanjiv Khanna**, has proposed the elevation of **Delhi High Court Chief Justice Manmohan** to the Supreme Court. This recommendation comes as the court operates with **32 judges**, two short of its sanctioned strength of **34**, following the retirements of Justices **DY Chandrachud** and **Hima Kohli**. The decision was finalized by a five-member Collegium, including Justices **BR Gavai, Surya Kant, Hrishikesh Roy, and AS Oka**.
- The **Ashtalakshmi Mahotsav 2024** will be held at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**, from **December 6th to 8th**, showcasing the cultural and economic potential of **Northeast India**. Organized by the **Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER)**, the event features over **250 artisans** displaying **handicrafts, handlooms, and GI-tagged products**. Key highlights include the **Eri and Muga Silk Gallery**, and technical sessions on topics like **women's leadership, IT, and healthcare**. The festival's mascot, **Purvi**, represents all eight northeastern states.
- The '**Hamara Samvidhan, Hamara Samman**' campaign, launched on **January 24, 2024**, celebrates **75 years of India as a Republic** and its **Constitution**. Aimed at reaffirming commitment to the Constitution and raising awareness about **legal rights and duties**, the campaign features **regional events** and utilizes the '**Hamara Samvidhan Hamara Samman Portal**' (launched on **July 16, 2024**) as a key resource for **constitutional rights, legal literacy, and fundamental duties**.
- On **October 31, 2024**, **Union Minister Piyush Goyal** inaugurated the "**One District One Product**" (**ODOP**) Wall at the Indian Embassy in **Riyadh, Saudi Arabia**. The initiative showcases local **Indian products** on international platforms, promoting the "**Made in India**" movement. It aims to transform districts into "**Made in India**" hubs, boosting visibility, market reach, and creating **sustainable livelihoods** for **artisans and entrepreneurs** through partnerships with global retail chains.

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- The **New Pamban Bridge**, India's first **vertical lift railway sea bridge**, is replacing the 105-year-old **Pamban Bridge** to improve connectivity between the **Indian mainland** and **Rameswaram, Tamil Nadu**. The **2.05 km bridge**, costing **Rs 535 crore**, features a fully automated vertical lift span for **22 meters of air clearance** for ships. Designed for **double tracks and high-speed trains**, it began construction in **February 2020**, with completion expected by **June 30, 2024**, after delays due to the **pandemic**. The original bridge was decommissioned in **December 2022**.
- The **Ministry of Ayush**, under **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, has transformed into a global leader in traditional medicine since its inception in **2014**. Key achievements include over **755,780 registered practitioners**, **886 undergraduate** and **251 postgraduate colleges**, and **3,844 hospitals** with **36,848 dispensaries**. The Ministry has also expanded infrastructure with **satellite centers** of **AIIA, NIUM, and NIH**, adding **400 education seats** and **550 beds**, aligning with **UN SDGs** and **Universal Health Coverage**.
- **PRAGATI** (Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation), launched under **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, has transformed **India's infrastructure development**. The platform fosters **accountability** and **collaboration** between federal and regional authorities, accelerating delayed projects. A study by **Oxford University** and the **Gates Foundation** highlights its impact, overseeing **\$205 billion** worth of projects.

- India's **tiger population** has grown significantly, reaching **3,682** in 2022, up from **1,411** in 2006, reflecting a **6% annual increase** in monitored areas. This growth is attributed to conservation efforts under **Project Tiger** and the **National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)**. Key regional trends include a rise in **Central India** and **Eastern Ghats** (1,033 to 1,439), **Shivalik-Gangetic Plains** (646 to 819), and **Sundarbans** (88 to 101), while **Northeastern India** saw a decline, particularly in **Arunachal Pradesh** (29 to 9).
- Ratapani Tiger Reserve**, located in Madhya Pradesh, has been officially designated as India's **57th Tiger Reserve**. Spanning **1,271.4 sq km**, it includes a **763.8 sq km core area** and a **507.6 sq km buffer area**. This move strengthens India's commitment to **tiger conservation** and reinforces Madhya Pradesh's status as the "**Tiger State of India**".
- The **National Legal Metrology Portal (eMaap)**, introduced by the **Indian government**, aims to ensure **fair trade** and **consumer protection** by promoting transparency and compliance with metrology standards. The **digital platform** will streamline registration, certification, and provide **automated workflows** for businesses. It also focuses on **consumer awareness** and grievance redressal for measurement issues.
- India has declared **snakebite** a **notifiable disease**, aiming to reduce the high mortality and morbidity rates, particularly in rural and tribal areas. This move, announced by the **Union Health Ministry** in November 2024, mandates **reporting of all snakebite cases** in healthcare facilities. It aligns with the **WHO's target** to halve global snakebite deaths and injuries by 2030, enhancing **surveillance**, treatment, and prevention strategies.
- Shri Pralhad Joshi**, Union Minister, launched **Anna Chakra** and the **SCAN portal** to modernize India's **Public Distribution System (PDS)** and **subsidy claim** mechanisms. **Anna Chakra** aims to optimize the **PDS supply chain** for efficient food grain movement, while **SCAN** streamlines **subsidy claims** under the **National Food Security Act (NFSA)** with **single-window submission**, **automation**, and **rule-based processing** for faster subsidy release.
- The **Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP)** scheme, launched in 2015, has improved the **Sex Ratio at Birth (SRB)** from 918 in 2014-15 to 930 in 2023-24 and raised the **Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER)** for girls at the secondary level from 75.51% to 79.4%. The scheme focuses on eliminating gender-biased practices, promoting **girl child protection**, and **education**. It is centrally funded under the **Mission Shakti Sambal** vertical, with funds allocated based on SRB data. However, **West Bengal** has not implemented the scheme.
- The **Bharatiya Vayuyan Vidheyak, 2024** replaces the 90-year-old **Aircraft Act of 1934**, modernizing India's aviation regulations. Passed by **Parliament**, it aims to enhance **safety**, **affordability**, **governance**, and **consumer protection** while promoting **investment** and **self-reliance** in aircraft manufacturing. The bill also seeks to streamline processes and align with **international standards**. The renaming in **Hindi** reflects the government's goal to promote **indigenous identity** despite sparking debates.
- The **SMILE** sub-scheme, a **central government initiative**, aims to rehabilitate individuals, including **children**, involved in **begging**. Implemented across **81 cities** in **26 states and UTs**, it focuses on areas with significant **religious**, **historical**, or **tourist** importance. The scheme supports **reintegration** of marginalized individuals into society.
- India has been chosen to chair the **68th Session of the UN Commission on Narcotic Drugs (CND)**, marking its first time in this role. **Ambassador Shambhu S Kumaran** assumed the chairmanship, overseeing global drug policy and international cooperation on drug control. The **CND** monitors drug trends, advises member states, and oversees international drug conventions, functioning under **United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC)**, based in Vienna, and is a functional commission of the **UN Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)**.
- The **Supreme Court of India** granted a **permanent commission** to Lt. Col. in the Army, who was unfairly denied the same benefits as her male counterparts. The court highlighted **gender discrimination** and ruled that the officer should have received **age relaxation** like others in similar positions. This ruling aligns with the broader effort to ensure **equal opportunities** for women in the **armed forces**, as seen in a **2024 verdict** directing the government to grant permanent commissions to all female officers.
- The **22nd Divya Kala Mela** was inaugurated by **Union Minister Dr. Virendra Kumar** at **India Gate, New Delhi** from **December 12-22, 2024**. The event celebrates the **talent and entrepreneurial spirit** of **Divyang artisans and entrepreneurs**, aiming to enhance the **visibility and economic independence** of **persons with disabilities (PwDs)**. Organized by **DEPwD** and **NDFDC**, it features over **100 participants** from **20 states and UTs**.
- India has declared **Ratapani Wildlife Sanctuary** in **Madhya Pradesh** as its **57th tiger reserve**, reinforcing its commitment to tiger conservation. This initiative is part of **Project Tiger (1973)**, which aims to protect tigers and their habitats. India now holds over **70%** of the world's wild tiger population.

- The **Supreme Court Collegium**, led by **CJI Sanjiv Khanna**, recommended the appointment of seven **Additional Judges** as **Permanent Judges** for the **Delhi, Karnataka, and Punjab & Haryana High Courts**. The appointments include **Justice Shalinder Kaur** and **Justice Ravinder Dudeja** (Delhi), **Justice Ramachandra Huddar**, **Justice Venkatesh Naik Thavaryanaik**, **Justice Vijaykumar Patil**, and **Justice Rajesh Rai Kallangala** (Karnataka), and **Justice Harpreet Singh Brar** (Punjab & Haryana). This move addresses judicial vacancies in the High Courts.
- The **Ministry of Textiles, Government of India** is hosting the **Viraasat Sari Festival 2024** from **15th to 28th December** at **Handloom Haat, Janpath, New Delhi**. Building on previous success with 20,000 visitors, the festival celebrates India's **handloom heritage** and sari weaving traditions. It aims to unite **weavers, designers, enthusiasts, and buyers**, showcasing the cultural and economic significance of the **handloom sector** and providing artisans a platform to display and sell their creations.
- India's first **diabetes biobank** has been established in **Chennai** through a collaboration between the **ICMR** and the **Madras Diabetes Research Foundation (MDRF)**. The biobank will collect, process, store, and distribute **biological samples** to study **diabetes**, its causes, variations, and related disorders, advancing scientific research and contributing to global **health research**.
- India has achieved a milestone in **decarbonizing the steel sector** with the release of its first-ever **Taxonomy of Green Steel** by **Shri H.D. Kumaraswamy**, Union Minister of **Steel & Heavy Industries**. This historic move positions India as a global leader in **green steel production**, supporting its commitment to achieving **net-zero emissions by 2070** and advancing the transition to a **low-carbon economy**.
- India and Russia are set to introduce a **visa-free travel system** for Indian nationals, expected to begin in **spring 2025**. This move follows **bilateral talks** in June 2024, aiming to ease **visa restrictions** and promote **group tourist exchanges**, strengthening **tourism** and **bilateral relations**.
- Vice President **Jagdeep Dhankhar** inaugurated the **GSI Geoscience Museum** in **Gwalior**, located in the historic **Victoria Market Building**. The museum highlights **Earth's geological wonders** and celebrates the **Geological Survey of India's (GSI)** contributions to exploring India's **geological resources**, blending **tradition** with **modern innovation**.
- Dr. Jitendra Singh unveiled **Kisan Kavach**, India's first **indigenous anti-pesticide bodysuit**, developed by **BRIC-inStem** in collaboration with **Sepio Health Pvt. Ltd.** The suit aims to protect farmers from harmful pesticide exposure, preventing health issues like **breathing disorders, vision loss**, and fatalities. The launch supports **Prime Minister Modi's vision** of empowering India's agricultural community using **science and technology**.
- The **Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS)** upgraded its **Search and Rescue Aid Tool (SARAT)** to **SARAT 2** for enhanced **sea rescue operations**. Launched in 2016, SARAT helps predict the drift of objects and individuals based on **wind, currents, and waves**. The upgraded version includes **advanced features** for more **accurate predictions**, optimizing **search efficiency**.
- India has achieved a milestone in **wildlife conservation** with the **first-ever satellite tagging** of a **Ganges River Dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*) in Assam. This initiative, part of **Project Dolphin**, was a collaboration between the **Wildlife Institute of India (WII)**, **Assam Forest Department**, and **Aaranyak**, funded by the **National CAMPA Authority**. The tagging aims to enhance understanding of the species' **migratory patterns** and **habitat use**.
- The 10th **International Forest Fair** in **Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh**, runs from **December 17 to 23, 2024**. The fair focuses on **sustainable forest practices**, **empowering women** in the forestry sector, and promoting **minor forest produce**. The theme, "**Women Empowerment through Minor Forest Produce**," highlights that **50% of the workforce** in this sector is women. The event fosters collaboration among **government officials, traders, producers, scientists, and policymakers**.
- The **Bharat Mobility Global Expo 2025** will be held from **January 17-22** in **Delhi NCR**, featuring **1,500 exhibitors** and expecting **500,000 visitors**. It will showcase leading automakers like **Maruti Suzuki, Tata Motors, and BYD**, focusing on **electric vehicles (EVs), hybrid technologies, and alternative fuels**. The expo aims to solidify India's role as a global hub for **sustainable mobility** and **engineering excellence**.
- On **National Consumer Day 2024**, the Department of Consumer Affairs launched three new apps to enhance consumer protection and address deceptive online practices, marking a significant step forward in empowering consumers in the digital age. Building on the foundation of the **Consumer Protection Act of 1986**, these tools highlight the government's commitment to addressing emerging challenges such as dark patterns in e-commerce. Among the apps, the **Jago Grahak Jago App** provides crucial information about e-commerce platforms, alerting users to potentially unsafe websites and raising awareness for safer online shopping. The **Jagriti App**, on the other hand, encourages proactive consumer engagement by allowing users to report websites suspected of deceptive practices directly to the Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) for investigation, empowering consumers to take action against unfair practices.

- The **Ministry of Defence** announced the theme for the **Republic Day 2025** tableaux as “**Swarnim Bharat: Virasat aur Vikas**” (Golden India: Heritage and Development). This year’s tableaux will showcase the dynamic relationship between India’s rich heritage and its ongoing development. The display will take place on Kartavya Path and feature creative exhibits from various states, Union Territories, and central ministries. Aimed at highlighting India’s diversity, the Republic Day tableaux will offer a glimpse of the country’s cultural roots and modern progress.
- **Nitin Gadkari**, Union Minister for **Road Transport and Highways**, inaugurated **India’s first bio-bitumen-based National Highway stretch** on **NH-44** in **Mansar, Nagpur, Maharashtra**. The stretch uses **lignin-based bio-bitumen technology** developed by **Praj Industries** in collaboration with **CSIR-CRRI, NHAI, and Oriental**. This milestone represents a significant advancement in **sustainability** and **self-reliance** in India’s road development sector.
- The **Indian government** abolished the **No-detention policy** for **Class 5 and 8** students, which previously ensured automatic promotion. Under the new amendment to the **Right to Education rules, 2010**, students failing their year-end exams must retake them within **two months**. If they fail again, they will have to **repeat the academic year**. This rule affects over **3,000 centrally run schools**, including **Kendriya Vidyalayas, Sainik Schools, and Navodaya Vidyalayas**.
- The Indian government launched the ‘**Udaan Yatri Cafe**’ initiative to address concerns over overpriced food at airports. The pilot project, located at **Kolkata’s Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose International Airport**, offers **affordable refreshments** like water, tea, coffee, and snacks. If successful, the initiative will expand to other **Airports Authority of India (AAI)-run airports**.
- **Queen’s University Belfast** and **Coventry University** have applied to set up international campuses at **GIFT City in Gujarat**, marking a significant step as **India** relaxes regulations for foreign institutions. **Queen’s University** plans to offer **postgraduate** programs, while **Coventry University**, with existing global campuses, will expand its presence in **India**.
- Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** chaired a review meeting of **Bhartiya Beej Sahkari Samiti Limited (BBSSL)** in New Delhi, highlighting its role in realizing **PM Modi’s vision** of “Sehkar Se Samridhi” by empowering farmers through traditional seed preservation. **Key objectives** included expanding the cooperative network by connecting with **20,000 additional cooperatives** by **2025-26**, focusing on **sustainable seeds** with lower water and pesticide needs, and evaluating the **nutritional value** of indigenous and hybrid seeds through organizations like **IFFCO and KRIBHCO**.

International Current Affairs of January 2024

- **China** has recently named **Dong Jun** as its **new defense minister**, marking a significant shift in the country's military leadership. This move comes two months after the official removal of his predecessor, **Li Shangfu**, who was last seen in public in August.
- **BRICS**, the group of emerging-market nations comprising **Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa**, is poised to undergo a significant expansion on **January 1**. South Africa's envoy to the bloc revealed that Saudi Arabia, Iran, the United Arab Emirates, Ethiopia, and Egypt have accepted invitations to join, effectively doubling the organization's membership.
- In a significant economic development, Goods and Services Tax (GST) collections for December 2023 reached **₹1,64,882 crore**, marking a notable 10.28% surge compared to the ₹1,49,507 crore collected in the same month the previous year. This accomplishment underscores the seventh consecutive month in the fiscal year where average GST collections have exceeded **₹1.6-lakh crore**. Notably, November 2023 witnessed GST collections at ₹1,67,929 crore, contributing to the overall positive trend.
- The **Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC)** is once again in the spotlight as **President Felix Tshisekedi** secures victory in the highly contested December 20 election. However, the results have sparked condemnation from various opposition candidates who label the election a "sham" and demand a rerun.
- Cash-strapped Pakistan is poised to receive a crucial **\$700 million bailout tranche** from the International Monetary Fund (IMF) during the Executive Board meeting on January 11. The disbursement, under the existing **\$3 billion Stand-By Arrangement (SBA)**, is expected to provide much-needed financial support to Pakistan's struggling economy.
- **Chad's transitional government** has taken a significant step towards establishing civilian rule by appointing former opposition leader **Succes Masra** as the **prime minister of Chad**.
- France's development agency, **AFD**, and Germany's **KfW Bank** are reportedly in talks with India to extend a **€100 million loan** to support the country's **urban infrastructure plan**, specifically the **Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT) 2.0**. Negotiations for the loan are scheduled for early 2024, with the signing expected to take place in February.
- Russian President **Vladimir Putin** officially marked the commencement of **Russia's 2024 BRICS Chairmanship**.

During this handover, President Putin emphasized the motto for the upcoming tenure, **"Strengthening Multilateralism for Equitable Global Development and Security."** This signifies Russia's commitment to fostering collaboration among the BRICS nations – Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.

- In a pioneering move, France has become the first European Union member to introduce fully **digital Schengen visas for the 2024 Olympic** and Paralympic Games in Paris. Commencing on January 1, 2024, the newly launched "Olympic Consulate" system operates through the France-Visas portal, streamlining the application process for 15,000 international athletes, 9,000 journalists, and foreign delegations.
- In a surprising turn of events, **Queen Margrethe II of Denmark**, in her **New Year's speech**, revealed her decision to abdicate the **throne after 52 years of rule**. The announcement, made on the **14th of January**, marks the anniversary of her own accession to the **throne at the age of 31**, following the death of her **father, King Frederik IX**.
- **Bangladesh's Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina** has been re-elected for a fifth term, marking a significant milestone in the country's political landscape. The ruling Awami League, under Hasina's leadership, has triumphed once again, securing more than half of the parliamentary seats. This victory reaffirms Sheikh Hasina's position as the world's longest-serving female head of government.
- Vietnamese electric vehicle giant **VinFast Auto Ltd** made a significant announcement on Sunday, revealing plans to establish an integrated **electric vehicle facility in the Indian state of Tamil Nadu**. With an eye on breaking into the world's third-largest automobile market, the automaker confirmed its commitment to invest a staggering **\$2 billion** in the state.
- A groundbreaking development in agricultural technology has emerged from the **laboratories of Linköping University in Sweden**. Scientists have unveiled an **electrically conductive "soil"** engineered to foster exceptional growth in crops, particularly barley seedlings, **marking a potential 50 per cent surge in growth within a mere 15-day period**.
- **Tropical Cyclone Alvaro** made landfall in southwest **Madagascar** on January 1st, 2024, marking the first significant cyclone impact on the island nation in the ongoing 2023-2024 cyclone season for the **southwest Indian Ocean region**. This season, spanning late October to May, has brought unprecedented challenges to the region, with Alvaro being the latest cyclone to wreak havoc.

- French President Emmanuel Macron has made a significant political move by appointing **Gabriel Attal as the new prime minister of France**. At 34 years old, Attal not only becomes the youngest prime minister in the country's history but also the **first openly gay official to hold this prestigious position**.
- The United States, led by Secretary of State Antony Blinken, has identified several nations as **'Countries of Particular Concern'** due to severe violations of religious freedom. This decision aligns with the **International Religious Freedom Act of 1998**, emphasizing the commitment to advancing freedom of religion globally. **China, North Korea, Pakistan, Cuba, Eritrea, Iran, Nicaragua, Russia, Saudi Arabia, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, and Myanmar** have been labeled as 'Countries of Particular Concern.' Algeria, Azerbaijan, the Central African Republic, Comoros, and Vietnam are placed on the 'Special Watch List' for tolerating severe religious freedom violations.
- **Singapore's Changi Airport** has once again been crowned the **World's Best Airport for the year 2023**, according to the prestigious awards presented by the air transport research firm, Skytrax. After losing the title in the past two years to Qatar's Hamad International Airport, Changi Airport reclaimed its status as the best in the world, marking the **twelfth time** it has received this coveted accolade.
- **European Union's Copernicus Climate Change Service (C3S)** declared that the year gone by was the hottest on record, significantly surpassing previous temperatures and potentially marking the **warmest period in the last 100,000 years**. The announcement sheds light on the alarming trajectory of global warming, with each passing month breaking climate records and raising concerns about the consequences for the planet.
- In a significant political development, Bhutanese voters have overwhelmingly chosen **Tshering Tobgay as their Prime Minister for a second term**. The **People's Democratic Party (PDP)**, led by Mr. Tobgay, secured a landslide victory, winning nearly two-thirds of the seats in the recent election, as announced by the election commission on January 10.
- **South Korea's parliament** made history by passing a groundbreaking bill that **bans the eating and selling of dog meat**. This move marks the end of a centuries-old practice that has been increasingly criticized in the face of growing support for animal welfare.
- Chinese President **Xi Jinping** and Maldivian President **Mohamed Muizzu** recently held significant talks, culminating in the signing of **20 key agreements** that span various areas of cooperation. The leaders announced the elevation of bilateral ties to a Comprehensive Strategic Cooperative Partnership, demonstrating the mutual commitment to enhancing diplomatic relations between the two nations.
- **China** has recently sent a groundbreaking astronomical satellite named **Einstein Probe (EP)** into space on a mission to observe mysterious transient phenomena in the universe. The satellite, **shaped like a lotus in full bloom**, employs innovative **X-ray detection technology inspired by the functioning of a lobster eye**. Launched from the Xichang Satellite Launch Centre in southwest China's Sichuan Province, this mission marks a significant step in unraveling the secrets of the cosmos.
- **New Zealand's** veteran pace bowler **Tim Southee** has created history by becoming the first bowler to take **150 wickets in T20 Internationals**. This milestone was achieved during a T20 match against Pakistan, where New Zealand secured a convincing victory.
- In a groundbreaking election, Taiwanese voters have chosen **William Lai Ching-te**, a pro-sovereignty candidate from the **Democratic Progressive Party (DPP)**, as their president, marking a significant departure from China.
- **Denmark** witnessed a historic moment on January 14 as **King Frederik X ascended the throne**, succeeding his mother, **Queen Margrethe II**, who formally abdicated after an impressive 52 years as the monarch. The capital brimmed with anticipation and excitement as large crowds gathered to witness this significant event in the nation's history.
- **Bernardo Arévalo** was officially sworn in as the **President of Guatemala on January 15, 2024**, overcoming months of political challenges and efforts to derail his inauguration.
- The **World Economic Forum (WEF) 2024** kicked off on January 15 in Davos, Switzerland, where global leaders are slated to address a peculiar concern known as **Disease X**. This enigmatic term refers to an illness triggered by an unidentified yet potent microbial threat. A panel of the World Health Organization (WHO) is set to collaborate with other health officials to deliberate on this mysterious health menace.
- **China's Betavolt**, a cutting-edge startup, has introduced a groundbreaking nuclear battery that claims to provide **uninterrupted electricity for 50 years** without the need for charging or maintenance. The miniaturization of atomic energy sets this battery apart as the first of its kind globally, challenging conventional views on nuclear technology.
- **Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi rebels** have intensified their attacks on ships in the **Red Sea**, citing revenge against Israel for its actions in Gaza. This has prompted the **US and UK** to launch strikes against Houthi targets in Yemen, leading to concerns about a broader regional conflict. The attacks have disrupted global trade routes, raising fears of a significant impact on the world economy.
- **China faces a demographic crisis as its population dropped for the second year in a row in 2023**. This decline is attributed to a falling birth rate and an increase in deaths, especially after the lifting of COVID-19

restrictions. China's total population stood at **1.4 billion**, with the country falling behind India as the world's most populous nation.

- The **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)**, in collaboration with the Government of Denmark, has introduced a groundbreaking initiative in Ukraine, the establishment of **"green rooms"** at the National Police headquarters in **Zaporizhzhia Oblast**. This innovative project aims to create a safe and supportive environment for effective communication between law enforcement officers and child survivors or witnesses of crime.
- In a significant move towards sustainable development, the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)** and the **European Union (EU)** have allocated grants totaling over **US\$420,000** (approximately 1.6 million PGK) to support initiatives aimed at combating deforestation, improving food and nutrition security, and adapting to the impacts of climate change. These grants are set to benefit communities across six districts in **Enga Province, Papua New Guinea**.
- In a recent announcement, the **World Health Organization (WHO)** has officially certified **Cabo Verde as a malaria-free country**. This accomplishment positions Cabo Verde alongside Mauritius and Algeria as the third nation in the WHO African region to achieve malaria-free status.
- **Japan** has marked a significant achievement in space exploration by becoming the **fifth country to successfully soft-land a spacecraft on the Moon**. The Smart Lander for Investigating Moon (SLIM) touched down near the Shioli crater, south of the lunar equator, utilizing precision technology that allowed it to land closer to its target site than any previous mission.
- In a remarkable display of goodwill and humanitarian assistance, the **Indian government** has stepped forward to aid the **Afghan people** in confronting the locust menace. The generous support comes in the form of **40,000 litres of Malathion**, an environmentally friendly pesticide known for its efficacy in arid regions and minimal water usage. The supplies were sent through **Iran's Chabahar port**, showcasing a collaborative effort to address a pressing agricultural concern.
- The **Iranian army** marked a significant milestone in its defense capabilities as it **formally received a substantial number of domestically developed reconnaissance and combat drones** in a ceremony held on January 23, 2024. The event, attended by the Iranian Army's Chief Commander **Abdolrahim Mousavi** and Defense Minister Mohammad-Reza Ashtiani, showcased the latest advancements in unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) technology.
- In a groundbreaking move, **Saudi Arabia** is preparing to open its first alcohol store, exclusively for diplomats. This significant development represents a notable shift in the Kingdom's approach to alcohol, which has traditionally been banned under its strict interpretation of Islamic law.

- In a groundbreaking turn of events, **Kenneth Smith**, a convicted murderer, has become the **first person in the United States to be executed by nitrogen gas**. The execution, which took place in Alabama, introduces a new method intended to be the most painless and humane alternative to the previously predominant lethal injection.
- French President **Emmanuel Macron** concluded his two-day visit to India, participating as the chief guest in the 75th Republic Day celebrations. The visit aimed at strengthening strategic ties between India and France, featuring a 40-member delegation and significant diplomatic engagements.
- In a disputed electoral process, **Comoros President Azali Assoumani** has claimed victory for a fourth term with 63% of the vote, as announced by the electoral body Ceni. However, the opposition, boycotting the poll, decries it as "fraudulent."
- Bhutan's liberal leader, **Tshering Tobgay**, from the People's Democratic Party (PDP), has commenced his second term as prime minister, following recent elections in the nation.
- **QatarEnergy and Exceleerate Energy** have finalized a pivotal 15-year LNG Sale and Purchase Agreement (SPA) with the goal of providing LNG to Bangladesh. Under the SPA, Exceleerate will secure up to one million tons per annum (MTPA) of LNG from QatarEnergy. The deliveries, set to commence from January 2026, will be directed to floating storage and regasification units in Bangladesh. The agreement encompasses Exceleerate's procurement of 0.85 MTPA of LNG in 2026 and 2027, and one MTPA from 2028 to 2040.
- In a historic ceremony, **Sultan Ibrahim of Johor** state has been installed as **Malaysia's 17th king**. This event marks a significant moment in the nation's constitutional monarchy system, where the throne rotates among the rulers of the nine Malay states.
- In a surprising move, the military regimes in **Burkina Faso, Mali, and Niger** have announced their immediate withdrawal from the **Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)**, citing the bloc as a threat to member states. The Sahel nations, facing challenges of jihadist violence and poverty, have had strained relations with ECOWAS since recent coups. Despite being founding members in 1975, they were suspended and faced heavy sanctions for the overthrow of civilian governments.
- In a significant milestone, the **World Health Organization (WHO)** has issued its first-ever certificates acknowledging advancements in eliminating trans fatty acids (TFA), both industrially produced and naturally occurring. Five countries—**Denmark, Lithuania, Poland, Saudi Arabia, and Thailand**—have been commended for their pioneering efforts in demonstrating effective policies and robust monitoring and enforcement mechanisms in their TFA elimination strategies.

International Current Affairs of February 2024

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- In a significant development on January 1, **Saudi Arabia, Egypt, the United Arab Emirates, Iran, and Ethiopia** officially joined the BRICS group, expanding its membership to ten nations. The expansion, initially set to occur during the 15th BRICS summit in August 2023 in Johannesburg, South Africa, aims to enhance the group's influence on the global stage. Argentina, initially invited, opted out in December.
- In a groundbreaking move, **Michelle O'Neill**, an Irish nationalist representing Sinn Fein, has been appointed as **Northern Ireland's First Minister**. This marks a significant departure from the traditional dominance of pro-British unionists in the region's political landscape.
- As of January 1, 2024, France** has pioneered the issuance of **Digital Schengen visas**, marking a significant leap in streamlining visa processes within the **European Union**. This groundbreaking initiative precedes the broader digitalization of Schengen visa procedures scheduled for full implementation in **2026**. The move is strategically aligned with the preparations for the **2024 Olympic and Paralympic Games in Paris**, with French authorities aiming to distribute around **70,000 digital visas**.
- Yemen's** Presidential Leadership Council, in a significant move, appointed Foreign Minister **Ahmed Awad bin Mubarak** as the country's new Prime Minister. This appointment comes at a critical time as Yemen faces increased tensions and security challenges. The outgoing Prime Minister, **Maeen Abdulmalik Saeed**, has been appointed as an advisor to the Chairman of the Presidential Leadership Council, marking a notable shift in the country's political landscape.
- The **Geological Institute of Israel** has recently made a groundbreaking discovery near Cyprus, uncovering an underwater canyon of unprecedented proportions. Named **Eratosthenes** after the nearby underwater mountain, this canyon sheds new light on the geological history of the Mediterranean region.
- Sri Lanka, facing economic challenges and seeking to spur growth, plans to establish **free trade agreements (FTAs)** with several countries including India by the end of 2024. Foreign Minister **Ali Sabry** outlined the government's strategy to address the nation's economic woes.
- Iran eliminates visa requirements for Indian tourists from **February 4, 2024**, aiming to boost tourism and global engagement. Indian ordinary passport holders can visit every six months for up to 15 days. The move extends to 33 countries, acknowledging India's growing outbound tourism market.
- El Salvadoran President **Nayib Bukele** triumphantly secures his reelection, despite lingering concerns over authoritarian tendencies. Bukele's landslide victory underscores his firm stance against gang violence and his vision for democratic reforms.
- Kazakh President **Kassym-Jomart Tokayev** has appointed **Olzhas Bektenov**, his chief of staff, as the new prime minister. Bektenov, aged 43, previously headed the state anti-corruption agency and assumed the role of presidential administration head in April 2023.
- The Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), the largest sovereign wealth fund in the UAE, is establishing a substantial investment fund totaling **\$4-5 billion through India's Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City)**, situated in Prime Minister Narendra Modi's home state.

- **China** has inaugurated its newest Antarctic research station, the **Qinling facility**, situated on Inexpressible Island in the Ross Sea. This marks **China's fifth research station** in Antarctica and signifies its commitment to advancing scientific exploration in the region.
- Former Prime Minister **Alexander Stubb** secured victory in **Finland's presidential runoff** against ex-Foreign Minister **Pekka Haavisto**. This win places Stubb in charge of navigating Finland's foreign and security policies, particularly significant given Finland's recent NATO membership following Russia's invasion of Ukraine.
- **China** has officially opened the **Qinling Station in Antarctica**. This significant development marks a new chapter in China's scientific exploration and research in the Antarctic region, underscoring its commitment to contributing to global understanding of this remote and pristine environment.
- The Prime Minister of Trinidad and Tobago has officially declared a **state of "national emergency"** following a significant oil spill in the eastern Caribbean. The spill, originating from an overturned vessel near Tobago, has led to widespread environmental damage along the coastline, prompting concerns about the impact on the nation's economy, particularly its tourism sector.
- **Saudi Arabia** is preparing to introduce its **first luxury train**, named the **Dream of the Desert**. It will be the first luxury train in the Middle East, offering travelers a journey through Saudi Arabia. With its promise of luxury and cultural immersion, this new venture is positioned to become a classic in its own right. Reservations for the train's first ride will open by late 2024, before its planned launch in 2025.
- Official data reveals that **Germany** has surpassed **Japan** as the **world's third-largest economy**, primarily due to a significant depreciation in the yen compared to the stability of the euro. Japan's economy, despite growing 1.9% last year, contracted in the fourth quarter, leading to its relegation to the fourth position.
- **Prabowo Subianto** emerges victorious in Indonesia's Presidential race, securing nearly 60% of the votes in the first round. His military background and alignment with **President Joko Widodo's** policies propel him to a clear-cut victory, sparking positive reactions in Indonesian markets.
- The **US House of Representatives** has overwhelmingly passed the **Quad bill** aimed at enhancing cooperation between the **US, Australia, India, and Japan**. The bill mandates the establishment of a Quad Intra-Parliamentary Working Group to bolster joint efforts in various domains.
- Greece has made history by legalizing same-sex marriage and granting **equal parental rights to same-sex couples**, marking a significant shift in the country's societal and legal landscape. Despite facing opposition from the **Orthodox Church**, lawmakers passed the bill, making Greece the first Orthodox Christian nation to embrace such progressive legislation.
- **India's infrastructure and innovation** landscape, the Japanese government has pledged a substantial loan of **232.209 billion yen (approximately Rs 12,800 crore)** to fund nine distinct projects across various sectors in India. This financial assistance marks a notable step in enhancing the strategic and global partnership between India and Japan, a relationship that has been thriving since 1958. The agreement was formalized between **Vikas Sheel**, Additional Secretary of the Department of Economic Affairs, and **Suzuki Hiroshi**, the Japanese Ambassador to India.
- **Malta**, a small yet significant player in the global arena, recently took a remarkable step towards sustainable energy by joining the **International Solar Alliance (ISA)**. This move underscores the country's commitment to reducing reliance on non-renewable energy sources and embracing environmentally friendly alternatives.
- The **Government of Japan** has committed **Official Development Assistance (ODA)** loan of JPY 232.209 billion for **nine projects** across various sectors in India. The exchange of notes for these projects took place between **Mr. Vikas Sheel**, Additional Secretary, Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Government of India, and **Mr. Suzuki Hiroshi**, Ambassador of Japan to India, marking another milestone in the partnership between the two nations.
- As the two-year anniversary of Russia's invasion of Ukraine approaches, **Japanese Prime Minister Fumio Kishida** has affirmed Japan's commitment to Ukraine's long-term reconstruction, labelling it as a strategic investment for the future. In a significant move, Japan, in collaboration with the Ukrainian government and various business organizations, co-organized a conference where Kishida outlined a vision for a comprehensive partnership between the two nations, emphasizing inclusivity, humanitarianism, and the sharing of technology and knowledge.
- **Turkey** celebrates a milestone achievement as its **first fifth-generation aircraft, KAAN**, successfully completes its inaugural flight, marking a significant advancement in the country's military capabilities.
- **Bangladesh** observes **Amar Ekushey** on February 21st, a day to remember the people who died fighting for Bangla to be an official language in 1952. This event led to significant changes in the country.

- **India and Thailand**, four revered relics of Lord Buddha and his disciples have arrived in Bangkok, Thailand, accompanied by a delegation from India. The delegation, led by Governor of Bihar Shri Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar and Union Minister of Social Justice and Empowerment Dr. Virendra Kumar, includes esteemed monks, officials, curators, artists, and scholars.
- In Pakistan, two big-time political groups, the **Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz (PML-N)** and the **Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP)**, have decided to share power. This means Shehbaz Sharif is set to be the Prime Minister again, and Asif Ali Zardari will be the President. It's like when two captains from different teams decide to work together to win the game.
- The **Philippines** has achieved a significant milestone by becoming the first Asian country to ratify the **Violence and Harassment Convention 2019 (No. 190)** as announced by the **International Labor Organization (ILO)**. The convention addresses workplace violence and harassment comprehensively, marking a crucial step towards ensuring safe and respectful work environments globally.
- Vietnam has set forth an ambitious national hydrogen strategy, aiming to become a significant player in the global hydrogen market. With targets ranging from **100,000 to 500,000 tons** of clean hydrogen production annually by 2030, escalating to **10-20 million tons by 2050**, the strategy seeks to leverage both green and blue hydrogen production methods.
- **Dubai's Department of Economy and Tourism (DET)** has announced the introduction of a five-year multiple-entry visa aimed at enhancing travel between India and the UAE. This initiative comes in response to the significant increase in Indian visitors to Dubai, with India being the top source market for tourists in the region.
- Less than two years after being demoted to the **Financial Action Task Force's (FATF) "gray list,"** the United Arab Emirates (UAE) has been swiftly removed, signaling significant progress in the country's efforts to combat illicit financial activities. The Paris-based watchdog acknowledged the UAE's strengthened anti-money laundering and counter-terrorist financing measures, leading to the country's exit from increased monitoring.
- **Maryam Nawaz**, the daughter of Pakistan's former Prime Minister **Nawaz Sharif** and a senior leader of the Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz (PML-N) party, has achieved a significant political milestone by becoming the first woman Chief Minister of Punjab province.
- **Algeria** celebrated the grand opening of what has been acclaimed as **"Africa's largest mosque"** and the third-largest mosque in the world. **President Abdelmadjid Tebboune** presided over the ceremony, officially revealing the Great Mosque of Algiers as the world's third-largest mosque.

- The **New Zealand government** plans to revoke a pioneering law scheduled for implementation in July. This law, considered the toughest globally, aimed to ban tobacco sales to individuals born after January 1, 2009, while also reducing nicotine content and slashing tobacco retailers by over 90%.
- In 2023, **South Korea** experienced a further decline in its already **record-low fertility rate**, exacerbating concerns about population decline. Political promises aim to tackle the crisis, but similar trends in Japan and China underscore the complex challenges of reversing declining birth rates.
- **Peru** has declared a **health emergency** in response to the escalating cases of **dengue fever** across the nation. Health Minister **Cesar Vasquez** announced on Monday that over **31,000** cases of dengue have been reported within the first eight weeks of **2024**, resulting in **32** fatalities. The emergency declaration will encompass **20 out of Peru's 25 regions**.

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- **Tuvalu** has named **Feleti Teo**, the former Attorney General, as the Pacific Island nation's new prime minister. This appointment comes in the aftermath of a general election that placed the country's diplomatic affiliations, especially its ties with Taiwan, under intense scrutiny.
- **Dubai** witnessed an extraordinary event with the city-state's inaugural jet suit race. Organized by Gravity Industries in collaboration with the **Dubai Sports Council**, this groundbreaking competition showcased pilots equipped with jet engines on their hands and backs, resembling real-life 'Iron Men'.
- In a groundbreaking move, **France** has made history by becoming the **first nation globally** to anchor the right to abortion within its constitution. This decision represents a significant advancement in the protection of reproductive rights, sparking a mix of applause and criticism across different spectrums of society.
- Hungary's parliament recently appointed a new president following the resignation of the previous head of state amidst a scandal involving a controversial pardon granted in a child sexual abuse case. The appointment of **Tamás Sulyok**, a former head of Hungary's Constitutional Court, sparked debate among opposition parties calling for direct presidential elections.
- Sweden formally became the **32nd member of NATO** after completing its accession process in Washington. This decision comes two years after Sweden's application, triggered by Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine, highlighting concerns about regional security.

- **Panama** has officially become the **97th member** of the **International Solar Alliance (ISA)**. This milestone was announced by Randhir Jaiswal, the spokesperson for the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**. Panama's accession underscores the country's commitment to embracing sustainable energy sources and marks a crucial step in the global march towards a greener future.
- The **Indian Consulate in Dubai** has introduced a new **insurance package** called the **Life Protection Plan (LPP)** for **Indian blue-collar workers** in the United Arab Emirates (UAE). This plan aims to provide **financial benefits** to the families of the workers in case of **natural or accidental deaths**.
- **Hong Kong** has introduced a **new national security law draft**. The proposed legislation, covering treason, espionage, and external interference, signifies a significant increase in state authority in the region. This development arises amidst a wider crackdown on dissent, resulting in pro-democracy figures being imprisoned or exiled.
- Asif Ali Zardari took oath as **Pakistan's 14th President** following his overwhelming victory in the presidential election.
- China recently announced a new territorial sea baseline in the northern part of the **Gulf of Tonkin**, shared with Vietnam, sparking concerns about potential impacts on existing agreements and regional stability.
- In a landmark gathering in **Yaoundé, Cameroon**, health ministers from **11 African nations**, along with global malaria partners and stakeholders, convened to address the escalating **malaria crisis** in Africa. Despite available tools and systems, malaria cases surged globally, with Africa bearing the brunt, accounting for 94% of cases and 95% of deaths in 2022.
- The naval forces of **China, Iran, and Russia** launched a joint exercise near the **Gulf of Oman**, aimed at safeguarding regional maritime security. The **"Security Belt-2024"** exercise marks the fourth time these countries have conducted such a drill since 2019.
- President **Mahmoud Abbas** of the Palestinian Authority (PA) has appointed **Mohammad Mustafa as the new Prime Minister**. Mustafa, a U.S.-educated economist, is one of the leading Palestinian business figures with a track record of overseeing Gaza's reconstruction efforts under Hamas' rule.
- **Britain** has recently conducted successful test firings of its **DragonFire Laser Directed Energy Weapon (LDEW)**, showcasing its capability to intercept enemy aircraft and missiles at a remarkably low cost. A January demonstration in Scotland displayed the laser's precision in targeting and destroying aerial threats, marking a potential game-changer in air defense technology.
- Russian President **Vladimir Putin** clinched victory in the recent election with a commanding lead of **76.1% of the vote**, as per preliminary results. This win marks Putin's continued dominance in Russian politics, now extending his tenure to a total of 24 years in power.
- In a move to boost its **tourism industry**, the government of Nepal has officially declared **Pokhara**, a city in the Gandaki province, as the **tourism capital** of the Himalayan nation. The declaration was made during a special ceremony held at the **Barahi Ghat** on the shores of the **Phewa Lake**.
- **Vaughan Gething**, who currently serves as the **Economic Minister of Wales**, has been elected as the new **leader of the Welsh Labour Party**. His victory marks a **historic milestone** as he becomes the **first ever Black person to lead a European country**.
- The **New Zealand government** has announced a **ban on disposable e-cigarettes or vapes**. The move comes less than a month after the country repealed a law that aimed to phase out **tobacco smoking**.
- The **United States, the United Kingdom, and Australia** have forged the AUKUS partnership to bolster trilateral security and construct **nuclear-powered submarines** for the Royal Australian Navy. This landmark agreement signifies a significant advancement in defense collaboration among the three nations.
- **Simon Harris**, a prominent figure in Irish politics, has emerged as the sole candidate in the race to become Ireland's next prime minister following the unexpected departure of **Leo Varadkar**. At 37 years old, Harris is poised to become the **youngest prime minister in Ireland's history**.
- The **Francis Scott Key Bridge in Baltimore** collapsed early on March 26 after a container ship collided with a pylon, resulting in the presumed death of six individuals who fell into the cold waters below. The incident has halted operations at one of the **busiest ports on the U.S. Eastern Seaboard**.
- After eight years of Socialist rule in Portugal, **Luis Montenegro**, leader of the centre-right Democratic Alliance (AD), has been appointed as the new prime minister. However, his minority government faces challenges due to his refusal to ally with the far-right Chega party.
- **Rumi Alqahtani**, a 27-year-old model and influencer from Saudi Arabia, announced on Instagram that she will be the first participant from the country in the **Miss Universe** competition. Alqahtani was born in **Riyadh** and has previously won the titles of **Miss Saudi Arabia, Miss Arab World Peace 2021, and Miss Woman (Saudi Arabia)**. This will be the **Kingdom of Saudi Arabia's first appearance** in the Miss Universe pageant.
- **Bassirou Diomaye Faye**, an anti-establishment figure, has won the **Senegalese presidential election** with **54.28 per cent** of the votes in the first round. At 44 years old, Faye is set to become **Africa's youngest elected president** and the first opponent to win in the first round since Senegal's independence from France in 1960. His victory still needs to be validated by Senegal's Constitutional Council in the next few days.

- **Thailand's lower house** of Parliament has passed a groundbreaking bill to **legalize same-sex marriage**, marking a significant step towards equality in Southeast Asia. The legislation, an amendment to the Civil and Commercial Code, garnered overwhelming support in the House of Representatives.
- **Florida Governor Ron DeSantis** has signed a bill that **prohibits minors under 14 from having social media accounts**. The law requires **parental permission** for 14- and 15-year-olds to create accounts on platforms like **Meta, TikTok**, and others. All social media users in Florida must **submit identification documents** to verify their ages.

International Current Affairs of April 2024

- Saudi Arabia has been chosen to chair the **UN Commission on the Status of Women (CSW)**, despite widespread criticism due to its poor record on **women's rights**. The appointment of **Saudi Ambassador Abdulaziz Alwasil** has sparked outrage from human rights groups, given the stark disparity between the kingdom's actions and the commission's mandate to promote gender equality.
- Romania and Bulgaria have taken a significant step in their integration with the **European Union by partially joining the Schengen travel zone**. While travelers arriving by air or sea now enjoy ID-check-free access, land border checks persist due to opposition from Austria.
- **The International Year of Millets (IYM) 2023**, concluded with a closing ceremony held at the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) headquarters in Rome, Italy, on **March 29th, 2024**. The event served as a platform to assess the accomplishments and insights gained from the year-long celebration.
- **Katchatheevu, an Indian island** with a tumultuous past, has been a focal point of contention between **India and Sri Lanka since its cession in 1974**.
- The Democratic Republic of Congo has appointed **Judith Suminwa Tuluka** as the country's **first female Prime Minister**. This move by President Felix Tshisekedi fulfills a campaign promise and comes at a time of **worsening violence** in the mineral-rich **eastern region** bordering Rwanda.
- On **April 1, 2024**, Germany became the largest **European Union (EU)** nation to **legalize recreational cannabis use**, despite facing opposition from politicians and medical associations. Under the new law, **adults over 18** are now permitted to carry up to **25 grams of dried cannabis** and cultivate up to **three marijuana plants** at home.
- Scientists in South Korea have set a new world record using the **Korea Superconducting Tokamak Advanced Research (KSTAR)** device, an **"artificial sun" nuclear fusion reactor**. During tests conducted between December 2023 and February 2024, they generated **plasma temperatures of 100 million degrees Celsius** for a duration of **48 seconds**.
- **Egypt's President Abdel Fattah al-Sisi, 69**, has commenced his third term as the leader of the nation, extending his tenure until 2030. Amidst battling economic challenges, **Sisi vows to prioritize national interests and fulfill the aspirations of the Egyptian people for a modern, democratic state**.
- A research center in **Romania has revealed the world's most potent laser**, based on the groundbreaking inventions of **Nobel Physics Prize winners Gerard Mourou and Donna Strickland**. The laser, operated by the French company Thales, promises revolutionary applications across sectors from healthcare to space exploration.
- **Zimbabwe, along with Zambia and Malawi**, has declared a state of disaster due to a severe drought sweeping across southern Africa. **President Emmerson Mnangagwa** cited an **"El Nino-induced drought"** causing below-normal rainfall, affecting over **80% of the country**. This drought, exacerbated by climate change, has led to dire food shortages and humanitarian crises across the region.
- **The North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)** is marking its **75th anniversary this year**. The alliance, founded in 1949, will hold a special event in Brussels, Belgium to commemorate this milestone.
- In Slovakia's recent presidential election, **Peter Pellegrini** emerged victorious, reinforcing the pro-Russian stance of **Prime Minister Robert Fico's government**. Pellegrini's win signals a **continuity in Fico's policies**, characterized by a tilt towards Russia, controversial reforms, and strained relations with the West.
- China has surpassed India as the primary importer of Russian crude oil via sea routes, with **China importing 1.82 million barrels per day (bpd) in March compared to India's 1.36 million bpd**. This shift is attributed to India's slowdown in imports due to sanctions and rising prices.
- British national Russ Cook, known as the **"Hardest Geezer,"** has successfully completed a challenging trek that took him over 352 days to finish. During his journey, he covered more than 10,000 miles, passed through 16 countries, and took over 19 million steps, all while raising money for charity.
- **Simon Harris, aged 37**, has been elected as Ireland's youngest-ever prime minister, succeeding **Leo Varadkar who resigned last month**. Harris, a former health and higher education minister, secured the nomination with a vote of 88-69 in parliament, garnering support from independent lawmakers, as well as his coalition partners Fianna Fail and the Green Party.

- In an effort to stabilize its economy after years of turmoil, **Zimbabwe has launched a new gold-backed currency called ZiG, an abbreviation for "Zimbabwe Gold."** This move comes as the country grapples with hyperinflation and a volatile financial landscape.
- **Former Pakistan Prime Minister Yousaf Raza Gillani and Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz (PML-N) leader Syedal Khan Nasir** have been elected as Pakistan's Senate chairman and deputy chairman, respectively.
- In a significant development, Israel deployed its ship-mounted defense system, the **C-Dome, for the first time against a suspicious aerial target near the southern city of Eilat.** The incident occurred following an alert in the area, which had previously been targeted by missile fire from **Yemen's Houthi rebels.** The C-Dome, a naval adaptation of the Iron Dome, successfully intercepted the target, marking its maiden operational use.
- **Russia** successfully tested its **Angara-A5 space rocket** for the first time on April 11, 2024. The test launch was conducted from the **Vostochny Cosmodrome** in the Far East of Russia. In fact, rocket test launches on April 9 and 10 were cancelled due to a malfunction in the pressurization system and a problem with the engine launch-control system.
- In a recent announcement on April 20, 2024, **North Korea revealed the testing of a new anti-aircraft Pyoljji-1-2 missile and a super large strategic cruise missile Hwasal-1 Ra-3 warhead in the West Sea of Korea.** These tests, conducted on April 19, 2024, mark a significant escalation in tensions between North Korea, South Korea, and the United States.
- **Mayako Pahichan Nepal, in collaboration with the Nepal Tourism Board,** orchestrated the groundbreaking **first International Rainbow Tourism Conference.** This one-day event marks a significant leap forward in fostering diversity and inclusivity within Nepal's tourism industry, positioning the country as a welcoming destination for the sexual minority community in South Asia.
- **Indonesia's electoral commission** has officially declared **Prabowo Subianto** as the president-elect after the country's highest court rejected challenges to his landslide victory lodged by two losing presidential candidates. Subianto, currently serving as the defense minister, secured 58.6% of the votes, amounting to more than 96 million ballots, which is more than twice the number received by either of his rivals.
- In the recently released **2024 Special 301 Report by the U.S. Trade Representatives (USTR),** India finds itself on the Priority Watch List for **intellectual property (IP)** protection and enforcement. This decision comes amidst ongoing concerns regarding India's handling of IP security issues.
- The **Iranian Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC)** has introduced a **new kamikaze drone resembling Russia's Lancet drone.** This drone, yet to be named publicly, is designed for targeted attacks, akin to those witnessed in the Ukraine conflict.
- **Iraq's parliament recently passed a stringent law criminalizing same-sex relationships,** imposing a **maximum 15-year prison sentence.** The legislation, titled the Law on Combating Prostitution and Homosexuality, reflects a concerning trend of increased scrutiny and persecution of LGBT individuals in Iraq.
- **Humza Yousaf, Scotland's first Muslim First Minister** and leader of the Scottish National Party (SNP), has announced his resignation amid political turmoil.
- Sri Lanka, amidst a financial crisis stemming from a severe shortage of dollars, has taken a significant step by partially lifting import restrictions. This move aims to rejuvenate the economy, which has been struggling since March 2020.
- Dubai is embarking on an ambitious endeavor to construct the **world's largest airport, Al Maktoum International Airport,** boasting an unprecedented capacity to accommodate 260 million passengers annually, with 400 terminal gates and five parallel runways. **Spearheaded by Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum,** the project signifies Dubai's commitment to innovation and global connectivity.

International Current Affairs of May 2024

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- **Paleontologists from Argentina** have revealed the unearthing of a novel medium-sized herbivorous dinosaur, **Chakisaurus nekul**, which thrived approximately 90 million years ago during the Late Cretaceous period in **present-day Patagonia**. The finding, detailed in the journal Cretaceous Research, sheds light on a remarkable creature known for its speed and unique tail anatomy.
- In a triumphant display of dominance, **Paris Saint-Germain** secured their record **12th Ligue-1 title in the 2023-24 season**. The club's relentless pursuit of excellence saw them claim victory for the third consecutive year, further solidifying their stature as a powerhouse in French football. Under the astute leadership of **coach Luis Enrique**, PSG showcased their prowess with a commanding performance throughout the season.
- Zimbabwe has launched a new currency called the **ZiG** (short for **Zimbabwe Gold**) in an attempt to address the country's long-running **currency crisis**. The ZiG, backed by Zimbabwe's **gold reserves**, was introduced electronically in early April and has now been released in **banknote** and **coin** form.
- China is set to launch the **Chang'e-6 lunar probe** on a **round trip to the Moon**, marking a significant advancement in their space exploration. The mission aims to gather soil and rock samples from the far side of the Moon, providing crucial insights into its early evolution and the inner solar system.
- In a significant political development, the **Solomon Islands** has elected former Foreign Minister **Jeremiah Manele** as its new prime minister, indicating that the South Pacific island nation is likely to maintain close ties with China.
- **American Express** is set to inaugurate its expansive new campus in **Gurugram**, spanning nearly **one million square feet**, showcasing the company's commitment to fostering a vibrant work environment. The move signifies a strategic step in leveraging global expertise and local talent to drive innovation and value for customers worldwide.
- The Japanese men's under-23 football team etched their name in history by clinching the **AFC U-23 Asian Cup** for the second time, defeating Uzbekistan in a nail-biting final at the **Jassim bin Hamad Stadium** in Doha, Qatar. The solitary goal scored by substitute Yamada in injury time secured Japan's victory and qualification for the **2024 Paris Olympics**.
- In a groundbreaking endeavor, **China** has launched the **Chang'e-6 probe** on an ambitious mission to collect samples from the **far side of the Moon**. If successful, China will etch its name in history as the first country to retrieve lunar samples from the enigmatic far side, a feat yet unaccomplished by any other nation.
- In a significant political development, **José Raúl Mulino** has emerged victorious in Panama's presidential election, securing nearly **35%** of the counted votes with over **92%** of the ballots tallied. The 64-year-old former security minister has gained an unassailable 9% lead over his nearest rival, prompting three of his closest opponents to concede defeat.
- In a groundbreaking move that combines cutting-edge technology with diplomacy, **Ukraine** has unveiled an **AI-generated spokesperson**, named **Victoria Shi**, to deliver official statements from its foreign ministry. This significant technological leap in diplomatic communication has captured global attention.
- **Nepal's population growth rate** has hit a historic low, **standing at 0.92% per annum** over the past decade, the slowest in the last eighty years, as reported by the **National Statistics Office (NSO)**. The current population stands at approximately 29.2 million, with a growth of **2.7 million from mid-April 2011 to mid-April 2021**.
- **John Swinney**, a veteran of the **Scottish National Party (SNP)**, has been elected as the party's **new leader**, paving the way for him to succeed **Humza Yousaf** as Scotland's **First Minister**. Swinney emerged as the sole contender in the contest to pick a new premier, solidifying his position as a prominent figure in Scottish politics.
- As **Vladimir Putin** embarks on his **fifth term as President of Russia**, the nation finds itself at a critical juncture, with global attention keenly focused on the trajectory of **Putin's leadership and Russia's** evolving role on the world stage.
- The **Sri Lankan government** has approved an agreement with **Adani Green Energy**, led by **Gautam Adani**, for the development of **wind power stations** in **Mannar** and **Pooner**. The agreement was given the green light by the Sri Lankan cabinet on **May 7**. Under the **power purchase agreement**, which has a duration of **20 years**, Adani Green Energy will be paid **8.26 cents per kilowatt-hour (kWh)** for the electricity generated from the wind power stations.
- **Mahamat Idris Deby Itno**, **Chad's military dictator** and interim president, has secured victory in the presidential election held on May 6, 2024. This provisional result, announced by the **National Election Management Agency** on May 10, 2024, is poised to extend Deby's rule for another six years.
- In a widely anticipated move, Russian President **Vladimir Putin** has reappointed **Mikhail Mishustin** as the **Prime Minister** of Russia, subject to approval by the lower house of parliament, the **State Duma**. This decision comes as part of the legal procedure following Putin's inauguration for his fifth presidential term.

- The **European Union has passed its first-ever legislation** aimed at combating violence against women. The law mandates all EU member states to criminalize practices such as female genital mutilation, forced marriage, and online harassment. Despite unanimous agreement on the necessity of the legislation, disagreements arose regarding a common definition of rape. Despite this, the law marks a significant step forward in protecting women's rights across the EU.
- Japanese men's hockey team etched its name in the history books by clinching its **maiden Sultan Azlan Shah Trophy** title. The match against **Pakistan** ended in a 2-2 deadlock after regulation time, leading to a penalty shootout. Japan emerged victorious, defeating Pakistan 4-1 in the nerve-wracking shootout at the **Azlan Shah Stadium in Ipoh, Malaysia**, on 11 May 2024.
- **Russia** has claimed to have discovered massive oil and gas reserves in the **British Antarctic Territory**, a region currently protected under the 1959 Antarctic Treaty. According to evidence submitted to the Commons Environment Audit Committee, the reserves uncovered by Russian research ships contain around **511 billion barrels worth of oil**, a staggering amount equivalent to approximately **10 times the North Sea's output over the last 50 years**.
- In a strategic move aimed at positioning **Dubai** as a global gaming hub and bolstering its digital economy, **His Highness Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum**, the **Crown Prince of Dubai**, has unveiled the '**Dubai Gaming Visa**' as part of the **Dubai Program for Gaming 2033**.
- China's industrial output grew by **6.7% year-on-year in April**, a significant **increase from the 4.5% growth recorded in March**. This robust growth, as reported by the National Bureau of Statistics (NBS) on Friday, exceeded analysts' expectations of a 5.5% rise, indicating a strengthening recovery in the manufacturing sector.
- **Nepalese Prime Minister Pushpa Kamal Dahal, also known as Prachanda**, is set to seek his fourth vote of confidence on Monday amidst turmoil in parliament. The Janata Samajbadi Party Nepal has withdrawn its support within 18 months of Dahal taking office, prompting this latest confidence vote.
- Hundreds of residents **near Mount Ibu**, an active volcano on **Halmahera island in eastern Indonesia**, have been evacuated following a significant increase in volcanic activity. Authorities raised the alert status to the highest level after two consecutive days of massive eruptions, prompting precautionary measures to ensure the safety of local communities.
- India and the UAE recently concluded a significant meeting focused on the **India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEEC)**. The meeting, held under the Intergovernmental Framework Agreement, aimed at enhancing cooperation for the development and operationalization of the corridor. This initiative is set to provide alternative supply routes, generating efficiencies and reducing costs.
- In the latest move against perceived infringements on its territorial claims, China has sanctioned **Boeing and two other US defense companies** for their involvement in **arms sales to Taiwan**. The announcement came on the day of Taiwan's presidential inauguration, highlighting tensions in the region.
- **Venezuela** has recently witnessed a poignant environmental milestone, marking a grim reality of the climate crisis. The nation has likely become the **first in modern history to lose all its glaciers**, with the reclassification of the Humboldt glacier as an ice field, its final icy vestige, earlier this month.
- **Japanese consortium** has unveiled the prototype of what is touted to be the **world's first high-speed 6G device**, promising data transfer rates at lightning speed. This groundbreaking innovation opens the door to a realm of possibilities previously unimaginable.
- In a proud moment for Kannadigas and dairy farmers in Karnataka, the **Scotland cricket** team has unveiled its **new ICC T20 World Cup** jersey adorned with the **Karnataka Milk Federation's (KMF) Nandini logo**. This collaboration signifies a significant milestone, bridging the worlds of cricket and dairy in a unique partnership.
- **Iran** mourns its **President Ebrahim Raisi, Foreign Minister Hossein Amir-Abdollahian**, and other officials who were killed in a **helicopter crash in northwest Iran**. This incident occurs amidst heightened tensions in West Asia, notably the ongoing conflict between **Israel and Gaza** and the broader geopolitical confrontations involving Iran, Israel, and the US.
- **Lai Ching-te was sworn in as Taiwan's new President** in a ceremony on Monday after winning the election earlier this year. He succeeds **Tsai Ing-wen**, who led Taiwan through eight years marked by economic and social progress despite the COVID-19 pandemic and China's increasing military threats.
- **To Lam**, Vietnam's former minister of public security, has been confirmed as the nation's new president by the National Assembly. His rise comes amid an ongoing **anti-corruption campaign** that has shaken the country's political establishment and business elites, resulting in multiple high-level government changes.
- Spain has officially become the **99th member of the International Solar Alliance (ISA)**. The Instrument of Ratification was handed over by Spain's Ambassador to India, José María Ridao Domínguez, to Abhishek Singh, Joint Secretary in the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**, during a meeting in New Delhi.
- The **European Union** has given the **final green light to the AI Act**, marking a historic step in regulating artificial intelligence. This groundbreaking legislation establishes comprehensive rules to ensure trust, transparency, and accountability in AI technologies while fostering innovation within Europe.

- Amid the ongoing **Israel-Hamas conflict**, Ireland, Norway, and Spain have formally recognized Palestine as a state. In response, Israel has recalled its ambassadors to Ireland and Norway, with warnings directed at Spain. This move adds to the diplomatic tensions amidst the escalating **violence in Gaza**.
- **Klaus Schwab**, founder and executive chairman of the **World Economic Forum (WEF)**, will transition from his current role to become chairman of the board of trustees by January next year, according to an emailed statement from the Geneva-based institution. This move is part of a planned **"governance evolution"** from a founder-managed organization to one where the president and the managing board assume full executive responsibility.
- **UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan** awarded the **First-Class Medal of Independence to Jose Aguero Avila**, Ambassador of the Republic of Paraguay to the UAE, on the occasion of the end of his tenure as ambassador to the country.
- The **University of Tokyo** has inaugurated the **Atacama Observatory (TAO)**, which has been awarded a Guinness World Record for being the **highest observatory in the world**. Situated at a staggering **5,640 meters above sea level** on the summit of Cerro Chajnantor in the Antofagasta Region of Chile, TAO stands as a testament to human ingenuity and determination.
- In a move that reflects the strengthening ties between India and the Maldives, the island nation has announced its intention to launch **India's RuPay service**. This decision underscores the growing economic and financial cooperation between the two countries. While the specific launch date for the RuPay service has not yet been disclosed, the upcoming integration holds promise for enhanced financial inclusivity and cost-saving measures.
- **Saudi Arabia's** appointment of **Faisal bin Saud Al-Mejfel as its ambassador to Syria** signifies a significant shift in bilateral relations, marking the first such appointment in over a decade. This move comes amidst a period of thawing relations between the two nations following years of estrangement sparked by the Syrian civil war.
- In a resounding victory, **Lithuanian President Gitanas Nausėda** has clinched a second term, triumphing over **Prime Minister Ingrida Šimonytė**. With preliminary results indicating Nausėda's commanding lead with 74.5% of the votes, his reelection underscores broad support for his moderate conservative stance and unwavering advocacy for Ukraine.
- **Ghana's Next-Gen Infrastructure Company (NGIC)** collaborates with Reliance Jio's subsidiary, Tech Mahindra, and Nokia to bolster its **4G and 5G capabilities**. With a focus on emulating India's telecom success, Ghana aims to enhance connectivity and digital services across various sectors.
- **Nepalese climber Purnima Shrestha** has achieved the extraordinary accomplishment of **climbing Mount Everest three times** during the current season. Shrestha, who works as a photojournalist, successfully summited the world's highest peak on **May 12, May 19, and May 25**.
- **Chad**, a north-central African nation, has witnessed a significant transition in leadership as **Mahamat Idriss Deby** was sworn in as the country's new president. Deby's ascension to power marks the end of three years of **military rule in the oil-rich but impoverished nation**.
- A devastating landslide in the remote village of **Yambali** in the **Enga Province of Papua New Guinea** has buried an entire village, resulting in a catastrophic loss of life. According to the United Nations agency International Organization for Migration (IOM), more than **670 people** have died, and over **2000** are feared trapped under the soil.
- Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) has forged a significant technology partnership with **Norway's Nel ASA** to expedite its foray into new energy investments. This alliance is poised to play a pivotal role in facilitating RIL's transition towards green energy, particularly through the production of green hydrogen.
- Russia is set to remove the **Taliban from its list of banned terrorist organizations**, three years after the group regained power in Afghanistan. This move, reported by state-run **RIA Novosti** news agency, comes after years of Russia fostering relations with the Taliban, including holding multiple rounds of talks and boosting trade despite international sanctions.
- In a significant move to fortify **Ukraine's defense capabilities against Russia**, Sweden has announced the donation of two Saab Airborne **Surveillance and Control (ASC) 890 aircraft**. These radar surveillance planes will play a crucial role in enhancing Ukraine's long-range target identification capabilities and supporting the integration of F-16 fighter jets provided by other Western nations.



International Current Affairs of June 2024

- **China's space agency** announced on 4 June 2024 that BEIJING- **China's Chang'e-6** probe has lifted off from the far side of the moon, starting its journey back towards Earth. China is getting closer to being the first nation to return samples from the far side of the moon, which is always facing away from Earth, thanks to the probe's successful exit from the moon.
- **Dr. Helen Mary Roberts**, a **Christian lady**, became the first woman to be promoted to the rank of one-star officer in **Pakistan's 77-year military history**. Her ascension coincides with increased attention being paid to atrocities against minorities in the nation with a majority of Muslims, particularly against Christians. In a historic move, the Pakistani Army elevated Dr. Helen Mary Roberts, a **Christian woman**, to the esteemed **rank of Brigadier** in the nation with a majority of Muslims.
- In a **historic moment** for Mexico, **Claudia Sheinbaum** has been elected as the country's first woman president, according to the provisional results announced by the Mexican election commission. Sheinbaum, from the ruling **Morena party**, has taken an unassailable lead over her nearest rivals in the presidential contest held on **June 2, 2024**.
- Pakistan has launched its second satellite, the Multi-Mission Communication Satellite (**PAKSAT MM1**), in **collaboration with China**. This satellite aims to enhance internet connectivity across Pakistan and improve various communication services.
- **South Korea** has officially launched its space agency, the **Korea AeroSpace Administration (KASA)**, to lead policy and industrial development in its aerospace sector. The establishment was made possible after the Country's national assembly **passed a special law** in January to unify government organizations in charge of space policy and projects. The new agency is based in **Sacheon, South Gyeongsang Province**, with an **annual budget of 758.9 billion won (\$556 million)**.
- Amidst tightening Western sanctions, **India's reliance on Russian oil** has seen a significant shift. Despite a decline in imports due to sanctions-related challenges, Russia has maintained its position as India's leading oil supplier for the second consecutive year.
- **Roscosmos state corporation cosmonaut Oleg Kononenko**, who currently works at the **International Space Station** has **booked a record of 1,000 days** for the **first time in the world** in terms of total spaceflight duration.
- **12 countries signed the Zero Debris Charter**, a landmark initiative led by the **European Space Agency (ESA)** to address the pressing issue of space debris. Unveiled in 2023, the Charter commits signatories to achieving **debris-neutral space activities by 2030**.
- The **Bank of England** is replacing old banknotes featuring **Queen Elizabeth** with new ones featuring **King Charles III**. People can exchange their old notes for new ones **until June 30, with a limit of £300**.
- **Sheikh Meshal** recently dissolved parliament for as many as **four years** amid the widespread political dysfunction that's gripped Kuwait. **Kuwait Emir** named the small nation's **new crown prince**, nearly six months after he took the throne. **Sheikh Sabah Khalid Al Sabah** will become next in line to the throne.
- India, the United States, South Korea, Japan, and the European Union have launched a **Biopharmaceuticals Alliance**, with its first meeting held in **San Diego, USA**, during the **Bio International Convention 2024**, the **world's largest pharmaceutical exhibition**.
- On **June 6, 2024**, the **United Nations General Assembly** convened to **elect new non-permanent members** to the UN Security Council. **Pakistan, Somalia, Panama, Denmark, and Greece** secured seats for a two-year term starting **January 1, 2025**, replacing **Japan, Malta, Mozambique, Ecuador, and Switzerland**. These newly elected members will join Algeria, Guyana, the Republic of Korea, Sierra Leone, and Slovenia as the other non-permanent members.
- The main tunnel of the **900 MW Arun III Hydropower Project**, being constructed with Indian assistance has achieved a breakthrough, with Nepal Prime Minister **Pushpakamal Dahal 'Prachanda'** on **June 5**, triggering the last blast to mark the completion of heading excavation. **Prime Minister 'Prachanda'** attended an event to mark the completion of heading excavation for the **11.8 km-long Head Race Tunnel of the 900 MW Arun- 3 Hydro Electric Project in the Sankhuwasabha District in eastern Nepal**.
- A **700-metre pedestrian bridge**, inaugurated on **June 4**. The Bridge of National Unity is **one of the longest bridges in the world**. The **eastern Hungarian city of Satoraljaújhely** has a **new tourist attraction**.
- The **UN General Assembly (UNGA)** on June 6, elected former Cameroonian **Prime Minister Philemon Yang** as president of the **79th UNGA session**. Yang will succeed **Denis Francis of Trinidad and Tobago**, president of the **78th UNGA session**, when the 79th UNGA session opens on Sept. 10 at the **UN headquarters in New York**.
- The **European Commission (EC)** has made a significant decision regarding **Tanzania's eligibility** for a conservation grant under its **NaturAfrica initiative**. This decision has implications for **conservation efforts in East Africa**, particularly concerning the **Eastern Rift Savannas and Watersheds (ERiSaWa)** component of the initiative.
- Portugal plans to adapt its **golden visa scheme** to allow wealthy foreigners seeking residency rights to invest in affordable housing for locals or accommodation for migrants.

- In response to his party's heavy loss in the European Parliamentary elections, **French President Emmanuel Macron** has dissolved the **National Assembly** and called for **snap parliamentary elections**. The far-right **Rassemblement National (RN)** secured a significant victory, **winning 31.5%** of the vote compared to **Macron's Renaissance Party's 15.2%**. Macron announced the dissolution of the National Assembly in an hour-long national address, citing the need to restore trust in the French electoral process.
- **Russia and Belarus** have commenced the second stage of joint drills focused on **tactical nuclear weapons**, aimed at bolstering readiness and deterring Western support for Ukraine. These exercises, initiated by Moscow in response to perceived provocations from Western officials, underline the Kremlin's strategic stance amid heightened tensions.
- **Armenian Prime Minister Nikol Pashinyan** has announced Armenia's decision to leave the **Collective Security Treaty Organization (CSTO)**, a Russian-led military alliance. Pashinyan cited the alliance's perceived favoritism towards Azerbaijan during the Nagorno-Karabakh conflict as a primary reason for Armenia's withdrawal.
- The World Health Organisation (WHO) has designated the **National Institute of Indian Medical Heritage (NIIMH) in Hyderabad**, under the **Ministry of Ayush**, as a WHO Collaborating Centre (CC) for traditional medicine research. **Established in 1956**, NIIMH has been a pioneer in various digital initiatives of Ayush. This recognition, announced on Friday, has been granted for a period of four years, marking NIIMH as the third Indian institute to receive such an honor.
- The G7 has agreed to leverage frozen Russian assets to secure a **\$50 billion loan for Ukraine** to aid in its **defense against Russian invasion**. **US President Joe Biden** emphasized this move as a firm stance against **Russia**, while **President Vladimir Putin** condemned it as theft.
- In a ceremony marked by heightened security following an assassination attempt on **Prime Minister Robert Fico**, **Peter Pellegrini** has been inaugurated as **Slovakia's sixth president**.
- **South African President Cyril Ramaphosa** was reelected by lawmakers for a **second term** on June 14, after his party struck a dramatic late coalition deal with a former political foe just hours before the vote. Ramaphosa won the vote against **Julius Malema**, leader of the far-left **Economic Freedom Fighters**, winning 283 votes to Malema's 44.
- The **Israeli Navy** on June 16, received the second of two new landing craft from a shipyard in the **United States**, with the vessel mooring at the **Haifa Naval Base** after making a lengthy voyage to the country. The US-built **INS Komemiyut** was the Navy's second landing craft, after the **INS Nahshon**, which was received in early October last year.
- **Chinese scientists** have made a significant breakthrough in solar research through the use of their solar exploration satellite, the **Chinese H-alpha Solar Explorer (CHASE)**, which has led to the discovery of a new pattern of **solar atmospheric rotation**.
- In 2023, the **world's nuclear-armed nations** witnessed significant developments in their arsenals, with a notable increase in spending on nuclear weapons. The **Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI)** highlighted that the United States led global expenditures, followed by **China and Russia**. This surge in investment underscores a growing reliance on nuclear deterrence strategies reminiscent of the **Cold War era**.
- **State-run Coal India Ltd (COALNS)**, opens new tab is exploring **lithium blocks** in **Argentina** along with a **U.S. company** to secure supplies of the battery material, an Indian source with direct knowledge said on June 18.
- **Thailand** will become the **first nation in Southeast Asia** to legalize **same-sex marriage** after the kingdom's Senate approved a **marriage equality bill** on June 18, with supporters calling it a "**monumental step forward for LGBTQ+ rights**."
- The **United Kingdom (UK)** has overtaken China to become **India's fourth-largest export market** in May 2024, commerce department data showed. The UK was India's **sixth-largest export destination** in **May last year**. While exports to the UK grew by a third to **\$1.37 billion** in May, the shipments to China saw **3 per cent growth at \$1.33 billion** last month.
- According to the **Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI)**, China has significantly increased its nuclear warhead count, rising from 410 in 2023 to 500 at the beginning of this year. The growth suggests a rapid expansion of China's nuclear capabilities, positioning it as the fastest-growing nuclear power globally.
- On June 19, the upper house of the Tajikistan parliament, **Majlisi Milli**, passed a law prohibiting "**alien garments**," which primarily targets the hijab and other traditional Islamic clothing. The **lower chamber, Majlisi Namoyandagon**, had passed the bill on May 8. This move has sparked debate among Tajikistan's predominantly Muslim population in the tightly governed ex-Soviet republic.

International Current Affairs of July 2024

- On **July 3**, **Japan** will introduce new banknotes featuring what it claims to be the world's pioneering use of **advanced holography**. This technology creates the illusion of historic figures' portraits rotating in **3D** on the bills, serving as a key anti-counterfeit measure. This marks the **first redesign of the banknotes in 20 years**.
- On June 30 and July 1, 2024, the world witnessed a significant event in international relations. The **third United Nations Conference on Afghanistan** took place in

Doha, Qatar, marking the first time the **Taliban** participated in such talks since taking control of Afghanistan.

- China has constructed a **new presidential palace in Vanuatu**, symbolizing the strengthening relationship between the two nations. The **Vanuatu Prime Minister, Charlot Salwai**, inaugurated the new building, which is part of a broader project that includes a new finance ministry and renovations to the foreign affairs department.
- More than **300 domestic companies** and over **100 foreign buyers** from the **US, Germany and other countries** are expected to participate in the four-day international toy fair **beginning on July 6** in the national capital. More than **250 Indian brands** will display their products during the fair, which is being organised at **Pragati Maidan Delhi**.
- Hungary has assumed the rotating presidency of the Council of the European Union for the next six months. Under the leadership of **Prime Minister Viktor Orban**, Hungary aims to prioritize EU competitiveness, defense policy, migration control, and agricultural reform. The presidency's motto, **"Make Europe Great Again,"** reflects a stance emphasizing unity and proactive global engagement.
- Former spy chief **Dick Schoof** is the new **Dutch prime minister**, leading a right-wing coalition with a focus on implementing the **"strictest-ever"** immigration policy. Schoof, 67, previously headed the **Dutch Secret Service** and takes over from Mark Rutte, who served 14 years in power.
- **Russia** has approved the schedule for the creation of a **Russian orbital station by 2033**. The schedule includes the design and construction of the space modules, flight tests of a new-generation manned spaceship, the creation of launch vehicles and space infrastructure on **Earth**, and a timetable for the work of **scientific institutes** supporting the project.
- **Keir Starmer**, born in 1963 to a working-class family near London, is set to **become Britain's next Prime Minister**. With a background in human rights law and public prosecution, he entered politics relatively late, becoming an MP in 2015.
- **Masoud Pezeshkian**, a seasoned lawmaker and cardiac surgeon, has emerged victorious in **Iran's presidential election**, defeating hardliner Saeed Jalili.
- **Rachel Reeves** has become the **first woman finance minister of UK**. The 45-year-old is an economist and has pledged to grow the nation's economy. Rachel was appointed as the chancellor on June 5, after the **Keir Starmer-led Labour Party** won a majority in Thursday's general election. She is now in charge of the **UK's Budget**.

- **India and Russia** have set a target to increase **bilateral trade to \$100 billion by 2030**, emphasizing economic collaboration in energy, trade, manufacturing, and fertilizers. Discussions included balancing trade, reducing non-tariff barriers, and exploring an **India-Eurasian Economic Union Free Trade Area**.
- The **Colombo Security Conclave (CSC)**, a regional security grouping, welcomed **Bangladesh** as its **fifth member** at the **8th Deputy National Security Adviser (DNSA)** level meeting hosted virtually by Mauritius. The CSC includes India, Sri Lanka, Mauritius, and the Maldives, with Seychelles participating as an Observer State.
- As of June 30, 2024, Ireland has overtaken Mauritius to secure the fourth spot among preferred destinations for **Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs)** routing funds into India. **Ireland boasts assets under custody (AUC) totaling Rs 4.41 trillion**, slightly edging out Mauritius which recorded Rs 4.39 trillion. The shift highlights Ireland's appeal, with a 26% increase in AUC in the first half of the year compared to Mauritius' 11% uptick.
- In a comprehensive study conducted by InterNations in 2024, **Vietnam** has once again secured its position as the **most affordable destination for expatriates**. This marks the fourth consecutive year that the Southeast Asian nation has topped the list, solidifying its reputation as a prime location for those seeking an economical lifestyle abroad.
- **K.P. Sharma Oli** on July 15 was sworn in as **Nepal's Prime Minister** for the **fourth time**. The leader of Nepal's largest communist party was appointed Nepal's Prime Minister on July 14, by **President Ram Chandra Paudel** to lead a new coalition government that faces the daunting challenge of providing political stability in the Himalayan nation.
- The **Philippines** has been chosen to host the board of the **"Loss and Damage"** fund created by **U.N.** talks, marking another step towards providing financial help for countries to recover and rebuild from the impact of global warming. Last month, the **World Bank's board** approved a plan for the bank to act as interim host of the fund for four years.
- A new **high-quality malaria vaccine** developed by the **Serum Institute of India** and the **University of Oxford** is officially being rolled out in **Africa**. With this, **Côte d'Ivoire** has become the **first country in West Africa** to start **administering R21/Matrix-M**.
- **President Paul Kagame** has secured a decisive victory in **Rwanda's 2024 presidential election**, capturing 99.15% of the votes, as reported by the National Electoral Commission. This marks his fourth consecutive term in office.

- **Roberta Metsola**, a prominent **Maltese politician**, has secured a historic **second term as President of the European Parliament**, making her the first woman to achieve this feat in the EU assembly's history. Known for her leadership and advocacy, Metsola garnered significant support from EU politicians, receiving **562 out of 623 votes in her favor**.
- The **annual Kataragama Esala festival** is being celebrated in **Sri Lanka**. Devotees who started their **Pada Yatra** in May have reached Kataragama completing a **journey of over 500 kilometres** across difficult terrain on foot from as far afield as **Jaffna in Sri Lanka's northern peninsula**.
- Belarus has announced a new visa-free regime allowing citizens from **35 European countries** to stay in the country for up to **90 days per year**. This policy, effective from July 19, 2024, is seen as an attempt by Minsk to ease tensions with the West, following recent geopolitical shifts and ongoing sanctions.
- **Ivory Coast (Côte d'Ivoire)** has recently become the **53rd Party to the 1992 UN Water Convention**, officially known as the **Convention on the Protection and Use of Transboundary Watercourses and International Lakes**. This accession marks Ivory Coast as the 10th African nation to join the treaty. The move highlights a growing trend among African nations to enhance cooperative water management amidst increasing water stress and climate change impacts.
- **China** has built the **world's first passenger train** made from carbon fibre, a material that makes it much lighter and more energy-efficient than conventional trains.
- **Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy** spoke with Estonia's newly elected **Prime Minister Kristen Michal** on his first day in office, July 22.
- The **Israeli Knesset** has approved a bill to designate the **United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestinian Refugees (UNRWA)** as a terrorist organization.
- The **International Olympic Committee** named the **French Alps** as the host for the **2030 Winter Games** on July 24, though the decision is subject to certain conditions.
- **Salt Lake City** in **Utah** state of the **USA** will host the **Winter Olympics and Paralympics Games in 2034**. The decision was taken by the IOC Members during the **142nd IOC Session in Paris** here on July 24.
- **Azerbaijan**, hosting **COP29 from November 11 to 22 this year**, has announced the creation of a **Climate Finance Action Fund (CFAF)**.
- India is hosting the **World Heritage Committee Meeting** for the first time. It takes place from **21 to 31 July 2024**, at **Bharat Mandapam** in **New Delhi**.
- The **UNESCO World Heritage committee** on July 27 decided to register Japan's controversial **Sado** gold mine as a cultural heritage site.
- **TIME magazine** has highlighted three Indian destinations in its prestigious list of **'World's Greatest Places of 2024.'**

International Current Affairs of August 2024

- The **Neelakurinji** (*Strobilanthes kunthiana*), a remarkable flowering shrub native to the montane grasslands of southwest India, has recently been added to the **International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List of Threatened Species**.
- In a groundbreaking discovery, archaeologists may have uncovered the **world's oldest solar calendar** at the renowned archaeological site of **Göbekli Tepe** in southern Turkey.
- **India and Australia** recently held two significant **bilateral meetings** to enhance their Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. Australia hosted the **6th India-Australia Maritime Security Dialogue in Canberra**, while India hosted the **14th India-Australia Joint Working Group on Counter-Terrorism in New Delhi**.
- Germany's recent inclusion in the U.S.-led United Nations Command (UNC) in South Korea marks a significant expansion of the command's member states, now totaling 18 nations.
- **Sweden** has confirmed its **first case of the mpox Clade I variant**, marking the first occurrence of this more dangerous strain outside Africa.
- A **human rights team** from the **United Nations** will visit Dhaka next week to discuss with the **Bangladesh interim government**, investigations into the human rights violations during the recent **unrest in Bangladesh**.
- The ICC has announced the relocation of the **Women's T20 World Cup 2024 from Bangladesh to the United Arab Emirates (UAE)** due to significant safety concerns.
- The Environmental Strategic Partnership between **India and Denmark** has launched a **Smart Laboratory on Clean Rivers (SLCR)** with initial funding of **Rs 16.8 crore from the Jal Shakti Ministry** and an additional **Rs 5 crore from Denmark**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** pledged extensive humanitarian support and handed over four **BHISHM (Bharat Health Initiative for Sahyog Hita and Maitri)** Cubes to the Ukrainian government.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi's visit to Poland** marked a historic moment as it was the **first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to the country in 45 years**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** has wrapped up his **trip to Ukraine**. Modi became the first Indian prime minister to make a state visit to Ukraine since the two countries established relations over three decades ago.
- **North Korean leader Kim Jong Un** recently unveiled a new type of **"suicide drone,"** with state media reporting that he personally oversaw a performance test of the weaponry.
- **India and Indonesia** have reaffirmed their commitment to combating terrorism, including addressing the misuse of new and **emerging technologies by terrorists**. During the sixth meeting of the India-Indonesia Joint Working Group on **Counter-Terrorism held in Jakarta**.

- The 24th International Mother Teresa Awards Ceremony took place on August 26, 2024, at **Millennium Plaza Dubai**, marking the **114th birth anniversary** of the esteemed humanitarian.
- **Typhoon Shanshan** made landfall on **Japan's southwestern main island of Kyushu** on August 29.
- Singapore Airlines on August 30, said it has received **approval from the Indian government** for the foreign direct investment as part of the proposed merger of **Vistara with Air India**. This deal will create one of the **world's largest airline groups**.
- **WHO** has declared **Dhulikhel Municipality of Kavrepalanchok district** as **Nepal's first 'healthy city' and second healthiest city in Asia**. Since 2014, **Dhulikhel Municipality** has implemented various programmes to achieve the status.
- The **United Nations** has allocated **\$100 million** from the **Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF)** to address **critical humanitarian needs in 10 countries** across Africa, the Middle East, Asia, and the Caribbean. Acting UN humanitarian chief Joyce Msuya emphasized the dire need for this funding, noting that a lack of resources is hindering aid agencies from providing essential life-saving assistance.

International Current Affairs of September 2024

- **Super Typhoon Yagi**, the **most powerful storm** to hit Asia in over a decade, has caused significant disruption across Southeast Asia. After devastating the northern Philippines, the typhoon made landfall in **southern China's Hainan province**, leading to mass evacuations and widespread damage. Yagi is expected to continue its path towards Vietnam and Laos, impacting northern regions with severe weather conditions.
- The British government has announced plans to erect a **national memorial for Queen Elizabeth II in St James's Park, London**. This site was chosen due to its historical significance and its close connection to the late monarch, who passed away on September 8, 2022, after over seven decades on the throne.
- French President **Emmanuel Macron** has made a significant political decision by appointing **Michel Barnier**, the former EU Brexit negotiator, as France's new Prime Minister on September 5, 2024. This appointment comes after an extended period of political uncertainty and marks a crucial moment in France's ongoing efforts to form a stable government.
- **Algerian President Abdelmadjid Tebboune** has been re-elected for a second term with 95% of the vote, according to the **country's electoral authority, ANIE**. The official results indicate that Tebboune received 94.65% of the vote, while his opponents, **Abdelaali Hassani Cherif** and **Youssef Aouchiche**, garnered **3% and 2%** respectively. Voter turnout was reported at 48%, with more than 24 million Algerians registered to vote.
- **Israel's Tower Semiconductor** and **India's Adani Group** are set to **invest 839.47 billion rupees (\$10 billion)** in a semiconductor manufacturing project in Maharashtra. The initiative highlights India's push to become a global hub for chip production, despite previous challenges such as Foxconn's withdrawal from a \$19.5 billion joint venture with Vedanta and stalled plans by ISMC to invest \$3 billion.
- In a solemn and significant ceremony held today at the **Office of the President, Sheetal Niwas, Ashok Raj Sigdel** was officially sworn in as the **45th Chief of the Army Staff (CoAS)** of the **Nepali Army**. This momentous occasion marks a new chapter in Nepal's military leadership and underscores the nation's commitment to its armed forces.
- Nepal has become the **101st** country to join the International Solar Alliance (ISA) as a full member. The Ministry of External Affairs said that Nepal handed over its **Instrument of Ratification to the ISA in New Delhi** on 9th September.
- Mexico became the world's first country to **allow voters to elect judges at all levels** after protesters invaded the upper house and suspended debate on the issue. The reform was approved with 86 votes in favor and 41 against, garnering the two-thirds majority needed to amend the constitution.
- **United States of America's president Joe Biden** will host leaders from QUAD members of other countries like India, Japan and Australia in Wilmington, Delaware on 21st September in the USA.
- The United Nations General Assembly provides an opportunity to member states a unique forum for multilateral discussions on international issues, this year **79th session of UNGA started on 10th September**. **Philemon Yang from Cameroon** is the new president of UNGA this year.
- Algeria has been officially authorized to join the **BRICS New Development Bank (NDB)**, as announced by the bank's president, **Dilma Rousseff**, during the **ninth annual meeting in Cape Town**. The NDB, established by the BRICS countries (Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa) in 2015, aims to support infrastructure and sustainable development projects in emerging economies and developing nations.
- Iran launched its **Chamran-1 research satellite** into orbit on Saturday, its **second successful satellite** launch this year, taking another step in advancing its aerospace programme reported by the state media.
- **Typhoon Bebinca** strikes many countries, as it looks dangerous, it has already striked in the **Philippines, Japan and will hit Shanghai** city in China soon.
- **Jordan's King Abdullah II** has accepted the resignation of **Prime Minister Bisher al-Khasawneh** following last

week's parliamentary elections. **Al-Khasawneh**, a seasoned diplomat who had been in office since October 2020, resigned in accordance with the constitutional norm after legislative elections. Jafar Hassan, a technocrat and former planning minister who was serving as the king's head of office, has been appointed as the new prime minister.

- The World Health Organization (WHO) has officially recognized Jordan as the first country globally to eliminate leprosy, marking a significant milestone in public health. **WHO Director-General Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus** praised this achievement, emphasizing the collective efforts to stop transmission and reduce the stigma associated with leprosy.
- **Nepal** marked a significant milestone in its democratic journey by celebrating the **ninth anniversary** of the declaration of its constitution. The nation erupted in jubilant festivities, with the capital city of Kathmandu at the epicenter of the celebrations.
- **Anura Kumara Dissanayake** has emerged as **Sri Lanka's newly elected president**, securing 42% of the vote in the country's first election since the 2022 economic collapse.
- **China will hold joint naval and air drills with Russia in the Sea of Japan and the Sea of Okhotsk** along with the two countries carrying out a joint maritime patrol in the Pacific.
- Amid the growing tension in the Middle-East, Iran for the first time has showcased the **Shahed 136B drone and Jihad ballistic missile**.
- The **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** has taken a significant step to support Pakistan's struggling economy by approving a new **\$7 billion loan**. This decision, announced on Wednesday, comes more than two months after initial negotiations between the IMF and Pakistani authorities reached a staff-level agreement.
- **Dassault Aviation**, the renowned French aircraft manufacturer famous for its **Rafale fighter planes**, has taken a significant step towards expanding its presence in the Indian market. On Wednesday, the company announced the establishment of a new subsidiary dedicated exclusively to military **Maintenance, Repair, and Overhaul (MRO)** operations in India.
- **Thailand** the **third place in Asia**, after Taiwan and Nepal, to allow same-sex marriage. The bill grants full legal, financial and medical rights for marriage partners of any gender. **Thailand's landmark marriage equality bill was officially written into law allowing same-sex couples to legally wed.**
- **The iconic Shah Alam Stadium**, one of Malaysia's premier sports venues with a seating capacity of **80,372**, met its demise as concerns over its safety rendered it unfit for use. **Established in 1994**, the stadium not only served as the backdrop for exhilarating football matches but also hosted globally renowned concerts.

- **Shigeru Ishiba**, former defence minister, is poised to become **Japan's next prime minister** after winning the **Liberal Democratic Party's (LDP) leadership vote**. Ishiba will succeed Fumio Kishida, who stepped down following scandals that damaged his tenure. With the LDP holding a majority in the lower house, Ishiba's path to the role is effectively secured. He edged out economic security minister Sanae Takaichi by a narrow margin of **21 votes** in the leadership race.
- **NATO plans to set up a new land command in Finland near the Russian border in 2025**, to lead land force operations in northern Europe during potential military conflicts. **Finland, which joined NATO last year** after Russia's invasion of Ukraine in 2022, is preparing for the alliance's presence on its territory.

International Current Affairs of October 2024

- **NATO plans to set up a new land command in Finland near the Russian border in 2025**, to lead land force operations in northern Europe during potential military conflicts. **Finland, which joined NATO last year** after Russia's invasion of Ukraine in 2022, is preparing for the alliance's presence on its territory.
- Foreign Minister of Israel Katz announced that they decided to declare the U.N. Secretary-General António Guterres an undesirable personality in Israel and to ban his entry into Israel. Israel has declared UN chief António Guterres banning him from entry for "failing" to condemn Iran's missile attacks on Israel.
- The first shipment of **100 land-based Harpoon anti-ship missile systems ordered from the United States** has reportedly arrived in **Kaohsiung, Taiwan**, marking a significant milestone in the island's defense capabilities. The equipment was unloaded at Kaohsiung Port on September 27.
- **Claudia Sheinbaum** made history by being **sworn in as Mexico's first female president**, marking a significant milestone for the nation. Taking office after outgoing president Andrés Manuel López Obrador, her close ally from the Morena party, Sheinbaum's leadership symbolizes a continuation of progressive policies.
- The redrawing of borders between **Italy and Switzerland** is a striking response to the **rapid melting of glaciers caused by climate change**. As global temperatures rise, glaciers in the Alps are shrinking, leading to shifts in natural watershed lines that have historically defined the frontier between these two countries. This agreement, made official by Switzerland on September 27, 2024, follows a recommendation from a commission formed in 2023 to assess climate impacts on glaciers. Italy is expected to approve the changes soon, which primarily affect regions around the **Matterhorn**.

- Nepal's President Ramchandra Paudel on Sunday appointed **Prakash Man Singh Raut as the new Chief Justice** of the country. Paudel administered the oath of office and secrecy to Chief Justice Raut at a special ceremony organized at Sheetal Niwas, the President's Office.
- After **181 years of horse racing**, **Singapore** hosted its final race day at the **Singapore Turf Club** on Saturday, as the site prepares to be repurposed for new housing developments. This decision, influenced by the growing population surpassing six million, marks a significant shift in the city-state's approach to land use, prioritizing housing over recreational activities.
- The recent inauguration of a new runway at **Hanimadhoo International Airport** and the launch of the **RuPay card** in the Maldives signify a pivotal moment in the evolving relationship between **India and the Maldives**. Conducted through a virtual ceremony, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Maldivian President Mohamed Muizzu marked these developments as essential steps to enhance economic ties and boost tourism cooperation.
- **Bangladesh's interim government** has established a **nine-member Constitution Reform Commission**, headed by **Bangladeshi-American professor Ali Riaz**, to review and propose reforms within 90 days. The commission, formed after Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina resigned, aims to create a more representative and democratic framework. Members include professors, legal experts, and student representatives, with student **Mahfuj Alam** serving as special assistant to **Chief Adviser Muhammad Yunus**.
- President **Kais Saied** has secured a second **five-year term** as Tunisia's leader in an election marked by both overwhelming numbers and significant concerns. The Independent High Authority for Elections of Tunisia (ISIE) announced on October 7, 2024, that Saied had won a staggering **90.7 percent** of the votes cast, a figure that has raised eyebrows among democratic observers worldwide.
- The World Health Organization (WHO) has officially validated India's elimination of trachoma as a public health problem, marking a significant achievement in public health. **Trachoma, caused by the bacterium Chlamydia trachomatis**, is one of the leading causes of global blindness. **WHO Director-General Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus** praised India for its commitment to combating this debilitating disease, joining the ranks of Nepal and Myanmar in the WHO South-East Asia Region and 19 other countries worldwide that have achieved this milestone.
- **Beijing is systematically increasing pressure on Taiwan through a multifaceted strategy** that military officials describe as the **"Anaconda Strategy,"** aimed at compelling Taipei to accept reunification as inevitable.
- The **UN General Assembly (UNGA)** has elected **18 new members** to the **47-member Human Rights Council** for the **2025-2027 term**. This election, conducted via secret ballot, includes countries such as **Benin, Bolivia, Colombia, Cyprus, Qatar, and Thailand**. The newly elected members will start their three-year terms on **January 1, 2025**. Based in **Geneva**, the Human Rights Council is vital for promoting and protecting human rights worldwide. The elections emphasize a commitment to staggered terms, ensuring continuity in the Council's composition.
- **Nicaragua** has officially severed **diplomatic relations with Israel**, a move announced by **Vice President Rosario Murillo** following a congressional resolution. This decision aligns with **Nicaragua's** leftist government, led by **President Daniel Ortega**, which has condemned Israel's actions in the ongoing Gaza conflict and labeled its government as **"fascist and genocidal."**
- **United States** has announced it will send the advanced **THAAD missile defence system** to Israel. This move is part of a broader strategy to bolster Israel's defence capabilities and deter further aggression from Iran and other regional adversaries. The deployment underscores the **US's "ironclad commitment"** to Israel's defence and comes at a time of heightened geopolitical sensitivity in the region. **THAAD** stands for **Terminal High-Altitude Area Defense**, a cutting-edge **anti-ballistic missile defense system** developed by **Lockheed Martin Corporation**. The system is designed to intercept and destroy enemy missiles in their final, or **terminal phase**, making it a critical asset for defending against missile threats.
- Tensions between India and Canada have escalated significantly, particularly following the murder of Sikh separatist **Hardeep Singh Nijjar** in June 2023. This incident triggered a series of diplomatic retaliations, including the expulsion of Indian diplomats by Canada and subsequent expulsions by India. The conflict has deep roots, dating back to controversies involving **Sikh separatism** and criticisms exchanged over various issues, including farmer protests in India.
- Lok Sabha Speaker **Om Birla** recently addressed the **149th Assembly of the Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU)** held from **October 13 to 17, 2024**, at the IPU headquarters in **Geneva, Switzerland**. During his address, Birla emphasized the critical need for **multilateralism** in today's world, advocating for dialogue and cooperation among parliaments in the realms of **science, technology, and innovation** for the common good.
- The **Financial Action Task Force (FATF)** has introduced significant **changes to its criteria for placing countries on its grey list**, aiming to relieve the burden on least developed countries (LDCs) while targeting nations that pose greater risks to the international financial system.

FATF's Revised Criteria

1. The changes prioritize active reviews of countries that meet specific risk criteria, focusing on FATF Members.
 2. **Countries on the World Bank's High-Income Countries list** (excluding those with only two or fewer banks in the financial sector).
 3. **Countries with financial sector assets above USD 10 billion.**
 4. **Least developed countries will not be prioritized unless they pose significant risks related to money laundering or terrorist financing.**
- India has fulfilled a significant commitment made during the third **Forum for India-Pacific Islands Cooperation (FIPIC III) Summit** by sending its first consignment of **12 Haemo-Dialysis machines to Papua New Guinea (PNG)**. Also in response to rising tensions and ongoing conflict in southern Lebanon, India has dispatched the first tranche of a **33-ton consignment of medical supplies as part of a humanitarian effort to support Lebanon**.
 - Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurated three new airports developed under the Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS) – UDAN (Ude Desh Ka Aam Nagrik) from Varanasi in Uttar Pradesh today. The newly inaugurated airports are located in **Rewa (Madhya Pradesh), Ambikapur (Chhattisgarh), and Saharanpur (Uttar Pradesh)**.
 - Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **Karmayogi Saptah, or National Learning Week**, on October 19, 2024, at the **Dr. Ambedkar International Centre in New Delhi**. This initiative is part of Mission Karmayogi, which aims to foster continuous skill enhancement among civil servants, aligning their competencies with the evolving goals of India, especially towards achieving a developed nation by 2047.
 - Union Culture and Tourism **Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat** and **Minister of State for Coal and Mines Satish Chandra Dubey** inaugurated the **first-ever coal gallery** at the **National Science Centre in New Delhi**. The exhibition, titled **"Black Diamond – Unveiling the Depths,"** highlights **coal's journey** from its formation to its essential role in modern energy production.
 - The **first anniversary of Namo Bharat train** operations was celebrated as **Namo Bharat Diwas in New Delhi**, marking a significant milestone in India's transportation history. The **National Capital Region Transport Corporation (NCRTC)** organized the event, attended by Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs, Shri Manohar Lal Khattar, and Union Minister of State for Housing and Urban Affairs, Shri Tokhan Sahu. During the celebration, excellence awards were presented to outstanding employees who contributed to the success of the Namo Bharat initiative.

- Union Food and Consumer Affairs Minister **Shri Pralhad Joshi** has launched the retail phase of **Bharat Chana Dal Phase II in Delhi-NCR**, marking a significant step in the government's commitment to provide essential food items at affordable prices.
- The government will celebrate the **150th birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** with a nationwide program spanning two years, from 2024 to 2026. Announced by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah on October 23, 2024**, the initiative aims to honor Patel's monumental contributions to India.
- The Union Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry, and Dairying, **Shri Rajiv Ranjan Singh**, also known as Lalan Singh, is set to launch the **21st Livestock Census operation**, a significant initiative aimed at gathering comprehensive data on India's livestock sector. The launch event is scheduled for October 25, 2024.
- The Department of Pension and Pensioners' Welfare (DoPPW) has announced a significant **new initiative for central government pensioners aged 80 and older**, introducing an additional pension known as the compassionate allowance. This development comes with newly issued guidelines aimed at simplifying the process for retirees to access these supplementary benefits.
- The **National Centre for Good Governance (NCGG)** has successfully concluded its **34th Capacity Building Programme (CBP)** for Maldivian civil servants in New Delhi. Held from October 14–25, 2024, this two-week program, organized in collaboration with the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**, represents the second initiative under a renewed Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) signed by **India's External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar and Maldives' Foreign Minister Mr. Moosa Zameer**.
- Airbus has inaugurated its new **India and South Asia Headquarters and Training Centre**, marking a significant investment in the Indian aerospace sector. Located in the National Capital Region (NCR), this facility is poised to play a key role in **training pilots and technicians** and expanding Airbus's industrial footprint in India. The centre is equipped with four A320 simulators and boasts a **capacity to train up to 800 pilots and 200 technicians annually**.
- **Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh** launched the 21st Livestock Census on Friday, which will be conducted **until February next year at a cost of ₹200 crore**. He emphasized that the collection of precise data is crucial for the government to formulate effective policies **aimed at ensuring animal health security and promoting growth in the livestock sector**.
- Newly inaugurated **President Prabowo Subianto** has unveiled **Indonesia's largest-ever Cabinet, comprising 109 members**. Named the **"Red and White Cabinet"** after Indonesia's flag, this lineup reflects his vision of a strong, unified government.

- On October 21, **Pakistan enacted the Constitution (26th Amendment) Act, 2024**, limiting the Chief Justice's tenure to three years and establishing a special commission for appointing the top judge from **three senior-most Supreme Court judges**. The amendment received **President Asif Ali Zardari's** assent.
- Pakistan has appointed Justice Yahya Afridi** as the next Chief Justice, bypassing the traditional seniority principle. This decision follows the **26th Constitutional Amendment**, which granted the committee the authority to appoint the top judge, replacing the seniority-based elevation system.
- Vietnam's parliament** elected army general **Luong Cuong** as the new state president, marking a significant move to restore stability after a period of political upheaval. The 67-year-old Cuong succeeds To Lam.
- Maldives President Mohamed Muizzu** has announced the introduction of **India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** to enhance the country's economy by improving financial inclusion and transaction efficiency. This initiative is part of a broader strategy to strengthen ties with India following Muizzu's previous stance against Indian military presence in the Maldives.
- Egypt** has reached a significant public health milestone by being officially declared **'malaria-free' by the World Health Organization (WHO) on October 20, 2024**. This achievement makes Egypt the **second country in the world to receive this certification in 2024, following Cabo Verde**.
- The **United States, Japan, and South Korea** have jointly announced the **Digital Infrastructure Growth Initiative for India (DiGi Framework)**, marking a new chapter in digital infrastructure support for India. The DiGi Framework, formalized on October 25, 2024, was signed by **US International Development Finance Corporation (DFC)**, **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)**, and **Korea Eximbank**.
- A cyber-espionage operation allegedly orchestrated by a Chinese hacking group known as **"Salt Typhoon"** has reportedly targeted the **phone data of former President Donald Trump**, his running mate JD Vance, and various Democratic figures, including staff from Vice President Kamala Harris's campaign.
- Brazil** has chosen not to join **China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI)**, becoming the second member of the **BRICS bloc**, after India, to opt out of Beijing's ambitious multi-billion-dollar infrastructure project. The move has sparked widespread interest and debate, as it reflects Brazil's cautious stance on joining China's influential global initiative.
- Hezbollah, the Lebanese Shia** paramilitary and political group, announced the appointment of **Sheikh Naim Qassem** as its new secretary-general following the recent assassination of **Hassan Nasrallah by Israel** on September 27.

- Lahore has once again claimed the title of the most polluted city globally, with the **Air Quality Index (AQI)** soaring to alarming levels. Recently recorded at a staggering 708, the PM2.5 levels reached an unprecedented **431 µg/m³**, significantly exceeding the World Health Organization's recommended **annual limit by 86 times**.

International Current Affairs of November 2024

- Duma Boko, Botswana's newly elected president**, has made history by ending the six-decade rule of the Botswana Democratic Party (BDP). Boko, a 54-year-old human rights lawyer, is recognized for his confidence, humility, and dedication to justice, marking a significant political shift in Botswana's history with his victory over the long-standing ruling party.
- On November 2, **Kemi Badenoch, 44**, made history as the **first Black woman to lead the UK's Conservative Party**, succeeding Rishi Sunak. Badenoch won the leadership race after Sunak's resignation, defeating former minister Robert Jenrick with 53,806 votes, representing a 72.8% turnout among Conservative Party members.
- Donald Trump has won a crucial victory in Wisconsin**, securing 276 electoral votes, surpassing the 270 needed to reclaim the White House as America's 47th president. Speaking to a jubilant crowd in West Palm Beach, Florida, he expressed gratitude for the honor of being elected, acknowledging his distinctive role as both the 45th and now the 47th president. JD Vance will serve as vice president in this administration.
- Moldova** as pro-Western President **Maia Sandu** won a second term in a highly contested presidential runoff.
- Switzerland is set to enforce its controversial **"burqa ban" starting January 1, 2025**.
- All members of **Bangladesh's National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)** resigned on Thursday, shortly after the release of a critical report highlighting an increase in mob violence.
- Australia is set to implement a significant move by banning social media access for **children under 16, starting in November**.
- Mount Lewotobi Laki-laki in eastern Indonesia erupted on November 7, sending a massive ash column over 6,500 meters into the sky. The 1,584-meter volcano, located on Flores Island.
- India did not support Pakistan and Syria's resolution on "conventional arms control at the regional and subregional levels"** during the First Committee of the UN General Assembly. The resolution, which aimed at promoting arms control in specific regions, was adopted with 179 votes in favor.
- Canada** has reported its **first presumptive human case of H5 bird flu** in British Columbia, where a teenager tested positive for the H5 influenza virus. Health authorities called it a rare event, highlighting the country's ongoing efforts to monitor and manage avian diseases.

- **The Government of Canada** has officially terminated its Student Direct Stream (SDS) program, which was popular among Indian students for its expedited study permit processing. Effective immediately, students from India and 13 other countries who previously used the SDS will now have to apply through the standard study permit system.
- **Tayyab Ikram** has been re-elected as President of the International Hockey Federation (FIH) for a second consecutive term. At the 49th FIH Congress in Muscat, Oman, he won with 79 votes out of 126, defeating competitor Marc Coudron of Belgium, who received 47 votes. This marks a significant achievement for Pakistan's hockey.
- In a major political shift, Mauritius' opposition is on track for victory in the recent legislative elections, with Prime Minister Pravind Jugnauth conceding defeat on November 11th. Opposition leader **Dr. Navin Ramgoolam is set to become prime minister** for the third time, heading the Alliance of Change coalition.
- **The UN's World Meteorological Organization (WMO) has issued a "red alert" on climate change, warning that 2024 is on track to be the hottest year on record.** Global temperatures from January to September were 1.54°C above pre-industrial levels, largely due to the warming impact of an El Niño event.
- **Businessman Alix Didier Fils-Aime has been sworn in as Haiti's new prime minister,** pledging to tackle the country's security challenges and restore stability. He replaces Garry Conille, who was ousted after just five months in office due to a power struggle with Haiti's transitional council over ministerial appointments.
- President-elect Donald Trump has chosen Republican Rep. **Elise Stefanik to serve as U.S. Ambassador** to the United Nations, marking his first Cabinet pick for his second term.
- Australia has appointed its **first Anti-Slavery Commissioner, Chris Evans,** who will serve a five-year term starting in December 2024.
- Scarecrow Incorporated, based in Tokyo's Shibuya Ward, has secured the **world's first patent for its animal supplement, Pinfenon (S) (R).** This innovative product is designed to treat and prevent cardiac disorders in dogs by reducing atrial natriuretic peptide (ANP) levels.
- China's \$1.3 billion megaport in Chancay, Peru, majority-owned by Chinese shipping giant Cosco, aims to strengthen trade links between South America and Asia.
- Former Democratic Congresswoman **Tulsi Gabbard** was appointed as the **Director of National Intelligence (DNI)** by U.S. President-elect Donald Trump on **November 13.**
- A new dataset released at the UN climate talks shows that cities in Asia and the **U.S. are the biggest contributors to greenhouse gas emissions,** with Shanghai leading the list, followed by Tokyo, New York, and Houston.
- **Super Typhoon Man-yi,** locally known as **Pepito,** has made a second landfall on the **Philippines' Luzon Island,** bringing severe **winds,** torrential **rains,** and life-threatening **storm surges.**
- Gabon held a historic **referendum** where **91% of voters** approved a new constitution, signaling a significant political shift. The new constitution seeks to end **55 years of dynastic rule** and restore a **democratic civilian government.** The **military junta,** which seized power in a **coup** in August 2023, orchestrated the referendum, marking the beginning of a new era of governance in the country.
- Iraq is conducting its first nationwide **census** since 1987, with **120,000 researchers** collecting data across all 18 governorates. The **two-day survey** is aimed at modernizing **data collection,** assisting in **development planning,** and offering a comprehensive view of Iraq's **demographic, social, and economic landscape.** The last census was held in **1987,** with a **1997 census** excluding the **Kurdish region.**
- On November 21, 2024, Mali's ruling **military junta** dismissed **Prime Minister Choguel Maiga,** replacing him with junta spokesperson **Abdoulaye Maiga.** The move comes amid increasing criticism of the junta's management of the **transition to democracy** and rising **political tensions** in the country.
- The **Ngusaba Goreng** festival in **Bali** is a two-week-long **Thanksgiving** celebration for a rich harvest, central to **Balinese Hinduism** and blending **Hindu, animist, and Buddhist** traditions. The festival features sacred dances like **Rejang Dewa** and **Rejang Pucuk,** performed by **girls** who have not yet reached puberty, symbolizing **purity.** **Ngusaba** translates to the "gathering of gods and goddesses."
- **UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer** announced the resumption of **Free Trade Agreement (FTA)** negotiations with **India** in early 2025, following a meeting with **Prime Minister Narendra Modi.** This move aims to strengthen their **strategic partnership** across sectors like **security, defense, technology, climate, health, and education.** Bilateral trade stands at **GBP 42 billion** annually. The talks, which were paused due to elections, will build on the progress from the **14th round** of discussions, with both sides aiming to close remaining gaps for a successful deal.
- **Yamandu Orsi,** a former **history teacher** and **mayor of Canelones,** has been elected **Uruguay's president** with **49.8%** of the vote in the **November 2024 runoff.** Representing the **center-left Broad Front coalition,** Orsi defeated **Alvaro Delgado** of the **conservative National Party.** His victory signals a shift back to **center-left governance** after five years of conservative rule, promising **change** while maintaining Uruguay's **moderate ethos.**

- Sri Lanka's **Central Bank (CBSL)** has introduced a single **Overnight Policy Rate (OPR)** of **8%** to support the country's recovery post-financial crisis. This move replaces the previous system of **Standing Deposit Facility Rate (SDFR)** and **Standing Lending Facility Rate (SLFR)**, signaling a shift in the **monetary policy** framework amidst ongoing **debt restructuring**.
- The **first round** of the **India-Japan Dialogue on Economic Security, Strategic Trade, and Technology** took place in **Tokyo** on **November 27, 2024**. Co-chaired by **Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri** (India) and **Vice Minister Masataka Okano** (Japan), the dialogue focused on enhancing **bilateral cooperation** in **economic security, supply chain resilience, and emerging technologies**, marking a significant step in strengthening the **India-Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership**.
- India and **Bosnia & Herzegovina** held their **4th Foreign Office Consultations (FOC)** in **Sarajevo**, led by **Arun Kumar Sahu** (India) and **Tarik Bukvic** (Bosnia). Discussions focused on strengthening **bilateral political ties, trade and investment, scientific collaboration, and cultural relations** through **student exchanges** and **youth programs**. The two sides reviewed **regional developments** and discussed global issues, including cooperation in **BRICS, UN, EU, and NAM**. These consultations are part of efforts to celebrate **30 years of diplomatic ties** in 2025 and deepen multi-faceted relations.
- The **Indian and Sri Lankan Navies** conducted a successful **anti-narcotics operation** in the **Arabian Sea**, seizing **500 kg of crystal methamphetamine** from two **Sri Lankan-flagged fishing vessels** on **November 24-25, 2024**. The operation, based on inputs from the **Sri Lankan Navy**, highlights the growing **cooperation** between the two nations in combating **transnational crimes**.
- **External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar** inaugurated the new **Indian Embassy Chancery** in **Rome**, emphasizing the **historical ties** and **maritime connections** between **India** and **Italy**. The inauguration strengthens the growing **India-Italy partnership** and enhances the Embassy's capacity to serve the **Indian diaspora**, reflecting India's expanding **global presence** and **diplomatic outreach**.
- **Australia** has introduced a **world-first legislation** banning children under **16** from social media platforms like **TikTok, Facebook, and Instagram** to protect minors from online harm. The law imposes fines of up to **AUD 50 million** for non-compliance, with platforms given one year to implement changes. While praised for enhancing **child safety**, critics express concerns about potential **privacy risks** and unintended harm to vulnerable youth.
- **Typhoon Kong-rey** made landfall in **Taiwan** on **October 31, 2024**, prompting authorities to take swift action. **Schools, offices, and financial markets** were closed, and thousands of residents were **evacuated** from **high-risk areas** to ensure public safety.

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- **Donald Trump**, the **US President-elect**, has appointed **Kash Patel** as the next **FBI Director**, succeeding **Christopher Wray**. Patel, a **Trump loyalist** known for his criticism of the **"deep state"** and federal agencies, has a history of strong support for Trump's policies.
- **Donald Trump** has threatened to impose **100% tariffs** on **BRICS** countries, including **India**, if they reduce reliance on the **US dollar** in international trade. This threat follows discussions at the **BRICS Summit** in October about **de-dollarisation**, posing challenges to India's **export sectors** like **pharmaceuticals, textiles, and IT services**.
- **Aleppo**, Syria's second-largest city, has fallen from **government control** for the first time since the conflict began, following a surprise offensive by **Islamist rebel groups** supported by **Hayat Tahrir al-Sham** and allies. This marks a key turning point, as Aleppo was **recaptured** by government forces in **2016**.
- **Oxford Word of the Year 2024** is **'brain rot'**, reflecting concerns about the negative impact of excessive **low-quality online content**, especially on **social media**. Selected through a global vote and expert analysis, the term highlights the growing debate around digital consumption. Originally coined in **1854** by **Henry David Thoreau**, it has gained new relevance, particularly among **Gen Z** and **Gen Alpha** on platforms like **TikTok**.
- **Justice Murdu Nirupa Bindushini Fernando** was sworn in as the **48th Chief Justice of Sri Lanka** on **December 2, 2024**, marking a historic moment as the **second woman** to hold the position, after **Justice Shirani Bandaranaike**. She was appointed following the retirement of **Chief Justice Jayantha Jayasuriya**.
- China has opened its first **atmospheric monitoring station** in **Antarctica**, located in **Larsmann Hills, East Antarctica**. The **Zhongshan National Atmospheric Background Station** will provide continuous data on **climate change** and human impact, enhancing China's role in **Antarctic research** as part of its goals as a **polar power**.
- **Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah**, Namibia's first female president, made history with her election at age 72, winning over **57% of the vote**. A key political figure, she rose from **activism** against South African occupation to leadership in post-independence Namibia. Her victory highlights the power of **perseverance, activism, and a commitment to economic and social progress**.
- After over **five decades** of unbroken rule, the **Assad family's reign** in **Syria** ended as **rebel forces**, led by **Hayat Tahrir al-Sham (HTS)**, breached **Damascus**, forcing **President Bashar al-Assad** to flee. This marks the end of the **Alawite dynasty**, which began in **1970** when **Hafez al-Assad** took control.

- **John Dramani Mahama**, Ghana's former president, made a historic return to power by defeating the ruling **New Patriotic Party (NPP)** in the presidential election. This marks his **third attempt** after previous defeats in **2016** and **2020**. The victory reflects voter frustration with **NPP's** handling of the **economic crisis** under **President Nana Akufo-Addo** and is seen as a significant **political shift** in Ghana, known for its **democratic stability**.
- Burkina Faso's **ruling military junta** appointed **Rimtalba Jean Emmanuel Ouedraogo** as the new **prime minister** after dissolving the national government. Ouedraogo, a former **communications minister** and government spokesperson, was appointed by junta leader **Ibrahim Traore** via decree and announced on **state television**. The country continues to face significant **security challenges** and **political instability** under military rule.
- Dubai unveiled the **world's largest gold bar** on December 7-8, 2024, weighing **300.12 kg** and valued at **\$25 million (₹211 crore)**. Displayed at the **Dubai Gold Souk Extension**, the bar sets a new **Guinness World Record** and symbolizes Dubai's commitment to excellence in the **precious metals industry**.
- Merriam-Webster has chosen "**polarization**" as the **2024 Word of the Year**, reflecting the **deep societal, cultural, and political divides** of the year. The word was selected based on a rise in searches and usage. Other top words include **demure**, **fortnight**, **totality**, and **resonate**.
- India's **billionaire count** has risen to **185** in 2024, a **20% increase** from 2023, ranking **third globally** after the **US** and **China**. The growth is fueled by **family-led businesses** across sectors like **pharma**, **fintech**, and **edtech**. In contrast, China's billionaire numbers dropped from **520** to **427** due to **economic slowdowns** and **regulatory changes**. The report forecasts continued growth for India, following a trajectory similar to China's pre-2020 pattern.
- **Mohammed al-Bashir** has been appointed as **Syria's caretaker prime minister** following the fall of **President Bashar al-Assad**. Al-Bashir, former head of the **Syrian Salvation Government (SSG)**, will lead the **transitional government** until **March 1, 2025**, after the 12-day offensive that ended Assad's rule.
- **President Droupadi Murmu** awarded **Nepal's Army Chief, General Ashok Raj Sigdel**, the honorary rank of '**General of the Indian Army**' at **Rashtrapati Bhavan**. This reflects the longstanding military ties and mutual respect between **India** and **Nepal**, dating back to 1950. The ceremony highlights both nations' commitment to **strengthening defense collaboration** and fostering **friendly relations**.
- The **Supreme Court of Bangladesh** stayed a **High Court** verdict that declared '**Joy Bangla**' as the national slogan. Popularized by **Sheikh Mujibur Rahman** during the **Bangladesh liberation movement**, the slogan had been recognized by the previous government led by **Sheikh Hasina**. The decision reflects ongoing **political shifts** and **changes in government policy**, emphasizing the complexities of **national identity** and **governance** in Bangladesh.
- **Time magazine** has named **Donald Trump** as its **Person of the Year** for 2024, marking his second win. This recognition highlights his **political influence**, **historic comeback** after defeating **Vice President Kamala Harris** in the November 5 election, and his role in reshaping the **American presidency**.
- **Elon Musk**, CEO of **Tesla** and **SpaceX**, has made history by surpassing a net worth of **\$400 billion**, according to the **Bloomberg Billionaires Index**. This achievement reflects his success in ventures like **Tesla**, **SpaceX**, and **xAI**, driven by insider share sales, stock performance, and political connections, cementing his status as the **richest person** in the world.
- French President **Emmanuel Macron** has appointed **François Bayrou** as the new **Prime Minister** amidst growing political instability. Bayrou, a centrist ally of Macron, faces challenges in navigating a divided parliament, particularly in passing the **2025 budget bill**. His appointment follows the ousting of **Michel Barnier's minority government** after a vote of no-confidence, adding to the country's **political instability**, rising **borrowing costs**, and a **European leadership vacuum**.
- Switzerland has decided to suspend the '**Most Favoured Nation**' (**MFN**) clause in its **tax treaty** with **India**, potentially raising taxes on **Indian companies** operating in Switzerland. Following a **2023 Indian Supreme Court ruling** that altered the interpretation of the MFN clause, Switzerland will impose a **10% withholding tax** on dividends paid to Indian companies starting **January 1, 2025**, up from the previous 5%.
- The unexpected victory of **far-right, pro-Russian candidate Călin Georgescu** in Romania's presidential race has raised concerns in **Brussels** about potential shifts that could destabilize the **EU** and **NATO**. With Romania leaning towards **ultranationalism** and Moscow's influence growing in **Eastern Europe**, fears are rising of Romania adopting **anti-Western policies**. This could impact **EU unity** and complicate consensus-building within the alliance.
- The **Bloomberg list of the world's richest families** for 2024 highlights significant wealth disparities, with the **Walton family** (Walmart) leading at **\$432.4 billion**, surpassing **Elon Musk**. Other notable families include the **Al Nahyan** (UAE), **Al Thani** (Qatar), and **Hermès** (France). **Indian families** like the **Ambanis** and **Mistrys** are also in the top 25, reflecting the rising influence of **Indian billionaires** globally. The list underscores the growing concentration of wealth among a few elite families.
- **Mikheil Kavelashvili**, a 53-year-old former footballer, was elected **President of Georgia** on **December 16, 2024**, signaling a shift in the country's politics. His win, supported by the **Georgian Dream party**, comes amid concerns over Georgia's growing **alignment with Russia** and constitutional changes replacing direct presidential elections with a **300-seat electoral college**. Critics fear this election could harm Georgia's **European Union** aspirations and reflect increasing **authoritarianism**.

- **Mount Semeru in East Java, Indonesia**, erupted on **15th December**, releasing a thick column of **ash** up to **1,000 meters** high. The eruption triggered an **aviation warning** from Indonesia's **Center for Volcanology and Geological Hazard Mitigation**, issuing an **orange Volcano Observatory Notice**. **Flight restrictions** were enforced within a **5-kilometer radius** of the volcano.
- On **December 15, 2024**, the **United Kingdom** became the first **European nation** to join the **Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP)**. This move is part of the UK's **post-Brexit strategy** to boost its economy through new **business opportunities** and trade benefits in the **Indo-Pacific region**. The **CPTPP**, originally formed by 11 countries, aims to reduce trade barriers and accounts for **15% of global GDP**, including fast-growing markets.
- The **U.S. military** successfully tested its **Long-Range Hypersonic Weapon (LRHW)**, also known as "**Dark Eagle**," at **Cape Canaveral Space Force Station, Florida**. The missile reached speeds over **3,800 miles per hour (Mach 5)** and demonstrated its ability to strike **distant, well-defended targets**. This milestone in **hypersonic technology** brings the weapon closer to **operational deployment by 2025**.
- **Cyclone Chido**, a **Category 4 storm**, caused widespread destruction in **Mayotte** before making landfall in **Mozambique's Cabo Delgado province** on **December 15, 2024**. The storm caused severe damage in Mayotte with **winds exceeding 220 km/h**. After crossing the **Mozambique Channel**, it intensified, impacting **northern Mozambique** with **winds over 200 km/h** and heavy rainfall, threatening lives and properties.
- The **Gympie-Gympie (Dendrocnide moroides)** is the **most toxic plant** in the world, found in **Australia, Indonesia, and the Moluccas**. Despite its **heart-shaped leaves**, it is covered with **neurotoxin-laden trichomes** that cause **excruciating pain** upon contact, described as a combination of **burning with hot acid** and **electrocution**, with effects lasting weeks or months.
- **Javier Milei**, Argentina's President, was granted **Italian citizenship** due to his **Italian ancestry**, sparking criticism in Argentina. The decision highlights Italy's **citizenship by descent** policy, which offers citizenship to **descendants of Italian emigrants**. Critics argue the policy is unfair to children of immigrants born in Italy. This move could also strengthen **Italy-Argentina** political and economic ties.
- Israel has approved a settlement expansion plan in the **Golan Heights**, allocating **\$11.13 million** to enhance infrastructure and double the population in this **strategically significant region**. Captured during the **1967 Six-Day War** and annexed in **1981**, the Golan Heights holds value for **defense** and **water resources**. Currently, it houses **50,000 residents**, including **20,000 Israeli settlers** and local **Druze Arabs** and **Alawites**.
- **Moldova** officially joined the **International Solar Alliance (ISA)**, reinforcing its commitment to **renewable energy** and **sustainability**. The agreement was signed by **S. Jaishankar** and **Mihai Popșoi** in New Delhi. The ISA, headquartered in India, aims to address challenges in **solar energy financing, technology, and scalability**, with a goal of mobilizing over **USD 1,000 billion** in investments by 2030.
- **Japan** and **India** have teamed up to address the growing issue of **space debris**, focusing on **laser technology** and debris removal. **Orbital Lasers (Japan)** and **InspeCity (India)** signed a preliminary agreement to explore space debris removal using **laser-equipped satellites** to vaporize debris and facilitate spacecraft servicing. Testing is expected after **2027**. **InspeCity** has raised **\$1.5 million**, while **Orbital Lasers** has secured **\$5.8 million**. The collaboration also extends to **lunar exploration**, emphasizing joint efforts in space.
- The **Ministry of Culture**, in partnership with **France Museums Développement (FMD)**, has launched the **Yuga Yugeen Bharat National Museum** project in **New Delhi**. Spanning **1,55,000 square meters** across the **North and South Blocks**, the museum will highlight India's **civilizational history** and serve as a key element of the **Central Vista Redevelopment Project**. Announced by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** at the **International Museum Expo** in May 2023, the initiative emphasizes **cultural heritage preservation** and **international collaboration**.
- **Donald Trump**, US President-elect, has appointed **Indian-American entrepreneur** and **venture capitalist Sriram Krishnan** as **Senior Policy Advisor for Artificial Intelligence (AI)** at the **White House Office of Science and Technology Policy**. Krishnan will work with **David Sacks**, the **White House AI & Crypto Czar**, to ensure **America's leadership in AI**, shape AI policy, and collaborate with the **President's Council of Advisors on Science and Technology**.
- **Rodrigo Rato**, former **IMF Chief** and **Spain's Deputy Prime Minister**, was sentenced to **four years, nine months, and one day** in prison by a Madrid court for **corruption, tax offences, and money laundering**. He was convicted on three counts and ordered to pay over **€2 million** in fines, along with **€568,413** in penalties to **tax authorities**. Rato denies wrongdoing and plans to **appeal** the decision.
- **Aisake Valu Eke** has been elected as **Tonga's new Prime Minister** following the abrupt resignation of **Siaosi Sovaleni**. This political transition comes amid challenges such as **strained monarchy-government relations, economic hardships, and the aftermath of natural disasters**.
- An **Azerbaijan Airlines Embraer 190** jet crashed near **Aktau, Kazakhstan**, after being rerouted due to heavy fog. The flight, en route from **Baku to Grozny**, had 62 passengers and 5 crew members onboard. Several passengers were injured in the emergency landing, with a passenger capturing footage of the incident. The crash underscores the risks of rerouting and the unpredictability of air travel emergencies.

- China has approved the construction of the world's largest dam on the **Yarlung Zangbo (Brahmaputra)** River in **Tibet**, raising **strategic** and **environmental concerns** for **India** and **Bangladesh**. Estimated at **\$137 billion**, the dam could give China control over water flow, potentially flooding Indian border areas during conflicts. In response, India is building its own dam in **Arunachal Pradesh**. Both countries have a **data-sharing framework** through the **Expert Level Mechanism (ELM)**, which was reaffirmed during talks between India's NSA and China's Foreign Minister.
- On **Christmas Eve 2024**, President **Joe Biden** signed a historic law officially recognizing the **bald eagle** as the **national bird** of the United States. While the eagle has symbolized the country since 1782, it was never formally designated until this legislation, led by **Minnesota lawmakers**. The move honors the eagle's representation of **strength, courage, and freedom**, as well as its remarkable recovery from near extinction.
- The **Ocean Anoxic Event 1a (OAE 1a)**, occurring 120 million years ago, was triggered by massive volcanic eruptions releasing **CO₂**, causing **global warming** and **oceanic anoxia**. This event disrupted marine ecosystems, leading to **plankton extinction** and the formation of **black shale deposits**. Volcanic activity, particularly from the **Ontong Java Nui complex**, caused oceanic oxygen depletion, creating **anoxic marine basins** like the **Black**

Sea. OAE 1a offers insights into modern **climate change** and its potential impacts on marine life.

- A **federal-level emergency** was declared in Russia following a **catastrophic oil spill** on December 15, caused by damage to two Russian-flagged oil tankers near the **Kerch Strait**. The spill released thousands of tons of **mazut** into the **Black Sea**, affecting 55 kilometers of coastline. Despite local cleanup efforts, the crisis escalated, prompting **federal intervention** as the regional authorities lacked sufficient resources to handle the disaster. The spill has severely impacted **marine ecosystems, local communities, and the coastal economy**.



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- **Gujarat**, known for its rich cultural heritage and commitment to health and wellness, achieved a remarkable feat on New Year's morning by making an indelible mark in the **Guinness Book of World Records**. The state hosted the largest simultaneous Surya Namaskar performance, involving over 4,000 participants from 108 locations across 51 categories.
- In a groundbreaking move for the state of **Uttar Pradesh**, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath inaugurated the **state's first floating air-conditioned restaurant** during his visit to Sangam City. The restaurant, managed by the **Uttar Pradesh State Tourism Development Corporation (UPSTDC)**, is set to redefine the dining experience for visitors on the picturesque Yamuna river.
- Chief Minister Hemant Soren of **Jharkhand** announced a reduction in the qualifying age for old-age pensions. The decision primarily targets tribals and Dalits, lowering the age threshold **from 60 to 50 years**. This bold initiative **aims to provide financial support to a broader segment of the population**, acknowledging the specific challenges faced by these communities.
- In a significant step towards environmental sustainability, **Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma** flagged off **200 electric buses from Guwahati**. This initiative marks one of the state government's most substantial efforts to create a pollution-free environment in Assam.
- For the **third consecutive year**, **Uttar Pradesh** has achieved the **highest entry rate on the Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System (ICJS) platform**, showcasing the state's commitment to leveraging technology in the administration of justice. The ICJS platform, a brainchild of the Supreme Court's e-committee and implemented by the **Ministry of Home Affairs**, plays a pivotal role in enhancing the efficiency of the criminal justice system in India.
- **Punjab**, known for its vibrant culture and rich heritage, has achieved a significant milestone in road safety. The state has become the **first in India to meticulously map all 784 accident black spots using the Mappls App**, a cutting-edge navigation system developed by **MapMyIndia**.
- The **Assam government** is gearing up for the **fifth edition** of '**Gunotsav 2024**,' a comprehensive state-wide assessment aimed at evaluating the performance of approximately 40 lakh students across government schools. The initiative, slated to run from January 3 to February 8, 2024, is poised to play a pivotal role in enhancing the quality of education and improving learning outcomes in the state.
- In a landmark decision, the **Maharashtra government** appointed **Rashmi Shukla**, a distinguished 1988 batch Indian Police Service (IPS) officer, as the **Director General of Police (DGP)**. This appointment is groundbreaking as Ms. Shukla becomes the first woman to hold this prestigious position in the state.
- The Tamil Nadu government, led by Chief Minister MK Stalin, revealed its ambitious vision for the state to achieve a **\$1 trillion economy by 2030** during the **Global Investors Meet** in Chennai on January 7.
- The **Mulugu district of Telangana** has become the stage for an unexpected archaeological revelation following the devastating floods in July 2023. Amidst the aftermath of the natural disaster, a team of amateur historians stumbled upon a **collection of paleolithic quartzite tools** that have not only captivated the local community but also pushed back the understanding of human habitations in Telangana and central India.
- West Bengal Chief Minister **Mamata Banerjee** has recently introduced a comprehensive social welfare scheme named "**Yogyasree**." The initiative aims to provide free training modules for **Scheduled Caste (SC) and Scheduled Tribe (ST) students in West Bengal**, specifically targeting entrance and competitive examinations. This move comes ahead of the Lok Sabha polls, reflecting the government's commitment to educational empowerment.
- In the heart of **Odisha's Mayurbhanj district**, a unique culinary tradition has thrived for centuries. Locally known as '**Kai Chutney**,' this savoury delight is crafted using red weaver ants, scientifically identified as **Oecophylla smaragdina**. These ants, infamous for their painful sting, are harvested from the lush forests of Mayurbhanj, including the renowned Similipal forests, Asia's second-largest biosphere.
- Chhattisgarh Government will launch the **Ramlala Darshan Scheme**, a pilgrimage to the newly built Ram Temple at Ayodhya. The decision was made during a state cabinet meeting held in Raipur.
- The Maharashtra government has established a crucial new wildlife habitat in Sangli district, aptly named the **Atpadi Conservation Reserve**. Spanning a compact 9.48 sq. km, this reserve prioritizes the protection of the endangered 'canid' family, including wild dogs, wolves, jackals, and foxes.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the **27th National Youth Festival in Nashik**, Maharashtra, on January 12th, 2024. This annual event honors the inspiring ideals of Swami Vivekananda and empowers young minds across the nation.

- **Naveen Patnaik**, achieved a significant milestone with the inauguration of the **Malkangiri airport** in the southwestern region of the state. This strategic initiative is designed to **enhance connectivity and foster development in the tribal-dominated areas**, marking a crucial step forward in the region's progress.
- In a significant stride towards bolstering Gujarat's infrastructure, the **Shanghai-based New Development Bank (NDB)** inked an agreement during the Vibrant Gujarat Summit, pledging a substantial \$500 million loan to the Gujarat government. This financial infusion is earmarked for the **Mukhayamantri Gram Sadak Yojana**, a pivotal project in the state.
- The **Government of Maharashtra** has recently declared the establishment of a new Conservation Reserve in the Atpadi region of Sangli district, named the '**Atpadi Conservation Reserve**'. This significant development is a step forward in the conservation of wildlife and biodiversity in the region.
- **Pench Tiger Reserve** in Maharashtra has made history by securing recognition as **India's inaugural Dark Sky Park**, marking its position as the fifth in Asia. This prestigious acknowledgment underscores the reserve's unwavering commitment to protecting the sanctity of the night sky and creating an optimal setting for astronomy enthusiasts.
- In a spectacular display of talent, Madhya Pradesh emerged as the undisputed overall champion at the **first-ever Beach Games 2024** hosted in Diu. The landlocked state secured an impressive total of 18 medals, including 7 golds, showcasing the depth of its athletic prowess. The competition, unfolding from January 4-11 at the pristine **Ghoghla Beach**, featured 1404 young athletes from 28 states and Union Territories engaging in various disciplines.
- The **Kerala Drug Control Department** has taken a proactive step to combat the growing threat of **antimicrobial resistance (AMR)** through **Operation Amrith** (Antimicrobial Resistance Intervention For Total Health). This initiative **aims to curb the overuse of antibiotics** in the state by conducting surprise raids in pharmacies and detecting over-the-counter (OTC) sales of antibiotics without a doctor's prescription.
- **Tamil Nadu**, a lively state in South India renowned for its cultural richness and traditional festivities, kicked off the **Jallikattu competition** in the village of Avaniyapuram within Madurai district. The spirited audience erupted with cheers as the traditional and widely-loved sport unfolded. Jallikattu, a highlight of the Pongal harvest festival held in the second week of January, is poised to extend its excitement over a **three-day period** with Avaniyapuram hosting the first day, followed by Palamedu on the second day and Alanganallur on the third.
- In a momentous event, Prime Minister **Shri Narendra Modi** inaugurated **three pivotal infrastructure projects** in Kochi, Kerala, signaling a significant stride towards transforming India's ports, shipping, and waterways sector. These projects, **collectively worth over Rs 4,000 crore**, align with the Prime Minister's vision to enhance the nation's maritime capabilities and foster self-sufficiency.
- The **SMPP (Shree Mandir Parikrama Prakalpa)** introduces a **75-meter-wide space around the temple**, referred to as the **heritage corridor**. This expansive area has been meticulously divided into **nine distinct zones**, each serving a specific purpose aimed at **enhancing the overall experience for visitors and preserving the cultural heritage** surrounding the Shree Jagannath Temple.
- In a significant move to boost fish production and promote sustainable fishing, Union Fisheries Minister **Parshottam Rupala** inaugurated an artificial reef project in **Vizhinjam, Kerala**. This initiative aims to double the income of fishermen by enhancing fish stocks and contributing to the economic well-being of the local fishing community.
- **Arunachal Pradesh**, nestled in the northeastern part of India, boasts a vibrant cultural mosaic and unparalleled biodiversity. The **Pakke Paga Hornbill Festival (PPHF)** serves as a testament to this diversity, bringing together communities, traditions, and conservation efforts. Let's delve into the intricacies of this festival, explore the Nyishi tribe, and uncover the conservation initiatives contributing to the region's ecological balance.
- The **Andhra Pradesh government** is set to unveil the **world's tallest statue of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar**, the esteemed architect of the Indian Constitution, in a grand ceremony today in Vijayawada.
- After a hiatus of nine years, **Moh-Juj**, the traditional buffalo fights, have made a comeback in **Assam**. This revival, held during the Magh Bihu festival in mid-January 2024, marks a significant cultural reclamation in Assam. The Assam Government's approval, along with strict Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), ensures a balance between cultural preservation and animal welfare.
- Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee inaugurated the **47th International Kolkata Book Fair** on January 18, amidst a drizzle that posed challenges for last-minute preparations for several stall owners. Despite the weather, the event kicked off at the **Boi Mela Prangan in Central Park, Salt Lake**, marking an early start compared to the previous edition when the gates opened on January 30.
- The **Assam government** recently launched a financial assistance scheme, the **Mukhyamantri Mahila Udyamita Abhiyaan (MMUA)**, with the aim of empowering rural women entrepreneurs. The program is designed to **provide financial assistance to women** who aspire to embark on their entrepreneurial journey independently, beyond their association with Self-Help Groups (SHGs). This initiative introduces unique conditions, focusing specifically on the number of eligible children for the beneficiaries.

- The beautiful town of **Udhampur** witnessed a glorious spectacle today as the sacred precincts of the **Jagannath Temple** came alive with the vibrant celebrations of the much-anticipated '**Gole Mela**.' Devotees from Udhampur district and beyond flocked to the temple to partake in this annual religious and cultural extravaganza.
- In a significant stride towards its ambitious goal of becoming a USD 1 trillion economy, Maharashtra Chief Minister Eknath Shinde announced the signing of **19 Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs)** during his visit to the World Economic Forum Annual Meeting in Davos. Accompanied by Industries Minister Uday Samant and senior officials, Shinde expressed his determination to lead the state towards economic prosperity.
- **Yogi government of Uttar Pradesh** has announced the prestigious '**UP Gaurav Samman**' award for two distinguished personalities – eminent scientist **Dr. Ritu** and renowned entrepreneur **Naveen**. This award highlights the government's commitment to acknowledging excellence and inspiring future generations.
- In a significant development, the **Indo-Islamic Cultural Foundation (IICF)** has announced the commencement of the construction of a grand mosque in Ayodhya, starting this May. The mosque, named "**Masjid Muhammed bin Abdullah**" after Prophet Muhammad, aims to foster unity and goodwill among people, transcending religious differences. The initiative comes on the same day as Prime Minister Narendra Modi presides over the consecration ceremony of the Ram Temple.
- The Chief Minister of Telangana, **Revanth Reddy**, has taken significant strides to expedite the implementation of various welfare schemes, including the much-anticipated **Gruha Jyothi Scheme**. The state government aims to roll out this scheme from the first week of February, bringing relief to numerous households.
- In a significant move, the YS Jagan Mohan Reddy government in **Andhra Pradesh** has initiated a comprehensive caste census, marking the state's commitment to understanding and addressing the complex caste dynamics within its population. Launched with the aid of a specially designed phone app, this ambitious census aims to enumerate all castes in the state and is expected to be **completed within the next 20 days to one month**.
- In a groundbreaking move, Odisha Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik has unveiled plans for the establishment of the **world's first 'black tiger safari'** near the Similipal Tiger Reserve (STR) in Mayurbhanj. This visionary project aims to provide tourists and visitors with a rare glimpse of the melanistic tigers, commonly known as black tigers, recently spotted at the **Similipal National Park**.
- The **63rd gathering of the Central Geological Programming Board (CGPB)** took place in **Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh**, with Shri V.L. Kantha Rao, Secretary of the Ministry of Mines, presiding. Notable participants included Shri Sanjay Lohiya, Additional Secretary of the Ministry of Mines, and Shri Janardan Prasad, Director General of the **Geological Survey of India (GSI)**.
- In a significant turn of events ahead of the upcoming Lok Sabha polls, Janata Dal-United (JDU) chief **Nitish Kumar** was sworn in as Bihar Chief Minister for the ninth time, breaking ties with the 'Mahagathbandhan' and securing support from the BJP. The swearing-in ceremony, held at Raj Bhavan in Patna, saw Bihar Governor Rajendra Arlekar administering the oath of office.
- The vibrant hues of oranges and the aroma of citrus filled the air as the **4th edition of the Rüsoma Orange Festival** unfolded in the picturesque village of Rüsoma, nestled in the Kohima district in **Nagaland**. With approximately 3400 attendees, this year's event showcased the best of organic produce, community spirit, and rural entrepreneurship.
- The **National Chilika Birds Festival**, a hallmark event in Odisha's calendar, commenced with grandeur on January 26. Hosted against the breathtaking backdrop of Chilika Lake, this festival brings together birders and enthusiasts from across India to celebrate the State of India's Birds.
- Under the visionary leadership of **Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann**, a groundbreaking initiative has been unveiled to enhance road safety across the state. The inauguration of the **Sadak Surakhya Force (SSF)** marks a significant leap forward in safeguarding lives and preventing accidents on Punjab's extensive road network.

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- In a significant political development, **Champa Soren** has been announced as the **next Chief Minister of Jharkhand**, following the resignation of **Hemant Soren**. This marks a pivotal moment in Jharkhand's political landscape, bringing Champa Soren, a seasoned politician and a key figure in the **Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM)**, to the forefront of the state's governance.
- Madhya Pradesh CM **Mohan Yadav** announced the green light for **IIT Indore's Ujjain satellite campus**, marking a pivotal moment for education and skill development. With approval from Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, this project promises substantial benefits for the region.
- Tamil Nadu** has set a new benchmark in environmental conservation and biodiversity protection by securing two more **Ramsar sites**, thus achieving the highest number of such designated areas in the country. The recent addition of the **Longwood Shola Reserve Forest in The Nilgiris** and the **Karaivetti Bird Sanctuary in Ariyalur** has propelled the state to the forefront of ecological conservation efforts in India. With these new designations, Tamil Nadu now boasts 16 Ramsar sites, a testament to its rich biodiversity and the state government's commitment to preserving it.
- Assam**, under the leadership of Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, advances with key decisions. The recent cabinet meeting saw approvals crucial for the state's growth. These include the **Assam Tourism Development and Registration Bill 2024** and the **Mising Autonomous Council Amendment Bill 2024**. Additionally, infrastructure strides are evident with the approval of a significant flyover project in Guwahati.
- The first-ever **Mangalore Beachside Startup Fest** is set to unfold from February 16th to 18th, marking a significant milestone in the region's entrepreneurial landscape. With a focus on nurturing and promoting nascent ventures, this event promises to be a catalyst for the burgeoning startup ecosystem in Mangalore.
- Surat Airport**, situated in Gujarat, has officially received recognition as an **International Airport** from the Indian government, a significant development overseen by the **Ministry of Civil Aviation** and the Union Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- Karnataka** clinched the **Nagesh Trophy**, marking a significant milestone in the **Men's National T20 Cricket Tournament for the Blind 2023-24**. The thrilling final, held in Nagpur, saw **Karnataka** defeating Andhra Pradesh by nine wickets, ending a 20-year wait for a national title.
- The Yogi Adityanath-led Uttar Pradesh government is set to establish a cutting-edge **Centralized GIS Data Centre in Ayodhya** under the Ayodhya Development Authority (ADA). This initiative aligns with the Chief Minister's vision to enhance the city's infrastructure and efficiently manage the ongoing **141 projects worth Rs 30,977 crore**, aimed at restoring Ayodhya's historical grandeur.
- The Uttarakhand Cabinet, led by Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, has greenlit the **Uniform Civil Code (UCC) bill**, marking a historic move. The bill, crafted based on recommendations from a government-appointed committee, will be presented in the **Uttarakhand Assembly on February 6**. If passed, Uttarakhand would be the first state post-Independence to adopt the Uniform Civil Code, aiming to standardize civil laws for all citizens, irrespective of their religious affiliations.
- Justice Ritu Bahri** has become the new **Chief Justice of the Uttarakhand High Court**. The Governor, Lt Gen (retd) Gurmit Singh, gave her the oath at a beautiful ceremony at Raj Bhawan. Many important people, including the Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, were there to see this big moment. It shows how important Justice Bahri's new job is.
- The **Ellora – Ajanta International Festival**, held in **Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar** concluded marking the end of a three-day musical extravaganza that delighted audiences with a rich cultural treat. After a **seven-year hiatus**, the event returned in 2023.
- Punjab Governor and Chandigarh Administrator **Banwarilal Purohit** resigned from his post, citing "personal reasons." In his resignation letter, he wrote, "Due to my personal reasons and certain other commitments, I tender my resignation from the post of governor of Punjab and Administrator, Union Territory, Chandigarh. Please accept the same and oblige."
- Uttarakhand**, Chief Minister **Pushkar Singh Dhami** inaugurated the **"Dhami against drugs campaign,"** a pivotal initiative spearheaded by the Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha Metropolitan Dehradun. This campaign, running from February 5 to February 10, marks a significant step in the state government's resolution to eradicate drug abuse and cultivate a healthier, drug-free society by the year 2025.
- In the heart of Patna, Bihar, a new landmark has emerged as a monumental tribute to **Mahatma Gandhi**, fondly known as the **Father of the Nation**. The **Bapu Tower**, located in Gardanibagh, stands as a testament to the enduring legacy and ideals of Mahatma Gandhi. This tower, the first of its kind in the country dedicated to Gandhi, has been completed, marking a significant milestone in the architectural and cultural landscape of Bihar.

- The collaboration between the **Maharashtra government** and the **National Highways Logistic Management Limited (NHLML)** marks a significant step towards advancing connectivity and tourism development through ropeways under the **National Ropeway Programme 'Parvatmala'**.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** recently embarked on a day-long visit to **Goa**, where he inaugurated several significant infrastructural projects aimed at advancing various sectors, including sea survival training, energy, education, and waste management. These projects not only signify India's progress towards self-reliance but also underscore the government's commitment to fostering development and innovation across different domains.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi marked a historic moment in Goa's educational landscape as he inaugurated the **permanent campus of the National Institute of Technology Goa**. The campus, built at a cost of over ₹1330 crore, is equipped with state-of-the-art facilities tailored to meet the diverse needs of students, faculty, and staff.
- **Kyasanur Forest Disease (KFD)**, also known as **Monkey Fever**, has emerged as a significant health concern in Karnataka, India. With two fatalities reported this year and 49 positive cases, the state's health department is on high alert. Originating from the Kyasanur Forest in 1957, KFD is caused by the **Kyasanur Forest Disease Virus (KFDV)**, belonging to the Flaviviridae family. This article delves into the essentials of KFD, from transmission and symptoms to diagnosis, treatment, and prevention.
- **The Uttar Pradesh government** is taking significant steps to promote the manufacture and use of electric vehicles (EVs) in the state. One of the key initiatives in this endeavour is the enhancement of the **'EV Upyog' portal**, which serves as a platform to facilitate EV-related activities.
- **Maharashtra government** has announced **'Chief Minister Vayoshree Yojana'** is set to benefit around **15 lakh senior citizens** suffering from physical or mental disabilities. Under this scheme, eligible citizens above the **age of 65** will receive financial assistance of three thousand rupees, providing much-needed support and relief to vulnerable members of society.
- In response to growing safety concerns among **Telangana citizens residing abroad** and recognizing the need for immediate support and assistance for Telangana citizens facing challenges overseas, Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy has announced the **establishment of a dedicated help desk**.
- **Uttarakhand** has marked a significant milestone in **India's legislative history by becoming the first state** to implement the **Uniform Civil Code (UCC)**. This groundbreaking move was initiated by Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, with the state Assembly passing the UCC Bill. The UCC aims to standardize laws governing personal matters like marriage, divorce, inheritance, and more across all citizens, irrespective of their religion.
- In a significant move towards bolstering infrastructure and fostering socio-economic development, Chief Minister (CM) **Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu** recently spearheaded the **'Sarkar Gaon Ke Dwar' program** at Amb-Pathiyar under the Jawalamukhi assembly constituency. The event served as a platform for the CM to engage with local residents and gain insight into their concerns, while also unveiling a series of transformative announcements aimed at propelling the region forward.
- In a collaborative effort between the **Assam government** and **Larsen & Toubro (L&T)**, Chief Minister Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma inaugurated the **Construction Skill Training Centre in Assam**. This initiative **aims to address unemployment** by providing comprehensive training opportunities to the youth and enhancing their employability in the construction sector.
- **Uttar Pradesh** aims to revolutionize its energy sector by constructing **one million tonne per annum (mtpa)** green hydrogen production capacity, generating an estimated **120,000 jobs**. This initiative stems from the state's commitment to sustainable development and capitalizes on the burgeoning global green hydrogen market.
- Telangana Governor **Tamilisai Soundararajan** made groundbreaking announcements during her address to the joint session of the legislature, outlining the state government's ambitious agenda for digital inclusion and technological advancement. With a focus on ensuring universal access to the internet and **positioning Hyderabad and Telangana as the nation's AI capital**, Governor Soundararajan's vision sets a bold precedent for the state's future development.
- In a significant move towards empowering the youth of **Odisha**, the state government has unveiled the **'Swayam' scheme** aimed at providing interest-free loans to young entrepreneurs. This initiative, announced by Odisha Agriculture Minister Ranendra Pratap Swain, underscores the government's commitment to fostering self-employment opportunities and economic growth.
- **Karnataka** has emerged as the frontrunner in **India's electric vehicle (EV) infrastructure** development, boasting the highest number of public charging stations according to **Bureau of Energy Efficiency statistics**.
- In the dynamic landscape of India's automobile industry, the latest data from the **Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM)** for October-December 2023 reveals intriguing trends. **Uttar Pradesh emerges as the frontrunner** in vehicle sales during this period, with Maharashtra closely trailing behind.
- **Arunachal Pradesh**, nestled in the northeastern corner of India, celebrates its Foundation Day annually on **February 20th**, marking the day it attained **full statehood in 1987**. This occasion commemorates the region's transition from the **North-East Frontier Agency (NEFA)** to a distinct state within the Indian union.

- The renowned **Khajuraho Dance Festival** embarks on its **50th year of celebration** in **Khajuraho, Madhya Pradesh**, marking a milestone in the preservation and promotion of India's classical dance heritage. This prestigious event is being inaugurated by Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav, showcasing the state's commitment to cultural festivities.
 - The Maharashtra Cabinet has approved a draft bill to extend a **10 percent reservation to the Maratha community** in both educational institutions and government employment. This move follows a report submitted by the **Maharashtra Backward Class Commission (MBCC)** justifying the extension beyond the 50 percent cap.
 - **Arunachal Pradesh** has made a significant achievement by **reaching 100 percent saturation** in the '**Har Ghar Jal**' scheme under the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM), announced by Chief Minister Pema Khandu. This milestone sets Arunachal Pradesh apart as the first state in the northeast and the **tenth in India to fully embrace the central government's initiative**, aimed at ensuring clean and safe piped water for every household.
 - **Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami** unveiled the '**Himalayan Basket**' initiative from his residence. Initially conceived by local entrepreneurs Sumit and Sneha Thapliyal in 2018, this innovative project aims to harness the agricultural riches of Champawat district, propelling it towards becoming an ideal district through the enhancement of local employment opportunities.
 - The **Arunachal Pradesh** government recently signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)** to establish the **state's first Special Tiger Protection Force (STPF)**. This move aims to bolster conservation efforts and protect the tiger population within the state.
 - The Medaram Jatara, known as **Sammakka Saralamma Jatara**, began this year on February 21 in Medaram, Mulugu district, showcasing Telangana's rich tribal heritage. This four-day event, considered the world's largest tribal gathering, attracts pilgrims to the remote village of Medaram once every two years.
 - In a bold move aimed at revolutionizing the educational landscape, the **Madhya Pradesh government** has announced a groundbreaking initiative – the introduction of a '**bag-less school**' policy. This policy, set to be implemented once a week from the upcoming academic session of 2024-25, marks a significant departure from traditional educational norms and underscores the government's commitment to student welfare and holistic development.
 - The **Forest Department in Uttar Pradesh's Gonda district**, in collaboration with the **Turtle Survival Alliance Foundation India**, is initiating a conservation effort. This endeavor aims to establish a **turtle conservation reserve** along the Sarju river, a tributary of the Ghaghra river.
- Gonda district is known for its turtle diversity, making it an ideal location for such a conservation effort.
- **Haryana** Chief Minister Manohar Lal Khattar inaugurated the "**Savera**" program, a groundbreaking initiative aimed at early detection and prevention of breast cancer in women. Developed in collaboration with the Medanta Foundation and the Health Department, Savera leverages the **unique ability of visually impaired women** to conduct breast cancer screenings.
 - Recently, the **Central University of Bihar (CUSB)** achieved a significant milestone as the **University Grants Commission (UGC)** granted it **Category-1 status**. This accomplishment holds particular significance in a state where state universities encounter accreditation challenges and academic performance issues.
 - In a significant development for India's defense sector, the Adani Group has inaugurated the **Ammunition & Missiles Complex in Kanpur**, Uttar Pradesh. This complex, owned by Adani Defence, marks the first phase of the state's defense corridor and is dedicated to the brave warriors of the Balakot strike.
 - Prime Minister Narendra Modi ceremonially laid the foundation stone for **Sikkim's inaugural railway station in Rangpo**, marking a significant moment in the state's history. The station's design, deeply rooted in local culture, heritage, and architecture, reflects Sikkim's rich traditions and the majestic Himalayan landscape.
 - The **Tripura Chief Minister, Dr. Manik Saha**, marked a pivotal moment in the state's development with the inauguration of the **Jagannath Dighi Waterfront Development Project** in Udaipur. This significant endeavor reflects the government's commitment to enhancing infrastructure and promoting tourism in the region.
 - In a significant move, the Telangana government has opted to discontinue the much-touted **Hyderabad Pharma City project**, citing legal complexities, farmer protests, and environmental concerns.
 - The **Uttarakhand government** will introduce a bill to hold rioters responsible for damage to both government and private property. In the upcoming budget session, they intend to present the **Uttarakhand Public and Private Property Damage Recovery Bill**, aiming to make rioters financially liable for losses resulting from protests or strikes.
 - **Chief Minister Prof Dr Manik Saha** inaugurated the **2nd State Level Shehri Samridhi Utsav** organized by Tripura Urban Livelihood Mission at Children's Park, Agartala. The event aimed at fostering urban livelihood opportunities and empowering women in the region.
 - **Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh**, is set to unveil a groundbreaking innovation in timekeeping with the world's first **Vedic Clock**. This meticulously crafted timepiece, housed on an **85-foot tower at the city's Jantar Mantar**, will be officially inaugurated on **March 1st, 2024**, by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** in a virtual ceremony.

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- **Sarbananda Sonowal**, Union Minister of MoPSW & AYUSH, virtually inaugurated the 60T bollard pull tug named '**Ocean Grace**' and the Medical Mobile Unit (MMU) on March 2, 2024. The Ocean Grace is the first Make-in-India **ASTDS Tug** developed by Cochin Shipyard Limited under MoPSW. The MMU is part of the port's commitment to corporate social responsibility.
- **Chapchar Kut**, the grandest festival in **Mizoram**, resonated throughout the state with vibrant traditional customs and jubilant festivities. Thousands of attendees converged upon the Assam Rifles Ground – Lammual – in the heart of Aizawl city, filling it to its capacity. The event featured a rich display of Mizo community traditions and culture, highlighted by traditional songs and captivating cultural dance performances, making it a day-long celebration to remember.
- In Uttar Pradesh, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath has launched an initiative to support young entrepreneurs called "**Mukhyamantri Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan (MYUVA)**." This program offers interest-free loans to help young people kickstart their business ventures with projects valued up to Rs 5 lakh.
- **Uttar Pradesh**, under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, has achieved a milestone by becoming the **first state in the country to issue five crore Ayushman cards**. This accomplishment underscores the state government's commitment to ensuring the health and well-being of every citizen.
- **Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Sukhu** has announced a groundbreaking initiative aimed at empowering women in the state. The announcement comes as part of the Congress party's pre-election promises, marking a pivotal step towards fulfilling its commitments to the electorate. Chief Minister Sukhvinder Sukhu unveiled the "Indira Gandhi Pyari Behna Sukh Samman Nidhi Yojna," a scheme designed to provide financial support to women aged between 18 to 60 years. Under this scheme, eligible women will receive a **monthly stipend of ₹1,500**, amounting to an annual expenditure of ₹800 crore.
- **Bengaluru**, famously known as the Garden City, is poised to become the epicenter of cutting-edge advancements in the horticulture sector. The **Indian Institute of Horticultural Research (IIHR)** is gearing up to host the three-day **National Horticultural Fair 2024** at its Hessarghatta premises, situated on the outskirts of Bengaluru.
- **South Eastern Coalfield Limited's (SECL) Gevra mine**, located in **Chhattisgarh**, is on the verge of becoming the largest coal mine in Asia. The mine recently received environmental clearance to enhance its production capacity to 70 million tons per annum, up from the existing 52.5 million tons.
- **Kerala school** has introduced **Iris**, a humanoid teacher, marking a significant milestone in the realm of educational technology. Developed in collaboration with **Makerlabs Edutech Private Limited**, Iris represents a pioneering effort to make learning more interactive, engaging, and accessible.
- **Kerala**, renowned for its cultural richness and cinematic brilliance, is set to make history in the digital entertainment landscape with the launch of **CSpace**, **India's** maiden government-backed **Over-The-Top (OTT) platform**. The much-anticipated unveiling ceremony will take place at Kairali Theatre on Thursday, March 7, at 9:30 am, with Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan spearheading the event.
- Under the directions and guidance of Hon'ble **Chief Minister Shri Pushkar Singh Dhami**, a significant Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was signed on Tuesday, 5th March. This pivotal agreement took place between **CSIR Indian Institute of Petroleum, Dehradun**, and **UCOST** under the aegis of the "Adarsh Champawat" mission. The MoU signifies a collaborative effort to address environmental challenges and promote sustainable development in the region.
- **Uttar Pradesh government**, led by **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath**, has announced a complete waiver of electricity bills for private tube wells owned by farmers, effective from April 1, 2023. This decision, announced, aims to alleviate the financial burden on the state's farmers, enhancing their agricultural productivity and overall well-being.
- **Karnataka state government**, in a strategic alliance with the **World Economic Forum (WEF)**, has announced the establishment of a cutting-edge AI centre in the state. This collaboration formalized through a Letter of Intent signed on February 29, aims to position Karnataka as a global hub for artificial intelligence, marking a significant step in integrating the state into the global digital and technological landscape.
- Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister **Yogi Adityanath** on March 6 took the priority corridor of the **Agra Metro**, for an inaugural ride after Prime Minister Narendra Modi virtually flagged off the project earlier in the day. The **6 km long priority corridor** connects the iconic **Taj Mahal's eastern gate to the Mankameshwar Temple station**, providing a vital transportation link for tourists and commuters alike.
- The **Bengaluru Metro Rail Corporation Limited (BMRCL)** has received the first set of six train coaches for its upcoming **driverless metro line**, called the **Yellow Line**. This 18.8 km-long line, connecting **RV Road and Bommasandra**, will be the first in India to have a **driverless train system**.

- At the **4th Semicon India FutureDesign Roadshow in Kerala**, Union Minister Shri Rajeev Chandrasekhar lauded the remarkable progress of India's semiconductor industry under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. He emphasized the transformative role of technology and semiconductor engineering in shaping India's future.
- **Bichom**, carved out of West and East Kameng, has been declared the **27th district of Arunachal Pradesh**. Chief Minister Pema Khandu led the inauguration ceremony, marking a significant milestone for the region.
- The **3-day National Dairy Mela** and Agricultural Exhibition at Chaibasa in Jharkhand was inaugurated by Union Minister of Tribal Affairs, Agriculture, and Farmers Welfare, Shri Arjun Munda. Organized by the National Dairy Research Institute, Karnal, Haryana, this event marks the first of its kind in Jharkhand, aimed at fostering the comprehensive development of livestock and agriculture in tribal areas.
- The state of **Maharashtra** has announced its fourth **women's policy**, which aims to promote the **holistic development** of women. Aditi Tatkare, the **Women and Child Development Minister**, unveiled this policy on the eve of **Women's Day** during the golden jubilee year of the Women's Economic Development Corporation.
- The Chief Minister of Assam, **Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma**, performed the Bhumi Pujan ceremony for a **50 MW Solar Project in Sonitpur district**. The project, being developed by **SJVN Green Energy Limited (SGEL)**, holds promise for bolstering Assam's renewable energy sector and contributing to sustainable development.
- The **Tamil Nadu government** has launched the '**Neengal Nalama**' (**Are you fine?**) scheme, a **beneficiary outreach program** aimed at reviewing the implementation of **flagship schemes** and addressing the **grievances of the public**. The initiative was kickstarted by Minister of Rural Development I. Periyasamy, with Chief Minister M.K. Stalin, other ministers, senior officials, and district collectors reaching out to beneficiaries across the state.
- **Nayab Singh Saini**, an **influential** leader from the **Other Backward Classes (OBC)** community, has been appointed as the new **Chief Minister of Haryana**. The decision was announced by the **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)** on Tuesday afternoon, shortly after **Manohar Lal Khattar**, the outgoing Chief Minister and his entire cabinet stepped down.
- **Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin** on Tuesday, **March 12, 2024**, announced that the **Citizenship (Amendment) Act (CAA)**, whose rules were notified by the **Union Home Ministry** on **March 11**, will not be implemented in the state. The decision comes amid growing concerns that the CAA goes against **minorities** and **Sri Lankan Tamils** living in camps in Tamil Nadu.
- The **Geological Survey of India**, State Unit: Andhra Pradesh, unveiled a representative **Stratigraphic Column** of the Cuddapah Supergroup in Vajrakarur Diamond Processing Camp, Anantapur district, **Andhra Pradesh**. The ceremony took place on 10th March 2024 and was attended by prominent dignitaries including Shri Ch Venkateswara Rao, ADG & HoD, GSI, Southern Region, and Shri S. N. Mahapatro, Deputy Director General, SU: Andhra Pradesh.
- For the first time, the district of **Simdega** in Jharkhand is hosting the **Pusa Krishi Vigyan Mela**, a national-level **agricultural science fair**. The event, organized by the **Indian Agricultural Research Institute, Pusa (New Delhi)**, is being held at the **Albert Ekka Stadium** from **March 10th to 12th**, marking a significant stride towards realizing the vision of a **prosperous farmer community**.
- **Odisha government** led by **Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik** has announced an additional **10 days of casual leave for women** working in various government departments. This decision aims to recognize the multitude of responsibilities women shoulder and provide them with greater flexibility to strike a better work-life balance.
- The **Maharashtra** government has taken a historic step by securing approval from the **Jammu and Kashmir** administration to acquire **2.5 acres of land in Ichgam, near Srinagar airport**, for the construction of **Maharashtra Bhawan**. This initiative symbolizes a proactive approach towards fostering cultural and touristic ties between the two regions.
- The Rajasthan government has decided to distribute **free seeds of millets** and coarse grains to the state's farmers. This move aims to **boost millet production** in the state.
- **Tamil Nadu dominates** the illegal trade in shark body parts, comprising nearly 65% of seizures between January 2010 and December 2022, as per a recent analysis by **TRAFFIC and WWF-India**. This alarming trend poses a significant threat to marine biodiversity, with **Karnataka, Gujarat, Kerala, and Maharashtra** also contributing to this illicit trade.
- The Maharashtra Cabinet has announced its decision to **rename Ahmednagar district** as '**Ahilya Nagar**'. The renaming is in honor of the **18th-century Maratha queen Ahilyabai Holkar**.
- **Tamilisai Soundararajan**, the Governor of **Telangana**, has **resigned** from her position on Monday, March 18, 2024. According to sources, she is likely to **contest** the **Lok Sabha elections** from the state of **Tamil Nadu**.
- Odisha Chief Minister **Naveen Patnaik** inaugurated India's first **indoor athletics stadium** and **indoor aquatic centre** at the **Kalinga stadium** in **Bhubaneswar**. The Chief Minister also laid the foundation stone for a new **indoor diving centre** in the stadium complex.

- The Election Commission has launched a special campaign in Himachal Pradesh to boost voter turnout in 414 polling stations with less than 60% voting during the last Lok Sabha polls.
- Jharkhand Governor CP Radhakrishnan has been given the additional responsibility as the in-charge governor of Telangana. This comes after Tamilisai Soundararajan resigned from her constitutional post as the Telangana Governor.
- The city of Begusarai in Bihar is the most polluted city in the world, according to the World Air Quality Report 2023 released by IQAir, a Switzerland-based organization. The report states that out of the top 100 most polluted places globally, 83 are from India.
- The Uttar Pradesh police force is set to adopt the advanced Trinetra app 2.0, a cutting-edge digital platform that promises to revolutionize crime prevention and investigation in the state.
- Tamil Nadu is set to witness a historic event as one of its space startups, Agnikul Cosmos Private Limited, prepares to launch its first rocket, Agnibaan Sub Orbital Technology Demonstrator (SOTeD), from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh. This launch marks several significant milestones in India's space exploration journey.
- Bihar Diwas 2024, celebrated on 22nd March 2024 in India, holds immense historical and cultural significance for the state of Bihar. It commemorates the founding of Bihar as a separate state in 1912, marking its separation from the Bengal Presidency. The inception of Bihar Diwas dates back to 2010, when the state government initiated the celebrations to honor Bihar's 112th statehood anniversary. Since then, Bihar Diwas has evolved into a vibrant occasion, reflecting the essence of Bihar's rich heritage and traditions.
- Researchers have made an exciting discovery off the coast of Kollam in Kerala. They have found a new species of deep-sea isopod, which is a tiny crustacean that feeds on fish. This new species belongs to the genus Brucethoa and was found living inside the gill cavity of a fish called the Spinyjaw greeneye.
- The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) is conducting excavations at two mounds in Nachne village, located in the Panna district of Madhya Pradesh. The goal of these excavations is to uncover what could potentially be the oldest temple in India.
- The Allahabad High Court's Lucknow bench has declared the UP Board of Madarsa Education Act of 2004 as unconstitutional. The court ruled that the act violated the principle of secularism, as well as several articles of the Constitution, including Articles 14, 21, and 21-A. Additionally, the court found that the act also contravened Section 22 of the University Grants Commission Act of 1956.

- Uttar Pradesh boasts of being the state with the most districts in India, totaling 75 districts divided into 18 divisions. Additionally, it comprises 822 development blocks, 17 municipal corporations, and 351 tehsils. The easternmost district is Ballia, while Saharanpur is the northernmost, Sonbhadra the southernmost, and Shamli the westernmost district. In this article, we will get to know about the village of "Choti Kashi" in Uttar Pradesh.
- Gujarat's Minister of State for Education, Praful Pansheriya, launched the online learning platform Shiksha Reform in Surat. The event was attended by noted educationist Deepak Rajguru, trustees, principals, Kimmo Nikkanen from Finland's Kajaani University of Applied Sciences, and educationist Antti Isoviita.

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- Tamil Nadu Governor R.N. Ravi inaugurated the Param Vir Chakra garden and Aikyam exhibition at the Kanchi Mahaswami Vidya Mandir in Tambaram. Ravi was accompanied by Lt. Gen. Karanbir Singh Brar, Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM), General Officer Commanding (Dakshin Bharat area), and V.Shankar, chairman of the Sri Kanchi Mahaswami Trust.
- The state government of Uttarakhand has initiated proactive measures to assess and mitigate the risks associated with Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs). Two expert panels have been established to conduct risk assessments and monitor five high-risk glacial lakes in the region. These lakes have been identified as prone to immediate danger, necessitating urgent attention and intervention.
- In an innovative move aimed at enhancing voter engagement and accessibility to election-related information, Punjab's Malerkotla district has introduced the 'Booth Raabta' website. Spearheaded by District Election Officer and Deputy Commissioner, Dr. Pallavi, this platform, accessible via boothraabta.com, serves as a comprehensive resource hub for voters and polling personnel alike.
- The 34th Seng Khihlang festival, a revered event for adherents of the Khasi Indigenous Faith, recently concluded in Wahiajer, Meghalaya. Spanning from April 19, 2024, the festival celebrated the unity and traditions of the indigenous community.
- The southern Indian state of Kerala is renowned for its rich cultural tapestry, encompassing a diverse array of religions, landscapes, rituals, and histories. Amidst this vibrant melting pot, one festival stands out as a true embodiment of Kerala's profound cultural heritage – the Thrissur Pooram.
- In Manipur, Khongjom Day is observed on April 23 to pay homage to the brave souls who fought against the British in the Khongjom Battle during the Anglo-Manipuri War of 1891. This day holds great significance in the history of Manipur, as it commemorates the valor and sacrifice of those who laid down their lives to protect their homeland.

- The **government of Tamil Nadu** has launched a three-day survey of the **Nilgiri Tahr**, the state's iconic animal. This initiative aims to better understand and conserve this **endangered species** that faces numerous challenges, including **habitat loss** and **poaching**.

States Current Affairs of May 2024

- The **government of Tamil Nadu** has launched a three-day survey of the **Nilgiri Tahr**, the state's iconic animal. This initiative aims to better understand and conserve this **endangered species** that faces numerous challenges, including **habitat loss** and **poaching**.
- **Maharashtra Day**, also known as **Maharashtra Divas**, is celebrated every year on **May 1st** to commemorate the **formation of the state in 1960**. Maharashtra was carved out of the Bombay Presidency and declared a separate state on this historic day. Present-day Gujarat constitutes the other part of the former Bombay state. The division was a result of the States Reorganisation Act of 1956, which aimed to reorganize states based on linguistic boundaries, following massive protests for linguistic states.
- **Gujarat Day**, celebrated on **May 1st**, commemorates the formation of the **vibrant state of Gujarat on May 1st, 1960**. This annual occasion reflects Gujarat's rich cultural heritage, resilience, and contributions to India's cultural mosaic. With a history steeped in tradition and progress, Gujarat Day serves as a reminder of the state's journey towards independence and its ongoing pursuit of growth and prosperity.
- The **Uttarakhand government** has **suspended** the manufacturing licenses of **14 products from Patanjali Ayurved**, founded by **Baba Ramdev**, citing misleading advertisements about their efficacy. This move comes amid ongoing scrutiny and legal proceedings against Ramdev for non-compliance with directives to cease misleading advertising.
- The **Union Ministry of Home Affairs** has granted approval to the Uttar Pradesh Government's proposal to **rename eight railway stations in Amethi district**. Spearheaded by BJP Amethi MP Smriti Irani, this decision aims to preserve the cultural identity and heritage of the region by honoring local temples, saints, idols, and freedom fighters through the new station names.
- In response to a **public interest litigation (PIL)** on child marriage, the **Rajasthan High Court** has issued a directive aimed at curbing the practice in the state. With the approaching **Akshay Tritiya festival**, notorious for child marriages, the court has emphasized the responsibility of sarpanchs and panchayat members in preventing such unions.
- As the Lok Sabha elections in Gurugram, scheduled for May 25, draw near, the district administration has taken a unique approach to encourage voter participation. In a bid to attract the attention of the electorate, particularly

the youth, the authorities have roped in **India cricketer Yuzvendra Chahal**, as well as popular singers **MD Desi Rockstar** and **Naveen Punia**, as brand ambassadors.

- Amidst the aftermath of ethnic strife and severe hailstorms, **Manipur's government introduces** the **"School on Wheels" program**, aiming to provide education to students sheltered in relief camps across the state. The initiative, inaugurated by **Governor Anusuiya Uikey**, entails a mobile educational setup equipped with a library, computers, and sports items, accompanied by a teacher, to visit various camps.
- Kerala's health authorities have reported West Nile fever cases in three districts: Kozhikode, Malappuram, and Thrissur. In response, the state government has directed all districts to be vigilant and implement mosquito control measures, including pre-monsoon cleaning drives and surveillance activities.
- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has been actively assisting the state in combating the forest fires. In response to the raging fires in the Pauri Garhwal sector, the IAF provided much-needed relief by undertaking **Bambi Bucket operations** using its **Mi17 V5 helicopters**.
- The **Uttarakhand government** has launched the **'Pirul Lao-Paise Pao'** campaign to contain the raging **forest fires** in the state. Chief Minister **Pushkar Singh Dhami** launched the campaign in the **Rudraprayag district** on **May 8, 2024**. He urged the people to actively participate in the campaign and stated that cooperatives, **Yuva Mangal Dal**, and **Van Panchayat** would also take part.
- Meghalaya has made history by appointing **Idashisha Nongrang** as the state's first woman **Director General of Police (DGP)**. Nongrang, a 1992 batch Indian Police Service (IPS) officer, will succeed **Lajja Ram Bishnoi**, who is set to retire on May 19, 2024.
- In a remarkable achievement, **P Shyaamnikhil** from Tamil Nadu has etched his name in the annals of Indian chess history by becoming the country's **85th Grandmaster (GM)**. The **31-year-old chess prodigy**, who embarked on his journey at the tender age of eight, finally secured the coveted **third and final GM norm** at the prestigious **2024 Dubai Police Masters Chess Tournament**.
- Assam has taken a significant step towards enhancing its disaster management capabilities with the launch of the **Disaster Reporting and Information Management System (DRIMS)**. This state-of-the-art digital platform, an initiative of the **Assam State Disaster Management Authority (ASDMA)**, aims to streamline the reporting and assessment of damages caused by various disasters, enabling prompt disbursement of aid to those affected.
- The **Karnataka government** has mandated a **33% reservation for women** in outsourced government jobs. This aligns with existing quotas for permanent positions and applies to jobs lasting more than 45 days and involving over 20 employees.

- In a heartening development, the annual waterhole census conducted in the **National Desert Park, Jaisalmer, Rajasthan**, has revealed a significant presence of the critically endangered Great Indian Bustard. The survey, which employs the waterhole technique during the scorching summer months, counted a staggering **64 Great Indian Bustards** within the park's boundaries.
- According to the **Central Electricity Authority's latest data**, **Uttar Pradesh** has emerged as the top state in terms of adding transmission lines by **state transmission companies in 2023-24**. This achievement follows its leading position in the previous fiscal year, 2022-23.
- **Goa Statehood Day** is celebrated annually on **May 30** to commemorate the day when **Goa** attained statehood in **1987**. This occasion marks the recognition of Goa as a separate state within the Indian union, distinct from the Union Territory it was previously part of.

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- **Telangana Formation Day** is a momentous occasion celebrated annually on **June 2** in the Indian state of **Telangana**. This day marks the **official establishment** of Telangana as the **28th state** of India on June 2, 2014, after years of **struggle** and **aspirations** for a separate state identity.
- The central government has approved Assam's proposal to establish a new Indian Institute of Management (IIM) in Kamrup district. **Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma** announced the **"in-principle approval"** from the **Ministry of Education**, with IIM Ahmedabad slated to mentor the new institution.
- In a bid to bolster cyber security awareness, Zupee, India's largest skill-based Ludo platform, has partnered with Gurugram Cyber Police for the 11th edition of the Cyber Security Summer Internship Program, titled **'Cyber Warriors'**. The month-long internship aims to train selected candidates in cyber security under the guidance of experts, fostering responsible digital citizenship and tackling real-world cyber threats.
- On **2 June 2024**, the city of **Hyderabad** officially ceases to be the joint capital of **Telangana** and **Andhra Pradesh**. This milestone marks the end of a ten-year period during which Hyderabad served as the shared capital for the two states.
- **Haryana Chief Secretary T V S N Prasad** announced the launch of a **Rs 10,000-crore project** funded by the World Bank to address **air pollution in the state**. The Haryana Clean Air Project for Sustainable Development will be rolled out in phases, starting with districts in the National Capital Region (NCR).
- The Uttarakhand government organized India's first-ever **astro-tourism** event called **'Nakshatra Sabha'** in **Mussoorie**, the 'Queen of Hills', on **June 1 and 2, 2024**. The inaugural event was held at the **George Everest Peak**, famous for its breathtaking views of the Doon Valley and the snow-capped Himalayas.
- India has added **two bird sanctuaries from Bihar, Nagi and Nakti** – to the **'Ramsar Sites'** list, taking the tally to 82. The newest 'Wetlands of International Importance', both man-made reservoirs situated in the **Jhajha forest range of Jamui District in Bihar**, were added to **Ramsar Sites** as part of World Environment Day, observed annually on June 5.
- After a decade-long hiatus, **TDP leader N. Chandrababu Naidu** is poised to reclaim the **Chief Minister's position in Andhra Pradesh**, with his swearing-in ceremony scheduled for **June 12 at Kesarapalli IT Park near Gannavaram airport**.
- In response to the needs of **Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)**, the Haryana government has established two specialized cells to address their concerns and facilitate investments. These cells, announced by **Chief Minister Manohar Lal Khattar during the Pravasi Haryana Divas 2017**, aim to streamline grievance resolution and investment processes for NRIs.
- **Bhajan Lal Sharma**, the Chief Minister of Rajasthan, has announced an ambitious plan to develop the **Maharana Pratap Tourist Circuit** with an investment of **Rs 100 crore**. This announcement was made on **8 June 2023** during the inauguration of the Maharana Pratap Jayanti celebration in Udaipur, where the **484th birthday** of the legendary Maharana Pratap of Mewar was celebrated on **9 June 2024** (according to the Hindu calendar).
- **Sikkim Krantikari Morcha (SKM)** supremo **Prem Singh Tamang** on June 10 took oath as the **Chief Minister of the Himalayan state** for the **second consecutive term**. The 56-year-old politician was administered the oath of office and secrecy by **Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya** at a function held in **Paljor Stadium in Gangtok**.
- **Visakhapatnam Port** achieves the **19th position** in the Container Port Performance Index 2023, surpassing Mundra Port. Operated by **J M Baxi Ports & Logistics**, it runs a high-capacity terminal contributing to its efficiency.
- A day before his **swearing-in** as the **chief minister of Andhra Pradesh**, **TDP supremo N Chandrababu Naidu** has announced that **Amaravati** will be the **sole capital** of the state.
- The **Uttar Pradesh government** has unveiled its plans for the **MotoGP event** as it will be hosted by the city of **Noida from 2025 until 2029** and announced a **collaboration with Spain's Dorna Sports** and the Indian partner which is **Fairstreet sports**. Initially, the event was to **take place in 2024**, but resulted in postponement due to weather conditions and is now slated for March 2025.
- Three years after vowing to enter the Assembly only as **Chief Minister**, **N. Chandrababu Naidu** has been **sworn in** for his **fourth term** as the **Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh**. The **oath-taking ceremony**, held near **Gannavaram Airport in Kesarapalli** on the outskirts of **Vijayawada**, saw the attendance of key figures including **PM Modi** and **Home Minister Amit Shah**.

- **Pema Khandu** of the **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)** took the oath as the **Chief Minister of Arunachal Pradesh** for the third consecutive time.
- **Janasena** chief **Pawan Kalyan** was named the **Deputy Chief Minister** in a highly-anticipated move by the **Andhra Pradesh government** on June 14. The actor-turned-politician has also been allocated the **Panchayat Raj and Rural Development, Environment, Forests, and Science and Technology** portfolios in the **Chandrababu Naidu-led government**.
- **Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav** launched an intra-State air service to promote tourism on June 13 from **Raja Bhoj International Airport** in the state capital **Bhopal**. It is called '**PM Shri Paryatan Vayu Seva**' and the first flight was flagged off from the capital **Bhopal to Jabalpur**. The service operated by the **Madhya Pradesh Tourism Board (MPTB)** with two aircraft will connect eight cities across the State- **Bhopal, Indore, Jabalpur, Gwalior, Khajuraho, Ujjain, Rewa, and Singrauli**.
- **Kerala's Kozhikode** is all set to host the **Malabar River Festival 2024**, featuring the International White Water Kayaking Championship from **July 25 to 28**. This exciting event aims to promote white-water kayaking in the region and will be held in **Thusaharagiri, Chalipuzha, and Iruvazhinjipuzha**. The high-octane events and pre-events will host over 100 national-level kayakers from India and kayaking professionals from over 20 countries.
- **Punjab Police** in association with the **Border Security Force (BSF)** and Village Defence Committees (VDCs) will carry out a one-week **drive against drugs** in **Fazilka** district. They will reach out to residents of as many as 42 villages along the India-Pakistan border to gather actionable intelligence about the demand and supply of drugs.
- **Tesam Pongte** was unanimously elected as the Speaker of the **8th Arunachal Pradesh Assembly** on June 15. **Pro-tem Speaker Ninong Ering** announced that **Pongte** was elected unopposed as the Speaker of the Assembly.
- The **Madhya Pradesh government** has completed preparations for its ambitious cheetah reintroduction project at **Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary**. This is slated to be the **second home for cheetahs** in India after **Kuno National Park**.
- In a historic move, senior **BJP leader Surama Padhy** has been unanimously elected as the Speaker of the **Odisha Assembly**, becoming only the second woman to hold this prestigious position. Padhy, a two-term MLA from the **Ranpur constituency** in **Nayagarh district**, assumed office unopposed during a special session of the Assembly.
- **Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot** of **Karnataka** inaugurated the **National Yoga Olympiad 2024 in Mysuru**, emphasizing yoga's integral role in Indian culture and its global significance. More than 400 students and 100 teachers from across the country are participating in this inaugural three-day event.
- The **Hemis Festival**, a vibrant celebration of **Tibetan Buddhism**, takes place annually in **Ladakh, India**. In 2024, this important cultural event will be held on **June 16th and 17th**.
- **Telugu Desam Party's** Narsipatnam MLA **C. Ayyanna Patrudu** was elected unanimously as the Speaker of the **16th Andhra Pradesh Legislative Assembly** on June 22, 2024. Mr. Ayyanna Patrudu's election was a mere formality as no other MLA filed a nomination for the Speaker's post to challenge him.
- On **June 23, 2024**, **Kozhikode** made history by becoming the first **UNESCO City of Literature** in India. This prestigious recognition highlights the city's rich literary heritage and cultural significance.
- **Uttar Pradesh** is set to establish the **world's first conservation and breeding centre** for Asian king vultures or red-headed vultures in **Maharajanj**. The facility will improve the population of critically endangered species listed in the International Union for Conservation of Nature's red list since 2007. The centre is named **Jatayu Conservation and Breeding Centre**.
- **Nayab Singh Saini** announced that the reservation for the backward classes in **Group-A and Group-B posts**, currently at **15 per cent**, will be increased to **27 per cent**, "**in line with the Central government's policy**". Saini was addressing a gathering at '**OBC Morcha Sarv Samaj Samrasta Sammelan**' held in Gurugram.
- **Srinagar** has become the **fourth Indian city** to be recognised as a '**World Craft City**' by the World Craft Council (WCC). Three years after it was designated as part of the **UNESCO Creative City Network (UCCN)** for **crafts and folk arts**.
- The **Madhya Pradesh cabinet, led by Chief Minister Mohan Yadav**, decided on June 25, 2024, that state ministers will now be responsible for paying income tax on their salaries and allowances out of their own pockets. This marks a significant change from a 1972 rule under which the state government bore the tax burden. This decision was approved unanimously during a cabinet meeting held in Bhopal.
- The **Uttar Pradesh government** has announced an ambitious plan to establish a **bioplastic park** in the **Lakhimpur Kheri district**. This innovative project aims to address environmental concerns while boosting the local economy. Let's explore the details of this groundbreaking initiative.
- The **Pench Tiger Reserve** in **Maharashtra** has taken a significant step forward in wildlife protection by introducing an advanced **Artificial Intelligence (AI) system** for early forest fire detection. This innovative approach marks a new chapter in conservation efforts, combining cutting-edge technology with traditional wildlife management practices.

States Current Affairs of July 2024

- **Hul Kranti Diwas** is celebrated on **June 30** every year to mark the independence **movement of 1855** led by tribal heroes **Sidho, Kanho, Chand, Bhairav**, among others. More than **50,000 tribals** from **400 villages of Jharkhand** had revolted against **British Rule**.
- Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister **Chandrababu Naidu** launched the **NTR Bharosa pension scheme**, fulfilling a key election promise and bringing hope to millions of beneficiaries across the state.
- A team of researchers from the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** has recorded a new species of forest-dwelling horned frog in **Arunachal Pradesh**. The new-to-science **Xenophrys apatani**, recorded from the **Talle Wildlife Sanctuary** in the Lower Subansiri district, has been named after the dominant **Apatani community** in recognition of their ingenuity in the conservation of **wild flora and fauna**.
- **Uttar Pradesh (UP)**, the state government has passed the draft for the **Uttar Pradesh Nodal Investment Region for Manufacturing (Construction) Area Bill (NIRMAN)-2024**. This initiative, chaired by **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath**, is part of a broader strategy to uplift the state's economy to the one trillion dollar mark.
- **Bhopal**, Chief Minister **Dr. Mohan Yadav** has said that our aim is to make all departments as accountable as possible towards the public. **Lokpath Mobile App** prepared by the Public Works Department is being launched with a view to continuously moving forward on the path of public welfare by adopting a more transparent and accountable working system towards the public.
- **Hemant Soren** has returned as **Chief Minister of Jharkhand**, reinstated after a five-month hiatus that began with his arrest by the **Enforcement Directorate**. His reappointment follows a tumultuous period marked by political maneuvering within the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM), which heads the state's ruling alliance.
- National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) declared the mica mines of Jharkhand 'child labour-free' at an event in **Koderma, Jharkhand**. NCPCR chairperson **Priyank Kanoongo** announced this as the first-ever successful endeavor to cleanse a supply chain of child labour in mica mining.
- **Jagannath Rath Yatra** is a famous Hindu festival celebrated every year in the **city of Puri, Odisha**. It takes place on the Dwitiya Tithi, the second day of the bright fortnight of Sharad Paksha, a period of increasing moonlight considered auspicious for spiritual activities. This festival falls in the month of Asadh according to the Hindu lunar calendar, usually corresponding to June or July in the Gregorian calendar.
- The 15th Agriculture Leadership Awards Committee has announced that **Maharashtra** has won the **Best Agriculture State Award for 2024**. The announcement was made by the committee headed by **Justice P Sathasivam**, former Chief Justice of India and Governor of Kerala.
- The **Uttar Pradesh government**, led by Chief Minister **Yogi Adityanath**, has unveiled a major environmental initiative called '**Mitra Van**' (**Friendship Forest**) as part of the Vriksharopan Jan Abhiyan-2024. This ambitious project aims to enhance greenery along the borders of Uttar Pradesh, including its international border with Nepal.
- The Uttar Pradesh government has secured over **154 defence manufacturing deals worth Rs 25,000 crore**, marking a significant stride in bolstering India's defence production capabilities. These initiatives are part of the **Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor (UPDIC)**, spanning Lucknow, Kanpur, Jhansi, Aligarh, Chitrakoot, and Agra districts.
- The **Forest Department of Uttar Pradesh** has released its latest summer census figures for the state bird, the **Sarus Crane**. The report, unveiled on July 10, 2024, reveals a promising trend in the conservation efforts of this majestic species.
- In a significant recognition of its efforts in agricultural development, **Nagaland** has been awarded the title of **best state in horticulture** at the prestigious **Agriculture Leadership Awards 2024**. This accolade highlights the state's commitment to innovative agricultural practices and rural development.
- The Haryana Cabinet has approved the launch of the **IT Saksham Yuva Scheme, 2024**, targeting the provision of jobs to 5,000 youths in the first phase. This initiative aligns with the '**Mission 60,000**' from the **2024-25 budget**, aiming to employ 60,000 young individuals from poor families. Under the scheme, graduates or postgraduates from IT backgrounds will undergo specially designed short-term courses for a minimum of three months.
- The **Jharkhand government** is working on a plan to open eastern **India's first university for physically challenged students in Ranchi (Jharkhand)** a minister said on June 11. The proposed university will offer **education** according to the needs of students with disabilities. Higher and technical education minister **Champai Soren** directed officials to prepare a proposal to open the university for **physically challenged students in Ranchi**.
- Uttar Pradesh **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath** announced on June 12, in Lucknow that the State would be exporting 40 tonnes of mangoes to **Japan and Malaysia**. And for the first time in its **160-year** history, Lucknow's famous **Dussehri** is to be exported to the **United States**. He was inaugurating the **Uttar Pradesh Mango Festival 2024** at **Awadh Shilp Gram**.

- **Justice Aalia Neelum** on July 11, took oath as the **Chief Justice of the Lahore High Court (LHC)** of Pakistan (Lahore), making her the first woman to be elevated as the court's top judge. **Punjab Governor Sardar Saleem Haider Khan** administered the oath of office to her. Punjab province's **first woman Chief Minister Maryam Nawaz** was also present in the oath-taking ceremony.
- **Tripura Chief Minister Manik Saha** emphasized the importance of educating the younger generation about the historical background of **Kharchi Puja** and its **fourteen deities**. The inauguration of the traditional festival at the **Chaturdash Devta temple** in old Agartala's Khayerpur on June 14.
- The Himachal Pradesh Cabinet gave its approval on July 12, to rationalise the provisions for **zero electricity bills for domestic consumers** by restricting subsidy to **'one family, one meter'** and interlinking power connections with ration cards.
- The research wing of the Uttarakhand Forest Department established **Uttarakhand's first bird gallery** at the Nature Education Centre, **Jolly Grant, in Dehradun** on July 15. This gallery showcases high-resolution images of Uttarakhand's birds, giving visitors an eye-catching display of the state's feathery inhabitants.
- In a significant stride towards enhancing digital healthcare infrastructure, the Uttarakhand government has successfully integrated its **eSwasthya Dham portal** with the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)**. This integration marks a crucial step in improving health monitoring and management for pilgrims undertaking the revered **Char Dham Yatra**, while also aligning with India's broader digital health initiatives.
- **July 16**, marks the **official beginning of Sawan** accompanied by the vibrant **Harela festival** celebrated across **Uttarakhand**. This traditional festival holds deep significance for the region's **agriculture and culture**, symbolising prosperity and overall well-being.
- **Indore** on July 14, set a new **Guinness World Record** in the category of **"the most trees planted by a team in 24 hours"** by planting **more than 11 lakh saplings**. Chief Minister **Mohan Yadav** stated that Indore, already the cleanest city in India and the economic capital of Madhya Pradesh, has now achieved the world record of planting more than **11 lakh saplings in a single day**. The programme was **organised by the state government**.
- In a bid to tackle **unemployment among the youth**, the **Government of Maharashtra** has unveiled the **Mukhyamantri Yuva Karya Prashikshan Yojana** (Chief Minister Youth Work Training Scheme). It **aims** to provide valuable internship opportunities, equipping young individuals with essential skills and enhancing their employability in a competitive job market.
- The first confirmed death due to **Chandipura virus infection in Gujarat** was reported as a **four-year-old child**

from **Mota Kanthariya in Aravalli**. The confirmation came from Pune's National Institute of Virology. The virus, initially reported in north Gujarat, has spread to new areas, raising concerns about a potential outbreak with 14 deaths in two weeks and 26 suspected cases under investigation.

- Scientists from Hyderabad's **National Geophysical Research Institute (NGRI)** have revealed a historic collision between **India and East Antarctica over a billion years ago**. Their findings, including a hidden ridge in **Andhra Pradesh's Darsi and Addanki regions**, suggest significant geological shifts. Seismic data reprocessing uncovered Proterozoic sediment layers, shedding new light on India's eastern coast evolution. Published in the **Journal of Pure and Applied Geophysics**, this research enriches the understanding of ancient Indian subcontinent ties to Antarctica.
- Madhya Pradesh has been recognized as the **'Best Performing State'** under the **Prime Minister SVANidhi scheme**, which supports urban street vendors with collateral-free loans up to ₹50,000. The Union Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry announced this accolade, with Assam securing the second position in the **'Best Performing States – Innovation and Best Practices Award'** category.
- **Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy** launched a unique programme to provide financial assistance to the **Civil Services aspirants from Telangana**, under which the candidates who qualify for the Mains exams will be provided with **₹1 lakh for preparation**.
- **Meghalaya** launched State-owned **Hello Meghalaya**, an **OTT platform** primarily for regional languages with a limited reach or small market, on July 11.
- The **Assam Cabinet** has approved the repeal of the **Assam Muslim Marriages and Divorce Registration Act of 1935** through the **Assam Repealing Bill, 2024**.
- In a significant step towards eradicating tuberculosis (TB), **Telangana** launched the **"Project Swasthya Nagaram,"** a unique model for **TB-free municipalities**, on July 24, 2024, in **Hyderabad**.
- On July 24, 2024, the Bihar Assembly passed the **Anti-Paper Leak Bill** to combat malpractices in government recruitment exams.
- **Mumbai**, India's bustling financial capital, is set to witness a significant transformation in its urban transit system with the inauguration of its first underground metro, the **Aqua Line**.
- Municipal Corporations of Gurugram and Faridabad are all set to establish **two waste-to-charcoal plants**, also known as **green coal plants**, in the two districts at a cost of **₹500 crore each**.
- The **Atomic Minerals Directorate for Exploration and Research (AMD)**, a unit of the **Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)**, has identified lithium resources in the **Mandya and Yadgiri districts of Karnataka**.

- On July 25, 2024, **Union Minister of Coal and Mines, Shri G. Kishan Reddy**, launched the **Vriksharopan Abhiyan 2024** at Bharat Coking Coal Limited (BCCL) in Dhanbad.
- In a significant milestone for India's community radio landscape, **Union Minister of Information and Broadcasting Ashwini Vaishnaw** inaugurated the **country's 500th community radio station**, Apna Radio 90.0 FM, at the Indian Institute of Mass Communication (IIMC) in Aizawl, Mizoram.
- On July 27, 1939, the **Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)** was established as the Crown Representatives Police in response to political turmoil within princely states.
- The **Department of Posts** has released a commemorative postage stamp at Dras, Kargil in Ladakh, marking the Silver Jubilee of Kargil Vijay Diwas.
- The **Ahom dynasty's Moidams in Assam** have been officially inscribed on the **UNESCO World Heritage List** as **India's 43rd entry**.
- Chief Minister **A. Revanth Reddy** attended a public meeting in **Kalwakurthy** to mark the **death anniversary** of former Union Minister S. Jaipal Reddy.
- The **Uttar Pradesh Assembly** on July 30, passed the **UP Prohibition of Unlawful Conversion of Religion (Amendment) Bill, 2024** that enhances punishment for forced conversions.
- The state cabinet on August 6, approved the **426.52-km Wainganga-Nalganga river linking project**, with an estimated cost of **₹88,575 crore**.
- The **Maharashtra government** has approved the **Logistics Policy 2024**, aimed at revolutionizing the state's logistics infrastructure and generating approximately **500,000 job opportunities**.
- IIT Indore** has created advanced shoes incorporating **Tribo-Electric Nanogenerator (TENG) technology**, which generates electricity from human motion and integrates **GPS for real-time location tracking**.
- Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann** inaugurated the '**Punjab Help Centre**' at Terminal 3 of **Indira Gandhi International Airport, New Delhi**.
- The **Bihar government** on August 8, mandated **registration of temples, mutts and trusts**, and directed **all District Magistrates** in the State to ensure that the bodies are registered and details of their immovable assets are submitted to the **Bihar State Board of Religious Trusts (BSBRT)** soon.
- The Maharashtra government has recently declared the **geoglyphs and petroglyphs in Ratnagiri** as protected monuments under the **Maharashtra Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1960**.
- The Rajasthan government has received investment proposals amounting to over **Rs 5.21 lakh crore (approximately USD 62 billion)** in the lead-up to the '**Rising Rajasthan**' Investment Summit 2024.
- Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu** inaugurated 16 industrial projects in Sri City and signed deals worth **Rs 3,683 crore**.
- The **Green Strategic Partnership between India and Denmark** has led to the creation of the **Smart Laboratory on Clean Rivers (SLCR)** in Varanasi.
- The **Kakrapar Atomic Power Station (KAPS)** in Gujarat, India, has reached full operational capacity with its **second 700 MW nuclear reactor, KAPS-4**, which started operating at full power on August 21, 2024.
- Kaanu**, a **South Indian Adivasi Knowledge Centre**, will be launched at the **Tribal Health Resource Centre (THRC)** at **BR Hills, Karnataka** on August 25.
- The **Maharashtra Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Eknath Shinde**, has approved the implementation of a **revised National Pension Scheme (NPS)** for state government employees on the lines of the **Centre's Unified Pension Scheme (UPS)**.
- the state of **Assam** has officially recorded the presence of **mithun (Bos frontalis)** for the first time. This discovery comes generations after the semi-wild, gaur-like animal began to be reared by tribal communities in the state's hill district of **Dima Hasao**.
- In a significant move ahead of the **October 2024 Legislative Assembly election**, Maharashtra has become the first state to adopt the **Unified Pension Scheme (UPS)** for its employees, just hours after the central government introduced the scheme.

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- At least **42 people have died** and 5,938 houses were destroyed due to disasters in **Mizoram** between March and May.
- The **Tata Group** has inaugurated a **₹27,000 crore semiconductor assembly** and test facility in Assam, aiming to produce **15 billion chips annually**.
- In a significant judgment, the **Madras High Court** has declared **Section 77-A** of the Registration Act, 1908 **unconstitutional**.
- Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini** made a historic announcement that could reshape agricultural policy in India.
- 10-day pilgrimage to Shri Baba Buddha Amarnath in the Loran Valley** of Poonch district began today and will conclude on the 19th of this month, coinciding with **Sawan Purnima and Raksha Bandhan**.
- The **Andhra Pradesh government** has decided to scrap the **two-child norm** for contesting local body elections in view of the declining fertility rate in the state.
- Odisha has introduced India's first round-the-clock grain dispensing machine, known as the **Annapurthi Grain ATM**, designed to transform the **Public Distribution System (PDS)** for ration cardholders.
- Chhattisgarh** on August 7, cleared a **long-pending proposal** to notify a **new tiger reserve – the third largest in the country**.

- In a significant move to boost religious tourism and cultural heritage, the Chief Ministers of Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh have announced plans to develop a new religious circuit called the **'Shri Krishna Gaman Path'**. This initiative aims to connect the birthplace of Lord Krishna in Mathura with the sacred city of Ujjain in Madhya Pradesh, tracing the footsteps of one of Hinduism's most revered deities.
- The **Himachal Pradesh government** has allocated **Rs 53.21 crore** annually to fund the **'Mukhya Mantri Sukh Shiksha Yojana,'** aimed at supporting the education and well-being of children from vulnerable families.
- The **Uttar Pradesh government** has introduced the **Digital Media Policy, 2024**, which **incentivizes social media influencers** to promote state initiatives, schemes, and achievements through various online platforms.
- the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) launched its first indigenously developed **Pollution Control Vessel, 'Samudra Pratap,'** in Goa. **Raksha Rajya Mantri Shri Sanjay Seth**, who presided over the event, emphasized the need for industry partners to contribute towards India becoming fully self-sufficient (Aatmanirbhar) in defense production and a net exporter.
- On the occasion of **National Sports Day**, Bihar took a significant leap forward in its commitment to sports development. **Chief Minister Nitish Kumar** inaugurated a trio of state-of-the-art facilities in **Rajgir**, marking a new chapter in the state's sporting history.
- **Cyclone Asna** has formed over the **Kutch coast in Gujarat** and adjoining areas of **Pakistan**, the India **Meteorological Department (IMD)** said on August 30. The **cyclonic storm** – a rare land-originating one in August and headed to the **Arabian Sea** – is expected to move further away from the western coast in the next 48 hours.
- The West Bengal Assembly has unanimously passed the **'Aparajita Woman and Child Bill (West Bengal Criminal Laws and Amendment) 2024'**, marking a significant development in the state's legal framework against sexual crimes. This bill introduces the death penalty for individuals convicted of rape if their actions result in the victim's death or leave her in a vegetative state. With this move, West Bengal becomes the first state to amend central laws dealing with rape, gang-rape, and sexual crimes against children.
- The **Madhya Pradesh** government, under the leadership of **Chief Minister Mohan Yadav**, has approved a groundbreaking scheme named **'Brindavan Gram'**. This initiative, formally announced on **Janmashtami** (August 26), aims to transform selected gram panchayats into model villages, focusing on cow protection and rural development.
- The Uttar Pradesh government has announced the **construction of a Vedic-3D museum at Sampurnanand Sanskrit University in Varanasi**, Prime Minister Narendra Modi's parliamentary constituency. This state-of-the-art museum will focus on Indian astrology, astronomy, and Vedic literature. Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath made the announcement during his visit to the university, highlighting its role in showcasing the evolution of Vedic literature, including the **16 Sanskars, 64 arts, and 18 Vidya Sthans**, as well as the contributions of Indian sages.
- The Rajasthan State Cabinet, led by **Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma**, has approved a significant policy shift by **mandating a 33% reservation for women in the police force**. This decision, made on September 4, 2024, aligns with the BJP's 2023 Assembly election manifesto promise to enhance female representation within law enforcement. The amendment to the Rajasthan Police Subordinate Service Rules, 1989, will soon be formalized through a notification by the Personnel department.
- The government of Telangana has taken a significant step towards establishing itself as a global AI hub by signing a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **World Trade Centres' Association** for the creation of a **World Trade Centre (WTC)** within the proposed **AI City** near Hyderabad. This strategic move underscores Telangana's commitment to fostering innovation, attracting global investments, and positioning itself at the forefront of artificial intelligence and emerging technologies.
- Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister **Yogi Adityanath** inaugurated the **Jatayu Conservation and Breeding Centre** in **Bharivaisi, Campierganj Range** of the Gorakhpur Forest Division. This groundbreaking facility marks a significant milestone in wildlife conservation as the **world's first** dedicated conservation and breeding center for the **Asian King Vulture**, also known as the red-headed vulture.

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- The **University of Manipur**, in collaboration with the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC), successfully hosted a two-day **'Training Programme on Human Rights in India'** on **30th August 2024 at the Court Hall, Manipur University**. The event saw participation from over 100 legal experts, academicians, human rights defenders, and students.
- The **Uttar Pradesh government** is set to make a significant investment of approximately **Rs 33,500 crore (around \$4 billion)** to spur growth in the **Information Technology (IT) and IT-enabled Services (ITeS)** sectors over the next five years. The plan aims for a tenfold increase in these sectors by developing technology hubs across **five major cities**: Noida, Lucknow, Kanpur, Varanasi, and Prayagraj (Allahabad).

- Shri Piyush Goyal, as he inaugurated the **Akurli bridge on the Western Express Highway in Mumbai** on 10th September, and he stated that this will not just benefit North Mumbai but will benefit the entire city. He is also Member of Parliament from Mumbai North.
- Recent horrific incident in West Bengal hospital which shook the nation, aftermath of this case West Bengal cabinet proposes to set up a **POCSO (Protection of children from sexual offenses) Fast track special court** to fast track the cases related to these cases.
- The Union Cabinet has approved the **Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana – IV (PMGSY-IV)** for the financial years **2024-25 to 2028-29**, with a total outlay of **₹70,125 crore**. This initiative aims to construct 62,500 kilometers of roads to connect 25,000 previously unconnected habitations, enhancing accessibility and promoting socio-economic development in remote rural areas.
- **The governor of Maharashtra Shri. C. P. Radhakrishnan** has announced in the event that Maharashtra state will establish the tribal university for the development of tribal students and for their better future. This university will be established in the **Nashik district of Maharashtra**.
- **Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath** and **Tripura Chief Minister Dr. Manik Saha** jointly inaugurated the newly built **Sidheshwari Temple at Barkathal in Tripura** on September 16, 2024. Yogi Adityanath also laid the foundation stone for the Ved Vidyalaya at Chitta Dham, Barakathal, Mohanpur, West Tripura.
- In a significant development for the state of Uttarakhand, **Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami** expressed his profound gratitude to the Governor for approving the **Uttarakhand Public (Government) and Private Property Damage Recovery (Ordinance) Act 2024**. This groundbreaking legislation represents a crucial step towards addressing the financial implications of civil unrest and riots in the state.
- **Kerala has once again secured first position** in the **State Food Safety Index (SFSI) 2024**, marking the second consecutive year that the southern state has claimed the spot. The report was released in the inaugural session of FSSAI Global Food Regulators Summit 2024.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** laid the foundation stone for the **PM Mega Integrated Textile Regions and Apparel Park (PM MITRA)** in Maharashtra's Amravati.
- **Tripura Chief Minister Manik Saha** launched the '**Mukhyamantri Nagar Unnayan Prakalp**,' a **Rs 530 crore water supply project** funded by the **Asian Development Bank (ADB)**, aiming to upgrade drinking water infrastructure in 12 cities. The project, expected to be completed in three years, will address water needs for over 75,000 families across the state.
- **Maharashtra government** approved a proposal to name **Pune airport as Jagadguru Sant Tukaram Maharaj Pune International Airport**.
- **Mizoram Chief Minister Lalduhoma** officially launched the state's **new flagship initiative, the Hand Holding Scheme (Bana Kaih)**, during a ceremony held at Vanapa Hall.
- **The Kolkata trams**, which have operated **since the late 19th century**, are a testament to the city's rich transportation history. The Kolkata tram is set to be **discontinued soon due to congestion**. However, **one route will still be operational**.
- Recently, the **Mankidia community became the 6th particularly vulnerable tribal group (PVTG)** PVTG to **get habitat rights over forests in Odisha**. The Mankidia are a **semi-nomadic community known for their traditional skill of rope making, trapping and eating monkeys**.
- Telangana state government launched the '**Telangana Darshini**' Program to those government school students to explore historical and tourist sites at no cost. It is also designed **to enrich the educational experiences** of government school students.
- The Maharashtra government granted the status of **Rajyamata-Gomata** to desi cows in the state. This is the first time that such a title has been bestowed on any creature. In a government resolution (GR) passed by the dairy development department, the state specified that the status of Rajyamata will be extended only to desi cows.

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- To address the **immediate skill gaps in Andhra Pradesh**, Shri Jayant Chaudhary, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, and Minister of State for the Ministry of Education, Government of India, **inaugurated a new National Skill Training Institute (NSTI) extension center at the Andhra Medical Tech Zone (AMTZ) campus in Visakhapatnam**.
- **Kaziranga National Park**, renowned for its iconic **one-horned rhinoceros**, has now gained recognition as India's second-largest butterfly diversity hub. Following Namdapha National Park in Arunachal Pradesh, Kaziranga is home to an impressive 446 butterfly species. This newfound distinction highlights the park's rich biodiversity.
- In a significant move to fight against child marriage in Assam, **Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma** of Assam has initiated the disbursement of monthly financial assistance under the **Nijut Moina scheme**. This step marks a decisive phase in the government's ongoing battle against this social issue, aiming to provide crucial support to families and empower young girls to pursue their education and well-being.

- **The Assam government** has launched an ambitious project aimed at revitalizing 129 beels (wetlands), covering an area of 3,800 hectares, to mitigate flooding and boost fish production in the state. These wetlands **serve as essential water and fishery resources**, offering vital hydrological regulation services, including flood mitigation, groundwater recharge, river flow regulation, and erosion control.
- **The Asian Development Bank (ADB)** has sanctioned a **USD 434.25 million loan to support Assam's renewable energy ambitions** by constructing a **500 MW grid-connected solar photovoltaic (PV) facility** in the Karbi Anglong district.
- The central government has given its in-principle approval for Bihar's second tiger reserve in Kaimur district. This decision follows a proposal from the Bihar government to develop the **Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary (KWLS) into a tiger reserve**.
- Bihar Chief Minister **Nitish Kumar** inaugurated and laid the foundation stones for a range of development projects totaling Rs 7,160 crore. Among these initiatives are 2,615 panchayat government buildings spread across various blocks in the state and a new panchayat resource center in Sonapur, Saran district.
- To enhance citizen safety, **Ahmedabad Police** is establishing a **state-of-the-art Command and Control Centre** equipped with advanced technologies, marking a significant upgrade in public security measures. This initiative reflects a growing trend in urban policing that integrates modern technology for improved operational efficiency and crime control.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** laid the foundation stone and **inaugurated projects worth over ₹284 crore** in the Narmada district, which is home to the iconic Statue of Unity.
- **Nayab Singh Saini** was sworn in as **Haryana's Chief Minister** for the second time, marking BJP's third consecutive term in power in the state. **Governor Bandaru Dattatreya** administered the oath at a ceremony attended by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Ministers, and NDA leaders. Saini's council of 13 ministers also took the oath. Saini, a Dalit leader from Kurukshetra, led the BJP to victory in the October 5 Assembly elections, **securing 48 seats in the 90-member house**.
- In a significant move, **Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini** has fulfilled his first poll promise by announcing that all government hospitals in the state will **provide free dialysis to chronic kidney patients**. This decision was made during his inaugural cabinet meeting after the BJP's return to power for a third consecutive term, where Saini emphasized the people's mandate against Congress' narrative during the elections.
- **Haryana has become the first state to implement sub-quotas** for the Dalit community by **subclassifying the Scheduled Castes (SCs)**. The decision follows the Supreme Court's August 2023 ruling, granting states the power to divide SCs and STs for preferential reservations. Haryana's move, backed by a state commission's recommendations, is aimed at addressing the underrepresentation of the **"Deprived Scheduled Castes" (DSC)**, who are more marginalized in employment sectors compared to **"Other Scheduled Castes" (OSC)**. The state has divided the SC community into two groups: DSC, which includes 36 castes like Balmikis and Dhanaks, and OSC, which includes castes such as Chamars and Jatavs.
- **A Grand Cultural Event** The **International Gita Mahotsav** will be celebrated from **November 28 to December 15, 2024**, in **Kurukshetra, Haryana**, promising a grand display of Indian heritage, spirituality, and culture. Since 2016, this event has expanded globally, spreading the message of the **Bhagavad Gita** and enhancing Haryana's global presence.
- Chief Minister **Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu** has unveiled a transformative state government initiative named 'Sankalp', marking a significant step in Himachal Pradesh's fight against drug trafficking and addiction. The initiative was officially announced on October 6, 2024, at an event organized by Divya Jyoti Jagriti Sansthan in the state capital, **Shimla**.
- Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu announced on 30th October that the **Durgesh Aranya Zoological Park**, located in the Bankhandi area of Kangra's Dehra assembly constituency, will be the first zoo in India to receive certification from the **Indian Green Building Council (IGBC)**.
- At the second edition of the **Indian Gaming Convention (IGC)**, Shri Priyank Kharge, Karnataka's Minister of Information Technology and Biotechnology, expressed the state's ambition to lead the gaming and animation industry. Kharge stated, "Karnataka has all that is **needed to ensure that we become the gaming and animation capital of not only this country but also of Asia.**" "India—the Next Superpower in Gaming" emphasizes India's growth trajectory to becoming a global leader in gaming.
- On the occasion of **Valmiki Jayanti**, Karnataka Chief Minister **Siddaramaiah** announced that all Scheduled Tribe (ST) residential schools in the state and Raichur University will be named **after Maharishi Valmiki**.
- After devastating floods and landslides claimed over 200 lives in Kerala's Wayanad district in July 2024, the **Union Ministry of Earth Sciences** took a crucial step to bolster disaster preparedness by approving the installation of an **X-band radar** in the region. The torrential rains, which triggered a massive landslide in the valley above Punchirimattom near the Mundakkai area, led to catastrophic debris flows, intensifying the destruction.

- **The Kerala Assembly unanimously passed a resolution** urging the BJP-led central government to **withdraw the Waqf (Amendment) Bill 2024**, which was introduced in the Lok Sabha in August and subsequently referred to a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC). The state's lawmakers expressed concerns over the bill, asserting that it could undermine the autonomy of Waqf boards and the management of Waqf properties.
- In a significant move to enhance traffic law enforcement, Kerala's Motor Vehicle Department (MVD) **has launched the Citizen Sentinel mobile application**, empowering citizens to actively participate in ensuring road safety.
- The Maharashtra government granted the status of **Rajyamata-Gomata** to desi cows in the state. This is the first time that such a title has been bestowed on any creature. In a government resolution (GR) passed by the dairy development department, the state specified that the status of Rajyamata will be extended only to desi cows.
- Maharashtra Government Renames Skills University After Ratan Tata. In a significant tribute to the late industrialist Ratan Tata, the Maharashtra government announced on October 14, 2024, that the Maharashtra State Skills Development University will be renamed the **"Padma Vibhushan Ratan Tata Skills University."** This decision honors Tata's substantial contributions to education, skill development, and social causes across India.
- The **"Mera Hou Chongba"** festival was celebrated in Manipur amidst ongoing ethnic tensions **between the Meitei and Kuki-Zo communities**. This annual festival serves as a significant cultural event aimed at reinforcing the bonds of brotherhood and harmony among the indigenous communities of the state, highlighting the rich cultural tapestry of Manipur. The festival took place on the **15th Lunar day of Mera Month**, at **Sana Konung and Kangla Uttra in Imphal, the state capital**.
- In a pioneering move aimed at **enhancing the safety of women** in healthcare settings, **Madhya Pradesh** has installed **'pink alarms'** at the government-run district hospital and medical college in **Datia**. This initiative addresses growing concerns about the safety of female staff in public hospitals, a pressing issue that gained heightened attention following the tragic rape and murder of a trainee doctor at RG Kar Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata.
- **The Department of Tourism in Nagaland** is set to celebrate the **25th Hornbill Festival**, marking its **silver jubilee from December 1 to 10** at the Heritage Village, Kisama. Dr. G. Hukugha Sema, Commissioner and Secretary for Tourism, expressed excitement, stating it's going to be a remarkable festival.
- Odisha government has announced an increase in the **casual leave (CL)** entitlement for women employees, granting an additional **12 days annually**, effective immediately. This brings their total CL to 27 days, compared to 15 days for male employees.
- **Aandhi, a small village** located about 43 km from Jaipur in Rajasthan, is making strides towards becoming a zero-waste model through the implementation of green technology interventions. This initiative aims to transform various types of waste such as food waste, agricultural waste, wastewater, and hospital waste generated from local sources, including schools, farms, and community health centers, into valuable resources.
- Telangana state government launched the **'Telangana Darshini'** Program to those government school students to explore historical and tourist sites at no cost. It is also designed **to enrich the educational experiences** of government school students.
- In a groundbreaking initiative to further strengthen the ecosystem for women entrepreneurs in Telangana, NITI Aayog, in collaboration with **Telangana government**, launched the **first State chapter of Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP)**, with WE Hub serving as the nodal organization. To promote and support women entrepreneurs across various sectors, providing them with resources, tools, and a robust network to enhance their business growth.
- **Telangana becomes the third state** to initiate a caste-based headcount, **following Andhra Pradesh and Bihar**. The Telangana government has initiated the process of a comprehensive household caste survey in the state aimed at targeted and equitable resource distribution among all communities. The caste survey aims **to promote targeted and equitable resource distribution among all communities, ensuring justice for weaker sections like OBCs, SCs, STs, and other marginalized groups**.
- In a significant move to strengthen bilateral ties, the **Indo-Turkiye Friendship Association (ITFA)** was inaugurated in Hyderabad on October 16, 2024. The initiative seeks to enhance cooperation in key areas such as economy and trade, culture and tourism, science and technology, and education between India and Turkiye.
- Chennai is set to witness a significant advancement in its public transportation system with the upcoming trial run of the first three-coach **driverless train** for the **Phase II project** of the Chennai Metro Rail. This ambitious initiative, part of a larger Rs **63,246 crore** investment in urban infrastructure, marks a pivotal step in modernizing the city's metro services and improving overall connectivity. The inaugural trial run is expected to take place on **October 26**, with high-profile dignitaries such as **Chief Minister M.K. Stalin** and **Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal Khattar** invited to flag off the event.
- **India's first 'Writer's Village'** was inaugurated in **Dehradun** by former President Ram Nath Kovind, along with Uttarakhand Governor Lt Gen Gurmeet Singh (retd) and Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami. This unique village aims to foster creativity and provide a nurturing environment for writers from across the country, establishing Dehradun as a new cultural hub for literary talent.

- **Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath** unveiled the new **multi-colored logo for Mahakumbh 2025** at an event. Kumbh Mela, recognised by the UNESCO as an 'Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity,' is regarded as the world's largest peaceful gathering of pilgrims
- Enterprising rural women in **Uttar Pradesh, working as BC Sakhis**, have facilitated **Rs 27,000 crore** in financial transactions over the past four and a half years. BC Sakhis, appointed under a nationwide women empowerment initiative, are part of **self-help groups (SHGs)** providing banking services in rural, unbanked areas. Uttar Pradesh leads the nation in the number of BC Sakhis, followed by Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan. These women have earned Rs 75 crore in commission, making significant contributions to financial inclusion.
- During the grand '**Deepotsav 2024**' celebrations, Ayodhya made history by setting two **Guinness World Records** on 30th October evening. In a dazzling spectacle, the Uttar Pradesh Tourism Department, alongside the district administration, illuminated the banks of the Saryu River with over 25 lakh diyas (earthen lamps), creating the world's largest display of oil lamps.

States Current Affairs of November 2024

- **Karnataka** is celebrating the **Bali Padyami festival** on the fourth day of Deepavali, marking the return of the Asura king, Bali Chakravarty, from Pathala Loka (the underworld) to Bhuloka (the earth), as granted by Lord Vishnu during his Vamana Avatar. The festival holds cultural significance in Hindu mythology. Deepavali festivities in Karnataka include worship of Ganga Matha on the first day, Naraka Chaturdashi on the second day, and Lakshmi Pooja on the third day.
- The **Uttar Pradesh government has introduced a new policy to improve veterinary services** by offering diploma and certificate courses in animal husbandry and para-veterinary medicine. This move, announced by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, aims to address the shortage of veterinarians in the state, which has only 8,193 veterinarians compared to the national total of around 34,500.
- Madhya Pradesh cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, **approved a 35 percent reservation for women in all state government recruitments**. The decision was made during a cabinet meeting held at the Mantralaya in Bhopal.
- The **Supreme Court's** new guidelines to **eliminate child marriages in Rajasthan by 2030** have empowered civil society organizations. These guidelines emphasize accountability for local panchayats, school authorities, and child protection officers, aiming to tackle the widespread issue of child marriages in the state.

- **Ningol Chakkouba**, a major festival of the Meitei community in Manipur, was celebrated with great religious fervor and joy. Observed on the second day of the lunar month Hiyangei in the Meitei calendar, the festival celebrates family bonds and togetherness.
- The **Uttar Pradesh Cabinet has approved a significant semiconductor manufacturing project** led by Vama Sundri Investment, a subsidiary of HCL Tech, in partnership with Foxconn. Set to be established along the Yamuna Expressway with an investment of ₹3,706 crore, the facility aims to enhance India's semiconductor production.
- **Telangana has launched a statewide caste census** conducted by the State Planning Department to gather comprehensive socio-economic, political, and educational data, including caste details for all households. The door-to-door survey collects information on income, employment, health hazards, and welfare benefits, while verifying caste certificates for SC, ST, BC, and EWS categories. Enumerators are assigned 150 households each to ensure thorough data collection.
- In response to cheetahs from Madhya Pradesh straying into neighboring Rajasthan, a joint corridor management committee has been formed between the two states. The committee will focus on cheetah conservation, developing suitable habitats, and facilitating the relocation of cheetahs from **Madhya Pradesh's Kuno National Park (KNP) and Gandhi Sagar Sanctuary**.
- The Indian government has signed a **\$200 million loan agreement with the Asian Development Bank (ADB) to enhance urban infrastructure and improve essential services in Uttarakhand**. The initiative aims to modernize water supply systems, sanitation, urban mobility, and other key public amenities, thereby fostering sustainable development in the state.
- **Sultanganj railway station** in Bihar's **Bhagalpur district** is set to be renamed in honor of the revered **Hindu shrine, Ajgaibinath Dham**.
- Uttarakhand, a state rich in culture and tradition, observes a unique festival known as **Igas Bagwal**. This festival, also called **Budhi Diwali** or **Harbodhni Ekadashi**, is celebrated in the mountainous regions with reverence and joy, precisely **11 days after Diwali**.
- **Uttar Pradesh** Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath launched the **state's first double-decker electric bus** at the Aakanksha Haat programme in Indira Gandhi Pratishthan. This initiative aims to modernize public transport, ease urban traffic congestion, and promote eco-friendly travel, contributing to environmental conservation.
- **Delhi Metro** launched a new **bike taxi service** on November 11, 2024, available through the official Delhi Metro app, DMRC Momentum (Delhi Sarthi 2.0). In partnership with First And Last Mile Connectivity India Pvt. Ltd., the service offers a dedicated bike taxi option for women, improving commuter convenience and safety.

- **Mahesh Kumar Khichi**, the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) candidate, emerged victorious in the Delhi mayoral polls.
- For the first time, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has introduced a localized weather forecasting system for the **Sabarimala pilgrimage**.
- **Uttarakhand CM Pushkar Singh Dhami** inaugurated the **Jauljibi Mela 2024** in **Pithoragarh**, calling it an "invaluable heritage" that fosters harmony among India, Tibet, Nepal, and neighboring regions. He also launched 18 development projects worth ₹64.47 crores, focusing on rural and agricultural sectors.
- Odisha achieved a significant milestone with **24 coastal villages** from six districts being officially recognized as 'Tsunami Ready' by the **Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC)** of **UNESCO** during the **2nd Global Tsunami Symposium** in Indonesia on November 11, 2024. The recognition highlights the state's efforts in **disaster preparedness** and **community resilience** in tsunami-prone areas.
- Australia's **University of Wollongong (UOW)** has officially inaugurated its India campus at **Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City)** in **Gandhinagar**. The campus will offer Master's degrees in **Financial Technology** and a **Graduate Certificate** in the field, marking a strategic entry into India's expanding **fintech sector**. This development follows **Deakin University's** campus opening in GIFT City in **July 2024**, further enhancing the educational landscape in India.
- Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, **Shri Bhupender Yadav**, announced the notification of the **Guru Ghasidas-Tamor Pingla Tiger Reserve** in **Chhattisgarh** as the **56th Tiger Reserve** in India. Spanning **2,829.38 sq. km**, it is the third-largest tiger reserve in India, following **Nagarjunasagar-Srisailem** in Andhra Pradesh and **Manas Tiger Reserve** in Assam.
- Karnataka **Chief Minister Siddaramaiah** announced the creation of three **Global Innovation Districts (GIDs)** in **Bengaluru, Mysuru, and Belagavi** to attract **Global Capability Centres (GCCs)**. The announcement was made at the **27th Bengaluru Tech Summit**, where the CM also unveiled **India's first dedicated GCC policy** to boost innovation. These districts will play a crucial role in fostering **research, development, and emerging industries**, reinforcing Karnataka's position as a global tech hub.
- **Japan** has been announced as the official partner country for the **25th Hornbill Festival** in **Nagaland**, joining **Wales** as a confirmed partner. This partnership was solidified through meetings between **Nagaland's Chief Minister Neiphiu Rio** and **Japanese Embassy** representatives, including **Takashi Ariyoshi** and **Mayumi Tsubakimoto**. The festival, scheduled from **December 1-10** at **Kisama near Kohima**, will feature Japan's contributions in **cultural performances, capacity building, and workshops on handicrafts and bamboo products**, led by renowned **Japanese artists**. The **Hornbill Festival** is Nagaland's premier cultural event, celebrating the state's **heritage, traditions, and diverse ethnic communities**.
- The **Telangana government** launched its **Electric Vehicles (EV) Policy** on **November 17, 2024**, to promote **sustainability, energy efficiency, and reduce air pollution**. Key features include **100% road tax and registration fee exemptions** for all EVs until **December 31, 2026**. This applies to **two-wheelers, four-wheelers, taxis, auto-rickshaws, and electric buses**. Savings can reach up to **₹15,000** for two-wheelers and **₹3 lakh** for four-wheelers. The policy also removes limits on eligible EVs for tax exemptions.
- On November 20, 2024, the **Central Government** appointed **Justice D. Krishnakumar** from the **Madras High Court** as the new **Chief Justice of Manipur High Court**. This follows the retirement of **Justice Siddharth Mridul**. The appointment was made based on recommendations by the **Supreme Court Collegium**, recognizing Justice Krishnakumar's **legal acumen and integrity**.
- At **The Hindu AI Summit 2024**, **Kumar Jayant**, Additional Chief Secretary of Tamil Nadu's **Department of Information Technology and Digital Services**, announced the state's initiative to establish a **Centre of Excellence (CoE)** with an **AI lab**. The initiative aims to foster **research, development, and support startups and academic institutions**. Tamil Nadu is also integrating **AI into governance**, enhancing services in **healthcare, agriculture, and public sector monitoring**, demonstrating its commitment to leveraging AI for **societal benefit and innovation**.
- On **November 21, 2024**, the **Assam government** renamed **Karimganj district** to **Sribhumi** and its headquarters to **Sribhumi town**, honoring the region's **cultural heritage** and fulfilling a **longstanding local demand**.
- The **Andhra Pradesh Legislative Assembly** approved a bill on **November 21, 2024**, to **abolish the garbage tax** introduced by the previous **YSRCP government**. Championed by **Municipal Administration Minister P. Narayana**, the move aims to ease **financial pressure on citizens** and investigate potential **contractor benefits** tied to the tax.
- **Hemant Soren** is set to take oath as the **Chief Minister of Jharkhand** on **November 28**, after meeting **Governor Santosh Kumar Gangawar** to stake his claim to form the government. This follows the victory of the **INDIA bloc**, comprising **Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM), Congress, Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD), and CPI (ML)**, in the recent state elections.

- **Gyan-Kumbh 2024**, organized by **Siksha Sanskriti Utthan Nyas**, was held at **Pondicherry University** from **November 21st to 23rd, 2024**. The event focused on **transformative educational philosophies, sustainability, and human unity**, with the **Auroville Foundation** showcasing its vision of **human unity and sustainable living**. Auroville's stall attracted educational leaders, and representatives **Dr. Mollika Ganguly** and **Ms. Vishnupriya** engaged visitors with insights into Auroville's innovative educational approach.
- For the first time, **Jammu and Kashmir (J&K)** observed **Constitution Day (Samvidhan Diwas)** on **November 26, 2024**, marking the **75th anniversary** of India's Constitution. The event highlighted core values of **justice, equality, and fraternity**, with **Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha** leading the celebrations, emphasizing the region's **integration** into the national framework.
- The **Supreme Court** upheld the **Uttar Pradesh government's decision to acquire land** urgently for the development of the **Yamuna Expressway**. The Court justified the use of **urgency provisions** under **Sections 17(1) and 17(4)** of the **Land Acquisition Act, 1894**, allowing the **Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA)** to proceed without waiting for **objections** from landowners.
- **Amara Raja Infra**, part of the **Amara Raja Group**, has launched **India's first green hydrogen fuelling station** in **Leh, Ladakh** for **NTPC Ltd.** The station, producing **80 kg of green hydrogen daily**, supports **NTPC's green mobility initiatives** under the **National Hydrogen Energy Mission**. Inaugurated by **Union Power Minister Manohar Lal**, it will fuel **hydrogen fuel cell buses** and contribute to the development of **hydrogen infrastructure** in India, marking a key step towards **emission-free transport**.
- The **International Gita Mahotsav** celebrates the birth of the **Bhagavad Gita**, marking Lord Krishna's divine discourse to Arjuna on the battlefield of **Kurukshetra** over 5152 years ago. In 2024, the event will run from **November 28 to December 15** and take place in **Kurukshetra, Haryana**, aligning with the **Shukla Paksha Ekadashi** of the **Margashirsha month** in the Hindu lunar calendar.
- The **Gujarat government** launched the **Cottage and Rural Industries Policy 2024-29** to strengthen the cottage industry, preserve handicrafts, and boost its market presence. The policy focuses on **increased credit support, infrastructure development**, and promoting local products through initiatives like **One District One Product (ODOP)** and **GI tagging** for intellectual property protection. The policy was announced by **Ministers Balvantsinh Rajput and Jagdish Panchal** in **Gandhinagar**.
- **Chief Minister Neiphiu Rio** inaugurated new facilities at **Naga Heritage Village, Kisama**, ahead of the **25th Hornbill Festival**. The enhancements include the **International Morung** for cultural exchange, a **Lodge/Dormitory** for cultural troupes, a **Handloom & Craft Pavilion** showcasing Naga crafts, a **medical booth** with cash vending facilities, a **Tourism Department Lounge** for VIPs, and a **Toyota Ki Display Area**. The event also marked the inclusion of the **USA** as a new partner country.
- A **deep depression** over the **Southwest Bay of Bengal** is expected to intensify into **Cyclone Fengal** and make landfall between **Karaikal** and **Mahabalipuram** on **November 30**, bringing **heavy rainfall** and **strong winds** to **Tamil Nadu** and **Puducherry**.
- The **Odisha government** has approved **20 major investment projects** worth **Rs 1.36 lakh crore** across nine sectors, including **steel, chemicals, aluminium, green energy, aviation fuel, apparel, power, and cement**. These projects, approved by the **High-Level Clearance Authority (HLCA)** led by **Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi**, will create over **74,350 jobs** and boost the state's **industrial and infrastructural development**. The initiative strengthens Odisha's position as a key hub for **industrial growth**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** will inaugurate the **Rising Rajasthan Global Summit** at the **Jaipur Exhibition and Convention Center (JECC)** on **December 9, 2024**. The three-day event (December 9-11) aims to **boost industrial growth** and attract investments to **Rajasthan**. **Chief Minister Bhajanlal Sharma** highlighted the summit's role in accelerating the state's **economic trajectory** under Modi's leadership.
- The **12th Edition of the International Tourism Mart (ITM)** began on **November 27, 2024**, in **Kaziranga, Assam**, highlighting the tourism potential of **Northeast India**. Inaugurated by **Union Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat**, with **Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sharma** and **Arunachal Pradesh CM Pema Khandu** in attendance, the event aims to promote the region's **cultural, natural, and biodiversity-rich** tourism, fostering collaboration among **tourism professionals, buyers, sellers, and government agencies**.
- Gujarat's '**Gharchola**' handicraft has been awarded the **Geographical Indication (GI) tag**, bringing the state's total to **27 GI tags**, with **23 for handicrafts**. Traditionally worn in **Hindu and Jain weddings**, Gharchola is recognized for its rich cultural significance and vibrant colors. The craft has evolved with modern designs while maintaining its traditional appeal, and its popularity is growing, with increased availability at **Garvi Gurjari** sales centers in Gujarat.
- During **Deepotsav 2024** on **October 30**, **Ayodhya** set two **Guinness World Records** by lighting over **25 lakh diyas** (oil lamps) on the banks of the **Saryu River**, creating the world's largest display of oil lamps. The five-day festival celebrates **Lord Ram's return** after his 14-year exile and holds special significance as the first since the '**Pran Pratishtha**' ceremony of **Ram Lala** at the **Ayodhya temple**.

- On **October 30**, **Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu** announced that the **Durgesh Aranya Zoological Park** in **Kangra** will be the first zoo in India to receive certification from the **Indian Green Building Council (IGBC)**. This certification recognizes the zoo's commitment to **sustainable and eco-friendly infrastructure**, setting a new standard for **conservation** in India.
- On **October 30, 2024**, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** began a two-day visit to **Gujarat**, starting in **Ekta Nagar**. He laid the foundation stone and inaugurated projects worth over **₹284 crore** in **Narmada district**, home to the **Statue of Unity**. Key projects included a **Bonsai Garden**, a **Sewage Treatment Plant**, the **Sardar Sarovar Dam Experience Center**, and a **50-bed sub-district hospital** with advanced facilities like a **trauma center**, **CT scan**, and **ICU-on-wheels** service.

States Current Affairs of December 2024

- The **Uttar Pradesh government** has declared the **Maha Kumbh area** in **Prayagraj** as the new **Maha Kumbh Mela district** ahead of the **January 2025 Kumbh Mela**. This move aims to improve **administration, coordination, law enforcement**, and **resource management** for the event, which attracts millions of pilgrims.
- Telangana** has joined India's **mineral auction regime**, auctioning two **limestone blocks** in **Sultanpur** and **Saidulnama** to **NCL Industries** and **Deccan Cement**. This makes **Telangana** the **14th state** to participate, responding to the Centre's push for auctioning **critical minerals**. The state's move aims to boost **mineral production** for industries like **cement manufacturing**, with more auctions expected.
- Mission Arun Himveer** has been launched by the **Arunachal Pradesh Government** to improve market access for local **farmers, SHGs, FPOs, and cooperatives**. The **Arunachal Pradesh Agriculture Marketing Board (APAMB)** signed an **MoU** with **ITBP** to purchase **fruits, vegetables, meat, and poultry** directly from farmers. This initiative aims to boost **economic growth** in rural areas, support the **Vibrant Village Programme**, and promote **reverse migration**. A **₹4 crore revolving fund** will ensure farmers receive **100% payments**.
- West Bengal** has gained international recognition with **UNESCO** declaring it a top destination for **heritage tourism**. **Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee** highlighted the state's growth in **religious, heritage, and tea tourism**, driving job creation for youth. The focus on enhancing **religious sites and heritage spots** is elevating the state's position in India's tourism sector.
- Uber** has launched **Asia's first water transport service, Uber Shikara**, in **Dal Lake**, **Srinagar**, **Jammu** and **Kashmir**. This service modernizes the traditional **shikara ride**,

combining **technology** with **Kashmir's cultural heritage** to enhance the **tourism experience**. Launched by **Uber India President Prabhjeet Singh**, it aims to improve **accessibility** and make the **shikara ride** more **convenient** for tourists.

- The **Telangana government**, under **CM A. Revanth Reddy**, will launch the **Rythu Bharosa Scheme** after **Sankranti**, providing **₹15,000 annual subsidies** to farmers. This scheme replaces the previous **Rythu Bandhu** and aims to improve farmers' welfare. Additionally, the government has cleared **₹7,625 crore** in **crop loan arrears** for **Kharif 2023** and waived loans up to **₹2 lakh** for **25.35 lakh farmers**, marking a historic move. **Subsidies** for palm oil, drip irrigation, and fodder seeds are also continued, with an **₹8,000 crore** allocation.
- Devendra Fadnavis** has been elected as the leader of the **Maharashtra BJP legislature party**, paving the way for his **third term** as Chief Minister. Alongside him, **Eknath Shinde** and **Ajit Pawar** will serve as deputy chief ministers. The **BJP** won a historic **132 seats** in the **2024 Maharashtra elections**, contributing to the **Mahayuti coalition's** total of **230 seats**, securing a commanding majority.
- Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma** announced a **complete ban on beef** in **hotels, restaurants, and public places** across the state, effective immediately. This move amends existing laws, extending the ban beyond the 5-km radius around **temples and religious sites** to include all **public functions** and events.
- Google** and the **Telangana government** have signed an agreement to establish the **Google Safety Engineering Centre (GSEC)** in **Hyderabad**, Google's second such center in Asia Pacific. The center will focus on **AI-driven security**, advancing **cybersecurity capabilities**, and creating **employment opportunities**. GSEC will enhance **cybersecurity** for **businesses, governments, and citizens**, while strengthening **Hyderabad's** position as a global leader in IT and cybersecurity.
- Amit Shah**, Union Home Minister, unveiled an **11-ft tall statue** of **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** in **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**. The statue, weighing **1,100 kg** and made of multiple metals, stands on an **8-ft pedestal**. Shah highlighted Patel's contributions to India's unity and his recognition under **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's** leadership. The ceremony was attended by **Union Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat** and other dignitaries.
- Bihar's sex ratio at birth** has declined to **882 females per 1,000 males** in 2023-24, down from **894** in 2022-23, highlighting a severe gender imbalance. In response, the state has committed to stricter enforcement of the **PC-PNDT Act** and launched awareness campaigns to combat **female foeticide** and improve **gender parity**, positioning Bihar among India's **worst-performing states** in terms of child gender ratio.

- The **4th Eaglenest Bird Festival** will be held from **January 17-19, 2025**, in **Khellong and Thongre village**, West Kameng District, **Arunachal Pradesh**. The festival, unveiled by **Chief Minister Pema Khandu**, celebrates the region's **biodiversity** and promotes **sustainable eco-tourism** and **community-driven conservation**.
- On **Gita Jayanti 2024**, **Bhopal** set a **Guinness World Record** with over 5,000 **Acharyas** reciting '**Karma Yog**' from the **Bhagavad Gita**, while **Kurukshetra** saw **1.5 crore people** globally joining via an online platform. The event in Bhopal highlighted spiritual empowerment, with funds transferred to the **Ladli Behans welfare scheme**. In Kurukshetra, **18,000 children** chanted the Gita's verses, and leaders like **Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini** and **Union Ministers** emphasized the Gita's impact on personal and societal growth.
- Under **Yogi Adityanath's** leadership, **Uttar Pradesh** has made significant strides in **cow protection** and welfare, focusing on indigenous cow breeds and increasing **milk production**. The **Gorakshapeeth** plays a key role in preserving native cow breeds, with the **Gorakhnath Temple's** cowshed dedicated to cow protection. These efforts aim to make Uttar Pradesh a leader in **cow milk production**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated **167 development projects** worth ₹5,500 crore in **Prayagraj** to enhance infrastructure and amenities for the **Maha Kumbh 2025**. The projects focus on improving **city infrastructure, transportation**, and facilities for pilgrims. Modi also launched the **Sah'Al'yak Chatbot**, an **AI-based platform** for seamless communication with pilgrims. He emphasized the **cultural, spiritual, and economic significance** of the event, promoting **unity** and **national integration**.
- **Uttarakhand**, known as "Devbhoomi," is set to become the first Indian state with a dedicated **Yoga Policy**, aiming to make it a global yoga destination. Building on **Rishikesh** as the "Yoga Capital of the World," the policy, led by **Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami**, integrates **yoga, Ayurveda**, and **wellness** to boost **tourism, health**, and **employment**, aligning with the success of the **AYUSH policy**.
- **Manipur** commemorated **Nupi Lal Numit 2024**, honoring the courage of women in the **Nupi Lal uprisings of 1904 and 1939**. Led by **Chief Minister N. Biren Singh** at the **Nupi Lal Memorial Complex**, the event highlighted Manipuri women's pivotal role in history and their continued progress. The Chief Minister emphasized **women's empowerment** and called for **peace** and **unity** across the state. The uprisings were key moments in Manipuri history, with women protesting against **British colonial injustices**, leading to significant **political and social changes**.
- Uber has launched the '**Moto Women**' pilot program in **Bengaluru**, offering an on-demand bike taxi service exclusively for **female riders and drivers**. The initiative focuses on **safety, empowerment**, and **privacy**, addressing concerns over bike taxi operations in **Karnataka**. Currently, around **300 women drivers** are employed, providing a secure and flexible transportation option.
- **Uttarakhand** will be the first Indian state to implement the **Uniform Civil Code (UCC)** starting January 2025, fulfilling a promise by **Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami**. The UCC aims to standardize personal laws on **marriage, divorce, inheritance, and adoption** across religions and castes, excluding tribal communities. The **UCC Bill** was passed in February 2024 and received **presidential assent** in March 2024, marking a significant legal reform in India.
- **Madhya Pradesh** has been recognized by the **Wall Street Journal** as a "**Go-To Global Destination for 2025**," highlighting its **heritage, wildlife, and natural beauty**. The state features iconic **UNESCO World Heritage Sites** like **Khajuraho, Panna, and Bandhavgarh**, along with vibrant **cultural experiences** and **nine Tiger Reserves**. The **Madhya Pradesh Tourism Board** is actively promoting these attractions to enhance global travel interest.
- **Rajnath Singh** and **Yogi Adityanath** unveiled a statue of **Atal Bihari Vajpayee** at **Kudiya Ghat** in **Lucknow** on December 25, 2024, to honor his legacy. The event celebrated Vajpayee's contributions to India, with **sculptor Amarpal Singh** being felicitated for his craftsmanship.
- **Ladakhi Losar**, a vibrant New Year festival, celebrates Ladakh's culture and traditions. Organized by **LAHDC Leh** and the **Culture Academy**, the celebrations, running from **December 20 to 31**, featured cultural performances, traditional dishes, and community feasts. The festival emphasizes **heritage preservation**, eco-friendly practices, and adapting traditions to modern times, while fostering a sense of community and pride among **villagers** and **tourists**.
- **IndiGoReach** launched the **Zero Waste Airport Project** at **Indore Airport** in collaboration with the **Airports Authority of India (AAI)** and **AAS Foundation**. The initiative aims to minimize environmental impact using the **4R strategy: Reduce, Reuse, Recycle, and Recover**. The project focuses on **sustainable waste management, behavioral change**, and **stakeholder engagement**, targeting both airport staff and passengers.
- **Uttar Pradesh CM Yogi Adityanath** and **Defence Minister Rajnath Singh** inaugurated the '**Atal Yuva Maha Kumbh**' in **Lucknow** to honor the **100th birth anniversary** of former PM **Atal Bihari Vajpayee**. The event celebrated his **legacy**, with **cultural tributes**, recognition of **meritorious students**, and discussions on Vajpayee's contributions. December 25 is also observed as **Good Governance Day**.
- On the **20th memorial day** of the **2004 tsunami**, **Puducherry** organized various events across affected districts. In **Nagapattinam**, wreath-laying and candle lighting honored **6,065 victims**, led by **P. Akash** and others. **Velankanni** saw a **3-km procession** with interfaith prayers, led by **Fr. R. Irudayaraj**. **Mayiladuthurai** focused on victims of **Tharangambadi taluk** with floral tributes. **Karaikal** held ceremonies and prayers at multiple locations, led by **P. R. N. Thirumurugan** and others.

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Union Territories of India

January to December 2024

Union Territories of India of October 2024

Jammu and Kashmir

- **Omar Abdullah**, a prominent leader of the **Jammu and Kashmir National Conference (JKNC)**, has been sworn in as the new Chief Minister of Jammu and Kashmir, marking a significant political transition in the region. Abdullah took the oath of office in a ceremony administered by Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha. His ascension to the position comes after the National Conference emerged victorious in the recent elections, albeit without the direct involvement of the Congress party, which has chosen to provide external support instead.

Ladakh

- NTPC has teamed up with the Indian Army to establish a **solar hydrogen-based microgrid** at **Chushul, Ladakh**, aimed at ensuring a stable power supply for off-grid

Army locations using green hydrogen. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh laid the foundation stone for this innovative project through video conferencing.

Delhi

- Despite the Delhi government's "**Pink Ticket**" scheme enabling free bus travel for women since October 2019, a recent Greenpeace report reveals that **77% of women feel unsafe on buses after dark** due to poor lighting, infrequent schedules, and incidents of harassment, particularly in overcrowded buses.
- **Delhi government, led by Chief Minister Atishi**, has approved the establishment of special courts dedicated to people with disabilities. This initiative aims to provide fair and swift justice by designing court environments that cater specifically to the needs of individuals with disabilities.

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Schemes and Committees of January 2024

- In a promising **New Year development** for small businesses, loans disbursed under the **Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY)** have soared to an unprecedented **₹3-lakh crore** in **December 2023**, showcasing a remarkable **16%** year-on-year growth.
- The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** has recently approved the appointment of **Vivek Srivastava**, a seasoned 1989-batch IPS officer of Gujarat cadre, as the **Director General of Fire Service, Civil Defence & Home Guards under the Ministry of Home Affairs**.
- The newly elected BJP government in Rajasthan is making strides to merge its state health insurance scheme, **Chiranjeevi**, with the central **Ayushman Bharat programme**. This move, pending approval from the union health ministry, aims to create a unified initiative called the **Ayushman Bharat Mukhyamantri Chiranjeevi Health Insurance Scheme**.
- Jammu and Kashmir** has taken a significant step towards empowering its vibrant community of artisans and craftspeople by becoming the first Union Territory (UT) to implement the **PM Vishwakarma Yojana (PMVY)**. This initiative, launched by the Central government in September 2023, aims to uplift and recognize the crucial role these skilled individuals play in preserving and enriching India's cultural heritage.
- In a groundbreaking collaboration with **Compassion Unlimited Plus Action (CUPA)**, Murty Trust unveils the '**Maitri**' initiative, a trailblazing community cat sterilization center in Bangalore. This state-of-the-art facility, inaugurated on January 1, 2024, signifies goodwill and friendship while addressing challenges in India's animal welfare sector.
- The **Department of School Education & Literacy, Ministry of Education**, proudly presents **Prerana: An Experiential Learning program**. This unique initiative aims to empower students of classes IX to XII with leadership qualities and provide them with a meaningful, unique, and inspiring experience.
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- In a significant move to promote ethical practices in higher education, the **University Grants Commission (UGC) of India** has introduced **Mulya Pravah 2.0**. This new guideline comes as a response to surveys that highlighted unethical practices such as favouritism, sexual harassment, and gender discrimination within various educational organizations.
- The **ANUBHAV Awards Scheme**, initiated by the **Department of Pension and Pensioners Welfare (DoPPW)**, is an innovative platform for recognizing the contributions made by retired officials to nation-building during their tenure in government service. Launched in 2015 under the guidance of the Hon'ble Prime Minister of India, the scheme is a step towards documenting India's administrative history through written narratives by retired Central Government employees.
- In a significant move towards uplifting **Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs)**, Prime Minister Narendra Modi is set to **release ₹540 crore**, the inaugural tranche of funding, for pucca homes under the **Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G)** on January 15. This disbursement, part of the recently launched **PM-JANMAN package**, aims to foster the comprehensive development of PVTG habitations.
- The state of **Chhattisgarh**, inspired by the successful implementation of the 'Aarthik Sarkari Ladli Bahna Yojana' organized by the Madhya Pradesh government, has recently launched a new scheme known as **Mahtari Vandana Yojana 2024**. Under this initiative, the government aims to provide economic assistance of **one thousand rupees to women every month**, amounting to a total annual financial aid of **12,000 rupees**.
- In a significant move to enhance the efficiency of the **Electronic Toll Collection (ETC) system** and streamline traffic at Toll Plazas, the **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)** has introduced the '**One Vehicle, One FASTag**' initiative. This strategic measure aims to curb the prevalent practice of using a single FASTag for multiple vehicles or **linking multiple FASTags to a specific vehicle**.
- The launch of the **e-SAKSHI mobile application** marks a significant advancement in the administration of the **Member of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS) in India**. This digital initiative, spearheaded by the Union Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI), aims to transform the way MPs engage in and manage development projects within their constituencies.
- In a progressive move aligning with the National Education Policy (NEP)-2020, the state of **Himachal Pradesh** has unveiled the ambitious '**My School-My Pride**' campaign under the '**Apna Vidyalay**' programme. This initiative is set to revolutionize the quality of education in government schools, providing a holistic approach to student growth and development.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi, on a historic day after presiding over the consecration ceremony of the Ram temple in Ayodhya, announced a groundbreaking initiative aimed at harnessing solar energy. The initiative, named '**Pradhanmantri Suryodaya Yojana**,' seeks to propel India towards self-reliance in the energy sector while benefitting the common citizens.

- In a landmark event at Dr Ambedkar International Centre, Vice-President Shri Jagdeep Dhankhar launched the nationwide campaign '**Hamara Samvidhan, Hamara Samman**' to mark India's 75th year as a Republic. The initiative seeks to reinforce commitment to constitutional principles, fostering pride and responsibility among citizens.
- In a significant development, REC Ltd, a Maharatna power finance company, has been designated as the nodal agency for the ambitious **Pradhan Mantri Suryodaya Yojana**. This initiative, announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on January 22, aims to install rooftop solar panels in one crore households. REC Ltd, under the leadership of CMD Vivek Kumar Dewangan, is set to lend up to Rs 1,20,000 crore for this massive undertaking.
- The Union Cabinet, on January 24, 2024, gave the green light to a groundbreaking **Viability Gap Funding (VGF) scheme**, allocating Rs 8,500 crores for **Coal Gasification Projects**. This strategic move is a pivotal step towards realizing the government's ambitious mission to **gasify 100 million tonnes of coal by 2030**. The initiative is set to revolutionize the energy sector, particularly with the active involvement of major players like Coal India, GAIL (India), and BHEL.
- In a significant move towards the development and empowerment of approximately one crore tribals in Odisha, the state government, led by Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik, has approved the launch of the '**LABHA**' scheme. LABHA, an acronym for **Laghu Bana Jatya Drabya Kraya**, is a 100% state-funded Minimum Support Price (MSP) for Minor Forest Produce (MFP).

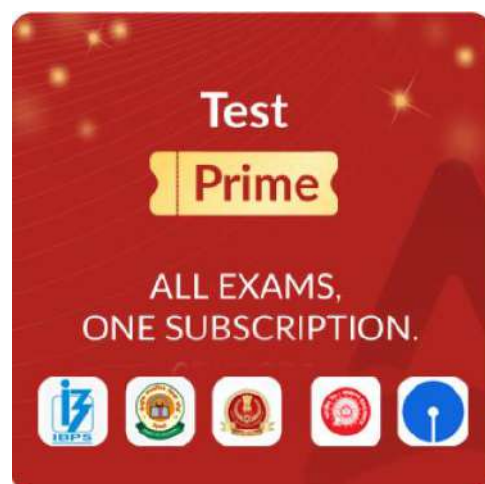
Schemes and Committees of February 2024

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- Tamil Nadu Youth Welfare and Sports Development Minister **Udhayanidhi Stalin** recently announced a pioneering scheme aimed at nurturing sports talent at the grassroots level. Named after the late Kalaingar Karunanidhi, the '**Kalaingar Sports Kit**' initiative is set to provide sporting kits to 12,000 village panchayats across the state.
- **Tamil Nadu government**, under the leadership of Chief Minister **M.K. Stalin**, has taken a significant step towards improving public service delivery and expediting the implementation of various schemes through the launch of the '**Ungalai Thedi, Ungal Ooril**' (**Bringing Services to Your Doorstep**) scheme. This innovative initiative aims to bridge the gap between the government and the public by ensuring that the benefits of various schemes reach the grassroots level.

- In an era where digital devices have become an extension of our lives, the **Government of Karnataka** has taken a pioneering step towards fostering a healthier digital ecosystem. Recognizing the need to mitigate the adverse **effects of excessive online gaming**, the state has announced a groundbreaking **digital detox initiative** to create a responsible gaming environment. This move not only highlights the government's commitment to public health but also sets a precedent for digital wellbeing.
- In a monumental achievement, the **Mera Yuva Bharat (MY Bharat) portal** has garnered over 1.45 crore youth registrations within a remarkable three-month period, attesting to its widespread popularity. Launched by Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi on October 31, 2023, the platform has swiftly become a crucial driver of youth development and engagement.
- In a concerted effort to fortify child protection measures, the **Ministry of Women and Child Development** has pioneered the development of two pivotal portals: the **Track Child Portal** and the **Ghar – Go Home and Re-Unite Portal**. These platforms play a crucial role in tracking missing and found children, enhancing restoration and repatriation processes, and safeguarding the welfare of vulnerable minors under the purview of the Juvenile Justice system.
- In a significant stride towards scientific progress, **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)** has initiated two groundbreaking endeavors: **the establishment of the Human DNA Bank** and **the imminent completion of the Wildlife DNA Bank**. These initiatives, powered by cutting-edge technologies such as the Automated DNA Extractor Machine, epitomize India's commitment to innovation and indigenous manufacturing under the Make in India initiative.
- Union Ministers of State for Health and Family Welfare, Prof. S P Singh Baghel and Dr. Bharati Pravin Pawar, virtually launched the **Kilkari programme** and **Mobile Academy**, aimed at strengthening public health infrastructure in **Maharashtra and Gujarat**. Kilkari provides timely audio messages on reproductive maternal, neonatal, and child health, while Mobile Academy offers training for Accredited Social Health Activists (ASHAs) via mobile phones.
- The Cabinet has given its approval for the upcoming telecom spectrum auctions, scheduled to take place later this year. The reserve price for the auctions has been fixed at **Rs 96,317 crore**. All available spectrum in various bands including **800, 900, 1800, 2100, 2300, 2500, 3300 megahertz (MHz)**, and 26 gigahertz (GHz) will be up for auction. The decision aligns with recommendations from the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) and follows the government's commitment to holding annual spectrum auctions, as decided in September 2021.

- Union Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister **Arjun Munda** introduced several key initiatives under the **Prime Minister Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)** in New Delhi on 8th February 2024. These initiatives aim to benefit insured farmers and mitigate their risks.
- In a significant stride towards fostering entrepreneurship in **Tamil Nadu**, the MSME Minister, T M Anbarasan, launched two pivotal initiatives during an event organized by StartUp TN. These initiatives, the **Smartcard scheme** and the **StartUp Challenge website**, underscore the government's unwavering commitment to nurturing startups and fostering innovation in the state.
- In a groundbreaking move for the Northeast region, **Chief Minister Prem Singh Tamang of Sikkim** announced the revival of the **Old Pension Scheme (OPS)** for state government employees **hired on or after April 1, 2006**, during the State Level Temporary Employees' Convention. This decision underscores the government's commitment to the welfare of its workforce.
- **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath** responded to queries from the opposition, emphasizing the importance of stability and sustainability in driving infrastructure and industrial development in Uttar Pradesh. He highlighted the proactive measures taken by the state government, including the establishment of the **Bundelkhand Industrial Development Authority (BIDA)** between Kanpur and Jhansi, a significant development after 46 years. CM Yogi underscored the strategic importance of semiconductors in advancing industrial growth.
- In a move aimed at providing relief to beneficiaries of social security schemes in Odisha, Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik has announced a significant increase in monthly pension amounts under the **Madhu Babu Pension Yojana (MBPY)**. Rs 500 increase for each category, effective from February.
- **Odisha** has taken a significant step towards conservation by declaring the **Gupteswar forest in Koraput district** as its **fourth Biodiversity Heritage Site (BHS)**. This declaration marks a pivotal moment in the state's environmental conservation efforts, joining the ranks of Mandasaru, Mahendragiri, and Gandhamardan, which have previously been recognized for their unique biodiversity.
- The NTR Stadium in Hyderabad hosts the 36th edition of the National Book Fair. Organized by the Hyderabad Book Fair Society, the event kicked off on February 9. The book fair runs until February 19. Drawing bibliophiles (People who love and collect books) from all corners of the city, the fair is a highly anticipated annual event.
- **Assam**, the state government has officially declared **kaji nemu (Citrus limon)**, a variety of lemon unique to the region, as the **'State Fruit'**. The announcement was made by State Agriculture Minister Atul Bora, following a Cabinet meeting on February 12, underscoring the fruit's cultural, traditional, and nutritional significance to the state and its people.
- India is set to launch its **first Helicopter Emergency Medical Service (HEMS)** from **Uttarakhand**, marking a significant milestone in the country's healthcare and aviation sectors. Civil Aviation Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia recently announced this groundbreaking initiative, highlighting its importance in providing rapid medical assistance to those in need.
- **Sandeep Kaur**, Director of the Women's Welfare Department, has declared substantial increments in grants under the Mukhyamantri Kanya Sumangala Yojana. This follows Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath's directive to raise the grant from **Rs 15,000 to Rs 25,000 per beneficiary** annually starting this April.
- **The Tamil Nadu Assembly** made a significant political statement by unanimously adopting two resolutions that challenge the Union government's proposals on **'One Nation, One Election'** and the **post-2026 delimitation process**. This move underscores the state's firm stance on maintaining its democratic principles and the autonomy of its electoral processes.
- In a significant move towards environmental conservation, **Haryana Chief Minister Manohar Lal Khattar** inaugurated the **'Van Mitra'** scheme and its accompanying portal. This innovative initiative is designed to foster community engagement in afforestation efforts, specifically targeting non-forest areas across the state.
- **Rajasthan's Karauli district** has emerged as a new focal point for mineral exploration after the Mines Department announced the discovery of substantial iron ore deposits. This find, located near Hindon, spans approximately **1,888 hectares** and is poised to significantly impact the state's industrial landscape.
- The World Bank has approved a new project aimed at supporting the state of Sikkim in India. The project focuses on training, upskilling, and providing jobs for **300,500 women and youth** in high-growth and priority sectors.
- Odisha Chief Minister **Naveen Patnaik** inaugurated the **Bagchi Sri Shankara Cancer Centre and Research Institute (BSCCRI)** in Bhubaneswar. This state-of-the-art facility, established in collaboration with the Sri Shankara Cancer Hospital and Research Centre in Bengaluru, represents a leap forward in making high-quality cancer treatment accessible and affordable to patients.
- G Kishan Reddy and Mohan Yadav laid the foundation stone for the **Komuravelli Railway Station in Siddipet District, Telangana**. The station aims to improve transportation to the renowned Komuravelli Mallikarjuna Swamy Temple, attracting millions of devotees annually.
- The government is preparing to extend the benefits of the Ayushman Bharat Scheme to **Accredited Social Health Activists (ASHAs)** and **Anganwadi workers/helpers**. This initiative aims to provide free health coverage to these essential healthcare workers, aligning with the broader goals of the **AB-PMJAY** scheme.

- On the occasion of the International Day of Women and Girls in Science on 11 Feb, 2024, the **Indian National Science Academy (INSA)**, New Delhi, witnessed the launch of the “**Science for Women-A Technology & Innovation (SWATI)**” Portal. Prof Ajay Kumar Sood, the Principal Scientific Advisor to the Government of India, initiated this significant step towards addressing gender disparity in science and technology fields.
- Hon'ble Secretary of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India, Shri S. Krishnan, inaugurated the groundbreaking SWASTHA project and the state-of-the-art ISO 5 and 6 Clean Room Facilities at IIT Guwahati's Centre for Nanotechnology on 9th February 2024. Prof. Rajeev Ahuja, Officiating Director, IIT Guwahati, and other dignitaries were also present at the event.
- Dharmendra Pradhan, Union Minister of Education, Skill Development, and Entrepreneurship, inaugurated the National Conference on **APAAR: One Nation One Student ID Card** in New Delhi. This conference aimed to emphasize the importance of the APAAR ID as a universally recognized document for students across the nation. Pradhan highlighted the significance of Digital Public Infrastructures (DPIs) and their proliferation, both globally and within India, with 19 established DPIs in the country.
- In a significant move towards the welfare of laborers and street vendors in **Rajasthan**, Finance Minister Diya Kumari presented the state's budget on February 8, 2024, under the leadership of Chief Minister Bhajan Lal. This budget marks the presentation of the financial budget in Rajasthan after nearly 22 years. Notably, it includes special announcements for the youth, farmers, women, and the elderly.
- Union Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying, **Shri Parshottam Rupala**, unveiled the realigned **Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund (AHIDF) scheme** and introduced a **Radio Jingle** for AHIDF in New Delhi. The Minister highlighted the significance of the scheme, especially during the challenging times of the COVID-19 pandemic, and emphasized its realignment and extension for another three years.
- The **16th Finance Commission (FC)** convened its inaugural session with **Arvind Panagariya** at the helm to deliberate upon its **Terms of Reference (ToR)**. The commission aims to engage in comprehensive analytical endeavors and leverage expertise from prominent research institutions and think tanks specializing in fiscal federal relations.
- The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) introduces the ‘**Sangam: Digital Twin**’ initiative, calling upon industry leaders, startups, MSMEs, academia, and innovators to join hands in reshaping infrastructure planning and design through cutting-edge technologies and collaborative efforts.
- Union Minister of Food Processing **Shri Pashupati Kumar Paras** inaugurated “**SUFALAM: Start-Up Forum for Aspiring Leaders and Mentors Startup Conclave 2024,**” stressing the importance of such events in promoting networking, sharing knowledge, and aiding startups in accessing government schemes.
- MSME Minister **Narayan Rane** launched a special scheme for informal micro enterprises (IMEs), exempted from the Goods and Services Tax (GST) regime. This scheme **enables IMEs to access collateral-free loans up to Rs 20 lakh** under the government's Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises (CGTMSE). The scheme, titled ‘**Special Provision for Informal Micro Enterprises under Credit Guarantee Scheme,**’ aims to provide credit support to micro or nano enterprises. It seeks to moderate the credit risk perception associated with lending to IMEs, as stated by the MSME Ministry.
- The Union Cabinet has approved modifications to the **National Livelihood Mission (NLM)**, enhancing its scope with **new subsidy provisions**. These changes aim to bolster entrepreneurship in the livestock sector and improve fodder cultivation, alongside simplifying the livestock insurance program.
- Union Minister of Education and Skill Development & Entrepreneurship, **Dharmendra Pradhan**, alongside Chief Minister of Chhattisgarh, **Vishnu Deo Sai**, marked the inauguration of **211 PM SHRI schools in Raipur**. This significant event showcased the government's commitment to bolstering the education sector, particularly through schemes like PM SHRI.
- The Indian government has decided to extend its flagship scheme for **women safety until 2025-26** with a budget approval of **Rs 1,179.72 crore**. This decision aims to combat the rising incidents of crimes against women across the country, as evidenced by recent statistics from the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB).
- Union Minister of Education and Skill Development & Entrepreneurship, Shri Dharmendra Pradhan inaugurated the **Rashtriya Udyamita Vikas Pariyojana** in Sambalpur, Odisha. The initiative, launched virtually across 9 cities, aims to empower beneficiaries of the **PM SVANidhi scheme** nationwide.



- After discussions within the Financial Stability and Development Council (FSDC) regarding the need for **uniform Know Your Customer (KYC) norms**, the government has taken action by establishing an expert committee. Headed by Finance Secretary **T V Somanathan**, this committee aims to streamline and finalize uniform KYC norms across various sectors.

Schemes and Committees of March 2024

- Telangana Chief Minister **A Revanth Reddy** has announced the launch of the **Indiramma Housing Scheme** starting March 11. The scheme aims to provide housing solutions to the economically disadvantaged segments of society.
- During **DefConnect 2024** in New Delhi on March 4, 2024, Raksha Mantri **Rajnath Singh** unveiled the **Acing Development of Innovative Technologies with iDEX (ADITI) scheme**. The scheme aims to promote innovations in critical and strategic defence technologies, providing start-ups with significant grants for research and development.
- **Jharkhand** Chief Minister **Champai Soren** has launched a pioneering initiative, the '**Vidhwa Punarvivah Protsahan Yojana**' (**Widow Remarriage Incentive Scheme**). This scheme, a first in India, aims to support and encourage widows to embark on a new journey of companionship by providing a financial incentive of Rs 2 lakh to those who choose to remarry.
- Union Minister for Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution, Commerce and Industry, and Textiles, **Shri Piyush Goyal**, launched the '**e-Kisan Upaj Nidhi**' (**Digital Gateway**) of the Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority (WDRA) in New Delhi. This initiative is poised to become a cornerstone in India's journey to becoming a developed nation, 'Viksit Bharat', by 2047, with agriculture as its foundational pillar.
- The Union Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has sanctioned the **Uttar Poorva Transformative Industrialization Scheme, 2024 (UNNATI – 2024)**. This scheme, spearheaded by the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry**, aims to invigorate industrial development in the North East Region, fostering economic growth and job creation.
- The Indian Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has greenlit the ambitious **IndiaAI mission**, allocating a substantial budget of **Rs. 10,371.92 crore**. This initiative aligns with the vision of bolstering AI innovation within India and leveraging AI for the nation's advancement. The mission aims to establish a robust AI ecosystem through a strategic public-private partnership approach.
- The **NAMASTE Scheme**, a joint initiative by the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment** and the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs**, aims to eliminate manual engagement of sanitation workers in hazardous sewer and septic tank cleaning operations. Implemented by the **NSKFDC** for three years, the scheme prioritizes the safety and well-being of workers with a budget of 349.73 crores.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi virtually launched the '**Mahtari Vandan Yojana**' in Chhattisgarh from Kashi, Uttar Pradesh. The scheme aims to provide financial assistance to women in the state. PM Modi disbursed the first installment of Rs 1,000 to 70,12,417 women in Chhattisgarh. The state government has allocated Rs 655.57 crore for this purpose.
- The **Department of Pharmaceuticals, Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers**, introduces the **Revamped Pharmaceuticals Technology Upgradation Assistance Scheme** to enhance industry capabilities and align with global standards. Its approval follows a thorough review by the Scheme Steering Committee, considering the revised Schedule-M of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rule, 1945.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the '**Pradhan Mantri Samajik Utthan and Rozgar Adharit Jankalyan**' (**PM-SURAJ**) national portal during an event organized by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment. The portal signifies the government's commitment to extending credit support and empowering **one lakh entrepreneurs from disadvantaged communities**.
- **NITI Aayog** launched the '**Vocal for Local**' initiative under its **Aspirational Blocks Programme** on March 13, 2024. This initiative aims to bolster local economies and promote grassroots entrepreneurship, ultimately fostering self-reliance and sustainable growth.
- The **Ministry of Heavy Industries**, Government of India, in collaboration with the Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance, introduces the **Electric Mobility Promotion Scheme 2024 (EMPS 2024)**. This scheme aims to expedite the uptake of **electric vehicles (EVs)** within the country, fostering a sustainable and eco-friendly transportation ecosystem while bolstering the EV manufacturing sector.
- **Bank of Baroda**, one of India's leading public sector banks, has announced the launch of the **bob Earth Green Term Deposit Scheme**. The scheme aims to raise deposits that will be **used to finance eligible environment-friendly projects and sectors**, fostering India's transition to a green and sustainable economy.
- The Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports, **Shri Anurag Singh Thakur**, has inaugurated a unique talent hunt event called **KIRTI (Khelo India Rising Talent Identification)** in Chandigarh. This nationwide programme, under the Khelo India mission, aims to identify talented athletes between the ages of 9 and 18 years, currently enrolled in schools across the country.

- The Tamil Nadu government has agreed to implement the **PM SHRI Schools (PM Schools for Rising India) scheme** by signing a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Ministry of Education, Government of India. This initiative aims to enhance the quality of education in the state and align with the objectives of the National Education Policy 2020.
- In response to the urgent need to protect the endangered **Great Indian Bustard (GIB)** population from extinction caused by collisions with high-powered power cables in **Gujarat and Rajasthan**, the Supreme Court of India has taken decisive action. A bench led by **Chief Justice of India DY Chandrachud, JB Pardiwala, and Manoj Misra** has appointed an expert committee to address this critical issue while balancing conservation efforts with renewable energy goals.

Schemes and Committees of April 2024

- The **Indian government has launched CDP-SURAKSHA**, a groundbreaking digital platform aimed at streamlining the distribution of subsidies to horticulture farmers under the **Cluster Development Programme (CDP)**. This initiative comes amidst the significant contribution of the horticulture sector to **India's agricultural Gross Value Added (GVA)**, with consistent growth in crop production over the years.
- At the 42nd **Inter-Agency Space Debris Coordination Committee (IADC)** annual meet, **ISRO Chairman S. Somanath** announced India's pledge to achieve debris-free space missions by 2030. This commitment aligns with global efforts to ensure the sustainability of space exploration.
- In the landmark **Supriyo Chakraborty vs. Union Of India Case 2023**, the **Special Marriage Act of 1954** was challenged for its exclusion of same-sex marriages, citing a violation of Article 14 of the fundamental rights. Despite the Act allowing marriages between individuals of different religions, it did not extend this provision to same-sex couples. The committee, chaired by Union Home Secretary Rajiv Gauba, comprises six members including secretaries from key ministries.
- The Union rural development ministry announced the revision of wages under the **Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme on March 27**, following clearance from the Election Commission amidst the ongoing Lok Sabha polls and the **Model Code of Conduct (MCC)** in force.
- The **Delhi High Court** has appointed former judge **Najmi Waziri** to lead a committee focused on safeguarding the forests in the national capital. This decision follows concerns about various government departments not fully cooperating with efforts to protect these vital natural resources.

- **Bilquis Mir**, a canoeist from Jammu and Kashmir, is set to make history as the **first woman from India** to represent the country as a jury member at the upcoming Summer Olympics in Paris. This prestigious appointment was officially conveyed through a letter from the Indian Olympic Association (IOA) to the J&K administration.
- In FY24, small business loans under the **Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY)** witnessed a record surge, crossing the **₹5 lakh crore milestone**, as per recent government data. Disbursements totaled **₹5.20 lakh crore**, a significant increase from ₹4.40 lakh crore in the previous fiscal year. Notably, nearly 70% of the beneficiaries of these loans are women.
- **NTPC Limited**, India's largest power company, is set to unveil a new version of its flagship corporate social responsibility initiative, the **Girl Child Empowerment Mission (GEM)**. This program aligns with the **Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao (Save the Girl Child, Educate the Girl Child)** campaign launched by the Government of India.

Schemes and Committees of May 2024

- **India is embarking on Mission ISHAN**, aimed at consolidating its fragmented airspace management into a single, unified system headquartered in Nagpur. This move promises to revolutionize air traffic management, benefitting both airlines and passengers.
- In a concerted effort to combat the rising threat of fraudulent SMS, the **Department of Telecommunication (DoT)**, in collaboration with the **Union Ministry of Home Affairs**, has launched the **Sanchar Saathi Initiative**. This initiative aims to tackle the proliferation of deceptive messages targeting unsuspecting mobile users. Notably, the government has identified and blocked eight SMS headers frequently exploited by cybercriminals.
- The **Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS)** has launched the **Pharma Research in AyurGyan And Techno Innovation (PRAGATI-2024)** initiative to promote research and innovation in the field of ayurveda. This initiative aims to provide an opportunity for collaborative research between **CCRAS and the ayurveda drug industry**.

Schemes and Committees of June 2024

- **Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare**, Shri Jagat Prakash Nadda launched the **National STOP Diarrhoea Campaign 2024**, on June 24. He was joined by **Smt. Anupriya Patel** and **Shri Jadhav Patraprao Ganpatrao**, Union Ministers of State for Health and Family Welfare. The dignitaries also released IEC materials like **logo, posters, radio spots and audio visuals** for the campaign and distributed oral rehydration salts (**ORS**) and **zinc tablets** to children on the occasion.

- Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Earth Sciences, MoS PMO, Department of Atomic Energy, Department of Space, Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions **Dr. Jitendra Singh on June 24**, launched **“One Week One Theme” (OWOT)** campaign showcasing recent success stories of India in different streams of science and technology.
- **Chief Minister Mohan Yadav** said the centre of **‘Bharatiya Gyan Parampara’** will be opened in every PM College of Excellence and necessary arrangements will be made in this regard. The PM College of Excellence is going to get **started from July 1** in all the **55 districts of Madhya Pradesh**.
- The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) has launched the **Safai Aapao, Bimaari Bhagao (SABB)** initiative under **Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0**, running from **July 1 to August 31, 2024**. This initiative aims to bolster Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) in tackling heightened cleanliness and health challenges during the monsoon season. It aligns with the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare’s **‘STOP Diarrhoea Campaign’**, emphasizing comprehensive interventions and inter-departmental collaboration.
- In a recent report **American multi-national investment bank** and financial company **Morgan Stanley** has all praise for **PM Gati Shakti scheme**. The report highlights **increased and more targeted investments**, suggesting a continued emphasis on infrastructure spending in India’s future.

Schemes and Committees of July 2024

- The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** has introduced the **eSankhyiki portal** to revolutionize data accessibility and user experience. This initiative aims to centralize and streamline access to key national statistical data, supporting planners, policymakers, researchers, and the public.
- **Union Minister for Coal and Mines, Shri G Kishan Reddy**, inaugurated the **NIRMAN portal in New Delhi**, aligning with **PM Modi’s “Mission Karmayogi.”** This CSR initiative by Coal India Limited aims to aid meritorious youth from its operational districts who cleared the UPSC Preliminary exams in 2024.
- In a significant move to accelerate the development of India’s most challenging regions, **NITI Aayog** is set to launch the **‘Sampoornata Abhiyan’** on July 4, 2024. This ambitious **3-month campaign** aims to achieve saturation in key indicators across **112 Aspirational Districts** and **500 Aspirational Blocks**, marking a new chapter in India’s journey towards inclusive growth.

- In a landmark event for India’s cultural diplomacy, the nation is set to host the **46th session of the UNESCO World Heritage Committee** from July 21-31, 2024. This prestigious gathering will take place at the **Bharat Mandapam** in New Delhi, bringing together delegates from around the world to discuss and decide on matters of global cultural significance.
- The Women Entrepreneurship Platform (**WEP**) and **TransUnion CIBIL** have launched **SEHER**, a credit education program designed to empower women entrepreneurs in India. SEHER aims to provide financial literacy content and business skills, facilitating access to essential financial tools for growth and employment creation.
- The **Uttar Pradesh government** has constituted a three-member judicial commission to investigate the stampede that occurred during a Satsang in Hathras on 3 July 2024, resulting in 121 fatalities. Uttar Pradesh Governor **Anandiben Patel** issued the notification for this commission.
- India, a vibrant center of artistic expression, has a rich history of public art reflecting its cultural and spiritual diversity. **Project PARI (Public Art of India)**, initiated by the Ministry of Culture and executed by **Lalit Kala Akademi** and the **National Gallery of Modern Art**, seeks to blend India’s millennia-old artistic heritage with modern themes and techniques.
- The government has designated the **Ministry of Minority Affairs as the nodal ministry for the Haj Committee**, taking over from the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**. This change includes new rules and the nomination of officers from various ministries to the committee.
- The Government of India is set to launch the **‘Agri Fund for Start-Ups & Rural Enterprises’ (AgriSURE)** to support start-ups and agripreneurs through investments in sector-specific, sector-agnostic, and debt **Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs)**, as well as direct equity support to start-ups working in agriculture and allied sectors. This initiative aims to foster innovation and sustainability in India’s agricultural sector through the establishment of a **Rs 750 crore Category-II Alternative Investment Fund (AIF)**.
- The second regional event of the **‘Hamara Samvidhan Hamara Samman’** campaign, under the aegis of **Designing Innovative Solutions for Holistic Access to Justice (DISHA)**, is scheduled to take place in **Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh on the 16th of July 2024**. This event commemorates the 75th anniversary of the adoption of the Indian Constitution and India becoming a Republic. The campaign aims to promote understanding of the Constitution and raise awareness about legal rights.
- The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** is set to unveil a groundbreaking initiative that promises to revolutionize the landscape of agricultural and animal husbandry research in India. The **‘One Scientist-One**

Product' programme, scheduled for launch on July 16, marks a significant milestone in the organization's commitment to advancing agricultural science and technology.

- **Maharashtra Chief Minister Eknath Shinde** announced the '**Ladla Bhai Yojana**' for boys in the state after announcing the '**Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana**' for girls. The latter aims to provide **monthly financial assistance of ₹1,500 to eligible women**. Speaking in **Maharashtra's Pandharpur** on the occasion of **Ashadhi Ekadashi**, Shinde reportedly said the state government does not differentiate between boys and girls and that the '**Ladla Bhai Yojana**' scheme will solve the **unemployment issue**.
- Under the **Atmanirbhar Bharat** initiative, India has marked a significant achievement in the global coal mining sector. The **Gevra and Kusmunda coal mines**, operated by **South Eastern Coalfields Limited (SECL)**, a subsidiary of Coal India, have secured prominent positions among the world's largest coal mines. These mines, located in **Chhattisgarh's Korba district**, have been recognized as the **2nd and 4th largest coal mines** globally by **WorldAtlas.com**, producing over 100 million tons of coal annually and contributing about 10% to India's total coal production.
- **Lok Sabha Speaker** sets up the **Business Advisory Committee** for the new session. The Committee includes members such as **Sudip Bandhyopadhyay, Gaurav Gogoi, Dayanidhi Maran, PP Chaudhary, and Anurag Thakur, among others**.
- The **Gujarat state government** launched the **Shramik Basera Scheme 2024**. The Gujarat state government introduced the **Shramik Basera Scheme 2024** to provide temporary housing facilities to the financially unstable, especially the laborers.
- **The Centre has introduced a revised Model Skill Loan Scheme, designed to provide financial support for skill development courses to the nation's youth**.
- Union Education Minister **Dharmendra Pradhan** has launched the National Apprenticeship and Training Scheme (NATS) 2.0 portal and disbursed **Rs. 100 crore** in stipends to apprentices via **Direct Benefits Transfer (DBT)**.

Schemes and Committees of August 2024

- The government of Jharkhand, led by Chief Minister **Hemant Soren**, has unveiled a significant welfare initiative aimed at empowering women in the state. The **Mukhyamantri Maiyaan Samman Yojana**, set to be officially launched on August 16, 2024, represents a major step towards providing financial assistance to eligible women across Jharkhand.
- The **Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM)** announced on August 6, the launch of the initiative "**Million Designers, Billion Dreams**."

Schemes and Committees of September 2024

- In a significant development for India's agricultural sector, **Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare and Rural Development, Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan, launched the AgriSURE Scheme in New Delhi**.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** is set to launch a groundbreaking initiative called "**Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari**" in **Surat, Gujarat**. This initiative represents a significant step towards enhancing community involvement in water conservation efforts across India. The launch aligns with the ongoing "**Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain**" campaign, reinforcing the Prime Minister's vision of collaborative water management to ensure long-term water security for the nation.
- Launched on September 12, 2019, the **Pradhan Mantri Kisan Maandhan Yojna (PM-KMY)** has provided social security to land-holding **Small and Marginal Farmers (SMFs) across India**. This voluntary and contributory old-age pension scheme offers a fixed monthly pension of Rs. 3,000 to eligible farmers after they turn sixty. Farmers contribute monthly to the pension fund, with matching contributions from the central government.
- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation, **Shri Amit Shah**, has been unanimously **re-elected as the Chairperson of the Parliamentary Committee on Official Language**. Following the formation of the new government, the committee held a meeting in New Delhi to reconstitute itself, leading to Shah's re-election. He previously served as the **Chairperson from 2019 to 2024**. Shah expressed gratitude for the unanimous support and discussed his vision for Hindi's role in government and education.
- The central government will launch the **Partnerships for Accelerated Innovation and Research (PAIR)** programme designed to elevate research capabilities in **higher education institutions (HEIs)** by linking top-tier research institutions with those where research capability is limited, creating a collaborative mentorship environment.
- The Union Cabinet has extended the benefits of the **Ayushman Bharat PM Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) to all senior citizens aged 70 and above**, irrespective of their income. Announced by Union Minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw**, the scheme will provide free treatment up to Rs 5 lakh per year, benefiting around **6 crore individuals and 4.5 crore families**.
- The **Union Minister Shri Rajeev Ranjan Singh** unveiled a series of initiatives aimed at transforming India's fisheries sector. A key highlight was the launch of the **National Fisheries Development Program (NFDLP) portal**, which will provide digital identities to fisheries industry workers and enterprises across the value chain. This initiative is under the **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-**

Yojana (PM-MKSSY), a sub-scheme of Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY), enabling fish workers to access benefits like institutional credit, performance grants, and aquaculture insurance.

- The **Union Cabinet** of India, under the leadership of **Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi**, has approved a groundbreaking policy aimed at revolutionizing the country's biotechnology sector. The **BioE3 Policy** (Biotechnology for Economy, Environment and Employment) sets the stage for fostering high-performance biomanufacturing, positioning India at the forefront of global biotechnological innovation.
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved '**Mission Mausam**' on September 11, 2024, with an outlay of **₹2,000 crore over two years**. The mission, led by the Ministry of Earth Sciences, aims to enhance research and development in atmospheric sciences and improve weather forecasting and management.
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurated **SEMICON India 2024** at **India Expo Mart in Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh, on September 11, 2024**. The three-day conference, running from September 11 to 13, showcases India's semiconductor strategy and policy with the aim of positioning the country as a global semiconductor hub.
- The union cabinet meeting chaired by honorable prime minister Mr. Narendra Modi has approved the proposal of the **Ministry of Power for modification of the scheme of budgetary support for the cost of Enabling Infrastructure for Hydro Electric Projects (HEP)** with a total outlay of Rs.12461 crore.
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the **PM-eBus Sewa-Payment Security Mechanism (PSM)** scheme with a **budget of INR 3,435.33 crore**. This initiative is designed to promote the deployment and operation of electric buses (e-buses) by Public Transport Authorities (PTAs) from **FY 2024-25 to FY 2028-29**.
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the **PM Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement (PM E-DRIVE)** Scheme to promote electric mobility in India. The scheme, with an outlay of **Rs 10,900 crore over two years**, aims to expedite EV adoption, improve air quality, and reduce the environmental impact of transportation.
- On September 11, 2024, Prime Minister Narendra Modi virtually inaugurated the **2nd International Conference on Green Hydrogen**, which is being held at **Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi from September 11-13, 2024**. The conference aims to position India as a leader in the global green hydrogen ecosystem by discussing recent technological advances and fostering strategic investments and partnerships to accelerate green hydrogen adoption.

- The **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY)**, launched in 2020, is a comprehensive initiative aimed at transforming India's fisheries sector and enhancing the welfare of fishermen. This scheme, under the **Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying**, addresses critical issues in fish production, productivity, quality, technology, and infrastructure while strengthening the fisheries value chain.
- The **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**, under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, is set to launch a groundbreaking digital platform named **Bharat Startup Knowledge Access Registry (BHASKAR)** under the Startup India program. This initiative aims to strengthen India's startup ecosystem by centralizing and streamlining collaboration between key stakeholders like startups, investors, mentors, service providers, and government bodies.
- In 1994, the United Nations General Assembly proclaimed **September 16** as the **International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer**, commemorating the signing date of the Montreal Protocol in 1987.
- Every year on **September 15**, people across the globe unite to commemorate the **International Day of Democracy**. Established by the **United Nations General Assembly** in 2007, this day serves as a powerful reminder of the importance of democratic principles and practices in our societies.
- The **NPS Vatsalya Scheme**, announced in the Union Budget 2024-25, will be launched by **Finance Minister Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman** on September 18, 2024, in **New Delhi**. This initiative allows parents to invest in pension accounts for their children with flexible contributions starting at Rs. 1,000 annually, offering long-term wealth building through compounding.
- **Honorable Prime Minister of India Shri. Narendra Modi** launched the scheme of "**Subhadra**", **flagship initiative of the State Government of Odisha** designed to benefit the **one crore women** in the state.
- About 7 crore people have subscribed to the **Atal Pension Yojana (APY)**, accumulating a corpus of **Rs 35,149 crore**, as announced by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman. The **APY, launched in 2015**, is a low-cost pension scheme providing a guaranteed minimum pension ranging from Rs 1,000 to Rs 5,000 per month, depending on the contributions made by subscribers. In case of the subscriber's death, the pension is extended to the spouse for life, and upon the demise of both, the nominee receives the entire corpus.
- The **Union Cabinet, chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi**, has accepted the recommendations of the **High-Level Committee on Simultaneous Elections (One Nation One Election – ONOE)** under the chairmanship of former President Shri Ram Nath Kovind.

- The **Union Cabinet** has approved several key proposals with a total outlay **exceeding ₹60,000 crore**, covering areas from agriculture to space exploration. The much-anticipated 'One Nation, One Poll' policy, enabling simultaneous elections across India, also received approval. Additionally, the **PM-AASHA scheme** was revamped with a **₹35,000 crore budget** to ensure Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for farmers. The Cabinet also sanctioned a ₹24,474.53 crore subsidy on phosphatic and potassic (P&K) fertilizers for the 2024-25 rabi season.
- The Union Cabinet has approved the **Biotechnology Research Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development (Bio-RIDE)** scheme to boost biotechnology research, innovation, and entrepreneurship with an outlay of **₹9,197 crore for the 15th Finance Commission period (2021-22 to 2025-26)**.
- In 2014 Honorable Prime Minister of India launched the **Swachh Bharat Abhiyan**, it has a transformative impact in our society. This year it will mark its **10th anniversary** and this year **Swachhata hi Seva 2024** campaign embraces the theme of 'Swabhav Swachhata – Sanskaar Swachhata'.
- **Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman** officially launched the **NPS Vatsalya scheme** in line with the announcement made in the Union Budget 2024.
- The Union Cabinet has approved the **Pradhan Mantri Janatiya Unnat Gram Abhiyan (PM-JUGA)**, a comprehensive mission aimed at improving the socio-economic conditions of tribal communities in India. This ambitious initiative comes with a total outlay of **Rs. 79,156 crore** to be implemented over a period of **five years**.
- The **Ayushman Bharat PM-Jay Jan Arogya Yojana (ABPMJ)** scheme introduced by Prime Minister Narendra marked his 6th year anniversary.
- **Chief Minister Dr. Manik Saha** officially launched the **CM-SATH scheme** to boost the educational prospects of the state's brightest students. The scheme, **designed to provide financial support to meritorious students for their higher education**, reflects the **state government's commitment to quality education**.
- India has been elected to the **15-member Globe Steering Committee**, which focuses on combating corruption and asset recovery. This decision was made during a **plenary session in Beijing on September 26, 2024**, following a multistage voting process. As a member of the Steering Committee, India is poised to play a pivotal role in shaping the global anti-corruption agenda, leveraging its experience and expertise in the field.
- The Department of Science and technology (DST) in India with the collaboration with the British Council launches the initiative of **"A Women in Space Leadership" (WiSLP)** as a part of the UK-India Education and Research Initiative (UKIERI).

- On the occasion of **World Tourism Day**, the Ministry of Tourism launched **"Paryatan Mitra" and "Paryatan Didi,"** a responsible tourism initiative aimed at improving tourist experiences across India. The initiative focuses on empowering local communities, especially women and youth, to serve as ambassadors and storytellers of their destinations, enhancing hospitality, cleanliness, and sustainability.

Schemes and Committees of October 2024

- In the **first 100 days** of the new government, significant strides have been made in enhancing the ease of living for citizens and providing a dignified way of life. **Union Minister Shri Manohar Lal** addressed the press, highlighting the government's commitment to fulfilling basic necessities, particularly housing and water management.
- Marking the completion of a **decade of the Swachh Bharat Mission**, Prime Minister Narendra Modi will participate in the **Swachh Bharat Diwas 2024 on 2nd October, Gandhi Jayanti**, at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.
- **Union Minister for Ports, Shipping, and Waterways, Shri Sarbananda Sonowal**, launched the **'Cruise Bharat Mission'** from Mumbai port on October 1, 2024. The mission aims to enhance India's potential as a global hub for cruise tourism, targeting a doubling of cruise passenger traffic by 2029. It focuses on three key cruise segments: ocean and harbor, river, inland, and island. This initiative is expected to significantly revamp the cruise sector in India and promote the country as a leading global cruise destination.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** launched **₹83,700 crore developmental projects** in Jharkhand on Gandhi Jayanti, including the **Dharti Aaba Janatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan**, with **₹79,150 crore** aimed at the **holistic development** of over **5 crore tribals** across **63,000 villages** in **549 districts**. The scheme addresses **social infrastructure, health, education, and livelihood gaps** through **25 interventions** by **17 ministries**. PM also launched the **PM Janati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan (PM-JANMAN)** worth ₹1,360 crore, focusing on road construction, anganwadi centers, multi-purpose centers, and hostels. PM-JANMAN, with a ₹24,000 crore budget, focuses on PVTGs, providing housing, clean water, sanitation, electricity, and connectivity. Additional initiatives include electrification of 75,800 PVTG households, 275 mobile medical units, 500 anganwadi centers, and piped water to 5,550 PVTG villages. PM also inaugurated 40 Eklaya Model Residential Schools (EMRS) and laid the foundation for 25 more, worth ₹2,800 crore, for tribal students' education and development.

- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi launched the **Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan (DAJGUA)**, on the occasion of the birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi, from Hazaribagh, Jharkhand. The scheme has a total outlay of Rs.79,156 crores with the contribution from Central government is Rs.56,333 crore and State government is Rs. 22,823 crore. Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan envisions saturation of critical gaps in social infrastructure, health, education, livelihood, through 25 interventions implemented by 17-line ministries of Govt of India by convergence and outreach; and ensures holistic and sustainable development of tribal areas and communities.
- The Union Cabinet has recently approved the Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare's proposal to consolidate various **Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS)** into two main **umbrella schemes**: the **Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (PM-RKVY)** and the **Krishonnati Yojana (KY)**. This strategic move aims to promote sustainable agriculture through PM-RKVY and enhance food security and agricultural self-sufficiency via KY. With a total proposed expenditure of **₹1,01,321.61 crore**, these schemes will be executed by State Governments, ensuring continuity and effective implementation of existing initiatives.
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has **approved the National Mission on Edible Oils – Oilseeds (NMEO-Oilseeds)**, a landmark initiative aimed at boosting domestic oilseed production and **achieving self-reliance (Atmanirbhar Bharat) in edible oils. To increase primary oilseed production from 39 million tonnes (2022-23) to 69.7 million tonnes by 2030-31. To make India self-reliant in oilseed production in the next 7 years.**
- The **PM GatiShakti National Master Plan**, launched on **October 13, 2021**, by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, marks three years of transformative achievements in India's infrastructure landscape. The initiative has significantly improved project execution by integrating data from over **44 central ministries and 36 states and union territories**, leading to reduced logistics costs and enhanced service delivery. As of now, over **200 major infrastructure** projects have been assessed, focusing on multimodal connectivity and efficient resource allocation.
- In a significant move, the **Hemant Soren cabinet in Jharkhand** has increased the monthly honorarium for women under the **Maiyaan Samman Yojana** from **₹1,000 to ₹2,500**. This decision is seen as a response to the **BJP's Gogo Didi Yojana**, which promises **₹2,100 per month** to women as outlined in their election manifesto.
- **Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath** unveiled a series of **welfare schemes for police personnel**, including a substantial 70% increase in uniform allowance and a 25% hike in housing allowance for constables residing in barracks.
- **Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma** officially launched Mission Basundhara 3.0 at an event held at Srimanta Sankardev Kalakshetra in Guwahati. This ambitious initiative is designed to **empower indigenous communities** by providing them with formal land rights, ensuring greater security and recognition of their holdings.
- Union Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya launched the upgraded **'e-Shram: One Stop Solution'** portal, aimed at enhancing access to social security schemes for over 300 million unorganised workers in India. The initiative consolidates data from various central ministries into a single repository, simplifying the registration process and ensuring that potential beneficiaries are identified state and district-wise.
- The government has doubled the limit of Mudra loans under the **Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY)** from **Rs 10 lakh to Rs 20 lakh**, introducing a new **'Tarun Plus' category**. This change, announced by **Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman** in her **July 2024 Budget speech**, aims to promote entrepreneurship and support emerging business owners.

Schemes and Committees of November 2024

- On November 1, **Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu** launched the **Deepam 2.0** scheme in Edupuram, Srikakulam district, aimed at empowering women by providing free gas cylinders.
- **South Africa has launched the Trusted Tour Operator Scheme (TTOS)** to attract more visitors from India and China. The initiative aims to streamline the visa application process, making it quicker and easier for tourists from these countries, especially addressing the low number of Chinese visitors to South Africa compared to other destinations like Australia.
- **Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman** inaugurated five **"Nari Shakti"** branches of Union Bank of India in Bengaluru, Chennai, Visakhapatnam, and Jaipur. These branches are designed to promote financial inclusion and support women entrepreneurs, particularly in manufacturing and services. The initiative focuses on empowering women with accessible finance, skills training, and advisory services, aligning with India's goal of gender-focused economic growth.
- The **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** and the **Biotechnology Research and Innovation Council (BRIC)** launched the **'One Day One Genome'** initiative to map India's **microbial wealth**. Announced by **Amitabh Kant**, India's G-20 Sherpa, on **November 9, 2024**, during BRIC's 1st foundation day at the **National Institute of Immunology (NII)**, the initiative aims to highlight the role of unique **bacterial species** in **India's environment, agriculture, and human health**.
- The **Ministry of Rural Development** marked the **8th anniversary** of the **Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana** –

Gramin (PMAY-G) on Awaas Diwas 2024, celebrating its contribution to “Housing for All”. Launched in 2016, PMAY-G aims to provide **pucca houses** with essential amenities to houseless and families in **dilapidated homes**. The scheme's target has been revised to build **2 crore additional houses** by 2029, with a total outlay of **₹3,06,137 crore**, including **₹54,500 crore** for FY 2024-25. The initiative also focuses on improving **rural infrastructure** through **convergence** with other schemes like **MGNREGA** and the **Jal Jeevan Mission**.

- The **Delhi government** expanded its **old-age pension scheme** to include 80,000 more senior citizens, raising the total beneficiaries to **5.3 lakh**. **Arvind Kejriwal** launched an **online portal** to streamline applications. Seniors aged 60-69 will receive **Rs 2,000** monthly, and those 70+ will get **Rs 2,500**. The scheme also introduces a **Rs 5,000** pension for **differently-abled** individuals. Eligibility includes being a **Delhi resident**, **60+ years old**, with an **annual family income** under **Rs 1 lakh**, and no other government pension.
- On **December 9**, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** will launch the '**Bima Sakhi Yojana**' in **Panipat, Haryana**, to empower women by creating job opportunities in the **insurance sector**. Under this scheme, women will work as **LIC agents**, selling insurance and earning income. This initiative aims to promote **women's empowerment**, **economic independence**, and **financial literacy** across India.
- The government has issued **14 lakh Ayushman Vay Vandana cards** to senior citizens aged 70 and above under the **Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY)**, as of November 25, 2024. This initiative aims to provide comprehensive healthcare coverage to vulnerable populations, benefiting approximately 6 crore individuals from 4.5 crore families.

Schemes and Committees of December 2024

- **Kirti Vardhan Singh**, Union Minister of State for **Environment, Forest, and Climate Change**, inaugurated a 15-day trial of **Nano Bubble Technology** at the **National Zoological Park, Delhi**. The trial aims to improve **water quality** in zoo ponds by removing **algae**, **foul odors**, and **discoloration** caused by pollution, benefiting **aquatic animals**. Successful implementation could lead to broader use for cleaner, healthier water.
- The **Mahila Samman Savings Certificate (MSSC)** scheme, launched on **March 31, 2023**, has reached a milestone of over **43 lakh accounts** by **October 31, 2024**. Aimed at empowering **women** and **minor girls**, the scheme offers a **7.5% annual interest rate**, compounded quarterly, with a **two-year tenure**. It allows **partial withdrawals** (up to 40%) and **premature closure** on compassionate grounds. To open an account, women or guardians can visit **Post Offices** or designated banks, with deposit limits ranging from **₹1,000** to **₹2 lakh**.

- **SheSTEM 2024**, organized by **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)** and the **Swedish Embassy** in partnership with **Innovation Norway**, **Innovation Centre Denmark**, and **Business Finland**, celebrated the contributions of **women in STEM**. The initiative invited **Indian students** from grades 6–12 to present innovative ideas on **Battery Technology and Energy Storage (BEST)**. Over 1,000 submissions were received, showcasing **youth creativity** and future leadership in **science**, **technology**, and **sustainability**. The event is part of the **India-Nordic BEST project** aimed at advancing energy storage solutions.
- The **Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSGMBY)**, launched in **February 2024**, is transforming India's **solar energy** sector. In just 9 months, it has achieved **6.3 lakh installations**, with a goal of **10 lakh** by March 2025 and **1 crore** by March 2027. This makes it the world's largest **domestic rooftop solar scheme**.
- The **Pradhan Mantri Gramin Digital Saksharta Abhiyan (PMGDISHA)** has trained **6.39 crore** individuals, surpassing its target of 6 crore rural households by March 31, 2024. Launched under the **Digital India Programme**, it aims to empower rural households with essential **digital skills**. The scheme has enrolled **7.35 crore** individuals, with **4.78 crore** certified, helping beneficiaries access **cashless transactions**, **online government services**, and improve livelihoods.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched **LIC's Bima Sakhi Yojana** in Panipat, Haryana, to empower women by integrating them into the **insurance sector**. The scheme targets women aged 18-70 with at least 10th-grade education, aiming to train 100,000 women in the first year. Participants can earn **₹15,000 monthly** as **LIC agents** and receive financial assistance over three years. The initiative promotes **women-led participation** and aligns with the vision of a **Viksit Bharat**.
- The **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)** has launched a scheme extending the **Smart City Mission**, with **Rs 8,000 crore** allocated as a performance-based challenge fund to incubate **8 new cities**. This initiative aims to address **urbanization pressures** and allow each state to develop one new city using the allocated funds.
- Delhi CM **Arvind Kejriwal** launched the **Mukhya Mantri Mahila Samman Yojana**, aiming to empower women financially by increasing monthly assistance from **₹1,000** to **₹2,100** post-elections. The scheme targets women aged 18+, not in government jobs or paying taxes. Registration starts on **December 13, 2024**. The initiative, similar to successful schemes in **Madhya Pradesh** and **Maharashtra**, focuses on financial aid for non-taxpayers and those without government pensions.
- India is advancing its electric vehicle (EV) ecosystem with the launch of the **PM Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement (PM E-DRIVE)** scheme,

backed by ₹10,900 crore over two years (2024-2026). This initiative aims to boost **electric mobility** and reduce fossil fuel dependence. Additionally, the third phase of the **FAME** scheme (FAME-III) will roll out soon, with the goal of making India a global leader in **electric mobility** and supporting the vision of a 'Viksit Bharat'.

- **Northern Coalfields Limited (NCL)**, under the Ministry of Coal, launched the **CHARAK** project to provide **free treatment** for economically weaker sections in **Singrauli** and **Sonbhadra** districts. The initiative targets families with incomes below **Rs. 8 lakh**, covering diseases like **malignancy, TB, HIV, cardiovascular diseases**, and more. Treatment will be provided at **NCL's hospital** or empanelled hospitals nationwide, aligning with NCL's commitment to improving the region's **socio-economic condition**.
- **Mamata Banerjee**, the **West Bengal Chief Minister**, launched the "**Banglar Bari**" housing scheme to provide **affordable housing** to the rural population of the state. The scheme is a response to alleged negligence by the **BJP-led Central government** regarding the **Prime Minister Awas Yojana (PMAY)**. At the launch, held at the **Nabanna Secretariat**, **Rs 60,000** was distributed to **42 beneficiaries** from **21 districts**. A survey identified over **28 lakh beneficiaries**, with an additional **16 lakh** expected to receive housing assistance before the **2026 Assembly elections**.
- **Arvind Kejriwal**, AAP leader, launched the **Dr Ambedkar Samman Scholarship** to fund **Dalit students** from **Delhi** for higher education in top **foreign universities**. Announced before the **Delhi Assembly elections**, the scheme honors **Babasaheb Ambedkar** and counters the **BJP's** alleged disrespect toward him. The **Delhi government** will cover all costs for education, travel, and accommodation for students admitted to premier global institutions.

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** laid the foundation for the **Ken-Betwa river-linking project**, aimed at addressing **water scarcity** in **Bundelkhand**. The project will channel water from the **Ken River** to the **Betwa**, benefiting **4.4 million people** in **Madhya Pradesh** and **2.1 million** in **Uttar Pradesh**. With an estimated cost of **₹44,605 crore**, it will provide **drinking water**, boost **agricultural irrigation**, and generate **hydropower** and **solar energy**, promoting overall regional development.
- The **Aam Aadmi Party (AAP)**, led by **Arvind Kejriwal**, has launched the **Dr. Ambedkar Samman Yojana** to support **Dalit students** pursuing **higher education abroad**. The scheme covers all educational expenses, including **tuition, travel costs**, and other essential fees. It aims to empower **Dalit students** by eliminating financial barriers, aligning with **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's** vision of educational equality for marginalized communities.
- On **Good Governance Day**, **Dr. Jitendra Singh** launched the '**Viksit Panchayat Karmayogi**' initiative to empower **Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs)** and decentralize governance. Part of the '**Prashasan Gaon Ki Aur**' campaign, it aims to improve grassroots governance by providing **modern tools** and **knowledge** for effective decision-making. The initiative uses **technology-driven solutions** like **e-learning platforms, AI-powered chatbots**, and **mobile apps** to enhance **public service delivery** and foster **sustainable development** in rural India.
- **Nvidia** has launched the **Jetson Orin Nano Super Generative AI supercomputer** at an affordable price of **\$249**, a significant drop from its predecessor's **\$499**. This model offers a **1.7x improvement** in **generative AI inference performance** and a **70% increase** in overall performance, reaching **67 INT8 TOPS**. Additionally, its **memory bandwidth** is boosted by **50%** to **102GB/s**, enhancing its ability to process complex AI tasks, making it ideal for **hobbyists, developers, and students**.

10

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding

January to December 2024

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of January 2024

- In a significant move towards self-reliance in defence manufacturing, the Ministry of Defence has finalized two pivotal contracts, collectively valued at Rs 802 crore. The agreements include the procurement of **697 Bogie Open Military (BOM) Wagons** and **56 Mechanical Minefield Marking Equipment (MMME) Mark II** from domestic firms.
- India and Nepal solidified their commitment to a long-term energy partnership with the signing of an agreement for the export of **10,000 MW of power to India over the next 10 years**. The bilateral agreement, signed by India's Energy Secretary Pankaj Agrawal and Nepal's Energy Secretary Gopal Sigdel, is a testament to the shared vision of sustainable energy cooperation.
- Indian Railways**, a key player in the transportation sector, has reaffirmed its commitment to environmental sustainability by renewing its Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **Confederation of Indian Industry (CII)**. The collaboration aims to reduce energy and water consumption, ultimately **lowering greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions**. This marks the third consecutive term of partnership between Indian Railways and CII.
- Researchers from the prestigious **Indian Institutes of Technology (IIT) Madras** and **Mandi** have achieved a significant milestone in the field of biotechnology. They have successfully metabolically engineered plant cells to boost the production of the anti-cancer drug camptothecin (CPT).
- In a significant move towards sustainable development, the Union Cabinet, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, has given its approval for the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) signed between **India and the United States Agency for International Development (USAID)**. The focus of this collaboration is to support Indian Railways in **achieving 'net zero carbon emission' by the ambitious target year of 2030**.
- The Union Cabinet, under the leadership of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has granted approval for the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between the **Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas, Government of India, and the Ministry of Natural Resources, Republic of Guyana**. This MoU aims to **foster collaboration in the hydrocarbon sector**, covering various aspects of the value chain.
- The Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras)**, a leading engineering institute in India, is set to expand its horizons by establishing a new campus in **Kandy, Sri Lanka**. This move is a significant development in educational collaboration between India and **Sri Lanka**.
- In a significant diplomatic move, Ukrainian President **Volodymyr Zelenskiy** and British Prime Minister **Rishi Sunak** signed an unprecedented **security agreement** between their nations in **Kyiv**. The accord, as described by Zelenskiy, holds immense importance for Ukraine's security and signifies a robust alliance with the United Kingdom. The signed security accord is poised to remain **in effect until Ukraine becomes a member of NATO**, marking a strategic commitment between the two nations. Zelenskiy emphasized the historical significance of the agreement, underlining its potential impact on Ukraine's defense capabilities.
- In a strategic partnership, the **Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras)** has joined forces with Altair, a global technology leader specializing in simulation, **high-performance computing (HPC)**, and **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**. Together, they are set to inaugurate the cutting-edge eMobility Simulation Lab within the Department of Engineering Design at IIT Madras.
- In a historic breakthrough, Switzerland and India have finally sealed a **free-trade agreement (FTA)** following a marathon 16-year negotiation period. The announcement came from Swiss Economy Minister Guy Parmelin, who, after attending the World Economic Forum in Davos, swiftly headed to India for crucial discussions with his counterpart, Piyush Goyal.
- In a significant development for global health preparedness, the **Serum Institute of India (SII)** has joined the **Coalition for Epidemic Preparedness Innovations (CEPI)** network of vaccine producers in the Global South. This collaborative effort **aims to strengthen the response to future public health disease outbreaks** through rapid, agile, and equitable means.
- With the growing activities of international pirates off the Gulf of Aden driving up the costs of freight and shipping, the Indian government has taken a significant step to ensure the safety of international shipping lanes. In a recent development, the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** signed a contract with **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd (MDL)**, Mumbai, for the acquisition of **14 Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs)** for the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)**.

- The Union Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has given the green light for the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between **India and Oman** in the field of **Information Technology (IT)**. The MoU, inked on December 15, 2023, between the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology of India and Oman's Ministry of Transport, Communications, and Information Technology, aims to foster comprehensive collaboration through mutual support, technology sharing, information exchange, and investments in IT.
- **India's ACME Group and Japan's IHI Corporation** have inked a groundbreaking deal for the supply of 0.4 million metric tons per annum (MMTPA) of green ammonia from Odisha, India, to Japan. The agreement, signed by Manoj Upadhyay, ACME Group's Founder and Chairman, and Hiroshi Ide, President and CEO of IHI Corporation, establishes a long-term partnership covering production, logistics, and supply of green ammonia for diverse industrial uses in Japan, ultimately aimed at reducing emissions.
- Amidst the grandeur of India's Republic Day celebrations, a significant milestone was quietly achieved as **French Defence Minister Sebastien Locornu** and India's National Security Advisor Ajit Doval sealed the **Defence Space Agreement** on January 26. The low-key signing belied the transformative potential of this pact, marking a pivotal moment in Indo-French relations.
- **NITI Aayog** and the Embassy of the **Kingdom of the Netherlands** have collaborated on energy transition efforts since 2020. Their joint report, released during India Energy Week on February 6, 2024, focuses on the adoption of **LNG as a transportation fuel** in medium and heavy commercial vehicles (MHCVs) in India.
- **India and Russia** have strengthened their long-standing nuclear cooperation with the signing of a protocol amending the 2008 intergovernmental agreement. The agreement focuses on the construction of additional nuclear reactors at the **Kudankulam Nuclear Power Project** site and the development of Russia-designed nuclear power plants at new locations in India.
- In a significant development in the aerospace industry, **Brazilian aerospace giant Embraer** and **Mahindra** announced a strategic partnership aimed at fulfilling the Indian Air Force's (IAF) acquisition of the **C-390 multi-mission transport aircraft**. With the IAF seeking to replace its aging fleets of AN32 planes, this collaboration aligns with India's defense modernization efforts under the Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative.
- Aiming to significantly broaden the accessibility of football within the school setting for students, the **Ministry of Education** has embarked on a transformative initiative in partnership with the **Federation Internationale de Football Association (FIFA)**. This initiative involves the distribution of 11 lakh footballs across the country in a phased manner, benefitting more than 1.5 lakh schools.
- In a development for indigenous manufacturing and innovation, **Prama India** has forged a partnership with the Government of India's **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)**. This collaboration, facilitated through a Transfer of Technology (ToT) agreement, focuses on the production, marketing, and support of Thermal Cameras.
- Multiple memoranda of understanding (MoUs) were exchanged between **India** and the **United Arab Emirates** during a significant diplomatic event, signifying a deepening of ties and cooperation between the two nations. An MoU on interlinking the instant payment platforms – **UPI (India) and AANI (UAE)** – was among the key agreements exchanged. This move aims to facilitate seamless cross-border transactions, enhancing financial connectivity between India and the UAE.
- **India and Colombia** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on Cooperation in the field of Sharing Successful Digital Solutions Implemented at Population Scale for Digital Transformation. The agreement aims to foster **digital transformation** through the sharing of India's open-sourced Digital Public Infrastructures (DPIs), particularly focusing on India Stack Solutions.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of February 2024

- Amidst the grandeur of India's Republic Day celebrations, a significant milestone was quietly achieved as **French Defence Minister Sebastien Locornu** and India's National Security Advisor Ajit Doval sealed the **Defence Space Agreement** on January 26. The low-key signing belied the transformative potential of this pact, marking a pivotal moment in Indo-French relations.
- **India and Oman** have taken significant strides in bolstering their strategic partnership through **enhanced defence cooperation**. The recent signing of a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) underscores their commitment to deepening collaboration in various realms of defence engagement.
- **India and Saudi Arabia** recently engaged in discussions aimed at bolstering their bilateral defence and strategic cooperation. These talks, held between Minister of State for Defence **Ajay Bhatt** and Saudi Arabia's Defence Minister **Prince Khalid bin Salman bin Abdulaziz Al-Saud** in Riyadh, highlighted several key areas of collaboration.

- An innovative endeavor is underway to improve fishermen's direct market reach in India's fisheries industry through digital commerce. Scheduled for February 19th, 2024, at Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi, an important Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) will be inked between the **Department of Fisheries (GoI)** and **Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)**.
- **Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Ltd. (IREDA)** and **Punjab National Bank (PNB)** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to advance renewable energy initiatives across the nation. Signed at IREDA's registered office in New Delhi on February 19, 2024, the agreement paves the way for **joint efforts in co-lending and loan syndication** for a spectrum of renewable energy projects.
- The Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (**IEPFA**), operating under the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, has partnered with **DBS Bank** to bolster awareness regarding **investment safety and fraudulent schemes**. The Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between these entities aims to utilize DBS Bank's digital platforms to disseminate crucial messages to investors across India.
- The **Cochin International Airport Ltd (CIAL)**, renowned as the **world's first airport fully powered by solar energy**, has embarked on a groundbreaking collaboration with **Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL)** to establish a Green Hydrogen plant within its premises.
- The Government of Goa has unveiled plans for a pioneering **Blended Finance facility** in collaboration with the World Bank. This initiative marks a significant step towards climate-focused financing at a subnational level, aiming to bolster Goa's resilience to the challenges posed by climate change.
- **Greek Prime Minister Kyriakos Mitsotakis** engaged in extensive discussions with Prime Minister Narendra Modi to bolster cooperation between the two nations. The visit marks the first by a Greek head of state to India in 15 years. The talks primarily focused on expanding strategic collaboration in various sectors, including trade, defense, and counter-terrorism efforts, with an emphasis on doubling bilateral trade by 2030.
- The **Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC)** has partnered with **Swiggy**, a leading food delivery platform in India, to facilitate the **delivery of pre-ordered meals** booked by passengers through IRCTC's e-catering portal. This collaboration aims to enhance convenience and choice for railway travelers.
- Renewable power solutions provider **CleanMax** and **Bangalore International Airport Limited (BIAL)** have signed a **25-year long-term power purchase agreement** aimed at fostering sustainable energy practices. The agreement entails the generation and supply of renewable energy sourced from a Solar-wind Captive Power Project, marking a pivotal step towards green energy adoption in the region.

- In a collaborative effort between the **US Consulate and the Mahratta Chamber of Commerce**, Industries and Agriculture (MCCIA), the first-ever **US-India Cyber Security Initiative** has been launched.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of March 2024

- In a recent development, **India and Nepal** have bolstered their financial cooperation, with a focus on digital payments. This initiative aims to streamline cross-border transactions and enhance convenience for citizens of both nations.
- Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) under NITI Aayog and Meta have joined forces to establish **Frontier Technology Labs (FTLs)** in strategically important schools. This collaboration aims to democratize access to future technologies and foster innovation among students.
- **India** aims to enhance its strategic partnership with **South Korea** by expanding cooperation into new and critical areas, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar announced during the **10th India-South Korea Joint Commission Meeting in Seoul**. Co-chairing the meeting with his South Korean counterpart, Cho Tae-yul, Jaishankar highlighted the comprehensive and productive discussions held on various aspects, including defence, science and technology, trade, and people-to-people exchanges.
- National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has forged a strategic partnership with the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bangalore, to conduct joint research on Blockchain and Artificial Intelligence (AI) technology. This collaboration aims to establish the **"NPCI-IISc Centre of Excellence (CoE) for Deep Tech Research & Development"** to drive innovation in the fintech sector.
- **Airbus**, a prominent name in the aviation industry, has announced a significant partnership with the esteemed **Indian Institute of Management Mumbai (IIM Mumbai)** to deliver high-quality aviation training to professionals. This collaboration marks a crucial step towards enhancing industry-ready skills among aspiring and working individuals in the aviation sector.
- **Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Sports**, has introduced significant reforms in the recruitment, promotion, and incentive mechanisms for athletes. This initiative underscores the government's commitment to nurturing sporting talent and turning sports into a lucrative career option.
- India and the European Free Trade Association (EFTA) comprising **Switzerland, Iceland, Norway, and Liechtenstein** have signed a **Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA)**. This modern and ambitious agreement marks India's first Free Trade Agreement (FTA) with four developed nations in Europe, offering significant economic opportunities and promoting free trade and economic integration.

- NTPC and its renewable energy arm NGEL signed non-binding MoUs with **Rajasthan Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Limited (RVUNL)** in Jaipur. These agreements represent a significant stride towards improving the efficiency and cost-effectiveness of the **Chhabra Thermal Power Plant**. The focus lies on exploring avenues for integrating supercritical units into the current infrastructure to modernize and enhance power generation.
- The **Universal Service Obligation Fund (USOF)** under the Department of Telecommunications (**DoT**) has entered a tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (**MoU**) with **Prasar Bharati**, under the Ministry of Information & Broadcasting, and the **Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)**, a Digital Public Infrastructure (**DPI**) initiative of the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, Ministry of Commerce & Industry.
- On March 12, 2024, a significant milestone in the diplomatic and economic relations between **India** and the **Dominican Republic** was achieved as the Protocol for the establishment of the **Joint Economic and Trade Committee (JETCO)** was signed at the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Dominican Republic in Santo Domingo.
- Grain commerce platform **Arya.ag** has collaborated with **Shivalik Small Finance Bank** to extend financial assistance to farmers, agro-processors, and micro-enterprises. This partnership aims to facilitate over **₹200 crore** in warehouse receipt financing in the current fiscal year, enhancing financial inclusion in the agricultural ecosystem.
- **India and Singapore** have solidified their cooperation in the realm of **law and dispute resolution** through a Memorandum of Understanding (**MOU**) signed by Singapore's Minister for Culture, Community and Youth, and Second Minister for Law **Mr. Edwin Tong SC** and India's Minister for Law and Justice **Mr. Arjun Ram Meghwal**. This agreement aims to bolster collaboration in areas such as international commercial dispute resolution.
- The **Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPWD)** is collaborating with the **Council of Architecture (COA)** to enhance inclusivity and accessibility for **Persons with Disabilities (PwDs)** in public spaces and buildings. This partnership signifies a significant advancement in architectural practices and aims to raise awareness about designing environments that accommodate the needs of PwDs.
- In a significant step towards promoting innovation and advancing the automotive and electric vehicle (**EV**) sector, the **Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI)** and the **Indian Institute of Technology, Roorkee (IIT Roorkee)** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (**MoU**).
- The **Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)** and **Europol** have entered into a significant **Working Arrangement**

aimed at combating crime and fostering cooperation between the two agencies. This collaborative effort underscores the necessity of global partnerships in addressing modern-day challenges posed by transnational crime networks.

- **Tech Mahindra** and **IBM** have joined forces to inaugurate a **Synergy Lounge** in **Singapore**, aimed at accelerating digital adoption for enterprises across the **Asia-Pacific region**. This collaboration seeks to leverage next-gen technologies to drive innovation and offer unique solutions to various industries.
- State-owned power giant **NTPC** has finalized an agreement with the **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)** to obtain foreign currency loans totaling **USD 200 million (JPY 30 billion or approximately Rs 1,650 crore)**. This financing arrangement signifies a significant step in NTPC's endeavor to augment its renewable energy initiatives.
- The **Indian Parliamentary Delegation**, led by **Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha Harivansh Narayan Singh**, held a bilateral meeting with their **Armenian counterparts** on the sidelines of the **Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU)** event in **Geneva, Switzerland**.
- The **SatCom Industry Association of India (SIA-India)** and **ABRASAT, the Brazilian Satellite Communications Association**, have joined forces to propel advancements in the space sector. This strategic partnership aims to foster collaboration and drive innovative ventures and technological cooperation between India and Brazil.
- In a significant move poised to reshape **India's Aerospace, New Space, and Defence (ASD) industry**, the **Indian Institute of Management Mumbai (IIM Mumbai)** partners with **Starburst**, a prominent **European Aerospace, New Space, and Defence (ASD) accelerator**. This collaboration aims to bolster the ASD startup ecosystem in India, leveraging the resources and expertise of both entities.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of April 2024

- The Indian and Nepalese governments, along with scholars from both countries, have collaborated to advance **Sanskrit research and education**. This partnership aims to strengthen bilateral relations and preserve the cultural heritage shared by **India and Nepal**.
- **Indian Oil Corporation Ltd. (IOCL)** has collaborated with **Panasonic Energy** to establish a joint venture aimed at producing lithium-ion cells in India. This strategic partnership comes in response to the anticipated surge in demand for electric vehicles (**EVs**) and energy storage solutions within the country.
- **SJVN, formerly Satluj Jal Vidyut Nigam**, has forged a strategic partnership with the **Indian Institute of Technology Patna (IIT Patna)** aimed at revolutionizing tunneling project performance through the integration of advanced geological models.

- The **United States and Britain** have joined forces to bolster the safety measures surrounding **artificial intelligence (AI)** amidst concerns over upcoming advanced AI iterations. This collaboration, formalized through a memorandum of understanding, aims to collectively develop advanced AI model testing procedures, aligning with commitments made during the AI Safety Summit held at Bletchley Park.
- The **European Union (EU)** and India have embarked on a collaborative effort to nurture startups in the field of **Electric Vehicle (EV)** battery recycling. This initiative is a direct outcome of the India-EU **Trade and Technology Council (TTC)** announced in April 2022, aimed at enhancing cooperation in clean and green technologies.
- In the wake of the recent **terrorist attack in Moscow**, believed to be perpetrated by extremists from Central Asia potentially influenced by Pakistani seminaries, **India and Kazakhstan** convened in Astana to bolster their collaboration against terrorism.
- In a significant move toward bolstering India's mineral security, **Khanij Bidesh India Limited (KABIL)** and the **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research – Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology (CSIR-IMMT)** have entered into a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for Technical & Knowledge cooperation**. The agreement aims to leverage CSIR-IMMT's technical prowess in various domains crucial for mineral processing and metal extraction.
- The Indian Embassy in Kuwait announced the launch of the **first-ever Hindi radio broadcast in Kuwait**, a significant step to deepen ties between the two nations. Initiated by Kuwait's Ministry of Information, the program will air every Sunday on FM 93.3 and AM 96.3, highlighting the bond between India and Kuwait.
- **Rashtriya Raksha University (RRU)** in Gandhinagar, India, and Starburst Aerospace of France have signed a significant **memorandum of understanding (MoU)** aimed at advancing innovation in aerospace, defence, and homeland security. This collaboration, aligned with the India-France Strategic Partnership, includes the creation of a 100 million euros venture capital fund and export promotion support for Indian startups.
- In a bid to empower tribal and underprivileged youth across India, the **International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON)** and the **National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)** have joined forces. The partnership aims to provide vocational training to marginalized communities, initially focusing on Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Gujarat, and Madhya Pradesh.
- **Air India** has entered into a **codeshare partnership** with **All Nippon Airways (ANA)**, Japan's largest airline. This agreement, effective from **May 23, 2024**, will allow passengers of both airlines to **combine flights** between India and Japan using a single ticket.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of May 2024

- **India's Bharat 6G Alliance** is set to sign a cooperation agreement with Europe's Industry Alliance 6G, following a similar agreement with the US. This partnership aims to foster collaboration in **developing 6G technology**.
- In a groundbreaking move, **NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)** has joined hands with the **Bank of Namibia (BoN)** to introduce a real-time payment system akin to India's Unified Payment Interface (UPI) in Namibia. This partnership marks NPCI's first collaboration with a central bank for deploying the UPI stack in an international market, aiming to revolutionize digital payments in Namibia.
- In a significant development, **Girish Chandra Murmu, the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG)**, has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Toyam Raya, Auditor General of Nepal**. This agreement aims to strengthen collaboration and facilitate the exchange of expertise in auditing practices between the **Supreme Audit Institutions (SAIs)** of both countries.
- **India and Nigeria** have agreed to finalize the **Local Currency Settlement System Agreement** to enhance bilateral trade. The agreement, to be settled in Indian rupees and Nigerian naira, was discussed during the **2nd session of the India-Nigeria Joint Trade Committee in Abuja**.
- Infibeam Avenues' **CCAvenue, a leading payments platform**, has entered into a strategic partnership with **Shivalik Small Finance Bank (SFB)** to enhance merchant access. Through this collaboration, merchants registered with CCAvenue will gain access to Shivalik SFB's extensive customer base.
- The **Kohima Peace Memorial and Eco Park** in Nagaland hold profound significance, celebrating the collaborative effort between the **Government of Japan**, the **Japanese International Cooperation Agency**, and the **Government of Nagaland**. The inauguration of these projects represents not only historical importance but also serves as a symbol of **peace, reconciliation, and educational value**.
- The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) and **Hindalco Industries**, a leading industry group, have joined forces to promote the manufacturing and supply of **indigenous marine-grade aluminium** for the construction of ships. The collaboration, formalized through a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)**, aims to enhance India's self-reliance in the shipbuilding sector.
- In a significant move to bolster research and conservation efforts concerning sharks and rays in the **Arabian Sea**, **India and Oman** are set to embark on a joint initiative. This collaboration aims to enhance understanding, promote conservation, and facilitate capacity building in elasmobranch research, with a particular focus on the Arabian Sea region.

- **India and Iran** have inked a significant **10-year bilateral contract** aimed at enhancing the operations of the **Chabahar Port**. This move underscores India's strategic interests in bolstering trade links with Central Asia and parts of Europe, leveraging the port's strategic location on Iran's southwestern coast.
- In a significant step towards empowering women in emerging technology sectors, the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd to conduct **two Pilot Projects under the Drone Didi Yojana**.
- India and the UK have reaffirmed their commitment to concluding a mutually beneficial **Free Trade Agreement (FTA)** during the annual UK-India Strategic Dialogue in London. This marks a significant step as the two nations have already conducted 13 rounds of talks, with the **14th round commencing in January 2024**. The discussions also reviewed progress on the 2030 Roadmap, established in 2021 to enhance cooperation in various sectors.
- The **Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying (DAHD)** under the Union Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)** India to digitalize vaccine cold chain management, enhance communication planning, and build capacity.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of June 2024

- In a significant partnership, Finnish telecom giant **Nokia** and **Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya (GSV)** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to jointly explore advancements in **5G and 6G communications**, specifically targeting transportation and logistics sectors. The agreement, signed in the presence of **Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw, Chancellor of GSV**, aims to leverage Nokia's expertise in telecommunications to enhance various aspects of transportation and logistics.
- The **Department of School Education** signed an Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **National Book Trust** to create an institutional framework for the **Digital Library Platform, Rashtriya e-Pustakalaya**.
- In a significant step towards enhancing investment cooperation between India and Qatar, the inaugural meeting of the **Joint Task Force on Investment (JTFI)** took place in New Delhi. Co-chaired by **Ajay Seth, Secretary of India's Department of Economic Affairs**, and **Mohamed bin Hassen Al-Malki, Undersecretary of Qatar's Ministry of Commerce and Industry**, the meeting aimed to fortify bilateral relations and explore avenues for accelerated growth and collaboration across sectors like infrastructure, energy, technology, and innovation.

- In a significant move aimed at addressing the mental health needs of armed forces personnel and their families, the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** and the Ministry of Defence (MoD) have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU). This collaboration establishes a dedicated **Tele MANAS cell**, the digital extension of the District Mental Health Programme (DMHP), to provide comprehensive, integrated, and inclusive 24/7 tele-mental health services.
- **IIT Kanpur**, in collaboration with the **Centre of Excellence for UAVs and DFI**, has unveiled **UDAAN**, a pioneering drone startup acceleration initiative. **UDAAN aims to empower emerging drone ventures by offering them access to state-of-the-art facilities, expert mentorship, financial support, and tailored business development guidance, fostering rapid business growth.**
- India and the UAE have embarked on a groundbreaking initiative with the introduction of the **Local Currency Settlement System (LCSS)**, aimed at transforming their economic relations. This system allows transactions between the two nations to be conducted in their respective domestic currencies—**Indian Rupees and UAE Dirhams**—thus reducing reliance on intermediary currencies like the US Dollar.
- **Adani Defence and Aerospace** has announced a strategic cooperation agreement with **UAE-based EDGE Group**, aimed at integrating their defence and aerospace capabilities. This partnership will leverage their combined product portfolios to cater to global and regional defence needs, emphasizing advancements in technology and bilateral cooperation between India and the UAE.
- In a significant move to enhance public accessibility to Indian art and culture, the **Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA)** has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with **Sansad TV**. This collaboration allows Sansad TV to broadcast **IGNCA's cultural programs** and utilize its extensive archival content. The **MoU was formalized by Dr. Sachchidanand Joshi**, Member Secretary of IGNCA, and **Mr. Rajat Punhani, CEO of Sansad TV**.
- **Oracle** has teamed up with the **Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation** to enhance IT skills among the state's youth through the **Naan Mudhalvan program**. This initiative aims to provide training and certification in cutting-edge technologies like cloud computing, data science, AI, ML, and blockchain, offering employment-linked opportunities to over 200,000 students.
- The **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)** and the State Bank of India (SBI) have formalized a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to integrate **SBI's payment gateway, SBIPay, with the eMigrate portal**. This collaboration aims to bolster digital payment services for Indian migrant workers, recruiting agents, and users of the portal.

- The Central Council for Research in Yoga & Naturopathy (CCRYN), in collaboration with Svyasa, Deemed to be University, organized a Conference on **"Yoga for Space" at S-Vyasa University, Bengaluru**, in observance of International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2024 with the theme **"Yoga for Self & Society."** This conference brought together experts from various fields to enhance societal health, including astronauts, by exploring the benefits of yoga in extreme conditions and space environments.
- The Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) and Mastercard India have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to collaborate on enhancing **cyber-resilience in India's financial sector**. This partnership aims to leverage the shared expertise of both entities in cybersecurity incident response, capacity building, and advanced malware analysis.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of July 2024

- The Asian Development Bank (ADB) has entered into a **\$60 million** financing agreement with **Aadhar Housing Finance Limited (AHFL)** to provide housing loans to women in India. The initiative aims to address the shortage of financing in the **low-income and affordable housing segment**. Half of the funds will be deployed in Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, and West Bengal.
- The **Philippines and Japan** have taken a big step in their security relationship. They signed a new deal that allows their military forces to enter each other's countries more easily. This comes at a time when there are growing concerns in the Indo-Pacific region.
- The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) has initiated talks with the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) to develop an **AI Audit Tool** aimed at overseeing corporate India and detecting frauds. **ICAI President Ranjeet Kumar Agarwal** has confirmed that a proposal has been sent to **MeitY Secretary Krishnan**.
- The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) and the **M. S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF)** have signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** aimed at enhancing livelihood opportunities among rural, tribal, and farming communities in India. This collaboration aims to leverage CSIR's technological innovations and MSSRF's grassroots outreach to empower marginalized groups.
- The **India-Taiwan Mutual Recognition Agreement (MRA)** for Organic Products, effective from **July 8, 2024**, aims to enhance trade by allowing certified organic products from each country to enter the other's market. India's **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)** and Taiwan's Agriculture and Food Agency are the respective implementing agencies for this landmark agreement.

- The government and Netflix India have partnered to create opportunities for voice-over artists, especially women, to enhance their skills and find better opportunities in the media and entertainment sector. The **National Film Development Corporation (NFDC)** and Netflix India signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to launch **"The Voicebox,"** a program to train voice-over artists in **multiple languages** including English, Hindi, Marathi, Bengali, Malayalam, Tamil, Telugu, and Gujarati.
- The **Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)** announced the signing of a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru, for the establishment of the 'BIS Standardization Chair Professor' at the latter. This initiative **formalised on July 3, 2024**, marks a significant **step towards institutionalising BIS's** collaboration with leading academic and research establishments across India.
- In a significant step towards developing Indigenous technology, the **Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)**, signed an agreement with the Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee (IIT Roorkee) and Indian Institute of Technology, **Mandi (IIT Mandi)**.
- India is hosting the **World Heritage Committee Meeting** for the first time. It takes place from **21 to 31 July 2024**, at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.
- On July 26, 2024, India and the United States signed their first-ever Cultural Property Agreement (CPA) during the 46th World Heritage Committee meeting at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of August 2024

- In a significant move towards **disaster preparedness**, the **State Government and SBI General Insurance** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** for Disaster Risk Transfer Parametric Insurance Solution (DRTPS).
- **India and New Zealand** have signed a **Bilateral Customs Cooperation Arrangement** to facilitate easier trade between the two nations.
- The Ministry of External Affairs (**MEA**) and NewSpace India Limited (**NSIL**), the **commercial arm of ISRO**, have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to facilitate the launch of Nepal's Munal satellite.
- A Memorandum of Understanding (**MoU**) was signed between the **National Health Authority (NHA)** and **Maharashtra University of Health Sciences (MUHS)** in the presence of Union Health Minister, **Shri J P Nadda**, on August 13.
- Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises, **MSME** has signed a Memorandum of Understanding, **MoU** with the Small Business Administration (**SBA**) of the Government of the United States of America to promote Cooperation on Small and Medium-size Enterprises (**SMEs**).

- The **Indian Navy** has signed a significant **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **BEML Ltd.**, a leading defence and heavy engineering manufacturer, on **August 20, 2024**.
- Khadi and Village Industries Commission (**KVIC**), Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (**MSME**) signed an important **MoU** with the Department of Posts working under the Ministry of Communications at KVIC, **Rajghat New Delhi office** on August 20.
- The **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)**, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, Government of India and Public Service Department, Prime Minister's Department, **Government of Malaysia signed MoU**.
- **GAIL (India) Limited** and **US-based Petron Sciencetech Inc** signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to explore the development of a **500 Kilo Tonne per Annum (KTA) bio-ethylene** plant in India.
- In a significant development, the **Central Institute of Fisheries Education (ICAR-CIFE)** and the Vaikunth Mehta National Institute of Cooperative Management (**VAMNICOM**) signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on **August 26, 2024**.
- The **United States and Peru** have signed an agreement to enhance cooperation in the sector of critical minerals. The memorandum, **signed in Lima**. It aims to boost governance, investment, and global supply chain security for critical mineral resources.
- **India and Malaysia** have very close **political, economic and socio-cultural relations**. To further strengthen this relationship, **India and Malaysia** have signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)**.
- **National Security Adviser** to the Prime Minister of India, **Ajit Doval**, participated in the signing of the Founding Documents of the **Colombo Security Conclave**. The signing event marked a significant step in regional security collaboration among India, Maldives, Mauritius, and Sri Lanka.



Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of September 2024

- **Bisleri International Pvt. Ltd.** has partnered with the **Government of Goa to improve waste management in Mormugao, Vasco**. This collaboration was solidified during the Green Goa Summit 2024, where a Letter of Intent (LOI) was exchanged between Bisleri and the Goa State Pollution Control Board, with the presence of **Chief Minister Dr. Pramod Sawant**. The partnership aims to enhance plastic waste management under Bisleri's CSR initiative, '**Bottles for Change**,' focusing on sustainable development and environmental stewardship.
- The 2024 **Chief Science Advisers' Roundtable (CSAR)** is scheduled for September 6, 2024, at UNESCO's headquarters in Paris. This event is a collaborative effort between the Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India and **UNESCO's Natural Sciences Sector**. Originally launched during **India's G20 Presidency in 2023**, CSAR aims to enhance global science advisory mechanisms.
- **India and Singapore** have signed multiple agreements aimed at enhancing cooperation in semiconductors, healthcare, and digital economies, elevating their ties to a **comprehensive strategic partnership**. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, during his visit to Singapore, emphasized the importance of collaboration for regional peace, stability, and prosperity, while describing Singapore as an "**inspiration**" for India's development.
- In a significant move towards enhancing international cooperation in public sector auditing, the **Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG)** has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **UAE Accountability Authority**. This agreement marks a new chapter in the bilateral relations between India and the United Arab Emirates, focusing on strengthening their respective audit institutions and promoting good governance.
- **India and the UAE** have signed a significant Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for civil nuclear cooperation during **Sheikh Khalid bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan's** visit to New Delhi. The deal, involving the Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL) and the Emirates Nuclear Energy Company (ENEC), marks a historic step in bilateral relations and reflects a commitment to peaceful nuclear energy utilization.
- **India and the United Arab Emirates (UAE)** took a significant step forward in their strategic partnership by signing **five groundbreaking agreements**. These deals, covering crucial areas such as **nuclear energy, fossil fuels, and food security**, were formalized during a high-level meeting between **Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan** and Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi.

- **Abu Dhabi National Oil Company (ADNOC)** and **ExxonMobil** have announced a landmark partnership to develop the world's largest low-carbon hydrogen facility. This ambitious project, set to be located in **Baytown, Texas**, marks a significant milestone in the race to lead sustainable energy production and combat climate change.
- This week **Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, Sheikh Khaled**, on his official state visit to India. He met the **Prime Minister of India Shri. Narendra Modi** and held talks on the different points for the betterment of country development and future of both countries.
- The **National Health Authority (NHA)** and **IIT Kanpur** signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) in the presence of Union Health Secretary Shri Apurva Chandra on 11th September. The partnership aims to revolutionize Artificial Intelligence in health research with an innovative data platform.
- **India and the European Union (EU)** agreed to enhance cooperation in sustainable water management at the **6th EU-India Water Forum** held on the sidelines of the 8th India Water Week, in New Delhi.
- Rashtrapati Nilayam in collaboration with the **Ministry of Development of North-East Region** and the **Ministry of Culture** will host the **first edition of Bharatiya Kala Mahotsav** from September 29 to October 6, 2024.
- The **Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)**, under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, held a bilateral meeting with the **Bhutan Food and Drug Authority (BFDA)** during the **Global Food Regulators Summit at Bharat Mandapam**. The meeting focused on implementing the "**Agreement**" signed on March 21, 2024, during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Bhutan.
- In a significant move towards global climate action and sustainable economic growth, the **United States** and **India** have announced a groundbreaking partnership aimed at boosting clean energy manufacturing. This initiative, unveiled following a meeting between **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **US President Joe Biden** in Greenville, Delaware, marks a new chapter in the bilateral relationship between the two nations.
- The **Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)** has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **Ministry of Agriculture and Livestock (MAPA) of Brazil**. This collaboration aims to strengthen food safety measures and promote bilateral cooperation in the sector.
- The **Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA)** licence of the **International Cooperative Alliance (ICA)** was cancelled by the Union Home Ministry for alleged rule violations. The **ICA, established in 1895**, is an apex body representing cooperatives worldwide and has over 1 billion members.
- A memorandum of understanding was signed between **Rubber Research Institute of India (RRII)** and **Indian Oil Corporation Ltd (IOCL)** to enhance the research on using **Rubber Process Oils** marketed by IOCL in different tyre and non-tyre rubber products.
- **Tech Mahindra** has signed an **MoU** with the **University of Auckland (UoA)** to promote innovation in AI, machine learning (ML), and quantum computing. The collaboration will target sectors like healthcare, banking, financial services, insurance, and government, enhancing industry-academic partnerships to boost graduate employability.
- The **Union Labour Ministry** and **Amazon** have signed an **MoU to leverage the National Career Service (NCS)** portal for boosting job opportunities in India. The agreement, signed by **Union Minister Mansukh Mandaviya** and **Minister of State Shobha Karandlaje**, aims to expand job accessibility for the country's youth by providing diverse employment services through the **NCS platform**. The partnership highlights the role of advanced technologies like AI in upgrading the portal to offer a more user-friendly experience for job seekers and employers alike.
- The **Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)** has partnered with the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)** to enhance the collection and sharing of critical climate and weather data in **Latin America and the Caribbean**. This collaboration aims to support climate adaptation efforts and improve regional climate coordination.
- **Amazon India** has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the Ministry of Labour and Employment to leverage the **National Career Service (NCS) portal**, aiming to connect job seekers with career opportunities that match their skills and qualifications. This partnership will help Amazon India and its staffing agencies post job openings, source candidates from the NCS portal, and provide better access to job opportunities across India.
- **India and Uzbekistan** have signed a **Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT)** aimed at boosting investor confidence and enhancing economic cooperation between the two nations. The treaty was formalized by **Indian Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman** and **Uzbekistan's Deputy Prime Minister Khodjayev Jamshid Abdulkhakimovich in Tashkent**. This BIT assures protection for investors from both countries, providing a minimum standard of treatment and non-discrimination while facilitating dispute resolution through arbitration.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of October 2024

- **The United Kingdom and Mauritius** reached an historical agreement to cede **sovereignty of the Chagos Islands**, a strategically significant archipelago in the Indian Ocean to hand over to Mauritius. The agreement allows Mauritius to regain sovereignty while ensuring the continued operation of the U.S. military base on Diego Garcia.
- **The Department of Posts (DoP)**, with its deep reach, and Amazon, one of the world's largest e-commerce companies, together seek to **empower India's growing e-commerce sector by enhancing logistical capabilities**, supporting job creation, and contributing to economic growth, signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU).
- **Nepal, India, and Bangladesh** have recently entered into a significant **tripartite agreement** aimed at facilitating cross-border electricity trade, marking a notable step in regional energy cooperation. This agreement allows Nepal to export its surplus electricity to Bangladesh via India during the rainy season, specifically from June 15 to November 15 each year. In the initial phase, **Nepal is set to export 40 MW** of hydroelectricity, leveraging India's infrastructure for transmission. The agreed rate per unit of electricity is fixed at 6.4 cents, with Nepal expected to generate approximately **USD 9.2 million** annually from this trade.
- India has extended significant financial aid to the Maldives by signing a **\$750 million currency swap agreement** to ease the country's foreign exchange crisis. This includes a **\$400 million swap** and an additional **₹3,000 crore (\$357 million)** under the SAARC Currency Swap Framework, available until 2027. The agreement was sealed during a meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and **Maldivian President Mohamed Muizzu**, who is on a five-day visit to India. Both leaders discussed key economic and security collaborations, adopting a **"vision statement"** that reinforces their partnership.
- The Uttarakhand Madrasa Education Board (**UMEB**) has **proposed making Sanskrit a compulsory subject in 416 madrassas across the state**. This initiative aims to enhance the educational curriculum and support the academic growth of students.
- **India and Mauritania** have taken a significant step towards enhancing their bilateral relations by signing **four Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs)** during Indian President **Droupadi Murmu's visit** to the North African country. This visit, a historic moment in Indo-African diplomacy, marked the first time an Indian president set foot in **Mauritania**, as part of President Murmu's three-nation tour, which also includes **Algeria** and **Malawi**.

During the visit, **four MoUs** were signed between India and Mauritania, aiming to enhance collaboration in multiple areas. These MoUs focused on:

1. **Training of Diplomats** – Establishing a framework for capacity-building and exchange of knowledge between the foreign services of both countries.
 2. **Cultural Exchange** – Fostering mutual understanding and appreciation through cultural programs, exhibitions, and artist exchanges.
 3. **Visa Exemption** – Offering visa exemptions for diplomatic and official passport holders to facilitate smooth diplomatic engagements.
 4. **Foreign Office Consultations** – Enhancing regular consultations between the foreign offices of both nations to ensure continuous dialogue on bilateral and international issues.
- **India and Colombia** have signed an **Audio-Visual Co-Production Agreement** on October 15, 2024, to enhance collaboration in the film industries of both nations. This agreement, signed by **Dr. L. Murugan, India's Minister of State for Information & Broadcasting**, and **Jorge Enrique Rojas Rodriguez, Vice Minister of Foreign Affairs of Colombia**, marks a significant step in deepening cultural ties and cooperation across various sectors. The partnership aims to pool creative and technical resources, enabling filmmakers from both countries to collaborate on film projects, thereby expanding their markets and promoting goodwill.
 - India and Germany are set to sign a pact next week to facilitate the **movement of workers and recognize skills between the two countries**. Through the agreement, skilled professionals here can be easily absorbed by German industry, sources familiar with the development.
 - **India and Pakistan** have agreed to renew their pact on the **Kartarpur Sahib Corridor for an additional five years**.
 - In a significant step to bolster **entrepreneurship in India's Northeast**, the Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Shillong has partnered with the Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI). Through its **IIM Shillong Foundation for Incubation and Enterprise (IIMSFIE)**, this collaboration introduces a structured entrepreneurship training and incubation programme.
 - **The Election Commission of India** signed an agreement for electoral cooperation with **Uzbekistan's central poll body**. This agreement was formalized during Chief Election Commissioner Rajiv Kumar's visit to Tashkent, where he is serving as an international observer for the upcoming elections scheduled for October 27.
 - Indian Railways has renewed its **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with Switzerland's Federal Department of the Environment, Transport, Energy and Communications (DETEC) to deepen technical collaboration, targeting infrastructure modernization and operational efficiency.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of November 2024

- **Cairn Oil & Gas, part of Vedanta Group**, has become the first oil and gas producer in India to join the UN Environment Programme's Oil & Gas Methane Partnership (OGMP) 2.0. This commitment to reducing methane emissions marks a significant step toward enhancing environmental sustainability in the sector.
- **India and Algeria** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on defense cooperation during Gen. Anil Chauhan's visit to Algeria, strengthening bilateral defense ties.
- **IREL (India) Limited and Kazakhstan's Ust-Kamenogorsk Titanium and Magnesium Plant JSC** have signed a joint venture agreement to form IREUK Titanium Limited. The new venture will focus on producing titanium slag in Odisha, India, marking a significant Indo-Kazakh collaboration in the titanium production sector.
- **India and Russia** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to jointly manufacture the **Pantsir air defence missile-gun system**, a major step in advancing India's Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative in the defense sector. The agreement was formalized between Bharat Dynamics Ltd (BDL) and Russia's Rosoboronexport (ROE).
- **Tata Power** has formed a strategic partnership with **Druk Green Power Corporation Ltd (DGPC)** to develop at least **5,000 MW of clean energy** capacity in **Bhutan**. This collaboration focuses on harnessing Bhutan's hydropower potential to enhance **energy security** and **sustainability** in the region. The initiative supports Bhutan's vision to diversify its **energy portfolio** and improve **regional energy integration**.
- On **19th November 2024**, the **Solar Energy Corporation of India Ltd (SECI)** signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with **H2Global Stiftung** under the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**. This partnership focuses on promoting **Green Hydrogen** initiatives, facilitating **knowledge exchange** on market mechanisms, and fostering **cooperation** between India and international stakeholders.
- **Tata Power**, a leading **integrated power company** in India, has signed a **\$4.25 billion MoU** with the **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** to finance various **clean energy projects**, advancing sustainable energy initiatives.
- The **Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)** has signed an **MoU** with the **Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE)** to promote **commerce-based skill courses**, particularly in the **Banking, Financial Services, and Insurance (BFSI)** sector. The collaboration aims to equip students with **industry-aligned competencies**, enhancing **employability** and bridging the gap between **academic learning** and **professional requirements**.

- India has signed the **Riyadh Design Law Treaty (DLT)**, a landmark agreement adopted by **WIPO** member states after nearly **20 years of negotiations**. The treaty aims to **harmonize industrial design registration** procedures globally, enhancing **accessibility** and **efficiency** for applicants and promoting **equitable access to intellectual property (IP)** protection across jurisdictions.
- India and the **United Kingdom** have signed a **framework agreement to co-design and co-produce electric propulsion systems** for future warships, strengthening their **strategic defense collaboration**. This initiative aligns with the broader **India-UK partnership** and focuses on **indigenous development** of advanced naval technologies. The **Statement of Intent (Sol)** outlines the roadmap for collaboration, particularly for projects like **Landing Platform Docks** to be built in Indian shipyards.

Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) of December 2024

- On **December 4, 2024**, **India and Kuwait** established a **Joint Commission for Cooperation (JCC)**, led by their **foreign ministers**. The JCC, formalized through a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)**, will serve as a key mechanism to review and enhance **bilateral relations**. This decision came during a meeting between **External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar** and **Kuwaiti Foreign Minister Abdullah Ali Al Yahya**, marking a significant step in strengthening ties between the two nations.
- During **Prime Minister K P Sharma Oli's visit to China**, **Nepal and China** signed the **Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) Cooperation Framework**, aiming to accelerate BRI projects. This agreement focuses on **enhanced connectivity**, including infrastructure development in **ports, railways, roads, and telecommunications**. While Nepal initially sought **grants**, a compromise replaced it with **"aid and technical assistance,"** raising concerns about potential loan implications. The **Trans-Himalayan Multi-Dimensional Connectivity Network (THMDCN)** and related projects are expected to be finalized soon, supporting Nepal's political stability and economic growth.
- **Flipkart** has signed an **MoU** with the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** to boost **tech startups** in India. The partnership expands on Flipkart's **\$100 million venture fund**, which supports initiatives like **Flipkart Leap and Ventures**. The collaboration aims to mentor and invest in **early-stage startups**, helping them scale and expand internationally.
- **Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya (GSV)** and the **Indian Navy** signed an **MoU** to enhance **education, research, and training in logistics**. The partnership aims to strengthen the Navy's logistics capabilities, focusing on **supply chain management, multimodal transportation, and sustainability**. It aligns with national initiatives like the **PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan** and **National Logistics Policy 2022**.

- India and the **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** have signed a **\$350 million loan** under the **Strengthening Multimodal and Integrated Logistics Ecosystem (SMILE)** program. The initiative aims to improve **logistics efficiency, infrastructure, and digital integration**, enhancing the **manufacturing sector, supply chain resilience**, and promoting **sustainable economic growth**.
- On December 20, 2024, the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** signed a **Rs 7,628.70 crore** contract with **Larsen & Toubro (L&T)** for **155 mm/52 calibre K9 VAJRA-T Self-Propelled Artillery Guns**. This move supports **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** and advances **India's defence modernization and indigenous manufacturing** under the **Make-in-India** initiative.
- **India and Kuwait** marked a historic milestone in their bilateral relations during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's first official visit to Kuwait on December 21-22, 2024. The visit culminated in the elevation of their ties to a **"Strategic Partnership,"** signifying deeper cooperation across trade, defence, energy, and cultural domains. Kuwait also honored PM Modi with its highest civilian award, **'The Order of Mubarak Al-Kabeer,'** in recognition of his role in fostering bilateral ties.



11 New Appointments: National & International

January to December 2024

New Appointments: National & International of January 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Chairman of the Sixteenth Finance Commission	Arvind Panagariya	-
Director (Human Resources), Indian Oil Corporation	Rashmi Govil	-
Chairman & Managing Director, Power Grid Corporation	Ravindra Kumar Tyagi	Sreekant Kandikuppa
Managing Director, Nivea India	Geetika Mehta	-
Managing Director & CEO, Kia India	Gwanggu Lee	Tae Jin Park
Permanent Representative to UN, Geneva	Arindam Bagchi	-
Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Western Naval Command	Vice Admiral Sanjay Jasjit Singh	Vice Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi
Director (Regulatory and Corporate Affairs), Vodafone Idea	Ambika Khurana	Mr P Balaji
Executive Chairperson, NALSA	Justice B R Gavai (Appointed in November, 2024)	Justice Sanjiv Khanna (Earlier)
Chairperson, FAITH	Puneet Chhatwal	Nakul Anand
President, European Investment Bank	Nadia Calvino	Werner Hoyer
President, AIRA	Shashi Singh	Ramesh Kejriwal
Managing Director, NARCL	P Santhosh	Natarajan Sundar
Executive Director, SEBI	G Ram Mohan Rao	-
CEO & MD, NIIFL	Sanjiv Aggarwal	-
Executive Director, ADB	Vikas Sheel	-
CEO, Indian Olympic Association	Raghuram Iyer	-
Managing Director, Adani Ports & SEZ	Karan Adani	Gautam Adani (now Executive Chairman)
Secretary General, BIMSTEC	Ambassador Indra Mani Pandey	Tenzin Lekphell
CEO, International Payments Business, PhonePe	Ritesh Pai	-
Additional Secretary & DG (Acquisition), Defence Ministry	Samir Kumar Sinha	-
Ambassador to WTO, Geneva	Senthil Pandian C	Brajendra Navnit
Member, UPSC	Sheel Vardhan Singh	-
Chief of Staff, Southern Naval Command	Rear Admiral Upal Kundu	-
Country Managing Director, Experian India	Manish Jain	-
Director General Naval Operations (DGNO)	Vice Admiral AN Pramod	-
Commandant, Indian Naval Academy	Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty	-
Brand Ambassador, RuPay Prime Volleyball League	Hrithik Roshan	-
Director General, Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)	Daljit Singh Chaudhary	-
CEO, PepsiCo India	Jagrut Kotecha	Ahmed El Sheikh
MD & CEO, DCB Bank	Praveen Achuthan Kutty	-
Judge, Supreme Court of India	Justice Prasanna B Varale	-
Chief Secretary, Puducherry	Sharat Chauhan	-

New Appointments: National & International of February 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Chief Secretary of Puducherry	Sharat Chauhan	-
Chairman of Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI)	Anil Kumar Lahoti	PD Vaghela
Non-Executive Chairman, AU Small Finance Bank	Harun Rashid Khan	-
President, Asian Cricket Council (ACC)	Jay Shah (Not changed Yet After Jay Shah Became ICC Chairman)	- (Third consecutive term)
Chief Adviser (Cost), Ministry of Finance	Pawan Kumar	-
Health Secretary	Apurva Chandra	-
Information and Broadcasting Secretary	Sanjay Jaju	Apurva Chandra
Brand Ambassador & Stakeholder, boAt	Ranveer Singh	-
Vice Chief of Indian Army	Lt. Gen. N. S. Raja Subramani (From July 1, 2024)	Lt. Gen. Upendra Dwivedi
Eminent Jurist & Distinguished Professor, K.R. Mangalam University	Hon'ble Justice U.U. Lalit	-
Advocate General of Rajasthan	Rajendra Prasad Gupta	-
Country Director for India, Asian Development Bank (ADB)	Mio Oka	Takeo Konishi
Chief Justice, Gauhati High Court	Justice Vijay Bishnoi	-
CEO & MD, Tata Digital	Naveen Tahilyani	Pratik Pal
MD & CEO, LIC Mutual Fund Asset Management	Ravi Kumar Jha	-
MD & CEO, Tata AIA Life Insurance	Venkatachalam Iyer	-
Non-Executive Chairman, NPCI	Ajay Kumar Choudhary	-
Brand Ambassador, Fit India Movement	Narendra Kumar Yadav	-
President, ICAI	CA. Ranjeet Kumar Agarwal	-
Vice-President, ICAI	CA. Charanjot Singh Nanda	-
CMD, IRCTC	Sanjay Kumar Jain	-
MD & CEO, SBI Capital Markets (SBICAPS)	Virendra Bansal	-
MD, Boeing Defense India	Nikhil Joshi	-
Speaker, Bihar Legislative Assembly	Nand Kishore Yadav	-
President, International Court of Justice (ICJ)	Nawaf Salam	Joan Donoghue
State Icon, Punjab (Chief Electoral Office)	Shubman Gill	-
Joint Managing Director, Kotak Mahindra Bank	KVS Manian	-
Non-Executive Chairmen, Indian Banks	M R Kumar (Bank of India)	-
Non-Executive Chairmen, Indian Banks	Srinivasan Sridhar (IOB)	-
Non-Executive Chairmen, Indian Banks	Aravamudan Krishna Kumar (UCO Bank)	-
MD & CEO, SBM Bank India	Ashish Vijayakar	-
Board of Directors, US India Strategic and	Salil Parekh	-

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Partnership Forum (USISPF)		
Vigilance Commissioner, Central Vigilance Commission	A S Rajeev	-
Director, Independent Evaluation Office (GEF)	Geeta Batra	-
Chairperson, Lokpal	Justice Ajay Manikrao Khanwilkar	-
CEO for India, World Gold Council	Sachin Jain	-
Chairperson & Independent Director, PayU Payments	Renu Sud Karnad	-
Director-Operations, NTPC Ltd	Ravindra Kumar	-

New Appointments: National & International of March 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Brand Ambassador for BPCL's premium petrol variant, 'Speed'	Neeraj Chopra	—
Chairperson of the Prasar Bharati Board	Navneet Kumar Sehgal	A Surya Prakash
New Chief Secretary of Bihar	Brajesh Mehrotra	—
First woman sniper of BSF	Sub-Inspector Suman Kumari	—
Managing Director and CEO of Future Generali India Life Insurance	Alok Rungta	Bruce De Broize
Brand Ambassador for Slice	Nayanthara	—
President and Managing Director of SAP Indian Subcontinent	Manish Prasad	Kulmeet Bawa
Chairman and Managing Director of NHPC	Raj Kumar Chaudhary	—
President of the Paralympic Committee of India	Devendra Jhajharia	Deepa Malik
Vigilance Commissioner in the Central Vigilance Commission	AS Rajeev	—
Chairman of the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC)	Kishor Makwana	—
Lokayukta (anti-corruption ombudsman) of Madhya Pradesh	Justice Satyendra Kumar Singh	—
Director General of Indian Sugar & Bio-energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA)	Deepak Ballani	—
Director (Projects) at NHPC Limited	Sanjay Kumar Singh	—
Election Commissioner	Gyanesh Kumar and Sukhbir Singh Sandhu	—
Chairman and Managing Director of Northern Coalfields Limited (NCL)	B Sairam	—
CEO of Poonawalla Fincorp	Arvind Kapil	Abhay Bhutada
Ambassador of India to Russia	Vinay Kumar	—
CEO of P&G India	Kumar Venkatasubramanian	—
Director General of Police, West Bengal	Rajeev Kumar (From July 2024)	Sanjay Mukherjee
Chairman of Indian Banks' Association (IBA)	M V Rao	—
President of the Indian Steel Association (ISA)	Naveen Jindal	Dilip Oommen
Head of Microsoft's AI division	Mustafa Suleyman	—
President of the Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO)	Ashwani Kumar	—
Chairperson of the Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA)	Mariam Mammen Mathew	Tanmay Maheshwari
Chairman of Surat Diamond Bourse (SDB)	Govind Dholakia	Vallabhbhai Patel
Ambassador of India to Myanmar	Abhay Thakur	—

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Brand Ambassador for Eveready Industries India	Neeraj Chopra	—
Director in the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC)	Hansha Mishra	—
Judicial Member of the Lokpal of India	Justice Ritu Raj Awasthi	—
Director General of NIA	Sadanand Vasant Date	—
MD & CEO of the Bank of Maharashtra	Nidhu Saxena	—
Assistant Secretary-General for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNDRR)	Kamal Kishore	—
Additional Judge of the High Court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh	Justice Mohammad Yousuf Wani	—
Chairman of the Automotive Tyre Manufacturers' Association (ATMA)	Arnab Banerjee	—
Head of Microsoft's combined Windows and Surface teams	Pavan Davuluri	Panos Panay
CMD of New India Assurance	Girija Subramanian	—
CMD of United India Insurance	Bhupesh Sushil Rahul	—

New Appointments: National & International of April 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
President of JNUTA	Moushumi Basu	N/A (New Appointment)
National President of FICCI Ladies Organisation (FLO)	Joyshree Das Verma	N/A (New Appointment)
Managing Director (MD) and CEO of Axis Capital	Atul Mehra	N/A (Pending Approval)
Principal Director General, Press Information Bureau	Sheyphali B. Sharan	Manish Desai
President of ASSOCHAM	Sanjay Nayar	Ajay Singh
Director General of DGEME	Lieutenant General JS Sidana	N/A (New Appointment)
Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Konkan Railway Corporation Ltd.	Santosh Kumar Jha	N/A (New Appointment)
President of FISME	Sandeep Jain	N/A (New Appointment)
Brand Ambassador for the Election Commission of India's Youth Voting Campaign	Ayushmann Khurrana	N/A (New Appointment)
Managing Director of Tata International	Rajeev Singhal	Anand Sen
Member of World Bank Group's Economic Advisory Panel	Rakesh Mohan	N/A (New Appointment)
Chairman of the Indian Vaccine Manufacturers Association (IVMA)	Krishna Ella	Adar C. Poonawala
Director in the Department of Land Resources	Sarvadanand Barnwal	N/A (New Appointment)

New Appointments: National & International of May 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Director of the Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs	Sunil Kumar Yadav	N/A (New Appointment)
President of Indian Vaccine Manufacturers Association (IVMA)	Krishna Ella	Adar C. Poonawala
Director in the Department of Land Resources	Sarvadanand Barnwal	N/A (New Appointment)
Presiding Officer of the Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT)	Justice Dinesh Kumar	N/A (New Appointment)
Managing Director and CEO of Jio Financial Services	Hitesh Kumar Sethia	N/A (New Appointment)
Director in the Department of Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)	Pratima Singh	N/A (New Appointment)
MP and Former Union Minister V. Srinivas Prasad (Deceased)	N/A	N/A (Deceased)

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Secretary (Director Level) of the National Jute Board	Shashi Bhushan Singh	N/A (New Appointment)
Part-time Chairman of HDFC Bank	Atanu Chakraborty	N/A (Re-appointment)
President of Goods & Services Tax Appellate Tribunal (GSTAT)	Justice Sanjaya Kumar Mishra	N/A (New Appointment)
Director in the Ministry of Ayush	Subodh Kumar	N/A (New Appointment)
Chairman of HDFC Life Insurance	Keki Mistry	Deepak Parekh
President of Tata Sons	N Chandrasekaran	Banmali Agrawala
Chairman and Vice Chairman of IFFCO	Dileep Sanghani (Chairman), Balvir Singh (Vice Chairman)	N/A (New Appointment)
CEO of Wipro for APMEA Strategic Market Unit	Vinay Firage	N/A (New Appointment)
Chief AI Officer of NASA	David Salvagnini	N/A (New Appointment)
President of Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA)	Kapil Sibal	Adish C. Aggarwala
Additional Directors in CBI	A Y V Krishna, N Venu Gopal	N/A (New Appointment)
Whole Time Director at IDFC FIRST Bank	Pradeep Natarajan	N/A (New Appointment)
President of CII	Sanjiv Puri	R Dinesh
Chief of Measurement Science & Analytics at BARC India	Dr. Bikramjit Chaudhuri	Dr. Derrick Gray
Vice-Chairman of the International Aluminium Institute	John Slaven	N/A (New Appointment)
Member of the Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC)	Ramesh Babu V.	N/A (New Appointment)
Managing Director and CEO of IndiaFirst Life Insurance	Rushabh Gandhi	N/A (New Appointment)
CEO of L&T Technology Services	R Shankar Raman	N/A (Promotion)
Chairman of NAFED	Jetha Ahir	N/A (New Appointment)
CEO of Sony India	Gaurav Banerjee	N/A (New Appointment)
Managing Director and CEO of NARCL	P Santhosh	N/A (New Appointment)
Brand Ambassador of Muthoot Pappachan Group	Shah Rukh Khan	N/A (New Appointment)
Chairman of ICICI Prudential Life Insurance	Sandeep Batra	N/A (New Appointment)
Chairman of Staff Selection Commission (SSC)	Rakesh Ranjan	N/A (New Appointment)
Director General of World Organization for Animal Health (WOAH)	Dr. Emmanuelle Soubeyran	N/A (New Appointment)

New Appointments: National & International of June 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Ambassador to the United Nations	Parvathaneni Harish (From September 1, 2024)	Ruchira Kamboj (Till September, 1 2024)
Brand Ambassador for Greenday's 'Better Nutrition'	PV Sindhu	-
Chairman, Deendayal Port Trust, Kandla	Sushil Kumar Singh	-
Vice-Chancellor, Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT)	Rakesh Mohan Joshi	-
Director General, Employees' State Insurance Corporation (ESIC)	Kamal Kishore Soan	-
Brand Ambassador for Bisleri Limonata	Aditya Roy Kapur	-
Managing Director & CEO, PNB MetLife India Insurance	Sameer Bansal	Ashish Srivastava
Director, Department of Rural Development	Raj Priy Singh	-
Secretary, Competition Commission of India (CCI)	InderPal Singh Bindra	Anupama Anand
Chairman, Cellular Operators' Association of India (COAI)	Abhijit Kishore	-
Army Chief of Bangladesh	Lt Gen Waker-Uz-Zaman	-

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Managing Director & CEO, SBICAP Ventures Limited (SVL)	Prem Prabhakar	-
President, Asian Association of Hair Restoration Surgeons (AAHRS)	Dr Kapil Dua	-
National Security Adviser (NSA)	Ajit Doval	-
Principal Secretary to PM Narendra Modi	P.K. Mishra	-
Managing Director & CEO, Dhanlaxmi Bank	Ajith Kumar KK	-
Non-Executive Independent Director, Paytm	N V Srinivasan (from Aug-24)	Rajeev Agarwal
Commissioner, Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD)	Ashwani Kumar	-
Chairman, Global Wind Energy Council India	Girish Tanti	-
Director (Enterprise), Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL)	Rajiv Kumar	-

New Appointments: National & International of July 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Chairman, Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT)	Ravi Agrawal	Nitin Gupta (tenure ended June 30, 2024)
Chairman, State Bank of India (SBI)	Challa Sreenivasulu Setty	Dinesh Khara (term ends August 2024)
Chief General Manager, Southern Region Transmission System-I (SRTS-I), Power Grid Corporation of India Ltd (PGCIL)	Akhilesh Pathak	
Brand Ambassadors, Puma India	Riyan Parag, Nitish Kumar Reddy	-
Head, National Medical Commission	Dr. BN Gangadhar	Officiating Chairperson
Additional National Security Adviser (NSA)	Rajinder Khanna	-
Deputy National Security Advisers (NSA)	T V Ravichandran, Pavan Kapoor	-
Managing Director & CEO, SBI General Insurance Company Ltd.	Naveen Chandra Jha	Kishore Kumar Poludasu
Chief Justice, Punjab and Haryana High Court	Justice Sheel Nagu	-
Executive Director (ED), Reserve Bank of India (RBI)	Aviral Jain (Oct-24)	-
Principal Spokesperson, Government of India	Dhirendra K Ojha	-
CEO and Managing Director, Life Insurance Corporation (LIC)	Siddhartha Mohanty (redesignated)	-
Chief Justice, Jharkhand High Court	Justice Mamidanna Satya Ratna Sri Ramachandra Rao (From September 21, 2024)	Justice Bidyut Ranjan Sarangi
President, Financial Action Task Force (FATF)	Elisa de Anda Madrazo	-
Chairman, Search and Selection Committee for Vice-Chancellors, West Bengal Universities	Uday Umesh Lalit	-
Chairman & Managing Director, Indian Energy Exchange (IEX)	Satyanarayan Goel	-
Managing Director & CEO, Utkarsh Small Finance Bank (Utkarsh SFB)	Govind Singh	-
Principal Adviser, National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme	Prof. (Dr.) Soumya Swaminathan	-
President, News Broadcasters & Digital Association (NBDA)	Rajat Sharma	-
Brand Ambassador, Hoop	PV Sindhu	-
Chairman & Managing Director, Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL)	Robert Jerard Ravi	-
Managing Director & CEO, Paytm Payments Bank	Arun Kumar Bansal	-
Director General of Police (DGP), West Bengal	Rajeev Kumar	Sanjoy Mukherjee

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Judges, Supreme Court of India	Justice N Kotiswar Singh, Justice R Mahadevan	-
Chairman, Maharashtra Real Estate Regulatory Authority (MahaRERA)	Manoj Saunik	Ajoy Mehta (term ends Sept 2024)
CEO, HSBC Holdings Plc	Georges Elhedery	-
President, European Commission	Ursula von der Leyen	-
Chairman, Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)	Sanjay Agarwal	-
Managing Director, Federal Bank	Krishnan Venkat Subramanian	-
President, Institute of Cost Accountants of India (ICMAI)	CMA Bibhuti Bhusan Nayak	-
Indian Olympic Committee (IOC) Member	Nita Ambani	-
Director General of Police, Andaman and Nicobar Islands	Hargobinder Singh Dhaliwal	-
Festival Director, International Film Festival of India (IFFI)	Shekhar Kapur	-
Chairman & Managing Director, Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)	Manoj Mittal	-
President, Venezuela	Nicolas Maduro	-
Tennis Player, India	Rohan Bopanna	-
Badminton Player, India	Ashwini Ponnappa	-
Chairperson, Union Public Service Commission (UPSC)	Preeti Sudan	Manoj Soni (resigned)
Governor, Jharkhand	Santosh Kumar Gangwar	-

New Appointments: National & International of August 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
President, Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences	Janet Yang	N/A
Prime Minister of Bangladesh	Not Decide Yet but Mohd. Yunus Chief Advisor of Interim Government	Sheikh Hasina (resigned)
Director General, Assam Rifles	Lt General Vikas Lakhera	N/A
Chairman, State Bank of India (SBI)	Challa Sreenivasulu Setty	N/A
Additional Secretary, Prime Minister's Office (PMO)	Amit Singh Negi	N/A
Managing Director and CEO, Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX)	Praveena Rai	N/A
Prime Minister of Tunisia	Kamel Maddouri	Ahmed Hachani
CEO, DBS Group (Singapore)	Tan Su Shan (to succeed in March 2025)	Piyush Gupta
Member, Central Electricity Regulatory Commission, Power Ministry	Harish Dudani	N/A
Cabinet Secretary of India	T.V. Somanathan	Rajiv Gauba
Chairman & Managing Director, NHPC Limited	Raj Kumar Chaudhary	N/A
President of Rwanda	Paul Kagame	N/A
CEO, Bharat Interface for Money (BHIM)	Lalitha Nataraj	N/A
Managing Director (MD) of State Bank of India (SBI)	Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh	N/A
Secretary, Ministry of Steel	Shri Sandeep Poundrik	N/A
Ambassador of India to the United States	Vinay Mohan Kwatra	N/A
Prime Minister of Japan	Shigeru Ishiba	Fumio Kishida
Prime Minister of Thailand	Paetongtarn Shinawatra	N/A
Director, Enforcement Directorate	Rahul Navin	N/A

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Managing Director & CEO, Tamilnad Mercantile Bank (TMB)	Salee Sukumaran Nair	N/A
Director General, Employees' State Insurance Corporation (ESIC)	Ashok Kumar Singh	N/A
Chef de Mission (CDM) for Indian team	Satya Prakash Sangwan	N/A
Interim Chairman, Airports Authority of India (AAI)	M Suresh	N/A
Union Home Secretary, Government of India	Govind Mohan	Ajay Kumar Bhalla
Secretary, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)	Amardeep Singh Bhatia	N/A
Retired from International Football	Ilkay Gundogan	N/A
President-designate, National Association of Software and Service Companies (NASSCOM)	Rajesh Nambiar	N/A
Secretary, Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)	Deepti Gaur Mukherjee	N/A
Retired from International Cricket	Shikhar Dhawan	N/A
CEO, Nestlé	Laurent Freixe	Mark Schneider
National President, Lok Janshakti Party	Chirag Paswan	N/A
Chairman, Texas Economic Development Corporation (TEDC)	Arun Agarwal	N/A
Additional Director General (ADG), ITBP	Sanjeev Raina	N/A
Chairperson, Nasscom	Sindhu Gangadharan	N/A
Chair of International Cricket Council (ICC)	Jay Shah	Greg Barclay
Director General, National Security Guard (NSG)	B Srinivasan	N/A
Chairman & CEO, Railway Board	Satish Kumar	N/A
Director General, Project Seabird	Vice Admiral Rajesh Dhankhar	Vice Admiral Tarun Sobti
Government Spokesperson, Iran	Fatemeh Mohajerani	N/A
Managing Director & CEO, Shriram Capital	Subhasri	N/A
Director General, Border Security Force (BSF)	Daljit Singh Chaudhary	N/A
Director General, Central Industrial Security Force (CISF)	Rajwinder Singh Bhatti	N/A
Cabinet Secretary, Government of India	Dr. T.V. Somanathan	Rajiv Gauba

New Appointments: National & International of September 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Deputy Chief of the Air Staff (DCAS), Indian Air Force	Air Marshal Tejinder Singh	N/A (new appointment)
Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Central Air Command	Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit	N/A (new appointment)
Managing Director, Philips India	Bharath Sesha	Daniel Mazon
Global Brand Ambassador, L'Oreal Paris	Alia Bhatt	N/A (new appointment)
ITTF Foundation Ambassador	Sharath Kamal	N/A (new appointment)
Selector, Indian Men's Cricket Team	Ajay Ratra	N/A (new appointment)
Chairperson, Uttar Pradesh Women's Commission	Babita Chauhan	N/A (new appointment)
MD & CEO, Central Depository Services (India) Limited	Nehal Vora	N/A (new appointment)
President, Olympic Council of Asia (OCA)	Randhir Singh	N/A (new appointment)
Retired England Cricketer (International Cricket)	Moeen Ali	N/A (new appointment)
Finance Secretary, Government of India	Tuhin Kanta Pandey	N/A (new appointment)

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Ambassador to Croatia	Arun Goel	Raj Kumar Srivastava
State Mission Director, National Health Mission	Dr. Vinay Goyal	K. Jeevan Babu
Non-Executive Chairperson, ONDC	RS Sharma	N/A (new appointment)
Ambassador to Iceland	Mr. R. Ravindran	N/A (new appointment)
Director General, Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)	Amrit Mohan	N/A (new appointment)
Director General, Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)	Anurag Garg	N/A (new appointment)
President, National Rifle Association of India	Kalikesh Narayan Singh Deo	N/A (new appointment)
Managing Director and CEO, Federal Bank	KVS Manian	Shyam Srinivasan
Director, Fund for Responding to Loss and Damage	Ibrahima Cheikh Diong	N/A (new appointment)
Heads of NCRB and SVPNPA	Alok Ranjan (NCRB), Amit Garg (SVPNPA)	N/A (new appointments)
Non-Executive Director, Reliance Home Finance	Jai Anmol Ambani	N/A (new appointment)
Director General, Aeronautical Development Agency (ADA)	Jitendra J Jadhav	N/A (new appointment)
Chairperson, Asian Organisation of Supreme Audit Institutions (ASOSAI)	Girish Chandra Murmu	N/A (new appointment)
Commanding Officer, International Space Station (ISS)	Sunita Williams	N/A (new appointment)
Former IPS Officer & Poet	Keki N. Daruwala	N/A (passed away)
Chief Justice, Delhi High Court	Justice Manmohan	N/A (new appointment)
Director General of Police (DGP), Jammu and Kashmir	Nalin Prabhat	N/A (new appointment)
Deputy Chief Minister, Tamil Nadu	Udhayanidhi Stalin	N/A (new appointment)
President, The Indian Newspaper Society (INS)	M V Shreyams Kumar	Rakesh Sharma

New Appointments: National & International of October 2024

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Chief Justice of Delhi High Court	Justice Manmohan	Chief Justice Satish Chandra Sharma
Director General of Police (DGP), Jammu and Kashmir	IPS Nalin Prabhat	R.R. Swain
Deputy Chief Minister, Tamil Nadu	Udhayanidhi Stalin	-
President of The Indian Newspaper Society (INS)	M. V. Shreyams Kumar	Rakesh Sharma
CMD (Chairman and Managing Director) of RINL	Shri AK Saxena	Atul Bhatt
Director General, Armed Forces Medical Services (DGAFMS)	Vice Admiral Arti Sarin	-
Executive Director (ED), RBI	Aviral Jain	-
Ambassador to France	Sanjeev Kumar Singla	Mr. Jawed Ashraf
Chief of Anti-Corruption Unit (ACU), BCCI	Sharad Kumar	KK Mishra
Deputy Governor, RBI	M. Rajeshwar Rao	-
Vice Chief of the Air Staff	Air Marshal SP Dharkar	Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh
Managing Director, Nestlé India Limited	Manish Tiwary	Suresh Narayanan
Chairman of Tata Trusts	Noel Tata	Ratan Tata
Additional CEO, Government e Marketplace (GeM)	L Satya Srinivas	P K Singh
CMD and CEO, Indian Railway Finance Corporation (IRFC)	Manoj Kumar Dubey	-
Director General, Indian Coast Guard	S. Paramesh	DG Rakesh Pal
MD and CEO, Bandhan Bank	Partha Pratim Sengupta	Chandra Shekhar Ghosh

Designation/Post	Who is Appointed	Replacing Whom
Ambassador to India, Maldives	Aishath Azeema	Ibrahim Shaheeb
CMD, AI Assets Holding Limited (AIAHL)	Amit Kumar	-
National Brand Ambassador, I4C	Rashmika Mandanna	-
Chief Justice of India (CJI)	Justice Sanjiv Khanna	Justice DY Chandrachud (upcoming)
MD/CEO, Digital India Corporation (DIC)	Akash Tripathi	-
Special Secretary for Internal Security	Praveen Vashista	Sivagami Sundari Nanda
CEO, ACKO Life	Sandip Goenka	-
New President, Indian Chamber of Commerce	Abhyuday Jindal	
New Chairperson of the National Commission for Women (NCW)	Smt. Vijaya Kishore Rahatkar	
Coal Secretary	Vikram Dev Dutt	VL Kantha Rao
Director General of Police (DGP) for Jharkhand	Ajay Kumar Singh	
Google's Chief Technologist	Prabhakar Raghavan	
Chief executive officer (CEO) of JP Morgan India	Pranav Chawda	
New Director General International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics (ICRISAT)	Dr. Himanshu Pathak	
51st Chief Justice of India (CJI),	Justice Sanjiv Khanna	CJI DY Chandrachud's
Ambassador of India to the Kingdom of Sweden	Dr. Neena Malhotra	
Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of Axis Bank	Amitabh Chaudhry	
Managing Director (MD) of the National Agriculture Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Ltd	Deepak Agarwal	
Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Punjab National Bank (PNB)	Ashok Chandra	
Chairman of the Airports Authority of India	Vipin Kumar	
Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Bharti Airtel	Shashwat Sharma	
New independent chair for its Anti-Corruption Unit (ACU) of International Cricket Council	Sumathi Dharmawardena	
Chairman of International Cricket Council (ICC)	Jay Shah (From December 1)	Greg Barclay

New Appointments: National & International of November 2024

- **India Yamaha Motor** has appointed **Itaru Otani** as its new Chairman, a significant move aimed at enhancing the company's presence in India's dynamic two-wheeler market. With over 30 years of experience at Yamaha Motor Company,
- **India and France have been re-elected as the president and co-president** of the International Solar Alliance (ISA), respectively, at the seventh ISA assembly held in New Delhi. **Ashish Khanna, a World Bank energy specialist,** has been selected as the next Director General of ISA.
- The Financial Services Institutions Bureau (FSIB) has recommended Rahul Bhawe, the Deputy Managing Director of IFCI Ltd, for the position of Managing Director (MD) and CEO, marking a key development in the financial sector.
- The FICCI National Executive Committee Meeting (NECM) has officially announced **Harsha Vardhan Agarwal as the President.**
- On November 11, 2024, **Justice Sanjiv Khanna was sworn in as the 51st Chief Justice of India**, succeeding Justice D.Y. Chandrachud. His appointment, following Chandrachud's recommendation, was officially notified by the Centre on October 24. Justice Khanna will serve a six-month term until May 13, 2025, bringing a legacy of significant rulings to his new role.
- **Sonu Sood**, the celebrated actor, humanitarian, and philanthropist, has taken on an exciting new role as the **Brand Ambassador and Honorary Tourism Advisor** for Thailand.
- **Mara Kocho** has been recommended as the **next Managing Director (MD) of the North Eastern Handicrafts & Handlooms Development Corporation Limited (NEHHDC)**, a public sector undertaking under the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (DoNER).

- **Arvindar Singh Sahney** has been appointed as the new chairman of Indian Oil Corporation (IOC), the nation's largest oil firm.
- The Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI) announced that **Amandeep Johl** will take over as its new Chief Executive Officer (CEO) starting January 2025.
- The **Dubai Sports Council** has appointed four global sports icons as its **Sports Ambassadors**, including **Harbhajan Singh** (former Indian cricketer) and **Sania Mirza** (former Indian tennis player). The initiative aims to enhance **Dubai's reputation** as a global sports hub by attracting prestigious international events, promoting **sports tourism**, and nurturing local talent. The other appointed ambassadors are **Khabib Nurmagomedov** (Russian UFC champion) and **Patrice Evra** (French footballer).
- **Valdecy Urquiza**, Brazilian Federal Police Commissioner, has been elected as the new **Secretary General of Interpol** during the organization's **92nd General Assembly** in **Glasgow, Scotland** (November 4-7, 2024). Urquiza will succeed **Jurgen Stock**, the outgoing Secretary General, and officially take over the role on **November 7, 2024**, marking a significant leadership transition at the world's largest police organization.
- The government has appointed **K Sanjay Murthy** as the next **Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG)** of India. A **1989-batch IAS officer** from the **Himachal Pradesh cadre**, Murthy will succeed **Girish Chandra Murmu**. Currently serving as the **Secretary of the Department of Higher Education** in the **Ministry of Education**, Murthy is set to take over the crucial role of ensuring **financial accountability** and **transparency** in public expenditure in India.
- **Mithali Raj**, the former captain of India's women's cricket team, has been appointed as the **mentor for Women's Cricket Operations** by the **Andhra Cricket Association (ACA)**. In this role, she will focus on **scouting** and **nurturing young cricket talent** across **Andhra Pradesh**, making a significant contribution to the development of **women's cricket** in the state.
- **Nandan Kumar Jha** from India has been appointed as the new **president** of the **International Mind Sports Association (IMSA)**, which promotes and governs **mind sports** globally. The announcement was made during **IMSA's annual general assembly** in **Sao Paulo, Brazil**.
- **Pankaj Tripathi** has been appointed as the **festival ambassador** for the **Arunachal Rang Mahotsav 2024**, a prestigious international theatre festival. This recognition highlights his contribution to **Indian cinema** and the growing cultural significance of **Arunachal Pradesh**. The **Arunachal Rang Mahotsav**, running from **November 29, 2024** to **December 5, 2024**, is the largest theatre festival in **Northeast India**, celebrating the state's rich cultural heritage and **theatre traditions**.
- **Balasubramanian**, an experienced **Indian Foreign Service (IFS)** officer from the **1998 batch**, has been appointed as the next **High Commissioner of India** to the **Republic of Maldives**. His appointment highlights India's strategic focus on strengthening ties with the **Maldives**, a key partner in the **Indian Ocean Region**.
- **Shri Dinesh Bhatia**, a **1992-batch Indian Foreign Service (IFS)** officer, has been appointed as the next **Ambassador of India** to **Brazil**. The **Ministry of External Affairs** announced the appointment on **November 25, 2024**. Bhatia brings extensive **diplomatic experience** from his roles in multiple countries and key positions.
- **Dr. Jaiteerth Raghavendra Joshi** has been appointed as the new **Chief of BrahMos Aerospace**, known for the **BrahMos supersonic cruise missile system**. With over **three decades** of experience, he has made significant contributions to **missile technology**, **non-destructive testing (NDT)**, and **industry professional development**, emphasizing **innovation** and **excellence** in India's defense sector.
- The **International Federation of Pharmaceutical Manufacturers and Associations (IFPMA)** has appointed **Dr. Thomas Schinecker**, CEO of **Roche**, as its new **President**, effective **January 1, 2025**. **Rob Davis**, CEO of **MSD**, will serve as **Vice-President**. This leadership change follows the completion of **Dr. Albert Bourla's** term as President.
- **Praveena Rai** officially became the **CEO and MD** of the **Multi Commodity Exchange of India (MCX)** on **October 31, 2024**, starting a five-year term. Her appointment marks a new chapter for MCX as she brings her expertise in **banking**, **payments**, and **transaction management** to lead India's largest **commodity derivatives exchange**.
- **Dr. Jacqueline d'Arros Hughes**, the outgoing **Director General** of **ICRISAT**, will assume the role of **Secretary General** of the **World Agriculture Forum (WAF)** in mid-November 2024. Known for her commitment to **sustainable agriculture** and **food security**, Dr. Hughes brings extensive expertise to WAF, a key platform shaping the future of **global agriculture**.



- **Rajesh Kumar Singh**, a 1989-batch **IAS officer** from Kerala, officially assumed the role of **Defence Secretary** in **New Delhi**. He succeeds **Giridhar Aramane**, a 1988-batch IAS officer from Andhra Pradesh, who retired on **October 31, 2024**, after serving a two-year term in this key position.

New Appointments: National & International of December 2024

- **Eurogrip Tyres**, a leading Indian brand for **2, 3-wheeler**, and off-highway tyres, has signed **M.S. Dhoni** as its brand ambassador. The partnership emphasizes the brand's values of **performance, reliability, and safety**, aiming to boost **visibility** and **trust**. Dhoni's passion for **motorcycles** and his focus on **dependability** align with Eurogrip's mission to empower **riders**.
- **Anurag Mehrotra**, with over two decades of experience in the automotive industry, resigned as **Vice President** of **Tata Motors** Commercial Vehicles. He is set to join **JSW MG Motor** as **CEO** in February, aiming to triple the company's volumes in the next 3-5 years. Mehrotra's career includes leadership roles, notably as **Managing Director** of **Ford India**.
- **Devajit Saikia**, former **Assam cricketer**, has been appointed as the **acting secretary** of the **Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)**, filling the vacancy left by **Jay Shah**, who became **ICC chairman**. Saikia's appointment is temporary until a permanent secretary is chosen. During his tenure, **Jay Shah** implemented significant reforms as BCCI secretary from **October 2019**.
- **TransUnion CIBIL** has appointed **Bhavesh Jain** as the new **Managing Director and CEO**, succeeding **Rajesh Kumar**. Jain, previously the **Chief Revenue Officer**, brings extensive experience from **Citi, Kone, and Thomson Reuters**. His appointment emphasizes the company's commitment to **financial inclusion** and **digital transformation** in India.
- **YES Bank** announced the **appointment of Manish Jain** as **Executive Director (Whole-Time Director)**, approved by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**. The appointment, effective from **December 11, 2024**, is for a **three-year term**. Jain, who joined the bank in **September 2023**, brings extensive experience in **corporate and wholesale banking**. The appointment is subject to **YES Bank's shareholders' approval**.
- **Google** has appointed **Preeti Lobana** as its new **Country Manager** and **Vice President** for **India**. With over three decades of experience, Lobana takes over from **Sanjay Gupta**, who moves to a larger role as **President of Asia Pacific**. This strategic move aims to strengthen Google's presence in **India's digital economy**.
- **Rama Mohan Rao Amara** has been appointed as the new **Managing Director (MD)** of **State Bank of India (SBI)** for three years. His appointment, approved by the **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)**, follows a recommendation from the **Financial Services Institutions Bureau (FSIB)**. Amara succeeds **CS Setty**, who became **Chairman** of SBI in August. With extensive **SBI experience**, Amara is set to lead the bank through key growth phases.
- **Nepal's President Ram Chandra Paudel** has reappointed **Dr. Shankar Prasad Sharma** as **Resident Ambassador to India** and appointed **Netra Prasad Timilsina** as **Resident Ambassador to Malaysia**. These diplomatic appointments, made under **Article 282 (1)** of Nepal's Constitution, follow recommendations from the **Council of Ministers**.
- **Salman Khan** has been appointed as the **brand ambassador** for the inaugural **Kho Kho World Cup**, scheduled in **New Delhi** from **January 13-19, 2025**. The event will feature **24 countries** and showcase both **men's and women's teams**, aiming to boost the **global profile** of **Kho Kho** and highlight its widespread appeal.
- In a strategic move to address political and administrative challenges, President Droupadi Murmu announced the appointment of two new governors and reassigned three others **across five states: Kerala, Bihar, Odisha, Manipur, and Mizoram**. **Ajay Kumar Bhalla**, former Union Home Secretary, was appointed Governor of Manipur, bringing his extensive knowledge of security issues to a state grappling with ethnic violence between the Meitei and Kuki communities. **Arif Mohammed Khan** was transferred from Kerala to Bihar, succeeding Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar, in a move aimed at easing political tensions in Kerala, while Arlekar was reassigned to Kerala to strengthen governance. **Hari Babu Kambhampati** was transferred to Odisha, replacing Raghubar Das, and **General V.K. Singh**, a retired Army officer and former Union Minister, was appointed Governor of Mizoram, bringing his military and administrative expertise to the state. These appointments reflect a calculated effort to address regional challenges, balance political dynamics, and ensure effective governance in key states.
- **Justice Madan B Lokur**, former **Supreme Court Judge of India**, has been appointed as the **Chairperson** of the **United Nations Internal Justice Council (IJC)** by **UN Secretary-General António Guterres**. The appointment, effective from **December 19, 2024**, lasts until **November 12, 2028**. The IJC ensures the **impartiality, professionalism, and independence** of the UN's internal justice system, marking a significant achievement for **India** and highlighting Justice Lokur's **global legal stature**.

- The **Chairperson post of the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)** remained vacant after **Justice Arun Kumar Mishra's** tenure ended on **June 1, 2024**. On **December 23, 2024**, **President Droupadi Murmu** confirmed the appointment of **V. Ramasubramanian**, former **Supreme Court judge** and **Chief Justice of Himachal Pradesh High Court**, as the new chairperson. His appointment follows the acting leadership of **Vijaya Bharathi Sayani** and a selection committee led by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**.
- The **Centre** has appointed **Justice Gurmeet Singh Sandhawalia** as the new **Chief Justice of the Himachal Pradesh High Court**, following a recommendation by the **Supreme Court Collegium**. Sandhawalia, the senior-most puisne judge of the **Punjab and Haryana High Court**, replaces **Justice Rajiv Shakdher**, who retired in **October 2024**. His appointment comes after a delay of over **three months**.
- **Arunish Chawla**, a senior IAS officer from the **1992 batch** (Bihar cadre), has been appointed as the new **Revenue Secretary** in the **Ministry of Finance**. This follows the vacancy created after **Sanjay Malhotra's** appointment as **RBI Governor**. Chawla will take over from **Ajay Seth**, who held the additional charge. Chawla will also continue to hold the additional responsibility of the **Ministry of Culture** until a regular appointment is made.
- **Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) Bank's** share price surged by **7.4%** on **December 26, 2024**, after **Amitava Chatterjee** was appointed as the new **MD and CEO** for a three-year term, starting **December 30, 2024**. His appointment was approved by the **RBI**, following the retirement of **Baldev Prakash** on **December 27, 2024**.
- The **SC Collegium** has recommended judges for various projects. Key recommendations include **Chandra Shekhar Sharma**, **Pramil Kumar Mathur**, and **Chandra Prakash Shrimali** for **Rajasthan**, **Ashish Naithani** for **Uttarakhand**, **Pravin Sheshrao Patil** for **Bombay**, and **Praveen Kumar Giri** for **Allahabad**. **Justice G Narendar** is recommended as **Chief Justice** for **Uttarakhand**, and **Justice GS Sandhawalia** for **Himachal Pradesh**. These recommendations aim to address the **sanctioned vs. current judge** ratios in various high courts.
- **Indian public sector banks (PSBs)** reported a **25% increase** in net profit for **H1 2024-25**, reaching **Rs 85,520 crore**, up from **Rs 68,500 crore** in **H1 2023-24**. This growth is driven by low **NPAs**, strong **credit growth**, and a solid **capital adequacy ratio**. PSBs recorded their highest-ever net profit of **Rs 1.41 trillion** in **FY24**, with the **Gross NPA ratio** dropping to **3.12%** in **September 2024** from **14.58%** in **March 2018**. Profits are expected to surpass **Rs 1.5 trillion** for **FY25**.
- **Asia** has joined **World Boxing**, strengthening the sport's Olympic presence, including for **LA 2028**. The **Boxing Federation of India (BFI)** played a key role, securing **seven influential positions**. **Ajay Singh**, BFI president, will serve on the board, while other officials hold roles in the **Olympic Commission**, **Finance and Audit Committee**, **Constitution Commission**, **Sports and Competition Commission**, and **Medical Commission**. **Lovlina Borgohain**, Olympic medallist, was appointed to the **Athletes' Commission** to ensure athlete representation in the sport's future.
- **Dr. Sandip Shah** has been appointed as the new **Chairperson of the National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL)**. With over three decades of experience in **healthcare, pathology, and diagnostics**, Dr. Shah is a **Gold Medalist in MD Pathology and Bacteriology** from **B.J. Medical College, Ahmedabad**. His appointment supports NABL's mission to improve quality and reliability in testing and calibration services.

Awards Current Affairs of January 2024

- In a notable achievement, **Prof. B.R. Kamboj**, the Vice Chancellor of **Chaudhary Charan Singh Haryana Agricultural University**, has been bestowed with the prestigious **M.S. Swaminathan Award**. This recognition comes in appreciation of his significant contributions as a scientist and extension specialist in the field of agronomy.
- Hero MotoCorp**, the world's largest two-wheeler manufacturer, has made significant waves in water conservation, bagging the **CII National Award for Excellence in Water Management** and setting an ambitious goal to become 500% water positive by 2025.
- The New Year Honours list for 2024 has acknowledged the outstanding contributions of individuals across various fields in the UK. Among the distinguished honorees is **Professor Adrian Michael Cruise**, a leading figure in space science research, particularly known for his role in the Gravitational Wave Research Group at the University of Birmingham. The recognition highlights his services to space and places him alongside other influential figures in the **realm of UK astronomy**.
- In a prestigious recognition of his literary contributions, renowned Bengali writer **Shirshendu Mukhopadhyay** has been awarded the **2023 Kuvempu Rashtriya Puraskar**. The national award, named in honour of the late Kannada poet Kuvempu, celebrates writers who have made significant contributions to any Indian language.
- The **Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports** has recently unveiled the recipients of the prestigious '**Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puruskar**' for the year **2023**. These awards are a testament to the commendable contributions made by corporate entities, Sports Control Boards, NGOs, and sports bodies at the State and National levels towards the promotion and development of sports in India.
- The **National Institute of Construction Management and Research (NICMAR)**, located in Hyderabad, has recently been awarded the prestigious Platinum certification by the **Indian Green Building Council (IGBC)** under its **Green Campus Rating program**. This accomplishment highlights NICMAR Hyderabad's commitment to sustainability and eco-friendly practices in its campus operations and infrastructure.
- In a heart-touching ceremony, **President Draupadi Murmu** posthumously conferred the prestigious **Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Award** upon **Savita Kanswal**. The award, presented to her father Radheshyam Kanswal, is a testament to Savita's exceptional achievements in the field of mountaineering.
- Deepa Bhandare**, associated with **Shri Datta Cooperative Sugar Factory (SSK)** in **Shirol taluka of Kolhapur**, emerged as a trailblazer as she clinched the prestigious **Best Environment Officer Award** at the ceremony. The award, conferred by VSI Chairman Sharad Pawar, marks a historic moment as Bhandare becomes the only woman in the long and illustrious history of Maharashtra's sugar industry to receive this accolade.
- In a groundbreaking moment, Second Lt. **Madison Marsh**, an officer in the U.S. Air Force, was crowned **Miss America**, marking the **first time an active-duty service member has clinched this prestigious title**, as confirmed by the Air Force.
- REC Limited**, a prominent **Maharatna Public Sector Unit** and a leading **Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** under the **Ministry of Power**, has been honored with the prestigious 'Plaque' at the ICAI Awards for Excellence in Financial Reporting. The recognition is in the 'Financial Services Sector (Other than Banking and Insurance)' category for the financial year 2022-23.
- In a glittering ceremony at the Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum Creative Sports Awards, **FIFA President Gianni Infantino** was bestowed with the prestigious **International Sports Personality of the Year award**. The event, inspired by the love of sport exhibited by Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, has been recognizing outstanding achievements in the realm of sports since its inception in 2009.
- Former Chief Justice of India and current Rajya Sabha MP, **Ranjan Gogoi**, is set to be honored with the prestigious '**Assam Baibhav**' award, the highest civilian award in Assam. This announcement was made by the Chief Minister of Assam, Himanta Biswa Sarma, who highlighted Gogoi's significant contributions to the **field of justice and jurisprudence**. The award ceremony is scheduled to take place on February 10.
- At the prestigious Wings India Awards 2024, both the **Kempegowda International Airport in Bengaluru** and the **Indira Gandhi International Airport in Delhi** were jointly awarded the '**Best Airport of the Year**'. This accolade celebrates world-class operators and individuals who have significantly contributed to the aviation industry, especially during challenging times.
- Skyways Air Services Pvt Ltd** has been recognized for its outstanding cargo services at the prestigious **Wings India Awards held in Hyderabad**. This recognition is a testament to Skyways Air Services' commitment to excellence in the aviation cargo sector.

- Former India captain and head coach **Ravi Shastri** expressed his gratitude on January 21, 2024 for being awarded the prestigious **Col CK Nayudu Lifetime Achievement Award** at a glittering ceremony organized by the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI). The ceremony also saw other cricketing stalwarts, such as **Farokh Engineer**, being honored for their contributions to the sport.
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) announced five ICC Teams of the Year across formats for men and women as part of the ICC Awards 2023. Six Indians were featured in the ICC Men's ODI team of the year with Rohit Sharma named as the captain of the 11-member team.

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- The prestigious **Blavatnik Awards** will recognize the exceptional contributions of Rahul R Nair, Mehul Malik, Tanmay Bharat, and other early career scientists at a black-tie gala in London on February 27. These awards, totaling 480,000 pounds in grants, underscore the importance of recognition and research funding in propelling scientific breakthroughs.
- **Nikhil Mukund Wagh**, who works as a **Public Relations Officer at Goa Shipyard Limited**, was recently given the **"Maha Gaurav 2024" award**. This award was handed to him by **Shri Ajit Pawar**, the Deputy Chief Minister of Maharashtra, during a ceremony at Kaneri Math in Kolhapur on Monday, January 29. The award is a big deal because it recognizes Nikhil's great work in public relations.
- **Priest Ishwari Prasad Namboodiri**, the chief priest (Rawal) of the world-renowned Badrinath Dham in Uttarakhand, was honoured with the **Shankar Smriti Award in Kerala**. This recognition marks a significant acknowledgement of his dedication and service to the spiritual domain, enhancing the rich tapestry of Indian religious practices.
- **Dr. Bina Modi**, the esteemed Chairperson of Modi Enterprises, has been honored with the prestigious **'Outstanding Business Woman of the Year' Award**. This recognition, bestowed upon her by **Rajnath Singh**, Defence Minister of India, at a distinguished conference organized by the Indo-American Chamber of Commerce (IACC), underscores her exceptional leadership and contributions to the industry.
- Renowned Mathematics educator **Anand Kumar**, founder of Super 30, achieved a significant milestone on Tuesday, February 6, as he was granted the prestigious **'Golden Visa'** by the **United Arab Emirates (UAE) government**. This recognition catapults Kumar into an elite group, traditionally dominated by Bollywood stars and sports icons.
- In a celebration of nature's serene beauty, a photograph depicting a **polar bear asleep on an iceberg** has clinched the prestigious **Wildlife Photographer of the Year People's Choice Award**. This enchanting image, titled 'Ice Bed,' captured by British amateur photographer Nima Sarikhani, has emerged victorious in a competition that saw a record-breaking 75,000 votes from the public.
- The **second DNPA Conclave & Digital Impact Awards** served as a pivotal platform for discussions on the **revenue-sharing disparity between digital news publishers and major technology platforms**. Key stakeholders, including the Minister of State for Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), converged to address this pressing issue amidst the backdrop of the imminent Digital India Act. The Conclave focuses on the theme **'Navigating Digital Transformations and Challenges in the Media Industry.'**
- **Pyarelal Sharma**, one-half of the legendary composer duo **Laxmikant-Pyarelal**, has been felicitated with the prestigious Lakshminarayana International Award. This honour was bestowed upon him as part of the Lakshminarayana Global Music Festival, acknowledging his invaluable contributions to the Indian music industry.
- The government of India has recently unveiled the prestigious **'National Creators Award'**, a groundbreaking initiative aimed at acknowledging and celebrating the remarkable contributions of new-age influencers and creators in shaping India's digital landscape.
- The field of space exploration and technology in India witnessed a momentous occasion as the **IEEE Kerala Section** announced the recipient of the prestigious **K.P.P. Nambiar Award**. This year, the accolade was bestowed upon **ISRO Chairman S. Somanath**, a figure synonymous with innovation and leadership in space technology.
- Noida, a city in the National Capital Region, has garnered recognition for its efforts in water conservation and management. **The Department of Water Resources, River Development, and Ganga Rejuvenation**, under the Union Water Ministry, has honored Noida with the title of **"Water Warrior" city**. This recognition comes as a testament to the city's measures in waste water treatment and reuse for various purposes, particularly irrigation.
- **India** was honoured with the **9th GovTech Prize at the World Government Summit 2024**, held in the **United Arab Emirates**. This accolade is a testament to India's innovative use of artificial intelligence in enhancing government services, specifically under the 'AI-Powered Government Services' category. The award, established by the UAE government, acknowledges the creative and innovative technological solutions implemented by government entities worldwide.

- **Havildar Varinder Singh**, a member of the Sikh Regiment in the Indian Army, has been honored with the prestigious **Vishisht Seva Medal** for his remarkable contribution to military technology. President Droupadi Murmu bestowed this accolade upon him in recognition of his outstanding efforts in developing a groundbreaking piece of equipment.
- **The National Film Awards**, one of India's most prestigious film award ceremonies, is set to see significant changes in its 70th iteration in 2022. Previously known as the **Indira Gandhi Award for Best Debut Film**, this category will now be simply referred to as the **"Best Debut Film of a Director."** The award category previously known as the **Nargis Dutt Award for Best Feature Film on National Integration** has undergone not just a name change but also a broadening of its scope. It will now be known as the **"Best Feature Film Promoting National, Social, and Environmental Values,"** effectively merging the aspects of national integration, social issues, and environmental conservation into a single category.
- The Hon'ble President of India, in a momentous ceremony on Republic Day 2024, bestowed the prestigious **'Jeevan Raksha Padak'** upon **Sh. Shashikant Kumar**, a constable of the Railway Protection Special Force (RPSF). This esteemed recognition stands as a testament to Kumar's exceptional valor and selflessness in the face of danger.
- Diplomat, author, and politician, **Shashi Tharoor** has been bestowed with the prestigious **'Chevalier de la Légion d'Honneur'** (Knight of the Legion of Honour), **France's** highest civilian honour. This accolade celebrates Tharoor's lifelong dedication to fostering global understanding and his significant service to India and the world at large.
- Swedish photographer **Alex Dawson** has clinched the prestigious title of **Underwater Photographer of the Year 2024**. His winning entry, 'Whale Bones', is a mesmerizing image that transports viewers beneath the icy expanse of the Greenland ice sheet, where a diver is seen exploring the skeletal remains of a minke whale.
- In a world propelled by technological advancements, quantum computing emerges as a frontier of innovation. At its forefront stands **Dr. Aditi Sen De**, a distinguished physicist from the Harish Chandra Research Institute in Prayagraj. Recently honored with the **2023 GD Birla Award** for Scientific Excellence, Dr. De's groundbreaking contributions to quantum technologies mark a significant milestone in scientific research.
- **Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)**, the premier Telecom R&D centre of the Government of India, has achieved a remarkable feat by clinching the **top position in three categories** at the esteemed **14th Annual Aegis Graham Bell Awards**. The event, held on February 21, 2024, at the NDMC Convention Centre, New Delhi, witnessed C-DOT's groundbreaking innovations being recognized and celebrated.
- The recipient of this year's **Romain Rolland Book Prize** is **Pankaj Kumar Chatterjee** for his remarkable translation of Jean-Daniel Baltassat's **"Le Divan de Staline"** into Bengali, titled **"Staliner Divan."** Published by New Bharat Sahitya Kutir, Kolkata, Chatterjee's translation stood out for its linguistic prowess and fidelity to the original text. This marks the second time that a Bengali translation has been honoured with this prestigious award.

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- **Dr. Pradeep Mahajan**, the Founder and Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of StemRx Hospital and Research Centre, along with StemRx Bioscience Solutions, has been awarded the prestigious **Maharashtra Bhushan Award 2024**.
- On the occasion of the **48th Foundation Day** of the Indian Civil Accounts Service, the **Ministry of Information & Broadcasting** has been honored with the **Award for Best Performance in Accounts during the Financial Year 2023-24**. This prestigious accolade signifies the Ministry's outstanding contribution and commitment to financial excellence.
- Legendary golfer **Tiger Woods** has been selected to receive the Bob Jones Award, the highest honour bestowed by the **United States Golf Association (USGA)**. This prestigious award recognizes Woods' dedication to sportsmanship, his respect for the traditions of the game, and his significant charitable endeavors.
- **Yatin Bhaskar Duggal**, a promising talent from Haryana, has emerged triumphant as the winner of the esteemed **National Youth Parliament Festival, 2024**. The announcement came during the conclusive session held in New Delhi, where Duggal was awarded the first prize for his exceptional performance.
- **Sahitya Akademi**, the esteemed National Academy of Letters in India, is marking its **70th anniversary** this year, and in honor of this milestone, the annual **'Sahityotsav'** has transformed into the world's largest literary festival.
- Renowned filmmaker **Zoya Akhtar** and British Indian chef **Asma Khan** were honored at the annual **'India-UK Achievers'** awards in London. The event celebrated Akhtar's acclaimed work in cinema and Khan's contributions to culinary arts.
- India has been awarded the prestigious **'Measles and Rubella Champion' Award** by The Measles and Rubella Partnership. This award recognizes India's **exemplary efforts in preventing measles and rubella diseases**.

- Delhi Airport has once again asserted its dominance in the aviation sector by securing the prestigious title of **'Best Airport'** in the Asia-Pacific region for the sixth consecutive year. This accolade, bestowed by the **Airport Service Quality (ASQ) Awards**, reaffirms Delhi Airport's commitment to excellence and leadership in providing top-notch services to passengers.
- **Riken Yamamoto**, a Japanese architect from Yokohama, has been named the winner of the **2024 Pritzker Architecture Prize**, widely regarded as the highest honour in the field of architecture.
- The **Praemium Erasmianum Foundation** has awarded the **Erasmus Prize 2024** to the Indian writer **Amitav Ghosh**. He receives this prestigious honour for his **passionate contribution** to the theme "imagining the unthinkable," in which he explores the **unprecedented global crisis of climate change** through his literary works.
- **Mr. Srinivasan Swamy**, currently serving as the chairman and managing director of RK Swamy Ltd, was honored at the 45th IAA World Congress in Penang, Malaysia. Governor Tun Ahmad Fuzi Abdul Razak presented him with the esteemed **IAA Golden Compass Award**, recognizing his significant contributions to the global marketing, advertising, and media industries.
- President **Droupadi Murmu** was conferred with the honorary degree of Doctor of Civil Law by the University of Mauritius. This prestigious honor demonstrates the depth of bilateral ties between India and Mauritius.
- The prestigious **Chameli Devi Jain Award 2024** for Outstanding Woman Media Person of the Year has been given **jointly** to two remarkable journalists: Greeshma Kuthar – Independent Journalist and Ritika Chopra – Indian Express.
- **Ratan Tata**, former chairman of **Tata Sons**, has been bestowed with the prestigious **PV Narasimha Rao Memorial Award**. He received the award for his **outstanding philanthropic contributions**. The award ceremony took place in **Mumbai** on **March 15, 2024**.
- **Uday Bhatia** and **Manasi Gupta** from India were honored with the prestigious **'Diana Memorial Award'** on **14 March 2024**.
- Thodur Madabusi Krishna, a **renowned Carnatic musician**, has been chosen as the **Sangita Kalanidhi** awardee for 2024. This award, considered the **Oscar equivalent** for Carnatic music, is given away by the **Music Academy** in Chennai.
- Noted **Malayalam poet and author Prabha Varma** has been selected for the prestigious **33rd Saraswati Samman** for the year 2023. He won the award for his **novel in verse 'Roudra Sathwikam'** published in 2022.
- The **Raksha Mantri Trophy** for the **Best and Second Best Command Hospitals** of the **Armed Forces Medical Services (AFMS)** for the year 2022 was awarded on 19th March 2024 in New Delhi. The **Command Hospital (Southern Command)**, Pune was judged as the **Best Command Hospital**, while the **Command Hospital (Central Command)**, Lucknow was the **Second Best** for 2022.
- Dr. Uma Rele, the esteemed **Principal of Nalanda Nriyaya Kala Mahavidyalaya** in Mumbai, has been conferred with the prestigious **Maharashtra Gaurav Award**. The honour was bestowed upon her by Maharashtra Industrial Minister Uday Sawant and Minister Deepak Vasant Kesarkar in recognition of her invaluable contributions to the realm of **Indian classical dance**, particularly **Bharata Natyam**.
- Indian Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** has created history by becoming the first **non-Bhutanese** to receive the **'Order of the Druk Gyalpo'**, **Bhutan's highest civilian award**. He received this prestigious honour from **Bhutan's King Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck** during his two-day state visit to Thimphu. The 'Order of the Druk Gyalpo' is a **lifetime achievement award** and is considered the **pinnacle of Bhutan's honour system**. Only four eminent personalities have received this award since its institution.
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (**ISRO**) has been honored with the prestigious **Aviation Week Laureates Award** for its remarkable achievements in the **Chandrayaan-3 mission**. **Sripriya Ranganathan**, Deputy Ambassador at the Indian Embassy in the US, accepted the award on behalf of ISRO.
- **Bina Agarwal** and **James Boyce** have been awarded the first **"Global Inequality Research Award"** for their significant contributions to understanding global inequalities, specifically in the areas of social and environmental inequalities. The **laureates** will be invited to receive their awards and present an overview of their work at conferences in Paris in the fall and spring of 2024. These conferences will be organized in conjunction with **Sciences Po's Social-Ecological Transitions (SET) initiative**.
- The **International Astronomical Union (IAU)**, a global organization responsible for naming celestial objects, has bestowed a rare honour upon an Indian scientist. Professor **Jayant Murthy**, an esteemed astrophysicist, has been recognized for his remarkable contributions to the field by having an asteroid named after him – **(215884) Jayantmurthy**.
- The Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters has awarded the **2024 Abel Prize** to **Michel Talagrand** of the French National Center for Scientific Research (CNRS), Paris, France. Talagrand received the prestigious prize "for his **groundbreaking contributions to probability theory and functional analysis**, with outstanding applications in **mathematical physics and statistics**."
- At a glittering event recently held in **Noida**, organized by **The Times Group**, **Vijay Jain**, the **Managing Director of Star Estate**, was awarded the prestigious **Times Power Icon 2024 Award**. The event celebrated and honoured top industry leaders, gracing the occasion with the presence of industry leaders and celebrities, including **Cine icon Ada Sharma**, who presented the award to Vijay Jain.

Awards Current Affairs of April 2024

- **Professor Meena Charanda**, Principal of **Kalindi College, Delhi University**, has been awarded the prestigious '**International Culture Award**' for the year **2024**. Prof. Charanda received this honour in recognition of her remarkable work in the field of **education and social service**. The award ceremony took place on **March 30, 2024**, at the **India International Center**.
- **Vineet Jain**, the managing director of the **Times Group**, received the prestigious **Exchange4Media News Broadcasting Awards (ENBA) Lifetime Achievement Award 2023** for his significant contributions to **Indian television news**.
- **REC Limited**, a Maharatna Central Public Sector Enterprise under the Ministry of Power and a leading NBFC, has been bestowed with the **SKOCH ESG Award 2024** in the '**Renewable Energy Financing**' category. The award underscores REC's dedication to sustainable financing, paving the way for a greener future and accelerating the transition to renewable energy. Executive Director of REC Limited, Shri T.S.C. Bosh, received the award in New Delhi.
- Dr. Kommuri was felicitated with the Distinguished Overseas Dental Specialist (Orthodontics and Orofacial Pain) title at the **National Fame Awards 2024**, held at The Club in Mumbai. The chief guest of the ceremony was Dia Mirza.
- **SJVN Limited**, a leading public sector undertaking, has been honored with two prestigious awards at the **15th CIDC Vishwakarma Awards 2024**. The awards were given by the Construction Industry Development Council (CIDC) in recognition of SJVN's remarkable contributions to corporate social responsibility (CSR).
- The small town of **Miraj in Maharashtra's Sangli district** is known for its craftsmanship in making musical instruments, particularly **sitars and tanpuras**. These instruments have now been awarded the coveted Geographical Indication (GI) tags, recognizing their unique origin and quality.
- **GAIL (India) Limited** has been honored with the prestigious **15th CIDC Vishwakarma Award in the 'Achievement Award for Best Construction Projects' category** for its remarkable accomplishment in the **Barauni – Guwahati Natural Gas Pipeline project (BGPL)**. The project, an integral component of the Jagdishpur – Haldia & Bokaro – Dhamra Pipeline project, marks a significant milestone by connecting North-East India to the National Gas Grid for the first time.
- The late Russian dissident **Aleksei Navalny and his wife, Yulia Navalnaya**, will receive the Freedom Prize of the Media from a leading German forum, the Ludwig Erhard Summit. The award is presented annually to public figures who have made significant contributions to freedom of expression, dialogue, and democracy.
- **Dr. Agarwal's Eye Hospital's** research team has been honoured with the prestigious '**Best Scientific Poster Award**' at the **2024 Annual Meeting of the American Society for Cataract and Refractive Surgery (ASCRS)**. The award-winning study focused on 'The efficacy of RevitalVision vision-training software in improving best-corrected vision in stable keratoconus patients post Crosslinking surgery.'
- **Gopi Thotakura** is making history as the first Indian pilot to venture into space as a tourist, joining **Blue Origin's NS-25 mission**. His selection highlights a significant milestone in India's space exploration journey, marking a new era for space tourism.
- **Dr. Gagandeep Kang**, an Indian researcher, has been awarded the **2024 John Dirks Canada Gairdner Global Health Award** for her achievements in global health research.
- The **American President's Volunteer Service Award** was established in 2003 during George Bush's presidency. The award is given to individuals who have provided at least 500 hours of voluntary service in the United States and whose work has positively impacted communities and inspired those around them.
- **Lindy Cameron**, a distinguished **Oxford University alumna and former CEO of the UK's National Cyber Security Centre**, has been appointed as the first woman high commissioner to India. Her appointment marks a significant milestone in UK-India relations, coming 70 years after India appointed its first high commissioner to London.
- **Pavuluri Subba Rao**, the Founder, CEO, and Chairman of **Ananth Technologies**, has been conferred with the prestigious '**Aryabhata Award**' by the **Aeronautical Society of India (ASI)**. This honour recognizes Rao's "tremendous lifetime contribution to the promotion of astronautics in India."
- **Mohammed Salem** is a Palestinian photographer who works for the news agency Reuters. In 2024, he won a very important award called the **World Press Photo of the Year award**.
- **Renowned industrialist and philanthropist Ratan Tata, Chairman Emeritus of the Tata Group**, was honored with the esteemed **KISS Humanitarian Award 2021** at a ceremony held at his Mumbai residence. The award, initiated in 2008 by Achyuta Samanta, recognizes individuals and organizations epitomizing humanitarian efforts globally.
- Two Indian student teams have brought laurels to the country by winning prestigious awards at the NASA Human Exploration Rover Challenge (HERC). The **KIET Group of Institutions from Delhi-NCR** bagged the "**Crash and Burn**" award, while the **Kanakia International School from Mumbai** received the "**Rookie of the Year**" award.

- In a prestigious ceremony held at Mumbai's **Dinanath Mangeshkar Natyagrih**, actor **Randeep Hooda** was bestowed with the **Lata Deenanath Mangeshkar Award**. This honor recognizes his remarkable contributions to **Indian cinema** and his recent film "**Swatantrya Veer Savarkar**".
- **Gina Justus**, an English High School teacher at the Sharjah Girls Branch in the United Arab Emirates (UAE), has been named the regional winner for the **Middle East and North Africa (MENA)** region at the prestigious **2024 Cambridge Dedicated Teacher Awards**. This achievement celebrates her outstanding mentorship and dedication to charity work.
- **Sana**, the **AI-powered news anchor** developed by the **India Today Group**, has achieved remarkable success at the prestigious **International News Media Association (INMA) Global Media Awards** held in London. This groundbreaking **AI** innovation has captured two coveted awards, solidifying its position as a **trailblazer** in the field of AI-driven journalism.
- **Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE)** honored **K.V. Kamath**, Chairman of National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development and Chairman of Jio Financial Services Ltd., with an honorary doctorate at a special convocation on April 29, 2024. The ceremony celebrated Kamath's exceptional leadership in banking, finance, and sustainable development, recognizing his significant contributions to India's financial sector and global impact.
- **Dr. Bina Modi**, Chairperson and Managing Director of Modi Enterprises – KK Modi Group, was honoured by the esteemed Vice President of India, Jagdeep Dhankar, for her 'Outstanding Contribution to the cause of **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)**'. The felicitation took place during the inauguration of the new building for the Society of Indian Law Firms (SILF), where the Vice President graced the occasion as the chief guest.
- **Dr. Purnima Devi Barman**, a wildlife biologist from **Assam**, has been recognized with the prestigious **Whitley Gold Award** for her exemplary conservation efforts aimed at protecting the endangered Greater Adjutant Stork and its wetland habitat. This accolade, often referred to as the 'Green Oscar', highlights her remarkable contributions to wildlife conservation and underscores the importance of grassroots efforts in safeguarding biodiversity.
- In a gesture of solidarity and recognition, **Palestinian journalists** covering the **crisis in Gaza** have been named laureates of the **2024 UNESCO/Guillermo Cano World Press Freedom Prize**. The announcement comes from the recommendation of an International Jury of media professionals, emphasizing the courage and commitment of these journalists amidst challenging circumstances.
- Bollywood actress **Kareena Kapoor Khan** has been appointed as the **National Ambassador** for **UNICEF India**. This prestigious role comes as a recognition of her long-standing association with the organization since 2014, where she has served as a **Celebrity Advocate**.
- In a remarkable feat, The Hindu secured three prestigious awards at the **6th International Newspaper Design Competition** organized by **newspaperdesign.in**. The accolades were garnered for their exceptional explainer page titled "**The science behind Neeraj's skills**," shedding light on Neeraj Chopra's remarkable journey and success in athletics.
- Oxford Bookstores announced **Bhavi Mehta** as the winner of the **9th edition of the Oxford Bookstore Book Cover Prize**. Mehta's winning entry was the book jacket for "**The Book Beautiful**" published by Hachette India and authored by Pradeep Sebastian.
- **Pawan Sindhi** was bestowed with the prestigious **Global Pride of Sindhi Award 2024** at an event attended by esteemed **saints, Mahatmas, and sadhus**. The occasion celebrated Mr. Sindhi's remarkable contributions to society and his dedication to serving humanity.
- **Dr. Soumya Swaminathan**, a globally renowned leader in public health and infectious diseases, has been named among the 10 exceptional individuals to receive an honorary degree from Canada's prestigious **McGill University** during the Spring 2024 Convocation ceremonies.

Awards Current Affairs of May 2024

- **Gina Justus**, an English High School teacher at the Sharjah Girls Branch in the United Arab Emirates (UAE), has been named the regional winner for the **Middle East and North Africa (MENA)** region at the prestigious **2024 Cambridge Dedicated Teacher Awards**. This achievement celebrates her outstanding mentorship and dedication to charity work.
- **Sana**, the **AI-powered news anchor** developed by the **India Today Group**, has achieved remarkable success at the prestigious **International News Media Association (INMA) Global Media Awards** held in London. This groundbreaking **AI** innovation has captured two coveted awards, solidifying its position as a **trailblazer** in the field of AI-driven journalism.
- **Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE)** honored **K.V. Kamath**, Chairman of National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development and Chairman of Jio Financial Services Ltd., with an honorary doctorate at a special convocation on April 29, 2024. The ceremony celebrated Kamath's exceptional leadership in banking, finance, and sustainable development, recognizing his significant contributions to India's financial sector and global impact.

- In a prestigious ceremony held in New Delhi, **Cmde Hemant Khatri**, the Chairman and Managing Director (C&MD) of **Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)**, was bestowed with the esteemed '**PSU Samarpan Award**' by Gov Connect. The award recognizes Khatri's outstanding leadership and his pivotal role in driving the transformation of the shipyard, inspiring countless individuals within the industry.
- In a prestigious ceremony held at the Sahara Star Hotel in Mumbai on May 12th, **Chandrakant Satija**, the renowned educationist and Founder/CEO of **Chandra Admission Consultants**, was honored with the **Global Excellence Award 2024**. The award, presented by the famous Bollywood actress **Shilpa Shetty Kundra**, recognized Satija as the **Most Trusted Admissions Consultant in the Vidarbha Region**.
- In a momentous occasion, the **eminent author Ruskin Bond** has been bestowed with the **Sahitya Akademi Fellowship**, the highest honour conferred by India's premier literary organization, the Sahitya Akademi. Due to Bond's **ill health**, the prestigious award was presented to him at his **Mussoorie home** by Sahitya Akademi President Madhav Kaushik and Secretary K. Sreenivasarao, in the presence of his son.
- Indian spiritual guru Sri Sri Ravi Shankar received the first stamp released to commemorate the completion of 200 years of **Indian Origin Tamils (IOT) in Sri Lanka**. The stamp was presented by the Governor of the Eastern Province of Sri Lanka, Senthil Thondaman.
- The public sector company **NTPC** has secured the **third rank in the world for the Talent Development category** at the prestigious **ATD BEST Awards 2024**. The award ceremony was held in New Orleans, United States of America, on 21 May 2024. Ms. Rachana Singh Bhal, NTPC's chief general manager strategic HR & talent management, accepted the award on behalf of the company.
- **Srinivas R. Kulkarni**, an Indian-origin U.S. scientist and brother of renowned author Sudha Murty, has been awarded the **prestigious Shaw Prize in Astronomy** for 2024. This prestigious recognition celebrates Kulkarni's **groundbreaking discoveries** in the field of astronomy, including his pioneering work on **millisecond pulsars, gamma-ray bursts, supernovae, and other transient astronomical phenomena**.
- **Arti**, an 18-year-old woman from the Bahraich district of Uttar Pradesh, has been honored with the prestigious **Amal Clooney Women's Empowerment Award** by King **Charles III** of the United Kingdom.
- **NHPC**, India's premier hydropower company, has been bestowed with the prestigious 'The Economic Times HR World Future Ready Organization Award 2024-25'. This coveted recognition highlights NHPC's unwavering commitment to fostering a future-ready workforce and its strategic approach to human resource management.
- The 77th Cannes Film Festival witnessed a remarkable achievement for Indian cinema as **Payal Kapadia's** film 'All We Imagine as Light' won the prestigious **Grand Prix** award, the second-highest honour at the festival. This triumph marks a historic moment, as Kapadia becomes the first Indian filmmaker to receive this prestigious accolade.
- The Indian gymnast, **Dipa Karmakar**, has scripted history by becoming the first-ever Indian to secure a gold medal in any **Asian Championships**. Hailing from Tripura, Dipa achieved this remarkable feat in the women's vault individual final at the Asian Women's Artistic Gymnastics Championships 2024, held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan, on May 26, 2024.
- **Major Radhika Sen**, an **Indian military peacekeeper** serving with the United Nations Organization Stabilization Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (**MONUSCO**), has been awarded the prestigious **2023 United Nations Military Gender Advocate of the Year Award**. This award recognizes her dedication and efforts in promoting the principles of **UN Security Council resolution 1325 on women, peace, and security**.

Awards Current Affairs of June 2024

- The famous Annual **Hindi Sahitya Bharati Award** has been given to **Krishna Prakash**, who is well-known for leading Mumbai Police's special counterterrorism team, Force One. The award was given out at Mumbai's multicultural **Sab Me Ram Shashwat Shri Ram event**.
- **Poet and playwright Siddhalinga Pattanashetti** has been chosen for the prestigious **Gudleppa Hallikeri Award** for 2024 by the **Gudleppa Hallikeri Memorial Foundation, Hosaritti (Haveri District)**. Veeranna Chekki, senior trustee of the **Gudleppa Hallikeri Memorial foundation** of Hosaritti, Haveri District announced. This is the **19th award** and will be presented in the honour of the birth anniversary of **Gudleppa Hallikeri on 6 June**.
- At the prestigious **New York Indian Film Festival 2024**, **Sanya Malhotra** has etched her name in glory by winning the **Best Actress award** for her captivating performance in the film "Mrs." This triumph marks a significant milestone in Malhotra's burgeoning career and underscores her exceptional talent as an actress.
- The **All India Tennis Association (AITA)** has announced the **Dilip Bose award** for lifetime achievement to coach **Nar Singh**. The first award would be presented to the 69-year-old **Rohini Lokhande** who was a member of the national team along with **Kiran Bedi, Nirupama Mankad, Susan Das and Udaya Kumar**, before she took to coaching at a young age.
- The **Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)**, established on August 24, 1984, by the Government of India, is a premier telecom research and development centre. Its mission is to revolutionize the telecom sector in India by developing cutting-edge technologies and products tailored to Indian conditions.

- The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has been awarded the Asia-Pacific region's 'Best Conduct of Business Regulator' by The Asian Banker. The award was received by SEBI's Whole Time Member, Kamlesh Chandra Varshney, at a ceremony held in Hong Kong.
- Vellayan Subbiah, Executive Vice Chairman of Tube Investments of India (TII) and Chairman of Cholanmandalam Investment and Finance Co Ltd., secured the prestigious EY World Entrepreneur of the Year 2024 award, marking the fourth time an entrepreneur from India has won this global title. His visionary leadership and transformative strategies have propelled both TII and Chola to unprecedented success, earning him recognition on the global stage.
- Siddhesh Sakore, a farmer and the founder of AGRO RANGERS from Maharashtra, has been recognized as a Land Hero by the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) on World Desertification and Drought Day. The announcement was made during a programme in Bonn, Germany, honoring 10 Land Heroes from around the globe.
- Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has been awarded the prestigious "Risk Manager of the Year Award 2024" by Central Banking, a renowned publication headquartered in London. This accolade recognizes the RBI's significant strides in cultivating a robust risk culture and heightened awareness, solidifying its essential role in maintaining the stability of India's financial system.
- The Sahitya Akademi on June 15, announced the names of 23 writers, including English writer K Vaishali and Hindi author Gaurav Pandey, who will receive the prestigious Yuva Puraskar across as many languages.
- The Kottakkal Arya Vaidya Sala, a renowned Ayurvedic institution, celebrated a significant achievement as its managing trustee and chief physician, P. Madhavankutty Varier, was awarded an honorary Doctor of Science (DSc) degree by the Kerala University of Health Sciences (KUHS).
- Eminent children's filmmaker Vinod Ganatra has become the first Indian to be conferred with South Africa's prestigious 'Nelson Mandela Lifetime Achievement Award' for his outstanding contribution to children's cinema. The award was presented to him at the 7th Nelson Mandela Children's Film Festival.
- The renowned wildlife filmmaker Subbiah Nallamuthu has been conferred with the prestigious 18th V. Shantaram Lifetime Achievement Award for his outstanding contributions to the field of non-feature and wildlife documentary filmmaking. The award was presented to him by the Union Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting, L. Murugan, at the inaugural ceremony of the 18th Mumbai International Film Festival in Mumbai, Maharashtra.
- Karnataka Vikas Grameena Bank (KVGB), a regional rural bank sponsored by Canara Bank, has been honoured with a national award by the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) for significant enrolment under the Atal Pension Yojana (APY).
- India's first artificial intelligence university, Universal AI University (UAIU), has appointed international strategist and multiple award-winning professor Simon Mak as its vice-chancellor. Mak is the first non-Indian to hold the position of founding vice chancellor of an Indian institution.
- Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE) Ltd. has been honoured with the "Sustainable Governance Champion Award" at the Outlook Planet Sustainability Summit & Awards 2024. This recognition highlights GRSE's unwavering commitment to sustainable practices and governance excellence.
- In a significant recognition of her literary contributions, Booker Prize-winning author Arundhati Roy has been awarded the esteemed Pen Pinter Prize for 2024. This honour comes at a time when Roy faces potential legal challenges, highlighting the importance of her work and the ongoing struggle for freedom of expression.
- In a heartwarming celebration of linguistic and cultural ties between India and Nepal, Dr. Usha Thakur has been honoured with the 12th Vishwa Hindi Samman. This prestigious award recognizes her outstanding contributions to Hindi literature and her efforts in strengthening the bonds between Hindi and Nepali languages.

Awards Current Affairs of July 2024

- In a significant recognition of feminist literature and studies, writer, critic, and feminist activist P. Geetha has been awarded the first K. Saraswathi Amma Award. This prestigious accolade, instituted by WINGS (Women's Integration and Growth Through Sports) Kerala, marks a pivotal moment in the acknowledgment of feminist contributions to literature and social discourse.
- Sopna Kallingal of Kallingal Plantation, Thrissur, received Spice Award 2024, instituted by ICAR-Indian Institute of Spices Research. The award has been given to her for her initiatives in enterprise diversification and integrated crop management strategies, promoting a sustainable spice-based cropping system.
- Roshni Nadar Malhotra, Chairperson of IT services firm HCLTech, has been conferred with the "Chevalier de la Légion d'Honneur" (Knight of the Legion of Honour), the highest civilian award of France.
- Tamil literature, renowned author Sivashankari has been selected as the recipient of the highly esteemed Dr. C. Narayana Reddy National Literary Award. This prestigious accolade celebrates her immense contributions to the rich tapestry of Tamil literary culture and her role in shaping contemporary Indian literature.

- In a significant recognition of his contributions to alternative medicine, **Dr. Arpit Chopra**, a distinguished homoeopathic practitioner, was bestowed with the **Excellence Award at the NDTV MSMES (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) Summit held in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh**. The award ceremony, which took place at the Marriott Hotel, saw the presence of several high-ranking state officials and industry leaders.
- Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** ceremoniously presented with the **Order of St Andrew the Apostle the First-Called**, which was bestowed on him in the year 2019 at St Catherine's Hall of the Moscow Kremlin. The order was presented to the Prime Minister of India for his distinguished contribution to the development of a privileged strategic partnership between Russia and India and friendly ties between the two countries.
- In a significant recognition of his contributions to the field of **victimology**, retired professor **K. Chockalingam** from Tamil Nadu, India, has been selected for the esteemed **Hans von Hentig award**. This honour highlights the global impact of Indian scholarship in the study of crime victims and their experiences within the criminal justice system.
- Renowned sand artist **Sudarsan Pattnaik** on July 12, won the **Golden Sand Master award** at an international championship in **Russia**. The event, International Sand Sculpture Championship was **organised from July 4-12 in St Petersburg** at the iconic **Peter and Paul Fortress**. The **world's 21 master sculptors** participated in the event.
- **Andhra Pradesh Community Managed Natural Farming (APCNF)** initiative has been awarded the prestigious **2024 Gulbenkian Prize for Humanity**. This accolade not only highlights India's progress in sustainable farming but also places Andhra Pradesh on the global map for its pioneering efforts in eco-friendly agriculture.
- **Sobha Group's CSR wing, Sri Kurumba Educational and Charitable Trust**, has been honoured with the **"Best Child and Women Development Initiatives of the Year 2024."** This esteemed accolade was presented at the Global CSR, Sustainability, and ESG Awards 2024, at the **Hyatt Regency, Gurgaon**. The event was organised by Marketing and Brand Honchos and brought together industry leaders and champions of social responsibility.
- The **Committee on Space Research (COSPAR)**, the world's first scientific body dedicated to space science research, has recognized the outstanding contributions of two Indian space scientists at its 45th scientific assembly in Busan, South Korea. **Prahlad Chandra Agrawal**, one of India's most senior space scientists, received the esteemed **Harrie Massey Award**. **Anil Bhardwaj**, the director of the Ahmedabad-based **Physical Research Laboratory (PRL)**, was awarded the **Vikram Sarabhai Medal**.
- **Rigoberta Menchú Tum**, the renowned **Nobel Peace Prize** laureate and Guatemalan human rights activist, has been honored with the **Gandhi Mandela Award 2020**. This prestigious accolade recognizes her lifelong commitment to advocating for **Indigenous rights** and promoting peace and social justice.
- **Ram Charan**, the superstar known for his stellar performance in the global blockbuster "RRR", is set to be the guest of honor at the prestigious **Indian Film Festival of Melbourne (IFFM) 2024**. This recognition comes as a testament to his significant contributions to Indian cinema and his rising international profile.
- The **Indian Institute of Spices Research (IISR)** has received the best technology award for its pioneering work in the field of horticultural sciences. Union Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan presented the award during the **96th Foundation Day celebrations** of the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) in New Delhi.
- **Curator and author Rahaab Allana** has been awarded the insignia of **Officier dans l'Ordre des Arts et des Lettres** by the **French government**.
- The International Olympic Committee (IOC) has **honored Abhinav Bindra, India's first individual Olympic gold medalist**, with the prestigious Olympic Order.
- Bollywood superstar **Shah Rukh Khan** has been honoured with customised **gold coins by the Grevin Museum in Paris**.
- Union Minister for Information and Broadcasting, **Ashwini Vaishnaw**, announced the winners of the **10th National Community Radio Awards** and inaugurated the country's **500th Community Radio Station**.
- The Town Official Language Implementation Committee (TOLIC) honored **Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)** in Visakhapatnam with the **'Rajbhasha Gaurav Samman'** for the year 2023-24.
- In a ceremony to mark the **International Meet** of leading medical celebrities, professionals and Medicos from all over the country and abroad, **Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh** was conferred the prestigious **"Lifetime Achievement Award"**
- The Central Water Commission (CWC) has been honored with the **GEEF Global WaterTech Award** in the category **'Water Department of the Year'** at the **Global Water Tech Summit - 2024**, held by the Global Energy and Environment Foundation (GEEF) in New Delhi.
- Indian students have secured **two gold and three silver medals** at the **54th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2024** held between **July 21 and July 29 in Isfahan, Iran**.
- The year 2024 marks a significant milestone in the field of Indian epigraphy as **V. Vedachalam**, a renowned Tamil epigrapher and historian, receives the prestigious **V Venkayya Epigraphy Award**.

Awards Current Affairs of August 2024

- Bollywood's charismatic **'King Khan'**, graced the **77th Locarno Film Festival** with his presence on August 10, receiving a career achievement award that further gilds his storied career.
- Out of **208 gallantry awards**, **52** have been awarded to the personnel deployed in Left-wing extremism areas, **31 in the Jammu and Kashmir** region, and **17 to those from Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra**.
- The **Rajiv Gandhi International Airport (RGIA)** in Hyderabad has once again been recognized as the **Best Airport** at the prestigious **India Travel Awards**, marking its third consecutive win in this category.
- President **Droupadi Murmu** presided over a distinguished ceremony at the Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi to confer the prestigious **2023 National Geoscience Awards** to outstanding individuals and teams in the field of geosciences.
- The **Export Promotion Council for Handicrafts (EPCH)** organised its **24th Handicrafts Export Awards Function** on August 21, at the Convention Hall.
- President **Droupadi Murmu** presided over the first-ever investiture ceremony for the **Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar** (National Science Awards).
- The 11th edition of the **Puthiya Thalaimurai Tamilan Awards** recently honored outstanding individuals across various fields, recognizing both seasoned professionals and emerging talents.
- The **Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI)** recently organized its prestigious **Young Leaders Awards** in New Delhi, bringing together a diverse array of talented individuals from various fields. The ceremony was graced by two outstanding personalities who received the coveted **FICCI Young Leaders Youth Icon** award:
- **Ayushmann Khurrana**: Bollywood superstar and versatile actor
- **Neeraj Chopra**: Olympic gold medalist (Tokyo 20) in javelin throw
- **Kerala Tourism** has once again put India on the global tourism map by winning the prestigious **Pacific Asia Travel Association (PATA) Gold Award 2024**.

Awards Current Affairs of September 2024

- President **Emmanuel Macron** of France was awarded the **Olympic Order in gold**. This prestigious distinction was bestowed upon him by the **International Olympic Committee (IOC)** in recognition of his unwavering support for the Olympic Games Paris 2024.
- India celebrated Teachers' Day with a prestigious ceremony in New Delhi, where **President Droupadi Murmu** conferred the **National Teachers' Award 2024** to 82 exceptional educators from across the country. This annual event, commemorating the birth anniversary of Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, recognizes the pivotal role of teachers in shaping the nation's future.

- **Prasanthi Ram (32)**, who was an Indian origin lecturer from the University of Nanyang technological University won the Singapore literature prize for English fiction for her short story **'Nine Yard Sarees'** and it was her debut work which was published at the end of year 2023.
- **Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL)**, the corporate entity of **Visakhapatnam Steel Plant**, has once again achieved excellence in energy efficiency and conservation by winning the prestigious **National Energy Leader Award** from the **Confederation of Indian Industry – Green Business Centre (CII-GBC)**. This marks the sixth consecutive year that RINL has received this accolade, demonstrating its steadfast commitment to sustainable energy practices.
- On 14th September 2024, during Hindi Diwas Celebrations at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, the Secretary of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (**DARPG**), **Mr. V. Srinivas**, was awarded the **Rajbhasha Kirti Puraskar by the Hon'ble Home Minister, Shri Amit Shah**.
- The Indian Women Dubai Awards 2024 took place in Dubai, honoring the achievements of **Indian women who have contributed in various fields of excellence across the UAE**. This event celebrated empowerment, resilience, and unity, showcasing the impact of women who are shaping the community.
- At the **South Indian International Movie Awards (SIIMA) 2024**, **Aishwarya Rai Bachhan** stood out as she received the **Best Actress (critics) Award** for her role in **Maniratnam's epic "Ponniyin Selvan 2"**.
- **Dhruvi Patel**, a Computer Information System student from the USA, has been declared the **winner of Miss India Worldwide 2024**, the longest running Indian pageant outside of India.
- **Jaipur, the capital of Rajasthan**, is set to host the prestigious 25th edition of the **International Indian Film Academy (IIFA) Awards** from March 7 to 9, 2025, at the **JECC Sitapura**. The announcement was made during a formal agreement signing ceremony at the **iconic Albert Hall**, attended by **Deputy Chief Minister Diya Kumari**. The Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was signed by Rajasthan Tourism Commissioner **VP Singh** and IIFA Vice President **Suresh Iyer**, marking the beginning of preparations for this grand event.
- **Emerging swimmer Pratyasa Ray** has been selected for the **32nd Ekalabya Puraskar for 2024** for her achievements in swimming. A proud moment for **Odisha's sporting fraternity**.
- **Rhea Singha**, a **19-year-old model from Gujarat**, was crowned **Miss Universe India 2024** in Jaipur. She will represent India at the **global Miss Universe competition in Mexico**.
- Renowned Bollywood producer **Vinod Bachchan** received the prestigious **Global Prestige Award at the House of Lords, UK Parliament**, recognizing his significant contributions to the Indian film industry.

- **Visionary industrialist and leader Shri Deepak C Mehta**, Chairman and Managing Director of Deepak Nitrite Limited, has been conferred the prestigious **Lifetime Achievement Award by the Indian Chemical Council (ICC) at the 59th ICC Annual Awards Function in Mumbai.**
- The world of mathematics is set to celebrate another brilliant mind as the **2024 SASTRA Ramanujan Prize** finds its recipient. This prestigious award, which recognizes outstanding contributions in mathematics, particularly those influenced by the legendary Srinivasa Ramanujan, will be bestowed upon **Alexander Dunn** of the Georgia Institute of Technology, U.S.

Awards Current Affairs of October 2024

S.No.	Name of Award	Winner
1	SASTRA Ramanujan Prize	Alexander Dunn
2	Dadasaheb Phalke Award	Mithun Chakraborty
3	MIDORI Prize for Biodiversity 2024	Vera Voronova, Ysabel Agustina Calderón
4	Honorary Doctorate in Political Science	President Droupadi Murmu
5	Femina Miss India 2024	Nikita Porwal
6	V&A Illustration Awards - Emerging Illustrator	Aditi Anand
7	National Kishore Kumar Award	Rajkumar Hirani
8	2024 Patrick J. McGovern Awards	Narayana Murthy
9	International Astronautical Federation (IAF) World Space Award	Dr. S. Somanath
10	Special Recognition at the Conscious Companies Awards	Mohanji
11	Jury Member for ALT EFF 2024	Dia Mirza
12	Richest City Globally for Sovereign Wealth Funds	Abu Dhabi
13	SHRM HR Excellence Awards	Steel Authority of India Limited
14	Mahatma Gandhi Leadership Award	Darasing Khurana
15	Global Anti-Racism Championship Award	Urmila Chaudhary
16	Sakharov Prize for Freedom of Thought	María Corina Machado and Edmundo González
17	Sakharov Prize for Freedom of Thought is the highest human rights honor	Soviet physicist and dissident Andrei Sakharov
18	Harry Messel Award for Conservation Leadership	Bibhab Kumar Talukdar
19	A+ grade in the Central Bank Report Cards 2024	Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Shaktikanta Das
20	ANR National Awards 2024	Actor Chiranjeevi
21	Honourary Officer of the Order of Fiji	Gurudev Sri Sri Ravi Shankar
22	Best Companies for Women in India'	DBS Bank India
23	Francis Ford Coppola	AFI Life Achievement Award

Awards Current Affairs of November 2024

- Anil Pradhan has been awarded the prestigious **Rohini Nayyar Prize for 2024**, recognizing his impactful contributions to rural development in India. Known for his dedication to empowering rural communities, Pradhan's work has brought positive change and opportunities to underserved areas.
- **Kunal Dalal, Managing Director of JBCN Education**, was awarded Education Leader of the Year at the Education World India School Ranking Awards 2024-2025 in Gurgaon. The recognition highlights his visionary leadership and commitment to developing a progressive network of international schools.
- **Veteran Australian filmmaker Phillip Noyce**, renowned for his acclaimed works such as Clear and Present Danger, Salt, and Rabbit-Proof Fence, will be honored with the prestigious **Satyajit Ray Lifetime Achievement Award** at the 55th International Film Festival of India (IFFI).
- **The ICC** has announced the winners of the **Players of the Month for October 2024**, with New Zealand's all-rounder Amelia Kerr and Pakistan's spinner Noman Ali taking the honors.

- British author **Samantha Harvey** has won the prestigious **Booker Prize for Fiction** for her novel "Orbital," a thought-provoking and imaginative exploration set in the unique setting of the **International Space Station (ISS)**.
- The **Commonwealth of Dominica** has announced that it will award **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** its highest national honour, the **Dominica Award of Honour**, in recognition of his significant contributions to the island nation, particularly during the **COVID-19 pandemic**.
- Manoj Bajpayee's** film **The Fable** won the **Best Film award at the 38th Leeds International Film Festival**, securing recognition in the **Constellation Feature Film Competition**. Directed by **Raam Reddy**, the film has been praised for its unique storytelling and magical realism, marking a significant achievement for both Indian and international cinema.
- GMR Hyderabad International Airport Limited (GHIAL)** has received global recognition at the prestigious '**Airport Excellence Awards**' during the **Saudi Airport Exhibition 2024**, held on November 12 at the **Riyadh International Convention and Exhibition Center**.
- Prime Minister **Shri Narendra Modi** was awarded the prestigious "**Grand Commander of the Order of Niger**" by **H.E. Mr. Bola Ahmed Tinubu**, President of Nigeria, at the **State House**. This honor recognizes Modi's **visionary leadership, transformative governance**, and his significant efforts in strengthening **India-Nigeria relations** and supporting the aspirations of the **Global South**.
- At the **73rd Miss Universe** pageant in **Mexico**, **Victoria Kjaer Theilvig** from **Denmark** made history by becoming the country's first-ever **Miss Universe**. The **21-year-old** from **Søborg** outshone **125 contestants**, including India's **Rhea Singha**. The **first runner-up** was **Chidimma Adetshina** from **Nigeria**, and the **second runner-up** was **Maria Fernanda Beltran** from **Mexico**.
- The **Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament, and Development** for 2023 was awarded to **Daniel Barenboim**, a renowned pianist and conductor, and **Ali Abu Awwad**, a Palestinian peace activist, on **November 19, 2024**. The prestigious award honors their exceptional contributions to promoting **peace and non-violence**.
- Coal India Limited (CIL)** won the **Green World Environment Award 2024** in the **CSR** category and was named **Green World Ambassador**. This recognition highlights CIL's commitment to **sustainability and social welfare**, acknowledging its balance between industrial operations and environmental contributions.
- Shivangi Desai**, a **22-year-old** final-year law student at the **Indian Law School (ILS) Pune**, has made India proud by winning the prestigious **Miss Charm India 2024** title. Representing India at **Miss Charm 2024** in **Vietnam** this December.
- The **Association of Indian American Minorities (AIAM)**, a newly launched NGO, was inaugurated on **November 22, 2024**, at the **Sligo Seventh-day Adventist Church** in **Maryland, USA**. The organization seeks to promote unity and uplift minority communities within the **Indian American diaspora**. During the launch, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** was honored in absentia with the '**Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Global Peace Award for Minority Upliftment**' for his contributions to **inclusive development and minority welfare**.
- The **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare's 'One Health' Pavilion** at the **43rd India International Trade Fair (IITF)** in **New Delhi** was awarded a **Special Appreciation Medal** for its innovative design and impactful presentation of India's **healthcare initiatives**. This recognition highlights the Ministry's commitment to a **holistic approach** to health, integrating **human, animal, plant, and environmental well-being**.
- The **Indian Chemical Council (ICC)** was awarded the prestigious **2024 OPCW-The Hague Award** at the **29th Session of the Conference of the States Parties (CSP)** in **The Hague** on November 25, 2024. This marks the first time a **chemical industry body** has received the award, highlighting India's commitment to **chemical safety** and compliance with the **Chemical Weapons Convention (CWC)**. **Mr. D. Sothi Selvam**, Director General of ICC, accepted the award from **Ambassador Fernando Arias** (OPCW Director-General).

Awards Current Affairs of December 2024

- Maria Victoria Juan**, a nurse from the **Philippine Army Health Services**, has been awarded the **Aster Guardians Global Nursing Award 2024** for her exceptional contributions to healthcare. Recognized for her dedication and resilience, she was honored for transforming the healthcare landscape, particularly within the **Armed Forces of the Philippines**.
- Jasleen Kaur**, a Glasgow-born Scottish Sikh artist, won the **Turner Prize 2024** for her solo exhibition **Alter Altar** at **Tate Britain**. The exhibition combines **sculpture, sound, and music** to explore **community, cultural inheritance, and anti-colonial struggles**. Kaur's work, using everyday objects like **Irri-Bru, family photos, and a vintage Ford Escort**, reflects themes of **resilience, memory, and identity**. She received a **£25,000** prize for her innovative storytelling.
- India won the **ISSA Good Practice Award for Asia and Pacific 2024** for its innovative social security practices. **EPFO** also received **five Certificates of Merit** for enhancing **service delivery, communication, and inclusivity** in social security. The awards were presented by **Dr. Mohammed Azman** at the **Regional Social Security Forum** in **Riyadh, Saudi Arabia**.

- **Payal Kapadia** made history as the first **Indian director** to receive a **Golden Globe nomination** for **Best Director (Motion Picture)**. Her film, **All We Imagine As Light**, also earned a nomination for **Best Motion Picture (Non-English Language)** at the **82nd Golden Globe Awards**, highlighting the global impact of Indian cinema and her exceptional storytelling.
- **Bharati Kolli**, a 43-year-old from **Vizianagaram, Andhra Pradesh**, has been named one of the **Rising Star Women Leaders of Banking for 2024** by **Women We Admire**. Her exceptional contributions in **data management** have earned her this honor. Bharati currently serves as the **Director of the Data Management Office** at the **Industrial and Commercial Bank of China (ICBC)** in **New York**.
- Veteran filmmaker **Shaji N Karun** has been awarded the **JC Daniel Award 2023** for his lifetime contributions to **Malayalam cinema**. This prestigious recognition includes a **Rs 5 lakh purse, citation, and statuette**. The jury, led by **TV Chandran**, praised Shaji for his influence on **new-wave Malayalam cinema**, which redefined the global perception of the industry.
- **Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)** won two prestigious awards at the **3rd PSU Transformation Awards 2024** in **New Delhi** for its innovation and technological advancements in the **shipbuilding** and **ship repair** industry. These accolades emphasize HSL's commitment to pioneering solutions in the **maritime sector**, solidifying its position as a key player in the field.
- **Ang Lee**, the Taiwanese American filmmaker, has been awarded the **2025 Directors Guild of America (DGA) Lifetime Achievement Award**. Recognized for his **innovative storytelling** and versatility across genres, Lee's career spans over three decades, earning him **two Academy Awards** and numerous accolades. His influence continues to inspire both audiences and filmmakers globally.
- India's "**The Kumbaya Story**" won the **Transforming Society Short Film** category at the **13th tve Global Sustainability Film Awards (GSFA)** in **London**, highlighting India's growing influence in sustainability storytelling. The film, produced by **Kumbaya Producer Co. Ltd.**, showcases women transforming their lives through weaving. Other Indian achievements include "**GOBUK – Harmony in the Highlands**" (shortlisted in Young Filmmakers category) and "**Laapataa Ladies**" (India's official **Oscar 2025** entry, shortlisted for Founder's Award).
- The **Ram temple** project in **Ayodhya** received the prestigious '**Sword of Honour**' from the **British Safety Council** for outstanding safety measures. The award, announced by **Nripendra Misra**, chairman of the **Construction Committee**, highlights the project's adherence to global safety standards. To earn the award, the temple's construction underwent a rigorous audit, achieving a **five-star assessment** and excelling in on-site safety practices, setting a global construction safety benchmark.
- **Suryabala**, the Hindi writer, has been awarded the **34th Vyas Samman 2024** for her novel **Kaun Des Ko Vasi: Venu Ki Diary**, published in 2018. The novel explores **cultural conflicts** and **identity struggles** of Indian youth in **America**. Instituted by the **KK Birla Foundation**, the award includes a **₹4 lakh** prize, a citation, and a plaque. The selection committee was led by **Prof. Ramji Tiwari**.
- **Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw**, Chairperson of **Biocon Group**, was honored with the **Jamsetji Tata Award** by the **Indian Society for Quality (ISQ)** for her outstanding contributions to the **biosciences** sector. This award recognizes her leadership in making **Biocon** a global leader in **biotechnology** since 1978, while maintaining a strong focus on **quality**. The award, instituted in 2004, celebrates business leaders who exemplify innovation, quality, and societal commitment, reflecting the legacy of **Jamsetji Tata**.
- **Arun Kapur**, an Indian educationist, was honoured by **Bhutan's King Jigme Khesar Namgyel** during the **117th Bhutanese National Day** celebrations in **Thimphu**. He was conferred the prestigious **Red Scarf** and the rare '**Dasho**' title for his contributions to education in **India, Bhutan, and Oman**. The '**Dasho**' title is typically reserved for senior Bhutanese officials.
- The **100th edition** of the **Tansen Sangeet Samaroh** concluded in **Gwalior** from **December 15-19, 2024**, celebrating India's rich classical music heritage. Organized by Madhya Pradesh's **Culture Department**, the festival honored **Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri**, a **Padma Shri** recipient and tabla virtuoso, with the **Rashtriya Tansen Samman 2023**. The award includes a **₹5 lakh cash prize** and a citation plaque. Chaudhuri, renowned for his mastery of the **Farukhabad gharana**, expressed gratitude, marking this recognition as a highlight in his career. The **Raja Mansingh Tomar Samman 2023** was also awarded to **Sanand Nyas Sanstha** from **Indore**.
- **Tom Cruise** has received the **US Navy's Distinguished Public Service Award** for his contributions in promoting the military, particularly through his iconic roles in **Top Gun**. The award recognizes his efforts in increasing **public awareness** and appreciation of the **US Navy** and its personnel.
- **Caitlin Sandra Neil**, a **19-year-old Indian-American** from **Chennai**, was crowned **Miss India USA 2024**. A second-year student at the **University of California, Davis**, Caitlin focuses on **women's empowerment** and **literacy**, aspiring to be a **web designer**, model, and actress. Other winners included **Mrs. India USA 2024 Sanskriti Sharma** and **Miss Teen India USA 2024 Arshita Kathpalia**. The **runners-up** were **Nirali Desia** (First) and **Manini Patel** (Second).

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Ranks and Reports Current Affairs

January to December 2024

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of January 2024

- In a recent on-time performance review conducted by aviation analytics firm **Cirium**, **Hyderabad and Bengaluru airports** have emerged as global leaders in punctuality, securing the second and third ranks, respectively. With over 84 per cent on-time departures, these airports have showcased their commitment to efficiency and reliability in air travel.
- Francoise Bettencourt Meyers** has made history by becoming the **first woman to amass a staggering \$100 billion fortune**. This remarkable achievement not only cements her status as a global financial powerhouse but also signifies a significant milestone for the expanding fashion and cosmetics industries in France. Bettencourt Meyers' wealth surged to an astounding **\$100.1 billion** as reported by the **Bloomberg Billionaires Index**.
- The **International Labour Organization (ILO)** warns of a slight increase in global unemployment this year, with the rate projected to reach 5.2%, up from 5.1% in 2023. This modest rise, outlined in the ILO's "World Employment and Social Outlook Trends: 2024" report, is primarily driven by job losses in advanced economies.
- Hyderabad**, the capital city of Telangana, achieved a significant milestone by **securing the ninth position** in cleanliness among cities with a **population exceeding one lakh** in the Swachh Survekshan Awards 2023. Additionally, **Siddipet**, a city in Telangana, proudly clinched the national award for being the **cleanest city in south India** within the 50,000-1 lakh population category.
- In a significant stride towards poverty alleviation, a recent NITI Aayog report reveals that **24.82 crore people in India** have successfully moved out of **multidimensional poverty** from 2013-14 to 2022-23. The decline is remarkable, dropping from **29.17% to 11.28%** during this period. The multidimensional poverty index assesses deprivations across health, education, and standard of living using 12 sustainable development goals-aligned indicators. At the state level, **Uttar Pradesh takes the lead** with 5.94 crore people escaping poverty, followed by Bihar at 3.77 crore and Madhya Pradesh at 2.30 crore.
- In the recently unveiled **Edelman Trust Barometer 2024**, India emerges as a global frontrunner in trust, topping the charts in confidence in businesses and non-governmental organizations (NGOs). However, the nation secures the 4th spot for media trust and the 5th position for trust in the government. The comprehensive survey, encompassing over 32,000 respondents across 28 countries, highlights a pattern where developing nations outpace their developed counterparts in overall trust perception.
- The startup ecosystem in India witnessed a significant boost as **Gujarat, Kerala, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu** emerged as the **best-performing states in the Startup Ranking for 2022**. The rankings, released by Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, highlight the commendable initiatives undertaken by these states to foster the growth of startups and encourage budding entrepreneurs. **Maharashtra, Odisha, Punjab, Rajasthan, and Telangana** were also recognized as top performers in this dynamic landscape.
- The World Health Organization (WHO) has issued comprehensive guidelines for the ethical use and governance of **Large Multi-Modal Models (LMM) in healthcare**. These advanced generative AI technologies, such as ChatGPT, Bard, and Bert, have rapidly transformed healthcare delivery and medical research by processing diverse data inputs like text, videos, and images. Despite their potential benefits, WHO emphasizes the critical need to carefully evaluate the risks associated with LMM adoption.
- Bhopal**, the capital city of Madhya Pradesh, has made significant strides in cleanliness, emerging as the **5th cleanest city in India** among those with a population exceeding 1 lakh. The Bhopal Municipal Corporation's persistent efforts have not only elevated its ranking from 6th in 2022 but also earned it a coveted **5-star Garbage Free City (GFC) rating**, making it the cleanest State capital in the nation.
- The '**INDIA AGEING REPORT 2023**,' jointly conducted by the **International Institute for Population Sciences** and the **United Nations Population Fund**, provides a comprehensive overview of the aging demographic in Jammu Kashmir. **Jammu Kashmir** emerges as a region with remarkable resilience against elderly poverty, boasting a mere 4.2 percent of its aged population falling below the poverty line. Among the elderly, constituting 9.4 percent of the region's population, Jammu Kashmir stands out with the **highest life expectancy after the age of 60**. Males exhibit a life expectancy of 20.3 percent, and females, 23.0 percent, making it the leader in this demographic indicator between 2015-19.
- The **All India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) 2021-22**, released by the Ministry of Education, unveils a significant spike in higher education enrollment. The total enrollment soared from 4.14 crore in the previous session to nearly 4.33 crore in 2021-22, marking a notable uptick of 19 lakh students. The report highlights a commendable rise in female enrollment in the science stream, surpassing male counterparts.

- Union Minister of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change, Shri **Bhupender Yadav**, released a significant report on the status of Snow leopards in India. This groundbreaking study, part of the **Snow Leopard Population Assessment in India (SPAI) Program**, marks the first-ever scientific exercise to assess the population of this elusive species in the country.
- India's placement in the Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) for 2023 remained largely unchanged, securing the **93rd position out of 180 countries**. The CPI, curated by Transparency International, evaluates nations based on their perceived levels of public sector corruption, utilizing a scale from 0 to 100, where 0 signifies high corruption and 100 represents very clean governance.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of February 2024

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- In a remarkable achievement, Mukesh Ambani, the visionary leader steering Reliance Industries Limited, secures the first position among Indian executives and an impressive second globally in the prestigious **Brand**

Guardianship Index 2024 by Brand Finance. This recognition places Ambani ahead of renowned global leaders such as Satya Nadella, Sundar Pichai, Tim Cook, and Elon Musk.

- India's logistics performance has seen remarkable improvements, as indicated by its rank in the **Logistics Performance Index (LPI) Report by the World Bank**. Through collaborative efforts among various ministries and departments, alongside the implementation of key policies and initiatives, India is advancing towards enhancing its competitiveness globally. India has significantly climbed in the Logistics Performance Index (LPI) ranking, securing the **38th position out of 139 countries**, according to the World Bank's report.
- **TomTom**, a leading expert in location technology, has unveiled revealing insights into the global challenge of traffic congestion. Among the standout findings, **London emerges as a focal point**, experiencing the slowest traffic in 2023. This revelation, based on TomTom's comprehensive analysis, underscores the pressing need for innovative solutions to tackle urban mobility challenges. TomTom's report also sheds light on the traffic woes plaguing major Indian cities such as Bengaluru, Pune, Delhi, and Mumbai.
- The latest Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) data released by the National Statistical Office indicates a continued improvement in India's urban labour markets. The **urban jobless rate** for Q3FY24 dropped to **6.5%**, showcasing a marginal decrease from the previous quarter and marking a significant decline from the peak observed during the Covid-affected period in FY22.
- In a significant step towards environmental conservation and sustainable land management, **NITI Aayog**, the premier policy think tank of the Government of India, launched the **Greening and Restoration of Wasteland with Agroforestry (GROW) report and portal**. This groundbreaking initiative aims to transform India's underutilized wastelands into productive agroforestry zones, leveraging state-of-the-art remote sensing and **Geographic Information Systems (GIS) technologies** for a comprehensive analysis at both state and district levels.
- In 2023, India ranked as the **80th most targeted country** for cybercrime globally. Local threats affected approximately 34% of users, resulting in the blocking of 74,385,324 incidents by **Kaspersky products**. The country's cybersecurity market reached USD 6.06 billion in 2023, yet the surge in sophisticated external cyber threats poses a significant challenge for enterprises, according to IDC.
- In 2023, **India surpassed China** to become **HSBC's third-largest profit hub**, showcasing a remarkable surge in profitability. The fiscal year ending December 2023 saw India's profits soar by 25% to reach an impressive **\$1.5 billion**. HSBC's annual report for the fiscal year ending December 2023 unveiled key insights into India's exceptional performance.

- NITI Aayog CEO **B V R Subrahmanyam** highlights key findings from the latest NSSO consumer expenditure survey, revealing a significant reduction in poverty levels to **below 5% in India**. He emphasizes the growing prosperity evident in both rural and urban areas, as indicated by the substantial increase in per capita monthly household expenditure.
- India's weightage in the **MSCI Global Standard (Emerging Markets) index** has reached a **historic high of 18.2%** following MSCI's February review. This surge, **nearly doubling since November 2020**, is attributed to various factors such as standardized foreign ownership limits, sustained domestic equity rally, and relative underperformance of other emerging markets, particularly China.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of March 2024

- Bloomberg has announced the inclusion of **India's Fully Accessible Route (FAR) bonds** in its Emerging Market (EM) Local Currency Government Index and related indices, with a phased approach over ten months starting January 31, 2025. This follows JP Morgan's similar move earlier, signaling increased foreign investment potential in Indian government securities.
- According to the latest data from the **Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI)**, India was the world's top arms importer for the period 2019-2023. India's arms imports witnessed a **4.7% increase** compared to the 2014-2018 period.
- **Dr. Jitendra Singh** unveiled the report "**A Decade of Science – Technology Panorama for Aatmanirbhar Bharat**" at Vigyan Bhavan. Under the leadership of **Prof. Ajay Kumar Sood**, the (Office of Principal Scientific Advisor) OPSA to the Government of India, in collaboration with **FAST India**, has compiled a comprehensive overview of India's technological advancements over the past decade in this report.
- India's position on the **DHL Global Connectedness Index** has seen a notable rise, reflecting its burgeoning role in the global economy. From ranking **67th in 2022**, India has advanced to the **62nd position in 2023**, underscoring its increasing significance in the realm of globalization.
- The **World Meteorological Organization (WMO)** released its **State of the Global Climate 2023** report, revealing unprecedented levels of climate change indicators. These indicators underscore the urgent need for global action to mitigate the impacts of climate change.
- The **United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD)** has released its **Global Trade Update report**, outlining the state of global trade in 2023 and projections for 2024. Despite a 3% dip in global trade to **\$31 trillion in 2023**, a rebound is expected in 2024 amid geopolitical uncertainties and logistical challenges.

- In a landmark shift, **Mumbai has overtaken Beijing as Asia's billionaire capital**, according to the latest report from the **Shanghai-based Hurun Research Institute**. This monumental achievement reflects Mumbai's burgeoning economic landscape and underscores India's rising prominence in global wealth distribution.
- In the latest **Brand Finance Insurance 100, 2024 report**, Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) solidifies its position as the strongest insurance brand worldwide, maintaining a stable brand value of Rs 816 billion. With a **Brand Strength Index score of 88.3 and an AAA brand strength rating**, LIC showcases its unparalleled prominence in the industry.
- The **International Labour Organization (ILO)** in collaboration with the **Institute of Human Development (IHD)** has released the '**India Employment Report 2024**,' shedding light on the challenges faced by the Indian job market as the financial year comes to a close. **Chief Economic Adviser V. Anantha Nageswaran** unveiled the report, which outlines significant shifts in employment patterns and trends in education levels among the unemployed, spanning two decades up to 2022.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of April 2024

- The northern Indian state of **Uttar Pradesh** has taken the lead in having the highest number of **Geographical Indication (GI)** certified products in the country. With the recent addition of 15 new products, Uttar Pradesh now boasts a total of **69 GI-tagged products**, surpassing Tamil Nadu's 58.
- A recent Lancet study reveals a significant rise in global life expectancy, with an **average increase of 6.2 years between 1990 and 2021**. Notably, India has seen an eight-year increase during this period. The study attributes this rise to declines in deaths from various ailments such as diarrhoea, respiratory infections, stroke, and heart disease, although the gains were somewhat offset **by the arrival of the Covid-19 pandemic in 2020**.
- India has been identified as the country with the highest percentage of doping offenders, according to the 2022 **World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA)** report. Out of 4,064 samples collected from Indian athletes, 127 individuals tested positive for banned substances, constituting 3.26% of the sample size. This highlights a concerning trend in Indian sports and underscores the need for comprehensive measures to address doping.
- According to a report released by the think tank '**InfluenceMap**', **just 57 companies** are responsible for **80% of the world's carbon emissions** from fossil fuels and cement over the past seven years. These 57 companies are involved in the production of oil, gas, coal,

and cement in the world. The report concludes that the net zero target set under the Paris Climate Change Agreement in 2015 has not been achieved, and fossil fuels have not been able to have a significant impact on production.

- The World Health Organisation's (WHO) **2024 Global Hepatitis Report** reveals that **India is second only to China in the number of Hepatitis B and C infections, with 3.5 crore cases**. Hepatitis, characterized by liver inflammation, poses significant health risks and can be fatal. The report highlights that 254 million people are affected by Hepatitis B and 50 million by Hepatitis C globally.
- In a momentous achievement, **Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU)** has secured the top position in the **QS World University Rankings by Subject 2024**, reaffirming its status as India's premier academic institution. This remarkable feat not only underscores JNU's commitment to academic excellence but also reflects India's growing prominence in the global education landscape.
- In 2023, India emerged as a frontrunner in digital services exports, surpassing China, as outlined in the **World Trade Organisation (WTO)** report. The report highlights significant growth in digitally delivered services globally, with **India's exports reaching \$257 billion**, marking a 17 percent increase from the previous year. This growth outpaced that of Germany and China, which registered only 4 percent each.
- In its recent report titled **"Interwoven Lives, Threads of Hope,"** the **United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA)** sheds light on India's demographic landscape. With a current estimated population of 1.44 billion, India maintains its status as the most populous country globally. Notably, 24% of this vast populace falls within the age bracket of 0-14 years, indicating a significant youth demographic.
- A recent study conducted by **Australian firm Compare the Market AU** has revealed intriguing insights into **global passport affordability and accessibility**. According to the study, the **Indian passport ranks as the second cheapest worldwide**, with the UAE passport claiming the top spot for affordability. While the Indian passport offers a cost-effective option in terms of both acquisition cost and yearly expenses, its visa-free access is relatively limited compared to higher-priced passports.
- A recent report by the **Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis (IEEFA)** and **Ember** evaluates the **progress of India's clean electricity transition at the state level**. While **Karnataka and Gujarat maintain strong performances**, states like Jharkhand, Bihar, West Bengal, and Uttar Pradesh lag behind, necessitating increased efforts for renewable energy integration and decarbonization.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of May 2024

- In a remarkable achievement, **Emeritus**, the Indian edtech startup, has secured the coveted **top spot** in **TIME Magazine's "World's Top EdTech Companies of 2024" ranking**. Founded in 2015 by Ashwin Damera and Chaitanya Kalipatnapu, Emeritus offers courses from prestigious global universities, including the University of Cambridge, Harvard Business School, and MIT Sloan, among others.
- The Ministry of Health and Population of Nepal has **urged residents to wear masks** due to the alarming increase in air pollution levels in the Kathmandu valley. According to IQAir, an organization that measures real-time pollution in 101 cities worldwide, **Kathmandu has been ranked as the most polluted city globally**.
- In a testament to India's sustained economic growth, **Mumbai and Delhi** have debuted in the **top 50 wealthiest cities** worldwide according to the **Wealthiest Cities Report 2024 by Henley & Partners and New World Wealth**. **Mumbai** secured the **24th position** while **Delhi** claimed the **37th spot**.
- In 2023-24, India experienced positive export growth to **115 out of 238 countries/territories**, with major gains seen in key markets such as the USA, UAE, China, and the UK. However, import declined from **124 countries during this period**.
- The **22nd Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)** conducted by the **National Sample Survey Office (NSSO)** revealed that the unemployment rate among individuals aged 15 years and above in urban areas of India decreased to **6.7% in the January-March 2024 period**. The survey offers insights into various labor force indicators, including unemployment rate, worker population ratio (WPR), and labor force participation rate (LFPR) based on the Current Weekly Status (CWS) approach.
- The **Center for World University Rankings (CWUR)** released its **2024 report**, revealing a mixed bag for Indian higher education institutions. While the **Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Ahmedabad improved its rank**, many others, including the prestigious Indian Institute of Science, experienced a decline. The report indicates that despite advancements in research output, this success isn't translating equally to higher education excellence. Furthermore, Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs) witnessed varied performances, with IIT Bombay notably climbing in rankings.
- The **Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)**, a digital infrastructure initiative **launched in 2021**, has witnessed remarkable growth, with transactions **crossing 70 lakh in April this year**. Led by the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**, ONDC aims to democratize digital commerce and create a level playing field for businesses of all sizes. Let's explore the key highlights and significance of ONDC through subheadings.

- India has ascended to the **39th spot in the World Economic Forum's Travel & Tourism Development Index 2024**, marking a significant improvement from its 54th position in 2021. Despite challenges posed by the pandemic, India showcases resilience and competitiveness in various aspects of its travel and tourism industry.
- According to a recent report by the **Wildlife Institute of India**, there are more than **4000 Gangetic dolphins in the Gangetic River basin**. Over **2000** of these dolphins are found in **Uttar Pradesh**, primarily in the Chambal River. This increase suggests that the river's pollution levels are declining, and the government's conservation efforts are proving effective.
- In the latest **Oxford Economics' Global Cities Index**, Delhi emerges as the **highest-ranked Indian city**, securing the **350th position** among the **world's 1000 largest cities**. However, no Indian city managed to break into the top 300. The index, encompassing cities from 163 countries, evaluates cities across five key categories: **Economics, Human Capital, Quality of Life, Environment, and Governance**. New York clinches the top spot, with London, San Jose, Tokyo, and Paris following suit.
- The World Bank's report, **'Water For Shared Prosperity'**, unveiled at the **10th World Water Forum**, delineates the critical role of water in fostering equitable societies amidst global water access disparities exacerbated by population growth, urbanization, and climate change. It highlights the urgency of comprehensive strategies to ensure inclusive water security worldwide.
- In its latest notification, the Income Tax department has established the **Cost Inflation Index (CII) for the financial year 2024-25 at 363**. This index is crucial for taxpayers as it aids in computing long-term capital gains arising from the sale of various capital assets, including immovable property, securities, and jewellery. The CII serves as a tool to adjust for inflation, allowing taxpayers to determine gains accurately by considering the real appreciation of assets rather than gains attributed solely to inflation.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of June 2024

- The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations released **The State of World Fisheries and Aquaculture 2024**, its flagship report providing a comprehensive analysis of the global and regional status and trends in fisheries and aquaculture. It shows, for the first time in 2022, that aquaculture production exceeded fisheries.
- **Infosys**, a leading information technology company, has secured its position among the **100 most valuable brands in the world** for the third consecutive year. This recognition comes from Kantar, a prominent marketing data and analytics business, further solidifying Infosys' reputation as a global brand powerhouse.

- The **Visakhapatnam Port Authority (VPA)** has secured the **18th position** in the World Bank's Container Port Performance Index (CPPI), marking a significant milestone for India's maritime industry. This achievement underscores the exemplary efforts of Terminal Operator M/s. Visakha Container Terminal Pvt. Ltd. (VCTPL) in enhancing operational efficiency and service delivery.
- Mumbai and Delhi have emerged as top performers in the global luxury real estate market, according to Knight Frank's recent report, **"Prime Global Cities Index January-March 2024"**. Both cities recorded significant increases in house prices, positioning them among the top five global cities for prime residential price growth.
- In **Mercer's 2024 Cost of Living Survey** released on June 17, Mumbai solidifies its position as **India's most expensive city** for expatriates, climbing to **136th globally and 21st in Asia**. New Delhi follows at 30th within Asia, showcasing a notable shift in cost dynamics across Indian cities. Despite economic challenges, India remains resilient, offering affordability advantages for global talent recruitment.
- India has achieved significant milestones in its domestic aviation sector over the past decade, emerging as the **world's third-largest market for domestic airlines by April 2024**. This marks a remarkable ascent from its fifth position ten years ago, driven by robust growth and strategic developments under **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership**.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of July 2024

- The **Fauna of India Checklist Portal** is the first comprehensive document on the faunal species reported from India. **India** has become the **first country** in the world to prepare a checklist of its entire **fauna**, covering **104,561 species**. The **'Fauna of India Checklist Portal'** was launched on the occasion of the 109th Foundation Day of the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) in Kolkata** on Sunday by **Union environment minister Bhupender Yadav**.
- **India ranks fifth in Generative AI (GenAI) innovations**, trailing behind China, the US, Republic of Korea, and Japan. Despite India's position, the country has shown the highest annual growth rate in GenAI patent publications, with significant potential for economic impact.
- India's population is projected to peak at **1.7 billion in the early 2060s** before declining by **12%**, as **predicted by the United Nations' World Population Prospects 2024** report. Despite the decline, India will remain the world's most populous country throughout the 21st century.
- A recent study by Kantar reveals that **Google, Tata Motors, Amazon, Jio, and Apple** are ranked as the **'most inclusive' brands in India**. The Kantar Brand Inclusion

Index 2024 highlights significant issues of discrimination and the importance of diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) for Indian consumers.

- India should set an ambitious target of achieving **\$500 billion in electronics manufacturing by 2030, as stated in a recent NITI Aayog report**. This goal includes \$350 billion from finished goods manufacturing and \$150 billion from component manufacturing. Currently, India's electronics production totals \$101 billion, with \$86 billion from finished goods and \$15 billion from components. The report, titled **"Electronics: Powering India's Participation in Global Value Chains,"** also forecasts that India's electronics exports could reach \$240 billion, with domestic value addition expected to surpass 35%.
- India has **maintained its 124th position** in the latest FIFA men's rankings released. This comes as a small relief for the success-starved nation, which has been experiencing a downward trend in recent months.
- In a recent report by the **Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)**, India has made significant strides in increasing its **forest area, gaining 266,000 hectares annually from 2010 to 2020**.
- The **data on Employment and Unemployment** is collected through **Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)** which is conducted by the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** since 2017-18.
- **Parle**, the biscuit brand owned by Parle Products, continues to be India's top FMCG brand. According to the latest edition of Brand Footprint, Kantar **World panel's annual ranking** of the **most chosen consumer brands in India**.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of August 2024

- Union Minister for Education **Shri Dharmendra Pradhan** on August 12, released the **India Rankings 2024**, which implements the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) drafted for this purpose by the Ministry of Education in 2015.
- According to the **latest data from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, net foreign direct investment (FDI) in **India surged to \$6.9 billion** during the **April-June quarter of FY25**, compared to \$4.7 billion in the same period last year.
- **Mumbai and Delhi** are at the second and third positions, respectively, among **44 cities globally** in annual price rise of prime residential properties during the June quarter, Knight Frank said in a report.
- The **Hurun India Rich List 2024** has unveiled a significant shift in the landscape of wealth distribution across Asia, with **Mumbai** emerging as the new **"billionaire capital of Asia"**.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of September 2024

- **Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, and Arunachal Pradesh** are among the least literate states, facing challenges such as inadequate infrastructure, socio-economic issues, and geographical barriers. Understanding these challenges is essential for crafting effective solutions to enhance education and foster equitable development throughout the country.
- The release of the **TIME100 Most Influential People in AI 2024 List** has once again highlighted India's significant contributions to the rapidly evolving field of artificial intelligence. Leading the pack of Indian influencers is **Sundar Pichai**, the CEO of Google and Alphabet.
- TIME Magazine's **'TIME100 Most Influential People in AI 2024'** list celebrates **15 Indian or Indian-origin individuals**, showcasing their contributions to the AI landscape. Key figures include Sundar Pichai (CEO, Google), Satya Nadella (CEO, Microsoft), Ashwini Vaishnaw (Indian Information Technology Minister), Nandan Nilekani (Infosys co-founder), and Bollywood actor Anil Kapoor. Kapoor's inclusion follows his legal victory in 2023, protecting his image from unauthorized AI use.
- The Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT), under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India, has been ranked No. 1 globally for Networking in LinkedIn's Global MBA Ranking 2024, while securing the **51st position among the top 100 MBA programmes worldwide**.
- India has overtaken China in the Morgan Stanley Capital International (MSCI) **Emerging Markets Investable Market Index (EM IMI)** with a **weightage of 22.27%**, surpassing China's 21.58%. This shift reflects India's strong market performance and favorable macroeconomic conditions, contrasted with China's economic challenges.
- As Indians roam all around the world, recent data came out as **Sri Lanka** is also one of the top travel destinations for **Indians in 2024**. India maintained the top spot for **Sri Lanka in the first 8 months of this year**.
- In a new survey which is called "Best countries for 2024" it is found that Switzerland was crowned as the best country in the world. Switzerland achieved this fate in the third year successively. This survey has included 89 countries for the results.
- **Cristiano Ronaldo**, the football icon, has once again proven his unparalleled global appeal by achieving a remarkable milestone in the world of social media. His ability to captivate audiences extends far beyond the football pitch, making him a beloved figure even among those who don't actively follow the sport.

- **India has jumped to Tier 1** in the **Global Cybersecurity Index (GCI) 2024**, released by the **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)**, when it comes to role-modeling as part of the country's cybersecurity commitments and resulting impacts.
- **Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM)**, authored by EAC-PM member **Sanjeev Sanyal**, highlights the relative economic performance of Indian states from 1960-61 to 2023-24. Titled **"Relative Economic Performance of Indian States: 1960-61 to 2023-24,"** the paper reveals that West Bengal, once holding the third-largest share of the **national GDP at 10.5% in 1960-61**, has seen a consistent decline, now accounting for only **5.6% of India's GDP in 2023-24**. The report notes that maritime states have generally outperformed others, with the exception of West Bengal.
- In a remarkable achievement for the nation's digital landscape, **India has secured Tier 1 status** in the **Global Cybersecurity Index (GCI) 2024**, published by the **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)**. This prestigious recognition places India among the world's top cybersecurity performers, showcasing the country's commitment to robust digital safety practices on a global scale.
- The **Financial Action Task Force (FATF)** recently released its **Mutual Evaluation Report on India**, following an on-site assessment in November 2023. India, which became a FATF member in 2020, was placed in the **"regular follow-up"** category, which is viewed positively given prior objections from some developed countries. The FATF identified key areas for improvement, including the prosecution of money laundering (ML) and terror financing (TF) cases, the protection of the non-profit sector from terrorist abuse, and the implementation of preventive measures.
- The IMD's recent **World Talent Ranking 2024** shows that **Switzerland ranks first**, followed by Singapore; **India finds itself ranked 58th globally**, with a talent score of **40.47**. The IMD World Talent Ranking 2024 shows the **overall ranking for 67 economies**. The economies are ranked from the most to the least competitive, and the change from the Previous year's rankings are also shown.
- **The World Wildlife Fund (WWF) has released its 2024 Living Planet Report**, revealing a stark and alarming decline in global wildlife populations. According to the report, the average size of monitored wildlife populations has **plummeted by 73% since 1970**, underscoring the urgent need for concerted efforts to address biodiversity loss. This assessment, **based on nearly 35,000 wildlife populations and 5,495 species across various ecosystems**.
- A recent survey by the **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)** highlights a remarkable **increase in the average monthly income** of rural households, which rose by 57.6% over the past five years. The second **'All India Rural Financial Inclusion Survey (NAFIS) 2021-22'** reports that the average **monthly income grew from ₹8,059 in 2016-17 to ₹12,698 in 2021-22**, indicating a **compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 9.5%**.
- The **Economic Freedom of the World: 2024 Annual Report** evaluates the extent to which individuals in **165 jurisdictions** can make their own economic choices. According to the latest data from 2022, the top three most economically free regions are **Hong Kong (1st), Singapore (2nd), and Switzerland (3rd)**. The report indicates a global decline in economic freedom over the past three years, reversing a trend of improvement that lasted nearly two decades. Also **Japan: 11th, Germany: 16th, Korea: 32nd, France: 36th, Italy: 51st, Mexico: 65th, India: 84th, Brazil: 85th, China: 104th, Russia: 119th**.
- Shillong has emerged as the most popular destination for **Indian travellers in 2025**, as revealed by Skyscanner's **"Travel Trends Report"** released on Wednesday. Meghalaya's capital topped the list, surpassing **Baku (Azerbaijan) and Langkawi (Malaysia)**, showing a strong interest among Indians for unique and immersive experiences.
- The **World Justice Project (WJP) Rule of Law Index 2024** ranks **India 79th among 142 countries**, highlighting a continued global decline in the rule of law, with 59% of surveyed nations experiencing downturns for the sixth year in a row. **Denmark, Norway, and Finland** top the list with scores of 0.87, 0.86, and 0.84, respectively, followed by Sweden and Germany. Other high-ranking countries include the **Netherlands, New Zealand, Canada, Australia, and Singapore**, all reflecting stronger rule-of-law indicators compared to the global average.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of October 2024

- India has witnessed **significant employment growth** over the years. With employment increasing by nearly **36%, adding around 17 million jobs during 2016-17 and 2022-23**, India's economic trajectory demonstrates sustained job creation across key sectors. With a robust democracy, dynamic economy, and a culture that celebrates unity in diversity, India's journey toward becoming a global powerhouse continues to inspire the world.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of November 2024

- **Artificial intelligence (AI)** is rapidly transforming the global economy, with the market projected to grow at a **36.6% CAGR from 2024 to 2030**. **The IMF's AI Preparedness Index 2023** ranks countries based on factors like digital infrastructure, human capital, and legal frameworks. Singapore leads the list, followed by Denmark and the U.S., while India ranks 72nd globally.

- **London** has retained its position as the world's top "city brand" for the second consecutive year, according to Brand Finance's Global City Index. The ranking, based on a survey of 15,000 people across 20 countries, places London first, followed by New York, Paris, Tokyo, Dubai, Singapore, Los Angeles, Sydney, San Francisco, and Amsterdam in the top 10.
- **India ranked 6th globally in intellectual property filings for the first time in 2023**, according to the WIPO Global Patent Filing Report. This milestone follows a 15.7% growth in patent filings, marking the fifth consecutive year of double-digit growth, with over 64,480 patents filed in 2023.
- **India** has reached a major milestone in **intellectual property (IP) rights**, ranking among the top 10 countries globally for patents, trademarks, and industrial designs, according to the WIPO's 2024 World Intellectual Property Indicators.
- India ranked **10th** in the **Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2025**, maintaining a strong position despite slipping two spots. The report highlights India's **low per-capita emissions**, rapid progress in **renewable energy**, and advancements in **electric vehicles** and **energy efficiency**. However, challenges include heavy reliance on **coal** and a growth-driven climate approach. India has set a **net-zero emissions target by 2070** and aims for **500 GW renewable energy** by 2030. The **top performers** include **Denmark, Netherlands, and UK**, while **Iran, Saudi Arabia, and Russia** are the lowest.
- **Union Ministers Dharmendra Pradhan and Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya** launched the **World Bank report** titled "**Jobs at Your Doorstep: A Jobs Diagnostics for Young People**" in **New Delhi**. The report focuses on bridging **skill gaps** and aligning **school curricula** with **industry needs** in six states under the **STARS initiative**. The states covered are **Himachal Pradesh, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, and Rajasthan**.
- India has climbed 11 spots to **49th** in the **2024 Network Readiness Index (NRI)**, reflecting significant progress in **network infrastructure, digital capabilities, and technological advancements**. India improved its score from **49.93** in 2023 to **53.63** in 2024, ranking **1st** globally in **AI scientific publications, AI talent concentration, and ICT services exports**. The country also ranked highly in **5G launch, broadband expansion, and telecom infrastructure growth**, positioning itself as a leader in **digital transformation** and **future telecom technologies** like **Bharat 6G**.

Ranks and Reports Current Affairs of December 2024

- **IndiGo Airlines** ranked **103rd out of 109** in the 2024 **AirHelp Score** report, placing it among the worst-performing global airlines. **Air India** ranked slightly better at **61st**. IndiGo disputes the findings, criticizing the

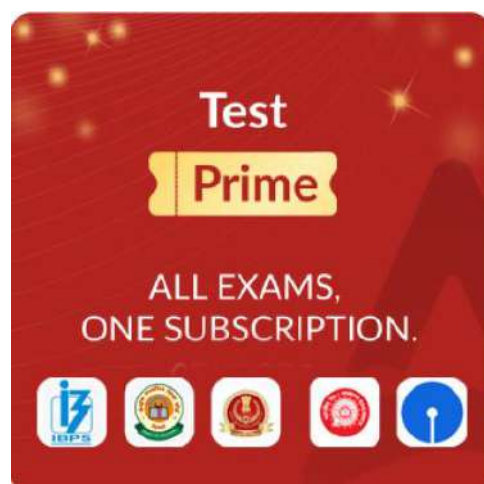
methodology for lacking **transparency**, particularly regarding the **sample size** from India.

- India has become the global leader in **mobile malware attacks**, surpassing the **US** and **Canada**, with **28%** of global attacks in 2024, according to a **Zscaler ThreatLabz report**. This rise highlights the increasing **cybersecurity vulnerabilities** amid India's rapid **digital transformation**, especially with a surge in **Trojans** and **phishing attacks** targeting the **financial sector**.
- **Kerala** ranks **fifth** in the **India Skills Report 2025**, with an impressive **71% employability rate**. The state is recognized for its **talent, workplace inclusivity, and effective education and skill development**. The report also highlights **India's leadership in AI skill penetration** and the **transformative impact** of AI on the workforce. Kerala secures the fifth position nationally, after **Maharashtra, Delhi, Karnataka, and Andhra Pradesh**.
- A **UNCCD** report highlights that over **77%** of Earth's land has become drier over the past 30 years, leading to an expansion of **global drylands** by 4.3 million square kilometers. If **greenhouse gas emissions** aren't reduced, an additional 3% of **humid areas** could turn into drylands by 2100. This will severely affect **2.3 billion people** currently living in drylands, with projections rising to **5 billion** by the century's end.
- **Taste Atlas** has ranked the **Top 10 Best Food Cities in the World** for 2024-25, with **Italy** dominating the list, claiming six spots. **Mumbai** ranks 5th, showcasing India's culinary diversity, particularly with **Vada Pav**. Other notable cities include **Osaka** (Japan) and **Paris** (France). The rankings are based on over **477,000 ratings** of dishes, with cities like **Naples, Milan, and Bologna** topping the list. Indian cities like **Amritsar, New Delhi, Hyderabad, and Kolkata** also feature, reflecting India's growing global food recognition.
- India has risen to **39th** in the **WEF Travel and Tourism Development Index (TTDI) 2024**, up from **54th** in 2021. This improvement reflects India's recovery in **global tourism** post-pandemic and its growing prominence in **medical and cultural tourism**.
- India has risen **11 places** in the **2024 Network Readiness Index (NRI)**, moving from **60th** in 2023 to **49th**, with an improved score of **53.63**. This reflects India's commitment to advancing **digital infrastructure and technology adoption**. The **NRI**, published by the **Portulans Institute**, evaluates how nations use technology for **governance and citizen engagement**, highlighting India's growing role as a global **technological leader**.
- **Forbes** released its **21st annual list** of the **World's 100 Most Powerful Women**, recognizing influential figures across various fields. This year, **three Indian women—Nirmala Sitharaman, Roshni Nadar Malhotra, and Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw—**earned prominent spots for their remarkable achievements in **business, politics, and philanthropy**.

Sports Current Affairs of January 2024

- Australian cricket stalwart **David Warner** officially announced his retirement from ODI cricket. This announcement came just before his final Test match against **Pakistan at the Sydney Cricket Ground**.
- **India's Koneru Humpy** showcased her prowess in chess by clinching the **women's individual silver medal** at the **2023 World Rapid Chess Championships held in Samarkand, Uzbekistan**. Despite a valiant effort, the **36-year-old Grandmaster succumbed to Russian player Anastasia Bodnaruk** in a tie-break sudden death on time.
- **Anahat Singh**, a rising star in Indian squash, secured victory in the **girls' under-19 category at the 2023 Scottish Junior Open squash held in Edinburgh**. Her remarkable triumph added another feather to her cap, concluding a stellar year that included a double win at the National championships and success in the Asian Games.
- **Oman** is set to unveil its latest sports marvel—a cutting-edge complex designed to host the **FIH Hockey5s World Cup qualifiers**. This grand facility is a testament to Oman's commitment to fostering excellence in the world of sports, particularly in the realm of hockey.
- **Kenya's Beatrice Chebet** concluded her remarkable year by smashing the **world record for the women's 5 km marathon at the Cursa dels Nassos in Barcelona**. **Clocking an astounding 14:13**, Chebet outpaced her competitors and bettered the previous record by six seconds, setting the stage for a memorable achievement. Although subject to World Athletics' ratification procedure, this victory marks a triumphant end to **Chebet's stellar 2023 campaign**.
- **Germany** beat top seeds **Poland** to clinch the United Cup on Sunday after **Alexander Zverev** and **Laura Siegemund** won the deciding mixed doubles tie over Hubert Hurkacz and Iga Swiatek. **The United Cup** final delivered a spectacle of tennis prowess, determination, and sportsmanship, leaving fans on the edge of their seats until the last point was played.
- In a historic moment for Indian sports, the accomplished equestrian athlete, **Divyakriti Singh**, has been conferred with the prestigious **Arjuna Award**, making her the first woman from Rajasthan to achieve this honour. The award was presented in a grand ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhavan by the President of India, Droupadi Murmu.
- **Asian Shooting Championships 2024** in Jakarta, Indonesia, **Rhythm Sangwan** secured a **bronze medal in the women's 25m pistol event**, obtaining a Paris 2024 Olympic quota for India. This accomplishment marked **India's 16th shooting quota** for the upcoming Olympics, surpassing the previous record tally of 15 set for the Tokyo 2020 Games.
- The **9th Asian Winter Games**, set to illuminate the winter sports landscape in 2025, have officially entered an exciting phase with the unveiling of its core symbols – the slogan, emblem, and mascots. Embracing the spirit of unity and sportsmanship, the official slogan "Dream of Winter, Love among Asia" resonates deeply with the ethos of the Games. The heart and soul of the Games are personified in its mascots, "Binbin" and "Nini", two charming Siberian tiger cubs. The official emblem, aptly named "Breakthrough", is a creative masterpiece blending Chinese cultural elements with Olympic symbols.
- India's young wrestling sensation, **Aman Sehrawat**, set the stage on fire at the **Zagreb Open 2024** by winning a **gold medal in the 57 kg category of the men's singles event**. The 20-year-old wrestler demonstrated his prowess by defeating China's Zou Wanhao 10-0 in the final, securing victory by technical superiority. This impressive win marked a stellar beginning for Sehrawat in the year 2024.
- **Real Madrid** played against **Barcelona** and won 4-1. This big game was part of the Spanish Super Cup final and happened on January 14, 2024. It took place in **Riyadh, Saudi Arabia**.
- In a historic moment for Indian cricket, **Rohit Sharma**, the captain of Team India, etched his name in the record books by becoming the **first men's player to feature in 150 T20 International matches**. This milestone was achieved during the second T20I against **Afghanistan** at the Holkar Cricket Stadium, marking a remarkable feat in Rohit's illustrious career.
- **Australia's Shaun Marsh**, a renowned name in international and domestic cricket, has announced his retirement from all forms of the sport. This article provides a comprehensive overview of his career and the impact he has had on the game.
- **Rameshbabu Pragganandhaa**, an 18-year-old chess prodigy from Chennai, achieved a historic milestone in his career by defeating World Champion **Ding Liren from China**.

- Indian cricket team captain **Rohit Sharma** has created history by becoming the first batsman to score five centuries in T20 Internationals (T20Is). This milestone was achieved during the third T20I match against Afghanistan in Bengaluru on January 17, 2024.
- In a groundbreaking development for women's cricket, **Sue Redfern** from **England** is set to become the **first ICC-appointed female neutral umpire** to officiate in a bilateral series. This historic moment is scheduled to take place during the upcoming WT20I between Australia and South Africa, marking a significant step forward for gender inclusivity in cricket officiating.
- The **Asia Olympic Qualifiers** witnessed a remarkable display of skill and precision from Indian shooters, with **Yogesh Singh** emerging as the star of the event. Singh not only **secured the individual gold medal** in the **men's 25m centre fire pistol** competition but also led the Indian trio to clinch the team gold. Additionally, other Indian shooters showcased their talent in different categories, contributing to the nation's successful campaign.
- Carlos Sainz**, at the age of 61, has made history by winning the **Dakar Rally for the fourth time**. His latest victory in the 2024 rally marks him as the oldest winner of this gruelling race. Sainz, also known as **'El Matador'**, is renowned for his extraordinary skills and endurance in one of the most challenging motorsport events in the world.
- Tokyo Olympic silver medallist **Ravi Kumar Dahiya**, who faced a setback in the form of injuries, made a triumphant return to the wrestling arena by securing a **bronze medal** at the prestigious **Grand Prix De France Henri Deglane wrestling tournament** held in Nice, France.
- In the Olympic year, badminton enthusiasts witnessed an extraordinary performance by Chinese Taipei's legendary player, **Tai Tzu Ying**. After facing a Malaysian Open final loss, Tai Tzu Ying bounced back with determination, **securing victory in the India Open 2024 women's singles title**.
- Madrid** is set to become the new host city for the **Spanish Formula 1 Grand Prix starting from 2026**. This marks a significant shift in the Spanish Grand Prix's location, as Barcelona has been the **event's home since 1991**. The transition will see Madrid hosting the Grand Prix for 10 years, from 2026 to 2035, introducing a brand-new circuit to the world of Formula 1.
- In a spectacular display of skill and determination, the Indian shooting duo **Raiza Dhillon and Gurjoat Singh Khangura** clinched the **bronze medal** in the mixed skeet team event at the **Asian Shotgun Championships 2024 in Kuwait City**. The event marked a triumphant conclusion for India, securing a total of one gold, three silvers, and four bronze medals on the closing day.
- The **Asian Marathon Championships 2024** marked a historic moment for Indian athletics as **Man Singh**, a 34-year-old marathon runner from India, clinched the gold medal. This achievement is significant for Man Singh and Indian sports, showcasing the country's growing prowess in long-distance running.
- Indian table tennis player **Sreeja Akula** achieved a significant milestone in her career by securing her **maiden international title at the WTT Feeder Corpus Christi 2024 in Texas, USA**. The 25-year-old athlete displayed exceptional skill and determination in the women's singles event, culminating in a remarkable victory.
- Indian tennis star **Rohan Bopanna** has etched his name in the history books by becoming the oldest player to claim the **No. 1 spot in the men's doubles rankings at the age of 43**. This remarkable achievement was secured following his quarter-final victory at the 2024 Australian Open, alongside Australia's Matthew Ebden.
- India** finished as runner-up at the inaugural edition of the FIH Hockey 5s Women's World Cup after a 7-2 loss to the **Netherlands** in the final in Muscat. India tried to make a comeback and scored twice – **Jyoti Chhattri (20th minute) and Rutaja Dadaso Pisal (23rd minute)** – but could not catch the Dutch team which added one more goal courtesy of Kalse before the full-time hooter.
- Hyderabad's Tanmay Agarwal** scored an unbeaten **323 off just 160 balls** against **Arunachal Pradesh in the Ranji Trophy Plate Group game**. His innings included 33 fours and 21 sixes, showcasing his aggressive batting style. Agarwal achieved his triple century in a record 147 balls, surpassing the previous record of 191 balls set by Marco Marais. This feat also marked the second-fastest triple ton by time, taking 183 minutes.
- Naorem Roshibina Devi**, the pride of Manipur, has clinched the prestigious title of **International Wushu Federation Female Athlete of the Year**, solidifying her place as a powerhouse in the world of wushu.



- **Sonam Maskar** made a remarkable debut in the **shooting World Cup in Cairo, Egypt**, clinching the women's air rifle **silver medal**. Despite her impressive performance, she was narrowly **beaten by Anna Janssen of Germany** by a mere 0.9 points. Maskar's stellar performance highlights her potential as a rising star in the sport.
- Indian boxer **Mandeep Jangra** secured a remarkable triumph at the US-based National Boxing Association's (NBA) intercontinental **super featherweight championship**. His win came after a compelling bout against American Gerardo Esquivel in Toppenish City, Washington.
- The mascot for the Khelo India Winter Games 2024 is the majestic snow leopard, named **'Sheen-e She' or 'Shan' in the Ladakh region**. Native to the high-altitude areas of J&K and Ladakh, the snow leopard symbolizes the spirit of the Games and brings attention to the conservation of this endangered species.
- India's shining moment at the **ISSF (International Shooting Sport Federation) World Cup** was marked by stellar performances in the **10m air pistol mixed** team event and the **10m air rifle mixed** team event. Rhythm Sangwan and Ujjwal showcased exceptional skill and coordination to secure gold in the 10m air pistol mixed team event, while **Arjun Babuta and Sonam Uttam Maskar** displayed resilience to clinch silver in the 10m air rifle mixed team event.
- **Divyansh Singh Panwar** continues to carve his name in the annals of shooting history, securing his **fourth World Cup gold** in the **10m air rifle event**. This latest triumph adds to his impressive collection, which includes victories in Munich, Beijing, and Delhi since 2019.

Sports Current Affairs of February 2024

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- The ancient tradition of the **Olympic Torch Relay** continues its journey towards **Paris 2024**, with the flame set to cross the Mediterranean and embark on a 68-day adventure across France. **Abhinav Bindra**, India's first individual Olympic gold medalist and an IOC Athletes' Commission member, is among the 11,000 torchbearers chosen to carry the iconic symbol.
- The highly anticipated **FIFA World Cup 2026** is set to take centre stage, promising football fans a thrilling and expanded 48-team tournament. The **United States, Canada, and Mexico** are co-hosting this global spectacle, with **MetLife Stadium in New York** selected as the venue for the July 19 final. In this blog post, we'll delve into the key details and highlights of the upcoming tournament. **MetLife Stadium in New York emerged victorious in the bid to host the final on July 19**, overcoming stiff competition from Dallas.
- **PT Usha**, was honoured with the prestigious **'Lifetime Achievement'** award. This accolade was presented to her by the **Sports Journalists Federation of India (SJFI) and Delhi Sports Journalists Association (DSJA)**, recognizing her extraordinary contributions to Indian athletics. The award ceremony saw the attendance of notable

personalities, including **Rajeev Shukla, Member of Parliament – Rajya Sabha and Vice President of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)**, and former Indian shooter **Jaspal Rana**, among the Guests of Honour.

- The **Telangana Football Association (TFA)** has achieved a significant milestone by securing approval to host the FIFA World Cup qualifiers round between **India and Kuwait**. The match is scheduled to take place on June 6th of this year in **Hyderabad**, announced Dr. K.T. Mahi, Chairman of TFA.
- **Saurashtra Cricket Association (SCA) Stadium** is set to be rebranded as the **Niranjan Shah Stadium**. This change comes as a tribute to the former first-class cricketer and senior cricket administrator, Niranjan Shah, marking his immense contributions to the sport and the region.
- The **International Football Association Board (IFAB)** is preparing to debut a new card, the **blue card** as part of trials involving sin bins in professional football. In November 2023, the governing body recognized the necessity of addressing player conduct towards match officials, leading to the implementation of temporary dismissals for dissent and certain tactical infractions.
- Grand Master **Wei Yi** emerged triumphant in the highly anticipated **2024 Tata Steel Chess Tournament**, showcasing his exceptional skill and tactical prowess.
- In a surprising turn of events, the **SAFF Women's U-19 Championships** concluded with **India and Bangladesh** being declared joint winners. The tournament, held in Dhaka, witnessed a series of unusual occurrences that led to this unprecedented decision.
- With the Paris Olympic Games approaching, the National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA) hosted the **"Road to Paris 2024: Championing Clean Sports and Uniting for Anti-Doping"** Conference. The event aimed to educate Indian athletes about the dangers of prohibited substances while emphasizing ethical competition.
- **Etihad Airways** joins forces with the **Chennai Super Kings (CSK)** as their official sponsor, marking a thrilling new chapter for both entities. This strategic partnership, announced on February 9th, 2024, promises to propel the excitement of cricket to new heights for fans around the world.
- The iconic **Jungfrauoch**, also known as the **Top of Europe**, witnessed a momentous event recently. India's Olympic gold medalist and world champion javelin thrower, **Neeraj Chopra**, was honoured with a **commemorative plaque** at the renowned **Ice Palace**. This prestigious recognition adds another feather to his cap and strengthens the bond between **Switzerland and India**.
- **Pathum Nissanka** etched his name in Sri Lankan cricket history, by becoming the **first-ever player** to score a **double century** in One Day Internationals (ODIs) for the nation. His **unbeaten knock of 210 runs** against Afghanistan was a masterclass in batting, shattering records and propelling Sri Lanka to a massive victory.
- **Australia U19** win the **U19 World Cup 2024 Final** by 79 runs. With the massive win over India, Australia has secured its fourth World Cup title in U-19 cricket. Australia added to their triumphs in **2002, 2010, and 2020**.
- **Chennai Super Kings (CSK)** have officially announced the appointment of **Katrina Kaif** as their brand ambassador for the upcoming **Indian Premier League (IPL) 2024 season**. This partnership marks a significant milestone for the five-time IPL champions, signalling a new chapter in their illustrious journey.
- Nagal's journey began in 2023 when he played as a player ranked 506 in the world and qualified for the ATP Chennai Open Challenger. Despite setbacks, including a hip injury in 2021, Nagal persisted and continued to pursue his dream. His success in Chennai Challenger last year marked the beginning of his resurgence after surgery.
- In an event that has cast a shadow over the world of athletics, **Kelvin Kiptum**, the men's marathon world record holder, and his coach, Gervais Hakizimana, met with a tragic end in a traffic accident on the night of February 12, 2024.
- **International Cricket Council (ICC)** has announced the winners of the **ICC Men's and Women's Player of the Month for January 2024**. West Indies' Shamar Joseph and Ireland's Amy Hunter have been bestowed with this honour, marking their remarkable contributions to their respective teams in the past month.
- Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** inaugurated the **Gandhinagar Premier League (GPL) in Ahmedabad, Gujarat**. The event, graced by the presence of Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel among other dignitaries, marks a pivotal step towards enhancing grassroots cricket and fostering local talent across the nation. **Hardik Pandya**, an India all-rounder, was spotted with Union Home Minister Amit Shah at the Gandhinagar Premier League's launch.
- Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports **Anurag Singh Thakur** handed over the **Chess Olympiad Torch to Budapest, Hungary**, the host city for the **45th edition of the Chess Olympiad**. The ceremony, held at the Major Dhyanchand National Stadium in New Delhi, was not just a formal handover but also a celebration of chess as an intellectual sport deeply rooted in India's heritage.
- The Athletics Integrity Unit (AIU) has suspended hammer thrower Rachna Kumari for 12 years for a second anti-doping rule violation.
- **Taghi Askar**, a 100-year-old diver from the Islamic Republic of Iran, made waves at the **Diving World Championships in Doha** as he wiped away tears of gratitude and emotion for the overwhelming support he received.
- **Indian football**, the national team has fallen **15 places to the 117th position** in the latest FIFA rankings, registering its lowest position in the past seven years.

- **Ravichandran Ashwin** has etched his name in the annals of cricket history by becoming the second Indian bowler to take **500 wickets in Test matches**. This milestone was reached during the second day of the third Test between India and England in Rajkot, marking a significant achievement in Ashwin's already storied career.
- UK-based club cricketer **Rizwan Javed** has been handed a severe ban from all cricketing activities for a period of **17 ½ years**. This decision comes in the wake of his involvement in several breaches of the **Emirates Cricket Board (ECB) Anti-Corruption Code for Participants**. The ramifications of his actions highlight the stringent measures taken to uphold the integrity of the sport.
- **Shah Alam, Malaysia**, the Indian women's badminton team etched their names into history by clinching a historic gold medal at the **Badminton Asia Team Championships 2024**.
- Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports **Anurag Singh Thakur** inaugurated the **Khelo India University games** in Guwahati. The Prime Minister, Narendra Modi, addressed Khelo India University Games being held across the seven states in the Northeast via a video message.
- An eight-year-old chess prodigy from **Singapore** has made headlines by achieving a remarkable feat in the world of chess. In a gripping three-hour game at Switzerland's Burgdorfer Stadthaus-Open, **Ashwath Kaushik** emerged victorious against the seasoned Polish grandmaster **Jacek Stopa**, securing his place in history as the **youngest chess player to defeat a grandmaster**.
- **Babar Azam** showcased his unparalleled prowess once again as he etched his name in the annals of cricket history by becoming the quickest batter to surpass the milestone of **10,000 runs in T20 cricket**.
- In a remarkable display of endurance and determination, **Bhagwan Singh and Mahesh Khurana from Bhopal** have completed the **Pangong Frozen Lake Marathon 2024**, held in Leh-Ladakh.
- In a groundbreaking move for Indian cricket, **Jacintha Kalyan** has etched her name in the annals of sports history as the country's first female pitch curator. With the highly anticipated **2nd edition of the Women's Premier League (WPL)** just around the corner, the excitement among fans, players, and tournament organizers is palpable.
- Indian off-spinner **Ravichandran Ashwin** etched his name in cricketing history, surpassing legendary leg-spinner **Anil Kumble** to become the **leading wicket-taker in Test matches played on Indian soil**.
- **Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh** has demonstrated unwavering support for Armed Forces personnel who excelled in the **19th Asian Games** and **4th Asian Para Games**, held in Hangzhou, China, during September-October 2023. In a landmark move, the Ministry of Defence has announced a **Financial Incentive Scheme to reward the Medal Winners**, aiming to foster Recognition and Motivation among these athletes as they prepare for the Paris Olympics Games 2024.

- **Jan Nicol Loftie-Eaton**, the dynamic **Namibian batter**, etched his name in cricketing history by scoring the **fastest T20 International (T20I) century** in a blistering innings against Nepal. Loftie-Eaton's extraordinary feat occurred during the first T20I of the Tri-Nation series on Tuesday, February 27, leaving fans and pundits in awe of his remarkable display of power-hitting.
- Veteran fast bowler **Neil Wagner** has called time on his international cricketing career, bringing an end to a distinguished 12-year Test match journey with the Black Caps.

Sports Current Affairs of March 2024

- The **10th edition of the Pro Kabaddi League (PKL)** concluded with **Puneri Paltan** emerging as champions for the first time, after a closely contested final against **Haryana Steelers**. The final score read 28-25 in favor of Puneri Paltan, with the match taking place on March 1. Pankaj Mohite shone brightly for Paltan, scoring nine raid points, including a crucial super raid that proved to be a game-changer.
- The scenic town of Shimla has become the centre stage for the first-ever **Asian River Rafting Championships**, officially opened on March 4th, 2024, by Chief Minister **Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu**.
- **B. Sai Praneeth**, the decorated Indian badminton player, has announced his retirement from the sport.
- **Spain's women's team** secured a historic victory over **France**, winning the **first-ever UEFA Women's Nations League** with a convincing 2-0 triumph in Seville. The win represents a significant achievement for Spain in the realm of women's football, further solidifying their position as a dominant force in the sport.
- Union Minister **Anurag Singh Thakur** grandly inaugurated the **Sansad Khel Mahakumbh 3.0** at the **Luhnu Cricket Ground** in **Bilaspur** on **March 5, 2024**. Chief Guests Indian cricket team captain **Rohit Sharma** and Indian cricket team coach **Rahul Dravid** graced the occasion as chief guests.
- **Hardeep Singh Puri**, Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas and Housing & Urban Affairs, inaugurated the **5th ONGC Para Games**, praising para-athletes for their unwavering determination. The event took place at **Thyagaraj Stadium, New Delhi** with the presence of Shri Pankaj Jain, Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas, and senior officials from Oil & Gas PSUs.
- England's **James Anderson** claimed his **700th Test wicket** by dismissing India's **Kuldeep Yadav** in **Dharamsala** on the morning of **Day 3** of the final Test against India. This historic milestone makes Anderson the **third bowler** to reach the 700-wicket mark in Test cricket.
- Indian badminton stars **Satwiksairaj Rankireddy** and **Chirag Shetty** have won the BWF French Open men's

doubles title, defeating **Chinese Taipei's Lee Jhe-Huei and Yang Po-Hsuan in the final.**

- **Yashasvi Jaiswal**, the young Indian opener, has been named the **ICC Men's Player of the Month for February 2024**. In the women's category, **Annabel Sutherland** of Australia claimed the **ICC Women's Player of the Month** award for February 2024.
- **Mumbai** won the **Ranji Trophy 2024** after beating Vidarbha by 169 runs at the Wankhede Stadium in Mumbai. This was their **42nd Ranji Trophy title**, showcasing their dominance in Indian domestic cricket. Mumbai ended their **8-year drought** by winning the championship after last lifting the title in the 2015-16 season.
- Red Bull's **Max Verstappen** clinched **victory** at the Saudi Arabian Grand Prix, starting from **pole position**. It marked Red Bull's second consecutive **one-two finish** in the 2024 Formula One season.
- The **V-Dem Institute's Democracy Report 2024** highlights India's continued descent into electoral autocracy since its downgrade in 2018. The report underscores the deterioration of democratic principles, particularly in the areas of freedom of expression, media independence, and civil liberties. India's status as one of the top standalone autocracies further accentuates the gravity of its democratic decline.
- Australian **wicketkeeper-batter Matthew Wade** has announced his decision to **retire from red-ball cricket** (first-class cricket).
- The **Election Commission of India (ECI)** and the **Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)** organized an exhibition cricket match to promote **voter education and inclusivity**. The match was played between the **Indian Deaf Cricket Association (IDCA) Team** and the **Delhi & District Cricket Association (DDCA) team** on **March 16, 2024**, at **Karnail Singh Stadium in New Delhi**.
- In the final of the **Indian Wells ATP tournament** on Sunday, **Carlos Alcaraz** of Spain defeated **Daniil Medvedev** of Russia in straight sets, with a score of **7-6 (7/5), 6-1**.
- In the women's **long jump** event at the **3rd Indian Open Jumps Competition**, **Nayana James** from Kerala recorded a **personal best mark of 6.67m** to secure the **gold medal**.
- **Ace table tennis player Sharath Kamal** will be the **Indian team's flagbearer** for the upcoming **Paris 2024 Olympics**. The announcement was made by the **Indian Olympic Association (IOA)**.
- Indian **star paddler G. Sathiyam** has achieved a remarkable feat by becoming the **first-ever Indian** to win a **men's singles trophy** at a **WTT Feeder Series** event. This historic moment took place in **Beirut, Lebanon**, where Sathiyam triumphed over his compatriot **Manav Thakkar** with a **3-1 (6-11 11-7 11-7 11-4)** victory in the final of the **WTT Feeder Beirut 2024**.

- Australian Grand Prix, **Carlos Sainz** of **Ferrari** emerged victorious, marking a remarkable comeback just **two weeks after undergoing appendicitis surgery**. The race was filled with drama, including the **first retirement** in two years for **Red Bull's reigning world champion Max Verstappen**.
- Indian cricket captain **Virat Kohli** has etched his name in history by becoming the **first Indian cricketer** to score **12,000 runs** in the **T20 format**. Kohli accomplished this remarkable feat during the opening match of the **2024 Indian Premier League (IPL)** between **Chennai Super Kings (CSK)** and **Royal Challengers Bangalore (RCB)** at the **MA Chidambaram Stadium**.
- In a historic move, the **Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG)** will host a **day-night Test match** between the **Australian and English women's cricket teams**. This will be the first time a **pink-ball Test** is played at the iconic venue. The **four-day match** is scheduled from **January 30 to February 2, 2025**.
- **Haryana** clinched the **team titles** in both the boy's and girls categories with an impressive combined haul of **19 medals** at the **Boxing Sub Junior National Championship**. Haryana showcased its dominance by finishing on top in both categories. The tournament witnessed the participation of **612 boxers**, including **337 boys** and **275 girls**.
- The **Sunrisers Hyderabad (SRH)** team created history by posting a mammoth **277/3** against the **Mumbai Indians (MI)** in their **Indian Premier League (IPL) 2024** match in Hyderabad. This score surpassed the previous **highest total in the IPL** of 263 runs, set by the **Royal Challengers Bangalore (RCB)** against Pune Warriors India in 2013.
- Indian paddler **Sreeja Akula** clinched the **women's singles title** at the **WTT Feeder Beirut II 2024** in Beirut, Lebanon. The **world no. 47** Indian came from behind to secure a **6-11, 12-10, 11-5, 11-9** victory over the lower-ranked **Sarah D Nutte** of Luxembourg in the final.
- Veteran Kenyan allrounder **Collins Obuya** has announced his **retirement from cricket** following Kenya's defeat to Uganda in the **third-place play-off match** at the **African Games**.
- The International Hockey Federation (FIH) has appointed former Indian men's hockey team captain and goalkeeper **PR Sreejesh** and Chile's **Camila Caram** as **co-chairs of the FIH Athletes Committee**. This announcement was made by the FIH on March 27, 2024.
- **IIT Madras** is set to host the prestigious **'6th Shaastra Rapid FIDE Rated Chess Tournament'** on March 30 and 31, 2024. The tournament, sanctioned by the **International Chess Federation (FIDE)**, will draw the participation of esteemed players from across the globe, including Grandmasters, International Masters, and Women Grandmasters.

- **Sharfuddoula** has created history by becoming the first **Bangladeshi umpire** to be appointed to the **ICC Elite Panel of Umpires**. His appointment was confirmed following the **International Cricket Council's** annual review and selection process.

Sports Current Affairs of April 2024

- **Mahendra Singh Dhoni**, the legendary **wicketkeeper-batter**, has etched his name in the history books once again. During an **Indian Premier League (IPL)** match between **Delhi Capitals (DC)** and **Chennai Super Kings (CSK)**, Dhoni achieved a remarkable feat, becoming the first **wicketkeeper** to record **300 dismissals** in **T20 cricket**.
- The top-seeded duo of **Rohan Bopanna** from India and **Matthew Ebden** from Australia won the **Men's Doubles Title** at the **Miami Open**, a prestigious **ATP Masters 1000 match on clay courts**, marking a significant milestone in his career. Nagal's remarkable feat at the **Rolex Monte Carlo Masters cements his status as India's top tennis player**.
- **The Indian hockey** landscape is set to witness a groundbreaking event with the inaugural season of the **National Women's Hockey League 2024 – 2025**. Scheduled to be held in Ranchi from April 30 to May 9, this league promises to be a thrilling showcase of the country's top women's hockey talent.
- India's 19-year-old **Udit** won the silver medal in the men's 57kg category at the **Asian Wrestling Championships 2024** in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan. **Abhimanyu (men's 70kg)** and **Vicky (men's 97kg)** also won the bronze medals in their respective weight divisions to take India's tally to three medals after the opening day of the competition.
- In a display of sheer dominance, **Max Verstappen** of Red Bull Racing claimed a resounding victory at the long-awaited **Chinese Grand Prix**, extending his lead in the 2024 World Championship. The Dutchman's triumph marked the first Formula One race in China in five years, and he left no room for doubt, leading from start to finish.
- In a remarkable achievement, Indian chess prodigy **Dommaraju Gukesh**, aged just 17, has made history by winning the FIDE Candidates tournament, becoming the youngest-ever challenger in the history of the World Chess Championship. Not only that, but Gukesh is also the first teenager to win the prestigious tournament.
- In a move to strengthen its **international presence**, 'Nandini', the dairy brand of the Karnataka Milk Federation (KMF), has announced its decision to **sponsor** the cricket teams of **Scotland** and **Ireland** for the upcoming **2024 T20 World Cup**. According to KMF's managing director, **MK Jagadish**, the teams will prominently display the 'Nandini' brand during the matches.
- In a remarkable achievement, **World No. 6 Casper Ruud** of Norway defeated **Stefanos Tsitsipas** of Greece, clinching the **ATP Barcelona Open 500** singles title. The final scoreline of 7-5, 6-3 marked a significant milestone for Ruud, as he secured the **biggest trophy** of his professional career.
- **The International Cricket Council (ICC)** has named Sri Lankan cricketer **Kamindu Mendis** as the **ICC Men's Player of the Month for March 2024**. Mendis' historic batting performances in the first Test against Bangladesh in Sylhet were instrumental in Sri Lanka's comfortable victory. On the women's side, **England's Maia Bouchier** has been awarded the **ICC Women's Player of the Month for March 2024**.
- In a historic moment for **Indian tennis**, **Sumit Nagal** becomes the first Indian player to win an **ATP Masters 1000 match on clay courts**, marking a significant milestone in his career. Nagal's remarkable feat at the **Rolex Monte Carlo Masters cements his status as India's top tennis player**.
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- **Yuzvendra Chahal**, the wily leg-spinner from Rajasthan Royals, stands tall as the **highest wicket-taker in IPL history**. With a staggering 200 wickets in 153 matches.
- Indian squash Player, **Saurav Ghosal**, the nation's premier player, has announced his retirement from professional squash. The 37-year-old's decision marks the end of an illustrious career that spanned over two decades, during which he achieved numerous milestones and brought glory to the country.
- Legendary sprinter **Usain Bolt** has been named the official ambassador for the upcoming **ICC Men's T20 World Cup**, co-hosted by the West Indies and the United States from **June 1 to 29**. The Jamaican icon, known as the fastest man alive, brings his passion for cricket and global appeal to ignite the tournament and propel the sport into new territories.
- In a groundbreaking announcement, Saudi Arabia's oil behemoth, **Aramco**, and the international football governing body, **FIFA**, have joined forces in a strategic global partnership. The deal, spanning until 2027, designates Aramco as FIFA's Major Worldwide Partner exclusively in the energy sector, encompassing sponsorship rights for marquee events including the **FIFA World Cup 2026 and the FIFA Women's World Cup 2027**.
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has announced the appointment of Pakistan cricket legend **Sana Mir** as the ambassador for the upcoming **ICC Women's T20 World Cup Qualifier**. Mir, who represented Pakistan in 226 international games, with 137 of them as captain, will bring her invaluable experience to the event.
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has announced the appointment of Indian cricket legend **Yuvraj Singh** as an ambassador for the upcoming **ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2024**. The announcement comes with just 36 days remaining until the highly anticipated global event for T20 cricket commences.
- The Indian athletes continued their impressive medal-winning spree at the **21st U-20 Asian Athletics Championship 2024**, with **Harshit Kumar** clinching a gold medal in the highly competitive Hammer throw event. His outstanding throw of 66.7 meters secured India's latest gold at the prestigious event. As the third day of the championship drew to a close, the Indian contingent had amassed a total of **18 medals**, including five from the latest round of events.
- The **Chennai Super Kings (CSK)** secured a resounding **78-run** victory over the **Sunrisers Hyderabad (SRH)** on Sunday, potentially shaping the trajectory of both teams' **2024 Indian Premier League (IPL)** campaigns. This emphatic win significantly boosted **CSK's net run rate**, propelling them to the **third position** in the league standings. Conversely, SRH suffered their second consecutive defeat, slipping to the **fourth spot**.

Sports Current Affairs of May 2024

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- The **16th edition** of the **Tata Consultancy Services World 10K Bengaluru** witnessed Kenyan runners **Peter Mwaniki** (28:15) and **Lilian Kasait** (30:56) emerging victorious in the **international elite men's and women's categories**, respectively.
- The renowned Indian dairy giant **Amul** has been named the Lead Arm sponsor for the USA and South Africa cricket teams during the highly anticipated **T20 World Cup** in June.
- The **International Cricket Council (ICC)** has taken strong action against West Indies player Devon Thomas by imposing a **five-year period of ineligibility** from all cricket after he admitted to breaching multiple anti-corruption codes.
- The **Badminton World Federation (BWF)** has announced that India will host the prestigious **2025 BWF World Junior Championships** at the **National Centre of Excellence in Guwahati**. This marks a significant milestone as India will be hosting this premier badminton event for the first time since 2008, when it was held in Pune.
- The People's Republic of China has reclaimed its throne as the top badminton nation, clinching both the men's and women's titles at the prestigious **2024 BWF Thomas & Uber Cup Finals** in Chengdu. This remarkable feat marks the first time since 2012 that China has conquered both the men's and women's world team championships.
- **Lando Norris** of **McLaren** clinched his **first-ever Grand Prix victory** in a pulsating showdown at the **Miami Grand Prix**. The young Briton's triumph sent shockwaves through the motorsport world, igniting jubilant celebrations and a deluge of admiration across social media platforms.
- The 2024 Madrid Open, held in the Spanish capital from April 22 to May 5, witnessed two remarkable champions

in the singles events. **Iga Swiatek** of Poland claimed her first Madrid Open title, while **Andrey Rublev** of Russia secured his second triumph in this prestigious tournament.

- The Spanish football giants, **Real Madrid**, have etched another remarkable achievement in their illustrious history by securing the **La Liga 2023-24 season title**. Los Blancos, as they are affectionately called by their supporters, sealed the championship after defeating Cadiz 3-0, while their closest rivals Barcelona suffered a 4-2 loss against Girona.
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has unveiled the fixtures for the highly anticipated **ninth ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2024**, set to take place from **3 to 20 October** in Bangladesh. Cricket enthusiasts worldwide are eagerly awaiting this prestigious tournament, which promises to be an action-packed spectacle of skill and sportsmanship.
- **Yuzvendra Chahal**, the wily leg-spinner from Rajasthan Royals, continues to etch his name in the annals of T20 cricket history. In the ongoing edition of the **Indian Premier League (IPL)**, Chahal achieved a remarkable feat by becoming the **first Indian bowler to take 350 wickets** in the shortest format of the game.
- The **United World Wrestling (UWW)** has provisionally suspended Indian wrestler **Bajrang Punia** until **December 31, 2024**, following his suspension by the **National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA)** for his 'refusal' to provide a urine sample.
- **Sri Lanka Cricket** has announced that the Indian milk producer **Amul** has been appointed as the 'Official Sponsor' of the **Sri Lanka Men's Team** for the duration of the **ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2024**.
- In a surprising move, **Colin Munro**, the hard-hitting New Zealand top-order batsman, has announced his retirement from **international cricket** after being overlooked for the upcoming **T20 World Cup**. The decision marks the end of an era for the explosive left-hander, who etched his name as one of the most destructive T20 batters in the world.
- **Anandana**, The Coca-Cola India Foundation, has forged its maiden alliance with Hockey India for the **National Women's Hockey League 2024**. This collaboration aims to elevate women's hockey by providing essential resources and support to players, aligning with Coca-Cola India's commitment to sports and gender equality through its **#SheTheDifference** campaign.
- **Neeraj Chopra**, the reigning Olympic and world champion in javelin throw, started his 2024 season on a strong note, securing a **second-place finish** at the **Doha Diamond League 2024**. Chopra's impressive throw of **88.36m** on his final attempt fell just **2cm short** of Czechia's **Jakub Vadlejch**, the reigning Diamond League champion and Tokyo 2020 silver medalist.

- In a display of sheer dominance, **World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen** pulled off an incredible comeback to claim victory at the 2024 Superbet Rapid & Blitz Poland. Despite starting the day trailing by 2.5 points behind **GM Wei Yi**, Carlsen embarked on a remarkable 10-game winning streak, ultimately overtaking his rival and securing the championship title.
- In a showcase of electrifying motorcycle racing, **Jorge Martin** of Pramac Ducati emerged victorious in the nail-biting 2024 French MotoGP. The Spaniard fended off fierce challenges from **Marc Marquez** and **Francesco Bagnaia** to claim the top spot on the podium, extending his lead in the championship standings.
- In a historic move, the **United Nations General Assembly** has unanimously proclaimed **May 25** as the **World Football Day**, marking a significant milestone in the global celebration of the world's most popular sport.
- In a remarkable achievement, **P Shyaamnikhil** from Tamil Nadu has etched his name in the annals of Indian chess history by becoming the country's **85th Grandmaster (GM)**. The **31-year-old chess prodigy**, who embarked on his journey at the tender age of eight, finally secured the coveted **third and final GM norm** at the prestigious **2024 Dubai Police Masters Chess Tournament**.
- **Sunil Chhetri**, India's **most decorated footballer**, has announced his retirement from **international football**. The **FIFA World Cup Qualifier** game against **Kuwait** in **Kolkata** on **June 6** will be his last appearance for the national team.
- **Cristiano Ronaldo**, despite nearing the twilight of his career, has secured the **top spot on Forbes' list of the world's highest-paid athletes**. His significant earnings in Saudi Arabia have propelled him to this position for the fourth time.
- Indian para-athlete **Deepthi Jeevanji** etched her name in history by winning the **gold medal** in the women's **T20 400m event** at the **World Para Athletics Championships 2024**. Her stunning performance on Monday not only secured India's first gold medal at the prestigious event but also set a new **world record** time of **55.07 seconds**.
- The world's third-ranked Indian badminton pair of **Satwiksairaj Rankireddy** and **Chirag Shetty** etched their names in glory by winning the coveted **Thailand Open 2024** men's doubles title. In a thrilling final clash on **May 19, 2024**, the dynamic duo defeated the Chinese pair of **Chen Bo Yang** and **Liu Yi** with a scoreline of **21-15, 21-15**, in a match that lasted **46 minutes**.
- **German tennis star Alexander Zverev** etched his name in history by winning the **Italian Open** singles title for the second time. The 25-year-old defeated the first-time Masters finalist, **Nicolas Jarry of Chile**, in straight sets, **6-4, 7-5**, to claim his eighth overall Masters title.
- The Indian boxing contingent made a remarkable impact at the 3rd Elorda Cup 2024, held in the Kazakh capital city of **Astana**. The team returned with an impressive haul of **12 medals**, including **2 gold, 2 silver, and 8 bronze**.

- **Max Verstappen**, the defending Formula 1 World Champion, showcased his prowess on the track by clinching a hard-fought victory at the **Emilia Romagna Grand Prix 2024**. The Dutchman held off a spirited challenge from McLaren's rising star, **Lando Norris**, to secure his third win of the season.
- In a historic moment for South American football, **Brazil** was declared the host of the **2027 Women's World Cup** at the **FIFA Congress**. The Brazilian bid triumphed over the joint bid from **Belgium, Netherlands, and Germany**, becoming the first South American country to secure the hosting rights for the prestigious tournament.
- The **Asian Football Confederation (AFC)** has confirmed **Australia** as the hosts for the **AFC Women's Asian Cup 2026**. The continental football governing body made this announcement after the AFC Executive Committee ratified the recommendations of the AFC Women's Football Committee at its meeting in Bangkok, Thailand.
- The **International Olympic Committee (IOC)** has launched the **"Let's Move India"** campaign in collaboration with the **Reliance Foundation** and the **Abhinav Bindra Foundation**. The initiative aims to celebrate the Olympians heading to the upcoming **Paris Olympics** and encourage everyone to participate in physical activity.
- The International Cricket Council (ICC), the **global governing body** of cricket, has appointed the legendary Pakistani cricketer **Shahid Afridi** as the brand ambassador for the upcoming 9th ICC Men's T20 World Cup. This highly anticipated tournament will be co-hosted by the **West Indies** and the **United States of America** from **1st to 29th June 2024**.
- The Indian gymnast, **Dipa Karmakar**, has scripted history by becoming the first-ever Indian to secure a gold medal in any **Asian Championships**. Hailing from Tripura, Dipa achieved this remarkable feat in the women's vault individual final at the Asian Women's Artistic Gymnastics Championships 2024, held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan, on May 26, 2024.
- **Charles Leclerc**, the **Ferrari driver**, has achieved a remarkable feat by becoming the first **Monegasque driver to win the Monaco Grand Prix** since **Louis Chiron** in **1931**, ending a drought of 92 years.
- **Nayana James**, an Asian Athletics Championships bronze medalist, etched her name in glory by clinching the **gold medal** in the women's **long jump** event at the **Taiwan Athletics Open 2024** held in Chinese Taipei. Braving rainy conditions at the Taipei Municipal Stadium, Nayana recorded an impressive distance of **6.43m** to secure the top spot on the podium.
- The ninth edition of the **ICC Men's T20 World Cup** promises to be a thrilling spectacle, with the winners set to take home a **record-breaking prize money** of at least **\$2.45 million**. In addition to the championship glory, the **runners-up** will receive a substantial sum of at least **\$1.28 million**, while the losing **semi-finalists** will each earn a significant **\$787,500**. The total prize pot for the tournament stands at an impressive **\$11.25 million**, ensuring that even the teams that fail to advance beyond the Super 8s stage will be rewarded handsomely.
- The cricketing world witnessed another veteran hanging up his boots as **Kedar Jadhav**, the 39-year-old former Indian all-rounder, announced his retirement from all forms of cricket.
- Rohit Sharma, fondly known as the "Hitman" for his ability to hit towering sixes, etched his name in the record books by becoming the first cricketer in the world to hit 600 sixes in international cricket.
- The International Shooting Sports Federation (ISSF) World Cup, a prestigious shooting tournament, is currently underway in **Munich, Germany**, from **May 31 to June 8, 2024**. Amidst the intense competition, Indian shooter **Sarabjot Singh** has etched his name in history by claiming India's **first medal** at the event.
- The prestigious **Norway Chess Tournament** witnessed an electrifying conclusion as the reigning **World No. 1**, **Magnus Carlsen**, etched his name into the annals of chess history by claiming his sixth title. In a gripping final round, Carlsen outmanoeuvred the formidable **Fabiano Caruana** in an intense **Armageddon** match, solidifying his dominance on the global stage.
- The **Canadian Grand Prix 2024**, also known as the **AWS GRAND PRIX DU CANADA 2024**, witnessed a remarkable display of skill and determination as Dutch-Belgian racing driver **Max Verstappen** of **Red Bull** claimed his third consecutive victory at the prestigious event. The 9th round of the 2024 F1 championships, held at the iconic **Circuit Gilles-Villeneuve** in Montreal, Quebec, Canada, further solidified Verstappen's dominance on the track.
- Indian tennis sensation **Sumit Nagpal** has etched his name in history by winning the prestigious **Heilbronn Neckarcup 2024 ATP Challenger Tennis tournament** in Germany. This remarkable achievement marks Nagpal's **sixth ATP Challenger title**, a feat that solidifies his position as India's top-ranked men's singles player.

Sports Current Affairs of June 2024

- **Dinesh Karthik**, the veteran **wicketkeeper-batter**, announced his **retirement** from all forms of cricket. The writing was on the wall after his emotional farewell from the **Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB)** franchise in the recently concluded **Indian Premier League (IPL)** season.
- Wembley Stadium, **Real Madrid** etched their name in the history books once again by securing a record-extending **15th UEFA Champions League title**. The Spanish giants showcased their trademark resilience and clinical edge, overcoming a valiant **Borussia Dortmund** side with a **2-0 victory**.

- Indian strawweight **Puja Tomar** became the first ever Indian to win a bout in the UFC as she defeated **Brazil's Rayanne Amanda dos Santos** via split decision at the **UFC Louisville** on June 8. **Puja Tomar beat Rayanne Amanda dos Santos 30-27, 30-27, 29-28.**
- In a landmark decision, the Executive Board of the International Hockey Federation (FIH) has designated India as the host country for the inaugural **FIH Hockey Men's Junior World Cup featuring 24 teams**, set to take place in December 2025.
- Shruti Vora**, astride Magnanimous, has become the **first Indian rider** to win a **three-star Grand Prix event**- a historic achievement for the Indian equestrian. Shruti scored **67.761 points in the CDI-3 event in Lipica, Slovenia** from June 7-9. The Indian finished ahead of **Moldova's Tatiana Antonenco (Aachen)**, who scored 66.522. **Austria's Juliane Jerich (Quarter Girl)** completed the top 3 with a score of **66.087.**
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has named **Gudakesh Motie** of the West Indies as the **ICC Men's Player of the Month for May 2024.** In the women's category, **Chamari Athapaththu** of Sri Lanka has been named the **ICC Women's Player of the Month for May 2024.**
- The **2024 FIDE U-20 World Chess Championship**, organized by the International Chess Federation (FIDE), witnessed a remarkable achievement as **18-year-old Divya Deshmukh** from Nagpur, India, clinched the **FIDE Under-20 Girl's World Chess Championship** title. Deshmukh's triumph marks her as the **fourth Indian woman** to win this prestigious title, following in the footsteps of chess legends **Koneru Humpy, Harika Dronavalli, and Soumya Swaminathan.**
- In a thrilling final at the **BWF Australian Open 2024** in Sydney on Sunday (16 June), **Lee Zii Jia** from **Malaysia** emerged victorious against **Naraoka Kodai** of Japan, securing his second title of the season.
- According to the **Celebrity Brand Valuation Report 2023** released by global consulting firm Kroll, cricketer **Virat Kohli** has reclaimed the top spot as India's **most valued celebrity brand** with a brand value of **\$227.9 million.** This marks a **30% jump** from his brand value of \$176.9 million in 2022.
- The Indian National Ultimate Frisbee team put up a valiant effort in the finals of the **Asia Oceanic Beach Ultimate Championships (AOBUC) 2024**, finishing as runners-up after a hard-fought match against the Philippines with a final score of 9-12. This marks a historic milestone for Indian Ultimate Frisbee as the national team reached the finals for the first time, demonstrating significant growth and potential on the international stage. The tournament featured 16 teams from across Asia, Australia, and New Zealand.
- Indian **javelin star Neeraj Chopra** added another feather to his cap by clinching the **gold medal** in the men's javelin throw event at the **Paavo Nurmi Games 2024** in Turku, Finland. The Paavo Nurmi Games is a prestigious **World Athletics Continental Tour (Gold level)** event, and Neeraj's victory further solidifies his position as a dominant force in the sport.
- Pat Cummins**, the fast bowler, spearheaded the bowling attack by claiming a hat-trick, while David Warner's unbeaten fifty guaranteed a smooth chase as Australia comfortably defeated Bangladesh in their **'Super 8s' Group 1** encounter of the **T20 World Cup.** The match, held in **Antigua** on June 21, was under the threat of rain that disrupted proceedings twice.
- Olympic bronze medalist wrestler Bajrang Punia** has been suspended by the **National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA)** for a second time for refusing to provide a urine sample during selection trials. This suspension comes after NADA revoked his previous suspension due to procedural issues. Punia's legal team plans to challenge the suspension, arguing he did not refuse to provide a sample but sought clarification on expired kits used previously.
- In a thrilling display of skill and strategy, **Max Verstappen** secured victory at the **Spanish Grand Prix** on Sunday, further solidifying his position atop the **Formula 1 drivers championship.**
- In a remarkable display of athletic prowess and dedication, four officers from the Armed Forces Medical Service (AFMS) of India achieved unprecedented success at the **43rd World Medical and Health Games in Saint-Tropez, France.** Lt Col Sanjeev Malik, Maj Anish George, Capt Stephen Sebastian, and Capt Dania James collectively secured a record-breaking 32 medals, comprising 19 golds, 9 silvers, and 4 bronzes. These achievements underscore their exceptional performance in the world's largest sporting event for health professionals.
- The **Archery World Cup 2024 Stage 3 in Antalya, Turkey** concluded on June 23, 2024, with Indian archers showcasing their exceptional skills and bringing home multiple medals. 22-year-old **Dhiraj Bommadevara** emerged as a star performer for India, securing two bronze medals in recurve events.
- Rohit Sharma** became the first player to hit **200 sixes in T20Is** during the T20 World Cup 2024 Super Eight Group 1 match against Australia at the **Daren Sammy National Cricket Stadium in St. Lucia** on June 24. Rohit struck a **41-ball 92 and hit eight sixes in the innings**, taking his overall tally to **203 maximums** in the shortest format of the game.
- Indian wrestlers ended their campaign in the **Under-17 Asian Wrestling Championship 2024** with an impressive tally of **11 medals**, including **four gold, two silver, and**

five bronze. The event was held in Amman, Jordan, from 22-24 June 2024. Following the U-17 competition, the U-23 championship commenced.

- **Smriti Mandhana** became the **first Indian woman** to record **two consecutive ODI hundreds** during the second ODI against **South Africa** at the **M Chinnaswamy Stadium** in **Bengaluru** on June 19. She scripted history on June 23, after she registered the record for the most runs by an Indian woman in a bilateral **One-Day International series**.
- **Pat Cummins** made history on June 23, as he became **first player** to pick up **2 hat-tricks in T20 World Cups** during the Super 8 clash between **Australia and Afghanistan** in St. Vincent. Cummins picked up the wickets of **Rashid Khan, Karim Janat and Gulbadin Naib** to achieve the feat.
- The **cricketing world** bid farewell to one of its most dynamic players as **David Warner** officially retired from international cricket. Warner's illustrious 15-year career with the **Australian national team** came to an end following Australia's elimination from the **T20 World Cup** in the Super Eight phase.
- On a remarkable Friday at Chennai's Chepauk Stadium, young Indian opener **Shafali Verma** etched her name in the annals of cricket history with a **record-breaking double century against South Africa** in the one-off Test match.
- After a successful **first season in Dubai**, the Global Chess League will return for another edition, this time in London. The highly anticipated second edition of Tech Mahindra Global Chess League will take place in London, England from 3rd to 12th October 2024. It will take place at Friends House in central London.

Sports Current Affairs of July 2024

- In a **historic** moment for Indian cricket, the national team lifted the **T20 World Cup** trophy, ending an 11-year wait for a global title. The **nail-biting final** against South Africa saw India emerge victorious by a narrow margin of seven runs. As the team celebrated their hard-fought win, fans were stunned by an unexpected announcement from their beloved captain, **Virat Kohli**.
- In the aftermath of India's **thrilling victory** over South Africa in the T20 World Cup final, Rohit Sharma confirmed that he had donned the blue jersey for the last time in T20 internationals. The announcement sent ripples through the cricketing world, marking the end of an era for Indian T20 cricket.
- Star India all-rounder **Ravindra Jadeja** has announced his decision to **retire from T20 internationals** following **India's T20 World Cup 2024 triumph**. Ravindra Jadeja has called it quits from **T20 internationals**, bowing out on a high with the **T20 World Cup 2024 trophy**.

- **Viswanathan Anand**, the former world chess champion from India, achieved a remarkable feat. He won the **Leon Masters chess championship** for the 10th time, defeating **Jaime Santos Latasa** of Spain in the final with a score of 3-1. This victory adds another jewel to Anand's crown of achievements in the world of chess.
- The **Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)** has announced a consolidated cash prize of **Rs. 125 crore** for the Indian **men's T20 World Cup-winning squad**. The amount is a little over three times than the combined figure that was distributed as bonus after the Men in Blue won the **2011 ODI World Cup**.
- **India's U23 wrestling team** excelled in **Amman, Jordan**, clinching a total of **19 medals across women's wrestling, Greco-Roman, and freestyle categories**. The women wrestlers led with three gold medals, showcasing dominance in their divisions. Meenakshi, Pushpa Yadav, and Priya Malik stood out with impressive performances, securing victories by various methods including **Victory by Superiority and Victory by Fall**.
- The **Austrian Grand Prix 2024** will be remembered as a day of unexpected twists and turns, culminating in a stunning victory for **George Russell of Mercedes**. This race, held at the iconic **Red Bull Ring** in Spielberg, Austria, showcased the unpredictable nature of Formula 1 racing and the skill of drivers who can capitalize on sudden opportunities.
- A 28-member **Indian athletics team**, led by men's javelin throw defending champion **Neeraj Chopra**, will compete at the **Paris 2024 Olympics**, the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) announced on June 04. Chopra made history three years ago by becoming the first Indian **track and field** athlete to win a medal at the Olympics, that too a **gold**. This time, the Indian javelin throw ace will have Olympic debutant Kishore Jena for company in his pet event.
- **Lewis Hamilton** has won the **British Grand Prix 2024**. He became the first F1 driver to win on any track nine times and also extended his F1 record to 104 wins. His last came at the Saudi Arabian GP in December 2021 — the year he lost the title to Red Bull driver Verstappen.
- **Dhruv Sitwala** claimed his **third Asian Billiards Title** by defeating **Pankaj Advani in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia**. Organized by the ACBS, the championship featured various events including Men's Snooker Team, Men's Billiards, and Women's Asian Snooker.
- Indian squash players secured two titles at the recently concluded **Asian Squash Doubles Championship 2024** held at the Arena Emas in **Johor, Malaysia**. The Indian team clinched victories in both the men's doubles and mixed doubles categories.
- Sports brand **PUMA India** has announced a significant partnership with the **Indian Olympic Association (IOA)**,

becoming the **Official Footwear Partner** for the Indian contingent at the **Paris Olympics 2024**. This collaboration marks a major step in supporting Indian athletes on the global stage and promoting sports excellence in the country.

- **The Indian Olympic Association (IOA)** has announced that India will continue the tradition of having two flag bearers for the **Paris 2024 Olympics**, following the precedent set at Tokyo 2020. This decision aligns with the **International Olympic Committee's** push for gender equality in sports. **PV Sindhu**, the badminton ace, has been chosen as the female flag bearer for the Indian contingent. **Sharath Kamal**, the veteran table tennis player, will serve as the male flag bearer.
- **Jasprit Bumrah**, the hero of India's victorious **T20 World Cup** campaign, has added another accolade to his illustrious career. He was named the '**ICC Men's Player of the Month for June**', cementing his status as one of cricket's premier fast bowlers. **Smriti Mandhana**, the vice-captain of the Indian women's cricket team, secured her first **ICC Women's Player of the Month** award.
- **Four-time Olympian** and **2012 Olympic bronze medalist** Gagan Narang has been appointed as India's Chef-De-Mission for the **2024 Paris Olympics**. This decision comes after Mary Kom's resignation from the position due to health issues.
- In a significant development for Indian sports, **Gautam Adani**, Chairman of the Adani Group, has declared that the conglomerate will be the principal sponsor of the Indian contingent at the upcoming **2024 Paris Olympics**. This announcement marks a pivotal moment in the preparation of Indian athletes for one of the world's most prestigious sporting events.
- In a momentous occasion for cricket fans worldwide, **James Anderson**, the veteran English speedster, has officially announced his retirement from Test cricket. The 41-year-old bowler's illustrious career, spanning an impressive **21 years**, came to a close at the very ground where it all began – the iconic **Lord's Cricket Ground** in London.
- In a thrilling finale to Euro 2024, **Spain** secured their **fourth European Championship** trophy with a nail-biting 2-1 victory over **England** at the **Olympiastadion** in Berlin. This win cements Spain's status as the most successful nation in the tournament's history and marks their third title in the last five editions.
- In a **riveting finale** of the World Championship of Legends 2024, **India Champions** clinched a memorable victory against their arch-rivals **Pakistan Champions** by five wickets. The match, held at **Edgbaston** on July 13, 2024, showcased the enduring spirit of cricket and the fierce competition between these two cricketing powerhouses.

- In a move that marks the conclusion of an illustrious international career, **Thomas Müller**, the German football icon, has announced his retirement from international football following the conclusion of **Euro 2024**. This decision brings to a close a chapter that has spanned over a decade, leaving an indelible mark on German and world football.
- **Cricketer Virat Kohli** has reclaimed the top spot to become **India's most valued celebrity**, boasting a brand value of **\$227.9 million in 2023**. However, this value still falls short of his peak brand value of **\$237.7 million in 2020**, as reported by Kroll's **Celebrity Brand Valuation Report 2023**.
- The **Chennai Super Kings (CSK)**, one of the most successful franchises in the **Indian Premier League (IPL)**, has announced a significant expansion of its global presence with the establishment of its third international **Super Kings Academy** in Sydney, Australia. This move not only enhances CSK's international profile but also reinforces the franchise's long-standing connection with Australian cricket.
- **Eurosport India** has announced the appointment of renowned Indian cricketer **Shikhar Dhawan** as the brand ambassador for **MotoGP™** in India.
- Former Indian tennis stars **Leander Paes** and **Vijay Amritraj** have become the **first Asian men** to be inducted into the prestigious **International Tennis Hall of Fame**.
- **Manolo Marquez** was appointed as the new head coach of the **Indian men's football team** by the **All India Football Federation (AIFF)** on July 20. Marquez will take over as the **full-time national team head coach** after **ISL 2024-25**.
- The **Board of Control for Cricket** in India Secretary Jay Shah on July 20 said that the **BCCI** will provide **Rs 8.5 crore** to the **Indian Olympic Association (IOA)** as a support for the Indian contingent.
- **Harmanpreet Kaur** has now become the top run-scorer in women's T20I cricket for India, overtaking **Smriti Mandhana**.
- **Indian hockey goalkeeper PR Sreejesh**, a pivotal figure in the sport, has announced that he will retire from international hockey following the **Paris Olympics 2024**.
- The Australian Formula 1 (F1) racer **Oscar Piastri** secured his first-ever F1 title victory at the **Hungarian Grand Prix**.
- The **International Olympic Committee (IOC)** on July 12, announced that it has partnered with the National Olympic Committee (NOC) of **Saudi Arabia** to host the inaugural **Olympic Esports Games 2025** in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.
- **Ajinkya Naik**, at 37 years old, has been elected as the youngest president in the history of the **Mumbai Cricket Association (MCA)**.
- Six-time Grand Slam winner and former **World No. 1** in women's doubles **Sania Mirza**, six-time World Champion

and Olympic bronze medallist **MC Mary Kom** and actor **Rannvijay Singha** have joined 'Play Sports' as brand ambassadors.

- The Australian Formula 1 (F1) racer **Oscar Piastri** secured his first-ever F1 title victory at the **Hungarian Grand Prix**. The Australian rookie led a strong McLaren one-two finish alongside the British-Belgian racer **Lando Norris**.
- **Kush Maini** achieved his **first-ever Formula 2 win** at the **Hungarian Grand Prix** after **Richard Verschoor**, the original sprint race winner, was disqualified due to a technical infringement. This victory marks **Maini's fifth podium of the season**, placing him eighth in the championship standings, just three points behind Dennis Hauger.
- **Lewis Hamilton** clinched victory at the 2024 Formula 1 Rolex **Belgian Grand Prix** under dramatic circumstances after his Mercedes team-mate George Russell, who initially crossed the finish line first, was disqualified due to a technical infringement.
- As the 2024 Paris Olympics kick off, India's athletes are ready to shine on the global stage with a strong ambition to win medals.
- As of July 28, 2024, the Olympic medal standings reflect an intense competition among nations. **Australia has taken an early lead, securing the top spot with three gold medals.**
- The **Asian Cricket Council (ACC)** has announced that **India** will host the next edition of the **Men's Asia Cup** cricket tournament in 2025.
- In a remarkable display of skill and precision, **Manu Bhaker and Sarabjot Singh** has secured a bronze medal in the **10m Air Pistol Mixed Team event at the Paris Olympics.**
- As the 2024 Paris Olympics kick off, India's athletes are ready to shine on the global stage with a strong ambition to win medals.
- As of July 28, 2024, the Olympic medal standings reflect an intense competition among nations. **Australia has taken an early lead, securing the top spot with three gold medals.** Following closely behind are the People's Republic of China and the United States of America.
- The **Basketball Federation of India (BFI)** has set up the **National basketball academy** in collaboration with **Corvuss American Academy** in Mumbai.
- As of July 28, 2024, the Olympic medal standings reflect an intense competition among nations. **Australia has taken an early lead, securing the top spot with three gold medals.**
- The **Asian Cricket Council (ACC)** is poised for a significant leadership change as **Mohsin Naqvi**, the current chairman of the **Pakistan Cricket Board (PCB)**, is expected to assume the role of ACC president later this year.

Sports Current Affairs of August 2024

- **Novak Djokovic** of Serbia secured his first Olympic gold medal at the **Paris 2024 Olympics**. The 37-year-old tennis legend overcame Spain's **Carlos Alcaraz** in a gripping men's singles final at **Roland Garros** on Sunday, cementing his status in the annals of tennis history.
- **Manu Bhaker**, India's two-time Olympic bronze medallist, has been chosen to be **India's flagbearer** for the closing ceremony of the Paris Olympics.
- **American sprinter Noah Lyles clinched gold** in the **men's 100-meter** sprint at the 2024 Paris Olympics. The race was one of the closest in Olympic history, with Lyles finishing just 0.005 seconds **ahead of Jamaica's Kishane Thompson.**
- In a significant gesture to commemorate the upcoming **Paris Olympics**, the **Department of Posts** is set to release a special set of postage stamps. This event, scheduled for Monday, 5th August 2024, at 12:00 PM.
- **India and Saint Christopher & Nevis** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to enhance **cooperation in the field of sports.**
- In a move that bridges the cricketing worlds of India and South Africa, former Indian wicketkeeper-batsman **Dinesh Karthik** has been named the brand ambassador for the **SA20 League.**
- Indian wrestler **Vinesh Phogat** has been **disqualified from the Paris Olympics** after failing to meet weight requirement for her **50 kg gold medal.**
- **Vinesh Phogat**, one of India's most promising wrestlers, has announced her **retirement** from the sport following a devastating turn of events at the **Paris Olympics 2024.**
- The **Indian women's national volleyball team** has once again proven their mettle on the international stage by clinching the gold medal at the **4th CAVA (Central Asian Volleyball Association) Women's Volleyball Nations League.**
- The **Indian Olympic Association (IOA)** has announced that **hockey goalkeeper PR Sreejesh** and **pistol shooter Manu Bhaker** will be the **co-flag bearers for India** at the **closing ceremony of the Paris 2024 Olympic Games.**
- The first-ever **Global Women's Kabaddi League** will commence next month (September) in **Haryana.** Officially named the **Global Pravasi Women's Kabaddi League (GPKL)**, this groundbreaking tournament will feature **female athletes from over 15 countries.**
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has revealed the recipients of the ICC Players of the Month awards for July 2024. England's **Gus Atkinson** and Sri Lanka's **Chamari Athapaththu** have been crowned as the standout performers in men's and women's cricket.
- Hockey India (HI) has officially announced that retiring **goalkeeper PR Sreejesh** will be the **new head coach for the Indian junior men's hockey team.**

- **Para shuttler Pramod Bhagat** has been suspended by the Badminton World Federation for a period of **18 months** for breaching the **anti-doping regulations**. Now, Pramod will **miss the Paris 2024 Paralympic Games**.
- The **Paralympic Committee of India** has made a significant announcement regarding the country's representation at the upcoming **2024 Paris Paralympics**.
- **Top-ranked Jannik Sinner** and **women's No. 2 Aryna Sabalenka** each secured their **first Cincinnati Open** titles with straight-set victories.
- **Neeraj Chopra** delivered an impressive performance at the **Lausanne Diamond League**, securing his second-best javelin throw ever with a **season-best distance of 89.49 meters** on his final attempt.
- **Diana Pundole, a teacher and mother from Pune**, has made history as the first Indian woman to win the national championship in the saloon category at the **MRF Indian National Car Racing Championship 2024 held in Chennai**.
- The **Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)** secretary **Jay Shah** is all set to replace the incumbent Greg Barclay as the new chairman of the International Cricket Council (ICC).
- The Dutch Grand Prix witnessed a spectacular display of skill and determination as **Lando Norris** secured his **second career win**, outpacing championship leader **Max Verstappen** in a thrilling race.
- **14-year-old Tanvi Patri** from Odisha, India, has etched her name in the annals of badminton history. Patri clinched the **women's singles title** at the prestigious Asian U-15 Junior Championships 2024, held in **Chengdu, People's Republic of China**, from August 20-25, 2024.
- In a significant achievement for Indian surfing, the national team secured a **silver medal** at the prestigious **Maruhaba Cup**, a team event at the **Asian Surfing Championships 2024**. The competition, held in **Thulusdhoo, Maldives**, concluded on Sunday, marking a new chapter in India's surfing history.
- **Dawid Malan**, the former top-ranked **T20 batter** and a versatile player who achieved the rare feat of scoring centuries for England in all formats, has announced his retirement from international cricket.
- **Karthik Venkataraman** won the 61st edition of the **Indian National Championship** after **scoring 9/11 points** at the event organised by the **Haryana Chess Association**.
- **Bangladesh** has emerged as the new champion of the **SAFF (South Asian Football Federation) U-20 Championship** football tournament. This victory marks a significant milestone in Bangladesh's football history, as it is the first time the nation has claimed this prestigious title.

- **Para shooter Avani Lekhara** created history on August 30, by becoming the **first Indian woman** to win **two gold medals at Paralympics**. Avani, who became the **first Indian woman to win a Paralympic Games gold medal** during the women's 10m air rifle standing SH1 event at the **Tokyo 2020 edition**, retained her title in Paris.
- Indian shooter **Manish Narwal** has earned a silver medal in the **Men's 10m Air Pistol SH1 event at the Paris Paralympics 2024**. This victory adds to India's growing success at the Games, bringing the country's total medal count to four.
- Indian athlete **Preethi Pal** has achieved a historic milestone by winning **India's first-ever medal in the 100m event at the Paralympic Games**. Competing in the **women's T35 100m event**, Pal clinched the bronze medal with a remarkable personal best time of 14.21 seconds.
- **Mona Agarwal** made history at the **2024 Paralympics** by securing a **bronze medal** in the **women's 10m air rifle standing SH1 event** on August 30. Mona Agarwal's remarkable achievements include a **bronze medal in the Women's 10m Air Rifle SH1 at the Paris Paralympics 2024**.

Sports Current Affairs of September 2024

- **Rubina Francis** etched her name in **Paralympic history** on August 31, with a **bronze medal in Paris**. She rose on the occasion and clinched a **bronze** in the women's **10m air pistol SH1 event**. Para-athletes never have an easy journey, as they have to fight against all odds and show grit and resilience to reach the top, which was also the case with **Rubina**.
- At **Paris Paralympics 2024**, Indian Para Athlete **Preethi Pal** secured yet another medal for India, clinching a **Bronze medal in the Women's 200 meters – T35 Final**. She won the medal with a personal best timing of 30.01 seconds. With this win, she became the first track and field Indian Woman Para Athlete to win two medals at the Paralympics.
- **India's Nishad Kumar** secured a **silver medal** in the **men's T47 high jump final** at the **Paris Paralympics** on September 2.
- India's **Yogesh Kathuniya** won the silver medal in the men's **discus throw F56 event** at the **Paris 2024 Paralympics** on September 2.
- In a moment of sporting glory, **Indian para-shuttler Nitesh Kumar** achieved a monumental victory by clinching the gold medal in the men's singles SL3 event at the **Paris Paralympic Games 2024**.
- In a historic step towards developing **sports infrastructure in Bihar**, **Hockey India** announced that the upcoming **Hockey Women's Asian Champions Trophy 2024** will be held in **Rajgir** from **November 11 to 20**. The tournament will take place at the newly constructed Rajgir Hockey Stadium, where India will defend their title against teams from **China, Malaysia, Japan, Thailand, and Korea**.

- **Guwahati-based NorthEast United Football Club** etched their names in Indian football history by clinching their maiden **Durand Cup** title. In a thrilling final that went to a penalty shootout, they defeated the defending champions, **Mohun Bagan Super Giant (MBSG)**, 4-3. The match took place at the iconic Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan in Kolkata on August 31, 2024.
- Indian duo of **Sheetal Devi and Rakesh Kumar** claimed the **bronze medal** in the mixed team compound archery competition at the **Paralympics 2024 on September 2nd**. Their victory was secured with a nail-biting 156-155 win over Italy's Eleonora Sarti and Matteo Bonacina, marking only the second time that India has won a medal in archery at the Paralympics.
- Indian para-badminton star **Suhas Lalinakere Yathiraj** added yet another accolade to his remarkable career by winning the **silver medal in the men's singles SL4 category at the Paris 2024 Paralympics**.
- In a remarkable display of skill and perseverance, Indian para-badminton players **Thulasimathi Murugesan and Manisha Ramadass** clinched **silver and bronze medals**, respectively, in the **women's singles SU5 class at the Paris 2024 Paralympics**. Their outstanding performances not only showcased their exceptional talent but also marked a historic moment for Indian badminton.
- The prestigious **Lord's Cricket Ground in London** is set to make history by **hosting the final of the ICC World Test Championship (WTC) from June 11 to June 15, 2025**. This event marks the first time that the iconic venue, often referred to as the "Home of Cricket," will host the climax of cricket's most revered format.
- In a remarkable display of skill and determination, **Sharad Kumar and Mariyappan Thangavelu** secured silver and bronze medals respectively in the men's high jump T63 event.
- **Deepthi Jeevanji**, the 20-year-old **world champion sprinter** from India, has secured a **bronze medal** in the **women's 400m T20 event** at the 2024 Paris Paralympics.
- **Sumit Antil** etched his name in the annals of Indian sports history at the **Paris 2024 Paralympics**. The 26-year-old para-athlete not only claimed the gold medal in the **men's javelin throw F64 class** but also became the **first Indian male para-athlete to successfully defend his Paralympic title**.
- In a gripping final at the second **World Deaf Shooting Championship in Hannover, Germany**, teenage shooter Anuya Prasad from Jaipur secured the gold medal in the women's air pistol event.
- In a remarkable display of skill and precision, **Harvinder Singh** etched his name in the annals of Indian sports history by securing India's first-ever **Paralympic gold medal in archery** at the **Paris 2024 Paralympics**. This achievement comes three years after his groundbreaking bronze medal at the Tokyo 2020 Paralympics, further solidifying his status as a trailblazer in Indian para-archery.
- The Paris 2024 Paralympics witnessed a remarkable performance by India's **Sachin Sarjerao Khilari**, who secured a **silver medal** in the **men's shot put F46** event. This achievement not only adds to India's growing medal tally but also highlights the nation's emerging prowess in para-athletics.
- **Dharambir**, the 35-year-old athlete from **Sonepat**, etched his name in Paralympic history with a spectacular performance. Complementing Dharambir's gold was **Pranav Soorma**, who secured the **silver medal**.
- **Kapil Parmar** has etched his name in the annals of Paralympic history by securing India's **first-ever medal in judo** at the Paralympic Games. Parmar's bronze medal victory in the **men's 60kg (J1)** category marks a significant milestone in the country's para-sports journey.
- In a stunning display of perseverance and skill, India's **Hokato Hotozhe Sema** has clinched the bronze medal in the **men's shot put F57 class** at the **Paris 2024 Paralympics**. This achievement not only marks a personal milestone for Sema but also contributes to India's growing success in para-athletics on the global stage.
- Indian para-athlete **Praveen Kumar** has etched his name in the annals of Paralympic history with his spectacular gold medal win in the **men's high jump T64 final** at the **Paris Paralympics 2024**. This victory not only marks a personal milestone for Kumar but also adds to India's growing success in para-athletics on the global stage.
- **Jannik Sinner**, the world's No. 1 tennis player, clinched his second **Grand Slam title at the U.S. Open**, defeating Taylor Fritz in a thrilling final. This victory marked a remarkable comeback for Sinner, who faced significant challenges leading up to the tournament.
- In a significant development for traditional Indian sports, **Yogasana** has been officially included as a **demonstration sport** in the upcoming **2026 Asian Games**, set to take place in **Aichi-Nagoya, Japan**. This decision marks a pivotal moment in the recognition of yoga as a competitive athletic discipline on the international stage.
- The **4th Intercontinental Cup men's football championship** concluded with a stunning victory for **Syria**, as they defeated the defending champions **India** with a decisive **3-0** score in the final round-robin match. The tournament, held from September 3 to 9, 2024, at the **GMC Balayogi Gachibowli Stadium in Hyderabad, Telangana**, showcased Syria's dominance throughout the competition.
- In a groundbreaking moment for Indian boxing, **Deepali Thapa** etched her name in the annals of sports history by becoming the **first-ever schoolgirl champion** at the **Asian Youth Boxing Championships** held in **Al Ain, UAE** on Sunday. This remarkable achievement not only highlights Thapa's exceptional talent but also underscores India's rising prowess in women's boxing on the international stage.

- The **Subroto Cup International Football Tournament**, a premier inter-school football competition, celebrated its 63rd edition in 2024. Manipur's TG English School emerged victorious with a **4-3 win** in the shootout.
- An olympic champion, **Neeraj Chopra** finished **second in the Diamond League (DL)** final by throwing the **throw of 87.86m in Brussels**. He just missed first place by just 0.01m to Andersen Peters. Neeraj Chopra finished the 2024 season with silver in the last competition.
- **Oscar Piastri** of **McLaren** secured his first Formula 1 victory at the **Azerbaijan Grand Prix**, marking a significant milestone in his career. The race, held at the **Baku City Circuit**, concluded under a **virtual safety car** due to a late crash, adding an element of drama to the final moments.
- The **WorldSkills 2024** competition in Lyon, France, witnessed a remarkable performance by the Indian contingent, showcasing the country's growing prowess in various skill domains on the international stage. With an impressive haul of **4 Bronze medals** and **12 Medallions of Excellence**, India has firmly established itself as a rising force in the global skills arena.
- **Saleema Intiaz** has made history by becoming the **first Pakistani woman** to be nominated to the **ICC International Panel of Development Umpires**, according to an announcement by the Pakistan Cricket Board (PCB).
- India's Men's Hockey Team **clinched the 5th Title of Asian Champions Trophy in 2024**, by winning a goal from Jugraj Singh, India beat China 1-0 in the final game of the tournament.
- The **International Cricket Council (ICC)** has announced that **men's and women's cricket teams will receive equal prize money in all World Cup events**, starting with the 2024 Women's T20 World Cup. Set to take place next month in the UAE, this tournament will make cricket the **first major team sport to offer equal prize money across genders**.
- **Glasgow**, which hosted the event 10 years ago, will do so again, though some sports will need to be dropped as the Commonwealth Games Federation aims to reduce costs.
- India's Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW) appointed **Manu Bhaker**, the double Olympic medal winner, as a **brand ambassador**.
- The **14th Hockey India Junior Men National Championship 2024** concluded with an exhilarating finale on September 19, 2024, at the **Olympian Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium in Jalandhar, Punjab**. This prestigious event, organized by **Hockey India**, showcased the nation's top young talent in a fierce competition that spanned from September 9 to September 19, 2024.
- In a momentous achievement for Indian cricket, **Jasprit Bumrah** has become the **10th Indian bowler** to reach the illustrious milestone of **400 international wickets**. This feat was accomplished during the **first Test against Bangladesh at Chennai**, further cementing Bumrah's status as one of India's premier fast bowlers.
- **Magnus Carlsen and Judit Polgar** were **felicitated with the best male and female player awards**, respectively at the **FIDE 100 Awards ceremony in Hungary**.
- Renowned **Indian boxer Nikhat Zareen** has reported for duty as **Deputy Superintendent of Police** after handing over her joining report to the **Director General of Police Jitender**.
- **Commonwealth Heavyweight champion** Sangram Singh has made an unforgettable entrance into the world of **Mixed Martial Arts (MMA)**. The Indian wrestler's debut at the **Gama International Fighting Championship in Tbilisi, Georgia**, has set a new benchmark for Indian fighters in international MMA competitions.
- The **Singapore Grand Prix** on Sunday, September 22, 2024, witnessed a spectacular display of skill and nerve as **Lando Norris** of McLaren secured his third career victory in Formula 1. This win not only showcased Norris's growing prowess but also injected fresh excitement into the championship battle.
- The **Duleep Trophy** final between **India-A and India-C** concluded in dramatic fashion, with India-A emerging victorious by a margin of 132 runs. The match, which seemed destined for a draw that would have crowned India-C as champions, took a sudden turn in the closing stages, showcasing the unpredictable nature of cricket's longer format.
- The partnership between **JK Lakshmi Cement (JKLC)** and **Indian cricket team captain Rohit Sharma** enters its **fifth consecutive year**. Known for his cricketing excellence and leadership, Sharma's association has strengthened the brand's image and helped JKLC connect with a wider audience. This renewed collaboration will see him featured in advertising campaigns, brand activations, and promotional activities, enhancing JKLC's visibility across India.
- **Bangladesh's All time great cricketer Shakib Al Hasan** is set to **retire from the Tests and modern T20 format**. Shakib made the decision public during a press conference ahead of the second India-Bangladesh Test in Kanpur.
- **IBSF (International Billiards and Snooker Foundation) World Men's 6, 2024 Red Snooker Championship** A veteran **Kamal Chawla** wins **Gold** after beating a player from Pakistan in the final. Also, India begged **three bronze medals** also in the event final. The tournament was held in Mongolia.
- **Dwayne Bravo** has confirmed his **retirement from all cricket** after his final season in the CPL (Caribbean Premier League) was cut short by injury. The West Indies maestro will take up a **new role as Mentor in franchise cricket**.
- India's **Gulveer Singh** set a new national record en route to winning the men's 5000m gold in the **Yogibo Athletics Challenge Cup of World Athletics Continental Tour** at

Niigata, Japan. Gulveer won the race with a time of 13:11.82 to improve upon his own national record earlier this year.

- To expand the cricketing infrastructure, **BCCI** (Board of Control for Cricket In India) inaugurated the new state of art facilities which are called the **Centre Of Excellence** in the outskirts of the Bengaluru city. Which is also called New National Cricket Academy.
- The ongoing India vs Bangladesh 2 test match series, **Ravindra Jadeja** became the first Indian left arm spinner to take **300 test wickets** in Test cricket. The all rounder became the second fastest player who scored 3000 test runs and scalped 300 test wickets. It is a huge achievement for him and he joins the elite list in the history of cricket.

Sports Current Affairs of October 2024

Cricket {National Game of Australia, Bermuda, England, Jamaica No. of Players: 11}

Important Terms associated: Arm ball, Beamer, Bottom hand, Bouncer, Cameo, Carrom ball, Chinaman, Flick, Free hit, Glance, Googly, Hat-trick, Hit wicket, Leg bye, Nelson, Night watchman, Pinch hitter, Sweep, Upper Cut.}

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- **Virat Kohli completed 27000 international runs** and became the fastest cricketer to reach that milestone and broke the record of Sachin Tendulkar who earlier held the record. Virat achieved this feat against Bangladesh in the 2nd test match in Kanpur.
- **Sri Lanka spinner Praveen Jayawickrama** has been **banned** from all forms of cricket for **one year**, with the last six months suspended, for breaching the sport's anti-corruption code, as per International Cricket Council (ICC). According to ICC charges related to the Sri Lanka Premier League and International Cricket.
- **Irani cup** title finally returning to **Mumbai after the drought of 27 years**. Ajinkya Rahane led reigning Ranji champion team has drawn the match after taking the first innings lead against the Rest of India in a 5 day match. In which they stood victorious due to courtesy of the first innings lead.

- **International Cricket Council (ICC)** has revealed the **Players of the Month for September 2024**, honoring **Sri Lanka's Kamindu Mendis** and **England's Tammy Beaumont** for their outstanding performances in international cricket. Both players have earned this prestigious recognition for the **second time**, reflecting their consistency and dominance on the global cricketing stage.
- In a historic recognition, former **Indian cricketer Neetu David**, along with **England's Alastair Cook** and **South Africa's AB de Villiers**, has been inducted into the ICC Hall of Fame for 2024.
- **Sourav Ganguly**, the former Indian cricket captain and ex-BCCI President, has been named the **Director of Cricket for JSW Sports**. In this role, Ganguly will oversee all cricketing operations for the organization.
- In a remarkable display of resilience and skill, **Virat Kohli crossed the prestigious 9000 Test runs** milestone during India's first Test against New Zealand at the **M Chinnaswamy Stadium in Bengaluru**.
- Cricket, one of the most popular sports globally, is set to make a comeback at the **Los Angeles 2028 Olympic Games (LA28)**, pending approval by the **International Olympic Committee (IOC)**. This inclusion marks the sport's second appearance at the Olympic Games, following its debut in **Paris 1900**.
- **New Zealand Women's Team Lift the ICC T20 World Cup After 23 Years** at the Dubai International Cricket Stadium. They defeated the South African team with 32 runs. South Africa won the toss and opted to Bowl first. The New Zealand Team set the target of 158-5 after completing 20 overs.
- Zimbabwe's cricket team etched their name in history by posting a record-breaking total of **344/4** in a T20 International, led by **Sikandar Raza's unbeaten 133** off just 43 balls. His explosive innings, featuring 15 sixes, helped Zimbabwe achieve this landmark in the **ICC Men's T20 World Cup Africa Sub-Regional Qualifier B** match against **Gambia**.
- **Kagiso Rabada** has etched his name in cricket history by becoming the fastest bowler to reach 300 Test wickets based on balls bowled, achieving the milestone in just **11,817 deliveries**. The South African pace sensation is now among the greats, surpassing legends like **Waqar Younis (12,602 balls)** and **Dale Steyn (12,605 balls)**.
- In a spectacular performance during the second Test against New Zealand in Pune, **Ravichandran Ashwin** set a new benchmark by becoming the highest wicket-taker in the **ICC World Test Championship (WTC)**. He started the match just one wicket behind Australian spinner **Nathan Lyon**, who held the top spot with 187 wickets. However, Ashwin's brilliant bowling helped him overtake Lyon, ending the day with **189 WTC wickets**.

- In a prestigious recognition, Maria Sharapova and twins Bob and Mike Bryan were named to the **International Tennis Hall of Fame's Class of 2025**. The induction ceremony will be held on August 23 in Newport, Rhode Island, where they will be celebrated for their trailblazing achievements and contributions to tennis.
- **Veteran Australian wicketkeeper-batter Matthew Wade** has officially retired from international cricket after an illustrious 13-year career, leaving a lasting impact on the sport. Known for his fighting spirit, Wade's journey from a hard-hitting batter to a strategic finisher has been nothing short of inspiring.
- **Ravindra Jadeja** achieved a significant milestone by becoming the **fifth-highest wicket-taker** for India in Test cricket. This feat was accomplished on the first day of the third Test match against New Zealand in Mumbai, where Jadeja surpassed Ishant Sharma's wicket tally. Jadeja now stands among India's legendary bowlers, with only four players ahead of him. Anil Kumble, Ravichandran Ashwin, Kapil Dev, Harbhajan Singh.

Important Terms associated: tennis

- Two upcoming tennis giants featured in the final game of the **China Open 2024**, **Carlos Alcaraz** from Spain **beat the World No.1 Jannick Sinner** from Italy in the final game and won the title. The Spaniard has beaten the Sinner three times this year in all competitions.

Football {National Game of Brazil, Italy, Germany, Israel, Mauritius, Poland No. of Players: 11}

Important Terms Associated: Back Pass, Corner Kick, Free Kick, Dribble, Futsal, Header, Kick off, Banana Kick, Toe Poke, Throw-in, Bicycle Kick}

The Indian Men's Football U-17 (Under 17) lifted the SAFF (South Asian Football Federation) Men's U-17 Championship after defeating **Bangladesh** in the final game of the tournament. The final was played at the Changlimithang Stadium in Thimphu, Bhutan. An unbeaten run throughout the tournament after winning the title is like cherry on top for Indian Football.

Awards of the tournament

- **Player of the Tournament** : Mohammed Arbash (INDIA)
- **Goal Keeper of the Tournament** : Aheibam Suraj Singh (INDIA)
- **Top Scorer of the Tournament** : Sujan Dangol (4 Goals) (NEPAL)
- **Fair Play Trophy** : BHUTAN
- **Andrés Iniesta**, The Spaniard, maestro of the game announced retirement from professional football after a long 22 years serving in the field. The player who represented the **National team of Spain and FC Barcelona**, one of the best clubs in the world.

- **Ngangom Bala Devi**, born on February 2, 1990, has etched her name in **Indian football history** by becoming the **first Indian woman to score 50 international goals**. Playing as a forward for the Manipur Police and the Indian national team, Devi's journey reflects her dedication and significant contributions to women's football in India.
- The **Indian men's football team** has made a modest advancement in the **FIFA rankings**, moving up one spot to **125th**, as per the latest update released on Thursday. This progress is attributed to their resilient performance in a recent international friendly against Vietnam, where they managed a 1-1 draw. Argentina tops the list and France ranked number 2 in the list.

Sports Events | Tournaments Current Affairs

Other Sports Current Affairs

- India's Gulveer Singh set a new national record en route to winning the men's 5000m gold in the Yogibo Athletics Challenge Cup of World Athletics Continental Tour at Niigata, Japan. Gulveer won the race with a time of 13:11.82 to improve upon his own national record earlier this year.
- **Kho Kho Federation of India (KKFI)** in collaboration with the **International Kho Kho Federation** revealed plans to organize the inaugural **Kho Kho World Cup** in India come 2025. This historic event marks a significant milestone in the journey of this traditional Indian sport toward global recognition.
- **Indian trio wins team Gold medal** at ISSF Junior World Championship 2024 in 25 Men's Rapid Fire Pistol event. The competition was held in Lima, Peru. The trio was **Raajwardan Patil, Mukesh Nelavalli and Harsimar Singh Rattha**.
- **Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar** unveiled the **logo and mascot** for the **Women's Asian Champions Trophy 2024**. Scheduled to take place in Rajgir from November 11 to 20, the tournament will feature the mascot named **'Gudiya,'** inspired by **Bihar's state bird, the sparrow**. The unveiling marks a significant step toward creating a vibrant atmosphere for the upcoming championship.
- **Dipa Karmakar, India's trailblazing gymnast**, who narrowly missed out on a podium finish at the Rio 2016 Olympics, has announced her retirement from the sport. Famous for performing the risky **"Produnova"** vault, often called the **"vault of death,"** Karmakar leaves behind a legacy of courage and determination that redefined Indian gymnastics.
- In a remarkable display of skill and determination, ace Indian **cueist Pankaj Advani** clinched the prestigious Songhe Singapore Open title by defeating local favorite Jaden Ong 5-1 in the final held in Singapore.
- The **Indian Olympic Association (IOA)** has chosen **Uttarakhand** as the host for the **38th Summer National Games**, scheduled to take place from **28th January to 14th February 2025**. This announcement marks a

significant achievement for the state, as it will be hosting the prestigious event for the first time, followed by the upcoming **Winter Games**, which will be held outside **Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh** for the first time.

- The Indian men's table tennis team won a **bronze medal** at the **2024 Asian Table Tennis Championships** in **Astana, Kazakhstan**. This achievement marks their **third consecutive bronze** in this event. The women's doubles duo, **Ayhika and Sutirtha Mukherjee**, became the **first all-Indian pair** to win a medal at the Asian Championships, also securing **bronze**. They reached the semi-finals but lost to Japan's **Miwa Harimoto and Miyuu Kihara**. Overall, India concluded the championships with **three bronze medals**, including the women's team's **first medal since 1972**. Individual performances saw early exits for former Commonwealth champion **Manika Batra** and veteran **Sharath Kamal**. India's total medal tally at the Asian Championships now stands at **eight bronze medals**.
- In a significant achievement for Indian shooting sports, the **International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF)** announced that India will host the **ISSF Junior World Cup in 2025**. ISSF President **Luciano Rossi** made this declaration during a press conference in New Delhi, where he praised India's contributions to the sport and its increasing global prominence.
- India's shooting contingent made a strong mark at the ISSF World Cup Final with **Vivaan Kapoor securing a silver medal in the men's trap event** and **Anant Jeet Singh Naruka claiming a bronze in the men's skeet competition**.
- Railway Sports Promotion Board (RSPB) won the **Senior Women Inter-Departmental National Hockey Championship** by defeating **Indian Oil 3-1 in the final**, held at **Major Dhyanchand National Stadium**.
- The **24th National Para-Swimming Championship** concluded with **Karnataka** emerging as the overall champion, amassing an impressive 392 points. The competition saw a fierce battle for the top spots, with Maharashtra finishing a close second with 378 points, and Rajasthan securing third place with 248 points.
- **Deepika Kumari**, a four-time Olympian from India, secured the **silver medal in the women's recurve event** at the **2024 Archery World Cup Final** held on **October 20, 2024**, in **Tlaxcala, Mexico**.
- **Chirag Chikkara** made history by becoming **only the third Indian wrestler to win the Under-23 World Championship**.
- India achieved a commendable **runner-up position** in the overall team standings at the Asian Arm Wrestling Cup 2024, which took place at the Aurika Skycity Hotel in Mumbai. The Indian team **finished second in the medal tally, only behind Kazakhstan**, the top-ranking nation in the world of arm wrestling.

Sports Current Affairs of November 2024

- Indian wicketkeeper-batter **Wriddhiman Saha** has announced his retirement from all formats of cricket, bringing an end to his nearly two-decade-long career. He revealed that the ongoing Ranji Trophy season would be his last.
- **India has submitted a Letter of Intent to the International Olympic Committee (IOC)** to host the **2036 Olympic and Paralympic Games**, marking a major step toward fulfilling Prime Minister Modi's vision of hosting the prestigious event for the first time.
- Indian professional boxer **Mandeep Jangra** claimed the World Boxing Federation's super featherweight world title after defeating Britain's **Conor McIntosh** in an intense match in the Cayman Islands.
- **Max Verstappen's** incredible victory at the Brazil Grand Prix has captivated the Formula 1 world. Starting from 17th place, Verstappen showcased remarkable skill and resilience, storming to the front despite challenging rain-soaked conditions at the Interlagos circuit in Sao Paulo.
- **Brigadier (Dr) BD Mishra (Retd)**, the **Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh**, inaugurated the much-awaited **4th LG Cup Horse Polo-2024 Tournament** at the newly constructed **Polo Stadium at Goshan, Drass**. This event, organized by the **Department of Youth Services and Sports, UT Ladakh**.
- **Alexander Zverev**, the German tennis star from Hamburg, **claimed his second Masters 1000 title of 2024**.
- Three-year-old **Anish Sarkar from Kolkata** has become the world's youngest-rated chess player, achieving an impressive FIDE rating of 1555.
- **Arjun Erigaisi** made a significant leap in the chess world by securing the world No. 2 spot in live ratings on 7th November.
- India's celebrated badminton star and **Olympic medallist, PV Sindhu, laid the foundation stone for the PV Sindhu Centre for Badminton and Sports Excellence** on November 7, in **Chinna Gadili village on the outskirts of Visakhapatnam**.
- Afghanistan's iconic all-rounder, **Mohammad Nabi**, will bring his illustrious **ODI career** to a close following the **2025 ICC Champions Trophy** in Pakistan.
- **Pankaj Advani** clinched his 28th world title by defeating England's Robert Hall 4-2 at the **IBSF World Billiards Championship** in Doha on November 9, 2024. This victory marked his seventh consecutive World Billiards Championship win.
- **GM Aravindh Chithambaram** made a remarkable late surge in the final rounds, winning the last two classical games to secure the **Chennai Grand Masters 2024 title**.
- **Union Minister for Youth Affairs & Sports, Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya**, launched a nationwide initiative to combat doping in sports, encouraging athletes, coaches, and the sporting community to use the National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA) India's 'Know Your Medicine (KYM)' app.

- **Tim Southee**, New Zealand's all-time leading wicket-taker, has announced his decision to **retire from international cricket** after the completion of the current ICC World Test Championship campaign.
- **Prajesh Gunneswaran**, the Indian tennis star who won a **bronze medal in singles at the 2018 Jakarta Asian Games**, announced his **retirement from professional tennis**.
- FIFA has unveiled the **2025 Club World Cup** trophy, designed in collaboration with **Tiffany & Co.** The golden trophy features a **24-carat gold-plated finish** with intricate engravings, drawing inspiration from **NASA's Voyager missions**, the **periodic table**, and **astronomical maps**. Its design symbolizes the future of football and global unity, with engravings in 13 languages, **Braille**, and a **world map**.
- **Magnus Carlsen**, the World No. 1 chess player, achieved a remarkable **double** at the **Tata Steel Chess India** tournament in **Kolkata**, winning both the **blitz** and **rapid** events. The 33-year-old Norwegian claimed the **blitz** title with a dominant performance, securing the victory with a round to spare.
- **Odisha** triumphed in a spectacular fashion at the **14th Hockey India Senior National Championship**, defeating **two-time champions Haryana 5-1** in the final at the **SDAT-Mayor Radhakrishnan Stadium** in **Chennai**. This historic victory secured Odisha's **first-ever gold medal** in the tournament, with **Shilanand Lakra** delivering an outstanding **hat-trick**, making a pivotal contribution to the win.
- At the **GT Open 2024** in **Luxembourg**, India's **Jyothi Surekha Vennam** won the **gold** in women's compound archery, defeating **Sarah Prieels** of Belgium with a **147-145** victory. In the men's competition, **Abhishek Verma**, who shot a perfect **600** in qualifications, claimed **silver** after a shoot-off loss to **Mike Schlosser**.
- The **4th National Finswimming Championship 2024** concluded in New Delhi with impressive performances from 1500 participants across 26 states and union territories. **West Bengal** emerged as the **team champions** with 151 medals (67 gold, 43 silver, 41 bronze), followed by **Karnataka** (50 medals) and **Uttarakhand** (21 medals). Organized by the **Underwater Sports Federation of India (USFI)**, the event highlighted India's growing success in finswimming.
- **Harshit Mahimkar** and **Prisha Shah** dominated the **Maharashtra State Open Badminton Tournament 2024**, winning the **men's** and **women's singles** titles, as well as the **U-17 boys'** and **girls' singles** crowns. Held at the **Willingdon Sports Club**, their performances showcased exceptional skill, harking back to previous triumphs in Maharashtra's badminton circuit and setting a high standard for future competitors.
- India will host the inaugural **Kho Kho World Cup** from **January 13 to 19, 2025**, at the **Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium** in **New Delhi**. This historic event aims to elevate **Kho Kho**, one of India's cherished indigenous games, to the global stage. Supported by the **Indian Olympic Association (IOA)** and the **Kho Kho Federation of India (KKFI)**, the tournament is set to be a major milestone in promoting **traditional sports**.
- **Rafael Nadal**, one of tennis's greatest players, bid farewell to professional tennis at the **2024 Davis Cup** in **Málaga, Spain**. His final match ended in a **6-4, 6-4 loss** to **Botic Van de Zandschulp** of the Netherlands, marking the end of an extraordinary career. With **22 Grand Slam titles**, **four Davis Cup victories**, and **two Olympic golds**, Nadal leaves behind an **unmatched legacy** defined by **grit**, **humility**, and incredible prowess on the court.
- India's **Women's Hockey Team** defended their title at the **Women's Asian Champions Trophy**, defeating **China 1-0** in the final. **Deepika's reverse-hit goal** in the 31st minute secured India's **third ACT** title and back-to-back championships, highlighting their dominance alongside **South Korea**.
- India's legendary cricketer **Jhulan Goswami** will be honored with a **stand named after her** at the **Eden Gardens, Kolkata**, by the **Cricket Association of Bengal (CAB)**, making her the **first woman cricketer** to receive such recognition. The unveiling will occur on **January 22, 2025**, during the **India-England T20I match**, celebrating her **extraordinary achievements** and contributions to **women's cricket**.
- **Alistair Brownlee**, a **double Olympic champion** and pivotal figure in British triathlon, has announced his **retirement** at **36**. Renowned for his iconic victories in **London 2012** and **Rio 2016**, he has inspired a new generation, including current Olympic champion **Alex Yee**, leaving a lasting legacy in the sport.
- **Italy** won its **fifth Billie Jean King Cup** title on **November 20, 2024**, defeating **Slovakia 2-0** in the final in **Malaga, Spain**. **Jasmine Paolini** secured the victory with a dominant **6-2, 6-1** win over **Rebecca Sramkova**, following **Lucia Bronzetti's 6-2, 6-4** triumph against **Viktoria Hrucakova**.
- **Bihar** will host the **Khelo India Youth Games (KIYG)** and **Para Games (KIPG)** in **April 2025**, reflecting its capability to host major sporting events. Announced by **Union Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya**, this aligns with the vision of a '**Viksit Bharat**' by 2047.
- On **22nd November**, **Jay Shah**, ICC president-elect and chief of the **BCCI** and **ACC**, announced a historic partnership between the **Asian Cricket Council (ACC)** and **Sony Sports Networks**. The deal, effective from **2024 to 2031**, ensures exclusive broadcasting of all **ACC tournaments** on **Sony Sports**, significantly enhancing cricket's visibility in the region.

- **Rishabh Pant** made history by becoming the **costliest player** in IPL history, fetching ₹27 crore from **Lucknow Super Giants (LSG)**, despite mixed white-ball performances. His move was influenced by uncertainty over his **captaincy** at **Delhi Capitals**. **Shreyas Iyer** followed closely with ₹26.75 crore, while **Venkatesh Iyer** was a surprise, returning to **Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR)** for ₹23.75 crore, showcasing the franchise's faith in him.
- **Vaibhav Suryavanshi**, a 13-year-old cricketer from **Bihar**, made history by becoming the youngest player ever signed at an **IPL auction**. On **Day 2 of the IPL 2025 Mega Auction** in **Jeddah**, **Rajasthan Royals** secured him for ₹1.10 crore, outbidding **Delhi Capitals** in a fierce bidding war. This remarkable achievement has positioned Suryavanshi as a promising **rising star** in Indian cricket.
- On **November 24, 2024**, **Anders Antonsen** made history as the first **Danish player** to win the **China Masters men's singles title**, defeating **Jonatan Christie** (Indonesia) 21-15, 21-13. This marked Antonsen's **fourth BWF Tour title** of 2024, securing his top spot in the **Race to Finals** rankings. Despite the defeat, **Christie** earned a spot in the **BWF Tour Finals** in **Huangzhou**.
- **Reetika Hooda** made history by winning the **gold medal** in the **women's 76kg category** at the **World Military Championships**, becoming the second **Indian woman** to achieve this feat. This victory follows **Jyoti Sihag's** gold in the **55kg category**, marking a significant debut for **India's women's wrestling contingent** at the prestigious event.
- The **40th edition** of the **Governor's Gold Cup International Football Tournament** concluded on **November 24, 2024**, at **Paljor Stadium** in **Gangtok**, with **NorthEast United FC** winning in a dramatic **4-3 penalty shootout** over **Gangtok Himalayan SC**.
- On **November 25, 2024**, **India** achieved a historic **295-run victory** over **Australia** in the **first Test** of the **Border-Gavaskar Trophy** at **Optus Stadium, Perth**. This stunning win gave India a **1-0 lead** in the series and shattered a **47-year-old record**, marking India's **biggest victory against Australia** in Australia in terms of runs, surpassing the previous record of **222 runs** set in **Melbourne** in 1977.
- **Emma McKeon**, Australia's most decorated Olympian, announced her retirement on **November 25, 2024**, at age 30. She leaves a remarkable legacy with **14 Olympic medals**—six **golds**, three **silvers**, and five **bronzes**—earned across **three Olympics**: **Rio 2016**, **Tokyo 2020**, and **Paris 2024**. McKeon's **historic seven-medal performance** at **Tokyo 2020** remains the most by a female swimmer at a single Games and tied for the most by any female athlete in one Olympics.
- The **National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA)** has imposed a **four-year suspension** on Olympic bronze medallist **Bajrang Punia** for violating the **anti-doping code**. The suspension follows his refusal to provide a **urine sample** during **selection trials** on **March 10, 2024**. This decision extends the **provisional suspension** from April 2024, barring him from **competitive wrestling** and **coaching opportunities** abroad.
- **Divith Reddy**, an **eight-year-old** from **Hyderabad**, won the **Under-8 World Cadets Chess Championship**, securing **9/11 points** and the **gold medal** on tie-break over fellow Indian **Sattwik Swain**, who earned silver. **Ziming Guo** of **China** took the bronze with 9/11 points. This victory highlights **India's growing dominance** in junior chess.
- **Max Verstappen** secured his **fourth consecutive Drivers' Championship title** despite finishing **fifth** in the **2024 Las Vegas Grand Prix**. The race, held on **November 24** in the **United States**, saw **George Russell** of **Mercedes** emerge victorious, with **Lewis Hamilton** finishing second. Verstappen's dominance continued, as his commanding lead in the points table ensured his historic fourth title, making him the **sixth driver** in history to achieve this feat.
- **Siddarth Kaul**, a 34-year-old fast bowler, announced his retirement from Indian cricket after a 17-year career. Kaul, who played six international matches (3 ODIs, 3 T20Is), was part of India's **Under-19 World Cup winning team** in 2008 and had **IPL success** with **Sunrisers Hyderabad**, where he was the joint-highest wicket-taker in 2018. He intends to explore **opportunities overseas** after achieving his childhood dream of representing India.
- **Ravindra Jadeja** became the fifth-highest wicket-taker for India in Test cricket, surpassing **Ishant Sharma** during the third Test against **New Zealand** in Mumbai. Jadeja now joins **Anil Kumble**, **Ravichandran Ashwin**, **Kapil Dev**, and **Harbhajan Singh** among India's top wicket-takers.

Sports Current Affairs of December 2024

- **Jay Shah**, **Secretary of BCCI**, has begun his tenure as **ICC Chairman** at 36, becoming the youngest to hold the position. His leadership comes during a pivotal time for global cricket, with key opportunities and challenges in expanding the sport's **reach** and **inclusivity**.
- **Arjun Erigaisi** has made history by becoming only the second **Indian** after **Viswanathan Anand** to breach the **2800 ELO rating** in classical chess, ranking **4th globally** with a rating of **2801**. This achievement follows his strong performance in **2024**, including an individual gold and team title at the **45th Chess Olympiad**. Erigaisi now joins the elite group, ranking just below **Magnus Carlsen** (2831) and **Fabiano Caruana** (2805).
- **Pavan Kampelli** made history by winning **India's first-ever bronze medal** in **eFootball** at the **2024 Asian Esports Games** in **Bangkok**. Known as '**Mr Tomboy**', Pavan's exceptional skill marked a significant milestone in **India's esports journey**.
- At the **Syed Modi International Super 300** (December 2024) in **Lucknow**, **PV Sindhu** claimed her **3rd title**, defeating **Luo Yu Wu** of China (21-14, 21-16). **Lakshya**

Sen won his **first Syed Modi title** in men's singles, beating **Jia Heng Jason Teh** of Singapore (21-6, 21-7). **Treesa Jolly** and **Gayatri Gopichand** made history as the **first Indian women's doubles pair** to win the title. The event was held at the **Babu Banarasi Das Academy** in **Uttar Pradesh**.

- India's men's junior hockey team clinched their **fifth Junior Asia Cup** title with a **5-3 victory** over **Pakistan** on December 4, 2024, in **Muscat**. This win marked their **third consecutive championship** (2015, 2023, 2024). **Araijeet Singh Hundal** was the hero, scoring **four goals** to secure the historic triumph.
- Lando Norris** won the **Abu Dhabi Grand Prix**, ending **McLaren's 26-year wait** for a **constructors' championship**, last achieved in **1998**. The race, filled with incidents and penalties, overshadowed a tough race for other drivers like **Max Verstappen** and **Lewis Hamilton**, who finished **fourth** in his final race for **Mercedes**.
- Bangladesh U-19** defended their **Asia Cup** title with a **59-run victory** over **India** in the final. Bangladesh set a target of **199 runs**, and India was bowled out for **139** in **35.2 overs**. Key performances from **Mohammad Shihab James**, **Rizan Hossan**, and **Azizul Hakim** helped Bangladesh post a strong total, while **Hakim**, **Iqbal Hossain Emon**, and **Rizan Hossan** took three wickets each to dismantle India's batting.
- Aarit Kapil**, a **nine-year-old chess prodigy** from Delhi, made history by becoming the **youngest Indian** to defeat a **chess Grandmaster**. In the **KIIT International Open Tournament**, he won against **Raset Ziatdinov**, a 66-year-old Grandmaster from the US. At just **9 years, 2 months, and 18 days**, Aarit set a **national record** and became the **third-youngest player** globally to achieve this under **classical time control**.
- Kush Maini** made history as the **first Indian** to win the **FIA F2 Constructors' World Championship** with **Invicta Racing**. This achievement follows his milestone as the first Indian to claim an **F2 pole position**. Despite challenges, Maini's **consistency** and key contributions helped Invicta Racing secure the title, showcasing his **talent and resilience**.
- Japan won the **20th Asian Women's Handball Championship** by defeating **South Korea** 25-24, claiming their second-ever title. This victory ended South Korea's seven-title streak. In the **fifth-place match**, **China** defeated **India** 41-30, with **Bhawana** scoring 9 goals for India. **Kazakhstan** secured third place, defeating **Iran** 28-22, while **Hong Kong** won the **seventh-place match** against **Singapore** 33-18.
- The **Khelo India Winter Games 2025** will showcase winter sports in **Ladakh** (ice events, Jan 23-27) and **Jammu & Kashmir** (snow events, Feb 22-25). This premier event aims to **promote winter sports**, identify young talent, and serve as a platform for athletes, particularly from remote **Himalayan regions**.

- Pakistan's **Haris Rauf** and England's **Danni Wyatt-Hodge** were named **ICC Players of the Month** for November 2024. Rauf's standout bowling helped Pakistan secure their first ODI series win in Australia since 2002, while Wyatt-Hodge's explosive batting led England to a T20I series victory over South Africa.
- FIFA has announced that **Spain, Portugal, and Morocco** will jointly host the **2030 Men's Football World Cup**, with additional matches in **Argentina, Paraguay, and Uruguay** to mark the tournament's centenary. **Saudi Arabia** will host the **2034 World Cup**. The decisions were made during an Extraordinary FIFA Congress meeting, with mixed reactions regarding the **bidding process**.
- Shaheen Shah Afridi** has made history as the youngest bowler to take **100 wickets** in all three formats of cricket. He achieved this milestone during the first **T20I** against **South Africa**, becoming the first **Pakistani** bowler to do so. Afridi claimed **3 wickets for 22 runs** in the match, joining a prestigious group of bowlers like **Lasith Malinga, Shakib Al Hasan, and Tim Southee**.
- Dommaraju Gukesh** became the **youngest chess world champion** at 18, defeating **Ding Liren** in the **FIDE World Chess Championship 2024** in **Singapore**. The 14-round event, with a **\$2.5 million** prize fund, ended with a score of **7.5-6.5** in Gukesh's favor, surpassing **Garry Kasparov's** record. His victory marks a milestone in chess history, showcasing his **dedication and talent**.
- Imad Wasim**, Pakistan's star **all-rounder**, announced his retirement from **international cricket** after a **nine-year** career. The **35-year-old** played a crucial role in Pakistan's **2017 Champions Trophy** win. While retiring from international cricket, Imad plans to continue playing in **domestic and franchise cricket**.
- Mumbai** defeated **Madhya Pradesh** by **five wickets** to win the **Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy (SMAT) 2024**. **Madhya Pradesh** posted **174/8**, with **Rajat Patidar** scoring an unbeaten **81**. Mumbai chased the target comfortably, reaching **180/5** in **17.5 overs**. This marks Mumbai's second SMAT title, following their first in **2022**.
- The **Indian women's junior hockey team** successfully defended their **Women's Junior Asia Cup** title by defeating **China 3-2** in a penalty shoot-out after a 1-1 draw in regulation time. The final was held in **Muscat, Oman** from **December 7-15, 2024**. This victory secured India's qualification for the **2025 FIH Women's Junior Hockey World Cup** in Chile.
- On **December 15, 2024**, at the **Mangaung Oval** in **Bloemfontein, England** made history in women's cricket. **Nat Sciver-Brunt** set the record for the **fastest Test century** by a woman, reaching 100 runs off just **96 balls**, surpassing the previous record of **Chamani Seneviratna**. **Maia Bouchier** also marked her **Test debut** with a century. Although both players were dismissed before

converting their centuries into bigger scores, their performances gave England a strong position.

- **Ravichandran Ashwin**, India's premier spinner, announced his retirement from international cricket after the third **Border-Gavaskar Trophy Test** in **Brisbane** on **December 18, 2024**. With a remarkable 14-year career, Ashwin became India's **second-highest Test wicket-taker** with **537 wickets** in **106 Test matches**. He also excelled in **ODIs** and **T20Is**, playing a total of **287 international matches**. His legacy includes **37 five-wicket hauls**, ranking second behind Muttiah Muralidaran.
- **Jasprit Bumrah** became India's highest wicket-taker in **Test cricket** on **Australian soil** on **December 18, 2024**, surpassing **Kapil Dev's** record of **51 wickets**. Achieving **52 wickets** during the third Test at **The Gabba, Brisbane**, Bumrah solidified his position as a key figure in India's **pace attack**.
- **Real Madrid** triumphed in the **2024 FIFA Intercontinental Cup**, defeating Mexico's Pachuca 3-0 in a dominant performance at **Lusail Stadium, Qatar**. The Spanish giants were in control throughout the match, with Kylian Mbappe, Rodrygo, and Vinicius Jr all contributing to the scoreline. Despite some early threats from Pachuca, Real Madrid's offensive power and defensive stability ensured a comfortable victory.
- Uttarakhand unveiled the **mascot, logo, jersey, anthem**, and **tagline** for the **38th National Games 2025** at **Maharana Pratap Sports College, Dehradun**. The Games,

scheduled from **January 28 to February 14, 2025**, highlight the state's rich heritage and athleticism. The **mascot "Mauli"** is inspired by the **Monal**, the state bird, symbolizing ambition. The **logo** reflects Uttarakhand's beauty and biodiversity, while the **tagline**, "**Sankalp Se Shikhar Tak**" (**From Resolve to Zenith**), represents determination. Traditional sports like **yoga** and **mallakhamb** will also be featured.

- The **Indian men's hockey team** has achieved **fifth place** in the latest **FIH world rankings**, following back-to-back Olympic medals at the **2024 Paris Olympics**. **Netherlands** remains top, with **India** securing **2955 points** in fifth, behind **England** and **Belgium**. This milestone highlights India's growing success in **hockey**.
- India's wicketkeeper-batter **Richa Ghosh** etched her name in history by smashing the **joint-fastest fifty** in women's T20Is. She achieved this feat during the third and final T20I of the series against **West Indies Women** at the **DY Patil Stadium**.
- India will host the **2025 Para Athletics World Championships** from **September 26 to October 5, 2025**, at **Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, New Delhi**. This historic event marks the first time India hosts the championships, which will feature over **1,000 athletes** from **100+ nations** and serve as a qualifier for the **2028 Los Angeles Paralympic Games**.

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Summits And Conferences

January to December 2024

Summits And Conferences of January 2024

- In preparation for the upcoming **biennial Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit**, the Indian state of Gujarat has sealed preliminary investment deals totaling **7.17 trillion Indian rupees (\$86.07 billion)** with 58 companies spanning sectors like energy, oil and gas, and chemicals. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's home state has been strategically securing these agreements ahead of the summit scheduled from January 10 to January 12 in Gandhinagar.
- The **10th edition of the Vibrant Gujarat Global Investors Summit (VGGS)** is set to take place in Gandhinagar from **January 10 to 12, 2024**. The theme for this edition is **"Gateway to the Future."** This biennial event serves as a crucial platform for global policymakers, diplomats, business leaders, and investors to foster collaborations, partnerships, and explore investment opportunities.
- At a curtain-raiser program in New Delhi, Union Minister Piyush Goyal revealed the logo and booklet for the highly anticipated **"Bharat Mobility Global Expo 2024."** Emphasizing India's innovative and holistic approach under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, Goyal encouraged the automotive industry to target a 50% export share, highlighting global economic opportunities.
- At the **Global Investors Meet (GIM) 2024**, Denmark unveiled the **Green Fuels Alliance India (GFAI)**, a pivotal initiative under the **Green Strategic Partnership (GSP)** signed between India and Denmark in 2020. The GFAI aims to accelerate collaboration in the sustainable energy solutions sector, aligning with the joint global objective of carbon neutrality.
- In a momentous event, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **Vibrant Gujarat Global Trade Show** in Gandhinagar, alongside esteemed guests including President Filipe Nyusi of Mozambique, President José Ramos-Horta of Timor Leste, and Gujarat CM Bhupendra Patel. The grand affair, held at Mahatma Mandir, is a precursor to the upcoming Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit.
- In a historic milestone for India, the nation is set to chair the **UNESCO World Heritage Committee and host its 46th session in New Delhi from July 21 to 31, 2024**. This significant announcement was made by Vishal V Sharma, India's Permanent Representative to UNESCO, on January 9, underlining the nation's growing influence and commitment to global cultural and natural heritage conservation.
- In a momentous event, Union Minister of Commerce & Industry, Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution, and Textiles, Shri Piyush Goyal inaugurated **'Indus Food 2024'** at India Exposition Mart, Greater Noida.

Commending India's diverse food industry, Goyal emphasized its global potential and underscored the need for technological innovation in the culinary landscape.

- **Gensol Engineering**, a prominent player in the sustainable energy sector, has embarked on a significant venture by entering into a strategic partnership with the **Government of Gujarat**. This collaboration is a pivotal step towards advancing the country's journey towards a sustainable future. The Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was formalized as part of the investment promotion activities associated with the **Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit 2024**, signifying a landmark agreement between the two entities.
- During the **Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit**, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman outlined ambitious projections for India's economic growth. Currently the world's fifth-largest economy at USD 3.4 trillion, India aims to become the third-largest by 2027-28, reaching a GDP of over USD 5 trillion. Sitharaman expressed confidence that even with conservative estimates, India's economy could soar to USD 30 trillion by 2047.
- Ukrainian President **Volodymyr Zelenskiy** has secured Switzerland's agreement to host a **global peace summit** aimed at resolving the conflict sparked by Russia's incursion into Ukraine on Feb. 24, 2022. Switzerland, known for its neutrality and past mediation roles, will facilitate talks to find a resolution.
- **IndoSpace**, a leading player in industrial and logistics real estate, has solidified its commitment to **Tamil Nadu's economic development** by signing a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) valued at **Rs 2000 crore**. This landmark agreement was unveiled during the **Tamil Nadu Global Investors Meet 2024**, a prestigious event attended by key dignitaries, including MK Stalin, Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, and Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry.
- The **India International Science Festival (IISF) 2023** has commenced today on January 17, marking the beginning of a four-day extravaganza celebrating the achievements of India in the frontier areas of science and technology. Organized by the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, Govt. of India, and coordinated by the **National Innovation Foundation-India**, IISF 2023 aims to foster scientific temperament, acknowledge achievements, and spread awareness among the Indian populace.
- In a significant move on the sidelines of the World Economic Forum Annual Meeting, India has unveiled the **"Alliance for Global Good-Gender Equity and Equality."** The initiative has gained support from influential entities, with the World Economic Forum (WEF) and Invest India joining as crucial partners.

- External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar recently provided a glimpse into the **19th Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) Summit, which commenced in Uganda**. The two-day summit, under the theme **'Deepening Cooperation for Shared Global Affluence,'** brings together over 120 developing countries, signifying a crucial moment in history. India, as a leading and founding member of NAM, wholeheartedly supports Uganda's theme, reaffirming its commitment to the movement's principles and values.
- In a momentous event, Union Minister for Culture and Tourism, G. Kishan Reddy, inaugurated five new galleries at the renowned **Salar Jung Museum** in Hyderabad. Recognized as one of India's premier cultural institutions, the Salar Jung Museum has undertaken significant initiatives under the leadership of Kishan Reddy to revitalize its exhibitions.
- India has been announced as the host of the **ISSF Junior World Cup 2025**, confirmed by the ISSF on **December 20, 2024**. This marks the **ninth** top-level shooting championship hosted by India, highlighting its growing reputation as a global hub for **shooting sports** and adding to the **National Rifle Association of India's (NRAI)** impressive track record.
- **India** clinched the **inaugural U10 Women's Asia cup T20 title** by defeating Bangladesh by 41 runs in the final held at the Bayuemas Oval, Kuala Lumpur on December 22, 2024. The victory was powered by a stellar half century from Gongadi Trisha and an impressive bowling performance, highlighting India's dominance in the tournament.
- **Punjab's top order batter, Anmolpreet Singh**, scripted a history by scoring a **third fastest List A century in just 35 balls** during Vijay Hazare Trophy match against Arunachal Pradesh in Ahmedabad. This incredible feat places him behind only Jake Fraser McGurk (29 Balls) and AB de villiers (31 Balls) in all time records for List A centuries.
- **Daniil Savelev**, the Russian tennis player, has been handed a **two-year suspension** for testing positive for the banned substance **meldonium** in **July 2024**. The **International Tennis Integrity Agency (ITIA)** confirmed the doping was **unintentional**, caused by confusion with family medication. Savelev accepted the suspension, which will last until **August 2026**.
- On December 26, 2024, **Virat Kohli** was fined **20%** of his match fee and received **one demerit point** for a **shoulder barge** against Australian player **Sam Konstas** during the **Boxing Day Test** at the **MCG**. The incident occurred after the 10th over of Australia's innings, and Kohli was found guilty of breaching **Level 1 of the ICC Code of Conduct** for inappropriate physical contact.
- **Sachin Tendulkar** has been appointed an **Honorary Cricket Member** of the prestigious **Melbourne Cricket Club (MCC)**, recognizing his extraordinary contributions to cricket over his 24-year career. The **MCC**, known for managing the iconic **Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG)**, awards honorary memberships to individuals who have made significant impacts on the sport.

Summits And Conferences of February 2024

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** is all set to inaugurate the **Bharat Mobility Global Expo**, a groundbreaking event in India's automotive landscape. Taking place from **February 1-3** in the national capital, this expo aims to highlight India's emergence as a global hub for mobility. With over 800 exhibitors and 50 overseas participants, the event covers the entire mobility value chain.
- The **PM GatiShakti Summit**, a collaboration between the **Federation of Indian Chamber of Commerce & Industry (FICCI)** and the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**, unfolded in New Delhi, marking a significant milestone in India's infrastructure development strategy.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi kickstarted the **Commonwealth Legal Education Association (CLEA) – Commonwealth Attorneys and Solicitors General Conference (CASGC) 2024** at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi, focusing on Cross-Border Challenges in Justice Delivery.
- Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi is set to address the prestigious **World Government Summit (WGS)** in Dubai on February 14. This marks his second invitation to the WGS, with the **first being in 2018**. The WGS, an annual global gathering held in Dubai since 2013, convenes world leaders, policymakers, and experts to tackle pressing global issues.
- A **North-East Sammelan** convened at the **Dr. Ambedkar International Centre in New Delhi** drawing attention to the region's progress and collaborative efforts. The event boasted the presence of distinguished ministers, MPs, MLAs, officers, and students, accentuating the significance of the occasion.
- In a significant moment for regional sports diplomacy, the **first-ever BIMSTEC Aquatics Championship** was officially declared open in New Delhi on February 6th, 2024. The ceremony, graced by the esteemed presence of **Shri Anurag Singh Thakur**, Honourable Union Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports of India, and **Shri Dig Bahadur Limbu**, Honourable Minister of Youth & Sports of Nepal, marked the commencement of a historic sporting event within the BIMSTEC framework.
- The **2024 World Governments Summit**, scheduled to be held in Dubai from February 12-14, has designated **India, Türkiye, and Qatar** as guests of honor. Themed 'Shaping Future Governments,' the summit aims to facilitate discussions among over 25 government and state heads worldwide.
- The Railway Protection Force (RPF) is organizing the **67th All India Police Duty Meet (AIPDM)** in Lucknow from February 12th to 16th, 2024. This esteemed event, entrusted to the RPF by the Central Coordinating Committee of AIPDM, aims to foster excellence and collaboration among police officers, enhancing internal security through scientific crime detection and investigation.

- The 7th Indian Ocean Conference recently convened in Perth, Australia, drawing together leaders, ministers, and officials from Indian Ocean rim countries. Organized by India Foundation in collaboration with the Ministry of External Affairs and Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade, the conference aimed to address diverse issues under the theme "Towards a Stable and Sustainable Indian Ocean."
- At the **World Government Summit 2024**, Dubai has unveiled groundbreaking agreements to introduce the world's inaugural air taxi service, setting a new standard in urban transportation. This initiative, centered around the innovative **Joby Aviation S4 aircraft**, promises to revolutionize Dubai's cityscape with its electric-powered, environmentally friendly design.
- External Affairs Minister **Dr. S Jaishankar** is currently participating in the **60th Munich Security Conference in Germany**. During the conference, he is engaging in various discussions and meetings with global leaders to address bilateral cooperation and key global and regional concerns.
- The highly anticipated **INDUS-X Summit** is set to take place on February 20-21, 2024, in New Delhi, marking a significant milestone in the collaborative efforts between India and the United States in defense innovation. **Organized by Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX)** under the Department of Defence Production, Ministry of Defence, and Department of Defence (DoD), United States, in conjunction with the U.S.-India Business Council and Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM), the summit aims to drive strategic technology partnerships and defense industrial cooperation between the two nations.
- The **Neem Summit & Global Neem Trade Fair**, held in New Delhi on 19-20 February 2024, is a collaborative effort between ICAR-Central Agroforestry Research Institute, Jhansi, and various stakeholders. The event aims to showcase the multifaceted uses of neem in agriculture, healthcare, and environmental sustainability.
- **Mobile World Congress (MWC)** brings people from the mobile industry together and gives them a chance to connect as well as collaborate. It also, given its importance, sets the technology tone for companies that deal in mobile and wireless technologies. At the same time, MWC gives companies a chance to showcase their latest products and innovations. This year, the event will start with a keynote on February 26 and will go on until February 29.
- The **Vimarsh 2023 5G Hackathon**, a collaborative effort between **Telecom Centres of Excellence (TCoE) India** under the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) and the **Bureau of Police Research and Development (BPR&D)**, Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), aimed to revolutionize Law Enforcement Agencies (LEAs) operations. This initiative sought to explore groundbreaking solutions and promote innovation within the law enforcement domain.

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated **Bharat Tex 2024**, the largest textile event in India, emphasizing its focus on sustainability, circularity, and economic growth. The event witnessed participation from over 3000 exhibitors and traders from 100 countries, showcasing India's rich textile heritage and modern innovations.

Summits And Conferences of March 2024

- A five-day exchange programme for faculty members of foreign service academies within the Bay of Bengal **Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC)** member states has commenced in Dhaka, marking the first of its kind.
- **Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras)** is hosting the **All India Research Scholars' Summit (AIRSS) 2024** from 4th to 7th March 2024. Organized by the Research Affairs Council of IIT Madras, this event promises to be a gathering of minds from diverse disciplines across India, aiming to showcase and explore the latest advancements in various research domains.
- The inaugural **Bharat Steam Boiler Expo 2024** has officially commenced in **Guwahati, Assam**, marking a significant milestone in India's industrial journey. Launched with the objective of enhancing the growth and efficiency of sectors reliant on steam boilers, this three-day event has been inaugurated by Sanjay Kishan, the state's Labour and Employment Minister.
- India is set to host the prestigious **World Telecom Standardization Assembly (WTSA) 2024**, organized by the International Telecommunication Union (ITU), along with the India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2024. These events aim to foster global collaboration, drive telecom reforms, and showcase India's technological prowess.
- The fourth edition of the **Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Startup Forum** convened in New Delhi on March 19, 2024, with a focus on enhancing interactions among SCO Member States' startups, fostering innovation, creating employment opportunities, and nurturing young talent.
- **India and Brazil** recently held their inaugural '**2+2**' **defence and foreign ministerial dialogue**, marking a significant milestone in their bilateral relations. The talks aimed to deepen cooperation across various sectors, emphasizing energy, critical minerals, technology, and counter-terrorism.
- The Indian Army is organizing the first **Army Commanders' Conference** for the year 2024 in a **hybrid mode**. The virtual segment of the conference is scheduled for **28th March 2024**, followed by the physical mode in **New Delhi** on **1st and 2nd April 2024**. The conference will be chaired by the **Chief of the Army Staff (COAS), General Manoj Pande**, and attended by senior military leadership, including Army Commanders participating virtually from their respective Command Headquarters.

- The METOC seminar ‘Meghayan-24’ was conducted by the School of Naval Oceanology & Meteorology (SNOM) and the Indian Naval Meteorological Analysis Centre (INMAC) at the Southern Naval Command on March 28, 2024. It was organized in commemoration of World Meteorological Day, with the theme ‘At the Frontline of Climate Action’ set by the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) for 2024.

Summits And Conferences of April 2024

- The 19th annual meeting of the secretaries of the security councils of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) member states was held in Astana, Kazakhstan, from 2 to 3 April 2024. The Indian delegation was led by the National Security Advisor (NSA) Ajit Doval. He also met Kazakhstan President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, the current Chairman of SCO.
- Masdar, the UAE’s prominent clean energy company, is set to host the World Future Energy Summit (WFES) from April 16 to 18 at the Abu Dhabi National Exhibition Centre (ADNEC). This summit serves as a pivotal global event focusing on future energy, clean technology, and sustainability, featuring various discussions, forums, and activations.
- India, led by Earth Sciences Secretary M. Ravichandran, advocated for the establishment of a region-specific ocean observation center during the 2024 Ocean Decade Conference held in Barcelona, Spain. The conference, organized by the Spanish government and UNESCO’s Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission, aimed to assess progress toward the goals of the United Nations Decade of Ocean Science for Sustainable Development (2021-2030) and foster collaboration among stakeholders.
- On Earth Day 2024, Bhutan is spearheading the Sustainable Finance for Tiger Landscapes Conference. With a goal of mobilizing \$1 billion over a decade, the conference aims to preserve tiger habitats critical for biodiversity and supporting millions of people.

Summits And Conferences of May 2024

- India reaffirms its commitment to safeguarding Antarctica’s delicate ecosystem and advancing scientific exploration in the region. The Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES), Government of India, in collaboration with the National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR), is set to host the 46th Antarctic Treaty Consultative Meeting (ATCM 46) and the 26th Meeting of the Committee for Environmental Protection (CEP 26) from May 20 to 30, 2024, in Kochi, Kerala.
- The 26th ASEAN-India Senior Officials’ Meeting took place in New Delhi, co-chaired by Secretary (East) Jaideep Mazumdar and Permanent Secretary Albert

Chua of Singapore. Discussions encompassed the three pillars of engagement—political-security, economic, and socio-cultural—reviewing ASEAN-India relations as outlined in the ASEAN-India Plan of Action (2021-2025).

- The 10th World Water Forum, themed “Water for Shared Prosperity,” officially commenced on May 21 in Bali, Indonesia. Attendees included numerous country leaders and United Nations representatives. The forum focused on four critical topics: water conservation, clean water and sanitation, food and energy security, and mitigation of natural disasters.
- India has taken on the chairmanship of the Colombo Process for the first time since the forum’s establishment in 2003. The Colombo Process is a regional consultative forum consisting of 12 member states from South and Southeast Asia focused on the management of overseas employment and the protection of migrant workers.

Summits And Conferences of June 2024

- The Supreme Court of India has reconstituted its Gender Sensitisation and Internal Complaints Committee, in accordance with the Gender Sensitisation and Sexual Harassment regulations of 2013. The reconstitution, initiated by the Chief Justice of India, appoints Justice Hima Kohli as the Chairperson, alongside Justice BV Nagarathna as a Member and Dr. Sukhda Pritam as the Member Secretary.
- In response to the dynamic growth of Indian securities markets, SEBI has established a committee, chaired by Usha Thorat, former Deputy Governor of the RBI, to assess and propose enhancements to the ownership and economic framework of clearing corporations.
- On June 5, Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the ‘Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam’ campaign to commemorate the World Environment Day. He planted a Peepal tree sapling at Buddha Jayanti Park in Delhi. He was accompanied by Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and Delhi’s Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena.
- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has taken a significant step towards enhancing pensioner services by forging partnerships with four prominent banks. These Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) aim to establish SPARSH service centers, leveraging the System for Pension Administration (RAKSHA), across 1,128 branches nationwide. SPARSH, a web-based system, facilitates streamlined pension processing and direct crediting to defense pensioners’ bank accounts.
- Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan lead the chart of 1.16 lakh farmers who have voluntarily given up the benefits of the annual Rs 6,000 Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-Kisan) scheme across the country from June 2023 to May 2024. The Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare had introduced a module in the PM-Kisan mobile app and website last year which enables farmers to voluntarily exit the scheme.

- The **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** has slapped a **fine of Rs 7.75 crore on 11 individuals** for allegedly operating a **'pump and dump' scheme in scrip of Svarnim Trade Udyog**. The markets regulator has also debarred them from the securities market and ordered disgorgement of **Rs 92.37 lakh with 12 per cent annual interest**.
- The Prime Minister, **Shri Narendra Modi**, has said that the decision of **3 crore additional rural and urban houses** under **Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY)** underscores the government's commitment to addressing the **housing needs** of our nation and ensuring that every citizen leads a better quality of life.
- The Assam government has taken a commendable step towards promoting girl education and addressing the issue of child marriage in the state. On June 12, 2024, Chief Minister **Himanta Biswa Sarma** announced the launch of the **Mukhya Mantri Nijut Moina (MMNM)** scheme, which was approved by the Assam government cabinet.
- On June 18, 2024, Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** awarded certificates to over 30,000 self-help groups as **Krishi Sakhis** in Varanasi. This initiative aims to enhance the skills of rural women in agriculture, recognizing their vital role in this sector.
- **Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare**, Shri Jagat Prakash Nadda launched the **National STOP Diarrhoea Campaign 2024**, on June 24. He was joined by **Smt. Anupriya Patel** and **Shri Jadhav Patraprao Ganpatrao**, Union Ministers of State for Health and Family Welfare. The dignitaries also released IEC materials like **logo, posters, radio spots and audio visuals** for the campaign and distributed oral rehydration salts (**ORS**) and **zinc tablets** to children on the occasion.
- Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Earth Sciences, MoS PMO, Department of Atomic Energy, Department of Space, Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions **Dr. Jitendra Singh** on **June 24**, launched **"One Week One Theme" (OWOT)** campaign showcasing recent success stories of India in different streams of science and technology.
- **Chief Minister Mohan Yadav** said the centre of **'Bharatiya Gyan Parampara'** will be opened in every PM College of Excellence and necessary arrangements will be made in this regard. The PM College of Excellence is going to get **started from July 1** in all the **55 districts of Madhya Pradesh**.
- The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) has launched the **Safai Apnao, Bimaari Bhagao (SABB)** initiative under **Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0**, running from **July 1 to August 31, 2024**. This initiative aims to bolster Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) in tackling heightened cleanliness and health challenges during the

monsoon season. It aligns with the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare's **'STOP Diarrhoea Campaign'**, emphasizing comprehensive interventions and inter-departmental collaboration.

- In a recent report **American multi-national investment bank** and financial company **Morgan Stanley** has all praise for **PM Gati Shakti scheme**. The report highlights **increased and more targeted investments**, suggesting a continued emphasis on infrastructure spending in India's future.

Summits And Conferences of July 2024

- The **International Association of Stem Cell & Regenerative Medicine (IASRM)** and the **Anti-Ageing Foundation (India)** hosted the **9th Annual World Congress – Longevity Revolution 2024 in New Delhi**. The event featured **advances in regenerative medicine, workshops**, keynotes from renowned scientists, and discussions on aging, aesthetics, and health.
- The **'Global IndiaAI Summit 2024'** commences today in **New Delhi**, hosted by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. This two-day event aims to position India as a global leader in AI innovation while promoting ethical and inclusive AI advancement. It will feature sessions on IndiaAI's strategic pillars, including compute capacity, datasets platform, innovation centers, and skills development. Sessions will explore topics like **'IndiaAI: Large Language Models'** and **'GPAI Convening on Global Health and AI'**.
- India chaired its first meeting as Chair of the **'Colombo Process'** at the Permanent Representative **Level Meeting in Geneva**, marking a significant moment in regional migration cooperation. The Colombo Process, comprising 12 Asian member states, focuses on enhancing governance and opportunities for overseas employment. Under India's leadership, priorities include financial sustainability, membership expansion, and collaboration with regional bodies like the Abu Dhabi Dialogue.
- Laos authorities have discussed preparations for the **57th Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) Foreign Ministers' Meeting** and related meetings, scheduled to take place in the **Laos capital Vientiane from July 21 to 27**.
- The **NATO summit**, hosted by **President Joe Biden in Washington, DC** from July 9 to 11, marks a pivotal moment for the alliance. It will include Sweden as a new member, highlighting NATO's expansion and unity amidst global challenges. Biden aims to strengthen support for Ukraine, with announcements expected to bolster military, political, and financial aid. The summit, commemorating **NATO's 75th anniversary**, underscores its role in Euro-Atlantic security and collective defense against evolving threats.

- **Om Birla, Speaker of the Lok Sabha**, will head a prominent Indian parliamentary delegation to the **10th BRICS Parliamentary Forum in St. Petersburg, Russia**. The forum aims to explore the role of parliaments in advancing global development and security through multilateral cooperation.
- **India** will host the first **World Audio Visual and Entertainment Summit** in November alongside the International Film Festival of India in **Goa**. I&B Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw promising to strengthen the ecosystem for the protection of intellectual property rights in the media and entertainment sector.
- **IIT Delhi and Prasara Bharati** will host the **two-day Robot Competition 'DD-Robocon' India 2024** from July 13, at **Thyagaraj Stadium in Delhi**. The event will host more than **750 students** from over 45 colleges, institutions, and universities in the country.
- The **International Cricket Council (ICC)** is set to make history as it holds its **Annual Conference** in Sri Lanka from July 19th to 22nd, 2024. This marks the **first time** the prestigious event will be hosted in the **Asian region**, highlighting the growing importance of Asian cricket on the global stage.
- The **All-India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA) in New Delhi** successfully concluded its **Second National Seminar SAUSHRUTAM Shalya Sangoshti** on July 15, 2024, celebrating Sushruta Jayanti. The three-day event, beginning on July 13, honored Sushruta, the father of surgery, with a series of live surgical demonstrations and expert discussions.
- India is hosting the **UNESCO World Heritage Committee meeting for the first time**, alongside the **2024 World Heritage Young Professionals Forum in New Delhi**. From July 14 to 23, young professionals from around the world will gather to enhance their skills in heritage preservation and sustainable development. The forum, organized by the **Ministry of Culture and the Archaeological Survey of India**, focuses on integrating global heritage concepts with local Indian heritage management.
- **India** is set to host the second Asia Pacific ministerial conference on **civil aviation on September 11 and 12**, with representatives from **around 40 countries**, including **China and Pakistan**. The Asia Pacific region is a significant contributor to global air traffic, and India the world's fastest-growing aviation market.
- **Translational Health Science and Technology Institute (THSTI)**, under the **Biotechnology Research and Innovation Council (BRIC)**, hosted **SYNCHN 2024** on **July 14th, 2024**. This event aimed to strengthen academia-industry collaborations in the NCR Biotech Cluster, focusing on advancing biomanufacturing and bio-innovation.
- A milestone event in space exploration, the **45th Scientific Assembly of the Committee on Space Research (COSPAR)** commenced in **Busan, South Korea**. Hosted for the first time by South Korea, the conference gathered 3,000 scientists and industry leaders from 60 nations.
- The Indian team, which participated at the **35th International Biology Olympiad (IBO) 2024** achieved remarkable success, with one student winning a **GOLD medal** and three students securing **SILVER medals**.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **46th session of the World Heritage Committee** at **Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi**, emphasizing India's commitment to global heritage preservation. **PM Modi announced a \$1 million** contribution to the **UNESCO World Heritage Centre for heritage conservation**, particularly in the Global South. He highlighted India's efforts in conserving heritage sites in countries like Cambodia, Vietnam, and Myanmar.
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi chaired the 9th Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog on July 28. The Meeting was held at the Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre, New Delhi.
- Foreign ministers from **Australia, India, Japan** and the **United States** said on July 29, they were seriously concerned about intimidating and dangerous manoeuvres in the **South China Sea** and pledged to bolster maritime security in the region.

Summits And Conferences of August 2024

- The **Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **32nd International Conference of Agricultural Economists (ICAE)** at National Agricultural Science Centre (NASC) Complex, **New Delhi** on August 3.
- The **Ministry of External Affairs** of the Government of India in association with Confederation of Indian Industries (CII) will host the **1st BIMSTEC Business Summit in New Delhi** on August 6, 2024.
- India will host the **3rd Voice of Global South Summit** on 17 August 2024. This unique initiative began as an extension of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi's vision of '**Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas aur Sabka Prayas**', and is underpinned by India's philosophy of **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam**.
- **India and Japan** will hold **2+2 Ministerial Dialogue** in New Delhi on August 20. On the sidelines of the 2+2 dialogue, a bilateral meeting is scheduled between the Defence Minister and his Japanese counterpart.
- The **European Union (EU)** and the **external affairs ministry** are organising a regional conference in New Delhi to discuss emerging threats in **online radicalisation** and to jointly counter the **exploitation of online spaces** by terrorists.

- The **2nd India-Singapore Ministerial Roundtable (ISMR)**, aimed at further strengthening trade and economic ties between the two countries, will be held in Singapore on August 26.
- The **Second Meeting of the Joint Russian- Indian Commission** on the Cooperation in the Field of Emergency Management was held on 28th August 2024 in **Moscow, Russia**.
- The **US-India Strategic Partnership Forum** announced the third edition of the **India-US Defense Acceleration Ecosystem (INDUS-X) Summit** at Stanford University on Sept 9-10, 2024.
- Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh has chaired a **bilateral meeting on US-India Civil Nuclear Commerce** in New Delhi.
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the continuation of three umbrella schemes merged into a unified central sector scheme called '**Vigyan Dhara**' under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**.
- In a big announcement ahead of assembly elections in one state and a Union Territory this year, the government has launched the **Unified Pension Scheme (UPS)** amid protests by several **non-BJP-ruled states** over the **New Pension Scheme (NPS)**.
- The Spices Board of India has introduced the SPICED scheme, a strategic initiative to enhance spice exports and productivity. This scheme, officially named '**Sustainability in Spice Sector through Progressive, Innovative and Collaborative Interventions for Export Development**,' will be implemented throughout the remainder of the **15th Finance Commission cycle**.
- The **Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)** has completed a **milestone 10 years** today. Acknowledging this, Prime Minister Narendra Modi took to social media to congratulate the beneficiaries.
- The Union Minister of **Women and Child Development, Annapurna Devi**, launched the new **She-Box** portal, a centralized platform aimed at making workplaces safer for women by addressing complaints of sexual harassment.

Summits And Conferences of September 2024

- On September 4-5, 2024, a significant event took place in the military landscape of India. The **first Joint Commander's Conference** of the Armed Forces was held in **Lucknow**, Uttar Pradesh, marking a new era in the coordination and integration of India's military forces.
- **Indian Coast Guard** participated in the **20th Heads of Asian Coast Guard Agencies Meeting (HACGAM)** held in **Incheon, South Korea**. This important gathering, which took place from September 2-6, 2024, brought together

coast guard agencies from across Asia to discuss crucial maritime issues and strengthen collaborative efforts.

- As a precursor to **International Literacy Day 2024**, the Ministry of Education, Government of India, will host an International Conference titled "**Spectrum of Literacy**" on **September 7, 2024**. This virtual conference will be **organized by CIET, NCERT, New Delhi**, and will bring together global and national experts, educators, policymakers, and literacy advocates to explore the multifaceted dimensions of literacy in today's world.
- India's aviation sector has experienced significant growth, evolving into one of the **largest and most dynamic markets in the world**. With the **2nd Asia Pacific Ministerial Conference** on Civil Aviation scheduled from September **11-12, 2024, in New Delhi**, India is set to reinforce its leadership in aviation. The conference, **co-hosted by ICAO and the Ministry of Civil Aviation**, will focus on exploring new opportunities for growth, infrastructure, and collaboration, especially in regional connectivity.
- **Union Minister for Civil Aviation, Shri Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu**, inaugurated the **2nd Asia-Pacific Ministerial Conference on Civil Aviation (APMC)** at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, on 11th September. Along with him, the Union Minister for State also attended the event.
- India took part in the **BRICS Literature Forum 2024**, which began in **Kazan, Russia on 11th September 2024**. The event, inaugurated by **Kazan Mayor Ilсур Metshin**, focused on the theme "**World Literature in the New Reality: Dialogue of Traditions, National Values, and Cultures**."
- The third edition of the **INDUS-X Summit, held on 9-10 September 2024 in California**, marked significant progress in advancing a joint defence innovation ecosystem between India and the **USA**. **Co-organised by the U.S.-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF)** and Stanford University, the event focused on deepening defence collaboration through innovation, joint research, and investment.
- India participated in the **G20 Agriculture Ministerial Meeting** in **Cuiabá, Brazil**. Led by Minister of State for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, **Ram Nath Thakur**, the Indian delegation engaged in bilateral discussions with several global partners to enhance agricultural cooperation and address market access issues.
- India is set to host the **2nd Formal Meeting of the COP9 (Conference of Parties) Bureau** and the **3rd Formal Meeting of the Fund Approval Committee under the UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization) International Convention against Doping in Sport** on September 17-18, 2024, in **New Delhi**.

- At the **4th RE-Invest Summit**, hosted by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)** and Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), leading renewable energy (RE) developers, manufacturing companies, banks, and financial institutions pledged close to **\$386 billion (Rs 32.45 trillion)** to develop RE projects by 2030.
- The **Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS)**, **Ministry of Jal Shakti**, organized the **International WASH (Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene) Conference** during the 8th India Water Week from 17th-19th September 2024 in New Delhi. The conference, with the theme 'Sustaining Rural Water Supply', focused on knowledge exchange, innovations, and best practices to tackle global WASH challenges, especially **Sustainable Development Goal 6 (SDG 6)**.
- The **Sharjah Investment Forum (SIF) 2024** has concluded, marking a significant milestone in the realm of global business and technology. Held at the prestigious **Al Jawaher Reception and Convention Centre**, this two-day event drew an impressive crowd of over **5,000 attendees**, including a diverse array of high-profile officials, entrepreneurs, and industry leaders from around the world.
- The **Ministry of Food Processing Industries** is all set to host the **third edition of World Food India 2024**, from September 19 to 22, at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. **Aimed at becoming the largest event for the food processing and allied sectors in India**, this prestigious gathering will bring together industry leaders from across the globe.
- The **second edition of the Global Food Regulators Summit** was inaugurated on September 20, 2024, in **New Delhi**, marking a significant milestone in international cooperation for food safety and regulation. This high-profile event, organized alongside the **3rd World Food India 2024**, brings together food regulators and experts from around the world to discuss critical issues in food safety and standards.
- The Indian government will host the inaugural **World Audio Visual & Entertainment Summit (WAVES)** from February 5 to 9, 2025, to boost the **country's media and entertainment industry** and enhance its global influence. This will be the first global summit covering the entire media and entertainment spectrum.
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi participated in the sixth Quad Leaders' Summit in Wilmington, Delaware on **21 September 2024**, hosted by the **President of the United States of America, Joseph R. Biden**, Prime Minister of Australia Mr. Anthony Albanese and Prime Minister of Japan Fumio Kishida also participated.
- The Indian Navy hosted the fifth edition of the **Goa Maritime Symposium (GMS) 2024** from 23-24 September under the aegis of the Naval War College, Goa. Conducted in the newly inaugurated Chola building,

this year's theme was **"Common Maritime Security Challenges in the IOR – Progressing Lines of Effort to Mitigate Dynamic Threats such as Illegal, Unreported, and Unregulated (IUU) Fishing and Other Illegal Maritime Activities."**

- **External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar** participated in the **first-ever Joint Ministerial Meeting of the L.69 and C-10 groupings of nations** on the sidelines of the 79th session of the United Nations General Assembly in New York.
- As India gears for hosting **World Telecom Standardisation Assembly (WTSA2024)**, Department of Telecommunications (**DoT**) has set the ball rolling by **launching the WTSA2024 Outreach Sessions**, Scheduled in Delhi, Hyderabad, and Bengaluru.

Summits And Conferences of October 2024

- Shri Prataprao Jadhav, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge), Ministry of Ayush, and Union Minister of State, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India, inaugurated the **Ayush Medical Value Travel Summit 2024**. The event took place in Mumbai.
- Italian Prime Minister **Giorgia Meloni** convened a **call of G7 leaders** to discuss the escalating **crisis in the Middle East**. Italy, holding the rotating presidency of the G7, emphasized its commitment to finding a diplomatic solution amidst growing tensions, particularly focusing on the Israeli-Lebanese border and Iran's missile attack on Israel.
- **External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar** will lead India's delegation to Pakistan for the **Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's (SCO) Heads of Government meeting** in Islamabad on October 15-16, 2024. This marks the **first visit by an Indian External Affairs Minister to Pakistan since Sushma Swaraj attended a conference in 2015**. The visit is focused on the SCO's regional cooperation agenda, with no bilateral meetings confirmed as of now, according to the Ministry of External Affairs.
- The **World Health Organisation (WHO)** has commenced its **77th Regional Committee session** for Southeast Asia in New Delhi, marking a significant gathering of health leaders from across the region. **JP Nadda**, India's Minister of Health, has been elected as the **Chairperson** of the 77th Session, bringing his extensive experience in health policy to guide the deliberations.
- The **Second Army Commanders' Conference of 2024** began on October 10 in a hybrid format at a forward location in **Gangtok, Sikkim**. Bringing together senior leaders of the Indian Army, the conference serves as a crucial platform to review the nation's overall security landscape, address key conceptual issues, and devise strategies to tackle emerging challenges.

- The **44th and 45th Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN)** Summits and related events began on October 9 in Vientiane, Laos, focusing on the theme **"ASEAN: Enhancing Connectivity and Resilience."** Lao President Thongloun Sisoulith urged member countries to uphold peace, stability, and sustainable development while honoring their commitments to multilateralism. This year marks a significant opportunity for ASEAN to build a more integrated and resilient community in response to pressing challenges.
- The **India Digital Agri Conference 2024**, co-organized by the **Indian Chamber of Food and Agriculture (ICFA)** and **IIT Ropar TIF – AWaDH in New Delhi**, marked a significant milestone in revolutionizing Indian agriculture. The event focused on leveraging digital technologies like AI, IoT, drones, and data analytics to address challenges such as climate change, food security, and sustainable resource management. By modernizing farming practices, enhancing productivity, and fostering cross-sector collaboration, the conference laid the foundation for **India's leadership in Agri-tech**.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **first-ever telecom standards conference** organized by the **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)** in India, alongside the eighth edition of the India Mobile Congress (IMC) in New Delhi. This event marks a significant milestone for India as it hosts the **World Telecommunication Standardization Assembly (WTSA)** for the first time in the Asia-Pacific region, highlighting India's growing role in the global telecom landscape.
- **Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia, the Union Minister of Communications and Development of the North Eastern Region**, inaugurated the International 6G Symposium alongside the **ITU-WTSA24 and IMC 24 events**. He emphasized the transformative potential of 6G technology in driving economic growth and innovation, stating that the shift towards software-centric approaches offers a significant opportunity for India, which boasts a large pool of engineering and software talent.
- **NITI Aayog** is gearing up to host the **Second International Methanol Seminar and Expo 2024 on October 17-18, 2024**, at the Manekshaw Centre in New Delhi. This two-day event is a significant part of India's Methanol Economy Programme, initiated in 2016 in collaboration with the Methanol Institute, USA.
- The seminar will bring together global experts, industry leaders, and policymakers to discuss the future of methanol as a low-carbon fuel and its role in the world energy transition.
- On its 31st Foundation Day, the National Human Rights Commission (**NHRC**) organized a day-long national conference on the **"Rights of Older Persons" at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi**. During the keynote address, Acting

Chairperson Smt. Vijaya Bharathi Sayani emphasized the invaluable role of elders as the architects of the nation's history, keepers of cultural heritage, and foundational pillars of families.

Conference Overview

- NHRC's 31st Foundation Day conference focused on the **"Rights of Older Persons."**
- The event aimed to address the **growing challenges faced by the elderly population in India**.

The **2024 BRICS Summit**, held in **Kazan, Russia**, from October 22-24. The summit witnessed the adoption of the BRICS Kazan Declaration, endorsing UN reforms and investigating cross-border financial solutions to reduce reliance on the US dollar.

16th BRICS Summit: Key Outcomes

- **BRICS Pay:** A new payment system introduced to facilitate financial transactions among member nations, providing an alternative to SWIFT for international settlements.
- **Kazan Declaration:** Adoption of reforms to the UN, support for Palestine's full UN membership under the two-state solution, and deliberations on using national currencies for trade.

The Ministry of Information & Broadcasting is proud to announce **Australia as the "Country of Focus"** for the **55th edition of the International Film Festival of India (IFFI)**, scheduled to take place in Goa from November 20 to 28, 2024. This special recognition celebrates Australia's dynamic contributions to the global film industry, showcasing its rich storytelling traditions, vibrant cinema culture, and innovative cinematic techniques.

The 2024 edition of the Embassy's flagship diaspora engagement event, **Pravasi Parichay**, was inaugurated by **Dr. Suhel Ajaz Khan, the Ambassador of India to Saudi Arabia**, at the Embassy Auditorium in Riyadh. This week-long cultural celebration kicked off with a specially curated event titled **"Classical Languages of India,"** designed to showcase the country's rich linguistic diversity.

About Classical Languages of India

- **Earlier, India had six classical languages** Tamil, Sanskrit, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, and Odia.
- Tamil was declared a classical language in 2004, Sanskrit in 2005, Kannada in 2008, Telugu in 2008, Malayalam in 2013, and Odia in 2014.
- All the Classical Languages are listed in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution.
- **In October 2024** The Union Cabinet granted classical language status to Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali, increasing recognized classical languages to eleven.

The Asia Clean Energy Summit (ACES), a cornerstone event of the annual Singapore International Energy Week (SIEW), is held on the **11th edition from October 22-24, 2024**, in Singapore. This premier conference and exhibition brings together experts, innovators, and policymakers to advance clean energy solutions in Asia.

Chief Minister Shri Bhupendra Patel inaugurated the **17th Urban Mobility India Conference & Expo-2024** today at the Mahatma Mandir Convention Centre in Gandhinagar, Gujarat. The event, running from **October 25 to 27, 2024**, gathers over **2,000 professionals** and academics to discuss the future of urban transport in India. The conference focuses on the theme **"Standardisation and Optimisation of Urban Transport Solutions,"** aiming to enhance urban mobility through integrated strategies and innovative practices.

Summits And Conferences of November 2024

- India is hosting the first-ever **Asian Buddhist Summit (ABS)** in New Delhi from November 5 to 6, 2024, under the theme, **"Role of Buddha Dhamma in Strengthening Asia."** This event, organized by the Ministry of Culture and the International Buddhist Confederation (IBC), celebrates the deep-rooted Buddhist heritage in India and underscores its role in promoting peace and unity across Asia.
- Union Home Minister Amit Shah chaired the 32nd meeting of the **'Kendriya Hindi Samiti' in New Delhi**. The committee, which is the highest body for promoting the Hindi language, focuses on providing guidelines for its development and widespread use across India. The Kendriya Hindi Samiti, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, comprises 21 members, including 9 Union Ministers, 6 Chief Ministers, the Deputy Chairman of the Parliamentary Committee on Official Language, and other key officials from the Department of Official Language and sub-committees.
- India** has signed the **Host Country Agreement with the Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)**, allowing the Alliance's Secretariat to be established in India.
- On November 12, 2024, Union Minister for Power, Shri Manohar Lal, **chaired the Conference of Power Ministers in New Delhi**. The conference addressed key issues in the power sector, including operational performance, the financial health of DISCOMs, and the integration of renewable energy.
- India's Minister for Communications, Jyotiraditya M. Scindia**, inaugurated the **25th Meeting of the South Asian Telecommunication Regulators' Council (SATRC-25)** in New Delhi.
- At **COP29 in Baku, Azerbaijan**, the **UAE** announced the creation of the **Global Energy Efficiency Alliance**, with the goal of doubling global annual **energy efficiency** rates by **2030**. This initiative supports the UAE's commitment

to **reducing carbon emissions** and promoting sustainable resource use. Building on the **UAE Consensus** from **COP28**, the alliance aims to foster **international collaboration, innovation, and knowledge sharing** to achieve sustainability goals through partnerships and investment.

- Brazil officially transferred the **G20 Presidency** to **South Africa** during the closing ceremony of the **2024 G20 summit in Rio de Janeiro**. This marks a historic milestone as **South Africa** becomes the first **African nation** to lead the G20, with a **robust agenda** set for its presidency.
- The **Sagarmanthan Dialogue 2024** highlights India's push to lead in **sustainability, innovation, and connectivity**. India's **maritime sector** is crucial to its economic growth, with a **7,500-kilometer coastline, 12 major ports**, and over **200 minor ports**. It handles **95% of trade by volume** and **70% by value**, and ranks as the **third-largest** in **ship recycling** globally. In 2023, India had a fleet of **1,530 ships**. The sector has seen significant growth, with cargo capacity at major ports increasing by **87.01%** from 2014-15 to 2023-24. Merchandise **exports** reached **USD 451 billion** in FY23. **Paradip Port**: Became India's largest port by cargo volume in FY24, handling 145.38 million tonnes.
- Armenia** has become the **104th full member** of the **International Solar Alliance (ISA)**, established in **2015** to promote global **solar energy adoption**. This reflects Armenia's commitment to sustainable energy and supports the ISA's goal of mobilizing **USD 1000 billion by 2030**.
- India will host the **ICA Global Cooperative Conference in New Delhi from November 25-30, 2024**, marking the first time in its history. **PM Modi** will launch the **United Nations International Year of Cooperatives 2025**. The event, led by **IFFCO**, will welcome **3,000 delegates**, including **1,000 international delegates**, with **Bhutan PM** and **Fiji Deputy PM** attending. **Amit Shah** will chair the inaugural session.
- COP29** marked a historic milestone with the first-ever **Tourism Day** at the summit, featuring the **First Ministerial Meeting on Enhanced Climate Action in Tourism**. Over **50 countries** supported a landmark declaration to drive **climate action** in the tourism sector, acknowledging its impact on global **greenhouse gas emissions** while also recognizing its role in promoting **climate adaptation** and **regeneration strategies**.
- The **United Nations Climate Change Conference (COP29)** in **Baku** ended with a controversial agreement to **triple climate finance** for developing nations to **\$300 billion annually by 2035**, far short of the **\$1.3 trillion** requested by these nations until 2030. The deal faced strong opposition, particularly from **India**, which rejected the proposed goal as **"abysmally poor"** and criticized the **unfair distribution** of funds.

- The **Global Cooperative Conference 2024** was inaugurated by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**, marking the launch of the **United Nations' International Year of Cooperatives 2025**. The event highlighted the role of cooperatives in global development, particularly for **rural populations, women, and farmers**. Key moments included the release of a **commemorative postal stamp** and an address by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah**.

Summits And Conferences of December 2024

- The **14th Asia-Oceania Meteorological Satellite Users' Conference (AOMSUC-14)** is being held from **December 4–6, 2024** in **New Delhi**, hosted by the **India Meteorological Department (IMD)**. The event brings together **meteorologists, satellite operators, scientists, and researchers** to promote **collaboration** and advance **satellite meteorology** through **presentations, panel discussions, and a training workshop**.
- The **World Maritime Technology Conference (WMTTC)**, held every three years, will take place in **Chennai, India** from **December 4-6, 2024**. Organized by the **World Maritime Technology Congress**, the event brings together **21 member organizations** from **17 countries** in the maritime technology sector. It will be hosted by the **Institute of Marine Engineers (India) Chennai Branch**.

- The **10th World Ayurveda Congress (WAC 2024)** and **Arogya Expo** were inaugurated in **Dehradun**, with a focus on **"Digital Health: An Ayurveda Perspective."** Dignitaries like Union Minister **Prataprao Jadhav** and **Uttarakhand CM Pushkar Singh Dhami** attended the event, emphasizing Ayurveda's integration with modern technology. Key announcements included the launch of **Prakriti Parikshan Abhiyan**, aiming to assess the **constitution** of 1 crore individuals, and the introduction of the **Ayush Grid** to enhance healthcare delivery, supported by a \$1.3 billion investment pipeline.
- India participated in the **24th BIMSTEC Senior Officials Meeting (SOM)**, held virtually by **Thailand** on **December 20, 2024**. **Jaideep Mazumdar**, Secretary (East) from **MEA**, represented India. The meeting reviewed BIMSTEC's progress, discussed regional cooperation, finalized documents, and prepared for the **6th BIMSTEC Summit**.
- On December 26, 2024, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** chaired the 45th **PRAGATI** meeting, reviewing **eight key projects** worth over **Rs 1 lakh crore** in sectors like **urban transport, road connectivity, thermal power, and renewable energy**. **PRAGATI**, an ICT-based platform for **Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation**, focuses on **coordination** between the **Centre** and **state governments**. Modi stressed **timely execution**, resolving **public grievances**, and adopting **innovative practices** for project implementation.



Important Days

January to December 2024

Important Days of January 2024

Date	Day & Theme
January 1	Global Family Day
January 3	International Mind-Body Wellness Day
January 4	World Braille Day
January 5	National Bird Day
January 6	World Day of War Orphans
January 8	Earth's Rotation Day
January 9	Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
January 10th	World Hindi Day Theme: Hindi–Bridging Traditional Knowledge and Artificial Intelligence
January 11	- National Human Trafficking Awareness Day 58th death anniversary of Lal Bahadur Shastri,
January 10th to January 18th	Startup India Innovation Week 2024
January 11 to 17	National Road Safety Week
January 12th	National Youth Day
January 15	Indian Army Day Theme: In Service of the Nation
January 16	National Startup Day
January 19th	Kokborok Day
January 21st	52nd anniversary of statehood for Tripura, Manipur, and Meghalaya
January 23rd	Parakram Diwas
January 24th	International Day of Education Theme: Learning for Lasting Peace
January 24th	National Girl Child Day 2024
January 25	The National Voters' Day Theme: 'Nothing Like Voting, I Vote For Sure'
January 25	National Tourism Day
January 26	International Customs Day
January 27	National Geographic Day 2024
January 28th	- Indian Newspaper Day - World Leprosy Day
January 30th	Martyrs' Day, also known as Shaheed Diwas
January 31	International Zebra Day

Important Days of February 2024

Date	Day & Theme
February 1st	Indian Coast Guard Day
February 2	- World Wetlands Day - Rheumatoid Arthritis Awareness Day
February 1st to 7th	World Interfaith Harmony Week (WIHW)
February 4th	- World Cancer Day Theme: "Close the Care Gap: Everyone Deserves Access To Cancer Care," - International Day of Human Fraternity
February 6th	- International Day of Zero Tolerance for Female Genital Mutilation - Safer Internet Day Theme: "Inspiring Change. Making a difference, managing influence and navigating change online,"
February 7th	National Black HIV/AIDS Awareness Day Theme: Engage, Educate, Empower: Uniting to End HIV/AIDS in Black Communities
February 10th	- International Day of the Arabian Leopard - World Pulses Day Theme: Pulses: Nourishing Soils and People
February 11th	International Day of Women and Girls in Science
February 11	World Unani Day
February 12th	- International Day for the Prevention of Violent Extremism as and when Conducive to Terrorism - National Productivity Day
February 13th	- World Radio Day - National Women's Day
February 13th	International Epilepsy Day Theme: Milestones on My Epilepsy Journey
February 14	Congenital Heart Defect Awareness Day
February 14	Basant Panchami
February 15th	- International Childhood Cancer Day - World Hippo Day - World Anthropology Day
February 17	United Nations' Global Tourism Resilience Day
February 18	World Whale Day (3 rd Sunday of Feb.)
February 19th	Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Jayanti
20th of February	World Day of Social Justice
February 20th	Mizoram Foundation Day
February 21	International Mother Language Day in 2024 Theme: Multilingual education – a pillar of learning and intergenerational learning
February 24th	Central Excise Day
February 23	World Peace and Understanding Day
February 27th	World NGO Day
	National Science Day Theme: 'Indigenous Technologies for Viksit Bharat',

Important Days of March 2024

Date	Day & Theme
March 4	National Safety Day
March 5	International Day for Disarmament and Non-Proliferation Awareness
7th March	Jan Aushadhi Diwas
March 8th	International Women's Day Theme: Invest in Women: Accelerate Progress
March 10	- CISF Raising Day - International Day of Women Judges Theme: Women in Justice, women for justice
11 March	World Plumbing Day
14th March	World Kidney Day Theme: Kidney Health for All – Advancing Equitable Access to Care and Optimal Medication Practice
March 14	- International Day of Action for Rivers - Pi Day
March 15	World Consumer Rights Day
March 16th	National Vaccination Day
March 18th	Ordnance Factories Day
March 20th	- International Day of Happiness - World Sparrow Day - World Oral Health Day
21st March	- International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination Theme: A Decade of Recognition, Justice, and Development: Implementation of the International Decade for People of African Descent - World Forestry Day Theme: Forests and Innovation: New Solutions for a Better World."
March 21	World Down Syndrome Day
March 22	World Water Day Theme: Water for Peace
March 23rd	- World Meteorological Day - Shaheed Diwas, or Martyr's Day
March 24th	- World Tuberculosis (TB) Day – Yes we can end TB - International Day for the Right to the Truth concerning Gross Human Rights Violations and for the Dignity of Victims
March 27	World Theatre Day
March 28th	World Piano Day 2024
March 29th	Good Friday
March 30th	International Day of Zero Waste

Important Days of April 2024

Date	Day & Theme
1st April	Odisha Day or Utkala Dibasa
April 2nd	World Autism Awareness Day Theme: Empowering Autistic Voices.
April 1 to April 7	Prevention of Blindness Week

Date	Day & Theme
4th April	International Mine Awareness Day
5 April	- International Conscience Day Theme: Promoting a Culture of Peace with Love and Conscience - National Maritime Day Theme: Navigating the future: safety first!
April 6th	International Day of Sport for Development and Peace Theme: Sport for the Promotion of Peaceful and Inclusive Societies
April 6	National Handmade Day Theme: Buy a Handmade Product'
April 6	National Library Day
April 7th	World Health Day Theme: My Health, My Right
April 10th	World Homeopathy Day Theme: Homeoparivar: One Health, One Family
April 11th	National Safe Motherhood Day
April 11	World Parkinson's Day
April 12	International Day of Human Space Flight
April 14th	World Chagas Disease Day
April 13th	International Turban Day
April 14	World Quantum Day
April 15th	World Art Day Theme: A Garden of Expression: Cultivating Community Through Art
April 17th	World Hemophilia Day Theme: Equitable access for all: recognizing all bleeding disorders
April 18	World Heritage Day Theme: Disasters & Conflicts Through the Lens of the Venice Charter
April 19th	World Liver Day
April 21st	National Civil Service Day
April 22nd	Earth Day Theme: Planet vs. Plastics
April 23rd	World Book and Copyright Day
April 24th	National Panchayati Raj Day
April 24th	International Day of Multilateralism and Diplomacy for Peace
April 24 to 30	World Immunization Week Theme: Humanly Possible: Immunization for All
April 25	World Malaria Day Theme: Accelerating the fight against malaria for a more equitable world
April 25	International Girls in ICT Day
April 25	International Delegate's Day
April 26th	International Chernobyl Disaster Remembrance Day
April 26th	World Intellectual Property Day Theme: 'IP and the SDGs: Building Our Common Future with Innovation and Creativity
April 27th	World Veterinary Day
April 28th	World Day for Safety and Health at Work
April 29th	International Dance Day
April 30th	International Jazz Day
April 30th	Ayushman Bharat Diwas

Important Days of May 2024

Date	Important Days
May 01, 2024	International Labor Day
May 01, 2024	Maharashtra Foundation Day 2024
May 01, 2024	Gujarat Foundation Day 2024
May 02, 2024	World Tuna Day
May 03, 2024	World Press Freedom Day
May 04, 2024	International Day for Mine Awareness
May 05, 2024	World Portugal Language Day
May 07, 2024	World Asthma Day 2024
May 08, 2024	World Red Cross and Red Crescent Day
May 08, 2024	World Thalassaemia Day 2024
May 08, 2024	Rabindranath Tagore Jayanti 2024
May 09, 2024	Maharana Pratap Jayanti 2024
May 10, 2024	International Day of Argania
May 11, 2024	National Technology Day 2024
May 11, 2024	World Migratory Bird Day
May 12, 2024	International Day of Plant Health
May 12, 2024	Mother's Day 2024
May 12, 2024	International Nurses Day 2024
May 15, 2024	International Day of Families
May 16, 2024	International Day of Living Together in Peace
May 16, 2024	International Day of Light
May 17, 2024	World Telecommunication and Information Society Day
May 18, 2024	World's AIDS Vaccine Day 2024
May 20, 2024	World Bee Day
May 21, 2024	International Tea Day 2024
May 21, 2024	World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development
May 21, 2024	Anti-Terrorism Day 2024
May 22, 2024	International Day for Biological Diversity
May 23, 2024	Vesak, the Day of the Full Moon
May 23, 2024	World Turtle Day 2024
May 25-31, 2024	Week of Solidarity with the Peoples of Non-Self-Governing Territories
May 28, 2024	World Hunger Day 2024
May 28, 2024	International Everest Day 2024
May 29, 2024	International Day of Action for Women's Health 2024
May 29, 2024	International Day of UN Peacekeepers
May 30, 2024	International Day of Potato
May 30, 2024	Hindi Journalism Day 2024
May 31, 2024	World No-Tobacco Day

Important Days of June 2024

Date	Important Days
June 1, 2024	World Milk Day
June 1, 2024	Global Day of Parents
June 2, 2024	International Sex Worker's Day
June 2, 2024	Telangana Formation Day
June 3, 2024	World Bicycle Day
June 4, 2024	International Day of Innocent Children Victims of Aggression
June 5, 2024	World Environment Day
June 5, 2024	International Day for the Fight against Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated Fishing
June 6, 2024	UN Russian Language Day 2024
June 7, 2024	World Food Safety Day
June 7, 2024	World Oceans Day
June 8, 2024	World Brain Tumour Day
June 9, 2024	World Accreditation Day
June 9, 2024	International Archives Day
June 11, 2024	International Day of Play 2024
June 12, 2024	World Day Against Child Labor
June 13, 2024	International Albinism Awareness Day
June 14, 2024	World Blood Donor Day
June 15, 2024	World Elder Abuse Awareness Day
June 15, 2024	World Father's Day
June 16, 2024	International Day of Family Remittances
June 17, 2024	World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought
June 18, 2024	International Day for Countering Hate Speech 2024
June 18, 2024	Sustainable Gastronomy Day 2024
June 19, 2024	International Day for the Elimination of Sexual Violence in Conflict 2024
June 19, 2024	World Sickle Cell Day
June 20, 2024	World Refugee Day
June 21, 2024	World Music Day
June 21, 2024	World Hydrography Day
June 21, 2024	International Yoga Day
June 21, 2024	Summer Solstice
June 22, 2024	World Rainforest Day
June 23, 2024	International Olympic Day
June 23, 2024	United Nations Public Service Day
June 23, 2024	International Widow's Day
June 24, 2024	International Day of Women in Diplomacy 2024
June 25, 2024	International Day of the Seafarer 2024
June 26, 2024	International Day against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking

Date	Important Days
June 26, 2024	International Day in Support of Victims of Torture
June 27, 2024	Micro-, Small and Medium-sized Enterprises Day 2024
June 27, 2024	International Pineapple Day 2024
June 28, 2024	National Insurance Awareness Day 2024
June 29, 2024	National Statistics Day
June 29, 2024	International Day of Tropics
June 30, 2024	World Asteroid Day

Important Days of July 2024

Date	Important Days
July 1, 2024	National Doctor's Day
July 01, 2024	National Chartered Accountants Day
July 01, 2024	GST Day
July 02, 2024	World Sports Journalists Day
July 02, 2024	World UFO Day
July 03, 2024	International Plastic Bag Free Day
July 06, 2024	World Zoonoses Day
July 06, 2024	International Day of Cooperatives
July 07, 2024	World Kiswahili Language Day
July 11, 2024	World Population Day
July 11, 2024	International Day of Reflection and Commemoration of the 1995 Genocide in Srebrenica
July 12, 2024	Malala Day
July 12, 2024	International Day of Combating Sand and Dust Storms
July 15, 2024	World Youth Skills Day
Jul 17, 2024	World Day for International Justice
July 18, 2024	International Nelson Mandela Day
July 20, 2024	World Chess Day
July 20, 2024	International Moon Day
July 22, 2024	National Mango Day
July 22, 2024	World Brain Day
July 23, 2024	National Broadcasting Day
July 24, 2024	National Income Tax Day
July 25, 2024	World Drowning Prevention Day
July 26, 2024	Kargil Vijay Diwas
July 28, 2024	World Hepatitis Day
July 29, 2024	International Tiger Day
July 30, 2024	International Day of Friendship
July 30, 2024	World Day against Trafficking in Persons
July 31, 2024	World Ranger Day

Important Days of August 2024

Date	Important Days
01 st August 2024	World Wide Web Day
01 st August 2024	World Lung Cancer Day
01 st August 2024	National Mountain Climbing Day
01 st August – 07 th August 2024	World Breastfeeding Week
04 th August 2024	Friendship Day in India
06 th August 2024	Hiroshima Day
07 th August 2024	National Handloom Day
07 th August 2024	National Javelin Day
09 th August 2024	International Day of World's Indigenous People
09 th August 2024	Nagasaki Day
10 th August 2024	World Lion Day
10 th August 2024	World Biofuel Day
11 th August 2024	World Steelpan Day
12 th August 2024	International Youth Day
12 th August 2024	World Elephant Day
13 th August 2024	World Organ Donation Day
14 th August 2024	Partition Horrors Remembrance Day in India
15 th August 2024	Independence Day of India
16 th August 2024	Atal Bihari Vajpayee Death Anniversary
19 th August 2024	World Humanitarian Day
19 th August 2024	Rakshabandhan
21 st August 2024	International Day of Remembrance and Tribute to the Victims of Terrorism
22 nd August 2024	International Day Commemorating the Victims of Acts of Violence Based on Religion or Belief 2024
23 rd August 2024	International Day for the Remembrance of Slave Trade and Abolition
23 rd August 2024	ISRO Day
26 th August 2024	Mother Teresa Anniversary
29 th August 2024	National Sports Day
29 th August 2024	International Day Against Nuclear Tests
29 th August 2024	World Water Week 2024
30 th August 2024	International Day of the Victims of Enforced Disappearances
31 st August 2024	International Day for People of African Descent

Important Days of September 2024

Date	Event
September 1-7	National Nutrition Week
September 2	World Coconut Day
September 5	International Day of Charity
September 5-15	Onam
September 7	World Duchenne Awareness Day

Date	Event
September 7	International Day of Clean Air Theme: "Invest in #CleanAirNow"
September 7	International Day of Police Cooperation
September 7	International Vulture Awareness Day (IVAD)
September 9	UN International Day to Protect Education from Attack
September 11	National Forest Martyrs Day
September 14	Hindi Diwas
September 16	International Day of Science, Technology, and Innovation for the South
September 16	International Day for Interventional Cardiology
September 17	World Patient Safety Day Theme: "Improving diagnosis for patient safety"
September 17-20	India Water Week Theme: "Partnerships and Cooperation for Inclusive Water Development"
September 20	World Cleanup Day
September 21	International Day of Peace Theme: "Cultivating a Culture of Peace"
September 23	International Day of Sign Languages Theme: "Sign up for Sign Language Rights"
September 22	World Rhino Day
September 24	World Bollywood Day
September 25	Antyodaya Diwas
September 25	World Pharmacist Day
September 26	International Day for the Total Elimination of Nuclear Weapons
September 26	World Maritime Day Theme: "Navigating the Future: Safety First!"
September 26	World Environmental Health Day
September 26	World Contraception Day
September 27	World Tourism Day
September 28	International Day for Universal Access to Information Theme: "Artificial Intelligence, E-Governance, and Access to Information"
September 28	World Rabies Day Theme: "Breaking Rabies Boundaries"
September 29	World Heart Day
September 30	International Translation Day

Important Days of October 2024

Date	Day/Observance	Theme/Description
October 1	United Nations International Day of Older Persons	Theme: "Ageing with Dignity: The Importance of Strengthening Care and Support Systems for Older Persons Worldwide."
October 1	International Coffee Day	Theme: "Coffee, Your Daily Ritual, Our Shared Journey," focusing on sustainable and ethical coffee practices.
October 1	World Vegetarian Day	Advocates for a meat-free lifestyle, promoting animal rights, environmental sustainability, and human health.
October 2	International Day of Non-Violence	Established to coincide with Mahatma Gandhi's birthday, promoting non-violence and peace.
October 4	World Animal Day	Commemorates St. Francis of Assisi's feast day, advocating for animal welfare.
October 4-10	World Space Week	Theme: "Space & Climate Change," celebrating contributions of science and technology.
October 5	World Teachers' Day	Acknowledges the invaluable contributions of educators in shaping society.
October 6	World Cerebral Palsy Day	Raises awareness and advocates for the rights of individuals with cerebral palsy.
October 7	World Cotton Day	Celebrates cotton as a versatile crop in various industries beyond textiles.

Date	Day/Observance	Theme/Description
October 8	Indian Air Force Day	Commemorates the dedication and sacrifices of air warriors in India.
October 9	World Post Day	Theme: "150 years of enabling communication and empowering peoples across nations."
October 10	World Mental Health Day	Raises awareness about mental health issues globally.
October 10	National Postal Day	Marks the establishment of the Indian Postal Service and its crucial role in communication.
October 11	International Day of the Girl Child	Theme: "Girls' Vision for the Future," recognizing the rights and potential of girls globally.
October 12	World Migratory Bird Day	Focuses on the conservation of migratory birds and their habitats; Theme: "Insects for Birds."
October 13	International Day for Disaster Risk Reduction	Theme: "Education as a Lifeline for Youth in Disaster Risk Reduction."
October 14	World Standards Day	Theme: Our Shared Vision For a Better World
October 15	International Day of Rural Women	Theme: "Rural Women Sustaining Nature for Our Collective Future."
October 15	World Students' Day	Honors the life and contributions of Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam.
October 16	World Food Day	Theme: "Right to Foods for a Better Life and a Better Future."
October 16	World Anaesthesia Day	Theme: "Workforce Well Being," celebrating the role of anaesthesia in medicine.
October 17	International Day for the Eradication of Poverty	Theme: "Ending Social and Institutional Maltreatment: Acting Together for Just, Peaceful, and Inclusive Societies."
October 17	International Abhidhamma Divas	Celebrates the philosophical tradition of Abhidhamma.
October 16	Raising Day of the National Security Guard (NSG)	Commemorates the bravery and dedication of NSG personnel; established in 1984.
October 20	World Statistics Day	Celebrates the significance of statistics in shaping societies; first observed in 2010.
21st October	World Iodine Deficiency Day	The primary goal of this observance is to raise awareness about the importance of iodine in maintaining good health and to emphasize the adverse consequences of iodine deficiency, which remains a global public health issue.
24 Oct, 2024 – Wed, 30 Oct, 2024	Disarmament Week	. The week-long observance is dedicated to raising awareness about the importance of disarmament and promoting international dialogue to reduce the spread and impact of weapons.
24 th to 31 st October	Global Media and Information Literacy Week	The New Digital Frontiers of Information: "Media and Information Literacy for Public Interest Information"
October 24	United Nations Day	This day is a global celebration of the UN's mission to promote peace, security, human rights, and development around the world. In 2024, The United Nations was officially established on October 24, 1945, after the UN Charter was ratified by a majority of signatories, including the five permanent members of the Security Council: the United States, the United Kingdom, the Soviet Union, China, and France.
October 24	World Development Information Day	This observance was established by the United Nations General Assembly in 1972, with the primary goal of drawing global attention to development issues and promoting the dissemination of information that supports international cooperation for development.
October 24	World Polio Day	The day underscores global efforts to eradicate the disease and ensure a polio-free world for future generations.
October 24	International Day of Diplomats	The International Day of Diplomats, celebrated annually on October 24, shines a spotlight on the critical role that diplomats play in shaping international relations, promoting peace, and fostering cooperation among nations.

Date	Day/Observance	Theme/Description
October 25	International Dwarfism Awareness Day	Highlights the lives and challenges faced by people with dwarfism, while also raising awareness about conditions like Achondroplasia. This day encourages understanding and inclusion of people with short stature, breaking stereotypes and misconceptions.
October 27	World Day for Audiovisual Heritage	Established by UNESCO in 2005, this day highlights the importance of preserving audiovisual materials like films, sound recordings, and broadcasts, which face unique risks such as chemical decay and technological obsolescence.
October 27	Infantry Day	This day marks the landing of the 1st Battalion of the Sikh Regiment at Srinagar airfield in 1947, a pivotal moment in the defense of Jammu and Kashmir against invading forces.
October 28	International Animation Day	International Animation Day (IAD) was created by ASIFA (Association Internationale du Film d'Animation) in 2002 to honor the origins and influence of animation.
October 29	Ayurveda Day	9th Ayurveda Day on October 29, 2024, this observance aligns with Dhanvantari Jayanti and brings together over 150 countries under the theme, "Ayurveda Innovations for Global Health."
28 th October 2024 to 3 rd November 2024	Vigilance Awareness Week	Theme : "Culture of Integrity for Nation's Prosperity"
October 31st	National Unity Day	India celebrates National Unity Day to honor the birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, a key figure in the nation's independence movement and its first Deputy Prime Minister and Home Minister. Known as the "Iron Man of India," Patel was instrumental in uniting the country's diverse princely states into a single, independent nation.

Important Days of November 2024

Date	Event/Observance	Details
November 1	Coal India Limited (CIL) 50th Foundation Day	Marked its golden jubilee; tribute at the Coal Martyrs' Memorial by Chairman PM Prasad.
November 2	International Day to End Impunity for Crimes Against Journalists (IDEI)	Theme: "Safety of Journalists in Crises and Emergencies"; focuses on protection in conflict zones and crisis situations.
November 5	World Tsunami Awareness Day (WTAD)	Theme: "Building Resilient Communities"; aims to promote awareness and preparedness for tsunamis.
November 6	International Day for the Prevention of Exploitation of the Environment in War and Armed Conflict	Encourages global efforts to protect the environment in conflict situations.
November 7	National Cancer Awareness Day	Observed in India to raise awareness about cancer prevention and treatment.
November 8	World Radiology Day	Theme: "Radiographers: Seeing the Unseen"; honors Wilhelm Conrad Röntgen for discovering X-rays in 1895.
November 9	International Week of Science and Peace (IWOSP)	Observed November 9–15; highlights science and technology's role in promoting global peace and solutions to challenges.
November 9	World Adoption Day	Dedicated to raising awareness about adoption's life-changing impact.

Date	Event/Observance	Details
November 9	Uttarakhand Foundation Day	Marks the formation of Uttarakhand as a separate state.
November 10	World Science Day for Peace and Development	Theme: Why Science Matters: Engaging Minds and Empowering Futures ,“Youth at the Forefront”; celebrates science's contribution to peace and development.
November 10	World Immunization Day	Marks WHO's Expanded Program on Immunization (EPI), launched in 1974.
November 11	National Education Day	Honors Maulana Abul Kalam Azad's birth anniversary; recognizes his contributions to India's education system.
November 11–15	World Quality Week	Theme: “Quality: From Compliance to Performance”; emphasizes the shift to superior organizational performance.
November 12	World Pneumonia Day	Theme: “Every Breath Counts: Stop Pneumonia in Its Tracks”; raises awareness about pneumonia prevention.
November 14	World Diabetes Day	Theme for 2024–26: “Diabetes and Well-being”; raises awareness about diabetes prevention and management.
November 14	Children's Day (India)	Celebrates children and honors Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru's birth anniversary.
November 14–20	All India Cooperative Week	Theme: “Role of Cooperatives in Building Viksit Bharat”; emphasizes the economic and social impact of cooperatives.
November 15	Birsa Munda Jayanti (Janjatiya Gaurav Divas)	Celebrates tribal leader Birsa Munda's legacy.
November 15	Jharkhand Foundation Day	Marks the formation of Jharkhand state.
November 16	National Press Day	Commemorates the establishment of the Press Council of India in 1966.
November 16	International Day for Tolerance	Promotes mutual understanding among cultures.
November 17	World Day of Remembrance for Road Traffic Victims (WDR)	Observed on the third Sunday of November; honors road traffic victims.
November 18	World Day for the Prevention of Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Violence	Raises awareness about child abuse and advocates for prevention.
November 18–24	World AMR Awareness Week (WAAW)	Theme: “Educate. Advocate. Act Now.”; focuses on combating Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR).
November 19	International Men's Day	Theme: “Positive Male Role Models”; recognizes men's contributions and addresses critical issues.
November 19	National Integration Day	Honors Indira Gandhi's birth anniversary and her role in strengthening India's unity.
November 20	World Children's Day	Theme: “Listen to the Future”; highlights children's voices and perspectives.
November 21	World Fisheries Day	Theme: “India's Blue Transformation”; focuses on sustainable fisheries and aquatic ecosystem protection.
November 21	National Philosophy Day (World Philosophy Day)	Emphasizes philosophy's role in addressing global challenges and promoting critical thought.
November 21	World Television Day	Highlights television's role as a vital medium of communication.
November 25	International Day for the Elimination of Violence Against Women	Marks the 25th anniversary of its UN designation; focuses on eliminating violence against women and girls.
November 25–29	Aviation Safety Awareness Week	Organized by the Airports Authority of India (AAI); promotes a strong safety culture.

Date	Event/Observance	Details
November 26	National Milk Day	Celebrates Dr. Verghese Kurien's birth anniversary, recognizing his contributions to India's dairy industry.
November 29	International Day of Solidarity with the Palestinian People	Highlights the inalienable rights of Palestinians and calls for peace and justice.
November 29	International Jaguar Day	Promotes conservation of jaguars, apex predators in the Americas.
November 30	Day of Remembrance for All Victims of Chemical Warfare	Honors chemical warfare victims and emphasizes eradicating chemical weapons.

Important Days of December 2024

Date	Day/Observance	Theme/Description
December 1	World AIDS Day	Theme: "Take the rights path: My health, my right!" Focus on human rights and Universal Health Coverage.
December 2	International Day for the Abolition of Slavery	Highlights the fight against modern slavery and promotes human rights.
December 3	International Day of Persons with Disabilities (IDPD)	Advocates for the inclusion of persons with disabilities in all spheres of life.
December 4	Indian Navy Day	Theme: "Strength and Capability through Innovation and Indigenization." Honors Operation Trident (1971).
December 4	International Day of Banks	Highlights the role of banks in sustainable growth and economic stability.
December 4	International Cheetah Day	Raises awareness about cheetah conservation globally.
December 5	International Volunteer Day (IVD)	Celebrates the contributions of volunteers to social and economic development.
December 5	World Soil Day	Theme: "Caring for Soils: Measure, Monitor, Manage." Advocates sustainable soil management.
December 6	Mahaparinirvan Diwas	Marks the death anniversary of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, promoting equality and social justice.
December 6	All India Civil Defence and Home Guards Day	Recognizes the role of Home Guards in national crises and emergencies.
December 7	Armed Forces Flag Day	Honors the Indian Armed Forces and encourages welfare contributions.
December 7	International Civil Aviation Day (ICAD)	Theme: "Safe Skies. Sustainable Future." Celebrates 80 years of the Chicago Convention.
December 9	International Day of Commemoration and Dignity of the Victims of the Crime of Genocide	Marks the UN Genocide Convention's adoption in 1948.
December 9	International Anti-Corruption Day	Theme: "Uniting with Youth Against Corruption: Shaping Tomorrow's Integrity."
December 10	World Human Rights Day	Theme: "Our rights, our future, right now." Emphasizes human rights and dignity.
December 11	International Mountain Day	Highlights the role of mountains in biodiversity and sustainable development.
December 12	International Day of Neutrality	Promotes neutrality for peace and stability in international relations.

Date	Day/Observance	Theme/Description
December 12	Universal Health Coverage (UHC) Day	Advocates quality health services for all without financial hardship.
December 14	National Energy Conservation Day	Promotes energy efficiency for sustainable development.
December 15	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Tribute	Recognizes Patel's contributions to India's integration and governance.
December 16	Vijay Diwas	Commemorates India's 1971 victory over Pakistan and the liberation of Bangladesh.
December 17	Pensioners Day	Honors D.S. Nakara's fight for pension equality and dignity.
December 18	International Migrants Day	Theme: "Honouring the contributions of migrants and respecting their rights."
December 18	Minorities Rights Day	Highlights rights and welfare efforts for minority communities.
December 19	Goa Liberation Day	Marks the end of Portuguese rule in Goa in 1961.
December 19-24	Good Governance Week	Campaign: Prashasan Gaon Ki Ore, focusing on improving rural governance.
December 20	SSB Raising Day	Celebrates the achievements of Sashastra Seema Bal.
December 20	International Human Solidarity Day	Promotes cooperation for addressing global issues like poverty and climate change.
December 21	World Basketball Day	Celebrates basketball's role in fostering unity and athleticism worldwide.
December 21	World Meditation Day	Promotes peace and mental well-being through meditation.
December 22	National Mathematics Day	Honors Srinivasa Ramanujan, one of history's greatest mathematicians. It was first announced in 2012 by India's former Prime Minister, Dr. Manmohan Singh, to recognize Ramanujan's significant contributions to mathematics.
December 23	National Farmers' Day or Kisan Diwas	To honor farmers and commemorate the birth anniversary of Chaudhary Charan Singh, India's fifth Prime Minister.
December 24	National Consumer Day	The 2024 theme, "Virtual Hearings & Digital Access to Consumer Justice," highlights technology's role in empowering consumers.
December 25	Good Governance Day	The day marks the birth anniversary of Atal Bihari Vajpayee, former Prime Minister and a revered leader.
December 26	Veer Bal Diwas	Honors the martyrdom of Sahibzada Zorawar Singh and Sahibzada Fateh Singh, the young sons of Guru Gobind Singh.
December 27	International Day of Epidemic Preparedness	Emphasizes the importance of investing in public health systems to prevent, detect, and respond to infectious disease outbreaks.

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Defence Current Affairs

January to December 2024

Defence Current Affairs of January 2024

- India's **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** commemorated its **66th Foundation Day on January 1, 2024**, marking a significant journey of innovation and self-reliance in the country's defence sector. The day was celebrated with great enthusiasm and a renewed commitment to bolstering India's defence capabilities.
- The collaborative military exercise '**Desert Cyclone 2024**' is set to mark a significant milestone in the partnership between **India** and the **United Arab Emirates (UAE)**. Scheduled to take place in **Rajasthan** from January 2 to January 15, this joint manoeuvre aims to enhance interoperability through the exchange of knowledge and best practices, particularly in urban operations.
- Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** inaugurated the **first all-girl Sainik School in Vrindavan, Mathura district, Uttar Pradesh**. This groundbreaking event marks a significant advancement in women empowerment and educational reform in India. The Defence Minister hailed this initiative as a "golden moment in the history of women empowerment."
- On January 4, 2024, **Vice Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi, AVSM, NM**, officially took over as the **Vice Chief of the Naval Staff**, succeeding in a distinguished naval career. The assumption of this crucial position was marked by a solemn tribute to the fallen heroes at the National War Memorial.
- The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) of India**, in a significant advancement, introduced '**Ugram**,' an **advanced 7.62 x 51 mm calibre assault rifle**. This rifle, embodying a blend of indigenous design, development, and production, was unveiled in Pune by Dr. Shailendra V. Gade, Director General of Armament and Combat Engineering Systems at the DRDO. This development marks a key achievement in collaboration with the private sector, specifically with Hyderabad-based Dvipa Armour India Private Limited.
- The **Indian Navy** marked its presence in the Pacific, on **January 9th, 2024**, with the arrival of a **P-8I aircraft at Guam, USA**. This deployment signals the navy's participation in the fourth edition of **Ex Sea Dragon 24**, an Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW) exercise spearheaded by the US Navy.
- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh** has embarked on a crucial **three-day visit to London**, emphasizing the multifaceted dimensions of the **India-UK Defence Partnership**. The visit aims to foster high-level discussions covering a broad spectrum of defence, security, and industrial cooperation issues between the two nations. Accompanied by a delegation from the Ministry of Defence, Singh's itinerary includes meetings with top UK officials, industry leaders, and engagements with the Indian diaspora.
- The **Indian Navy** has recently acquired its first indigenous **medium-altitude long-endurance (MALE) drone**, the **Drishti 10 Starliner unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV)**. This marks a significant development in enhancing the navy's intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance capabilities. Manufactured by Adani Defence and Aerospace in collaboration with Israeli defence firm Elbit Systems, the drone offers versatility and advanced features.
- In a significant step towards modernization and operational efficiency, the **Indian Army has declared 2024 as the "Year of Technology Absorption."** This move underscores the Army's commitment to leveraging technology as a catalyst for transformative change, enhancing operational and logistic capabilities through in-house expertise, and working in collaboration with the domestic defence industry.
- The **Indian and Japanese Coast Guards** have recently conducted a successful joint exercise named '**Sahyog Kaijin**' off the coast of Chennai. This exercise is a part of the ongoing collaboration between the two countries under the Memorandum of Cooperation (MoC) signed in 2006. The joint exercise, which commenced on January 8, focused on enhancing interoperability and sharing best practices in maritime law enforcement, search and rescue operations, and pollution response at sea.
- The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** achieved a significant milestone with the successful flight test of the **New Generation AKASH (AKASH-NG) missile**. The test, conducted at the Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur off the coast of Odisha, showcased the system's capability to intercept high-speed unmanned aerial targets at very low altitudes.

- India's Defence Minister, **Rajnath Singh**, has recently approved a groundbreaking scheme aimed at **providing insurance cover to casual workers employed by the Border Roads Organisation (BRO)**. This move is designed to address the inherent risks associated with the challenging tasks these workers undertake in remote and hazardous areas. The scheme is **expected to offer financial security and welfare to the families of casual paid labourers** who play a crucial role in building infrastructure in the country's farthest frontiers.
- Union Minister of State for Defence, **Ajay Bhatt**, marked a historic moment on January 14, by flagging off the indigenously developed **Astra air-to-air missiles**. The ceremony took place at the **Kanchangbagh unit of Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL) in Hyderabad**, signifying a crucial step towards the missile's induction into the Indian Air Force (IAF).
- Indian Navy and Royal Thai Navy (RTN)** joined forces for the maiden bilateral exercise named **'Ex-Ayutthaya'** in December 2023. This maritime collaboration, symbolizing the invincible spirit, holds profound significance as it connects the ancient cities of **Ayodhya in India and Ayutthaya in Thailand**, reflecting shared historical narratives and rich cultural ties dating back centuries.
- The **Indian Army**, in a groundbreaking collaboration with the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, is spearheading the development of **cutting-edge military-grade software**. This partnership aims to harness the power of technology for bolstering national defense capabilities, focusing on areas such as artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, digital infrastructure, and healthcare.
- In response to escalating terrorist activities in **Jammu and Kashmir**, the **Indian Army** is launching **Operation Sarvashakti**, a strategic initiative aimed at curbing the influence of Pakistani proxy terrorist groups. Focused on the **Pir Panjal mountain ranges** in the Union Territory, this operation seeks to eliminate terrorists operating in the sensitive Rajouri Poonch sector.
- The **11th edition** of the **India-Kyrgyzstan Joint Special Forces Exercise KHANJAR** has kicked off at the Special Forces Training School in Bakloh, Himachal Pradesh. Scheduled to take place from 22nd January to 3rd February 2024, this annual event has become a crucial platform for fostering collaboration and enhancing the capabilities of both nations' special forces.
- In a significant milestone for the Indian aviation industry, **Timetooth**, a Bengaluru-based engineering company, has unveiled **India's first-ever domestically manufactured aircraft passenger seat** at the **Wings India 2024 event**. This groundbreaking development marks a departure

from the industry norm, where 100% of aircraft seats used by India's registered air travel companies are imported.

- The **Indian Army contingent**, comprised of 25 highly skilled personnel from **The Parachute Regiment (Special Forces)**, has arrived in Egypt to participate in the eagerly awaited 2nd edition of the **India-Egypt Joint Special Forces Exercise CYCLONE**.
- The Indian Navy has strategically chosen Telangana as the location for its second **Very Low Frequency (VLF) communication transmission station** in the country. This significant development is set to take place in the Vikarabad district, with the new VLF center scheduled for completion by 2027.
- In a significant move towards strengthening military cooperation and addressing regional security concerns, **India, France, and the United Arab Emirates (UAE)** conducted a major air exercise, named **'Desert Knight', over the Arabian Sea**. This joint exercise, held on January 23, 2024, comes against the backdrop of rising global concerns over Houthi militants targeting commercial vessels in strategic waterways.
- The inaugural joint military exercise, **Sada Tanseeq**, between the armies of **India and Saudi Arabia**, is poised to commence in **Rajasthan**, showcasing a significant leap in bilateral relations between India and Saudi Arabia. Scheduled from **January 29th to February 10th, 2024**, **Sada Tanseeq** signifies a landmark collaboration, epitomizing the growing strategic partnership between India and Saudi Arabia.
- In the realm of national defense, rapid deployment and robust infrastructure are paramount. The **Indian Army**, under the Ministry of Defence, stands vigilant against external threats, prioritizing cutting-edge equipment like **SARVATRA** – a Multispan Mobile Bridging System. Crafted by **Armament and Combat Engineering Systems (ACE)** under the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), **SARVATRA** epitomizes innovation in bridging solutions, ensuring seamless connectivity for the Indian Army.

Defence Current Affairs of February 2024

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- **Visakhapatnam's Naval Dockyard** will witness a momentous occasion as **Defence Minister Rajnath Singh** presides over the commissioning ceremony of **INS Sandhayak**. This event marks a significant addition to the Indian Navy's capabilities, reinforcing its presence in the Indian Ocean Region. Distinguished guests, including Chief of Naval Staff Admiral R. Hari Kumar and senior officials from the navy and the **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)**, will be in attendance to celebrate this milestone.
- **Havildar Preeti Rajak**, a distinguished trap shooter in the Indian Army, has reached a historic milestone by being promoted to the esteemed rank of **Subedar**. Her promotion marks a groundbreaking achievement, as she becomes the **first woman in the Indian Army to hold this prestigious rank**, signifying not only her personal accomplishment but also a significant advancement for women in the armed forces.
- In a strategic move to bolster efficiency and bolster the well-being of its civilian workforce, the **Indian Navy** has declared 2024 as the **'Year of Naval Civilians.'** This groundbreaking initiative targets comprehensive Civilian HR Management, with a sharp focus on enhancing administrative efficiency, embracing digital transformation, implementing targeted training programs, and fostering employee welfare activities.
- India's strategic collaboration with the **United States** in defense takes a significant leap forward with the procurement of **MQ-9B armed drones**. This acquisition underscores the strengthening ties between the two nations and represents a pivotal moment in enhancing India's military capabilities.
- **The Indian Air Force (IAF)** is set to conduct **Exercise Vayu Shakti-24**, a grand display of its aerial might, on 17 February 2024, at the Pokhran Air to Ground Range near Jaisalmer. Following the successful execution of the previous edition on 16 February 2019, this year's exercise promises to be an even more impressive demonstration of the IAF's offensive and defensive capabilities, both during the day and night.
- Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) **General Anil Chauhan** made a significant announcement at the Defence Literature Festival, "Kalam and Kavach," in Pune. He unveiled a groundbreaking book titled **'Artificial Intelligence and National Security,'** marking a pivotal moment in blending India's rich cultural heritage with contemporary national security strategies.
- In an endeavor to bolster border security measures, India has embarked on a significant project to fence the entire **1643-kilometer-long Indo-Myanmar border**. Home Minister Amit Shah made the announcement, underscoring the government's commitment to fortifying national borders and enhancing surveillance capabilities.
- Chief of Naval Staff (CNS) Admiral **R. Hari Kumar** visit was the inauguration of a state-of-the-art **Precision Approach Radar (PAR) at INS Utkrosh**. This advanced radar system is a game-changer for naval aviation, providing highly accurate horizontal and vertical guidance to aircraft, particularly under low visibility conditions such as heavy rain and fog.
- India has announced the **replacement of military personnel** operating aviation platforms in the Maldives with competent Indian technical personnel. This decision comes after negotiations between Indian and Maldivian authorities, with the latter expressing a clear demand for the withdrawal of Indian troops.
- In a memorable event at **Tons Bridge School in Dehradun**, Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** and Uttarakhand's Chief Minister **Pushkar Singh Dhami** unveiled a statue of General Bipin Rawat, who was India's first Chief of Defence Staff (CDS). This ceremony was not just about remembering a great leader but also about inspiring the future generations.
- The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** has achieved a significant milestone on the **Government e-Marketplace (GeM) portal**, recording procurement worth **₹1 lakh crore** since the portal's inception in 2016. This achievement underscores MoD's commitment to optimizing public spending in the defense sector through efficient procurement practices on GeM.
- The Defence Acquisition Council (DAC), chaired by Raksha Mantri **Shri Rajnath Singh**, has approved various capital acquisition proposals amounting to **Rs 84,560 crore** on February 16, 2024. These approvals emphasize the procurement of equipment from Indian vendors to promote self-reliance in defence manufacturing.
- The **12th edition** of the **MILAN naval exercise** is poised to set sail in the strategic port city of Visakhapatnam from February 19 to 27, marking a significant gathering of naval forces from over 50 countries. This year's theme, "Forging Naval Alliances for a Secure Maritime Future," underscores the exercise's commitment to enhancing global maritime security through cooperation and strategic dialogue.
- The **SAMAR** (Surface-to-Air Missile for Assured Retaliation) air defense missile system marked a significant milestone as it was **fired for the first time during the Vayushakti Exercise** in Rajasthan's Jaisalmer on Saturday, February 17th.

- The Indian Army is embarking on a significant endeavor to modernize its armored forces by replacing its aging Russian T-72 tank fleet with cutting-edge **Future Ready Combat Vehicles (FRCVs)**. These FRCVs, totaling 1,770 units, will be produced indigenously in India with advanced technologies including **artificial intelligence (AI)**, **drone integration**, **active protection systems**, and enhanced situational awareness. The induction will occur in three phases, each incorporating newer technologies for maximum survivability and lethality.
- **Indian Air Force (IAF)** conducted '**Exercise Vayu Shakti-24**' at the **Pokhran range near Jaisalmer, Rajasthan**, presenting a formidable display of its aerial firepower. The event, attended by the Chief of Defence Staff, General Anil Chauhan, marked a significant demonstration of the IAF's offensive capabilities through a series of meticulously planned aerial manoeuvres and precision strikes.
- India is hosting the **12th edition of the 'Milan' naval exercise in Visakhapatnam**, aimed at bolstering maritime cooperation among like-minded nations. The exercise comes amidst growing global concerns over the deteriorating security situation in the Red Sea.
- **Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)** in collaboration with the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** embarks on a comprehensive upgrade project worth **Rs 60,000 crore** for the **Su-30MKI** fighter jet fleet. The initiative aims to bolster the aircraft's capabilities through the integration of advanced technologies and indigenous systems.
- **Kathmandu** became the focal point of global peacekeeping efforts as it hosted the commencement of the multinational military exercise '**Shanti Prayas IV**'. This significant event, which draws army representatives from 19 countries actively involved in United Nations Peacekeeping missions, underscores the collaborative spirit and dedication towards maintaining global peace and security.
- **The Aeronautical Development Agency (ADA)** has taken a significant stride towards enhancing the operational capabilities of the **Light Combat Aircraft (LCA) Tejas** by signing a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**. This strategic partnership aims to integrate futuristic weapons and sensors onto the LCA Tejas platform, ensuring its readiness and effectiveness in modern warfare scenarios.
- In a notable stride towards advanced military technology, the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** is reportedly gearing up to test a real prototype of its indigenous laser weapon system, **DURGA-2**. The project, designed in secrecy by the Indian defence establishment, has garnered attention in global strategic circles due to its potential to transform warfare dynamics by neutralizing ballistic missiles.
- **Indian and Sri Lankan coast guard ships** joined the **Dosti 16 exercise** held in the **Maldives** from February 22-25. This year marked a significant development with Bangladesh participating as an observer, indicating a widening scope for the exercise and underlining the growing importance of maritime collaboration in tackling evolving challenges.
- The **Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS)** has approved the acquisition of over **200 BrahMos Extended Range (ER) supersonic cruise missiles** for deployment on Indian Navy warships. The deal, valued at **₹19,000 crore**, signifies a significant step towards bolstering India's naval capabilities.
- The **5th edition** of the **Joint Military Exercise 'Dharma Guardian'** commenced today at the Mahajan Field Firing Ranges in Rajasthan, India. The exercise, scheduled to run from February 25th to March 9th, 2024, brings together the **Indian Army and the Japan Ground Self-Defense Force (JGSDF)** for a focused training program aimed at enhancing interoperability and fostering closer military cooperation.
- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has taken a significant stride in bolstering the nation's air defense capabilities with the development of the **Surface to Air Missile for Assured Retaliation (SAMAR-2) missile system**. This innovative system leverages repurposed **Russian R-27 air-to-air missiles**, transforming them into a potent surface-to-air defense solution.
- The **North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)** launched its largest military exercise in Europe in decades, **Steadfast Defender 2024**, in late January 2024. This large-scale operation, conducted against the backdrop of the ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict, serves as a potent symbol of NATO's collective military might and unwavering commitment to the security of its member states.

Defence Current Affairs of March 2024

- The **Indian Navy** is set to inaugurate a new naval base, **INS Jatayu, on Minicoy Island**, marking a significant step in bolstering security infrastructure in the strategically vital Lakshadweep Islands. Scheduled for March 6, the commissioning ceremony will be graced by Admiral R Hari Kumar, Chief of the Naval Staff, underscoring the importance of this development.
- The **Indian Navy** is poised to achieve a significant milestone on March 6, 2024, with the commissioning of the **MH 60R Seahawk helicopter at INS Garuda, Kochi**. This induction marks a crucial juncture in India's defense modernization efforts, further bolstering its maritime capabilities. The Seahawks squadron will be designated as **INAS 334**, symbolizing a new era in naval aviation for the country. These helicopters are part of a 24-aircraft Foreign Military Sales (FMS) contract inked with the US government in February 2020.

- **Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh** inaugurated the new **Administrative & Training building at the Naval War College (NWC), Goa** on March 5, 2024. The modern edifice, named the '**Chola**', pays homage to the mighty maritime empire of the Chola dynasty of ancient India. The event marked a significant milestone in the history of the NWC, reinforcing its commitment to excellence in military education and nurturing maritime thought.
- The Indian Navy took a significant stride in fortifying its operational prowess with the commissioning of its new base, **INS Jatayu, at Minicoy island of Lakshadweep**. This strategic move aims to enhance the Navy's capabilities and reach in the vital Indian Ocean region, reinforcing its efforts in anti-piracy and anti-narcotics operations in the Western Arabian Sea.
- The three forces of India – Army, Navy, and Air Force – are going to conduct the biggest exercise called '**Bharat-Shakti**' at **Asia's largest field firing range** located in **Jaisalmer** district of Rajasthan. **PM Modi's Likely Visit** Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** may visit **Pokhran** on **March 12, 2024**, to witness this show of strength by the Indian Armed Forces.
- The arrival of the US Coast Guard Cutter **Bertholf** at Port Blair signals the commencement of '**Sea Defenders-2024**,' a joint exercise between the **United States Coast Guard (USCG)** and the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)**. Scheduled for March 9-10, 2024, this drill reflects the deepening strategic ties between the two nations and aims to enhance maritime safety and uphold a rules-based order in the Indo-Pacific region.
- **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** has successfully conducted the maiden flight test of the **locally developed Agni-5 missile with multiple independently targetable re-entry vehicle (MIRV) technology**. This new capability allows the weapon system to deliver **multiple nuclear warheads** against different targets spread across hundreds of kilometers, further enhancing India's **strategic deterrence capability**. The test, codenamed "**Mission Divyastra**" (divine weapon), propels India into an exclusive league of countries that possess the capability to deploy **MIRV missile systems**, including the United States, the United Kingdom, France, Russia, and China.
- Coinciding with International Women's Day and the 40th anniversary of INAS 318, the Andaman & Nicobar Command achieved a significant milestone by conducting its **first-ever all-women maritime surveillance mission**. This landmark event underscores the commitment to gender equality and recognizes the indispensable role of women in national defense.
- The **Indian Navy** recently took part in a major maritime exercise called **Exercise Cutlass Express – 24 (CE-24)**. This exercise was held in **Port Victoria, Seychelles** from **26 February to 08 March 2024**.
- On 13th March 2024, a significant milestone was achieved in the **Indian Navy's** shipbuilding program with the launch of '**Agray**' and '**Akshay**', the **5th and 6th ships of the 08 x ASW (Anti-Submarine Warfare) Shallow Water Craft (SWC) Project**. These ships are being built by M/S Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE) in Kolkata for the Indian Navy.
- In a significant stride towards gender equality and inclusivity, the **Railway Protection Force (RPF)** has emerged as a frontrunner among central paramilitary forces in **terms of female representation**. This achievement marks a notable departure from the traditional male-dominated landscape within such organizations. With women now constituting a remarkable **10 percent of its personnel**, the RPF has set a new benchmark in gender diversity within central paramilitary forces.
- The Indian Navy has finally got its own dedicated **headquarters** building. The newly constructed **Nausena Bhawan** located at **Delhi Cantonment** was formally **inaugurated** by **Defence Minister Rajnath Singh** on **March 15th, 2024**.
- An Indian Army contingent has departed for Seychelles today to participate in the **Tenth edition** of the **Joint Military Exercise "LAMITIYE-2024"** between the **Indian Army** and **Seychelles Defence Forces (SDF)**. The exercise will be conducted in Seychelles from **18-27 March 2024**.
- A joint military exercise called **Tiger Triumph-24** between **India** and the **United States** started on March 18 and will continue until March 31. This exercise is taking place on the **Eastern Seaboard (East Coast)** of India. The main purpose of this exercise is to improve **cooperation** between the two countries' armed forces for **humanitarian assistance** and **disaster relief** operations.
- The Indian Army has set up a specialized **technology unit** called **Signals Technology Evaluation and Adaptation Group (STEAG)** to research and evaluate **next-generation communication technologies**.
- The **Indian defence industry** is expanding its reach to the **Caribbean** region. The **Guyana Defence Force (GDF)** plans to purchase two aircraft from **India** with a loan of **\$23.27 million** from the **Export-Import Bank of India**.
- The Indian Army has raised its **first squadron**, the **451 Aviation Squadron**, to operate the newly acquired **AH-64E Apache attack helicopters**. The squadron was formally established on **March 15** at **Jodhpur**.
- The Indian Navy is all set to participate in the second edition of the **India-Mozambique-Tanzania Trilateral Exercise (IMT TRILAT-2024)**, a joint maritime exercise scheduled from **21-29 March 2024**. The Indian Naval Ships **INS Tir** and **INS Sujata** will represent India in this trilateral exercise.

- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has achieved a significant milestone with the successful landing of **Pushpak, India's first Reusable Launch Vehicle (RLV)**, during the RLV-LEX-02 landing experiment at the Aeronautical Test Range in Chitradurga on March 22, 2024. This accomplishment marks a continuation of ISRO's success in space exploration and technology advancement.
- In response to escalating tensions along the northern borders with **China**, the **Indian Army** has initiated significant enhancements to its air defence capabilities. Central to this strategic maneuver is the deployment of cutting-edge **Integrated Drone Detection and Interdiction Systems (IDD&IS)**, developed domestically in collaboration between the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** and **Bharat Electronics**.
- The second edition of the **India-Mozambique-Tanzania Trilateral Exercise, IMT TRILAT 24**, concluded successfully in **Nacala, Mozambique** on March 28th, 2024. This week-long exercise aimed to strengthen maritime cooperation and interoperability among the navies of **India, Mozambique, and Tanzania**.

Defence Current Affairs of April 2024

- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** is showcasing its might and capability to carry out **high-octane operations** during the upcoming '**Gagan Shakti-2024**' exercise "in a realistic environment" from **April 1-10**. The exercise involves **all air force bases and assets** scattered across the country.
- Highlighting the importance of "**collaboration and interoperability**" among the coast guards personnel of the Maldives, India, and Sri Lanka, Maldivian Defence Minister **Mohamed Ghassan Maumoon** said the trilateral exercise '**Dosti**' will unite the troika to address "**shared maritime security concerns** through collaboration."
- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) announced that India's defence exports surged to a record **Rs 21,083 crore in the fiscal year 2023-24**, marking a remarkable growth of 32.5% from the previous year. This achievement is attributed to the concerted efforts of both the private sector and **Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs)**, supported by policy reforms and initiatives aimed at facilitating ease of doing business.
- The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** has commenced a project in Junput village, West Bengal, to establish a test centre for the country's weapon systems. This initiative aims to address the saturation of testing activities at **Odisha's Chandipur Integrated Test Range (ITR)** by providing an additional operational area.
- The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** and **India's Strategic Forces Command (SFC)** have successfully conducted a flight test of the new generation ballistic missile called '**Agni-Prime**'.
- The **Army Medical Corps (AMC)** celebrated its **260th Raising Day on 03rd April 2024**. Raised in the year 1764, the Corps has rendered selfless service to the nation over centuries of progress, development, dedication, and sacrifice, both in combat and in peace, living up to the Corps motto of '**Sarve Santu Niramaya**' meaning 'let all be free from disease'.
- The Indian Army has commenced the induction of the indigenous **Akashteer system**, marking a significant advancement in its air defence capabilities. This automated air defence control and reporting system, developed by **Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)**, aims to integrate the army's air defence units for enhanced operational efficiency.
- **Indian Coast Guard Director General Rakesh Pal** inaugurated the **Indian Coast Guard Aquatic Centre at ICGS Mandapam near Rameshwaram, Tamil Nadu**, as part of his four-day visit to the maritime force's bases in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, and Puducherry. The visit aimed to review operational preparedness and infrastructure development in the region, with a focus on ensuring safe, secure, and clean seas.
- A two-day coastal security exercise called **Sagar Kavach 01/24** was conducted off the Lakshadweep Islands from **April 1-2, 2024**. The exercise involved the participation of all maritime security agencies, including the Indian Navy, Indian Coast Guard, Marine Police, Fisheries, Customs, and other security agencies.
- The Indian Army has bolstered its **Very Short Range Air Defence (VSHORAD)** capabilities with the acquisition of **Igla-S Man Portable Air Defence Systems (MANPADS)** from Russia. This procurement, part of a larger deal for 120 launchers and 400 missiles, signifies a significant upgrade over outdated systems.
- The inaugural **Tri-Service Planning Conference**, dubbed '**Parivartan Chintan**,' convened in **New Delhi on April 8, 2024, orchestrated by the Ministry of Defence**. This landmark event aimed to foster jointness and integration among the Indian Armed Forces, especially in light of ongoing efforts to establish unified theatre commands.
- Every year on **April 9th**, the **Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)** celebrates its Bravery Day, or Valour Day, to pay tribute to the brave soldiers who have selflessly served the nation. **This year, 2024, marks the 59th anniversary of this significant day.**
- In a significant training endeavor, the **Trishakti Corps of the Indian Army** executed a rigorous **Anti-Tank Guided Missile (ATGM)** exercise in Sikkim, operating at an altitude of 17,000 feet. The exercise involved Missile Firing Detachments from Mechanized and Infantry Units of the Eastern Command, emphasizing live firing scenarios against both moving and static targets, simulating battlefield conditions.

- The fifth edition of the India-Uzbekistan **Joint Military Exercise DUSTLIK** is set to commence on **April 15, 2024, in Termez District, Uzbekistan**. This exercise marks another milestone in the strategic partnership between the two nations, fostering mutual cooperation and enhancing military capabilities.
- The Indian Navy conducted a mega exercise, '**Poorvi Leher**,' along the East Coast to validate its procedures and assess its preparedness to meet maritime security challenges in the region. The extensive drill witnessed the participation of ships, submarines, aircraft, and special naval forces.
- **India has emerged as the fourth largest military spender globally in 2023**, allocating \$83.6 billion for defense, following the United States, China, and Russia. This significant investment underscores India's commitment to enhancing its defense capabilities, particularly along the **China border post the Ladakh standoff in 2020**.
- In a move to honour the **courageous Indian soldiers** who fought valiantly in the **First and Second World Wars**, the Brighton and Hove City Council in England has taken a commendable step. They have decided to hold an **annual multi-faith event** at the town's **India Gate memorial** this October, recognizing the pivotal role played by these **warriors from the undivided Indian subcontinent**.
- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** and Indian Navy have bolstered their combat capabilities with the induction of the Rampage long-range supersonic air-to-ground missile, previously utilized by the Israeli Air Force in operations against Iranian targets. The missile, known as the **High-Speed Low Drag-Mark 2** within the Indian Air Force, offers a striking range of up to 250 kilometers.
- **Flying Wedge Defence**, a Bengaluru-based defense and aerospace technology firm, recently revealed the **FWD-200B**, India's inaugural indigenous bomber unmanned aircraft. With a focus on cost-effectiveness and self-reliance, the firm aims to position India as a leader in innovative defense solutions.
- Air Marshal **Nagesh Kapoor** has taken charge as the **Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C) of the Training Command (TC) in the Indian Air Force**. With over 34 hundred hours of flying experience, he was commissioned into the Fighter stream in December 1986.
- Ujjivan Small Finance Bank has announced the appointment of **Sanjeev Nautiyal** as its **Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (MD & CEO)** for a tenure of three years, effective from July 1, 2024.
- **Visa**, the global digital payments platform, announced on Tuesday that it has appointed **Sujai Raina** as the new **Country Manager for India**. In this role, Raina will be responsible for leading and executing Visa's strategic initiatives in the Indian market, partnering with clients and the broader payments ecosystem.
- The Indian Army's **Kharga Corps**, under the aegis of the Army's Western Command, successfully conducted a three-day joint exercise with the Indian Air Force (IAF) at multiple locations in Punjab. The exercise aimed to refine processes and validate the employment of **attack helicopters** in support of mechanized operations in developed terrain.
- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bhubaneswar have initiated a partnership aimed at advancing research in **electronics warfare, AI-driven surveillance, power systems, and radar systems**. DRDO has sanctioned nine projects from the **Electronics and Communication Systems (ECS) Cluster** to IIT Bhubaneswar, with an additional seven projects awaiting approval, backed by ₹18 crore in funding.
- **Vice Admiral Sanjay Bhalla, AVSM, NM**, a seasoned naval officer with over 35 years of distinguished service, has assumed the pivotal role of **Chief of Personnel of the Indian Navy on 10 May 2024**. His extensive career has been marked by a series of challenging and fulfilling appointments, both at sea and ashore.
- In a strategic move to bolster its surveillance capabilities along the Pakistan border, the Indian Army is set to induct advanced drones, including the **Drishti-10 (Hermes-900)**. Scheduled for an induction ceremony in **Hyderabad on May 18**, these drones mark a significant addition to the Army's existing fleet, aligning with the '**Make in India**' initiative in Defence.
- The Indian Air Force recently conducted a test in Agra for the BHISHM portable hospital, a crucial component of "**Project BHISHM**" aimed at providing rapid and comprehensive medical assistance during emergencies.

Defence Current Affairs of May 2024

- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** and Indian Navy have bolstered their combat capabilities with the induction of the Rampage long-range supersonic air-to-ground missile, previously utilized by the Israeli Air Force in operations against Iranian targets. The missile, known as the **High-Speed Low Drag-Mark 2** within the Indian Air Force, offers a striking range of up to 250 kilometers.
- The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** has achieved a significant milestone in enhancing India's anti-submarine warfare capabilities with the successful flight-test of the Supersonic Missile-Assisted Release of Torpedo (**SMART**) system. This next-generation **torpedo delivery system** was successfully flight-tested on **May 01, 2024**, at around 8:30 AM from Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the coast of Odisha.
- The Indian Army and the Punit Balan Group joined hands to inaugurate the nation's **first Constitution Park in Pune**. The ceremony, **led by Lt. Gen. Ajai Kumar Singh**, emphasized the importance of citizens honoring their duties outlined in the Constitution to drive India towards development by 2047.

These portable cubes, part of a broader initiative, can cater to up to 200 casualties, emphasizing swift response and extensive care.

- Defence Secretary Giridhar Aramane unveiled a commemorative Rs 250 coin during the celebration of the 250th anniversary of Mazagon Dock Limited (MDL) in New Delhi on May 14, 2024. The event, hosted by MDL, commemorated its evolution from a dry dock in 1774 to a premier naval shipyard under the Ministry of Defence.
- **Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) Gen Anil Chauhan** attended the 'Exercise Cyber Suraksha – 2024' on May 22, 2024, emphasizing the critical importance of enhancing India's cyber defence capabilities. Conducted by the Defence Cyber Agency from May 20 to May 24, 2024, this comprehensive cyber defence exercise aims to bolster collaboration and integration among military and national agencies, advancing the nation's cyber defence readiness.
- **Indian Army** has joined hands with the **Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOCL)** for **demonstration trials of Hydrogen Fuel Cell Bus technology**. This collaboration underscores the Army's commitment to innovation and environmental stewardship.
- **Chennai-based startup Agnikul Cosmos** has achieved a remarkable feat by successfully launching the **world's first space rocket with a single-piece three-dimensional (3D) printed engine**. After four failed attempts, Agnikul triumphed on its fifth try, launching its own rocket, named **Agnibaan**, into space. This launch marks **India's first semi-cryogenic engine-powered rocket**, which was completely designed and manufactured indigenously.
- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has joined a **16-day multi-nation mega military exercise in Alaska, United States**, designed to provide **realistic training** to participating forces in a **simulated combat environment**. The exercise, known as '**Red Flag 24**', commenced on **May 30** and will continue until **June 14**.

Defence Current Affairs of June 2024

- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has deployed its formidable **Rafale fighter jets** for the two-week multinational air exercise **Red Flag**, which commenced on **May 30** in **Alaska**. The IAF contingent, supported by **IL-78 air-to-air refuelers** and **C-17 transport aircraft**, arrived at the **Eielson Air Force Base** in the United States for the advanced aerial combat training exercise.
- A tech-based innovation, an integrated generator monitoring, protection and control system, developed by the Indian Army was launched on June 5. '**Vidyut Rakshak**', developed by the **Army Design Bureau (ADB)** was launched by the **Army's Vice Chief Lt Gen Upendra Dwivedi**.

- **Lieutenant General Upendra Dwivedi** will take over as the next **Chief of the Army Staff (COAS)** on June 30. In his career of over 39 years, he has served as **Northern Army Commander and Director General (DG)** infantry amongst other appointments.
- The **8th edition of the Japan-India Maritime Exercise (JIMEX-24)** has commenced at Yokosuka, Japan, hosted by the **Japan Maritime Self-Defence Force (JMSDF)**. Indian Navy's **INS Shivalik** and Japan's **JS Yugiri** are participating.
- The launch of '**Missile Cum Ammunition Barge, LSAM 13 (Yard 81)**', the **fifth Barge** of 08 x Missile Cum Ammunition Barge project, built by **MSME Shipyard. M/s SECON Engineering Projects Pvt Ltd (SEPPL)**, Visakhapatnam for Indian Navy, was undertaken on **10 Jun 24** at **M/s Vinayaga Marine Petro Ltd, Mira Bhayandar, Maharashtra** (launch site of **M/s SECON Engineering Projects Pvt Ltd**). The launching Ceremony was presided over by **Cmde Manish Vig, General Manager (QA), ND(Mbi)**.
- India has achieved a significant milestone in its defense capabilities with the induction of the **indigenous Nagastra-1 kamikaze drones** developed by **Solar Industries, based in Nagpur**. This deployment addresses the escalating drone-related incidents along India's Northern borders, highlighting the critical need for advanced indigenous drone technologies in combat applications.
- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** is set to make history this August by hosting its first-ever multinational air exercise, **Tarang Shakti-2024**. The exercise is slated to be held in two phases, with the initial phase commencing in the first two weeks of August in southern India, followed by the second phase in the western sector from **late August to mid-September**.
- The **Indian Army** on June 18, announced the opening of a **state-of-the-art skin bank** facility at the Army Hospital (Research & Referral). The facility offers the latest modern treatment for **severe burn injuries** received by armed forces personnel and their families.
- In a significant move towards self-reliance, the **Northern Command** of the Indian Army has ordered 550 indigenously designed, developed, and manufactured **ASMI submachine guns** worth Rs 4.26 crores from **Hyderabad-based Lokesh Machine Limited**. This marks the first time an indigenously designed and manufactured weapon has been inducted into the Indian Army.
- **Chief of Defence Staff Gen Anil Chauhan** released the **Joint Doctrine for Cyberspace Operations** during the **Chiefs of Staff Committee (COSC)** meeting held on **June 18, 2024**, in New Delhi. The Joint Doctrine is a keystone publication that will guide Commanders in conducting Cyberspace Operations in today's complex military operating environment.

- In a landmark event, the Military College of Telecommunication Engineering (MCTE) of the Indian Army and the **Society for Applied Microwave Electronics Engineering & Research (SAMEER)** signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to collaborate on 'Next Generation Wireless Technologies for the Indian Army'.
- **India's defence exports to the United States (US)** has grown to account for **over 50 per cent of the total exports**, exceeding **\$2.8 billion** during the last 5 years, said **Ranjana Khanna**, Director General and CEO – American Chamber of Commerce in India (Amcham).
- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) handed over the **Medium Range-Microwave Obscurant Chaff Rocket (MR-MOCR)** to the Indian Navy in a ceremony **held in New Delhi**. This rocket creates a microwave obscurant cloud in space, forming an effective shield against threats with radio frequency seekers.
- **Jaipur Military Station** has become the **second military station in India** to have a road made from plastic waste. The **road, inaugurated on June 26, 2024, by Major General R.S. Godara**, General Officer Commanding of 61 Sub Area, is 100 meters long and stretches from Sagat Singh Road under bridge to Cubs Corner complex.
- The deployment marks sustained participation of an Indian Military Contingent in military parade organized as part of Seychelles National Day **since 1976**. **INS Sunayna** entered **Port Victoria**, Seychelles on 26 Jun 24 as part of her long range deployment in the **South West Indian Ocean Region**.
- **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** has successfully completed six consecutive development trials of High Speed Expendable Aerial Target (HEAT) '**ABHYAS**' with improved booster configuration from the Integrated Test Range (ITR), **Chandipur, Odisha**.
- The Indian Air Force (IAF) Chief, **Air Chief Marshal V R Chaudhari**, inaugurated the **Weapon Systems School (WSS) in Hyderabad**, marking a significant advancement for the IAF. Established to recalibrate and transform the IAF into a future-oriented force, the WSS aims to provide contemporary, effect-based training to officers of the newly formed Weapon Systems (WS) branch.
- **Indian army** has inducted the first-ever indigenous **chip-based 4G mobile base station**, which it procured from **Bangalore-based firm Signaltron** through the government e-marketplace portal. **Signaltron** founder **Himamshu Khasnis** told PTI that the chip used in the **Sahyadri LTE base stations** has been developed by **Signalchip**.
- **India's defence sector** has achieved a remarkable milestone in the fiscal year 2023-24, with total annual defence production reaching an all-time high of **Rs 1,26,887 crore**. This unprecedented achievement, announced by the **Union Ministry of Defence on July 5, 2024**, marks a significant leap in India's journey towards self-reliance in defence manufacturing.
- India has unveiled the '**Zorawar**' light tank, developed jointly by **DRDO and Larsen & Toubro**, aimed at bolstering military capabilities in high-altitude environments. Designed within a record two-year timeframe, the tank features advanced weaponry and protection systems, including a 105mm rifled cannon and composite modular armor. **Named after General Zorawar Singh**, the tank is slated for extensive trials before potential deployment in Ladakh, Sikkim, or Kashmir.
- The Border Security Force (BSF), in collaboration with the State Bank of India (SBI), organized the "**Grow with the Trees**" plantation drive at the **BSF Headquarters in Srinagar**. The initiative aimed to create a greener environment and promote the importance of tree plantation, involving BSF officials, jawans, SBI officials, and school children.
- **Azerbaijan Army** servicemen have arrived in **Kazakhstan to take part in the "Birlestik-2024"** operational-tactical command-staff exercise. This joint military drill, scheduled from July 11 to July 17, will be conducted at the Oymasha training ground and Cape Tokmak in the Caspian Sea. The exercise is part of a collaborative effort between the Defense Ministries of Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, and Uzbekistan.
- The Armed Forces Medical Services witnessed a significant change in leadership as **Lt Gen Shankar Narayan, NM, VSM**, assumed the role of Commandant at the **Army Hospital (Research & Referral)**, widely recognized as the apex hospital of the Indian Armed Forces. This appointment marks a new chapter in the hospital's illustrious history and promises to bring fresh perspectives to military healthcare.

Defence Current Affairs of July 2024

- India has taken a significant leap in military technology with the development of **SEBEX 2**, a powerful new explosive. Certified by the Indian Navy, SEBEX 2 is reported to be twice as lethal as the standard Trinitrotoluene (TNT), marking it as one of the most powerful non-nuclear explosives globally. This breakthrough is set to revolutionize artillery shells and warheads, enhancing their destructive capabilities without increasing their weight.
- July 1, 2024, marks the beginning of an important event in India-Thailand relations. The **Maitree Exercise**, a joint military exercise between the **Indian Army** and the **Royal Thai Army**, kicks off at Fort Vachiraprakan in Tak Province, Thailand. This two-week exercise, running until July 15, 2024, is a significant step in strengthening military ties between the two nations.

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has expanded the scope of remittances to **International Financial Services Centres (IFSCs)** under the **Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS)**. This allows resident Indians to open fixed deposits in dollars at GIFT IFSC, facilitating various financial services and products as per the **International Financial Services Centres Authority Act, 2019**.
- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has embarked on a significant international engagement by participating in **Exercise Pitch Black 2024**, hosted by the **Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)** at their Base Darwin, Australia. This biennial, multi-national exercise, scheduled from July 12 to August 2, 2024, represents a crucial platform for enhancing international military cooperation and showcasing air combat capabilities.
- The Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) has taken a significant step towards promoting self-reliance in the defense sector by awarding seven new projects to industries under the **Technology Development Fund (TDF) scheme**. These projects aim to address various requirements of the Armed Forces and the aerospace & defense sectors, while simultaneously nurturing the growth of industries, particularly **MSMEs and start-ups**, in these domains.
- On July 14, 2024, **Visakhapatnam** hosted the prestigious **Fleet Awards Function** to honor the **Eastern Fleet's exceptional operational achievements** over the past year. **INS Delhi** was recognized as the Best Ship of the Eastern Fleet for its outstanding performance and operational prowess.
- Indian Navy's frontline frigate, **INS Tabar** arrived at Hamburg, Germany on **17 July 24** for a three day visit. It will participate in a exercise. During the visit, activities will include **professional exchanges** between the Indian and German Navies, tours of the German Naval Academy, and public visits to the ship. The crew of **INS Tabar** will also engage in community service.
- **Captain Supreetha C.T.** has etched her name in history by becoming the **first woman officer from the Corps of Army Air Defence** to be operationally deployed at the **Siachen Glacier**.
- On July 23, 2024, India's naval prowess took a significant leap forward with the launch of the first of two Advanced Frigates at **Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)**.
- On July 24, 2024, the **Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO)** of India achieved a significant milestone in its ongoing efforts to enhance national security.
- The Indian Army contingent has embarked on its journey to participate in the multinational military exercise **KHAAN QUEST 2024**.
- **INS Tabar**, a frontline frigate of the **Indian Navy**, arrived in **Saint Petersburg** to participate in the **328th Russian Navy Day celebrations**.

- The **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** unveiled its new '**Suvidha Software Version 1.0**' during the inaugural '**Annual Operational Sea Training Conference**' held in **Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh**, on July 30, 2024.

Defence Current Affairs of August 2024

- **Daljit Singh Chawdhary**, the **Director General of Sahastra Seema Bal (SSB)**, took over the additional charge of Director General Border Security Force on August 3.
- The **Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)** has successfully conducted a demonstration and **trial of the formidable Typhoon vehicle** at its **Transport Battalion in Chandigarh**.
- The Indian Army has conducted a strategic military exercise, '**Parvat Prahaar**', in **Ladakh**, focusing on high-altitude warfare and operations.
- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has given clearance to the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** and the **Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)** to produce **200 Astra air-to-air missiles** for its Su-30 and LCA Tejas fighter aircraft.
- The bilateral air exercise "**Udara Shakti 2024**" between the Indian Air Force (IAF) and the Royal Malaysian Air Force (RMAF) concluded successfully on August 9, 2024. This exercise, hosted by the RMAF at its base in **Kuantan, Malaysia**.
- India is on the brink of commissioning its **second nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine, INS Arighat**.
- The **Mitra Shakti** military exercise, an annual bilateral engagement between the Indian Army and the Sri Lankan Army, commenced on **August 12, 2024**. This year's exercise, held at the **Sri Lankan Army Training School in Maduru Oya**, marks a significant milestone in the military cooperation between these two South Asian nations.
- **Army chief General Upendra Dwivedi** on August 20, chaired a high-level meeting focusing on the ongoing transformational initiatives by the Indian Army and its contribution towards achieving the objective of **Viksit Bharat by 2047**.
- For the first time in recent history, the **51st Fighter Wing at Osan Air Base**, Republic of Korea, is incorporating its recurring wing readiness exercise into **Ulchi Freedom Shield 24**.
- The Indian Defence Ministry is finalizing a repeat order for **73,000 SiG 716 G2 patrol assault rifles from the US** to equip its frontline troops. This follows a **2019 procurement of 72,400 SiG 716 rifles (7.62 x 51mm calibre)** under the '**Buy (Global)**' category through a fast-track procedure, which were distributed across the Army, Air Force, and Navy.

- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has taken a significant step in international aviation diplomacy by dispatching its renowned **Sarang Helicopter Display Team** to participate in the inaugural **Egypt International Airshow**. This event, scheduled from **September 3 to 5, 2023**, at the **Al-Alamein International Airport** in Egypt's El Dabaa, marks a crucial moment for India to demonstrate its indigenous aviation capabilities on the global stage.
- **INS Tabar**, a frontline frigate of the **Indian Navy**, visited **Malaga, Spain**, on 25 August 2024, for a **two-day engagement**. Upon departure on 27 August, it participated in a **Maritime Partnership Exercise (MPX)** with the **Spanish Navy Ship Atalaya** in the **Mediterranean Sea**.

Defence Current Affairs of September 2024

- A successful test launch of the **Agni-4 Intermediate Range Ballistic Missile (IRBM)** was carried out from the **Integrated Test Range in Chandipur, Odisha**, on September 6, 2024. The missile, developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), validated all operational and technical parameters during the test.
- The **21st edition of Varuna (Varuna-23)** naval exercise between the **Indian and French Navies** was held in two phases in 2023. India-France Bilateral Naval Exercise Varuna is a key strategic exercise, **initiated in 1993 and named 'Varuna' in 2001**. Phase II took place in the **Arabian Sea** and involved joint operations using guided missile frigates, tankers, Maritime Patrol Aircraft, and helicopters.
- The **5th Defence Cooperation Dialogue** between **India and the Maldives** was held in New Delhi on September 6, 2024. The Indian delegation was led by **Defence Secretary Shri Giridhar Aramane**, while the Maldivian delegation was **headed by General Ibrahim Hilmy**, Chief of Defence Force, Maldives National Defence Force. The meeting provided a platform to advance bilateral defence cooperation, focusing on the implementation of ongoing projects and fostering stability in the Indian Ocean region.
- Since 1967, **International Literacy Day (ILD)** has been observed annually on **September 8th** across the globe. This day serves as a crucial reminder to policymakers, practitioners, and the public about the critical importance of literacy in creating a more literate, just, peaceful, and sustainable society.
- The **20th edition** of the India-USA Joint Military Exercise, **YUDH ABHYAS-2024**, commenced on September 9, 2024, at the **Foreign Training Node in Mahajan Field Firing Ranges, Rajasthan**. This annual exercise, alternating between India and the USA since 2004, is set to run until September 22, 2024, showcasing a remarkable increase in scale and sophistication compared to previous iterations.
- **Indian Army and Indian Air Force** signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with **Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya in Vadodara**. This collaboration aims to enhance the logistics capabilities of personnel and align with national development plans such as the **PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan 2021** and the **National Logistics Policy 2022**. The agreement was formalized in New Delhi in the presence of Defence Minister Shri Rajnath Singh and Railways Minister Shri Ashwini Vaishnaw.
- On **September 9, 2024**, the **Cochin Shipyard** marked a significant milestone in India's naval defense capabilities by launching two new vessels: **Malpe**: The fourth ship in the Mahe Class and **Mulki**: The fifth ship in the Mahe Class.
- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Navy successfully conducted a flight test of the **Vertical Launch Short Range Surface-to-Air Missile (VL-SRSAM)** from the **Integrated Test Range (ITR) in Chandipur, Odisha**, on September 12, 2024, at around 3 PM.
- The Indian Army contingent has departed for the fifth edition of the **India-Oman joint military exercise, Al Najah**, which will take place from September 13 to 26, 2024, at the **Rabkoot Training Area in Salalah, Oman**.
- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh inaugurated the **India Defence Aviation Exposition (IDAX-24)** at Jodhpur on September 12, 2024. This major event coincides with **Exercise Tarang Shakti-24**, one of the largest multinational air exercises hosted by the Indian Air Force. The IDAX-24, running from September 12-14, showcases significant advancements and contributions of the Indian aviation industry.
- Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully conducted the preliminary automotive trials of the **Indian Light Tank, Zorawar**, on September 13, 2024.
- The **Kalvari Submarine Escape Training Facility (VINETRA)** was commissioned by **Vice Admiral Rajesh Pendharkar**, the **Flag Officer Commanding-in-chief**, Eastern Naval Command, at **INS Satavahana, Visakhapatnam**.
- **Navika Sagar Parikrama II**, led by Indian Navy officers **Lt Cdr Roopa A** and **Lt Cdr Dilna K**, is set to continue India's rich sailing tradition with a historic all-women expedition to circumnavigate the **globe aboard INSV Tarini**. This voyage celebrates maritime skill and gender equality, showcasing the Indian Navy's commitment to preserving maritime heritage and promoting seamanship. Both officers have been training rigorously for three years, accumulating thousands of nautical miles, and were mentored by **Cdr Abhilash Tomy (Retd.)**.
- The Government of India has launched **Operation Sadbhav** to provide humanitarian relief/assistance to countries **affected by Typhoon Yagi**. This will Express Solidarity with Storm-Hit Nations, **India Dispatches of Aid to Myanmar, Vietnam and Laos**.

- The poem “National War Memorial” is to appreciate the spirit behind it. The chapter titled ‘Veer Abdul Hameed’ honors the Braveheart CQMH (Company Quarter Master Havildar). Abdul Hameed who made the supreme sacrifice fighting for the country during the **India-Pakistan war of 1965**.
- Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh, flagged-in, in New Delhi, a **first-of-its-kind Open Water Swimming Expedition** to the **21 Islands of the Andaman & Nicobar archipelago** named after the **Param Vir Chakra (PVC) Awardees**.
- The **National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)**, in collaboration with the **Southern Command of the Indian Army**, is organized a **two-day national symposium, ‘Exercise AIKYA’**, on disaster management.
- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh inaugurated the **Sainik School in Jaipur, Rajasthan** on September 23, 2024, as part of the **Government’s plan to establish 100 new Sainik Schools** in partnership mode across India.
- Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh inaugurated the **41st edition of the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) Commanders’ Conference** in New Delhi on September 24, 2024. This three-day conference serves as a crucial platform for ICG Commanders to engage in meaningful discussions on strategic, operational, and administrative matters amid evolving geopolitical landscapes and maritime security complexities.
- **Russia and China** started naval exercises in the **Sea of Japan**. The exercises will include anti-aircraft and anti-submarine weapons. This exercise aims to **deepen the strategic cooperation level between the Chinese and Russian militaries** and enhance their ability to jointly deal with security threats.
- India’s **Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO)**, along with researchers of **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi** has developed Light Weight Bullet Proof Jackets named **ABHED (Advanced Ballistics for High Energy Defeat)**.
- **MALABAR exercise** kick off from 8th October in Visakhapatnam in Andhra Pradesh. It hosted by India, this year’s exercise will see the participation of Australia, Japan, and the United States of America beginning with the Harbour Phase in Visakhapatnam, followed by the sea phase. The exercise conducted from **8th October to 18th October. Malabar 2024 is designed to enhance cooperation and operational capabilities among participating navies**.
- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** marked its **92nd anniversary on October 6, 2024**, with a stunning air show that attracted an estimated 1.5 million spectators at **Marina Beach, Chennai**. The event, attended by **Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin** and **Air Chief Marshal AP Singh**, showcased the theme “**Sashakt, Saksham, Atmanirbhar**” (Potent, Powerful, Self-reliant), reflecting the IAF’s evolution into a modern and formidable force.
- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh will inaugurate **DefConnect 4.0 on October 7, 2024**, at the Manekshaw Centre in Delhi, marking a major milestone in advancing indigenous defence innovation. Organised by **Innovations for Defence Excellence – Defence Innovation Organisation (iDEX-DIO)** under the Ministry of Defence’s Department of Defence Production, the event brings together various stakeholders to promote collaboration and innovation in the defence ecosystem.
- The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** successfully carried out three flight-tests of the advanced fourth-generation Very Short Range Air Defence System (**VSHORADS**) at the Pokhran Field Firing Ranges in Rajasthan on October 3-4. The tests mark a significant step in enhancing India’s defense capabilities, showcasing the missile’s precision and reliability in engaging fast-moving aerial targets.
- The Indian Naval Ships **Tir and Shardul**, along with the Indian Coast Guard Ship Veera, from the **First Training Squadron (1TS) of the Indian Navy**, have successfully arrived in **Muscat, Oman**, as part of their long-range training deployment. This visit underscores the Indian Navy’s commitment to enhancing maritime cooperation and strengthening ties with regional partners.
- The Indian Navy has received its latest **large Survey Vessel** for deep water hydrographic mapping specially designed, **Nirdeshak (Yard 3026)**, second of four Survey Vessel (Large) ships, steered by the Indian Navy’s Warship Design Bureau and being built at Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (**GRSE**), Kolkata was delivered to the Indian Navy.
- On October 15, 2024, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh laid the foundation stone for a new **Very Low Frequency (VLF) Station** of the Indian Navy at **Damagundam Reserve Forest, Vikarabad, Telangana**. Covering 2,900 acres and costing Rs 3,200 crore, this facility aims to enhance the Navy’s communication capabilities,

Defence Current Affairs of October 2024

- **8th India-Kazakhstan joint military exercise KAZIND-2024** started at Surya Foreign Training Node, Auli, Uttarakhand. An annual affair, the exercise will end on 13th October. To bid to improve the joint military capability and undertake counter terrorism operations in a sub conventional scenario.
- The Indian Army hosted the much-anticipated “**Army Sports Conclave**” today, highlighting the role of the Indian Army in India’s sporting ecosystem. As India sets its sight on **hosting the 2036 Olympics**, the Army Sports Conclave serves as a crucial platform to align efforts and contribute to this national mission.

facilitating secure and reliable long-distance transmission essential for effective command and control in complex maritime environments.

- On October 14, 2024, the Indian Navy marked a significant milestone with the **launch of the first ship, 'Samarthak,'** under the **Multi-Purpose Vessel (MPV)** project at **L&T Shipyard in Kattupalli, Chennai**. The vessel was launched by Shashi Tripathi, President of the Navy Welfare and Wellness Association, and the ceremony was presided over by **Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi, Chief of Naval Staff**. This launch reflects the Indian Navy's commitment to indigenous shipbuilding, aligning with the Government of India's vision for **'Aatmanirbhar Bharat'** and **'Make in India.'**
- The Indian Army is set to embark on a **month-long series of commemorative events from October 17 to November 14, 2024**, to honor the brave soldiers who fought valiantly in the Battle of Walong during the 1962 Sino-Indian War. This year **marks the 62nd Walong Day**, celebrating the courage and sacrifice of those who **defended India's eastern front**.
- The Indian Coast Guard successfully conducted the coastal security exercise **'Sagar Kavach'** on October 16-17, covering **Gujarat, Daman & Diu**, as well as **Goa and Maharashtra**. The exercise aimed to enhance coastal and maritime security, improve coordination among agencies, and test existing Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) in response to potential threats such as infiltration and smuggling. **Objective:** The primary aim of Sagar Kavach is to enhance maritime and coastal security preparedness, validate existing Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and ensure coordinated response to various maritime threats.
- The India-Oman bilateral naval exercise **Naseem-Al-Bahr**, held from October 13 to 18, 2024, **off the coast of Goa**, featured the participation of the Indian Navy's **INS Trikanth** and **Dornier Maritime Patrol Aircraft**, alongside the Royal Navy of Oman's vessel **Al Seeb**. The exercise was conducted in two phases.
- The Army's Sudarshan Chakra Corps of the Southern Command is currently conducting **'Exercise SWAVLAMBAN SHAKTI'** at the **Babina Field Firing Ranges near Jhansi**, with the primary objective of enhancing combat capabilities through the integration of niche and emerging technologies. The exercise commenced on 17th October, 2024 and is set to continue until October 22, as stated in a defense release.
- The third edition of the **Indian Navy's Naval Innovation and Indigenisation Organisation (NIIO) Seminar**, took place in New Delhi on October 22, 2024. Chaired by **Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan**, Vice Chief of Naval Staff (VCNS), the event highlighted the Navy's commitment to showcasing significant advancements in innovation and indigenisation aimed at bolstering India's defense capabilities.

- **India's fourth nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN)**, designated **S4***, was officially **launched into the water** at the Ship Building Centre in Visakhapatnam, according to official sources. This advanced submarine represents a **significant leap in capability and size compared to its predecessor, INS Arihant**.
- The **Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS)**, led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the establishment of a new missile testing range in **Nagayalanka, Andhra Pradesh**. This initiative aims to bolster India's defense capabilities, particularly for testing tactical missile systems.
- The **31st edition of the Singapore India Maritime Bilateral Exercise (SIMBEX)** is underway from **October 23 to 29, 2024**, at the **Eastern Naval Command (ENC) in Visakhapatnam**. This annual exercise showcases the evolving maritime collaboration between the **Indian Navy** and the **Republic of Singapore Navy (RSN)**, furthering the strategic partnership and shared objectives of maritime security and interoperability.
- The Indian Navy and German Navy recently completed their inaugural **Maritime Partnership Exercise (MPX)** in the **Indian Ocean**, marking a key milestone in naval collaboration. The exercise, held in the **Bay of Bengal**, included joint operations involving **INS Delhi**, a guided-missile destroyer from India, and **Baden-Württemberg** and **Frankfurt Am Main**, a frigate and replenishment tanker from Germany.
- The **Chanakya Defence Dialogue 2024** concluded on **October 25th** at the Manekshaw Centre in Delhi, marking the second edition of this significant international seminar hosted by the Indian Army. The event brought together a diverse group of stakeholders, including policymakers, strategic thinkers, academics, veterans, and defense personnel from various countries, all focused on analyzing India's strategic directions and developmental priorities. The theme of this year's dialogue, **"Drivers in Nation Building: Fueling Growth Through Comprehensive Security,"** facilitated vital discussions on how security dynamics intertwine with national and international policymaking.
- On October 25, 2024, the **Indian Navy's seventh Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW SWC)**, named **'Abhay'**, was launched at M/s L&T's Kattupalli facility. Built by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)**, this vessel marks a significant addition to India's maritime defense capabilities.
- **Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)** launched **two indigenous fast patrol vessels, Adamya and Akshar**, designed for the Indian Coast Guard, on 28th October. These vessels are intended to enhance the protection of offshore assets, island territories, and conduct surveillance operations.

- India is set to mark a significant milestone in its aerospace industry with the rollout of the first locally assembled **C295 military transport aircraft** from the **Vadodara facility in September 2026**. This initiative, part of the **"Make in India"** campaign, represents a robust collaboration between Airbus and Tata Advanced Systems. The facility was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez, highlighting the deepening defense ties between India and Spain.

Defence Current Affairs of November 2024

- The 5th edition of the Vietnam-India Bilateral Army Exercise, "VINBAX 2024,"** began on Monday at Ambala. Scheduled from **November 4 to 23**, the exercise will take place at both **Ambala and Chandimandir**, aiming to strengthen military cooperation and interoperability between the two nations.
- The **Indian Navy** successfully conducted the third edition of the **Mahasagar summit**, continuing its flagship outreach initiative for maritime security in the Indian Ocean Region (IOR). Held virtually under the theme, "Training Cooperation to Mitigate Common Maritime Security Challenges in the IOR."
- The **2nd edition of the Indian Military Heritage Festival (IMHF)** is set to begin on November 8, 2024, in New Delhi.
- India has launched a significant **tri-services military exercise, 'Poorvi Prahaar,'** beginning November 8, aimed at strengthening military readiness across the eastern front. This 10-day exercise follows the recent disengagement between Indian and Chinese troops at key **friction points in eastern Ladakh, including Depsang and Demchok**, and underscores India's commitment to enhanced defense capabilities.
- The third edition** of the joint military exercise **AUSTRAHIND** commenced today at the Foreign Training Node in **Pune, Maharashtra**.
- The Defence Space Agency is conducting **Antariksha Abhyas – 2024**, a three-day exercise from November 11-13, to simulate and address threats to space-based assets and services, marking a groundbreaking initiative in space defense.
- The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) and Sri Lanka Coast Guard (SLCG)** held their **7th Annual High-Level Meeting in Colombo on November 11, 2024**.
- On November 12, 2024, the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** successfully conducted the first flight test of the **Long Range Land Attack Cruise Missile (LRLACM)** with a range of 1,000 km. The test took place at the Integrated Test Range (ITR) in Chandipur, Odisha.
- Air Marshal **Ashutosh Dixit, Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief**, Central Air Command, inaugurated the Indian Air Force (IAF) C-295 Full Motion Simulator (FMS) facility on November 11, 2024, at Air Force Station Agra.
- Chief of Defence Staff **General Anil Chauhan** chaired the **35th Tri-Services Commanders' Conference (TSTCC)** at the **Southern Naval Command, Kochi**, on 13 November 2024.
- The Indian Navy** will conduct the fourth edition of its nationwide coastal defence exercise, **Sea Vigil-24, on November 20 and 21**.
- In a move to **strengthen Rajasthan's defence industrial base**, the Army's Jaipur-based South Western Command has established a think tank named **Gyan Shakti**.
- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) has successfully completed a series of flight tests for the **Guided Pinaka Weapon System**, conducted as part of the Provisional Staff Qualitative Requirements (PSQR) Validation Trials.
- India successfully conducted the flight trial of its first **long-range hypersonic missile** on **November 16**, marking a major milestone in its defense capabilities. The missile, developed by **DRDO**, can travel at speeds exceeding **Mach 5 (over 6,174 km/h)** and has a range of over **1,500 km**. It is capable of hitting both **moving sea targets** and **static land targets**. The test was conducted at **Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Island in Odisha**, placing India in an exclusive group of nations with **hypersonic weapons** technology.
- The **Indian Army** successfully conducted the **"Sanyukt Vimochan 2024"** exercise, a **Multilateral Annual Joint Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)** event, in **Ahmedabad and Porbandar, Gujarat** on **November 18-19, 2024**. The exercise demonstrated India's readiness and collaborative capabilities in **disaster response** and was attended by various **national and international agencies**, including **Chief of Army Staff (COAS) General Upendra Dwivedi**.
- The **Indian Naval Sailing Vessel (INSV) Tarini** began the second leg of the **Navika Sagar Parikrama-II (NSP-II)** on **November 24, 2024**, after being flagged off by **Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi** on **October 2, 2024**. The expedition, with a **two-woman naval crew**, aims to circumnavigate the globe. This leg, covering **3,400 nautical miles** from **Fremantle, Australia to Lyttelton, New Zealand**, underscores India's commitment to **gender equality, maritime cooperation, and women's empowerment**.
- The **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** will host the **11th edition of SAREX-24** (National Maritime Search and Rescue Exercises & Workshop) in **Kochi** from **November 27 to 30, 2024**. Organized under the **National Maritime Search and Rescue (NMSAR) Board**, the event aims to enhance India's **maritime search and rescue (SAR)** capabilities through **collaboration** with national and international

stakeholders. **Rajesh Kumar Singh**, IAS (Defence Secretary), will inaugurate the event.

- **Army Chief General Upendra Dwivedi** presented the prestigious **President's Colours** to the **26th and 27th Battalions of the Mechanised Infantry Regiment** and the **20th and 22nd Battalions of the Brigade of The Guards** at a ceremony in **Ahilyanagar**. This significant achievement honors these units as the youngest battalions of the arm, with the event attended by veterans, military officials, and civil dignitaries.
- The Indian Army launched "**Eklavya**", an online learning platform to enhance officers' training, aligning with the 2024 theme, "**Year of Technology Absorption**." Developed in collaboration with **BISAG-N** at zero cost, the platform integrates with the **Army Data Network** and offers **96+ courses** from **17 Category 'A' training establishments**. **Eklavya** supports continuous professional development while optimizing training resources, contributing to the Army's broader "**Decade of Transformation**".
- India successfully tested the **K-4 nuclear-capable ballistic missile** with a **3,500 km** range from the **INS Arighaat** submarine in the **Bay of Bengal**. This test enhances India's **nuclear deterrence** and positions it among the few nations with the capability to launch **submarine-launched ballistic missiles (SLBMs)**.
- The **Indian Coast Guard** conducted **SAREX-2024**, the 11th National Maritime Search and Rescue Exercise, off the **Kochi** coast. Inaugurated by **Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh**, the two-day event focused on **sea drills**, workshops, and **search-and-rescue** collaboration. It supported India's **SAGAR** vision and involved **38 international observers**, reinforcing India's role in global maritime security.
- A 25-member **Indian Army** contingent from the **Parachute Regiment (Special Forces)** participated in the **9th India-Indonesia Joint Special Forces Exercise, GARUD SHAKTI 24**, held in **Cijantung, Jakarta** from November 1-12, 2024. The exercise aims to enhance **interoperability, cooperation**, and mutual understanding, strengthening **bilateral relations** and tactical skills, and supporting common security goals in the **Indo-Pacific region**.
- The **Indian Army** participated in the **15th India-US joint Special Forces Exercise, VAJRA PRAHAR**, held from November 2-22, 2024, at the **Orchard Combat Training Centre** in **Idaho, USA**. This exercise highlights the growing **military cooperation** and **tactical interoperability** between India and the US. It follows the earlier **Exercise YUDH ABHYAS 2024** in **Rajasthan**, marking a year of significant **India-US defence engagements** to strengthen their strategic partnership and promote peace and stability in mutual interest regions.

Defence Current Affairs of December 2024

- The **Indian Army** and **Cambodian Army** have begun their first-ever **Joint Table Top Exercise, CINBAX**, in **Pune** from **1st to 8th December 2024**. The exercise, involving **20 personnel** from each army, focuses on **counter-terrorism** operations under **UN Charter Chapter VII** to enhance **strategic cooperation, trust, and interoperability**.
- The **4th India-Malaysia Joint Military Exercise, HARIMAU SHAKTI**, began on **December 2, 2024**, at **Bentong Camp, Malaysia**. Running until **December 15**, the exercise aims to strengthen military cooperation, focusing on **counterinsurgency operations** in **jungle terrain**. The Indian contingent consists of **78 personnel** from the **MAHAR Regiment**, while **123 Malaysian personnel** from the **Royal Malaysian Regiment** are participating. The exercise aims to enhance joint military capabilities and foster stronger **India-Malaysia defense relations**.
- **Adani Defence** has delivered the **Drishti-10 Starliner drone** to the **Indian Navy**, enhancing India's maritime surveillance capabilities. The drone features **36-hour endurance, 450 kg payload**, and is **NATO certified for all-weather military operations**. Designed for **intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance (ISR)**, it offers **persistent, autonomous monitoring** of maritime threats, supporting **satellite communication-based operations**.
- The **Biden administration** has approved a **\$1.17 billion deal** under the **Foreign Military Sales (FMS)** program to provide advanced **communication systems, sensors, and logistical support** for India's **Sikorsky MH-60R helicopters**. This deal strengthens the **India-US defense partnership** and aims to counter challenges in the **Indian Ocean Region**. The **MH-60R helicopters** are equipped with **anti-submarine warfare** capabilities, including **Mk 54 torpedoes** and **Hellfire missiles**, along with advanced **radar and sonar systems**.
- **Amit Shah**, India's **Union Home Minister**, announced the creation of a comprehensive **anti-drone unit** to counter drone-related threats, particularly along borders. A **laser-equipped anti-drone gun mount system** has been developed through collaboration with the **BSF, Ministry of Defence, DRDO**, and Indian research departments. The system has significantly improved drone interception, with the **neutralisation rate** along **Punjab's International Border** rising from **3% to 55%**.
- **INS Tushil**, a **Russian-built guided missile frigate**, was commissioned into the **Indian Navy** at **Kaliningrad, Russia**, in the presence of **Defence Minister Rajnath Singh** and **Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi**. This marks a significant milestone in **India-Russia naval cooperation** and strengthens India's maritime capabilities amid increasing **Chinese presence** in the **Indian Ocean**. The warship is part of a **2016 deal** for four **stealth frigates** to enhance India's naval power.

- India is finalizing a **USD 4 billion** defense deal with **Russia** to acquire an advanced **Voronezh radar** system, enhancing missile detection and air defense. The radar can track ballistic missiles and aircraft up to **8,000 kilometers**, extending India's surveillance capabilities and supporting the **Make in India** initiative.
- India, **France**, and the **UAE** have launched the trilateral **air combat exercise "Desert Knight"** over the **Arabian Sea** to strengthen **defence cooperation**, enhance **interoperability**, and prepare for complex **combat scenarios**. The exercise, held in a strategically important region, highlights the growing trilateral ties amidst evolving **global security** challenges. Key goals include improving collaboration, enhancing air forces' synergy, and fostering realistic operations.
- The **Indian Navy** will commission **INS Nirdeshak** on December 18, 2024, in **Visakhapatnam**. Built by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers**, it is the second ship under the **Survey Vessel (Large) Project**. The 110-meter vessel, weighing 3,800 tons, is powered by dual diesel engines and features advanced **hydrographic and oceanographic equipment**. Over **80% of its components** are locally sourced, reflecting India's **self-reliance in defense manufacturing**. The ship will enhance India's **maritime presence**, particularly in the **Indian Ocean Region**.
- The **Sri Lanka-India Naval Exercise (SLINEX) 2024** will be held from **December 17 to 20** in **Visakhapatnam**, organized by the **Eastern Naval Command**. The exercise consists of two phases: the **Harbour Phase** (Dec 17-18) focusing on professional exchanges and mutual understanding, and the **Sea Phase** (Dec 19-20) involving joint operations like **Special Forces**, **gun firings**, **communication drills**, and **seamanship practices**. SLINEX, initiated in 2005, strengthens **maritime cooperation** and **regional security** between **India and Sri Lanka**.
- The **Indian Army** launched the **Indian Army AI Incubation Centre (IAAIC)** in **Bengaluru**, led by **Chief of Army Staff General Upendra Dwivedi**. In collaboration with **Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)**, the centre aims to develop **AI-driven solutions** to enhance **decision-making**, **operational efficiency**, and readiness for **AI-driven warfare**, supporting India's **Atmanirbhar Bharat** campaign.
- The **Indian Government** has formed a high-level committee under **Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh** to assess the **Indian Air Force's (IAF)** capability development amid concerns over **China's expanding air power** and **Pakistan's strengthening air force**. The committee will focus on **indigenous design, development, and acquisition** projects and is expected to submit its report in **2-3 months**, addressing gaps in **IAF's fighter aircraft and missile capabilities**.
- On **December 25, 2024**, **Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh** launched the **Rashtraparv Website and Mobile App** to mark **Good Governance Day** and **Atal Bihari Vajpayee's birth anniversary**. Developed by the **Ministry of Defence**, the platform aims to enhance transparency and citizen access to information regarding national events like **Republic Day**, **Beating Retreat**, and **Independence Day**. The initiative focuses on **better accessibility** and **information sharing** based on feedback from **states and attendees**.
- The **SLINEX 24** (Sri Lanka-India Exercise 2024) took place from **December 17 to 20, 2024**, in **Visakhapatnam**, aimed at enhancing **maritime cooperation** and **interoperability** between the Indian and Sri Lankan navies. The exercise, held under the **Eastern Naval Command**, featured a **Harbour Phase** and **Sea Phase**, with participation from both navies' **Special Forces** and key naval vessels, promoting a **rule-based maritime domain** in the **Indian Ocean**.
- In FY 2023-24, India's **defence exports** reached a record **Rs 21,083 crore (USD 2.63 billion)**, marking a **32.5% growth**. Indigenous defence production also set a record at **Rs 1,26,887 crore**, up **16.7%** from the previous year. This success highlights India's strengthened **defence sector**, driven by both **private sector** and **Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs)**, contributing to a **self-reliant defence ecosystem**.

Science and Technology of January 2024

- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** marked the beginning of 2024 with a significant milestone, launching its first mission of the year. On January 1, ISRO successfully lifted off the **XPoSat** (X-ray Polarimeter Satellite) along with 10 other satellites from the Sriharikota spaceport, using the reliable PSLV-C58 rocket.
- This groundbreaking mission **marks India's foray into space-based polarisation measurements of X-ray emissions from celestial sources**, with a specific focus on the enigmatic world of black holes.
- In a groundbreaking move, **NewSpace India Ltd (NSIL)**, the commercial arm of the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)**, has announced its collaboration with **SpaceX**, owned by billionaire Elon Musk, to **launch the communication satellite GSAT-20**. This marks India's first partnership with SpaceX, reflecting a significant stride in space exploration and satellite deployment.
- On January 1, 2024, the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** achieved a significant milestone by successfully testing a **100 W class Polymer Electrolyte Membrane Fuel Cell based Power System (FCPS)** in its orbital platform, **POEM3**. This remarkable feat took place aboard the **PSLV-C58 mission**, marking a crucial step in the assessment of fuel cell technology for future space missions.
- In a monumental achievement, the **Peregrine-1 lunar lander**, operated by private firm Astrobotic, successfully launched from Cape Canaveral, marking the first American lunar mission in 51 years. Scheduled to land on February 23, the mission, conducted under **NASA's Commercial Lunar Payload Services (CLPS) initiative**, aims to study the Moon's surface environment in preparation for upcoming human missions.
- **Microsoft India** has unveiled the **'AI Odyssey' initiative**, aiming to train **100,000 Indian developers** in the latest AI technologies. Emphasizing AI as the future of innovation, Microsoft underscores India's leadership in tech talent. The program seeks to equip developers with skills essential for executing AI projects aligning with business goals.
- **Mitsubishi Heavy Industries** has achieved a significant milestone in space exploration and national security with the successful launch of an **H-IIA rocket carrying Japan's Information-Gathering Satellite "Optical-8"**. This event marks a key development in Japan's aerospace capabilities and strategic surveillance.
- In a groundbreaking initiative, researchers at the **University of Oxford in the United Kingdom** have commenced the **first-in-human vaccine trials for the deadly Nipah virus**. This initiative is a significant step forward in addressing the severe impact of the virus on various Asian countries, including India. The trials will be conducted on 51 individuals aged 18 to 55 and are led by the Oxford Vaccine Group.
- The Indian Science, Technology, and Engineering facilities Map, known as **I-STEM**, is set to embark on a groundbreaking initiative named **'Samavesha.'** This ambitious project, spearheaded by the Office of Principal Scientific Advisor, Government of India, aims to **transform research collaboration in the country** by facilitating easier access to scientific facilities and laboratories.
- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** has been at the forefront of technological innovation, contributing significantly to various fields. One such noteworthy development is the second-generation **'Distress Alert Transmitter' (DAT-SG)**, a remarkable advancement in satellite communication and navigation capabilities. Operational **since 2010**, the DAT-SG has become a crucial tool for fishermen at sea, allowing them to send emergency messages and receive real-time acknowledgments.
- In a significant development, MeitY Secretary S Krishnan inaugurated the **India Innovation Centre for Graphene (IICG)** and a Centre of Excellence (CoE) in **Intelligent Internet of Things (IIoT) Sensors** in Kerala. The Digital University Kerala (DUK) (formerly IIITMK) and CMET, Thrissur, play crucial roles as technical partners in establishing these pioneering centers.
- In a significant industry shift, **Apple Inc.'s iPhone** has outpaced **Samsung Electronics Co. devices**, securing the title of the best-selling smartphone series in 2023. This marks the first time since 2010 that Samsung has conceded the top spot in the smartphone market.

Science and Technology of February 2024

- **Japan** is poised to join an exclusive group of nations that have successfully landed on the Moon. The **Smart Lander for Investigating Moon (SLIM)**, developed by the **Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)**, is scheduled to touch the lunar surface on January 20, 2024. This mission marks a significant milestone in Japan's space exploration endeavours and offers a unique opportunity to advance lunar science.
- In a historic event, SpaceX successfully launched the **Ax-3 mission** to the International Space Station (ISS) from NASA's Kennedy Space Center on January 18. The Crew Dragon capsule, named "Freedom," was propelled into space atop a Falcon 9 rocket, marking the third mission organized by Houston-based Axiom Space. The launch, initially scheduled for January 17, was delayed by a day for additional prelaunch checks.
- **CoRover.ai**, a leading player in the Conversational AI space, has recently introduced **BharatGPT, India's first Large Language Model (LLM)**. This groundbreaking development aims to revolutionize **AI conversations across 22 Indian languages**, addressing the language diversity challenges prevalent in the country. Positioned as an Indigenous Generative AI platform, BharatGPT integrates seamlessly with both voice and text modalities, offering a unique solution to the complexities of linguistic diversity.
- **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** announced that it has successfully executed all experiments within the **Payload Orbital Experiment for Microgravity (POEM-3)** mission, which was launched as part of the PSLV-C58 mission.
- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** is set to launch its latest meteorological satellite, **INSAT-3DS**, marking a significant advancement in India's space capabilities. This satellite, **designed to enhance weather forecasting and disaster management**, represents a culmination of rigorous testing and collaboration between ISRO and various stakeholders.
- In a remarkable discovery, scientists have identified a new species of tiny lizards in the biodiverse forests of the Western Ghats, describing them as "**diminutive dragons**." The newfound species, named **Agasthyagama edge** or the northern kangaroo lizard, belongs to the **Agamidae family**, characterized by its diminutive size with a maximum snout-vent length of 4.3 cm.
- In a groundbreaking development, **Neuralink**, the neurotechnology company co-founded by **Elon Musk**, has successfully implanted its first brain chip into a human being. This marks a significant step forward in the field of **brain-computer interfaces (BCIs)** and opens up a myriad of possibilities for the future of medical treatment and human enhancement.
- In a pioneering leap for India's space endeavors, **Vyommitra**, the woman robot astronaut developed by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), is set to embark on an uncrewed mission in the third quarter of this year. The mission, named after the Sanskrit words "**Vyoma**" (Space) and "**Mitra**" (Friend), signifies a significant stride towards the ambitious Gaganyaan mission, the country's maiden manned space flight, slated for 2025.
- Russian cosmonaut **Oleg Kononenko** achieved a historic milestone by setting a world record for the **most time spent in space**, surpassing his compatriot Gennady Padalka's previous record of 878 days in orbit, as reported by Russia's space corporation, Roscosmos.
- In a strategic partnership aimed at advancing India's self-reliance in defence, **Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras)** and **Munitions India Limited** have joined forces to pioneer the development of 155 Smart Ammunition. This groundbreaking collaboration underscores a concerted effort towards achieving indigenisation in the defence sector.

- **NASA's Transiting Exoplanet Survey Satellite (TESS)** has made a significant discovery—a **super-Earth** located in a habitable zone, offering tantalizing possibilities for the conditions conducive to life. This discovery sheds light on the diversity of planets in our universe and the potential for habitable worlds beyond our solar system.
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- Alphabet's Google has made significant strides in the realm of artificial intelligence (AI), recently rebranding its chatbot and introducing a new subscription plan. This move places Google in direct competition with its rival OpenAI, signaling a pivotal moment in the ongoing AI race.
- The vast expanse of our planet's oceans and the intricate dance of Earth's atmosphere hold key secrets to understanding and battling climate change. In a recent groundbreaking move, **NASA** launched the **Plankton, Aerosol, Cloud, ocean Ecosystem (PACE)** mission, embarking on a crucial journey to unlock these mysteries. This ambitious project promises to revolutionize our understanding of the complex interactions between air, water, and life, providing invaluable insights into our planet's changing climate.
- **The Epic Foundation** has recently unveiled the **Milkyway tablet**, heralding a new era of '**designed in India**' technology tailored for the educational needs of school children. Ajai Chowdhry, the Chairman of Epic Foundation, emphasized that the Milkyway tablet is the first product designed from the ground up in India to be fully repairable and upgradable, setting a benchmark for sustainability and innovation.
- Professor **Karan Nathwani** from IIT-Jammu has created a groundbreaking anti-drone system that relies on **sound technology**. This innovative approach ensures affordability and user-friendliness. Unlike conventional methods using visual or radar technology, Nathwani's system identifies drones accurately by analyzing their distinct acoustic signatures.
- India is preparing to launch its first spy satellite developed by **Tata Advanced Systems Ltd (TASL)** aboard a **SpaceX rocket** in April. This satellite, designed for discreet information gathering, will bolster the country's defense capabilities by providing real-time monitoring and ground control.
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) introduces the "**Young Scientist Programme**" "**YUva Vigyani KARYakram**" (**YUVIKA**) to foster the innate curiosity of children and youth towards space science. YUVIKA aims to impart fundamental knowledge on Space Science, Technology, and Applications, particularly targeting rural areas. The program aspires to ignite interest in STEM fields and nurture future talents in space exploration.
- In a groundbreaking collaboration between **NASA** and the Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (**JAXA**), the world's first wooden satellite, dubbed the **LignoSat probe**, is poised for imminent launch. Developed by Kyoto University scientists in partnership with Sumitomo Forestry, this innovative initiative aims to revolutionize spaceflight operations by prioritizing sustainability.
- India has taken a significant step by opening its space sector to **100% foreign direct investment (FDI)** through an amendment in the FDI policy. This move aims to attract investors, enhance ease of doing business, and foster growth, in line with the vision of an Atmanirbhar Bharat as outlined by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- The collaboration between **Microsoft** and **iCreate** to launch the **iMPEL-AI (iCreate-Microsoft program for Emerging Leaders in Artificial Intelligence)** program marks a significant milestone in India's quest to harness the power of Artificial Intelligence (AI) for economic growth and innovation. This article provides a detailed analysis of the initiative and its potential impact on the Indian startup ecosystem.
- **Odysseus spacecraft**, spearheaded by **Intuitive Machines (IM)**, has achieved what was once solely the domain of national space agencies: a successful soft landing on the lunar surface. This landmark event marks the first commercial venture to accomplish such a feat, signalling a significant leap forward in private sector involvement in space exploration.
- In a groundbreaking partnership, **Nokia** and the **Indian Institute of Science (IISc)** have united to pioneer **6G technology research** and its real-world applications, with a particular focus on India. This collaboration, headquartered at **Nokia's newly inaugurated 6G Lab in Bengaluru**, will delve into various facets of 6G technology, from radio technologies to architecture, while integrating machine learning into the 6G air interface.
- In a monumental stride towards promoting technological advancement and innovation, the **Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati**, in collaboration with **EduRade**, has inaugurated **India's largest Remote Pilot Training Organisation (RPTO)**. Spanning across 18 acres, this initiative boasts the capability to simultaneously fly 9 medium-class drones, positioning itself as a frontrunner in drone technology training.

- The newly discovered **Northern Green Anaconda**, scientifically named **Eunectes akayima**, challenges our perceptions of the natural world. Measuring an astonishing **26 feet in length and weighing 200 kg**, this anaconda's dimensions are beyond any previously recorded. Its head, comparable in size to that of a human, and a body as wide as a car tyre, underscore the snake's immense size and strength.
- For the first time, an international collaboration of researchers has successfully demonstrated the **laser cooling of Positronium**, a short-lived hydrogen-like atom that provides an ideal testing ground for bound-state quantum electrodynamics.
- In the recently published paper in the **Physical Review Letters**, the AEGIS team has described the laser cooling of Positronium atoms achieved from ~380 Kelvin (106.85 degrees Celsius) to ~170 Kelvin (minus 103.15 degrees Celsius), using a 70-nanosecond pulsed alexandrite-based laser system.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi, during his address at the **Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC)** in Thiruvananthapuram, declared India's plan to establish its own space station by 2035. This initiative aims to facilitate advanced exploration of the universe.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for the **Indian Space Research Organisation's (ISRO) second spaceport in Kulasekarapattinam, Tamil Nadu**. This marks a significant milestone in India's space exploration endeavors, promising to revolutionize the nation's satellite launch capabilities.
- Union Minister **Rajeev Chandrasekhar** and **Prof. Thillai Rajan A** of **IIT Madras** inaugurated the '**Investor Information and Analytics Platform**,' developed by **CREST**. This platform serves as a centralized hub for startups to access investors, government schemes, and other crucial components of the startup ecosystem.

Science and Technology of March 2024

- Google's DeepMind team introduces "**Genie**," a groundbreaking AI platform poised to transform the gaming industry and creative endeavors. This innovative project signifies a fusion of cutting-edge technology and imaginative potential, offering the capability to craft interactive **2D video games from single image prompts or text descriptions**.
- **Iran's venture** into space exploration and satellite deployment continues with the launch of the "**Pars 1**" satellite, facilitated by **Russia** from the Vostochny Cosmodrome. This event underscores the technological collaboration between Iran and Russia, occurring against a backdrop of heightened scrutiny and concern from Western nations.
- In an exciting development for space exploration, astronomers affiliated with the **International Astronomical Union** have identified three new moons in

the outer reaches of our solar system. These celestial bodies, with **two orbiting Neptune and one around Uranus**, were detected through the use of powerful land-based telescopes across the globe.

- Union Minister of State for Science and Technology Jitendra Singh inaugurated a pioneering technical center in Ahmedabad, representing a significant advancement in India's space sector. Established by the **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACE)**, this center aims to revolutionize private sector involvement in space technology development and testing.
- **MethaneSAT**, a groundbreaking initiative spearheaded by the **Environmental Defense Fund (EDF)**, heralds a new era in environmental monitoring. Designed to address the elusive yet critical issue of methane emissions, MethaneSAT promises to **revolutionize how policymakers and industries tackle greenhouse gas pollution**. With its advanced technology and global reach, MethaneSAT aims to **independently verify industry reports and pinpoint methane hotspots**, thereby empowering stakeholders to take decisive action.
- **Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC) in Kerala**, Union Minister Rajeev Chandrasekhar, responsible for Electronics & IT, Skill Development & Entrepreneurship, and Jal Shakti, articulated India's potential as a global semiconductor hub. Chandrasekhar emphasized the imperative of designing chips and IPs for diverse industries, outlining a roadmap for entrepreneurs in Trivandrum and Kerala to lead the innovation drive.
- ISRO chief **S Somnath** informed at the National Space Science Symposium (NSSS 2024) that the Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO) is preparing to launch the **next lunar mission Chandrayaan-4**. This mission will include **five spacecraft modules**.
- The **Indian government**, led by Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has approved a new **\$1.24 billion investment for the IndiaAI mission**. This initiative aims to create an **all-Indian AI ecosystem** from scratch, bolstering India's technological prowess and fostering innovation in AI.
- Researchers have made an exciting discovery – a previously unknown **scorpion species with 8 eyes and 8 legs** in Thailand's **Kaeng Krachan National Park**.
- **MoRD (Ministry of Rural Development)** and **IIT Delhi** have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to collaborate on **geospatial technology and artificial intelligence (AI) for rural development**. The partnership aims to leverage technology to enhance the effectiveness and transparency of rural development initiatives. The MoU signifies a collaborative effort to address rural challenges through technological solutions, setting a precedent for effective collaboration between academia and government.

- **Google** has partnered with the **Election Commission of India (ECI)** to provide authoritative information on voting processes for the upcoming general elections. Through Google Search and YouTube videos, voters will be able to access critical details on how to register and vote, as well as information about candidates.
- **SpaceX's** Starship rocket, aimed at **lunar missions** and beyond, faced another setback as it disintegrated during its **third test flight**. Despite achieving several engineering milestones, the failure highlights challenges in its development. The Starship, consisting of the cruise vessel atop the Super Heavy rocket booster, launched from Starbase near Boca Chica Village, Texas.
- **IIT Delhi** recently announced a collaboration with **Israel Aerospace Industries (IAI)**, a significant step in applied research. This partnership, emphasized in an official statement from IIT Delhi, reflects IAI's commitment to corporate social responsibility (CSR) in India, **aiming to promote innovation and technological advancement** through joint projects, training initiatives, and research consultancy.
- In October of this year, **NASA** will embark on its **Europa Clipper mission**, aiming to explore **Jupiter's moon Europa** in search of signs of life. Scientists are particularly interested in a potential salty lake hidden beneath its icy crust. As part of this mission, NASA plans to send a unique message to Europa, symbolizing human curiosity and creativity.
- Researchers have uncovered a monumental discovery on **Mars**—a colossal volcano named **Noctis Volcano**. Standing at an impressive **29,600 feet** tall and stretching approximately **450 kilometers** in width, this massive volcano lies just south of Mars' equator within the **Eastern Noctis Labyrinthus** region. The finding, made possible by data from a suite of missions including NASA's Mariner 9, Viking Orbiter 1 and 2, Mars Global Surveyor, Mars Odyssey, Mars Reconnaissance Orbiter, and the ESA's Mars Express, unveils a hidden geological marvel.
- With the **Lok Sabha elections** approaching in India, Meta unveils its strategy to tackle the growing threat of **AI-generated fake content** that could influence the electoral process. In response to concerns raised by the Election Commission of India regarding the **spread of misinformation**, Meta announces its comprehensive plan to safeguard the integrity of the elections.
- **Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC)** has developed **SAKHI**, a revolutionary app aimed at aiding astronauts during the **Gaganyaan space flight mission**. SAKHI, or Space-borne Assistant and Knowledge Hub for Crew Interaction, offers indispensable support across various critical aspects of the mission.
- The European Space Agency's **Gaia space telescope** has made a groundbreaking discovery, uncovering two

ancient streams of stars named **Shiva and Shakti**. Led by **Khyati Malhan** of the **Max Planck Institute for Astronomy (MPIA)** in **Germany**, this revelation significantly enhances our understanding of the **Milky Way's** origins.

- The **Indian Institute of Technology-Guwahati (IIT-G)** has transferred a **first-of-its-kind vaccine technology** to **BioMed Pvt. Ltd.**, a company specializing in vaccine manufacturing. This revolutionary technology involves a **recombinant vector vaccine** specifically designed to combat the **classical swine fever virus** in **pigs and wild boars**. It fills a significant gap in India's vaccine landscape.
- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** will conduct the **Space Science and Technology Awareness Training (START) 2024** program during **April and May**. ISRO is inviting **Expression of Interest (EOI)** from educational institutes, universities, and colleges within India offering **UG and PG courses in physical sciences and technology** to host START-2024.

Science and Technology of April 2024

- In a groundbreaking collaboration, tech giants Microsoft and OpenAI have revealed plans to construct an unprecedented artificial intelligence supercomputer known as **"Stargate."** This ambitious endeavor, estimated to cost a staggering \$100 billion, represents a significant leap forward in **AI infrastructure and capabilities**.
- Meta, the parent company of **Facebook, WhatsApp, and Instagram**, has extended its third-party fact-checking initiative in India by partnering with the **Press Trust of India (PTI)**. This collaboration establishes PTI as a dedicated fact-checking unit within its editorial department, enabling the identification, review, and rating of misinformation across Meta platforms.
- **Tata Advanced Systems Ltd (TASL)**, in collaboration with Satellogic, has successfully launched India's inaugural private sector-built sub-metre resolution earth observation satellite, **TSAT-1A**. This significant milestone marks a new era in India's space endeavors, offering enhanced surveillance capabilities to the country.
- **GUJCOST** has been appointed as the **Nodal Centre for ISRO's START programme**, aimed at nurturing aspiring scientists and engineers in the field of space science and technology. The programme, conceptualized by ISRO, provides an introductory online platform covering various areas of space science research.
- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)**'s **Chandrayaan-3 mission** team has been awarded the **2024 John L. "Jack" Swigert, Jr. Award** for Space Exploration by the **US-based Space Foundation**. This prestigious award is given to recognize the remarkable achievements of a space agency, company, or consortium in the realm of space exploration and discovery.

- Researchers at the **Indian Institute of Technology Jodhpur (IIT Jodhpur)** have unveiled a groundbreaking nano-sensor designed to swiftly detect Cytokines, vital proteins regulating various cellular functions. This innovation aims to combat the high mortality rates resulting from delayed diagnoses and the absence of early warnings in disease progression.
- In a joint announcement, **President Joe Biden** and **Japanese Prime Minister Fumio Kishida** revealed that Japanese astronauts will join future **NASA lunar missions as part of the Artemis program**. This move is seen as a strategic effort to strengthen economic and defense ties between the United States and Japan.
- Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) chief **S Somanath** has revealed that the upcoming phase of the **Chandrayaan project** is in progress, aiming to advance India's lunar exploration efforts. He indicated that Chandrayaan-4 marks the initial stride towards India's aspiration of landing an astronaut on the **moon by 2040**.
- Since its inception in 2001, **SPACE India** has been on a mission to integrate **Astronomy and Space Science** into school curricula nationwide, inspiring over 1.5 million students across 1,000 schools. The organization has been instrumental in demystifying rocket science and making space education accessible to all.
- In a significant step towards enhancing India's naval capabilities, the Department of Defence (R&D) and the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** have recently inaugurated a state-of-the-art facility called the **Submersible Platform for Acoustic Characterisation and Evaluation (SPACE)** at the Underwater Acoustic Research Facility in Kulamavu, Idukki, Kerala.
- **European astronomers** have made a groundbreaking discovery – the largest **stellar black hole** in our **Milky Way galaxy**. Named '**BH-3**', this celestial behemoth has a staggering mass **33 times greater than our Sun** and is located a mere **2,000 light-years away from Earth**.
- **Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg** has announced the launch of the company's advanced AI assistant, **Meta AI**, powered by the state-of-the-art language model **Llama 3**. The new AI offering is designed to enhance the user experience across Meta's popular apps, including WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, and Messenger, while also being available on a dedicated website, meta.ai.
- In a remarkable discovery, scientists have identified a new species of wild cat thriving in the dense rainforests of Brazil. Dubbed the **clouded tiger cat (Leopardus pardinoides)**, this feline marvel has captivated the hearts of animal enthusiasts and conservationists alike, sparking renewed efforts to safeguard the region's rich biodiversity.
- **Microsoft Research Asia's AI team** has introduced **VASA-1**, an innovative AI application showcased in a **recent paper on arXiv**. VASA-1 converts still images into

animated representations with synchronized speech or song, exhibiting realistic facial expressions.

- **The Himalayan Mountains, known as the "Third Pole" for their vast glaciers**, are experiencing significant changes due to global climate shifts. Glacial retreat leads to the formation and enlargement of lakes, posing risks like **Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs)**. Monitoring these changes is challenging but essential for understanding environmental impacts and managing risks.
- **Reliance Jio, the telecom leader in India**, has outpaced China Mobile to become the **world's largest mobile operator by data traffic consumption**. With a **subscriber base of 481.8 million, including 108 million on its True5G Standalone network**, Jio's dominance underscores its position in the global telecom market.
- **NASA recently launched a groundbreaking space mission from New Zealand**, deploying the **Advanced Composite Solar Sail System spacecraft aboard Rocket Lab's Electron rocket**. This innovative spacecraft utilizes solar energy for propulsion, marking a significant leap in space exploration technology.
- **Phi-3-mini marks a significant milestone in AI innovation**, offering unparalleled performance and efficiency. **Microsoft's latest small language model (SLM)** has surpassed benchmarks, demonstrating superiority over models of similar and larger sizes. Leveraged by prominent entities like India's ITC, Phi-3-mini showcases Microsoft's commitment to delivering cutting-edge AI solutions.
- In the latest advancement of China's space program, the **Shenzhou-18 mission** saw the successful launch of a **three-member crew aboard the Shenzhou-18 spacecraft**. The mission's objective is to rendezvous with the Tiangong space station, marking another milestone in China's ambitious space exploration endeavors.
- In a collaborative effort between the **Systematic Voters' Education and Electoral Participation Cell (SVEEP)** of Kamrup Election District and the **Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati**, a groundbreaking 3D-printed dummy ballot unit has been unveiled. The initiative aims to enhance voter awareness and engagement, particularly among new voters and senior citizens, by providing a practical experience of the voting process.

Science and Technology of May 2024

- In a collaborative effort between the **Systematic Voters' Education and Electoral Participation Cell (SVEEP)** of Kamrup Election District and the **Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati**, a groundbreaking 3D-printed dummy ballot unit has been unveiled. The initiative aims to enhance voter awareness and engagement, particularly among new voters and senior citizens, by providing a practical experience of the voting process.

- Indian-origin astronaut **Sunita Williams**, alongside colleague **Butch Wilmore**, is embarking on her third space mission to the **International Space Station (ISS)**. This mission marks the inaugural crewed flight of the Starliner spacecraft, designed to test its systems from launch to landing.
- In a groundbreaking discovery detailed in *Frontiers in Marine Science*, researchers have revealed the **Taam Ja' Blue Hole in Mexico's Chetumal Bay** as the deepest known blue hole on Earth, descending to a staggering depth of 1,380 feet. Surpassing the previous record-holder, the **Sansha Yongle Blue Hole**, by **480 feet**, this abyss presents a tantalizing opportunity for scientific exploration and the potential discovery of new marine life.
- **Setu**, a leading Indian **fintech** company and part of the **Pine Labs Group**, has unveiled **Sesame**, India's first **Large Language Model (LLM)** specifically designed for the **banking, financial services, and insurance (BFSI)** sector. Developed in collaboration with indigenous AI research firm **Sarvam AI**, this groundbreaking initiative marks a significant milestone in the adoption of advanced AI technologies in the financial services industry.
- ISRO, through the **Liquid Propulsion Systems Centre (LPSC)** with support from other launch vehicle centers, is advancing the development of a semi-cryogenic propulsion system. This system aims to enhance the payload capacity of **Launch Vehicle Mark-3 (LVM3)** and future launch vehicles by utilizing a 2,000 kN thrust semi-cryogenic engine powered by a combination of **liquid oxygen (LOX) and kerosene**.
- NASA has unveiled its ambitious plan to construct the **first lunar railway system, known as FLOAT (Flexible Levitation on a Track)**, designed to revolutionize payload transport on the Moon. This innovative system aims to provide reliable, autonomous, and efficient transportation essential for the daily operations of a sustainable lunar base, aligning with NASA's Moon to Mars initiative and mission concepts like the **Robotic Lunar Surface Operations 2 (RLSO2)**.
- **NASA and the Japanese Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)** have decided to operate an instrument on the **X-ray Imaging and Spectroscopy Mission (XRISM)** satellite as-is for at least the next year and a half, despite encountering an issue affecting one of its instruments. This decision showcases the agencies' determination to push forward with this groundbreaking X-ray astronomy mission.
- Highlighting the historical importance and modern relevance of millets, **Google Arts & Culture**, in collaboration with **India's Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare**, presents an engaging digital exhibition titled **"Millets: Seeds of Change."** This exhibition delves into the journey of millets, showcasing their evolution from ancient staples to contemporary superfoods, and

emphasizes their nutritional value, role in climate resilience, and potential to address global food security challenges.

- In a move that underscores its commitment to **artificial intelligence (AI)** and cloud computing, tech giant **Microsoft Corp.** has announced plans to invest a staggering **€4 billion** (approximately **\$4.3 billion**) in building **cloud and AI infrastructure in France**. This latest investment highlights the company's continued focus on advancing its AI capabilities and expanding its cloud services globally.
- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** is gearing up for a landmark mission that aims to land a **rover and helicopter on Mars**. This historic endeavor, named **Mangalyaan-2**, seeks to place India alongside the US and China as a significant player in interplanetary exploration. The project was unveiled during a presentation at the Space Application Centre on National Technology Day.
- Indian expatriate **Gopi Thotakura** joined the ranks of space explorers as the first **Indian to embark on a journey beyond Earth's atmosphere**. The NS-25 mission, part of **Jeff Bezos's Blue Origin program**, saw **Thotakura** and five other crew members lift off aboard the New Shepard spacecraft from a private ranch in West Texas.
- Leading smartwatch and connected lifestyle brand, **Noise**, has announced the acquisition of the **AI-powered women's wellness platform SocialBoat**. This strategic move is part of Noise's broader strategy to **advance innovation in smart rings**, particularly its flagship wearable, the **Luna Ring**.
- Microsoft has introduced a new category of personal computers, **'Copilot+ PCs'**, featuring advanced AI capabilities to compete with Alphabet and Apple. These devices, developed in collaboration with **Acer and ASUS** **TeK Computer**, aim to perform AI tasks locally without relying on cloud data centers. The launch event took place at Microsoft's Redmond, Washington campus on May 20, with sales starting on June 18 at a base price of \$1,000.
- Direct geological evidence of recent volcanic activity on Venus has been confirmed for the second time, thanks to archival data from NASA's Magellan mission. Scientists in Italy have detected surface changes indicating new rock formations from lava flows linked to volcanic eruptions that occurred while the spacecraft was in orbit.

Science and Technology of June 2024

- As part of the **Artemis program**, which intends to bring humans back to the lunar surface, **NASA and the European Space Agency (ESA)** are working together to create a **common time system** for the moon. The project aims to meet the requirement for a common timekeeping system to manage missions from various nations and private organizations.

- **Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang** revealed the company's groundbreaking next-generation AI chip platform, Rubin, set for a 2026 release. The Rubin family, comprising GPUs, CPUs, and networking processors, promises to revolutionize AI capabilities. Notably, Nvidia plans an aggressive shift to annual releases, aiming to keep pace with AI advancements and maintain its market dominance.
- Boeing and NASA are gearing up for the highly anticipated launch of the **Starliner spacecraft's first crewed flight test**, scheduled for **June 5 from Cape Canaveral Space Force Station in Florida**. This historic event marks a significant milestone in space exploration, with veteran NASA astronauts Butch Wilmore and Suni Williams aboard the spacecraft.
- ISRO, through its Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC), has introduced the **PraVaHa software**, a **Computational Fluid Dynamics (CFD)** tool aimed at facilitating aerodynamic design and analysis for aerospace vehicles.
- A group of teachers and students at the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Dharwad**, directed by **Profs. Sudheer Siddapureddy and Ameer Mulla**, with funding from the **TIHAN Foundation, IIT Hyderabad (NMICPS, Indian government)**, has created a **drone for fire rescue assistance**.
- **Volvo Cars** announces the debut of the **world's first EV battery passport**, which meticulously documents the lineage of **raw materials, components, recycled content, and carbon footprint** for its forthcoming **flagship EX90 SUV**, ahead of the EU rules. Volvo owners can access a simplified version of the passport using a **QR code on the inside of the driver's door**.
- **Nvidia's** remarkable rally to record highs on Wednesday saw the artificial intelligence chipmaker's valuation soar past the \$3 trillion mark, eclipsing Apple and securing its position as the **world's second most valuable company**. This significant shift marks a departure from Silicon Valley's traditional dominance by Apple, particularly since the launch of the iPhone in 2007.
- Dhruva Space, a Hyderabad-based space tech startup, has successfully completed its maiden mission with the **Thybolt-1 and Thybolt-2 satellites**. These satellites have securely deorbited after completing **15,000 orbits around Earth**. Launched aboard **ISRO's PSLV C54 in November 2022**, this achievement marks a significant milestone for the company.
- **Nvidia**, the startup at the centre of the **artificial intelligence boom**, has become the world's most valuable company, knocking **Microsoft off** the top spot. Nvidia's market **capitalisation hit \$3.335 trillion** on June 18, as shares of the chipmaker rose by **3.5 percent to \$135.58**.
- **SpaceX** has launched NASA's final satellite for the **NOAA program**, enhancing continuous weather monitoring across the **Western Hemisphere**. This launch improves the **US ability to monitor solar flares from eight-hour intervals to every 30 minutes**.

Science and Technology of July 2024

- **Space Exploration and Research Agency (SERA) and Blue Origin** have designated India as a partner nation in their **human spaceflight initiative**, inviting Indian citizens to participate in a historic opportunity. The program offers six seats aboard Blue Origin's New Shepard rocket, taking participants on an 11-minute journey beyond the Kármán line, the boundary of space.
- A **Google employee** recently created the **"world's first AI dress"** and it has astonished many on the internet. **Christina Ernst**, a **software engineer** at the tech giant and the **Founder of SheBuildsRobots.org**, a platform which aims to educate girls on building robots, shared a clip of her creation which has robotic snakes attached to it to detect faces.
- **The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** on June 2, announced that India's inaugural solar mission has completed **its halo orbit around the Sun-Earth L1 point** on July 2. This significant breakthrough was achieved after a station keeper manoeuvre made its transition into the **second halo orbit**.
- **Europe's new Ariane 6 rocket** successfully blasted off for the **first time**, restoring the continent's independent access to space after a series of setbacks. Initially delayed for an hour by a small problem, the rocket lifted off from Kourou, French Guiana, releasing satellites into orbit. This launch marked a significant milestone for European space efforts, which had suffered from delays and loss of independent launch capabilities.
- The World Health Organization (**WHO**) has launched **MeDeViS (Medical Devices Information System)**, an online platform designed to be the first global open access clearing house for information on medical devices. It aims to support governments, regulators, and users in making informed decisions about the selection, procurement, and use of medical devices for diagnostics, testing, and treatment of various health conditions.
- **Raksha Rajya Mantri Shri Sanjay Seth** inaugurated the GRSE Accelerated Innovation Nurturing Scheme (GAINS 2024) at **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited (GRSE) in Kolkata** on July 10, 2024. This initiative aims to foster technological solutions for shipyard challenges and promote innovation through Indian start-ups.
- In a groundbreaking achievement, NASA has transmitted Missy Elliott's 1997 hit song **"The Rain (Supa Dupa Fly)" to Venus**, marking the first time a hip-hop song has been beamed into deep space. The transmission was made possible through **NASA's Deep Space Network (DSN)**, from their **Jet Propulsion Laboratory in Southern California**. Traveling at the speed of light, the song covered the vast distance of 158 million miles to Venus, taking approximately 14 minutes to reach its destination.
- **Elon Musk** said on July 16, said that he would move the **headquarters of two of his businesses**, the social media platform X and the **rocket manufacturer SpaceX**, to Texas, escalating an increasingly contentious **fight with California**.

- NASA has achieved a significant milestone with the discovery of **six new exoplanets**: HD 36384 b, TOI-198 b, TOI-2095 b, TOI-2095 c, TOI-4860 b, and MWC 758 c. This brings the total number of confirmed exoplanets outside our solar system to 5,502, marking a remarkable advancement in our understanding of the universe and the potential for extraterrestrial life.
- In a bold move that could reshape the landscape of internet search, **OpenAI**, the company behind the revolutionary ChatGPT, has announced the development of an **AI-powered search engine** called **SearchGPT**.
- **SpaceX and NASA** said on July 26, they plan to launch the **space agency's Crew-9 mission** to the International Space Station (ISS) no earlier than Aug. 18.

Science and Technology of August 2024

- **Women** led the way in **living organ donation**, offering patients suffering from end-stage organ failure a new lease of life. Data released by the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare** show that the number of women living donors was **9,784 last year compared to 5,651 men**.
- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** is set to celebrate its 55th foundation day on August 15, 2024, with a significant milestone – the launch of the **Earth Observation Satellite-08 (EOS-08)**.
- China has taken a significant step in advancing its **low-altitude economy** by testing its **largest unmanned cargo aircraft yet**. This move highlights the country's push to expand its drone capabilities, with the goal of creating a **\$279-billion industry by 2030**.
- The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** on August 13, 2024 successfully carried out the maiden flight test of the **long-range glide bomb (LRGB)** Gaurav from a **Su-30 MK-I fighter jet** of the Indian Air Force.
- SpaceX's upcoming **Polaris Dawn mission** is set to make history as the **first private spacewalk**. Scheduled for launch on August 26, 2024, at 3:38 a.m. EDT (0738 GMT).
- **Gopichand Thotakura**, **India's first civilian space tourist**, received a warm welcome in Delhi upon his return on August 26, 2024.
- The **Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation** has granted approval to **Siemens Healthineers for the manufacture of RT-PCR testing kits** for detection of **Mpox**, a senior Health Ministry official said.
- **Bharat Biotech International Ltd** has launched **Hillchol (BBV131)**, a novel single-strain oral cholera vaccine (OCV) developed under license from **Hilleman Laboratories**. This launch is critical as global demand for **OCVs exceeds 100 million doses annually**, and there has been a deficit of approximately **40 million doses** due to limited supply.
- An outbreak of bird flu, caused by the **H5N1 strain of avian influenza**, has been reported in **Pipili town, Puri**

district, Odisha. Authorities have culled over **11,700 chickens** following the **detection of the virus**.

- **NASA engineers** are developing **underwater robot probes** to measure the rate of ice shelf melting in Antarctica due to climate change. These robots, developed by NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory, aim to provide accurate data to improve predictions of sea level rise.
- **More than 50 illnesses and nine deaths** have been reported due **Listeria outbreak in US**. According to latest data released by the **Centre for Disease Control and Prevention CDC**, the outbreak has been reported in 18 states with a total of 57 people have been hospitalised.

Science and Technology of September 2024

- **Google DeepMind's India** unit is spearheading an ambitious **AI project named Morni** (Multimodal Representation for India), aiming to encompass **125 Indic languages and dialects**. Speaking at the Global Fintech Fest, Manish Gupta, Director of Google DeepMind India, highlighted that among these languages, 73 had no existing digital corpus. Despite Hindi being spoken by nearly 10% of the global population, its online text representation is just 0.1%.
- **Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan**, the **Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi**, has officially inaugurated the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi Abu Dhabi campus**.
- In a significant development for the global telecommunications industry, **Counterpoint Research** has reported that India has surpassed the United States to become the **world's second-largest market for 5G smartphones**. This shift underscores India's rapid technological advancement and the growing demand for high-speed connectivity across the nation.
- The Union Cabinet has approved the **Chandrayaan-4 mission**, which aims to develop technologies for returning to Earth after landing on the moon and collecting lunar samples for analysis. The total cost of the mission is **Rs 2104.06 crore**, covering spacecraft development, two LVM3 launches, deep space network support, and special tests for validation. The mission will be **completed within 36 months**, involving significant participation from industry and academia.
- **The Union Cabinet chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi** has approved the development of **Next Generation Launch Vehicle (NGLV)**, that will be a significant step towards the Government's vision of establishing & operating the Bharatiya Antariksh Station and towards developing capability for Indian Crewed Landing on the Moon by 2040.

Science and Technology of October 2024

- **SpaceX's Polaris Dawn mission**, concluded on September 15, 2024, with a splashdown in the **Gulf of Mexico**, is a significant breakthrough in commercial space exploration. **Led by billionaire Jared Isaacman**, this mission achieved several firsts, including the first private spacewalk and the highest orbital altitude reached since **NASA's Apollo era**. These milestones mark a new era for private space ventures, pushing boundaries in space technology, exploration, and research.
- **ISRO, IN-SPACe, and NSIL** have reached a significant milestone by signing **75 Technology Transfer Agreements (TTAs)** with **non-governmental entities (NGEs)**. On September 20, 2024, five TTAs were signed at IN-SPACe, Bengaluru, with Anabond Ltd., Salvo Industries Pvt. Ltd., Micropack Pvt. Ltd., and Astra Microwave Products Ltd. These TTAs reflect India's efforts to boost private participation in space technology, expanding the scope for commercial applications and the overall growth of the space industry.
- **Russian cosmonauts Oleg Kononenko and Nikolai Chub** have set a new record for the longest single mission aboard the **International Space Station (ISS)**, surpassing the previous record held by cosmonauts Sergei Prokopyev, Dmitry Petelin, and NASA astronaut Francisco Rubio, who spent 370 days onboard from September 2022 to September 2023. **Kononenko and Chub arrived at the ISS on September 15, 2023, via the Soyuz MS-24 spacecraft** and are scheduled to return to **Earth on the Soyuz MS-25 on September 23, 2024, totaling 374 days in space**.
- In a monumental step for **India's space program**, **Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla** of the Indian Air Force (IAF) will pilot the Axiom-4 (Ax-4) mission to the International Space Station (ISS) in 2025.
- As we commemorate **Google's 26th anniversary** in 2024, we reflect on the tech giant's remarkable journey from a simple search engine to a global powerhouse that has fundamentally reshaped our digital landscape. Founded in 1998, Google has become an integral part of our daily lives, offering a vast array of services that span information retrieval, communication, entertainment, and beyond.
- Earth is set to welcome a temporary **"mini-moon"** in the form of a small asteroid **named 2024 PT5**, which will orbit our planet from **September 29 to November 25, 2024**. Discovered by **NASA's Asteroid Terrestrial-Impact Last Alert System (Atlas)** on August 7, 2024, this asteroid measures approximately **33 feet wide** and originates from the **Arjuna asteroid belt**, a region filled with various space rocks. While it cannot be observed with the naked eye or typical telescopes, professional astronomers will be able to capture images of this tiny object moving rapidly across the night sky.
- **Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)**, a Navratna defense PSU, and Israel Aerospace Industries (IAI), Israel's leading aerospace and defense company, have established a **joint venture (JV)** named **BEL IAI AeroSystems Private Ltd.** The JV, headquartered in Delhi, aims to serve as the single point of contact for long-term product support of the Medium Range Surface-to-Air Missile (MRSAM) systems utilized by India's defense forces. This partnership underscores the long-standing collaboration between BEL and IAI on various strategic programs, enhancing India's defense capabilities while aligning with the government's vision of 'Atmanirbhar Bharat'.
- **NASA's SpaceX Crew-9 mission** successfully launched on Sept. 28, 2024, from Space Launch **Complex-40, Cape Canaveral**, at 1:17 p.m. EDT. The mission is part of NASA's continued efforts to support scientific research aboard the ISS. **Astronaut Nick Hague and cosmonaut Aleksandr Gorbunov** will spend five months aboard the space station, conducting crucial scientific experiments.
- Google for India 2024, marking the **tech giant's 10th event in the country**, underscored its commitment to driving India's digital transformation through AI-powered innovations. **Celebrating 20 years of Google's operations in India**, the event focused on addressing India's unique challenges by introducing AI solutions across healthcare, payments, language support, and sustainability.
- India's National Space Commission has officially approved the **Lunar Polar Exploration Mission (Lupex)**, marking the country's fifth lunar mission. This mission follows the successful landing of **Chandrayaan-3** in August 2023, which made India the fourth nation to land on the Moon. Lupex is a collaborative endeavor between India's **ISRO** and Japan's **JAXA**, aimed at exploring the Moon's resources, particularly water in its polar regions.
- The recent outbreak of **Marburg virus in Rwanda** has raised significant alarm, marking the first reported cases in the country. As of late September 2024, health officials confirmed **26 cases**, including **12 fatalities**, with over 80% of infections occurring among healthcare workers. The Marburg virus is one of the deadliest pathogens known, causing severe hemorrhagic fever with a case fatality rate ranging **from 24% to 88%**. Given Rwanda's limited healthcare resources, this outbreak poses a substantial threat to the country's already fragile health system.
- **ShakthiSAT Mission: Empowering 12,000 Girls in Space Technology** Aerospace startup Space Kidz India has launched the **ShakthiSAT** mission, aiming to **train 12,000 girls aged 14-18 from 108 countries** in space technology, targeting a satellite launch under ISRO's **Chandrayaan-4** mission in 2026. A prototype presentation will be made to Prime Minister Narendra Modi later this year or early next year.

- In a significant step towards positioning India as a **global leader in biotechnology and sustainable solutions**, **Dr. Jitendra Singh**, Union Minister of State for Science and Technology, inaugurated **India's first Demonstration Facility for Biopolymers at Jejuri** in Pune in October 2024.
- The **Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** has partnered with Meta to introduce an AI-powered assistant for the **Skill India Digital (SID)** Portal and establish **five Centres of Excellence (CoEs)** in Virtual Reality (VR) and Mixed Reality (MR) across India. The AI assistant, built on Meta's open-source Llama model, aims to streamline learning experiences and improve skill development outcomes for Indian youth. Sarvam AI, the technical partner, will pilot the chatbot over six months, offering 24/7 support via WhatsApp in English, Hindi, and Hinglish, enhancing accessibility for learners. Skill India Mission: Key Points
- Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan announced the establishment of three **Artificial Intelligence Centres of Excellence (AI-COEs)** focused on health, agriculture, and sustainable cities. These centres, located at **AIIMS Delhi, IIT Ropar, and IIT Kanpur**, will promote research, innovation, and economic development while addressing public welfare.
- **NASA's Europa Clipper spacecraft** has embarked on a monumental **journey to explore Europa, one of Jupiter's moons that is believed to harbor a vast subsurface ocean beneath its icy shell**. The mission, which launched on October 14, 2024, aboard a SpaceX Falcon Heavy rocket, marks the beginning of an exciting scientific quest to determine whether this distant ocean world could support life.
- The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras** has announced plans to launch its inaugural **international flagship centre** in Dubai, focusing on research, innovation, and entrepreneurship. Set to open in early 2025, this initiative aims to foster collaboration and knowledge exchange between India and the UAE.
- Union Culture and Tourism **Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat** and **Minister of State for Coal and Mines Satish Chandra Dubey** inaugurated the **first-ever coal gallery** at the **National Science Centre in New Delhi**. The exhibition, titled **"Black Diamond – Unveiling the Depths,"** highlights **coal's journey** from its formation to its essential role in modern energy production.
- A team of scientists has discovered a new species of snake in the Western Himalayas, naming it **Anguiculus dicaprio** in honor of Hollywood star Leonardo DiCaprio, recognizing his significant contributions to wildlife conservation.
- In a strategic move to bolster **artificial intelligence (AI)** in India, Meta has partnered with IndiaAI and the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** to drive open-source AI research and skill development. This collaboration includes establishing a Center for Generative AI at IIT Jodhpur and launching the **"AI for Skilling and Capacity Building"** initiative, aimed at empowering the youth and fostering a sustainable AI ecosystem.
- China successfully launched a new spacecraft carrying three astronauts, including the country's first female space engineer, on a six-month mission. This crew will work on fine-tuning operations at **China's low-orbit space station, marking a significant step in the country's advancing space exploration efforts.**

Science and Technology of November 2024

- ISRO announced the launch of its **analogue space mission in Leh, Ladakh**. This innovative mission aims to simulate life in an interplanetary habitat, addressing the challenges associated with establishing a base station beyond Earth. Through this initiative, ISRO seeks to gather insights and prepare for future space exploration endeavors.
- **ISRO is set to launch the European Union's Proba-3 Solar Observation Mission** in December from Sriharikota. The mission aims to study the Sun's faint corona and is India's third space collaboration with the EU, following Proba-1 and Proba-2.
- Japanese scientists have launched **the world's first wooden satellite, LignoSat**, developed by Kyoto University in collaboration with Sumitomo Forestry. The satellite, made from honoki wood, aims to test the viability of timber for future space structures, exploring its resilience in space's extreme conditions.
- Zimbabwe has launched its second satellite, **ZIMSAT-2**, from the **Vostochny Cosmodrome in Russia**, a major milestone in the country's growing space programme. This satellite, equipped with a high-resolution multispectral camera, will aid in agriculture, resource exploration, environmental monitoring, and disaster management.
- Scientists have discovered a **new fire-resilient species of Dicliptera, named Dicliptera polymorpha**, in the Northern Western Ghats of India. Found in the fire-prone grasslands of Talegaon-Dabhade, this species is notable for its ability to thrive in harsh conditions and its rare dual-blooming behavior.
- **IIT Madras is partnering with ISRO to establish a Centre of Excellence for research in 'Fluid and Thermal Sciences'**. With seed funding of Rs 1.84 Crore from ISRO, the center will focus on advancing research in these key areas crucial for space exploration.

- NASA and Microsoft have partnered to develop "Earth Copilot," an AI-powered chatbot designed to simplify access to NASA's vast geospatial data. By utilizing Microsoft's **Azure cloud** and advanced AI, Earth Copilot enables users to interact with complex **Earth Science data** through simple, **plain-language queries**. This makes it easier for a broader audience to retrieve and understand information on topics like **hurricane impacts** and **climate change monitoring**, which previously required specialized knowledge.
- On **November 18, 2024**, **SpaceX** successfully launched the **ISRO's GSAT-N2** communication satellite from **Canaveral Space Force Station** in Florida. The satellite is designed to enhance **broadband connectivity** and support India's **Smart Cities Mission**. This launch, carried aboard **SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket**, marks the first **commercial collaboration** between **ISRO** and **SpaceX**, highlighting India's increasing reliance on **international partnerships** to achieve its ambitious space and technological goals.
- India's **GSAT-20** heavy communication satellite, weighing **4,700 kg**, will be launched from **Cape Canaveral, USA** on **November 19, 2024**, by **Elon Musk's SpaceX**. Developed by the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)**, the satellite will provide crucial **communication services**, including internet connectivity to remote areas. This launch marks a significant milestone in **India's space endeavors**, as the satellite is too heavy for India's own launch vehicle, the **LVM-3 "Bahubali"**.
- **STRONG** is a new **computational language** developed by researchers at the **Indian Institute of Science (IISc)** for encoding the shape and structure of **nanopores**. It uses unique letters to represent atomic configurations at nanopore edges, simplifying their representation for **machine learning (ML)** models. **STRONG** enables **data reduction**, integrates with **ML** for accurate property predictions, and aids in **reverse engineering** nanopores with desired characteristics. The tool is a major advancement in **nanopore research** and **materials science**.
- An international team of astronomers, led by **Kathleen Charlton** from the **University of Cape Town**, discovered a new **giant radio galaxy (GRG)** using the **MeerKAT radio telescope** in the **Cosmological Evolution Survey (COSMOS)** field. The discovery, published on **November 11, 2024**, reveals **MGTC J100022.85+031520.4**, a galaxy with remarkable properties that offer insights into **galaxy evolution** and **radio source formation**. GRGs are rare, massive structures known for their immense size and powerful emissions.
- **TakeMe2Space (TM2Space)**, a **Hyderabad-based** space tech company, will launch **India's first AI laboratory in space**, **MOI-TD**, aboard **ISRO's PSLV C60 rocket** in December 2024. The mission will enable **real-time in-orbit data processing**, reducing **data transmission costs** and expanding space research access. Developed with support from **IN-SPACe Technical Centre**, the initiative aims to **democratize space technology** and accelerate **India's space innovation**.
- **ISRO** will launch the **ESA's Proba-3 mission** on **December 4, 2024**, using the **PSLV-XL rocket**. The mission will study the **Sun's corona** through **precision formation flying** with two satellites: the **Occulter Spacecraft** (200 kg) and the **Coronagraph Spacecraft** (340 kg). This mission, the first of its kind, aims to create an **artificial solar eclipse** to observe the Sun's outer atmosphere, showcasing a **technological breakthrough** and **international collaboration** in space exploration.
- **ISRO** has announced several **groundbreaking initiatives**, including the **Shukrayaan Venus Mission** set for launch in **2028** to explore **Venus's atmosphere and surface**. Other plans include advancements in **lunar**, **Mars missions**, the development of **India's space station**, and upgrades to **weather** and **communication systems**, reflecting India's growing ambitions in **space exploration** and interplanetary studies.
- Union Minister **Dr. Jitendra Singh** announced the selection of **eight startups** under the **National Quantum Mission (NQM)** and **National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NMICPS)**. These startups are driving innovations in **quantum technology**, focusing on areas like **secure communication**, **quantum computing**, **quantum sensing**, and **energy efficiency**. Notable startups include **QNu Labs**, **QPIAI India**, **Dimira Technologies**, and **Pristine Diamonds**, among others, contributing to advancements in **cryogenics**, **superconducting materials**, and **quantum applications**.

Science and Technology of December 2024

- **IIT Ropar's iHub – AWaDH** celebrated its **4th Foundation Day** with a **Farmer Engagement Session**, marking progress in transforming agriculture through **technology**. Launched under the **National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NM-ICPS)** with support from the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)**, **AWaDH** focuses on **agriculture**, **water**, and **IoT**. It has developed over **70 technologies** and nurtured **100+ agri-tech and water-tech startups** for sustainable solutions.
- Amazon has introduced **Nova Foundation Models (FMs)**, a breakthrough in **generative AI**, designed to process **text**, **images**, and **videos**. The **Amazon Nova** series aims to enhance **multimedia content creation**, **document analysis**, and **video understanding**, addressing challenges like **latency**, **cost-effectiveness**, and **customization**. This positions Amazon as a strong competitor in the AI space, alongside **OpenAI**, **Meta**, and **Adobe**.
- On **December 5, 2024**, **ISRO's PSLV-C59 rocket** successfully launched the **ESA's Proba-3 mission** to study the **Sun's corona**. The **twin-satellite mission** involves the **Occulter** and **Coronagraph** spacecraft, which will fly in **formation** to block the Sun's light and observe its outer atmosphere. The mission aims to demonstrate **precise formation flying** and advance understanding of **space weather**. The satellites were placed in a highly elliptical orbit with a perigee of 600 km and an apogee of 60,000 km.

- **Wisdom**, the world's **oldest wild bird** at **74 years old**, a **Laysan albatross**, has made history by laying her first egg in **four years**. First banded in **1956**, Wisdom's remarkable longevity and survival instincts make her an iconic figure in **wildlife conservation**, symbolizing **resilience** and the **delicate balance of nature**.
- Google DeepMind introduced **GenCast**, an AI model for **weather forecasting**, surpassing the **ECMWF ENS** in accuracy. **GenCast** can predict daily weather and track extreme events like **storms**, marking a significant advancement in weather prediction technology.
- India's **Aditya L1** and ESA's **Proba-3** missions will collaborate on solar research starting in 2025. **Aditya L1**, operational since January 2024, observes the Sun from the **Lagrange point (L1)**, while **Proba-3**, launched in December 2024, uses two satellites in formation to simulate a solar eclipse. Both missions employ **coronagraphs: VELC** on Aditya L1 and **ASPIICS** on Proba-3, to study the **Sun's corona**, offering unprecedented insights into its outer regions.
- In December 2024, **marine scientists** discovered a new species of **damselfish, Chromis abadhah**, in the **mesophotic zone** of the **Maldives**. This groundbreaking discovery, made by an **international team**, adds to the country's marine biodiversity and underscores the importance of **global scientific collaboration** in exploring **deep-sea coral reefs**.
- Google's **Willow** quantum chip marks a breakthrough in computing, reducing errors and achieving exponential speed. It performs a computation in **5 minutes** that would take current supercomputers **10 septillion years**. This innovation advances Google's decade-long effort toward a **scalable quantum computer**, capable of solving complex global challenges.
- **OpenAI** has launched its AI video generation model, **Sora**, for **paid subscribers**. Known as **Sora Turbo**, it enables users to create **20-second videos in 1080p resolution**. After a nine-month delay to enhance **privacy** and **safety** features, Sora is now available for **ChatGPT Plus** and **Pro users**, allowing AI-generated videos from **text prompts** and **storyboards**.
- India plans to establish the **Bharat Antariksha Station** by **2035** and land an **Indian astronaut on the Moon** by **2040**, as revealed by **Union Minister Jitendra Singh**. These ambitious goals aim to position India as a **global leader in space exploration**, emphasizing **self-reliance** in science and technology.
- On **December 12, 2024**, **ISRO** successfully conducted a **sea-level hot test** of its **CE20 cryogenic engine** at the **ISRO Propulsion Complex** in **Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu**. This critical test demonstrated the engine's restart systems and showcased innovations like the **Nozzle Protection System** to mitigate challenges. The **CE20** engine, with a thrust of **19 tonnes** (upgraded to **22 tonnes**), enhances **India's space exploration** capabilities, enabling heavier payload launches and contributing to missions like **Chandrayaan-3** and **Gaganyaan**. This positions India among the few countries with indigenous cryogenic engines.
- **China** has set a new global record in space exploration, with astronauts **Cai Xuzhe** and **Song Lingdong** completing a **9-hour spacewalk** aboard the **Tiangong space station**. This achievement surpassed the previous record of **8 hours 56 minutes** set by U.S. astronauts in 2001, marking a significant milestone in **China's space ambitions**.
- **ISRO** and the **European Space Agency (ESA)** have signed a landmark agreement to boost collaboration in **human space exploration**. The partnership will focus on **astronaut training, mission implementation, and joint research experiments**. Signed by **ISRO Chairman S. Somanath** and **ESA Director General Dr. Josef Aschbacher**, the agreement establishes a strong framework for cooperation, enhancing the relationship between the two space agencies.
- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** is launching the **Space Docking Experiment (SpaDeX)** mission in **December 2024** aboard **PSLV-C60**. The mission will demonstrate autonomous **space docking** with two spacecraft, **SDX01 (Chaser)** and **SDX02 (Target)**, in **low-Earth orbit**. Key objectives include **rendezvous, docking, undocking, power transfer, composite spacecraft control, and payload operations** post-undocking, advancing India's space capabilities for **lunar missions, the Bharatiya Antariksha Station (BAS), and satellite servicing**.
- The **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)**, **NITI Aayog**, and **UNDP**, in partnership with **Citi Foundation**, launched the 7th edition of the **Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge** for **2024-2025**. Introduced in India in 2019, the initiative has empowered over **2,600 youth-led social innovation teams**. This year, it focuses on **social entrepreneurship** to enhance opportunities and well-being for **Persons with Disabilities (PwDs)**, advancing **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.
- **Glass Child Syndrome** refers to the emotional challenges faced by siblings of children with **chronic illnesses or disabilities**. These siblings often feel **invisible** and suppress their own needs to avoid adding stress to their already overburdened parents. The syndrome can lead to **perfectionism, anxiety**, and strained adult relationships. **Cultural factors**, like traditional roles in **Asian families**, may worsen these feelings, making it harder for these children to express their emotional needs. The term was highlighted by **Alicia Maples** in a **2010 TEDx talk**.
- India's first **Undergraduate Minor Programme in Quantum Technologies**, launched by **AICTE** and **National Quantum Mission (NQM)**, will begin in the next academic session. Targeting engineering students in their third or fourth semester, the program focuses on subjects like **quantum mechanics, quantum computing, quantum cryptography, and quantum algorithms**. This initiative aims to develop a skilled workforce in **quantum technologies**, contributing to **cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, and high-performance computing** while advancing India's position in the global quantum arena.

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Books & Authors

January to December 2024

Books & Authors of January 2024

Name of Book	Author
<i>Ram Mandir Rashtra Mandir Ak Sajhi Virast</i>	Geeta Singh, Arif Khan
<i>Srirangam – The Resplendent Kingdom of Rangaraja</i>	Geeta Venkataramanan
<i>Four Stars of Destiny: An Autobiography</i>	General Manoj Mukund Naravane
<i>Sanskriti ke Ayaam</i>	Manorama Mishra
<i>Modi: Energising A Green Future</i>	R. K. Pachnanda, Bibek Debroy, Anirban Ganguly Published by Pentagon Press
<i>Gandhi: A Life in Three Campaigns</i>	M.J. Akbar and K. Natwar Singh
<i>An Uncommon Love: The Early Life of Sudha and Narayana Murthy</i>	Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni
<i>Conversations with Aurangzeb</i>	Charu Nivedita (Translated by Nandini Krishnan)
<i>Assam's Braveheart Lachit Barphukan</i>	Arup Kumar Dutta
<i>Political History of Assam (1947-1971) - Volume 1</i>	Rajen Saikia
<i>Ek Samandar, Mere Andar</i>	Sanjeev Joshi

Books & Authors of February 2024

Name of Book	Author
<i>Political History of Assam (1947-1971) - Volume 1</i>	Rajen Saikia
<i>Ek Samandar, Mere Andar</i>	Sanjeev Joshi
<i>9 Incredible Years of Haryana Government – Rise of a New and Vibrant Haryana</i>	Dr. Kuldip Chand Agnihotri
<i>Maha Swaapnikudu (A Great Visionary)</i>	P. Vikram
<i>Dabbling in Diplomacy: Authorised & Otherwise, Recollections of a Non-Career Diplomat</i>	Professor S.D. Muni
<i>Sculpted Stones: Mysteries of Mamallapuram</i>	Ashwin Prabhu
<i>Basic Structure and Republic</i>	Shri P. S. Sreedharan Pillai

Books & Authors of March 2024

Name of Book	Author
<i>The Gems of Indian Art</i>	Harish Khullar
<i>Sagar Parikrama</i>	-
<i>Phool Bahadur (English Translation)</i>	Abhay K
<i>From A Car Shed To The Corner Room & Beyond</i>	S. Raman
<i>Code Dependent: Living in the Shadow of AI</i>	Madhumita Murgia

Books & Authors of April 2024

Name of Book	Author
Knife	Salman Rushdie
The Idea of Democracy	Sam Pitroda
Law and Spirituality: Reconnecting the Bond	Professor Raman Mittal and Professor Seema Singh
Just a Mercenary?: Notes from My Life and Career	Duvvuri Subbarao
India — the Road to Renaissance: A Vision and an Agenda	Bhimeswara Challa
The Winner's Mindset	Shane Watson
Heavenly Islands of Goa	P.S. Sreedharan Pillai
India's Nuclear Titans	Soumya Awasthi and Shrabana Barua

Books & Authors of May 2024

Name of Book	Author
<i>The Winner's Mindset</i>	Shane Watson
<i>Kairos</i>	Jenny Erpenbeck (Author), Michael Hofmann (Translator)

Books & Authors of June 2024

Name of Book	Author
<i>Source Code: My Beginnings</i>	Bill Gates
<i>A Fly on the RBI Wall: An Insider's View of the Central Bank</i>	Alpana Killawala
<i>I Have the Streets: A Kutti Cricket Story</i>	Ravichandran Ashwin and Sidharth Monga
<i>Ed Finds a Home</i>	Alia Bhatt

Books & Authors of July 2024

Name of Book	Author
<i>Venkaiah Naidu: Life in Service</i>	Dr. I. V. Subba Rao
<i>Celebrating Bharat: The Mission and Message of Shri M Venkaiah Naidu as 13th Vice-President of India</i>	Shri Sanjay Kishore
<i>Mahaneta: Life and Journey of Shri M. Venkaiah Naidu</i>	Shri Sanjay Kishore
<i>Manoj Bajpayee: The Definitive Biography</i>	Piyush Pandey
<i>The Prisoner of Bhopal</i>	Tim Walker
<i>Power Within: The Leadership Legacy of Narendra Modi</i>	Dr. R Balasubramaniam
<i>(Title Missing - Story of Jamsetji Tata and Indian Brands)</i>	-
<i>Breaking Rocks and Barriers</i>	Sudipta Sengupta

Books & Authors of August 2024

Name of Book	Author
India@100: Envisioning Tomorrow's Economic Powerhouse	Prof. K V Subramanian
75 Great Revolutionaries of India	MP Bhim Singh
Modi's Governance Triumph: Reshaping India's Path to Prosperity	Tarun Chugh
The Scientist Entrepreneur: Empowering Millions of Women	Dr. Kalpana Sankar
(First comic book series dedicated to IAF heroes)	Indian Air Force (IAF)

Books & Authors of September 2024

Name of Book/Work	Author/Creator
From Oil to Lithium: Navigating the Future of Energy	Kuldeep Gupta
200 Not Out (Documentary on Mumbai Samachar)	(Event presided by Shri Amit Shah)
Sri Rama in Tamilagam – An Inseparable Bond	Dr. D. K. Hari and Dr. D.K. (Released by Hon. Governor Thiru. R.N. Ravi)
Khaki Mein Sthitapragya	Anil Raturi
Lara: The England Chronicles	Co-authored by Brian Lara and Phil Walker

Books & Authors of October 2024

Name of Book	Author
“Lara: The England Chronicles”	Brian Lara and Co- Authored- Phil Walker
War	Bob Woodward
Mountain Mammals of the World	M.K. Ranjitsinh
Thank You, Gandhi	Krishna Kumar
Mother Mary Comes to Me	Arundhati Roy
Mountain Mammals of the World	M.K. Ranjitsinh

Books & Authors of November 2024

Name of Book	Author
Friends – India’s Closest Strategic Partners	Prof. Sreeram Chaulia
Speaking with Nature: The Origins of Indian Environmentalism	Ramachandra Guha
Maa-Mother	Dr. Davendra Kumar Dhodawat
Why Bharat Matters	Dr. S. Jaishankar
Beyond the Higgs Boson: The W Boson and Dr. Ashutosh Kotwal’s Quest for the Unknown	Manik Kotwal (translated by Jerry Pinto)
My Beloved Life	Amitava Kumar

Books & Authors of December 2024

Name of Book	Author
Dalai Lama’s Secret to Happiness	Dr. Dinesh Shahra
BRING IT ON: The Incredible Story of My Life	Dr. Deepa Malik
The Unyielding Judge: The Life and Legacy of Justice A.N. Grover	Gauri Grover

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Miscellaneous Current Affairs

January to December 2024

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of January 2024

- In a remarkable archaeological discovery, an inscription dating back to the **10th century A.D.** has been found in the **Mahadeva temple at Cacoda in southern Goa**. The inscription, written in both Kannada and Sanskrit, sheds light on a historical episode during the Kadamba period, providing valuable insights into the region's past. Retired associate professor **T. Murugeshi**, specializing in ancient history and archaeology at **Mulki Sundar Ram Shetty College in Udupi district**, meticulously studied the inscription.
- Kyrgyzstan**, a country nestled in the heart of Central Asia, has **officially declared the snow leopard as its national symbol**, signifying a profound commitment to conservation and ecological balance. **President Sadyr Zhaparov**, through a signed decree, emphasized the snow leopard's role not only as a symbol of natural wealth and cultural prosperity but also as a vital indicator of the stability and health of the mountain ecosystems that cover a substantial portion of the global territory.
- In a remarkable achievement, **Delhi's per capita income** surged by over 14%, reaching Rs 4,44,768 in the current fiscal year. The latest **Statistical Handbook-2023**, released by the Economic and Statistics department of the Delhi government, highlights the capital's outstanding socio-economic progress.
- International Purple Fest – Goa 2024**, India's inaugural inclusive festival for persons with disabilities, kicked off today and is set to captivate audiences until January 13. The festival, organized by the Office of the State Commissioner of Persons with Disabilities, Government of Goa, and supported by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, showcases unity and diversity in a spectacular display.
- Kerala teenager **Suchetha Satish** achieved a remarkable feat by setting a **Guinness World Record** during her performance at the 'Concert for Climate' in **Dubai** on November 24, 2023. Singing in an astounding **140 languages**, she captivated the audience and earned widespread acclaim for her musical prowess.
- The **Ganga Sagar Mela** stands as a testament to the vibrant cultural and spiritual tapestry of India. Held annually in **Sagardwip, West Bengal**, this magnificent fair has earned the distinction of being the **second most popular mela** in the country, surpassed only by the revered **Kumbh Mela**. The festival draws a massive influx of devotees who converge to partake in rituals, seek spiritual purification, and celebrate with immense fervor.
- Delhi Lieutenant Governor **VK Saxena** inaugurated the much-anticipated '**Patang Utsav**' at **Baansera**, the city's first bamboo-theme park located at Sarai Kale Khan on the scenic banks of the Yamuna River. The two-day festival, organized by the Delhi Development Authority, **promises a visual feast as over 30 professional kitists from diverse states**, including Rajasthan, Sikkim, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Punjab, Lakshadweep, and Gujarat, showcase their artistic prowess in the sky.
- As the devoted city of Ayodhya eagerly counts down to the grand opening of the **Ram Temple on January 22**, a spectacular celebration is set to unfold. In a remarkable display, the **world's largest lamp, standing at an impressive 300 feet**, will illuminate the city at **5:00 p.m. on Friday, adding a dazzling touch to the festivities**.
- As the **Ram Mandir in Ayodhya** gears up for its **Pran Pratishtha (consecration) ceremony**, it has received two unique offerings: the **world's largest lock, weighing 400 kg, and a colossal 1,265 kg laddoo Prasad**.
- The vibrant **Mamani Ethnic Food Festival of Purig**, held annually at Heritage Village Styangkung Barsoo, stands as a triumphant celebration of culinary diversity, cultural heritage, and community unity. Organized by the **Himalayan Cultural Heritage Foundation** in collaboration with **Nyarpa Committee Styangkung**, this annual festival has become a cornerstone in preserving and reviving the rich traditions of the Ladakh region.
- Kachchhi Kharek**, the indigenous date variety from the arid region of **Kutch in Gujarat**, has recently been awarded the prestigious **Geographical Indication (GI) tag**. This accolade recognizes Kachchhi Kharek as the second fruit from Gujarat, after the **Gir Kesar mango**, to be distinguished with such an honour.
- The Doomsday Clock**, established by the **Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists**, is a metaphorical representation of the proximity of humanity to global catastrophes, primarily caused by man-made technologies and environmental challenges. Recently, this symbolic clock has drawn significant attention due to its alarming setting close to midnight.
- Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** is on the brink of etching her name in history books as she gears up to **present her sixth consecutive Budget** (Five consecutive annual Budgets and one interim Budget), an unparalleled feat in Indian parliamentary annals. Building upon her legacy of fiscal stewardship, Sitharaman's tenure resonates with the tenure of former Prime Minister Morarji Desai, who previously held the finance portfolio during 1959-1964.

- In a monumental stride towards sustainability, maritime titan **Maersk** unveils its latest marvel: **the Ane Maersk**, a revolutionary container vessel powered by green methanol derived from green hydrogen.
- On the **occasion of the 159th birth anniversary of Lala Lajpat Rai, January 28, 2024**, we commemorate the life and contributions of one of India's most revered freedom fighters, politicians, and authors. Fondly known as **Punjab Kesari**, **Lala Lajpat Rai** left an indelible mark on India's struggle for independence and its socio-political landscape.
- On **January 28**, we celebrate the **birth anniversary of Field Marshal Kodandera M. Cariappa**, the **inaugural Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Army**. Recognized as a national hero, Cariappa's pivotal role in shaping the Indian military from colonial to independent India remains revered.
- **India** has nominated the **'Maratha Military Landscapes'** for inclusion in the **UNESCO World Heritage List for the 2024-25 cycle**. This significant move by the Culture Ministry highlights the exceptional fortification and military systems envisioned by the Maratha rulers.
- A remarkable feat unfolded as two-year-old **Carter Dallas** from **Scotland** etched his name into the annals of mountaineering history by becoming the **youngest person to reach the Mount Everest base camp**. Accompanied by his parents, Ross and Jade, Carter embarked on an extraordinary journey that captured the world's attention.

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of February 2024

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- In a groundbreaking move towards inclusivity and equality, **Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal** announced a significant government initiative **declaring free bus travel for the transgender community within the national capital**. Emphasizing the long-standing neglect faced by marginalized groups, Kejriwal underscored the importance of extending equal rights and privileges to all members of society, regardless of gender identity.
- The **New Delhi Book Fair**, organized by the **National Book Trust** in collaboration with the **India Trade Promotion Organization (ITPO)**, is set to enchant visitors at Pragati Maidan from February 10 to 18, 2024. This year's theme, **"Multilingual India: A Living Tradition,"** promises a celebration of linguistic diversity and cultural exchange.
- **Sindhu Ganapathy's** appointment as the **first transwoman Travelling Ticket Examiner (TTE) of Southern Railway** marks a significant milestone in the journey towards inclusivity and acceptance in the Indian workforce. At the age of 37, Ms. Ganapathy has not only broken barriers but also set a precedent for the transgender community's representation in prestigious government positions.
- In a momentous commemoration of the **200th birth anniversary of Swami Dayananda Saraswati**, **Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi** delivered a profound address via video message at the birthplace of the revered **Swami, Tankara in Morbi, Gujarat**. The event, organized by the Arya Samaj, stands as a testament to Swami Ji's enduring contributions to Indian spirituality and societal reform.
- **Nepal** is a tapestry of cultures and traditions, each contributing to the rich mosaic of its heritage. Among these, the **Tamang community** holds a significant place, celebrating their identity and history through the vibrant festival of **Sonam Losar**. Sonam Losar, the New Year according to the Tamang calendar, is not just a festivity but a profound expression of the community's culture, spirituality, and ancestral bonds.
- In a development announced by India's Transport Minister Nitin Gadkari, the nation is set to embark on testing (Global navigation satellite system) **GNSS-based toll collection** on the **Mysuru-Bengaluru Expressway**. This move underscores the government's commitment to leveraging technologies to modernize infrastructure and improve transportation systems.
- The **Sominsai festival**, an ancient tradition deeply rooted in Japanese culture, has recently concluded its final celebration after a millennium-long legacy. Commencing on the seventh day of the Lunar New Year and spanning through the night, it was a spectacle of tradition and spirituality.
- **U Tirot Sing Syiem**, a revered freedom fighter from the Khasi community, was commemorated for his indomitable spirit and sacrifice as the **Meghalaya government** unveiled his life-size bust at the **Indira Gandhi Cultural Centre (IGCC) in Dhaka, Bangladesh**.

- The annual “**Aadi Mahotsav – National Tribal Festival**,” inaugurated by Hon’ble President, Smt. Droupadi Murmu, concluded on 18th February 2024. Held at the Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium, New Delhi, from February 10 to February 18, the 9-day festival organized by **TRIFED (Tribal Co-operative Marketing Federation of India)** showcased a vibrant tapestry of Tribal Entrepreneurship, Crafts, Culture, Cuisine, and Commerce.
- The **Northern Railway Firozpur division** is set to revolutionize connectivity in the region with the introduction of a new **Mainline Electric Multiple Unit (MEMU)** and **Diesel Multiple Unit (DMU)** train service between Baramulla and Sangaldan stations, Jammu and Kashmir. This initiative marks a significant milestone in the ongoing **Udhampur-Srinagar-Baramulla Rail Link (USBRL) project**, enhancing transportation infrastructure and facilitating easier access for commuters.
- **The vibrant city of Chandigarh** became a melting pot of cultural heritage and artistic innovation as it hosted the **11th International Puppet Festival at Tagore Theatre**. The event, inaugurated by Punjab Governor and Administrator of Union Territory Chandigarh, **Banwarilal Purohit**, alongside Adviser to the Administrator Rajeev Verma and other dignitaries, marked a significant celebration of puppetry’s rich legacy and its enduring appeal across ages.
- **CITCO (Chandigarh Industrial and Tourism Development Corporation)** introduces a **pizza maker** near Sukhna Lake, producing hot pizzas in three minutes, a first in North India. The pizza vending machine is the only one operational in India, marking a significant breakthrough.
- The **International Gita Mahotsav (IGM)**, a celebration deeply rooted in the spiritual and cultural heritage of India, is set to embark on a new journey as it finds its foreign soil in **Sri Lanka**. Scheduled from March 1 to 3, the **fifth edition** of the IGM promises to be a grand affair, bringing together devotees and enthusiasts from around the world.
- **The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports** has officially unveiled the logo for the highly anticipated **7th North East Youth Festival 2024**. The emblem beautifully encapsulates the vibrant essence of the eight northeastern states, marking a tribute to the rich cultural tapestry of the region. Moreover, the festival has chosen the Phayre’s leaf monkey as its mascot, further symbolizing the unique biodiversity and heritage of the North East.
- The **Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI)** has commissioned **India’s largest solar-battery energy storage system (BESS)** in **Rajnandgaon, Chhattisgarh**.
- Researchers in **Ecuador’s rainforest** have uncovered a new species of anaconda, **Eunectes Akiyama**, which split from its closest relatives 10 million years ago. Despite their genetic distinction, these anacondas are visually identical to the previously known species, **Eunectes murinus**.
- **The Geological Survey of India (GSI)** commemorated its **174th Foundation Day on March 4th, 2024**, with zeal and enthusiasm resonating across all its offices nationwide. The event was a grand affair, with celebrations held in Kolkata, the Central Headquarters of GSI, and the Southern Region’s headquarters in Hyderabad.
- In a significant nod to India’s rich heritage of craftsmanship and artistry, the **Cuttack Rupa Tarakasi**, more widely known as **Silver Filigree**, has recently been awarded the **Geographical Indication (GI)** tag by the Geographical Indications Registry in Chennai. This recognition, sought by the Odisha State Co-operative Handicrafts Corporation Limited and supported by the Department of Textile and Handicrafts, Government of Odisha, places Cuttack’s Silver Filigree on the map as a unique and protected form of art.
- President Droupadi Murmu **nominated** author and philanthropist **Sudha Murty** to the **Rajya Sabha**. Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced this and congratulated Sudha Murty, saying her contribution to diverse fields has been “immense and inspiring”.
- Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) Science & Technology, Dr Jitendra Singh, announced the establishment of **North India’s first Government Homeopathic College** in the Jasrota area of Kathua district, J&K. The project, funded centrally at Rs 80 crore, reflects a significant stride in healthcare and education infrastructure development in the region.
- **Majuli**, the largest river island in the world, has received **two prestigious Geographical Indication (GI) tags** from the Indian government for its traditional crafts – **Majuli mask making and Majuli manuscript painting**.
- Sea6 Energy, a **pioneer in the Blue Economy**, has launched the world’s first large-scale **mechanized tropical seaweed farm** off the coast of Lombok, Indonesia. The **one-square-kilometer seaweed farm** is a significant milestone in establishing the scalability of **sustainable tropical seaweed cultivation** for various industrial applications.
- Excavation sites worldwide yield artifacts and fossils crucial for understanding history. In **Nuremberg, Germany**, construction laborers stumbled upon an astonishing find while building a house: a vast number of human skeletons, indicating the presence of what may be **Europe’s largest cemetery**. Nearly a thousand skeletons have been unearthed so far, with estimates suggesting the total could surpass **1500**.
- The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (**FSSAI**) has certified nearly **100 jails** across the nation as ‘**Eat Right Campus**,’ a part of its broader Eat Right India movement. This initiative aims to ensure safe, healthy, and sustainable food practices within various institutional settings, including correctional facilities.

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of March 2024

- A groundbreaking archaeological discovery has been made in Chettimedu Pathur village, approximately 77 kilometres from **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**. Researchers from the Department of Ancient History and Archaeology at the **University of Madras** have unearthed a child burial site dating back to the Neolithic period, around 2500 BCE to 3000 BCE, offering new insights into ancient burial rites and cultural practices in the region.

- The beautiful **Dal Lake in Kashmir** witnessed an exciting event on March 18. **Formula-4 car racing** was held for the first time in the region. The sleek racing cars raced along the Boulevard road near the lake, creating a thrilling atmosphere. The Zabbarwan Hills provided a stunning backdrop for the event.
- In a groundbreaking medical achievement, surgeons from **Massachusetts General Hospital in Boston** have performed the first **pig-to-human kidney transplant**. A **62-year-old man** with **end-stage renal disease** received a new kidney from a **genetically modified pig**.
- The **Chipko Movement** originated in the **Uttarakhand** region of the Himalayas in early 1973. The name "Chipko" means "to hug" in Hindi, referring to the practice of **embracing trees** to protect them from being cut down. The Chipko movement, which began in Uttarakhand, a state in the Himalayas, in early 1973, marks its 50th anniversary.
- A **900-year-old Kannada inscription** dating back to the **Kalyana Chalukya dynasty** has been discovered in a state of utter neglect at **Gangapuram**, a temple town in **Jadcherla mandal, Mahabubnagar district**. The rare inscription was found lying uncared for on a tank bund near the **Chowdamma temple**.
- The world's first-ever temple designed in the iconic **Om shape** has been inaugurated in the village of Jadan, **Pali district of Rajasthan**. This architectural masterpiece, spanning across **250 acres**, is not only expected to attract tourists but will also boast an impressive visual presence visible from space.
- **Allu Arjun**, the popular **Telugu actor**, has achieved a new milestone in his career. He has been honoured with a **wax statue** at the renowned **Madame Tussauds Museum** in **Dubai**.

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of April 2024

- Three traditional products from Tripura have recently received the prestigious Geographical Indication (GI) tag. The products are **Matabari pera prasad, Rignai pachara textiles and Risa**. With this, Tripura now has 4 GI Protected products.
- Perched atop the picturesque **Palani Hills in Tamil Nadu**, the iconic **Kodaikanal Solar Observatory (KSO)** recently commemorated a remarkable milestone – its **125th anniversary** of studying the celestial body that sustains life on Earth, the Sun.
- In a significant milestone for agricultural recognition, the **indigenous wheat variety** from the Bundelkhand region in Uttar Pradesh, locally known as **Kathiya Gehu**, has been granted the prestigious **Geographical Indication (GI) tag**. This is the **first farm produce** from Uttar Pradesh to receive this honor.
- The **Manohar International Airport in Mopa, Goa**, has become the **14th airport in India to launch the Digi Yatra system**. This biometric-enabled system uses facial recognition technology to automate the entry and verification of passengers at various airport checkpoints, making the travel experience more seamless and convenient. The Digi Yatra system is already operational in 13 other Indian airports, including Delhi, Bengaluru, Varanasi, Hyderabad, Kolkata, and Mumbai, among others.
- In a collaborative project involving researchers from Kerala University and various other institutions, a significant archaeological excavation has revealed a **5,200-year-old Harappan settlement at Padta Bet, near Khatiya village in Kachchh district, Gujarat**. Led by **assistant professors Abhayan G.S. and Rajesh S.V. from Kerala University's Department of Archaeology**, the expedition uncovered crucial evidence shedding light on the cultural formation of Early Harappan settlements in the region.
- In a strategic partnership aimed at enhancing banking convenience, J&K Bank has teamed up with Paymart India Pvt Ltd to launch a **Virtual ATM (VATM) facility**. This innovative service enables cardless cash withdrawals for customers through local retailers, particularly benefiting areas like **Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh where accessibility to traditional ATMs may be limited**.
- **Guinness World Records (GWR)** has shared a video of the world's oldest living man, 111-year-old **John Alfred Tinniswood, from England**. In the video, Tinniswood reveals what he believes is the secret to his exceptional longevity and also offers a piece of advice for others.
- The '**Yoga Mahotsav**' was held in **Pune, Maharashtra**, to mark the 75-day countdown to the **International Day of Yoga**. Organized by the **Morarji Desai National Institute of Yoga and the National Institute of Naturopathy, Ministry of Ayush**, the event witnessed the overwhelming participation of thousands of people. The participants engaged in the practice of the Common Yoga Protocol (CYP) starting at 6.00 AM on April 7th, showcasing the growing popularity of Yoga.
- **Gangaur** is an important festival celebrated throughout Rajasthan, commemorating the union of **Lord Shiva (Gan) and Goddess Parvati (Gauri)**. The term "**Gan**" refers to Lord Shiva, while "**Gauri**" or "**Gaur**" represents Goddess Parvati, Shiva's heavenly consort. Gangaur symbolizes the happiness and auspiciousness of marriage, making it a significant celebration for the people of Rajasthan.
- The **Sangeet Natak Akademi (SNA)** is organizing the festival '**Shakti – A Festival of Music and Dance**' from **April 9 to 17, 2024**. The festival is celebrated in seven different Shaktipeeths (sacred sites) across the country. The event is being organized under the Kala Pravah series to revive the temple traditions in the country during the auspicious Navratri period.
- **Comet Pons-Brooks**, currently orbiting near Jupiter, is captivating astronomers and stargazers alike as it approaches its closest point to the Sun on April 21, 2024. Its increasing brightness and elongating tail make it a spectacle in the night sky, visible even to the naked eye.

- In a significant ruling, the **Jammu and Kashmir High Court has quashed the detention of Jaffar Ahmad Parray under the Public Safety Act.** Justice Rahul Bharti emphasized that India operates under the rule of law, asserting that citizens cannot be detained without proper legal grounds. Parray had been held since May based on allegations of being associated with terrorist groups, but the court found the detention illegal and ordered his immediate release.
- In a significant development, two iconic products from the historic city of **Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh**, have been granted the coveted **Geographical Indication (GI)** status. On April 16, 2024, the GI Registry Office based in Chennai announced that the **Tiranga Barfi** of Varanasi and the **Dhalua Murti Metal Casting Craft** have been included in the prestigious GI category.
- In a groundbreaking event that blurs the lines between reality and artificial intelligence, the world is set to witness the first-ever beauty pageant exclusively for **AI-generated models and influencers.** Dubbed “Miss AI,” this unique contest will pit these virtual creations against each other, judging them on their online presence, aesthetics, and the technical prowess behind their creation.
- **Archaeologists in Telangana have unearthed three remarkable sites**, each offering distinct insights into the region’s ancient history. Among these discoveries are over 200 megalithic monuments nestled within dense forests, an exceptional Iron Age megalithic site displaying unique architectural styles, and two rock art sites revealing ancient artistic expressions. These findings not only illuminate Telangana’s past but also emphasize the necessity for continued exploration and preservation endeavors.
- The **Lakshmana Tirtha River, renowned for its scenic beauty in the Kodagu District of Karnataka, has succumbed to severe drought and intense heat.** Originating from the forests in Kutta, it extends about 180 km before merging into the Cauvery River. However, this year, the river has dried up entirely, exacerbating the water crisis in the region.
- On a momentous occasion, members of the **Shompen tribe**, one of India’s Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs), exercised their democratic right for the **first time** by casting votes in the Andaman and Nicobar Lok Sabha constituency elections. This significant event marks a milestone for the indigenous community residing in the dense tropical rainforests of the **Great Nicobar island.**

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of May 2024

- Bajaj Auto, led by **Managing Director Rajiv Bajaj**, is all set to introduce a groundbreaking innovation in the world of motorcycles. Amidst soaring petrol prices, the company is gearing up to launch the **world’s first CNG-powered motorcycle on June 18, 2024.** This move aims to provide

consumers with a cost-effective alternative for daily commuting, promising lower running costs compared to traditional petrol-powered bikes.

- **Rabindranath Tagore Jayanti 2024**, also known as **Rabindra Jayanti**, falls on **May 8th** to commemorate the **birth anniversary of Rabindranath Tagore.** Born on May 7, 1861, in Kolkata to Debendranath Tagore and Sarada Devi, Tagore’s influence extends far beyond his birthplace, resonating across literature, music, and art worldwide.
- **Maharana Pratap was born on May 9, 1540**, according to the Julian calendar, the transition to the Gregorian calendar shifted his birthdate to May 19, 1540. However, the modern celebration aligns with the Hindu calendar.
- The **National Archives of India (NAI)** has acquired a **priceless collection** of private papers and original correspondences belonging to the late **Shri Rafi Ahmad Kidwai**, a prominent figure in India’s freedom struggle and nation-building efforts. This acquisition ensures the preservation of a significant part of our nation’s history and the legacy of a remarkable leader.
- Renowned **Nepali mountaineer Kami Rita Sherpa** has achieved a historic feat by conquering Mount Everest for the 29th time. At 54 years old, Kami reached the 8,849-meter summit at 7:25 am local time on Sunday, leading a group of climbers organized by Seven Summit Treks.
- Thiruvananthapuram International Airport has made history as the first airport in India to achieve the prestigious recognition of **zero waste to landfill (ZWL).** This commendation comes from the **Confederation of Indian Industry (CII-ITC)** Centre of Excellence for Sustainable Development, confirming the airport’s commitment to environmentally responsible practices.
- A low-pressure system over the Bay of Bengal is set to intensify into **Cyclone Remal**, reaching **Bangladesh and adjoining West Bengal** coasts as a severe cyclonic storm. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) forecasts the cyclone’s progression, predicting it to become a severe cyclonic storm by **May 25 morning** and **make landfall** between **Sagar island in West Bengal and Khepupara in Bangladesh by May 26 evening.**
- **Jyoti Ratre**, an entrepreneur and fitness enthusiast from Madhya Pradesh, has etched her name in history by becoming the **oldest Indian woman to conquer Mount Everest.** Ratre’s triumphant ascent to the summit of the world’s highest peak comes precisely six years after **Sangeeta Bahl**, at the age of 53, earned the title of ‘India’s oldest woman to climb Mount Everest’ on May 19, 2018.
- In a remarkable feat, Indian mountaineer **Satyadeep Gupta** has etched his name in history by becoming the **first person to scale Mt. Everest and Mt. Lhotse** twice in a single season. Additionally, he is the **first Indian** to traverse the two peaks in an astonishing **11 hours and 15 minutes.**

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of June 2024

- **Congress nominee** and Minister Satish Jarkiholi's daughter **Priyanka Jarkiholi** has won from Chikkodi, defeating incumbent MP and BJP leader **Annasaheb Jolle**. Priyanka Jarkiholi **from Chikkodi** became the youngest tribal woman to enter Parliament from an **unreserved seat in Karnataka** since Independence. In fact, the BJP has won all the seats in Mumbai Karnataka, except Chikkodi.
- **Oxford University's Ashmolean Museum** has decided to return a **16th-century bronze sculpture of Saint Tirumankai Alvar to India**, following a formal request from the Indian government. The 60cm-tall statue, believed to have been stolen from a temple in Tamil Nadu, was acquired by the museum in 1967 from Sotheby's auction house. The decision comes after an independent researcher alerted the museum to the statue's origins, prompting the museum to notify the Indian High Commission.
- The **Indian Railways** completed a successful trial of an **electric engine from Sangaldan to Reasi**, crossing the **world's highest steel arch rail bridge, the Chenab Bridge**.
- Aiming to enable passengers to drop in their luggage, collect tags and print boarding passes to complete check-in in less time, the **Delhi International Airport Ltd** launched a **self-service mechanism** on 17 June.
- According to the Union Ministry of Education, the Union Territory of Ladakh has achieved full functional literacy under the **ULLAS-Nav Bharat Saaksharta Karyakram**. Ladakh now boasts over **97 percent literacy**. **Lieutenant Governor Dr. B.D Mishra** shared this milestone on June 25, 2024, at a function in **Sindhu Sanskritik Kendra (SSK)**, Leh.

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of July 2024

- **Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU)** has announced the launch of a new **MA programme in Bhagavad Gita Studies** for the academic session **2024-2025**. The course will begin in July 2024 and will be offered through **open and distance learning (ODL)**.
- **Union Minister Nitin Gadkari** launched **Bajaj Auto's new bike, Freedom, the world's first CNG motorcycle**. He praised it as **"eco-friendly"** and **"sustainable,"** highlighting the significant issues of air, sound, and water pollution, and the high cost of fossil fuel imports in India.
- The ambitious project to build the **"world's largest Ramayan temple"** has entered its second phase of construction in **East Champaran district** of Bihar. The **Viraat Ramayan Mandir**, as it is known, promises to be a monumental structure that will surpass the size of the recently constructed Ram Mandir in Ayodhya, drawing inspiration from various architectural marvels across Asia.

- International mountaineer **Nitish Singh** left for **Mount Kinabalu**, the highest peak in Malaysia, when the rain subsided. He conquered it at 5:30 am on July 9 and hoisted the **tricolor** there. International mountaineer Nitish Singh, a resident of Gorakhpur, UP, has created a new record by hoisting the tricolor on **Kinabalu**, the highest peak of **Malaysia**.
- **Manvi Madhu Kashyap** and two other transgender individuals have made history by becoming the **first transwoman sub-inspectors in Bihar Police**. Despite facing rejection and discrimination from coaching centers, Kashyap persevered and cleared the Bihar Police Subordinate Selection Commission (BPSSC) exams.
- **Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA)** has launched the trial operation of the **world's first electric abra manufactured using 3D printing technology**, in collaboration with the private sector. The abra, which can carry 20 passengers, was designed, and built to retain the traditional abra identity.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated **India's longest and largest urban tunnel** project, the **Thane Borivali Twin Tunnel**, developed by the **Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority (MMRDA)**. This Rs. 16,600 crore project will reduce travel time between Thane and Borivali from over an hour to just 12 minutes, cutting the travel distance by 12 km. This initiative is part of broader infrastructure projects worth **Rs. 29,000 crore** aimed at enhancing connectivity in Mumbai.
- **Ratings agency ICRA** has upgraded the rating of **Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ)** to **AAA/Stable** from **AA+/Stable**. The company's long-term fund based/non-fund based facilities, non-convertible debentures (NCDs) and commercial papers have been upgraded to **AAA/Stable**. APSEZ announced the development after market hours and the Adani Ports shares on July 18 ended at Rs 1,491.95 on the NSE, down by **Rs 7.10 or 0.47%**.
- **Dr Neeraj Mittal**, Secretary (Telecom) has inaugurated a **centre of excellence** on **"Classical and Quantum Communications for 6G"** at **IITM Research Park, Chennai**. This is a **sub-centre of Telecom Centres of Excellence (TCoE)-India** and it will spearhead the development and deployment of 6G technology, promising unprecedented speeds, ultra-low latency, and enhanced connectivity. Shri Sanjeev Kumar Bidwai, Sp DGT, **Tamil Nadu** was among those present at the occasion.
- The **Ahom dynasty's Moidams in Assam** have been officially inscribed on the **UNESCO World Heritage List** as **India's 43rd entry**. Announced on July 26, 2024, during the **46th session** of the World Heritage Committee in New Delhi, this makes the Moidams the first cultural property from Northeast India to receive this honor. The nomination was submitted on July 4, 2024, and underscores the global recognition of Assam's unique cultural heritage.

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of September 2024

- **Siddhartha Aggarwal from Bengaluru** has made history by becoming the oldest Indian to **swim solo across the English Channel**. On August 29, at the age of 49, Aggarwal completed the 42 km swim in 15 hours and six minutes. His remarkable achievement surpasses the previous record set by **Srikanth Viswanathan, who swam the Channel solo at age 46 in 2018**.
- In a significant policy shift, the Indian government has removed the **\$950 per tonne minimum export price (MEP)** on basmati rice. This decision, made in response to falling domestic paddy prices and trade pressures, aims to enhance export opportunities and support farmers' incomes. The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) will now oversee basmati rice exports without a floor price to ensure fair pricing and transparency.
- Union Minister for MSME, **Shri Jitan Ram Manjhi**, inaugurated the **Centre for Rural Enterprise Acceleration through Technology (CREATE)** at **Leh** via virtual mode. The event was attended by various dignitaries including the Minister of State for MSME, the Lieutenant Governor of UT-Ladakh, the Chairman of KVIC, and other officials from the Ministry of MSME, UT-Ladakh, KVIC, and MGRI, along with around 200 local artisans.
- In an effort to encourage voter participation in the upcoming Jammu and Kashmir Assembly Elections, the **Office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO)**, J&K, launched the **theme song 'Vote Ka Tyohar'**.
- 43 year old, **Atishi Marlena from Aam Aadmi Party (AAP)** will be the **new Chief Minister of state Delhi**. She will replace the AAP supremo and party chief Arvind Kejriwal. Decision was taken in the meeting of member of legislative assembly.
- The **19th edition of the Divya Kala Mela** was inaugurated in **Visakhapatnam** by the **Hon. Governor of Andhra Pradesh, Shri S. Abdul Nazeer**, alongside dignitaries like **Dr. Virendra Kumar**, Union Minister for Social Justice and Empowerment, and other MPs. The event provided concessional loans of ₹40 lakh to 10 Divyang beneficiaries under NDFDC schemes and distributed assistive devices with the support of CSR partners such as HPCL, GAIL India, and IOCL.
- **Megastar Chiranjeevi** has been officially recognized by **Guinness World Records** as the **most prolific actor/dancer** in the Indian film industry. Over 45 years, he has performed an astonishing **24,000 dance moves in 537 songs across 156 films**. This honor was conferred on September 20, 2024, during a special event where Chiranjeevi expressed gratitude for the recognition, attributing his success to the art of dance and the collaboration with directors, producers, and choreographers.
- The **Film Federation of India** has officially announced that filmmaker **Kiran Rao's "Laapataa Ladies"** has been chosen as **India's official entry** in the **Best Foreign Film Category** for the **Oscars 2025**. This selection marks a significant milestone for the film and its creators, putting it on the global stage of cinema.
- The **Pradhan Mantri Janatiya Unnat Gram Abhiyan**, a groundbreaking initiative by the Central Government of India, has chosen **Mana village** in the Joshimath block of Chamoli district for implementation. This selection marks a significant step towards improving the socio-economic conditions of tribal communities in the region.
- During Prime Minister **Narendra Modi's** recent visit to the United States, a landmark event took place that marked a significant victory in India's ongoing efforts to reclaim its cultural treasures. In a ceremony of great cultural and diplomatic importance, **297 antiquities** were officially handed over to **India by U.S. authorities**.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** has **gifted US President Joe Biden a silver train model** made by master artisans from Maharashtra and **First Lady Jill Biden a Pashmina shawl** in a papier mache box.
- **Wabtec Locomotive Private Limited**, a joint venture between **Indian Railways and Wabtec**, is set to enhance its **Marhowra plant's** capabilities by exporting Evolution Series ES43ACmi locomotives to global customers, particularly in Africa, starting in 2025. This initiative marks the plant's inaugural venture into manufacturing locomotives for export, underscoring India's growing prominence in the global locomotive manufacturing sector.
- An extraordinary mountaineering achievement, of a team from the **National Institute of Mountaineering and Adventure Sports (NIMAS)**, has successfully scaled an unnamed and unclimbed 6383 MSL or 20,942 ft high peak in **Gorichen range of Arunachal Pradesh Himalayas on Tawang-West Kameng region**.
- **Delhi Chief Minister Atishi** has announced a significant increase in the minimum wages for workers in the capital, effective October 1. Unskilled workers will now **earn ₹18,066, semi-skilled workers ₹19,929, and skilled workers ₹21,917 per month**. Atishi emphasized that under **Arvind Kejriwal's leadership**, Delhi boasts the highest minimum wages in the country, a historic step aimed at preventing the exploitation of the poor.
- Union Minister for Road, Transport and Highways **Shri. Nitin Gadkari Ji**, set to inaugurate **Oxygen Bird Park** (Amrit Mahotsav Park) on the Nagpur-Hyderabad National highway 44 in Nagpur, in state of Maharashtra.
- Delhi Lieutenant Governor (LG) **Shri. L. G. Saxena** launched the **Dust Free Drive** across the cities to combat the Air Pollution. This step looks to be important ahead of the tough and harsh air pollution in the winter in the Capital of Country.

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of October 2024

- **The Military Nursing Service (MNS)** marked its **99th Raising Day** on Oct 1, 2024 with solemnity and pride. Maj Gen Ignatius Delos Flora, Additional Director General of Military Nursing Services laid a wreath at the National War Memorial, in the presence of senior MNS officers and veterans.
- As Hurricane Milton threatens the Florida coast, residents of the **Tampa Bay region** are evacuating in droves, fearing a potentially catastrophic storm. Hurricane Milton regained strength on Tuesday afternoon, becoming a Category 5 storm with winds reaching 165 mph (265 kph). Predictions indicate the storm could make landfall in the densely populated Tampa Bay area, which has over 3.3 million residents. The National Hurricane Center has warned of heavy rainfall and storm surges, with some areas expected to receive up to 18 inches of rain.
- An 18-year-old Nepali mountaineer, **Nima Rinji Sherpa**, made history on Wednesday by becoming the youngest person to summit all **14 of the world's 8,000-meter** (26,246-foot) peaks. His remarkable achievement was sealed after successfully reaching the summit of Tibet's 26,335-foot Shisha Pangma.
- In a tribute to the legacy of **Ratan Naval Tata**, the **Bihar Postal Circle** has released a special cover commemorating his contributions to industry, philanthropy, and national development. This gesture serves not only as a tribute but also as a reminder of his enduring values and leadership.
- On October 4, 2024, Dr. Ajit Kumar Mohanty inaugurated the Major Atmospheric Cherenkov Experiment (MACE) Observatory in Hanle, Ladakh. MACE is the **largest imaging Cherenkov telescope** in Asia and the **highest in the world** at about **4,300 meters** altitude. Developed by the **Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC)** with support from **Electronics Corporation of India Limited (ECIL)** and other partners, this facility marks a significant milestone in India's **astrophysical research**. Its inauguration aligns with the **Platinum Jubilee** of the **Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)**, highlighting a strong commitment to scientific advancement.
- **The Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)**, the world's largest voluntary organization, is entering its 100th year on the auspicious occasion of Vijayadashami. Founded on this very day in 1925, also known as Dussehra, the RSS has grown exponentially over the past nine decades, expanding its reach across India and abroad.
- Arjun Vajpai Becomes First Indian to Conquer Mt. Shishapangma. **Arjun Vajpai**, the **youngest person** to climb Mt. Everest, has once again made India proud by accomplishing another historic feat. On October 9, 2024, Arjun Vajpai stood atop Mt. **Shishapangma**, completing his 8th successful summit of a peak over 8,000 meters.
- On the auspicious occasion of Dussehra, former **cricketer Ajay Jadeja** has been officially declared the heir to the throne of Jamnagar by his uncle, the Maharaja Shatrughn Singh Jadeja. At the age of 53, Ajay Jadeja is set to take on the title of the new Jamsaheb, the titular head of the historic princely state of Jamnagar, marking a significant moment in both his life and the legacy of the Jadeja family.
- **External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar** inaugurated the revamped **eMigrate V2.0 web portal** and **mobile app in Delhi**, aiming to enhance safe and legal migration for Indian citizens. This initiative underscores the Indian government's commitment to protecting the rights and dignity of workers abroad while facilitating their mobility and welfare.
- **State-owned Bharat Earth Movers Limited (BEML)** has been awarded a contract worth **₹866.87 crore by Integral Coach Factory (ICF)** to design, manufacture, and commission **India's first indigenously built bullet trains**. This project marks a significant milestone in India's high-speed rail journey, as it will feature two high-speed trainsets, each comprising eight cars, with a **test speed of 280 km/h** and an **operational speed of 250 km/h**.
- The World Health Organization **secured \$1 billion in pledges** during a fundraising event in Berlin, marking a significant initiative to reform its funding model and enhance its ability to address global health emergencies.
- **South Eastern Coalfields Limited (SECL)**, a Chhattisgarh-based subsidiary of Coal India, has opened its **fourth AMRIT (Affordable Medicines and Reliable Implants for Treatment) Pharmacy**, making it the first coal company to do so. This **216th AMRIT pharmacy**, located at SECL's Health Centre in Indira Vihar Colony, Bilaspur, will provide generic and life-saving medicines at highly subsidized rates, benefiting SECL employees, the general public, and underserved tribal and rural communities.
- Kaksar Bridge was renamed **Capt. Amit Bhardwaj Setu** to honor the sacrifice of **Capt. Amit Bhardwaj during the Kargil War**. The event, attended by prominent military and civil officials, including **CEC Dr. Mohd Jaffer Akhoun** and **Major General K. Mahesh, SM**, celebrated Bhardwaj's bravery and dedication to his nation.
- On the evening of **October 17, 2024**, the **Israel Defense Forces (IDF)** made a significant announcement: **Yahya Sinwar**, the head of Hamas in Gaza, was killed during a targeted ground operation in **Rafah**, located in southern Gaza. Sinwar, one of the most feared and influential leaders of Hamas, was among three high-ranking Hamas militants killed during this mission.
- The **20th edition of Jazzmandu**, also known as the Kathmandu Jazz Festival, is set to light up Kathmandu with an electrifying week of jazz, world music, and cultural fusion from **October 24 to October 30, 2024**. Celebrating two decades of rich musical exchange, this year's festival is marked by a star-studded lineup featuring international jazz icons and Nepalese musical talent. Jazzmandu has firmly established itself as one of the premier jazz festivals in South Asia.

- In the heart of the North Sea, an ambitious green energy project is taking shape. Named after **Belgium's Princess Elisabeth**, this groundbreaking **energy island** represents a bold step towards renewable energy transformation. At a bustling shipyard along the North Sea coast, workers are constructing massive concrete structures that will form the foundation of this world-first initiative.
- **Typhoon Kong-rey made landfall in Taiwan** on 31st October 2024. Considered the largest typhoon to directly impact Taiwan in nearly 30 years. Made landfall on Taiwan's eastern coast around 13:40 local time (04:40 GMT).

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of November 2024

- **Collins Dictionary has selected "brat" as its Word of the Year for 2024**, reflecting shifting social dynamics and pop culture influences. Once synonymous with misbehaving children, the term has evolved, largely through British singer Charli XCX's album, to embody a confident, independent, and hedonistic attitude.
- **Tropical Storm Sara made** landfall in northern Honduras, near Brus Laguna, on Thursday, bringing heavy rain and flooding risks to Central America and southern Mexico.
- **New Delhi's Sarai Kale Khan Chowk** was renamed **Bhagwan Birsa Munda Chowk** on the occasion of his 150th birth anniversary. The change was announced by Union Minister Manohar Lal Khattar.
- A potential cyclone, named '**Fengal**' by Saudi Arabia, is forming in the **Bay of Bengal**, according to the **India Meteorological Department (IMD)**. Starting as a cyclonic circulation on **November 21** near the South Andaman Sea, it is expected to develop into a **Low Pressure Area (LPA)** by **November 23** and intensify into a depression by

November 24. This follows the impact of **Cyclone Dana** on **Odisha** in **October 2024**.

- **Operation Tamarisk** was a **covert Cold War intelligence operation** involving **U.S., U.K., and French** agents. The mission targeted **Soviet troops** in **East Germany**, collecting and analyzing **discarded waste** (food scraps, letters, used toilet paper) for intelligence. The operation, known as **Tamarisk**, aimed to gain any advantage in the intense rivalry between the **United States** and the **Soviet Union**.

Miscellaneous Current Affairs of December 2024

- **Vikrant Massey**, renowned for his versatile performances across **TV, films, and OTT**, has announced his retirement from acting at **37** after nearly two decades in the industry. He shared the news through an emotional **Instagram** note and plans to complete two final projects before retiring in **2025**.



Obituaries Current Affairs of January 2024

- **Professor Ved Prakash Nanda**, a luminary in the Indian diaspora, recently passed away, leaving behind a legacy of profound contributions to literature, education, and international law.
- **Franz Beckenbauer**, one of only three men to have won the **FIFA World Cup** as a player and as a manager, has died at the age of 78.
- The Indian classical music world mourns the passing of **Ustad Rashid Khan**, a towering figure who left an indelible mark on the **Rampur-Sahaswan Gharana and beyond**. At just 55, this musical prodigy succumbed to complications arising from prostate cancer, leaving a legacy that resonates with profound beauty and innovative spirit.
- **German actor Christian Oliver**, known for his roles in films like *Speed Racer* and *Valkyrie*, met an untimely demise in a plane crash in the Caribbean. The 51-year-old actor, whose real name was Christian Klepser, was accompanied by his two daughters, Madita, 10, and Annik, 12. The **ill-fated flight was en route to St Lucia** after departing from the nation of Saint Vincent and the Grenadines (SVG).
- **Munawwar Rana**, a celebrated Urdu poet, passed away at the age of 71 due to cardiac arrest in Lucknow. He had been enduring a prolonged illness, including throat cancer, kidney, and heart-related ailments. He was receiving treatment at the Sanjay Gandhi Post Graduate Institute of Medical Sciences (SGPGIMS) in Lucknow.
- The Indian classical music fraternity mourns the loss of **Dr. Prabha Atre**, a revered classical vocalist and a luminary of the Kirana Gharana, who passed away in Pune at the age of 91. Known for her multifaceted contributions to the world of music, Dr. Atre's passing brings an end to a glorious chapter in the history of Indian classical music.
- Malayalam music director **K J Joy** has passed away in Chennai. **He was 77 years old**. Joy, is known as the first 'techno musician' in the Malayalam film music world for his use of instruments like the keyboard in the 1970s.
- **Norman Jewison**, the acclaimed Canadian director best known for his work on the classic film **'In the Heat of the Night'**, has passed away at the age of 97. His death marks the end of a remarkable era in cinema history, where Jewison's contributions played a pivotal role in shaping the landscape of modern filmmaking.
- **Dr. Nitya Anand**, who made the first oral contraceptive pill **'Saheli' in India**, passed away at 99 in Lucknow. Dr. Anand was in charge of the Central Drug Research Institute (CDRI) from 1974 to 1984. He was part of CDRI since it started in 1951. He guided 100 PhD students, wrote over 400 papers, and had more than 130 patents.
- The academic community is in mourning following the passing of **R. Champakalakshmi**, a revered historian,

former president of the Indian History Congress, and professor at the Centre for Historical Studies, Jawaharlal Nehru University.

Obituaries Current Affairs of February 2024

- **Dr. Nitya Anand**, who made the first oral contraceptive pill **'Saheli' in India**, passed away at 99 in Lucknow. Dr. Anand was in charge of the Central Drug Research Institute (CDRI) from 1974 to 1984. He was part of CDRI since it started in 1951. He guided 100 PhD students, wrote over 400 papers, and had more than 130 patents.
- The academic community is in mourning following the passing of **R. Champakalakshmi**, a revered historian, former president of the Indian History Congress, and professor at the Centre for Historical Studies, Jawaharlal Nehru University.
- Namibia is mourning the loss of **President Hage Geingob**, who succumbed to cancer at the age of 82. He had been undergoing treatment for the illness, leaving the nation in a period of transition.
- On February 1st, 2024, the entertainment world was rocked by the news of the passing of **Carl Weathers**, a beloved Hollywood actor renowned for his unforgettable roles in *'Rocky'* and *'Predator'*. The announcement, made by **Deadline**, a leading US-based media outlet, marked the end of an era in Hollywood.
- The prestigious **Bharat Rang Mahotsav**, India's foremost theatre festival, inaugurated its festivities in the culturally vibrant Kachchh district of Gujarat, heralding the onset of a lively homage to the performing arts. The festival kicked off in grand style with a mesmerizing rendition of **'Uttaramacharitam'**, a classic masterpiece by Bhavabhuti, directed by Dr. Chavan Pramod R. from Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda. This stirring play, presented in Gujarati, showcased the remarkable talent of NSD students.
- The **Civil Aviation Ministry** has granted in-principle approval for the installation of a towering **242 feet high statue of Adiyogi Shiva** near the upcoming Noida International Airport in Jewar, western Uttar Pradesh. This monumental decision clears the path for the Isha Foundation to spearhead the establishment of this spiritual landmark.
- India has taken a significant step towards the economic development of the **Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir** by announcing an **interim Budget of \$14 billion for fiscal year 2024-25**. This financial commitment is noteworthy, as it is approximately 4.5 times greater than the total amount Pakistan is seeking from the **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** to address its ongoing economic challenges. The allocation of such a substantial sum underscores India's dedication to fostering growth and development in Jammu and Kashmir.

- **The Divya Kala Mela**, an initiative by the **Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPwD)**, is set to grace the vibrant city of **Agartala, Tripura**. This event, inaugurated on **6th February 2024**, aims to celebrate the talents and skills of Divyang artisans and entrepreneurs from across the country.
- **Farooq Nazki**, a revered poet, broadcaster, and a distinguished recipient of the **Sahitya Akademi Award**. At the age of 83, Nazki's passing marks the end of an era in Kashmiri literature, leaving behind a legacy that will inspire generations to come.
- Chile's political landscape was shaken as news broke on February 6th of the tragic death of former **President Sebastian Pinera** in a helicopter crash in the south of the country.
- Art world lost one of its most distinctive voices when **Ramachandran** passed away.
- The literary world mourns the loss of **Usha Kiran Khan**, a distinguished writer and **Padma Shri awardee**, who passed away at the age of 78 after a brief illness in a private hospital on Sunday. Her demise has left an indelible void in the realm of Hindi and Maithili literature, marking the end of an era of profound storytelling and cultural enrichment.
- **Dattajirao Gaekwad**, the **nation's oldest Test cricketer**, passed away recently at the age of 95. Gaekwad, a name synonymous with resilience, elegance, and sportsmanship, leaves behind a legacy that is etched in the annals of Indian cricket history.
- **Chef Imtiaz Qureshi**, who passed away at the age of 93. The Padma Shri awardee, often hailed as a "culinary genius," was instrumental in bringing the ancient dum pukht cooking technique back to the forefront of Indian cuisine.
- **Kavita Chaudhary**, a veteran actor and creative force best known for her groundbreaking role in the television show "**Udaan**" and as the iconic Lalitaji in Surf commercials. Chaudhary passed away at the age of 67 due to cardiac arrest in Amritsar, leaving behind a legacy that continues to inspire generations.
- Renowned Jain monk **Acharya Vidyasagar Maharaj**, aged 77, breathed his last on Sunday, February 18 at Chandragiri Teerth in Chhattisgarh's Rajnandgaon district. The revered spiritual leader undertook 'sallekhna,' a Jain religious practice involving voluntary fasting unto death for spiritual purification.
- The Indian entertainment industry mourns the loss of **Rituraj Singh**, a versatile actor who passed away at the age of 59 due to cardiac arrest. () Renowned constitutional jurist and senior Supreme Court advocate **Fali S Nariman** passed away at the age of 95 in New Delhi.
- **Faiz Fazal**, the esteemed Vidarbha cricketer, has decided to retire from all forms of the game. At 38, his contributions to Vidarbha cricket have been immense, culminating in a legacy that will be celebrated for generations.
- **Ameen Sayani**, the legendary voice that defined radio for generations of Indians, passed away at the age of 91. Known for his iconic program **Binaca Geetmala**, Sayani's voice was a staple in Indian households, bridging the gap between music and its lovers across the nation.
- Former Lok Sabha Speaker and ex-Maharashtra Chief Minister, **Manohar Joshi**, passed away at the age of 86, marking the end of an illustrious career that spanned several decades in Indian politics.
- The world of football is mourning the loss of one of its most celebrated figures, **Andreas Brehme**, who passed away at the age of 63. Fondly remembered as **Germany's World Cup hero of 1990**, Brehme's sudden and unexpected death has left a profound sense of sadness among fans and former teammates alike.
- The Aegis South Zone tournament, a platform for cricket battles, turned into a scene of sorrow as Karnataka cricketer **Hoysala K**, aged 34, passed away due to a cardiac arrest. The tournament, which had been showcasing the rivalry between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, took a turn with the sudden demise of this player.
- The Indian film industry is mourning the loss of **acclaimed director Kumar Shahani**, who passed away at the age of 83 in Kolkata.
- The music world mourns the passing of legendary ghazal singer **Pankaj Udhas**, who died at the age of 72 after a prolonged illness.
- **Raja Venkatappa Naik**, a revered figure in Surapur's political landscape in Karnataka and a dedicated Congress MLA, bid farewell on February 25, leaving behind a rich political legacy. His demise, at the age of 66, marked a poignant moment for Surapur and Karnataka's political fraternity.
- **Shafiqur Rahman Barq**, a senior leader of the Samajwadi Party and MP representing Sambhal, Uttar Pradesh, breathed his last at a private hospital in Moradabad at the age of 94. Reportedly, he succumbed to a kidney infection after being in a weakened and unwell state for some time.

Obituaries Current Affairs of March 2024

- **Kapildev Prasad**, a renowned artisan and Padma awardee for his contributions to the handloom industry and the revival of Bababuti sarees, passed away in Basavanbigha village, Bihar Sharif. His demise has left the local community and handloom enthusiasts mourning the loss of a true pioneer.
- **Paul Alexander**, who spent much of his life in an iron lung after contracting polio as a child, has passed away at the age of 78. Despite being paralyzed from the neck down, Alexander's resilience and determination led him to become an inspirational figure, achieving milestones that defied his physical limitations.

- **Admiral Laxminarayan Ramdas**, the former Chief of Naval Staff of the Indian Navy (1990-1993), breathed his last peacefully at the age of 90 on March 15 morning, at the Military Hospital, Secunderabad, Telangana.
- Sadi Mohammad, a **legendary Rabindra Sangeet singer**, has passed away at the age of 70. His death has cast a **grim shadow** in the cultural sphere of the country.
- The former member of the **National Commission for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes** and prominent **Buddhist Monk of Ladakh**, popularly known as **Lama Lobzang**, passed away this morning at his residence in **New Delhi**. He was 94 years old.
- **Lakshmi Narayanan Seshu**, a beloved figure in the Tamil entertainment industry, breathed his last on Tuesday, March 26, 2024, at a private hospital in Chennai. The versatile actor, affectionately known as **Lollu Sabha Seshu**, was 60 years old at the time of his unfortunate demise.
- **Louis Gossett Jr.**, the first **Black man** to win the **Academy Award for Best Supporting Actor**, has sadly passed away at the age of 87. His cousin, Neal L Gossett, confirmed his demise on **March 29**, stating that he died at a rehabilitation center in **Santa Monica, California**.
- **Daniel Kahneman**, a psychologist who never studied economics but pioneered the field of **behavioural economics**, has passed away at the age of 90. Despite not having formal training in economics, Kahneman's groundbreaking work exploring the **psychology of decision-making** earned him the **Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences** in 2002.
- The Tamil Nadu political landscape lost a significant figure with the passing of **R.M. Veerappan**, one of the most trusted lieutenants of the late Chief Minister **M.G. Ramachandran (MGR)**, on April 9th. Veerappan, fondly known as RMV, was a powerful minister in MGR's cabinet during the 1980s and remained a close associate of the matinee-icon-turned-politician.
- **British physicist Peter Higgs** died at the age of 94. Peter Higgs gained fame for the discovery of '**Higgs-Boson Particle**' i.e. '**God Particle**'. Peter Higgs was awarded the Nobel Prize for Physics in 2013 for this groundbreaking discovery, which helped explain how the universe was created after the Big Bang. Higgs showed how bosons hold the universe together, a crucial understanding in the field of physics.
- **O.J. Simpson**, the former NFL star who was acquitted of murdering his ex-wife and her friend in a televised trial that gripped the nation, has died of cancer, according to his family. He was 76.
- **New Zealand Cricket (NZC)** took to social media to announce the demise of former legspinner **Jack Alabaster**, who passed away. night at the age of 93 in Cromwell, United Kingdom. NZC expressed deep sorrow over the loss, describing Alabaster as a "champion of Southland and @OtagoCricket" who played 21 Tests for New Zealand from 1955 to 1972, taking 49 wickets at an average of 38.02.
- The Australian cricketing community has lost a true icon with the passing of former Cricket Australia (CA) chair, **Jack Clarke**, at the age of 70 in Adelaide.
- The cricket world is in mourning as it bids farewell to one of its most revered figures, **Derek Underwood**, who has passed away at the age of 78. Underwood, a legendary spinner who represented England for over 15 years, was a true icon of the game, leaving an indelible mark on the sport with his exceptional skill and unwavering dedication.
- **K.G. Jayan**, a towering figure in Carnatic music and Malayalam cinema, passed away, at his residence in Thripunitura, Kerala. He was 90 years old. The legendary musician had been battling various age-related ailments.
- Squadron Leader **Dalip Singh Majithia**, the oldest living pilot of the Indian Air Force, passed away at the age of 103. Majithia's life was a testament to a lifetime of service, adventure, and a deep love for aviation.
- The cricketing world mourns the loss of a legendary figure as **Raman Subba Row**, the former England Test batsman, has passed away at the age of 92. The England and Wales Cricket Board (ECB) announced the sorrowful news, paying tribute to England's oldest living men's Test cricketer at the time of his demise.
- The world lost **Sudhir Kakar**, a renowned **writer, cultural critic**, and the "Father of Indian Psychology," who passed away at the age of 85. Kakar's life and work bridged the gap between Western and Eastern thought, leaving an indelible mark on the field of **psychoanalysis in India**.

Obituaries Current Affairs of April 2024

- Barbara Rush, a **Golden Globe-winning actress**, embarked on her journey in the entertainment industry in the 1950s. Her breakthrough role came in 1954 with the science-fiction film "**It Came from Outer Space**," which earned her the **Golden Globe Award for Most Promising Newcomer**.
- **Juan Vicente Pérez** was a man from Venezuela who lived a very, very long life. He was born on **May 27, 1909**, in a town called El Cobre. This means he was alive for 114 years. Now that Pérez has passed away, the title of "world's oldest man" is expected to go to a 112-year-old man from Japan named Gisaburo Sonobe. But this needs to be confirmed by Sonobe's family first.
- Veteran Tamil actor **Visheshwara Rao** passed away on April 2 at the age of 64. He died due to complications from cancer, which he had been battling for the last few years. Rao was undergoing treatment for the disease at a private hospital in Chennai when he breathed his last.
- **Gangu Ramsay**, the second-eldest son of FU Ramsay, passed away in Mumbai. He was 83 years old. Gangu Ramsay was a renowned cinematographer and filmmaker who was part of the iconic Ramsay Brothers banner. He contributed to over 50 iconic films under their production house.

- The world of Yakshagana, a traditional theatre form of Karnataka, has lost a towering figure. **Subrahmanya Dhareshwar**, a senior and well-known Yakshagana 'bhagavatha' (background singer), passed away in Bengaluru. He was 66 years old.

Obituaries Current Affairs of May 2024

- Vinay Vir, a **renowned journalist**, publisher, and editor of the Daily Hindi Milap, passed away on Saturday, April 27th, 2024, at the age of 72. He was a champion for the **Hindi language** in South India and a respected figure in the journalism community.
- Renowned playback singer **Uma Ramanan**, who predominantly sang in Tamil, passed away at the age of 72 in Chennai. The veteran singer, known for her melodious voice and extensive repertoire, has left an indelible mark on the Indian music industry.
- **Paul Auster**, the renowned American novelist and filmmaker, has passed away at the age of 77. The prolific writer, best known for his acclaimed work "The New York Trilogy," died on Tuesday at his home in Brooklyn, New York, due to complications from lung cancer.
- The entertainment industry mourns the loss of **Bernard Hill**, the esteemed British actor whose remarkable talent graced the silver screen in some of the most iconic films of our time. At the age of 79, the **Manchester-born** thespian has taken his final bow, leaving behind a **legacy** that will continue to inspire generations of actors.
- **Frank Shrontz**, who led Boeing as its **Chief Executive Officer** for a decade from 1986 to 1996, has passed away at the age of 92. Shrontz died on May 3, according to the Seattle Mariners baseball team where he was an ownership partner.
- In a significant recognition of Gujarat's rich cultural heritage, the traditional artisans of '**Kutch Ajrakh**' have been bestowed with the prestigious **Geographical Indication (GI)** certificate by the Controller General of Patents, Designs, and Trademarks (CGPDTM). This remarkable achievement celebrates the intricate textile craft that has been deeply rooted in the vibrant region of Kutch for centuries.
- Shaikh Abdussalam Abdurrazzaq, the renowned **Urdu litterateur** and **academician**, popularly known by his pseudonym **Salam Bin Razzaq**, passed away on Tuesday at his residence in Navi Mumbai after a prolonged illness, as informed by a family friend.
- Renowned filmmaker from Kerala **Sangeeth Sivan** passed away at the age of 61. He had films like 'Vyooham,' 'Daddy,' 'Gandharvam,' and the 'Yodha'. Apart from this, he also made 10 Hindi movies like 'Kya Kool Hai Hum' and 'Apna Sapna Money Money'.
- The literary world mourns the loss of **Surjit Patar**, a renowned Punjabi poet, writer, and **Padma Shri** recipient, who passed away in Ludhiana, Punjab, at the age of 79.

- The literary world mourns the loss of **Alice Munro**, the **Nobel Prize-winning author** renowned for her masterful crafting of **short stories**. Munro, who passed away on **May 13** at the age of 92, left an indelible mark with her **taut** and **acutely observed** narratives, which captured the essence of human nature with remarkable clarity.
- The Indian political landscape mourns the loss of a **pioneering figure**, Kamla Beniwal, who breathed her last on Wednesday, May 15, 2024, at the age of 97. Beniwal, a **veteran Congress leader** and former governor of Gujarat, Tripura, and Mizoram, left an indelible mark on the nation's political arena with her **unwavering commitment** and **decades-long service**.
- **Malti Joshi**, a revered figure in the literary world and recipient of the prestigious **Padma Shri award**, passed away at the **age of 90 after a battle with cancer**. Her legacy as a prolific writer and storyteller leaves an indelible mark on Hindi and Marathi literature.
- The ongoing conflict in Gaza has claimed the life of **Colonel (Retd.) Waibhav Anil Kale**, a former Indian Army officer who was serving as a staff member of the **United Nations Department of Safety and Security (DSS)** in the region. The tragic incident occurred on May 13, 2024, when Kale's vehicle came under attack in **Rafah, Gaza**, marking the first international casualty since the latest escalation of hostilities between Israel and Hamas.
- The Indian banking industry mourns the loss of a legendary figure, **N Vaghul**, who passed away on Saturday in Chennai at the age of 88. Vaghul, a **former chairman of ICICI Bank**, left an indelible mark on the financial sector with his visionary leadership and commitment to excellence.
- **Mohammad Mokhber**, born on June 26, 1955, in Dezful, Iran, is a prominent figure in Iranian politics. He holds two doctoral degrees, one in international law and another in management, along with a master's degree in management.
- **Richard M. Sherman**, one half of the renowned Sherman Brothers duo, who crafted some of Disney's most **iconic** and **memorable songs**, has passed away at the age of 95. Sherman, along with his late brother Robert, left an indelible mark on millions of childhoods through their award-winning compositions for films like "Mary Poppins," "The Jungle Book," and "Chitty Chitty Bang Bang."

Obituaries Current Affairs of June 2024

- The world of wildlife conservation has lost a **pioneering figure** with the passing of **A.J.T. Johnsingh**, a renowned **wildlife field biologist** and **conservationist**, in Bengaluru at the age of 78.
- **Retired astronaut William Anders**, one of the first three humans to orbit the moon, who captured the "**Earthrise**" **photo** during **NASA's Apollo 8 mission**, died on June 7 when the **small plane**, he was piloting, **crashed in Washington state**.

- **Malawi Vice President Saulos Chilima** and **nine other people**, including his wife, were killed as the **plane** they were onboard **crashed** in the **Chikangawa mountain range**, said President **Lazarus Chakwera**. The aircraft carrying Chilima, who was being seen as the **presidential candidate** in next year's **general elections** in Malawi, went **missing**.
- **Mumbai Cricket Association president Amol Kale** has passed away due to cardiac arrest in **New York**. Kale had travelled to United States and watched the **India vs Pakistan match** live from the **Nassau County International Cricket Stadium** along with MCA secretary **Ajinkya Naik** and apex council member **Suraj Samat** on June 9.
- The Indian classical music fraternity mourns the loss of the illustrious **Sarod maestro Pandit Rajeev Taranath**, who breathed his last on June 11, 2024, at the age of 91. The veteran musician, who was undergoing treatment at a private hospital in Mysuru for a fracture, passed away.
- Veteran sports journalist **Harpal Singh Bedi**, who covered several highs and lows of Indian sports in a career spanning over four decades, served as the **national Olympic contingent's press attache** in 2012 and charmed the media box with his inimitable wit and warmth, died after prolonged illness in New Delhi on June 15.
- The state of **Odisha** mourns the loss of **Murlidhar Chandrakant Bhandare**, the former **Governor** of the state, who passed away on **June 15** at the age of **95**.
- The **Canadian actor Donald Sutherland**, star of films including **The Hunger Games** and **Don't Look Now**, has died at 88 after a long illness.
- **Frank Duckworth**, the English statistician who co-invented the **Duckworth-Lewis-Stern (DLS)** method for determining cricket match results under rain-affected conditions, **died at 84** on June 21. The DLS method, **introduced in 1997**, is widely used in **international cricket** and was formally **adopted by the ICC in 2001**.

Obituaries Current Affairs of July 2024

- Former India midfielder **Bhupinder Singh Rawat**, who played in the **1969 Merdeka Cup in Malaysia** died after a brief illness, the All India Football Federation (AIFF) stated. A speedy winger of the 1960s and 1970s, Rawat played for India in the 1969 Merdeka tournament in Malaysia. Domestically, he played for **Delhi Garrison, Gorkha Brigade** and **Mafatlal**.
- **Robert Towne**, the acclaimed screenwriter whose work shaped the landscape of American cinema in the 1970s and beyond, passed away on Monday, December 4, 2023, at his home in Los Angeles. He was 89 years old.
- Veteran actor **Smriti Biswas** died on July 3 at the **age of 100**. The actor, best known for her work in **Bengali, Hindi, and Marathi films**, breathed her last at her house in **Nashik** due to age-related illness. Social media too is flooded with condolence posts for **Smriti Biswas** with many sharing pictures of the actor from her various films.

- **Jon Landau**, the Oscar-winning producer known for his collaborations with director James Cameron on blockbuster films like **Titanic** and the **Avatar** series, has died at the age of 63.
- **Aparna Vastarey**, a cherished **Kannada actress** and the familiar voice behind Namma Metro's announcements, has **passed away at the age of 57**. She succumbed to lung cancer on July 11, with her husband breaking the news to her fans via social media. He disclosed that Aparna was in the advanced **fourth stage of cancer** at the time of her death.
- The stationery industry in India lost a pioneer with the passing of **Subhash Dandekar**, the founder of the iconic brand **Camlin**. At the age of 86, Dandekar left behind a legacy that transformed the landscape of stationery and art supplies in the country. His vision and leadership not only built a household name but also contributed significantly to India's industrial and social development.
- **Kamala Pujari**, the renowned **Padma Shri** awardee and pioneering organic farmer, **passed away at the age of 74 due to kidney-related ailments**.
- On July 23, 2024, the world of economics lost a brilliant mind and compassionate soul. **C.T. Kurien**, a distinguished economist and former professor of Madras Christian College, passed away at the age of 93 due to age-related ailments.
- Vasai-based **Catholic priest Father Francis D'Britto**, writer and environmentalist, who translated the Bible into Marathi, passed away on July 25, 2024, after prolonged illness.
- **Hamzah Haz**, the **vice-president of Indonesia from 2001 to 2004**, has died. He was aged 84. Hamzah, who served under President Megawati Soekarnoputri.
- Hamas's political chief **Ismail Haniyeh** has been **assassinated in Iran's capital, Tehran**.

Obituaries Current Affairs of August 2024

- On August 3, 2024, India lost one of its most revered classical dancers, **Yamini Krishnamurthy**, who passed away at the age of 83 at Apollo hospital in New Delhi.
- The cricketing world mourns the loss of **Graham Thorpe**, a former England cricketer and coach, who passed away on Monday at the age of 55.
- The passing of **Shobhana Ranade** at the age of 99 in Pune marks the end of an era in India's social reform movement. A **renowned Gandhian** and **Padma Bhushan** recipient,
- **Former chief minister of West Bengal** and veteran **CPIM leader Buddhadeb Bhattacharjee** passed away on August 8, at his residence in **Kolkata's Palm Avenue**. Buddhadeb, who had been suffering from **chronic obstructive pulmonary**.
- **Chinese-American physicist Tsung-Dao Lee**, who in 1957 became the **second-youngest scientist** to receive a **Nobel Prize**, died on August 4, at his home in San Francisco at age 97.

- The academic community mourns the loss of **H. Devaraj**, former Vice-Chairman of the **University Grants Commission (UGC)**, who passed away at the age of 71.
- **Susan Wojcicki**, a pioneering figure in the tech industry and former **CEO of YouTube**, has passed away at the age of 56 following a **two-year battle with cancer**.
- Former **External Affairs Minister Natwar Singh** passed away at 95, due to a prolonged illness on August 10. He took his last breath at Medanta Hospital in **Gurugram near Delhi**.
- Dr. Ram Narain Agarwal, a **renowned Indian scientist** and the driving force behind India's missile program, passed away on Thursday in Hyderabad at the age of 84. Known affectionately as the '**Father of Agni Missiles**'.
- **Director General of the Indian Coast Guard, Rakesh Pal**, died of a severe cardiac arrest in Chennai.
- The **world's oldest person, Spain's Maria Branyas Morera**, who was born in the **US in 1907** and lived through two world wars, has died at the age of 117, her family said.
- Former Chief of Army Staff **General Sundararajan Padmanabhan**, who passed away at his **Chennai** residence on August 19, was cremated with full military honours at **Besant Nagar** on August 20.
- Dr. **Girish Sahni**, the former director-general of the **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)**, passed away on August 19, 2024, at the age of 68.
- Veteran Congress leader and recently elected **Nanded MP, Vasant Rao Chavan**, passed away at **4 a.m. on August 26, 2024**, at **KIMS Hospital in Hyderabad**.
- Former **Lebanese Prime Minister Salim Hoss**, a key figure during Lebanon's turbulent years, has passed away at the **age of 94**.
- The cycling world mourns the loss of **Daniela Larreal Chirinos**, a celebrated **Venezuelan Olympic cyclist** who passed away at the age of 51.
- **New Zealand's Māori King, Kiingi Tuheitia Pootatau Te Wherowhero VII**, passed away on August 30, 2024, at the **age of 69**, just days after celebrating **18 years on the throne**.

Obituaries Current Affairs of September 2024

- The tennis world mourns the loss of a true legend as **Luis Ayala**, one of Chile's most celebrated athletes, passed away at the age of 91. The **Chilean Tennis Federation** made the somber announcement on Wednesday, marking the end of an era in South American tennis history.
- Communist Party of India (Marxist) leader Shri. **Sitaram Yechury** passed away. He died at the age of 72 at AIMS hospital in New Delhi. From India most of the political leaders have offered condolence to him. He was born in Chennai in 1952 and is a prominent figure in Indian Politics.

- The world of entertainment mourns the loss of one of its brightest stars. **Dame Maggie Smith**, the celebrated British actress renowned for her roles in **Harry Potter** and **Downton Abbey**, has passed away at the age of 89. Her family confirmed the news in a heartfelt statement, sharing that she died peacefully in a hospital surrounded by close friends and family.

Obituaries Current Affairs of October 2024

S.No.	Person Died	Profession/Famous In
1	Dame Maggie Smith	Actor (National-International) - Known for roles in Harry Potter and Downton Abbey
2	Mohanraj	Actor (National - Malayalam Film Industry) - Famous for the role of "Keerikkadan Jose" in Kireedam
3	Ratan Tata	Businessman (National-International) - Chairman of Tata Sons, renowned industrialist and philanthropist
4	Dr. P. Venugopal	Medical Professional (National-International) - Former Director of AIIMS and celebrated cardiac surgeon
5	Indranand Singh Jha	Former radio presenter and compere at Akashvani Darbhanga
6	Atul Parchure	Renowned Marathi actor (theater, cinema, television)
7	Justice K.S. Puttaswamy	Pivotal petitioner in the landmark right to privacy case, passed away at the age of 98
8	Bibek Debroy	Prominent economist and chairman of the Prime Minister's Economic Advisory Council (EAC-PM),

Obituaries Current Affairs of November 2024

- Legendary folk singer, **Sharda Sinha**, known fondly as the "Bihar Kokila" (Nightingale of Bihar) has passed away at age 72 due to complications from cancer. Sinha's voice brought joy and pride to countless people, especially those who celebrated the traditional festivals of Bihar.
- **Harinder Singh Sodhi, also known as 'Billy,'** a legendary figure in Indian polo, passed away at 86 due to age-related issues. A respected player with a rare plus-five handicap, he was a stalwart of the sport and received the Arjuna Award for his contributions. His legacy in Indian polo is widely admired.
- **Pandit Ram Narayan**, a pioneering sarangi virtuoso, passed away on November 8, 2024, at the age of 96 in Mumbai. He was celebrated for transforming the sarangi from a traditional accompaniment into a prominent solo instrument in Hindustani classical music, leaving behind a lasting legacy in the world of Indian classical music.

- **Mahendra Singh Mewar, former BJP Member of Parliament and a member of the Mewar royal family**, passed away on November 10, 2024, at the age of 83. He died after a prolonged illness while being treated at a private hospital in Udaipur, Rajasthan.
- Noted Tamil actor '**Delhi**' **Ganesh**, renowned for his remarkable versatility in over 400 films, passed away late Saturday night at the age of 80.
- **The music world mourns the loss of legendary Mridangam artist and scholar, Varadarao Kamalakara Rao**, who passed away at 88 in Rajahmundry. Known for his mastery and innovative techniques, Rao made significant contributions to Indian classical music and inspired generations with his exceptional rhythm.
- **Princess Mikasa, the oldest member of Japan's royal family**, passed away at the age of 101.
- **John Prescott**, former **deputy prime minister** of the UK, passed away at 86. A prominent figure in the **Labour Party** and **trade union movement**, Prescott modernized the party while upholding its **working-class values**. Known for his **plain-speaking style**, he made significant contributions to **environmental policy** and **social justice**, leaving a lasting impact on British politics.
- **Justice Harjit Singh Bedi, a former Supreme Court judge and ex-Chief Justice of the Bombay High Court**, passed away at 78. Renowned for reviewing alleged **fake encounter cases in Gujarat**, he was a distinguished figure in the judiciary. His cremation is set for **Friday in Chandigarh**.
- **Shashikant Ruia, co-founder and Chairman of Essar Group**, passed away at 81 after a prolonged illness. Renowned for his **visionary leadership**, he played a key role in transforming **Essar** into a **global conglomerate**. His journey from a modest family business to a world-class enterprise reflects his **acumen, innovation**, and commitment to **philanthropy**.
- **Breyten Breytenbach, a South African-born poet, memoirist, and former political prisoner**, was a prominent **anti-apartheid** activist. His works captured the struggles of his time, shaped by his experiences of **exile, imprisonment**, and activism. Breytenbach passed away at 85 in **Paris**, marking the end of an era for **South African literature** and **anti-apartheid resistance**.
- **John Tinniswood, born in Liverpool, UK on August 26, 1912**, became the world's **oldest man** after the death of **Juan Vicente Perez** in April 2023. He passed away peacefully at **112 years old** in a **care home in Southport, England** on **November 25, 2024**. Tinniswood lived through major historical events, including both **World Wars** and the **Titanic sinking**, attributing his longevity to "pure luck" and promoting **moderation** in life.
- Professor **Amiya Kumar Bagchi**, a distinguished economic historian and macroeconomist, passed away on **November 28, 2024**. Known for his groundbreaking work on **India's colonial economic history**, development, and the impact of **imperialism**, Bagchi's scholarship bridged **economic theory** and **historical data**, influencing both economists and historians. His contributions remain vital to understanding **underdevelopment** in post-colonial India.
- Bibek Debroy, a renowned economist and Chairman of the **Prime Minister's Economic Advisory Council (EAC-PM)**, passed away at 69. He held significant roles at the **Indian Institute of Foreign Trade, Department of Economic Affairs**, and **National Council of Applied Economic Research**. Debroy was a key contributor to India's economic policy, publishing extensively on topics like **economic reforms, governance, macroeconomics**, and **infrastructure**. He was also instrumental in **Indian Railways** and served as a **Member of NITI Aayog** until 2019.
- Iconic Indian designer **Rohit Bal**, known for his mastery in **textile, design, and craftsmanship**, passed away on November 1, 2024, at 63. Affectionately called "**Gudda**," Bal celebrated **Indian heritage** through his work, leaving a lasting impact on global fashion. His death followed a prolonged battle with a **heart ailment**, but his legacy continues to inspire **designers** and **artists** worldwide.

Obituaries Current Affairs of December 2024

- **Brigadier Raj Manchanda**, known as the 'Old Fox,' passed away on December 1, 2024, at the age of 80. A **six-time National Squash Champion** (1977-1982), he was awarded the **Arjuna Award** for his contributions to the sport. Manchanda also achieved **fourth place** at the **1984 Asian Championships**. His legacy in Indian squash is marked by resilience, excellence, and dedication.



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- **Neale Fraser**, one of **Australia's tennis legends**, passed away at 91. He won **19 Grand Slam titles**, including **3 singles, 11 doubles, and 5 mixed doubles**. Fraser also led **Australia to 8 Davis Cup victories**. His career, spanning singles and doubles success, solidified his legacy as a tennis icon.
- **SM Krishna**, former Karnataka Chief Minister, passed away at 92 due to age-related issues. Known as the "architect of Brand Bengaluru," he played a key role in the city's growth. Over his nearly six-decade career, Krishna served as **Chief Minister of Karnataka, Union Minister for External Affairs, and Governor of Maharashtra**.
- **Nikki Giovanni**, renowned poet and key figure of the **Black Arts movement**, passed away at 81. Her impactful works on **Black liberation, love, and social justice** left a lasting legacy, especially within the **African American community**. Giovanni's poetry shaped the **artistic and political landscape** of the **1960s** and beyond.
- **Purushottam Upadhyay**, the renowned **Gujarati singer and composer**, passed away at 90, leaving a lasting legacy in **Gujarati music**. Known for his melodious voice and timeless **compositions**, his work deeply impacted the **Gujarati community** globally. His death marks the end of an era, with his contributions cherished by millions.
- **Padma Bhushan Ustad Zakir Hussain**, the legendary tabla virtuoso, passed away at 73 due to heart-related issues. Born in 1951 in Mumbai, India, and the son of Ustad Allah Rakha, he was known for his collaborations with icons like Pandit Ravi Shankar, John McLaughlin, and George Harrison. Hussain received prestigious awards, including Padma Bhushan (2002), Padma Shri (1988), Padma Vibhushan (2023), and a Grammy for *Planet Drum*. He revolutionized the tabla and globally promoted Indian music, leaving a lasting legacy.
- **Tulsi Gowda**, known as the "**Tree Goddess**," was an acclaimed environmentalist from **Karnataka**, recognized for her remarkable dedication to **afforestation and ecological preservation**. Born in 1944, she planted over **1 lakh trees** and received the **Padma Shri** in 2021 for her contributions. Her passing on **December 16, 2024**, marked the end of an era, leaving a lasting legacy of environmental conservation.
- **Pandit Sanjay Ram Marathe**, a renowned **classical singer and harmonium** artist, passed away on **December 15, 2024**, at the age of **68** due to a **heart attack** in **Thane, Maharashtra**. He was the eldest son of legendary musician **Pandit Ram Marathe** and leaves behind a significant legacy in **Indian classical music and theatre**.
- **Om Prakash Chautala**, former **Chief Minister of Haryana** and veteran politician, passed away at **89** on **December 20, 2024**, due to a **cardiac arrest**. A key figure in the **Indian National Lok Dal (INLD)**, he served as CM for **four terms** from **1989 to 2005**, marking the end of an era in Haryana's political landscape.
- **Meena Ganesh**, a legendary **Malayalam cinema and theatre** actor, passed away on **December 19, 2024**, at **81**. Known for her versatile performances in over **100 films** and numerous stage productions, her legacy in the **Malayalam entertainment industry** continues despite her recent health-related absence from acting.
- **Rohan Mirchandani**, the co-founder of the popular brand **Epigamia**, **tragically passed away at the age of 42**. Known for his entrepreneurial spirit and visionary leadership, Rohan played a pivotal role in transforming Epigamia into a household name. His untimely demise has left the business community and his admirers deeply saddened.
- **Shyam Benegal**, the renowned filmmaker known for his **socially relevant and realistic films**, passed away on **December 23, 2024**, in **Mumbai** at the age of **90** due to **kidney-related ailments**. His work bridged **commercial and art-house cinema**, making him one of India's greatest filmmakers. Benegal's films, rich in **social themes and poignant narratives**, left a lasting impact on **Indian cinema**, marking the end of an era.
- **Vasudevan Nair**, popularly known as **MT**, was a celebrated **writer, screenwriter, and filmmaker** from **Kerala**. Born in **1933**, his works explored **human emotions and rural life**, leaving a lasting legacy in **Malayalam literature and cinema**. With a career spanning over seven decades, his contributions resonate with both common people and intellectuals. MT's passing at **91** marks the end of an era in **Indian literature and cinema**.
- **Dr. Manmohan Singh**, former **Prime Minister** of India (2004-2014), passed away at 92. A distinguished **economist and statesman**, he played a key role in **India's economic liberalization** in the 1990s. His contributions greatly impacted India's political and economic landscape. Among his national honours, he received the **Padma Vibhushan** in 1987, India's second-highest civilian award.
- **Osamu Suzuki**, the long-serving **chairman and CEO** of **Suzuki Motor Corporation**, passed away at 94 on **Christmas Day 2024**. He was credited with transforming Suzuki into a **global automotive powerhouse** and played a key role in revolutionizing the **Indian car market**. Known for his **frugality** and sharp business sense, Suzuki led the company for over **four decades**, shaping it into a leader in **small cars**. His death marks the end of an era for the company.
- The **Government of India** has decided to allocate space for a **memorial** to honor **Dr. Manmohan Singh**, former Prime Minister, following his death on **December 26, 2024**. The **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** confirmed the decision, acknowledging his significant contributions to India's **economic development** and global stature. The announcement was made by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** to **Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge** after a **Cabinet meeting**.



Static Current Affairs

January to December 2024

Static Current Affairs of January 2024

Organization/Entity	Details
UNESCO	Headquarters: Paris, France; Founded: 16 November 1945, London, UK; Head: Audrey Azoulay (Director-General).
Press Council of India	Headquarters: New Delhi; Founder: Parliament of India; Founded: 4 July 1966, India; Chairman: Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai.
All India Football Federation (AIFF)	President: Kalyan Chaubey; Founded: 23 June 1937; Headquarters: Dwarka, New Delhi.
Adobe	CEO: Shantanu Narayen (since 1 Dec 2007); Headquarters: San Jose, California, USA; Founders: Charles Geschke, John Warnock; Founded: Dec 1982, Mountain View.
Assam Government	Industries & Commerce Minister: Shri Bimal Bora; Environment & Forest Minister: Chandra Mohan Patowary; Chief Minister: Himanta Biswa Sarma.
VA Tech Wabag	Chairman and Managing Director: Rajiv Mittal.
Singapore Government	Minister for Education: Mr. Chan Chun Sing.
State Bank of India (SBI)	Chairman: Challa Sreenivasulu Setty; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra; Established: 1955; Tagline: The Banker to Every Indian.
YES Bank	Managing Director & CEO: Prashant Kumar.
Jio Financial Services	CEO: Hitesh Sethia.
Thailand	Official Currency: Thai Baht.
Khelo India Programme	Launched: 2018.
Mastercard	Chief Marketing and Communications Officer: Raja Rajamannar.
International Cricket Council (ICC)	CEO: Geoff Allardice.
Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)	CEO: Shri Mihir Kanti Mishra.
Wrestling Federation of India (WFI)	President: Narsingh Yadav; Founded: 27 January 1967; Headquarters: New Delhi, India.
Competition Commission of India (CCI)	Chairperson: Ravneet Kaur; Formed: October 14, 2003.
All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE)	Chairman: T G Sitharam.
Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)	Founded: 1 October 2003; Headquarters: Chōfu, Tokyo, Japan.
UN World Tourism Organisation (UNWTO)	Secretary-General: Zurab Pololikashvili; Headquarters: Madrid, Spain; Established: 1975.
Mozambique	Capital: Maputo; Official Language: Portuguese; Currency: Mozambican Metical; Government: Republic; President: Filipe Jacinto Nyusi; PM: Adriano Maleiane.
SEBI	Chairperson: Madhabi Puri Buch; Formed: April 12, 1988; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra.
Survey of India (Sol)	Surveyor General: Hitesh Kumar S. Makwana; Headquarters: Dehradun, Uttarakhand; Established: 1767.

Organization/Entity	Details
UN Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO)	Director General: Gerd Müller; Headquarters: Vienna, Austria; Founded: 17 November 1966.
JioMart	CEO: Sandeep Varaganti.
Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change	Union Minister: Bhupender Yadav.
Indian Air Force	Chief of the Air Staff: Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh.
Badminton World Federation	President: Poul-Erik Hoyer Larsen; Headquarters: Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia.
Rashtriya Chemicals and Fertilizers (RCF)	Chairman & MD: S. C. Mudgerikar.
Universal Postal Union (UPU)	Headquarters: Bern, Switzerland; Founded: 9 October 1874; Founder: Heinrich von Stephan; Head: Masahiko Metoki; Parent: UN Economic and Social Council.
World Federation for Mental Health	President: Dr. Nasser Loza; Founded: 1948.
IDFC FIRST Bank	CEO: V. Vaidyanathan (since 19 Dec 2018); Headquarters: Mumbai.
Tata Power Company Limited	CEO & MD: Praveer Sinha.
Bridgestone India	MD: Stefano Sanchini.
International Olympic Committee (IOC)	President: Thomas Bach; Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland; Founded: 23 June 1894, Paris, France; Director-General: Christophe De Kepper.
Association of Mutual Funds in India	Founded: 22 August 1995; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India.
World Health Organization (WHO)	Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland; Founded: 7 April 1948; Director-General: Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus.
International Agency for the Prevention of Blindness	Chief Executive: Peter Holland; Headquarters: London; Founded: 1975.

Static Current Affairs of February 2024

Organization/Entity	Details
Etihad Airways	Headquarters: Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates; Foundation Year: 2003
National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)	Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Foundation Year: 2008
NASA	Headquarters: Washington, D.C., United States; Foundation Year: July 29, 1958; Administrator: Bill Nelson (as of February 10, 2024)
Switzerland	Capital: Bern; Currency: Swiss Franc (CHF); President: Ignazio Cassis (as of February 10, 2024); Official Languages: German, French, Italian, Romansh; Population: ~8.7 million; Area: 41,285 sq km; Government: Federal Republic
UNESCO	Headquarters: Paris, France; Founded: November 16, 1945 (London, UK); Head: Audrey Azoulay (Director-General)
Press Council of India	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founded: July 4, 1966; Founder: Parliament of India; Chairman: Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai
All India Football Federation	Headquarters: Dwarka, New Delhi, India; Founded: June 23, 1937; President: Kalyan Chaubey
Adobe	Headquarters: San Jose, California, United States; Founded: December 1982 (Mountain View, California); CEO: Shantanu Narayen (December 1, 2007–); Founders: Charles Geschke, John Warnock
YES BANK	Managing Director & CEO: Mr. Prashant Kumar

Organization/Entity	Details
Jio Financial Services	CEO: Hitesh Sethia
Thailand	Official Currency: Thai Baht
Khelo India Programme	Launched in the Year: 2018
Mastercard	Chief Marketing and Communications Officer: Raja Rajamannar
International Cricket Council (ICC)	Chief Executive Officer: Geoff Allardice
Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)	CEO: Shri Mihir Kanti Mishra
Competition Commission of India (CCI)	Founded: October 14, 2003; Chairperson: Ravneet Kaur
All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE)	Chairman: T. G. Sitharam
Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)	Headquarters: Chōfu, Tokyo, Japan; Founded: October 1, 2003
United Arab Emirates (UAE)	Capital: Abu Dhabi; Currency: United Arab Emirates Dirham; Prime Minister: Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum; President: Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan
IRCTC	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founded: September 27, 1999; Founder: Ministry of Railways
SBICAPS	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Parent Organization: State Bank of India; Founded: August 1986
American Anthropological Association	Headquarters: Arlington, Hopewell, Virginia, United States; Founded: 1902; Founder: Franz Boas; President: Ramona Perez
FIFA	Headquarters: Zurich, Switzerland; President: Gianni Infantino
Japan	Capital: Tokyo; Currency: Yen; Prime Minister: Mr. ISHIBA Shigeru
Tripura	Capital: Agartala; Governor: Shri Satyadeo Narain Arya; Chief Minister: Dr. Manik Saha
International Basketball Federation	Headquarters: Mies, Switzerland; Founded: June 18, 1932; President: Hamane Niang
Microsoft	Headquarters: Redmond, Washington, United States; Founded: April 4, 1975, Albuquerque, New Mexico; Founders: Bill Gates, Paul Allen; Chairman & CEO: Satya Nadella
Swimming Federation of India	Headquarters: Ahmedabad, Gujarat; Affiliation: World Aquatics; Founded: 1948; Membership: 30 State/UT Associations; CEO: Virendra Nanavati
Ireland	Capital: Dublin; Currency: Irish Pound, Euro; Prime Minister: Simon Harris
France	Capital: Paris; President: Emmanuel Macron; Prime Minister: François René Jean Lucien Bayrou; Official Language: French
International Solar Alliance	President: R. K. Singh; Founders: Narendra Modi, François Hollande; Founded: November 30, 2015
Nepal	Capital: Kathmandu; Currency: Nepalese Rupee; Prime Minister: K P Sharma Oli; President: Ram Chandra Paudel
Reliance Industries	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Founded: 1957; Founder: Dhirubhai Ambani; Owner: Mukesh Ambani
SBM Bank India	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Founded: December 1, 2018
National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founded: July 31, 2008; CEO: Ved Mani Tiwari
Madhya Pradesh	Capital: Bhopal; Bird: Indian Paradise Flycatcher; Flower: White Lily; Formation: January 26, 1950; Chief Minister: Mohan Yadav; Governor: Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

Static Current Affairs of March 2024

Organization/Entity	Details
DRDO	Founded: 1958; Headquarters: DRDO Bhavan, New Delhi; Agency Executive: Sameer V. Kamat, Chairman.
Central Vigilance Commission	Founded: February 1964; Headquarters: New Delhi.
National Commission for Scheduled Castes	Founded: 19 February 2004.
Tamil Nadu	Chief Minister: M. K. Stalin; Capital: Chennai; Governor: R. N. Ravi.
Haryana	Capital: Chandigarh; Governor: Bandaru Dattatreya; Chief Minister: Shri Nayab Singh Saini
World Plumbing Council	HQ: Zurich, Switzerland; Founded: October 2009; Head: Dave Viola.
Madhya Pradesh	Capital: Bhopal; Bird: Indian paradise flycatcher; Flower: White lily; Formation: 26 January 1950; CM: Mohan Yadav; Governor: Mangubhai Patel.
Jharkhand	Chief Minister: Hemant Soren; Capital: Ranchi; Founded: 15 November 2000; Bird: Koel; Flower: Palash.
National Commission for Protection of Child Rights	Founded: 2007; Headquarters: New Delhi; Chairman: Priyank Kanoongo.
Maruti Suzuki India Limited	Managing Director & CEO: Hisashi Takeuchi.
Odisha	Capital: Bhubaneswar; Chief Minister: Mohan Charan Majhi; Bird: Indian roller; Flower: Asoka; Governor: Raghubar Das.
North East Small Finance Bank Ltd	HQ: Hatigaon, Guwahati; MD & CEO: Satish Kumar Kalra; Established: October 17, 2017.
Indian Sugar & Bio-energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA)	HQ: New Delhi; Established: 1932.
Google	Founders: Larry Page, Sergey Brin; Parent Organization: Alphabet Inc.; CEO: Sundar Pichai; Founded: 4 September 1998, Menlo Park, California.
Seychelles	Capital: Victoria; President: Wavel Ramkalawan; Currency: Seychelles Rupee.
Election Commission of India	HQ: Delhi; Established: 25 January 1950; Chief Election Commissioner: Rajiv Kumar.
WHO	HQ: Geneva, Switzerland; Head: Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus; Founders: United States, Brazil, Mexico, France, UK; Founded: 7 April 1948.
Iran	Capital: Tehran; Official Language: Persian; President: Masoud Pezeshkian.
Tuvalu	Capital: Funafuti; Continent: Oceania; Official Languages: Tuvaluan, English; Currencies: Australian Dollar, Tuvaluan Dollar.
Kotak Mahindra Bank	CEO: Ashok Vaswani; Founder: Uday Kotak; Founded: 21 November 1985; HQ: Mumbai.
Geological Survey of India	Founded: 4 March 1851; Founder: Thomas Oldham; HQ: Kolkata, West Bengal, India; Government Agency Executive: Janardan Prasad.
Bihar	Capital: Patna; Chief Minister: Nitish Kumar; Bird: House sparrow; Flower: Marigold; Formation: 22 March 1912.
International Astronomical Union	President: Debra Elmegreen; HQ: Paris, France; Founded: 28 July 1919; General Secretary: Piero Benvenuti.
BSF	Founder: Khusro Faramurz Rustamji; Founded: 1 December 1965; Director General: Daljit Singh Chaudhary, IPS.
Himachal Pradesh	Capitals: Shimla (Summer), Dharamshala (Winter); Chief Minister: Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu; Bird: Western tragopan; Flower: Pink rhododendron.
Kerala	Capital: Thiruvananthapuram; Chief Minister: Pinarayi Vijayan; Fish: Green chromide; Flower: Golden shower tree.
Airbus	CEO: Guillaume Faury; HQ: Leiden, Netherlands; Founded: 10 July 2000.

Organization/Entity	Details
World Economic Forum	Chairperson: Børge Brende; Founder: Klaus Schwab; HQ: Cologny, Switzerland; Founded: 24 January 1971.
International Solar Alliance	Founders: Narendra Modi, François Hollande; President: R. K. Singh; Founded: 30 November 2015.
UAE	Capital: Abu Dhabi; Currency: United Arab Emirates Dirham; Prime Minister: Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum.
NSDC	HQ: New Delhi; Founded: 31 July 2008; CEO: Ved Mani Tiwari.
Zoological Survey of India	HQ: Kolkata; Founded: 1 July 1916; Director: Dhriti Banerjee.
NATO	Secretary-General: Jens Stoltenberg; Founded: 4 April 1949; HQ: Brussels, Belgium.
World Gold Council	CEO: David Tait; Founded: 1987; HQ: London, UK.
Bhutan	Capital: Thimphu; King: Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck; Currencies: Bhutanese Ngultrum, Indian Rupee; Official Language: Dzongkha.
ISRO	Founder: Vikram Sarabhai; HQ: Bengaluru; Founded: 15 August 1969; Chairman: Sreedhara Somanath.
Saudi Arabia	Capital: Riyadh; King: Salman of Saudi Arabia; Currency: Saudi Riyal.
Senegal	Capital: Dakar; President: Macky Sall; Currency: West African CFA Franc; Official Language: French.

Static Current Affairs of April 2024

Organization/Entity	Details
Democratic Republic of Congo	Capital: Kinshasa; Official Language: French; Currency: Congolese Franc; President: Felix Tshisekedi.
Election Commission of India	Headquarters: New Delhi; Formed: 25 January 1950; Chief Election Commissioner: Rajiv Kumar.
IRCTC	Headquarters: New Delhi; Founded: 27 September 1999.
United Nations (UN)	Headquarters: New York, USA; Founded: 24 October 1945, San Francisco, California, USA; Secretary-General: António Guterres.
UNESCO	Headquarters: Paris, France; Founded: 16 November 1945, London, UK; Head: Audrey Azoulay (Director-General).
World Health Organization (WHO)	Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland; Founded: 7 April 1948; Head: Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus.
Indian School of Business (ISB)	Founded: 2001; Chairperson: Harish Manwani; Dean: Madan Pillutla; Campus: Urban, 260 acres; Founders: Rajat Gupta, Anil Kumar.
European Union (EU)	Headquarters: Brussels, Belgium; Founded: 1 November 1993, Maastricht, Netherlands; Founders: Germany, France, Italy, Netherlands, Belgium, Luxembourg.
MobiKwik	Chairperson, Co-founder & COO: Upasana Taku.
Asian Development Bank (ADB)	Headquarters: Mandaluyong, Philippines; Founded: 19 December 1966; President: Masatsugu Asakawa.
HDFC Bank	Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Founded: August 1994; CEO: Sashidhar Jagdishan.
University Grants Commission (UGC)	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founded: November 1956.
DRDO	Headquarters: DRDO Bhavan, New Delhi; Founded: 1958; Chairman: Sameer V. Kamat.
Ghana	Capital: Accra; Currency: Ghanaian Cedi; President: Nana Akufo-Addo.
Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)	Headquarters: Kolkata, India; Founded: 1 July 1916; Director: Dr. Dhriti Banerjee.
Nicaragua	Capital: Managua; Currency: Nicaraguan Córdoba; President: Daniel Ortega.

Organization/Entity	Details
NATO	Headquarters: Brussels, Belgium; Founded: 4 April 1949, Washington, D.C., USA; Secretary-General: Jens Stoltenberg.
World Gold Council	Headquarters: London, UK; Founded: 1987; CEO: David Tait; President: Kelvin Dushnisky.
International Solar Alliance (ISA)	Founded: 30 November 2015; Founders: Narendra Modi, François Hollande; President: R. K. Singh.
Reliance Industries	Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Founded: 1957; Founder: Dhirubhai Ambani; President: Mukesh Ambani.
Microsoft	Headquarters: Redmond, Washington, USA; Founders: Bill Gates, Paul Allen; Chairperson: Satya Nadella.
SBM Bank India	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Founded: 1 December 2018.
NSDC (National Skill Development Corporation)	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founded: 31 July 2008; CEO: Ved Mani Tiwari.
International Narcotics Control Board	Headquarters: Vienna, Austria; Founded: 1968; President: Jallal Toufiq.
Russia	Capital: Moscow; Currency: Russian Ruble; President: Vladimir Putin; Prime Minister: Mikhail Mishustin.
CBI (Central Bureau of Investigation)	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founded: 1 April 1963.
Foxconn	Chairman & CEO: Young Liu.
Lokmanya Tilak National Award	Instituted: 1983.
Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change	Minister: Shri Bhupender Yadav.
Oracle	Headquarters: Austin, Texas, USA; Founders: Larry Ellison, Bob Miner, Ed Oates; CEO: Safra Catz.
NABARD (National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development)	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Founded: 12 July 1982; Chief General Manager, Rajasthan: Dr. Rajiv Siwach.
National Highways Authority of India	Chairperson: Santosh Kumar Yadav.
Oil India Limited	Chairman & Managing Director (CMD): Dr. Ranjit Rath.
Appointments Committee of the Cabinet	Chairperson: Narendra Modi.
Israel	Capital: Jerusalem; Currency: New Israeli Shekel (NIS); Prime Minister: Benjamin Netanyahu; President: Isaac Herzog.
Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board	Chairman: AK Jain.
National Commission for Protection of Child Rights	Chairman: Priyank Kanoongo.
Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare	Minister: J P Nadda
Intel	Headquarters: Santa Clara, California, USA; CEO: Patrick P. Gelsinger; Chairperson: Omar Ishrak.
World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)	Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland; Founded: 14 July 1967; Director General: Daren Tang.

Static Current Affairs of May 2024

Organization/Entity	Details
UNESCO	Headquarters: Paris, France; Founded: 16 November 1945, London, UK; Head: Audrey Azoulay (Director-General).
Press Council of India	Headquarters: New Delhi; Founder: Parliament of India; Founded: 4 July 1966, India; Chairman: Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai.
All India Football Federation (AIFF)	President: Kalyan Chaubey; Founded: 23 June 1937; Headquarters: Dwarka, New Delhi.
World Health Organization (WHO)	Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland; Founded: 7 April 1948; Director-General: Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus.
Google	Headquarters: Mountain View, California, USA; Founded: 4 September 1998, Menlo Park, California, USA; CEO: Sundar Pichai.
Coal India	Headquarters: Kolkata, India; Founded: November 1975.
Asian Cricket Council (ACC)	Headquarters: Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia; Founded: 1983; President: Shammi Silva.
Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)	Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India; Founded: 15 August 1969; Chairman: S. Somanath.
World Animal Health Organization (OIE)	Headquarters: Paris, France; Founded: 1924; Director General: Dr. Monique Eloit.
Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOCL)	Chairman: Shrikant Madhav Vaidya; Founded: 1959; Headquarters: New Delhi, India.
PepsiCo	Headquarters: Purchase, New York, USA; Founded: 1965; CEO: Ramon Laguarta.
National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)	Headquarters: Washington, D.C., USA; Founded: 29 July 1958; Administrator: Bill Nelson.
Asian Paints	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Chairman: Deepak Satwalekar.
World Wildlife Fund (WWF)	Headquarters: Gland, Switzerland; Founded: 29 April 1961; Director-General: Marco Lambertini.
Adani Group	Chairman: Gautam Adani; CEO and MD of Adani Ports & SEZ Limited: Karan Adani; Managing Director: Rajesh Adani.
Larsen & Toubro (L&T)	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; CEO: S. N. Subrahmanyam.
Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Chairperson: Rajesh Bhushan; CEO: G. Kamala Vardhana Rao.
National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Founded: 12 July 1982; Chairman: G.R. Chintala.
Federal Bank	Headquarters: Aluva, Kerala, India; Founded: 23 April 1931; CEO: Shyam Srinivasan.
International Council of Nurses (ICN)	Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland; Founded: 1899; President: Pamela Cipriano.
Mastercard	Headquarters: New York, USA; CEO: Michael Miebach.
Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)	Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland; Founded: 1988; Founder: Bert Bolin.
Central Bank of Israel	Headquarters: Kiryat HaMemshala, Jerusalem, Israel; Founded: 1954; Governor: Amir Yaron; Director General: Shulamit Geri.
Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)	Headquarters: Tokyo, Japan; Founded: 1 October 2003; Head: Hiroshi Yamakawa.
Asian Development Bank (ADB)	Headquarters: Manila, Philippines; Founded: 19 December 1966; President: Masatsugu Asakawa.
World Economic Forum (WEF)	Headquarters: Cologny, Switzerland; Founded: 1971; President: Børge Brende; Founder: Klaus Schwab.
Tata Group	Founder: Jamsetji Tata; Established: 1868; Chairman: Natarajan Chandrasekaran.
Razorpay	Founded: 2013; CEO: Harshil Mathur; Headquarters: Bangalore, India.

Organization/Entity	Details
Curlec	CEO: Zac Liew; Co-founded: 2018.
United Nations	Headquarters: New York City, USA; Founded: 24 October 1945; Secretary-General: António Guterres.
World Bank	Headquarters: Washington, D.C., USA; Founded: July 1944; President: Ajay Banga.
Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Established: 16 July 1929; Director: Himashu Pathak.
Handball Association India (HAI)	President: Digvijay Chautala.
United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO)	Headquarters: Madrid, Spain; Founded: 1975; Secretary-General: Zurab Pololikashvili.
Accenture	Headquarters: Dublin, Ireland; Founded: 1989; CEO: Julie Sweet.
Air India	Headquarters: Gurugram, Haryana, India; Founded: 15 October 1932; CEO: Campbell Wilson.
Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL)	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founded: 15 September 2000; Chairman and MD: P. K. Purwar.
Infosys	Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India; Founded: 2 July 1981; CEO: Salil Parekh.
United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)	Headquarters: New York City, USA; Founded: 11 December 1946; Executive Director: Catherine Russell.
International Monetary Fund (IMF)	Headquarters: Washington, D.C., USA; Founded: 27 December 1945; Managing Director: Kristalina Georgieva.
World Trade Organization (WTO)	Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland; Founded: 1 January 1995; Director-General: Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala.
Reliance Industries Limited	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Founded: 8 May 1973; Chairman and MD: Mukesh Ambani.
Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC)	Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founded: 14 August 1956; Chairman: Arun Kumar Singh.
United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)	Headquarters: Nairobi, Kenya; Founded: 5 June 1972; Executive Director: Inger Andersen.
IndusInd Bank	Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Founded: 1994; CEO: Sumant Kathpalia.

Static Current Affairs of June 2024

Organization/Entity	Details
UNESCO	Founded: 16 November 1945, London, United Kingdom; Headquarters: Paris, France; Director-General: Audrey Azoulay.
Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)	Chairman: Shri Sanjay Kumar Agarwal.
Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change	Minister: Bhupender Yadav.
Delhi's Lieutenant Governor	Vinai Kumar Saxena.
Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)	Director-General: Qu Dongyu; Founded: 16 October 1945, Québec City, Canada; Headquarters: Rome, Italy.
Press Council of India	Founded: 4 July 1966, India; Headquarters: New Delhi; Founder: Parliament of India; Chairman: Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai.
All India Football Federation (AIFF)	President: Kalyan Chaubey; Founded: 23 June 1937; Headquarters: Dwarka, New Delhi.
Adobe	CEO: Shantanu Narayen (since 1 Dec 2007); Founded: December 1982, Mountain View, California, USA; Headquarters: San Jose, California, USA.

Organization/Entity	Details
VA Tech Wabag	Chairman and Managing Director: Rajiv Mittal.
Singapore's Ministry of Education	Minister: Mr. Chan Chun Sing.
YES Bank	Managing Director & CEO: Prashant Kumar.
Jio Financial Services	Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Hitesh Sethia.
Thailand	Official Currency: Thai Baht.
Khelo India Programme	Launched in the year: 2018.
Mastercard	Chief Marketing and Communications Officer: Raja Rajamannar.
International Cricket Council (ICC)	Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Geoff Allardice.
Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)	CEO: Mihir Kanti Mishra.
Competition Commission of India (CCI)	Chairperson: Ravneet Kaur; Formed: 14 October 2003.
All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE)	Chairman: T G Sitharam.
Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)	Founded: 1 October 2003; Headquarters: Chōfu, Tokyo, Japan.
United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO)	Secretary-General: Zurab Pololikashvili; Founded: 1975; Headquarters: Madrid, Spain.
Mozambique	Capital: Maputo; Official Language: Portuguese; Currency: Mozambican Metical; President: Filipe Jacinto Nyusi; Prime Minister: Adriano Afonso Maleiane.
Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)	Formed: 12 April 1988; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra; Chairperson: Madhabi Puri Buch.
Survey of India (Sol)	Surveyor General: Hitesh Kumar S. Makwana; Founded: 1767; Headquarters: Dehradun, Uttarakhand.
Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)	General Anil Chauhan.
Indian Army	Founded: 26 January 1950; Commander-in-Chief: President Draupadi Murmu.
Malawi	Capital: Lilongwe; Currency: Malawian Kwacha.
United Nations General Assembly	Founded: 1945; Headquarters: New York, USA; Secretary-General: António Guterres.
Infosys	CEO: Salil Parekh (since 2 Jan 2018); Founded: 2 July 1981, Pune; Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India.
National Commission for Indian Medical Systems	Chairperson: Vaidya Jayant Yeshwant Deopujari; Formed: 7 October 2020; Headquarters: New Delhi, India.
University Grants Commission (UGC)	Founded: November 1956; Chairman: Prof. Mamidala Jagadesh Kumar.
World Health Organization (WHO)	Founded: 7 April 1948; Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland.
Arunachal Pradesh	Capital: Itanagar; Governor: Lt Gen (Retd) K T Parnaik.
National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)	Founded: 11 March 1986; Director: Alok Ranjan, IPS; Headquarters: Delhi.
Wipro	Chairman: Rishad Premji; Founded: 29 December 1945; Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India.
Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)	Agency Executive: Sameer V. Kamat, Chairman; Headquarters: New Delhi, India.
South Africa	Capitals: Cape Town, Pretoria, Bloemfontein; Currency: Rand.
Swiss National Bank	Established: 16 June 1907; Headquarters: Bern and Zurich, Switzerland; President: Thomas Jordan.
International Hydrographic Organization (IHO)	Founded: 21 June 1921; Secretary-General: Mathias Jonas; Headquarters: Monaco.

Organization/Entity	Details
Tajikistan	Capital: Dushanbe; President: Emomali Rahmon; Prime Minister: Kokhir Rasulzoda.
Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)	Founded: 1954; Headquarters: Bengaluru, India.
Sri Lanka	Capitals: Colombo, Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte; Currency: Sri Lankan Rupee; President: Ranil Wickremesinghe; Prime Minister: Dinesh Gunawardena.
China	Capital: Beijing; President: Xi Jinping; Premier: Li Qiang; Official Language: Mandarin.
National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)	Chairman: Santosh Kumar Yadav, IAS; Founded: 1988; Headquarters: New Delhi, India.
Sweden	Capital: Stockholm; Currency: Krona; Prime Minister: Ulf Kristersson.
Andhra Pradesh	Bifurcated on: 1 October 1953 (from Madras Presidency); Bird: Rose-ringed Parakeet.
United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD)	Founded: 1964; Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland.
Sony Pictures	CEO: Tony Vinciguerra; Founded: 21 December 1987, Delaware, USA; Headquarters: Culver City, California, USA.
International Maritime Organization (IMO)	Secretary-General: Arsenio Dominguez; Founded: 17 March 1958; Headquarters: London, United Kingdom.
International Sugar Organization (ISO)	Chairman: Sanjeev Chopra; Founded: 1968; Headquarters: London, United Kingdom.
Kotak Mahindra Bank	Chairman: Uday Kotak; Founded: 1985; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India.
Ladakh	Capital: Leh; Lieutenant Governor: Dr. B.D. Mishra.
North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)	Founded: 4 April 1949, Washington, D.C., USA; Headquarters: Brussels, Belgium.
Denmark	Capital: Copenhagen; Official Language: Danish; Prime Minister: Mette Frederiksen.
Kazakhstan	Capital: Astana; Currency: Kazakhstani Tenge; President: Kassym-Jomart Tokayev; Prime Minister: Oljas Bektenov; Official Language: Kazakh.

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Organization/Entity	Details
National Medical Commission (NMC)	Formation: 25 September 2020; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Head: Dr. BN Gangadhar.
NITI Aayog	Chairperson: Narendra Modi; Vice Chairman: Suman Bery; Founded: 1 January 2015.
Punjab National Bank (PNB)	Established: 19 May 1894; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Founder: Lala Lajpat Rai.
Press Council of India	Founded: 4 July 1966, India; Headquarters: New Delhi; Founder: Parliament of India; Chairman: Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai.
All India Football Federation (AIFF)	President: Kalyan Chaubey; Founded: 23 June 1937; Headquarters: Dwarka, New Delhi.
Adobe	CEO: Shantanu Narayen (since 1 Dec 2007); Founded: December 1982, Mountain View, California, USA; Headquarters: San Jose, California, USA.
VA Tech Wabag	Chairman and Managing Director: Rajiv Mittal.
Singapore Ministry of Education	Minister: Mr. Chan Chun Sing.
YES Bank	Managing Director & CEO: Prashant Kumar.
Jio Financial Services	CEO: Hitesh Sethia.
Thailand	Official Currency: Thai baht.
Khelo India Programme	Launched: 2018.
Mastercard	Chief Marketing and Communications Officer: Raja Rajamannar.

Organization/Entity	Details
International Cricket Council (ICC)	CEO: Geoff Allardice.
Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)	CEO: Shri Mihir Kanti Mishra.
National Commission for Protection of Child Rights	Founded: 5 March 2007; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Chairman: Priyank Kanoongo.
Financial Action Task Force (FATF)	Founded: July 1989; Headquarters: Paris, France.
Maharashtra	Governor: C. P. Radhakrishnan; Chief Minister: Devendra Fadnavis.
Indian Olympic Association (IOA)	President: P.T. Usha; Founded: 1927; Headquarters: New Delhi, India.
International Court of Justice (ICJ)	Established: 26 June 1945; President: Judge Nawaf Salam (Lebanon); Vice-President: Judge Julia Sebutinde (Uganda); Headquarters: The Hague, Netherlands.
Taiwan	Capital: Taipei; Currency: New Taiwan Dollar (TWD); President: William Lai Ching-te; Official Language: Mandarin Chinese.
Puma	Founder: Rudolf Dassler; Parent Organization: Artemis S.A.; Headquarters: Herzogenaurach, Germany; Founded: 1948.
Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)	Chairman: Sameer V. Kamat; Formed: 1958.
World Health Organization (WHO)	Founded: 7 April 1948; Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland; Parent Organization: United Nations (UN).
Ireland	Capital: Dublin; Currency: Euro (EUR).
Pakistan	Capital: Islamabad; President: Asif Ali Zardari.
Jharkhand	Capital: Ranchi; Founded: 15 November 2000 (Part of Bihar before); Chief Minister: Hemant Soren; Governor: Santosh Gangwar; State Bird: Koel.
NABARD	Established: 1982; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Chairman: Shaji K. V.
Tripura	Capital: Agartala; Governor: Indra Sena Reddy Nallu; Chief Minister: Dr. Manik Saha; State Bird: Green imperial pigeon.
World Bank	President: Ajay Banga; CFO: Anshula Kant; Founded: July 1944, Bretton Woods, New Hampshire, USA; Headquarters: Washington, D.C., USA.
Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)	Established: 16 July 1929; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Director: Himanshu Pathak.
University Grants Commission (UGC)	Founded: November 1956; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Chairman: Prof. Mamidala Jagadesh Kumar.
Rwanda	Capital: Kigali; Currency: Rwandan franc; President: Paul Kagame.
Mauritius	Capital: Port Louis; Currency: Mauritian Rupee; Prime Minister: Pravind Kumar Jugnauth.
Committee on Space Research (COSPAR)	Location: Paris, France; President: Pascale Ehrenfreund; Established: 1958.
International Chess Federation (FIDE)	President: Arkady Dvorkovich; Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland; Founded: 20 July 1924, Paris, France.
United Nations Office for Outer Space Affairs	Founded: 13 December 1958; Headquarters: Vienna, Austria; Director: Aarti Holla-Maini.
UNESCO	Founded: 16 November 1945; Headquarters: Paris, France; Director-General: Audrey Azoulay.
International Olympic Committee (IOC)	President: Thomas Bach; Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland; Established: 23 June 1894.
Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)	President: Qu Dongyu; Founded: 16 October 1945, Québec City, Canada; Headquarters: Rome, Italy.
Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)	Chairman & Managing Director: Brajesh Kumar Upadhyay; Founded: 1957; Headquarters: Goa, India.
Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)	Founded: 27 July 1939; Director General: Anish Dayal Singh; Headquarters: New Delhi, India.

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Organization/Entity	Details
Asian Institute of Transport Development	President: K. R. Narayanan; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1989
National Commission for Women	Chairperson: Vijaya Kishore Rahatkar; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1992
SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India)	Chairman: Madhabi Puri Buch (as of 2024); Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Establishment: 1988 (statutory powers: April 12, 1992)
Tunisia	President: Kais Saied (as of 2024); Capital: Tunis; Independence: March 20, 1956 (from France)
Sahastra Seema Bal (SSB)	Director General: Amrit Mohan Prasad; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1963
Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)	Director General: Shri Rahul Rasgotra; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: October 24, 1962
DRDO (Defence Research and Development Organisation)	Chairman: Dr. Samir V. Kamat (as of 2024); Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1958
ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation)	Chairman: S. Somanath (as of 2024); Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India; Establishment: August 15, 1969
UGC (University Grants Commission)	Chairman: M. Jagadesh Kumar (as of 2024); Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1956
NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India)	Chairman: Ajay Kumar Choudhary; MD & CEO: Dilip Asbe; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Establishment: 2008
NHPC Limited	Chairman & MD: Shri Raj Kumar Chaudhary; Headquarters: Faridabad, Haryana, India; Establishment: 1975
National Statistical Office (NSO)	Chief Statistician of India: Prof. Rajeeva Laxman Karandikar; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1950
RBL Bank	MD & CEO: R Subramaniakumar; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Establishment: 1943
Axis Bank	MD & CEO: Amitabh Chaudhry; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Establishment: 1993
Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd (BHEL)	Chairman & MD: Sadashiv Murthy Koppu; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1964
National Health Authority (NHA)	CEO: Deepti Gaur Mukerjee; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 2019
NOTTO (National Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation)	Director: Dr. Anup Kumar; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 2014
Australia	Prime Minister: Anthony Albanese; Capital: Canberra; Established: January 1, 1901 (Federation)
Turkey	President: Recep Tayyip Erdoğan; Capital: Ankara
Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)	Director General: Dr. N. Kalaiselvi; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1942
Indian Coast Guard	Head: Paramesh Sivamani; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1977
SpaceX	CEO: Elon Musk; Headquarters: Hawthorne, California, USA; Establishment: 2002
European Union (EU)	President of the European Commission: Ursula von der Leyen; Headquarters: Brussels, Belgium; Establishment: 1993 (Maastricht Treaty)
Export Promotion Council for Handicrafts (EPCH)	Executive Director: Rakesh Kumar; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1986
Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)	President: Roger Binny; Headquarters: Mumbai, India; Establishment: 1928
NASSCOM (National Association of Software and Service Companies)	Chairperson: Rajesh Nambiar; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1988

Organization/Entity	Details
Airports Authority of India (AAI)	Interim Chairman: Sanjeev Kumar; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1995
PhonePe	CEO: Sameer Nigam; Headquarters: Bengaluru, India; Establishment: 2015
Airtel Payments Bank	CEO: Anubrata Biswas; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 2016
Amul	Head: Tarun Bhatia; Headquarters: Anand, Gujarat, India; Establishment: 1946
GAIL (India) Limited	Chairman & MD: Sandeep Kumar Gupta; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1984
Indian Navy	Chief of Naval Staff: Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1950
Ukraine	President: Volodymyr Zelensky; Prime Minister: Denys Shmyhal; Capital: Kyiv; Currency: Ukrainian Hryvnia (UAH)
Japan	Prime Minister: Fumio Kishida; Capital: Tokyo; Currency: Japanese Yen (JPY)
FICCI (Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry)	President: Harsha Vardhan Agarwal; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1927
NASA (National Aeronautics and Space Administration)	Administrator: Bill Nelson; Headquarters: Washington, D.C., USA; Establishment: 1958
Odisha	Chief Minister: Mohan Charan Majhi; Governor: Raghubar Das; Capital: Bhubaneswar; State Formation: April 1, 1936
Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO)	Drugs Controller General of India: Rajeev Singh Raghuvanshi; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1940
Spices Board of India	Chairman: A.G. Thankappan; Headquarters: Kochi, Kerala, India; Establishment: 1987
Singapore	President: Tharman Shanmugaratnam; Prime Minister: Lawrence Wong; Capital: Singapore; Independence: August 9, 1965
Border Security Force (BSF)	Director General: Daljit Singh Chaudhary; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: December 1, 1965
Central Industrial Security Force (CISF)	Director General: Rajwinder Singh Bhatti; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: March 10, 1969
Iran	Supreme Leader: Ali Khamenei; President: Masoud Pezeshkian; Capital: Tehran; Established: Islamic Republic since 1979
Railway Board	Chairman & CEO: Satish Kumar; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1905
National Security Guard (NSG)	Director General: Nalin Prabhat; Headquarters: New Delhi, India; Establishment: 1984
International Cricket Council (ICC)	Chairman: Jay Shah; CEO: Geoff Allardice; Headquarters: Dubai, UAE; Establishment: 1909
UCO Bank	MD & CEO: Ashwani Kumar; Headquarters: Kolkata, West Bengal, India; Establishment: 1943
Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)	Chairman: Siddhartha Mohanty; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Establishment: 1956
NVIDIA	CEO: Jensen Huang; Headquarters: Santa Clara, California, USA; Establishment: 1993
Infosys	CEO: Salil Parekh; Chairman: Nandan Nilekani; Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India; Establishment: 1981
Reliance Jio	Chairman: Akash Ambani; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Establishment: 2007
Philippines	President: Ferdinand Marcos Jr.; Capital: Manila; Independence Day: June 12, 1898 (from Spain)
Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)	CEO & MD: K Krithivasan; Chairman: Natarajan Chandrasekaran; Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India; Establishment: 1968
ESAF Small Finance Bank	MD & CEO: K. Paul Thomas; Headquarters: Thrissur, Kerala, India; Establishment: 2017
Jana Small Finance Bank	MD & CEO: Aj

Static Current Affairs of September 2024

Organization	Head/Chairman/President	Headquarters	Established Year
India Post Payments Bank	R. Viswesvaran (MD & CEO)	New Delhi, India	2018
Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG)	Girish Chandra Murmu (President)	New Delhi, India	1858
Flipkart	Kalyan Krishnamurthy (CEO)	Bangalore, India	2007
HDFC Bank	Sashidhar Jagdishan (CEO)	Mumbai, India	1994
Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)	Roger Binny (President)	Mumbai, India	1928
Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL)	Nehal Vora (MD & CEO)	Mumbai, India	1999
Maldives	Mohamed Muizzu (President)	Malé	1965 (Independence)
International Olympic Committee (IOC)	Thomas Bach (President)	Lausanne, Switzerland	1894
Google	Sundar Pichai (CEO)	Mountain View, California, USA	1998
International Coconut Community	Uron N. Salum (President)	Jakarta, Indonesia	1969
United Nations (UN)	Mr. Philemon Yang (President)	New York City, USA	1945
Doordarshan	Navneet Kumar Sehgal (Chairman)	New Delhi, India	1959
Andaman and Nicobar Islands	Admiral D.K. Joshi (Administrator)	—	1956 (Union Territory)
Quality Council of India (QCI)	Jaxay Shah (Chairman)	New Delhi, India	1997
International Telecommunication Union (ITU)	Doreen Bogdan-Martin (Sec-Gen)	Geneva, Switzerland	1865
Confederation of Indian Industry (CII)	Sanjiv Puri (President)	New Delhi, India	1895
Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)	Dr. Samir V. Kamat (Chairman)	New Delhi, India	1958
Cochin Shipyard	Madhu S. Nair (Chairman & MD)	Kochi, India	1972
Iceland	Halla Tómasdóttir (President)	Reykjavik	1944
Croatia	Zoran Milanović (President)	Zagreb	1991 (Independence)
Olympic Council of Asia (OCA)	Raja Randhir Singh (President)	Kuwait City, Kuwait	1982
National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)	Ajay Kumar Chaudhary (Chairman)	Mumbai, India	2008
Adani Airports Holdings Limited	Gautam Adani (Chairman)	Ahmedabad, India	2020
Competition Commission of India (CCI)	Ravneet Kaur (Chairperson)	New Delhi, India	2003
Tata Capital Limited	Rajiv Sabharwal (Chairman)	Mumbai, India	2007
Housing and Urban Development Corporation Limited (HUDCO)	Sanjay Kulshrestha (Chairman & MD)	New Delhi, India	1970
State Bank of India (SBI)	Challa Sreenivasulu Setty	Mumbai, India	1806 (Bank of Calcutta)
SpaceX	Elon Musk (CEO)	Hawthorne, California, USA	2002
Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)	Anurag Garg (Director General)	New Delhi, India	1986
Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)	Amrit Mohan (Director General)	New Delhi, India	1963

Organization	Head/Chairman/President	Headquarters	Established Year
YES BANK	Prashant Kumar (MD & CEO)	Mumbai, Maharashtra, India	2004
European Union (EU)	Ursula von der Leyen (President)	Brussels, Belgium	1993 (Maastricht Treaty)
NASA (National Aeronautics and Space Administration)	Bill Nelson (Administrator)	Washington, D.C., USA	1958
International Hockey Federation (FIH)	Mohammad Tayyab Ikram (President)	Lausanne, Switzerland	1924
International Cricket Council (ICC)	Jay Shah (Chief Executive)	Dubai, UAE	1909
Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)	Narendra Modi (Chairperson)	New Delhi, India	—
International Maritime Organization (IMO)	Arsenio Dominguez (Sec-Gen)	London, UK	1948
International Monetary Fund (IMF)	Kristalina Georgieva (MD)	Washington, D.C., USA	1945
Central Silk Board	P. Sivakumar (Chairman)	Bengaluru, India	1948
Asian Development Bank (ADB)	Masatsugu Asakawa (President)	Mandaluyong, Philippines	1966
United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO)	Zurab Pololikashvili (Sec-Gen)	Madrid, Spain	1975
Amazon India	Samir Kumar (Head)	Bengaluru, India	2013
Uzbekistan	Shavkat Mirziyoyev (President)	Tashkent, Uzbekistan	1991 (Independence)
SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India)	Madhabi Puri Buch (Chairperson)	Mumbai, India	1992
Film Federation of India	Ravi Kottakara (President)	Mumbai, India	1951
International Space Station	Sunita Williams (Commandant)	Low Earth Orbit	1998 (first module)
Indian Chemical Council	Rajen K. Mariwala (MD)	Mumbai, India	1938
Indian Coast Guard	Rakesh Pal (Director General)	New Delhi, India	1978
National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)	Narendra Modi (Chairperson)	New Delhi, India	2005
Asian Organisation of Supreme Audit Institutions	Girish Chandra Murmu	—	1979
Kotak Mahindra Bank	Ashok Vaswani (MD & CEO)	Mumbai, India	1985
National Rifle Association of India	Raninder Singh (President)	New Delhi, India	1951
Federal Bank	KVS Manian (MD & CEO)	Aluva, Kerala, India	1931
Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)	Jin Liqun (President)	Beijing, China	2016
Axis Bank	Amitabh Chaudhry (MD & CEO)	Mumbai, India	1993
Inter-American Development Bank	Ilan Goldfajn (President)	Washington, D.C., USA	1959
Indian Oil Corporation Ltd (IOCL)	V. Satish Kumar (Chairman)	New Delhi, India	1959
Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)	Apurva Chandra (Chairperson)	New Delhi, India	2006
Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)	Praveen Sood (Director)	New Delhi, India	1963

Static Current Affairs of October 2024

Sr. No	Organization/Name	Designation	Established	Headquarters
1	NASA	Head: Senator Bill Nelson	29 July 1958	Washington, D.C., United States
2	SpaceX	Founder & CEO: Elon Musk	14 March 2002	Hawthorne, California, United States
3	Bharat Electronics Limited	Chairman & MD: Manoj Jain	1954	Bengaluru, India
4	Kho Kho Federation of India	President: Sudhanshu Mittal	1954	New Delhi, India
5	BCCI	President: Roger Binny	December 1928	Mumbai, India
6	Manganese Ore India Limited (MOIL)	Chairman & MD: Ajit Kumar Saxena	22 June 1962	Nagpur, India
7	Power Finance Corporation	Chairman & MD: Parminder Chopra	July 1986	New Delhi, India
8	Mauritius	Prime Minister: Pravind Jugnauth	-	Port Louis (Capital)
9	Switzerland	President: Viola Amherd	-	Bern (Capital)
10	Italy	President: Sergio Mattarella	-	Rome (Capital)
11	Finland	President: Alexander Stubb	-	Helsinki (Capital)
12	NATO	Secretary General: Mark Rutte	4 April 1949	Brussels, Belgium
13	Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)	Director-General: Dr. Qu Dongyu	16 October 1945	Rome, Italy
14	Lieutenant Governor of Jammu and Kashmir	Manoj Sinha	-	-
15	Inter-Parliamentary Union	President Tulia Ackson	30 June 1889	Geneva, Switzerland
16	Colombia	President: Gustavo Petro	-	Bogotá (Capital)
17	United Nations Statistical Commission	Chair: Gabriella Vukovich	1947	New York, United States
18	ICC	CEO: Geoff Allardice	15 June 1909	Dubai, United Arab Emirates
19	World Wide Fund	Director General: Kirsten Schuijt	29 April 1961	Gland, Switzerland
20	Indian Chamber of Food and Agriculture	Chairman: Suresh Prabhu	2015	New Delhi, India
21	International Astronautical Federation	President: Clayton Mowry	1951	-
22	Digital India Corporation	Managing Director & CEO: Akash Tripathi	2013	-
23	AI Assets Holding Limited	Chairman & MD: Amit Kumar	2018	New Delhi, India
24	Indian Meteorological Department	Director General Mrutyunjay Mohapatra	1875	New Delhi, India
25	UNESCO	Director-General: Audrey Azoulay	16 November 1945	Paris, France
26	United Nations	Secretary-General: António Guterres	1945	New York, USA
27	BRICS	-	2009	Shanghai, China
28	Steel Authority of India (SAIL)	Chairman Amarendu Prakash	24 January 1973	New Delhi, India

Sr. No	Organization/Name	Designation	Established	Headquarters
29	Indian Chamber of Commerce	President: Abhyuday Jindal	1925	Kolkata, India
30	NVIDIA	CEO: Jensen Huang	5 April 1993	Santa Clara, California
31	International Copper Association	President and CEO Juan Ignacio Díaz	1895	Brussels, Belgium
32	SBI	Chairman: Shri Challa Sreenivasulu Setty	1 July 1955	Mumbai, India
33	Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India	Chairperson Debasish Panda	1999	Hyderabad, Telangana
34	International Monetary Fund	MD: Kristalina Georgieva	1944	Washington, USA
35	Election Commission of India	CEC: Rajiv Kumar	25 January 1950	New Delhi, India
36	World Health Organization	Director-General: Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus	7 April 1948	Geneva, Switzerland
37	Asian Development Bank	President: Masatsugu Asakawa	1966	Manila, Philippines
38	Indo Tibetan Police Force	Director-General: Rahul Rasgotra	1962	New Delhi, India
39	International Monetary Fund	MD: Kristalina Georgieva	1944	Washington D.C., USA
40	Airports Authority of India	Chairman: Vipin Kumar	1 April 1995	New Delhi, India
41	EXIM Bank	Chairman: Ms. Harsha Bangari	1 January 1982	Mumbai, India
42	Employees' State Insurance Corporation	Chairman: Union Minister of Labour	24 February 1952	New Delhi, India
43	Reserve Bank of India	RBI Governor: Sanjay Malhotra	1 April 1935	Mumbai, India
44	Japan Bank for International Cooperation	Chairman: Maeda Tadashi	1 October 1999	Tokyo, Japan
45	Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	Chairman: Mr. Banavar Prabhakar	February 1, 2017	Bengaluru, Karnataka
46	All India Institute of Ayurveda	Director Prof. Tanuja Nesari	October 2010	New Delhi, India
47	Central Vigilance Commission	Chairman: Praveen Kumar Srivastava	February 1964	New Delhi, India
48	GAIL	CMD: Sandeep Kumar Gupta	1984	New Delhi, India
49	US International Development Finance Corporation	Chairman: Scott Nathan	20 December 2019	Washington D.C., USA
50	Bharti Airtel	Chairman: Sunil Bharti Mittal	7 July 1995	New Delhi, India
51	IndusInd Bank	Chairman: Sunil Mehta	April 1994	Mumbai, Maharashtra
52	Tata Power Renewable Energy Limited	Chairman: Deepesh Nanda	2007	Mumbai, Maharashtra
53	International Animated Film Association	President: Deanna Morse	1960	Annecy, France
54	Railway Protection Force	DGP: Manoj Yadava	1957	New Delhi, India
55	Indian Railway Board	Chairman & CEO: Sathish Kumar	1905	New Delhi, India
56	Taiwan	President: Lai Ching-te	-	Taipei (Capital)
57	Fiji	President: Wiliame Katonivere	-	Suva (Capital)
58	Brazil	President: Lula da Silva	-	Brasília (Capital)

Static Current Affairs of November 2024

Name (Org/Bank/Country/State)	Static Details
International Labour Organization	Gilbert Hounbo (President), HQ: Geneva, Switzerland
FICCI (Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry)	President: Harsha Vardhan Agarwal, HQ: New Delhi
SBI	Challa Sreenivasalu Setty (Chairman), HQ: Mumbai
SEBI	Madhabi Puri Buch (Chairman), HQ: Mumbai
NTPC (National Thermal Power Corporation)	Gurdeep Singh (Chairman), HQ: New Delhi
International Olympic Committee	Robin Mitchell (President), HQ: Lausanne, Switzerland
Punjab and Sind Bank	Dr. Charan Singh (Chairman), HQ: New Delhi
Canara Bank	Vijay Sri Rangan (Chairman), HQ: Bengaluru
ISRO	S. Somnath (Chairman), HQ: Bengaluru
International Finance Corporation	Makhtar Diop (Chairman), HQ: Washington D.C., USA
BEML (Bharat Earth Movers Limited)	Shantanu Roy (Chairman), HQ: Bengaluru
IDFC	MD and CEO V. Vaidyanathan, HQ: Mumbai
USA	President-elect Donald Trump, Capital: Washington D.C.
South Africa	President: Cyril Ramaphosa, Capital: Pretoria (Administrative)
Zimbabwe	President: Emmerson Mnangagwa, Capital: Harare
Switzerland	President: Viola Amherd, Capital: Bern
Botswana	President: Duma Boko (New Elected), Capital: Gaborone
World Meteorological Organization (WMO)	Estd. Year: 1950, President: Abdulla Al Mandous, HQ: Geneva, Switzerland
World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)	Estd. Year: 1967, Director General: Daren Tang, HQ: Geneva, Switzerland
United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC)	Estd. Year: 1992, HQ: Bonn, Germany
Defense Research and Development Organization (DRDO)	Estd. Year: 1968, Director General: Dr. Manu Korulla, HQ: New Delhi
Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO)	Estd. Year: 1969, Chairman: S. Somnath, HQ: Bengaluru
Indian Meteorological Organization (IMD)	Estd. Year: 1875, Director General: Dr. Mrutyunjay Mohapatra, HQ: New Delhi
Indian Coast Guard (ICG)	Estd. Year: 1977 (Formally in 1978), Director General: Paramesh Sivamani, HQ: New Delhi
Indian Oil Corporation (IOC)	Estd. Year: 1959, Chairman: Arvindar Singh Sahney, HQ: New Delhi
State Bank of India (SBI)	Estd. Year: 1955, Chairman: Challa Sreenivasulu Setty, HQ: Mumbai
Asian Development Bank (ADB)	Estd. Year: 1966, Chairman: Masatsugu Asakawa, HQ: Manila, Philippines
SoftBank Group Corp.	Estd. Year: 1990, Chairman: Masayoshi Son, HQ: Tokyo, Japan
Tata Power	Chairman: Natarajan Chandrasekaran
Minister of Finance	Nirmala Sitharaman
Minister of Home Affairs	Amit Shah
Minister of Power	Manohar Lal Khattar
Minister of Communications	Jyotiraditya Scindia
Minister of Law and Justice	Arjun Ram Meghwal
Canada	Prime Minister: Justin Trudeau, Capital: Ottawa, Currency: Canadian Dollar

Name (Org/Bank/Country/State)	Static Details
China	President: Xi Jinping, Capital: Beijing, Currency: Yuan
Japan	PM: Shiegru Ishiba, Capital: Tokyo, Currency: Yen
Haiti	President: Jovenel Moise, Capital: Port-au-Prince, Currency: Gourde
Mauritius	PM: Dr. Navin Ramgoolam, Capital: Port Louis, Currency: Mauritian Rupee
Australia	PM: Anthony Albanese, Capital: Canberra, Currency: Australian Dollar
Commonwealth of Dominica	PM: Roosevelt Skerrit, Capital: Roseau, Currency: East Caribbean Dollar
Uttar Pradesh	Governor: Anandiben Patel, CM: Yogi Adityanath, Capital: Lucknow
Delhi	L. Governor: Vinai Kumar Saxena, CM: Atishi Marlena, Capital: New Delhi
Rajasthan	Governor: Haribhau Kisanrao Bagade, CM: Bhajan Lal Sharma, Capital: Jaipur
Solar Energy Corporation of India Ltd	MD: Sh. R.P. Gupta, HQ: New Delhi
Druk Green Power Corporation Ltd (DGPC)	Dasho Chhewang Rinzin - Managing Director, HQ: Thimpu, Bhutan
Tata Power	Mr. Praveer Sinha - MD, HQ: Mumbai
All India Institute of Ayurveda	HQ: Delhi
SANGEET NATAK AKADEMI	Shri Raju Das - Secretary
UNFCCC	Mr. Simon Stiell - Executive Secretary, HQ: Bonn, Germany
United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO)	HQ: Madrid, Spain, Secretary General: Zura Pololikashvili
Coal India Limited (CIL)	HQ: Kolkata, West Bengal, PM Prasad - Chairman and MD
Asian Cricket Council	HQ: Colombo, Sri Lanka
EPFO (Employees Provident Fund Organization)	HQ: New Delhi, Central Provident Fund Commissioner: Neelam Shami Rao
Karnataka Bank	HQ: Karnataka, MD: Mr. Srikrishnan
World Bank	HQ: Washington D.C., President: Ajay Banga
SAUDI ARABIA	Head of State: King Salman, Capital: Riyadh
ITALY	PM: Giorgia Meloni, Capital: Rome
SPAIN	PM: Pedro Sanchez, Capital: Madrid
AZERBAIJAN	President: LLham Aliyev, Capital: Baku
ARMENIA	President: Vahagn Khachatryan, Capital: Yerevan
BRAZIL	President: Lula Da Silva, Capital: Brasilia
GUYANA	President: Irfaan Ali, Capital: Georgetown
DOMINICA	President: Sylvanie Burton, Capital: Roseau
TAMIL NADU	Governor: R. N. Ravi, CM: Thiru M.K.Stalin, Capital: Chennai
TELANGANA	Governor: Shri Jushnu Dev Varma, CM: Revanth Reddy, Capital: Hyderabad
BIHAR	Governor: Arif Mohammad Khan, CM: Nitish Kumar, Capital: Patna
NADA (National Anti Doping Agency)	HQ: Delhi
CII (Confederation of Indian Industry)	President: Sanjiv Puri
CCI (Competition of India)	Chairperson: Ravneet Kaur
PNB	Chairman: Shri K G Ananthakrishnan, HQ: New Delhi
ISRO	Chairman: S Somnath, HQ: Bengaluru
ICG (Indian Coast Guard)	DG: Vice Admiral Paramesh Sivamani

Name (Org/Bank/Country/State)	Static Details
Iceland	President: Halla Tomosdottir, Capital: Reykjavik
Norway	PM: Jonas Gahr Store, Capital: Oslo
Uruguay	President: Yamandu Orsi, Capital: Montevideo
Sri Lanka	President: Anura Kumara Disanayake, Capital: Colombo
Gujarat	Governor: Acharya Devvrat, CM: Bhupendra Patel, Capital: Gandhinagar
Nagaland	Governor: Shri La Ganesan, CM: Neiphiu Rio, Capital: Kohima
Haryana	Governor: Bandaru Dattatraya, CM: Nayab Singh Saini, Capital: Chandigarh
Andhra Pradesh	Governor: S. Abdul Nazeer, CM: Chandra Babu Naidu, Capital: Amaravati
Jharkhand	Governor: Santosh Gangwar, CM: Hemant Soren, Capital: Ranchi

Static Current Affairs of December 2024

Sr. No	Bank/Orgn./Country/States	Static Details
1	ISRO	Chairman - S Somnath Head Office - Bengaluru
2	ESA (European Space Agency)	Director General - Josef Aschbacher Head Office - Paris, France
4	SEBI	Chairperson - Madhabi Buch Head Office - Mumbai
5	Navi Finserv.	MD & CEO - Sachin Bansal Head Office - Bengaluru
6	TATA Motors	CEO & MD - Marc Llistosella Head Office - Worli, Mumbai
7	World Bank	President - Ajay Banga Head Office - Washington D.C.
8	National Small Industries Corporation Limited	MD - Dr. Subhansu Sekhar Acharya Head Office - Bengaluru
9	Kuwait	Emir - Mishal Al-Ahmad Al-Jaber Capital - Kuwait City
10	Sri Lanka	President - Anura Kumara Disanayake Capital - Colombo
11	Bhutan	PM - Tshering Tobgay Capital - Thimphu
12	Singapore	PM- Mr. Lee Hsien Loong Capital - Singapore City
13	Namibia	President - Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah Capital - Windhoek
14	Maharashtra	Governor - C.P. Radhakrishnan CM - Devendra Fadnavis Capital - Mumbai
15	Jharkhand	Governor - Santosh Gangwar CM - Hemant Soren Capital - Ranchi
16	Assam	Governor - Lakshman Prasad Acharya CM - Himanta Sarma

Sr. No	Bank/Orgn./Country/States	Static Details
17	Arunachal Pradesh	Governor - Kaiwalya Trivikram Parnaik CM - Pema Khandu Capital - Itanagar
18	West Bengal	Governor - C.V. Ananda Bose CM - Mamta Banerjee Capital - Kolkata
19	Telangana	Governor - Jishnu Dev Varma CM - Revanth Reddy Capital - Hyderabad
20	Uttar Pradesh	Governor - Anandiben Patel CM - Yogi Adityanath Capital - Lucknow

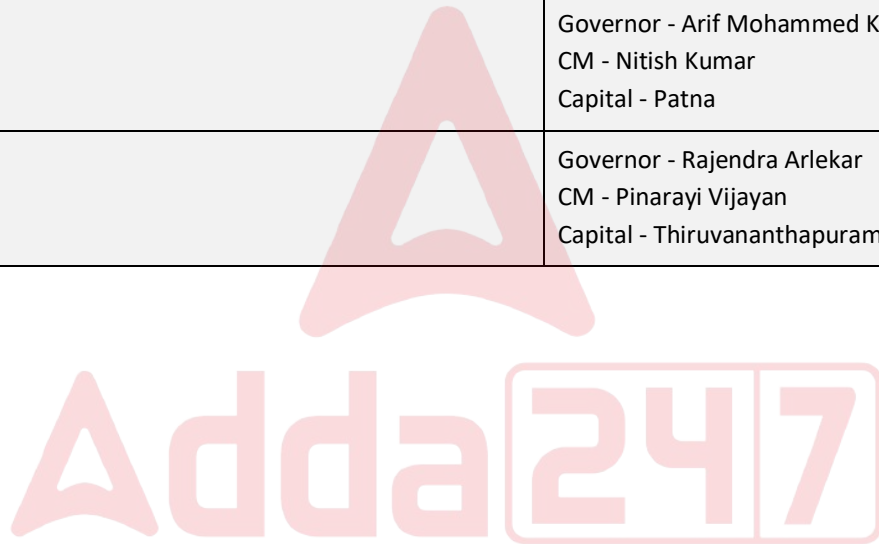
Sr. No	Bank Name/Orgn./Country/States	Static Details
1	RBI	Governor - Sanjay Malhotra Head Office - Mumbai
2	SBI	MD - Challa Sreenivasulu Shetty Head Office - Mumbai
3	Yes Bank	MD - Prashant Kumar Head Office - Mumbai
4	Max Life Insurance	MD - Mr. Prashant Tripathy Head Office - New Delhi
5	AMUL	MD - Jayen Mehta Head Office - Anand, Gujarat
6	ADB (Asian Development Bank)	President - Masatsugu Asakawa Head Office - Manila, Philippines
7	USA	President - Joe Biden (Donald Trump will take office from January 20) Capital - Washington D.C.
8	Switzerland	President - viola Amherd Capital - Bern
9	Ghana	President - Mr. John Mahama Capital - Accra
10	Italy	PM - Giorgia Meloni Capital - Rome
11	Nepal	President - KP Sharma Oli Capital - Kathmandu
12	Syria	President - Mr. Bashir Capital - Damascus
13	UAE	President - Mohammed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan Capital - Abu Dhabi
14	Rajasthan	Governor - Haribhau Bagade CM - Bhajanlal Sharma Capital - Jaipur
15	Uttarakhand	Governor - Gurmit Singh CM - Pushkar Dhami Capital - Dehradun
16	Delhi	L.Governor - Vinai Kumar Saxena CM - Atishi Capital - New Delhi

Sr. No	Bank Name/Orgn./Country/States	Static Details
17	Haryana	Governor - Bandaru Dattatreya CM - Nayab Singh Saini Capital - Chandigarh
18	Arunachal Pradesh	Governor - Kaiwalya Parnaik CM - Pema Khandu Capital - Itanagar
19	Andhra Pradesh	Governor - S. Abdul Nazeer CM - Chandrababu Naidu Capital - Amaravati
20	Minister of Railway	Shri. Ashwini Vaishnaw
21	Minister of Law and Justice	Shri. Arjun Ram Meghwal
22	UNESCO	HQ - Paris, France
23	UNICEF	HQ - New York, USA

Sr. No	Bank/Country/Org./State	Details
1.	ADB (Asian Development Bank)	President - Masatgasu Asakawa HQ - Manila, Philippines
2.	RBI	Governor - Sanjay Malhotra HQ - Mumbai
3.	ICICI Bank	MD - Sandeep Bakhshi HQ - Mumbai
4.	Canara Bank	MD - Shri. K. Satyanarayana Raju HQ - Bengaluru
5.	NTPC (National Thermal Power Corporation)	MD - Gurdeep Singh HQ - New Delhi
6.	FIFA	President - Giovanni Infantino Head Office - Zurich
7.	TATA Power	MD - Praveer Sinha Head Office - Mumbai
8.	Google	CEO - Sundar Pichai HQ - California
9.	BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral and Economic Cooperation)	HQ - Dhaka
10.	Russia	President - Vladimir Putin Capital - Moscow
11.	France	President - Emmanuel Macron Capital - France
12.	UAE	President - Sheikh Mhammed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan Capital - Abu Dhabi
13.	Nepal	PM - K P Sharma Oli Capital - Kathmandu
14.	Sri Lanka	President - Anura Kumara Disanayake Capital - Colombo
15.	USA	President - Biden (Trump from 20th January 25) Capital - Washington D.C.
16.	Georgia	President - Mikheil Kavelashvili Capital - Tbilisi

Sr. No	Bank/Country/Org./State	Details
17.	Uttarakhand	Governor - Gurmit Singh CM - Pushkar Singh Dhami Capital - Dehradun
18.	Bihar	Governor - Rajendra Arlekar CM - Nitish Kumar Capital - Patna
19.	Delhi	L. Governor - Vinai Kumar Saxena CM - Atishi Capital - New Delhi
20.	Assam	Governor - Lakshman Prasad Acharya CM - Hemanta Biswa Sarma Capital - Dispur
21.	Madhya Pradesh	Governor - Mangubhai Patel CM - Mohan Yadav Capital - Bhopal
22.	Security and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)	Chairman - Madhabi Puri Buch HQ - Mumbai
23.	ADB (Asian Development Bank)	President - Masatgasu Asakawa HQ - Manila, Philippines
24.	RBI (Reserve Bank of India)	Governor - Sanjay Malhotra HQ - Mumbai
25.	Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL)	CMD - Ajit Kumar Saxena Head office - Andhra Pradesh
26.	NVIDIA	CEO - Jensen Huang HQ - California
27.	Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO)	Chairman - S Somnath Head office - Bengaluru
28.	European Space Agency (ESA)	DG - Josef Aschbacher HQ - Paris
29.	Spain	President - Pedro Sanchez Capital - Madrid
30.	China	President - Xi Jinping Capital - Beijing
31.	Azerbaijan	President - Ilham Aliyev Capital - Baku
32.	Kazakhstan	President - Kassem Jomart Tokayev Capital - Astana
33.	USA	President - Biden (Trump from 20th January 25) Capital - Washington D.C.
34.	Melbourne Cricket Council	HQ - London
35.	Minister of External Affairs	Shri. S. Jaishankar
36.	Minister of Home Affairs	Shri. Amit Shah
37.	Minster of Defence	Shri. Rajnath Singh
38.	Defense Secretary	Shri. Rajesh Kumar Singh
39.	Revenue Secretary Finance	Shri. Arunish Chawla

Sr. No	Bank/Country/Org./State	Details
40.	Minster of Road, Highways and Transport	Shri. Nitin Gadkari
41.	Uttar Pradesh	Governor - Anandiben Patel CM - Yogi Adityanath Capital - Lucknow
42.	Madhya Pradesh	Governor - Mangu Bhai Patel CM - Mohan Yadav Capital - Bhopal
43.	Mizoram	Governor - Dr. Vinay Kumar Singh CM - Lalduhoma Capital - Aizawl
44.	Delhi	L. Governor - Vinai Kumar Saxena CM - Atishi Marlena Capital - New Delhi
45.	Bihar	Governor - Arif Mohammed Khan CM - Nitish Kumar Capital - Patna
46.	Kerala	Governor - Rajendra Arlekar CM - Pinarayi Vijayan Capital - Thiruvananthapuram



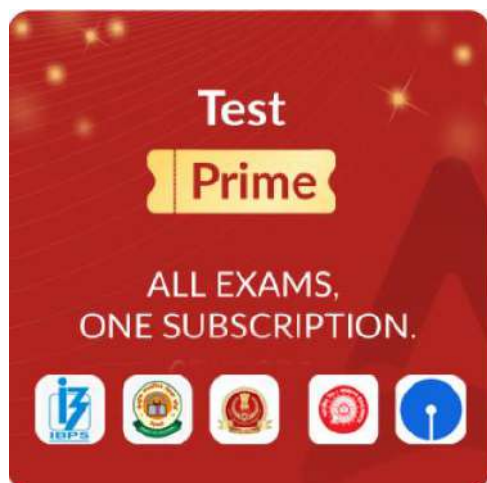
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Current Affairs Questions with Answers

January to December 2024

1. Who may be invited as the chief guest for India's Republic Day 2025?
Answer: Indonesia's President Prabowo Subianto.
2. What new feature has the National Stock Exchange (NSE) launched to promote financial inclusivity?
Answer: A multilingual mobile app and website supporting 12 languages.
3. What is India's commitment under the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KM-GBF) by 2030?
Answer: India has committed to protecting 30% of its terrestrial and marine areas.
4. Where did External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar inaugurate India's new consulate?
Answer: Brisbane, Australia.
5. Who launched the 'Shilp Samagam Mela 2024' at Dilli Haat, New Delhi?
Answer: Dr. Virendra Kumar.
6. What platform was unveiled to promote artisan empowerment in India?
Answer: TULIP platform.
7. On which ship did President Droupadi Murmu witness advanced naval operations?
Answer: INS Vikrant.
8. When was Bengaluru's first digital population clock inaugurated?
Answer: November 8, 2024.
9. What was the new penalty for stubble burning doubled to, according to the Union Environment Ministry?
Answer: Penalties for stubble burning were doubled under the Environmental Protection Act (EPA).
10. Where is the ATMOS 2024 tech fest taking place?
Answer: BITS Pilani, Hyderabad.
11. What milestone did NTPC celebrate recently?
Answer: NTPC celebrated its 50th Raising Day.
12. What initiative did the government call for in relation to green hydrogen?
Answer: The government called for proposals to establish Centers of Excellence for green hydrogen research.
13. Who became the first Black woman to lead the UK Conservative Party?
Answer: Kemi Badenoch.
14. Who were the main contenders in the US Election 2024?
Answer: Kamala Harris and Donald Trump.
15. Which country re-elected Maia Sandu as President amid Russian interference claims?
Answer: Moldova.
16. When will Switzerland's burqa ban law take effect?
Answer: In 2025.
17. What was Zimbabwe's latest achievement in space exploration?
Answer: The launch of ZIMSAT-2 to support agriculture and disaster management.
18. Which country did India oppose regarding the UN Arms proposal?
Answer: Pakistan.
19. What festival does Karnataka celebrate to mark the return of Asura king Bali?
Answer: Bali Padyami Festival.
20. What new policy did Uttar Pradesh introduce to improve animal husbandry?
Answer: A new veterinary policy offering diploma courses for para-veterinarians.
21. Which community in Manipur celebrates the Ningol Chakkouba festival?
Answer: The Meitei community.
22. What major semiconductor project was approved by the Uttar Pradesh Cabinet?
Answer: A ₹3,706 crore HCL-Foxconn semiconductor project.
23. What new survey did Telangana begin statewide?
Answer: A door-to-door caste and socio-economic data survey.
24. Which two states formed a joint committee for cheetah conservation?
Answer: Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.
25. Which Bihar station is being renamed as Ajgaibinath Dham?
Answer: Sultanganj Station.
26. How much loan did Uttarakhand receive from the ADB for urban infrastructure and green mobility?
Answer: \$200 million.
27. What percentage of job reservation for women was approved in Madhya Pradesh state government services?
Answer: 35%.

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|---|---|
| <p>28. What target did the Supreme Court set for eliminating child marriages in Rajasthan?
Answer: By 2030.</p> <p>29. Who was appointed as the Chairman of India Yamaha Motor?
Answer: Itaru Otani.</p> <p>30. Who is the new Defence Secretary of India?
Answer: Rajesh Kumar Singh.</p> <p>31. Who is appointed as Secretary General of the World Agriculture Forum (WAF)?
Answer: Dr. Jacqueline d'Arros Hughes.</p> <p>32. Who assumed the role of CEO and MD of MCX?
Answer: Praveena Rai.</p> <p>33. Who announced his retirement from all forms of cricket?
Answer: Wriddhiman Saha.</p> <p>34. Who has been recommended as MD & CEO of IFCI by the FSIB?
Answer: Rahul Bhawe.</p> <p>35. Who will assume the FICCI presidency on November 21, 2024?
Answer: Harsha Vardhan Agarwal.</p> <p>36. What were India's GST collections for October 2024?
Answer: ₹1.87 lakh crore.</p> <p>37. How much recovery target did Canara Bank set for FY25?
Answer: ₹6,000 crore.</p> <p>38. What equity infusion was approved for the Food Corporation of India?
Answer: ₹10,700 crore.</p> <p>39. What is the goal of reconstituting the Central Apprenticeship Council (CAC)?
Answer: To promote apprenticeship programs and industry reforms.</p> | <p>40. What reforms did SEBI propose for REITs and InvITs?
Answer: SEBI proposed changes to enhance flexibility and investor protection.</p> <p>41. What new rules did SEBI propose regarding securitisation?
Answer: SEBI proposed reforms including investment thresholds and liquidity safeguards.</p> <p>42. What milestone did SBI Mutual Fund achieve recently?
Answer: It crossed ₹10 lakh crore in assets under management (AUM).</p> <p>43. Which bank introduced e-Bank Guarantee with NeSL?
Answer: Punjab & Sind Bank.</p> <p>44. How much investment did Deutsche Bank inject to boost its India operations?
Answer: ₹5,113 crore.</p> <p>45. Which bank introduced real-time tracking for international money transfers?
Answer: IDFC FIRST Bank.</p> <p>46. What did the RBI include in the Fully Accessible Route for non-resident investments?
Answer: 10-year Sovereign Green Bonds.</p> <p>47. What new amendments did the RBI introduce to strengthen KYC processes?
Answer: Six amendments effective from November 6, 2024.</p> <p>48. How many UPI transactions were recorded in October 2024?
Answer: 16.58 billion UPI transactions.</p> <p>49. Which two companies formed a joint venture for green energy?
Answer: NTPC and ONGC.</p> <p>50. What self-certification status was awarded to BEML for defense equipment?
Answer: Self-Certification status by the Department of Defence Production.</p> <p>51. What was the IFC's investment in Bajaj Finance aimed at?
Answer: Promoting climate finance and women's empowerment.</p> <p>52. What electric vehicle brand was launched by Royal Enfield?
Answer: Flying Flea.</p> <p>53. Which country did India surpass to become the second-largest smartphone market?
Answer: The United States.</p> |
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| <p>54. Which country did CDS Gen Anil Chauhan sign a defense cooperation MoU with?
Answer: Algeria.</p> <p>55. What milestone did Cairn Oil & Gas achieve regarding methane emissions?
Answer: It joined UNEP's OGMP 2.0 for methane emissions reduction.</p> <p>56. Which companies formed a joint venture to produce titanium slag in Odisha?
Answer: IREL and Kazakhstan's UKTMP.</p> <p>57. Who was awarded the Rohini Nayyar Prize 2024 for contributions to rural development?
Answer: Anil Pradhan.</p> <p>58. Where is the ILO's 352nd Governing Body meeting being held?
Answer: Geneva.</p> <p>59. Who was re-elected as the President of the International Solar Alliance (ISA)?
Answer: India.</p> <p>60. What is the focus of the first-ever Asian Buddhist Summit hosted by India?
Answer: Strengthening Asia's spiritual development.</p> <p>61. Where is the Indian Navy's 3rd Mahasagar Summit on maritime security being conducted?
Answer: Indian Ocean Region.</p> <p>62. Who chaired the 32nd Kendriya Hindi Samiti meeting?
Answer: Amit Shah.</p> <p>63. Where did the Indian Army participate in the 15th India-US Special Forces Exercise?
Answer: Idaho, USA.</p> <p>64. What new initiative did the Indian Armed Forces start in Gujarat's Defence Corridor?
Answer: A strategic defense conference to bolster industry links.</p> <p>65. Who launched the National MSME Cluster Outreach Programme in Bengaluru?
Answer: Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman.</p> <p>66. Which corridor marks its 5th anniversary in 2024, enabling visa-free pilgrimages to Pakistan's Gurdwara Sri Kartarpur Sahib?
Answer: Kartarpur Sahib Corridor.</p> <p>67. Who retired as the Chief Justice of India on November 2024?
Answer: Justice D.Y. Chandrachud.</p> <p>68. Which company was ranked as the world's most sustainable aluminium company by S&P Global in 2024?
Answer: Hindalco.</p> | <p>69. What was the Supreme Court's historic ruling on November 8, 2024, regarding AMU's minority status?
Answer: The Supreme Court overturned the 1967 ruling, revising AMU's minority institution status.</p> <p>70. What event was celebrated from November 12-15, 2024, to honor Birsa Munda's legacy?
Answer: The 5th National EMRS Fest.</p> <p>71. Where did the 55th International Film Festival of India (IFFI) begin in November 2024?
Answer: Goa.</p> <p>72. Which force approved its first all-women battalion in November 2024?
Answer: CISF (Central Industrial Security Force).</p> <p>73. Where will the 18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas Convention take place in January 2025?
Answer: Bhubaneswar.</p> <p>74. What was the Supreme Court's decision regarding illegal property demolitions on November 2024?
Answer: The SC issued guidelines against demolitions based on mere accusations, emphasizing rights under Article 21.</p> <p>75. Which Canadian province reported the first human case of H5 bird flu in 2024?
Answer: British Columbia.</p> <p>76. Who was re-elected as the World Sailing President in 2024?
Answer: Li Quanhai.</p> <p>77. What program did Canada end, affecting students from India and 13 other countries?
Answer: The Student Direct Stream (SDS) program.</p> <p>78. Who is set to become the new Prime Minister of Mauritius following the November 2024 elections?
Answer: Dr. Navin Ramgoolam.</p> <p>79. What patent did Tokyo's Scarecrow Inc. receive in 2024 for canine treatment?
Answer: A patent for Pinfenon (S)(R), a cardiac disorder treatment for dogs.</p> <p>80. What cultural festival, celebrated in Uttarakhand, started on November 12, 2024?
Answer: Igas Bagwal.</p> <p>81. Which states launched double-decker electric buses in November 2024?
Answer: Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Karnataka.</p> <p>82. What new bike taxi service did Delhi Metro launch in November 2024?
Answer: A women-driven bike taxi service.</p> |
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| <p>83. Which project received a ₹13,500 crore loan from the World Bank and ADB for development in Andhra Pradesh?
Answer: The Amaravati Project.</p> <p>84. Who won the Delhi Mayor Polls in November 2024?
Answer: AAP's Mahesh Kumar Khichi.</p> <p>85. What was the name of the event inaugurated by CM Pushkar Singh Dhami in Uttarakhand on November 15, 2024?
Answer: Jauljibi Mela 2024.</p> <p>86. Who was appointed as the new Chief Justice of India in November 2024?
Answer: Justice Sanjiv Khanna.</p> <p>87. Who was appointed as the Brand Ambassador for Thailand's tourism in November 2024?
Answer: Sonu Sood.</p> <p>88. Who became the Managing Director of NEHDC in November 2024?
Answer: Mara Kocho.</p> <p>89. Who was appointed Chairman of Indian Oil Corporation in November 2024?
Answer: Arvind Singh Sahney.</p> <p>90. Who was appointed as the CEO of the Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI) starting January 2025?
Answer: Amandeep Johl.</p> <p>91. Who was named Education Leader of the Year at the Education World India School Rankings 2024?
Answer: Kunal Dalal.</p> <p>92. Which veteran filmmaker received the Satyajit Ray Lifetime Achievement Award at IFFI 2024?
Answer: Phillip Noyce.</p> <p>93. Who won the Booker Prize in 2024 for the novel "Orbital"?
Answer: Samantha Harvey.</p> <p>94. Which airport won the 'Airport Excellence Awards' for digital innovations in 2024?
Answer: Hyderabad Airport.</p> <p>95. Who won the Men's Player and Goalkeeper of the Year awards at the FIH Hockey Star Awards 2024?
Answer: Harmanpreet Singh (Men's Player), PR Sreejesh (Goalkeeper).</p> <p>96. Who won the ICC Players of the Month award for October 2024?
Answer: Amelia Kerr (New Zealand) and Noman Ali (Pakistan).</p> <p>97. What is celebrated on November 14 in India?
Answer: Children's Day.</p> <p>98. What date marks National Education Day in India?
Answer: November 11.</p> | <p>99. Where was the 7th Annual India-Sri Lanka Coast Guard Meet held in November 2024?
Answer: Colombo.</p> <p>100. What is the name of India's first space defense exercise held in November 2024?
Answer: Antariksha Abhyas – 2024.</p> <p>101. What new project was launched by the Indian Army to enhance air defense capabilities?
Answer: Project Akashteer.</p> <p>102. Where was the C-295 Full Motion Simulator inaugurated for pilot training in November 2024?
Answer: Air Force Station Agra.</p> <p>103. What was the name of the Indian Navy's largest coastal defense drill scheduled for November 2024?
Answer: Sea Vigil-24.</p> <p>104. What new RBI rules allow FPIs to reclassify investments as FDI?
Answer: The RBI framework for FPI to FDI conversion.</p> <p>105. Which banks were classified as Domestic Systemically Important Banks (D-SIBs) by the RBI in November 2024?
Answer: SBI, HDFC, and ICICI Bank.</p> <p>106. Which bank is seeking the largest dollar-denominated loan in 2024?
Answer: SBI (State Bank of India).</p> <p>107. Which company is investing ₹550 crore in renewable energy for Noida International Airport?
Answer: Tata Power.</p> <p>108. Which media companies are involved in an \$8.5 billion merger in 2024?
Answer: Disney and Reliance.</p> <p>109. What was India's Consumer Price Index (CPI) for October 2024?
Answer: 6.21%.</p> <p>110. What was India's industrial output growth in September 2024?
Answer: 3.1%.</p> <p>111. What was India's export growth in October 2024?
Answer: 17.3%.</p> <p>112. Where is the COP29 Climate Summit being held in 2024?
Answer: Baku, Azerbaijan.</p> <p>113. What major conference did Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia inaugurate in New Delhi in November 2024?
Answer: SATRC-25 Meeting.</p> <p>114. Which two countries signed a deal for an Energy Centre in Bengaluru in November 2024?
Answer: India and BIMSTEC.</p> |
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| <p>115. Which defense system is being jointly manufactured by India and Russia under the Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative?
Answer: Pantsir air defense system.</p> <p>116. What fire-resilient plant species was discovered in the Western Ghats in November 2024?
Answer: Dicliptera polymorpha.</p> <p>117. Which institution is collaborating with ISRO to establish a Centre of Excellence for fluid and thermal sciences?
Answer: IIT Madras.</p> <p>118. What missile did DRDO successfully test in November 2024?
Answer: Long Range Land Attack Cruise Missile (LRLACM).</p> <p>119. Which bank launched the Nari Shakti branches for women entrepreneurs in November 2024?
Answer: Union Bank.</p> <p>120. What rank did India achieve globally in WIPO patent filings in 2023?
Answer: 6th.</p> <p>121. Which city retained the top position in Brand Finance's Global City Index in 2024?
Answer: London.</p> <p>122. Who won the Men's Player and Goalkeeper of the Year awards at the FIH Hockey Star Awards 2024?
Answer: Harmanpreet Singh (Men's Player), PR Sreejesh (Goalkeeper).</p> <p>123. Who won the ICC Players of the Month award for October 2024?
Answer: Amelia Kerr (New Zealand) and Noman Ali (Pakistan).</p> <p>124. What is celebrated on November 14 in India?
Answer: Children's Day.</p> <p>125. How much worth of development projects did PM Modi virtually inaugurate in Maharashtra on September 29, 2024?
Answer: ₹11,200 crore.</p> <p>126. Which new airline is set to launch in India by the end of 2024 with hubs in Lucknow and Noida International Airport?
Answer: Shankh Air.</p> <p>127. When was the Swachh Bharat Mission launched by PM Modi as a national movement for a cleaner India?
Answer: On 2nd October 2014.</p> <p>128. How many years has the Swachh Bharat Mission completed as of October 2024?
Answer: 10 years.</p> | <p>129. Which languages were granted classical language status by the Union Cabinet on October 3, 2024?
Answer: Marathi, Bengali, Assamese, Pali, and Prakrit.</p> <p>130. Who is remembered as the founder of the Indian Home Rule Society and India House in London?
Answer: Shyamji Krishna Varma.</p> <p>131. What bonus amount did the Union Cabinet approve for 11.72 lakh railway employees?
Answer: ₹2,028.57 crore Productivity Linked Bonus.</p> <p>132. What mission did the Union Cabinet endorse to boost domestic oilseed production?
Answer: The National Mission on Edible Oils – Oilseeds.</p> <p>133. How many Jan Aushadhi Kendras were established nationwide under PMBJP as of September 2024?
Answer: 13,822 Kendras.</p> <p>134. Which former Defence Minister is set to become Japan's next Prime Minister?
Answer: Shigeru Ishiba.</p> <p>135. Which countries signed a Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT) in Tashkent to boost economic cooperation?
Answer: India and Uzbekistan.</p> <p>136. Which organization plans to establish a Northern Land Command in Eastern Finland near the Russian border in 2025?
Answer: NATO.</p> <p>137. Which country hosted a G7 call on October 2, 2024, to address Middle East tensions?
Answer: Italy.</p> <p>138. Which country's chief was banned by Israel for not condemning Iran's missile attacks?
Answer: UN Chief António Guterres.</p> <p>139. Who became Mexico's first female President?
Answer: Claudia Sheinbaum.</p> <p>140. Which two companies formed a joint venture to support MRSAM systems for Indian defense forces?
Answer: Bharat Electronics (BEL) and Israel Aerospace Industries (IAI).</p> <p>141. Why did Italy and Switzerland redraw their Alpine borders?
Answer: Due to melting glaciers around the Matterhorn.</p> <p>142. Which three countries signed an electricity trade agreement allowing Nepal to export hydroelectricity to Bangladesh via India?
Answer: Nepal, India, and Bangladesh.</p> |
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143. Which state launched a 'Dust Free Drive' to combat air pollution ahead of winter?
Answer: Delhi.
144. Who took oath as the Deputy Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu?
Answer: Udhayanidhi Stalin.
145. Which platform did NITI Aayog and Telangana launch to promote women entrepreneurs?
Answer: Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP).
146. Which festival is Nagaland preparing for, to be held from December 1-10 in Kisama?
Answer: The 25th Hornbill Festival.
147. Who was sworn in as the Chief Justice of Delhi High Court?
Answer: Justice Manmohan.
148. Who was appointed as the Director General of Armed Forces Medical Services (DGAfMS)?
Answer: Surgeon Vice Admiral Arti Sarin.
149. Which bank reappointed Sumant Kathpalia as MD & CEO for another term (2025-2028)?
Answer: IndusInd Bank.
150. Which bank partnered with Bhashini to enable vernacular support in its chatbot Feddy?
Answer: Federal Bank.
151. Which organization approved a \$162 million loan for sustainable tourism development in Himachal Pradesh?
Answer: Asian Development Bank (ADB).
152. What was India's forex reserves as of September 20, 2024?
Answer: \$692.3 billion.
153. By how much did India's employment increase between 2016-2023?
Answer: By 36%, adding 17 million jobs.
154. Which company secured a \$1.265 billion foreign currency loan for power infrastructure?
Answer: Power Finance Corporation (PFC).
155. Which team won the Irani Cup after 27 years, led by Ajinkya Rahane?
Answer: Mumbai team.
156. On which date is World Teachers' Day celebrated annually?
Answer: October 5th.
157. What is the theme for World Teachers' Day 2024?
Answer: "Valuing Teacher Voices: Towards a New Social Contract for Education."
158. Which veteran Malayalam actor, known for his role as Keerikkadan Jose, passed away at 70?
Answer: Mohanraj.
159. Which eight products from Assam received Geographical Indications (GI) tags?
Answer: Traditional foods and rice beer (specific products not listed).
160. Which union minister inaugurated the AYUSH Medical Value Travel Summit in Mumbai?
Answer: Prataprao Jadhav.
161. Which External Affairs Minister is set to visit Pakistan for an SCO meeting?
Answer: EAM Jaishankar.
162. Who authored the book titled "Khaki Mein Sthitapragya"?
Answer: Anil Raturi, former DGP of Uttarakhand.
163. What is the theme for the International Day for Universal Access to Information 2024?
Answer: "Artificial Intelligence, E-Governance, and Access to Information."
164. On which day is World Rabies Day 2024 observed?
Answer: September 28th.
165. What was the theme of World Rabies Day 2024?
Answer: "Breaking Rabies Boundaries."
166. On which date is International Coffee Day celebrated annually?
Answer: October 1st.
167. Which global event is celebrated from October 4-10 to recognize contributions of science and technology to humanity?
Answer: World Space Week.
168. Which renowned British actress passed away at the age of 89?
Answer: Dame Maggie Smith.
169. Which poet, winner of the Sahitya Akademi Award, passed away at the age of 87?
Answer: Keki N. Daruwalla.
170. Which traditional products from Assam received GI tags in 2024?
Answer: Traditional foods and rice beer.
171. Which project did Nitin Gadkari inaugurate on NH-44 in Nagpur, Maharashtra?
Answer: Oxygen Bird Park.
172. Which Indian athlete broke the national record in the 5000m event in Japan?
Answer: Gulveer Singh.
173. Which snooker player became the first Indian in a decade to reach the semi-finals of a ranking snooker tournament?
Answer: Ishpreet Singh.
174. Who holds the record for being the fastest cricketer to score 27,000 international runs, surpassing Sachin Tendulkar?
Answer: Virat Kohli.

175. Which team won the SAFF Men's U-17 Championship 2024 in Bhutan?
Answer: India's U-17 football team.
176. Who won the China Open 2024 title by defeating World No. 1 Jannik Sinner?
Answer: Carlos Alcaraz.
177. Which Indian men's team won gold at the ISSF Junior World Championship in Lima, Peru?
Answer: Indian men's team in Rapid Fire Pistol Event.
178. When did the 8th edition of the India-Kazakhstan joint military exercise KAZIND 2024 commence?
Answer: October 1, 2024.
179. Which organization celebrates its 99th Raising Day on October 1, 2024?
Answer: Military Nursing Service (MNS).
180. Which actor is set to receive the Dadasaheb Phalke Award at the 70th National Film Awards on October 8?
Answer: Mithun Chakraborty.
181. Who won the 2024 SASTRA Ramanujan Prize?
Answer: Alexander Dunn of Georgia Institute of Technology.
182. Which NASA astronaut assumed command of the ISS for the second time?
Answer: Sunita Williams.
183. What is the name of the asteroid that will orbit Earth from Sept 29 to Nov 25, 2024?
Answer: Asteroid 2024 PT5.
184. Which initiative was launched by the Ministry of Tourism to empower local communities for responsible tourism?
Answer: Paryatan Mitra and Paryatan Didi Initiative.
185. What is the outlay for the PM E-DRIVE Scheme launched to accelerate electric vehicle adoption in India?
Answer: ₹10,900 crore.
186. What is the total investment under the Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan launched by PM Modi?
Answer: ₹79,156 crore.
187. Which two umbrella schemes were approved by the Union Cabinet to promote sustainable agriculture?
Answer: PM-RKVY and Krishonnati Yojana.
188. Which Indian sporting body inaugurated the Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru?
Answer: BCCI.
189. Which world cup is India set to host for the first time in 2025?
Answer: Kho Kho World Cup.
190. Which Sri Lankan cricketer was banned for a year for violating the ICC's anti-corruption code?
Answer: Praveen Jayawickrama.
191. Which joint military exercise between India and Kazakhstan commenced on October 1, 2024?
Answer: KAZIND 2024.
192. Which union minister inaugurated development projects worth ₹11,200 crore in Maharashtra on September 29, 2024?
Answer: PM Narendra Modi.
193. What is the name of India's newest airline set to launch by the end of 2024?
Answer: Shankh Air.
194. Which Indian freedom fighter founded the Indian Home Rule Society and India House in London?
Answer: Shyamji Krishna Varma.
195. How many railway employees are set to receive a 78-day bonus approved by the Union Cabinet?
Answer: 11.72 lakh railway employees.
196. How much productivity-linked bonus (in crores) was approved for railway employees?
Answer: ₹2,028.57 crore.
197. Which mission did the Union Cabinet approve to boost domestic oilseed production under Atmanirbhar Bharat?
Answer: National Mission on Edible Oils – Oilseeds.
198. Which initiative of PMBJP achieved its highest-ever sales in September 2024?
Answer: 13,822 Jan Aushadhi Kendras with ₹200 crore sales.
199. Who is set to become Japan's next Prime Minister after winning the LDP leadership vote?
Answer: Shigeru Ishiba.
200. Which two countries signed a bilateral investment treaty in Tashkent to boost investor confidence and economic cooperation?
Answer: India and Uzbekistan.
201. Which international organization is planning to establish a Northern Land Command in Eastern Finland in 2025?
Answer: NATO.
202. Which country hosted the G7 call on October 2, 2024, to address Middle East tensions?
Answer: Italy.
203. Which country banned UN Chief António Guterres for not condemning Iran's missile attacks?
Answer: Israel.
204. Who became Mexico's first female president in 2024?
Answer: Claudia Sheinbaum.

- 205.** Which Indian company partnered with Israel Aerospace Industries to support MRSAM systems for Indian defense forces?
Answer: Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL).
- 206.** Why were new Alpine borders between Italy and Switzerland redrawn?
Answer: Due to melting glaciers.
- 207.** Which three countries signed an electricity trade agreement allowing Nepal to export hydroelectricity to Bangladesh?
Answer: Nepal, India, and Bangladesh.
- 208.** Which campaign was launched in Delhi to combat air pollution ahead of winter?
Answer: Dust Free Drive.
- 209.** Which Chief Justice took oath as Chief Justice of Delhi High Court in October 2024?
Answer: Justice Manmohan.
- 210.** Who was appointed as the new Director General of Police (DGP) of Jammu & Kashmir from October 1, 2024?
Answer: IPS Nalin Prabhat.
- 211.** Which individual was elected President of the Indian Newspaper Society (INS) in 2024?
Answer: Shreyams Kumar.
- 212.** Who assumed additional charge as CMD of Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL)?
Answer: A K Saxena.
- 213.** Which individual was promoted to Executive Director of RBI from Regional Director (Maharashtra)?
Answer: Aviral Jain.
- 214.** Which two countries signed an agreement to transfer the Chagos Islands, with the US military base at Diego Garcia remaining operational?
Answer: UK and Mauritius.
- 215.** Which department signed an MoU with Amazon to enhance e-commerce logistics and support job creation in India?
Answer: Department of Posts.
- 216.** Which bank reappointed Sumant Kathpalia as MD & CEO for another term (2025-2028)?
Answer: IndusInd Bank.
- 217.** Which new asset class did SEBI introduce while liberalizing the Mutual Funds Lite framework?
Answer: SEBI introduced a new asset class but specific details were not mentioned.
- 218.** Which financial institution launched a dedicated FPI Outreach Cell to assist Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) in accessing Indian markets?
Answer: SEBI.
- 219.** How much did India's forex reserves surpass, according to September 2024 reports?
Answer: \$700 billion.
- 220.** Which ministry issued new norms for handling delayed tax refund claims?
Answer: Finance Ministry.
- 221.** What was the growth rate for India's GST collections in September 2024, reaching ₹1.73 lakh crore?
Answer: 6.5%.
- 222.** Which Indian company partnered with Bhutan for renewable energy projects, including solar and hydroelectric?
Answer: Reliance Group (Anil Ambani).
- 223.** Which company partnered with Google to supply renewable energy from a solar-wind hybrid project in Gujarat?
Answer: Adani.
- 224.** Which company secured a \$1.265 billion loan, the largest-ever foreign currency loan by an Indian PSU for power infrastructure?
Answer: Power Finance Corporation.
- 225.** Where did PM Narendra Modi inaugurate the Banjara Virasat Museum?
Answer: Pohardevi, Washim, Maharashtra.
- 226.** Who inaugurated National Postal Week in Ahmedabad?
Answer: Postmaster General Krishna Kumar Yadav.
- 227.** Which two countries signed a Bilateral Investment Treaty reducing the arbitration period to 3 years?
Answer: India and UAE.
- 228.** Which political alliance won the elections in Jammu & Kashmir in 2024?
Answer: INC-NC alliance.
- 229.** Where will the National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC) be established?
Answer: Lothal, Gujarat.
- 230.** Who inaugurated the Indian Institute of Skills (IIS) in Mumbai?
Answer: PM Narendra Modi.
- 231.** How many new ESIC medical colleges will the government establish?
Answer: 10 new ESIC medical colleges.
- 232.** Who was appointed Chief Justice of Nepal in 2024?
Answer: Prakash Man Singh Raut.
- 233.** What is the new currency swap deal between India and the Maldives worth?
Answer: \$750 million.
- 234.** Which hurricane caused Tampa Bay residents to evacuate in 2024?
Answer: Hurricane Milton.

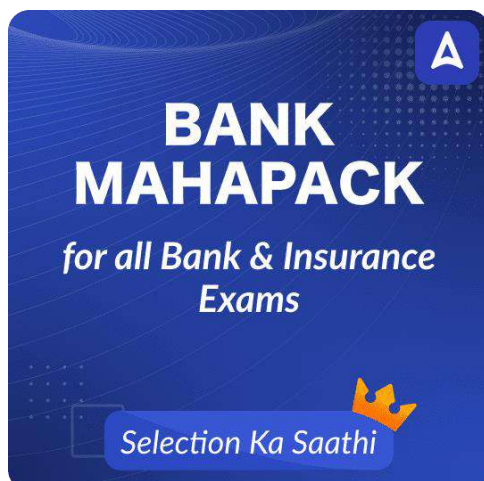
235. Which young Sherpa became the youngest to summit all 14 of the world's 8,000-meter peaks?
Answer: Nima Rinji, 18 years old.
236. Which event did India participate in from Oct 2-6, 2024, in Dresden, Germany?
Answer: 44th Codex Nutrition Committee meeting.
237. Who is on a historic visit to Algeria, Mauritania, and Malawi from Oct 13-19, 2024?
Answer: President Droupadi Murmu.
238. Which water conservation initiative was inaugurated by CM Vishnu Deo Sai in Chhattisgarh?
Answer: Jal-Jagar Mahotsav.
239. Who unveiled the logo for Mahakumbh 2025?
Answer: UP CM Yogi Adityanath.
240. What is the name of the anti-drug trafficking initiative launched by CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu in Himachal Pradesh?
Answer: 'Sankalp'.
241. Which district in Bihar was recently approved as a tiger reserve in 2024?
Answer: Kaimur district.
242. Who has been appointed as India's Ambassador to France?
Answer: Sanjeev Kumar Singla.
243. Who is the new Anti-Corruption Unit (ACU) Chief of BCCI?
Answer: Retired IPS officer Sharad Kumar.
244. Who has been appointed as the Vice Chief of Air Staff in 2024?
Answer: Air Marshal SP Dharkar.
245. Who will be the Managing Director of Nestlé India from August 1, 2025?
Answer: Manish Tiwary.
246. Which global health issue did WHO certify India free from in 2024?
Answer: Trachoma.
247. What is the name of India's fifth lunar mission approved in collaboration with Japan's JAXA?
Answer: Lunar Polar Exploration Mission (Lupex).
248. Where was the world's highest Imaging Cherenkov Telescope inaugurated in 2024?
Answer: MACE Observatory, Ladakh.
249. Which naval drill did India host in Visakhapatnam from October 8-18, 2024?
Answer: Malabar 2024 Naval Drill.
250. What missile was successfully tested by DRDO at Pokhran Field Firing Ranges in 2024?
Answer: VSHORADS (4th Gen) missile.
251. Which Indian Navy survey vessel was commissioned in 2024, and where was it built?
Answer: Nirdeshak, built at GRSE Kolkata.
252. Who will provide affordable insurance for Naval civilians as part of welfare initiatives?
Answer: Bajaj Allianz.
253. What is the worth of the currency swap agreement between RBI and the Maldives Monetary Authority, effective until 2027?
Answer: \$400 million.
254. Who received a one-year extension as RBI Deputy Governor?
Answer: M. Rajeshwar Rao.
255. Which stake did HDFC Bank sell for ₹192 crore in 2024?
Answer: HDFC Education.
256. Which financial institution increased its stake in the Bank of Maharashtra from 4.05% to 7.10%?
Answer: LIC (Life Insurance Corporation of India).
257. Which skincare brand was launched in India by Reliance's Tira in 2024?
Answer: Augustinus Bader.
258. What is the projected worth of India's e-commerce market by 2030, according to Deloitte?
Answer: \$325 billion.
259. Which app has integrated with UMANG for seamless government service access?
Answer: DigiLocker.
260. By how much did UPI transactions surge in the first half of 2024?
Answer: 52%, with 78.97 billion transactions.
261. How much worth of transactions have UP BC Sakhis facilitated in rural areas of UP?
Answer: Rs 27,000 crore.
262. What is the current repo rate maintained by RBI in 2024?
Answer: 6.5%.
263. What intervention stabilized the Indian rupee below 84 against the dollar?
Answer: RBI intervention.
264. Who received the MIDORI Prize 2024 for Biodiversity?
Answer: Vera Voronova (Kazakhstan) and Ysabel Calderón Carlos (Peru).
265. Who won the Nobel Chemistry Prize in 2024 for pioneering protein research?
Answer: David Baker, Demis Hassabis, and John Jumper.
266. Who was elected Chairperson of the 77th WHO Regional Committee for South-East Asia in 2024?
Answer: JP Nadda.
267. Which event will Bihar host from November 11-20, 2024?
Answer: Women's Asian Champions Trophy.

- 268.** Which Olympic gymnast known for the "Produnova" vault retired in 2024?
Answer: Dipa Karmakar.
- 269.** Where will the 38th National Games be held from January 28 to February 14, 2025?
Answer: Uttarakhand.
- 270.** Which scheme in Meghalaya was launched for conservation and forest enhancement in 2024?
Answer: GREEN Meghalaya Plus Scheme.
- 271.** Which scheme was launched in Assam to combat child marriage in 2024?
Answer: Nijut Moina Scheme.
- 272.** Which government pension scheme crossed 7 crore enrollments in FY 2024-25?
Answer: Atal Pension Yojana.
- 273.** What highway infrastructure and services initiative was launched by Nitin Gadkari in 2024?
Answer: Humsafar Policy.
- 274.** Which investigative journalist wrote the book "War," exploring dynamics between Trump, Biden, and Putin?
Answer: Bob Woodward.
- 275.** When is World Cotton Day celebrated, and what does it highlight?
Answer: October 7, highlighting cotton's role in textiles, medical supplies, and animal feed.
- 276.** What is the theme of World Cerebral Palsy Day 2024, celebrated on October 6?
Answer: "#UniquelyCP".
- 277.** When is World Mental Health Day observed?
Answer: October 10.
- 278.** Who passed away at 86, marking the end of an era in Indian business in 2024?
Answer: Ratan Tata.
- 279.** Which renowned cardiac surgeon, the first to perform a heart transplant in India, passed away at 82 in 2024?
Answer: Dr. P. Venugopal.
- 280.** Who inaugurated the National Postal Week in Ahmedabad?
Answer: Postmaster General Krishna Kumar Yadav.
- 281.** Where did PM Narendra Modi inaugurate the Banjara Virasat Museum in October 2024?
Answer: Pohardevi, Washim, Maharashtra.
- 282.** Which BIT agreement did India sign with the UAE in 2024, reducing the arbitration period to 3 years?
Answer: Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT).
- 283.** Which two political parties formed an alliance and won in Jammu & Kashmir's 2024 elections?
Answer: Indian National Congress (INC) and National Conference (NC).
- 284.** What is the name of the National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC) approved by the Union Cabinet in 2024?
Answer: NMHC at Lothal, Gujarat.
- 285.** What amount of agricultural and animal husbandry initiatives were launched by PM Modi in 2024?
Answer: ₹23,300 crore.
- 286.** Who has been appointed as Nepal's Chief Justice in 2024?
Answer: Prakash Man Singh Raut.
- 287.** What major sporting event will Uttarakhand host for the first time in 2025?
Answer: 38th National Games.
- 288.** Which international currency swap agreement worth \$750 million did India sign with the Maldives in 2024?
Answer: India-Maldives currency swap deal.
- 289.** Which hurricane caused Tampa Bay residents to evacuate in October 2024?
Answer: Hurricane Milton.
- 290.** Which protests erupted in Pakistan due to a 40% tax hike under the IMF bailout?
Answer: Anti-tax protests.
- 291.** Which country ended 181 years of horse racing in 2024 to repurpose land for housing developments?
Answer: Singapore.
- 292.** Who became the Chairperson of the WHO South-East Asia Regional Committee in 2024?
Answer: JP Nadda.
- 293.** Which rupee-denominated payment system did India introduce in the Maldives in 2024?
Answer: RuPay card.
- 294.** What project was announced as part of India-Maldives cooperation to ease foreign exchange crises in 2024?
Answer: Hanimadhoo International Airport upgrade.
- 295.** Who was re-elected as Tunisia's President with 90.7% of the vote in 2024?
Answer: Kais Saied.
- 296.** Who won the 2024 MIDORI Prize for Biodiversity?
Answer: Vera Voronova (Kazakhstan) and Ysabel Calderón Carlos (Peru).
- 297.** What was the theme for the 2024 World Habitat Day celebrated on October 7?
Answer: Youth empowerment for a sustainable urban future.
- 298.** Who unveiled the logo and mascot 'Gudiya' for the 2024 Women's Asian Champions Trophy?
Answer: Bihar CM Nitish Kumar.

- 299.** Which 18-year-old Sherpa made history by summiting all 14 of the world's 8,000-meter peaks?
Answer: Nima Rinji.
- 300.** Which organization celebrated its 100th year of establishment on Vijayadashami in 2024?
Answer: RSS (Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh), founded in 1925.
- 301.** What is the contract value and speed specification of India's first indigenous bullet trains by BEML?
Answer: ₹866.87 crore contract, with a test speed of 280 km/h and an operational speed of 250 km/h.
- 302.** Who was sworn in as the Chief Minister of Jammu and Kashmir with Congress support?
Answer: Omar Abdullah.
- 303.** What percentage of global 6G patents does India aim to achieve through Bharat 6G Alliance?
Answer: 10%.
- 304.** What was the recent dearness allowance hike for central government employees?
Answer: 3% increase, totaling 53% of basic pay.
- 305.** What symbolic change was made to the new Supreme Court statue of Lady Justice?
Answer: Now holds the Constitution instead of a sword and the blindfold was removed.
- 306.** What change did Indian Railways announce in Advance Reservation Period?
Answer: Reduced from 120 to 60 days starting November 1, 2024.
- 307.** Which country cut diplomatic ties with Israel due to the Gaza conflict?
Answer: Nicaragua.
- 308.** Which city was recognized as the world's richest with \$1.7 trillion in sovereign wealth funds?
Answer: Abu Dhabi.
- 309.** Who was nominated as the 51st Chief Justice of India?
Answer: Justice Sanjiv Khanna.
- 310.** Who was appointed as the chairman of Tata Trusts after Ratan Tata's passing?
Answer: Noel Tata.
- 311.** Which actress was appointed as jury member for ALT Environmental Film Festival 2024?
Answer: Dia Mirza.
- 312.** Which state initiated a caste-based survey in 2024?
Answer: Telangana.
- 313.** How many wetlands is Assam planning to revive?
Answer: 129 wetlands covering 3,800 hectares.
- 314.** Who was sworn in as Haryana CM for the second term?
Answer: Nayab Singh Saini.
- 315.** What is the new monthly honorarium for women in Jharkhand under Maiyaan Samman Yojana?
Answer: ₹2,500.
- 316.** Which bank launched the 'bob Utsav Deposit Scheme'?
Answer: Bank of Baroda.
- 317.** What rank did Navi achieve in UPI transactions?
Answer: 5th position.
- 318.** Which company became India's 14th Maharatna company?
Answer: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL).
- 319.** What was the value of India-U.S. defense deal for MQ-9B armed UAVs?
Answer: \$3.5 billion for 31 UAVs.
- 320.** Who received the IAF World Space Award for Chandrayaan-3's success?
Answer: ISRO Chairman S. Somanath.
- 321.** What is ShakthiSAT's main objective?
Answer: To train 12,000 girls globally in space technology.
- 322.** What is the duration of PM's Internship Scheme target?
Answer: To provide internships to one crore youth over five years.
- 323.** What was the income rise percentage for rural households according to NABARD?
Answer: 57.6% over five years.
- 324.** Who became the most expensive player in Hockey India League Auction 2024?
Answer: Harmanpreet Singh for Rs 78 lakh.
- 325.** Which three cricketers were inducted into the ICC Hall of Fame?
Answer: Neetu David, Alastair Cook, and AB de Villiers.
- 326.** What was the theme of International Day of Rural Women 2024?
Answer: "Rural Women Sustaining Nature for Our Collective Future."
- 327.** Which radio presenter from Darbhanga passed away at 77?
Answer: Indranand Singh Jha.
- 328.** What is the name of Meta and government's anti-online scam initiative?
Answer: "Scam se Bacho" Campaign.
- 329.** Who is the new CEO of Government e-Marketplace (GeM)?
Answer: L Satya Srinivas.
- 330.** What is the new name of Maharashtra State Skills Development University?
Answer: Padma Vibhushan Ratan Tata Skills University.

331. Where was India's first self-powered indoor air quality monitor launched?
Answer: Thiruvananthapuram Airport.
332. What is the wholesale inflation rate in September 2024?
Answer: 1.84%.
333. Which defense exercise was conducted by Indian Coast Guard?
Answer: 'Sagar Kavach' Drill.
334. Who won the National Kishore Kumar Award 2023?
Answer: Rajkumar Hirani.
335. What is the name of NASA's mission to explore Jupiter's moon?
Answer: Europa Clipper.
336. Where was India's first biopolymer demonstration facility inaugurated?
Answer: Pune.
337. Who is the new Maldives Ambassador to India?
Answer: Aishath Azeema.
338. How many madrasas in Uttarakhand will make Sanskrit mandatory?
Answer: 416 madrasas.
339. Which place was recognized as India's second-largest butterfly diversity hub?
Answer: Kaziranga.
340. What is the duration of PM GatiShakti's infrastructure transformation?
Answer: Three years.
341. Where was the National Skill Training Institute inaugurated?
Answer: Visakhapatnam.
342. What position did India achieve in supplying restricted tech to Russia?
Answer: Second-largest supplier.
343. What funding did WHO secure for global health emergency responses?
Answer: \$1 billion.
344. Which former RAW official is wanted by the FBI?
Answer: Vikash Yadav.
345. Where was the Indo-Turkiye Friendship Association launched?
Answer: Hyderabad.
346. What is the new version of eMigrate portal launched by EAM Jaishankar?
Answer: eMigrate V2.0.
347. Who was appointed as Special Secretary for Internal Security?
Answer: Praveen Vashista.
348. What is Karnataka's new ambition in the gaming industry?
Answer: To become Asia's top animation and gaming hub.
349. Which state assembly passed a resolution against the Waqf Amendment Bill 2024?
Answer: Kerala.
350. What is the name of the festival celebrated in Manipur to promote unity?
Answer: Mera Hou Chongba.
351. Where was the ASEAN Summit 2024 focused on?
Answer: Regional connectivity, digital economy, and climate change.
352. In which cities were AI Centres of Excellence launched?
Answer: Delhi, Ropar, and Kanpur.
353. Where did HDFC Bank open its first international branch?
Answer: Singapore.
354. Who was appointed as MD & CEO of Bandhan Bank?
Answer: Partha Pratim Sengupta.
355. Which bridge was renamed after Kargil War hero Capt. Amit Bhardwaj?
Answer: Kaksar Bridge.
356. What is the theme of World Anaesthesia Day 2024?
Answer: "Workforce Well Being."
357. When will India's sovereign bonds be included in FTSE Russell EMGB Index?
Answer: 2025.
358. Who became the new CEO of ACKO Life?
Answer: Sandip Goenka.
359. Which state's university will be named after Maharishi Valmiki?
Answer: Raichur University, Karnataka.
360. What is the main focus of India Digital Agri Conference 2024?
Answer: Promoting digital technologies like AI and IoT for agricultural advancement.
361. Where was the SCO Summit 2024 held?
Answer: Islamabad.
362. What award did Mohanji receive in 2024?
Answer: Prestigious 2024 Humanitarian Award.
363. Which bank was barred from disbursing loans by RBI?
Answer: Navi Finserv and 3 other NBFCs.
364. What initiative did SECL launch for affordable medicines?
Answer: AMRIT Pharmacies.

365. Who won ICC Player of the Month Awards for September 2024?
Answer: Kamindu Mendis and Tammy Beaumont.
366. What defense system did the US send to Israel?
Answer: THAAD missile defense system.
367. Where did the Indian Army organize events to honor 1962 war heroes?
Answer: Walong War.
368. What is the duration of President Murmu's tour?
Answer: Three-nation tour.
369. Which state is getting an X-Band radar after floods?
Answer: Kerala's Wayanad.
370. What is the focus of World Statistics Day 2024?
Answer: Role of statistics in sustainable development and informed policymaking.
371. What did WHO declare about India's vaccine regulatory system?
Answer: Declared functional and meeting global standards.
372. What license did Jio Payments Bank secure?
Answer: Mutual Funds Distribution License from AMFI.
373. Where was the Naval VLF Station foundation laid?
Answer: Telangana.
374. What is the theme of Breast Cancer Awareness Month 2024?
Answer: "No one should face breast cancer alone."
375. When is International Abhidhamma Divas celebrated?
Answer: October 17.
376. What is the focus of World Food Day 2024?
Answer: Global hunger and malnutrition challenges.
377. Who inaugurated the ITU Telecom Conference?
Answer: PM Narendra Modi.
378. What did the Supreme Court uphold with a 4-1 majority?
Answer: Constitutional validity of Section 6A of the Citizenship Act.
379. What initiative is PM Modi launching for civil servants?
Answer: 'Karmayogi Saptah' under Mission Karmayogi.
380. Which state became the first to subclassify Scheduled Castes into "Deprived" and "Other" groups?
Answer: Haryana
381. Who has been appointed as the 51st Chief Justice of India with oath-taking scheduled for November 11, 2024?
Answer: Justice Sanjiv Khanna
382. Name the first Indian woman footballer to score 50 international goals in the 2024 SAFF Women's Championship.
Answer: Bala Devi
383. Which company surpassed Apple in market value, reaching \$3.53 trillion due to high demand for AI supercomputing chips?
Answer: Nvidia
384. How many new airports did PM Modi inaugurate under the UDAN scheme recently?
Answer: Three airports (Saharanpur, Rewa, and Ambikapur)
385. Which African country was declared malaria-free by WHO on October 20, 2024?
Answer: Egypt
386. Who won silver at the 2024 Archery World Cup Final in Mexico?
Answer: Deepika Kumari
387. How much loan has ADB sanctioned for a 500 MW solar plant in Assam's Karbi Anglong district?
Answer: \$434 million
388. Which place has been named as the most popular travel destination for Indians in 2025?
Answer: Shillong
389. What is India's projected economic growth rate for FY25 according to Deloitte?
Answer: 7-7.2%
390. Which hurricane struck Cuba recently causing 6 deaths and triggering protests over power outages?
Answer: Hurricane Oscar
391. Who has been named as the new CEO of JP Morgan Chase India for three years with RBI approval?
Answer: Pranav Chawda



392. What is the name of the new snake species discovered in Western Himalayas named after a Hollywood actor?
Answer: Anguiculus dicaprioi (named after Leonardo DiCaprio)
393. How long have India and Pakistan extended the Kartarpur Corridor agreement?
Answer: Five years
394. Which Indian hockey legend retired after 254 matches and 120 goals?
Answer: Rani Rampal
395. What is the name of the coal gallery inaugurated at National Science Centre, New Delhi?
Answer: "Black Diamond – Unveiling the Depths"
396. Which country recently introduced UPI to boost its economy under President Mohamed Muizzu?
Answer: Maldives
397. Who has been appointed as the new Coal Secretary?
Answer: Vikram Dev Dutt
398. Which cricket player became the fastest to take 300 Test wickets by balls bowled?
Answer: Kagiso Rabada (in 11,817 deliveries)
399. What is the new Mudra loan limit after being doubled under the 'Tarun Plus' category?
Answer: ₹20 lakh (increased from ₹10 lakh)
400. Which Indian state launched the 'Pink Alarms' system for women's safety in government hospitals?
Answer: Madhya Pradesh
401. What is the time period for the 21st Livestock Census launched by Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh?
Answer: October 2024 to February 2025
402. How many members are there in Indonesia's newly announced "Red and White Cabinet"?
Answer: 109 members
403. Which IIT is planning to launch a research centre in Dubai by 2025?
Answer: IIT Madras
404. Where will the 18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas be held?
Answer: Bhubaneswar, Odisha
405. What is the amount granted by India for Sri Lanka's plantation sector education?
Answer: Rs. 600 million
406. Which Indian cricketer surpassed Nathan Lyon to become the top ICC World Test Championship wicket-taker?
Answer: Ravichandran Ashwin (with 189 wickets)
407. Which company has partnered with Nvidia to develop AI infrastructure in India?
Answer: Reliance Industries
408. Who has been appointed as Google's Chief Technologist?
Answer: Prabhakar Raghavan
409. What is the current FIFA ranking of the Indian Football Team?
Answer: 125th
410. Which state launched the 'Citizen Sentinel App' for reporting traffic violations?
Answer: Kerala
411. How many casual leave days per year has Odisha granted to women employees?
Answer: 27 days
412. When will the International Gita Mahotsav 2024 be held in Kurukshetra, Haryana?
Answer: November 28 to December 15
413. What is the name of the joint naval exercise between India and Oman held off Goa?
Answer: Naseem Al Bahr
414. Which country is being honored as the "Country of Focus" at IFFI 2024?
Answer: Australia
415. Who has been appointed as the 9th Chairperson of the National Commission for Women?
Answer: Vijaya Kishore Rahatkar
416. Which bank reappointed Amitabh Chaudhry as MD & CEO for three more years starting January 1, 2025?
Answer: Axis Bank
417. Who has been named as Ambassador to Sweden?
Answer: Dr. Neena Malhotra
418. Which state's CM initiated Rs 7,160 crore for panchayat development?
Answer: Bihar (CM Nitish Kumar)
419. What is the name of the organization that received dual honors from Avatar and Seramout for DEI?
Answer: HDFC Life
420. How many civil servants from Maldives will be trained between 2024-2029 under the MoU?
Answer: 1,000 civil servants
421. Which military leader was elected as President of Vietnam?
Answer: Luong Cuong
422. What is the duration of the Chief Justice's term according to Pakistan's 26th Amendment?
Answer: Three years

423. Who won the 2024 Sakharov Prize for Freedom of Thought?
Answer: María Corina Machado and Edmundo González Urrutia
424. What percentage increase in uniform allowance was announced for UP police?
Answer: 70%
425. Which team won the Senior Women Inter-Departmental National Hockey Championship?
Answer: Railways (defeating Indian Oil 3-1)
426. What was Zimbabwe's record-breaking highest T20I total against Gambia?
Answer: 344/4
427. Which state launched Mission Basundhara 3.0 to empower indigenous communities?
Answer: Assam
428. Who acquired a ₹1,000 crore stake in Karan Johar's Dharma Productions?
Answer: Adar Poonawalla
429. What is the name of the new ASW ship that joined the Indian Navy?
Answer: 'Abhay'
430. Which organization added 13 unauthorized forex trading platforms to its alert list?
Answer: RBI
431. When is World Audiovisual Heritage Day celebrated?
Answer: October 27
432. Which state won the 24th National Para-Swimming Championship?
Answer: Karnataka (with 392 points)
433. Which century's copper plates were discovered at Sri Singeeswarar temple, Tiruvallur?
Answer: 16th Century (dating back to 1513 CE)
434. Where is the India-Singapore maritime exercise SIMBEX 2024 taking place?
Answer: Visakhapatnam
435. How long has the UDAN scheme been extended for?
Answer: 10 years
436. Which is the latest country to join ADB as its 69th member?
Answer: Israel
437. Who will be inducted into the 2025 International Tennis Hall of Fame?
Answer: Maria Sharapova and Bryan Brothers
438. Who is the author of the book "Mountain Mammals of the World"?
Answer: M.K. Ranjitsinh
439. How much funding has European Investment Bank allocated for Bengaluru's suburban railway?
Answer: ₹2,800 Crore
440. When is the 63rd ITBP Raising Day celebrated?
Answer: October 24
441. Which insurance company received IRDAI license to expand its offerings to 25 million users?
Answer: Freeto
442. Which company has joined the International Copper Association (ICA)?
Answer: Hindalco Industries Ltd.
443. Who has been appointed as the new DGP of Jharkhand?
Answer: Mr. Prashant Singh
444. What is the current rate of inflation in Pakistan as per the latest CPI report?
Answer: 32%
445. What did PM Modi emphasize in the 115th Mann Ki Baat?
Answer: India's unity, cultural heritage, self-reliance, and technological advancements.
446. Which paintings did PM Modi gift to Putin at the BRICS Summit?
Answer: Jharkhand's Sohrai Painting and Maharashtra's Mother of Pearl Vase and Warli Painting.
447. When will the Census in India begin?
Answer: In 2025.
448. What digital initiative did the Railway Protection Force launch?
Answer: A digital memorial honoring fallen personnel.
449. Where was India's first Writer's Village inaugurated?
Answer: Dehradun.
450. What is the value of healthcare projects launched by PM Modi on Ayurveda Day?
Answer: ₹12,850 crore.
451. Where were Konark Wheel replicas recently installed?
Answer: At Amrit Udyan in Rashtrapati Bhavan.
452. What is India's first locally assembled aircraft, and when is it expected?
Answer: C295 aircraft, expected by 2026.
453. What age group is eligible for free healthcare under the Ayushman Vaya Vandana Card?
Answer: Citizens aged 70+.
454. Which zoo in India is set to receive IGBC certification?
Answer: Durgesh Aranya Zoological Park in Himachal Pradesh.

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| <p>455. Which countries introduced the DiGi Framework?
Answer: The US, Japan, and South Korea.</p> <p>456. What group allegedly hacked Trump's campaign data?
Answer: Chinese group "Salt Typhoon."</p> <p>457. Which country opted out of China's Belt and Road Initiative?
Answer: Brazil.</p> <p>458. What is the focus of the renewed MoU between Indian Railways and Switzerland?
Answer: Infrastructure modernization.</p> <p>459. Which country is developing the world's first green energy island?
Answer: Belgium.</p> <p>460. Who became Hezbollah's new chief after Hassan Nasrallah?
Answer: Sheikh Naim Qassem.</p> <p>461. What recent typhoon affected Taiwan?
Answer: Typhoon Kong-rey.</p> <p>462. Which village in Rajasthan has achieved zero-waste status?
Answer: Aandhi village.</p> <p>463. How much investment did PM Modi unveil in Gujarat's Ekta Nagar?
Answer: ₹284 crore.</p> <p>464. Who was appointed Chairman of Airports Authority of India?
Answer: Vipin Kumar.</p> <p>465. Who is the new CEO of Bharti Airtel?
Answer: Shashwat Sharma.</p> <p>466. Who succeeded Giridhar Aramane as Defence Secretary?
Answer: Rajesh Kumar Singh.</p> <p>467. Who was appointed as the Secretary General of the World Agriculture Forum?
Answer: Dr. Jacqueline d'Arros Hughes.</p> <p>468. Who is the new CEO and MD of MCX?
Answer: Praveena Rai.</p> <p>469. Which bank was awarded Best Bank in India 2024 by Global Finance Magazine?
Answer: State Bank of India.</p> <p>470. Which bank received RBI's approval to offer forex services?
Answer: Ujjivan Small Finance Bank.</p> <p>471. Who was recommended by FSIB as MD and CEO of Punjab National Bank?
Answer: Ashok Chandra.</p> <p>472. Which bank aims to increase female workforce representation to 35%?
Answer: DBS Bank India.</p> | <p>473. How much gold did RBI recently transport from the Bank of England to India?
Answer: 102 tonnes.</p> <p>474. Which company partnered with VERBIO India for biogas projects?
Answer: GAIL.</p> <p>475. Which company launched the New Health Seva Plan for free healthcare?
Answer: Reliance Foundation.</p> <p>476. Which banks partnered for collateral-free solar financing for MSEs?
Answer: IndusInd Bank and Tata Power.</p> <p>477. What is the starting amount for Jio Financial's SmartGold investment?
Answer: ₹10.</p> <p>478. Which two companies are collaborating on mutual fund ventures in India?
Answer: Jio Financial and BlackRock.</p> <p>479. What were the GST collections for October 2024?
Answer: ₹1.87 lakh crore.</p> <p>480. Which two vessels did Goa Shipyard Limited launch for the Coast Guard?
Answer: Adamya and Akshar.</p> <p>481. What is the name of the India-US Special Forces Exercise?
Answer: VAJRA PRAHAR.</p> <p>482. Which countries participated in the GARUD SHAKTI 24 Exercise?
Answer: India and Indonesia.</p> <p>483. Who won the Ballon d'Or 2024 awards?
Answer: Rodri and Bonmati.</p> <p>484. Who was honored with the ANR Award in cinema?
Answer: Chiranjeevi.</p> <p>485. Which sports league was awarded Best Sports League of the Year?
Answer: Pro Kabaddi League (PKL).</p> <p>486. Who received Fiji's highest civilian honor?
Answer: Sri Sri Ravi Shankar.</p> <p>487. Which Australian cricketer retired and joined the coaching staff?
Answer: Matthew Wade.</p> <p>488. Who won gold in the U23 World Wrestling Championships?
Answer: Chirag Chikkara.</p> <p>489. What place did India secure at the Asian Armwrestling Cup 2024?
Answer: Second place.</p> <p>490. What is the focus of the Pradhan Mantri Vanbandhu Kalyan Yojana?
Answer: Tribal welfare and sustainable development.</p> |
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- 491.** How many volunteers are engaged in the MY Bharat Diwali initiative?
Answer: 200,000 volunteers.
- 492.** When is International Animation Day celebrated?
Answer: October 28.
- 493.** Which day is observed on October 29 to honor caregivers?
Answer: International Day of Care and Support.
- 494.** What rank did India receive in the Rule of Law Index 2023?
Answer: 79th.
- 495.** How many diyas were lit for Ayodhya's Deepotsav 2024?
Answer: 2.5 million diyas. bold only questions
- 496.** When did India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) celebrate its 7th Foundation Day?
Answer: September 2, 2024.
- 497.** What did PM Modi highlight at the Economic Times World Leaders Forum?
Answer: India's 90% economic growth over the past decade and commitment to sustained reforms.
- 498.** What was unveiled by PM Modi during the District Judges Conference in New Delhi?
Answer: A commemorative stamp celebrating 75 years of the Supreme Court of India.
- 499.** Where and when was the 7th Rashtriya Poshan Maah 2024 launched?
Answer: Launched in Gandhinagar, Gujarat, by Union Minister Smt Annpurna Devi.
- 500.** What event did the University of Manipur host in collaboration with NHRC?
Answer: A two-day Human Rights Training Programme.
- 501.** Who unveiled the new Supreme Court flag and insignia?
Answer: President Droupadi Murmu during a national judiciary conference in New Delhi.
- 502.** What semiconductor unit was approved by the Union Cabinet and where?
Answer: Kaynes Semicon Pvt Ltd's unit in Sanand, Gujarat.
- 503.** How many agricultural schemes were approved by the Union Cabinet to boost farmers' incomes?
Answer: Seven schemes with an outlay of Rs 14,235.30 Crore.
- 504.** What was the focus of the "Vishanu Yuddh Abhyas" conducted in Rajasthan?
Answer: Pandemic preparedness under the National One Health Mission.
- 505.** Who was appointed as the 23rd Law Commission Chairman and when?
Answer: President Droupadi Murmu approved the constitution of the 23rd Law Commission for a three-year term starting September 2024.
- 506.** What historic visit did PM Narendra Modi make on September 3, 2024?
Answer: He became the first Indian Prime Minister to visit Brunei.
- 507.** What is India's target for global alcoholic beverage exports?
Answer: Rs. 8,000 crore (US\$ 952.9 million).
- 508.** What new fashion forecasting initiative was launched by India's Textile Ministry?
Answer: VisioNxt Fashion Forecasting Initiative with 'Paridhi 24x25'.
- 509.** When and where was the Khel Utsav 2024 organized?
Answer: August 27-30, 2024, at Major Dhyan Chand Stadium and Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, New Delhi.
- 510.** Where will the 2024 Women's Asian Champions Trophy be held?
Answer: Rajgir, Bihar, at the newly constructed Rajgir Hockey Stadium.
- 511.** What major investment did Uttar Pradesh announce for IT and ITeS hubs?
Answer: ₹33,500 crore across five major cities.
- 512.** What new scheme was launched by the Madhya Pradesh government?
Answer: 'Brindavan Gram' scheme to transform gram panchayats into model villages.
- 513.** Which states reported the highest GSDP growth in FY24?
Answer: Telangana, Tamil Nadu, and Rajasthan.
- 514.** What significant project will the Uttar Pradesh government build at Sampurnanand Sanskrit University?
Answer: A Vedic-3D museum.
- 515.** Who inaugurated IIT Delhi's Abu Dhabi campus?
Answer: Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan.
- 516.** What event will India and UNESCO co-host on September 6, 2024?
Answer: The 2024 Chief Science Advisers' Roundtable in Paris.
- 517.** Which powerful storm hit Southeast Asia recently?
Answer: Super Typhoon Yagi.
- 518.** Who assumed the role of AOC-In-C, Central Air Command on September 1, 2024?
Answer: Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit.

- 519.** Who took additional charge as IOCL Chairman after Shrikant Madhav Vaidya?
Answer: V. Satish Kumar.
- 520.** Who is the new Managing Director of Philips India?
Answer: Bharath Sessa.
- 521.** Which Bollywood actress was named L'Oreal Paris Global Ambassador?
Answer: Alia Bhatt.
- 522.** Who has been appointed as a selector for the Indian men's cricket team?
Answer: Ajay Ratra.
- 523.** What role has Sharath Kamal been appointed to?
Answer: ITTF Foundation Ambassador.
- 524.** Which two countries signed a semiconductor partnership agreement recently?
Answer: India and Singapore.
- 525.** What MoU was signed between India and UAE?
Answer: To strengthen audit cooperation.
- 526.** Where was the first Joint Commander's Conference of Indian Armed Forces held?
Answer: Lucknow.
- 527.** Which international event did the Indian Coast Guard participate in?
Answer: 20th HACGAM in Incheon, South Korea.
- 528.** What conference was organized by CIET, NCERT on September 7, 2024?
Answer: Conference on "Spectrum of Literacy".
- 529.** What is the name of India's first multi-brand co-branded card launched by fintech startup POP?
Answer: The card in partnership with RuPay and Yes Bank.
- 530.** What authorization did Tamil Nadu's Paysharp recently secure?
Answer: RBI authorization.
- 531.** What was India's GST collection in August 2024?
Answer: ₹1.75 lakh crore.
- 532.** What is the World Bank's new growth forecast for India for FY25?
Answer: 7%.
- 533.** What stake is the Finance Ministry planning to sell in GIC Re?
Answer: 6.78%.
- 534.** What partnership did Bisleri enter for waste management in Goa?
Answer: With the Goa government.
- 535.** Which company became India's first to surpass ₹10 lakh crore in annual revenue?
Answer: Reliance Industries Limited.
- 536.** What new insurance policies has Star Health introduced?
Answer: Braille insurance policies for the visually impaired.
- 537.** What is Kotak General Insurance's new name following Zurich's acquisition?
Answer: Zurich Kotak General Insurance.
- 538.** Who received SEBI approval for the position of MD & CEO of CDSL?
Answer: Nehal Vora.
- 539.** What is the focus of Google DeepMind's Morni AI project?
Answer: To cover 125 Indic languages, including 73 with no existing digital corpus.
- 540.** What fund was launched by Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan for agricultural and rural start-ups?
Answer: AgriSURE Fund with ₹750 crore.
- 541.** What new technology stack was launched by MeitY?
Answer: Vishvasya-Blockchain Technology Stack.
- 542.** What initiative is PM Modi set to launch for water conservation in Surat?
Answer: "Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari".
- 543.** When was the 21st edition of the India-France naval exercise Varuna held?
Answer: In two phases in 2023.
- 544.** What was the focus of the 5th India-Maldives Defence Cooperation Dialogue?
Answer: Defence cooperation in the Indian Ocean.
- 545.** When was the Agni-4 IRBM successfully tested?
Answer: September 6, 2024.
- 546.** What list named influential figures in AI, featuring prominent Indians?
Answer: TIME100.
- 547.** Who received the Olympic Order in gold from the IOC?
Answer: President Emmanuel Macron.
- 548.** Which animator received the Ramon Magsaysay Award 2024?
Answer: Hayao Miyazaki.
- 549.** Which ministry won the e-Governance Gold Award for the Poshan Tracker initiative?
Answer: Ministry of Women and Child Development.
- 550.** What is the title of Kuldeep Gupta's new book exploring global energy challenges?
Answer: "From Oil to Lithium: Navigating the Future of Energy".
- 551.** Which athlete won bronze in the Women's 10m Air Pistol SH1 event at the Paris Paralympics?
Answer: Rubina Francis.

552. Who became the first Indian woman to win two Paralympic medals in athletics?
Answer: Preethi Pal.
553. Which Indian athlete won silver in the men's T47 high jump at the Paris Paralympics?
Answer: Nishad Kumar.
554. Where will the ICC World Test Championship Final be held in 2025?
Answer: Lord's Cricket Ground.
555. Which team won their first Durand Cup title recently?
Answer: NorthEast United FC.
556. Who secured bronze in mixed team compound archery at the Paris 2024 Paralympics?
Answer: Sheetal Devi and Rakesh Kumar.
557. Which Indian badminton player won silver in the men's singles SL4 category at the Paris 2024 Paralympics?
Answer: Suhas Yathiraj.
558. What medals did Thulasimathi Murugesan and Manisha Ramadass win at the Paris 2024 Paralympics?
Answer: Silver and bronze, respectively, in women's singles SU5.
559. Who won gold in men's javelin throw F64 at the Paris 2024 Paralympics?
Answer: Sumit Antil.
560. Which athlete won gold in the women's air pistol event at the World Deaf Shooting Championship in Hannover, Germany?
Answer: Anuya Prasad.
561. Who won India's first-ever Paralympic gold medal in archery at the Paris 2024 Paralympics?
Answer: Harvinder Singh.
562. What medal did Sachin Sarjerao Khilari win in the men's F46 shot put event at the Paris 2024 Paralympics?
Answer: Silver.
563. Which athletes won gold and silver in the men's F51 club throw event at the 2024 Paralympics?
Answer: Dharambir (gold) and Pranav Soorma (silver).
564. Who won India's first Paralympic judo medal and in which category?
Answer: Kapil Parmar with bronze in the men's 60kg (J1) category.
565. What medal did Hokato Hotozhe Sema win at the Paris 2024 Paralympics?
Answer: Bronze in shot put F57.
566. Who won gold in men's high jump T64 at the Paris Paralympics 2024?
Answer: Praveen Kumar.
567. When is National Nutrition Week observed?
Answer: September 1 to 7.
568. What day is celebrated on September 2?
Answer: World Coconut Day.
569. When is Teacher's Day celebrated?
Answer: September 5.
570. What is the focus of the International Day of Charity observed on September 5?
Answer: Highlighting the importance of charity in promoting social bonds and addressing global challenges.
571. When is the International Day of Police Cooperation observed?
Answer: September 7.
572. What is the purpose of World Duchenne Awareness Day observed on September 7?
Answer: Focusing on Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy.
573. What is promoted on International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies?
Answer: Action for clean air globally.
574. When is International Literacy Day celebrated?
Answer: September 8.
575. What day is observed on the first Saturday of September?
Answer: International Vulture Awareness Day.
576. Which Chilean tennis legend recently passed away at age 91?
Answer: Luis Ayala.
577. Who released the '200 Not Out' documentary about Mumbai Samachar, Asia's oldest newspaper?
Answer: Amit Shah.
578. Which country has become the second-largest 5G smartphone market globally, surpassing the U.S.?
Answer: India.
579. Who was re-elected as the Chairperson of the Parliamentary Committee on Official Language?
Answer: Amit Shah.
580. When will India host the 2nd Asia Pacific Ministerial Conference on Civil Aviation?
Answer: September 11-12, 2024.
581. Which organization approved the National Test House, Ghaziabad, for drone certification?
Answer: Quality Council of India (QCI).
582. What was the 132nd anniversary that PM Modi marked with an emphasis on unity and peace?
Answer: Vivekananda's Chicago Speech.

- 583.** How many kilometers of roads will be constructed under PMGSY-IV from FY 2024-25 to 2028-29?
Answer: 62,500 km.
- 584.** What is the 'Rangeen Machhli' app launched for?
Answer: To support the ornamental fisheries sector.
- 585.** Which country will be the exclusive partner at European Hydrogen Week in 2024?
Answer: India.
- 586.** Who inaugurated the 2nd International Conference on Green Hydrogen in 2024?
Answer: PM Modi.
- 587.** Who was appointed as France's new Prime Minister on September 5, 2024?
Answer: Michel Barnier.
- 588.** Which country officially joined the BRICS New Development Bank in 2024?
Answer: Algeria.
- 589.** What is the name of the new species of the Genus *Curcuma* discovered in India?
Answer: A new species was discovered in Nagaland.
- 590.** Which MoU did India and UAE sign recently?
Answer: A historic MoU for civil nuclear cooperation.
- 591.** Who launched the third edition of the Asha Scholarship Program?
Answer: SBI Foundation.
- 592.** What was the CPI-based retail inflation in August 2024?
Answer: 3.65%.
- 593.** Which joint military exercise began in Rajasthan in 2024?
Answer: India-USA Yudh Abhyas-2024.
- 594.** What is the name of the light tank that DRDO recently completed the first phase of trials for?
Answer: Zorawar.
- 595.** Who authored the book "Five Decades in Politics"?
Answer: Sushil Kumar Shinde.
- 596.** What scheme is marking five years, providing pensions to small and marginal farmers?
Answer: PM-Kisan Maandhan Yojana.
- 597.** Who launched the 'Ashtalakshmi Mahotsav' website to promote Northeast India's cultural and economic richness?
Answer: Jyotiraditya Scindia.
- 598.** How many years has the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana completed in enhancing India's fisheries sector?
Answer: 4 years.
- 599.** Who inaugurated the Swachh Vayu Survekshan Award 2024?
Answer: Bhupender Yadav and Rajasthan CM.
- 600.** Who presented the National Florence Nightingale Awards 2024?
Answer: President Droupadi Murmu.
- 601.** Which Indian-origin lecturer won Singapore's literature prize for her debut work "Nine Yard Sarees"?
Answer: Prasanthi Ram.
- 602.** Where was the SEMICON India 2024 event held, inaugurated by PM Modi?
Answer: Greater Noida.
- 603.** When will the QUAD Leaders Summit 2024 be hosted by President Joe Biden?
Answer: September 21, 2024.
- 604.** What global ranking session began on September 10, 2024, focusing on international peace, security, and development?
Answer: 79th UN General Assembly Session.
- 605.** Which country participated in the BRICS Literature Forum 2024 in Kazan, Russia?
Answer: India.
- 606.** What did Amit Shah inaugurate in New Delhi related to national security in 2024?
Answer: National Security Strategies Conference 2024.
- 607.** Which event was organized by MoEFCC to advance climate action on World Ozone Day 2024?
Answer: A dialogue on the Montreal Protocol.
- 608.** Which summit concluded in California, fostering India-USA defense innovation collaboration?
Answer: INDUS-X Summit 2024.
- 609.** Which cricketer announced retirement from international cricket in 2024?
Answer: Moeen Ali.
- 610.** Which country won the 4th Intercontinental Cup Football Championship, defeating India?
Answer: Syria.
- 611.** Who became the first schoolgirl champion at the Asian Youth Boxing Championships?
Answer: Deepali Thapa.
- 612.** Which two athletes were selected as India's flag bearers for the Paralympics closing ceremony in 2024?
Answer: Harvinder Singh and Preeti Pal.
- 613.** Who won the men's singles title at the 2024 US Open?
Answer: Jannik Sinner.

614. Which Indian state ranks No. 1 for having the most AYUSH doctors in primary health centers?
Answer: Madhya Pradesh.
615. Which football tournament concluded its 63rd edition in New Delhi on September 11, 2024?
Answer: Subroto Cup International Football Tournament.
616. How many Indian companies were featured in TIME's World's Best Companies 2024 list?
Answer: 22 Indian companies.
617. What significant social media milestone did Cristiano Ronaldo achieve in 2024?
Answer: He reached a global social media milestone.
618. What cybersecurity ranking did India achieve in 2024?
Answer: Tier 1 in the Global Cybersecurity Index 2024.
619. What day celebrates India's linguistic diversity and adoption of Hindi as an official language in 1949?
Answer: Hindi Diwas 2024.
620. Which festival did Zaskar celebrate for the first time since becoming a district in 2024?
Answer: 9th Ladakh Zaskar Festival 2024.
621. Which country did India participate with in the BRICS Literature Forum 2024?
Answer: Russia (Kazan).
622. What was the name of the newborn calf introduced by PM Modi at his residence?
Answer: Deepjyoti.
623. What action did India take regarding the minimum export price of Basmati rice in 2024?
Answer: Removed the \$950 per tonne minimum export price.
624. Which new rapid rail service did PM Modi inaugurate in 2024?
Answer: Namo Bharat Rapid Rail (Ahmedabad to Bhuj).
625. Which UNESCO World Heritage Site was named Asia's most photogenic in 2024?
Answer: Angkor Wat, Cambodia.
626. What is the theme of Jammu and Kashmir's voter turnout campaign song for the upcoming elections?
Answer: 'Vote Ka Tyohar.'
627. Where will Bharatiya Kala Mahotsav 2024 be held?
Answer: Rashtrapati Nilayam.
628. What is the theme of Swachh Bharat Mission's SHS 2024 campaign?
Answer: 'Swabhav Swachhata - Sanskaar Swachhata.'
629. Who led the recommendations accepted by the Union Cabinet for Simultaneous Elections (ONOE)?
Answer: Ram Nath Kovind.
630. What is the name of India's first fashion forecasting initiative launched by NIFT in 2024?
Answer: 'VisioNxt'
631. Which event did President Murmu attend under the Swachhata Hi Seva—2024 campaign?
Answer: Safai Mitra Sammelan in Ujjain.
632. Which poem and chapter were included in Class VI curriculum in 2024?
Answer: 'National War Memorial' poem and 'Veer Abdul Hameed' chapter.
633. Which two countries marked 75 years of diplomatic relations in 2024?
Answer: India and Romania.
634. Who inaugurated the 'Samvidhan Mandir' in Maharashtra?
Answer: Vice President Jagdeep Dhankhar.
635. What center was inaugurated in Leh by MSME Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi?
Answer: Centre for Rural Enterprise Acceleration through Technology (CREATE).
636. Which state enacted the Public and Private Property Damage Recovery Ordinance Act 2024?
Answer: Uttarakhand.
637. Where was the 19th Divya Kala Mela inaugurated in 2024?
Answer: Visakhapatnam.
638. Where did PM Modi lay the foundation stone for the PM Mega Integrated Textile Regions and Apparel Park in 2024?
Answer: Maharashtra.
639. Which satellite did Iran launch in 2024?
Answer: Chamran-1 research satellite.
640. Which countries were struck by Typhoon Bebinca in 2024?
Answer: The Philippines, Japan, and soon expected in China (Shanghai).
641. Who was appointed as Jordan's new Prime Minister in 2024?
Answer: Jafar Hassan.
642. How many people were killed in Lebanon pager explosions in 2024?
Answer: 9 people.
643. Which two countries enhanced energy cooperation in 2024?
Answer: India and the US.
644. Which country launched the world's first AI-powered trade license service at SIF 2024?
Answer: United Arab Emirates (Sharjah).

645. Which country celebrated the ninth anniversary of its Constitution declaration in 2024?
Answer: Nepal.
646. What portal did Piyush Goyal launch to address exporters' issues in 2024?
Answer: 'Jan Sunwai Portal.'
647. What is the new UPI transaction limit for tax payments as per NPCI in 2024?
Answer: ₹5 lakh per transaction.
648. What was India's forex reserves as of September 6, 2024?
Answer: USD 689.24 billion.
649. Which state surpassed Punjab in GDP in 2024, according to the EAC-PM report?
Answer: Haryana.
650. What is the windfall tax on crude petroleum as of September 18, 2024?
Answer: Reduced to zero.
651. By what percentage did India's exports to China fall in August 2024?
Answer: 22.44%.
652. How much funding has been allocated for the revamped PM-AASHA scheme in 2024?
Answer: ₹35,000 crore.
653. By what year is India expected to become the third largest economy according to the 2024 report?
Answer: 2030-31.
654. How much disaster relief funding was allocated by the Modi government in 2024?
Answer: ₹12,554 crore.
655. What is the corpus of Atal Pension Yojana in 2024?
Answer: ₹35,149 crore.
656. What CSR initiative of HDFC Bank aims to increase farmers' income by 2025?
Answer: 'Parivartan.'
657. What platform is DPIIT launching to boost India's startup ecosystem?
Answer: BHASKAR (Bharat Startup Knowledge Access Registry).
658. Which company is LIC partnering with to develop its NextGen Digital Platform?
Answer: Infosys.
659. How much are Indian banks and financial institutions expected to invest in renewable energy by 2030?
Answer: Rs 32.5 trillion.
660. Which two entities launched the 'PaisaSave' Cashback Credit Card in 2024?
Answer: YES BANK and Paisabazaar.
661. By what percentage did India's exports shrink in August 2024?
Answer: 9.3%.
662. Which country did India surpass in MSCI ACWI market weight in 2024?
Answer: China.
663. What expedition is being led by Lt Cdr Roopa A and Lt Cdr Dilna K in 2024?
Answer: Navika Sagar Parikrama II.
664. What facility was commissioned at INS Satavahana in 2024?
Answer: VINETRA (Kalvari Submarine Escape Training Facility).
665. What humanitarian operation did India launch in response to Typhoon Yagi in 2024?
Answer: Operation Sadbhavana.
666. Who flagged in the Open Water Swimming Expedition to 21 Islands of Andaman & Nicobar in 2024?
Answer: Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh.
667. Who was appointed as the Director General of Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB) in 2024?
Answer: Amrit Mohan.
668. Who will replace Arvind Kejriwal as the Chief Minister of Delhi in 2024?
Answer: Atishi Marlena.
669. Which boxer joined the Telangana police as DSP in 2024?
Answer: Nikhat Zareen.
670. What light tank completed its first phase trials in 2024?
Answer: Light Tank 'Zorawar.'
671. What major lunar mission was approved by the Cabinet in 2024?
Answer: Chandrayaan-4 mission.
672. What new space module is India planning to launch by 2028?
Answer: Its first space station module.
673. Which planet is India set to explore with its new mission in 2024?
Answer: Venus.
674. What reusable launch vehicle was approved for future moon missions in 2024?
Answer: Next Generation Launch Vehicle (NGLV).
675. Where did India's third home-built 700 MWe nuclear reactor achieve criticality in 2024?
Answer: Rajasthan Atomic Power Project.
676. Which website was launched to promote Northeast India's culture and economy in 2024?
Answer: 'Ashtalakshmi Mahotsav' website.

677. What scheme marks 4 years of enhancing India's fisheries sector?
Answer: Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana.
678. What scheme did Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman launch for children's pension accounts in 2024?
Answer: NPS Vatsalya Scheme.
679. What scheme received ₹9,197 crore for biotech research in 2024?
Answer: Bio-RIDE scheme.
680. Who won Best Actress (Critics) at SIIMA 2024?
Answer: Aishwarya Rai for "Ponniyin Selvan 2."
681. Who won Miss India Worldwide 2024?
Answer: Dhruvi Patel.
682. What summit did Amit Shah inaugurate in New Delhi in 2024?
Answer: National Security Strategies Conference 2024.
683. Where was the third edition of the INDUS-X Summit held in 2024?
Answer: California.
684. Which forum did India and the EU deepen cooperation in 2024?
Answer: 6th EU-India Water Forum.
685. What major global food event was hosted by the Ministry of Food Processing Industries in New Delhi in 2024?
Answer: World Food India 2024.
686. Which book on Lord Rama's connection to Tamil Nadu was released in 2024?
Answer: 'Sri Rama in Tamilagam – An Inseparable Bond.'
687. Who finished second in the Diamond League Final 2024 with a throw of 87.86m?
Answer: Neeraj Chopra.
688. Who claimed their first Formula 1 victory at the Azerbaijan Grand Prix in 2024?
Answer: Oscar Piastri.
689. Which country won the 2024 Asian Champions Trophy in men's hockey?
Answer: India.
690. Which Indian cricketer joined the elite club with 400 international wickets in 2024?
Answer: Jasprit Bumrah.
691. How many Indian companies were featured in TIME's World's Best Companies 2024?
Answer: 22 Indian companies.
692. Which state topped the India Food Safety Index 2024?
Answer: Kerala.
693. What does Hindi Diwas 2024 celebrate?
Answer: Hindi Diwas 2024 celebrates India's linguistic diversity and the adoption of Hindi as an official language in 1949.
694. When is the International Day of Science, Technology, and Innovation for the South observed?
Answer: September 16, 2024.
695. What is the focus of the International Day for Interventional Cardiology 2024?
Answer: Advances in minimally invasive cardiac care.
696. Why is World Ozone Day 2024 celebrated?
Answer: To commemorate the 1987 Montreal Protocol, which protects the ozone layer.
697. What is the significance of International Day of Democracy, celebrated on September 15?
Answer: It promotes democratic principles worldwide.
698. National Engineer Day is observed in honor of which notable Indian personality?
Answer: M. Visvesvaraya.
699. When is World Patient Safety Day 2024 observed, and what is its focus?
Answer: September 17, 2024, focusing on "Improving diagnosis for patient safety."
700. What is the purpose of World Cleanup Day 2024, celebrated on September 20?
Answer: To raise awareness for sustainable clean-up efforts.
701. What anniversary does the International Day of Peace 2024 mark?
Answer: The 25th anniversary of the Declaration on a Culture of Peace.
702. What is special about the 9th Ladakh Zaskar Festival 2024?
Answer: It marks the first festival since Zaskar became a district.
703. How much humanitarian relief has India sent to Vietnam, Myanmar, and Laos under Operation Sadbhav?
Answer: \$1 million.
704. Which campaign did Bhupendra Yadav launch in Mumbai on International Coastal Clean-up Day?
Answer: Clean the Beach Campaign 2024.
705. What category was India placed in according to the FATF report?
Answer: Regular follow-up category.
706. How many antiquities were returned to India during PM Modi's visit to the US?
Answer: 297 antiquities.

707. What was the focus of the National Symposium 'Exercise AIKYA' organized by NDMA and the Indian Army?
Answer: Disaster management and preparedness.
708. What initiative was inaugurated by Union Minister Manohar Lal to protect the power sector?
Answer: CSIRT-Power.
709. Which organization's FCRA license was cancelled by the Union Home Ministry?
Answer: International Cooperative Alliance.
710. Who inaugurated the 16th ASOSAI Assembly?
Answer: President Droupadi Murmu.
711. What major event did PM Modi conclude during his three-day visit to the US?
Answer: The 6th Quad Summit.
712. How many years has the Central Silk Board celebrated its Platinum Jubilee?
Answer: 75 years.
713. What is the focus of India's 7th Rashtriya Poshan Maah 2024?
Answer: Nutrition and combating malnutrition.
714. Which anniversary did Nepal celebrate recently?
Answer: Ninth anniversary of the Constitution declaration.
715. Who was elected president of Sri Lanka?
Answer: Anura Kumara Dissanayake.
716. Who has been appointed as the first director of the UN's Loss and Damage Fund?
Answer: Ibrahim Cheikh Diong.
717. What significant naval drills did Russia and China begin?
Answer: Joint naval drills in the Sea of Japan and Okhotsk.
718. Who represented India at the 9th AIIB Board of Governors meeting?
Answer: Nirmala Sitharaman.
719. What foundation stone did PM Modi lay in Maharashtra?
Answer: PM Mega Integrated Textile Regions and Apparel Park.
720. What scheme was launched in Mizoram to support farmers?
Answer: 'Bana Kaih' scheme.
721. Which cashback credit card was launched by YES BANK and Paisabazaar?
Answer: 'PaisaSave' Cashback Credit Card.
722. Who has assumed office as the CEO of Federal Bank?
Answer: KVS Manian.
723. What is the GDP growth forecast for India retained by ADB for FY24?
Answer: 7%.
724. Which tournament did India win gold in both men's and women's categories?
Answer: 2024 Chess Olympiad.
725. Who released the book "Khaki Mein Sthitapragya"?
Answer: Anil Raturi.
726. When is the International Day for Universal Access to Information observed?
Answer: September 28th.
727. What record was Chiranjeevi recognized for?
Answer: Most prolific Indian film star with 24,000 dance moves.
728. What initiative focuses on nutrition and health across India during the Rashtriya Poshan Maah?
Answer: Combating malnutrition.
729. Who organized the two-day symposium on disaster management named 'Exercise AIKYA'?
Answer: NDMA and Southern Command of the Indian Army.
730. What did the Union Home Ministry cancel related to the International Cooperative Alliance?
Answer: FCRA license.
731. Who launched the Clean the Beach Campaign 2024?
Answer: Bhupendra Yadav.
732. How many antiquities were reclaimed by India from the US during PM Modi's visit?
Answer: 297 antiquities.
733. What does CSIRT-Power aim to safeguard in India?
Answer: Power sector against cyber threats.
734. Who was recently elected as the president of Sri Lanka?
Answer: Anura Kumara Dissanayake.
735. What is the new fund established by the UN to address climate issues called?
Answer: Loss and Damage Fund.



736. Which two countries began joint naval drills in the Sea of Japan?
Answer: Russia and China.
737. What significant event did PM Modi address at the 79th UN General Assembly?
Answer: Emphasizing global reforms.
738. What initiative aims to combat air pollution in Delhi?
Answer: Dust Free Drive.
739. Which city's airport was renamed after Jagadguru Sant Tukaram Maharaj?
Answer: Pune Airport.
740. What scheme was launched in Mizoram to assist farmers and entrepreneurs?
Answer: 'Bana Kaih' scheme.
741. What new credit card was launched by Axis Bank for small business owners?
Answer: MyBiz credit card.
742. Which bank collaborated with EaseMyTrip to launch a co-branded travel debit card?
Answer: Bank of Baroda.
743. Which organization retained India's GDP growth forecast at 7% for FY24?
Answer: ADB.
744. What major economic initiative did Piyush Goyal inaugurate in Singapore?
Answer: Invest India office.
745. Who made a historic debut at the Gama International Fighting Championship?
Answer: Sangram Singh.
746. What championship did Kamal Chawla win gold in?
Answer: IBSF World Men's 6-Red Snooker Championship.
747. Who won the Miss India Worldwide 2024 title?
Answer: Dhruvi Patel.
748. Who received the ICC Lifetime Achievement Award 2023?
Answer: Deepak C Mehta.
749. Who was appointed as the Director General of the Aeronautical Development Agency?
Answer: Jitendra J Jadhav.
750. Who has been elected as the President of the National Rifle Association of India?
Answer: Kalikesh Singh Deo.
751. What milestone did India achieve with its third home-built nuclear reactor?
Answer: Achieved criticality.
752. Which organization signed 75 Technology Transfer Agreements with private entities?
Answer: ISRO, IN-SPACe, and NSIL.
753. What was celebrated on September 24 to recognize the influence of Indian cinema?
Answer: World Bollywood Day.
754. Who inaugurated the 16th ASOSAI Assembly in India?
Answer: President Droupadi Murmu.
755. What is the focus of the Central Silk Board's Platinum Jubilee celebration?
Answer: Advancing India's silk industry.
756. What major international event did PM Modi attend during his recent US visit?
Answer: 6th Quad Summit.
757. What category did the FATF place India in regarding financial monitoring?
Answer: "Regular follow-up" category.
758. What was launched on International Coastal Clean-up Day in Mumbai?
Answer: Clean the Beach Campaign 2024.
759. Who was appointed as the first director of the UN's Loss and Damage Fund?
Answer: Ibrahima Cheikh Diong.
760. What significant military activity occurred between Russia and China in the Sea of Okhotsk?
Answer: Joint naval drills.
761. Which country celebrated the ninth anniversary of its Constitution declaration?
Answer: Nepal.
762. What action did Thailand take regarding same-sex marriage?
Answer: Legalized it starting January.
763. What did PM Modi lay the foundation for in Maharashtra?
Answer: PM Mega Integrated Textile Regions and Apparel Park.
764. Which state launched a Rs 530 crore water supply project for its cities?
Answer: Tripura.
765. What initiative did the Delhi government launch to support local communities in tourism?
Answer: Paryatan Mitra and Paryatan Didi Initiative.
766. What cashback credit card was launched by YES BANK and Paisabazaar?
Answer: PaisaSave Cashback Credit Card.
767. Who took charge as the MD and CEO of Federal Bank?
Answer: KVS Manian.

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| <p>768. What does SEBI mandate for bids up to ₹5 lakh in public debt issues starting November 1, 2024?
Answer: UPI payment method.</p> <p>769. Which rating agency raised India's GDP growth forecast to 7.1% for CY 2024?
Answer: Moody's.</p> <p>770. Who won gold for India in both men's and women's categories at the Chess Olympiad?
Answer: India.</p> <p>771. Which Indian cricketer joined the elite club with 400 international wickets?
Answer: Jasprit Bumrah.</p> <p>772. Who was honored with the Global Prestige Award at the House of Lords?
Answer: Vinod Bachchan.</p> <p>773. What award did Odisha swimmer Pratyasa Ray receive for her achievements?
Answer: Ekalabya Puraskar.</p> <p>774. Who was appointed as the Chief of the National Crime Records Bureau?
Answer: Alok Ranjan.</p> <p>775. Who joined the board of directors at Stability AI?
Answer: James Cameron.</p> <p>776. What did ISRO achieve with its third nuclear reactor at the Rajasthan Atomic Power Project?
Answer: Achieved criticality.</p> <p>777. What new initiative was launched to promote women in space leadership?
Answer: Women in Space Leadership Programme (WiSLP).</p> <p>778. What international day was observed on September 28, 2024, focusing on access to information?
Answer: International Day for Universal Access to Information.</p> <p>779. What is the theme for World Rabies Day 2024?
Answer: "Breaking Rabies Boundaries."</p> <p>780. Which city was awarded the Certificate of World Craft City?
Answer: Kashmir.</p> <p>781. Where did EAM Jaishankar unveil the Mahatma Gandhi bust?
Answer: Tokyo's Edogawa ward.</p> <p>782. Which anniversary of Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam was celebrated on July 27, 2024?
Answer: The 9th death anniversary.</p> <p>783. Who inaugurated India House at the Paris 2024 Olympics?
Answer: Nita Ambani.</p> | <p>784. What was celebrated at the Akhil Bhartiya Shiksha Samagam 2024?
Answer: The 4th anniversary of NEP 2020.</p> <p>785. Where was the 'One DAE One Subscription' initiative launched?
Answer: Tata Memorial Hospital.</p> <p>786. How many tigers died in India during the past five years?
Answer: 628 tigers.</p> <p>787. What was India's average tariff in 2023?
Answer: 17%.</p> <p>788. How many farmers in Andhra Pradesh benefited from PM Fasal Bima Yojana in 2022-23?
Answer: 3,49,633 farmers.</p> <p>789. Where was a wind turbine installed to power monitoring cameras and Wi-Fi?
Answer: Periyar Tiger Reserve.</p> <p>790. How many new UNESCO World Heritage Sites were added at the 46th session?
Answer: 24 new sites.</p> <p>791. What position did India achieve in global aluminium production?
Answer: 2nd largest producer.</p> <p>792. What new system was announced by Dr. Jitendra Singh?
Answer: Electronic Human Resource Management System (e-HRMS).</p> <p>793. Where was the Rashtriya Hindi Vigyan Sammelan 2024 held?
Answer: Bhopal.</p> <p>794. Who inaugurated the Governors' Conference on August 2, 2024?
Answer: President Droupadi Murmu.</p> <p>795. Which Indian naval ship participated in the Russian Navy Day celebrations?
Answer: INS Tabar.</p> <p>796. What status did UNESCO grant to Japan's Sado gold mine?
Answer: Cultural heritage site.</p> <p>797. Who won the presidential election in Venezuela for the third time?
Answer: Nicolas Maduro.</p> <p>798. Where will the India-Vietnam Maritime Heritage Complex be developed?
Answer: Lothal, Gujarat.</p> <p>799. Where was Hamas's political chief Ismail Haniyeh assassinated?
Answer: Tehran, Iran.</p> |
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- 800.** How much was the development package announced by Telangana CM for Kalwakurthy?
Answer: ₹309 crore.
- 801.** What new think tank was announced by Gujarat's Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel?
Answer: Gujarat State Institution for Transformation (GRIT).
- 802.** What new solar scheme was launched by Goa's Chief Minister Pramod Sawant?
Answer: 'Goem Vinamulya Vij Yevjan'.
- 803.** What bill did the UP Assembly pass regarding forced conversions?
Answer: Amended Anti-Conversion Bill.
- 804.** Who is the new Chairperson of UPSC from August 1, 2024?
Answer: Preeti Sudan.
- 805.** Who is set to become the President of the Asian Cricket Council?
Answer: Mohsin Naqvi.
- 806.** Who is the new Managing Director of the National Housing Bank?
Answer: Sanjay Shukla.
- 807.** Who is the first woman Director General of Medical Services (Army)?
Answer: Lieutenant General Sadhna Saxena Nair.
- 808.** Who is the new CMD of Sidbi?
Answer: Manoj Mittal.
- 809.** Who was appointed as the Director of ICAR-CMFRI?
Answer: Dr. Grinson George.
- 810.** Which agreement was signed between the Ministry of Ayush and WHO?
Answer: Agreement for the WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre in Jamnagar, Gujarat.
- 811.** What new tele-consultancy module was launched by the Indian Army for veterans?
Answer: E-SeHAT.
- 812.** Which Russian ship did INS Tabar complete a maritime exercise with?
Answer: Soobrazitelny.
- 813.** Who chaired the 9th Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog?
Answer: PM Modi.
- 814.** Where was the Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting held?
Answer: Tokyo.
- 815.** What event did India host after 66 years?
Answer: 32nd International Conference of Agricultural Economists.
- 816.** What significant event took place in New Delhi regarding UNESCO?
Answer: 46th World Heritage Committee Meeting.
- 817.** Where is the India International Hospitality Expo 2024 being held?
Answer: Greater Noida.
- 818.** What was the focus of the 14th India-Vietnam Defence Policy Dialogue?
Answer: Cyber security and military medicine.
- 819.** Which company acquired a 32.72% stake in India Cements?
Answer: UltraTech Cement.
- 820.** Which companies obtained the RBI cross-border payment license?
Answer: Amazon Pay, Adyen, and BillDesk.
- 821.** What license did insurtech startup Covrzy secure?
Answer: IRDAI broking license.
- 822.** Which two organizations entered a co-lending agreement for MSME credit?
Answer: UGRO Capital and SIDBI.
- 823.** What was the growth percentage of the Index of Eight Core Industries in June 2024?
Answer: 4.0%.
- 824.** What loan commitment did ADB make for solid waste management in India?
Answer: \$200 million.
- 825.** What is the cost of the project for PACS computerization?
Answer: ₹2,516 Crore.
- 826.** Which company received RBI approval to launch an Asset Reconstruction Company?
Answer: Shriram Capital.
- 827.** What position did India secure in the IPEF's Supply Chain Council?
Answer: Vice-Chair.
- 828.** What funding milestone did Rapido achieve?
Answer: Unicorn status with a \$120 million funding round.
- 829.** Which bank partnered with ICICI Lombard General Insurance?
Answer: Karnataka Bank.
- 830.** How many entities were selected for the RBI's 5th Cohort Regulatory Sandbox?
Answer: Five entities.
- 831.** What percentage of ₹2,000 banknotes were withdrawn from circulation as reported by the RBI?
Answer: 98%.
- 832.** What new credit card services did RBL Bank introduce?
Answer: RuPay Credit Cards with UPI and NCMC functionalities.

- 833.** Which two Small Finance Banks' MDs and CEOs were re-approved by the RBI?
Answer: Unity and Utkarsh Small Finance Banks.
- 834.** What AI chatbot was launched by SEBI for investors?
Answer: 'SEVA'.
- 835.** What was the GST collection amount in July 2024?
Answer: ₹1.82 lakh crore.
- 836.** How much was HDFC Life fined by IRDAI for regulatory breaches?
Answer: Rs 2 crore.
- 837.** What portal was launched by Shri Bhupender Yadav for environment-friendly lifestyle ideas?
Answer: Ideas4LiFE Portal.
- 838.** What software version did the Indian Coast Guard launch to enhance training protocols?
Answer: 'Suvidha Software Version 1.0'.
- 839.** How much stipend was disbursed with the launch of NATS 2.0?
Answer: Rs. 100 crore.
- 840.** Who received Parimal Nathwani's book 'Call of the Gir'?
Answer: Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- 841.** Which Indian destinations were featured in TIME's 'World's Greatest Places of 2024'?
Answer: Museum of Solutions in Mumbai, Manam Chocolate in Hyderabad, and NAAR restaurant in Himachal Pradesh.
- 842.** What position did India retain in global agriculture exports?
Answer: 8th position.
- 843.** What rank did India achieve in the WEF's 2024 Travel and Tourism Development Index?
Answer: 39th position.
- 844.** Which organization won the GEEF Global WaterTech Award 2024?
Answer: Central Water Commission (CWC).
- 845.** In which Olympiads did Indian students win medals in 2024?
Answer: International Physics and Chemistry Olympiads.
- 846.** Who was honoured with the prestigious V Venkayya Epigraphy Award?
Answer: V. Vedachalam.
- 847.** Which Google executive was honoured by IIT-Kharagpur?
Answer: Sundar Pichai and his wife Anjali Pichai.
- 848.** Which South African sites were inscribed as UNESCO World Heritage Sites?
Answer: Sites associated with Nelson Mandela.
- 849.** By what percentage did digital payments increase according to the RBI?
Answer: 12.6%.
- 850.** When is the SpaceX and NASA Crew-9 mission set to launch?
Answer: August 18, 2024.
- 851.** Which Indian Group Captains were selected for the Axiom-4 mission to the ISS?
Answer: Shubhanshu Shukla and Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair.
- 852.** Who won the 2024 Belgian Grand Prix?
Answer: Lewis Hamilton.
- 853.** Which Indian badminton star announced retirement in July 2024?
Answer: Ashwini Ponnappa.
- 854.** Who became the youngest and fastest para-swimmer to cross the English Channel?
Answer: Jia Rai.
- 855.** Which organizations collaborated to set up the National Basketball Academy in Mumbai?
Answer: BFI and Corvuss American Academy.
- 856.** Which Indian shooter won a bronze medal at the Paris Olympics?
Answer: Swapnil Kusale.
- 857.** When will India host the Men's Asia Cup in T20 format?
Answer: 2025.
- 858.** Which Indian duo won bronze in the 10m Air Pistol Mixed Team event at the Paris Olympics?
Answer: Manu Bhaker and Sarabjot Singh.
- 859.** Who became India's youngest boxing referee at the Paris Olympics?
Answer: Lt Col Kabilan Sai Ashok.
- 860.** What is the title of the new book on Sudipta Sengupta's life?
Answer: "Breaking Rocks and Barriers: The Adventurous Life of Sudipta Sengupta".
- 861.** When is International Day of Friendship observed?
Answer: July 30th.
- 862.** What is the theme for World Day Against Trafficking in Persons 2024?
Answer: "Leave No Child Behind in the Fight Against Human Trafficking".
- 863.** When is World Nature Conservation Day observed?
Answer: July 28th.
- 864.** What is celebrated on International Tiger Day 2024?
Answer: The conservation of tigers and their natural habitats.

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| <p>865. What is the theme for World Breastfeeding Week 2024?
Answer: "Closing the gap: Breastfeeding support for all."</p> <p>866. When is World Lung Cancer Day observed?
Answer: August 1, 2024.</p> <p>867. What event did the Union Ministry of Culture host for the creation of the Yuga Yugeen Bharat Museum?
Answer: A three-day event in New Delhi.</p> <p>868. Who is honoured on National Mountain Climbing Day?
Answer: Bobby Matthews and Josh Madigan.</p> <p>869. What is recognized on World Ranger Day?
Answer: Park rangers and conservationists.</p> <p>870. When India celebrate National Friendship Day in 2024?
Answer: August 4, 2024.</p> <p>871. Which former Indian cricketer and coach passed away at 71?
Answer: Anshuman Gaekwad.</p> <p>872. When did the CCEA approve the construction of eight new national high-speed corridor projects?
Answer: August 2, 2024.</p> <p>873. Where is the 10th National Handloom Day Exhibition "VIRAASAT" being held?
Answer: Handloom Haat, New Delhi.</p> <p>874. How many years have passed since the abrogation of Articles 370 and 35(A)?
Answer: 5 years.</p> <p>875. What is the duration of the pilgrimage to Shri Baba Buddha Amarnath in J&K?
Answer: 10 days.</p> <p>876. By what percentage has India's renewable energy capacity increased in the last decade?
Answer: 165%.</p> <p>877. Who introduced the Waqf (Amendment) Bill, 2024, in Lok Sabha?
Answer: Minority Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju.</p> <p>878. What bill aims to replace the Television Network Act of 1995?
Answer: Broadcasting Services (Regulation) Bill, 2024.</p> <p>879. What is the date range for the third edition of the 'Har Ghar Tiranga' campaign?
Answer: August 9 to August 15, 2024.</p> <p>880. Which state partnered with UNICEF to involve fathers in promoting breastfeeding?
Answer: West Bengal.</p> | <p>881. Who did India defeat to win the 4th CAVA Women's Volleyball Nations League?
Answer: Nepal.</p> <p>882. What was the theme of the Indian Cost Accounts Service (ICoAS) Foundation Day 2024?
Answer: 'ICoAS @ Viksit Bharat'.</p> <p>883. How much is the Union Cabinet's approved budget for eight new railway line projects?
Answer: ₹24,657 crore.</p> <p>884. What program is empowering ginners under the Ministry of Textiles?
Answer: Kasturi Cotton Bharat programme.</p> <p>885. Which union minister urged BIMSTEC members to finalize the Free Trade Agreement?
Answer: Union Minister Piyush Goyal.</p> <p>886. Which countries did President Droupadi Murmu visit in August 2024?
Answer: Fiji, New Zealand, and Timor-Leste.</p> <p>887. Who was re-elected as the President of the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences?
Answer: Janet Yang.</p> <p>888. Which city hosted the 5th AITIGA Joint Committee Meeting?
Answer: Jakarta.</p> <p>889. Who is set to lead Bangladesh's interim government after Sheikh Hasina steps down?
Answer: Nobel Laureate Muhammad Yunus.</p> <p>890. Which Indian GI-tagged product was first exported to Poland?
Answer: Fig juice.</p> <p>891. What grant program did Australia announce to foster collaboration with India?
Answer: Maitri Research and Cultural Partnerships Grants.</p> <p>892. What is the name of China's satellite constellation set to rival Starlink?
Answer: Thousand Sails.</p> <p>893. Which Prime Minister was replaced by Tunisia's President ahead of the October election?
Answer: Ahmed Hachani.</p> <p>894. Where will the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation set up a Faecal Sludge Treatment Plant?
Answer: Kozhikode, Kerala.</p> <p>895. Which state launched the Mukhyamantri Maiyaan Samman Yojana in August 2024?
Answer: Jharkhand.</p> <p>896. How much was the budget for Namami Gange Mission 2.0 projects in UP and Bihar?
Answer: Rs 920 crore.</p> |
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| <p>897. Which section of the Registration Act was declared unconstitutional by the Madras High Court?
Answer: Section 77-A.</p> <p>898. Which state became the first to purchase all crops at MSP?
Answer: Haryana.</p> <p>899. Which state scrapped the two-child policy for local body polls?
Answer: Andhra Pradesh.</p> <p>900. What is the name of India's third largest tiger reserve, approved by Chhattisgarh?
Answer: Guru Ghasidas-Tamor Pingla Tiger Reserve.</p> <p>901. Where was India's first 'Rice ATM' launched?
Answer: Mancheswar, Odisha.</p> <p>902. Which two rivers are involved in the Maharashtra river linking project?
Answer: Nalganga and Wainganga.</p> <p>903. How many logistics parks will be developed under Maharashtra's Logistics Policy 2024?
Answer: Over 200.</p> <p>904. Where did Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann inaugurate a dedicated NRI Facilitation Centre?
Answer: Delhi's IGI Airport.</p> <p>905. How many Urban Cooperative Banks' licenses has RBI canceled since 2014?
Answer: 78.</p> <p>906. What did the RBI revise for cooperative banks in August 2024?
Answer: NPA provisioning norms.</p> <p>907. Which two companies entered into a bancassurance partnership in August 2024?
Answer: Capital Small Finance Bank and Edelweiss Life Insurance.</p> <p>908. What is the current repo rate after the August 2024 MPC meeting?
Answer: 6.5%.</p> <p>909. What change did the RBI announce in the reporting frequency for credit information?
Answer: From monthly to every 15 days.</p> <p>910. What did the RBI revamp to enhance cheque clearing efficiency?
Answer: Cheque truncation system (CTS).</p> <p>911. What was India's fiscal deficit for Q1 FY25 as a percentage of the full-year estimate?
Answer: 8.1%.</p> <p>912. What is Ind-Ra's revised GDP growth forecast for FY25?
Answer: 7.5%.</p> | <p>913. What tax benefit was restored by the Indian government for property sales in August 2024?
Answer: Indexation benefits for LTCG tax.</p> <p>914. What is Deloitte India's predicted economic growth range for FY25?
Answer: 7% to 7.2%.</p> <p>915. What is the new UPI limit for tax payments as announced by the RBI in August 2024?
Answer: Rs 5 lakh per transaction.</p> <p>916. What is the 2024 Fortune Global 500 ranking of Reliance Industries Limited?
Answer: 86th position.</p> <p>917. How many chips will Tata Group's new semiconductor facility in Assam produce annually?
Answer: 15 billion chips.</p> <p>918. Which company launched UPISetu in partnership with Axis Bank?
Answer: Setu (owned by Pine Labs).</p> <p>919. Who took over as the Director General of the BSF on August 3, 2024?
Answer: Daljit Singh Chawdhary.</p> <p>920. Who assumed charge as the Director General of Assam Rifles in August 2024?
Answer: Lt Gen Vikas Lakhera.</p> <p>921. Who was named the brand ambassador for the SA20 League in August 2024?
Answer: Dinesh Karthik.</p> <p>922. Who will take over as the Chairman of SBI on August 28, 2024?
Answer: Challa Sreenivasulu Setty.</p> <p>923. Which senior IAS officer was appointed as additional secretary in the PMO in August 2024?
Answer: Amit Singh Negi.</p> <p>924. Who was approved as the MD & CEO of MCX by SEBI?
Answer: Praveena Rai.</p> <p>925. Who became the first female CEO of DBS in August 2024?
Answer: Tan Su Shan.</p> <p>926. Which state signed an MoU with SBI General Insurance for Disaster Risk Transfer Parametric Insurance Solution (DRTPS)?
Answer: Nagaland.</p> <p>927. When did PM Modi inaugurate the 32nd International Conference of Agricultural Economists?
Answer: August 3, 2024.</p> <p>928. Which vehicles did ITBP receive for the Line of Actual Control (LAC)?
Answer: Russian KAMAZ Typhoon vehicles.</p> |
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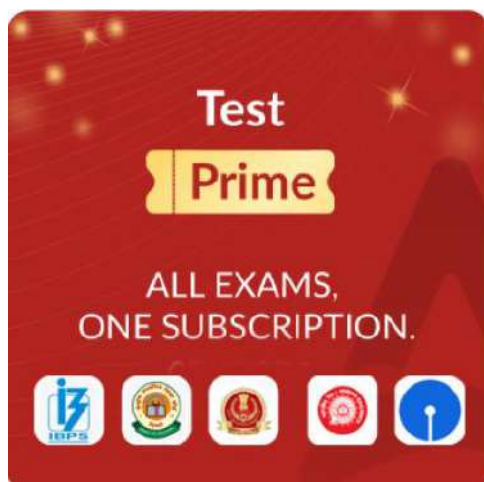
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| <p>929. Where was the 'Parvat Prahaar' high-altitude warfare exercise conducted?
Answer: Ladakh.</p> <p>930. Who authored "India@100: Envisioning Tomorrow's Economic Powerhouse"?
Answer: Prof. K V Subramanian.</p> <p>931. What satellite will ISRO launch on its 55th foundation day?
Answer: EOS-08 satellite.</p> <p>932. Which institute developed E-Shoes for live location tracking?
Answer: IIT Indore.</p> <p>933. As of July 19, 2024, how many accounts have been opened under PMJDY?
Answer: 52.81 crore accounts.</p> <p>934. Why was a committee formed by the Centre in August 2024?
Answer: To monitor the Bangladesh border situation.</p> <p>935. During her state visit to Fiji, which award did President Droupadi Murmu receive?
Answer: "Companion of the Order of Fiji."</p> <p>936. What is the purpose of the Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar?
Answer: To honor contributions to science, technology, and innovation.</p> <p>937. What was the year-on-year growth percentage of RBI's balance sheet as of March 31, 2024?
Answer: 11.08%.</p> <p>938. On which date was the 14th Indian Organ Donation Day observed in 2024?
Answer: August 3, 2024.</p> <p>939. What is commemorated on Hiroshima Day 2024?
Answer: The 79th anniversary of the atomic bombing.</p> <p>940. When is National Handloom Day celebrated in India?
Answer: August 7.</p> <p>941. What does National Javelin Day 2024 celebrate?
Answer: Neeraj Chopra's historic gold medal win in the 2021 Olympics.</p> <p>942. What is Quit India Movement Day also known as?
Answer: August Kranti Day.</p> <p>943. On which date is the International Day of the World's Indigenous Peoples observed?
Answer: August 9th.</p> <p>944. What does Nagasaki Day commemorate?
Answer: The atomic bombing in 1945.</p> | <p>945. When is World Steelpan Day celebrated in 2024?
Answer: August 11th.</p> <p>946. What is the focus of World Lion Day 2024?
Answer: Lion conservation and their ecological importance.</p> <p>947. Who won the gold medal in the men's 100m sprint at the Paris Olympics 2024?
Answer: Noah Lyles.</p> <p>948. Who was disqualified from the Paris Olympic 2024 for failing to meet the weight requirement?
Answer: Vinesh Phogat.</p> <p>949. Which Indian athlete announced retirement from wrestling at the Paris Olympics 2024?
Answer: Vinesh Phogat.</p> <p>950. What medal did Neeraj Chopra win in javelin at Paris 2024 Olympics?
Answer: Silver.</p> <p>951. Which team won bronze in men's hockey at the Paris 2024 Olympics?
Answer: India.</p> <p>952. Who will be India's co-flag bearers at the Paris 2024 Closing Ceremony?
Answer: PR Sreejesh and Manu Bhaker.</p> <p>953. Which iconic classical dancer passed away on August 3, 2024?
Answer: Yamini Krishnamurthy.</p> <p>954. At what age did Nobel Prize-winning physicist Tsung-Dao Lee pass away?
Answer: 97.</p> <p>955. Which states have yet to implement the RTE Act, 2009, as of August 7, 2024?
Answer: Punjab, Telangana, Kerala, and West Bengal.</p> <p>956. What technology did SAMEER recently transfer to private firms?
Answer: Microwave sugar measurement technology.</p> <p>957. What app did the Union Jal Shakti Ministry launch for flood updates?
Answer: FloodWatch India 2.0.</p> <p>958. What did PM Modi emphasize in his Independence Day speech?
Answer: The need for a 'Secular Civil Code'.</p> <p>959. What is the new government radio program to bridge the farm-science knowledge gap?
Answer: 'Kisan Ki Baat'.</p> <p>960. On what date will PM Modi be the chief guest at the ET World Leaders Forum?
Answer: August 31, 2024.</p> |
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- 961.** What new system has the Centre launched to assist farmers with pest management?
Answer: AI-based National Pest Surveillance System.
- 962.** What change has the Indian government made regarding the windfall tax on petroleum crude oil?
Answer: Reduced it to Rs 2,100 per metric tonne, effective August 17.
- 963.** What projects did the Union Cabinet recently approve with a total investment of ₹2,962 crore?
Answer: Major airport projects in West Bengal and Bihar.
- 964.** Who is the chairperson of the new Parliamentary Committee for the Welfare of OBCs?
Answer: Ganesh Singh.
- 965.** What agreement did India and New Zealand sign during President Murmu's visit?
Answer: Bilateral Customs Cooperation Arrangement.
- 966.** What did China recently test, aiming for a \$279-billion economy by 2030?
Answer: Its largest cargo drone.
- 967.** Which country will the UN human rights team visit to investigate recent unrest?
Answer: Bangladesh.
- 968.** Who announced his resignation as Japan's Prime Minister, effective next month?
Answer: Fumio Kishida.
- 969.** Which country recently joined the U.S.-led United Nations Command in South Korea?
Answer: Germany.
- 970.** Which milestone did NPCI International Payments Limited achieve in Nepal?
Answer: Surpassed 100,000 UPI merchant transactions.
- 971.** What stake did Bharti Global acquire in BT Group?
Answer: 24.5% stake for approximately \$4 billion.
- 972.** Which companies partnered to expand Amazon's electric vehicle delivery fleet in India?
Answer: Amazon India & Gentari.
- 973.** Which company achieved NBFC-ICC status after merging its subsidiaries?
Answer: L&T Finance.
- 974.** What did NPCI recently spin off into a separate subsidiary, and who was appointed as CEO?
Answer: BHIM; Lalitha Nataraj as CEO.
- 975.** Which company secured a 1,600 MW thermal power project in Jharkhand?
Answer: BHEL.
- 976.** To what level did India's retail inflation ease in July 2024?
Answer: A 5-year low of 3.5%.
- 977.** By how much did India's net direct tax collection surge by August 11, 2024?
Answer: 22.5% to Rs 6.93 trillion.
- 978.** What was India's urban unemployment rate in Q1 FY25?
Answer: 6.6%.
- 979.** What did the NSO report highlight regarding financial inclusion in India?
Answer: Significant gender disparity between men and women.
- 980.** Which country's hot rolled flat steel products is India investigating for anti-dumping?
Answer: Vietnam.
- 981.** By what percentage did FDI in India's food processing sector drop in 2023-24?
Answer: 30%.
- 982.** Who was appointed as the new Cabinet Secretary of India, starting August 30, 2024?
Answer: T.V. Somanathan.
- 983.** Who was appointed as Chairman & Managing Director of NHPC Ltd.? **Answer:** Raj Kumar Chaudhary.
- 984.** Who was sworn in for the fourth term as President of Rwanda?
Answer: Paul Kagame.
- 985.** Who was appointed as MD of SBI, overseeing Risk Compliance and SARG?
Answer: Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh.
- 986.** Who was appointed as the new head coach of India's junior men's hockey team?
Answer: PR Sreejesh.
- 987.** Who was appointed as the Director of ED for two years?
Answer: Rahul Navin.
- 988.** Which Bollywood actor received a Lifetime Achievement Award at the 77th Locarno Film Festival?
Answer: Shah Rukh Khan.
- 989.** Which book was launched by MP Bhim Singh, highlighting lesser-known freedom fighters?
Answer: '75 Great Revolutionaries of India'.
- 990.** Which satellite-related MoU was signed between MEA, NSIL, and Nepal?
Answer: MoU for the launch of Nepal's Munal satellite.

- 991.** Which MoU was signed to advance Digital Health education across India?
Answer: Between National Health Authority (NHA) and Maharashtra University of Health Sciences (MUHS).
- 992.** Which Indo-Malaysian air exercise concluded in Malaysia?
Answer: Exercise Udara Shakti 2024.
- 993.** Which Indo-Sri Lankan military exercise commenced on August 12, 2024?
Answer: Mitra Shakti 2024.
- 994.** What was successfully tested by DRDO from a Su-30 MK-I fighter jet?
Answer: Glide Bomb 'Gaurav'.
- 995.** Which former YouTube CEO passed away at 56 after battling cancer?
Answer: Susan Wojcicki.
- 996.** Which former External Affairs Minister of India died at 95?
Answer: Natwar Singh.
- 997.** Who was known as the 'Father of Agni Missiles' and passed away at age 84?
Answer: Dr. Ram Narain Agarwal.
- 998.** Which former Prime Minister of India was remembered on August 16, 2024, on his death anniversary?
Answer: Atal Bihari Vajpayee.
- 999.** On which date was World Biofuel Day 2024 observed?
Answer: August 10.
- 1000.** What was the theme for International Youth Day 2024?
Answer: "From Clicks to Progress: Youth Digital Pathways for Sustainable Development."
- 1001.** Which day is observed to raise awareness about elephant conservation?
Answer: World Elephant Day on August 12.
- 1002.** Which day promotes organ donation awareness globally?
Answer: World Organ Donation Day on August 13.
- 1003.** Which day was observed on August 14th to honour the victims of the 1947 partition?
Answer: Partition Horrors Remembrance Day.
- 1004.** Which flowering shrub of the Western Ghats was added to the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species?
Answer: Neelakurinji.
- 1005.** Which ancient geoglyphs and petroglyphs in Maharashtra were declared protected monuments?
Answer: Those in Ratnagiri.
- 1006.** Which state will host the first-ever Global Women's Kabaddi League in September?
Answer: Haryana.
- 1007.** What new registration mandate did Bihar introduce recently?
Answer: Registration of temples, mutts, and trusts.
- 1008.** Where was the world's oldest solar calendar potentially discovered?
Answer: Göbekli Tepe in Turkey.
- 1009.** When will India host the 3rd Voice of Global South Summit?
Answer: August 17, 2024.
- 1010.** Who were named ICC Players of the Month for July 2024?
Answer: Gus Atkinson and Chamari Athapaththu.
- 1011.** What new partnership did Prasar Bharati enter to promote cricket in India?
Answer: Partnership with BCL for a new franchise-based T20 league.
- 1012.** Who released the centenary commemorative coin of Dr. Kalaingar M. Karunanidhi in Chennai?
Answer: Defence Minister Rajnath Singh.
- 1013.** What is the name of India's first Constitution Museum to be inaugurated by OP Jindal Global University?
Answer: "The Constitution Academy and The Rights & Freedoms Museum."
- 1014.** Which online platform was launched by Manohar Lal Khattar on August 20 to monitor electricity projects?
Answer: Portal for Online Monitoring of Projects Thermal (PROMPT).
- 1015.** How many members are part of the National Task Force formed by the Health Ministry to address healthcare worker safety?
Answer: 14 members.
- 1016.** What challenge was launched by Ashwini Vaishnaw ahead of the World Audio Visual and Entertainment Summit?
Answer: 'Create in India Challenge-Season One.'
- 1017.** Which nuclear plant in India achieved full operational capacity with its second 700 MW reactor?
Answer: KAPS-4 Nuclear Plant.
- 1018.** What did PM Modi present to Ukraine during his visit, marking the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Ukraine?
Answer: BHISHM Cubes.
- 1019.** How much funding did China approve for constructing 11 new nuclear reactors?
Answer: \$31 billion.
- 1020.** Which country will export nearly 1,000 MW of electricity to India, as announced by External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar?
Answer: Nepal.

- 1021.** Which fighter wing integrated its readiness exercise with Ulchi Freedom Shield 24 in South Korea?
Answer: The 51st Fighter Wing at Osan Air Base.
- 1022.** Which state's CM inaugurated 16 industrial projects in Sri City, signing deals worth Rs 3,683 crore?
Answer: Andhra Pradesh.
- 1023.** How much investment did the Rajasthan government secure ahead of the 'Rising Rajasthan' Investment Summit 2024?
Answer: Rs 5.21 trillion.
- 1024.** Where will the South Indian Adivasi Knowledge Centre "Kaanu" be launched on August 25?
Answer: B.R. Hills, Karnataka.
- 1025.** Who was appointed as Director General of Employees' State Insurance Corporation (ESIC)?
Answer: Ashok Kumar Singh, IAS.
- 1026.** Which bank launched the Avni Savings Account for women?
Answer: Bandhan Bank.
- 1027.** Who chaired a high-level meeting focusing on the Indian Army's transformational initiatives?
Answer: Army Chief General Upendra Dwivedi.
- 1028.** Which Indian airport won the Best Airport Award at the India Travel Awards 2024?
Answer: Rajiv Gandhi International Airport (RGIA) in Hyderabad.
- 1029.** Which autobiography was released by Dr. Kalpana Sankar, highlighting women's empowerment?
Answer: "The Scientist Entrepreneur: Empowering Millions of Women."
- 1030.** Which Indian cricketer announced his retirement from international cricket but plans to continue in league cricket?
Answer: Shikhar Dhawan.
- 1031.** What is the name of the mission set for launch by SpaceX on August 26, 2024?
Answer: Polaris Dawn Mission.
- 1032.** On which day is National Space Day 2024 celebrated in India?
Answer: August 23.
- 1033.** Who passed away at the age of 59 due to a cardiac arrest in Chennai?
Answer: Rakesh Pal, Director General of the Indian Coast Guard.
- 1034.** Who was appointed as Chef de Mission for India at the Paris Paralympics 2024?
Answer: Satya Prakash Sangwan.
- 1035.** Who took over as the interim Chairman of the Airports Authority of India (AAI)?
Answer: M Suresh.
- 1036.** Which company announced Laurent Freixe as its new CEO?
Answer: Nestlé.
- 1037.** Which Indian bank launched 'UPI Circle' for secure payments among trusted users?
Answer: NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India).
- 1038.** What is the projected private capital expenditure for India in FY25, as per RBI?
Answer: ₹2.45 trillion.
- 1039.** Which two organizations signed an MoU to explore a 500 KTA bio-ethylene plant in India?
Answer: GAIL and Petron Scientech Inc.
- 1040.** What scheme was launched by the Postal Department to promote philately among students?
Answer: Deen Dayal SPARSH Yojana.
- 1041.** Which airport won the Best Airport Award at the India Travel Awards 2024?
Answer: Rajiv Gandhi International Airport (RGIA), Hyderabad.
- 1042.** Which global brand topped the food brand rankings in 2024?
Answer: Amul.
- 1043.** Who received the Lifetime Achievement Award at the 2023 National Geoscience Awards?
Answer: Prof. Dhiraj Mohan Banerjee.
- 1044.** Which Indian city will host the Strategic Alliance for Smart Laboratory on Clean Rivers (SLCR) under the India-Denmark partnership?
Answer: Varanasi.
- 1045.** Which state launched the Subhadra scheme offering ₹50,000 to one crore women?
Answer: Odisha.
- 1046.** Who took over as the Secretary of the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)?
Answer: Deepthi Gaur Mukherjee, IAS.
- 1047.** Which South Korean Air Base integrated its readiness exercise with Ulchi Freedom Shield 24?
Answer: Osan Air Base.
- 1048.** Who is the Indian Army General who passed away on August 19, 2024?
Answer: General S Padmanabhan.
- 1049.** Which Indian javelin thrower finished second in the Lausanne Diamond League?
Answer: Neeraj Chopra.
- 1050.** Which Indian cricketer won the CEAT International Cricketer of the Year Award at the 26th CEAT Cricket Awards 2024?
Answer: Rohit Sharma.

- 1051.** Who became the first Indian woman to win the national championship in the saloon category at MRF Indian National Car Racing Championship 2024?
Answer: Diana Pundole.
- 1052.** Who announced his retirement from international football as the captain of Germany?
Answer: Ilkay Gundogan.
- 1053.** Which university will inaugurate India's first Constitution Museum in 2024?
Answer: OP Jindal Global University.
- 1054.** Who chaired a high-level meeting focusing on the Indian Army's contributions towards achieving Viksit Bharat by 2047?
Answer: Army Chief General Upendra Dwivedi.
- 1055.** Which Indian minister launched three online platforms, including the Portal for Online Monitoring of Projects Thermal (PROMPT)?
Answer: Manohar Lal Khattar.
- 1056.** What international day is observed on August 21, emphasizing support for victims and protection of human rights?
Answer: International Day of Remembrance and Tribute to the Victims of Terrorism.
- 1057.** What significant day is India celebrating on August 23, 2024, marking a milestone in space exploration?
Answer: National Space Day 2024.
- 1058.** Which former CSIR Director-General passed away at the age of 68 due to a heart attack?
Answer: Dr. Girish Sahni.
- 1059.** Which Indian airport won the Best Airport Award at the India Travel Awards 2024?
Answer: Rajiv Gandhi International Airport (RGIA) in Hyderabad.
- 1060.** What is the budget allocated for Odisha's Subhadra scheme?
Answer: ₹55,825 crore.
- 1061.** Which global summit did Ashwini Vaishnaw launch 'Create in India Challenge-Season One' ahead of?
Answer: World Audio Visual and Entertainment Summit.
- 1062.** What is the name of the world's first mobile and reusable hybrid rocket launched by India?
Answer: RHUMI-1.
- 1063.** Who unveiled the e-magazine 'Sapno ki Udaan'?
Answer: Union Minister of Education Dharmendra Pradhan.
- 1064.** What new guidelines were launched by the Union Government in 2024?
Answer: New Public Grievance Redressal Guidelines.
- 1065.** Where did Union FM Nirmala Sitharaman inaugurate GST Bhawan?
Answer: Udaipur.
- 1066.** What was the focus of the 44th PRAGATI interaction chaired by PM Modi?
Answer: Governance and implementation.
- 1067.** Which nuclear missile submarine was commissioned by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh?
Answer: INS Arighat.
- 1068.** What is the RESET Programme launched by Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya aimed at?
Answer: Empowering retired sportspersons with career skills.
- 1069.** Which port's foundation will be laid by PM Modi?
Answer: Vadhvan Port.
- 1070.** What is the objective of Project NAMAN launched by the Indian Army?
Answer: Providing support to Defence pensioners and veterans via SPARSH-enabled service centres.
- 1071.** How many CPSEs were granted Navratna status by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman?
Answer: Four (NHPC, SECI, Railtel, and SJVN).
- 1072.** Who unveiled new 'Suicide Drones' on August 24, 2024?
Answer: North Korean leader Kim Jong Un.
- 1073.** Which two countries have enhanced their anti-terror cooperation?
Answer: India and Indonesia.
- 1074.** Where were the 24th International Mother Teresa Awards held?
Answer: Dubai.
- 1075.** Which typhoon recently hit Japan's Kyushu Island?
Answer: Typhoon Shanshan.
- 1076.** Who became Iran's first female government spokesperson?
Answer: Fatemeh Mohajerani.



- 1077.** Which state cabinet approved the revised National Pension Scheme (NPS)?
Answer: Maharashtra.
- 1078.** Which animal was recorded for the first time in Assam's Dima Hasao district?
Answer: Mithun.
- 1079.** What project did BPCL launch in Bihar using drone technology?
Answer: Aranya project for aerial seeding.
- 1080.** What policy did Uttar Pradesh introduce in 2024 for digital media?
Answer: UP Digital Media Policy 2024.
- 1081.** Where was the first indigenous pollution control vessel launched?
Answer: Goa.
- 1082.** Where was the 2nd India-Singapore Ministerial Roundtable held?
Answer: Singapore.
- 1083.** What was the focus of the bilateral meeting chaired by Jitendra Singh with the US?
Answer: Civil Nuclear Commerce.
- 1084.** Who was re-elected as the national president of Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas)?
Answer: Chirag Paswan.
- 1085.** Who was appointed as the chairman of Texas Economic Development Corporation?
Answer: Arun Agarwal.
- 1086.** Who is the new chairperson of Nasscom?
Answer: Sindhu Gangadharan.
- 1087.** Which two individuals were honored as Youth Icons by FICCI?
Answer: Ayushmann Khurrana and Neeraj Chopra.
- 1088.** Which state tourism won the PATA Gold Award 2024?
Answer: Kerala Tourism.
- 1089.** What is the name of the new RuPay Platinum Card launched by ESAF Small Finance Bank?
Answer: Inori RuPay Platinum Card.
- 1090.** Why did the RBI impose penalties on UCO Bank and Cent Bank Home Finance Ltd?
Answer: For regulatory non-compliance related to account openings, KYC, and fraud classification.
- 1091.** What is the name of the new term insurance product launched by Tata AIA Life?
Answer: Sampoorna Raksha Promise.
- 1092.** Which bank did Piramal Finance partner with for co-lending?
Answer: Central Bank of India.
- 1093.** How much dividend did LIC pay to the government for FY 2023-24?
Answer: ₹3,662 crore.
- 1094.** What is India's revised GDP growth forecast for 2024 by Moody's?
Answer: 7.2%.
- 1095.** What new initiative did the Indian Air Force launch to inspire youth?
Answer: Comic Book Series celebrating IAF heroes.
- 1096.** Which scheme did the Cabinet approve to enhance the STI ecosystem?
Answer: Vigyan Dhara Scheme.
- 1097.** What new scheme was introduced by the Spices Board?
Answer: SPICED Scheme.
- 1098.** Which city was named Asia's new billionaire capital in the Hurun India Rich List 2024?
Answer: Mumbai.
- 1099.** Who won the Dutch Grand Prix 2024?
Answer: Lando Norris.
- 1100.** Which country won the SAFF U-20 Championship 2024?
Answer: Bangladesh.
- 1101.** Who won the Indian National Chess Championship title in 2024?
Answer: Karthik Venkataraman.
- 1102.** Who is India's first civilian space tourist?
Answer: Gopichand Thotakura.
- 1103.** What technology did NASA develop to measure ice shelf melting in Antarctica?
Answer: Underwater Robots.
- 1104.** When is the International Day Against Nuclear Tests observed?
Answer: August 29.
- 1105.** Which day is celebrated on August 29th in India, honoring Major Dhyani Chand's legacy?
Answer: National Sports Day.
- 1106.** Which veteran Congress leader and Nanded MP passed away recently?
Answer: Vasant Rao Chavan.
- 1107.** Which Venezuelan Olympic cyclist passed away at 51?
Answer: Daniela Larreal Chirinos.
- 1108.** How many new districts were created in Ladakh recently?
Answer: Five.
- 1109.** When is Mother Teresa's birth anniversary observed?
Answer: August 26 (her 114th birth anniversary).

- 1110.** What program did PM Modi chair the 44th edition of?
Answer: PRAGATI Interaction.
- 1111.** Which major airline merger was approved by the Indian government in 2024?
Answer: Singapore Airlines-Vistara-Air India merger.
- 1112.** Which Indian Navy ship conducted a maritime exercise with the Spanish Navy?
Answer: INS Tabar.
- 1113.** Who became the first Goan to obtain Indian citizenship under CAA?
Answer: Joseph Francis Pereira.
- 1114.** Who inaugurated the new Sports University in Bihar?
Answer: Bihar CM Nitish Kumar.
- 1115.** Where is the INDUS-X Summit 2024 scheduled to take place?
Answer: Stanford University.
- 1116.** What was the focus of the 2nd Joint Russian-Indian Commission Meeting held in Moscow?
Answer: Emergency management cooperation.
- 1117.** Who was appointed as the Chairman and CEO of the Railway Board?
Answer: Satish Kumar.
- 1118.** Who took over as Director General of Project Seabird?
Answer: Vice Admiral Rajesh Dhankhar.
- 1119.** Who was appointed as Managing Director and CEO of Shriram Capital?
Answer: Subhasri.
- 1120.** Who succeeded Rajiv Gauba as the new Cabinet Secretary?
Answer: Dr. T.V. Somanathan.
- 1121.** Which countries signed a Critical Mineral Agreement to boost governance and investment?
Answer: U.S. and Peru.
- 1122.** Which two companies partnered to enhance telecom operations using GenAI solutions?
Answer: Infosys and NVIDIA.
- 1123.** Who won the PATA Gold Award 2024 for the 'Holiday Heist' campaign?
Answer: Kerala Tourism.
- 1124.** Which banks were fined by the RBI for regulatory non-compliance in 2024?
Answer: UCO Bank and Cent Bank Home Finance Ltd.
- 1125.** Which company partnered with Central Bank of India for co-lending to underserved markets?
Answer: Piramal Finance.
- 1126.** What is India's revised GDP growth forecast for 2025 by Moody's?
Answer: 6.6%.
- 1127.** What did the Indian Air Force launch to inspire national pride among the youth?
Answer: Comic Book Series celebrating IAF heroes.
- 1128.** How many government employees are expected to benefit from the Unified Pension Scheme (UPS)?
Answer: 23 lakh employees.
- 1129.** Which state was the first to implement the Unified Pension Scheme (UPS) ahead of the October 2024 elections?
Answer: Maharashtra.
- 1130.** What new portal was launched to enhance workplace safety for women in 2024?
Answer: SHe-Box Portal.
- 1131.** Which city was named Asia's new billionaire capital in the Hurun India Rich List 2024?
Answer: Mumbai.
- 1132.** Who won the Asian U-15 Junior Badminton Championships women's singles title in 2024?
Answer: Tanvi Patri.
- 1133.** Which Indian surfer team secured a silver medal at the Asian Surfing Championships 2024?
Answer: India.
- 1134.** Which England cricketer announced retirement from all forms of international cricket in 2024?
Answer: Dawid Malan.
- 1135.** Which Indian athlete won a bronze medal at the 2024 Paralympics in the women's 10m air rifle standing SH1 event?
Answer: Mona Agrawal.
- 1136.** What kind of robots did NASA develop to aid in climate change predictions?
Answer: Underwater Robots.
- 1137.** When is the International Day of the Victims of Enforced Disappearances observed?
Answer: August 30.
- 1138.** What is observed on August 31st to highlight the contributions and challenges of people of African descent globally?
Answer: International Day for People of African Descent.
- 1139.** Who was the New Zealand Māori King who passed away recently?
Answer: Kiingi Tuheitia Pootatau Te Wherowhero VII.
- 1140.** How many new districts were announced in Ladakh by the Ministry of Home Affairs?
Answer: Five.

- 1141.** When is National Doctor's Day observed?
Answer: July 1.
- 1142.** What was significant about July 1, 2018?
Answer: It marked the first anniversary of the GST system's adoption.
- 1143.** What is SEBEX 2?
Answer: An explosive certified by the Indian Navy, said to be two times more lethal than TNT.
- 1144.** Whose biography 'Swaraswamini Asha' was recently launched?
Answer: Asha Bhosle's.
- 1145.** Who received the Financial Services Institutions Bureau (FSIB) approval to head SBI as the next chairman?
Answer: CS Setty.
- 1146.** How many books on Venkaiah Naidu were released by PM Modi?
Answer: Three books: "Venkaiah Naidu – Life in Service," "Celebrating Bharat – The Mission and Message of Shri M Venkaiah Naidu as 13th Vice-President of India," and "Mahaneta – Life and Journey of Shri M. Venkaiah Naidu."
- 1147.** Which Indian cricketer announced T20I retirement after the T20 World Cup victory?
Answer: Ravindra Jadeja.
- 1148.** Who recently passed away at 85 according to the All India Football Federation (AIFF)?
Answer: Former Indian midfielder Bhupinder Singh Rawat.
- 1149.** What award did the BCCI announce for the T20 World Champions India?
Answer: INR 125 crore.
- 1150.** Which company is reported as India's most valuable brand?
Answer: Tata Group.
- 1151.** What amount did RBI increase for States/UTs financial accommodation to?
Answer: ₹60,118 crore.
- 1152.** How much financing did the World Bank approve to help India accelerate the development of low-carbon energy?
Answer: 1.5 billion dollars.
- 1153.** Which ministry launched the eSankhyiki Portal?
Answer: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).
- 1154.** What did Union Bank of India introduce for high-value customers in rural and semi-urban markets?
Answer: "Union Premier" branches.
- 1155.** Who was appointed as the new Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) chief?
Answer: IRS officer Ravi Agrawal.
- 1156.** When is World Sports Journalist Day observed?
Answer: July 2.
- 1157.** What is the purpose of World UFO Day?
Answer: To raise awareness about UFOs and the potential existence of extraterrestrial life.
- 1158.** Which former world chess champion won the Leon Masters for the 10th time?
Answer: V Anand.
- 1159.** What event was observed by the Sivagiri Matha Atheetha Athmiya Sangham at Varkala?
Answer: The 20th death anniversary of Swamy Saswathikananda.
- 1160.** Who was the Kazakh journalist and government critic who died in Ukraine?
Answer: Aidos Sadykov.
- 1161.** Which nation became the first to prepare a full list of fauna?
Answer: India.
- 1162.** What did Jharkhand celebrate recently?
Answer: Hul Diwas.
- 1163.** Which country introduced holographic technology in new banknotes?
Answer: Japan.
- 1164.** What significant event happened regarding the Kazakh journalist Aidos Sadykov?
Answer: He died in Ukraine amid an investigation.
- 1165.** Who took charge as the new CGM of PGCIL SRTS-I?
Answer: Not specified in the provided information.
- 1166.** What are RBI and ASEAN creating together?
Answer: A platform for fast cross-border retail payments.
- 1167.** Where is Air India setting up South Asia's largest flying school?
Answer: Amravati.
- 1168.** Which two companies announced a partnership for a human space flight programme in India?
Answer: SERA and Blue Origin.
- 1169.** What was the GST collection in June?
Answer: Rs 1.74 trillion.
- 1170.** What was the growth rate of the core sector in May 24?
Answer: 6.3% due to the higher base effect.
- 1171.** What new solution did SBI launch for MSMEs?
Answer: A 15-minute online loan solution.
- 1172.** Who was appointed as Chairperson of the National Medical Commission?
Answer: Dr. B.N. Gangadhar.
- 1173.** What campaign is NITI Aayog set to launch?
Answer: 'Sampoornata Abhiyan.'

- 1174.** Which significant event will India host in New Delhi?
Answer: UNESCO World Heritage Committee session.
- 1175.** Who won the first-ever K. Saraswathi Amma Award?
Answer: P. Geetha.
- 1176.** Who secured victory at the Austrian Grand Prix?
Answer: George Russell.
- 1177.** Who was appointed as Maharashtra's first woman Chief Secretary?
Answer: Sujata Saunik.
- 1178.** What plan did Russia approve for completion in 2033?
Answer: New Orbital Station.
- 1179.** What age limit extension was announced for the Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana in Maharashtra?
Answer: Extended to 65 years.
- 1180.** What technology did the Indian Army induct in its communication system?
Answer: The first indigenous chip-based 4G base station.
- 1181.** When will the Durand Cup 2024 start and where will it be hosted?
Answer: Starting July 27 at four different venues.
- 1182.** Which deal did the Bangladesh Navy ink with India's Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)?
Answer: For an 800-tonne ocean-going tug.
- 1183.** What program was launched by Women Entrepreneurship Platform and TransUnion CIBIL?
Answer: SEHER Program to empower women entrepreneurs.
- 1184.** What penalty did RBI impose on PNB?
Answer: ₹1.32 crore monetary penalty.
- 1185.** Which world's first did Bajaj roll out?
Answer: World's first CNG bike.
- 1186.** Who was appointed as the 15th Chief Justice of Jharkhand High Court?
Answer: Dr. Justice Bidyut Ranjan Sarangi.
- 1187.** What significant growth did the private sector witness in NPS?
Answer: 40.1% y-o-y growth at ₹2.47-lakh crore as of June 29.
- 1188.** Which organization partnered with the Indian Olympic Association as Principal Sponsor?
Answer: BPCL.
- 1189.** Who secured the Spice Award as an agri-entrepreneur?
Answer: Sopna Kallingal.
- 1190.** Who will lead the 28-member squad in the Paris Olympics?
Answer: Neeraj Chopra.
- 1191.** Which veteran actor passed away at age 100?
Answer: Smriti Biswas.
- 1192.** What stake did LIC raise in IDFC First Bank?
Answer: Not specified in the provided information.
- 1193.** What project did LIC launch to meet customers' evolving needs?
Answer: 'Jeevan Samarth.'
- 1194.** How many cooperative banks' licenses has RBI cancelled since January?
Answer: Seven.
- 1195.** Which cities will host the 133rd Durand Cup?
Answer: Kolkata, Kokrajhar, Jamshedpur & Shillong.
- 1196.** What was the record defence production in 2023-24?
Answer: Rs 1.26 lakh crore.
- 1197.** When is World Zoonoses Day observed?
Answer: July 6.
- 1198.** What is the theme for the International Day of Cooperatives this year?
Answer: "Cooperatives Building a Better Future for All."
- 1199.** What changes did the Modi government make recently?
Answer: Reconstituted 8 Cabinet Committees.
- 1200.** Which country became the 10th member of SCO?
Answer: Belarus.
- 1201.** What mission did the central government extend till March 2025?
Answer: Smart Cities Mission.
- 1202.** Who was appointed as the new additional NSA?
Answer: Ex-R&AW chief Rajinder Khanna.
- 1203.** Who was sworn in as the new Dutch PM?
Answer: Ex-spy chief, name not specified.
- 1204.** What plan did Paytm launch starting at ₹35?
Answer: 'Health Saathi' plan.
- 1205.** Who was named as the new MD & CEO of SBI General Insurance?
Answer: Naveen Chandra Jha.
- 1206.** Which meeting did India chair at the Permanent Representative Level in Geneva?
Answer: 'Colombo Process' Meeting.

- 1207.** How many new initiatives did SBI unveil on its 69th Foundation Day?
Answer: Eleven.
- 1208.** Who was re-designated as managing director & CEO of LIC?
Answer: Siddhartha Mohanty.
- 1209.** What mobile app did CM Mohan Yadav launch for the public?
Answer: 'Lokpath Mobile App.'
- 1210.** Which event did PM host for the winners?
Answer: ICC T20 World Cup Winners, 2024.
- 1211.** When will the world witness the first Indian in Space and another Indian in Deep Sea?
Answer: By 2025.
- 1212.** What events did Divya Kala Mela & Shakti celebrate?
Answer: India Celebrates Divyang Talent at KIIT Campus in Bhubaneswar.
- 1213.** What scheme did MNRE launch under the National Green Hydrogen Mission?
Answer: Rs 200 Crore Scheme.
- 1214.** Which new MA course did IGNOU launch?
Answer: MA Course In Bhagavad Gita Studies.
- 1215.** What event is Laos preparing to host?
Answer: 57th ASEAN Foreign Ministers' Meeting.
- 1216.** Who was appointed as Chief Justice of Punjab and Haryana High Court?
Answer: Justice Sheel Nagu.
- 1217.** Who is the new Executive Director appointed by RBI?
Answer: Smt. Charulatha S Kar.
- 1218.** Which company rebranded itself as Sammaan Capital?
Answer: Indiabulls Housing Finance.
- 1219.** Who will take oath as Jharkhand Chief Minister?
Answer: Hemant Soren.
- 1220.** Which organization was selected for the FATF Mutual Evaluation report 2023-24?
Answer: Muthoot Finance.
- 1221.** Which government has formed a judicial commission to investigate the Hathras stampede?
Answer: The Uttar Pradesh government
- 1222.** What reduction in licensing fees has Union Minister Piyush Goyal announced for women entrepreneurs?
Answer: 80% reduction
- 1223.** From which date must stainless steel and aluminium utensils conform to BIS standards and carry the ISI mark?
Answer: March 14, 2024
- 1224.** Which state's mica mines have been declared child labour-free by NCPCR?
Answer: Jharkhand's
- 1225.** Who has been elected as Iran's president?
Answer: Masoud Pezeshkian
- 1226.** Which countries are ranked as the most expensive cities to live in according to Mercer's 2024 report?
Answer: Hong Kong and Singapore
- 1227.** Who has been appointed as the first woman Chief Justice of Lahore High Court?
Answer: Justice Aalia Neelum
- 1228.** What is the name of India's newly unveiled indigenous light tank?
Answer: Zorawar
- 1229.** Which mutual fund has launched India's first Oil & Gas ETF?
Answer: ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund
- 1230.** What was India's retail inflation rate in June 2024?
Answer: 5.08%
- 1231.** Who has been selected to receive the Dr. C. Narayana Reddy National Literary Award?
Answer: Tamil writer Sivashankari
- 1232.** Who won the British Grand Prix 2024?
Answer: Lewis Hamilton
- 1233.** Who has been appointed as India's Chef-De-Mission for Paris Olympics 2024?
Answer: Gagan Narang
- 1234.** What is the name of the platform launched by WHO for medical device information?
Answer: MeDevIS
- 1235.** On which date is World Population Day observed?
Answer: July 11th
- 1236.** What is the target set for bilateral trade between India and Russia by 2030?
Answer: \$100 billion
- 1237.** Who has been appointed as the Principal Adviser for the National TB Elimination Programme?
Answer: Dr. Soumya Swaminathan
- 1238.** Which country tops InterNations' list as the most affordable expat destination for the fourth consecutive year?
Answer: Vietnam
- 1239.** What is the name of the AI-integrated health insurance product launched by ICICI Lombard?
Answer: Elevate
- 1240.** How much dividend have PSU banks paid to the government for FY 2023-24?
Answer: ₹6,481 crore

- 1241.** What is India's rank in GenAI innovations according to the report mentioned?
Answer: Fifth
- 1242.** Who has been awarded France's highest civilian honour, the Chevalier de la Légion d'Honneur?
Answer: Roshni Nadar Malhotra
- 1243.** Which company has been announced as the principal sponsor for the Indian team at the 2024 Paris Olympics?
Answer: Adani Group
- 1244.** What is the name of the fund launched by the government to support agricultural start-ups and rural enterprises?
Answer: AgriSURE (Agri Fund for Start-Ups & Rural Enterprises)
- 1245.** On which date is World Kiswahili Language Day celebrated?
Answer: July 7th
- 1246.** Who has been appointed as the new head coach of the Indian men's cricket team?
Answer: Gautam Gambhir
- 1247.** What is the theme for World Population Day 2024?
Answer: "Leave no one behind, count everyone"
- 1248.** Which rocket was successfully launched after a 4-year delay?
Answer: Europe's Ariane 6 rocket
- 1249.** What is India's composite score in the SDG India Index 2023-24 released by NITI Aayog?
Answer: 71
- 1250.** Who has announced retirement from Test cricket after a 21-year career?
Answer: James Anderson
- 1251.** What initiative has Tata Power launched in Uttar Pradesh to promote rooftop solar solutions?
Answer: 'Ghar Ghar Solar' initiative
- 1252.** Which state has won the Best Agriculture State Award for 2024?
Answer: Maharashtra
- 1253.** What is the name of the new security agreement signed between the Philippines and Japan?
Answer: A new security agreement to facilitate military cooperation
- 1254.** Who has been elected as the President of the News Broadcasters & Digital Association (NBDA)?
Answer: Rajat Sharma
- 1255.** What is the name of the plantation drive organized by BSF in Srinagar?
Answer: "Grow with the Trees"
- 1256.** How many new projects has DRDO awarded under the TDF Scheme?
Answer: Seven
- 1257.** What is the name of the new scheme launched by Haryana to provide IT jobs?
Answer: IT Saksham Yuva Scheme
- 1258.** Which city is planning to open East India's first university for physically challenged students?
Answer: Ranchi
- 1259.** What is the population of Sarus Cranes in Uttar Pradesh as per the latest count?
Answer: 19,918
- 1260.** Which state has been crowned the best state in horticulture at the Agriculture Leadership Awards 2024?
Answer: Nagaland
- 1261.** What is the name of the initiative launched by Uttar Pradesh along its borders to enhance greenery?
Answer: 'Mitra Van' initiative
- 1262.** Who will lead the Indian delegation to the BRICS Parliamentary Forum?
Answer: Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla
- 1263.** What is the theme of World Kiswahili Language Day 2024?
Answer: "Kiswahili: Education and Culture of Peace"
- 1264.** On which date is National Fish Farmer's Day celebrated in India?
Answer: July 10th
- 1265.** What is the name of the credit education program launched to empower women entrepreneurs?
Answer: SEHER Credit Education Program
- 1266.** Who inaugurated the INS Towers at the INS Secretariat in Mumbai?
Answer: Prime Minister Narendra Modi
- 1267.** When is India's population expected to peak according to the UN's World Population Prospects 2024 report?
Answer: Early 2060s
- 1268.** What new initiative did Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurate in Madhya Pradesh?
Answer: Pradhan Mantri Colleges of Excellence
- 1269.** What is the name of the toll-free helpline and email service launched by India to help report drug-related crimes?
Answer: MANAS
- 1270.** Who was re-elected as President of the European Parliament?
Answer: Roberta Metsola

- 1271.** Which country will host the board created by U.N. talks to aid countries recovering from global warming impacts?
Answer: Philippines
- 1272.** Which Indian state was recognized as the 'Best Performing State' under the Prime Minister SVANidhi scheme?
Answer: Madhya Pradesh
- 1273.** Who has been appointed as the new CMD of Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited?
Answer: Robert J Ravi
- 1274.** Which novel commemorates the 40th anniversary of the Bhopal gas tragedy?
Answer: "The Prisoner of Bhopal" by Tim Walker
- 1275.** Who won the men's singles title at Wimbledon 2024?
Answer: Carlos Alcaraz
- 1276.** Who inaugurated the Thane Borivali Twin Tunnel, India's longest and largest urban tunnel?
Answer: Prime Minister Narendra Modi
- 1277.** What is the new name of the merged training institutes of DoT?
Answer: National Communications Academy (NCA)
- 1278.** Which country did Dr. S Jaishankar visit to strengthen bilateral relations on July 16-17, 2024?
Answer: Mauritius
- 1279.** Which organization hosted the Second National Seminar SAUSHRUTAM Shalya Sangoshti in New Delhi?
Answer: All-India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA)
- 1280.** What is the new interest rate for SBI's "Amrit Vrishti" 444-day term deposit?
Answer: 7.25%
- 1281.** Which country introduces a 90-day visa-free regime for citizens of 35 European countries?
Answer: Belarus
- 1282.** Who has been appointed as India's next Ambassador to the United States?
Answer: Vinay Kwatra
- 1283.** What event was celebrated at the All-India Institute of Ayurveda?
Answer: SAUSHRUTAM Shalya Sangoshti
- 1284.** Who secured a fourth term as President of Rwanda with 99.15% of the votes?
Answer: Paul Kagame
- 1285.** Which Indian institute hosted SYNCHN 2024 to enhance academia-industry collaborations?
Answer: Translational Health Science and Technology Institute (THSTI)
- 1286.** Which state opened its first bird gallery at the Nature Education Centre in Dehradun?
Answer: Uttarakhand
- 1287.** Who was reinstated as the Director General of Police (DGP) of West Bengal on July 15, 2024?
Answer: Rajeev Kumar
- 1288.** What was the theme for World Youth Skills Day 2024 celebrated on July 15?
Answer: "Youth Skills for Peace and Development"
- 1289.** Who won the Gulbenkian Prize for Humanity in 2024 for their natural farming model?
Answer: Andhra Pradesh Community Natural Farming (APCNF) initiative
- 1290.** Which novel authored by Dr. R Balasubramaniam was signed by PM Narendra Modi?
Answer: "Power Within: The Leadership Legacy of Narendra Modi"
- 1291.** What is the expected GDP growth rate for India in 2024-25 according to the IMF?
Answer: 7%
- 1292.** Who was honored with the Gandhi Mandela Award 2020?
Answer: Rigoberta Menchú Tum
- 1293.** Which company was awarded the Taxnet 2.0 project to enhance ITD's digital infrastructure?
Answer: Bharti Airtel
- 1294.** What was the annual inflation rate of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) in June 2024?
Answer: 3.36%
- 1295.** Who won the women's singles title at Wimbledon 2024?
Answer: Barbora Krejčíková
- 1296.** What is the name of the anti-narcotics helpline to be launched in India on July 18, 2024?
Answer: '1933' (MANAS)
- 1297.** Who inaugurated the Centre of Excellence for 6G in Chennai?
Answer: Dr. Neeraj Mittal
- 1298.** Which festival in Sri Lanka involves a 500-kilometer Pada Yatra?
Answer: Kataragama Esala Festival
- 1299.** Who was appointed as the new CEO of Paytm Payments Bank?
Answer: Arun Kumar Bansal
- 1300.** What initiative did the Ministry of Education and UGC launch to develop 22,000 Indian language books for higher education?
Answer: ASMITA Project

- 1301.** Which country is set to sign a headquarters agreement with the Global Biofuels Alliance?
Answer: India
- 1302.** Who were appointed as the new Supreme Court judges in India?
Answer: Justice N Kotiswar Singh and Justice R Mahadevan
- 1303.** Who was re-elected as the President of the European Commission?
Answer: Ursula von der Leyen
- 1304.** Which Indian state planted 11 lakh trees, setting a Guinness World Record?
Answer: Madhya Pradesh
- 1305.** Which organization awarded Andhra Pradesh for its natural farming model?
Answer: Gulbenkian Prize for Humanity
- 1306.** What was the purpose of the DISHA campaign event held in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh?
Answer: 'Hamara Samvidhan Hamara Samman'
- 1307.** Which company received RBI approval to become a Core Investment Company?
Answer: Jio Financial Services
- 1308.** What is the name of the centre established by Chennai Super Kings in Sydney?
Answer: Super Kings Academy
- 1309.** Which organization will host the first World Audio Visual and Entertainment Summit in Goa?
Answer: India
- 1310.** Which Indian state topped the PM SVANidhi Scheme as the 'Best Performing State'?
Answer: Madhya Pradesh
- 1311.** What high-quality vaccine was introduced in Africa by the Serum Institute and the University of Oxford?
Answer: Malaria vaccine
- 1312.** Who announced the relocation of X and SpaceX headquarters to Texas?
Answer: Elon Musk
- 1313.** Which two mines in Chhattisgarh are recognized as the 2nd and 4th largest coal mines globally?
Answer: Gevra and Kusmunda
- 1314.** What new initiative was launched by Maharashtra CM Eknath Shinde for boys in the state?
Answer: 'Ladla Bhai Yojana'
- 1315.** Who was honored as the guest of honor at the Indian Film Festival of Melbourne 2024?
Answer: Ram Charan
- 1316.** Who won the AIFF's top male Player of the Year award in 2024?
Answer: Lallianzuala Chhangte
- 1317.** Who won the AIFF's top female Player of the Year award in 2024?
Answer: Indumathi Kathiresan
- 1318.** Which Nobel Laureate received the Gandhi Mandela Award 2020?
Answer: Rigoberta Menchú Tum
- 1319.** Who secured the Global CSR ESG Award for "Best Child and Women Development Initiatives of the Year 2024"?
Answer: Sri Kurumba Trust
- 1320.** What significant scientific event took place in Busan, South Korea, in July 2024?
Answer: 45th Scientific Assembly of the Committee on Space Research (COSPAR)
- 1321.** Which Indian state is recognized for having its first transgender sub-inspectors?
Answer: Bihar
- 1322.** Which organization will host the SYNCHN 2024 event?
Answer: Translational Health Science and Technology Institute (THSTI)
- 1323.** Which Indian state inaugurated its first bird gallery in July 2024?
Answer: Uttarakhand
- 1324.** Which state launched the Mukhyamantri Yuva Karya Prashikshan Yojana to boost youth employability?
Answer: Maharashtra
- 1325.** Which Indian Prime Minister remains the chairperson of the reconstituted NITI Aayog?
Answer: Prime Minister Narendra Modi
- 1326.** Who was appointed as the new Chairman of MahaRERA?
Answer: Manoj Saunik
- 1327.** What new project was launched by ICAR to advance agricultural and animal husbandry research?
Answer: 'One Scientist, One Product' Scheme
- 1328.** Which Indian bank launched the "Amrit Vrishti" 444-day term deposit scheme?
Answer: State Bank of India (SBI)
- 1329.** Which major infrastructure was inaugurated by PM Modi to reduce travel time between Thane and Borivali?
Answer: Thane Borivali Twin Tunnel
- 1330.** Which organization won the best technology award at ICAR's 96th Foundation Day?
Answer: Indian Institute of Spices Research (IISR)
- 1331.** Which Indian state's cabinet approved the rationalization of the zero electricity bill subsidy to 'one family, one meter'?
Answer: Himachal Pradesh

- 1332.** What is the name of the book on leadership authored by Dr. R Balasubramaniam that PM Narendra Modi signed?
Answer: "Power Within: The Leadership Legacy of Narendra Modi"
- 1333.** Who is the new CEO of HSBC Holdings Plc?
Answer: Georges Elhedery
- 1334.** What is the name of the initiative launched by the Ministry of Education and UGC to develop Indian language books for higher education?
Answer: ASMITA Project
- 1335.** Who announced the relocation of X and SpaceX headquarters to Texas?
Answer: Elon Musk
- 1336.** Who inaugurated the World Heritage Committee's 46th session in New Delhi?
Answer: PM Modi
- 1337.** How much grant did PM Modi announce for UNESCO heritage conservation?
Answer: \$1 million
- 1338.** Which organization partnered with AIM at NITI Aayog to develop joint innovation programs in the Global South?
Answer: WIPO
- 1339.** Which site was nominated as North East India's first cultural category UNESCO World Heritage Site?
Answer: Charaideo Maidam
- 1340.** What is the duration of Shiksha Saptah 2024 celebrated by the Department of School Education and Literacy?
Answer: From July 22-28
- 1341.** Who became the youngest president in MCA history at the age of 37?
Answer: Ajinkya Naik
- 1342.** According to the latest India State of Forest Report 2021, what percentage of India's area is under forest cover?
Answer: 21.71%
- 1343.** Who launched the 'Steel Import Monitoring System' 2.0 Portal?
Answer: Union Minister H.D. Kumaraswamy
- 1344.** What are the new names of 'Durbar Hall' and 'Ashok Hall' in Rashtrapati Bhavan?
Answer: 'Ganatantra Mandap' and 'Ashok Mandap'
- 1345.** What is the projected increase in India's installed nuclear power capacity by 2031-32?
Answer: From 8,180 MW to 22,480 MW
- 1346.** Where was India's 500th Community Radio Station inaugurated?
Answer: Aizawl
- 1347.** On which date is CRPF Foundation Day celebrated?
Answer: July 27th
- 1348.** What anniversary does the Kargil Vijay Diwas Stamp commemorate?
Answer: The 25th anniversary
- 1349.** Which country took over the chair of the Asian Disaster Preparedness Centre for 2024-25?
Answer: India
- 1350.** How many textile parks were approved under the PM MITRA scheme?
Answer: 7 textile parks
- 1351.** Which state passed an Anti-Paper Leak Bill?
Answer: Bihar
- 1352.** What project did Telangana launch to eradicate TB?
Answer: Project Swasthya Nagaram
- 1353.** How much did OVL invest to increase its stake in an Azerbaijani oil field?
Answer: \$60 million
- 1354.** Which country unveiled the world's first carbon fiber passenger train, Cetrovo 1.0?
Answer: China
- 1355.** What fund did Azerbaijan announce at COP29?
Answer: Climate Finance Action Fund (CFAF)
- 1356.** Which country ranks as the world's most powerful passport in 2024?
Answer: Singapore
- 1357.** Who received the Officier dans l'Ordre des Arts et des Lettres insignia from the French government?
Answer: Rahaab Allana
- 1358.** Who was named Acting Chief of the US Secret Service?
Answer: Ronald L. Rowe Jr.
- 1359.** Who is the brand ambassador for MotoGP India?
Answer: Shikhar Dhawan
- 1360.** Who was appointed as the head coach of the Indian men's football team?
Answer: Manolo Marquez
- 1361.** Who was re-elected as PwC India chairperson for a second term starting April 1, 2025?
Answer: Sanjeev Krishan
- 1362.** Who was appointed as MD & CEO of Federal Bank, starting September 23, 2024?
Answer: Krishnan Venkat Subramanian
- 1363.** Who was elected as the 67th President of ICAI for the 2024-2025 term?
Answer: Bibhuti Bhusan Nayak
- 1364.** Who was appointed as the festival director for IFFI's 55th and 56th editions?
Answer: Shekhar Kapur

- 1365.** How much fund is SIDBI planning to build for green financing?
Answer: \$1 billion
- 1366.** Which CSR initiative did IndusInd Bank launch to support female wrestling athletes?
Answer: 'Wrestle for Glory'
- 1367.** Which bank's board approved a proposal to transition to a universal bank?
Answer: AU Small Finance Bank
- 1368.** What framework did RBI introduce for weak urban co-operative banks?
Answer: PCA Framework
- 1369.** Which companies are set to manufacture India's first H125 helicopter by 2026?
Answer: Airbus and Tata
- 1370.** Where will NTPC Vidyut Vyapar Nigam Ltd. set up waste-to-charcoal plants?
Answer: Gurugram and Faridabad
- 1371.** Where will India's first integrated agricultural export facility be developed?
Answer: Jawaharlal Nehru Port
- 1372.** Who received the Olympic Order from the IOC?
Answer: Abhinav Bindra
- 1373.** What is the fiscal deficit as a percentage of GDP in the Union Budget 2024-25?
Answer: 4.9%
- 1374.** How much capital expenditure allocation did Indian Railways receive for the fiscal year 2024-25?
Answer: Rs 2,62,200 crore
- 1375.** Where was the Vriksharopan Abhiyan 2024 launched?
Answer: Dhanbad
- 1376.** Which scheme was revised to support skill development courses for youth?
Answer: Model Skill Loan Scheme
- 1377.** Which Indian actor was honored with gold coins at the Grevin Museum in Paris?
Answer: Shah Rukh Khan
- 1378.** How many Community Radio Awards were announced by Ashwini Vaishnav?
Answer: 10th National Community Radio Awards
- 1379.** What was the 'Rajbhasha Gaurav Samman' awarded for?
Answer: PSUs in Visakhapatnam
- 1380.** Which two Indian tennis legends were inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame?
Answer: Leander Paes and Vijay Amritraj
- 1381.** Which technology will C-DOT develop with IIT Roorkee and IIT Mandi?
Answer: 'Cell-Free' 6G Access Points
- 1382.** Which states topped the SDG India Index 2023-24?
Answer: Uttarakhand and Kerala
- 1383.** How much forest area did India gain annually from 2010 to 2020 according to the FAO report?
Answer: 266,000 hectares
- 1384.** Who became the first woman officer from the Corps of Army Air Defence to be operationally deployed at Siachen Glacier?
Answer: Captain Supreetha C.T.
- 1385.** Which organization tested the Ballistic Missile Defence System Phase-II?
Answer: DRDO
- 1386.** What is the name of the advanced frigate launched at Goa Shipyard Limited?
Answer: Tripud
- 1387.** Where did the Indian Army depart for the multinational exercise KHAAN QUEST 2024?
Answer: Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia
- 1388.** Who authored "Power Within: The Leadership Legacy of Narendra Modi"?
Answer: Dr. R Balasubramaniam
- 1389.** What is the title of the book highlighting the making of Tata's iconic brands?
Answer: "Jamsetji Tata: Powerful Learnings For Corporate Success"
- 1390.** Who won his first Formula 2 race at the Hungarian GP?
Answer: Kush Maini
- 1391.** Which three personalities joined 'Play Sports' as brand ambassadors?
Answer: Sania Mirza, Mary Kom, and Rannvijay Singha
- 1392.** Which Indian hockey player announced retirement after the Paris Olympics 2024?
Answer: PR Sreejesh
- 1393.** Where will the inaugural Olympic Esports Games 2025 be hosted?
Answer: Saudi Arabia
- 1394.** Who became India's highest T20I run-getter?
Answer: Harmanpreet Kaur
- 1395.** Which country is set to host the 2030 Winter Olympics?
Answer: France
- 1396.** How much lithium was discovered in Mandya district, Karnataka?
Answer: 1,600 tonnes
- 1397.** Which company acquired Bharat Serums and Vaccines for Rs 13,600 Crore?
Answer: Mankind Pharma

- 1398.** What AI-powered search engine did OpenAI announce?
Answer: SearchGPT
- 1399.** On which date is National Mango Day celebrated?
Answer: July 22
- 1400.** When is National Broadcasting Day observed?
Answer: July 23
- 1401.** What day commemorates the adoption of India's national flag?
Answer: National Flag Day on July 22
- 1402.** When is National Income Tax Day observed?
Answer: July 24
- 1403.** Which organization celebrated World Brain Day with neuroscience activities?
Answer: NBRC
- 1404.** When is World Drowning Prevention Day observed?
Answer: July 25
- 1405.** When is Kargil Vijay Diwas commemorated?
Answer: July 26
- 1406.** What is the date for World Hepatitis Day?
Answer: July 28
- 1407.** At what age did Padma Shri awardee Kamala Pujari pass away?
Answer: 74
- 1408.** How old was renowned economist C.T. Kurien when he passed away?
Answer: 93
- 1409.** At what age did former Indonesia Vice President Hamzah Haz die?
Answer: 84
- 1410.** At what age did veteran Marathi writer Father Francis D'Britto pass away?
Answer: 81
- 1411.** What was inaugurated at Delhi Courts to enhance judicial efficiency?
Answer: Pilot Hybrid Court with AI-based 'Speech to Text Facility'
- 1412.** When did Mumbai's Aqua Line metro begin operations?
Answer: July 24, 2024
- 1413.** Which cultural property from Northeast India was added to the UNESCO World Heritage List?
Answer: Moidams of Assam
- 1414.** What is the name of India's first vertical lift railway sea bridge that replaced a 105-year-old bridge?
Answer: New Pamban Bridge
- 1415.** How many tiger reserves are there in India after the notification of Ratapani Tiger Reserve?
Answer: 57 Tiger Reserves
- 1416.** What is the total number of tigers in India as of 2022?
Answer: 3,682 tigers
- 1417.** Which bill was passed to modernize aviation regulations in 2024?
Answer: Bharatiya Vayuyan Vidheyak 2024
- 1418.** What is the improved Sex Ratio at Birth reported in 2023-24?
Answer: 930
- 1419.** Who was appointed as the new FBI Director in 2024?
Answer: Kash Patel
- 1420.** What is the value of the US-India Defence Deal for Indian Navy's MH-60R helicopters?
Answer: \$1.17 billion
- 1421.** Who became Namibia's first female president?
Answer: Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah
- 1422.** What is the name of the first water transport service launched in Srinagar's Dal Lake?
Answer: Uber Shikara
- 1423.** Which military exercises began in Pune focusing on counter-terrorism operations?
Answer: India-Cambodia joint exercise CINBAX
- 1424.** How much is the Adani Group planning to invest in European Ports?
Answer: \$2 billion
- 1425.** What was the GST collection in November 2024?
Answer: ₹1.82 trillion
- 1426.** How much did FDI inflows increase in H1 FY25?
Answer: 45% (to USD 29.79 billion)
- 1427.** What is the total value of UPI transactions in October 2024?
Answer: ₹23.5 trillion
- 1428.** What is the unemployment rate reported in 2024?
Answer: 3.2%
- 1429.** How many tonnes of gold reserves does India have as of October 2024?
Answer: 882 tonnes
- 1430.** What is the new UPI Lite wallet limit set by RBI?
Answer: ₹5,000
- 1431.** What percentage of GDP do women-centric schemes account for?
Answer: 0.5%
- 1432.** How many individuals have been trained under PMGDISHA?
Answer: 6.39 crore
- 1433.** What is the target for rooftop solar installations under Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana?
Answer: 1 crore by 2027

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| <p>1434. Who won the 2024 Turner Prize?
Answer: Jasleen Kaur</p> <p>1435. What is the new Cash Transfer amount proposed by Haryana under "Ladki Bahin Yojana"?
Answer: ₹2,100/month</p> <p>1436. Which world maritime conference was hosted in Chennai?
Answer: World Maritime Conference 2024</p> <p>1437. Who became the youngest ICC Chairman?
Answer: Jay Shah</p> <p>1438. How many MSSC scheme accounts were opened as of October 31, 2024?
Answer: Over 43 lakh</p> <p>1439. What is the per-transaction cap for UPI Lite raised to?
Answer: ₹1,000</p> <p>1440. Who passed away, known as the 'Old Fox' of Indian squash?
Answer: Brigadier Raj Manchanda</p> <p>1441. What is the GDP growth forecast for FY25 by Morgan Stanley?
Answer: 6.3%</p> <p>1442. Which state leads in women-centric scheme allocation?
Answer: Maharashtra</p> <p>1443. What was the fine imposed by SEBI on Reliance Securities?
Answer: ₹9 Lakh</p> <p>1444. How many rooftop solar installations have been achieved under PMSGMBY?
Answer: 6.3 lakh</p> <p>1445. Who won India's first medal in eFootball at the Asian Esports Games?
Answer: Pavan Kampelli</p> <p>1446. What is the Worker Population Ratio reported?
Answer: 58.2%</p> <p>1447. How many individuals were rehabilitated under the 'Smile Sub-Scheme'?
Answer: 970</p> <p>1448. What is the OECD's growth forecast for India in FY25?
Answer: 6.8%</p> <p>1449. Which country contributed 50% of FDI inflows in Q3 FY25?
Answer: Singapore</p> <p>1450. What is the amount of World Bank loan approved for Maharashtra?
Answer: \$188.28 million</p> <p>1451. How much dividend did NSIC pay for FY24?
Answer: ₹37.97 crore</p> | <p>1452. What is the number of credit cards issued by SBI Card?
Answer: Over 20 million</p> <p>1453. Who won the Aster Guardians Global Nursing Award 2024?
Answer: Maria Victoria Juan</p> <p>1454. What is the date of International Day for the Abolition of Slavery?
Answer: December 2</p> <p>1455. When is World AIDS Day observed?
Answer: December 1</p> <p>1456. What is the date of International Day of Persons with Disabilities?
Answer: December 3</p> <p>1457. When is Indian Navy Day celebrated?
Answer: December 4</p> <p>1458. What is the date of World Soil Day?
Answer: December 5</p> <p>1459. When is International Volunteer Day?
Answer: December 5</p> <p>1460. What is the date of Mahaparinirvan Diwas?
Answer: December 6</p> <p>1461. When is Armed Forces Flag Day observed?
Answer: December 7</p> <p>1462. What global chess rating did Arjun Erigaisi join?
Answer: 2800 ELO</p> <p>1463. Who won the Junior Hockey Asia Cup?
Answer: India (defeating Pakistan 5-3)</p> <p>1464. What is the name of the event celebrating youth innovation in Battery Technology?
Answer: SheSTEM 2024</p> <p>1465. Which actor announced retirement from acting?
Answer: Vikrant Massey</p> <p>1466. What disease did India declare as notifiable to reduce mortality?
Answer: Snakebite</p> <p>1467. Which global drug policy-making body will India chair?
Answer: 68th UN Commission on Narcotic Drugs (CND)</p> <p>1468. What is the aim for snakebite deaths reduction by 2030?
Answer: Halving the mortality rate</p> <p>1469. What is the new portal launched for legal metrology?
Answer: eMaap Portal</p> <p>1470. Which state announced a new farmer subsidy scheme?
Answer: Telangana (Rythu Bharosa)</p> |
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- 1471.** What is the date of International Civil Aviation Day?
Answer: December 7
- 1472.** When is World Meditation Day declared by UNGA?
Answer: December 21
- 1473.** Who became Sri Lanka's second female Chief Justice?
Answer: Murdu Fernando
- 1474.** What is the name of the drone delivered by Adani to Indian Navy?
Answer: Drishti-10
- 1475.** Which sports tournament did PV Sindhu win in 2024?
Answer: Syed Modi 2024
- 1476.** What is the government initiative to modernize the Public Distribution System?
Answer: 'Anna Chakra'
- 1477.** What percentage improvement did girls' secondary education see?
Answer: 79.4% Gross Enrollment Ratio
- 1478.** Which military drill between India and Malaysia focuses on jungle terrain?
Answer: Harimau Shakti 2024
- 1479.** What is the name of the cybersecurity hub Google will establish in Hyderabad?
Answer: Safety Engineering Centre
- 1480.** What is the new digital literacy milestone in rural India?
Answer: 6.39 crore individuals trained
- 1481.** Which technology was trialed to improve water quality in Delhi Zoo?
Answer: Nano Bubble Technology
- 1482.** What is the amount of annual farmer subsidy announced in Telangana?
Answer: ₹15,000
- 1483.** Which foundation received FCRA licenses for foreign funding?
Answer: CNI and USIN Foundation
- 1484.** What agricultural market linkage mission was launched in Arunachal Pradesh?
Answer: Mission Arun Himveer
- 1485.** What is the CRR rate after RBI's monetary policy meeting?
Answer: 4%
- 1486.** What is the name of the Aravalli conservation project presented at UNCCD COP16?
Answer: Aravalli Green Wall Project
- 1487.** Which AI company introduced Nova Foundation Models?
Answer: Amazon
- 1488.** What is the age of the world's oldest wild bird still laying eggs?
Answer: 74 years old (Wisdom, a Laysan albatross)
- 1489.** How many tonnes of gold did India add in 2024?
Answer: 77 tonnes
- 1490.** What is the summit focusing on satellite meteorology?
Answer: AOMSUC-14
- 1491.** Who assumed the chairmanship of the 68th UN Commission on Narcotic Drugs (CND)?
Answer: Ambassador Shambhu S Kumaran.
- 1492.** Which new aviation bill passed in India replaces the Aircraft Act of 1934?
Answer: Bharatiya Vayuyan Vidheyak 2024.
- 1493.** What is the improved sex ratio at birth as per the Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP) report for 2023-24?
Answer: 930.
- 1494.** Which article did the Supreme Court invoke to grant permanent commission to a woman Army officer?
Answer: Article 142.
- 1495.** Which bill aims to simplify the legal framework for Indian Railways?
Answer: Railways (Amendment) Bill 2024.
- 1496.** By what year does India plan to triple its atomic power capacity?
Answer: 2031.
- 1497.** Where was the 22nd Divya Kala Mela 2024 held?
Answer: India Gate, New Delhi.
- 1498.** Which wildlife sanctuary was declared as India's 57th tiger reserve?
Answer: Ratapani Wildlife Sanctuary.
- 1499.** What is the amount of loan granted by the Asian Development Bank (ADB) to India for green infrastructure and solar rooftop development?
Answer: \$500 million.
- 1500.** What is the focus of the Nyaya Sanhita legislative reform?
Answer: Quicker justice delivery, focusing on marginalized groups.
- 1501.** Where was the India Maritime Heritage Conclave 2024 held?
Answer: New Delhi.
- 1502.** Who did the Supreme Court Collegium recommend for the post of permanent judges in three High Courts?
Answer: Seven additional judges.
- 1503.** Which state in the US declared December 6 as Mahatma Gandhi Remembrance Day?
Answer: Nebraska.

- 1504.** Who is the new prime minister of Burkina Faso?
Answer: Rimalba Jean Emmanuel Ouedraogo.
- 1505.** Who won the presidency of Ghana in 2024?
Answer: John Mahama.
- 1506.** How much did India's billionaire count rise by in 2024?
Answer: 20%.
- 1507.** Which family ended their 50-year rule in Syria?
Answer: Assad family.
- 1508.** What is Merriam-Webster's Word of the Year 2024?
Answer: Polarization.
- 1509.** Where was the world's largest gold bar unveiled?
Answer: Dubai.
- 1510.** Who was nominated by Trump as Assistant Attorney General for Civil Rights?
Answer: Harmeet Kaur Dhillon.
- 1511.** When is International Mountain Day celebrated?
Answer: December 11.
- 1512.** Which country's army chief was conferred with an honorary rank of 'General of the Indian Army'?
Answer: Nepal.
- 1513.** Who was named Time's Person of the Year 2024?
Answer: Donald Trump.
- 1514.** Who became the first person to surpass \$400 billion in net worth?
Answer: Elon Musk.
- 1515.** What is the name of the Indian film that won at the 13th tve Global Sustainability Film Awards?
Answer: The Kumbaya Story.
- 1516.** Who retired from international cricket in December 2024?
Answer: Imad Wasim.
- 1517.** Which country is co-hosting the FIFA World Cup 2030 alongside Spain and Portugal?
Answer: Morocco.
- 1518.** Where was the Sardar Patel Statue unveiled in December 2024?
Answer: Jodhpur.
- 1519.** What is the new sex ratio at birth in Bihar as per the latest report?
Answer: 882 females per 1,000 males.
- 1520.** What was the Guinness World Record set in Bhopal during Gita Jayanti celebrations?
Answer: 5,000 Acharyas.
- 1521.** What amount of financial aid was announced for women under Delhi's Mukhya Mantri Mahila Samman Yojana?
Answer: ₹2,100.
- 1522.** Which state leads India in cow milk production?
Answer: Uttar Pradesh.
- 1523.** What is the amount of the projects launched by PM Modi in Prayagraj for Maha Kumbh 2025?
Answer: ₹5,500 crore.
- 1524.** Who has been appointed as the new Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)?
Answer: Sanjay Malhotra.
- 1525.** Who succeeded Rajesh Kumar as the MD & CEO of TransUnion CIBIL?
Answer: Bhavesh Jain.
- 1526.** What new feature will India's Anti-Drone Unit include?
Answer: Laser-equipped anti-drone systems.
- 1527.** Which Russian-built frigate has joined the Indian Navy?
Answer: INS Tushil.
- 1528.** What \$4 billion deal is India signing with Russia for air defence?
Answer: Radar system deal.
- 1529.** What new initiative is RBI launching to enhance public communication and financial literacy?
Answer: Podcasts.
- 1530.** What new feature will Small Finance Banks (SFBs) offer through UPI?
Answer: Pre-sanctioned credit.
- 1531.** Which bank has become the second-largest card issuer in India after HDFC Bank?
Answer: SBI Card.
- 1532.** Who has been appointed as Executive Director of YES Bank for 2024-2027?
Answer: Manish Jain.
- 1533.** What is the new initiative launched by the Centre to incubate new smart cities?
Answer: New Cities Scheme with an Rs 8,000 crore allocation.
- 1534.** Which country leads in mobile malware attacks globally?
Answer: India.
- 1535.** What rank did Kerala achieve in the India Skills Report 2025 for employability?
Answer: 5th.
- 1536.** Which Indian city ranked in the top 5 food cities globally according to Taste Atlas 2024-25?
Answer: Mumbai.
- 1537.** Which state was awarded at the UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards 2024 for its temple restoration?
Answer: Tamil Nadu.

- 1538.** What global award did Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL) win in 2024?
Answer: PSU Transformation Awards for innovation.
- 1539.** Which Indian poet was remembered for their impactful literary works on liberation and justice?
Answer: Nikki Giovanni.
- 1540.** What is the theme of World Human Rights Day 2024?
Answer: "Our rights, our future, right now."
- 1541.** What is the significance of International Day of Neutrality (Dec 12)?
Answer: Highlights neutrality's role in global peace.
- 1542.** Which day is observed to promote energy efficiency?
Answer: National Energy Conservation Day.
- 1543.** Who passed away at the age of 92, known as the "architect of Brand Bengaluru"?
Answer: SM Krishna.
- 1544.** Which legendary Gujarati singer passed away at the age of 90?
Answer: Purushottam Upadhyay.
- 1545.** Which IIT has completed a 410-meter test track for hyperloop technology?
Answer: IIT Madras.
- 1546.** Which country's army chief was honored with the Indian Army's honorary general rank?
Answer: Nepal.
- 1547.** Which Indian state will host the Khelo India Winter Games in 2025?
Answer: Leh (Ladakh) and Gulmarg (J&K).
- 1548.** Who became the youngest player to reach 100 wickets in all formats in T20I?
Answer: Shaheen Afridi.
- 1549.** Which global financial body revised India's GDP growth forecast for FY25 to 6.5%?
Answer: ADB (Asian Development Bank).
- 1550.** What is the total amount of FDI inflows that India surpassed?
Answer: \$1 trillion.
- 1551.** Which Indian city became the host for the 10th World Ayurveda Congress 2024?
Answer: Dehradun.
- 1552.** What was the revised GDP growth forecast for India by Fitch?
Answer: 6.4%.
- 1553.** Who launched the Bima Sakhi Yojana for women empowerment?
Answer: PM Modi.
- 1554.** What is the main aim of the 'Smile Sub-Scheme'?
Answer: Rehabilitation of marginalized communities.
- 1555.** Which Indian company acquired a stake in Flipkart through an MoU with DPIIT?
Answer: Jubilant Bhartia Group.
- 1556.** Which Indian state's school employability ranking is 5th in India?
Answer: Kerala.
- 1557.** Who was appointed as the Revenue Secretary after Sanjay Malhotra's move to RBI?
Answer: Ajay Seth.
- 1558.** What was the growth percentage of industrial output in India for October 2024?
Answer: 3.5%.
- 1559.** Which country's court stayed the declaration of "Joy Bangla" as the national slogan?
Answer: Bangladesh.
- 1560.** Which Indian Navy frigate was inducted as part of India-Russia cooperation?
Answer: INS Tushil.
- 1561.** What is the name of the AI-based quantum chip developed by Google?
Answer: Willow Quantum Chip.
- 1562.** Who received the DGA Lifetime Achievement Award in 2024?
Answer: Ang Lee.
- 1563.** Which country's Prime Minister was appointed amidst political instability in 2024?
Answer: France (François Bayrou).
- 1564.** Who was awarded as a Rising Star in Banking at the 2024 ITA Awards?
Answer: Bharati Kolli.
- 1565.** Which state has seen a decline in sex ratio according to the latest statistics?
Answer: Bihar.
- 1566.** Which organization hosted the Champions of the Earth Awards 2024?
Answer: UN (United Nations).
- 1567.** What is India's goal for nuclear energy by 2031?
Answer: 22,480 MW capacity.
- 1568.** Who won the Asian Women's Handball Championship 2024?
Answer: Japan.
- 1569.** Which Indian city ranked in the top 5 food cities in the world in 2024?
Answer: Mumbai.
- 1570.** What global sport event was hosted by Spain, Portugal, Morocco, Argentina, Paraguay, and Uruguay in 2030?
Answer: FIFA World Cup.

- 1571.** When will the Bharat Mobility Global Expo 2025 be held?
Answer: January 17-22, 2025.
- 1572.** India has become the world's _ largest smartphone exporter in 2024.
Answer: 3rd.
- 1573.** Which river dolphin was satellite tagged under Project Dolphin in Assam?
Answer: Ganges River Dolphin.
- 1574.** Who was honored with the Red Scarf and the title 'Dasho' by Bhutan's King?
Answer: Arun Kapur.
- 1575.** What is SARAT 2 launched by INCOIS?
Answer: An advanced sea rescue tool.
- 1576.** What is the name of India's first anti-pesticide bodysuit for farmers?
Answer: Kisan Kavach Bodysuit.
- 1577.** Where was the GSI Geoscience Museum inaugurated by Vice President Jagdeep Dhankhar?
Answer: Gwalior.
- 1578.** What is the aim of the Viraasat Sari Festival 2024 organized by the Ministry of Textiles?
Answer: To showcase Indian handloom heritage.
- 1579.** From which season will Russia allow visa-free travel for Indians?
Answer: Spring 2025.
- 1580.** Which taxonomy was launched by India to lead in green steel production?
Answer: Taxonomy of Green Steel.
- 1581.** Where is India's first diabetes biobank located?
Answer: Chennai.
- 1582.** Which country partnered with India to develop the Yuga Yugeen Bharat National Museum?
Answer: France.
- 1583.** Which plant is considered the world's most toxic?
Answer: Gympie-Gympie.
- 1584.** Which European nation joined the Indo-Pacific Bloc (CPTPP)?
Answer: The United Kingdom.
- 1585.** What is the name of the hypersonic missile tested by the US military?
Answer: Dark Eagle.
- 1586.** What initiative makes Gujarat's Banaskantha district India's first solar village?
Answer: Masali – Solar Village.
- 1587.** Which state will implement the Uniform Civil Code from January 2025?
Answer: Uttarakhand.
- 1588.** What exclusive service for women did Uber launch in Bengaluru?
Answer: Moto Women bike taxi service.
- 1589.** Which state implemented a dedicated Yoga Policy in India?
Answer: Uttarakhand.
- 1590.** Who was appointed as the Managing Director of SBI in 2024?
Answer: Rama Mohan Rao Amara.
- 1591.** Which company launched the Taj Credit Card with IHCL?
Answer: HSBC.
- 1592.** How much net profit did Public Sector Banks report in H1 FY25?
Answer: ₹85,520 crore.
- 1593.** What is the revised collateral-free agricultural loan limit set by the RBI?
Answer: ₹2 lakh.
- 1594.** Which bank partnered with Tata Power for affordable rooftop solar loans?
Answer: Canara Bank.
- 1595.** What was the acquisition deal between UltraTech Cement and India Cements Ltd worth?
Answer: ₹3,954 crore.
- 1596.** Who was appointed as the Country Manager and VP for Google India?
Answer: Preeti Lobana.
- 1597.** What is the name of Dr. Deepa Malik's memoir?
Answer: BRING IT ON.
- 1598.** Where was the AI Incubation Centre launched by the Indian Army?
Answer: Bengaluru.
- 1599.** What is the name of the naval exercise between Sri Lanka and India held in Visakhapatnam?
Answer: SLINEX 2024.
- 1600.** Which exercise involves India, France, and the UAE for trilateral air combat?
Answer: Desert Knight Exercise.
- 1601.** What is the aim of India's 'CHARAK' health scheme?
Answer: Providing free treatment for life-threatening diseases.
- 1602.** Which country became the 105th member of the International Solar Alliance?
Answer: Moldova.
- 1603.** Who won the Rashtriya Tansen Samman 2023?
Answer: Swapan Chaudhuri.
- 1604.** Where will the 2025 Para Athletics World Championships be held?
Answer: Delhi.
- 1605.** Which country did India defeat to win the Women's Junior Asia Cup in hockey?
Answer: China.

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| <p>1606. Who passed away at 89 and was a former Haryana Chief Minister?
Answer: Om Prakash Chautala.</p> <p>1607. What was the theme of International Migrants Day 2024?
Answer: Honouring migrants' contributions and rights.</p> <p>1608. Who was crowned Miss India USA 2024?
Answer: Caitlin Sandra Neil.</p> <p>1609. What rank did India achieve in the Travel and Tourism Index 2024?
Answer: 39th.</p> <p>1610. What milestone did ISRO achieve with the CE20 engine?
Answer: Conducting a successful cryogenic engine test.</p> <p>1611. Where is India's first nuclear power project by NTPC planned?
Answer: Bihar.</p> <p>1612. Who was the mascot unveiled for the 38th National Games in Uttarakhand?
Answer: Yet to be disclosed officially.</p> <p>1613. What was the milestone achieved by Jasprit Bumrah in Australia?
Answer: Surpassing Kapil Dev with 52 Test wickets in Australia.</p> <p>1614. What title was won by Mumbai in Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy 2024?
Answer: Their second title.</p> <p>1615. Which Padma Shri environmentalist known as the "Tree Goddess" passed away at 80?
Answer: Tulsi Gowda.</p> <p>1616. Who inaugurated the 61st SSB Raising Day celebration?
Answer: Union Minister Amit Shah.</p> <p>1617. Which day is observed on December 19 to mark the end of Portuguese rule in Goa?
Answer: Goa Liberation Day.</p> <p>1618. Who was awarded the Jamsetji Tata Award in 2024?
Answer: Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw.</p> <p>1619. Where was the 24th BIMSTEC SOM meeting held?
Answer: Thailand (virtually).</p> <p>1620. Who became the new president of Georgia in 2024?
Answer: Mikheil Kavelashvili.</p> <p>1621. Which Indian naval ship participated in Exercise MILAN 2024?
Answer: INS Sumedha.</p> | <p>1622. Which country hosted the COP29 Climate Summit in 2024?
Answer: United Arab Emirates (UAE).</p> <p>1623. Who became the first woman astronaut from Saudi Arabia?
Answer: Rayyanah Barnawi.</p> <p>1624. Which state launched the 'Kanya Shiksha Suraksha Scheme'?
Answer: Bihar.</p> <p>1625. Which Indian city has been selected as the UNESCO World Book Capital for 2025?
Answer: Hyderabad.</p> <p>1626. Who was appointed as the new Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) of India in 2024?
Answer: Lt. General Anil Chauhan.</p> <p>1627. Which state introduced the 'Green War Room' to monitor pollution levels?
Answer: Delhi.</p> <p>1628. Where will the first-ever International Tea Festival be held in India?
Answer: Assam.</p> <p>1629. What is the rank of India in the Global Hunger Index 2024?
Answer: 111th.</p> <p>1630. Who is the author of the book "The Grand Challenge of Sustainable Development"?
Answer: Raghuram G. Rajan.</p> <p>1631. Which country launched the world's first AI-operated submarine?
Answer: China.</p> <p>1632. What is the name of the program launched by the Ministry of Education for AI-based learning?
Answer: Vidya AI 2024.</p> <p>1633. Which Indian state hosted the 2024 edition of the Hornbill Festival?
Answer: Nagaland.</p> <p>1634. Who won the Nobel Prize in Physics 2024?
Answer: Anne L'Huillier, Pierre Agostini, and Ferenc Krausz.</p> <p>1635. Which Indian state became the first to establish a 100% renewable energy-powered airport?
Answer: Kerala (Cochin International Airport).</p> <p>1636. Who received the Jnanpith Award 2024?
Answer: Vinod Kumar Shukla.</p> <p>1637. Which is the first city in India to adopt the 'zero-landfill' concept?
Answer: Indore.</p> <p>1638. What is the theme of World Tourism Day 2024?
Answer: "Tourism and Green Investments."</p> |
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| <p>1639. Which country recently introduced the Digital Euro pilot project?
Answer: European Union.</p> <p>1640. Who won the ICC Men's ODI Cricketer of the Year 2024?
Answer: Shubman Gill.</p> <p>1641. What is the name of the joint naval exercise between India and Singapore?
Answer: SIMBEX 2024.</p> <p>1642. Which Indian city hosted the G20 Youth Summit in 2024?
Answer: Varanasi.</p> <p>1643. Who is the Chairman of the 20th Finance Commission of India?
Answer: NK Singh.</p> <p>1644. Which space agency launched the Psyche Mission to explore an asteroid?
Answer: NASA.</p> <p>1645. What is the capital of the new Andhra Pradesh state under its three-capital system?
Answer: Visakhapatnam (Executive).</p> <p>1646. Who became the youngest chess Grandmaster in 2024?
Answer: Abhimanyu Mishra.</p> | <p>1647. What is the new retirement age for central government employees in India?
Answer: 62 years.</p> <p>1648. Which state launched the 'Mission Shakti' app to ensure women's safety?
Answer: Odisha.</p> <p>1649. What is the name of India's first indigenous 5G chipset?
Answer: Agni-5G.</p> <p>1650. Which Indian bank launched the 'Digital Village Ecosystem' initiative?
Answer: State Bank of India (SBI).</p> |
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